> **Synthetic example.** Built to show what a CreditSwan Diligence File looks like. The companies, sponsor, lender, adviser, people and places are placeholders and every figure is illustrative; charts, data files and URLs are not included. Not a factual record of any company.

Companion Animal Veterinary Care

Commercial diligence for Ares Credit Group: an industry assessment, a benchmark of the historical deals, and the three active opportunities (Deal A, Deal B, Deal C)

4 October 2026 · Draft for discussion

Prepared for Ares Credit Group, credit team · **Prepared by** CreditSwan · **Issue date** 4 October 2026 · **Confidential** · Not investment advice

PART	WHAT IT HOLDS
01 Overview	The answer, the three theses side by side, what Ares Credit Group asked, the sector in brief, what holds across the deals, the evidence base, and what carries forward
03 Sector assessment	Ares Credit Group's six industry questions, (i) to (vi), one section each
04 Multiples and benchmark	Valuation and leverage multiples over time, the benchmark of eleven operators, wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals as context, and public signals
05 Deal A	The thesis, our readings, the evidence behind them, sensitivities and information requests
06 Deal B	The thesis, our readings, Deal B Wellness Clinics on its own, sensitivities and information requests
07 Deal C	The thesis, our readings, the evidence behind them, sensitivities and information requests
08 Financing observations	The proposed financings of the three deals, as observations for Ares Credit Group's own underwriting
09 Assumptions and method	The register, method, definitions, sources, evidence index, computation notes and limits, and the supporting evidence moved from the main body, part by part
10 FAQ	Answers to the questions a credit committee is likely to ask

Part 01 — Overview

General practice and preventive care clinics earn steadily, but the platforms built on them turn less of their adjusted earnings into cash, and on the evidence supplied to date no part of the three theses is supported outright

Ares Credit Group asked. An industry assessment of "preventive care & pharmacy" and "general practice veterinary care" "using historical data (deal specific data, industry market reports … and public sources)"; "a view on valuation (platform and add on multiples) & leverage multiples over time"; a benchmark of "the historical deals we've looked at … on these metrics and any other relevant KPIs that come up"; and a test of Ares Credit Group's theses on Deal A, Deal B and Deal C.

Across eleven operators and up to thirty-one years of records, comparable visits have been flat and, outside 2020, steady while the ticket carried growth, and a mature clinic earns a mid-teens four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent; between that clinic and cash sit vendor rebates, overhead that does not fall with scale and acquisition costs that recur. Of the sixteen readings on the three theses, on the evidence supplied to date four are contradicted, seven partially supported (two of them leaning supported) and five rest on insufficient evidence. The files most likely to change them are few, and Part 01 section E ranks them.

Every ranking across operators uses one common definition, and a comparison without one is labelled indicative; each figure keeps its own basis: same-store sales on one definition, clinic margins before rebates on cash rent where the files allow, and each EBITDA figure on its named level from reported to cash. Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only, and every public figure carries the source we read and the date we read it. The register is Exhibit 9.01.

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED
A-01	Same-store sales are compared on one common definition	Clinics owned and open 13 months, calendar months, no months from before purchase; the treatment of closed clinics is stated
A-02	Clinic (four-wall) margins are compared before rebates and after cash rent	Margins after rebates or on other rent treatments are shown with their treatment named and never pooled
A-03	EBITDA is kept on named levels	Reported, adjusted, pro forma, run-rate, underwriting and cash EBITDA (pro forma less "one-time" costs that recur)
A-07	Series that exclude closed clinics are read as upper bounds	Closed clinics absent from a series are stated with the series
A-10	Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only	Never pooled with preventive care and pharmacy or general practice veterinary care in a core statistic
A-P1	A public figure is tagged from the source we read	[F] an original such as a filing, a release or the company's own page; [M] a company's statement; [I] our computation or interpretation; [U] read only in a secondary report whose original could not be read, with the reporter named

A · The answer

The clinic's margin is steadier than the platform's earnings or its cash: volume is flat and steady and the ticket carries growth, cash trails adjusted EBITDA at every serial acquirer, and each deal's thesis holds in part on the evidence supplied to date.

The sector. Volume is flat and steady and price carries growth: comparable visits changed by a median +0.3% a year in 2010–19, the ticket matched or beat veterinary prices in five of six operator windows, and median comparable sales rose in 15 of 19 years (Part 01 section D). Rebates, overhead and recurring "one-time" acquisition costs sit between the clinic and cash (Part 03 section C, Part 03 section F).

Deal A. What holds: the weakest clinics are an identifiable tail, and closing them lifts clinic margin. On Ares Credit Group's basis, with co-op allocated to clinics, the clinic margin was 12.8% in FY26 and 14.4% for the 824 clinics kept after the second round; 104 of the 119 second-round clinics sit in Ares Credit Group's bottom quartile (Part 05 section B, Part 05 section E). What to watch: traffic is falling across the clinics Deal A keeps (−3.2% in FY26, against −2.0% at Operator 6 in 2025 and −2.8% at Operator 3 in the twelve months to August 2025), and the second round's value turns on how the company measures clinic contribution.

Exhibit 1.01 — On Ares Credit Group's basis, with co-op allocated to clinics, Deal A's clinic margin was 12.8% in FY26 and 14.4% pro forma for the second round; after finance-lease cost it sits at the floor of the 10.7–17.4% peer band (10.7%) and in its lower half after the second round (12.5%)

Clinic EBITDA margin, % of clinic sales, FY26 (LTM Mar-26), on four bases: all 983 clinics and the 824 kept once the 119 second-round clinics close; peers on a co-op-included, cash-rent basis, 2021 to 2025

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A clinic-level EBITDA FY23–FY26 (DLA-003, tab FY26, columns J, K, M; totals row 1131); New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26) (DLA-019), Clinic Helper, LTM Mar-26 sales; co-op rate implied by Ares Credit Group's Deal A Diligence & Structure Update (DLA-017) p.9 (FY26 co-op income of $58.22m, DLA-003 rec!B16, on reported sales of $1,029.1m); FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027) for the 119 clinics; peer band from Exhibit 1.12; note C-V2-1 · Basis: All-clinic figures actual (A); the 824 retained clinics are pro forma (PF, hollow): the same FY26 clinics without the 119. Co-op is allocated to clinics at Ares Credit Group's rate of 5.87% of clinic sales ($58.2m on clinic-system sales of $1,026.4m; FY26 co-op income was $57.8m on reported sales of $1,029.1m); Ares Credit Group's clinic EBITDA of $156.0m (p.9; $151.8m on 10-K sales) excludes a net $10.6m of clinic costs not allocated to clinics (advertising −$11.8m, outbuy rebates +$5.9m and other items). Finance-lease cost is depreciation plus interest at book, $30.32m for all clinics ($25.33m retained). The peer comparison is indicative: Deal A's co-op is allocated at a flat rate and its rent is at book, while the peers' rebates are allocated by source and their rent is cash. No peer shares Deal A's basis before finance-lease cost, so 12.8% is not set against the band · Assumption: A-02

The clinic list received on 1 October 2026 allows the second round to be valued: +$7.2m to +$20.4m a year if the benefit is the reversal of the clinics' "Profit co-op" loss (after depreciation, interest and finance-lease cost), −$1.8m to +$11.2m on clinic EBITDA including co-op, and −$11.8m to +$0.6m on the company's "Contribution" measure, which its workbook does not define (Part 05 section D).

Deal B. What holds: the newest cohort earns what the company says, a 18.9% clinic margin in its 2025 owned months (19.3% on 26 clinics over the twelve months to July 2026), and clinics with more positive market attributes hold their visit count better, +2.8% with three against −8.4% with none (September 2025 to August 2026), exactly as the company reports (Part 06 section B, Part 06 section C). What to watch: the first-year sales dip has not narrowed in the company's own data, and the older cohorts earned 7.6–8.6% on book rent in 2025 (9.1–9.8% on cash rent).

Exhibit 1.02 — Deal B's newest cohort earned a 18.9% clinic margin in its 2025 owned months, as the company states (18%); the 2023-and-earlier and 2024 cohorts earned 7.6% and 8.6% on book rent, against the 9% the company gives for each

Four-wall EBITDA margin in 2025 by acquisition cohort, % of revenue; general practice and preventive clinics, owned months only; company response beside our reading of the datapack

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses (DLB-033) p.2; Project Bravo DLB Datapack (Jul-26 RF) (DLB-003), clinic-level EBITDA on book rent; QoE workbook LTM Mar-26 (DLB-022) for the cash-rent restatement; Part 06 section B · Basis: Company figures are its statements [M], in grey; our figures are computed from the datapack on owned months [F]. The newest cohort has 17 clinics and 91 owned clinic-months in 2025; on 26 clinics over the twelve months to July 2026 it earned 19.3%. Cash rent adds back FY25 book rent and deducts cash rent. A strong first owned year is not yet a sustained margin (Part 06 section B) · Assumption: A-02

The 2026 figures reconcile to within $1.0k and the April–August "other non-recurring" total ties approximately to the data, though its itemisation cannot be traced; no costed plan for twice the present size is in the files (Part 06 section D, Part 06 section E). Deal B Wellness Clinics earned $5.42m of four-wall EBITDA in January–July 2026, 26% below the seller's same months, with visit count down 16.1% in the second quarter and 17.3% on a per-day basis in July; the company's September recovery rests on weekly data not supplied (Part 06 section F).

Deal C. What holds: the audited clinic margin supports Ares Credit Group's first impression of a high-quality platform, 21.3% on book rent and 22.3% on cash rent after rebates in FY2025, above the peers' 16.5–18.7% on mixed bases (an indicative comparison only) (Part 07 section B, Part 07 section F). What to watch: same-store sales on the common definition fell to −3.2% in the second quarter of 2026 and same-store clinic EBITDA fell 5.8% over the twelve months to July 2026 (Part 07 section B).

Exhibit 1.03 — Indicative only (mixed rent bases, latest period each): Deal C's median with-rebates clinic margin of 20.9% (LTM Jul-26) is above Operator 3's 14.1% and Operator 5's 16.8%, but its interquartile range is the widest and its loss-making share (5.2%) above Operator 3's (2.0%)

Clinic-level EBITDA margin after vendor rebates and before corporate cost, % of revenue, with two reference rows before rebates on cash rent; latest period per operator (FY22 to LTM Jul-26)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C site-level database (to Jul-26) and FY25 audit; Operator 4, Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 5 and Operator 7 clinic-level files as supplied. Rows DLC-0421, DLC-0839 to DLC-0841, DLC-0845, DLC-5013, DLC-5014, OP4-1507, OP6-0357, OP3-1091, OP5-2060 to OP5-2446, OP5-2028, OP7-0515 · Basis: Filled = actual, hollow = pro forma. Deal C LTM Jul-26 is pro forma (QoE-adjusted to Apr-26,

management-adjusted May to Jul-26), owned months only; its FY25 rows are audited totals. Rent bases differ by row (book, cash, not stated) and Operator 6 is a per-location average, so this is a bounded, directional comparison, not a range placement

On matched sites, seller months against owned months to July 2026, the 2023–25 cohorts pooled gained +591bp of gross margin, against the 584bp claimed, but only +145bp of clinic EBITDA margin against the 594bp claimed; cash EBITDA was 0.31 of pro forma EBITDA in FY2025, held down by affiliate transaction bonuses (Part 07 section C, Part 07 section D).

The financings. The four financing readings are listed in Part 01 section B; Part 08 sets them out as observations for Ares Credit Group's own underwriting, with Deal A's read on the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026 (Part 08 section B).

Our reading on the evidence supplied to date. Each thesis component carries one of four labels: supported, partially supported, contradicted, or insufficient evidence. Part 01 section B gives all sixteen readings, with what holds, what does not and what would change each for the twelve business components; for the four financing readings it points to Part 08. None of them is an approval or a rejection of a transaction.

How to read the references. Each figure carries its period, an evidence tag ([F] documented fact, [M] management or sponsor claim, [A] Ares Credit Group's hypothesis or model, [I] our inference or computation, [U] unresolved; for a public figure, read only in a secondary report whose original could not be read, with the reporter named) and a reference, and, where the basis matters, a basis flag: A actual, PF pro forma, P projected. Codes, definitions and every reference form are explained in Part 09 section D.

B · Three theses

Of sixteen readings, four are contradicted, seven partially supported (two leaning supported) and five rest on insufficient evidence; what holds is mostly a starting position or clinic-level strength, and what does not is the trend since 2024 and the cash behind adjusted earnings.

Ares Credit Group framed a thesis for each deal: Deal A as a scaled platform whose second round of closures brings it closer to comparable operators; Deal B as an operator whose newer, better-placed acquisitions and cleaner reporting support growth to twice its size; and Deal C as one of the more attractive platforms Ares Credit Group has seen. We split each thesis into the components that can be tested, sixteen in all, and read each on the evidence supplied to date.

The labels mean the following. *Supported*: the evidence supports the component as stated. *Partially supported*: part of it holds and part does not, and the label says which; a partially supported reading flagged *leans supported* is one where the part that holds carries most of the component as Ares Credit Group framed it, and one open point is named. *Contradicted*: the evidence supplied runs against it. *Insufficient evidence*: the files needed to test it are not yet in hand.

Exhibit 1.04 — Of the sixteen readings across the three deals at October 2026, none is supported outright: four are contradicted, seven partially supported (two of them leaning supported) and five rest on insufficient evidence

One tile per thesis component, by deal, as read on 30 September 2026 and on 4 October 2026; business components in order, financing components in the last two columns

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: CreditSwan readings on Ares Credit Group's three investment theses, as set out in the summary and in the observations on the proposed financings of this document · Basis: Each tile is a reading of a thesis component against the four labels of the engagement brief, not an approval or rejection of a transaction. Two tiles changed on 4 October 2026: M1 and M4 moved from contradicted to partially supported, flagged as leaning supported (a corner flag in the legend colour for "leans supported"; the tooltip gives the qualifier). A partially supported reading flagged "leans supported" is one where the part that holds carries most of the component as Ares Credit Group framed it, and one open point is named (Part 09 section C). Deal C's financing component (ST4) is read separately for Option Two and Option One. An asterisk and a claret or pale-gilt corner flag mark a reading that carries a second label: M5 is contradicted as resilient at low leverage and partially supported as a sale-bridged loan; ST3 has insufficient evidence on underwriting EBITDA and is contradicted on cash earnings while the affiliate bonuses continue. A hollow tile is insufficient evidence; no actual, pro forma or projected distinction applies

The grid shows no component supported outright and a pattern across the deals: each thesis holds where it rests on a starting position or on clinic-level economics, and falls short where it depends on how those have moved since 2024 or on files not yet supplied. M3, MS1 and MS5 carry qualifiers drawn from the files received on 1 October 2026, and M5 is read on the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026.

Exhibit 1.05 — Across the three theses, what holds is mostly a starting position or a clinic-level strength; what does not is the trend since 2024 and the cash behind the adjusted earnings

Our reading on each thesis component on the evidence supplied to October 2026, with the evidence for and against it and what would change it; the financing component of each deal is read in Part 08

DEAL	THESIS COMPONENT	OUR READING ON THE EVIDENCE SUPPLIED TO DATE	WHAT HOLDS	WHAT DOES NOT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
Deal A	M1 · Underperformance is clinic-specific and curable by rationalisation	**Partially supported** (leans supported) — the tail is identifiable and closing it lifts clinic margin; the decline across retained clinics is not addressed by closures	The weak clinics are an identifiable group: 104 of the 119 second-round clinics sit in Ares Credit Group's bottom quartile, and closing them takes the loss-making share including co-op from 19.5% to 11.4% and the clinic margin on Ares Credit Group's basis from 12.8% to 14.4% (FY26) (Part 05 section B, Part 05 section E)	The decline runs across the clinics kept: with quartiles fixed at FY23, the top half's clinic EBITDA including co-op fell 16% to FY26, and comparable traffic at the 824 clinics kept fell 3.2% in FY26 (Part 05 section B, Part 05 section E)	FY27 results of the clinics kept, by quartile fixed at FY23; results of the clinics already closed, allowing an all-clinic comparison
Deal A	M2 · First-round closures delivered realised benefit	**Partially supported**	The closed clinics had lost $16.0m of clinic EBITDA in FY25, and the round realised about $24m of net proceeds (Part 05 section C)	Reported EBITDA excluding disposal gains still fell 33.2% in FY26; the files do not allow sales recapture to be measured (Part 05 section C)	Sales and addresses of the first round's 129 closed clinics (the company's closed-clinic list)
Deal A	M3 · Second round creates value after all costs	**Insufficient evidence** — the clinic list now allows a valuation; its sign turns on the definition of "Contribution" and on lease exits	The 119-clinic list received on 1 October values the round: +$7.2m to +$20.4m a year if the benefit is the reversal of the clinics' "Profit co-op" loss of $19.6m on $68.9m of sales (LTM Jun-26) (Part 05 section D)	On the workbook's "Contribution" measure, which it does not define, the same cases give −$11.8m to +$0.6m; closure cash is $21.79m to lease end plus $4.3m of fees, and 30 of 109 leases expire within 21 months (Part 05 section D)	The definitions of "Contribution $" and "Profit co-op $"; the lease-exit plan for the 109 leases with any buy-out costs; the overhead budget after the closures
Deal A	M4 · Remaining platform supports the quality premise	**Partially supported** (leans supported) — on Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost, the clinics kept sit in the lower half of the peer band; traffic remains last of three	Scale: 983 clinics and $1,029.1m of FY26 revenue; on Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost the 824 clinics kept earn 12.5%, in the lower half of the 10.7–17.4% peer band (indicative); the ticket kept pace with veterinary prices in FY26 (Part 05 section E; Part 09 section L)	Last of three on traffic: comparable traffic at the clinics kept −3.2% in FY26 and −4.0% in the first quarter of FY27, against −2.0% to −2.8% at the two surviving-clinic peers (2025 and LTM Aug-25); company EBITDA −34% in the first quarter of FY27 (Part 05 section E; Part 09 section L)	July–September 2026 trading; traffic at the clinics kept moving into the peer range
Deal A	M5 · Low-leverage financing is resilient	**Contradicted** as "resilient at low leverage"; **partially supported** as a sale-bridged loan	Set out in Part 08 section B	Set out in Part 08 section B	Set out in Part 08 section B
Deal B	MS1 · Newer cohorts have better sustainable economics	**Partially supported** — newer cohort's 18% clinic margin confirmed on owned months; sustained economics not yet shown; first-year dip not narrowing in the data	The newest cohort earned 18.9% in its 2025 owned months (17 clinics), as the company states (18%), and 19.3% on 26 clinics over the twelve months to July 2026; the 2024 and 2025 cohorts started above Operator 8's 0.59–0.70x, at 0.76x and 0.71x of seller EBITDA in their first owned year (Part 06 section B)	The first-year sales dip has not narrowed in the company's own data (−8.5%, −4.1%, −6.6% and −9.2% by cohort, oldest first, against the company's −13.3% to −6.2%); the first-half-2024 deals fell from 0.48x to 0.23x in their second year; the 46 clinics owned 21 months or more earned 8.4% on cash rent after rebates before any shared-services adjustment (LTM Mar-26), below the 10.7–17.4% peer range, or about 10.7–10.9%, at its bottom, if a shared-services charge sits in that figure (Part 06 section B, Part 06 section G)	A second owned year for the 2025 cohort; the definition behind the company's year-of-ownership sales table; a key from each deal to the clinic IDs
Deal B	MS2 · Higher-income, denser markets	**Partially supported** — density and acquisition returns not established	Higher household income on the company's data ($63,374 against $47,928) and on public census data; better-placed clinics earn more, and visit count comparables by number of positive attributes reproduce exactly from the company's data (+2.8% with three against −8.4% with none, September 2025 to August 2026) (Part 06 section C)	The company's and the public household counts point opposite ways (fewer households around the newer clinics on the company's figures, about twice as many on census data) and are not on the same basis; no acquisition returns by market (Part 06 section C)	The trade-area definition, vendor and data year behind the company's figures; rent and sale-leaseback proceeds by deal
Deal B	MS3 · Cleaner 2026 reporting	**Partially supported** — holds for the 2026 reconciliation; not supported on the historical base or on the missing bank ties	The 2026 figures reconcile to within $1.0k (Part 06 section D)	Reported EBITDA was negative in every year from 2023 to the twelve months to March 2026; the FY25 adjustment share (0.99–1.13) is above every peer (Part 06 section D)	The August 2026 quality-of-earnings roll-forward with bank-to-ledger ties

DEAL	THESIS COMPONENT	OUR READING ON THE EVIDENCE SUPPLIED TO DATE	WHAT HOLDS	WHAT DOES NOT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
Deal B	MS4 · Infrastructure supports 1.8x	**Insufficient evidence** — no costed doubling case; the evidence leans against	On the model's segment split, the plan grows the general practice and preventive business's revenue 1.57x on 0.93x overhead (9.2% to 5.9% of revenue by FY28E), and corporate heads per clinic fell from 0.76 to 0.46 (Part 06 section E)	Overhead per general practice and preventive clinic rose from $96.0k in FY24 to $137.1k for the twelve months to March 2026; the plan's saving per clinic has no costed case behind it; the integration budget is 13–31% of the like-for-like cost observed in 2023–25 (Part 06 section E)	A costed plan for twice the present size, reconciled to the acquisition add-backs
Deal B	MS5 · DBW economics and disposal value	**Insufficient evidence** — the owned-period gap is confirmed at −26%; the recovery after July rests on weekly data not supplied	Revenue per visit inside the wellness clinic range; bought at 3.2x; marketing and digital spend of $40.1K in January–July 2026 (none on digital from February) confirms the pause the company names among the causes (Part 06 section F)	Four-wall EBITDA of $5.42m in January–July 2026, 25.9% below the seller's same months; visit count −11.9% in the first quarter (−11.5% a day), −16.1% in the second and −17.3% a day in July; the company's recovery to −15.6% in September rests on weekly data not in the files; a value of $33–46m on wellness clinic multiples reaches Ares Credit Group's $44m only at its top (Part 06 section F)	The weekly same-store visit count file behind the August and September windows; DBW's four-wall bridge (labour, rebates, royalty); an owned-period comparable visit count (from December 2026)
Deal B	MS6 · Low leverage, pricing and upside compensate	**Contradicted** — on trailing leverage, cover and funding	Set out in Part 08 section C	Set out in Part 08 section C	Set out in Part 08 section C
Deal C	ST1 · Particularly attractive platform	**Partially supported** — the 2026 trajectory is not supported	Audited FY2025 clinic margin of 21.3% on book rent and 22.3% on cash rent after rebates; 38 of 86 clinics above 21% in the twelve months to July 2026 (Part 07 section B)	Same-store sales on the common definition −3.2% in the second quarter of 2026; same-store clinic EBITDA −5.8% over the twelve months to July 2026 (Part 07 section B)	August–September 2026 same-store results; a clinic rent roll and FY2025 rebate dollars
Deal C	ST2 · Demonstrated differentiation	**Contradicted** — the claimed 584/695bp uplift is not supported; the gross-margin mechanism is observed	Gross margin rises on the same sites after purchase, +591bp for the 2023–25 cohorts pooled, against the 584bp gross-margin gain claimed (Part 07 section C)	Clinic EBITDA-margin uplift of +145bp for the 2023–25 cohorts pooled, against the 594bp clinic EBITDA-margin gain claimed; acquired clinics earn 0.93x entry EBITDA against 1.15–1.63x at peers (each on its latest period, company-presented) (Part 07 section C, Part 07 section F)	The basis of each buy-down multiple, with seller P&Ls that show rent on owned property
Deal C	ST3 · Underwriting earnings are supportable	**Insufficient evidence** (underwriting EBITDA, E5; Accounting Firm 1 QoE absent) — cash earnings **contradicted** while the affiliate bonuses continue	An unmodified FY2025 audit opinion; without the affiliate bonuses, deal costs of 8.5% and 13.2% of purchase consideration (FY2024 and FY2025), inside the peer range (Part 07 section D, Part 07 section F)	$9.2m of Ares Credit Group's $29.4m (LTM September 2026E, P) is pre-acquisition and letter-of-intent earnings; cash EBITDA 0.28–0.31 of pro forma against a 0.73 peer median (Part 07 section D, Part 07 section F)	The Accounting Firm 1 quality-of-earnings report; the affiliate-bonus agreements and whether they end
Deal C	ST4 · 5.3x leverage is supportable	Option Two: **Contradicted**. Option One: **Insufficient evidence** — sponsor-instrument terms missing	Set out in Part 08 section D	Set out in Part 08 section D	Set out in Part 08 section D

Source: Part 05 section A, Part 06 section A and Part 07 section A (the readings tables of the three deal supplies) and Part 08 section A; each item points to the section that shows it, with its sources there · Basis: Labels as they stand on the evidence supplied to date; figures actual (A) unless the section names them pro forma (PF) or projected (P). For M1, public data add that proximity to an Operator 1 clinic does not separate the loss-making clinics from the rest within a state and banner (FY26 estate; closed clinics not covered); this is context beside the reading and does not change it · Assumption: A-01, A-02, A-03, A-07

The table places the evidence for Ares Credit Group's thesis beside the evidence against it for each of the twelve business components, one of which reads contradicted. Where a reading rests on insufficient evidence, the missing files could settle it either way; for MS4 the evidence in hand leans against the thesis. For the four financing readings the table gives the reading and points to Part 08, which sets out the evidence for and against each and what would change it.

C · What Ares Credit Group asked

Ares Credit Group asked for an industry assessment on six measures, a view on multiples and leverage over time, a benchmark of the historical deals and a test of three theses; each has an answer here and a part that substantiates it.

Scope. The study covers preventive care and pharmacy, and general practice veterinary care, as Ares Credit Group asked. Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals have their own economics: a wellness-clinic visit is built on a vaccine and wellness exam and an emergency or specialty case is a referral-driven, often insured case, both far from a core patient invoice in size and in what drives it. They are used as context where they help, in Part 04 section G, and never pooled with the core. Deal B's wellness clinic segment, Deal B Wellness Clinics, is analysed on its own in Part 06 section F and shown in its contribution to the consolidated results.

The table sets Ares Credit Group's thirteen asks in Ares Credit Group's words beside our answer in one line and the part that substantiates it. The thesis lines G11 to G13 are restated in neutral words.

Exhibit 1.06 — At October 2026 each of Ares Credit Group's thirteen asks has an answer here; the industry questions and the benchmark rest on up to eleven benchmark operators (thirteen for same-store sales), and the three theses hold in part

Ares Credit Group's goals for the study, in Ares Credit Group's words (September 2026), our answer in one line, and where it is substantiated

ID	WHAT ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN ONE LINE	WHERE IT IS SUBSTANTIATED
G1	A focus on "preventive care & pharmacy" and "general practice veterinary care"; emergency and specialty hospitals and wellness clinics "to incorporate as is helpful"	The core is eleven general practice and preventive operators; wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only and never pooled; Deal B's DBW segment is analysed on its own	Part 01 section C; Part 04 section G; Part 06 section F
G2	"create an industry assessment using historical data (deal specific data, industry market reports … and public sources)"	Built from 258 supplied files (266 through 28 September 2026 and six received on 1 October 2026), 134 public series (retrieved 28 September 2026) and 366 public figures read on 30 September 2026 (the read date of three census and Office of Management and Budget datasets is not recorded)	Part 03; Part 04; Part 04 section H; Part 01 section F
G3	"(i) consistency of volume over the long term"	Visits are flat over a cycle and, outside 2020, steady (half of operator-years between −3.8% and +3.0%); 2020 cut them 13–20% and the years since 2022 are softer; the ticket carried growth	Part 03 section A
G4	"(ii) pricing power"	The ticket matched or beat veterinary price inflation in five of six complete operator windows and outgrew veterinary wages in all six, with traffic within ±4% in five; it trailed veterinary prices from 2023	Part 03 section B
G5	"(iii) margin consistency"	Gross margin moves little within most operators; rebates and overhead make earnings less stable than clinic margins	Part 03 section C
G6	"(iv) unit economics"	A mature clinic earns a mid-teens four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent on $1.3–2.9m of sales	Part 03 section D
G7	"(v) same clinic sales growth in different environments"	Median comparable sales rose in 15 of 19 years (2007–2025) and averaged +2.4% to +8.3% a year at six operators with long records; they fell together in 2020 and rose together in 2021	Part 03 section E
G8	"(vi) typical cash flow profile"	Operators keep most of their EBITDA before financing; at serial acquirers cash EBITDA trails adjusted EBITDA	Part 03 section F
G9	"A view on valuation (platform and add on multiples) & leverage multiples over time"	Platform multiples rose partly on more adjusted earnings; small-clinic add-ons held at 4.0–5.8x standalone since 2021; first-lien leverage near 4.3x since 2014	Part 04 section A; Part 04 section B
G10	"benchmark the historical deals we've looked at … on these metrics and any other relevant KPIs that come up"	Eleven operators profiled on six of the eight areas; ten valid rankings, none overall; public signals added across operators	Part 04 section C to Part 04 section F; Part 04 section H
G11	Deal A: a scaled turnaround; Round 2 brings it closer to comparable operators; scale and diversity support low leverage	The weakest clinics are an identifiable tail, and closing them lifts clinic margin; on Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost the clinics kept sit in the lower half of the peer band; traffic is falling across the clinics kept; the second round's value turns on how the company measures clinic contribution; the financing is read in Part 08 section B	Part 05; Part 08 section B
G12	Deal B: better 2025–26 cohorts in richer, denser markets, cleaner 2026 reporting, infrastructure for twice its size, DBW; low leverage, high price, upside	The newest cohort's 18% clinic margin is confirmed but not yet sustained; richer markets, density not shown; 2026 reconciles; no costed doubling case; DBW's gap to the seller's period confirmed at −26%	Part 06; Part 08 section C
G13	Deal C: one of the more attractive platforms; the leverage requested is 5.3x	Audited clinic margins are strong; the 2026 trend, the acquired-clinic uplift and cash earnings are not; the 5.3x request is read in Part 08 section D	Part 07; Part 08 section D

Source: Ares Credit Group's note "Pet Care Services Project" (goals G1 to G13); the answers are summarised from the supplies named in the last column, where their sources are given · Basis: Summary of the supplies named; readings are our reading on the evidence supplied to date · Assumption: A-01, A-02, A-03, A-10

D · Sector in brief

General practice and preventive care shows flat, steady volume carried by price: comparable visits flat and, outside 2020, inside a narrow band, a ticket that keeps pace with veterinary prices, comparable sales that rise in most years and a mid-teens clinic margin; rebates,

overhead and acquisition costs make platform earnings less steady than clinics.

What holds. The durable features sit at clinic level. Comparable visits have been flat over a cycle (+0.3% a year in 2010–19) and, outside 2020, half of operator-years moved by between −3.8% and +3.0%. The ticket matched or beat veterinary prices in five of six operator windows, median comparable sales rose in 15 of 19 years, and a mature clinic earns a mid-teens four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent. Steady volume with pricing power is an acceptable credit profile.

What to watch. The years since 2023 have been softer and noisier. Vendor rebates are 4–42% of the four-wall margin including rebates, corporate overhead has not fallen with scale, and "one-time" acquisition costs recur for three to nine years at every acquisitive platform. Deal A's loss-making tail and fall in traffic are company-specific (Part 05).

Exhibit 1.07 — Across the core general practice and preventive operators, 2007–2025: visits flat and, outside 2020, mostly inside a narrow band; the ticket keeping pace with veterinary prices; median comparable sales positive in 15 of 19 years

Eight measures from Part 03, each with its period and the section that substantiates it; core operators only, actual figures

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Part 03 sections A, B and E, where each number carries its fact rows; notes C-02, C-10, C-40, C-42, C-43, C-44, C-51, C-120, C-121 · Basis: Actual (A). Medians across operator-years or operators on mixed clinic bases and definitions, as each section states; survivor-only series read high. Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are not included · Assumption: A-01; A-06; A-07

Exhibit 1.08 — Across the eight areas the durable features are flat, steady visits, full-cycle price pass-through, comparable sales that rise in most years, stable clinic margins and recurring "one-time" costs; the 2020 shock, the 2021–23 price surge and part of the 2024–26 soft period are temporary

Our answer on each of the eight areas Ares Credit Group asked about, what is durable, temporary or company-specific, and how deep the evidence is; operator records from FY1996 to 2026

AREA	WHAT THE EVIDENCE SHOWS	DURABLE, TEMPORARY OR COMPANY-SPECIFIC	DEPTH OF EVIDENCE
Volume consistency (Part 03 section A)	Comparable visits flat over a cycle (median +0.3% a year in 2010–19) and, outside 2020, steady: half of operator-years moved by between −3.8% and +3.0% (2007–2025); 2020 cut them 13–20% at the three core operators with data, none of which regained its 2019 level before its series ends; median −2.9% in the 2024 to 2026 soft period	Durable: flat, steady visits over a cycle. Temporary: the 2020 shock and part of the 2024 to 2026 soft period. Company-specific: Deal A's 33.9% fall in survivor comparable traffic from FY19 to FY26	Eight core operators, six economic environments, 2007–26; the 2008–09 recession rests on two operators
Pricing power (Part 03 section B)	The ticket matched or beat veterinary price inflation in five of six complete operator windows (Deal A +38.8% against +37.5% for veterinary prices, FY22–23) and outgrew veterinary wages in all six, with traffic within ±4% in five; it trailed veterinary prices from 2023 (a median gap of −3.6 points in 2024–26)	Durable: pass-through through the ticket, matched or beaten in five of six complete operator windows. Temporary: the ticket surges of 2020 and 2021–22. Company-specific: Deal A's loss of pharmacy and diet sales to online pharmacies	Eight core operators with ticket and traffic; like-for-like price and cost only at Operator 5; a manager-reported price component at Operator 8
Margin consistency (Part 03 section C)	Gross margin moves little within most operators (−1.8 to +0.4 points in the 2008–09 recession and the 2022–23 inflation at five operators; Operator 3 −6.2 points in 2023 and Deal A −2.4 points in FY21); clinic margin before rebates moved within 1.3–5.4 points at each platform; rebates are 4–42% of the four-wall margin including rebates (12–42% outside service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22)	Durable: gross-margin stability, rebate dependence, overhead that does not fall with scale. Company-specific: Deal A's loss-making tail	Nine core operators, FY07 to the twelve months to May 2026; clinic-level margins through a recession at one operator per recession
Unit economics (Part 03 section D)	A mature clinic earns a mid-teens four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent on $1.3–2.9m of sales; an Operator 1 single-clinic entry or organic build returned 42–72% a year after maintenance capex from year 3 (61% in year 5 across all single-clinic entries), on $0.27–0.41m of clinic capex excluding real estate; acquired clinics cost about $1.0–1.3m of purchase price per clinic in the add-on programmes of 2021–26, and $3.17m at Operator 4 in 2025, a year with a scale deal	Durable: the mid-teens clinic margin, low maintenance capex, a 4–5 year ramp. Company-specific: Deal A's clinic base	Clinic records at three cash-rent operators; the ramp rests on Operator 1 data to 2017
Same-store sales (Part 03 section E)	Median comparable sales rose in 15 of 19 years from 2007 to 2025 and averaged +2.4% to +8.3% a year at six operators with long records; they fell together in 2020 (−2.7% to −9.5% at the five core operators with data) and rose together in 2021 (+11.8% to +15.3% at seven); the ticket carries them	Durable: comparable sales that rise in most years through the ticket. Temporary: the 2020–21 swing and the 2021–23 ticket surge. Company-specific: Deal A's +0.5% average over 18 years	Thirteen core operators, 2005–25; only eight have a series on the common definition
Cash-flow profile (Part 03 section F)	Deal A converted a median 0.64 of reported EBITDA after total capex over 20 steady years (FY2000–26), and 0.44 in FY2026 excluding disposal gains; at acquisitive platforms cash EBITDA was 0.24–0.37 of the top adjusted figure in the heaviest acquisition periods	Durable: low maintenance reinvestment; "one-time" costs that recur for three to nine years. Temporary: working-capital swings, the 2022–26 rate cycle	Deal A's audited filings FY1996–FY2026; nine private platforms plus Deal C, mostly pro forma

AREA	WHAT THE EVIDENCE SHOWS	DURABLE, TEMPORARY OR COMPANY-SPECIFIC	DEPTH OF EVIDENCE
Valuation multiples (Part 04 section A)	Platform prints rose from 10–10x (2012–16) to 15–15.0x (2018–26), not on a common earnings definition; small-clinic add-ons cost 4.0–5.8x standalone since 2021	Durable: add-on pricing. The rise in headline multiples rests partly on more adjusted earnings	20 closed or signed platform transactions, 10 involving Operator 1; no print for 2013, 2017, 2019 or 2022
Leverage multiples (Part 04 section B)	First-lien leverage at close near a 4.3x median since 2014, peaking at Operator 2's 5.97x in 2021; at 4.8–5.8x, fixed-charge cover of about 0.7–1.2x at four of five prints, on mixed definitions	Durable: the 4.3x centre and the gap between earnings definitions. Temporary: the 2021 peak	Ten closed first-lien events at three operators, seven of them Operator 1

Source: Part 03 section A to Part 03 section F, Part 04 section A and Part 04 section B, where each figure carries its references; computation notes C-02, C-09, C-19, C-29, C-40, C-55 and C-63 · Basis: Mostly actual (A) for operating measures; valuation and leverage prints on pro forma deal-document earnings (PF) · Assumption: A-01, A-02, A-03, A-06, A-07, A-09, A-12

Exhibit 1.09 — Of 126 operator-by-area cells in the documents supplied to September 2026, 107 hold more than five actual figures, 10 hold five or fewer, 4 are pro forma or projected only and 4 are blank

Number of actual figures extracted, by operator and analytical area, all periods (the pro forma or projected count where there is no actual figure); documents supplied to September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: CreditSwan fact base (59,863 figures extracted from the documents Ares Credit Group supplied and from public filings), counted by operator, metric family and basis · Basis: A tile's number is the count of actual (A) values extracted in that area; where there is none it is the count of pro forma (PF, hollow) or projected (P, hatched) values. Grey tiles rest on five actual values or fewer. The picture depends on the mapping rule: a value is assigned by the family of its metric name (volume; price and ticket; gross margin, gross profit and EBITDA; clinic-level four-wall and per-clinic measures; same-store sales; cash-flow lines, capex, working capital and conversion; transaction prices and multiples; leverage, debt, cover ratios and financing terms). Families outside these, including revenue, clinic counts, rent, overhead, interest expense and interest cover, are not counted; counting interest cover as leverage would add actual leverage evidence for Operator 5, Operator 3 and Wellness Clinic Franchisor. A count is not by itself a usable series

The evidence is deep for the expansion of 2010–19 and for 2021–26, and thin for downturns before 2020, which rest on one to three operators each. The three live deals sit in the thinnest part of the record: Deal A's clinic records begin in FY20, and Deal B's and Deal C's clinic data in 2022–23. How to read the evidence-depth grid is set out in Part 09 section I.

E · Across the deals

Three findings hold at all three deals: the earnings measure decides the answer, less of the earnings reaches cash than reported or adjusted EBITDA suggests, and traffic is falling (at Deal C on the company's own measure only); at Deal B and Deal C acquired clinics also look different by months of ownership.

Read side by side, the three deals share three findings, the two acquirers share a fourth, and they differ on the rest. Each carries several EBITDA figures for one period, and the spread between them is wide. Each turns less of its earnings into cash than its reported or adjusted EBITDA suggests, for a different reason. Each is losing patient visits, Deal C on its own measure only; at Deal A and Deal B the ticket is carrying comparable sales. At Deal B and Deal C, acquired clinics look different once they are read by months of ownership. They do not share comparators, markets or causes.

Exhibit 1.10 — At October 2026 three findings hold at all three deals: the earnings measure decides the answer, cash falls short of reported or adjusted EBITDA, and traffic is falling (at Deal C on the company's own measure only); at the two acquirers acquired clinics also differ by months owned

The same measure read at each deal, with what transfers across the deals and what does not; latest period for each deal, FY2025 to July 2026

MEASURE	DEAL A	DEAL B	DEAL C	WHAT TRANSFERS, AND WHAT DOES NOT
Spread of EBITDA figures for one period	$56.4m reported without disposal gains ($71.2m with them) to $85.6m company non-GAAP EBITDA (FY26)	$1.22m reported to $13.79m pro forma (twelve months to July 2026)	$4.7m reported to $22.0m pro forma (FY2025)	Transfers: at all three, a comparison holds only on a named EBITDA measure
Cash against EBITDA, on the measure named in each cell	0.52 of FY26 reported EBITDA after capex (0.44 excluding disposal gains); $35.8m of the $77.9m of FY26 cash before financing costs came from a working-capital release; cash after financing costs is in Part 08 section B	Cash share 0.34–0.43 of adjusted EBITDA (twelve months to July 2026)	Cash share 0.28–0.31 of pro forma (FY2025 to the twelve months to April 2026)	Transfers: at all three, less of the earnings reaches cash than the EBITDA figure suggests (reported at Deal A, adjusted or pro forma at Deal B and Deal C). Does not: the reason, which at Deal A is capex, with a $35.8m working-capital release holding up FY26 cash, acquisition add-backs at Deal B and affiliate deal bonuses at Deal C
Comparable traffic	−3.9% (FY26), last of three on the common definition; −3.2% for the 824 clinics kept after the second round (pro forma)	−3.8% (twelve months to July 2026) on the common definition	−1.6% on the company's definition (twelve months to June 2026); no common-definition reading	Transfers: traffic is falling at all three (at Deal C on the company's own measure only), and at Deal A and Deal B the ticket is carrying comparable sales. Does not: Deal C cannot yet be placed on the common definition, and its comparable sales on that definition fell (−0.4%, twelve months to July 2026)
Clinic margin against peers	On Ares Credit Group's basis, co-op included and finance-lease cost at book, 10.7% (FY26) and 12.5% for the clinics kept (pro forma): at the floor of the 10.7–17.4% peer range and in its lower half, indicatively; 5.4–7.9% before co-op, on a rent treatment no peer shares (Exhibit 1.12)	After rebates on cash rent (twelve months to March 2026), 10.7% at the 103 surviving clinics and 8.4% at the 46 clinics owned 21 months or more, before any shared-services adjustment, against 10.7–17.4% in the peers' 2021–25 readings (Operator 8 2022–23, Operator 7 ST-22 2023–25, Operator 5 2021 to LTM March 2023); before rebates the general practice and preventive clinics cannot be placed (Exhibit 1.12, Part 06 section G)	22.3% after rebates on cash rent against 16.5–18.7% on mixed bases (FY2025; indicative only)	Does not transfer: each deal has a different set of valid comparators (Part 04 section F); Deal A's placement on Ares Credit Group's basis is indicative, as its co-op is allocated at a flat rate and its rent is at book
Acquired or closed clinics over time	First-round closures removed losses; the files do not allow sales recapture to be measured; the 119-clinic list values the second round at +$7.2m to +$20.4m a year on the clinics' "Profit co-op" loss, or −$11.8m to +$0.6m on the company's undefined "Contribution" measure (Part 05 section D)	The 2024 and 2025 cohorts start above Operator 8's band in their first owned year, the 2023 cohort just below it; the 2024 clinics then fell in their second year, while the 2023 cohort improved	Gross margin up +591bp on the same sites (2023–25 cohorts pooled), against the 584bp claimed; clinic EBITDA-margin uplift +145bp against the 594bp claimed	Transfers: at Deal B and Deal C, acquired clinics look different once read by months of ownership against a measured baseline. Does not: at Deal A the effect of the closures on the remaining clinics has no measured baseline in the files supplied
Where the clinics sit (public data: clinic locations read 30 September 2026; census income 2020–24)	Median household income within three miles $69.6k; an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles of 35.5% of clinics	$60.7k; Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles of 38.8% of clinics	$84.0k at the clinics mapped; Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles of 5 of 69 clinics mapped	Does not transfer: the three clinic bases serve different markets; proximity to Operator 1 does not separate Deal A's loss-making clinics within a state and banner

Source: Part 05 section A, Part 05 section C, Part 05 section E, Part 05 section F, Part 06 section A, Part 06 section B, Part 06 section G, Part 07 section A, Part 07 section B, Part 07 section C, Part 07 section F, Part 04 section H, and the exhibits of this section, where each figure carries its references · Basis: Actual (A) for traffic on the common definition (Deal C's company measure is pro forma), reported EBITDA, Deal A's cash and the clinic margins of Deal A and Deal C; pro forma (PF) for adjusted EBITDA, Deal B's clinic margins (cash-rent restatement of the company four-wall) and the cash shares of Deal B and Deal C; public figures as read on 30 September 2026 · Assumption: A-01, A-02, A-03, A-07, A-P3

Against the peers that share a definition. On comparable traffic Deal A falls faster than the two peers whose clinics survive in their series (−3.9% in FY26, −3.2% for the clinics it keeps, against −2.0% to −2.8% in 2025 and the twelve months to August 2025). Deal B's 2025 traffic (−2.6%) sat inside that range, and its −3.8% for the twelve months to July 2026 is 0.3 points below Operator 6's −3.4% for the twelve months to May 2026. Deal C has no reading on the common definition (Exhibit 1.11; Part 06 section G). On clinic margin after rebates on cash rent, Deal B sits at or below the bottom of its peer range, Deal C above an indicative one, and Deal A, on Ares Credit Group's co-op-included basis after finance-lease cost, at the floor of the range and in its lower half after the second round, indicatively (Exhibit 1.12). On cash against adjusted EBITDA, Deal C and Deal B sit well below the peer median of 0.84, and Deal A has no cash EBITDA on that definition (Exhibit 1.13).

Exhibit 1.11 — Comparable traffic fell 3.9% at Deal A (FY26), below the −2.8% to −2.0% of the two surviving-clinic peers (LTM Aug-25 and 2025), and 3.8% at Deal B (LTM Jul-26), 0.3 points below Operator 6's later −3.4% (LTM May-26); Deal C has no reading on the common definition

Comparable visit count, % change on the prior year: Deal A FY26, Deal B LTM Jul-26, Operator 3 LTM Aug-25, Operator 6 2025, Operator 8 2025, Deal C LTM Jun-26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A All Clinics KPI Report (DLA-0789); Deal B DLB Datapack, July 2026 (DLB-1518); Mike Visit Count and Average Invoice file (DLC-3100); Operator 3 datacube, August 2025 (OP3-0907); Operator 6 visit count file (OP6-1896; OP6-1952 for LTM May-26); Operator 8 databook, March 2026 (OP8-2114) · Basis: Actual (A) on the common definition (visit count in clinics owned and open for 13 months, calendar months, no seller data). Deal A, Operator 3 and Operator 6 are on surviving clinics, which flatters the reading; Operator 8 keeps closed clinics until closure and is one year on 21 clinics, so it is shown beside the range rather than inside it. Deal C supplied no site-level visit counts for the common definition; its company measure (pro forma, hollow) is adjusted for working days and includes seller months, and is not placed against the range. Periods differ by operator and are those used in the deal comparisons, not in every case the latest: Operator 6's later reading (−3.4%, LTM May-26) would move the peer range to −3.4% to −2.8% and narrow Deal A's gap to about 0.5–1.1 points, and Deal B's LTM Aug-26 reading is −4.1%. Operator 7 2025 reading (+10.9%) is not shown: it is a seller-period reading from before the combination of its two businesses, and its visit count definition is not stated

Exhibit 1.12 — On clinic margin, Deal B sits at or below the bottom of its cash-rent peer range (10.7% and 8.4%, LTM Mar-26, against 10.7–17.4% in 2021–25), Deal C above an indicative range (22.3% against 16.5–18.7%, FY25), and Deal A, on Ares Credit Group's co-op-included basis after finance-lease cost, at its floor (10.7%, FY26) and in its lower half after the second round (12.5%, pro forma), indicatively

Clinic-level (four-wall) EBITDA margin, % of clinic revenue; each deal against the peers that share its definition; deals FY25 to LTM July 2026, peers 2021 to LTM March 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal B DLB Datapack (Jul-26 RF) and QoE workbook, LTM March 2026 (DLB-3177, DLB-3203); Mike 2025 Audit and Site-Level Database (DLC-5014, DLC-0421); Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file, FY26 (DLA-0834, DLA-0857; DLA-003 tab FY26 with New Deal A Data Cuts DLA-019 for the co-op basis, note C-V2-1); peer clinic files: Operator 8 (OP8-0669, OP8-0813, OP8-1347, OP8-1395, OP8-1362, OP8-2762, OP8-1406), Operator 7 (OP7-0286 to OP7-0384), Operator 5 (OP5-1585, OP5-1586, OP5-2028, OP5-2029, OP5-2469, OP5-2470), Operator 4 (OP4-1507), Operator 6 (OP6-0357), Operator 3 datacube · Basis: Three definitions, one per group; a deal is drawn only in the group whose definition it shares. Deal B is pro forma (the company four-wall restated to cash rent, hollow) on the peers' definition: after rebates, on cash rent. Its clinics are survivors and the peers' are all clinics, which flatters Deal B. The 8.4% is before any shared-services adjustment; if the "NRA Shared Services" charge sits in the company four-wall, it would be about 10.7–10.9% (Part 06 section G). The peer range takes Operator 8 2022–23, Operator 7 ST-22 2023–25 and Operator 5 2021 to LTM Mar-23; its low end (Operator 8 2022) is actual and its high end (Operator 5 2022) pro forma. Before rebates the general practice and preventive clinics cannot be placed, because clinic rebates are given only for all clinic classes, which include the wellness clinics from December 2025 (Part 06 section G). Deal C's margin is after rebates, where the peers' rent bases differ (book, cash and not stated) and Operator 6 is a per-location average, so the comparison is indicative and bounded, not a placement; its FY25 point is audited (A); its LTM point is drawn pro forma because the site data are QoE- and management-adjusted, although they cover owned months only. Deal A is drawn twice. On Ares Credit Group's basis, co-op is allocated to clinics at 5.15% of clinic sales and finance-lease depreciation and interest are deducted at book (10.7% for all clinics, A; 12.5% for the 824 kept after the second round, PF); against the cash-rent peer range this is indicative, because the co-op is allocated at a flat rate and the rent is at book (Part 05 section E; note C-V2-1). Before co-op, Deal A's clinic EBITDA charges operating-lease rent only; no peer shares that basis, so it is shown alone as an upper bound and a book-cost approximation. Its two points use different sales denominators (clinic-system sales of $1,026.4m for the upper point, reported sales of $1,029.1m for the lower); on reported sales alone the pair is 7.85% and 5.56%, on clinic-system sales alone 8.20% and 5.39%. In the after-rebate group with mixed rent bases, Operator 5 and Operator 6 are pro forma and the range ends actual

Exhibit 1.13 — Cash EBITDA was 0.28–0.31 of adjusted EBITDA at Deal C (FY25 to LTM Apr-26) and 0.34–0.43 at Deal B (LTM Jul-26), against a median of 0.84 across 11 peer platform-periods (range 0.24–0.83)

Cash EBITDA as a share of the top adjusted EBITDA figure, ratio; peers FY2023 to LTM March 2026, deals FY2025 to LTM July 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C Internal Diligence Exhibits (DLC-4437, DLC-4426, DLC-4439, DLC-4430); Deal B financing models of July and September 2026 (DLB-6300, DLB-6302, DLB-5599); Operator 4 credit-agreement EBITDA bridge, Operator 8 databook, Operator 6 CIP and buy-side

QoE, Operator 3 sell-side QoE and model (row IDs in the data file) · Basis: Pro forma (PF) throughout: the denominator is each platform's top adjusted EBITDA. The 0.73 is the median of 11 platform-periods from four operators, not of operators; on each operator's latest period the readings are 0.29, 0.24, 0.73, 0.83. Operator 8's denominator is its as-owned adjusted EBITDA ($12.1m), because its top pro forma EBITDA ($23.8m) includes acquisitions through May 2026 with seller months and has no matching cash EBITDA. Cash EBITDA deducts the cash items presented as one-time that recur in three or more consecutive periods (transaction, integration, start-up). Deal C is on that definition. Deal B's numerator is Ares Credit Group's own cash adjustment for acquisition and closing costs paid in cash, a narrower deduction, shown on two denominators; its figures are consolidated, Deal B Wellness Clinics included (Part 06 section D). Deal A is not drawn: no cash EBITDA on this definition exists for it; its conversion of audited EBITDA to cash is a different measure

What would most change the readings. Of the requests for information across the three deals, ten files would move the most readings. Each would either confirm a thesis component or settle it against Ares Credit Group's view. The first two concern Deal A's current trading and the definition behind its second-round value; the next two, Deal C's earnings. The 119-clinic list received on 1 October 2026 allows the second round to be valued (Part 05 section D).

Exhibit 1.14 — Ten files would most change the readings at October 2026; the first four concern Deal A's current trading and the definition behind its second-round value, and Deal C's earnings

Information requested and not yet supplied, ranked by how many readings it bears on and how far it could move them; request numbers as listed in each deal part; the 119-clinic list, received on 1 October 2026, is not listed

RANK	FILE OR RESULT	DEAL AND REQUEST	READINGS IT BEARS ON	WHAT IT WOULD SETTLE
1	July–September 2026 actuals: monthly comparable sales, traffic and ticket	Deal A, request 1	M1, M4, M5	Whether the first quarter of FY27 is the run rate
2	The definitions of "Contribution $" and "Profit co-op $" in the closing-clinics file of 1 October, the lease-exit or assignment plan for its 109 leases with any buy-out costs, and a closure cash budget by quarter	Deal A, requests on the second round in Part 05 section G	M3, M5	The sign and size of the second round's value after all costs, and the timing of closure cash
3	The Accounting Firm 1 quality-of-earnings report with a bring-down to September 2026	Deal C, request 1	ST3, ST4	Whether the underwriting earnings hold
4	The affiliate transaction-bonus agreements and whether they continue after close	Deal C, request 2	ST3, ST4	How much of the gap between pro forma and cash earnings persists
5	The August 2026 quality-of-earnings roll-forward with bank-to-ledger ties, split between the general practice and preventive business and DBW	Deal B, request 1	MS3, MS5	Whether the cleaner 2026 reporting holds against the bank
6	A key from each acquisition to the clinic IDs, with sale-leaseback proceeds and rent per deal	Deal B, request 4	MS1, MS2	Cohort delivery turned into acquisition returns, by market
7	Results and addresses of the clinics closed since FY20	Deal A, requests 8 and 9	M1, M2	An all-clinic comparison and a measured recapture
8	August–September 2026 same-store sales and clinic EBITDA on the common definition	Deal C, request 6	ST1	Whether the 2026 decline persists
9	DBW's weekly same-store visit count file behind the August and September windows, its four-wall bridge to cash rent and an owned-period comparable visit count	Deal B, DBW requests in Part 06 section H	MS5	Whether the recovery after July is real, and the cause of the gap to the seller's period and to the wellness clinic peer
10	For each acquisition, the basis of the buy-down multiple, with seller P&Ls that show rent on owned property, and support for the pre-acquisition and letter-of-intent add-backs	Deal C, request 10	ST2, ST3	Whether the claimed uplift and the underwriting add-backs hold on a like basis

Source: Part 05 section G, Part 06 section H and Part 07 section G (the request lists); the readings in Exhibit 1.05 · Basis: Our ranking on the evidence supplied to date

Three further placements on the definitions the files allow, and the count of requests by deal and priority, are in Part 09 section I.

F · Evidence base

The study rests on 258 supplied files (266 through 28 September 2026 and six received on 1 October 2026), 134 public series and 366 public figures; the record is deepest for Operator 1, Operator 2 and Deal A's filings and thinnest for the live deals' clinic data, which begin in FY20 at Deal A and 2022–23 elsewhere.

What was read. Ares Credit Group supplied 266 source files in 13 folders through 28 September 2026, and six more on 1 October 2026: for Deal A, the recapitalisation model of 29 September, the FY27 closing-clinics analysis, a market-panel comparison of pharmacy unit sales and a sale-leaseback

valuation; for Deal B, its own and Deal B Wellness Clinics' written responses to Ares Credit Group's diligence questions. Every figure carries its period, evidence tag and reference, resolved in Part 09 section F. Beside the supplied files sit Deal A's public filings, 134 public series, 1,802 claims recorded from the industry reports supplied (Part 09 section H) and 366 figures from 149 public sources, listed in Part 09 section E and Part 09 section F and read in Part 04 section H.

Exhibit 1.15 — 266 source files in 13 folders were read, as supplied through 28 September 2026: 62 in the three live-deal folders and 190 in ten comparator folders

Unique source files by folder, count, documents supplied through 28 September 2026; 51 byte-identical duplicate copies are not counted

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Documents supplied by Ares Credit Group in 13 folders (266 files, unique within each folder; one industry primer is held in both the Operator 7 and Deal B folders and counted in each; each file carries a source ID with the folder prefix shown in the data file); CreditSwan count of files by folder · Basis: Count of unique files; gold = the three live-deal folders, teal = historical general practice and preventive comparators, grey = context sectors (wellness clinics, emergency and specialty hospitals)

Exhibit 1.16 — Three of the 13 folders hold 110 of the 266 source files, and the three live-deal folders hold documents dated 2024–26 only

Unique source files by folder, with vintages, document dates and main data types; documents supplied through 28 September 2026

FOLDER	FILES	SUB-FOLDERS / VINTAGES (FILES)	DOCUMENT DATES (EARLIEST – LATEST)	DATED BY YEAR ONLY OR UNDATED	MAIN DATA TYPES (FILES)
Operator 1	46	2014 Original Txn (15), 2018 (16), 2021 (8), 2023 (6), 2026 (9)	Mar-2012 – 14 Jun 2026	9	financial model 11, clinic-level 11, KPI datapack 6, IC memo 5, management presentation 4, market report 3, situation update 3
Operator 2	23	2018 Original (12), 2020 (2), 2021 (7), 2024 (3), 2026 (2)	Jun-2018 – 10 Aug 2026	2	clinic-level 6, situation update 5, financial model 3, IC memo 2, KPI datapack 2, QoE/FDD 2, unaudited FS 2
Deal A	21	root	Mar-2026 – 25 Sep 2026	0	clinic-level 7, KPI datapack 4, tracker/DD responses 4, financial model 2, unaudited FS 2, CIM/CIP 1, IC memo 1
Deal B	28	root	31 Jul 2024 – 25 Sep 2026	1	KPI datapack 11, QoE/FDD 3, financial model 3, tracker/DD responses 3, clinic-level 2, term sheet 2, IC memo 1
Deal C	16	root	3 Apr 2026 – 28 Sep 2026	1	KPI datapack 3, IC memo 2, clinic-level 2, CIM/CIP 1, audited FS 1, comps/benchmark 1, financial model 1
Operator 4 (incl. Operator 9)	11	root	28 Jan 2025 – 15 Jun 2026	0	audited FS 4, unaudited FS 3, IC memo 1, financial model 1, market report 1
Operator 5	13	root	May-2023 – 30 Jul 2023	4	KPI datapack 6, CIM/CIP 1, QoE/FDD 1, comps/benchmark 1, financial model 1, clinic-level 1
Operator 6	12	root	May-2026 – 14 Jul 2026	1	KPI datapack 3, CIM/CIP 2, tracker/DD responses 2, IC memo 1, financial model 1, lender presentation 1, market report 1
Operator 3	13	root	Jun-2025 – Nov-2025	1	KPI datapack 5, clinic-level 2, CIM/CIP 1, IC memo 1, QoE/FDD 1, financial model 1, management presentation 1
Operator 7	8	root	20 Jan 2025 – 22 Aug 2026	0	QoE/FDD 2, IC memo 1, KPI datapack 1, comps/benchmark 1, financial model 1, lender presentation 1, market report 1
Operator 8	14	root	12 Feb 2024 – 15 Jun 2026	0	KPI datapack 5, lender presentation 2, situation update 2, IC memo 1, QoE/FDD 1, financial model 1, clinic-level 1
Subsector – Wellness Clinic Info	30	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (19), Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (14), Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (1)	Jun-2025 – 5 Feb 2026	4	clinic-level 12, KPI datapack 9, QoE/FDD 3, IC memo 2, financial model 2, market report 2, CIM/CIP 1
Subsector – Emergency and specialty Info	34	Emergency Operator 1 (13), Emergency Operator 2 (15), Emergency Operator 3 (11)	Aug-2012 – 1 Dec 2025	4	KPI datapack 11, lender presentation 6, IC memo 5, management presentation 2, market report 2, situation update 2, clinic-level 2
Total	**266**	plus 51 byte-identical duplicate copies, not counted		**23**	

Source: Register of the source files, computation note C-01; the files are listed with their dates in Part 09 section E · Basis: Count of files, unique within each folder; 51 byte-identical duplicates registered and not counted, and one industry primer held in both the Operator 7 and Deal B folders counted in each. Document dates run from the earliest to the latest file dated at least to the month; files

dated by year only or not dated at all are counted in their own column. Data types as registered (KPI data and datapacks together; unclassified files not shown), the seven largest per folder

How far back it reaches. The history is deepest where the live deals are not. Clinic-level evidence through the 2008–09 recession exists for Operator 1 and Operator 2's predecessor only; Deal A's filings run from FY1996 to the first quarter of FY27; the three live-deal folders hold documents dated 2024–26, with clinic data from FY20 at Deal A and from 2022–23 at Deal B and Deal C. Statements across operators about the 2008–09 recession and the 2020 shock therefore rest on one to three operators each (Part 09 section H).

Exhibit 1.17 — Clinic-level data run from 2006 to 2026, but Operator 1 stops in 2017 and Operator 2 in 2021; only Deal A's filings span FY1996 to FY2026

Period covered by each platform's longest series, calendar years 1995 to 2026, by kind of record

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A Forms 10-K FY1996 to FY2026 (SEC EDGAR) and clinic KPI report (DLA-002); Operator 1 clinic P&Ls (OP1-015, OP1-021); Operator 2 KPI history and clinic databook (OP2-007, OP2-021); Operator 4 IC memo (OP4-005); Operator 5 volume trends (OP5-008); Operator 8 databooks (OP8-010, OP8-012); Operator 3 datacube (OP3-003); Operator 6 valuation summary (OP6-012); Operator 7 credit databook (OP7-005); Deal B and Deal C datapacks; Wellness Clinic Operator 1 clinic trends (QLX-029); Wellness Clinic Franchisor KPI per clinic (QLX-005); Emergency Operator 1 and Emergency Operator 2 lender materials · Basis: Periods as carried by the source files; fiscal years shown at their calendar span (Deal A FY ends March)

How much is documented fact. Documented facts are 38% of all figures recorded from the files; management or sponsor figures are the majority of the Operator 2, Operator 8, Operator 6 and Operator 4 files. Findings that rest on those files are stated as company-presented wherever they appear. Public figures carry the tag of the source we read, and a secondary report never stands as a fact (Part 09 section D).

Exhibit 1.18 — Documented facts are 38% of all fact rows as at 28 September 2026, from over 70% for Operator 1 and Operator 5 to under 20% for Operator 2, Deal B, Operator 3, Emergency Operator 2 and Emergency Operator 3, and 0% for Wellness Clinic Operator 2

Share of each company's fact rows by evidence tag, % of the company's rows; 59,863 fact rows from documents supplied through 28 September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: CreditSwan computation: fact rows counted by company (row-ID prefix) and evidence tag, from the documents Ares Credit Group supplied in the 13 folders and Deal A SEC filings · Basis: All bases (A, PF, P). Tags: F documented fact; M management or sponsor claim; I CreditSwan inference or computation; A Ares Credit Group hypothesis or model; U unresolved

The files by folder, the environments each platform reaches and the actual figures by platform and environment are in Part 09 section I.

G · Carrying forward

The next files the companies send would move several readings, and the measures that would show it are already defined in this document; the benchmark of eleven operators is a standing reference for the next veterinary services deal.

The readings stand on the evidence supplied to 1 October 2026, and the files that would move them are named in Part 01 section E: Deal A's July–September 2026 trading, the definition behind the clinic contribution in its closing-clinics file and the lease-exit plan for those clinics; Deal B's August 2026 quality-of-earnings roll-forward, the key from each acquisition to its clinics and DBW's weekly visit count file; and Deal C's quality-of-earnings report, its affiliate-bonus agreements and its August–September same-store results. Each could move a reading in either direction. The files that would make more peer comparisons valid are listed in Exhibit 4.17: Deal A's closed-clinic history, clinic margins restated to cash rent, and each deal's EBITDA and capex definitions. Those that would close the sector's remaining gaps, such as procedure-code price files, are listed in Exhibit 9.27.

Should Ares Credit Group proceed with any of the three, the first six measures in the table below, all from the companies' own records, would show a reading changing; the last three are public signals, which can be read again at any date as context and do not change a reading. Each is defined here with its source. CreditSwan's Operator 35 keeps the same evidence live: the measures read again from the companies' records, each against the level that would move a reading, and the public signals read again beside them. The benchmark of eleven operators, on six of the eight areas Ares Credit Group asked about, is a standing reference that Ares Credit Group can reuse on the next veterinary services deal (Part 04 section D).

Exhibit 1.19 — At October 2026, six measures from the companies' own records would show a reading changing; three public signals can be read again at any date as context

Measure, the readings it bears on, where it is shown in this document, and what a change would look like; readings on the evidence supplied to October 2026

MEASURE	READINGS IT BEARS ON	WHERE IT IS SHOWN	WHAT A CHANGE WOULD LOOK LIKE
Comparable traffic and ticket on the common definition, by month	M1, M4, MS1, ST1	Part 05 section E; Part 06 section G; Part 07 section F; Exhibit 1.11	Traffic declines narrowing towards the peer range, or a ticket no longer covering them
Share of Deal A clinics that lose money	M1, M4	Exhibit 9.52; Exhibit 5.12	The share falling below the 27–32% it has held in FY23 to FY26 before co-op, or below 19.5% (FY26) on Ares Credit Group's basis with co-op allocated to clinics (11.4% for the clinics kept after the second round)
Deal A closure cash and dark rent against the workbook	M3	Exhibit 5.10	Closure cash running above or below the workbook's $21.79m over the remaining lease terms, or operating-lease rent on leases not exited against the workbook's $5.75m a year on the operating-lease clinics (of its $12.13m of base rent; finance-lease payments continue in the lease lines)
The financing measures of the three proposed financings	M5, MS6, ST4	Part 08 section E	Set out in Part 08, for Ares Credit Group's own underwriting
Deal B cohort results by months of ownership	MS1	Exhibit 6.05	The 2025 cohort holding its first-year level into its second owned year
Cash share of adjusted EBITDA	MS3, ST3, ST4	Exhibit 1.13	Recurring deal and integration costs falling, so cash moves towards the 0.73 peer median
Employer ratings and review counts by operator (public)	M1, M4, ST1	Part 04 section H	Ratings or review counts moving against the operator's own record or its peers (context beside the readings; a public signal does not change a reading)
Client ratings on Deal B's clinic pages, by cohort (public)	MS1	Exhibit 9.132	Newer clinics' ratings diverging from the older cohorts' (context beside the reading; a public signal does not change a reading)
Share of each clinic base with an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles (public)	M1, MS2	Exhibit 4.22	The share rising as Operator 1 opens or converts clinics near the three deals (context beside the readings; a public signal does not change a reading)

Source: The exhibits and sections named in the third column, where each measure is defined and its sources given · Basis: Measures as defined in this document; public signals as read on 30 September 2026 · Assumption: A-01, A-02, A-03, A-P2

Part 03 — Sector assessment

In general practice and preventive veterinary care, patient volume has been flat and, outside 2020, inside a narrow band, while the ticket has carried growth; the clinic's margin is steadier than the platform's earnings or its cash

Ares Credit Group asked. Ares Credit Group asked for an industry assessment on six measures, in its words: "(i) consistency of volume over the long term", "(ii) pricing power", "(iii) margin consistency", "(iv) unit economics", "(v) same clinic sales growth in different environments" and "(vi) typical cash flow profile".

Comparable visits have been flat over the long run: the median change was +0.3% a year across 2010–19, and outside 2020 half of all operator-years moved by between −3.8% and +3.0%. The ticket carried growth, matching or beating veterinary price inflation in five of six complete operator windows (Deal A +38.8% against +37.5%, FY22–23), so median comparable sales rose in 15 of 19 years from 2007 to 2025 and averaged +2.4% to +8.3% a year at six operators with long records. The years since 2023 have been softer and noisier: the ticket has trailed veterinary prices at most operators, and comp traffic fell at four of seven core operators in 2024–26. Gross margin moves little within most operators and a mature clinic earns a mid-teens four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent; vendor rebates, corporate overhead and recurring acquisition costs make platform earnings and cash less steady than clinics.

Each area is read across the core operators with data, eight to thirteen by area, on stated definitions and across six or seven economic environments (seven for same-store sales and Deal A's cash flow; some environments rest on one or two operators), and each section separates what is durable, temporary and company-specific. Figures from series that exclude closed clinics are upper bounds, and wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only.

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED
A-01	Same-store sales are compared on one common definition	Clinics owned and open 13 months, calendar months, no months from before purchase; the treatment of closed clinics is stated
A-02	Clinic (four-wall) margins are compared before rebates and after cash rent	Margins after rebates or on other rent treatments are shown with their treatment named and never pooled
A-03	EBITDA is kept on named levels	Reported, adjusted, pro forma, run-rate, underwriting and cash EBITDA (pro forma less "one-time" costs that recur)
A-06	Economic environments are assigned by period end	Seven environments from before 2008 to the 2024 to 2026 soft period; twelve-month fiscal periods placed by the majority of their months
A-07	Series that exclude closed clinics are read as upper bounds	Closed clinics absent from a series are stated with the series
A-10	Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only	Never pooled with preventive care and pharmacy or general practice veterinary care in a core statistic

Exhibit 3.01 — On the six measures Ares Credit Group asked about, volume has been flat and, outside 2020, steady, the ticket has carried growth and clinic margins before rebates moved within 1.3–5.4 points at each operator (FY08 to 2026); rebates, overhead and recurring acquisition costs make platform earnings and cash less steady

Our answer on each of Ares Credit Group's six industry questions, (i) to (vi), with the depth of the evidence and what would change it; operator records from FY1996 to 2026

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
"(i) consistency of volume over the long term" (Part 03 section A)	Volume has been flat over the long run and, outside 2020, steady from year to year: comparable visits were flat in the 2010–19 expansion (median +0.3% a year), and outside 2020 half of 32 operator-years moved by between −3.8% and +3.0%. 2020 cut visits by 13–20% at the three core operators with data, none of which regained its 2019 level before its series ends (Operator 2 to March 2021, Operator 5 to 2022, Deal A to FY26), and median traffic was −2.9% in the 2024 to 2026 soft period.	Eight core operators with comparable volume on a stated clinic base, six economic environments from 2007 to 2026, all actual; the 2008–09 recession rests on two operators; national veterinary spending from 2005 to 2025 is context.	An all-clinic Deal A traffic series that includes closed clinics; Operator 1's December 2017 closed-clinics list joined to its clinic-level financials, and Operator 1 clinic data after 2017; site-level visit counts for Deal C
"(ii) pricing power" (Part 03 section B)	Operators have passed cost through the ticket over full cycles: comparable ticket matched or beat veterinary price inflation in five of six complete operator windows (Deal A +38.8% against +37.5% for the consumer price of veterinary services, FY22–23; Operator 3 trailed in 2023–24) and outgrew veterinary wages in all six, with traffic within ±4% in five of them. Since 2023 the ticket has trailed veterinary prices at most operators (a median gap of −3.6 points in the 2024 to 2026 soft period), and ticket growth mixes price with mix and attachment.	Eight core operators with ticket and traffic on the same comparable base, all actual; like-for-like price and cost only at Operator 5 (2016–22); a manager-reported price component at Operator 8 (2022–23); public price and wage indices for 2019 to 2025.	Procedure-code price files at Deal A and Operator 3; payroll hours giving veterinarian cost per billed hour

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
"(iii) margin consistency " (Part 03 section C)	Gross margin moves little within most operators: −1.8 to +0.4 points in the 2008–09 recession and the 2022–23 inflation at five operators, with larger falls at Operator 3 in 2023 (−6.2 points) and Deal A in FY21 (−2.4 points). Clinic margin before rebates moved within 1.3–5.4 points at each platform, with Operator 1 eroding even on constant clinics; stability through a recession is not established. Vendor rebates are 4–42% of the four-wall margin including rebates (12–42% outside service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22), and corporate overhead has not fallen with scale.	Nine core operators, FY07 to the twelve months to May 2026, mostly actual; clinic-level margins through a recession at one operator per recession.	Rent schedules restating Operator 2, Operator 3 and Operator 8 clinic margins to cash rent; an Operator 1 clinic databook for 2018–26; vendor agreements with tier and clawback terms
"(iv) unit economics" (Part 03 section D)	From FY08 to FY25 a mature general practice and preventive clinic earned a mid-teens four-wall margin, before rebates and on cash rent, on $1.3–2.9m of sales. At Operator 1 a single-clinic entry or organic build cost $0.27–0.41m of clinic capex excluding real estate (and, for single acquisitions, excluding the purchase price) and returned 42–72% a year after maintenance capex from year 3 (61% in year 5 across all single-clinic entries); acquired clinics cost about $1.0–1.3m of purchase price per clinic in the add-on programmes of 2021–26, and $3.17m at Operator 4 in 2025, a year with a scale deal.	Clinic records from three cash-rent operators (Operator 5 pro forma; Operator 7 on related-party rent) across six environments; capital and acquisition data from six more platforms; returns are our computation; the ramp rests on Operator 1 data to 2017.	Clinic results with rebates removed for Operator 6 or Operator 3; Operator 4's results deal by deal; Deal C's site database by age and cohort
"(v) same clinic sales growth in different environments" (Part 03 section E)	Organic growth has been positive over the long run: median comparable sales rose in 15 of 19 years from 2007 to 2025 (+3.0% in 2010–14, +3.2% in 2015–19, +1.8% in the 2024 to 2026 soft period) and averaged +2.4% to +8.3% a year at six core operators with long records. Comparable sales fell together in 2020 (−2.7% to −9.5% at the five core operators with data) and rose together in 2021 (+11.8% to +15.3% at seven); Deal A averaged +0.5% over 18 years, with nine negative years.	Thirteen core operators across the seven environments (the 2010–19 expansion in two halves), 2005 to 2025, mostly actual; only eight have a series on the common definition; the soft-period readings mix clinic bases and periods.	Clinic databooks for Operator 4 and Operator 9; Deal A's closed-clinic results for FY20–FY26; Deal C's site database with visit counts
"(vi) typical cash flow profile" (Part 03 section F)	Before financing, operators keep most of their EBITDA: Deal A converted a median 0.64 of reported EBITDA after total capex over 20 steady years (FY2000–26) but 0.44 in FY2026 excluding disposal gains, and company-stated maintenance splits give 0.73–0.85. At acquisitive platforms cash EBITDA fell to 0.24–0.37 of the top adjusted figure (Operator 8's 0.24 on its as-owned adjusted EBITDA) in the heaviest acquisition periods, once pro forma additions and "one-time" costs that recur for three to nine years are taken out.	Deal A's audited filings FY1996 to FY2026 (actual); nine private platforms plus Deal C, mostly pro forma and on company-stated maintenance splits; Deal B's figures include DBW and are read in Part 06.	A company-certified split of maintenance and growth capex; Deal A's second-quarter FY27 results; Operator 1 audited cash-flow statements for 2022–25

Source: Part 03 section A to Part 03 section F, where each figure carries its references · Basis: Mostly actual (A); pro forma (PF) where a section names it

A · Volume consistency

Comparable visits have been flat over the long run and, outside the 2020 shock, inside a narrow band: a median of +0.3% a year in 2010–19 and half of all operator-years between −3.8% and +3.0% from 2007 to 2025; the years since 2022 have been softer, and Deal A's fall is its own.

What holds. Volume has been consistent in the sense that matters to a lender: flat over a cycle and moving in a narrow band from year to year. The median change in comparable visits was +0.3% a year across the 2010–19 expansion, and outside 2020 half of the 32 operator-years moved by between −3.8% and +3.0% (median −0.1%). Real national spending on veterinary care was 1.2% above its 2019 level in 2025. Flat, steady volume with pricing power behind it is an acceptable credit profile; Part 03 section B shows the pricing side.

What to watch. 2020 cut visits by 13–20% at the three operators with data, and none had regained its 2019 level when its series ends. Median traffic was −2.4% in 2022–23 and −2.9% in 2024–26, mostly on files that leave out closed clinics and so read high. Deal A's 33.9% fall in surviving-clinic traffic from FY19 to FY26 is company-specific (Part 05).

Exhibit 3.02 — Outside 2020, half of core operator-years moved comp traffic by between −3.8% and +3.0% and the median was −0.1% (2007–2025); 2020 alone cut it by 13–20%

Comp traffic, % YoY, each operator-year with the median and the lowest-to-highest range, by economic environment and over all years; 2007 to 2025

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator comp traffic, sales and ticket from the documents Ares Credit Group supplied: Operator 10, Operator 14, Operator 16 and Operator 12 seller-period KPI data and Operator 2 clinic-level databook (Operator 2 data room); Operator 5 volume trends; Deal A all-clinics KPI report; Operator 3 datacube; Operator 6 visit count file; Operator 8 databook; Operator 7 credit databook. One fact row per value, listed in the data file; note C-120 · Basis: Actual (A). The same 35 operator-years as Exhibit 3.03; environments by the months each period covers (note C-02). The shaded band is the interquartile range of the 32 operator-years outside the 2020 shock; 61% of them sit within ±4%. The wide ends come from small or single-market chains (Operator 12 2017 −10.3%), Operator 10's 2011 visit count

shift (−10.4%), Deal A FY25 (−7.9%) and Operator 7 2025 (+10.9%, visit count definition not stated). Survivor-only files (Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6) exclude closed clinics and read high · Assumption: A-06; A-07

Exhibit 3.03 — From 2007 to 2025 median comp ticket rose in 15 of 19 years while median comp traffic fell in 10, mostly by less than 4%; comparable sales grew through the ticket, and 2020 was the one deep traffic fall shared by every operator with data that year (three)

Comp ticket, comp traffic and comp sales, % YoY, median across core operators with a comp traffic series (Deal A shown separately); calendar years 2007 to 2025

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator comp traffic, sales and ticket from the documents Ares Credit Group supplied: Operator 10, Operator 14, Operator 16 and Operator 12 seller-period KPI data and Operator 2 clinic-level databook (Operator 2 data room); Operator 5 volume trends; Deal A all-clinics KPI report; Operator 3 datacube; Operator 6 visit count file; Operator 8 databook; Operator 7 credit databook. One fact row per value, listed in the data file; note C-120 · Basis: Actual (A). The comp-traffic panel of Part 03 section A: 35 operator-years at seven core general practice and preventive parent companies (the Operator 2 lineage, with its four seller-period chains, counted once), comp visits (patient visits or patient invoices; invoice counts at Operator 5) on the clinic base each operator reports. Medians exclude Deal A, whose surviving-clinic traffic is drawn on its own; Deal A's fiscal year sits in the calendar year holding nine of its months (FY26 = 2025). One to four operators a year: one in 2007–12 (Operator 10, a City 9 chain of about 12 clinics) and 2018 and 2021–24, so a yearly median is often one operator; the count is in each tooltip and in the data file. Operator 10 2009–12 visit counts shift across all clinics (note C-11), and its 2011 ticket (+17.4%) is the mirror of that shift. 2025 rests on Operator 8, Operator 7 and Operator 6, two of them newly assembled bases; Deal A's survivor series and Operator 3's and Operator 6's survivor files exclude closed clinics · Assumption: A-06; A-07

Exhibit 3.04 — Real household spending on veterinary care was 1.2% above its 2019 level in 2025 (84.6 in the first half of 2026) and pets in U.S. households 1.6% above; the 2021–22 bulge, to 97.5, has unwound

Real household spending on veterinarian services, and dogs and cats in U.S. households; index, 2019 = 86; calendar years 2005 to 2025, with the latest 2026 reading

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: BEA, NIPA 2.1.3U line 171, real (Fisher quantity) index of personal consumption expenditure on veterinarian services (PCEVETSVC), annual and quarterly; an industry pet-ownership survey, dogs and cats in U.S. households, December and July 2026 observations; retrieved 2026-09-28; note C-122 · Basis: Actual (A); public series, context for the industry rather than operator volume. Spending is a price-adjusted quantity, which rises with work per visit and includes emergency, specialty and other pet-health spending, so it is not a count of visits at general practice and preventive operators. The 2026 marks (ringed) are the average of the first two quarters of 2026 at seasonally adjusted rates and the twelve months to July 2026. Rebased here from 2017 = 86 (spending) and the household pet count to 2019 = 86

The operator tables, the clinic-base caveats, the public signals and the limits of the evidence behind this section are in Part 09 section J, under "03 A Volume consistency: supporting evidence".

B · Pricing power

Operators have passed cost through the ticket over full cycles: comp ticket matched or beat veterinary price inflation in five of six operator windows from 2011 to FY26 and outgrew veterinary wages in all six, with traffic within ±4% in five of them; since 2023 the ticket has trailed veterinary prices at most operators.

What holds. Over complete windows the ticket kept pace with the consumer price of veterinary services in five of six cases and outgrew veterinary wages in all six; Deal A's rose 38.8% over FY22–23 against 37.5% for veterinary prices. In five of the six windows comp traffic moved by less than 4% while the ticket rose, so the price was taken without a material loss of customers; Deal A, where traffic fell 16.0% over the same window, is the exception and its causes are company-specific (Part 05). The median comp ticket rose in every economic environment from 2007 to 2026, and the consumer price of veterinary services rose 39.5% from 2019 to 2025 against 22.3% for general prices.

What to watch. Since 2023 the ticket has trailed veterinary prices at most operators, by a median of 4.1 points in 2024–26, and ticket growth mixes price with service mix and attachment.

Exhibit 3.05 — Comp ticket matched or beat veterinary price inflation in 5 of 6 operator windows from 2011 to FY26 and beat veterinary wages in all 6; comp traffic held within ±4% in five windows and fell 16.0% at Deal A

Cumulative change over each window, %: comp ticket, CPI veterinarian services, veterinary-occupation wages and comp traffic; operator windows 2011 to FY26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A all-clinics KPI report; Operator 5 volume trends; Operator 3 datacube; Operator 1 clinic-level P&L workbook; Operator 10 seller-period KPI data; BLS CPI-U veterinarian services (CUUR0000SS62053) and Employment Cost Index, wages, healthcare practitioner and technical occupations (ECI_VETOCC), retrieved 2026-09-28; note C-10 · Basis: Actual (A). Annual comp growth chained over each window on the operator's own comp base; public indices chained over the same months (note C-10). Ticket is revenue per visit (per pharmacy unit at Operator 1, where retail pharmacy units stand for volume) and mixes price, service mix and attachment. Operator 3 2023–24 trailed CPI (+14.1% against +15.6%). The wage index is an all-industry rate per hour, not an operator's labour cost per visit. Deal A and Operator 3 are survivor bases, which exclude closed clinics · Assumption: A-01; A-07

Exhibit 3.06 — Median comp ticket rose in every environment from 2007 to 2026 and trailed CPI veterinarian services in INFL22-23 and SOFT24-26; on these paired years volume fell in GFC, COVID20 and INFL22-23

Core operators: median annual comp ticket and comp volume growth against CPI veterinarian services, by environment (D10), %, 2007 to 2026; n = platform-years

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Comp ticket and volume series in documents Ares Credit Group supplied: Operator 1 clinic financials (OP1-015, OP1-020, OP1-021); Operator 2 KPI history, clinic-level analysis and clinic databook (OP2-007, OP2-009, OP2-021); Deal A clinic KPI report (DLA-002); Operator 5 volume trends (OP5-008); Operator 3 datacube (OP3-003); Operator 6 Consultant 1 Delta readout (OP6-002); Operator 7 credit databook (OP7-005); Operator 8 databook (OP8-010). Public: BLS CPI-U veterinarian services, not seasonally adjusted, matched months (CUUR0000SS62053) · Basis: A; comp series on each company's own comp base (survivor bases at Deal A and Operator 3); ticket is price, mix and attachment together; COVID20 and REOPEN21 rest on two to three operators each; the SOFT24-26 volume median (+1.0%, 9 platform-years) counts overlapping trailing-twelve-month windows and Operator 7 and Operator 8's 2025 traffic growth, while the comp-traffic panel of Part 03 section A (6 operator-years) gives −2.9%

Exhibit 3.07 — Veterinary prices rose 39.5% from 2019 to 2025, against 22.3% for general prices and 25.4% for wages in healthcare practitioner and technical occupations (all private industry)

Consumer price of veterinary services against all-items consumer prices and the wage index for healthcare practitioner and technical occupations across private industry; index of annual averages, 2019 = 86; 2019 to 2025

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: BLS: CPI-U veterinarian services (CUUR0000SS62053) and CPI-U all items (CUUR0000SA0), U.S. city average, not seasonally adjusted, monthly; Employment Cost Index, wages and salaries, private industry, healthcare practitioner and technical occupations (ECI_VETOCC), quarterly; retrieved 2026-09-28 · Basis: Actual (A). Each line is the calendar-year average of the published index (twelve months for the CPI series, four quarters for the ECI), rebased to 2019 = 86. October 2025 was not published for either CPI series, so their 2025 average is of eleven months. The CPI series is a price paid by pet owners across corporate groups, independent practices and emergency and specialty hospitals; the ECI is a wage per hour for an occupation group across all private industries, not operators' own labour cost per patient invoice · Assumption: Register A-11: pricing is tested against public price and wage series

The operator tables, the Operator 5 price-and-cost record, rebates, the public price and online-pharmacy signals and the limits of the evidence behind this section are in Part 09 section J, under "03 B Pricing power: supporting evidence".

C · Margin consistency

Gross margin moves little within most operators (−1.8 to +0.4pp in the GFC and the 2022–23 inflation at five operators, FY07 to LTM May-26; Operator 3 −6.2pp in 2023), but vendor rebates are 4–42% of four-wall margin including rebates (12–42% outside service-heavy Operator 7

ST-22) and corporate overhead has not fallen with scale.

What holds. Clinic economics are steadier than consolidated earnings. Through the 2008–09 recession and the 2022–23 inflation gross margin moved by between −1.8 and +0.4 points at five operators, and the four-wall margin before rebates moved within 1.3–5.4 points at each platform over its observed years. Clinic rank persists: 34–62% of clinics sit in the same quartile a year later, against 21% if rank were random, so a weak tail is a stable target.

What to watch. Vendor rebates are 4–42% of the four-wall margin including rebates (12–42% outside service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22), corporate overhead has not fallen with scale, and Deal A's consolidated EBITDA margin fell from 12.0% in FY22 to 6.2% in FY26. About a third of Deal A's clinics lost money in each year from FY23 to FY26 before co-op (28.7% in FY26); on Ares Credit Group's basis, with co-op allocated to clinics, the FY26 share is 19.5% and the clinic margin 12.8% before finance-lease cost (10.7% after it) (Part 05 section E).

Exhibit 3.08 — Gross margin moved less than 3 points from one year to the next inside each operator from FY07 to LTM May-26, including through the GFC, except Operator 3 in 2023–24 (−6.2 and +2.8 points); definitions differ, so levels are not compared across operators

Gross margin by operator and period, % of revenue, FY07 to LTM May-26; each panel on its own definition and its own scale

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A Forms 10-K FY07 to FY26 (SEC EDGAR; DLA-0054 to DLA-0073 series); Operator 1 clinic financials, December 2017 (OP1-021); Operator 2 historical financials, Operator 10 seller period (OP2-010); Operator 8 databooks (OP8-010, OP8-012); Operator 3 datacube (OP3-003); Operator 7 quality-of-earnings workbook (OP7-007); fact rows per point in the data file · Basis: A; definitions as labelled (Deal A's cost of sales carries distribution and occupancy; Operator 10's excludes labour); Operator 1 before supplier rebates; Deal A fiscal years tagged to the environment holding most of their months (FY20 EXP10-19, FY21 COVID20, FY22 REOPEN21, FY24 INFL22-23)

Exhibit 3.09 — Core four-wall margins before rebates ran 7.9–16.1% at the cash-rent and unstated-rent platforms from FY08 to LTM Mar-26 (Operator 7 ST-70, not comparable, 24–27%); Operator 1 fell from 15.0% to 9.8% by CY2016, and Deal A's FY26 book-rent approximation, 5.4%, is lowest.

D1.1 four-wall margin (clinic contribution after rent, before vendor rebates ÷ clinic sales), %, by platform and period; FY08 to LTM Mar-26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 1 Clinic P&L 2007–2014 and clinic-level financials (Dec-17) (OP1-2456, OP1-2457, OP1-5657 to OP1-5668); Operator 2 Clinic Level Databook, June 2021 (OP2-3401 to OP2-3462); Operator 5 Project Juliet Operating Model, 20 July 2023 (OP5-1152, OP5-1585, OP5-2028, OP5-2469); Operator 3 Datacube, 31 August 2025 (OP3-1012 to OP3-1088); Operator 8 Operator 8 Databooks (Feb-25, Mar-26) and Preferred Equity Presentation (Mar-26); Operator 7 Project India and Project Foxtrot diligence databooks (OP7-0286 to OP7-0483); Deal A Clinic-level EBITDA FY23–FY26 (DLA-0857) and Form 10-K FY26 sales (DLA-0017) · Basis: Actual (A) except Operator 5, which is pro forma (PF: adjusted trial balance from the financial due diligence; hollow markers). Rent treatment: Operator 1, Operator 5, Operator 8 to 2023 and Operator 7 on cash rent (R-CASH); Operator 2, Operator 3 and Operator 8 from 2024 not stated (R-UNK); Deal A at book rent (R-BOOK). Clinic base as named in each legend. Each point sits at the midpoint of its period; LTM windows overlap the calendar years beside them. Both panels share one scale. Operator 7 ST-70 corporate carries clinic-type costs, so its segment margin is not comparable with ST-22

Exhibit 3.10 — Operator 1 rebates rose from 3.4% to 9.0% of clinic sales between FY09 and FY17, reaching 42% of four-wall contribution including rebates; other core platforms book 0.6–6.7% of revenue and 12–32% of four-wall where it is plotted (Operator 7 ST-22 4–6%, not plotted).

Rebates as % of revenue and as share of the four-wall contribution including rebates (D1.2), by platform and period; FY09 to LTM Mar-26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 1 clinic-level financials (Dec-17), clinic sheets; Operator 2 Clinic Level Databook, June 2021 (OP2-3414 to OP2-3469); Operator 5 Project Juliet Financial Due Diligence Report (OP5-0311 to OP5-0313); Operator 3 Financial Update, 31 August 2025 (OP3-1013 to OP3-1089); Operator 8 Accounting Firm 2 Financial Diligence Report and Operator 8 Databook (Mar-26) (OP8-0813, OP8-0825, OP8-2092 to OP8-2102); Operator 7 Project India and Project Foxtrot diligence databooks (OP7-0004 to OP7-0490); Ares Credit Group Deal A Diligence & Structure Update, 15 September 2026, and Deal A Clinic-level EBITDA FY23–FY26 (DLA-3340 to DLA-3343, DLA-0846) · Basis: Actual (A) except Operator 5, which is pro forma (PF: diligence-adjusted; hollow markers). Rebates = vendor rebates, co-op or

allowances as booked by each operator; denominators differ (clinic sales, or consolidated or segment revenue). D1.2 = four-wall contribution including rebates. Clinic base: Operator 1 full-year general practice clinics; Operator 2 all owned clinics; Operator 3 survivor clinics; others consolidated or whole segment. No rent code applies to a rebate ratio. Each point sits at the midpoint of its period; Deal A's fiscal year ends in March

Exhibit 3.11 — Consolidated E1 margin fell at Deal A (12.0% in FY22 to 6.2% in FY26) and Operator 4 (6.3% in 2024 to −1.4% in 2025), and corporate overhead has not fallen with scale

Consolidated E1 margin and corporate overhead, % of revenue, with revenue and clinic scale, by platform; CY2009 to LTM Jun-26; notes C-20, C-26

PLATFORM	E1 MARGIN (A)	CORPORATE OVERHEAD % REVENUE	OVERHEAD BASIS AND DEFINITION	SCALE
Operator 1	CY2009 8.5%; CY2012 6.7%; CY2016 7.0%; CY2017 12.0%	CY2011 8.6%; CY2015 9.4%; CY2016 5.8%; CY2017 4.7%	A; incl. regional, DC and advertising; clinic support split out from CY2016 (definition break)	$161m → $499m revenue; 99 → 304 clinics
Deal A	FY12 15.0%; FY19 13.2%; FY22 12.0%; FY24 9.8%; FY25 7.6%; FY26 6.2%	FY17 3.0%; FY20 3.2%; FY22 3.3%; FY23 4.1%; FY26 4.7%	A; corporate department costs excl. advertising	$1.0–1.2bn revenue; 1,117 → 983 clinics (FY22 → FY26)
Operator 5	2020 9.3%; 2021 9.5%; 2022 9.4%	5.1%; 5.6%; 5.1%	PF; corporate on adjusted revenue, excl. distribution	$90–126m; 35–38 clinics
Operator 7 ST-22	2023 8.9%; 2024 9.9%; 2025 12.0%; LTM May-26 9.8%	2024 5.9%; 2025 4.7%; LTM May-26 5.6%	PF; QoE-recast administration	$17–26m; 10 clinics
Operator 8	2022 6.0%; 2023 6.6%; 2024 9.8% (sources differ: 5.9%); 2025 2.9% (sources differ: 10.4%); LTM Mar-26 0.5%	2021 4.2%; 2023 5.2%; 2024 4.1%; 2025 4.5%; LTM Mar-26 4.8%	A; net of add-backs 2021–22, gross from 2023	$18m → $112m revenue
Operator 3	–	2023 2.0%; 2024 2.6%; LTM May-25 3.2% (PF); LTM Aug-25 2.9% (A)	Actual corporate on PF revenue; then on actual revenue	$96–123m
Operator 4	2023 5.1%; 2024 6.3%; 2025 −1.4%; LTM Mar-26 −1.3% (E2, PF: 8.5%; 10.1%; 13.3%; 11.8%)	2024 7.7%; 2025 7.7%	A; support plus corporate (sources differ)	$321m → $551m revenue
Operator 2	Deck E1 2021 7.0% → LTM Jun-26 8.7% (A [M])	2019 4.7%; 2020 4.1%; LTM Mar-21 4.6%	PF; total corporate burden on PF sales incl. LOIs	$346–371m PF (2019–21)

Source: note C-20 (E1, E2) and note C-26 (overhead); rows DLA-0251, DLA-0317, DLA-1350, DLA-1295, DLA-1223, OP4-0053, OP4-0103, OP4-1077, OP8-1880, OP8-1781, OP8-0394, OP8-2103, OP3-2566, OP3-2568, OP1-3250, OP1-3251, OP1-3236, OP1-3237 · Basis: E1 is basis A throughout; E2 and overhead basis as stated in each row. Overhead definitions differ, so levels are not pooled · Assumption: Register A-03: EBITDA is kept on named rungs

The operator tables, the loss-making and rank-persistence evidence, the overhead record, the public cost signals and the limits of the evidence behind this section are in Part 09 section J, under "03 C Margin consistency: supporting evidence".

D · Unit economics

From FY08 to FY25 a mature general practice and preventive clinic earned a mid-teens four-wall margin on cash rent before rebates, on $1.3–2.9m of average sales across the cash-rent clinic-years; an Operator 1 organic build cost $0.37–0.41m of clinic capex excluding real estate, and Operator 1 single-clinic entries took 4–5 years to ramp.

What holds. From FY08 to FY25 a mature general practice and preventive clinic earned a mid-teens four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent, on $1.3–2.9m of average sales across the cash-rent clinic-years ($1.5–2.9m in the eight clinic-years of Exhibit 3.12): the median full-year clinic made $149–268k at Operator 1 and $410–472k at Operator 5 and Operator 7 ST-22. That level holds at Operator 1, Operator 5 and Operator 7 ST-22, read across environments from the 2008–09 recession to 2026, and maintenance capex is low, at about 0.2–1.3% of sales. An Operator 1 organic build cost $0.37–0.41m of clinic capex excluding real estate, and built clinics and single-clinic entries returned 42–72% a year after maintenance capex from year 3 (an Operator 1-only result).

What to watch. New clinics take 4–5 years to ramp. Acquired clinics cost $1.0–3.2m each (deals 2021–26), and their later uplift shows only on company-presented, synergised EBITDA. A third of Deal A's clinics lost money in FY26 before co-op (19.5% on Ares Credit Group's basis; Part 05 section E).

Exhibit 3.12 — A typical full-year clinic's median four-wall ran $152–494k on $1.5–2.9m of average sales, FY08 to FY25 (D1.1, cash rent; the top of both ranges is Operator 5 FY22, pro forma); Operator 1's fell from $269k in FY09 to $152k in CY2016

Typical full-year clinic in eight selected clinic-years (Operator 1 FY08, FY09, CY2010, CY2013, CY2016; Operator 5 FY22; Operator 7 ST-22 FY23, FY25): average sales ($m), median four-wall ($k) and ratio-of-sums margin (%), four-wall before supplier rebates (D1.1) on cash rent

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 1 clinic P&Ls 2007 to 2014 and clinic financials, December 2017 (OP1-015, OP1-021); Operator 5 operating model, July 2023 (OP5-011); Operator 7 quality-of-earnings workbook (OP7-007); note C-30; fact rows per bar in the data file · Basis: Filled bars actual; hollow bars pro forma (Operator 5 FY22, quality-of-earnings adjusted). Full-year clinics; four-wall before supplier rebates on cash rent; Operator 7 rent is related-party

Exhibit 3.13 — Built clinics and Operator 1 single-clinic entries return 44–77% a year at Operator 1 before maintenance capex from year 3, against 14–30% for acquired add-ons on purchase price (clinic records 2007 to 2026)

Clinic earnings ÷ capital invested per clinic, % a year, clinic records 2007 to 2026; organic capital excludes real estate and purchase price, add-on capital is the price paid

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: CreditSwan computation (note C-33) from documents Ares Credit Group supplied: Operator 1 clinic P&Ls, clinic financials, unit-economics file and Project Echo model (OP1-015, OP1-021, OP1-025, OP1-016); Operator 2 IC memos, incremental investment memo and clinic databook (OP2-004, OP2-013, OP2-021, OP2-023, OP2-025); Operator 5 CIM and operating model (OP5-010, OP5-011); Operator 6 valuation multiple summary and CIP (OP6-012, OP6-010); Operator 4 IC memo (OP4-005); fact rows per bar in the data file · Basis: Filled bars actual, hollow bars pro forma (Operator 5 greenfield; Operator 6 add-ons at entry, on seller earnings). Operator 2 Operator 10 greenfields are company-presented, seller period; Operator 6 and Operator 4 clinic earnings are company-presented and after synergies; Operator 2 2018 to 2020 greenfields are COVID-affected; capital and returns are paired only within a platform

Exhibit 3.14 — Operator 1 clinics opened Jun-14 to Nov-16 earned a 2.0% first-year four-wall margin (D1.1) against 9.5% for Jul-08 to May-14 openings, and had not closed the gap by year three

Mean revenue per clinic ($m) and D1.1 four-wall margin (%) by full owned age-year; openings Jul-08 to Nov-16, clinic years 2009 to Nov-17

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 1 clinic-level financials (Project Echo, Dec-17), one sheet per clinic; rows A4-S0001 to A4-S0088 (all entries) and A4-S0377 to A4-S0399 (by opening period); ramp as computed in note C-34 · Basis: Actual (A); cash rent (R-CASH); D1.1 = four-wall margin before vendor rebates. Clinic base: all clinics with a clinic sheet at Nov-17, so clinics closed earlier may be missing. Single-clinic entry = greenfield, brownfield or single acquisition (the series does not say which). Clinic counts fall with age: year 9 of the all-entries line has 3 clinics; year 3 of the Jun-14 to Nov-16 openings has 9

Exhibit 3.15 — Acquired clinics cost $1.0–3.2m each (deals 2021–26) against $0.37–0.41m of clinic capex for an Operator 1 organic build and $1.0–1.4m for an Operator 5 greenfield

Capital per clinic, $k, by entry route and platform: clinic capex for builds (Operator 1 openings to Nov-16; Operator 5 greenfields), purchase price for acquisitions (2021–26)

ROUTE	PLATFORM	WHAT THE FIGURE COVERS	$K PER CLINIC	BASIS
Organic	Operator 1	Greenfield / brownfield clinic capex, 12 months either side of opening, ex land, inventory	369 / 360	A
Organic	Operator 1	Company summary: greenfield / brownfield-acquisition-renovation; ground-lease greenfield incl. building	388 / 405; 969	A
Organic	Operator 2	Greenfield: ~199 capex + ~67 inventory and other	254	A [M]
Organic	Operator 5	Greenfield City 32 / City 12, ex land and building	1,122 / 1,040–1,387 (sources differ)	A
Organic	Operator 8	New build (plan; none executed)	422	P
Acquired	Operator 1	Single acquisition clinic capex only (purchase price not in the data)	254	A
Acquired	Operator 3	Average purchase price, acquisitions 2021–24	930	A [M]
Acquired	Operator 6	TEV per clinic, 31 add-ons (46 clinics) 2021–26; integration and transaction cost	1,303; 134–192	A; PF [I]
Acquired	Operator 4	Aggregate price ÷ clinics, 2021 / 2025	1,324 / 3,208	A [I]

ROUTE	PLATFORM	WHAT THE FIGURE COVERS	$K PER CLINIC	BASIS
Acquired	Deal A	Price ÷ seller prior-year sales (register)	0.69× (FY13) to 1.00× (FY22)	A

Source: Operator 1 OP1-1501, OP1-1500, OP1-1499; OP1-7076, OP1-7074, OP1-7077; Operator 5 OP5-0339; OP5-0342, OP5-0343; Operator 3 OP3-1842; Operator 6 A4-S0368; OP6-1881 to OP6-1883; Operator 4 OP4-0765/OP4-0764, OP4-0785/OP4-0784; Operator 2, Operator 8 and Deal A as in note C-32; note C-37 · Basis: A unless marked; Operator 8 P (plan, none executed); [M] a company figure; [I] our division of aggregate price by clinic count. Organic figures exclude land and building; acquired figures are price paid, except Operator 1 single acquisitions (clinic capex only, purchase price not in the data)

The clinic tables, the add-on entry and later multiples, the Operator 2 owned-year record and the limits of the evidence behind this section are in Part 09 section J, under "03 D Unit economics: supporting evidence".

E · Same-store sales

Organic growth has been positive over the long run: median comparable sales rose in 15 of 19 years from 2007 to 2025 (+3.0% in 2010–14, +3.2% in 2015–19) and averaged +2.4% to +8.3% a year at six operators with long records; 2020–26 has been the noisiest stretch, and Deal A's +0.5% over 18 years is company-specific.

What holds. Comparable sales have grown in most years, through the ticket rather than through more visits. The cross-operator median was negative in only 4 of 19 years from 2007 to 2025, ran at +3.0% in 2010–14 and +3.2% in 2015–19, and was +1.8% in the 2024–26 soft period. Over each operator's longest record, same-store sales averaged +2.4% to +8.3% a year at six core operators, with negative years in at most a third of each record. For credit, comps that rise in most years on a steady client base give a predictable revenue line outside a shock like 2020.

What to watch. 2020 cut comparable sales by 2.7–9.5% before a 11.8–15.3% rebound in 2021, and from 2020 to mid-2026 comp traffic ranged from −20% to +10% across operators. Deal A averaged +0.5% over 18 years, with 9 negative years.

Exhibit 3.16 — Over each core operator's longest record (5 to 18 years, 2005–2025) same-store sales averaged +2.4% to +8.3% a year at six operators, with negative years in at most a third of each record, and +0.5% at Deal A with 9 negative years of 18

Same-store sales growth, % YoY, by operator over its longest available record, with its long-run mean; calendar years 2005 to 2025, 2020–25 shaded

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A Forms 10-K comparable-clinic sales (SEC filings); Operator 4 and Operator 9 lender panel (OP4-005); Operator 1 clinic data and Ares Credit Group Operator 1 update; Operator 2 data room (Operator 10 seller-period KPIs, Operator 2 clinic-level databook, later company reports); Operator 5 volume trends; Operator 8 databooks. One row per bar in the data file; note C-121 · Basis: Actual (A), except Operator 2 2018, a pro forma company number from a lender deck (hollow). Each operator's best-available annual series as in note C-43, whatever its definition: company definitions for Deal A (public comp, all clinics), Operator 4 and Operator 9 (lender panel), Operator 1 after 2017 and Operator 2 after 2020; the common definition rebuilt from clinic data elsewhere. Means are simple averages of the annual values. The Operator 2 lineage is Operator 10 to 2017 and the Operator 2 platform from 2018. Operators measured over different spans and definitions are not ranked. Deal A's fiscal year sits in the calendar year holding nine of its months. Operators with fewer than five years (Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 29, Operator 7) and the PF company series of Deal C and Deal B are not shown · Assumption: A-01; A-07

Exhibit 3.17 — From 2020 to mid-2026 comp traffic ranged from −20% to +10% across core operators; at the other operators shown, comparable sales were positive in every reading from 2022, while Deal A's traffic fell in six of its last seven readings

Comp traffic and comparable sales, % YoY, by operator, annual and latest twelve-month or quarterly readings; 2019 to June 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A all-clinics KPI report FY20–Q1 FY27; Operator 2 clinic-level databook; Operator 5 volume trends; Operator 3 datacube (31 August 2025); Operator 6 visit count file (April and May 2026 update); Operator 8 databooks; Operator 7 credit databook (5 August 2026); Operator 4 lender panel (OP4-005 p.20). One fact row per value in the data file · Basis: Actual (A). Each operator on its own base and definition, so levels are not ranked: Deal A, Operator 3 and Operator 6 on survivor files (closed clinics excluded); Operator 8 2021 and Operator 4 on company definitions, Operator 4's "volume" measured in a unit the lender does not state; Operator 7 visit count

definition not stated. Deal A's fiscal years end in March and Q1 FY27 is April to June 2026; twelve-month and quarterly readings overlap the annual ones. Operators shown are those with comp traffic or a sales-and-volume split since 2020; on company definitions without a traffic series, Operator 2 (−0.3%), Operator 9 (0.0%) and Operator 29 (−5.4%) were flat to negative in 2024 (Exhibit 3.18). Deal B and Deal C company comps are pro forma and are read in Parts 06 and 07 · Assumption: A-01; A-07

Exhibit 3.18 — Median same-store sales growth across operators was negative in 4 of 19 years from 2007 to 2025, deepest at −5.9% in 2020; in 2024 operators ranged from −5.4% to +5.9% (Deal C, pro forma; +4.3% at Operator 4 is the highest actual reading)

Same-store sales growth, % YoY, one value per core operator per calendar year, with the cross-operator median; 2007 to 2025

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator documents supplied by Ares Credit Group (Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 3, Operator 8, Operator 6, Operator 7, Operator 4 and Operator 9, Operator 29, Deal B datapack, Deal C KPI data pack) and Deal A Forms 10-K; one fact row per dot, listed in the data file; series per operator as in note C-41, cross-operator median as in note C-42 · Basis: Actual (A) except Operator 2 2018 and Deal C 2023–25, which are pro forma (PF, company-adjusted; hollow). Colour gives the comp definition: SSS_CD rebuilt from clinic data on a comp base with closures dropping out going forward (CLOSE-FWD), SSS_CD on a survivor base (CLOSE-RETRO), or the company's own definition (SSS_ST-59). Calendar years; Deal A's fiscal year is mapped to the calendar year holding 9 of its 12 months; Operator 1 2008 = FY Jun-08 to May-09. Dots are offset sideways within each year by operator for legibility only. The median is across all definitions. Deal B 2024 and 2025 are on the common definition with closures dropping out going forward (D2.1, CLOSE-FWD), the values Part 06 section B uses; Deal B and Deal C rows were read once from the source

Exhibit 3.19 — Operators' mean comparable sales moved together in COVID20 (median −5.9%) and REOPEN21 (median +11.8%, all seven at +11.8% to +15.3%), were all positive but widely spread in INFL22-23 (median +5.3%), and diverged in the GFC, both halves of the 2010–19 expansion and SOFT24-26, 2005 to 2025

Mean annual same-store sales by operator and environment, % (number of years in brackets), 2005 to 2025; definition and closure code per row

OPERATOR	DEFINITION / CLOSURE CODE	PRE-GFC	GFC	EXP10-14	EXP15-19	COVID20	REOPEN21	INFL22-23	SOFT24-26
Deal A	SSS_ST-59 public; CLOSE-FWD type (all-clinic public base)	+2.2% (2)	+3.4% (2)	+0.6% (6)	−0.8% (5)	−9.5% (1)	+13.2% (1)	+0.3% (2)	−1.8% (2)
Operator 1	SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD; SSS_CO-PF 2018 and SSS_ST-59 Ares Credit Group 2023–25 (CLOSE-UNK)	–	+8.8% (1)	+5.7% (5)	0.0% (5)	−2.7% (1)	+11.8% (1)	+5.6% (2)	+1.1% (2)
Operator 2 lineage	SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD (Operator 10 standalone to 2017; platform 2019–20); SSS_ST-59 CLOSE-UNK otherwise	–	−0.3% (2)	+0.3% (6)	+5.4% (5)	−7.6% (1)	+11.8% (1)	+6.6% (2)	+0.8% (2)
Operator 4	SSS_ST-59, definition not stated; CLOSE-UNK	–	–	+5.9% (5)	+3.2% (5)	−5.9% (1)	+11.8% (1)	+4.8% (2)	+3.0% (2)
Operator 5	SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD	–	–	–	+3.6% (2)	−5.6% (1)	+14.1% (1)	+10.1% (1)	–
Operator 8	SSS_ST-59 2021 (CLOSE-UNK); SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD 2022–25	–	–	–	–	–	+11.8% (1)	+9.2% (2)	+5.3% (2)
Operator 3	SSS_CD CLOSE-RETRO (survivor)	–	–	–	–	–	–	+12.5% (2)	+2.4% (1)
Operator 6	SSS_ST-59 2023 (CLOSE-UNK); SSS_CD CLOSE-RETRO 2024–25 (13 clinics)	–	–	–	–	–	–	+5.3% (1)	+2.4% (2)
Operator 9	SSS_ST-59, definition not stated; CLOSE-UNK	–	–	–	–	–	+15.3% (1)	+4.8% (2)	+1.0% (2)
Operator 29	SSS_ST-59; CLOSE-UNK	–	–	–	–	–	–	+2.4% (1)	−1.9% (2)
Deal C (read once from the source)	SSS_ST-59 working-day and blackout adjusted; survivor site DB	–	–	–	–	–	–	+3.2% (1)	+5.2% (2)
Deal B	D2.1 SSS_CD, CLOSE-FWD	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	+0.4% (2)
Operator 7	SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD; pre-combination seller-period data	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	+11.4% (1)
Cross-operator median (n operators)	mixed	+2.2% (1)	+3.4% (3)	+3.0% (4)	+3.2% (5)	−5.9% (5)	+11.8% (7)	+5.3% (11)	+1.8% (12)

Source: note C-45 and note C-44; Deal B is the mean of −3.9% (2024) and +4.7% (2025), DLB-1361 and DLB-1406 (note C-92). Cell = mean of the operator's full-year values in that environment, years in brackets; month-majority tags (Deal A FY20 in EXP15-19, FY21 COVID20, FY22 REOPEN21, FY24 INFL22-23; calendar 2009 is tagged EXP10-14). Basis A except Operator 2 2018 and Deal C 2023–25 (PF, company-adjusted); Operator 1 2018 is an actual figure on a pro forma all-brands scope (SSS_CO-PF), as in Exhibit 3.18. Clinic base COMP throughout; closure code as listed. Definitions are mixed across rows, so a column is not like-for-like where SSS_ST-59 and SSS_CD are mixed. Means ending in 5 at the second decimal are rounded away from zero. Deal A SOFT24-26 mixes FY25 as reported (−4.5%) with FY26 days-adjusted (+1.2%); on the days-adjusted basis for both years the mean is −1.0%

The operator tables, the definition tests, the 2026 company statements and the limits of the evidence behind this section are in Part 09 section J, under "03 E Same-store sales: supporting evidence".

F · Cash-flow profile

Deal A, the only long audited record, converted a median 0.64 of reported EBITDA after total capex in 20 steady years (FY2000–26) but 0.44 in FY2026 excluding disposal gains; at acquisitive platforms cash EBITDA was 0.24–0.83 of top adjusted EBITDA (FY2023 to March 2026).

What holds. Before financing, general practice and preventive operators keep most of their EBITDA. Company-stated maintenance splits give 0.73–0.85 conversion, and Deal A, the only long audited record, converted a median 0.64 of reported EBITDA after total capex in 20 steady years from FY2000 to FY2026 (range 0.53–0.72), across all seven economic environments. Low maintenance reinvestment is the durable feature of the cash profile.

What to watch. Deal A converted 0.44 in FY2026 excluding disposal gains. At acquisitive platforms "one-time" deal and integration costs recur for three to nine consecutive years, so cash EBITDA ran at 0.24–0.83 of the top adjusted figure (median 0.73) and at 0.24–0.37 in the heaviest acquisition years. Leverage decides what is left after interest: levered free cash before growth was negative at Operator 4 and Operator 9. Deal A's cash after financing costs is read in Part 08 section B.

Exhibit 3.20 — Company-stated maintenance splits give 0.73–0.85 conversion; independent measures run lower, with Deal A's steady-state median at 0.64 (FY2000–26), 0.44 in FY2026 excluding disposal gains, and Operator 9 at 0.41 (FY Sep-25)

Conversion = (EBITDA − maintenance capex) ÷ EBITDA, ratio, by operator and period, FY2000 to LTM Mar-26; EBITDA rung and maintenance measure as labelled

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 6 Investment Committee Memo; Operator 3 lender model and Accounting Firm 3 pro forma; Operator 8 Accounting Firm 2 due diligence; Operator 1 CIM and bidder bank model; Operator 5 Accounting Firm 5 due diligence; Operator 4 and Operator 9 audits; Deal A 10-K filings (SEC); Deal C Internal Diligence Exhibits (QoE summary, p.11) and Financial Model (Summer 2026), fact rows DLC-4425 and DLC-005-000567. CreditSwan computation (note C-59, note C-60, note C-62); fact rows per bar in the data file · Basis: Filled = actual (audited or filed EBITDA, E1); hollow = pro forma (adjusted EBITDA, E2 or E3). Left: maintenance capex as split by the company; right: total capex or a depreciation proxy. Consolidated, all clinics. Deal B's company split is on consolidated EBITDA that includes DBW and is read in Part 06 · Assumption: Where the company gives no maintenance split, total capex (Deal A) or depreciation (Operator 5, Operator 4, Operator 9) stands in for maintenance capex

Exhibit 3.21 — Deal A's conversion after capex held at 0.55–0.72 in steady years FY2011–22 and fell to 0.52 in FY26 (0.44 excluding disposal gains)

Cash conversion ratio CONV_1 (E1 less total capex, over E1), Deal A fiscal years FY2010 to FY2026 (years ending March)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A Forms 10-K, FY2010 to FY2026 (income statement, cash-flow statement and clinic-count disclosures); FY2023–FY2026 fact rows DLA-0266 to DLA-0328; computation in note C-62 (fact row A6-P5-003 for FY2026 excluding gains on disposal) · Basis: Actual (A), consolidated, all clinics. E1 = operating income + D&A + impairment, gains on disposal included; the diamond restates FY26 on E1 excluding gains on disposal. CONV_1 deducts total capex, an upper bound on maintenance capex. Deal A's cash after interest and finance-lease principal is read in Part 08 section B · Assumption: Total capex is treated as maintenance capex; a BUILD year is one in which openings and acquisitions exceed 9% of the opening clinic base

Exhibit 3.22 — From FY2023 to TTM Mar-26 cash EBITDA ran at 24–86% of the top adjusted rung at core platforms; Operator 3 kept 82–86%, while Operator 8, Operator 4 from FY25 and Operator 6 FY24 sat below 38%

E6 cash EBITDA ÷ top adjusted EBITDA rung (E3; as-owned E2m for Operator 8), %, by platform and period, FY2023 to TTM Mar-26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 4 investment committee memorandum (credit-agreement EBITDA bridge) and audited financials; Operator 8 databook (Mar-26) and situation update; Operator 6 confidential information presentation and investment committee memorandum; Operator 3 confidential information presentation, lender model and early read. Gap as computed in note C-61; fact rows OP4-0011 to OP4-1081, OP8-1781 to OP8-2409, OP6-0047 to OP6-0649, OP3-1125 to OP3-2571 · Basis: Pro forma (PF): E3 (adjusted / pro forma EBITDA) and E6 are pro forma by definition, so every bar is hollow. E6 cash EBITDA = the top adjusted rung less the cash "one-time" costs that recur in three or more consecutive years, as in note C-61. Consolidated, all clinics. Operator 8's E6 is built from its as-owned adjusted EBITDA (E2m, $12.1m) and is drawn against it; its E3 ($23.8m) is fully pro forma for acquisitions through May-26 including seller data and has no matching E6. Only core platform-periods with an E6 value are drawn (11)

Exhibit 3.23 — "One-time" cash costs recurred for three to nine consecutive years at every acquisitive platform between FY2011 and 2026

Cash "one-time" add-back categories by platform: number of categories, number recurring three or more consecutive years, longest run in years, and transaction and integration cash as % of price, FY2011 to 2026

PLATFORM	CASH "ONE-TIME" CATEGORIES	RECURRING ≥3 CONSECUTIVE YEARS	LONGEST RUN (YEARS)	EXAMPLE (YEARS; ROWS)	TRANSACTION/INTEGRATION CASH AS % OF PRICE
Deal A	9	6	8	Acquisition costs FY2017–24 (DLA-1265..DLA-1356); clinic closing FY2021–26 (DLA-1232..DLA-1322)	0.6–1.8% (FY2016–20); 1.5% / 0.7% (FY2021 / FY2022)
Operator 2	43	14	9	Management/consulting fees 2018–26 (OP2-4126..4393); restructuring 2021–26 (OP2-4155..4408)	3.2% / 5.1% (FY2019 / FY2020); 2.3–62% by 2020 deal
Operator 1	7	4	4	Transaction costs 2012–14, 2016, 2018–20 (note C-57)	1.5% (Operator 27, FY2020); 13.3% of cohort EV (FY2021)
Operator 4	5	4	4	Integration and transaction 2023–26 (OP4-0987..0998)	2.5% / 2.3% (FY2024 / FY2025)
Operator 6	3	3	3	Transaction 2024–26 (OP6-0632, 563, 44)	14.1% / 10.1% (FY2024 / FY2025)
Operator 3	8	4	3	Acquisition costs 2023–25 (OP3-1146..1148)	2.7% / 6.3% (FY2023 / FY2024)
Operator 8	9	2	3	Transaction fees and retrofits 2024–26 (OP8-1812..1820, OP8-1951..1960)	6.7% (FY2025, four dated deals)
Operator 5	2	1	3	Non-recurring 2020–22 (OP5-0074..0076)	n/a

Source: note C-56, note C-57 and note C-58 (Deal A acquisition-cost rows from the 10-K public series DLA_ACQ and DLA_ACQ_COSTS). Only cash categories on A/PF annual consolidated rows are counted; impairment is tracked as non-cash. Under D3 these items are E6 deductions, not add-backs. Basis A or PF as in the source rows; clinic base ALL (consolidated)

The operator tables, the conversion bridges, working capital and the limits of the evidence behind this section are in Part 09 section J, under "03 F Cash-flow profile: supporting evidence".

Part 04 — Multiples and benchmark

Platform multiples have risen partly on more adjusted earnings, first-lien leverage at close has held near 4.3x, and the benchmark is a map of valid comparisons rather than a league table

Ares Credit Group asked. Ares Credit Group asked for "a view on valuation (platform and add on multiples) & leverage multiples over time" and to "benchmark the historical deals we've looked at … on these metrics and any other relevant KPIs that come up", using "public sources" among others; the emergency and specialty and wellness clinic files were uploaded "to incorporate as is helpful".

Headline platform multiples rose from 10–10x in 2012–16 to 15–15.0x in 2018–26, but not on a common earnings definition, while mid-market chains stayed at about 10–12x and small clinics have changed hands at 4.0–5.8x standalone clinic-level EBITDA since 2021; first-lien leverage at close has sat near a 4.3x median since 2014, on one or two operators per vintage. Ten common-definition rankings exist, each in one environment on three or four operators, so operators are described rather than ranked. Public clinic lists read on 30 September 2026 and census income for 2020 to 2024 place the three deals in markets with median household incomes of $60.7k to $84.0k within three miles.

Every multiple and leverage print is stated on its named earnings measure and debt perimeter, and operators are ranked only where at least three share one definition in one environment. Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only, and public figures are values of record on the date they were read.

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED
A-03	EBITDA is kept on named levels	Reported, adjusted, pro forma, run-rate, underwriting and cash EBITDA (pro forma less "one-time" costs that recur)
A-09	Operators are ranked only where a ranking is valid	At least three operators on one definition in one environment
A-10	Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only	Never pooled with preventive care and pharmacy and general practice veterinary care in a core statistic
A-12	Every multiple states its earnings measure and the debt it counts	Leverage from first-lien funded debt up to all debt with leases and supplier finance; multiples marked standalone or synergised
A-P2	Ratings, counts and posted prices are values of record on the date read	As read on 30 September 2026; public series as retrieved on 28 September 2026
A-P3	A clinic's trade area is a fixed radius around it	Census tracts within three miles (five where stated), American Community Survey 2020–2024

Exhibit 4.01 — Multiples rose partly on more adjusted earnings, first-lien leverage at close has held near 4.3x since 2014 on an Operator 1-heavy set, no operator can be ranked overall, and public data place the three deals in different markets

Our answer on each of Ares Credit Group's asks on multiples, leverage, the benchmark, the scope of wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals, and what public sources add; transactions 2012–26, operator records to 2026 (the longest from FY1996, Deal A), public sources read on 30 September 2026 (census income 2020–2024)

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
"A view on valuation (platform and add on multiples) … over time" (G9; Part 04 section A)	Headline platform prints rose from 10–10x (2012–16) to 15–15.0x (2018–26), partly on more adjusted earnings (the Operator 1 rise holds on less-adjusted EBITDA, 11.9x to 17.1x), while mid-market and regional-chain prints stayed at about 10–12x; only Operator 1 shows the rise inside one operator (9.9x in 2014 to 14.0x in 2018), and the 2021–26 prints of 13.5–15.2x at Operator 3, Operator 4 and Operator 6 rest on earnings that include letters of intent or run-rate synergies. Small-clinic add-ons have cost a stable 4.0–5.8x standalone clinic-level EBITDA since 2021; counting buyer synergies lowers a quoted multiple by a median 2.8 turns.	20 closed or signed platform transactions over 2012–26, 10 of them Operator 1, with no print for 2013, 2017, 2019 or 2022; add-on prints from eight acquirers, standalone only from 2021; almost all on pro forma deal-document earnings.	A 2019 or 2022 platform print on the buyer's quality-of-earnings EBITDA; later add-on multiples restated after corporate cost and integration capex
"… & leverage multiples over time" (G9; Part 04 section B)	First-lien leverage at close has sat near a 4.3x median on financing EBITDA since 2014, on one or two operators per vintage, with a 2021 peak at Operator 2's 5.97x; the earnings definition underneath moves quoted leverage more than vintage does. At 4.8–5.8x, fixed-charge cover reads about 0.7–1.2x at four of five prints (Operator 1 FY22: 1.38x at 5.53x), three of them on projected cases; it is an association on mixed definitions, not a threshold. The proposed financings of the three deals are read in Part 08.	Ten closed first-lien events from three operators (seven of them Operator 1); same-debt ladders at five platforms; nine cover prints from seven operators; closed prints on pro forma financing EBITDA, cover prints on actual, pro forma and projected bases; no default or restructuring in the set.	Reported and cash-EBITDA prints for Operator 1, Operator 3 and Operator 7; compliance certificates giving covenant headroom

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
"benchmark the historical deals we've looked at … on these metrics and any other relevant KPIs that come up" (G10; Part 04 section C to Part 04 section F)	No operator can be ranked overall: ten common-definition rankings exist, each in one environment on three or four operators, and ranks do not carry across environments. Read descriptively and each with a caveat on basis, clinic base or rent, Operator 5, Operator 7 ST-22 and Operator 3 show the strongest evidence and Deal A and Operator 4 the weakest (Operator 4 on earnings, cash and leverage measures); in the 2024 to 2026 soft period comparable traffic fell at every established operator with a common-definition reading (Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6) and rose only on newly assembled bases (Operator 8, Operator 7).	Eleven operators, each on its own period, rent treatment and clinic base; four of eight areas carry a ranking; margins, unit economics and cash flow are described only.	Deal A's closed-clinic history since FY20; four-wall margins before rebates on cash rent from Deal B and Deal C
Emergency and specialty hospitals and wellness clinics "to incorporate as is helpful" (G1; Part 04 section G)	Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only (Part 04 section G): a wellness clinic visit is a $86–111 ticket built on a wellness exam and an emergency and specialty patient invoice a $2,007–3,938 referral case often paid through pet insurance, so their clinic metrics are never pooled with the core. They inform leverage, adjustment share and multiples on a stated earnings measure; DBW compares with them on revenue per visit only.	Three wellness clinic and three emergency and specialty operators, readings from 2007 to 2026, mostly actual; wellness clinic traffic rests on two operators.	DBW's four-wall margin bridged to cash rent, and an owned-period comparable visit count
What "public sources" add across operators (G2, G10; Part 04 section H)	On clinic lists read on 30 September 2026 and census income for 2020 to 2024, the three clinic bases sit in different markets: median household income within three miles is $84.0k at Deal C's mapped clinics, $69.6k at Deal A and $60.7k at Deal B, and an Operator 1-banner clinic stands within three miles of 35.5% of Deal A's clinics and 38.8% of Deal B's clinics.	Public clinic lists, employer and complaint sites and company pages, each read on 30 September 2026, and census tracts for 2020–2024. The public lists (Deal A 924 clinics, Deal B 96 clinics, Deal C 72 clinics) are used only as the base for mapping; for clinic counts the supplied documents govern (Deal A 983 clinics, Deal B 103 clinics, Deal C about 86). The signals are operating signals only, never evidence of clinic economics.	A later reading of the same pages; Deal C's full clinic list; Operator 1's other banners mapped

Source: Part 04 section A to Part 04 section H, where each figure carries its references · Basis: Valuation multiples and closed leverage prints on pro forma deal-document earnings (PF); cover prints on actual, pro forma and projected bases (A, PF, P); operating measures mostly actual (A); public figures as read on 30 September 2026

A · Valuation multiples

Headline platform multiples rose from 10–10x in 2012–16 to 15–15.0x in 2018–26, but only Operator 1 shows the rise inside one operator, on the same rung (E4) with a larger share of adjustments (2014 to 2018); small-clinic add-ons have cost a stable 4.0–5.8x standalone clinic-level EBITDA since 2021.

What holds. Small independent clinics have changed hands at about 4.0–5.8x standalone clinic-level EBITDA in every environment with standalone data (5.8x in 2021, 4.0x in 2022–23, 4.8x in 2024–26), so the add-on price is the durable series. Mid-market and regional-chain prices stayed at about 10–12x.

What to watch. Headline platform multiples rose from 10–10x in 2012–16 to 15–15.0x in 2018–26, but only Operator 1 shows the step-up inside one operator, from 9.9x in 2014 to 14.0x in 2018, on increasingly adjusted EBITDA (the rise holds on less-adjusted EBITDA, 11.9x to 17.1x); the 2021–26 prints of 13.5–15.2x at Operator 3, Operator 4 and Operator 6 rest on EBITDA that includes letters of intent or run-rate synergies. Synergised add-on prints sit about three turns below standalone, so a quoted multiple needs its EBITDA named. Marks set at the 2021 peak have since been cut to 12.5x for Operator 1 and Operator 2.

Exhibit 4.02 — 2012 to 2026: Operator 1's headline entry multiple rose from 9.9x (2014) to 13.96x (2021, on a less comparable rung); 2024–26 lower-rung prints run 12.5–33.6x and synergised prints 5.8–15.2x

Platform and scale-transaction EV ÷ EBITDA multiples (x) by transaction date and EBITDA rung, 2012 to 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Ares Credit Group investment committee memoranda and situation updates for Operator 1 (2014, 2018, 2021, 2023, 2026), Operator 2 (2018, 2024), Operator 8 (with the Accounting Firm 2 financial diligence report), Operator 4, Operator 6 and Operator 7 (credit databook); note C-69. Fact rows listed per point in the data file · Basis: One marker per multiple as printed in the source, on the EBITDA rung the source states; several deals appear on more than one rung. Filled = actual EBITDA (Operator 30 2012, Operator 29, Operator 30 2025); hollow = pro forma EBITDA (all other prints). Letters of intent, bids, proposals and multiples on forecast EBITDA (projected basis), EBITDAR multiples and less-adjusted cross-checks are not drawn. Operator 30 prints are franchisor economics. Operator 2 (Sponsor 1) carries two prints from two documents (14.8x and 15.0x). Market multiples of the three live deals are not drawn; they are in Part 08 section B to Part 08 section D

Exhibit 4.03 — Add-on deals 2015 to 2026: standalone multiples have a median of 5.5x under $0.4m of target EBITDA and 6.7x at $1.0–2.2m; buyer synergies lower the same deals' multiples by 0–70%

Median add-on price ÷ acquired EBITDA (x) by acquired-EBITDA bucket (left); standalone vs synergised multiple for the same transaction (right); deals 2015 to 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 6 valuation multiple summary; Operator 7 credit databook; Operator 3 lender model (2025 add-ons); Operator 8 financial model (Dec-24) and situation update; Operator 2 investment committee memoranda, 2021 situation update and 2018 comparables file; Operator 1 investment committee memoranda (2018, 2021); Operator 4 investment committee memorandum; note C-66, note C-71. Fact rows listed per mark in the data file · Basis: Left: price ÷ acquired EBITDA as presented by the seller or on a pro forma basis; the source carries no actual / pro forma flag per deal, so marks are drawn filled. Pooled standalone = Operator 6, Operator 7, Operator 3 2025 deals and the Operator 8 financial-model deals; the under-$0.4m bucket includes two Operator 3 deals dated after the 10 October 2025 pipeline update (projected closings), without which its median is 4.8x on 34 deals [1]. Right: filled = actual (Operator 4 pools, standalone), hollow = pro forma (all other values). Pairs with a projected-basis leg and the Operator 3 2025 pipeline medians (scheduled, not closed) are not drawn. The emergency and specialty merger of 2019 is context and sits in Exhibit 9.94

Exhibit 4.04 — 2015 to 2026: on the same transaction, synergised EBITDA lowers the multiple by up to 6.2 turns (0–61%) across the 15 core deals drawn, and Operator 4/Operator 9, left off for scale, falls from 33.6x to 6.6x

EV ÷ EBITDA on standalone and on synergised EBITDA for the same transaction, x, 2015 to 2026; Operator 4/Operator 9 (33.6x standalone against 6.6x and 9.4x) is left off for scale

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Ares Credit Group investment committee memos for Operator 1 (2018, 2021, 2023), Operator 2 and Operator 4; Operator 8 (Operator 8) Financial Model (Dec-24); Operator 3 Business Update Package (October 2025); note C-71; two fact rows per transaction in the data file · Basis: Multiples as the company or sponsor presented them; synergies not verified. Filled = on actual EBITDA, hollow = on pro forma EBITDA, hatched = on projected EBITDA, as each source row is recorded

Exhibit 4.05 — 2010 to 2026: small-clinic add-ons cost 4.0–5.8x standalone in every environment with data; only regional chains reach 8.6x

Median entry multiple (x) of add-on acquisitions by seller EBITDA size and by market environment, standalone against synergised, 2010 to 2026; platform acquisition schedules

CUT	STANDALONE ENTRY: MEDIAN (N DEALS; PLATFORMS)	SYNERGISED OR SYNERGY-UNSTATED: MEDIAN (N DEALS; PLATFORM)	COMPUTATION NOTE
Seller EBITDA < $0.4m	4.8x (37; 4), P25–P75 4.0–5.8x	Operator 2 Sponsor 1-era 5.9x (13, unstated); Operator 2 Sponsor 2-era 4.3x (3, synergised); Operator 8 0.8x (1, synergised)	note C-66
Seller EBITDA $0.4–1.0m	4.7x (10; 3), P25–P75 3.7–6.7x	Operator 2 Sponsor 1-era 4.7x (13); Operator 2 Sponsor 2-era 2.3x (1); Operator 8 OP8-009 5.1x (1)	note C-66
Seller EBITDA $1.0–2.2m	6.7x (3; 2), P25–P75 5.7–7.2x	Operator 2 Sponsor 1-era 4.67x (14); Operator 2 Sponsor 2-era 5.6x (8); Operator 8 6.13x (6)	note C-66
Seller EBITDA $2.2–8.6m	no standalone small-clinic deal	Operator 2 Sponsor 1-era 6.7x (7); Operator 2 Sponsor 2-era 6.7x (5); Operator 8 7.9x (3); Regional Chain 1 11.2x standalone, consolidated E2 (1)	note C-66
Regional chains > $8.6m	no small-clinic deal	Operator 18 8.8x, Regional Chain 2 9.4x, Operator 27 10.2x, Operator 33 13.2x (all standalone, consolidated)	note C-69
EXP10-19	none on an EBITDA basis before 2020	5.7x (17; Wellness Clinic Operator 3 targets, Operator 2 Sponsor 2-era)	note C-64
COVID20	–	5.4x (5; Operator 2)	note C-64
REOPEN21	5.8x (4; 3)	5.8x (13; Operator 2)	note C-64
INFL22-23	4.0x (16; 3)	5.1x (9; Operator 2 Sponsor 1-era)	note C-64
SOFT24-26	4.8x (47; 4)	5.8x (35; Operator 2 Sponsor 1-era, Operator 8)	note C-64
Same-price pairs (17 core)	median gap 2.8 turns (32% of standalone; 32% ex Operator 9)		note C-71

Source: note C-66, note C-64, note C-71. Standalone pool = Operator 6 (OP6-012), Operator 7 (OP7-005, management estimates), Operator 3 2025 deals (OP3-005/OP3-001; two dated after the 10 October 2025 pipeline update are projected closings), Operator 8

OP8-003 derived standalone; seller EBITDA clinic-level or seller-adjusted; deals with seller EBITDA ≤ 0 or margin < 3% are n/m. Basis A/PF, P for the Operator 3 pipeline rows. Operator 2 Sponsor 1-era multiples use the debt-funded portion of price (OP2-025 footnote, OP2-4604). Clinic base: deals as closed (ALL)

The platform prints, the later multiples of surviving add-ons, the 2025–26 public transactions and the limits of the evidence behind this section are in Part 09 section K, under "04 A Valuation multiples: supporting evidence".

B · Leverage multiples

First-lien leverage at close has sat near a 4.3x median on financing EBITDA since 2014, on one or two operators per vintage; the EBITDA definition underneath moves the print more than vintage does, by a factor of 1.3x to about 3.4x.

What holds. First-lien leverage at close has sat near a 4.3x median on financing EBITDA since 2014 (Operator 1 4.10–4.27x in 2014–18, Operator 2 4.24x in 2018, Operator 1 4.38x in 2021, Operator 6 3.81x in 2026), though on one or two operators per vintage. The 2021 peak, Operator 2's 5.97x, was temporary.

What to watch. The EBITDA definition underneath moves the print more than vintage does: prints on adjusted rungs are a median 1.14x the financing print, and prints on reported or cash EBITDA 1.1–3.9x. Sponsor platforms have de-levered through acquired and adjusted EBITDA rather than paydown. Deal A's funded leverage of 0.73x in FY2026 becomes 5.30x once finance leases, capitalised rent and supplier finance are counted. The proposed financings of the three live deals are read in Part 08, not here.

Exhibit 4.06 — Closing first-lien leverage on pro forma financing EBITDA ranged 3.8–5.9x for core platforms across 2014–26, peaking at Operator 2's 2021 Sponsor 1 LBO; total-funded (LV2) prints ran 4.7–5.8x

Closing leverage (x) on financing EBITDA by close date and market environment: first lien (LV1), total funded (LV2) and company-defined, core platforms, 2014 to 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Ares Credit Group investment committee memoranda and situation updates for Operator 1 (2014, 2018, 2021, 2023, 2026), Operator 2 (2018, 2024), Operator 4, Operator 6 and Operator 8; note C-74, note C-75. Fact rows listed per mark in the data file · Basis: Closed financings only: one print per event and rung, gross where the document gives it, otherwise net (marked "net"). Every denominator is pro forma financing EBITDA (E3–E5 as defined in the credit document), so every marker is hollow. Proposals and underwriting cases, preferred-inclusive (LV4) and lease-adjusted (LV5) rungs are not drawn. Medians are of core closed gross prints per environment. Market environments are captioned above the plot (EXP10-19 to 2019, COVID20 2020, REOPEN21 2021, INFL22-23 2022–2023, SOFT24-26 from 2024); COVID20 and INFL22-23 are shaded. Operator 8's 0.93x is on TTM Sep-24 pro forma EBITDA of $8.3m (a second document in the same file prints 1.0x). Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital closing prints are context and are set out in Exhibit 9.98

Exhibit 4.07 — Dec-24 to Jul-26: the same debt reads 3.3–5.4x on financing EBITDA but up to 19.9x on cash and 16.8x on reported EBITDA at three platforms

Leverage (x) of one fixed debt amount on each EBITDA rung (E1 to E6), by platform and balance date, Dec-24 to Jul-26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 4 (Operator 4 HoldCo) FY25 and Q1 2026 financial statements; Operator 8 Q1 2026 lender update; Operator 6 investment committee memorandum; note C-77. Fact rows listed per mark in the data file · Basis: Each row holds the debt amount fixed and divides it by every EBITDA rung the documents give. Hollow = pro forma EBITDA; filled = actual (Operator 4 Dec-24 audited E1, Operator 6 as-owned E1). No proposed financing is drawn; Deal A's debt and leverage after FY2026 are in Part 08 section B. Operator 8 has no reported-EBITDA (E1) rung in the source. Log scale. Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital ladders are context and are set out in Exhibit 9.98

Exhibit 4.08 — Deal A FY20 to FY26, from its filings: first-lien LV1 stayed at or below 1.1x after FY20, while lease-inclusive LV3 rose to 3.0x and LV6 to 5.4x (6.2x excluding disposal gains)

Deal A leverage ladder (x): LV1, LV3, LV5 (5.3x rent) and LV6 on E1, gross, fiscal years FY2020 to FY2026 (years ending March), with FY26 on E1 excluding gains on disposal

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A Forms 10-K, FY2020 to FY2026 (balance sheet at fiscal year end, cash-flow statement, lease and supplier-finance disclosures); fact rows DLA-0221, DLA-0236, DLA-0251, DLA-0266, DLA-0283, DLA-0300, DLA-0317 and those listed in the data file; note C-81 · Basis: Actual (A): Deal A's own historical leverage from its filed balance sheets; this is not the proposed financing. E1 = operating income + D&A + impairment, gains on disposal included; diamonds use FY26 E1 excluding gains on disposal. Rent = cash operating-lease payments. LV4 equals LV3 (no preferred). LV6 is available from FY23. FY20 LV1 of 3.27x reflects the revolver drawn and held as cash (1.08x net). Gross figures; net variants are not drawn · Assumption: Operating leases are capitalised at 5.3x cash operating rent for LV5 and LV6

Exhibit 4.09 — 2014 to 2026: closed first-lien leverage at close had a median of 5.00x in 2010–19, 5.14x in 2021 and 3.81x in 2024–26, on one or two operators per vintage

Leverage at close (x) on financing EBITDA by rung and market environment: count, minimum, median and maximum of closed prints, proposals shown apart, 2014 to 2026; Ares Credit Group deal documents

RUNG, GROSS/NET	D10 VINTAGE	N PRINTS	OPERATORS	MIN	MEDIAN	MAX	BASIS	FACT ROWS
LV1 gross	EXP10-19	5	Operator 1 (4), Operator 2 (1)	4.10x	4.27x	4.27x	PF	OP1-7357, OP1-7584, OP1-7585, OP1-7795, OP2-0250
LV1 gross	REOPEN21	2	Operator 1, Operator 2	4.38x	5.14x	5.97x	PF	OP1-10719, P5-S001
LV1 gross	SOFT24-26	1	Operator 6	3.81x	3.81x	3.81x	PF	OP6-0031
LV1 net	REOPEN21	2	Operator 1, Operator 2	4.32x	5.10x	6.05x	PF	OP1-10721, OP2-3732
LV1 net	INFL22-23	1	Operator 1	3.87x	3.87x	3.87x	PF	OP1-10729
LV1 net	SOFT24-26	1	Operator 1	4.61x	4.61x	4.61x	PF	OP1-11220
LV2 gross	EXP10-19	4	Operator 1	4.67x	5.16x	5.95x	PF	OP1-7360, OP1-7587, OP1-7588, OP1-8157
LV2 net	EXP10-19 / REOPEN21 / SOFT24-26	1 / 1 / 1	Operator 1	5.76x / 5.80x / 5.55x	–	–	PF	OP1-7814, OP1-10742, OP1-11227
LV4 net	REOPEN21 / INFL22-23	1 / 1	Operator 1	7.19x / 5.98x	–	–	PF	OP1-10730, OP1-10738
LV5_6X gross	EXP10-19 / REOPEN21 / SOFT24-26	1 / 1 / 1	Operator 2 / Operator 2 / Operator 6	4.64x / 5.66x / 4.26x	–	–	PF	OP2-0251, OP2-3735, OP6-1877
Proposals, LV1 gross	SOFT24-26	2	Operator 3, Operator 7	2.25x	3.65x	4.70x	P	OP3-1326, OP7-1181

Source: note C-75. Denominator: each source's financing EBITDA (E4 synergised or normalised PF, or E5 underwriting EBITDA), the only rung every deal document prints. One print per platform-event; proposals are shown separately and never pooled with closed prints. The proposed financings of the three live deals are in Part 08. LV5_6X = (debt + 6× rent) ÷ EBITDAR, with rent code R-UNK for Operator 2 (implied from EBITDAR − EBITDA) and Operator 6; the two Operator 2 prints are recomputed from the figures the documents give, (49.0 + 6 × 7.6) ÷ 17.0 and (321.8 + 6 × 38.44) ÷ 87.96 (note C-75). Clinic base: consolidated

The definition tables, Deal A's leverage ladder by year, the coverage evidence and the limits behind this section are in Part 09 section K, under "04 B Leverage multiples: supporting evidence".

C · Operating benchmark

No platform can be ranked overall: each sits on its own period, rent code and clinic base, and in the 2024 to 2026 soft period every comp traffic reading on all comparable clinics in the files of the three established operators is negative, from −2.0% to −7.9%.

What holds. In the 2024 to 2026 soft period every comp traffic reading on all comparable clinics in the files of the three established operators is negative, and within 4% outside Deal A's FY25: Operator 6 −2.0% in 2025 and −3.4% in the year to May 2026, Operator 3 −4.1% in 2024 and −2.8% in the year to August 2025, Deal A −7.9% in FY25 and −3.9% in FY26, each an upper bound on a surviving-clinic base, with the ticket carrying sales. The positive readings sit on narrower or newly assembled bases: Operator 6's clinics acquired before 2023 (+2.3%), Operator 8 (+7.4%) and Operator 7 (+10.9%), all in 2025.

What to watch. Each platform sits on its own period, rent code and clinic base. Only Operator 1, Operator 7 ST-22, Operator 8 and Operator 5 carry a four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent, and no year holds three such operators on actual figures, so the operating table describes and does not rank. The valid comparisons for each live deal are set out in Part 04 section F.

Exhibit 4.10 — From CY24 to LTM Jun-26 comp traffic fell in 9 of 16 core readings while comp ticket rose in 12 of 14

YoY % change in comp traffic and comp average ticket per operator-period in SOFT24-26 (CY24 to LTM Jun-26); traffic grew only at Operator 8, Operator 7, Operator 6's pre-2023 clinics, Operator 4 and Deal C FY25

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A All Clinics KPI Report FY20–Q1 FY27 (DLA-0756 to DLA-0790); Operator 3 Datacube, 31 August 2025 (OP3-0890 to OP3-0908); Operator 6 Visit Count per Working Day and Project Hotel readout (OP6-1896, OP6-1952, OP6-1144 to OP6-1148); Deal B Datapack (Jul-26) (DLB-003-000385 to DLB-003-000388); Deal C Visit Count and Average Invoice file (22 September 2026) (A1-S002 to A1-S004, A5-P5-004 to A5-P5-006); Operator 8 Operator 8 Databook (Mar-26) (OP8-2106 to OP8-2115); Operator 7 Credit Databook, 5 August 2026 (OP7-1022 to OP7-1048); Ares Credit Group Operator 4 IC Memo, 15 June 2026 (OP4-0555, OP4-0556, OP4-0652 to OP4-0655); traffic and ticket as computed in note C-51 · Basis: Filled = actual (A); hollow = pro forma (PF), used where only the company's own comp definition is available (Deal B, Deal C). Clinic base as named under each row. Deal C's comp is working-day and blackout adjusted and excludes shelter and rescue contract visits; Deal B is one quarter on the company's comp; Operator 7 rows are seller-period data from before the combination; Operator 4 'volume' is a sponsor measure. Operator 6 all-comp rows have traffic only

Exhibit 4.11 — 2007 to 2026: four-wall, gross margin, comp and conversion figures sit on different rent codes, bases and periods for every core platform

Best available four-wall margin, gross margin, comp traffic or same-store sales, reported EBITDA margin, overhead and cash conversion by core platform, periods as stated, 2007 to 2026

PLATFORM	PERIOD OF BEST DATA	CLINICS	REVENUE ($M)	D1.1 FOUR-WALL (RENT CODE; BASE)	GROSS MARGIN	COMP TRAFFIC / SSS (DEFINITION; CLOSURE BASE)	E1 MARGIN	CORPORATE ST-50 % REVENUE	CONV_1	ORGANIC / ACQUIRED FLAG	LOCATORS
Core											
Operator 1	Clinic P&L Jun-07 – Nov-17; E1 CY2008–17	304 (CY2017)	496.4 (CY2017)	9.8% LTM Nov-17 (R-CASH; ALL); 12.1% on constant 92 clinics [I]; D1.2 19.9%	41.9% pre-ATF / 51.3% incl. ATF, LTM Nov-17 (ALL retail)	SSS_CD CY2022 +7.0% (D2.1; CLOSE-FWD); traffic n/a — retail comp pharmacy units YTD Nov-17 −6.3%	12.0% CY2017 (E1, A)	4.7% CY2017	0.44 FY2019 (total capex, E1, A); 0.76 on company split [M]	ALL = TOTAL; constant-base 92 = organic proxy	OP1-5668, OP1-5873; A3-P5-003; OP1-4179, OP1-4276; OP1-8859; OP1-5170; OP1-3260/OP1-3416; OP1-3238/OP1-3467; OP1-8678/OP1-8634
Operator 2	Clinic databook Jan-17 – Mar-21 (owned); Operator 10 clinic-month 2006 – May-18; decks to Jun-26	481 (Dec-25)	934.9 (CY2025; deck, A [M])	11.8% LTM Mar-21 (R-UNK; owned clinics, owned months); D1.2 14.9%	57.4% pre-rebate, LTM Mar-21 (owned)	SSS_CD CY2020 −7.6%, traffic −15.1% (CLOSE-FWD); SSS_ST-59 2025 +1.8% (undefined)	8.8% CY2025 (E1 deck, A [M])	4.6% LTM Mar-21 (PF)	0.66 median FY2021–25 (total capex, compliance E1, BUILD)	owned-year split in Exhibit 9.79	OP2-4291; OP2-4347/OP2-4274; OP2-3462, OP2-3469; OP2-3460; OP2-3525, OP2-3526; OP2-4279; OP2-2722; note C-60 (Operator 2 BUILD)

PLATFORM	PERIOD OF BEST DATA	CLINICS	REVENUE ($M)	D1.1 FOUR-WALL (RENT CODE; BASE)	GROSS MARGIN	COMP TRAFFIC / SSS (DEFINITION; CLOSURE BASE)	E1 MARGIN	CORPORATE ST-50 % REVENUE	CONV_1	ORGANIC / ACQUIRED FLAG	LOCATORS
Deal A	10-K FY1996–FY26 + Q1 FY27; clinic EBITDA FY23–23; survivor KPIs FY20 – Q1 FY27	983 (FY26)	1,029.1 (FY26)	Clinic EBITDA 7.9% FY26 (R-OPONLY; SURVIVOR; company basis); 5.4% with finance-lease cost at book (R-BOOK; open clinics)	31.2% consolidated (co-op netted); 34.2% survivor KPI GP before co-op, FY26	SSS_CD FY26 +1.1%, traffic −3.9% (CLOSE-RETRO survivor); public comp +1.2%	6.2% FY26 (D3 E1, A); 4.8% ex-gains [I]	4.7% FY26	0.52 FY26 (0.44 ex-gains); steady median 0.64 over 20 years (total capex, E1)	SURVIVOR = ORGANIC (survivor bias)	DLA-0017; note C-24 (FY26 survivor; ties DLA-0834); DLA-0857/DLA-0017; DLA-0054; DLA-0768; DLA-0788, DLA-0789; DLA-0363; DLA-0317/DLA-0017; DLA-1223
Operator 4 / Operator 9	Audited Operator 4 HoldCo FY23–21 + Q1-26; Operator 9 audits FY23–21	291 Operator 4 (Dec-25); 157 Operator 9 (Sep-25)	505.3 Operator 4 CY2025; 582.3 Operator 9 FY25	n/a on D1.1; hospital-level EBITDA 18.7% CY2025 (D1.2-type; R-UNK; constant 192)	40.1% Operator 4 CY2025; 17.8% Operator 9 FY25 (rebates in COGS)	SSS_ST-59 2025 +1.8% Operator 4 (sponsor "volume" +1%) and +1.8% Operator 9; definitions not stated	−1.4% Operator 4 CY2025 (E1, POOLED); 4.4% Operator 9 FY25 (E1 incl. real-estate VIEs)	7.7% Operator 4 CY2025	Operator 4 0.59 FY2023 (total capex, E1, steady); Operator 9 0.41 FY Sep-25 (total capex, E1; 0.41 on the equipment-depreciation proxy for maintenance capex, Exhibit 3.20)	POOLED (acquisitions inside)	OP4-0190; OP4-0535; OP4-0093; OP4-0365; OP4-1507; OP4-0105; OP4-0384; OP4-0556, OP4-0655; OP4-0593; OP4-0103; OP4-0380; OP4-1535; OP4-0011/OP4-0026; OP4-0380/OP4-0450
Operator 5	Clinic tickets and units 2017 – Jun-23; clinic P&L CY2020 – LTM Mar-23 (PF)	38 (Mar-23)	124.8 (CY2022)	15.2% LTM Mar-23 (R-CASH, 28 of 38 related-party; ALL; PF)	50.9% CY2022 (FDD-adjusted, PF)	SSS_CD CY2022 +10.1%, traffic −0.8% (CLOSE-FWD)	9.4% CY2022 (E1, A)	5.1% LTM Mar-23 (PF)	0.73 median FY2020–22 (E1; D&A proxy [I])	TOTAL	OP5-0640; OP5-0009; OP5-2469; OP5-0022; OP5-3878, OP5-3879; OP5-0061/OP5-0009; OP5-2474; note C-60 (Operator 5 E1)
Operator 6	Company data 2021 – TTM Mar-26; 31 add-ons	49 (Dec-25, survivor list); 61 (May-26)	n/a (no basis-A revenue row)	n/a on D1.1; clinic D1.2 16.1% LTM Mar-26 (rebates in COGS; R-UNK; PF; survivor)	n/a (no margin figures; Part 09 section H)	SSS_CD CY2025 +1.9% (13 pre-2023 clinics); all-comp traffic −2.0% (CLOSE-RETRO)	n/a (E1 $4.5m LTM Mar-26 as-owned, no matching revenue)	n/a (projections only)	0.85 median FY2024 – LTM Mar-26 (E3 PF, company split [M], BUILD)	acquired cohorts in Exhibit 9.79	OP6-0440; OP6-0442; OP6-0354/OP6-0357; OP6-1148; OP6-1896; OP6-0047; note C-60 (Operator 6 E3)
Operator 3	Datacube Apr-21 – Aug-25 (survivor)	54 datacube (Aug-25); 61 consolidated (Oct-25)	119.3 (LTM Aug-25)	12.4% LTM Aug-25 (R-UNK; SURVIVOR); D1.2 16.0%	51.9% LTM Aug-25 (after clinic rebates; survivor)	SSS_CD LTM Aug-25 +4.2%, traffic −2.8% (CLOSE-RETRO)	n/a (no matched E1)	2.9% LTM Aug-25	0.80 median FY2023–24 (E3 PF, company split [M], BUILD)	SURVIVOR = ORGANIC (survivor bias)	OP3-0123; OP3-2134; OP3-1994/OP3-1890; OP3-1088, OP3-0132; OP3-0126; OP3-0906, OP3-0907; note C-60 (Operator 3 E3)
Operator 7 (ST-22 segment)	QoE clinic P&L Jan-23 – Jan-26; KPIs Jan-24 – Jun-26	10 ST-22 (19 consolidated, Aug-26)	26.8 (ST-22, CY2025)	15.9% CY2025 (R-CASH, related-party below go-forward rent; ALL ST-22); 16.1% on 9 full-year clinics	41.9% CY2025 ST-22 (rebates in COGS)	SSS_CD CY2025 +11.4%, traffic +10.9% (CLOSE-FWD; visit count undefined; seller-period data)	12.0% CY2025 (E1, A)	4.7% CY2025 (PF)	0.71 (total capex, E1, [M]; ST-22 FY2024–25 and ST-70)	TOTAL	OP7-0019; OP7-0545; OP7-0346..OP7-0384; OP7-0515; OP7-0020/OP7-0019; OP7-1022, OP7-1023; OP7-0021; OP7-0800; note C-60 (Operator 7)

PLATFORM	PERIOD OF BEST DATA	CLINICS	REVENUE ($M)	D1.1 FOUR-WALL (RENT CODE; BASE)	GROSS MARGIN	COMP TRAFFIC / SSS (DEFINITION; CLOSURE BASE)	E1 MARGIN	CORPORATE ST-50 % REVENUE	CONV_1	ORGANIC / ACQUIRED FLAG	LOCATORS
Operator 8	Clinic P&L 2021 – LTM Mar-26; clinic-year volume 2021–24	62 (Dec-25)	86.5 (CY2025)	8.6% CY2023 (R-CASH; ALL; last R-CASH year); 10.8% LTM Mar-26 (R-UNK; POOLED)	50.8% CY2025	SSS_CD CY2025 +6.2%, traffic +7.4% (21 units; days unadjusted)	2.9% CY2025 (E1; sources differ)	4.5% CY2025	0.76 median FY2022 – LTM Nov-23 (E2q, company split [M], steady)	POOLED from 2024	OP8-2723; OP8-2631; OP8-2762/OP8-1362; OP8-2101; OP8-2098; OP8-2106, OP8-2114; OP8-2016/OP8-2631; OP8-2097; note C-60 (Operator 8)
Deal B — DLB	Clinic KPI details to Jul-26, including pre-acquisition months for legacy clinics (the source does not give the start month); four-wall Jan-23 – Jul-26	not in this benchmark	not in this benchmark	Company 4-wall by acquisition cohort, CY2025: 2021 −4.8%, 2022 6.3%, 2023 9.0%, 2024 8.6%; 2025 cohort 18.9% on its 2025 owned months (17 clinics; Exhibit 6.03); 2026 cohort 25.5% LTM Jul-26 (≤7 owned months) (R-BOOK incl. SLB rent; not D1.1); 2025 cohort 17.6% on cash rent (D1.2, R-CASH), LTM Mar-26, ≤12 owned months	not in this benchmark	SSS_CD CY2025 +4.7%, LTM Jul-26 +3.3% (D2.1; CLOSE-FWD); company comp traffic Q2-26 −5.7% (PF, one quarter)	n/a for the general practice and preventive business (reported EBITDA is consolidated, DBW included; Part 06 section D)	n/a for the general practice and preventive business (consolidated overhead; Part 06 section E)	n/a for the general practice and preventive business (consolidated conversion, DBW included, is read in Part 06 section D)	COHORT	DLB-003-000211, -000221, -000231, -000241, -000255; DLB-033 p.2 and Exhibit 6.03 (2025 cohort); DLB-3372; DLB-1406, DLB-1516; DLB-003-000386
Deal C	Site-level database Jan-22 – Jul-26	86 (Jul-26; 88 at Jun-26)	not in this benchmark (AUV $1.9m 2025, PF)	Clinic-level EBITDA 21.3% FY2025 (D1.2, rebates contra-COGS; R-BOOK; audited); 22.3% on cash rent; not D1.1	51.5% CY2025 (reported)	Common SSS 2025 +4.5%, LTM Jul-26 −0.4%, Q2-26 −3.2% (D2.1; CLOSE-RETRO); company comp visit count LTM Jun-26 −1.6% (PF, working-day adjusted)	n/a (E1 $4.7m on D3 vs QoE-adjusted E2 $17.6m, FY2025)	n/a (corporate G&A $5.9m CY2025)	0.76 FY2025 (E2, model maintenance [M], BUILD)	owned months	DLC-012-000305; DLC-0388, DLC-5013/5014; DLC-001-000659; DLC-0985, DLC-0994, DLC-1022; A1-S004; DLC-0019, DLC-4425; DLC-005-000143; DLC-4425/DLC-005-000567; DLC-0359; DLC-3498

Source: note C-03, note C-20, note C-24, note C-25, note C-26, note C-30, note C-51, note C-60; row IDs in the last column. Revenue in USD millions. Basis A unless marked PF or P; [M] management or company split; [I] CreditSwan calculation. Rent codes per D1.3; clinic bases per D8; closure codes per D2.2. Deal A E1 ex-gains = $56.4m ÷ $1,029.1m [DLA-0017]. Organic/acquired flag as recorded on the rows used

The acquired-clinic splits, the other operating KPIs (pharmacy share, retention, labour) and the notes on each column are in Part 09 section K, under "04 C Operating benchmark: supporting evidence".

D · Operator profiles

In the 2024 to 2026 soft period comparable traffic fell at the established operators (Deal A −3.9%, Operator 3 −2.8%, Operator 6 −2.0%) while ticket carried sales, and rose only on newly assembled bases (Operator 8 +7.4%, Operator 7 +10.9%); no operator is ranked overall.

What holds. At the established operators revenue has rested on the ticket while comparable traffic eased in the 2024 to 2026 soft period (Deal A −3.9% in FY26, Operator 3 −2.8% in the year to August 2025, Operator 6 −2.0% in 2025); traffic rose only on newly assembled bases, at Operator 8 (+7.4%) and Operator 7 (+10.9%) in 2025. Ticket-led pricing and rebate-dependent pharmacy margins are durable across the set.

What to watch. Company-specific are Deal A's loss-making clinics (28.7% in FY26 before co-op; 19.5% on Ares Credit Group's basis with co-op allocated to clinics), the clinic scale of Operator 5 and Operator 7 ($494k and $433k of median four-wall), and deal costs that held cash EBITDA to 0.24 of its as-owned adjusted EBITDA at Operator 8 (LTM Mar-26), and to 0.29 and 0.31 of pro forma (E3) EBITDA at Operator 4 (LTM Mar-26) and Deal C (FY2025).

Exhibit 4.12 — On the period each profile names, Deal A's record runs from FY1996 to the first quarter of FY27, the longest of the eleven; Deal B's clinic data start in January 2023 and Deal C's in January 2022, while most benchmark records end between 2017 and early 2026

Period covered by each operator's record as the profiles state it, start and end to the month, 1995 to 2026; live deals in teal. Some profiles cite longer series for single measures (Operator 4 same-store sales from 2010, Operator 2 to FY2025, Operator 1 clinic history from June 2007)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Exhibit 4.13 (Record column) and the eleven profiles in Part 09 section K · Basis: Periods as stated in the profiles; fiscal-year starts and ends are placed at the month each company's fiscal year begins or ends (Deal A April to March; Operator 1 June to May, so FY08 starts in June 2007); a bare year is read from January to December, and an end month runs to its last day. The live deals' end months are those of their latest monthly files (Deal B August 2026, Deal C July 2026). Length of record is not depth of evidence: see Exhibit 1.09 and Part 09 section I for the count of figures by area

Exhibit 4.13 — Eleven core operators on one line each, FY1996 to 2026; in the 2024 to 2026 soft period the established operators' revenue rested on the ticket; Deal A's record is the longest and Deal B's among the shortest

The one-sentence read of each operator profile, with the period its record covers; the full profiles, each with a six-area table and the decisive diligence, are in Part 09

OPERATOR	RECORD	THE READ IN ONE SENTENCE
Operator 1	FY08 to LTM Nov-17	Operator 1's clinic sheets, a decade of clinic-level record, show a growing preventive care and pharmacy chain holding its margin including rebates while its margin before rebates and its volume per clinic eroded.
Operator 2	2018 to LTM Mar-21 (Operator 10 2006–17)	Operator 2's owned-clinic databook shows acquired clinics in their third owned year earning more than those in their first, though the two groups are different clinics, and greenfields ramping slowly, and its Operator 10 chain shows comparable traffic drifting down 1.4% a year over 2006–17.
Operator 4 / Operator 9	FY23 to Q1-26	Operator 4 and Operator 9 show that a preventive care and pharmacy consolidator's hospital-level margin can hold while its reported earnings and levered cash turn negative in an acquisition year.
Operator 5	2017 to Jun-23	Operator 5 is the clearest evidence in the files that pharmacy product prices follow cost within the year and that large clinics in one dense market earn a high four-wall margin, though its clinic figures are pro forma.
Operator 6	2021 to TTM Mar-26	Operator 6 shows a small-clinic general practice roll-up whose traffic and ticket both lagged in the soft period, and whose add-on re-rating holds only on synergised, company-presented EBITDA.
Operator 3	Apr-21 to Aug-25	Operator 3 shows margin gains from integration and rebate capture on a surviving-clinic base while comparable traffic still fell.
Operator 7 (ST-22 segment)	Jan-23 to Jun-26	Operator 7 State 05 segment shows the highest actual four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent in the set, on ten clinics, below-market rent and an undefined visit count.
Operator 8	2021 to LTM Mar-26	Operator 8 shows positive traffic and comparable sales on a newly assembled base, with acquired units short of their underwriting and reported EBITDA near zero after transaction costs.
Deal A (live deal)	FY1996 to Q1 FY27	Deal A's audited record, the longest in the files, shows a large general practice and pharmacy estate whose visits, clinic profit and reported margin fell together in the 2024 to 2026 soft period, with a third of clinics losing money in every year from FY23 to FY26 before co-op (19.5% in FY26 with co-op allocated to clinics, Ares Credit Group's basis).
Deal B (live deal)	Clinic data from January 2023	Deal B's general practice and preventive operations show ticket-led comparable sales inside the peer range, newer cohorts that start better, and four-wall margin on cash rent at the bottom of the peer range.
Deal C (live deal)	Site data from January 2022; audited FY2025	Deal C shows a high, broad clinic margin on a young platform whose same-store sales and clinic EBITDA turned down in 2026 and whose deal costs hold cash EBITDA to about a third of pro forma (E3) EBITDA.

Source: The eleven operator profiles in Part 09 section K, where each figure carries its references; Deal A's loss-making share on Ares Credit Group's basis from Part 05 section E · Basis: Each operator on its own best available data, period, rent code and clinic base; described, not ranked (Part 04 section E); live-deal profiles carry operating measures only · Assumption: A-01, A-02, A-07

Each operator's full profile, a table across the six areas with the figure, period and reference the document carries, and the decisive diligence, is in Part 09 section K, under "04 D Operator profiles: the eleven profiles".

E · Rankings and limits

Ten common-definition rankings exist, each in one environment on three or four operators, and no rank carries across environments; Operator 5, Operator 7 ST-22 and Operator 3 are described as the strongest and Deal A and Operator 4 as the weakest, not ranked.

What holds. Ten common-definition rankings exist, covering volume, pricing, same-store sales and add-on valuation, each in one environment on three or four operators. Described rather than ranked, Operator 5, Operator 7 ST-22 and Operator 3 show the strongest evidence, and clinic scale is

the measure most closely associated with clinic margin across operators, accounting for 24–50% of its variance in five of eight datasets.

What to watch. Ranks do not carry across environments: Operator 2 is first on same-store sales in CY2019 and last in CY2020, and only Operator 5 holds one position, second in all three calendar rankings. Deal A and Operator 4 show the weakest evidence: Deal A is last in three rankings, and a third of its clinics lose money before co-op (19.5% on Ares Credit Group's basis in FY26; Part 05 section E); Operator 4's reported EBITDA turned negative in its FY25 acquisition year.

Exhibit 4.14 — From 2015 to 2026 the ten common-definition rankings each hold three or four operators in one environment; Deal A enters four rankings of the 2024–26 soft period and is last in three

Each panel is one ranking of the table below, best first: comparable traffic and same-store sales on the common definition (%), ticket less CPI (percentage points), and later add-on multiples (x, lower is better); Deal A in teal

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Exhibit 4.15, which gives the definition, base, basis and rows of each ranking · Basis: Actual (A) except R10, pro forma (PF). Each ranking compares only operators with the same measure, definition, closure base and environment; panels are not comparable with one another · Assumption: A-01, A-04

Exhibit 4.15 — 2015 to 2026: ten common-definition rankings, each in one environment and none with more than four operators

Order of operators, best to worst, on each metric where at least three share one definition, base and basis, by market environment, 2015 to 2026

#	AREA	METRIC (DEFINITION; BASE; BASIS)	ENVIRONMENT	N	ORDER, BEST → WORST (VALUE)
R1	A1 volume	SSS_TRAFFIC_CD chained 2015–17 (D2.5 on D2.1; COMP own data, CLOSE-FWD; A)	EXP10-19	4	Operator 14 +10.0% › Operator 16 +7.6% › Operator 10 +3.9% › Operator 12 −15.9%
R2	A1 volume	SSS_TRAFFIC_CD latest full year (CLOSE-RETRO survivor; A)	SOFT24-26	3	Operator 6 −2.0% › Operator 3 −2.8% › Deal A −3.9%
R3	A2 pricing	SSS_TICKET_CD chained 2015–17 minus CPI SS62053 +4.7% (CLOSE-FWD; A)	EXP10-19	4	Operator 10 +6.2pp › Operator 14 +0.8pp › Operator 16 −3.2pp › Operator 12 −8.1pp
R4	A2 pricing	SSS_TICKET_CD minus CPI SS62053, matched months (CLOSE-RETRO; A)	SOFT24-26	3	Operator 3 +2.2pp › Deal A +0.04pp › Operator 6 −5.7pp
R5	A5 SSS	SSS_CD CY2019 (D2.1; CLOSE-FWD; A)	EXP10-19	3	Operator 2 +6.7% › Operator 5 +3.4% › Operator 1 +0.4%
R6	A5 SSS	SSS_CD CY2020 (CLOSE-FWD; A)	COVID20	3	Operator 1 −2.7% › Operator 5 −5.6% › Operator 2 −7.6%
R7	A5 SSS	SSS_CD CY2022 (CLOSE-FWD; A)	INFL22-23	3	Operator 8 +11.8% › Operator 5 +10.1% › Operator 1 +7.0%
R8	A5 SSS	SSS_CD, years ending December 2024 to March 2025 (CLOSE-RETRO; A)	SOFT24-26	3	Operator 6 +2.9% › Operator 3 +2.4% › Deal A −4.1%
R9	A5 SSS	SSS_CD latest (CLOSE-RETRO; A)	SOFT24-26	3	Operator 3 +4.2% › Operator 6 +1.9% › Deal A +1.1%
R10	A7 valuation	TXN_MULT_CURRENT: price ÷ acquirer-period clinic EBITDA incl. synergies, lower = better (survivor deals; R-UNK; PF)	SOFT24-26	3	Operator 3 2.8× › Operator 4 3.2× › Operator 6 3.4×

Source: note C-83 (28 rows): R1 OP2-1176/1179/1182, OP2-0771/0774/0777, OP2-0673/0676/0679, OP2-0736/0739/0742; R2 OP6-1896, OP3-0907, DLA-0789; R3 OP2-1177/1180/1183, OP2-0772/0775/0778, OP2-0674/0677/0680, OP2-0737/0740/0743 with public series CUUR0000SS62053, matched months; R4 OP3-0908, DLA-0790, OP6-1146; R5 OP2-3520, OP5-3866, OP1-8856; R6 OP1-8857, OP5-3870, OP2-3525; R7 OP8-1714, OP5-3878 (sources differ: OP5-2562 11.1%; OP5-3878 is used and the rank is the same on either value), OP1-8859; R8 OP6-1147, OP3-0890, DLA-0756; R9 OP3-0906, OP6-1148, DLA-0788; R10 OP3-1494, OP4-0806, OP6-1733. Ranking rule: at least three operators on one metric code, definition_id, rent code, basis and clinic base. Operator 14, Operator 16, Operator 10 and Operator 12 are preventive care and pharmacy chains later acquired by Operator 2, ranked on their own pre-acquisition data in the Operator 2 files

The descriptions of the strongest and weakest operators, the figures that depend on a basis choice and the ranking-validity table are in Part 09 section K, under "04 E Rankings and limits: supporting evidence".

F · Comparator map

Each live deal has five comparators but few valid metrics: Deal A compares with Operator 3 on survivor-base comp traffic, ticket and same-store sales and, indicatively, with the cash-rent peer band on Ares Credit Group's co-op-included basis after finance-lease cost; Deal B and Deal C compare on same-store sales and adjustment share (Deal B's on consolidated earnings including DBW), and Deal C not on clinic margin.

What holds. Each live deal has five comparators, and three placements are valid on the definitions the files allow: same-store sales on the common definition (all three deals), the share of top-rung EBITDA that is adjustments (Deal B, on consolidated earnings including DBW, and Deal C) and the add-on entry multiple on standalone seller EBITDA (Deal C). Deal A can be set against Operator 3 on surviving-clinic comp traffic, ticket and same-store sales.

What to watch. The valid set is narrowest where the underwriting question is sharpest: clinic economics at Deal A and Deal C, and DBW, which compares on revenue per visit only. On Ares Credit Group's rebates-included basis Deal A's clinic margin can now be set, indicatively, against the 10.7–17.4% peer band: 10.7% for all clinics and 12.5% after the second round, after finance-lease cost (Part 05 section E). The eight questions below name the file that would make each missing comparison valid.

Exhibit 4.16 — On documents supplied to 1 October 2026, each live deal can be set against its five comparators on four to six of eight measures; clinic margin is valid only for Deal B against Operator 7, and for Deal A only indicatively on Ares Credit Group's basis

Number of each deal's five comparators against which a measure is valid on the same definition, rent treatment, basis and clinic base; Deal B's wellness clinic segment, DBW, is compared separately on revenue per visit (Part 06 section F)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Comparator tables Exhibit 9.119, Exhibit 9.140 and Exhibit 7.13 (column 'Valid metrics'); note C-84; Deal A's indicative placement Part 05 section E · Basis: A measure counts as valid for a comparator only where its table lists it as valid; within-platform statistics are not counted. Acquired-unit delivery counts only Operator 8, the one comparator measuring acquired-unit actuals against the pro forma underwriting; Operator 7 within-platform margin path is not counted. A count is not a ranking · Assumption: A-01, A-02, A-10

Exhibit 4.17 — On documents supplied to 1 October 2026, eight questions, three for Deal A, three for Deal B and two for Deal C, name the data that would make a missing comparison valid; the company's documents answer question 4 and supplies of questions 5, 6 and 7

Question for each live deal, the comparison it would resolve and the rows behind it; where the company's documents answer part of a question, the row gives the answer and the section that holds it; documents supplied to 1 October 2026

NO.	DEAL	QUESTION	WHAT IT WOULD RESOLVE
1	Deal A — true comp traffic	Provide the closed-clinic KPI and clinic-EBITDA history FY20 – Q1 FY27, so that comp traffic can be rebuilt with closed clinics in the base and the pre-closure margins of the first closure round measured.	Survivor bias in Deal A's comps, which are upper bounds today; on them Deal A is last on three of the four survivor-base SOFT24-26 rankings (R2, R8, R9) and second in R4 [DLA-0788, DLA-0789, DLA-0756]
2	Deal A — clinic economics on D1.1 and co-op durability	Provide finance-lease cash cost and cash rent by clinic, so the 28.7% loss share (R-OPONLY) can be restated to D1.1; and the co-op and vendor programme terms, given co-op fell from 6.7% to 5.1% of sales and equals 0.71× FY26 D3 E1 (0.96× ex-gains).	Four-wall comparability with R-CASH peers; rebate dependence [DLA-0862; DLA-3340, DLA-0846]
3	Deal A — which EBITDA	Reconcile E1 with and without impairment and disposal gains ($16.0m FY26; $19.7m LTM Jun-26), and supply a maintenance/growth capex split, so that conversion can be stated on certified maintenance capex.	Earnings and conversion on one definition [note C-62]
4	Deal B DLB — comps on the common definition	Answered from the clinic-month file (DLB-032 / DLB-006): on the common definition (D2.1, CLOSE-FWD) SSS_CD is +4.7% for CY2025 and +3.3% for LTM Jul-26, with traffic, ticket and cohort splits (Part 06 section G; Part 06 section B). The company's weekday-aligned comp (Q2-26 traffic −5.7%) is not set against peers' SSS_TRAFFIC_CD.	DLB comp placement [DLB-003-000386; DLB-1406; DLB-1516]

NO.	DEAL	QUESTION	WHAT IT WOULD RESOLVE
5	Deal B DLB — four-wall on cash rent before rebates	Cohort four-wall on cash rent including SLB rent is given (17.6% on cash rent after rebates for the 2025 cohort, LTM Mar-26 on ≤12 owned months; Part 06 section G). Outstanding: clinic-level vendor rebates by cohort, so that each cohort's four-wall margin can be stated before rebates on cash rent, and cohort margins after 21 months of ownership.	Cohort quality on a comparable basis: the 2025 cohort's 18.9% (book rent, 2025 owned months; Part 06 section B) and the 2026 cohort's 25.5% (≤7 owned months, PF) set against cash-rent peers before rebates (Operator 7 ST-22 16.1%, 2025; Operator 5 15.0%, 2022, PF) [DLB-033 p.2; DLB-003-000255; DLB-3372; OP7-0515; OP5-2028]
6	Deal B consolidated (DBW included) — earnings ladder and infrastructure	FY25 E1 −$3.2m against E3 of $18.5m in Accounting Firm 2's sell-side quality-of-earnings workbook (updated to 23 June 2026) and $10.1m in the company's financing model (July 2026), which reflects the FY25 audit adjustments; the recurrence test on the add-backs and the maintenance capex basis (CONV_1 0.62 and 0.46 on the two documents) are read in Part 06 section D. Outstanding: a certified maintenance and growth capex split.	Earnings definition and adjustment share, which is above every comparator on these documents [DLB-022-000487; DLB-008-000061]
7	Deal C — clinic economics on D1.1	Restate the FY2025 clinic-level EBITDA (21.3%, rebates in cost of goods, book rent; 22.3% on cash rent; audited) before vendor rebates and at market cash rent for the 32 related-party leases, and provide comparable-clinic traffic and ticket from the site-level database including closed clinics; the common SSS fell from +4.5% (2025) to −0.4% (LTM Jul-26) and −3.2% in Q2-26 (Part 07 section F) while the company series shows +1.6% (LTM May-26).	Clinic margin and comp placement [DLC-0388; DLC-5013/5014; DLC-0985; DLC-0994; DLC-1022]
8	Deal C — acquisition multiples	The 3.25× tuck-in entry multiple is net of sale-leaseback proceeds; gross, on cash consideration, seven of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database cost 2.4–3.2×, and the other three 6.2–6.6×, two of them single clinics bought with a sale-leaseback (2.9× and 4.2× net of the sale proceeds) (Part 07 section C). State the EBITDA basis (clinic-level or consolidated, standalone or synergised, pre- or post-SLB, seller or PF), whether the 3.0× later multiple uses the same basis, and the add-back detail behind the E1 $4.7m → E2 $17.6m → E3 $22.0m ladder (D3 rungs; run-rate $25.5m in the sell-side quality-of-earnings summary; Part 07 section D), so that recurring add-backs can be identified.	Add-on multiple comparability with peers' standalone add-ons at 4.4–6.0× (Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4); earnings quality [DLC-3427/3428; DLC-3424; DLC-1261..DLC-1279; DLC-0019; DLC-4425/4426/4427; OP3-1493; OP6-1731; OP4-0802]

Source: the comparator tables (Part 05 section E, Part 06 section G, Part 07 section F) and the rows cited in the last column. Question 4 is answered in Part 06 section G from the company's clinic-month data; questions 1, 2, 3 and 8 are outstanding in full; of the questions partly answered, outstanding are the cohort margins of question 5 before vendor rebates, the certified maintenance and growth capex split of question 6, and the D1.1 restatement and comparable traffic and ticket of question 7. DBW is compared only with the wellness clinic context set, and its questions are in Part 06 section F and Part 09 section K (under "04 G Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty"). Sources as listed in Part 09 section E

The comparator map by deal and metric, and the sources of the Deal B, DBW and Deal C figures, are in Part 09 section K, under "04 F Comparator map: supporting evidence".

G · Wellness clinics, emergency and specialty hospitals

Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals differ from core general practice care on ticket, payer, labour and volume (wellness clinic comp traffic fell in every year of 2016–25 except 2021), so their clinic metrics are never pooled with the core; DBW compares only on revenue per visit.

What holds. Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are different businesses from general practice and preventive care: a wellness clinic visit is a $86–111 ticket built on a wellness exam and an emergency and specialty patient invoice a $2,007–3,938 referral case often paid through pet insurance, against about $254–590 for a core patient invoice. Deal and financing measures can be read against the core on a stated rung: first-lien leverage at close in both sets, 3.94–4.73× on financing EBITDA, sits within the core band.

What to watch. Wellness clinic comp traffic fell in every year of 2016–25 except 2021, which we read as structural as three-year vaccine protocols lengthen the interval between visits, and clinic margins overlap the core only because definitions differ, so no clinic metric is pooled. DBW compares with wellness clinic operators on revenue per visit only, inside their $79–112 range (2024–25) at $99.2 in FY2025, before Deal B owned it, and $99.4 for LTM Jul-26, which includes seller months to November 2025; it is read in Part 06 section F.

Exhibit 4.18 — 2014 to 2025: wellness clinic comp traffic fell in every year except 2021 (Wellness Clinic Franchisor index 71.2 in 2025 on 2015 = 86) and ran below the core median in three of five environments

Comp traffic index, own base year = 86, context operators 2014 to 2025 (left); median year-on-year comp traffic (%) by market environment for core, wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals (right)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Wellness Clinic Franchisor per-clinic KPI overview; Wellness Clinic Operator 1 clinic performance trends; Emergency Operator 1 / Emergency Operator 4 merger analysis; Emergency Operator 2 KPI file; core medians from the comp-traffic series of Deal A, Operator 2 (with the pre-acquisition data of Operator 14, Operator 16 and Operator 12), Operator 5, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8 and Operator 7. Fact rows QLF-0547 to QLF-0712, QL1-0859 to QL1-0879, CO1-0958 to CO1-0968, COR-4133, COR-4139 and those listed in the data file; note C-03, note C-06 · Basis: Actual (A). Left: each operator indexed to its own base year, plotted at the calendar-year midpoint; Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Emergency Operator 4 on comparable clinics, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 and Emergency Operator 2 on comparable clinics among clinics still open (closed clinics are removed from the history, which flatters the series). Right: medians of year-on-year comp traffic across all operator-years in each class and environment; emergency and specialty medians rest on one or two operators (one in REOPEN21 and INFL22-23) and there is no emergency and specialty observation for GFC, COVID20 or SOFT24-26. Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context and enter no core statistic. Emergency Operator 4 LTM Sep-18 and Emergency Operator 2 LTM Jun-23 are partial windows and are not chained into the index

Exhibit 4.19 — CY2008 to LTM Mar-26: wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital four-wall margins of 10–15% as reported sit inside the core 9–16%; on estimated cash rent Wellness Clinic Operator 1 falls to 6–7%

Four-wall / facility margin (% of sales) per period: wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital context measures against the core range of four-wall margin before rebates, CY2008 to LTM Mar-26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Core range: the core general practice and preventive operators' clinic-level files (note C-19; fact rows in the data file). Context: Wellness Clinic Operator 1 financial due-diligence databook; Wellness Clinic Franchisor quality-of-earnings databook; Emergency Operator 3 financial updates and databook; Emergency Operator 2 clinic file; Emergency Operator 1 / Emergency Operator 4 merger analysis. Fact rows listed per dot in the data file; note C-21 · Basis: Each dot is one period in the source; the right-hand column gives the latest period. Filled = actual; hollow = pro forma (Emergency Operator 3 company facility margin, Emergency Operator 2 adjusted four-wall). Rent code per row: R-CASH cash rent, R-BOOK book (straight-line) rent, R-UNK not stated, R-NONE before rent. The core range is the lowest and highest annual four-wall margin before vendor rebates (D1.1) in the core operators' clinic files, FY08 to LTM Mar-26, on any rent code and including pro forma clinic figures (note C-19); it excludes one related-party-rent segment and one approximation from a company clinic file, and no core operator is plotted. Emergency Operator 1 / Emergency Operator 4 is clinic EBITDAR before rent and is excluded from the context range in the title. The Wellness Clinic Operator 1 cash-rent row is an estimate (an inference from the diligence databook), not a reported figure. Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context and enter no core statistic

Exhibit 4.20 — 2016 to 2026: wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals differ from core general practice care on ticket, cadence, labour, payer and rent

Ticket, visit frequency, labour, payer, vaccine cadence, rebates and rent code for wellness clinic and emergency and specialty operators against core general practice care, periods as stated, 2016 to 2026

DIMENSION	WELLNESS CLINIC OPERATOR 1 (QL)	WELLNESS CLINIC FRANCHISOR PVA / SYSTEM (QL)	WELLNESS CLINIC OPERATOR 2 (QL)	EMERGENCY OPERATOR 1 / EMERGENCY OPERATOR 4 (EMERGENCY AND SPECIALTY)	EMERGENCY OPERATOR 3 (EMERGENCY AND SPECIALTY)	EMERGENCY OPERATOR 2 (EMERGENCY AND SPECIALTY)	CORE PHARMACY / GENERAL PRACTICE (REFERENCE)
Ticket	$111 net, TTM P10-25 (QL1-0289)	~$107 system FY24; wellness exam $86–91 (QLF-0412, QLF-1121, QLF-1132)	$86, LTM Jul-25 (QL2-0344)	~$2,344 Emergency Operator 1; $1,984 Emergency Operator 4, LTM Sep-18 (CO1-0297, CO1-0975)	$3,492 LTM Jul-23; insured invoices $3,926 (CO3-1314, CO3-1350)	$3,116–3,604 per invoice, 2022–24 (CO2-025 p.6)	~$254–590 per visit/invoice, 2024–26 (DLA-0772, OP3-0040, OP8-0599, OP6-1121)
Frequency	20.1 patient visits/clinic-day; ~6,592/clinic-year; ~57% repeat (QL1-0283, QL1-0810, QL1-1070)	21–26 patient visits/day; 61–62% repeat (QLF-0413, QLF-0335, QLF-0950)	~20 patient visits/day (ST-22); ~62% repeat (QL2-0345, QL2-0362)	emergency visit about once every 7 years per pet (CO2-001 p.18)	~70 invoices/clinic-month; 14% repeat, LTM Jul-23 (CO3-1360, CO3-1324)	691–735 invoices/clinic-year (COR-5846, COR-5848, COR-5850)	illness-, age- and prevention-driven care and pharmacy visits (CO2-001, CO2-012, CO2-009)
Labour intensity	hourly clinic team, $17.3/hr loaded; labour 19.4% of net sales; 216% tech turnover (QL1-0947, QL1-1291)	$13.8/hr wellness techs; clinic labour 28% of sales (QLF-1912, QLF-0289)	10-minute drop-in wellness exam, 71% of revenue (QL2-0347)	specialist hours at referral rates; labour 37% of case mix (CO1-0304, CO1-1082)	25.3 billed hours/invoice; labour 33.6% of revenue; $42.9/hr blended (CO3-1321, CO3-1260, CO3-1320)	2,753 hours/tech (2022, PF) (COR-6152)	production-paid veterinarians on posted fee schedules (CO2-001, CO2-012, CO2-009)

DIMENSION	WELLNESS CLINIC OPERATOR 1 (QL)	WELLNESS CLINIC FRANCHISOR PVA / SYSTEM (QL)	WELLNESS CLINIC OPERATOR 2 (QL)	EMERGENCY OPERATOR 1 / EMERGENCY OPERATOR 4 (EMERGENCY AND SPECIALTY)	EMERGENCY OPERATOR 3 (EMERGENCY AND SPECIALTY)	EMERGENCY OPERATOR 2 (EMERGENCY AND SPECIALTY)	CORE PHARMACY / GENERAL PRACTICE (REFERENCE)
Pet insurance / referral exposure	none (owner-paid)	none	none	~82% pet-insurance-backed; referral network ~49% + SPP ~34% of 2016 revenue (CO2-001 p.13; CO1-0308, CO1-0310)	82.3% pet-insurance-backed; ~58% referral network; top-5 pet insurers 57–57% (CO3-1351, CO3-0006, CO3-1347)	top-5 pet insurers 48.2% (H1-23, PF); 624 referral partners (CO2-016; CO2-028 p.21)	none (owner-paid)
Vaccine and wellness cadence	wellness exams and vaccines 69% of net sales; intervals lengthen ~1%/yr (QL1-1247, QL1-1911)	5,661–6,610 wellness-plan pets a clinic (QLX-015 p.14)	2–3 visits a year (QL2-1102, QL2-1103)	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
Rebates / supply margin	vendor rebates 4.1–4.4% of sales; royalty 2.6%; ad fund 4.8% (QL1-0227, QL1-0241, QL1-0178, QL1-1894, QL1-1895)	rebates 4.1% of sales; supply contract ~49% of franchisor PF EBITDA (QLF-0217)	supplier-agreement savings add-back $3.3m (QLX-020 p.17)	Emergency Operator 1 nets vendor rebates in SG&A (CO2-001, CO2-012, CO2-009)	rebates held at corporate (CO3-1125)	surgical-supply rebates inside COGS (CO2-025, CO2-024, CO2-026)	0.6–10.9% of revenue from pharmacy/supplies vendors (note C-28)
Rent code of four-wall	R-BOOK; rent 10.0% of sales (QL1-0346)	R-CASH (QLF-0236)	R-UNK	R-NONE (clinic EBITDAR) (CO1-0942)	R-CASH as owned; R-UNK PF (CO3-1159, CO3-1464)	R-UNK (COR-0137)	R-CASH pooled only (note C-19)

Source: source documents QLX-031, QLX-018, QLX-019, QLX-017, QLX-020, CO2-001, CO2-012, CO2-009, CO2-039, CO2-038, CO2-033, CO2-025, CO2-024, CO2-026 (Part 09 section E); the row IDs in each cell refer to the Evidence index (Part 09 section F). Basis A unless marked PF. Clinic base: ALL for ticket and frequency unless a cohort is named

The context tables, why the metrics cannot be pooled, the public signals on wellness clinics and the limits of the evidence are in Part 09 section K, under "04 G Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty: supporting evidence".

H · Public signals

On clinic lists read on 30 September 2026 and census income for 2020 to 2024, the three clinic bases sit in different markets: median household income within three miles of $84.0k at Deal C's mapped clinics, $69.6k at Deal A and $60.7k at Deal B, and an Operator 1-banner clinic that close to about four in ten Deal A and Deal B clinics.

How to read public signals. Public signals show how operators look from outside, to pet owners, employees and the market, and where their clinics sit. They are read beside the company records and are no evidence of clinic economics. Ratings and counts move; every figure was read on 30 September 2026 unless another date is given.

What they show. The three clinic bases sit in different markets: the median Deal C clinic mapped serves a trade area with a median household income of $84.0k, Deal A's median clinic $69.6k and Deal B's $60.7k, against a US median of $71,197. A Operator 1-banner clinic stands within three miles of 38.8% of Deal B's clinics and 35.5% of Deal A's clinics, and of 5 of the 69 Deal C clinics with coordinates. On one site, Deal A's employer rating, 1.9 on 376 reviews, sits below every other operator with 44 or more reviews.

Exhibit 4.21 — On clinic lists read on 30 September 2026 and ACS 2020–2024 income, the median trade-area household income was $84.0k at Deal C's mapped clinics, $69.6k at Deal A and $60.7k at Deal B, against a US median of $71.2k

Median household income of the census tracts within three miles of each clinic: median and interquartile range across clinics, $ thousand; clinics on public lists read on 30 September 2026, income from the American Community Survey 2020-2024

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Company clinic lists and location pages read on 30 September 2026; U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey 2020-2024 five-year tract estimates and 2024 Gazetteer; Census QuickFacts for the US median, $71,197 in 2024 dollars; our computation [I, C-PUB-1] · Basis: Trade area = census tracts whose internal point lies within three miles of the clinic. Income = median of the pooled household-income brackets of those tracts. Deal C: 72 clinics mapped of about 86, 69 with coordinates, 68 with a trade area; the list holds three State 20 clinics (two Operator 13, one Operator 11). Deal A: the 924 company-operated clinics on its public clinic list on 30 September 2026. Deal B: 96 clinics on its public site. Public data on where clinics sit; no evidence of clinic economics

Exhibit 4.22 — At 30 September 2026 an Operator 1-banner clinic stood within three miles of 38.8% of Deal B's clinics, 35.5% of Deal A's clinics and 5.6% of Deal C's mapped clinics (5 of 69 with coordinates)

Share of each clinic base with an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles and within five miles, %; clinic lists read on 30 September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Company clinic lists and location pages of Deal B, Deal C's brands, Deal A and Operator 1, read on 30 September 2026; our computation [I, C-PUB-2] · Basis: Great-circle distance from each clinic to the nearest of 1,394 Operator 1-banner clinics with coordinates. Operator 1 is mapped for its own banner only, so competition is understated where its other banners trade. Deal C: 69 of 72 mapped clinics have coordinates, of about 86 clinics; three of the five clinics with an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles are State 20 clinics, and the public list holds three State 20 clinics (two Operator 13, one Operator 11) against 16 Operator 13 clinics in the supplied documents [M, DLC-4341], so the share describes the clinics mapped. Deal A: the 924 company-operated clinics on its public clinic list

Exhibit 4.23 — An employer review site at 30 September 2026: Deal A's employer rating was 1.9 on 376 reviews, against 3.0 to 3.7 at the three other operators in the supplied documents with 44 or more reviews

Overall employer rating on one employer review site, stars out of 5, with the number of reviews behind each; read on 30 September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Employer review site company pages of each operator, read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: One channel and one definition: the overall rating the site publishes for each employer, with the number of reviews or ratings, as the site labels the count. Operators with fewer than 44 reviews (Deal C 7, Operator 5 38, Operator 2 32, Operator 8 9, Operator 3 4) are drawn pale as anecdote. Five reference peers are marks only; Operator 29 is rated on its own employer page and was acquired by Operator 1 on 20 August 2026 [F, PUB-0020]. Ratings and counts move; each is as shown on the date read. The share who would recommend the employer is given in Part 09 section K for the operators with 44 or more reviews

Exhibit 4.24 — Read on 30 September 2026, the outside signals rest on Deal A's whole clinic list, Deal B's own clinic pages and a partial map of Deal C's clinics, so coverage differs by deal

One row per group of public signals, one column per deal; each cell gives the figure and the section or exhibit where the company record or the fuller public evidence on the same subject sits, or states that the document holds none

SIGNAL GROUP	DEAL A	DEAL B	DEAL C
Customers	907 complaints with a consumer complaints body in three years, 0.77 per clinic on 983 company-operated clinics at 27 June 2026 [F, PUB-0034] [F, DLA-0399] [I, C-PUB-7] Exhibit 9.115	82 of 96 clinic pages show a rating; 4.21 on 49,539 reviews [F, PUB-0106] [I, PUB-0107; PUB-0108; PUB-0109; C-PUB-4] Exhibit 9.132	Two clinics read: 4.1 on 111 verified reviews and 4.2 on 258 ratings; 9 complaints in three years at the Operator 17 brand [F, PUB-0030, PUB-0031, PUB-0032, PUB-0033, PUB-0231] Exhibit 9.100; Exhibit 9.101
Employees	Employer review site 1.9 on 376 reviews; 12% would recommend [F, PUB-0053, PUB-0054, PUB-0061] Exhibit 9.115	No employer rating shown in this section; posted roles are in Exhibit 9.134	Employer review site 3.9 on 7 reviews, fewer than 44 [F, PUB-0065, PUB-0066]; the company's veterinarian retention is in Part 09 section N (under "07 B")
Footprint and competition	Median three-mile income $69.6k across 938 clinics; an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles of 35.5% of 924 [I, C-PUB-1] [I, C-PUB-2] Part 05 section B	Median three-mile income $60.7k across 95 clinics; an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles of 38.8% of 96 [I, C-PUB-1] [I, C-PUB-2] Part 06 section C	Median three-mile income $84.0k across 68 clinics mapped; an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles of 6.3% (5 of 69), three of the five being State 20 clinics; the public list holds three State 20 clinics (two Operator 13, one Operator 11) against 16 Operator 13 clinics in the supplied documents [M, DLC-4341], so the share describes the clinics mapped; five metro areas hold 54.7% of 72 [I, C-PUB-1] [I, C-PUB-2] [I, C-PUB-3] Exhibit 9.144
Price and guarantee	Dental procedure guarantee of 12 or 21 months; clinic-supply and medical-waste charge up to 12%, no greater than $43.58 [F, PUB-0079, PUB-0080, PUB-0085, PUB-0086]; the document holds no company record on guarantees, and fee revenue by year is requested in Part 05 section G	Guarantee of 21 months or $21,161 of covered treatment [F, PUB-0078]; the document holds no company record on guarantees	Wellness-plan guarantees of 43 to 52 months across four brands, two with a return-visit condition [F, PUB-0071, PUB-0072, PUB-0074, PUB-0075, PUB-0073, PUB-0076, PUB-0077] Exhibit 9.145

SIGNAL GROUP	DEAL A	DEAL B	DEAL C
Technology	Booking and pharmacy pages on the company site; a consumer finance provider financing; the company states that it runs digital patient reminders [F, PUB-0233, PUB-0234, PUB-0235] [M, PUB-0302] Exhibit 9.115	Third-party online booking; a consumer finance provider and a consumer finance provider financing; no pharmacy search seen on the pages read [F, PUB-0237, PUB-0238] Exhibit 9.134	Third-party online booking on five brand sites; an online pharmacy storefront on three [F, PUB-0239, PUB-0240] Exhibit 9.145

Source: The exhibits and tables of this section · Basis: Operating signals only. Each figure carries the coverage and date stated where it is first shown in this section. The cells state what the public sources show and point to the section or exhibit that holds the company record or the fuller public evidence, or state that the document holds none

Customer ratings, complaints, the national surveys, guarantee terms, posted prices, customer-facing technology, regulatory actions and the limits of each signal are in Part 09 section K, under "04 H Public signals: supporting evidence".

Part 05 — Deal A

Deal A's weakest clinics are an identifiable tail, and closing them lifts clinic margin, on Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost, to the lower half of the peer band, but traffic is falling across the clinics it keeps and the second round's value turns on how the company measures clinic contribution

Ares Credit Group asked. Ares Credit Group's thesis, in neutral words: Deal A is a large, scaled platform in a turnaround. Its clinic base expanded too far and left a number of underperforming clinics. The first round of closures is done; Ares Credit Group is underwriting the second, which it believes brings Deal A closer in line with comparable operators, and it sees Deal A's scale and diversity as supporting an investment at a low leverage multiple (Part 05 section A; leverage in Part 08 section B).

On Ares Credit Group's basis, with vendor co-op allocated to clinics, Deal A's FY26 clinic margin is 12.8%, and 14.4% for the 824 clinics kept once the 119 second-round clinics close; after finance-lease cost, which peers on cash rent carry inside rent, it is 10.7% and 12.5%, the floor and then the lower half of the 10.7–17.4% peer band. 104 of the 119 sit in Ares Credit Group's bottom quartile, and closing them takes the loss-making share including co-op from 19.5% to 11.4%. Traffic is the open point: the clinics kept lost 3.2% of comparable traffic in FY26, against 2.0–2.8% at peers, and with quartiles fixed at FY23 the top half's clinic EBITDA fell 16% to FY26. Valued from the clinic list received on 1 October, the second round adds +$7.2m to +$20.4m a year if its benefit is the reversal of the clinics' "Profit co-op" loss, and −$11.8m to +$0.6m on the company's "Contribution" measure, which its workbook does not define.

Clinic margins are shown on Ares Credit Group's basis, with vendor co-op allocated to clinics at 5.15% of sales, beside clinic margins before co-op, with finance-lease cost labelled between them; peers are compared on a co-op-included, cash-rent basis, and the placement is indicative. Comparable traffic uses one common definition, and series that leave out closed clinics are read as upper bounds. The second round is valued on the company's two clinic measures, with clinic EBITDA including co-op between them; closure cash is the workbook's $21.79m to lease end, spread over the 42.1-month average remaining term.

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED
A-01	Same-store sales are compared on one common definition	Clinics owned and open 13 months, calendar months, no months from before purchase; the treatment of closed clinics is stated
A-02	Clinic (four-wall) margins are compared before rebates and after cash rent	In this part the comparison departs from this: for Deal A, clinic margins are shown on Ares Credit Group's co-op-included basis and before co-op, with finance-lease cost labelled between them, and peers co-op-included on cash rent; each treatment is named and never pooled
A-05	Disposal gains are shown separately from reported EBITDA	Deal A FY26 reported EBITDA shown with and without $16.0m of disposal gains
A-07	Series that exclude closed clinics are read as upper bounds	Closed clinics absent from a series are stated with the series
A-F2	Closure cash, amount and timing	$21.79m spread evenly over 42.1 months from April 2027, plus $4.3m of professional fees in Ares Credit Group's model in April to June 2027
A-P7	Deal A clinic results are those of the FY26 clinic-level file	983 clinics; loss-making means negative clinic-level EBITDA; clinics closed before the FY26 file date (28 March 2026) carry no address in the supplied files and are outside the public-data mapping

Exhibit 5.01 — Three of Deal A's four business components read partially supported, two of them leaning supported on Ares Credit Group's rebates-included basis; the second round's value turns on a definition Deal A has not yet given (evidence to October 2026)

Our reading on each component of Ares Credit Group's Deal A thesis (M1 to M5), with the depth of the evidence and what would change it; FY20 to the first quarter of FY27, files to 1 October 2026

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
M1 · Underperformance is clinic-specific and curable by rationalisation	**Partially supported (leans supported)** — the tail is identifiable and closing it lifts clinic margin; the decline across retained clinics is not addressed by closures. 104 of the 119 second-round clinics sit in Ares Credit Group's bottom quartile, and closing them takes the loss-making share including co-op from 19.5% to 11.4%; with quartiles fixed at FY23, the top half's clinic EBITDA fell 16% to FY26 (Part 05 section B, Part 05 section E).	Deal A's clinic-level earnings files FY23–FY26 and KPI files to the first quarter of FY27 (actual); the 119-clinic list of 1 October; co-op allocated at Ares Credit Group's rate; Ares Credit Group's quartile view reproduced exactly.	FY27 results of the clinics kept, by quartile fixed at FY23; results of the clinics already closed, allowing an all-clinic comparison

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
M2 · First-round closures delivered realised benefit	**Partially supported.** The closed set lost $16.0m of clinic EBITDA in FY25 and the round realised about $24m of net proceeds, but reported EBITDA excluding disposal gains still fell 33.2% in FY26 (Part 05 section C).	Deal A's clinic-level earnings file (FY23–FY25, actual), its FY26 10-K and the company's closure summary; no peer file measures a closure outcome, and the files do not allow Deal A's own recapture to be measured.	Sales and addresses of the first round's 129 closed clinics, to measure how many customers moved to surviving clinics
M3 · Second round creates value after all costs	**Insufficient evidence** — the clinic list now allows a valuation; its sign turns on the definition of "Contribution" and on lease exits. The round adds +$7.2m to +$20.4m a year if its benefit is the reversal of the clinics' "Profit co-op" loss, −$1.8m to +$11.2m on clinic EBITDA including co-op, and −$11.8m to +$0.6m on the undefined "Contribution"; closure cash is $21.79m to lease end plus $4.3m of fees (Part 05 section D).	The 119-clinic list (clinic results, rent, lease terms and cost to close, LTM June 2026); company estimates; Ares Credit Group's model; overhead ratios of three platforms, pro forma for two. No lease-exit plan.	The definitions of "Contribution $" and "Profit co-op $"; the lease-exit plan for the 109 leases with any buy-out costs; the overhead budget after the closures
M4 · Remaining platform supports the quality premise	**Partially supported (leans supported)** — on Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost, the clinics kept sit in the lower half of the peer band; traffic remains last of three. On Ares Credit Group's basis the clinic margin is 12.8% for all clinics and 14.4% for the 824 kept; after finance-lease cost, 10.7% and 12.5% against a 10.7–17.4% peer band (indicative); comparable traffic at the clinics kept −3.2% in FY26 against −2.0% to −2.8% (Part 05 section E).	Deal A's clinic-level earnings and KPI files (actual), pro forma for the 119 clinics; peers on a co-op-included, cash-rent basis (three operators, 2021–25); traffic against Operator 3 and Operator 6 on one definition.	July–September 2026 trading; traffic at the clinics kept moving into the peer range
M5 · Low-leverage financing is resilient	**Contradicted** as "resilient at low leverage"; **partially supported** as a sale-bridged loan. Read on the recapitalisation model of 29 September in Part 08 section B.	Part 08 section B	Part 08 section B

Source: Part 05 section A to Part 05 section G, and Part 08 section B for M5 · Basis: Mostly actual (A); clinic margins on Ares Credit Group's basis allocate co-op at a flat rate [I]; the second-round cases are pro forma run rates (PF) on the company's clinic measures; financing on the recapitalisation model of 29 September (P)

A · Thesis and readings

Deal A's weakest clinics are an identifiable tail, and closing them lifts clinic margin, on Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost, to the lower half of the peer band; traffic is falling across the clinics it keeps, and the second round's value turns on how the company measures clinic contribution (evidence to 1 October 2026).

Ares Credit Group's thesis. Deal A is a large, scaled platform in a turnaround whose clinic base expanded too far. With the first round of closures done, a second round of 119 closures adds about $12m of run-rate EBITDA and brings Deal A closer to comparable operators, and its scale and diversity make it attractive at a low leverage multiple [A, Deal A Diligence & Structure Update; M, Project Alpha CIP p.1; financing in Part 08 section B].

What holds. The weak clinics are a stable, identifiable group: 104 of the 119 second-round clinics sit in Ares Credit Group's bottom quartile, and closing them takes the clinic margin on Ares Credit Group's basis from 12.8% to 14.4% (from 10.7% to 12.5% after finance-lease cost, in the lower half of the peer band) (Part 05 section B, Part 05 section E). The first round removed real losses (Part 05 section C).

What to watch. Traffic at the clinics kept fell 3.2% in FY26, last of three against peers, and the second round's value turns on a clinic measure the company has not defined (Part 05 section D).

Exhibit 5.02 — Deal A's weakest clinics are an identifiable tail and closing them lifts clinic margin, on Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost, to the lower half of the peer band; traffic is falling across the clinics it keeps and the second round's value turns on how the company measures clinic contribution (evidence to October 2026)

Ares Credit Group's thesis on Deal A by component: our reading on the evidence supplied to date, its basis, what holds, what does not and what would change it; FY23 to Q1 FY27, files to 1 October 2026

THESIS COMPONENT	OUR READING ON THE EVIDENCE SUPPLIED TO DATE	BASIS	WHAT HOLDS	WHAT DOES NOT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
M1 · Underperformance is clinic-specific and curable by rationalisation	**Partially supported (leans supported)** — the tail is identifiable and closing it lifts clinic margin; the decline across retained clinics is not addressed by closures	Ares Credit Group's quartile view reproduced exactly from the clinic files; 104 of the 119 second-round clinics in its bottom quartile; loss-making share including co-op 19.5% for all clinics, 11.4% for the 824 kept; quartiles fixed at FY23 for the same clinics (clinic-level EBITDA file; Data Cuts; FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis)	The weak clinics are an identifiable group: 104 of the 119 second-round clinics sit in Ares Credit Group's bottom quartile, and closing them takes the loss-making share including co-op from 19.5% to 11.4% and the clinic margin on Ares Credit Group's basis from 12.8% to 14.4% (FY26); rank is sticky (Part 05 section B, Part 05 section E)	The decline runs across the clinics kept: with quartiles fixed at FY23, the top half's clinic EBITDA including co-op fell 16% to FY26, and comparable traffic at the 824 clinics kept fell 3.2% in FY26 (Part 05 section B, Part 05 section E)	FY27 results of the clinics kept, by quartile fixed at FY23; results of the clinics already closed, allowing an all-clinic comparison
M2 · First-round closures delivered realised benefit	**Partially supported**	Closed set lost $16.0m in FY25; about $24m net proceeds; reported EBITDA ex-gains still −33.2% in FY26; no peer measured a closure outcome (clinic-level EBITDA file; Alpha CIP p.1; FY26 10-K)	The closed set lost $16.0m of clinic EBITDA in FY25 (129 of the clinic-EBITDA file's 127 closed clinics negative); the round realised about $24m of net proceeds (Part 05 section C)	Reported EBITDA excluding disposal gains still fell 33.2% in FY26; the files do not allow recapture by surviving clinics to be measured (Part 05 section C)	Sales and addresses of the first round's 129 closed clinics, to measure recapture
M3 · Second round creates value after all costs	**Insufficient evidence** — the clinic list now allows a valuation; its sign turns on the definition of "Contribution" and on lease exits	The 119-clinic list received on 1 October: $68.9m of sales, "Profit co-op" −$19.6m and "Contribution" −$0.1m (LTM Jun-26); closure cash $21.79m to lease end, $9.63m of finance-lease interest, $12.13m of annual cash rent; 30 of 109 leases end within 21 months (FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis; note C-V2-3)	The round can now be valued: +$7.2m to +$20.4m a year if the benefit is the reversal of the clinics' "Profit co-op" loss; 103 of the 119 lost money on clinic EBITDA including co-op; the first round realised $10.4m of lease-termination gains, so exits are possible (Part 05 section C, Part 05 section D)	On clinic EBITDA including co-op the same scenarios give −$1.8m to +$11.2m, and on the undefined "Contribution" −$11.8m to +$0.6m; operating-lease rent of $5.75m a year continues on leases run to term; Deal A Banner 2 is 54 of the 119, and accounts the company labels strategic were $12.5m of FY26 sales (Part 05 section D)	The definitions of "Contribution $" and "Profit co-op $"; the lease-exit plan for the 109 leases with any buy-out costs; the overhead budget after the closures
M4 · Remaining platform supports the quality premise	**Partially supported (leans supported)** — on Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost, the clinics kept sit in the lower half of the peer band; traffic remains last of three	Clinic margin on four bases, all clinics and the 824 kept (FY26); peers on a co-op-included, cash-rent basis 10.7–17.4% (three operators, 2021–25; indicative); comparable traffic on the common definition (clinic-level EBITDA file; Data Cuts; Part 05 section E)	Scale: 983 clinics and $1,029.1m of FY26 revenue; on Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost the 824 clinics kept earn 12.5%, in the lower half of the 10.7–17.4% peer band (indicative); the ticket kept pace with veterinary prices in FY26 (Part 05 section E; Part 09 section L)	Last of three on traffic: comparable traffic at the clinics kept −3.2% in FY26 and −4.0% in the first quarter of FY27, against −2.0% to −2.8% at peers; company EBITDA −34% in the first quarter of FY27 (Part 05 section E; Part 09 section L)	July–September 2026 trading; traffic at the clinics kept moving into the peer range
M5 · Low-leverage financing is resilient	**Contradicted** as "resilient at low leverage"; **partially supported** as a sale-bridged loan	Set out on the recapitalisation model of 29 September in Part 08 section B	In Part 08 section B	In Part 08 section B	In Part 08 section B

Source: Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file FY23–FY26; New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26); FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027); Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update p.9; Project Alpha CIP p.1; Deal A FY26 10-K; Project Alpha Recapitalization Model v06 (DLA-026); each item as cited in the section named · Basis: A (filings, clinic files); clinic margins on Ares Credit Group's basis allocate co-op at a flat rate [I]; second-round cases pro forma (PF) on company clinic measures [F/I]; management plan (P); recapitalisation model (P) · Assumption: A-01, A-02, A-07, A-F2, A-P7

Where Ares Credit Group's view differs from ours. Ares Credit Group brings a lender's knowledge of this sector and of Deal A's entry point, and the files support it in several respects. Each point below states Ares Credit Group's view, the evidence each way and what would settle it.

Opportunistic entry. For: the company has launched a sale process (Part 08 section B), and in the proposed sale-leaseback Real Estate Advisor 1 values 26 owned sites alone at $44.4–46.9m [M, Project Charlie I-Chart, DLA-029]. Against: the value of the owned real estate rests on company and broker estimates; no third-party appraisal covers the $154.4m at which Ares Credit Group's collateral analysis carries it, the company's estimate built on tax-assessed values (June 2026; Part 08 section B). What would settle it: an appraisal of the owned sites, and evidence from the sale process.

Lower first-lien leverage than comparable deals. For: on the recapitalisation model of 29 September first-lien debt is 3.51x gross on LTM 2Q27F EBITDA of $67.2m (P), below Operator 6's 3.81x, Operator 3's 4.70x and Operator 4's 5.10x on the same rung, and above Operator 7 2.25x proposal [F/I, DLA-026 PF Cap Structure!P15; Part 08 section A]. Against: with

leases the covenant ratio peaks at 5.68x, and the model's own fixed-charge cover is 0.76–1.03x from March 2027 to FY31 (Part 08 section B). What would settle it: the covenant package as agreed, and July–September 2026 trading.

Corporate overhead opportunity. For: department costs rose from $44.4m (3.3% of revenue) in FY22 to $55.0m (4.7%) in FY26 while the clinic count fell from 1,117 to 983 [F/I, DLA-1295, DLA-1223, DLA-0017], and the recapitalisation model leaves its public-company cost-saving switch off ('FY27-FY31 P&L Assumptions'!D5 = FALSE), so a saving would be upside to that model. Against: no costed overhead plan is in the files. What would settle it: a costed overhead plan by function.

A healthy top half. For: on Ares Credit Group's sort the top two quartiles earned $154.2m of clinic EBITDA including co-op in FY26, at margins of 23.7% and 14.1% (Exhibit 5.03). Against: on a sort fixed at FY23 the top half's clinic EBITDA fell 16% to FY26, and traffic falls across the clinics kept (Part 05 section B, Part 05 section E). What would settle it: FY27 results for quartiles fixed on an earlier year.

The fuller evidence summary, the key-numbers table and the sale context behind this section are in Part 09 section L, under "05 A Thesis and readings: supporting evidence".

B · Underperformance drivers

Deal A's weak clinics are a persistent, identifiable group, and 104 of the 119 second-round clinics sit in Ares Credit Group's bottom quartile; with quartiles fixed at FY23, however, the top half's clinic EBITDA fell 16% to FY26, so the decline also runs through the clinics Deal A keeps (FY23 to Q1 FY27).

What holds. Ares Credit Group's quartile view reproduces from the clinic files (the bottom quartile's FY26 −$15.0m against −$14.9m printed), and it identifies the tail: 104 of the 119 second-round clinics sit in the bottom quartile, which lost $15.0m of clinic EBITDA including co-op in FY26. Rank is sticky: before co-op, 165 of 241 bottom-quartile clinics in FY25 stayed there in FY26, and region and pharmacy mix explain little of the clinic dispersion, as at peers. In the 13 weeks to 12 September Deal A's pharmacy units ran ahead of a market panel index for its footprint in 9 weeks [M].

What to watch. Sorting on the latest year selects the clinics that did well in it. With quartiles fixed at FY23, the top half's clinic EBITDA fell from $168.4m to $131.9m by FY26. The panel index includes Deal A, and in the 13 weeks before Deal A was behind it in 11.

Exhibit 5.03 — Sorted on FY26 results, as in Ares Credit Group's quartile analysis, Deal A's top two quartiles grew clinic EBITDA 7.6% from FY23 to FY26; with quartiles fixed on FY23 results, the same clinics' top half fell 16% ($168.4m to $131.9m), so the growth of the top half is largely a sorting effect

Clinic EBITDA including vendor co-op, $m, by clinic quartile, FY23 (LTM Mar-23) and FY26 (LTM Mar-26); count of second-round clinics in each quartile

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26) (DLA-019), Clinic Helper, clinic-level EBITDA and net sales LTM Mar-23 to LTM Mar-26; co-op rates 5.70% / 5.42% / 5.47% / 5.15% of clinic sales, implied by Ares Credit Group's Deal A Diligence & Structure Update (DLA-017) p.9 with the Clinic Helper clinic EBITDA before co-op (FY26 rate: DLA-003 rec!B16, $58.22m, over 10-K sales); FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027) for the 119 clinics; note C-V2-2 · Basis: Actual (A). Ares Credit Group's view reproduces its p.9 table exactly (237/278/278/281 current clinics; FY26 Q4 −$15.0m, printed −$14.9m). The fixed view sorts the 957 clinics with data on LTM Mar-23 clinic EBITDA including co-op (237/278/278/279) and tracks the same clinics to FY26. Clinics closed before the FY26 file are in neither view · Assumption: A-P7

Exhibit 5.04 — Deal A's clinic rank is sticky: 165 of 241 bottom-quartile clinics in FY25 were still bottom-quartile in FY26, and 177 of 241 top-quartile clinics stayed on top

Deal A clinics by four-wall margin quartile in FY25 (rows) and FY26 (columns), count of matched clinics (984); outlined cells = same quartile in both years

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A Clinic-level EBITDA FY23–FY26 (as of 28 March 2026) and Deal A All Clinics KPI Report FY20–Q1 FY27; CreditSwan computation (quartiles set within each year); note C-27 (DLA-003 clinic EBITDA) · Basis: Actual (A); company clinic EBITDA before co-op ÷ net sales, operating-lease rent only (R-OPONLY); clinics open at the file date and present in both years; Spearman rank correlation 0.71

Exhibit 5.05 — In the 13 weeks to 12 September 2026 Deal A's pharmacy units ran ahead of the market panel index for its footprint, which includes Deal A, in 9 weeks, by 1.3 points a week on average; the slide's "17.5%" is the sum of the 13 weekly gaps, and in the 13 weeks before Deal A was ahead in 2

Deal A comparable-clinic pharmacy units, year-on-year change, less the market panel index for Deal A's five-region footprint, percentage points by week, week ending 5 April 2025 to 12 September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A executive committee slide, Panel P13 week vs Deal A overview, 28 September 2026 (DLA-028), embedded workbook 'Slide 2' rows 2–65; note C-V2-6 · Basis: Company slide [M]; weekly series as the company built it. The index includes Deal A's own volume (slide footnote). Management attributes weeks ending 22 August to 5 September 2026 to ERP stocking disruption. Over all 68 weeks Deal A was ahead in 27

On Ares Credit Group's sort the top two quartiles grew clinic EBITDA from $139.6m to $154.2m (+7.6%) between FY23 and FY26; on the fixed sort the bottom quartile moved from −$7.6m to +$4.5m while the top half fell, which is what selection on the latest year predicts [I, note C-V2-2]. Of all 1,107 clinics open in FY23, before co-op, 115 of the FY23 bottom quartile had closed by the FY26 file and 46 are among the 119; the FY23 top quartile's 286 surviving clinics went from $97.5m to $75.9m (−17.4%) [I, note C-V2-2]. The panel slide's "▲17.5%" is the sum of 13 weekly gaps, an average of 1.5 points a week; management attributes the weeks ending 22 August to 5 September to ERP stocking disruption [M, DLA-028, 'Slide 2' rows 65–65; note C-V2-6].

The estate history, the long comparable-sales record, the market-versus-execution analysis, the traffic path against the core median and the public signals behind this section are in Part 09 section L, under "05 B Underperformance drivers: supporting evidence".

C · First-round closures

The first round removed real losses (the closed set lost $16.0m of clinic EBITDA in FY25) and realised about $24m of net proceeds, yet reported EBITDA excluding disposal gains fell 33.2% in FY26; the files do not allow the share of sales kept by surviving clinics to be measured.

What holds. The first round removed real clinic losses: the clinics closed had lost $16.0m of clinic EBITDA in FY25, 129 of the 127 in the clinic file at a loss, and the round realised about $24m of net proceeds from owned-clinic sales and lease assignments, with $10.4m of lease-termination gains, so some exits in a second round are possible [F/I, 1.0.4 FY25 columns L–M; CIP p.1 footnote 1]. Some sites went to competitors, including 28 leased clinics assigned to Operator 5.

What to watch. Reported EBITDA excluding disposal gains still fell 33.2% in FY26, from $86.6m to $56.4m, and company EBITDA from $97.5m in FY25 to $74.9m for the twelve months to June 2026 (Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update p.33). No peer file measures a closure outcome or a sales transfer, and the files carry no addresses for the closed clinics, so Deal A's own recapture cannot be measured [I, note C-62; DLA-0854].

Exhibit 5.06 — The 127 clinics in the clinic file's first-round closed cohort lost $16.0m of clinic EBITDA in FY25, nearly twice the $8.4m of FY23, and 129 of them lost money; the median clinic lost $104k

Left: clinic EBITDA before co-op of the clinics closed in the first round, $m, FY23 to FY25. Right: the same clinics by FY25 clinic EBITDA, number of clinics

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A clinic-level EBITDA FY23–FY26 (DLA-003), tabs FY23, FY24 and FY25, column L (YTD EBITDA) and column M (closure date); our count · Basis: Actual (A). The cohort is the 127 clinics with a closure date on the FY25 tab (119 closed in May 2025); the 10-K counts 130 closures and the company's closed-clinic list 129. Clinic EBITDA is raw, before co-op advertising income and before corporate costs; full fiscal years, the clinic file's own definition

Exhibit 5.07 — Reported EBITDA fell from $92.2m in FY25 to $71.2m in FY26 although disposal gains grew from $4.1m to $16.0m; excluding the gains it fell 33.2%, from $86.6m to $56.4m, and was $59.6m in the twelve months to June 2026

Deal A reported EBITDA (operating income plus depreciation, amortisation and impairment), split into gains on disposal of assets and the rest, $m, FY25, FY26 and the twelve months to June 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A Forms 10-K FY25 and FY26 and Form 10-Q Q1 FY27 (SEC EDGAR; the FY25 gain is read from the FY26 Form 10-K cash-flow statement, gain on disposal of assets, net); evidence rows DLA-0300, DLA-0315, DLA-0317, DLA-8701; note C-62 · Basis: Actual (A), consolidated. The gains are those recorded on clinic sales and lease terminations, mostly from the first round in FY26; reported EBITDA here is audited operating income plus depreciation, amortisation and impairment, not the company's adjusted EBITDA ($85.6m in FY26)

Our reading on M2, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported. What would change it: sales and addresses of the 129 first-round clinics, and the closed-clinic KPI history FY20 to Q1 FY27.

The clinic counts across the 10-K and the clinic file, the gains and fees, the peer closure record and Deal A's headcount across the round are in Part 09 section L, under "05 C First-round closures: supporting evidence".

D · Second-round closures

Valued from the 119-clinic list received on 1 October, the second round adds +$7.2m to +$20.4m a year if its benefit is the reversal of the clinics' "Profit co-op" loss (after depreciation, interest and finance-lease cost) and −$11.8m to +$0.6m on the company's undefined "Contribution", with clinic EBITDA including co-op between them (−$1.8m to +$11.2m); closure cash is $21.79m to lease end plus $4.3m of fees.

What holds. The clinic list allows the round to be valued. The 119 clinics lost $19.6m on the company's "Profit co-op" measure on $68.9m of sales (LTM June 2026), and 103 of them lost money on clinic EBITDA including co-op in FY26 (LTM March 2026). If the benefit is the reversal of that loss the round adds +$7.2m to +$20.4m a year across the scenarios, and 30 of the 109 leases end within 21 months, which eases exits.

What to watch. The sign turns on the measure. "Profit co-op" is after depreciation, bank interest and finance-lease cost, so it overstates the EBITDA removed; on clinic EBITDA including co-op the range is −$1.8m to +$11.2m, and on the undefined "Contribution" (−$0.1m) −$11.8m to +$0.6m. Deal A Banner 2 is 54 of the 119, and accounts the company labels strategic were $12.5m of their FY26 sales.

Exhibit 5.08 — Valued from the 119-clinic list, the second round adds +$7.2m to +$20.4m a year if its benefit is the reversal of the clinics' "Profit co-op" loss, −$1.8m to +$11.2m on clinic EBITDA including co-op, and −$11.8m to +$0.6m on the company's "Contribution" measure, which its workbook does not define (LTM June 2026)

Run-rate EBITDA effect, $m a year, of closing the 119 clinics: three definitions of the benefit, each under four scenarios for recapture, stranded costs and operating-lease exits; LTM June 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027), tab "New 119 Closures - UPDATED" row 142 (G, K, M, P, S) and Summary; New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26) (DLA-019), Clinic Profit/(Loss) LTM Jun-26; Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file (DLA-003) tab FY26; stranded-cost ranges as Exhibit 5.16; note C-V2-3 · Basis: Pro forma run rate (PF) [I] on company clinic figures [F]. Recapture = 13% × $72.48m × (gross margin 24.8% + co-op 5.15%) = $3.76m. Stranded overhead $2.1m / $3.9m / $4.7m and advertising $1.1m / $1.57m / $1.9m; operating-lease rent $5.75m a year where leases run to term. "Profit co-op" is clinic profit after depreciation, bank interest and finance-lease cost plus co-op at about 5.35%; the clinic-EBITDA line adds back $8.93m of those charges (approximation). One-off closure cash ($21.79m to lease end plus $4.3m of fees) is not in these run-rate figures · Assumption: A-F2

Exhibit 5.09 — Of the 119 second-round clinics, 54 trade as Deal A Banner 2 and 109 are leased, 30 of them on leases that end within 21 months ($2.8m of the $12.2m of annual cash rent); accounts the company labels strategic were $12.5m of their FY26 sales, 15.4% of LTM June 2026 sales

The 119 clinics by brand, by tenure, and leases by months remaining at July FY27 (gold: 21 months or less)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027), tab "New 119 Closures - UPDATED": brand, tenure, column U (months remaining), column Q (strategic sales, row 142), column S (cash rent, row 142 = Summary!J32) · Basis: Actual (A) as the company's file

states it; counts [I]. Annual cash rent: $5.75m on 54 operating leases, $6.99m on 51 finance leases. Strategic accounts are the company's label; the file does not say how much of those sales would move to clinics kept

Exhibit 5.10 — Spread over the 42.1-month average lease term, the workbook's $21.79m of closure cash is about $5.36m a year in FY28–FY31, against $4.3m in FY28 alone in Ares Credit Group's model

Second-round closure cost for 119 clinics by component and by fiscal year, $m: company workbook against Ares Credit Group model v24

COMPONENT	COMPANY WORKBOOK	ARES CREDIT GROUP'S MODEL
Common-area charges, to lease end	3.50	
Utilities, to lease end	6.38	
Real-estate taxes, to lease end	7.90	
Local taxes, to lease end	0.31	
Deferred maintenance ($26k a clinic)	3.69	
Cash closing costs	**21.79**	**4.3**
Finance-lease interest on the 51 finance-lease clinics	9.63	On our reading, inside the lease line, which the model does not charge to cash [I]
Professional fees	3.2 in the FY26 round; none in this estimate	4.3
Total as each source states it	**31.00**	**8.6**
Base rent on the 109 leased clinics, a year (in neither total; the finance-lease part includes the interest above)	12.13	Not shown. On our reading, operating-lease rent ($5.75m) ends at closure and finance-lease rent ($6.99m) stays in the lease lines [I]

CASH BY FISCAL YEAR	FY28	FY29	FY30	FY31	AFTER	TOTAL
Workbook cash over the remaining lease terms	5.36	5.36	5.36	5.36	0.68	21.79
Ares Credit Group's model: closure cash	4.3	0	0	0	0	4.3
Ares Credit Group's model: professional fees	4.3	0	0	0	0	4.3

Source: Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J32, J33, J37:J47, B49; Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!F20:I20, F21; Diligence & Structure Update p.11; timing by fiscal year: C-FIN-4 · Basis: M (company estimate, a maximum before lease assignments); A (Ares Credit Group model). Timing [I] · Assumption: The workbook gives no clinic-by-clinic schedule; its cash is spread evenly over the average remaining term of 42.1 months from April 2027, the month Ares Credit Group's model starts the closure. Deferred maintenance and the owned clinics' six-month costs would fall earlier

Management's $12m sits between case A and the clinic-EBITDA line; whether leases are exited or run to term moves each case by $5.75m a year of operating-lease rent [I, note C-V2-3]. The FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis gives the same closure cost as the September closure workbook (Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data) to the cent ($21.79m of cash to lease end, $9.63m of finance-lease interest, $31.00m in all), and its "CHANGE" row shows the cost to close rose by $22.61m from an earlier version of $8.51m that is not elsewhere in the files [F, FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis, Summary!J43, J45, J47; clinic tab Y142:Y143]. Annual cash rent is $12.13m ($5.75m on 54 operating leases, $6.99m on 51 finance leases), and the present value of the rent obligations is $65.59m [F, clinic tab S142, V142].

Our reading on M3, on the evidence supplied to date: insufficient evidence — the clinic list now allows a valuation; its sign turns on the definition of "Contribution" and on lease exits. What would change it: the definitions of "Contribution $" and "Profit co-op $", the lease-exit plan for the 109 leases with any buy-out costs, and the overhead budget after the closures (Part 05 section G).

The closure-cost composition against Ares Credit Group's model, the bounded valuation of the round without the clinic list, stranded overhead and advertising, and the plan beneath the uplift are in Part 09 section L, under "05 D Second-round closures: supporting evidence".

E · Against comparable operators

On Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost the clinics Deal A keeps earn 12.5%, in the lower half of the 10.7–17.4% peer band (indicative), and closing the 119 takes the loss-making share from 19.5% to 11.4%; on traffic the clinics kept stay last of three (FY26 −3.2% against −2.0% to −2.8%).

What holds. With vendor co-op allocated to clinics, as Ares Credit Group does and as peers report it, the FY26 clinic margin is 12.8% for all clinics and 14.4% for the 824 kept. After finance-lease cost, which Deal A carries below clinic EBITDA and peers on cash rent carry inside rent, it is 10.7% and

12.5%: at the floor, then in the lower half, of the band of three peers on the same basis. The loss-making share including co-op falls from 19.5% to 11.4%.

What to watch. The placement is indicative: co-op is allocated at a flat rate and Deal A's rent is at book. On traffic the clinics kept remain last of three, −3.2% in FY26 against −2.0% at Operator 6 (CY2025) and −2.8% at Operator 3 (LTM August 2025), and −4.0% in the first quarter of FY27. Before co-op, on the clinic file's basis, the margin is 7.9%.

Exhibit 5.11 — On Ares Credit Group's basis Deal A's FY26 clinic margin is 12.8% (14.4% for the 824 clinics kept after the second round); deducting finance-lease cost, which peers on cash rent carry inside rent, gives 10.7%, at the floor of the 10.7–17.4% peer band, and 12.5% for the clinics kept, in its lower half

Clinic EBITDA margin, % of clinic sales, FY26 (LTM Mar-26): from clinic EBITDA before co-op to Ares Credit Group's basis and after finance-lease cost, all clinics and the clinics kept; the comparable peer band, co-op included, cash rent

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A clinic-level EBITDA FY23–FY26 (DLA-003), tab FY26, columns J, K, M, totals row 1131; New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26) (DLA-019), Clinic Helper, LTM Mar-26 sales; co-op rate 5.15%, implied by Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update (DLA-017) p.9 with the clinic file (DLA-003 rec!B16, $58.22m, over 10-K sales of $1,029.1m); FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027); peer band Exhibit 1.12; note C-V2-1 · Basis: All clinics actual (A); the 824 clinics pro forma (PF, hollow). Co-op $58.2m ($56.9m for the 824) allocated at 5.15% of clinic sales, Ares Credit Group's rate. Finance-lease cost is book depreciation plus interest, $30.32m ($25.33m). Ares Credit Group's figure (p.9) leaves out a net $10.6m of clinic costs not allocated to clinics (advertising −$11.8m, outbuy rebates +$5.9m, other). The peer placement is indicative: Deal A's co-op is allocated at a flat rate and its rent is at book; no peer is on Deal A's basis before finance-lease cost, so 12.8% and 14.4% are not set against the band · Assumption: A-02

Exhibit 5.12 — Including co-op, 19.5% of Deal A's clinics lost money in FY26 and 11.4% of the 824 it keeps after the second round; 103 of the 119 closing clinics (73.1%) lost money on the same basis

Share of clinics with negative clinic EBITDA, %, FY26 (LTM Mar-26), on three bases (before co-op; including co-op; including co-op after finance-lease cost) for all clinics, the clinics kept and the 119 second-round clinics

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A clinic-level EBITDA FY23–FY26 (DLA-003), tab FY26, columns J, K, M; New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26) (DLA-019), Clinic Helper; FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027); note C-V2-1 · Basis: All clinics and the 119 actual (A); the 824 pro forma (PF). Co-op allocated at 5.15% of clinic sales (implied by Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update p.9 with DLA-003 rec!B16). Counts: 324 / 218 / 274 clinics of 983; 218 / 111 / 150 of 824; 112 / 103 / 122 of 119 · Assumption: A-02, A-P7

Exhibit 5.13 — The clinics Deal A keeps after the second round lost comparable traffic in every year from FY23, −3.2% in FY26 and −4.0% in the first quarter of FY27, against −2.0% and −2.8% at the two peers on the common definition; the 119 closing clinics fell faster (−11.9% in FY26)

Comparable-clinic traffic, change year on year, %, FY22 to Q1 FY27: all current clinics, the 824 kept and the 119 second-round clinics; peers on the common definition, latest year

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26) (DLA-019), tabs FY22 to Q1 FY27 (All Clinics KPI); FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027) for the 119; peers as Exhibit 9.122 (OP3-0907, OP6-1896) · Basis: Actual (A) for each clinic set; the 824 is a pro forma set (PF). Comp base: clinics with traffic in both years, opened before the prior year began. On this base, a close variant of the common definition, all current clinics read −8.0% in FY25; on the common definition (clinics open 13 months, KPI report), as in Exhibit 5.16, −7.9%. Survivor series, so upper bounds. Same-store sales for the 824: +2.1% FY26, −0.7% Q1 FY27 · Assumption: A-01, A-07

Ares Credit Group's clinic EBITDA of $156.0m (p.9) reconciles to the clinic file: $91.0m before co-op plus $57.8m of co-op is $151.8m on 10-K sales of $1,029.1m, and Ares Credit Group spreads the co-op on clinic sales of $1,026.4m, giving $156.0m. Neither figure includes a net $10.6m of clinic costs not allocated to clinics (advertising −$11.8m, outbuy rebates +$5.9m and other items) or −$2.3m for clinics closed in the first quarter of FY26 [F/I, clinic-level EBITDA file, rec!B2, B3:B12, B16; note C-V2-1]. Same-store sales at the 824 clinics kept were +2.1% in FY26 and −0.7% in the first quarter of FY27, against +1.1% and −1.3% for all current clinics [I, note C-V2-1].

Our reading on M4, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported (leans supported) — on Ares Credit Group's basis after finance-lease cost, the clinics kept sit in the lower half of the peer band; traffic remains last of three. What would change it: July–September 2026 trading, and traffic at the clinics kept moving into the peer range.

The comparator choice, the valid and non-valid comparisons, the 2024–26 rankings on the common definition, the breadth of negative comps and the four-wall bound before co-op are in Part 09 section L, under "05 E Against comparable operators: supporting evidence".

F · Cash conversion

Deal A turned 0.52 of FY26 reported EBITDA into cash after capex (0.44 excluding disposal gains), and $35.8m of its $77.9m of FY26 cash before financing costs came from a working-capital release; the plan assumes a return to the 20-year median of 0.75 by FY31.

What holds. The plan's conversion before financing sits inside Deal A's own record: on plan capex of $24.3–25.9m a year, conversion after capex runs from 0.59 in FY27 to 0.64 in FY31, the median of 20 steady years in Deal A's audited accounts (0.53–0.72) [I, DLA-2543..2547; A6-P5-003].

What to watch. The start is 0.09–0.22 below that median: 0.52 of FY26 reported EBITDA, 0.44 without disposal gains, and 0.47 for the twelve months to June 2026 on the same basis. $35.8m of the $77.9m of FY26 cash before financing costs came from a working-capital release, and after finance-lease cash cost conversion was 0.03.

Exhibit 5.14 — The plan returns conversion to Deal A's 20-year median of 0.75 by FY31 from 0.09–0.22 below it in FY26 and LTM June 2026, with and without disposal gains

Conversion = (EBITDA − total capex) ÷ EBITDA; from audited accounts FY10 to FY26 and LTM June 2026, management plan FY27 to FY31; steady-year median and range (20 years, FY2000–FY2026) and build-year median (eight years, FY1996–FY2017), note C-62

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A 10-K filings FY2010 to FY2026 and Q1 FY27 10-Q; Deal A 5-Year Financial Model for Financing Banks (4 August 2026), P&L row 181 and cash-flow row 24. Rows A6-P5-003; A6-P5-004; DLA-2543; DLA-2830; DLA-2544; DLA-2843; DLA-2545; DLA-2856; DLA-2546; DLA-2869; DLA-2547; DLA-2882 · Basis: Line from audited accounts (A): operating income plus depreciation and amortisation including impairment and disposal gains, fiscal years ending March; FY26 0.52, LTM June 2026 0.55 (drawn one quarter after FY26); squares remove $16.0m (FY26, 0.44) and $19.7m (LTM, 0.47) of disposal gains. Plan line (P, dashed): company non-GAAP EBITDA and plan capex, a different EBITDA definition from the line from audited accounts. Band and medians: Deal A's own steady years; shaded years are build years (openings and acquisitions above 9% of the base). The build-year median of 0.40 is set mostly by FY1996–FY1999 and FY2007, which are not drawn; the three build years drawn (FY10, FY13, FY17) sit at 0.57–0.70

Exhibit 5.15 — Of Deal A's $71.2m FY26 EBITDA, $42.9m remained after capex (0.52); a $35.8m working-capital release took cash before interest, finance-lease payments and dividends to $77.9m

Bridge from EBITDA derived from the audited FY26 accounts to cash after capex, working capital and tax, before interest, finance-lease payments and dividends; USD millions; fiscal year ended 28 March 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A FY26 Form 10-K, income statement and cash-flow statement (DLA-0317, DLA-0320; ratio DLA-0325) · Basis: Actual (A), consolidated. EBITDA is derived from the audited accounts (operating income plus depreciation, amortisation and impairment); it is not itself an audited line. It includes $16.0m of gains on disposal; excluding them EBITDA is $56.4m and conversion after capex is 0.44. Capex is total capex (no audited maintenance split). Working capital excludes supplier finance, whose balance fell $16.5m in the year and is outside this bridge. Interest (including interest on finance leases), finance-lease principal, acquisitions (nil), disposal proceeds ($26.1m) and dividends come after the end point; cash after interest and finance-lease payments is set out in Part 08 section B

The bridge cannot split maintenance from growth capex, because Deal A's capex has no audited split, and it leaves out the $16.5m fall in the supplier-finance balance, which is treated as financing; cash after interest and finance-lease payments, and debt service under the proposed financing, are in Part 08 section B.

The lease treatment and the supplier-finance balances behind this section are in Part 09 section L, under "05 F Cash conversion: supporting evidence".

G · Sensitivities and requests

The plan's recovery is the business sensitivity furthest from Deal A's record, and the second round's sign turns on the clinic measure behind its benefit and on lease exits; 25 requests follow, 9 of the highest priority, and the 119-clinic list has been received in part.

What holds. Each sensitivity is set against a range observed in Deal A's own files or at peers, and the clinic list received on 1 October allows the second round to be valued in two cases on the company's own clinic measures (Part 05 section D).

What to watch. The plan's comparable-sales path needs Deal A to move from the bottom of the survivor-base rankings to comps its peers reached only in single periods (Exhibit 5.16; Part 09 section L), and the second round turns on the definition of "Contribution", on lease exits, and on recapture, stranded overhead and advertising that no file pins down. The financing sensitivities are in Part 08 section E.

Exhibit 5.16 — Deal A's plan needs comps that its survivor-base peers reached only in single periods, and the second round rests on unmeasured recapture and up to $2.1–4.7m a year of stranded overhead (observed ranges to 2026)

Business sensitivities: alternative parameters (assumed), observed range with its source, Deal A's value and our reading; FY17 to LTM June 2026; supplied files and Parts 03 and 04

SENSITIVITY	ALTERNATIVE PARAMETERS (ASSUMED)	OBSERVED RANGE (SOURCE)	DEAL A VALUE	READING ON THE OBSERVED RANGE
Round 2 sales recapture	13% [M]; half-benefit variant	No peer measurement in the files (the Evidence index, Part 09 section F; note C-85); Deal A's first-round recapture not measurable from the files (Part 05 section C)	13% of $68.9m	13% remains a management claim with no measured anchor; half the closure benefit is run as a financing case in Part 08 section E
Stranded overhead on Round 2	Advertising left behind, taken at Deal A's consolidated advertising expense of 1.59% (FY25) to 2.36% (FY26) of sales and applied to the 119 clinics' sales (DLA-1242/DLA-0016; DLA-1226/DLA-0017; C-PUB-8)	Corporate overhead 2.6–5.9% of revenue at SOFT24-26 core peers (OP3-2567, OP7-0798; definitions differ); Deal A 3.0% FY17 → 4.7% FY26 while clinics fell (DLA-1350, DLA-1223)	$68.9m of sales leaving	Upper bound (assumes 100% of the overhead intensity is stranded): up to $2.1–4.7m a year of corporate cost stays behind ($3.9m at Deal A's FY26 ratio), recurring each year, on top of $1.1–1.9m of advertising
Closure cash cost	Ares Credit Group $4.3m of cash in FY28 plus $4.3m of fees	Company workbook: $21.79m over the remaining lease terms, a maximum before assignments (Summary!J43, J33, B49); the first round cost about $9.3m of cash, with $3.2m of fees (Diligence & Structure Update p.11; Summary!J59). "One-time" cash costs recurred for three to nine years at each acquisitive platform on file; Deal A's clinic-closing adjustment line ran FY21–FY26 (DLA-1322..1232); Operator 29 dark-rent adjustment $39.5m against a $21.0m closure adjustment for 82 clinics [M] (OP1-11268, OP1-11271)	$21.79m of cash; base rent $12.13m a year; $65.0m lease present value	Ares Credit Group's model differs in amount and in timing: the workbook (and Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update, up to $21.5m) spreads the cash over the lease terms, about $5.3m a year from FY28 to FY31, against $4.3m in FY28 alone in Ares Credit Group's model; its effect on liquidity is in Part 08 section E; dark rent is the larger exposure in the one peer programme on file
Plan recovery	Plan comps +3.2% then +2.6% [M]; EBITDA +9% a year	SOFT24-26 means ≥3%: on SSS_CD Operator 7 (+11.4%, seller-period) and Operator 8 (+5.3%); on SSS_ST-59 Deal C (+5.2%) and Operator 4 (+3.0%, undefined); survivor-based Operator 3 and Operator 6 +1.9% to +4.2% by year; median core comp traffic −2.8% across seven operators including Deal A, mixed bases (note C-50; Exhibit 9.63)	Survivor traffic −3.9% to −7.9% FY24–FY26; survivor SSS_CD −4.1% / +1.1%	The plan's comp needs Deal A to move from the bottom of the survivor-base rankings to comps its survivor-base peers reached only in single periods (Operator 3 LTM August 2025, Operator 6 2024) and that Operator 7 and Operator 8 (common definition) and Deal C and Operator 4 (company definitions) averaged in 2024–25
Conversion	Plan CONV_1 0.59–0.64 (P)	Deal A 20-year steady median 0.64 (0.53–0.72) (Exhibit 9.67)	FY26 0.52 (0.44 ex-gains); LTM Jun-26 0.55 (0.47 ex-gains)	The plan returns to the median by FY31 from 0.09–0.22 below it; cash after interest and finance-lease payments is in Part 08 section B

Source: Observed ranges of Part 03 and Part 04 with the fact rows and exhibits in each cell; Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J33, J43, J59, B49; Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!F20:I20, F21; Diligence & Structure Update p.11 · Basis: Readings on the observed ranges are [I]; alternative parameters are assumed; Deal A values are A except the plan (P) and the company's closure estimates (M) · Assumption: A-01, A-07, A-F2

The requests that would most change a reading. The July–September 2026 actuals (request 1), to show whether the decline at the clinics kept has stopped (M1, M4); the definitions of the company's clinic measures and the lease plan for the 119 clinics (requests 21 and 23), which would fix the sign of the second round (M3); the closed-clinic KPI history with addresses of the first-round clinics (requests 8 and 9), to measure recapture (M1,

M2); and finance-lease cash payments by clinic (request 3) with the co-op basis and terms (requests 13 and 14), to state clinic economics on cash rent and judge how durable co-op is (M4). Items that bear only on the financing are listed in Part 08 section B.

Information requests

Items marked *Outstanding* have been requested and have not yet been received in full. The requests are for the company and its bankers, through Ares Credit Group.

Highest priority

1. *Outstanding.* The Q2 FY27 (July–September 2026) flash P&L, with monthly comparable sales, traffic, ticket and pharmacy channels mix for July–September, at clinic level if possible.
2. *Outstanding.* The supply-chain-finance schedule by bank (Lender 3, Lender 2, Lender 4, Lender 5), invoice-dated, with each bank's intentions and notice periods, a monthly wind-down forecast for FY27–FY28 and vendors' standard terms after the unwind, so that trade payables and working capital can be stated on one definition — reconciled to the $197.6m in the FY26 10-K, the $151.8m in the company model and the $137.1m utilised in the Credit Summary of the company's current supply-chain-finance ageing.
3. *Received in part on 1 October 2026* (FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis: clinic, brand, region, sales, clinic profit including co-op, "Contribution", strategic sales, rent, lease type and remaining term, and cost to close for each of the 119 clinics). *Outstanding:* each clinic's TTM P&L with and without co-op on a defined basis and its assumed sales recapture; lease payments FY27–FY31 by clinic; FY26 finance-lease cash payments by clinic; and, by clinic ID, the street address of each clinic and the clinic or clinics expected to receive its customers.
4. The timing of the Round 2 closure plan, including how the 17 August closure tracker (no FY27/FY28 closures identified) relates to the 119-clinic list in the closure workbook (Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, September 2026) and in the FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (3 September 2026); and a list, by clinic ID, of the clinics closed between 30 June and 30 September 2026, with the clinic count by banner at the latest month-end.
5. *Outstanding.* A Round 2 closure cash budget by quarter, reconciled to the $21.79m of cash closing costs and the $9.63m of finance-lease interest in the clinic-closure file ($31.00m; "~$31mm" in the CIP); the lease-exit plan for the 109 leased sites (exit rights, landlord discussions, expected dark-rent period, buy-out costs; the file of 1 October shows 30 leases ending within 21 months); the corporate overhead budget after the closures; and how the Round 2 case treats base rent on the 109 leased clinics: about $52m of remaining contractual rent ($53.4m in the clinic-closure file, Summary!F32:G33; $12.13m a year over an average 42.1 months), against a lease-liability present value of $65.0m in the same file, which is higher than that rent and which the file does not reconcile to it.
6. For each receiving clinic named in request 3: number of exam rooms, veterinarians employed, open veterinarian positions, and veterinarian hours booked against hours available, for the last twelve months.
7. Advertising expense by channel and by market for fiscal 2024 to 2027 to date, the share paid for by vendors, and the company's own measure of the traffic or sales each channel brought.

Next priority

8. Clinic KPIs — traffic, sales and clinic EBITDA — for the clinics closed between FY20 and Q1 FY27, with the street address and closure date of each. The KPI file supplied covers only the 983 clinics open at the file date.
9. For the 129 Round 1 closed clinics, if not already covered by item 8: clinic-level sales and traffic FY23–FY26, street addresses, and dark-clinic costs paid by quarter since closure (rent, CAM and taxes on leases not exited).
10. The Round 1 closure files: the FY25–FY26 closed-clinic tracker (tracker file 1.9) and closed-clinic costs YTD FY26 (1.8); LTM earnings of the divested clinics; a bridge of the Round 1 run-rate EBITDA benefit, from the clinic losses removed to the benefit recognised in FY26 and Q1 FY27; and a reconciliation of the closed-clinic counts of 130 in the FY26 10-K and 129 on the company's closed-clinic list.
11. Price and volume history: the forecast file with FY20–FY26 actuals (1.2.1); revenue and units by category FY20–FY25 (1.2.2); and pharmacy units by brand and tier FY20–FY25.
12. A reconciliation, by clinic, of KPI-system net sales (file 1.0.2) to GAAP sales; KPI sales run about 1.3% higher.
13. The company's basis for vendor co-op and rebates in 'clinic-level EBITDA': whether each clinic-level figure it presents is before or after co-op, how co-op is allocated to clinics, and which basis the ~$12m Round 2 estimate uses, with a reconciliation of clinic-level EBITDA to company EBITDA (the FY26 clinic-level file gives $91.0m before co-op). Context: FY26 co-op of $57.8m in the clinic-level file equals 0.71x FY26 reported EBITDA (0.96x excluding disposal gains).
14. The top-10 vendor contracts and the co-op and rebate agreements, with the vendor spend files 4.4–4.7. FY26 co-op income was $57.8m.
15. The maintenance vs growth capex split, the basis for about $26m a year of forecast capex, and the Q2 FY27 10-Q when filed.
16. Headcount by function and level (clinic, district, region, headquarters) at each fiscal year-end from March 2024 and at the latest month-end; and headquarters cost by quarter, actual and planned to fiscal 2028, with fees to outside advisers and contractors shown separately.

17. Veterinarian and clinic-manager turnover, vacancies, time to fill and average hourly pay, by banner and by clinic, for fiscal 2024 to 2027 to date, for clinics still open and for clinics since closed.
18. The customer complaint log and the refund log by clinic and month for fiscal 2024 to 2027 to date, with any customer-satisfaction score the company tracks by clinic.
19. Revenue from pharmacy dispensing fees, medical-waste disposal and clinic-supply charges by year for fiscal 2020 to 2026, with the dates and amounts of each change to the fee schedule.
20. Supplier price changes attributed to manufacturer list-price increases since January 2025, by supplier and date; and any manufacturer price-protection credit, supplier credit or price reduction linked to a credit received in 2026, by month, showing where it is recorded in cost of sales, and in adjusted EBITDA.
21. Dated price actions from FY20 to date — each change to list prices, exam and procedure fees and other fees, by category and effective date — with gross margin by category and repeat-customer data by month over the same period.

If readily available

20. Whether any revenue or cost was reclassified between pharmacy products and service in FY25 (pharmacy product margin −321bp, service +532bp, total −68bp); and how the clinic budgets in the KPI report (ledgers 'BA' and 'B2') relate to the FY27 plan in the bank model, with the FY27 clinic budget.
21. A reconciliation of the $4.2m increase in clinic advertising reported for the quarter to 27 June 2026 to the advertising lines of the company model for that quarter and the same quarter a year earlier.
22. A schedule of open legal and agency matters with amounts reserved, and the status of the commitments made in the settlement announced on 13 July 2026, including the employee safety hotline.

Added from the files of 1 October 2026

21. *Highest priority.* The definitions of "Contribution $" and "Profit co-op $" in the FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis, with the build of each for one clinic, and which of them, or which other measure, the ~$12m second-round estimate uses. "Contribution $" totals −$0.08m and does not equal "Clinic Contribution" in the Data Cuts (−$1.58m, LTM June 2026); "Profit co-op $" (−$19.41m) equals clinic profit after depreciation, bank interest and finance-lease cost plus co-op at about 5.35%.
22. *Highest priority.* For each of the 30 leases ending within 21 months and the other 77 leases of the 119 clinics: whether the company plans to exit, assign or run the lease to term, with any agreed or expected buy-out cost and dark period.
23. *Next priority.* What the earlier cost to close of $8.51m covered, against the $31.00m now shown (the "CHANGE" row of the clinic tab, +$22.61m).
24. *Next priority.* The accounts the company labels strategic, served by the 119 clinics ($12.24m of FY26 sales): the accounts, sales by account, and the clinics expected to serve them after the closures.
25. *If readily available.* The panel series behind the slide of 28 September 2026 excluding Deal A's own volume, by product tier and region, for the 23 weeks to date.

The fuller account of the sensitivities is in Part 09 section L, under "05 G Sensitivities and requests: supporting evidence".

Part 06 — Deal B

On the evidence to August 2026, Deal B's newest cohort earns the 18% clinic margin the company states, its better-placed clinics hold their visit count, and its 2026 figures reconcile; where it can be tested the newer cohorts' start has not yet lasted, and density, capacity for twice the size and DBW's value are not shown

Ares Credit Group asked. Ares Credit Group's thesis, in neutral words: Deal B is an emerging operator that grew over 2021 to 2023 on its own resources by buying low-priced rural sites, and has built infrastructure and corporate cost to support about twice its current size. The 2025–26 cohorts show that, with sufficient capital, it can acquire more attractive sites in areas of higher household income and population density; its financial reporting became cleaner in 2026; it has a wellness clinic segment, Deal B Wellness Clinics (DBW); and Ares Credit Group is considering a low-leverage, high-priced financing with upside (Part 06 section A; the financing in Part 08 section C).

The company's responses of 30 September and 1 October hold up on several points that matter for its thesis: the newest cohort earned 18.9% in its 2025 owned months (the company says 18%), visit count comparables by number of positive market attributes reproduce exactly (+2.8% with three against −8.4% with none), and the April–August 2026 non-recurring total and deferred seller payments tie approximately to the data. In their first owned year the 2024 and 2025 cohorts delivered 0.76x and 0.71x of the seller EBITDA they were priced on, above Operator 8's 0.59–0.70x. What is not yet shown is that the start lasts: the first-year sales dip has not narrowed in the company's own data, the first-half-2024 deals fell to 0.23x in their second year, and the older cohorts earned 7.6–8.6% on book rent in 2025. DBW earned $5.42m of four-wall EBITDA in January–July 2026, 25.9% below the seller's same months, with visit count down 16.1% in the second quarter; no costed plan for twice the present size is in the files.

Clinic margins are compared on cash rent after rebates (before rebates the general practice and preventive clinics cannot be separated from DBW's), and Deal B's surviving clinics are read as an upper bound against peers' all-clinic bases; earnings are kept on named levels, and DBW is wellness clinic context, never pooled with the general practice and preventive clinics. Figures from the company's responses of 30 September and 1 October are company statements [M] until they tie to a data file, and are shown beside the data figure where the two differ. Public market measures use census tracts within three miles of each clinic, on the company's own cohorts, with 93 of 103 clinics matched.

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED
A-02	Clinic (four-wall) margins are compared before rebates and after cash rent	For Deal B, after rebates on cash rent, because before-rebate figures cannot separate the general practice and preventive clinics from DBW's; the treatment is named and never pooled
A-03	EBITDA is kept on named levels	Reported, adjusted, pro forma, run-rate, underwriting and cash EBITDA (pro forma less "one-time" costs that recur)
A-07	Series that exclude closed clinics are read as upper bounds	Closed clinics absent from a series are stated with the series
A-08	Live-deal figures come from the companies' own documents	Where a measure exists on two definitions, both are shown with the definition named
A-10	Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only	Never pooled with general practice veterinary care and preventive care and pharmacy in a core statistic
A-P6	Deal B's public measures are read on the company's own cohorts	93 of 103 clinics matched to their public location pages

Exhibit 6.01 — Deal B's newest cohort earns the 18% clinic margin the company states and its 2026 figures reconcile, but no business component of the thesis is supported outright on the evidence to August 2026

Our reading on each component of Ares Credit Group's Deal B thesis (MS1 to MS6), with the depth of the evidence and what would change it; January 2023 to August 2026

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
MS1 · Newer cohorts have better sustainable economics	**Partially supported** — newer cohort's 18% clinic margin confirmed on owned months; sustained economics not yet shown; first-year dip not narrowing in the data. The newest cohort earned 18.9% in its 2025 owned months, and the 2024 and 2025 cohorts started above Operator 8's 0.59–0.70x (0.76x and 0.71x of seller EBITDA in the first owned year); the first-year sales dip is −9.2% for the newest cohort in the company's own data, against the −6.2% it states, and the first-half-2024 deals fell from 0.48x to 0.23x in year two (Part 06 section B).	103 surviving clinics, monthly clinic earnings January 2023 to July 2026 (actual); seller EBITDA pro forma with its window not stated; one peer measures delivery the same way; the 2025 cohort has no second owned year.	A second owned year for the 2025 cohort; the definition behind the company's year-of-ownership sales table; a key from each deal to the clinic IDs

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
MS2 · Higher-income, denser markets	**Partially supported** — density and acquisition returns not established. Median household income is $63,374 for the 2025–26 clinics against $47,928 on the company's data, and visit count comparables by number of positive attributes reproduce exactly, +2.8% with three against −8.4% with none (September 2025 to August 2026); the company's figures give the newer clinics fewer households, public census data about twice as many (Part 06 section C).	Company data for 103 clinics; public census measures for 93 matched clinics, read on 30 September 2026; the two sets are on different bases; no link to acquisition returns.	The trade-area definition, vendor and data year behind the company's figures; a deal-to-clinic key with rent and sale-leaseback proceeds
MS3 · Cleaner 2026 reporting	**Partially supported** — holds for the 2026 reconciliation; not supported on the historical base or on the missing bank ties. The borrower model now ties to the quality-of-earnings figure within $1.0k, but reported EBITDA was negative in every year from 2023 to the twelve months to March 2026 and the FY25 adjustment share (0.99–1.13) is above every peer (Part 06 section D).	Quality-of-earnings workbook, FY25 audit adjustments and the July 2026 financing model; five peers on adjustment share, two on conversion; reported EBITDA and audit adjustments are actual (A), adjusted and pro forma earnings are pro forma (PF).	The August 2026 roll-forward with bank-to-ledger ties; a certified split of maintenance and growth capex
MS4 · Infrastructure supports 1.8x	**Insufficient evidence** — no costed doubling case; the evidence leans against. On the model's segment split, overhead per general practice and preventive clinic rose from $96.0k in FY24 to $137.1k for the twelve months to March 2026; the borrower's plan brings it to about $117k in FY28E (1.57x revenue on 0.93x overhead) with no costed case behind it, and the integration budget is 13–31% of the like-for-like cost observed (Part 06 section E).	Actual overhead FY23 to March 2026 and the borrower's plan to FY28 (projected), general practice and preventive business with DBW's clinics and overhead excluded; acquisition expense detail for 2023–25; peers' overhead on their own definitions, described rather than ranked.	A costed plan for twice the present size, reconciled to the acquisition add-backs; overhead savings delivered by function
MS5 · DBW economics and disposal value	**Insufficient evidence** — the owned-period gap is confirmed at −26%; the recovery after July rests on weekly data not supplied. DBW's four-wall EBITDA of $5.42m in January–July 2026 is 25.9% below the seller's same months; visit count was −16.1% in the second quarter and −17.3% a day in July; its value on wellness clinic multiples is $33–46m (Part 06 section F).	38 clinics; seller data 2023–25 and owned months from December 2025, not a same-store base; one like-for-like wellness clinic peer on margin; wellness clinic multiples on unstated or different earnings measures.	The weekly same-store visit count file behind the August and September windows; DBW's four-wall bridge (labour, rebates, royalty); an owned-period comparable visit count (from December 2026)
MS6 · Low leverage, pricing and upside compensate	**Contradicted** — on trailing leverage, cover and funding. Set out in Part 08 section C.	Part 08 section C	Part 08 section C

Source: Part 06 section A to Part 06 section H, and Part 08 section C for MS6 · Basis: Clinic results actual (A); seller EBITDA and adjusted earnings pro forma (PF); plans projected (P)

A · Thesis and readings

Deal B's newest cohort earns the 18% clinic margin the company states, its better-placed clinics hold their visit count, and its 2026 figures reconcile; sustained cohort economics, density, capacity for twice the size and DBW's value are not yet shown (to August 2026).

Ares Credit Group's thesis. Deal B grew over 2021 to 2023 on its own resources by buying low-priced rural sites and has built infrastructure for about twice its size; with capital, its 2025–26 cohorts show it can buy more attractive sites in richer, denser markets; its reporting became cleaner in 2026; it owns Deal B Wellness Clinics (DBW); and Ares Credit Group is considering a low-leverage, high-priced financing with upside [A, DLB-001 pp.3–5, 8, 14; financing in Part 08 section C].

What holds. The newest cohort earns the 18% clinic margin the company states, clinics with more positive market attributes hold their visit count better, and the 2026 figures reconcile within $1.0k (Part 06 section B to Part 06 section D).

What to watch. The first-year sales dip has not narrowed in the company's own data, the older cohorts earned 7.6–8.6% on book rent in 2025, and DBW's visit count was down 17.3% a day in July (Part 06 section B, Part 06 section F).

Exhibit 6.02 — The newest cohort earns the 18% clinic margin the company states and 2026 reporting reconciles, but sustained cohort economics, capacity for twice the size and DBW's value are not shown on the evidence supplied to date (to August 2026)

Our reading of each Deal B thesis component, with the evidence for and against it; company data to August 2026, the company's responses of 30 September and 1 October 2026, public data read on 30 September 2026

THESIS COMPONENT	OUR READING ON THE EVIDENCE SUPPLIED TO DATE	BASIS	WHAT HOLDS	WHAT DOES NOT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
MS1 · Newer cohorts have better sustainable economics	**Partially supported** — newer cohort's 18% clinic margin confirmed on owned months; sustained economics not yet shown; first-year dip not narrowing in the data	Newest cohort 18.9% in its 2025 owned months (company 18%); older cohorts 7.6% and 8.6% on book rent (company 9% and 9%); first-year same-store sales −8.5% / −4.1% / −6.6% / −9.2% by cohort (company −13.3% to −6.2%); first owned year 0.55x / 0.76x / 0.71x of seller EBITDA against Operator 8 0.59–0.70x (DLB Datapack; DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses p.2; Historical Acquisition Detail; Part 06 section B)	The newest cohort earned 18.9% in its 2025 owned months (17 clinics), as the company states, and 19.3% on 26 clinics over the twelve months to July 2026; the 2024 and 2025 cohorts started above Operator 8's band, at 0.76x and 0.71x of seller EBITDA in their first owned year (Part 06 section B)	The first-year sales dip has not narrowed in the company's own data (−8.5%, −4.1%, −6.6% and −9.2% by cohort, oldest first); the first-half-2024 deals fell from 0.48x to 0.23x in their second year; the 46 clinics owned 21 months or more earned 8.4% on cash rent after rebates before any shared-services adjustment (LTM Mar-26; about 10.7–10.9% if the "NRA Shared Services" charge sits in that figure), below or at the bottom of the 10.7–17.4% peer range (Part 06 section B, Part 06 section G)	A second owned year for the 2025 cohort; the definition behind the company's year-of-ownership sales table; a key from each deal to the clinic IDs
MS2 · Higher-income, denser markets	**Partially supported** — density and acquisition returns not established	Median household income $63,374 against $47,928; three-attribute clinics 19.5% four-wall margin against 4.8% for those with none or one; density and acquisition returns not shown (Ares Credit Group Diligence Requests 8.21.26, attribution tabs; Part 06 section C). On public census data the 2025–26 clinics sit in markets with about twice the households within three miles and 8% higher household income than earlier clinics (93 of 103 clinics matched); the company's household figures are not on the same basis.	Higher income shows on the company's data and on public data; visit count comparables by number of positive attributes reproduce exactly from the company's data (+2.8% with three against −8.4% with none, September 2025 to August 2026); better-placed clinics earn more, inside the pre-2025 cohort too (10.3% against 4.1%) (Part 06 section C)	Density is not established: the company's figures give the newer clinics fewer households (22,466 against 29,060) and public data about twice as many, on different bases; market attributes cannot be linked to acquisition returns without a deal-to-clinic key (Part 06 section C)	The trade-area definition, vendor and data year behind the company's figures; a deal-to-clinic key with sale-leaseback proceeds and rent per deal
MS3 · Cleaner 2026 reporting	**Partially supported** — holds for the 2026 reconciliation; not supported on the historical base or on the missing bank ties	2026 reconciles to within $1.0k; FY25 adjustment share 0.99–1.13 against 0.11–0.93 at peers; conversion 0.37–0.59 against 0.78–0.85 (Financing Model Jul-26 RF; Accounting Firm 2 QoE; Part 06 section D)	The borrower model's post-audit pro forma equals the Accounting Firm 2 figure less the audit adjustments to within $1.0k, so the 2026 numbers reconcile; the LTM July 2026 adjustment share of 0.89–0.78 sits inside the peer range (Part 06 section D)	Reported EBITDA was negative in every year from 2023 to LTM March 2026, and is −$0.19m for LTM July 2026 without $1.38m of gains; acquisition add-backs recur ($4.4m, $9.4m and $9.0m in 2023–25); conversion after maintenance capex is below every peer; the August 2026 roll-forward and bank ties are not in the files (Part 06 section D)	The August 2026 QoE roll-forward with bank ties; a certified split of maintenance and growth capex
MS4 · Infrastructure supports 1.8x	**Insufficient evidence** — no costed doubling case; the evidence leans against	No costed doubling case; on the model's segment split the general practice and preventive business's overhead per clinic rose from $96.0k (FY24) to $137.1k (LTM Mar-26), and the borrower's forecast adds about $38k per added clinic (1.57x revenue on 0.93x overhead to FY28E); integration budget 13–31% of like-for-like observed cost (Financing Model; Diligence Requests tab 6; Part 06 section E)	The borrower's plan grows the general practice and preventive business 1.15x in clinics and 1.57x in revenue on 0.93x overhead, so overhead falls from $138k to $117k per clinic and from 9.2% to 5.9% of revenue by FY28E; corporate heads per clinic fell from 0.76 to 0.46 between December 2022 and March 2026 (Part 06 section E)	Overhead per general practice and preventive clinic rose from $96.0k in FY24 to $137.1k for the twelve months to March 2026, and the plan's saving per clinic has no costed case behind it; overhead ratios did not fall with scale at Operator 8 or Operator 3; the $11.1k integration budget per clinic is 13–31% of the like-for-like cost observed (Part 06 section E)	A costed 1.8x case reconciled to the $9.0–9.4m a year of acquisition add-backs; overhead savings delivered by function
MS5 · DBW economics and disposal value	**Insufficient evidence** — the owned-period gap is confirmed at −26%; the recovery after July rests on weekly data not supplied	Four-wall −25.9% on the seller's same months (January–July 2026); visit count −11.5% a day in Q1, −16.1% in Q2, −17.3% a day in July; company windows −21.8% (August) and −15.6% (September) without weekly data; value $33–46m on wellness clinic multiples (DBW Datapack; DBW Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses; Part 06 section F)	Revenue per visit inside the wellness clinic range; bought at 3.2x; marketing and digital spend of $40.1K in January–July 2026 confirms the pause the company names among the causes; DBW earns 23.5% of consolidated four-wall EBITDA on 13.3% of revenue (January–July 2026) (Part 06 section F)	Four-wall EBITDA of $5.42m in January–July 2026, 25.9% below the seller's same months; visit count −11.9% in the first quarter (−11.5% a day), −16.1% in the second and −17.3% a day in July; the company's recovery to −15.6% in September rests on weekly data not in the files; a value of $33–46m reaches Ares Credit Group's $44m only at its top (Part 06 section F)	The weekly same-store visit count file behind the August and September windows; DBW's four-wall bridge (labour, rebates, royalty); an owned-period comparable visit count (from December 2026)
MS6 · Low leverage, pricing and upside compensate	**Contradicted** — on trailing leverage, cover and funding	Read in Part 08 section C	Set out in Part 08 section C	Set out in Part 08 section C	Set out in Part 08 section C

Source: Sections B to G of this part, with the documents and rows cited there: Project Bravo DLB Datapack (DLB-003), Historical Acquisition Detail (DLB-029), QoE Workbook LTM Mar-26 (DLB-022), Financing Model Jul-26 RF (DLB-008), Ares Credit Group Diligence

Requests 8.21.26 (DLB-028), DBW Datapack (DLB-002), DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses (DLB-033), DBW Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses (DLB-034); public census data around 110 matched clinics [I, C-PUB-5]. The financing component is read in Part 08 section C · Basis: Reading labels as in Exhibit 1.05 and Exhibit 8.02. Figures are actual (A) unless marked; seller closing EBITDA and cash-rent margins are pro forma (PF); the borrower's plan is projected (P)

Where Ares Credit Group's view differs from ours. Ares Credit Group knows how acquired clinics behave in their first years, and the company's responses support its view on several points. Each point below states Ares Credit Group's view, the evidence each way and what would settle it.

Newer cohorts are more attractive. For: the newest cohort's 18% clinic margin is confirmed on its owned months (18.9% in 2025; 19.3% on 26 clinics for the twelve months to July 2026); the 2024 and 2025 cohorts started above Operator 8's 0.59–0.70x of seller EBITDA in their first owned year; and clinics with three positive market attributes held visit count at +2.8% against −8.4% for clinics with none (Part 06 section B, Part 06 section C). Against: in the company's own data the newest cohort's first-year sales dip is the deepest (−9.2%), not the shallowest; the 2024 cohort's 2026 gains came from the ticket, with visit count still −7.6% in July–August; and the first-half-2024 deals fell to 0.23x in their second year. What would settle it: a second owned year for the 2025 cohort, and the definition behind the company's year-of-ownership sales table.

Cleaner 2026 reporting. For: the 2026 figures reconcile to the audit within $1.0k, and the April–August "other non-recurring" total and the deferred seller payments tie approximately to the data (Part 06 section D). Against: the itemisation of the non-recurring costs cannot be traced, the $6.9m equity raised for working capital is supported only indirectly, and the August roll-forward and bank ties are not in the files. What would settle it: the August 2026 quality-of-earnings roll-forward with bank-to-ledger ties.

DBW recovers after the rebrand. For: the marketing pause the company names is confirmed by marketing and digital spend of $40.1K in January–July 2026, with no digital spend from February, the rebrand is installed at 38 of 38 clinics [M], and the company's quartile shares tie approximately (Part 06 section F). Against: visit count was −16.1% in the second quarter and −17.3% a day in July, and the recovery to −15.6% in September rests on weekly data not supplied. What would settle it: the weekly same-store visit count file behind the August and September windows.

The fuller evidence summary and the cohort table by acquisition year are in Part 09 section M, under "06 A Thesis and readings: supporting evidence".

B · Acquisition cohorts

The newest cohort earns the 18% clinic margin the company states (18.9% in its 2025 owned months; 19.3% on 26 clinics for the twelve months to July 2026), and newer cohorts start better against their purchase price; that the start lasts is not yet shown: the first-year sales dip has not narrowed in the company's own data, and the 2024 clinics fell back in their second owned year.

What holds. The company's headline cohort figure reproduces: the 2025–26 cohort earned 18.9% on book rent in its 2025 owned months (17 clinics), as the company states, and 19.7% on cash rent. On an age-matched first owned year the newer cohorts start better against the seller EBITDA they were priced on, 0.76x (2024) and 0.71x (2025) against Operator 8's 0.59–0.70x.

What to watch. The older cohorts earned 7.6% and 8.6% on book rent in 2025 (9.1% and 9.8% on cash rent), against the 9% stated, whose basis the company does not give. The company describes a first-year sales dip narrowing from −13.3% to −6.2%; in its data the dips are −8.5%, −4.1%, −6.6% and −9.2%, oldest cohort first. The 2024 clinics' four-wall EBITDA fell to 49 (first six owned months = 86) by months 13–18.

Exhibit 6.03 — The newest cohort's 18% clinic margin reproduces from the company's own data (18.9% on its 2025 owned months), but the older cohorts earned 7.6% and 8.6% on book rent in 2025 against the 9% stated (9.1% and 9.8% on cash rent), and the narrowing first-year sales dip the company describes (−13.3% to −6.2%) does not appear: in the data the newest cohort's dip is the deepest (−9.2%)

Left: four-wall EBITDA margin in 2025 by acquisition cohort, company response against the datapack on book and on cash rent. Right: same-store sales in the first owned year by cohort, company response against the datapack; to July 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses, 1 October 2026 (DLB-033) p.2; Project Bravo DLB Datapack (Jul-26 RF) (DLB-003), 4-Wall EBITDA, Net Revenue and Clinic Level Information; KPI Details incl. Pre-Acq; QoE DD #4 (cash rent); CreditSwan check of the responses against the data files · Basis: Company figures [M] beside datapack figures [F/I]. The 2025-and-2026 margin is on 17 clinics and 91 owned clinic-months in 2025 (19.3% on 26 clinics for LTM July 2026). First-year same-store sales: owned months 1–12 from the first full month against the same months a year earlier, pre-acquisition months from the seller's system; the newest cohort's windows are partial to July 2026 (25 clinics; 11 clinics with a full first year −11.9%). Counting from the acquisition month deepens every dip · Assumption: A-07, A-08

Exhibit 6.04 — In their first owned year the 2024 and 2025 cohorts sit above the Operator 8 band and 2023 just below it; the 11 clinics of the 2024 cohort with a second owned year fall to 0.21x in year two (0.23x on the ten first-half-2024 clinics followed from year one; 2022–2025 cohorts, to LTM Jul-26)

Clinic four-wall EBITDA delivered ÷ seller EBITDA used in pricing, x, by acquisition-year cohort; owned months January 2023 to July 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Bravo DLB Datapack (Jul-26 RF), Project Bravo Historical Acquisition Detail, Project Bravo Ares Credit Group Diligence Requests (25 September 2026); Operator 8, Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4 lender materials. DLB-0114, DLB-0142, DLB-0166, DLB-0186, DLB-7667, DLB-7682, DLB-7697, DLB-7711, OP8-1703, OP8-2211, OP6-1731, OP6-1733, OP3-1493, OP3-1494, OP4-0802, OP4-0806 · Basis: Numerators: Deal B four-wall on the company definition, book rent, surviving clinics, actual (A). Denominators: seller closing EBITDA in the acquisition schedule, pro forma, window not stated. Hatched = annualised or estimated (the March–August doubling; the 2025 full-year range). Peers: hollow = pro forma, rent basis not stated · Assumption: Age-matched ratios use the closing-date groups in which every acquired unit maps to a datapack clinic and all seller EBITDA is stated. The alternative basis doubles March–August 2026; the 2025 range applies the 2022 and 2023 cohorts' ratio of twelve months to the doubled six

Exhibit 6.05 — The 2023 clinics dipped to 65 in owned months 7–12 and reached 107 by months 21–26; the 2024 clinics fell to 49 by months 13–18 (four-wall EBITDA, months 1–6 = 86; to July 2026)

Clinic four-wall EBITDA by six months of ownership, index (the same clinics' owned months 1–6 = 86), by acquisition-year cohort; monthly data January 2023 to July 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Bravo DLB Datapack (Jul-26 RF), tabs '4-Wall EBITDA' (monthly columns, January 2023 to July 2026) and 'Clinic Level Information' (acquisition date per clinic) · Basis: Actual (A): four-wall EBITDA on the company definition, book rent, 103 surviving general practice clinics (Deal B Wellness Clinics is not in this datapack). Owned month 1 = the calendar month after the month of closing. Each point sums the clinics that have the whole six-month block and is indexed to those same clinics' months 1–6, so later points rest on fewer clinics: only those closed earliest, shown as diamonds with the count and not joined to the line. Odd-numbered blocks fall in the same half of the year as months 1–6; even-numbered blocks fall in the opposite half. Surviving clinics only (closed clinics are not in the datapack), which flatters every curve. A calendar view of the same 32 clinics acquired in 2024 shows a smaller fall than the ownership-age index: January–July 2026 four-wall is -17.8% on January–July 2025, against an index of 49 in owned months 13–18

The responses describe causes of the first-year dip and the company's initiatives against them, among them Steer Phones, a call-handling service, with a call-conversion target of 35% against 32% today and visit count comparables of +1.3% from the fourth week after launch against −2.9% at clinics not yet launched; no data file covers these figures [M, DLB-033 pp.3–5]. The 2024 cohort's same-store sales improved from −1.0% in the first quarter of 2026 to +2.7% in July–August (the company says −2.3% to +3.9%), with visit count at −10.0% and −7.6% on the weekday-aligned set, so the gain came from the ticket [F, DLB-028; DLB-033 p.2]. The newest cohort's median pharmacy share is 5.8% in the attribution data [F, DLB-028 'S1. Positive Attribution'], against the 3% stated [M, DLB-033 p.2].

Our reading on MS1, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported — newer cohort's 18% clinic margin confirmed on owned months; sustained economics not yet shown; first-year dip not narrowing in the data. What would change it: a second owned year for the 2025 cohort, the definition behind the company's year-of-ownership sales table, and a key from each deal to the clinic IDs.

The cash-rent cohort margins, the delivery tests on twelve owned months, the transition visit loss, comps and loss-making clinics by cohort, acquisition pricing and the public ratings are in Part 09 section M, under "06 B Acquisition cohorts: supporting evidence".

C · Markets served

On the company's data the 2025–26 clinics sit in higher-income markets ($63,374 against $47,928 median household income), and clinics with more positive market attributes hold their visit count better (+2.8% with three against −8.4% with none, reproduced exactly); density is not established, because the company's household figures and public census figures point opposite ways (September 2026).

What holds. Higher income holds on the company's data and on public census data, and the market attributes the company uses separate results: visit count comparables by number of positive attributes reproduce exactly from its workbook, +2.8% with three against −8.4% with none (September 2025 to August 2026), and better-placed clinics earn higher four-wall margins, inside the older cohorts too.

What to watch. Density is not established. On the company's figures the newer clinics have fewer households around them (22,466 against 29,060), on public census data about twice as many, and the company's trade-area definition is not stated. Acquisition returns by market cannot be computed without a key from each deal to the clinic IDs.

Exhibit 6.06 — Clinics with more positive market attributes held their visit count better, +2.8% with three against −8.4% with none (September 2025 to August 2026), exactly as the company reports; sales and ticket comparables tie approximately, within 0.8 points

Same-store visit count, sales and average ticket, change year on year, %, September 2025 to August 2026, by number of positive market attributes (income, households, pharmacy mix); 88 comparable clinics; company response against its diligence-requests workbook

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses (DLB-033) p.3; Ares Credit Group Diligence Requests 8.21.26 (DLB-028), S1. SSS Visit Count and attribution tabs; CreditSwan check of the responses against the data files · Basis: Actual (A). Visit count on the company's weekday-aligned set; the data's sales and ticket are calendar-month comparables on the same clinic-months. Labels show both figures, the company's on the left bar of each pair. visit count reproduces exactly; the data's sales and ticket exclude 12 clinic-months whose prior-year month is a partial acquisition month. The attributes are the company's, on a trade-area definition its files do not state · Assumption: A-P6

Exhibit 6.07 — The 2025–26 sites sit in higher-income trade areas (median $63,374 against $47,928) with fewer households, and clinics with three positive attributes earned 19.5% against 4.8% for those with none or one (year to August 2026)

Trade-area household income ($), households (count) and pharmacy mix (% of clinics below 13%) by acquisition year, 103 clinics; four-wall margin by attribute, % of revenue, September 2025 to August 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Bravo Ares Credit Group Diligence Requests (25 September 2026), tabs 'S1. Positive Attribution', '1. Attributes - Acq. Pipeline', 'S1. Revenue' and 'S1. 4-Wall EBITDA'. DLB-8111, DLB-8114, DLB-8115, DLB-8118, DLB-8595, DLB-8599, DLB-8603, DLB-8607, DLB-8611, DLB-8631, DLB-8635 · Basis: Company-supplied trade-area data (the source of the demographics and the trade-area definition are not stated); medians across clinics of each acquisition-year group. Four-wall margin: actual (A), company definition, book rent, clinics owned throughout the window, August 2026 preliminary. Positive attributes are the company's own thresholds for household income, households and pharmacy mix. Nine of the thirty newer-site attributes are estimates or duplicated trade-area data. 17 of the 26 clinics acquired in 2025–26 are in the 92-clinic margin panel

Exhibit 6.08 — Public census data put the 2025–26 clinics in markets with about twice the households and 8% higher income than earlier clinics; company figures show a wider income gap and fewer households (September 2026)

Median household income ($) and median households in the trade area, by the company's acquisition cohort: public census data within three miles of each clinic (American Community Survey 2020–24) against the company's figures for the same clinics (supplied September 2026)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Public: US Census Bureau, American Community Survey 2020–24 five-year tract tables and 2024 Gazetteer, measured around the 93 of 103 company clinics matched to the company's public location pages (read on 30 September 2026). Company: clinic attribution data supplied in September 2026. Our computation [I, C-PUB-5; PUB-0115; PUB-0116; PUB-0432; PUB-0433; PUB-0269; PUB-

0270; PUB-0271; PUB-0272] · Basis: Medians across clinics; the number of clinics behind each bar is in brackets. Public trade area: every census tract whose internal point lies within three miles of the clinic; income is the median interpolated from pooled income brackets. One clinic in each cohort has no census tract within three miles and is left out of the public income and household medians, which rest on 72 and 20 clinics. A median of an even number of clinics that falls on a half is shown at the nearer even unit. The company's figures are as supplied and are the ones the reading on MS2 rests on; the census measures are the public cross-check; the two sets are not on the same basis, and neither is shown as a correction of the other. Clinic by clinic the company's household count is a median 2.30 times the public three-mile count for clinics acquired before 2025 and 0.91 times for 2025–26 clinics. Six 2025–26 clinics (one City 2-area group) have no public location page and are outside both sets of bars; on all 103 clinics the company's medians are $47,928 against $63,374 and 29,060 against 22,466 households

Exhibit 6.09 — Public census measures and the company's own figures differ in level for the earlier clinics and in direction on households (Deal B clinics by the company's acquisition cohort, September 2026)

Medians across clinics; public measures from the American Community Survey 2020–24 around each matched clinic; company figures as supplied in September 2026

MEASURE (MEDIAN ACROSS CLINICS)	ACQUIRED BEFORE 2025 (CLINICS)	ACQUIRED 2025–26 (CLINICS)	2025–26 AGAINST EARLIER	REFERENCE
Public: household income within three miles	$59,626 (72)	$66,309 (20)	+8.1%	[I, PUB-0115; PUB-0116; C-PUB-5]
Public: household income within five miles	$58,444 (72)	$70,570 (21)	+16.1%	[I, PUB-0265; PUB-0266; C-PUB-5]
Public: households within three miles	9,794 (72)	20,863 (20)	+96%	[I, PUB-0432; PUB-0433; C-PUB-5]
Public: households within five miles	21,795 (72)	41,797 (21)	+76%	[I, PUB-0434; PUB-0268; C-PUB-5]
Company: household income, the same matched clinics	$49,295 (76)	$61,557 (21)	+25.5%	[I, PUB-0269; PUB-0270; C-PUB-5]
Company: households, the same matched clinics	31,457 (76)	20,192 (21)	−32%	[I, PUB-0271; PUB-0272; C-PUB-5]
Company: household income, all 103 clinics	$47,928 (77)	$63,374 (26)	+27.2%	[M, DLB-8114] [M, DLB-8118]
Company: households, all 103 clinics	29,060 (77)	22,466 (26)	−21%	[I, C-PUB-5; DLB-028 'S1. Positive Attribution' rows 7–109, households column E]
Company households ÷ public households within three miles, clinic by clinic	2.30x (72)	0.91x (20)	all matched clinics 2.27x (92)	[I, PUB-0121; PUB-0122; PUB-0119; C-PUB-5]
Company households ÷ public households within five miles, clinic by clinic	1.08x (72)	0.46x (21)	all matched clinics 0.97x (96)	[I, PUB-0273; PUB-0274; PUB-0120; C-PUB-5]

Source: US Census Bureau, American Community Survey 2020–24 five-year tract tables and 2024 Gazetteer; Deal B location pages read on 30 September 2026; company clinic attribution data supplied in September 2026; our computation [I, C-PUB-5] · Basis: 93 of 103 company clinics matched to a public location page by town, state and clinic name (76 of 77 acquired before 2025; 21 of 26 acquired in 2025–26). Public trade area = census tracts whose internal point lies within the stated radius; income is interpolated from pooled brackets. A clinic with no census tract within the radius is left out of the public income and household medians, so the number of clinics is in brackets. A median of an even number of clinics that falls on a half is shown at the nearer even unit. The company's figures and the public measures are not on the same basis; the company's figures are the ones the reading on MS2 rests on, the census measures are the public cross-check, and neither is shown as a correction of the other

The responses also state the median household income by cohort, $50K, $46K and $62K, which ties to the attribution data ($50,182, $47,185 and $63,374), and that 71% of the 2025–26 clinics have two or more positive attributes against 52% and 49% for the older cohorts (data: 74.1%, 51.7% and 49.3%) [F, DLB-033 p.2; DLB-028 'S1. Positive Attribution' and '1. Attributes - Acq. & Pipeline' column H].

Our reading on MS2, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported — density and acquisition returns not established. What would change it: the trade-area definition, vendor and data year behind the company's figures, and a deal-to-clinic key with rent and sale-leaseback proceeds by deal.

The company's attribute data, the four-wall panel by attribute and the public census test in full are in Part 09 section M, under "06 C Markets served: supporting evidence".

D · Reporting quality

Deal B's 2026 numbers reconcile to the audit within $1.0k, and the April–August 2026 "other non-recurring" total and the deferred seller payments tie approximately to the data; without the $1.38m of gains, adjustments still exceed the whole of adjusted EBITDA (share 0.90–0.87, LTM July 2026), and conversion after maintenance capex (0.37–0.59) is below every peer.

What holds. The borrower model's post-audit pro forma EBITDA equals the quality-of-earnings figure less the audit adjustments to within $1.0k, so the 2026 numbers reconcile, and the LTM July 2026 adjustment share of 0.89–0.78 sits inside the peer range. Of the reporting figures in the responses of 1 October, the seasonality ties to the data, and the non-recurring total and the seller payments tie approximately.

What to watch. Reported EBITDA was negative in every year from 2023 to the twelve months to March 2026, and −$0.19m for LTM July 2026 without $1.38m of gains. Acquisition add-backs recur ($4.4m, $9.4m and $9.0m in 2023–25), conversion after maintenance capex is below every peer, and the August roll-forward and bank ties are not in the files.

Exhibit 6.10 — FY25 adjustments of 1.13–1.13 of top adjusted EBITDA exceed every operator shown; LTM Jul-26's 0.76–0.78 becomes 0.90–0.87 without $1.38m of gains, and conversion sits below Operator 3 and Operator 6

Adjustment share of the top adjusted EBITDA, and EBITDA less maintenance capex ÷ EBITDA, ratios; FY25 and LTM July 2026 against comparable operators' latest periods

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Bravo QoE Workbook (LTM Mar-26); Project Bravo Financing Model (Jul-26 RF); Ares Credit Group variant of the Project Bravo Financing Model (12 September 2026); Operator 3, Operator 2, Operator 6, Operator 8 and Operator 4 quality-of-earnings and lender materials. DLB-3866, DLB-3901, DLB-3900, DLB-5250, DLB-5644, DLB-5599, DLB-6300, DLB-5598, DLB-5645, DLB-9108, OP3-1127, OP3-2161, OP2-4347, OP6-0047, OP6-0060, OP6-0593, OP8-1781, OP8-2409, OP4-0269, OP4-1035 · Basis: All marks pro forma or adjusted (PF): the numerator of each ratio is an adjusted EBITDA. Reported EBITDA is owned months, with gains on asset sales left in (Deal B LTM Jul-26 reported EBITDA is $1.22m, or −$0.19m without $1.38m of gains). Maintenance capex is each company's own split. Top rung differs by operator (pro forma including pre-acquisition months, or adjusted), as labelled in the data file. Operator 6's top rung is the buy-side pro forma of $15.0m (OP6-0060) in the first panel and the company's adjusted EBITDA of $16.5m (OP6-0593) in the second; on $16.5m its adjustment share would be 0.61. Operator 8's reported EBITDA differs between two source documents (share 0.54 on the other). Conversion peers are the two operators with a company maintenance split on a pro forma rung

Exhibit 6.11 — Of the reporting figures in Deal B's responses of 1 October, the seasonality ties to the company's data and the April–August 2026 "other non-recurring" total and the deferred seller payments tie approximately; the itemisation cannot be traced and the $6.9m equity is supported only indirectly

Reporting and cash figures stated in the DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses (1 October 2026) against the data files supplied; company figure, data figure and how far they tie

FIGURE (RESPONSE PAGE)	COMPANY	DATA FILES	HOW FAR IT TIES
"Other non-recurring", April–August 2026 (p.9)	$1.6m	$1,637.3K across four lines of the diligence workbook, tab 5 (professional services $1,052.0K, business expense $510.5K, wages $52.6K, marketing $47.0K)	Total ties approximately [F]
Itemisation of the same costs (p.9)	$1,391K itemised (professional and advisory $1,033K; people $226K; other)	Professional-services line $1,052.0K; no vendor- or ledger-level detail in the files	Items not traceable [M]
Deferred seller payments, June–August 2026 (p.8)	$4.0m, funded from operating cash	$3,920.0K ($810.5K, $2,954.8K, $67.5K), tab 5 row 42, a line that also carries other items	Ties approximately [F]
Equity contributed in Q2 2026 for working capital (p.8)	$6.9m	Member equity up $6,702K from the March 2026 QoE to the July 2026 financing model; total equity and retained earnings in the two do not reconcile	Indirect only [M]
Seasonality: January–February against March–August 2025, 77 clinics (p.8)	About −10%	−10.2%; State 19 −15.0%, State 24 −19.9%, State 20 −4.6%, State 35 −1.8%	Ties [F]
Pharmacy and dental seasonality, January–September 2026 (p.8)	Pharmacy products −12%, dental −17%	No data file covers the window	Not testable [M]

Source: DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses (DLB-033) pp.8–9; Ares Credit Group Diligence Requests 8.21.26 (DLB-028) tab 5; Financing Model (Jul-26 RF) (DLB-008) BS!C53; QoE Workbook LTM Mar-26 (DLB-022); Project Bravo DLB Datapack (DLB-003) · Basis:

Company figures [M]; data figures as read [F] or computed [I]; actual (A)

Our reading on MS3, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported — holds for the 2026 reconciliation; not supported on the historical base or on the missing bank ties. What would change it: the August 2026 consolidated quality-of-earnings roll-forward with bank-to-ledger ties, ledger support for the itemised non-recurring costs, and a certified split of maintenance and growth capex.

The earnings ladder, the adjustment share and conversion against peers, the recurrence test on acquisition add-backs and the earnings-quality table are in Part 09 section M, under "06 D Reporting quality: supporting evidence".

E · Scaling capacity

No costed plan for twice the size is in the files supplied: overhead per general practice and preventive clinic rose from $96.0k in FY24 to $137.1k for the twelve months to March 2026, and the integration budget is 13–31% of observed like-for-like cost.

What holds. The borrower's plan grows the general practice and preventive business 1.15x in clinics and 1.57x in revenue on 0.93x overhead, so overhead falls from 9.2% to 5.9% of revenue by FY28, and corporate heads per clinic fell from 0.76 to 0.46 between December 2022 and March 2026: there is operating leverage in Deal B's own history.

What to watch. Overhead per general practice and preventive clinic rose from $96.0k in FY24 to $137.1k for the twelve months to March 2026, the plan's saving per clinic has no costed case behind it, overhead ratios did not fall with scale at Operator 8 or Operator 3, and the $11.1k integration budget per clinic is 13–31% of the like-for-like cost observed. The company's responses of 1 October do not address the point.

Exhibit 6.12 — Overhead per general practice and preventive clinic rose from $96.0k in FY24 to $137.1k for the twelve months to March 2026, and the plan shows $112.0k in FY28E, while overhead falls from 9.2% to 5.9% of revenue

Corporate overhead of the general practice and preventive business ÷ its clinics at period end ($k) and ÷ its reported revenue (%), FY23 to FY28E; actuals to LTM March 2026, borrower plan LTM Sep-26E to FY28E; DBW excluded

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Bravo Financing Model (Jul-26 RF): consolidated income statement (total corporate overhead, clinics at period end, revenue) less the DBW segment (clinics, revenue) and DBW corporate overhead tabs. DLB-5004..5011, DLB-4932..4939, DLB-4940..4947, less DLB-6063..6068, DLB-5939..5946 and DLB-5947..5952 · Basis: Filled = actual (A): FY23, FY24, FY25 and LTM March 2026, reported, owned months. Hatched = projected (P): the borrower's plan for LTM September 2026 to FY28E; FY26E onward includes acquisitions not yet closed, and LTM Sep-26E overlaps FY26E (the FY26E value rests on 130 clinics at the year end, 23 more than at September 2026). Overhead and revenue are owned months while clinics are counted at the period end. General practice and preventive business = the model's consolidated figures less Deal B Wellness Clinics: its 38 clinics (which the model's consolidated clinic count includes in every year, including FY23 and FY24 before they were bought), its revenue and its own corporate overhead ($0.5m for the four owned months to March 2026; $2.8–3.6m a year in the plan); DBW is read in Part 06 section F. Shaded band: other operators' latest overhead per clinic, on their own definitions

Exhibit 6.13 — For the general practice and preventive business, twice today's size means 206 clinics or $307–346m of revenue; the borrower's FY28E plan reaches 136 clinics and $272.8m with overhead up 0.93x, and integration has cost $32–86k per unit against a $11.1k budget

General practice and preventive business (DBW's 38 clinics, revenue and overhead excluded, on the financing model's segment split): size measures now (LTM Mar-26; FY25 pro forma revenue) and in the borrower's FY28E plan, the 1.8x level, corporate overhead ($m, per clinic, % of revenue) and integration cost per acquired unit ($k)

MEASURE	NOW (ROW)	BORROWER FY28E, P (ROW)	1.8X	OVERHEAD NOW → FY28E	OVERHEAD PER UNIT OF THE MEASURE	PEER ANCHOR (DESCRIBED, NOT RANKED)
General practice and preventive clinics	103, Mar-26 (DLB-5814)	136 (DLB-4939 less DLB-5946) = 1.15x	206	$16.8m (DLB-5007 less DLB-6064) → $17.6m (DLB-5011 less DLB-6068) = 0.93x	$138k → $117k per clinic; marginal $38k [I]	$51.0k (Deal A, FY26; DLA-1223 ÷ 983 clinics) to $174.3k (Operator 7 ST-22, LTM May-26; OP7-0803 ÷ 10 clinics) per clinic, latest period of each of Deal A, Operator 1, Operator 3, Operator 8, Operator 4, Operator 7 ST-22 and Operator 5 (note C-26) [I]

MEASURE	NOW (ROW)	BORROWER FY28E, P (ROW)	1.8X	OVERHEAD NOW → FY28E	OVERHEAD PER UNIT OF THE MEASURE	PEER ANCHOR (DESCRIBED, NOT RANKED)
Reported revenue	$153.4m LTM Mar-26 (DLB-4943 less DLB-5948); $169.8m FY25 PF (DLB-3902 less DLB-5973)	$272.8m (DLB-4947 less DLB-5952) = 1.57x / 1.31x	$307m / $346m	same	9.2% → 5.9% of revenue [I]	2.0–9.4% (2.0–7.7% leaving out Operator 1 before its CY2016 definition break); ratio not falling with scale at Operator 8, Operator 3 (Exhibit 3.11)
D1.1 R-CASH four-wall	Not built for the general practice and preventive clinics alone: clinic rebates are given only for all clinic classes, which include DBW from Dec-25 (all-clinic $18.2m LTM Mar-26, DLB-3466)	not built in the model	–	–	–	–
Integration cost per acquired unit, like for like	$11.1k base estimate [M] (DLB-7866..7870)	–	–	–	Observed $32–86k: 2023 $32k on 28 units, 2024 $86k on 32, 2025 $82k on 24 general practice and preventive units (DD #1 sub-lines b-2, c, e, f ÷ units; DLB-4151..4195 ÷ DLB-7674/7689/7704); on 62 units including DBW's 38 the 2025 figure would be $32k, because the QoE lines are consolidated	No peer on this subset
Transaction and integration add-backs per acquired unit	–	–	–	–	Observed $140–319k: DD #1 sub-lines a–j excluding d ÷ 28, 32 and 24 units (DLB-4135..4227 ÷ DLB-7674/7689/7704); 2025 $121k on 62 units including DBW's 38 (the QoE lines are consolidated)	Operator 6 $134–192k (OP6-1881..1883)

Source: Financing Model Jul-26 RF (DLB-008), consolidated income statement less the DBW segment and DBW corporate overhead tabs; QoE Workbook, 'DD #1 - Acquisition Expenses' (DLB-022); Ares Credit Group Diligence Requests, tab 6 (DLB-028); rows as shown; peers note C-26 · Basis: Now: A (LTM Mar-26) and PF (FY25 revenue); FY28E: P (borrower plan, including acquisitions not yet made); integration budget [M]; observed integration cost [I] on the like-for-like sub-lines named. DBW is read in Part 06 section F

Our reading on MS4, on the evidence supplied to date: insufficient evidence — no costed doubling case; the evidence leans against. What would change it: a costed plan for twice the present size, reconciled to the $9.0–9.4m a year of acquisition add-backs, and overhead savings delivered by function.

The three measures of size, overhead against peers, the integration-cost comparison and the public view of the platform are in Part 09 section M, under "06 E Scaling capacity: supporting evidence".

F · Deal B Wellness Clinics

DBW earned $5.42m of four-wall EBITDA in January–July 2026, 25.9% below the seller's same months, as the datapack confirms; visit count was down 16.1% in the second quarter and 17.3% a day in July, and the recovery to −15.6% in September that the company reports rests on weekly data not supplied.

What holds. DBW earns more than its share of revenue: 13.3% of consolidated revenue and 23.5% of four-wall EBITDA in January–July 2026, on the financing model's reported figures. Its revenue per visit, $100.7 in owned months, sits inside the $79–112 wellness clinic range, it was bought at 3.2x, and the marketing pause the company names among the causes of the decline is confirmed: DBW's marketing and digital spend was $40.1K in January–July 2026.

What to watch. Four-wall EBITDA is 25.9% below the seller's same months. Visit count was 11.5% a day below the seller's in the first quarter (the company says about 9%), 16.1% below in the second and 17.3% a day below in July; the August and September windows behind the company's recovery are not in the files.

Exhibit 6.14 — Deal B Wellness Clinics' four-wall EBITDA was $5.42m in January–July 2026 against $7.53m under the seller a year earlier (−26%), on 13.4% fewer patient visits; loss-making clinics rose from 5 to 10 of 38

Deal B Wellness Clinics, 38 clinics: four-wall EBITDA ($m) and margin (% of revenue) by quarter, Q1 2023 to Q2 2026; change January–July 2026 on January–July 2025, %

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Bravo DBW Datapack (Jul-26 RF), tabs '4-Wall EBITDA', 'Net Revenue' and 'Visit Count'. DLB-0780, DLB-0775, DLB-0864..0867, DLB-1306, DLB-1312 and the quarterly rows DLB-0795..0862 · Basis: Four-wall EBITDA on the company definition and book rent. Grey = the seller's system data before Deal B's ownership from December 2025 (actual, as supplied); hollow = the quarter that mixes seller and owned months (pro forma); gold = owned months (actual). The January–July comparison sets owned months against seller months on the same 38 clinics, so it is not a same-store measure, and the seller's and Deal B's systems may count patient visits differently

Exhibit 6.15 — DBW's visit count ran 11.5% a day below the seller's in the first quarter of 2026, 16.1% below in the second and 17.3% a day below in July; the company's −21.8% for 8–29 August and −15.6% for 5–26 September rest on weekly data not in the files

DBW visit count, all 38 clinics, change against the seller's same period a year earlier, %, January to July 2026 by month (per day), and the two company windows of August and September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: DBW Datapack (Jul-26 RF) (DLB-002), Visit Count, seller 4-4-5 periods; DBW Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses, 30 September 2026 (DLB-034) p.1; CreditSwan check of the responses against the data files · Basis: Datapack months [F], per-day basis because the seller's periods differ in length; the 2025 months are seller-system data, so this is not a comparable-clinic measure on the common definition. The August and September windows are company figures [M]. Quarter totals: −11.5% (Q1, per day; −11.9% raw), −16.1% (Q2). The company's Q1 figure is "about −9%" · Assumption: A-10

Exhibit 6.16 — DBW's earnings are concentrated: its first quartile of 12 clinics earns 64.5% of four-wall EBITDA at a 38.6% margin and the fourth quartile loses money (LTM July 2026); the company's quartile table, which states LTM August 2026, ties to these shares and margins approximately, but not to the first quartile's EBITDA growth (company −14%, datapack −8.4%)

Share of DBW four-wall EBITDA and four-wall margin, %, by clinic quartile, company response against the DBW datapack, LTM July 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: DBW Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses (DLB-034) p.4; DBW Datapack (Jul-26 RF) (DLB-002), 4-Wall EBITDA by clinic; CreditSwan check of the responses against the data files · Basis: Company figures [M] beside datapack figures [I]. The datapack ends in July 2026, so the company's LTM August 2026 table cannot be reproduced exactly; LTM July 2026 includes seller months. Book rent · Assumption: A-10

Exhibit 6.17 — DBW's responses of 30 September confirm the marketing pause and the 38-clinic base, but their first-quarter visit count differs from the data, the closure-clinic losses rest on another period, and the recovery windows rest on data not in the files

Figures stated in the DBW Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses (30 September 2026) against the DBW datapack and quality-of-earnings files; company figure, data figure and how far they tie

FIGURE (RESPONSE PAGE)	COMPANY	DATA FILES	HOW FAR IT TIES
Same-store visit count, Q1 2026 (p.2)	About −9%	−11.9% raw; −11.5% per day	Differs [M]
Visit count by late April to early May 2026 (p.2)	About −16%	Q2 2026 −16.1%; April and May −15.0% per day	Ties approximately [F]
Visit count 8–29 August and 5–26 September 2026 (p.1)	−21.8% and −15.6%; 31 of 38 clinics improving	No weekly or post-July data; July −17.3% per day	Not testable [M]
Marketing paused at acquisition, about 8 points of the decline (p.2)	Paused	DBW marketing and digital spend $40.1K in January–July 2026, digital $0 from February to July	Pause confirmed [F]; points not testable
Losses at the four closure-review clinics, "12 months to 1 December 2025" (p.3)	+$24K, −$49K, −$146K, −$44K	Match June 2024 to May 2025; the stated period gives −$7.6K, −$24.8K, −$91.3K and −$63.6K	Period differs [M]
Rebrand installed (p.1)	38 of 38 clinics at 30 September	34 installed at 10 September (Lender Update p.3); "complete as of August" (Early Read p.6)	Not testable; the documents differ [M]
Revenue and EBITDA of the 38 clinics, 2023 and 2025 (pp.1–2)	Revenue $34.6m to $37.5m; EBITDA $10.7m to $10.3m	$36,291.4K to $35,570.9K; $10,509.9K to $10,218.1K	Ties [F]

Source: DBW Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses (DLB-034) pp.1–4; DBW Datapack (Jul-26 RF) (DLB-002); DBW QoE workbook, 'DBW PF Adj. & Walk' rows 11–49; Financing Model (Jul-26 RF) (DLB-008); Lender Update, 10 September 2026, p.3; Early Read p.6 · Basis: Company figures [M]; data figures as read [F] or computed [I]; the 2025 months are seller-system data

The company's bridge for the decline, about 2 points of momentum, 8 of paused marketing, 9 of household budgets and pet-owner sentiment and 6 of the sign changeover, is a management estimate: the marketing pause is confirmed, and on the per-day data the second quarter's further fall was about 6 points and the change from the second quarter to July under 1.3 points [M, DLB-034 p.2; I, DLB-002]. The value on wellness clinic multiples is $33–46m, which reaches Ares Credit Group's $44m only at its top (Part 09 section M).

Our reading on MS5, on the evidence supplied to date: insufficient evidence — the owned-period gap is confirmed at −26%; the recovery after July rests on weekly data not supplied. What would change it: the weekly same-store visit count file behind the August and September windows, DBW's four-wall bridge (labour, rebates, royalty), and an owned-period comparable visit count from December 2026.

DBW's contribution to consolidated results on each basis, the wellness clinic context set, the margin gap to the one like-for-like peer, the value range and the public record of the 38 clinics are in Part 09 section M, under "06 F Deal B Wellness Clinics: supporting evidence".

G · Against comparable operators

Against operators on the same definitions, Deal B's comps (+4.7% in 2025, ticket-led) sit inside the 1.1–6.2% range of Deal A, Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 8 and above the two roll-ups alone (1.9–4.2%), its cash-rent four-wall at or below the bottom (103 survivors 10.73% against 10.7–17.4%, LTM March 2026), and its FY25 adjustment share above every comparator.

What holds. Organic growth on the common definition is inside the peer range: same-store sales of +4.7% in 2025, above the two sponsor roll-ups (Operator 6 +1.9% in 2025, Operator 3 +4.2% for the twelve months to August 2025), and +3.3% for the twelve months to July 2026, inside that 2025 range, with a ticket of +7.6% in 2025. Falling traffic carried by pricing is the subsector's pattern, so Deal B's comps are not an outlier on these figures.

What to watch. Traffic was negative in every window (−2.6% in 2025, −3.8% for LTM July 2026). On cash rent after rebates the 103 surviving clinics earned 10.73%, at the bottom of the 10.7–17.4% peer range, and the 46 clinics owned 21 months or more 8.4% before any shared-services adjustment.

Exhibit 6.18 — Deal B's CY25 and LTM Jul-26 comps sit inside the peer range on the common definition (CY24, −3.9%, below it) and, like every other operator shown except Operator 8, rest on ticket with traffic negative (CY24 to LTM Jul-26)

Same-store sales, comp traffic and comp ticket, % change year on year; seven operator-periods, 2024 to LTM July 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Bravo DLB Datapack (Jul-26 RF); Deal A clinic file FY26; Operator 3 datacube; Operator 6 and Operator 8 lender materials. DLB-1361, DLB-1363, DLB-1364, DLB-1406, DLB-1408, DLB-1409, DLB-1516, DLB-1518, DLB-1519, DLB-0239, DLB-0241, DLA-0788..0790, OP3-0906..0908, OP6-1148, OP6-1896, OP8-2106, OP8-2114, OP8-2115 · Basis: Actual (A) throughout on the common definition: clinics owned and open in every month from m−12 to m, calendar months, no seller data; traffic and ticket on the same comp base. Deal B and Operator 8 keep closed clinics until closure; Deal A, Operator 3 and Operator 6 are survivor bases. Hollow marker = Deal B's own weekday-aligned definition (2025 on a 42-clinic set). Operator 6: sales on 13 pre-2023 clinics, traffic on all comp clinics, no ticket; Operator 8 21 clinics

Exhibit 6.19 — On LTM Mar-26 cash-rent four-wall, three of four Deal B cohorts, and its clinics owned 21 months or more, sit below the 10.7–17.4% peer range; the 103 survivors sit at its bottom

Four-wall margin after rebates on cash rent (D1.2, R-CASH), LTM Mar-26, %; shaded = peer range (Operator 8 2022–23, Operator 7 State 05 2023–25, Operator 5 2021 to LTM Mar-23)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal B: Project Bravo DLB Datapack (Jul-26 RF) and QoE Workbook LTM Mar-26 (cash-rent schedule); fact rows DLB-3255, DLB-3307, DLB-3346, DLB-3372, DLB-3177, DLB-3203. Peers: Operator 8 (Operator 8) databook, Operator 7 clinic P&Ls, Operator 5 Accounting Firm 5 due diligence (OP8-1395, OP5-2029) · Basis: Deal B pro forma (PF) on its own datapack, surviving clinics, owned months; peers actual (Operator 8, Operator 7 State 05) and pro forma (Operator 5), all clinics; the 2025 cohort covers 12 or fewer owned months

Exhibit 6.20 — On cash rent after rebates three of four cohorts and the 46 clinics owned 21 months or more sit below the 10.7–17.4% peer range and the 103 survivors at its bottom (10.73%); before rebates the general practice and preventive clinics cannot be placed (LTM Mar-26)

Four-wall margin, % of revenue, on the common definitions (after and before rebates, cash rent): Deal B cohorts, mature clinics and all clinics against cash-rent peers; FY25 and LTM Mar-26

MEASURE (DEFINITION; RENT CODE; CLINIC BASE; PERIOD; BASIS)	DEAL B (ROW)	PEER COMPARATORS (ROW / TABLE)	RANGE	POSITION
D1.2 R-CASH, cohort, LTM Mar-26	2022 7.4% (DLB-3255); 2023 9.8% (DLB-3307); 2024 8.8% (DLB-3346); 2025 17.6%, ≤12 owned months (DLB-3372)	Operator 8 2022 10.7% / 2023 12.0% (A, ALL); Operator 7 ST-22 2023–25 15.6–17.4% (A, ALL); Operator 5 2021–LTM Mar-23 16.9–17.4% (PF, ALL) (Exhibit 9.50)	10.7 – 17.4 %	2022–24 below by 0.5–3.2pp; 2025 above by 0.6pp (not comparable before 21 months)
D1.2 R-CASH, clinics owned ≥21 months, LTM Mar-26	8.4% before any shared-services adjustment, 46 clinics (DLB-3203); ≈10.7–10.9% if the 2.0–2.3% NRA Shared Services charge sits in the datapack four-wall [U] (DLB-3435/3455)	as above	10.7 – 17.4 %	Below by 2.0pp before adjustment; at the bottom if adjusted [U]
D1.2 R-CASH, 103 survivors, LTM Mar-26	10.73% (DLB-3177; $18.4m, DLB-3176)	as above	10.7 – 17.4 %	At the bottom
Not built: D1.1 R-CASH, general practice and preventive clinics	– (clinic rebates given only for all clinic classes, which include DBW from Dec-25; DLB-3447, DLB-3467)	Operator 8 2022–23 7.9–8.6% (A); Operator 5 2022–LTM Mar-23 15.2–15.0% (PF); Operator 7 ST-22 2023–25 14.6–16.1% (A) (Exhibit 9.50)	7.9–16.1 %	Not placed
Not valid: D1.1 on R-UNK	–	Operator 3 12.4% LTM Aug-25 (survivor), Operator 2 11.8% LTM Mar-21, Operator 8 10.8% LTM Mar-26 (Exhibit 9.50)	–	Not placed: rent basis unknown (D1.3); pooling needs R-CASH

Source: Sources as shown. Cohort figures are survivor clinics of each acquisition-year cohort; peers are all clinics. Deal B D1.1 by cohort, or for the general practice and preventive clinics alone, cannot be built because clinic rebates are given only at all-clinic level, which includes DBW's clinics from December 2025 (DLB-022 Rep-to-Adj Clinic-level; DBW in Part 06 section F); Exhibit 4.17 question 5 is therefore answered for cash rent and not for rebates · Basis: Deal B PF (cash-rent normalisation of the company four-wall); peers A, except Operator 5 PF; Deal B survivors against all-clinic peers, which flatters Deal B

The comparator set, the earnings-ladder placements, the same-store table, the shared-services question and the loss-making clinics against peers are in Part 09 section M, under "06 G Against comparable operators: supporting evidence".

H · Sensitivities and requests

On observed anchors to LTM July 2026 the 2025 cohort would earn about $6.9–8.3m a year, 0.52–0.61x of its underwriting, and doubling the 103 general practice and preventive clinics would add $4.3–16.8m of overhead a year at $38–138k per clinic; the six closure and watch clinics all lose money, and 25 requests follow, 5 of the highest priority.

What holds. The company's own list of closure and watch clinics is supported by its data: all six lost money at clinic level over the twelve months to August 2026 (−$373K to −$72K) and in January–August 2026, and the attributes and trends it gives for them tie or tie approximately [F, DLB-033 p.6; DLB-028 S1 tabs; DLB-003].

What to watch. The company puts lease breakage on the four closure and sale candidates at $2.6m in a mid case and $5.1m in a high case; its stated high-case method, the present value of remaining rent less 26%, does not reproduce clinic by clinic from $9.5m of remaining rent [M]. The financing sensitivities are in Part 08 section C.

Exhibit 6.21 — On observed anchors the 2025 cohort would earn about $6.9–8.3m a year (0.52–0.61x of underwriting), cash EBITDA is $5.7–11.7m, and doubling the general practice and preventive clinics would add $4.3–16.8m of overhead a year at $38–138k per clinic (anchors to LTM Jul-26)

Commercial sensitivities of Deal B's business, each on an observed anchor with its source; the rows that bear on the financing (S3, S4, S8 and S10) are in Part 08

NO.	SENSITIVITY	OBSERVED ANCHOR (SOURCE)	DEAL B VALUE	RESULT ON THE ANCHOR [I]	ALTERNATIVE PARAMETERS (ASSUMED)
S1	2025 cohort annual four-wall	2022–24 cohorts' LTM Jul-26 ÷ (Mar–Aug-26 × 2) = 0.59–0.66 (DLB-0114/0142/0166 vs DLB-3632..3634 notes)	Mar–Aug-26 four-wall $5.11m (DLB-3635 note); seller EBITDA $11.47m (DLB-7711)	$6.9–8.3m; 0.52–0.61x of underwriting	Mar–Aug × 2 = $10.67m, 0.77x ("−8%")

NO.	SENSITIVITY	OBSERVED ANCHOR (SOURCE)	DEAL B VALUE	RESULT ON THE ANCHOR [I]	ALTERNATIVE PARAMETERS (ASSUMED)
S2	Cash EBITDA	Peer E6 ÷ top rung 0.28–0.83, median 0.73 (Exhibit 9.69)	Post-audit pro forma $13.79m (DLB-5599); Ares Credit Group cash 0.34 of it (DLB-6302)	$11.7m at the peer median; $5.7m at Ares Credit Group's own ratio	Ares Credit Group cash-adjusted $5.7m only
S5	Overhead cost of 2x, general practice and preventive clinics	Per clinic, on the model's split of overhead between the segments (DBW's overhead and 38 clinics excluded): Deal B $138k LTM Mar-26 (DLB-5007 less DLB-6064, ÷ DLB-5814), marginal $38k in the borrower plan to FY28E (DLB-5011 less DLB-6068; DLB-4939 less DLB-5946); peers $51.0k (Deal A, FY26) to $174.3k (Operator 7 ST-22, LTM May-26) per clinic (DLA-1223 ÷ 983 clinics; OP7-0803 ÷ 10 clinics; note C-26). Per revenue: plan 9.2% → 5.9% (DLB-4943 less DLB-5948; DLB-4947 less DLB-5952); peers' ratio not falling with scale (Exhibit 3.11)	103 clinics; $16.8m overhead	Per-clinic reading: +$4.3m a year for 206 clinics at the plan's marginal $38k, +$16.8m at today's $138k. Revenue reading: about +$4.1m at the plan's FY28 ratio (5.86%) on 1.8x LTM revenue ($307m)	Corporate cost not treated as a constraint (no figure)
S6	Integration cost per acquired unit (like for like)	Deal B 2023–25 DD #1 sub-lines b-2, c, e, f: $32–86k per unit (DLB-4151..4195); full transaction add-backs $140–319k on 28, 32 and 24 acquired units, or $121k for 2025 on 62 units including DBW's 38, because the QoE lines are consolidated (DLB-4135..4227; DLB-7674/7689/7704); Operator 6 $134–192k transaction-related (OP6-1881..1883)	Budget $11.1k per clinic (DLB-7866..7870); the 23 clinics the borrower plan adds by FY26E (161 clinics against 143 at September 2026; DLB-4937, DLB-4936)	Like for like $1.0–2.3m for the 23 clinics against $0.3m budgeted; full transaction costs $3.3–8.8m ($3.8–8.8m on the 24-unit basis for 2025)	The borrower's model assumes $38k of growth capex and $6.9k of maintenance capex per acquired clinic (DLB-008 '(B.1) NearTerm Acq. Assumption'!R47:S67); the $11.1k integration budget sits inside the growth allowance
S7	DBW value	Wellness clinic multiples 4.4–6.3x (QL2-1038; QL1-1722/1736/1735/1729)	Standalone EBITDA ≈$6.2m (DLB-0780; DLB-0775/0765; DLB-6066)	$33–46m; 3.2x entry = $23m	$5.9–6.3m × 5.3x = $37–38m; Ares Credit Group "$44m"
S9	Traffic stress	Deal B D2.1 traffic −9.3% (CY24) to −2.6% (CY25) (DLB-1363; DLB-1408); peer SOFT24-26 −2.0% to −3.9% (Exhibit 9.142; −4.1% at Operator 3 in 2024 and −7.9% at Deal A in FY25, Part 04 section C); core COVID20 −12% to −20% over 2020, −20% in Operator 2's worst quarter (Exhibit 9.34)	LTM Jul-26 −3.8% (DLB-1518)	The EBITDA effect needs a decremental margin that the files do not give; not computed	–
S11	Closure lease tail	Undiscounted remaining rent on 19 under-performing clinics: $2.8m / $15.1m / $17.4m by category (DLB-7949/7946/7943); shutdown estimate $76–90k excluding leases (DLB-7885)	Ares Credit Group E5 $11.16m	Up to 1.3x Ares Credit Group E5 if the "Action Needed" category closed with its full tail	–

Source: Rows and exhibits as shown in each cell · Basis: Results [I] computed on the anchors shown; alternative parameters are assumptions, kept beside the anchored result

Information requests

Items marked *Outstanding* have been requested and have not yet arrived in full. The items are for the company and its bankers.

Highest priority

1. *Outstanding.* The August 2026 Accounting Firm 2 QoE roll-forward — consolidated, with bank-to-ledger ties and the split between the general practice and preventive business and DBW, and the journal controls behind it — Accounting Firm 2's explanation of the −$3.3m 'Monthly checks – EBITDA' line, and the FY25 audited financial statements with the auditor's management letter.
2. The corporate organisation chart with names, roles and start dates, in particular the finance team (chief financial officer, controller, accounting and reporting staff), and the corporate positions now open.
3. For DBW: the purchase agreement for the 38 clinics and any transition services agreement with the seller (services, fees, end dates); a list of the obligations under the FTC order that apply to Deal B entities, with their status; and a legal-entity chart showing which entity holds the 38 clinics.

Next priority

4. *Outstanding.* A key from each deal in the Historical Acquisition Detail ('DLB Site N') to the datapack clinic IDs, with, for each deal, the sale-leaseback proceeds, rent, the period and basis of the seller EBITDA, the funding by cash, debt and equity, and the latest 4-wall EBITDA; and a clinic key for all 103 clinics (clinic ID, trading name, street address and acquisition date), with, for the six City 2-area 2025–26 clinics, their public web page if they have one.
5. Clinic-level vendor rebates, and the split of the 'NRA Shared Services' charge by clinic.
6. *Outstanding.* For DBW: a four-wall bridge to cash rent (labour, area-manager allocation, supplier and animal health manufacturer rebates, royalty status); a separation model; an owned-period comparable visit count (from December 2026); ticket history and the pharmacy-supply terms with its primary distributor; and the buy-side DBW QoE.

7. *Outstanding.* The full rent roll by clinic with lease type (sale-leaseback, third party, related party), escalators and cash vs book rent; the sale-leaseback and master-lease schedules; any REIT buy-out terms; and, for each property, the landlord and any lease-financing party and the segment it serves (general practice and preventive, or wellness clinic).
8. *Outstanding.* Monthly balance sheets and cash-flow statements for 2025–26, and the final August 2026 flash.
9. Uploads of VDR 7.1.4 (August RF model), 2.1 (datapacks) and 4.6.6.1–2 (add-on acquisition memos), which the company's recent diligence responses refer to. For the household count and household income given for each clinic: the definition of the trade area (radius or drive time), the data vendor and the year of the data, and whether one definition was used for clinics acquired before 2025 and for 2025–26 clinics.
10. A systems map by clinic and acquisition cohort: practice management, booking, diagnostic imaging, accounting and payroll systems in use, the date each clinic moved to the common system, and the clinics still to move.
11. Veterinarian, veterinary technician and client-service headcount, vacancies, time to fill and turnover by clinic and by cohort, for 2024 to 2026 to date.
12. Supplier price changes attributed to manufacturer list-price increases since January 2025, by supplier and date; and any rebate true-up, supplier credit or price reduction linked to a credit received in 2026, by month, showing where it is recorded in cost of sales and in adjusted and pro forma EBITDA.
13. For DBW: the trading name or names of the 38 clinics since December 2025, any licence, franchise or other agreement that governs the name they use, and the cost and timing of any planned change of name.
14. For DBW: the client claims log since December 2025, and for the seller's period where held: number of patient-injury claims, amounts paid and open, and the insurance cover and retention that applies.
15. How hiring, payroll, area management and clinic management of the wellness clinics are divided between the DBW and Deal B teams, and how those costs are charged to each segment.
16. The overhead savings delivered to date, by function, with the amount and date of each, reconciled to corporate overhead in the financing model.
17. The results of closed clinics by acquisition cohort: revenue and four-wall EBITDA for each clinic closed since acquisition, month by month to its closure, with the closure date.
18. The full capital put into each acquisition: purchase price and fees, integration, rebranding and capital expenditure since closing, by deal.
19. Dated price actions by service category since 2023, with category gross margin and repeat-client data before and after each.

If readily available

20. *Received in part on 1 October 2026* (DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses: the 19 under-performing units, the four closure or sale candidates and two watch clinics, with a lease-breakage range). *Outstanding:* the closure history (the documents supplied give both five and seven closed clinics) and lease-exit costs for the 19 under-performing clinics beyond the four costed; a reconciliation of the $11.1k per-clinic integration estimate with the $9.0–9.4m a year of acquisition add-backs; a costed staffing and systems plan for about twice the current size (finance, IT/ERP, HR, purchasing, M&A and integration, as well as field roles); and a certified maintenance/growth capex split by cohort.
21. Customer rating and review count by clinic and month since acquisition, with the acquisition cohort of each clinic, and any customer-satisfaction score and complaint or refund log the company keeps by clinic.

Requests arising from the files received on 1 October 2026

20. *Highest priority.* The clinic list and the first month counted behind the same-store sales table by year of ownership in the responses (stated as weekday-aligned and including pre-acquisition data), with the number of pre-acquisition months in each cohort's first year, which gives a narrowing first-year dip (−13.3% to −6.2%) that the datapack does not show (−8.5%, −4.1%, −6.6%, −9.2%).
21. *Highest priority.* For DBW: the weekly same-store visit count file behind the windows of 8–29 August (−21.8%) and 5–26 September 2026 (−15.6%), with the 31 of 38 clinics stated as improving.
22. *Next priority.* The basis of the 18% and 9% cohort clinic margins in the responses: book or cash rent, owned months or full years.
23. *Next priority.* Ledger support for the $1,391K itemisation of the April–August 2026 "other non-recurring" costs, by vendor and account.
24. *Next priority.* The lease-breakage calculation by clinic for the four closure and sale candidates: remaining rent, discount rate, re-leasing assumption and landlord investment; the stated method (present value of remaining rent less 26%) does not reproduce clinic by clinic.
25. *Next priority.* For DBW: the list of the 20 flagged clinics, and the August 2026 datapack roll-forward.
26. *Next priority.* For Steer Phones: call conversion and visit count by clinic and week since launch, against the clinics not yet on the service.
27. *If readily available.* For DBW: the period behind the closure-review clinics' losses, stated as the twelve months to 1 December 2025 (the figures match June 2024 to May 2025).

The note on how the sensitivities are anchored is in Part 09 section M, under "06 H Sensitivities and requests: supporting evidence".

Part 07 — Deal C

Deal C's audited FY2025 clinic margin supports Ares Credit Group's view; its 2026 same-store decline, an acquired-clinic EBITDA-margin uplift far below the claim and cash earnings held down by affiliate deal bonuses do not yet carry the rest of the thesis on the evidence supplied to date

Ares Credit Group asked. Ares Credit Group's initial reaction is that Deal C is one of the more attractive platforms it has seen, and the leverage requested is 5.3x (Part 07 section A; the leverage in Part 08 section D).

Deal C's audited clinic margin supports Ares Credit Group's first impression of a high-quality platform: 21.3% on book rent and 22.3% on cash rent after rebates in FY2025, with 38 of 86 clinics above 21% in the twelve months to July 2026, and seven of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database bought at 2.4–3.2x seller clinic EBITDA, gross, on cash consideration (the other three at 6.2–6.6x, of which the two bought with a sale-leaseback cost 2.9x and 4.2x net of the sale proceeds). On 24 matched acquired sites of the 2023–25 cohorts, seller months against owned months in the twelve months to July 2026, gross margin rose +591bp after purchase, in line with the 584bp claimed. What does not yet carry the rest of the thesis: on the common same-store definition sales fell from +4.5% in 2025 to −3.2% in the second quarter of 2026 and same-store clinic EBITDA fell 5.8% over the twelve months to July 2026; the clinic EBITDA-margin uplift on those 24 sites is +145bp against the 594bp claimed; and cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs was $8.3m in FY2025, 0.31 of pro forma against a peer median of 0.84, held down by affiliate deal bonuses.

Same-store sales are compared on one common definition, with the company's own series shown beside it and labelled, and clinic margins after rebates are compared with peers only as an indication because no comparator shares Deal C's rent and rebate treatment. Earnings are kept on named levels, from audited reported EBITDA to Ares Credit Group's underwriting figure and cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs.

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED
A-01	Same-store sales are compared on one common definition	Clinics owned and open 13 months, calendar months, no months from before purchase; the treatment of closed clinics is stated
A-02	Clinic (four-wall) margins are compared before rebates and after cash rent	Margins after rebates or on other rent treatments are shown with their treatment named and never pooled
A-03	EBITDA is kept on named levels	Reported, adjusted, pro forma, run-rate, underwriting and cash EBITDA (pro forma less "one-time" costs that recur)
A-07	Series that exclude closed clinics are read as upper bounds	Closed clinics absent from a series are stated with the series
A-08	Live-deal figures come from the companies' own documents	Where a measure exists on two definitions, both are shown with the definition named

Exhibit 7.01 — Deal C's audited clinic margin holds, but its 2026 trend, its acquired-clinic EBITDA-margin uplift and its cash earnings do not carry the rest of the thesis on the evidence to July 2026

Our reading on each component of Ares Credit Group's Deal C thesis (ST1 to ST4), with the depth of the evidence and what would change it; FY2025 to July 2026

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
ST1 · Particularly attractive platform	**Partially supported** — the 2026 trajectory is not supported. The audited FY2025 clinic margin of 21.3% on book rent and 22.3% on cash rent after rebates holds (not yet tested at market rent or before rebates), but same-store sales on the common definition fell to −0.4% for the twelve months to July 2026 and −3.2% in the second quarter of 2026 (−1.3% in the second quarter on the acquisition-lag variant), and same-store clinic EBITDA fell 5.8% (Part 07 section B).	FY2025 audit (actual); site database to July 2026 (pro forma, owned months); four peers on the same same-store definition for 2025; the margin comparison with peers is indicative only.	August–September 2026 same-store sales and clinic EBITDA on the common definition; a clinic rent roll and FY2025 rebate dollars
ST2 · Demonstrated differentiation	**Contradicted** — the claimed 584/695bp uplift is not supported; the gross-margin mechanism is observed. On the same sites clinic EBITDA margin rose +145bp for the 2023–25 cohorts pooled, against the 594bp claimed, while gross margin rose +591bp, against the 584bp claimed; acquired clinics earn 0.93x their entry EBITDA against 1.15–1.63x at peers (Part 07 section C, Part 07 section F).	43 matched acquired sites, seller months against owned months to July 2026 (pro forma); company-presented buy-down multiples at Deal C and three peers.	The basis of each buy-down multiple, with seller P&Ls that show rent on owned property
ST3 · Underwriting earnings are supportable	**Insufficient evidence** (underwriting EBITDA, E5; Accounting Firm 1 QoE absent) — cash earnings **contradicted** while the affiliate bonuses continue. $9.2m of Ares Credit Group's $29.4m is pre-acquisition and letter-of-intent earnings; cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs was 0.31 of pro forma in FY2025, and about 0.59 if the bonuses end (Part 07 section D).	FY2025 audit (actual); Ares Credit Group's Internal Diligence Exhibits (pro forma and projected); the cash share at the roll-up peers; no quality-of-earnings report.	The Accounting Firm 1 quality-of-earnings report; the affiliate transaction-bonus agreements and whether they end after close

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
ST4 · 5.3x leverage is supportable (Option Two; Option One)	Option Two: **Contradicted**. Option One: **Insufficient evidence** — sponsor-instrument terms missing. Set out in Part 08 section D.	Part 08 section D	Part 08 section D

Source: Part 07 section A to Part 07 section G, and Part 08 section D for ST4 · Basis: Audited FY2025 figures actual (A); site database pro forma (PF); underwriting earnings projected (P), including pre-acquisition months

A · Thesis and readings

The audited FY2025 clinic margin of 21.3–22.3% supports Ares Credit Group's first impression of a high-quality platform; Ares Credit Group's view falls short on the 2026 same-store decline, a matched clinic EBITDA-margin uplift of +145bp to LTM July 2026 against 594bp claimed, and cash EBITDA at 0.28–0.31 of pro forma (FY2025, LTM April 2026).

Ares Credit Group's thesis. Ares Credit Group's initial reaction is that Deal C is one of the more attractive platforms it has seen, on high clinic margins, veterinarian retention, and a pricing matrix and rebate programme that the sponsor presents as lifting acquired-clinic gross margin by 584bp and clinic EBITDA margin by 594bp; Ares Credit Group is earlier in its evaluation, and the leverage requested is 5.3x [A, Deal C Early Read Memo v19; financing in Part 08 section D].

What holds. The clinic-margin level rests on audited figures, the earnings are broad at the top, organic growth kept pace with peers through 2025, and the gross-margin mechanism is observed on the same sites (Part 07 section B, Part 07 section C).

What to watch. Same-store sales and clinic EBITDA turned down in 2026, most of the gross-margin lift does not reach clinic EBITDA, and cash earnings are held down by affiliate deal bonuses (Part 07 section D). The platform is three and a half years old and has no downturn history.

Exhibit 7.02 — FY2024 to LTM Sep-26E: Deal C's audited clinic margin holds; its 2026 trend, the claimed acquired-clinic uplift and its cash earnings are where the evidence falls short of Ares Credit Group's initial view

Our reading of each component of Ares Credit Group's Deal C thesis on the evidence supplied to date, with its basis, what holds, what does not and what would change it; FY2024 to LTM Sep-26E

THESIS COMPONENT	OUR READING ON THE EVIDENCE SUPPLIED TO DATE	BASIS	WHAT HOLDS	WHAT DOES NOT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
ST1 · Particularly attractive platform	**Partially supported** — the 2026 trajectory is not supported	Audited clinic margin 21.3–22.3% (with rebates; peer comparison indicative only); same-store sales on the common definition −0.4% for the twelve months to July 2026 and −3.2% in the second quarter of 2026 (−1.3% on the lag variant); same-store clinic EBITDA −5.8% over the twelve months to July 2026 (2025 Audit; Site-Level Database; Part 07 section B, Part 07 section F)	A high audited clinic margin, above peers' after-rebate figures (indicative only) (Part 07 section B, Part 07 section F); 38 of 86 clinics above 21% in the twelve months to July 2026 (Part 07 section B); 2025 same-store sales inside the peer range (Part 07 section F)	Same-store sales and clinic earnings fell in 2026 (Part 07 section B); the margin is not tested at market rent or before rebates (Part 07 section B); the widest spread of clinic margins among peers (Part 07 section F)	August–September 2026 same-store results; a clinic rent roll and rebate dollars
ST2 · Demonstrated differentiation	**Contradicted** — the claimed 584/695bp uplift is not supported; the gross-margin mechanism is observed	Matched clinic EBITDA-margin uplift +145bp pooled against 594bp claimed (gross margin +591bp against 584bp claimed); acquired-clinic EBITDA 0.93x entry against 1.15–1.63x at peers (Site-Level Database; KPI Data Pack; Part 07 section C, Part 07 section F)	Gross margin rises on the same sites after purchase (+591bp pooled) (Part 07 section C); rising rebates (Part 07 section C); seven of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database bought at 2.4–3.2x seller clinic EBITDA, gross, on cash consideration; the other three at 6.2–6.6x (the two bought with a sale-leaseback 2.9x and 4.2x net of the sale proceeds) (Part 07 section C)	The lift mostly does not reach clinic EBITDA (Part 07 section C); the 2024 cohort's margin fell after purchase (Part 07 section B, Part 07 section C); acquired clinics re-rate less than at every peer (Part 07 section F)	Per-deal buy-down basis; seller P&Ls showing rent on owned property

THESIS COMPONENT	OUR READING ON THE EVIDENCE SUPPLIED TO DATE	BASIS	WHAT HOLDS	WHAT DOES NOT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
ST3 · Underwriting earnings are supportable	**Insufficient evidence** (underwriting EBITDA, E5; Accounting Firm 1 QoE absent) — cash earnings **contradicted** while the affiliate bonuses continue	Accounting Firm 1 QoE not supplied; cash EBITDA 0.28–0.31 of pro forma against a 0.73 peer median; deal costs 30–33% of price against 2–14% (2025 Audit Note 3; Internal Diligence Exhibits p.11; Part 07 section D, Part 07 section F)	Adjustments inside the roll-up range (Part 07 section F); an unmodified audit opinion (Part 07 section D); deal costs inside the peer range without the affiliate bonuses (Part 07 section D, Part 07 section F)	$9.2m of the $29.4m is pre-acquisition and LOI earnings (Part 07 section D); the QoE is missing (Part 07 section D); deal costs are about a third of purchase price while the bonuses continue (Part 07 section D, Part 07 section F)	Accounting Firm 1 QoE; the affiliate-bonus agreements and whether they end (cash share about 0.59 if they do)
ST4 · 5.3x leverage is supportable (Option Two; Option One)	Option Two: **Contradicted**. Option One: **Insufficient evidence** — sponsor-instrument terms missing. Read in Part 08 section D	Part 08 section D	Part 08 section D	Part 08 section D	Part 08 section D

Source: Sections of this part as named in each row: 2025 Audit; Site-Level Database; KPI Data Pack; Internal Diligence Exhibits. The financing row is read in Part 08 section D · Basis: Basis flags and evidence tags as in the sections cited; readings are ours, on the evidence supplied to date

Where Ares Credit Group's view differs from ours. Ares Credit Group's first read is of a platform with unusually strong clinics, and the audited figures bear that out. Each point below states Ares Credit Group's view, the evidence each way and what would settle it.

A particularly attractive platform. For: an audited clinic margin of 21.3–22.3% after rebates, 2.6–3.0 points above the peers' 16.5–18.7% (indicative), 38 of 86 clinics above 21%, and seven of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database bought at 2.4–3.2x seller clinic EBITDA, gross, on cash consideration (the other three at 6.2–6.6x gross, of which the two bought with a sale-leaseback cost 2.9x and 4.2x net of the sale proceeds), against 4.4–6.0x for peers' standalone add-ons (Part 07 section B, Part 07 section C, Part 07 section F). Against: same-store sales on the common definition fell to −3.2% in the second quarter of 2026 and same-store clinic EBITDA fell 5.8% over the twelve months to July 2026; 32 of 88 clinics lease from founders. What would settle it: August–September 2026 same-store results, and a clinic rent roll at market.

Pricing and purchasing lift acquired clinics. For: on matched sites, for the 2023–25 cohorts pooled, gross margin rose +591bp after purchase, in line with the 584bp claimed, and rebates rose from 0.8–1.0% of gross sales to 1.32% (Part 07 section C). Against: clinic EBITDA margin rose +145bp against the 594bp claimed, and acquired clinics earn 0.93x their entry EBITDA against 1.15–1.63x at peers. What would settle it: the basis of each buy-down multiple, with seller P&Ls that show rent on owned property.

Supportable underwriting earnings. For: the FY2025 audit opinion is unmodified, and without the affiliate bonuses deal costs would have been 7.4% and 13.2% of purchase consideration, inside the peer range, and FY2025 cash EBITDA about 0.59 of pro forma (Part 07 section D). Against: $9.2m of Ares Credit Group's $29.4m is pre-acquisition and LOI earnings, and while the bonuses continue cash EBITDA is 0.28–0.31 of pro forma. What would settle it: the Accounting Firm 1 quality-of-earnings report and the affiliate-bonus agreements.

The fuller evidence summary, the key-numbers table and how earnings are measured in this part are in Part 09 section N, under "07 A Thesis and readings: supporting evidence".

B · Business quality

Deal C's audited FY2025 clinic margin of 21.3–22.3% after rebates is high and broad, with 38 of 86 clinics above 21% in LTM July 2026; but same-store sales fell to −3.2% in Q2 2026 and same-store clinic EBITDA by 5.8% over LTM July 2026.

What holds. Audited FY2025 gross profit less clinic operating expenses was 21.3% of net sales on book rent and 22.3% on cash rent, after rebates, and the earnings are broad at the top: in the twelve months to July 2026, 38 of 86 clinics earned more than 21% and produced $28.0m of the $43.6m of clinic EBITDA. Every cohort earns 17.9–25.7% on owned months, and same-store sales rose 4.5% in 2025 on the common definition.

What to watch. Same-store sales fell to −0.4% for LTM July 2026 and −3.2% in Q2 2026, same-store clinic EBITDA fell 5.8%, and the 55 clinics owned before 2025 earned 8.79% less clinic EBITDA in January–July 2026 than a year earlier. The margin is not yet tested at market rent or before rebates.

Exhibit 7.03 — LTM Jul-26: 38 of 86 clinics earn a margin above 21% and produce $28.0m of the $43.6m of clinic EBITDA; the 20 clinics below 13% produce $1.9m

Number of clinics and clinic-level EBITDA ($m) by clinic EBITDA-margin band, LTM Jul-26, 86 clinics

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Ares Credit Group Internal Diligence Exhibits (September 2026), unit margin analysis, drawn from the Deal C site-level database. Rows DLC-4137 to DLC-4164 · Basis: Hollow = pro forma: the clinic figures are as populated in the site database, which includes seller months for clinics acquired between Aug-25 and Jul-26 (the source notes that the historical data are not fully pro forma for acquisitions). Margin after vendor rebates, on book rent, before corporate cost. Surviving clinics only. The company counts three loss-making clinics for LTM Jun-26; the site database gives four for LTM Jul-26

Exhibit 7.04 — Deal C's clinic margin sits between 17.9% and 25.7% in every acquisition cohort on owned months, LTM Jul-26; on the same definition the 2024 cohort earned 27.9% in CY2024, when 9 of its 15 clinics were owned

Clinic-level EBITDA margin after rebates by acquisition cohort, LTM Jul-26, owned months only, %

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C: Mike Site-Level Database (clinic-level EBITDA and net revenue by site and month); fact rows DLC-0745, DLC-0697, DLC-0705, DLC-0721, DLC-0737; first owned year DLC-0513 · Basis: Pro forma (PF): the management-adjusted site database used in the quality-of-earnings work; book rent; owned full months only. With seller months the 2025 and 2026 cohorts read 24.9% and 19.6%. The CY2024 figure for the 2024 cohort (27.9%, not drawn) is on the same definition and basis, on the 9 clinics owned for full months in 2024

Exhibit 7.05 — Deal C's comp visit count fell in three of four periods from FY23 to LTM Jun-26 while its average patient invoice rose in every one, by 3.3% to 11.5%

Deal C company comp visit count and average patient invoice growth, %, FY23 to LTM Jun-26; adjusted for working days and blackout dates, certificate-only visits excluded

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C: Mike Visit Count – Average Invoice workbook, tab "Visit Count & Average Invoice - Total", rows 31 and 31; fact rows A1-S001 to A1-S004 and A5-P5-003 to A5-P5-006 · Basis: Pro forma (PF): the company's own adjusted definition; not placed against other operators' traffic, which is measured differently

Our reading on ST1, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported — the 2026 trajectory is not supported. What would change it: August–September 2026 same-store sales and same-store clinic EBITDA on the common definition, and a clinic rent roll with FY2025 rebate dollars.

The audit tie and rent-code bounds, the site database on owned and seller months, the cohort margins, the same-store series on both definitions, traffic and ticket, and the public footprint are in Part 09 section N, under "07 B Business quality: supporting evidence".

C · Claimed differentiation

The claimed lifts, 584bp of gross margin and 594bp of clinic EBITDA margin, compare different cohorts; on the same sites, seller months against owned months in LTM July 2026, the pooled 2023–25 cohorts gained +591bp of gross margin, in line with the gross-margin claim, but

only +145bp of clinic EBITDA margin, so most of the lift does not reach EBITDA.

What holds. The pricing and purchasing mechanism is observed: on the same sites, gross margin rose after purchase in every cohort, +591bp for the 2023–25 cohorts pooled against the 584bp claimed, and vendor rebates rose from 0.8–1.0% of gross sales in FY2023–24 to 1.32% in the six months to April 2026. Most tuck-ins are bought cheaply: seven of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database (Sponsor 3's [name withheld] clinic has eight seller months, from its opening in May 2025; its pre-opening months are left out) cost 2.4–3.2x seller clinic EBITDA, gross, on cash consideration, against 4.4–6.0x for peers' standalone add-ons (the peers' entry multiples are in the row labels of Exhibit 7.12, their basis in Exhibit 7.13).

What to watch. Clinic EBITDA margin rose only +145bp on the same sites against the 594bp claimed, and fell 522bp for the 2024 cohort; clinics bought with a sale-leaseback gained gross margin but lost 13bp of EBITDA margin. On the buy-down basis acquired clinics earn 0.93x their entry EBITDA. The other three deals cost 6.2–6.6x gross, two of them single clinics bought with a sale-leaseback (2.9x and 4.2x net of the sale proceeds).

Exhibit 7.06 — Seller months to LTM Jul-26, same sites: clinic EBITDA-margin uplift is +794, −522, +261 and +432bp for the 2023–26 cohorts and +145bp pooled for 2023–25, against a 594bp headline

Margin uplift in basis points on 43 matched acquired sites: up to twelve seller months before acquisition against owned full months in LTM Jul-26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C site-level database (seller and owned months by site, to Jul-26); sponsor headline from the KPI Data Pack and Confidential Information Presentation. Rows DLC-1196 to DLC-1259, DLC-3394, DLC-4373 · Basis: Hollow = pro forma: the seller months are pre-ownership results as recorded in the site database. The uplift is pro forma: both windows come from the site database, whose owned months are QoE-adjusted to Apr-26 and management-adjusted for May–Jul-26 and whose seller months are pre-ownership results. Ratio of sums per group. At least six seller months are required: 44 of 51 acquired sites qualify on that test and 43 are matched here, each with at least one owned full month in LTM Jul-26; legacy clinics are excluded. Seasons are not aligned between the two windows. Seller results for clinics bought with a sale-leaseback carried no rent on owned property

The 2025 audit records twenty-one clinic acquisitions from January 2025 to February 2026 (Notes 3 and 14); the ten deals are those whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database, and the other ten acquisitions have five to eleven seller months there or, for Burnsville, none, so the multiples describe about half of the period's clinic deals. Of the ten deals, six single clinics cost 2.4–3.0x seller clinic EBITDA and the five-clinic Sponsor 3 deal 3.2x; the two single clinics bought with a sale-leaseback cost 6.2x (Reliable, 2.9x net of the $1.0m sale proceeds) and 6.2x (Premier ST-74, 4.2x net of $2.2m), and the ECM and Operator 34 acquisitions of 27 February 2026 (seven sites together, recorded separately in audit Note 14) 6.6x. Multiples are cash consideration over the seller's clinic EBITDA in the twelve months before purchase, gross of sale-leaseback proceeds; Sponsor 3 (rollover equity and an earnout) and Premier ST-74 (rollover equity) also carried consideration that audit Note 14 does not quantify, so their multiples are lower bounds [I, DLC-1261..1279; Site-Level Database; 2025 audit Notes 3 and 14].

Our reading on ST2, on the evidence supplied to date: contradicted — the claimed 584/695bp uplift is not supported; the gross-margin mechanism is observed. What would change it: the per-deal buy-down basis with seller P&Ls that show rent on owned property, and matched 21-month cohort data including brownfields.

The construction of the claimed lifts, the matched-site method, the buy-down ratios by cohort, the rebate lever and the public brand terms are in Part 09 section N, under "07 C Claimed differentiation: supporting evidence".

D · Earnings quality

Reported FY2025 EBITDA was $4.7m against Ares Credit Group's $29.4m underwriting figure for LTM September 2026E, which includes $9.2m of pre-acquisition and LOI earnings; cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs was $8.3m, 0.31 of pro forma, and about $15.5m if affiliate bonuses end.

What holds. The FY2025 audit opinion is unmodified, adjustments are 69% of pro forma EBITDA in FY2025, inside the roll-ups' range, and the cash shortfall has one identified cause: without the affiliate transaction bonuses, deal costs would have been 7.4% and 13.2% of purchase consideration in FY2024 and FY2025, inside the peer range, and FY2025 cash EBITDA about $15.5m, 0.59 of pro forma.

What to watch. Of Ares Credit Group's $29.4m, $9.2m is pre-acquisition and LOI earnings, and the Accounting Firm 1 quality-of-earnings report that would test the add-backs was not supplied. While the bonuses continue, cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs is 0.31 and 0.28 of pro forma (FY2025, LTM April 2026), against a peer median of 0.84.

Exhibit 7.07 — FY25 to LTM Sep-26E: Deal C's adjustment intensity is inside the roll-up range, but its cash EBITDA is about a third of E3 — a level peers show only in their heaviest acquisition years

EBITDA by rung, $m (FY25, LTM Apr-26, LTM Sep-26E); adjustment share and cash share of the top rung, ratio, against peers (FY23 to LTM Mar-26)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C FY25 audit, sell-side QoE summary in Ares Credit Group's Internal Diligence Exhibits, sponsor financial model and Ares Credit Group Early Read Memo v19; peer QoE and credit-agreement bridges as supplied. Rows DLC-0019, DLC-4425 to DLC-4427, DLC-4429, DLC-4430, DLC-4434, DLC-4437, DLC-4439, DLC-4443, DLC-4002, DLC-4195; peer rows in the data file · Basis: Filled = actual (E1 reported), hollow = pro forma (E2, E3, E6 and Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA), hatched = projected (LTM Sep-26E includes forecast months). E6 = E3 less the transaction, integration and start-up costs that recur in every period. Ratios are computed on pro forma rungs and drawn hollow; the "if affiliate bonuses end" point is a sensitivity. The peer median (0.73) is taken over 11 platform-periods; Operator 3's three periods are drawn as one row. Operator 8: two sources differ on reported EBITDA; the company databook value is shown. Operator 8's cash share is taken on its as-owned adjusted EBITDA (E2m, $12.1m), the base its E6 is built from; its E3 ($23.8m) is fully pro forma for acquisitions to May-26 · Assumption: The "if affiliate bonuses end" point adds the audited FY25 affiliate bonuses ($7.12m) back to E6; it mixes the audit's bonus amount with the QoE transaction line and is approximate

Exhibit 7.08 — FY24 and FY25: Deal C's audited deal costs were 28.5% and 31.2% of purchase consideration against 1.5–14.1% at peers; excluding the affiliate bonuses they fall inside the peer range

Transaction and integration cost as a share of purchase consideration, %, by platform-year (FY19 to FY25; sponsor model 2027P and 2030P)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C FY25 audit (transaction expense, affiliate bonuses, purchase consideration) and sponsor financial model; Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 4, Operator 8, Operator 2 and Operator 1 deal files as supplied. Total consideration (cash, rollover equity and contingent consideration: $27.9m FY24, $32.8m FY25) from the audit's Note 3, pp.17–19 (printed pp.15–17). Rows DLC-0031, DLC-0009, DLC-0200, DLC-0199, DLC-1481, DLC-1484; peer rows in the data file · Basis: Filled = actual (audited or as reported), hollow = audited expense adjusted to exclude affiliate transaction bonuses ($6.7m FY24, $7.2m FY25), hatched = projected (sponsor model: budgeted transaction expense over modelled acquisition spend). Platform-years only; Operator 1 FY21 is a share of cohort enterprise value

Our reading on ST3, on the evidence supplied to date: insufficient evidence (underwriting EBITDA, E5; Accounting Firm 1 QoE absent) — cash earnings contradicted while the affiliate bonuses continue. What would change it: the Accounting Firm 1 quality-of-earnings report, including the pre-acquisition and LOI earnings, and the affiliate transaction-bonus agreements with their post-close status.

The audited statements, Ares Credit Group's six earnings figures, the cash-EBITDA build, the affiliate bonuses and deal costs going forward are in Part 09 section N, under "07 D Earnings quality: supporting evidence".

E · Growth capacity

The claim of capacity for 127 clinics without added spend uses a 2023 ratio; in June 2026 area managers ran 3.8–5.3 clinics each, and the plan's fall in G&A share to 2030 exceeds any peer's 1.1 points while scaling.

What holds. The model plans for overhead growth rather than assuming it away: corporate G&A rises 17% a year, from $7.5m to $16.1m by 2030, and the brands are part-way through a rebranding that adds common customer-facing systems.

What to watch. The sponsor's "18 area managers × 7 clinics = 127 clinics with no incremental spend" uses the 2023 ratio; the June 2026 census shows 20 area managers at 3.8–5.3 clinics each. The plan takes beachhead plus corporate G&A from 7.3% of revenue to 4.8% by 2030; no platform in the set cut its overhead share by more than 1.1 points while it scaled.

Exhibit 7.09 — FY17 to 2030P: the sponsor's M&A case cuts G&A by 2.5 points of revenue; no platform in the set has cut its overhead share by more than 1.1 points while scaling

Overhead as % of revenue by platform, first to last observed period (FY17 to LTM May-26); Deal C FY23 to LTM Apr-26 and sponsor plan to 2030P

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C sponsor financial model (Summer 2026) and FY25 audit; Operator 8, Operator 3, Operator 7 ST-22, Operator 2 and Operator 5 QoE and data packs; Deal A 10-K. Rows DLC-1408 to DLC-1411, DLC-1417 to DLC-1420, DLC-1416, DLC-1425, DLC-1294, DLC-2006, DLC-2008, DLC-2009, DLC-0044, DLC-0022, OP8-0394, OP8-2103, OP3-2566, OP3-2568, DLA-1350, DLA-1223; others in the data file · Basis: Filled = actual, hollow = pro forma, dashed = projected (sponsor plan). Overhead definitions differ by platform, so levels are not comparable; only the direction of change within each platform is read. Peer labels give last minus first observed value; Operator 7 ST-22 fell 1.1 points from 2024 to 2025 before rising again

The overhead path in both of the sponsor's cases and the public record of the rebranding are in Part 09 section N, under "07 E Growth capacity: supporting evidence".

F · Against comparable operators

Deal C leads its comparators on clinic margin (indicatively, by 2.6–3.0 points on its FY2025 audit) and entry price, sits inside their range on 2025 same-store sales and adjustment share, below it on 2026 same-store sales and acquired-clinic re-rating, and in the bottom third of it on cash share.

What holds. Deal C leads its comparators on clinic margin, indicatively (21.3–22.3% against 16.5–18.7%), and on the price it pays for tuck-ins (3.25x across 30 tuck-ins, net of sale-leaseback proceeds, against 4.4–6.0x), and its 2025 same-store sales of +4.5% sit inside the +1.9% to +5.1% of Operator 6, Operator 3 and Deal B on the common definition.

What to watch. Its 2026 same-store sales are below Deal B's (−3.2% against +0.3% in Q2 2026), its acquired clinics re-rate less than peers' (0.93x against 1.15–1.63x), and its margin lead comes with the widest spread among the peers, an interquartile range of 12.1 points.

Exhibit 7.10 — Indicative only (mixed rent bases, latest period each): Deal C's median with-rebates clinic margin of 20.9% (LTM Jul-26) is above Operator 3's 14.1% and Operator 5's 16.8%, but its interquartile range is the widest and its loss-making share (5.2%) above Operator 3's (2.0%)

Clinic-level EBITDA margin after vendor rebates and before corporate cost, % of revenue, with two reference rows before rebates on cash rent; latest period per operator (FY22 to LTM Jul-26)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C site-level database (to Jul-26) and FY25 audit; Operator 4, Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 5 and Operator 7 clinic-level files as supplied. Rows DLC-0421, DLC-0839 to DLC-0841, DLC-0845, DLC-5013, DLC-5014, OP4-1507, OP6-0357, OP3-1091, OP5-2060 to OP5-2446, OP5-2028, OP7-0515 · Basis: Filled = actual, hollow = pro forma. Deal C LTM Jul-26 is pro forma (QoE-adjusted to Apr-26, management-adjusted May to Jul-26), owned months only; its FY25 rows are audited totals. Rent bases differ by row (book, cash, not stated) and Operator 6 is a per-location average, so this is a bounded, directional comparison, not a range placement

Exhibit 7.11 — Q1-24 to Q2-26: on the common definition Deal C and Deal B decelerated by about the same amount from Q2-25 to Q2-26 (9.5pp and 8.6pp); Deal C turned negative in 2026 (−1.3% in Q2 on the acquisition-lag variant)

Same-store sales growth on the common definition (owned and open 13 months, calendar months, no seller months), % year on year, by calendar quarter

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C site-level database; Deal B, Operator 3 and Operator 6 clinic-level files; Deal A 10-K and 10-Q clinic data; Deal C KPI Data Pack for the company definition. Rows listed in the data file · Basis: All common-definition series are actual (filled). The company-definition points are pro forma (hollow): working-day and blackout adjusted, with seller months in the base. Deal A is a surviving-clinic reading after more than 161 closures and is not ranked. Deal C comps start in Q2-24

Exhibit 7.12 — To LTM May-26, peers' acquired clinics earn 1.1–1.6x their entry EBITDA later; Deal C's earn 0.93x in total, its 2023 cohort 1.43x and its 2024 cohort less than at entry

Later clinic EBITDA ÷ clinic EBITDA at entry, x, by acquired pool; latest period per operator (Oct-24 to LTM May-26)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal C KPI Data Pack (acquisition multiple buy-down); Operator 6 valuation multiple summary; Operator 3 early-read and data pack; Operator 4 IC memo. Rows DLC-3427, DLC-3428, DLC-3434, DLC-3435, DLC-3441, DLC-3442, DLC-3448, DLC-3449, OP6-1731, OP6-1733, OP3-1493, OP3-1494, OP3-1846 to OP3-1856, OP4-0802, OP4-0806; Operator 6 buckets by years since close from note C-37 · Basis: Hollow = pro forma (company KPI basis, synergised or including seller months); filled = actual as presented by the company (Operator 4). All pools are company-presented, surviving deals only and before corporate cost, so each overstates value created. Deal C entry multiples are net of sale-leaseback proceeds

Exhibit 7.13 — 2025–26: Deal C can be placed against the roll-ups on same-store sales, adjustment share and add-on multiples, but not on clinic-level margin or traffic

Comparators, why each is included, and the measures on which each is and is not a valid comparison for Deal C on the common definitions; peer files and Deal C's site database

COMPARATOR	REASON FOR INCLUSION	VALID METRICS	NOT VALID, AND WHY
Operator 6	Acquisitive general practice roll-up with a full E1–E5 ladder; clinic-level add-on data; survivor comp	SSS_CD CLOSE-RETRO (Operator 6 CY2025 vs Deal C CY2025 / LTM Jul-26); ADJ_SHARE; add-on entry and later multiples on clinic-level EBITDA (company-presented)	Clinic-level margin (Operator 6 D1.2 R-UNK vs Deal C D1.2 on R-BOOK, rebates contra-COGS, audited; Part 07 section B); traffic (Deal C working-day and blackout-adjusted company comp, PF, vs D2.5); CONV_1 (Operator 6 E3 vs Deal C E2)
Operator 3	Acquisitive general practice and preventive platform with a full earnings ladder; add-on re-rating series	SSS_CD CLOSE-RETRO; ADJ_SHARE; add-on entry and later multiples	Margins (R-UNK D1.1/D1.2 vs Deal C D1.2 on R-BOOK, D1.1 not verifiable); traffic (company comp vs D2.5); CONV_1 (E3 vs E2)
Operator 2	Acquisitive with greenfields; five-year operating record	ADJ_SHARE (Operator 2 FY2025 compliance basis vs Deal C FY2025)	SSS (Operator 2 SSS_ST-59 undefined); margins (R-UNK)
Operator 8	Acquisitive preventive care and general practice platform with a wide E1–E2–E3 ladder	ADJ_SHARE (TTM Mar-26; E1 where sources differ shown both ways); CONV_1 with company maintenance split [M] on E2 (Operator 8 E2q steady vs Deal C E2 build)	SSS (Operator 8 CLOSE-FWD vs Deal C survivor); margins (R-UNK)
Operator 4	Preventive-care-heavy consolidator with EBITDA printed on E3 to E6 and a programmatic add-on pool re-rated 6.0× → 3.2×	Add-on entry and later multiples (pool aggregate); ADJ_SHARE (LTM Mar-26)	Hospital-level EBITDA margin (R-UNK D1.2-type vs Deal C D1.2 on R-BOOK); SSS (undefined SSS_ST-59); platform multiple (15.2× on E4 synergised)

Source: note C-84 (Deal C rows; OP6-1148, DLC-0985, DLC-0994, OP6-0047, OP6-0054, OP6-0060, DLC-0019, DLC-4425, DLC-4426, OP6-1731, OP6-1733, DLC-3427; OP3-0906, OP3-1127, OP3-2161, OP3-1493, OP3-1494; OP2-4347, OP2-4367, OP2-4426; OP8-1781, OP8-2426, OP8-2409, OP8-0743, OP8-0859, OP8-0744, OP8-0781, DLC-005-000567; OP4-0802, OP4-0806, OP4-0269, OP4-1035, DLC-3428). Operating measures only; the comparators' leverage and the proposed financing are in Part 08 section D

The comparator set, the clinic-margin, same-store, re-rating and cash-share tables, and the deal-cost comparison are in Part 09 section N, under "07 F Against comparable operators: supporting evidence".

G · Sensitivities and requests

The 2026 same-store trend, the deal-cost rate, the affiliate bonuses and the overhead path move Deal C's earnings most; the Accounting Firm 1 QoE, the bonus agreements and August–September 2026 trading would most change a reading.

What holds. Each sensitivity is set against a range observed at Deal C or its peers, and one of the largest has a contractual answer: if the affiliate bonuses ended, FY2025 cash EBITDA would have been about $15.5m rather than $8.3m.

What to watch. At the audited deal-cost rate the model's 2027 acquisition spend would carry $21.7m of deal cost against $6.7m budgeted, and holding the fall in overhead share to the largest observed would add $9.1m a year to the 2030 plan's G&A. The financing sensitivities are in Part 08 section D and Part 08 section E.

Exhibit 7.14 — FY2023 to 2030P: the 2026 same-store trend, the deal-cost rate, the affiliate bonuses and the overhead path move Deal C's earnings most; each is set against an observed range

Business sensitivities of Deal C's earnings, each against the range observed in this part or at peers, $m and %; FY2023 to the sponsor's 2030 plan; site database, 2025 audit, sponsor model

NO.	SENSITIVITY	OBSERVED RANGE (SOURCE)	DEAL C VALUE (SOURCE)	EFFECT ON THE RANGE [I]	SHOWN IN
S1	Same-store trajectory	Common-definition same-store sales from +4.5% (CY2025) to −3.2% (Q2-26); Operator 6, Operator 3 and Deal B +1.9% to +5.1% in 2025 (Deal B +5.1% with closed clinics dropped, as for Deal C; +4.7% with closed clinics carried forward; DLC-0985; DLC-1022; Exhibit 9.147)	Same-store clinic EBITDA +1.0% (CY2025) and −5.8% (LTM Jul-26) (DLC-0987; DLC-0996)	The 55 clinics owned before 2025 earned $15.0m in Jan–Jul 2026 against $17.3m a year earlier (−8.79%) on revenue down 1.8% (DLC-1188/1191; DLC-1186/1189)	Part 07 section B
S2	Deal-cost rate on the acquisition plan	8.8–10.1% of acquisition spend in the sponsor's 2027–30 plan; 13.2% ex affiliate bonuses and 31.2% audited in FY2025; peers 1.5–14.1% (DLC-1481..1484; DLC-0199; DLC-0009; note C-56)	Model 2027 acquisition spend $58.6m; $6.7m of deal cost budgeted (DLC-1844/1848; DLC-1481)	$9.0m of deal cost at 13.2%; $21.7m at 31.2%	Part 07 section D, Part 07 section F
S3	Affiliate transaction bonuses	Peers' cash EBITDA 0.24–0.83 of the top rung, median 0.73 (note C-61)	FY2025 D3 cash EBITDA $8.3m, 0.31 of E3; bonuses $7.12m (DLC-4437; DLC-0199)	About $15.5m, 0.59 of E3, if the bonuses end (approximate)	Part 07 section D
S4	Overhead path	Largest fall in overhead share at any platform while scaling: 1.1 points (Exhibit 3.11)	G&A 7.3% of revenue for LTM Apr-26, 4.8% in the 2030 M&A case; 2030 beachhead plus corporate G&A $31.1m (DLC-1408..1411; DLC-1417..1420; DLC-1288; DLC-1289; DLC-1416/1425/1294)	Holding the fall to 1.1 points (6.2% of revenue) adds $9.1m a year to 2030 beachhead plus corporate G&A	Part 07 section E
S5	Acquired-clinic uplift	Sponsor headline 594bp; matched sites −522bp to +794bp by cohort (DLC-3394; DLC-1202; DLC-1210)	+145bp pooled for the 2023–25 cohorts; acquired clinics 0.93x entry EBITDA against 1.15–1.63x at peers (DLC-1234; DLC-3427/3428)	Most of the gross-margin gain (+591bp pooled) does not reach clinic EBITDA	Part 07 section C, Part 07 section F
S6	Rebates and rent in the margin	Rebates 1.0–1.32% of gross sales in adjacent periods (DLC-3735/3736); related-party rent 36.9% of lease cost on 32 of 88 clinics (DLC-0195)	Audited FY2025 clinic margin 21.3% on book rent, 22.3% on cash rent, after rebates (DLC-0018; DLC-5013/5014)	Total-level margin before rebates, on cash rent, about 21.0–21.6% if FY2025 rebates lay in that range; the market-rent effect cannot be measured without a rent roll	Part 07 section B

Source: Rows as listed in each cell; the sections of this part named in the last column. Sensitivities of the proposed financing are in Part 08 section D and Part 08 section E · Basis: Deal C values A (audit) or PF (site database) as in the sections cited; the sponsor's plan is P; the effect column is our computation [I], shown where the section computes it · Assumption: Alternative parameters are those stated in the sections cited: the ex-bonus deal-cost rate, the largest observed fall in overhead share and the rebate range the company states for adjacent periods

The requests that would most change a reading. The Accounting Firm 1 quality-of-earnings report (request 1), without which the underwriting half of ST3 cannot move; the affiliate-bonus agreements and whether they end (request 2), which decide the cash half of ST3; August–September 2026 same-store sales and clinic EBITDA on the common definition (request 6), for ST1; a clinic rent roll and FY2025 rebate dollars (requests 8 and 9), for a pre-rebate, cash-rent placement; and the basis of each buy-down multiple (request 10), for ST2.

Information requests

Items marked *Outstanding* have been requested and have not yet been received in full. All items are for the company and its bankers, through Ares Credit Group.

Highest priority

1. *Outstanding.* The full Accounting Firm 1 sell-side QoE with a bring-down to September 2026.
2. The affiliate transaction bonuses: recipients, agreements, per-deal formula, 2026 accruals, whether the accrued deferred transaction expenses and bonuses — about $7.0m in the company's financial model at September 2026 (Three Statement Model, cell BR96) — are paid at close, and whether the bonuses continue after close; the post-close affiliate and management-fee contracts; and the unredacted audit p.28 EBITDA schedule, including 'EBITDA of closed business unit'.
3. A costed budget with and without acquisitions, including the G&A path by year, the acquisition funding plan, and any sponsor or banker downside cases (the model has no downside case).
4. A current clinic list with street address, brand, opening or acquisition date and status, including every State 20 clinic, reconciled to the 86 clinics in the site database.

5. The rebranding schedule by brand and clinic: clinics converted, clinics remaining, cost per clinic spent and budgeted, and the systems live at each clinic; and how rebranding and integration costs, past and still to come, are treated in adjusted and pro forma EBITDA and in the capital budget.

Next priority

6. *Outstanding.* Monthly management accounts and KPIs for May–September 2026, and August–September same-store sales and same-store clinic EBITDA on the common definition (owned and open thirteen months, calendar months, no seller data), including any tuck-ins closed in September.
7. *Outstanding.* Site-month visit counts, patient invoices and average invoice per visit for the comp base, including shelter and rescue accounts and closed clinics.
8. A clinic rent roll with cash rent, and the terms of the related-party leases (32 of 88 clinics) against market; and a bridge from the model's '4-Wall EBITDA' to the site database's 'Clinic-Level EBITDA', with the rent basis of each.
9. FY2025 vendor rebate dollars and their allocation by clinic, split by buying group or supplier programme (Pet Retailer 4, Animal Health Manufacturer 1 and others) with the agreements behind them; and the rebates and marketing support received under each programme by brand for FY2024 to the latest twelve months, with the conditions attached.
10. For each acquisition, the basis of the buy-down multiple — including seller P&Ls showing rent on owned property — and support for the pre-acquisition, LOI-clinic and brownfield add-backs.
11. The wellness-plan terms in force at each brand and the date each took effect; plan services delivered by brand for FY2024 to the latest twelve months; any deferred-revenue reserve held and how it is set; and who pays for care beyond the plan (the buying group, a plan administrator or the company).
12. Marketing spend by brand and channel (paid search, paid social, call tracking, other) for FY2024 to the latest twelve months, with any part treated as an adjustment to EBITDA.
13. Supplier price changes attributed to manufacturer list-price increases since January 2025, by supplier and date; and any rebate true-up, supplier credit or price reduction linked to a credit received in 2026, by month, showing where it is recorded in cost of sales and in adjusted and pro forma EBITDA.
14. For each acquisition, the full capital put into it: purchase price, deal costs, integration and rebranding spend and capital spent after close, net of any sale-leaseback proceeds.
15. Dated price actions — each change to exam and procedure fees and to the pricing matrix, with its date — with category margin and repeat-client data before and after each.

If readily available

16. *Outstanding.* The FY23 audited statements.
17. A reconciliation of transaction expense between the audit and the QoE ($9.1m against $13.8m for FY2024), with transaction-cost detail by year; matched 21-month cohort data including brownfields; cash taxes; and veterinarian separations on one definition, including involuntary and sub-90-day exits, with veterinarian headcount, turnover and average hourly pay by brand and year from acquisition.
18. Customer rating and review count by clinic on one site and one date, the source of any group-wide rating the company uses, and the complaint and refund log by clinic.

The fuller account of the sensitivities is in Part 09 section N, under "07 G Sensitivities and requests: supporting evidence".

Part 08 — Financing observations

Each proposed multiple holds only on one earnings measure and one definition of debt; at Deal A the recapitalisation model of 29 September repays supplier finance at close and the leverage covenant has room, while liquidity is the tighter test; funding at Deal B is tested before leverage, and at Deal C Option Two's fixed-charge cover on cash EBITDA is below 1.0x

Ares Credit Group asked. The leverage lines of Ares Credit Group's three theses: Deal A's scale and diversity make it compelling at a low leverage multiple; for Deal B, Ares Credit Group is considering a low-leverage, high-priced financing with upside; for Deal C, the leverage requested is 5.3x. This part sets out observations for Ares Credit Group's own underwriting; it makes no recommendation on quantum, pricing or structure.

On the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026, Deal A's $254m of funded debt is 3.51x gross first lien on the model's LTM 2Q27F EBITDA of $67.2m and the lease-adjusted covenant ratio peaks at 5.68x against 6.35x; with the company's closure cash and a $2.9m net closure benefit, minimum liquidity is $33.3m against a $21m minimum, and a 4.05% EBITDA shortfall takes it below. Deal B's $55m term loan reads 4.08x, and 7.59x with the HoldCo note, on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m of EBITDA, with fixed-charge cover of 0.70x on that figure (0.93x on the borrower's $14.77m) and the near-term acquisition batch $8.8–11.8m short of committed sources. Deal C's Option Two first lien is 5.96x gross on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m against 3.81–5.10x for the Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4 prints of 2025–26 on the same earnings measure (Operator 7 2026 proposal, at 2.25x, sits below).

The Deal A results come from a CreditSwan overlay on the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026 (v06): the company's $21.79m of closure cash spread over the remaining lease terms and $4.3m of fees, funded on the revolver, with a net closure benefit of $2.9m a year in the lead case, read at quarter-ends against the $21m minimum of the 21 September term sheet, which the model does not test. No term sheet later than 21 September is in the files. Every leverage print names its earnings measure and the debt it counts.

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED
A-12	Every multiple states its earnings measure and the debt it counts	Leverage from first-lien funded debt up to all debt with leases and supplier finance; multiples marked standalone or synergised
A-03	EBITDA is kept on named levels	Reported, adjusted, pro forma, run-rate, underwriting and cash EBITDA (pro forma less "one-time" costs that recur)
A-F11	Operating case on the recapitalisation model	The model of 29 September as it stands: scenario 3, downside on, closure scenario off
A-F12	Closure cash and fees on the recapitalisation model	$21.79m over 42.1 months from April 2027 and $4.3m of fees in the June 2027 quarter, funded on the revolver
A-F13	Net closure benefit in the lead case	$2.9m a year from April 2027 (clinic EBITDA including co-op, operating leases run to term)
A-F10	Refinancing need	Bank debt at September 2030 less cash above a $13m reserve

Exhibit 8.01 — On the evidence to October 2026, three financing readings are contradicted in whole or in part and one rests on missing terms; at Deal A the recapitalisation model repays supplier finance at close and liquidity is the tighter test, funding at Deal B is tested before the leverage covenant, and at Deal C Option Two's fixed-charge cover on cash EBITDA is below 1.0x

Our reading on the financing component of each thesis (M5, MS6, ST4 Option Two and Option One), with the depth of the evidence and what would change it; audited figures to FY26, models and term documents of September 2026

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
Deal A: its scale and diversity make it compelling at a low leverage multiple (M5)	**Contradicted** as "resilient at low leverage"; **partially supported** as a sale-bridged loan. On the recapitalisation model of 29 September the $254m of funded debt is 3.51x gross first lien on the model's LTM 2Q27F EBITDA of $67.2m, and supplier finance is repaid at close; the leverage covenant peaks at 5.68x against 6.35x. With the company's closure cash and a $2.9m net closure benefit, minimum liquidity is $33.3m against a $21m minimum (March 2029), and a 4.05% EBITDA shortfall takes it below; the model's own fixed-charge cover is 0.76–1.03x from March 2027 to FY31 (Part 08 section B).	Audited FY26 accounts and the June 2026 quarter (actual); the recapitalisation model of 29 September (projected), with a CreditSwan overlay for the company's closure cash and three closure-benefit cases; the 21 September term sheet, the only term sheet in the files.	July–September 2026 actuals; a term sheet on the model's structure, with its fixed-charge cover and liquidity tests; the closure cash budget and lease-exit plan; a third-party valuation of the owned real estate

ARES CREDIT GROUP ASKED	OUR ANSWER IN BRIEF	EVIDENCE BEHIND IT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
Deal B: a low-levered, high-priced deal with upside (MS6)	**Contradicted** — on trailing leverage, cover and funding. On Ares Credit Group's $11.16m of EBITDA for the twelve months to July 2026 the $55m term loan reads 4.08x first lien, inside the 2.25–5.10x of the four 2025–26 first-lien prints on the same measure, and 7.59x with the HoldCo note, above every peer print that includes holding-company or sponsor notes (5.4–7.2x); fixed-charge cover computes at 0.61x on that EBITDA and 0.93x on the borrower's $14.77m; the pricing is high (S+5.55%, equal to the widest spread in the 2025–26 set), and the near-term acquisition batch is $8.8–11.8m short of committed sources (Part 08 section C).	Ares Credit Group's response to the borrower's financing grid (19 September 2026) and the borrower's and Ares Credit Group's financing models (projected); post-audit earnings to July 2026 (pro forma); peer leverage prints from six core operators and cover prints from three, on mixed definitions.	The agreed closing EBITDA and the measure it is struck on; cash at close; executed HoldCo terms; a sources-and-uses for the acquisition batch
Deal C: the leverage requested is 5.3x (ST4, Option Two)	**Contradicted.** The $204.3m first lien is 5.96x gross on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m, against 3.81–5.10x for the Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4 prints of 2025–26 on the same earnings measure (Operator 7 2.25x proposal sits below); fixed-charge cover computes at 0.77x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back ($24.9m; $23.2m as printed), and at the 4.3x median the debt refinances only with at least 1.57% a year of EBITDA growth, against same-store clinic EBITDA of +1.0% for 2025 and −5.8% for the twelve months to July 2026 (Part 08 section D).	Ares Credit Group's Early Read Memo v19 and Internal Diligence Exhibits (projected, including forecast and pre-acquisition months); the FY2025 audit (actual); first-lien prints from six operators, 2014 to 2026; a six-year refinancing calculation on stated anchors.	The Accounting Firm 1 quality-of-earnings report; the affiliate-bonus agreements; August–September 2026 same-store EBITDA against the 1.57% threshold
Deal C: the leverage requested is 5.3x (ST4, Option One)	**Insufficient evidence** — sponsor-instrument terms missing. The $176.0m first lien is 5.30x gross on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m, above the 3.81–5.10x of the Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4 prints; on a path with no acquisitions the senior loan refinances at the 4.3x median on flat earnings; a 17% cash coupon on the $21m sponsor instrument turns that into a $2.3m gap, and the $70m delayed-draw loan drawn at the audited deal-cost rate leaves total debt, including the sponsor instrument, $8.0m short (Part 08 section D).	As for Option Two; the sponsor instrument's coupon, maturity, ranking and cash-pay terms are not in the documents supplied.	The sponsor instrument's coupon, maturity, ranking and cash-pay terms

Source: Part 08 section B, Part 08 section C and Part 08 section D · Basis: Leverage on reported (A) and underwriting (P or PF) earnings as named; liquidity and refinancing from models (P)

A · Scope and readings

Each proposed multiple holds only on one EBITDA and debt perimeter: Deal A's $254m of funded debt on the recapitalisation model of 29 September reads 3.51x first lien on the model's LTM 2Q27F EBITDA and peaks at 5.68x on the lease-adjusted covenant; liquidity at Deal A and funding at Deal B are tested before leverage, and at Deal C Option Two's cash cover is below 1.0x.

This part holds CreditSwan's observations on the three proposed financings, for Ares Credit Group's own underwriting; the financing judgement is Ares Credit Group's, and nothing here is a recommendation on quantum, pricing or structure. The labels use the rubric of Part 01 section B.

What holds. At Deal A the recapitalisation model repays supplier finance at close, and first-lien leverage of 3.93x sits below Operator 6's 3.81x, Operator 3's 4.70x and Operator 4's 5.10x on the same rung (Operator 7 2.25x proposal sits below it). Deal B's term loan alone, 4.08x on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m, is inside that set, and its pricing is high.

What to watch. Each multiple moves with the earnings measure and the debt counted, and at none of the three deals is the leverage covenant the first constraint: at Deal A it is liquidity, at Deal B funding of the near-term batch, at Deal C cash cover and the growth the refinancing needs (Part 08 section E).

Exhibit 8.02 — Readings on the three proposed financings (to October 2026): Deal A's $254m on the recapitalisation model is 3.51x first lien and peaks at 5.68x on the lease-adjusted covenant, Deal B's stack reads 7.59x, and Deal C's 5.96x first lien sits above every 2025–26 same-rung print

Reading label, basis, what holds, what does not and what would change it, for the financing component of each deal; leverage x, amounts $m; evidence supplied to 1 October 2026

DEAL	THESIS COMPONENT	OUR READING ON THE EVIDENCE SUPPLIED TO DATE	BASIS	WHAT HOLDS	WHAT DOES NOT	WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT
Deal A	M5 · Low-leverage financing is resilient	**Contradicted** as "resilient at low leverage"; **partially supported** as a sale-bridged loan	On the recapitalisation model of 29 September: $254m of funded debt, 3.51x gross and 2.80x net first lien on LTM 2Q27F EBITDA of $67.2m (P); adjusted gross debt ÷ EBITDAR peaks at 5.68x against 6.35x; with the workbook's closure cash and a $2.9m net benefit minimum liquidity is $33.3m against $21m, breached at a 4.05% EBITDA shortfall; the model's fixed-charge cover is 0.76–1.03x from March 2027 to FY31; at 4.3x the lead-case need of $257.8m is covered on reported LTM EBITDA (+$34.2m) and not on FY26 (−$8.6m) or on the model's LTM 2Q27F (−$33.9m) (Part 08 section B)	Supplier finance is repaid at close; first-lien leverage of 3.93x sits below Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4 on the same rung; the leverage covenant is never within 1.0x of 7.50x; liquidity clears the $21m minimum by $12.4m in the lead case; Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update states that the sale process has been launched	A 4.05% EBITDA shortfall takes liquidity below $21m in the lead case, and 1.6% with no closure benefit; closure cash paid inside four quarters takes it to $19.5m ($15.1m with no benefit); the model's fixed-charge cover is below 1.0x from March 2027 to March 2028; at maturity the debt does not refinance at 4.3x on FY26 or on the model's own closing EBITDA	July–September 2026 actuals; a term sheet on the model's structure, with the fixed-charge cover and liquidity tests; the closure cash budget and lease-exit plan; a third-party valuation of the owned real estate, including the 26 sale-leaseback sites
Deal B	MS6 · Low leverage, pricing and upside compensate	**Contradicted** — on trailing leverage, cover and funding	4.08x first lien and 7.59x with the HoldCo note on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m (term loan $55m); fixed-charge cover 0.61x on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m and 0.93x on the borrower's $14.77m (peer cover prints are on other definitions and are not set against these); S+5.55% equal to the widest spread in the set; batch short $8.8–11.8m (Part 08 section C)	First-lien leverage on the term loan alone is inside the 2.25–5.10x of the 2025–26 same-rung prints on every underwriting denominator (4.08x on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m) and reads 2.9–3.3x on the borrower's forward or pro forma bases; the pricing is high, S+5.55%, equal to the widest spread in the 2025–26 set, with 1.8–2.2% warrants	With the $36.9m HoldCo note the stack reads 7.59x, above every peer print that includes holding-company or sponsor notes (5.4–7.2x); fixed-charge cover computes at 0.61x on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m and 0.93x on the borrower's $14.77m; the warrants are worth about $0.4–2.1m against $93.4m of commitments; the near-term batch is $8.8–11.8m short of committed sources	The agreed closing EBITDA and rung; cash at close; executed HoldCo terms; a sources-and-uses for the batch
Deal C	ST4 · 5.3x leverage is supportable — Option Two	**Contradicted**	5.96x gross first lien on Ares Credit Group's underwriting EBITDA against 3.81–5.10x; fixed-charge cover computes at 0.77x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA (0.22x on cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs); refinances at the 4.3x median only with at least 1.57% a year of EBITDA growth, against +1.0% and −5.8% observed (Part 08 section D)	Cover computes at 0.96x on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m and 1.08x on the sponsor's $32.3m; with at least 1.57% a year of EBITDA growth on $29.4m Option Two refinances at the 4.3x median	The 5.96x gross first lien is above every 2025–26 print on the same rung (3.81–5.10x at Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4; 2.25x at Operator 7); cover is 0.77x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back ($24.9m), against cash breakeven EBITDA of $26.0m; same-store clinic EBITDA grew +1.0% in 2025 and −5.8% for LTM July 2026, below the growth the refinancing needs	The Accounting Firm 1 QoE; the affiliate-bonus agreements; August–September same-store EBITDA against the 1.57% threshold
Deal C	ST4 · 5.3x leverage is supportable — Option One	**Insufficient evidence** — sponsor-instrument terms missing	5.30x gross first lien, outside the 3.81–5.10x band; 5.76x net incl. sponsor debt; debt service untestable without the sponsor terms; the refinancing result reverses with a 17% cash coupon (senior tranche) or a drawn delayed-draw loan (total debt) (Part 08 section D)	Cover computes at 1.00x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back ($24.9m) and 1.23x on $29.4m (term loan only, at S+451); on a no-acquisition path the senior tranche refinances at the 4.3x median on flat $29.4m	The 5.30x gross first lien sits above every 2025–26 print on the same rung (3.81–5.10x at Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4; 2.25x at Operator 7); the $21m sponsor instrument's coupon, maturity, ranking and cash-pay terms are not in the files; a 17% cash coupon on it reverses the senior result, and the delayed-draw loan drawn at the audited deal-cost rate leaves total debt short	The sponsor instrument's coupon, maturity, ranking and cash-pay terms

Source: Leverage from first-lien funded debt to all debt with leases and supply-chain finance, and cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs, are defined in Part 09 section C · Basis: Figures as set out, with their references and bases (A, PF, P), in Part 08 section B, Part 08 section C and Part 08 section D

The full scope note, the same-rung print set, the deal-by-deal observations (Deal A's on the 21 September term sheet and Ares Credit Group's model v24) and the reading of the same debt across rungs are in Part 09 section O, under "08 A Scope and readings: supporting evidence".

B · Deal A financing

On the recapitalisation model of 29 September the leverage covenant holds with room (5.68x peak against 6.35x) and liquidity is the tighter test: with the company's closure cash and a $2.9m net closure benefit, minimum liquidity is $33.3m (March 2029), $12.4m above the $21m minimum, and a 4.05% EBITDA shortfall takes it below; at 4.3x in September 2030 the debt refinances on reported LTM EBITDA, not on FY26 EBITDA.

What holds. The recapitalisation model of 29 September repays the $145m of supplier finance at close, which removes the supplier-finance unwind, the main unresolved point of the 21 September term sheet, and replaces the delayed-draw loan with a $218m term loan beside a $111m revolver ($44m drawn). First-lien leverage is 3.51x gross and 2.80x net on the model's LTM 2Q27F EBITDA of $67.2m (P), and the leverage covenant peaks at 5.68x against 6.35x.

What to watch. The model carries no closure cash and does not test the $21m liquidity minimum. With the workbook's $21.79m of closure cash, $4.3m of fees and a $2.9m net benefit, minimum liquidity is $33.3m; paid inside four quarters, the closure cash takes it to $19.5m ($15.1m with no benefit). The model's own fixed-charge cover is 0.76–1.03x from March 2027 to FY31.

Exhibit 8.03 — On the recapitalisation model of 29 September, with the company's closure cash and a $2.9m net benefit, minimum liquidity is $33.3m (March 2029), $12.4m above the $21m minimum, and a uniform 4.05% EBITDA shortfall takes it below; with no benefit it is $27.1m, and with the closure cash paid inside four quarters it falls to $19.5m ($15.1m with no benefit)

Minimum quarter-end liquidity net of letters of credit, $m, and its quarter, December 2026 to March 2031, by case (C1 to C7, numbered as in the text); CreditSwan overlay on the recapitalisation model v06

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Alpha Recapitalization Model 1755.46.29 v06 (DLA-026), Draw Schedule Summary row 60 (liquidity net of LCs), rows 14 and 21, FY27-FY31 Covenants row 85; FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027) Summary!J43; Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24 (DLA-024) MODEL OUTPUT!F21 (fees); note C-V2-4 · Basis: Projected (P) [I] on the v06 projection. Closure cash and fees funded on the revolver at SOFR + 3.26%; quarter-end points (v06 is quarterly); no tax effect and no sweep interaction. The $21m is the 21 September term sheet's minimum average daily liquidity: v06 does not test it. v06 carries neither closure cash nor closure benefit · Assumption: A-F11, A-F12, A-F13, A-F14

Exhibit 8.04 — Liquidity is the tighter test: in the lead case it bottoms at $33.3m in March 2029 and rebuilds from FY30, while the leverage ratio peaks at 5.68x in March 2027 against 6.35x and falls as the plan's EBITDA grows; with no benefit and a 9% EBITDA shortfall it peaks at 5.58x

Left: liquidity net of letters of credit, quarter-end, $m, December 2026 to March 2031. Right: adjusted gross debt ÷ EBITDAR at each test date, March 2027 to March 2031; recapitalisation model v06 with the CreditSwan overlay

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Alpha Recapitalization Model 1755.46.29 v06 (DLA-026), Draw Schedule Summary row 60; FY27-FY31 Covenants rows 62, 55, 57 (C67≤6.35x); FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027); notes C-V2-4 and C-V2-5 · Basis: Projected (P) [I]. Overlay funding added to v06's adjusted gross debt; the 9% shortfall is applied to the overlay quarters from December 2026. v06's Covenants tab shows a flat 6.35x; its Draw Schedule Summary lists 6.35x / 6.13x / 5.91x / 5.95x / 5.81x (row 101); against the 6.13x step from June 2027 the C5 margin is 0.67x · Assumption: A-F11, A-F12, A-F13, A-F14

Exhibit 8.05 — At 4.3x in September 2030 the lead case's $257.8m refinancing need is covered on the plan's EBITDA and on reported LTM EBITDA (+$34.2m), and falls short on FY26 reported EBITDA (−$8.6m) and on the model's own closing EBITDA (−$33.9m), with EBITDA held at each level

Surplus or shortfall of refinancing capacity at 4.3x EBITDA, after about $112.3m of finance leases, against the bank debt and overlay funding outstanding at 30 September 2030, $m, by EBITDA anchor and case

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Alpha Recapitalization Model 1755.46.29 v06 (DLA-026): Debt Schedule!AE60 (term loan), AE34 (revolver), DSS!Y54 (cash), BS Annual rows 25 and 33 (finance leases), PF Cap Structure!U8; Deal A FY26 10-K and Q1 FY27 10-Q for the actual rungs; note C-V2-5 · Basis: Projected need (P) [I]; anchors actual (A), pro forma (PF) or projected (P) as marked. Need = term loan $199.25m + revolver $43.6m + overlay funding − cash above a $13m reserve. 4.3x is the median of closed first-lien prints (Part 04 section B); at 3.81x every actual rung falls short in the three cases shown · Assumption: A-F10, A-F12

Exhibit 8.06 — The recapitalisation model of 29 September keeps $336m of commitments but replaces the delayed-draw loan with a $218m term loan and repays $145m of supplier finance at close: funded debt is $254m, 3.51x gross on the model's LTM 2Q27F EBITDA, against $152m and 1.9x in Ares Credit Group's model of September

Main terms of the LW draft term sheet of 21 September 2026 (with Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24) against the recapitalisation model v06 of 29 September 2026, scenario 3

TERM	LW DRAFT TERM SHEET, 21 SEPTEMBER 2026	RECAPITALISATION MODEL V06, 29 SEPTEMBER 2026
Commitments	$336m: $111m super-senior revolver, $111m term loan, $111m delayed-draw term loan	$336m: $111m revolver, $218m term loan; no delayed-draw loan
Drawn at close	Revolver $44m deemed drawn; term loan $111m; Ares Credit Group's model v24: $152m of bank debt	Revolver $44m (minimum draw $44m); term loan $218m; total debt $254.5m
Supplier finance	Unwound over 15 months through the delayed-draw loan, subject to a 5.15x draw test	$145m repaid at close; the remaining Lender 6 line winds down over six months
Pricing and fees	S+5.26% term facilities; S+3.26% revolver, 21bp grid	S+5.26% term loan, 1% amortisation, 2% fee; S+3.26% revolver, 0.44% unused fee, 2% fee
Sweeps	67% of excess cash flow	67% of excess cash flow; 100% of asset-sale proceeds
Leverage at close	1.9x first lien on Ares Credit Group's $71.7m (LTM Sep-26, including a forecast quarter)	3.51x gross, 2.80x net on LTM 2Q27F EBITDA of $64.45m
Leverage covenant	Lease-adjusted net leverage, 6.35x stepping to 5.81x	Adjusted gross debt ÷ EBITDAR against a flat 6.35x on the Covenants tab (step-downs listed elsewhere in the model); peak 5.68x, March 2027
Minimum liquidity	$21.5m of average daily liquidity, tested quarterly	$21m input not referenced by any formula
Fixed-charge cover	No maintenance test	Labelled "≥1.08"; computes 0.76–1.03x from March 2027 to FY31
Second-round closures	Ares Credit Group's model v24: $12m benefit from April 2027; $4.3m of closure cash and $4.3m of fees	Closure scenario off: no benefit and no closure cash
December 2026 dividend	$7.4m permitted outside the payment conditions	$7.41m paid
Close and maturity	Calendar dates, not mapped to Deal A's fiscal quarters	Close 14 October 2026; maturity 30 September 2030 on the drivers tab, 31 October 2030 on the capital-structure tab

Source: LW draft term sheet, 21 September 2026 (DLA-023); Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24 (DLA-024); Project Alpha Recapitalization Model 1755.46.29 v06 (DLA-026): Scenario Drivers!E9, E13, E15, G23, G31, G36, G62:G92, G77; Sources & Uses rows 10–20, I19; PF Cap Structure!E11, E13, O15, P15, P18, U8; Covenants!C65, C67, C144; Draw Schedule Summary!J39, row 101 · Basis: Terms as each document states them [F]; leverage on projected EBITDA (P). No term sheet later than 21 September 2026 is in the files, so the right-hand column gives the model's terms

Liquidity. Seven cases are shown, each with a number (C1 to C7) and the name the exhibits use. C6, the lead case ($2.9m net closure benefit), pays the workbook's closure cash as the leases run and adds the net benefit of the second round on clinic EBITDA including co-op with operating leases run to term (Part 05 section D): $33.3m at its low in March 2029, below $21m at a uniform 4.05% EBITDA shortfall. Beside it, C2 (no closure benefit) has a minimum of $27.1m (below $21m at 1.6%), and C4 (management's $12m benefit) $37.0m (11.9%), like for like with the $36.6m on Ares Credit Group's model v24 and the 21 September term sheet (Part 09 section O). C1 (as modelled) has a minimum of $40.6m in June 2027. With the closure cash paid inside four quarters, the minimum is $15.1m with no benefit (C3) and $19.5m with the lead case's benefit (C7); with no benefit and a 9% EBITDA shortfall (C5) liquidity falls below $21m from March 2028 and below zero from December 2029, reaching −$14.1m by March 2031 [I, note C-V2-4; DLA-026 Draw Schedule Summary row 60].

Leverage and cover. The model computes the covenant as adjusted gross debt ÷ EBITDAR: 5.68x at March 2027 and 5.41x at June 2027 in the lead case, 5.58x and 5.52x in C5 (no benefit, 9% shortfall), against the flat 6.35x on its Covenants tab; its Draw Schedule Summary lists step-downs from 6.35x to 5.81x, and against the 6.13x step from June 2027 the margin in the shortfall case is 0.67x [F/I, DLA-026 Covenants!J67, C67; DSS row 101]. On audited earnings the $254m reads 3.14x FY26 reported EBITDA and 3.71x LTM June 2026 EBITDA without disposal gains [I]. Fixed-charge cover, labelled "≥1.08", computes at 0.93x in December 2026 and 0.76–0.79x through March 2028 [F, DLA-026 Covenants!I144:N144].

Refinancing. At maturity on 30 September 2030 the lead case needs $257.8m: at 4.3x it is covered on reported LTM June 2026 EBITDA (+$34.2m) and on company non-GAAP EBITDA for the twelve months to June 2026 (+$8.5m), and falls short on FY26 reported EBITDA (−$8.6m), on the model's LTM 2Q27F (−$33.9m) and without disposal gains (−$64.6m); at the 3.81x floor every actual rung falls short [I, note C-V2-5].

Collateral and the sale-leaseback. Recovery rests largely on owned real estate, carried at $154.4m in Ares Credit Group's collateral analysis (June 2026), the company's estimate built on tax-assessed values; no third-party appraisal covers it [A, DLA-3500; Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update p.36]. The sale-leaseback proposal in the files (Project Charlie) would sell 26 owned sites, valued by Real Estate Advisor 1 at $44.4–46.9m, for $3.44m of year-one rent rising 2.2% a year, covered 1.23x by site EBITDA; 14 of the sites lost money in FY26 (Exhibit 9.151) [M, DLA-029]. Proceeds at the low value applied to the term loan under the 100% asset-sale sweep would take gross leverage on LTM 2Q27F EBITDA after the new rent from 3.51x to 3.06x, and would remove these sites from the real estate behind recovery [I]. The model carries no sale-leaseback line.

Points to confirm in the model. The $21m minimum liquidity input is not referenced by any formula; the first of the three downside inputs on the drivers tab ($3.0m) is applied as $0.8m in the monthly P&L; the covenant tab hard-codes LTM EBITDA of $79.5m, $75.9m and $69.8m for June, September and December 2026 against the model's own $64.5m at December 2026; maturity is 30 September 2030 on the drivers tab and 31 October 2030 on the capital-structure tab; and the closure scenario is off [F, DLA-026 Scenario Drivers!G31:G34, G77; FY27 P&L - Monthly row 127; Covenants!G85:I85; DSS!J106; PF Cap Structure!E11]. No term sheet later than 21 September 2026 is in the files; terms not in that term sheet are taken from the model, and Part 08 section F reads the term-sheet observations against it.

Information that would sharpen these observations

1. A term sheet on the structure of the recapitalisation model of 29 September, including whether a fixed-charge cover covenant (labelled 1.08x in the model) and the $21m minimum liquidity are intended, and the leverage step-down schedule.
2. The points to confirm in the model above: the downside link, the maturity date, the step-downs and the hard-coded LTM EBITDA.
3. The closure cash budget by quarter, with the leases the company expects to exit or assign and those it expects to carry to term (Part 05 section G, requests 5 and 23).
4. The sale-leaseback site list against the owned-real-estate tape, the use of proceeds and the timing; and any third-party appraisal of the owned sites.
5. The revolver and supplier-finance balances expected at closing, by bank, reconciled to the 10-Q ($94.1m revolver and $183.9m supplier finance at June 2026), and how the $145m to be repaid at close was set.
6. *Outstanding.* Sale-process status, the buyer list, any executable sale or refinancing evidence and the Board's decision on route; and the Board's intention on the quarterly dividend ($7.41m in December 2026 in the model).

The analysis on the 21 September term sheet and Ares Credit Group's model v24 (structure, leverage ladder, draw mechanics, liquidity and refinancing cases, collateral, the sale path and the public filings) is in Part 09 section O, under "08 B Deal A financing: supporting evidence".

C · Deal B financing

On Ares Credit Group's $11.16m LTM July 2026 EBITDA the $55m term loan reads 4.08x, and 7.59x with the HoldCo note; fixed-charge cover is 0.61x on that EBITDA, 0.93x on the borrower's $14.77m; the near-term batch is $8.8–11.8m short of committed sources.

What holds. First-lien leverage on the term loan alone, 4.08x on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m, is inside the 2.25–5.10x of the 2025–26 same-rung prints and reads 2.9–3.3x on the borrower's forward or pro forma bases. The pricing is high: S+5.55% equals the widest spread in the 2025–26 set, with 1.8–2.2% warrants.

What to watch. With the $36.9m HoldCo note, which accrues at 15% PIK, the stack reads 7.59x; fixed-charge cover is 0.61x on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m and 0.93x on the borrower's $14.77m. Before the new structure, April–August 2026 adjusted levered free cash flow was –$1.15m, and the near-term batch is $8.8–11.8m short of committed sources.

Exhibit 8.07 — First-lien leverage on the term loan alone sits inside the 2025–26 same-rung band on every underwriting denominator; with the DDTL drawn it reads 6.14x on Ares Credit Group's EBITDA, above the band; the stack including HoldCo is above every peer LV4 print on Ares Credit Group's EBITDA (at close, 30 September 2026, on LTM July 2026, LTM September 2026E and at-close denominators)

Proposed debt at close ÷ EBITDA, x, gross, on six EBITDA denominators; three rungs of debt for each structure

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Ares Credit Group's response to the Proposed Financing Grid (19 September 2026); Ares Credit Group Term Sheet (September 2026); Project Bravo Financing Model (Jul-26 RF); Ares Credit Group variant of the Project Bravo Financing Model (12 September 2026); Operator 7, Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 4, Operator 8 and Operator 1 lender materials. DLB-9234..9491, DLB-5644, DLB-5598, DLB-6300, DLB-5599, OP7-1181, OP6-0031, OP3-1326, OP4-1442, OP8-2367, OP1-10730 · Basis: Every Deal B mark is the proposed structure at close (P). Fill shows the basis of the EBITDA denominator: filled = actual (reported), hollow = pro forma or adjusted, hatched with a dashed connector = a denominator that includes budget months or acquisitions not yet closed. Gross of cash. Peer band: the 2025–26 same-rung set of Part 08 section A, Operator 7 (proposal), Operator 6 (closed, pro forma), Operator 3 (proposal) and Operator 4 (on Lender 1's E5, pro forma). Peer lines: Operator 8 and Operator 1 net, pro forma. Marks with the DDTL drawn use the $52m term loan (on the $55m loan: 6.13x on Ares Credit Group's E5 and 4.69x on $14.77m)

Exhibit 8.08 — Consolidated adjusted cash EBITDA of $7.98m in April–August 2026 left adjusted levered free cash flow of −$1.15m, and −$3.31m after $2.19m of operations EBITDA adjustments

Deal B consolidated: adjusted cash EBITDA to levered free cash flow, $m, five months April to August 2026 (August preliminary)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Bravo Ares Credit Group Diligence Requests (25 September 2026), tab '5. EBITDA to FCF Analysis'. DLB-7850, DLB-7851, DLB-7853..7863 · Basis: Company figures. Subtotals are the company's adjusted measures on cash rent (pro forma, hollow); capex, working capital and debt service are actual cash movements (filled). August 2026 is a preliminary month. The five-month total depends on the window: adjusted levered free cash flow was −$3.98m in April alone and +$2.48m in August. Debt service is cash interest on seller notes and other debt plus non-interest debt service on the existing debt, before the proposed financing

Exhibit 8.09 — At September 2026 the near-term batch needs $47.5m of delayed-draw funding; net of the $26m commitment, the $11.1m revolver and cash against the $4.3m floor, $8.8m is unfunded on Ares Credit Group's model and $11.8m on the borrower's

Funding of the 23-unit near-term batch, $m: need, committed sources and residual shortfall, on the closing cash of each model

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: DLB-6069..6077 (batch and draw); DLB-026 (Ares Credit Group facility terms); DLB-6351 (Ares Credit Group model cash); DLB-5662 (borrower model cash); shortfall: computation note C-FIN-5 · Basis: P (models of a batch not yet closed) · Assumption: $4.3m minimum liquidity held; sale-leaseback proceeds of $12.9m are already inside the $47.5m net need

Exhibit 8.10 — At close the $55m term loan reads 4.08x first lien and 7.59x with the HoldCo note on Ares Credit Group's LTM July 2026 EBITDA: first lien inside the 2.25–5.10x of the 2025–26 same-rung prints, the stack above every peer LV4 print

Proposed debt at close (30 September 2026) ÷ EBITDA, x, gross, for the $55m and $52m term loans on six EBITDA denominators, with the peer comparison on the same rung

DENOMINATOR (RUNG; BASIS; ROW BLOCK)	TL $55M: LV1 / LV3 / LV4	TL $52M: LV1 / LV3 / LV4	PEER COMPARISON ON THE SAME RUNG
E1 LTM Jul-26 $1.22m (A; DLB-9442 / 8012)	39.7x / 47.2x / 74.9x	38.2x / 44.5x / 72.4x	Operator 6 LV1 on E1 as owned 16.59x (OP6-0034); Deal B above
E2 post-audit LTM Jul-26 $8.51m (PF; DLB-9424 / 8196)	5.58x / 6.55x / 10.43x	5.53x / 6.17x / 10.16x	No peer prints first-lien leverage on E2 alone; not placed
E5 Ares Credit Group LTM Jul-26 $11.16m (PF; DLB-9352 / 7904)	4.08x / 4.91x / 7.59x	3.91x / 4.53x / 7.77x	LV1 on E5, 2025–26 same-rung set: Operator 7 2.25x (P), Operator 6 3.81x (PF closed), Operator 3 4.70x (P), Operator 4 5.10x on Lender 1's E5 (PF) (OP7-1181; OP6-0031; OP3-1326; OP4-1442): inside. LV4: Operator 8 5.4–5.68x net (OP8-2819/2452/2367), Operator 1 6.0–7.2x net (OP1-10738/10730): above all
E4 post-audit LTM Jul-26 $13.79m (PF; DLB-9406 / 8010)	3.41x / 3.94x / 6.38x	3.24x / 3.68x / 6.13x	Operator 6 LV1 on buy-side QoE pro forma (E3) 4.84x (OP6-0032): below by 1.6–1.8x
E4 borrower LTM Sep-26E $14.77m (P; DLB-9370 / 8001)	3.28x / 3.71x / 5.99x	2.95x / 3.44x / 5.58x	LV1 on financing EBITDA (E4/E5, the Exhibit 4.09 convention): 2025–26 same-rung set 2.25–5.10x inside; closed first-lien band since 2014 3.81–4.27x below
E5 borrower $16.1m incl. acquisitions (P; DLB-9388 / 8163)	2.84x / 3.30x / 5.39x	2.80x / 3.14x / 5.17x	as above: inside

Source: DLB-026 (Ares Credit Group response to the Proposed Financing Grid); DLB-008 (Financing Model, Jul-26 RF); DLB-9234..9583; peer rows as listed · Basis: P (structure at close); each denominator's basis (A, PF, P) as marked in its row · Assumption: LV1 = term loan; LV3 adds the seller note $5.6m, other debt $0.8m and equipment leases $2.2m; LV4 adds the HoldCo note at $36.9m. Gross of cash. LV6 cannot be computed: no debt-like balances are disclosed (DLB-9584)

The company's responses of 1 October add two cash items. Deferred seller payments of $4.0m in June–August 2026 tie approximately to the diligence workbook ($3,920.0K, on a line that also carries other items) [F, DLB-033 p.8; DLB-028 tab 5 row 42]. The $6.9m of equity contributed in the second quarter of 2026 for working capital is supported only indirectly: member equity rose $6.82m between the March 2026 quality-of-earnings balance sheet and the July 2026 financing model, and total equity and retained earnings in the two do not reconcile [M, DLB-033 p.8; DLB-008 BS!C53; DLB-022]. The company's lease-breakage estimate for the four closure and sale candidates, $2.6m in a mid case and $5.1m in a high case, is in Part 06 section H.

Information that would sharpen these observations

1. The agreed closing EBITDA and its basis: the build-up of the borrower's $16.1m "deemed" figure, with support for each adjustment, and the company's reconciliation of it to its reported and adjusted EBITDA for the twelve months to July 2026.
2. The borrower's financing model run on the grid terms ($55m term loan, $26m DDTL and $11.1m revolver).
3. *Outstanding.* The four-wall EBITDA definition that the site-level covenant and the DDTL draw governor use: book or cash rent, fully pro forma or owned months.
4. *Outstanding.* The HoldCo note agreement (Sponsor 7), the deferral amendment and the cap tables; and, for any growth financing from the same holder, the instrument, the amount committed, the amount drawn to date and how it relates to the HoldCo notes.
5. Any equity commitment from existing investors, and the documentation of the $6.9m contributed in the second quarter of 2026.
6. For DBW, any valuation, indication of interest or sale-process material.

The structure, the leverage rungs, fixed-charge cover, pricing and warrants, the funding of the batch, the financing sensitivities and the public filings are set out in full in Part 09 section O, under "08 C Deal B financing: supporting evidence".

D · Deal C financing

Option Two's 5.96x gross first lien on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m sits above every 2025–26 same-rung print (3.81–5.10x at Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4; Operator 7 2.25x below), covers fixed charges 0.77x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back, and refinances at 4.3x only with at least 1.57% a year of EBITDA growth; Option One turns on sponsor-instrument terms not in the files.

What holds. Option Two's fixed-charge cover computes at 0.96x on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m and 1.08x on the sponsor's $32.3m, and on a no-acquisition path Option One's senior tranche refinances at the 4.3x median on flat $29.4m. Option Two's net loan-to-value at close is 34–44% on observed platform values.

What to watch. Option Two's 5.96x gross first lien is above every 2025–26 print on the same rung; its cover is 0.77x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the impairment added back ($24.9m), below the $26.0m of cash breakeven EBITDA; and at the 4.3x median it refinances only with at least 1.57% a year of EBITDA growth, against same-store clinic EBITDA of +1.0% (2025) and −5.8% (LTM July 2026). Option One's sponsor-instrument terms are not in the files.

Exhibit 8.11 — LTM Apr-26 and LTM Sep-26E: Option Two covers fixed charges above 1.0x only on underwriting EBITDA with forecast and pre-acquisition months; on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA 0.76x as printed (0.77x with the $1.0m impairment added back), after recurring deal costs 0.22x

Fixed-charge cover, x: (EBITDA − maintenance capex − cash tax) ÷ (cash interest + scheduled amortisation), by option and EBITDA measure; cash breakeven EBITDA, $m

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Ares Credit Group Early Read Memo v19 (terms, SOFR 4.19%) and Ares Credit Group Internal Diligence Exhibits (cash-flow bridge); sponsor financial model (maintenance capex 2026E). Rows DLC-4977, DLC-4947, DLC-4952, DLC-4953, DLC-4958, DLC-4959, DLC-4964, DLC-4965, DLC-4970, DLC-4982, DLC-4983, DLC-4945, DLC-4942, DLC-4443, DLC-4002 · Basis: The fill shows the basis of the EBITDA used: hollow = pro forma (LTM Apr-26), hatched = includes forecast months (LTM Sep-26E). Every cover ratio is itself computed on the proposed structure. Option One is on the term loan only, at S+451: the $21m sponsor instrument's coupon, maturity and cash-pay terms are not in the files. The Option One breakeven includes $0.826m of undrawn fees; the Option One cover ratios exclude them. E6 = E3 less recurring transaction, integration and start-up costs · Assumption: Maintenance capex $2.253m (sponsor model 2026E), cash tax $0.3m, 1% scheduled amortisation, SOFR 4.19%; Option Two interest includes undrawn fees on the revolver and DDTL

Exhibit 8.12 — To Sep-32 at the 4.3x median, Option Two on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m leaves an $7.5m gap at +1.0% a year and clears at +1.8%; on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back it still needs more than 4% a year

Refinancing gap at maturity (Sep-32), $m = net debt at maturity − refinancing multiple × year-six EBITDA less 2% fees; a negative number clears; outlined cell = base case

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Six-year deleveraging calculation on the terms in Ares Credit Group Early Read Memo v19. Multiples: Operator 6 Jul-26 close (OP6-0031), Operator 3 Dec-25 proposal (OP3-1326), Operator 4 Mar-26 (OP4-1442), median of closed first-lien prints since 2014. Growth anchors: Deal C same-store clinic EBITDA, CY2025 and LTM Jul-26 (DLC-0987, DLC-0996). Deal-cost rates: FY25 transaction expenses, and the same less affiliate bonuses (DLC-0009, DLC-0199), over total consideration of $32.8m (2025 Audit, Note 3, p.17) · Basis: Every cell is projected. Claret = a gap (shortfall), teal = clears. The $29.4m start includes forecast and pre-acquisition months; the $24.9m start is Ares Credit Group's LTM Apr-26 cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back. The multiples are observed on financing EBITDA, so applying them to the $24.9m path assumes the refinancing lender measures leverage on cash-basis earnings. Growth anchors are clinic-level, before G&A, applied to consolidated EBITDA as a proxy · Assumption: No-acquisition path: $204.3m at SOFR 4.19% + 5.55%, undrawn fees, 1% amortisation, $2.3m maintenance capex, $0.3m tax, $4.3m of stopping and settlement costs in the first ten months. Growth rows other than +1.0% and −5.8% are assumed. Sensitivities are assumed: $70m DDTL drawn at close on term-loan terms with acquired EBITDA leverage-neutral and deal costs at 13.2% or 31.2% of price; $21m sponsor instrument on cash pay at 10% or 17% (its terms are not in the files)

Exhibit 8.13 — At Sep-26 close: on a common rung the request is above every 2025–26 E5 print and every closed first-lien print but one; on audited FY25 earnings the existing debt is already 24.9x

First-lien funded debt ÷ EBITDA, gross, x: prints on financing EBITDA (2014 to 2026) and the same debt across EBITDA measures

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Ares Credit Group Early Read Memo v19 and Internal Diligence Exhibits (Deal C options); Deal C FY25 audit; Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 4, Operator 7, Operator 1 and Operator 2 financing documents as supplied. Rows DLC-4711, DLC-4725, DLC-4739, DLC-4753, DLC-4767, DLC-4781, DLC-4872, DLC-4886, DLC-4459, DLC-4501, DLC-4515, DLC-4543, OP6-0031 to OP6-0034, OP3-1326, OP7-1181, OP4-1434, OP4-1438, OP4-1442, OP4-1446, P5-S001 · Basis: Filled = actual (audited or reported earnings), hollow = pro forma at close, hatched = projected or proposed (both Deal C options and the Operator 3 proposal). Proposals and closed prints are shown separately and are not pooled. Gross leverage throughout. Option One excludes the $21m sponsor instrument that stays in place. Operator 7 2026 proposal, on the same rung at 2.25x (OP7-1181), sits below the axis of the upper panel. In the lower panel "cash + impairment" is Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back ($24.9m)

Exhibit 8.14 — Option Two's 5.96x and Option One's 5.30x gross first lien on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m sit above every 2025–26 print on the same rung (3.81–5.10x at Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4; 2.25x at Operator 7) and above the 4.3x closed median since 2014

First-lien funded debt ÷ EBITDA, x, gross and net, by print and rung; Deal C at the September 2026 close, peers 2014 to 2026

PRINT	RUNG AND BASIS	GROSS	NET	LOCATOR
Deal C Option Two (P)	LV1 on E5 $29.4m, LTM Sep-26E	5.96x	5.92x	DLC-4725/4726
Deal C Option One (P)	LV1 on E5	5.30x	5.10x	DLC-4872/4873
Deal C Option One incl. $21m sponsor debt (P)	LV4 on E5	5.96x	5.76x	DLC-4878/4879
Deal C FY25 legacy facilities (A)	LV1 on D3 E1 / E2 / E3 / E3-E4 model	24.9x / 6.6x / 5.4x / 4.5x	22.5x / 6.2x / 5.1x / 4.3x	DLC-4459/4460; 3891/4502; 3977/4516; 3924/4544
Operator 6, Jul-26 close (PF)	LV1 on E5	3.81x	–	OP6-0031
Operator 3, Dec-25 proposal (P)	LV1 on E5	4.70x	–	OP3-1326
Operator 4, Mar-26 (PF)	LV1 on Lender 1 E5	5.10x	–	OP4-1442
Operator 7, 2026 proposal (P)	LV1 on E5 $8.8m	2.25x	1.97x	OP7-1181/1180
Closed core prints, 2014–26	LV1 on financing EBITDA (E4/E5)	median 4.3x (3.81–5.97x)	–	notes C-75 and C-76
Operator 2 Sponsor 1 LBO, Sep-21 (PF)	LV1 on E4	5.97x	6.05x	P5-S001; OP2-3732
Operator 1, REOPEN21 / INFL22-23 (PF)	LV4 net on financing EBITDA	–	7.19x / 5.98x	OP1-10730; OP1-10738
Deal A, Operator 9, Operator 4 (A)	LV1 gross on D3 E1: Deal A FY26 / Operator 9 FY Sep-25 / Operator 4 FY24	0.62x / 6.32x / 8.60x	–	DLA-0472; OP4-1464; OP4-1394

Source: rows as listed; Exhibit 9.75. Proposals (P) and closed prints are shown separately and not pooled · Basis: Deal C options P; legacy facilities A; peers PF, P or A as marked

Information that would sharpen these observations

1. The EBITDA on which the facilities are to be sized and tested, with its bridge from reported EBITDA, and the credit-agreement EBITDA definition with its add-back caps.
2. *Outstanding.* The existing lenders and facility agreements — facility sizes, amounts drawn, pricing, maturity and financial covenants — with the ownership table.
3. The $21m sponsor instrument's issuer, coupon, maturity, ranking and funds trace; the agreed governor, covenant and pricing terms of each option; and August–September 2026 same-store clinic EBITDA.

The structure of both options, debt-service capacity, the refinancing test and its labelled sensitivities, collateral, the 5.3x request in context and the public filings are set out in full in Part 09 section O, under "08 D Deal C financing: supporting evidence".

E · Sensitivity register

Across the three deals the financing turns on operating inputs with observed ranges: on the recapitalisation model a 4.05% EBITDA shortfall takes Deal A's liquidity below $21m in the lead case, Deal B's batch is $8.8–11.8m short, and Deal C's Option Two needs at least 1.57% a year of EBITDA growth.

This register brings the sensitivities that bear on the three proposed financings into one place, each set against what the evidence shows. Exhibit 8.16 holds the Deal A rows, on the recapitalisation model of 29 September with the CreditSwan overlay (Part 08 section B); Exhibit 8.17 holds the Deal B and Deal C rows, from Part 08 section C and Part 08 section D. The sensitivities of the businesses close each deal part (Part 05 section G, Part 06 section H, Part 07 section G).

Exhibit 8.15 — On the recapitalisation model the uniform EBITDA shortfall that takes Deal A's liquidity below the $21m minimum is 1.6% to 11.9% in the four cases that do not pay the closure cash inside four quarters, and nil in the two that do (C3, C7); the lead case's 4.05% and the no-benefit case's 1.6% sit below the smallest annual decline in reported EBITDA Deal A shows for FY23 to FY26 (6.7%)

Uniform shortfall against the model's EBITDA in every quarter that takes minimum quarter-end liquidity net of letters of credit below $21m, %, by case (named as in Part 08 section B); cases C3 and C7 are below $21m with no shortfall

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Exhibit data of Exhibit 8.03 (DLA-026 Draw Schedule Summary row 60; note C-V2-4); Deal A's annual declines in reported EBITDA, FY23 to FY26, as in Exhibit 8.16 · Basis: Projected (P) [I], CreditSwan overlay on the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026, the $21m is the 21 September term sheet's minimum, which the model does not test. The band shows observed annual declines in reported EBITDA, not a forecast · Assumption: A-F11, A-F12, A-F13, A-F14

Exhibit 8.16 — On the recapitalisation model the closure benefit's definition moves the EBITDA shortfall that takes Deal A's liquidity below $21m from 1.6% to 11.9%, and paying the closure cash inside four quarters takes the minimum below $21m; the leverage covenant is never the first signal

Sensitivities that bear on the Deal A financing, set against observed ranges; CreditSwan overlay on the recapitalisation model v06 (29 September 2026); minimum quarter-end liquidity net of letters of credit, $m; refinancing at 30 September 2030

SENSITIVITY	RESULT ON THE RECAPITALISATION MODEL	OBSERVED RANGE (SOURCE)	READING ON THE OBSERVED RANGE
Closure benefit	No benefit $27.1m (below $21m at a 1.6% shortfall); $2.9m net benefit $33.3m (4.05%); management's $12m $37.0m (11.9%)	Second-round cases of −$11.8m to +$20.4m a year, by measure of the benefit and lease exits (Part 05 section D)	Among the cases with closure cash paid as the leases run, the definition of the benefit moves the threshold from 1.6% to 11.9%
Timing of closure cash	Over the remaining lease terms: $27.1m without benefit, $33.3m with it; inside four quarters: $15.1m and $19.5m	Workbook costs run to lease end, 42.1 months on average; 30 of 109 leases end within 21 months (FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis)	Paid as the leases run, the minimum clears $21m; paid inside four quarters, for example to buy out leases, it does not
EBITDA shortfall	Lead case below $21m at 4.05%; with no benefit and a 9% shortfall, liquidity below zero from December 2029 (−$14.1m by March 2031) and the leverage ratio peaks at 5.58x	Deal A's own annual declines in reported EBITDA of 7.7–23.5% (FY23–FY26) and −34% year on year in company EBITDA in the first quarter of FY27 (Deal A 10-K FY23–FY26; bank model row 181)	The liquidity threshold lies inside Deal A's observed declines; the leverage covenant does not give the first signal
Leverage covenant level	Peak 5.68x (lead) and 5.58x (9% shortfall) against a flat 6.35x; 0.67x of margin against the 6.13x step from June 2027 in the shortfall case	The model lists step-downs from 6.35x to 5.81x (Draw Schedule Summary row 101) but tests a flat 6.35x	Which schedule applies is a point to confirm

SENSITIVITY	RESULT ON THE RECAPITALISATION MODEL	OBSERVED RANGE (SOURCE)	READING ON THE OBSERVED RANGE
Refinancing multiple	Lead-case need $257.8m at 30 September 2030	Closed first-lien prints 3.81–4.27x (Operator 2's 2021 buyout at 5.97x aside), median 4.3x (Part 04 section B)	At 4.3x: +$34.2m on reported LTM EBITDA, −$8.6m on FY26, −$33.9m on the model's LTM 2Q27F; at 3.81x every actual rung falls short
Sale-leaseback	Proceeds of $44.4m on the term loan take gross leverage on LTM 2Q27F EBITDA after the new rent from 3.51x to 3.06x	26 sites; 14 with a site loss in FY26; rent cover 1.23x on $3.44m of year-one rent rising 2.2% a year (Project Charlie I-Chart)	Lowers funded debt, adds rent, and takes 26 sites out of the real estate behind recovery

Source: Project Alpha Recapitalization Model 1755.46.29 v06 (DLA-026); FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027); Project Charlie I-Chart (DLA-029); notes C-V2-3 to C-V2-5; observed ranges as cited in each row · Basis: P for the model results [I]; A for the observed ranges unless marked · Assumption: A-F11, A-F12, A-F13, A-F10

Exhibit 8.17 — Deal B needs EBITDA above both current measures to refinance in December 2030 and its batch is $8.8–11.8m short; Deal C's Option Two needs at least 1.57% a year of EBITDA growth against +1.0% and −5.8% observed

Financing sensitivities of the Deal B and Deal C proposals: Ares Credit Group's case, what the evidence shows, the value tested and its effect; leverage and cover x, amounts $m; terms of September 2026, maturities December 2030 and September 2032

DEAL	SENSITIVITY	ARES CREDIT GROUP'S CASE	WHAT THE EVIDENCE SHOWS	VALUE TESTED	EFFECT ON THE FINANCING READING
Deal B	EBITDA rung for leverage	$55m term loan at 4.08x first lien and 7.59x with the HoldCo note on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m, LTM July 2026 (DLB-9352; DLB-9355)	2025–26 same-rung first-lien prints 2.25–5.10x (Operator 7 and Operator 3 proposals, Operator 6 closed, Operator 4 on Lender 1's E5); closed first-lien band since 2014 3.81–4.27x on financing EBITDA, Operator 2's 2021 5.97x aside; peer LV4 prints 5.4–7.2x (OP7-1181; OP6-0031; OP3-1326; OP4-1442; OP8-2819/2367; OP1-10730/10738)	First lien 2.84x on the borrower's $16.1m to 5.58x on post-audit $8.51m; with the HoldCo 5.39x to 10.43x (DLB-9388..9391; DLB-9424..9427)	First lien reads inside the 2025–26 same-rung set on underwriting EBITDA and above it on post-audit adjusted EBITDA (E2, $8.51m); the stack is above every peer LV4 print on Ares Credit Group's EBITDA (Part 08 section C)
Deal B	Fixed-charge cover	FCCR_CD on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m with next-twelve-month charges of $9.38m (DLB-9610)	Peer prints 0.7–1.6x on mixed definitions; association only (note C-80)	1.08x ($16.1m), 0.93x ($14.77m), 1.00x (post-audit pro forma), 0.61x (Ares Credit Group's $11.16m), 0.34x (post-audit $8.51m) (DLB-9603..9607)	Cover is about 1x on the borrower's EBITDA and below 1x on Ares Credit Group's; the peer prints are on different definitions, so no position is taken
Deal B	HoldCo accretion, EBITDA flat for twelve months	HoldCo note of $36.9m at 15% PIK (DLB-5668)	Contractual accretion to $44.0m by September 2027 (DLB-9111); peer LV4 prints 5.4–7.2x	Total leverage 7.85–8.25x on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m and 6.00–6.35x on $14.77m	With EBITDA flat, total leverage on Ares Credit Group's EBITDA moves further above every peer LV4 print within a year; on $14.77m it stays inside the 5.4–7.2x range
Deal B	Refinancing at December 2030	Senior debt of $79–82m and the HoldCo note at $73.3m at maturity (DLB-6246)	Closed first-lien band 3.81–4.27x, median 4.3x (Exhibit 4.09); peer LV4 5.4–7.2x	EBITDA of $16.1–16.6m refinances the term loan and delayed-draw loan at 4.3x; $18.6–24.6m refinances them with the HoldCo at 5.4–7.2x	Both thresholds sit above today's $11.16m on Ares Credit Group's measure and $13.79m post-audit
Deal B	Funding of the near-term batch	$26m DDTL and $11.1m revolver; cash at close $5.03m (Ares Credit Group model) or $2.46m (borrower model) (DLB-026; DLB-6351; DLB-5662)	The 23-unit batch needs a $47.5m delayed-draw draw (DLB-6069..6077)	Residual shortfall $8.8m or $11.8m after the $4.3m liquidity floor (C-FIN-5)	On either model's closing cash the committed facilities leave the batch $8.8–11.8m short
Deal C	EBITDA rung for leverage	Option Two's $204.3m first lien at 5.96x gross on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m, LTM September 2026E, including $9.2m of pre-acquisition and LOI earnings (DLC-4725; DLC-4183)	2025–26 same-rung prints 3.81–5.10x at Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4, with Operator 7 2.25x proposal below; closed first-lien median 4.3x since 2014 (OP6-0031; OP3-1326; OP4-1442; OP7-1181; P5-S001)	5.19x net on the sponsor's $32.3m; 7.24x gross on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back ($24.9m); 20.0x gross on $8.6m of cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs (DLC-4712; DLC-4739; DLC-4781)	Above every 2025–26 same-rung print and above the 4.3x closed median on every EBITDA measure in the files; among closed first-lien prints since 2014 only Operator 2's 2021 buyout (5.97x) is higher
Deal C	Fixed-charge cover	Ares Credit Group's coverage method on its cash EBITDA	Cash breakeven EBITDA for Option Two $26.0m (DLC-4983)	Option Two 0.76x ($23.2m), 0.77x ($24.9m), 0.96x ($29.4m), 1.08x ($32.3m), 0.22x ($8.6m); Option One, term loan only at S+451: 1.00x ($24.9m), 1.23x ($29.4m), 1.37x ($32.3m) (DLC-4947..4982)	Option Two covers its fixed charges only on EBITDA that includes forecast months

DEAL	SENSITIVITY	ARES CREDIT GROUP'S CASE	WHAT THE EVIDENCE SHOWS	VALUE TESTED	EFFECT ON THE FINANCING READING
Deal C	Organic EBITDA growth to maturity	Option Two on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m, no-acquisition path to September 2032 (note C-90)	Same-store clinic EBITDA +1.0% for CY2025 and −5.8% for LTM July 2026 (DLC-0987; DLC-0996)	Gap at the 4.3x median: $23.0m flat, $7.5m at +1.0%, $101m at −5.8%; clears from 1.57% a year on $29.4m and 5.36% on $24.9m	Refinancing needs growth above what Deal C's clinics delivered in the latest two periods
Deal C	Refinancing multiple	4.3x median of closed first-lien prints (notes C-75 and C-76)	3.81x (Operator 6, closed) to 5.10x (Operator 4 on E5); 3.38x as a stress	Flat $29.4m clears only at 5.18x; gap of $53.0m at 3.38x	On flat earnings Option Two clears only at the top of the observed band
Deal C	DDTL drawn	$70m DDTL for acquisitions, left undrawn on the no-acquisition path	Deal costs 13.2% of price excluding affiliate bonuses ((DLC-0009 − DLC-0199) ÷ total consideration) and 31.2% on the audited rate (DLC-0009 ÷ total consideration of $32.8m, 2025 Audit Note 3, p.17)	DDTL drawn at close, acquired EBITDA leverage-neutral (assumed)	Option Two's gap at 4.3x on flat $29.4m widens from $23.0m to $35.7–51.5m; Option One's total debt misses by $8.0m at the audited rate
Deal C	Sponsor instrument on cash pay	Option One's $21m sponsor instrument carried at face with no cash coupon; its terms are not in the files [U]	No coupon, maturity, ranking or cash-pay term in the files	Cash coupon of 12% or 17% (assumed)	Option One's senior gap at 4.3x moves from −$23.9m to −$8.1m (10%) and +$2.3m (17%); its total gap to $13.4–23.4m

Source: Rows as cited in each cell; the underlying tables are Exhibit 8.10, Exhibit 9.162, Exhibit 9.164, Exhibit 9.165, Exhibit 9.166 and Exhibit 8.14; notes C-80, C-90 and C-FIN-5 · Basis: P for the proposed structures and every forward result; A or PF for the observed ranges as marked. All results [I] · Assumption: Growth rates other than Deal C's observed +1.0% and −5.8%, the 3.38x stress, the drawn DDTL and the sponsor coupons of 12% and 17% are assumed parameters

At none of the three deals is the leverage covenant the first constraint. At Deal A the closure benefit's definition moves the shortfall at which liquidity falls below $21m from 1.6% to 11.9%, and the timing of closure cash decides whether the minimum clears at all; at Deal B the first constraint is funding of the near-term batch; at Deal C, cash cover and the growth the refinancing needs.

The Deal A sensitivity rows on the 21 September term sheet and Ares Credit Group's model v24 are in Part 09 section O, under "08 E Sensitivity register: supporting evidence".

F · Deal A term sheet

On the recapitalisation model of 29 September the leverage covenant holds (5.68x peak against 6.35x) and liquidity remains the tighter test; three of the fifteen observations fall away with the delayed-draw loan, and fixed-charge cover becomes the point to settle.

CreditSwan's work here is commercial diligence; the financing judgement is Ares Credit Group's. No term sheet later than the LW draft of 21 September 2026 is in the files, so the fifteen observations on that term sheet are read here against the recapitalisation model of 29 September; where the term sheet is silent, the terms are the model's and are marked so. They are offered for Ares Credit Group and its counsel as observations or questions, not as recommendations.

What holds. On the model's structure the leverage covenant has room, 5.68x at its peak against 6.35x, and repaying the $145m of supplier finance at close removes the main unresolved point of the 21 September term sheet: the delayed-draw draw test, the revolver cap and the delayed-draw amortisation fall away, and supplier finance inside funded debt largely does.

What to watch. Fixed-charge cover becomes the point to settle: the model labels it "≥1.08" and computes 0.76–1.03x from March 2027 to FY31. Liquidity remains the tighter test (Part 08 section B), and the model does not test the $21m minimum.

Exhibit 8.18 — The recapitalisation model labels fixed-charge cover "≥1.08", yet its own path is 0.76x to 1.03x from March 2027 to FY31 (0.93x at December 2026): below that level in every period, were it a maintenance test

Fixed-charge cover, (EBITDAR − capex) ÷ (interest + rents), x, by quarter to March 2028 and by fiscal year-end to FY31, as computed in v06 (the second of its two definitions, row 144; the first, which also deducts tax and adds principal, reads lower)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Alpha Recapitalization Model 1755.46.29 v06 (DLA-026), FY27-FY31 Covenants!I144:Q144 (label C144 "≥1.08"); rows DLA-7618 to DLA-7626 · Basis: Projected (P) as the model computes it [F]; the closure scenario is off in v06. The 21 September term sheet has no fixed-charge cover maintenance test; whether one is intended is a point to confirm

Exhibit 8.19 — Read against the recapitalisation model of 29 September, three of the fifteen observations fall away with the delayed-draw loan, two largely or partly fall away with supplier finance repaid at close, and fixed-charge cover and the untested liquidity minimum become the points to settle

Each observation on the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026), with what the recapitalisation model v06 (29 September 2026) shows and its status; points to confirm in the model added

#	OBSERVATION ON THE TERM SHEET OF 21 SEPTEMBER	ON THE RECAPITALISATION MODEL OF 29 SEPTEMBER	STATUS
1	Leverage-ratio denominator: EBITDAR reading; stock compensation	Computes on EBITDAR and adds back stock compensation ($6.2m LTM at March 2027, Covenants!J86); the term-sheet wording is still to settle	Point to confirm
2	Covenant levels well above the modelled path (4.53x peak on Ares Credit Group's model v24)	Peak 5.68x against 6.35x (1.0x of room); the Covenants tab shows a flat 6.35x, the Draw Schedule Summary step-downs to 5.81x (row 101)	Holds, with less room
3	Delayed-draw condition tested at each draw	No delayed-draw loan; supplier finance repaid at close	Falls away
4	Revolver cap while the delayed-draw loan is available	No delayed-draw loan	Falls away
5	Letters of credit of at least $25.5m	The model carries $26m (Scenario Drivers!G23)	Point to confirm
6	Qualified Cash and control agreements	Not addressed in the model	Unchanged
7	December 2026 dividend outside the payment conditions; fixed-charge payment condition; run-rate add-backs	$7.41m paid in December 2026 (Draw Schedule Summary!J39); fixed-charge cover 0.77x at March 2027	Unchanged
8	EBITDAR clauses; disposal gains; closure-cash sub-cap	Closure-cash add-backs capped at $21m to FY29 and $13m after, the first cohort fully added back "per Ares Credit Group verbal" (Covenants rows 112–99; Scenario Drivers rows 24–23)	Point to confirm
9	Calendar against fiscal dates	Close 14 October 2026; maturity 30 September 2030 (Scenario Drivers!G77) against 31 October 2030 (PF Cap Structure!E11, E13)	Point to confirm
10	Supplier finance inside funded debt	$145m repaid at close; the remaining Lender 6 line winds down over six months (Scenario Drivers!G36)	Largely falls away
11	Excess-cash-flow treatment of supplier-finance payments and delayed-draw proceeds	67% excess-cash sweep and 100% asset-sale sweep	Partly falls away
12	Prepayment premium on closure-programme proceeds	Unchanged; now also bears on the sale-leaseback ($44.4–46.9m at Real Estate Advisor 1 values) under the 100% asset-sale sweep	Unchanged
13	Delayed-draw amortisation; debt carried in Ares Credit Group's model v24	No delayed-draw loan	Falls away
14	Conditions precedent; no mortgage provision	Unchanged; the sale-leaseback would take 26 owned sites out of the real estate behind recovery	Unchanged
15	No fixed-charge cover maintenance test	Labelled "≥1.08"; the model's own path is 0.93x at December 2026 and 0.76–1.03x from March 2027 to FY31, below that level in every period were it a covenant	Point to settle
New	Points to confirm in the model	The $21m minimum liquidity input (Scenario Drivers!G31) is referenced by no formula; the first downside input (G32, $3.0m) is applied as $0.8m in the monthly P&L (row 127), the other two ($2.6m, $5.9m) agree; Covenants!G85:I85 hard-code LTM EBITDA of $79.5m / $75.9m / $69.8m against the model's own $64.5m at December 2026 (Draw Schedule Summary!J106); the closure scenario is off; no sale-leaseback line	Points to confirm

Source: LW draft term sheet, 21 September 2026 (DLA-023); Project Alpha Recapitalization Model 1755.46.29 v06 (DLA-026), cells as cited in each row; the fifteen observations on the term sheet in Part 09 section O · Basis: Model terms and results as the model computes them [F]; projected (P). Statuses are our reading [I]

The cover note, the basis of the observations and the fifteen observations on the 21 September term sheet are in Part 09 section O, under "08 F Deal A term sheet: supporting evidence".

Part 09 — Assumptions and method

Every assumption is stated once and every figure resolves from this package alone, to a supplied document, a public source, a fact row or a computation note

This part holds the assumptions register, the method, the definitions and codes, how to read a reference, the Sources table, the Evidence index, the computation notes and the limits of the evidence. The Evidence index and the Sources table ship as data files beside this document, and the first rows are shown here.

A · Register

The readings rest on 31 stated assumptions: 12 analytical conventions, 14 for the Deal A financing models and 9 for the public signals, each with the value used, where it is documented and how much a headline moves.

The register below lists the choices that most affect the readings, the value used, where the choice is documented, how much a headline moves if the choice were made differently, and the supplies that use it. It has three groups: A-01 to A-12, the analytical conventions of the eight areas and the benchmark; A-F1 to A-F14, the assumptions of the Deal A financing models behind Part 08 section B (A-F1 to A-F10 for the 21 September term sheet on Ares Credit Group's model v24, kept in Part 09 section O; A-F11 to A-F14 for the recapitalisation model of 29 September); and A-P1 to A-P9, the conventions of the public signals. The opening of each of Part 01 and Part 03 to Part 08 names the rows it uses most, and the answers in Part 10 cite them by reference.

Assumptions register

Exhibit 9.01 — The readings rest on 31 stated assumptions; the EBITDA rung alone moves the same first-lien debt between 3.4x and 20x at three comparator platforms

Assumption, value used, where it is documented, how much a headline moves if it is made differently, and the supplies that use it: A-01 to A-12 analytical conventions, A-F1 to A-F10 the Deal A financing model on the 21 September 2026 term sheet, A-F11 to A-F14 the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026, A-P1 to A-P9 public signals

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED	BASIS	SENSITIVITY (HOW MUCH THE HEADLINE MOVES)	USED IN
A-01	Same-store sales are compared on one common definition	Clinics owned and open 13 months, calendar months, no seller-period data; closure treatment stated (CLOSE-FWD or CLOSE-RETRO)	Part 09 section C, Exhibit 9.03	Definition choice alone moves reported comparable sales by up to 4.5pp (Exhibit 9.64)	Parts 01, 03 to 07
A-02	Four-wall margins are compared before rebates and after cash rent	D1.1 on R-CASH for comparison; D1.2 (after rebates) and other rent codes shown with their code and never pooled	Part 09 section C, Exhibit 9.02	Deal C's FY25 clinic margin reads 21.3% on book rent and 22.3% on cash rent (Part 07 section B); Deal A's FY26 clinic EBITDA margin reads 7.9% with operating-lease rent only (company basis, surviving clinics) and 5.4% with finance-lease cost at book (open clinics) (Exhibit 4.11)	Parts 01, 03 to 07
A-03	EBITDA is kept on named rungs	E1 reported, E2 adjusted, E3 pro forma, E4 run-rate, E5 underwriting, E6 cash (the top adjusted rung less the cash "one-time" costs that recur in three or more consecutive years)	Part 09 section C, Exhibit 9.04	Cash EBITDA ran at 0.73 of the top adjusted rung in the median platform-year and far lower in acquisition years (Exhibit 3.22)	Parts 01, 03 to 08
A-04	Maintenance capex is measured independently where possible	Total capex used as maintenance for Deal A (an upper bound); company-stated splits tagged [M]	Part 03 section F; Exhibit 9.68	Company-stated splits give 0.73–0.85 conversion; independent measures give 0.41–0.76 on consolidated EBITDA (Exhibit 9.68)	Parts 01, 03 to 07
A-05	Disposal gains are shown separately from reported EBITDA	Deal A FY26 E1 shown with and without $16.0m of disposal gains	Part 05 section F; Part 01 section D	Deal A's FY26 conversion reads 0.52 on reported E1 and 0.44 ex-gains (Exhibit 9.68)	Parts 01, 03 to 05, 08

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED	BASIS	SENSITIVITY (HOW MUCH THE HEADLINE MOVES)	USED IN
A-06	Environments are assigned by period end	Seven D10 environments; twelve-month fiscal rows tagged by month majority	Part 09 section C, Exhibit 9.09	Moves individual fiscal years between adjacent environments (for example Deal A FY20 to EXP10-19 and FY21 to COVID20; Part 09 section F)	Parts 01, 03 to 05
A-07	Survivor-based series are read as upper bounds	Closed clinics absent from a series are stated with the series	Part 09 section C, Exhibit 9.03; Exhibit 9.52 note	165 Deal A clinics in the FY23 to FY25 tabs of the clinic-level EBITDA file (DLA-003) are absent from its FY26 tab and from the survivor KPI file (DLA-002), and were disproportionately loss-making (Exhibit 9.52)	Parts 01, 03 to 07
A-08	Live-deal figures come from the companies' source documents (Part 09 section E)	Live-deal figures in Parts 03 to 07 are read from the Deal A, Deal B and Deal C source documents (Part 09 section E); where a measure exists on two definitions, both are shown with the definition named	Part 01 section F	Where a measure is shown on two definitions, both are named and the deal part (Part 05, Part 06 or Part 07) states which one the reading uses	Parts 01, 03 to 08
A-09	Operators are ranked only where a ranking is valid	At least three operators on one definition in one environment	Part 04 section E, Exhibit 9.93	Ten rankings qualify, none with more than four operators (Exhibit 4.15); margins, unit economics and cash flow are described, not ranked	Parts 03 to 07
A-10	Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only	Never pooled with general practice veterinary care and preventive care and pharmacy in a core statistic	Part 04 section G	DBW is placed only against the wellness clinic context set (Part 06 section F)	Parts 01, 03, 04, 06
A-11	Pricing is tested against public price and wage series	CPI-U veterinarian services (SS62053) and the ECI wage rate, retrieved 28 Sep 2026	Part 09 section E	Series vintages and known traps are listed in Part 09 section E	Parts 03 to 05
A-12	Every multiple states its EBITDA rung and debt perimeter	Leverage rungs LV1 (first-lien funded debt) to LV6 (adds leases and supply-chain finance); multiples marked standalone or synergised	Part 09 section C, Exhibit 9.05 and Exhibit 9.08	The same first-lien debt reads 4–20x at Operator 4, Operator 8 and Operator 6 depending on the EBITDA underneath it (Exhibit 9.75)	Parts 01, 03 to 08
A-F1	How the delayed-draw loan is drawn	As each supplier-finance payment falls due	The LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) limits the loan to the supplier-finance unwind and lets revolver loans fund it only when the loan is unavailable (Use of Proceeds); note C-FIN-1	Moves minimum liquidity materially; the case drawn only when cash is short is in Exhibit 9.155 (Part 09 section O)	Part 09 section O; Part 08 section B (like for like)
A-F2	Closure cash, amount and timing	$21.79m spread evenly over 42.1 months from April 2027, plus $4.3m of fees in April to June 2027	Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J43, J33, B49; fees Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!F21; note C-FIN-4	Moves minimum liquidity; the case with closure cash paid inside four quarters is in Exhibit 9.155 (Part 09 section O)	Parts 05, 10; Part 09 section O
A-F3	Finance-lease cash	Principal (row 171) plus interest (row 22)	Row 152 is the bank model's principal line; Ares Credit Group's model nets the interest out (MODEL OUTPUT!D30, D171)	The interest is $9.2m to December 2027 and $28.4m through FY31 (MODEL OUTPUT!D22:L22)	Part 09 section O
A-F4	Letters of credit	$25.5m outstanding, reducing revolver availability	Deal A Q1 FY27 Form 10-Q	Each $1m is $1m of liquidity	Part 09 section O
A-F5	Operating case	Ares Credit Group's model v24 as it stands: EBITDA, $12m closure benefit from April 2027, capex, working capital, taxes, $177.7m of supplier-finance payments	Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT rows 13 to 28	The EBITDA shortfall at which a covenant is first breached is given in Part 09 section O (note C-FIN-2)	Part 09 section O; Part 08 section B (like for like)
A-F6	Timing inside a period	Flows spread evenly by month inside each quarter to March 2028 and each fiscal year after	The model gives quarters and years only	The daily path is in no file; results indicate direction	Part 09 section O

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED	BASIS	SENSITIVITY (HOW MUCH THE HEADLINE MOVES)	USED IN
A-F7	Quarter-average liquidity	Daily interpolation between month-end points	The covenant is on average daily Liquidity (LW draft term sheet, Financial Covenants)	The mean of month-ends differs by $0.1m to $0.3m in seven of the eight cases; in the eighth (loan drawn only when short, closure cash inside four quarters) the two conventions fall either side of the covenant	Part 09 section O
A-F8	Margins	One step up the grid throughout: S+5.55% term loans, S+3.38% revolver	The LW draft term sheet (Interest) sets the margin by a grid on the tested ratio; the ratio path is in Part 09 section O	Lower margins raise liquidity by the interest saved, 0.22 points on about $254m of debt	Part 09 section O
A-F9	Downside	EBITDA 9% below Ares Credit Group's model in every period; no closure benefit	A parameter, not an observation; Deal A's own annual declines are larger (Exhibit 9.168); note C-FIN-3	–	Part 09 section O
A-F10	Refinancing need	Bank debt at September 2030 less cash above a $13m reserve	$13m is the minimum cash in Ares Credit Group's model (MODEL OUTPUT!F159:L159); note C-FIN-3	–	Part 08; Part 09 section O
A-F11	Operating case on the recapitalisation model	The model of 29 September 2026 as it stands: scenario 3 ($218m term loan, $111m revolver with $44m drawn), downside on, closure scenario off	Project Alpha Recapitalization Model v06, Scenario Drivers!E9, E13; FY27-FY31 Covenants!C65; note C-V2-4	As modelled, minimum liquidity is $40.6m (June 2027); the overlay cases are in Part 08 section B	Part 08
A-F12	Closure cash and fees on the recapitalisation model	$21.79m spread evenly over 42.1 months from April 2027 and $4.3m of fees in the June 2027 quarter, funded on the revolver at SOFR + 3.26%	FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis, Summary!J43; fees Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!F21; note C-V2-4	Paid inside four quarters, minimum liquidity without closure benefit falls from $27.1m to $15.1m (Part 08 section B)	Part 08
A-F13	Net closure benefit in the lead case	$2.9m a year from April 2027: clinic EBITDA including co-op, 13% recapture, overhead at Deal A's ratio, operating leases run to term	Note C-V2-3; Part 05 section D	With no benefit the minimum is $27.1m; with management's $12m, $37.0m (Part 08 section B)	Parts 05, 08
A-F14	Liquidity points and minimum on the recapitalisation model	Quarter-end liquidity net of letters of credit, against $21m, the 21 September term sheet's minimum, which the model does not test	Draw Schedule Summary row 60; Scenario Drivers!G31; note C-V2-4	Quarter-end points can differ from the average daily balance a term sheet would test	Part 08
A-P1	A public figure is tagged from the source we read	[F] a filing, a release by the body concerned, a statistical table, the company's own page, or a review, complaint or job site publishing its own rating, count or posted term; [M] a company's statement; [I] a figure we compute from public data, or our interpretation; [U] read only in a secondary report whose original could not be read, with the reporter named, and never in a title, an In brief row or Part 01	Part 09 section D	A figure would carry more weight than its source allows	Parts 03 to 08
A-P2	Ratings, counts and posted prices are values of record on the date read	Ratings, review counts, complaint counts, open roles and posted prices as read on 30 September 2026 (public series as retrieved on 28 September 2026; three Census Bureau and Office of Management and Budget datasets carry their document dates, their read date not being recorded); a later reading that differs is a change, not an error	Part 09 section H	Figures date quickly; none is a series through time	Parts 03 to 07
A-P3	A clinic's trade area is a fixed radius around it	Census tracts whose internal point lies within three miles (five where stated), American Community Survey 2020–2024; median household income interpolated from pooled income brackets; a clinic with no coordinates or no tract in the radius has no value	Note C-PUB-1	Levels move with the radius; the ordering of the three deals does not change between three and five miles	Parts 04, 06, 07
A-P4	Competition is measured as an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles	Operator 1's 1,394 own-banner clinics with coordinates; its other banners are not mapped	Notes C-PUB-2 and C-PUB-6	Competition is understated where the other banners trade	Parts 04 to 07
A-P5	Clinic lists are those on each company's public pages	As listed on 30 September 2026: Deal A 924 company-operated clinics; Deal B 96 location pages; Deal C 72 clinics across its brand pages (of about 86; few State 20 clinics are listed)	Notes C-PUB-1 to C-PUB-3	Shares describe the clinics listed, not the whole estate	Parts 04 to 07
A-P6	Deal B's public measures are read on the company's own cohorts	77 clinics acquired before 2025 and 26 in 2025–26, joined to the public location pages by town, state and clinic name: 93 of 103 matched; six 2025–26 clinics have no public page. Where the join is not used, cohorts are dated by first public listing	Note C-PUB-5	The 2025–26 figures rest on 21 of 26 clinics	Part 06

REF	ASSUMPTION	VALUE USED	BASIS	SENSITIVITY (HOW MUCH THE HEADLINE MOVES)	USED IN
A-P7	Deal A clinic results are those of the FY26 clinic-level file	983 clinics; loss-making = negative clinic-level EBITDA. Clinics closed before FY26 carry no address in the supplied files and are not covered; 46 clinics are placed at the centre of their ZIP code	Note C-PUB-6	The result describes the surviving estate	Part 05
A-P8	What the document already carries governs	Where the document carries a measure from a supplied document, a filing or a public series, that value governs and the public figure is not added. The exception is Deal B's trade-area figures, where both are shown, each named	Part 09 section H	None: avoids two values for one measure	Parts 03 to 08
A-P9	What was not found in public sources is not evidence	What was looked for and not found in public sources is not shown; it becomes a request	Part 09 section H	None	Parts 03 to 08

Source: Part 09 section C; Part 09 section G (notes C-FIN-1 to C-FIN-4, C-V2-3, C-V2-4 and C-PUB-1 to C-PUB-6); the exhibits and sections cited in each row · Basis: Conventions and assumptions, not figures; each effect carries the basis of the exhibit or section it cites

B · Method

Readings rest on figures taken from the supplied originals and kept on named definitions of EBITDA, leverage, rent and same-store sales; public signals, read on 30 September 2026, add a dated outside view that changes no reading label.

Figures were read from the supplied documents and from public originals; three public figures could be read only in a secondary report and are tagged [U] with the reporter named. Every source file was registered, and every cited figure has a row in the Evidence index with its period, measure, basis, evidence tag, source, locator and check status (Part 09 section F). Every industry-report claim that a public series could test was tested against it (Part 09 section H), and every industry conclusion rests on at least three operators and two environments or is labelled otherwise. Every peer comparison in Part 05 to Part 07 names its comparators, definition and range. Management presentations, sponsor models and Ares Credit Group's own models were treated as claims to test, not as inputs. Reported, adjusted, pro forma, underwriting and cash EBITDA are kept distinct (E1–E6), as are gross and net leverage on each of six rungs, book and cash rent, and company and common same-store definitions. Where a comparison would require pooling incompatible definitions, the data are shown side by side and labelled, and the file that would make the comparison valid is named.

Method

What this document does. It tests the commercial evidence behind Ares Credit Group's thesis for each deal: volume, pricing, margins, unit economics, same-store sales, cash conversion, acquisition performance and the benchmark against historical deals. Each cited figure is recorded in the Evidence index (Part 09 section F) with its period, measure, basis, evidence tag, source, locator and check status; each computed figure also cites its computation note (Part 09 section G).

What it does not do. It does not set leverage, covenants, pricing or structure; the financing judgement is Ares Credit Group's. It does not replace a quality-of-earnings review or a legal review of the documents. Where a comparison is not valid on the evidence supplied, it is shown side by side with its definition and not ranked (A-09), and where the evidence is missing, the gap is named with the file that would close it (Exhibit 9.27; the information requests in Parts 05 to 07).

How to read a reading. Business quality is read here; the financing components of the three theses (Deal A M5, Deal B MS6 and Deal C ST4, by option) are set out in Part 08 section A as observations for Ares Credit Group's own underwriting. The labels below are our reading on the evidence supplied to date, using the four labels the engagement brief requires: **supported** — every essential condition is supported by direct evidence with no material contrary evidence unresolved; **partially supported** — some conditions are supported, while others are not or hold only under a definition or scenario; **contradicted** — the direct evidence supplied does not support at least one essential condition; **insufficient evidence** — an essential condition cannot be tested with the files supplied, and the missing item is named. Each reading is paired with the evidence that would change it (Part 01 section A). A label is a statement about the evidence, not a recommendation.

Checks and reproduction

How far the figures were checked. The Evidence index gives the check status of every cited row (Part 09 section D explains the phrases). Three in four cited fact rows rest on a single reading of the source, about one in five were re-read at the cited cell or page and agree, and for about one in twenty-five two sources differ and the text says which is used; the counts are in Part 09 section F. A single read is evidence; it has not been confirmed by a second reading. Adjusted and pro forma figures carry basis PF. The same-store rebuilds on D2.1 reconcile to the companies' own identities (Deal B residual ≈0; Deal C company-method replica within 0.1% of revenue).

Reproduced directly from originals: all Deal A term-sheet provisions cited; Ares Credit Group model cell formulas for the finance-lease treatment; bank-model EBITDA, payables and debt lines; closure schedule totals; clinic counts and loss-clinic shares; BLS and FRED series; Deal B financing-model sources-and-uses, FCCR cells, acquisition schedule and Early Read exhibits; financing-grid rows; Deal C audit cash-flow statement, memo slides, site database, SSS and visit count workbooks, employee census.

Computed by CreditSwan, with inputs and method in the computation notes (Part 09 section G): monthly cash paths, covenant proxies, cohort comparisons, matched-site uplifts, refinancing grids, the leverage ladders, and the Deal A refinancing test on observed anchors.

Cycle tags. The report uses month-majority tags throughout. The seller-period flag is applied row by row to the Deal B and Deal C rows (Part 09 section F) and, for the historical platforms, in notes.

Public signals

What they add. Alongside the documents Ares Credit Group supplied, the study reads the operators from outside: how customers and employees rate them, where their clinics sit and who competes with them there, what they post on price, wellness plans and pay, and what filings and agencies record about them. Public signals across the general practice and preventive care operators are in Part 04 section H; a signal that bears on one deal sits at the end of the section it bears on, under "Public signals"; public facts on a live deal's debt or shareholders sit in Part 08; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital operators appear only in Part 04 section G and Part 06 section F.

How they were read. Every public figure is dated: pages were read on 30 September 2026, except three Census Bureau and Office of Management and Budget datasets whose read date is not recorded and which carry their document dates, and public series were retrieved on 28 September 2026, and the value used is the one in the capture of the page that CreditSwan holds. A figure takes its evidence tag from the source read (register row A-P1): originals first, a secondary report only where the original could not be read and then with the reporter named, and no third-party estimate. Review, complaint and job sites contribute ratings, counts and posted terms with their sample and date, never the content of what is written there. Searches used public names only; clinic lists, census tracts and the company records were matched locally.

How they were computed. Figures computed from public data are recorded in notes C-PUB-1 to C-PUB-16: trade-area income and households within three and five miles of each clinic, proximity to an Operator 1 clinic, footprint concentration, rating statistics, and two joins of public data with company records, Deal B's own acquisition cohorts and Deal A's FY26 clinic results.

How they are used. A comparison is made only where both sides share scope, unit, period and definition. Where the document already carries a measure from a supplied document, a filing or a public series, that value governs and the public figure is not added (A-P8); Deal B's trade-area figures are the one case where both are shown, each named. What was looked for and not found is not evidence; it becomes a request (A-P9). No public signal changes the label of a reading.

C · Definitions

Ten definition families, D1 to D10, fix how four-wall EBITDA, same-store sales, EBITDA, leverage, cash, volume, price, clinic base, transactions and environments are measured, so operators are compared only on one named definition.

Definitions summary (CreditSwan definitions)

In the Evidence index (Part 09 section F; `data/[file]`) money is in USD thousands (public rows keep the unit of their source), ratios are decimals with the unit stated, and a period ends on the last day of the month in which it ends; Deal A's fiscal year ends on the last Saturday of March and the 2014-vintage Operator 1 fiscal year ends in May. Basis flags are A (actual: audited, QoE-tied or company system data), PF (pro forma or adjusted) and P (proposal, forecast, budget or underwriting; any LTM window containing a forecast month is P). Evidence tags are [F] documented fact, [M]

management claim, [A] Ares Credit Group view, [I] CreditSwan calculation and [U] unresolved. For public signals, a figure read only in a secondary report whose original could not be read is tagged [U], with the reporter named. A [U] figure never appears in a title, an In brief row or Part 01.

Reading labels. Each thesis component carries one of the four labels of the engagement brief: supported, partially supported, contradicted or insufficient evidence. A partially supported reading flagged *leans supported* is one where the part that holds carries most of the component as Ares Credit Group framed it, and one open point is named; the readings grid of Part 01 section B marks it with a corner flag in the legend colour for "leans supported". M1 and M4 carry the flag. A second label on a reading (M5, ST3) is marked with an asterisk and a corner flag in the colour of that label.

Definition codes ending "_CD" (for example SSS_CD, ST_4W_EBITDA_CD, FCCR_CD) are measures on the common definition set out in this section; codes ending "_ST-59" carry a company's own definition.

Exhibit 9.02 — D1 four-wall EBITDA: comparison basis is before rebates and after cash rent on every lease

Definition D1: four-wall EBITDA codes by rebate treatment and rent basis, and which are pooled

CODE	DEFINITION (ONE LINE)	HOW IT IS APPLIED
D1.1 ST_4W_EBITDA_CD	Clinic revenue less product cost, clinic labour, clinic operating costs and cash rent on every lease type; before vendor co-op and rebates, corporate allocation, D&A, impairment and asset-sale gains	—
D1.2 ST_4W_EBITDA_REB	D1.1 plus rebates allocated to the clinic, only where the source itself allocates them; never a CreditSwan allocation	OP8-1385/1395/1406/1417 coded ST_4W_MARGIN_REB; OP8-1417 and OP8-2091 differ by definition, not by source
D1.3 Rent code	R-CASH (cash rent, all leases), R-BOOK (straight-line / ASC 842), R-OPONLY (operating leases only), R-NONE (before rent), R-UNK (not stated); only R-CASH pooled without adjustment	Every four-wall row carries a rent code where the source states the rent basis; about 893 rows carry none and are not pooled
D1.4 Source treatment by platform	Each platform's source label, rebate, rent and corporate treatment, stated with its figures	Core platforms in Exhibit 4.11; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital operators in Part 04 section G
D1.5 Related measures	ST_EBITDAR_CD = D1.1 + cash rent; ST_4W_MARGIN = D1.1 ÷ REV_NET as a ratio of sums; distributions always on D1.1/D1.2 with rent code and clinic base	—

Source: CreditSwan definitions, as set out in this section · Basis: Definitions, not figures

Exhibit 9.03 — D2 same-store sales: owned and open for 13 months, calendar months, no seller data

Definition D2: same-store sales codes, clinic base and closure treatment

CODE	DEFINITION (ONE LINE)	HOW IT IS APPLIED
D2.1 SSS_CD	Clinic-month in the comp base when owned and open on every day of months m−12 to m and not closed, relocated or converted; Σ revenue ÷ Σ prior-year revenue − 1; no day, weather or holiday adjustment; no seller data	—
D2.2 Closed clinics	Default CLOSE-FWD (clinic leaves from month of closure); CLOSE-RETRO where only a survivor file exists, stated with the figure	—
D2.3 SSS_CD_24	As D2.1 but entry from the 25th owned month (acquisition-lag variant)	—
D2.4 SSS_ST-59	Company definition recorded verbatim (entry rule, calendar adjustments, closure treatment, PF/seller use, revenue source)	Seller-period rows flagged in notes (OP7-0607, OP7-0638); SELLER scope flag not applied to the historical platforms
D2.5 Components	SSS_TRAFFIC_CD and SSS_TICKET_CD on the same base with (1 + SSS) = (1 + traffic)(1 + ticket); residuals reported	Codes SSS_CD_RETAIL, SSS_VOL_PHARM_CD_RETAIL, SSS_TICKET_PER_PHARM_CD_RETAIL for the Operator 1 retail-only series

Source: CreditSwan definitions, as set out in this section · Basis: Definitions, not figures

Exhibit 9.04 — D3 EBITDA ladder: six rungs plus covenant, EBITDAR and adjustment-share memo codes

Definition D3: EBITDA rungs E1 to E6, with the covenant, EBITDAR and adjustment-share codes

CODE	DEFINITION (ONE LINE)	HOW IT IS APPLIED
E1 EB_R1_REPORTED	Operating income + D&A + impairment per the books; gains on asset sales and SLBs left in, with an EB_R1_GAINS memo line; basis A	Deal A E1 = OI + D&A as reported (incl. finance-lease ROU amortisation) + impairment; gains stay in E1 with a mandatory ex-gains line wherever E1 enters coverage, conversion or leverage; finance-lease cost stays below E1. Operator 1 rows OP1-3250..3260 coded EB_R1_REPORTED

CODE	DEFINITION (ONE LINE)	HOW IT IS APPLIED
E2 EB_R2_ADJ	E1 + non-recurring and normalisation adjustments; E2q third-party QoE, E2m management only; basis PF	OP1-3261..3271 coded EB_R2_ADJ (D3-E2m)
E3 EB_R3_PF	E2 + pre-acquisition results of closed acquisitions + full-period closures; LOI clinics recorded separately (EB_R3_PLUS); PF	—
E4 EB_R4_PF_RUNRATE	E3 + run-rate savings, synergies, ramps, rebate renegotiations; PF	—
E5 EB_R5_UW	Lender's or sponsor's underwriting figure as stated; PF or P	—
E6 EB_CASH	Top adjusted rung (E3, or E2 where no E3 exists) less the cash "one-time" costs that recur in three or more consecutive years; non-cash pro forma items and cash-rent shortfalls are also deducted where the bridge identifies them; PF [I]	—
EB_COV	Covenant EBITDA per credit agreement or term sheet	Used for covenant-definition prints; DLA-2988 coded EB_COV
EBITDAR_CD; ADJ_SHARE	Stated rung + operating-lease cash rent; (final rung − E1) ÷ final rung	—

Source: CreditSwan definitions, as set out in this section · Basis: Definitions, not figures

Exhibit 9.05 — D4 leverage ladder: every print gross and net, always with its EBITDA rung and period

Definition D4: leverage rungs LV1 to LV6, gross and net, by the debt each includes

CODE	DEFINITION (ONE LINE)	HOW IT IS APPLIED
LV1 LEV_LV1	Drawn first-lien term loan + RCF + DDTL	Deal A LV1–LV6 stated on D3 E1 with ex-gains lines
LV2 LEV_LV2	LV1 + second lien, unsecured, seller notes, fixed cash-pay earn-outs, other funded debt	—
LV3 LEV_LV3	LV2 + finance-lease liabilities + failed-SLB obligations	—
LV4 LEV_LV4	LV3 + debt-like preferred, HoldCo PIK and sponsor notes at accreted value	—
LV5 LEV_LV5_6X / _8X	LV4 + 6× (or 8×) LTM operating-lease cash rent, over EBITDAR_CD	—
LV6 LEV_LV6	LV5 + supply-chain finance, deferred price, contingent consideration, lease-exit liabilities, unpaid transaction costs	Deal A supplier-finance balances differ between sources (Part 08 section B)
FCCR_CD	(EBITDA rung − maintenance capex − cash taxes) ÷ (cash interest + scheduled principal incl. finance-lease principal)	Deal A FCCR on D3 E1 with ex-gains line

Source: CreditSwan definitions, as set out in this section · Basis: Definitions, not figures

Exhibit 9.06 — D5 cash bridge: twelve coded lines and three conversion ratios

Definition D5: the coded lines of the cash bridge and its conversion ratios

CODE	DEFINITION (ONE LINE)	HOW IT IS APPLIED
CF_CAPEX_MAINT	Maintenance capex; company splits [M]; otherwise per-clinic figure or clinic-equipment D&A proxy [I]	—
CF_DNWC	Change in NWC excluding supplier finance (CF_SCF); positive = outflow	Operator 1 OP1-8652/8653/8654 converted to the D5 sign
CF_TAX, CF_INT	Cash taxes; cash interest incl. finance-lease interest (PIK as memo)	Deal A interest paid FY17/FY18 at the FY2019 10-K reclassified values
CF_LFCF_PRE	EBITDA − maintenance capex − ΔNWC − tax − interest − scheduled amortisation and finance-lease principal	Labelled "LFCF before growth and before ΔNWC" where ΔNWC is excluded
CF_CAPEX_GROWTH … CF_DIST; CF_LFCF_POST	Growth capex, acquisitions, integration, earn-outs, SLB proceeds, distributions; change in net debt before financing	—
CONV_1 / CONV_2 / CONV_3	(EBITDA − maintenance capex) ÷ EBITDA; also less ΔNWC; CF_LFCF_PRE ÷ EBITDA; BUILD tag when openings or acquisitions exceed 9% of the clinic base	Deal B CONV_1 on post-audit E3 (0.46), Accounting Firm 2 draft 0.62 as memo

Source: CreditSwan definitions, as set out in this section · Basis: Definitions, not figures

Exhibit 9.07 — D6 volume and D7 price, ticket and mix: revenue growth is never read as volume, and ticket is read as price only with a documented price action

Definitions D6 and D7: volume, price, ticket and mix measures

CODE	DEFINITION (ONE LINE)	HOW IT IS APPLIED
VOL_VISITS, VOL_INV, VOL_PHARM_UNITS, VOL_LABOR_HRS, VOL_WELL, VOL_VISITS_PER_STORE	Patient visits; patient invoices; pharmacy units; billed veterinarian hours; wellness exams; visits per average clinic, each tagged with clinic base	OP1-5180..5188 labelled "SL pharmacy units incl. clinic wholesale"
PRC_ARO, PRC_REV_PER_VISIT, PRC_ASP_PHARM, PRC_LABOR_RATE	Revenue ÷ patient invoices; revenue ÷ patient visits; pharmacy revenue ÷ units; professional-fee revenue ÷ billed hours	—
MIX_PHARM_SHARE, MIX_SERVICE_LINES, ATTACH_RATE	Pharmacy revenue share; service-line shares; service revenue per pharmacy ticket	—
Decomposition rule	(1 + revenue growth) = (1 + volume)(1 + ticket); ticket labelled "price" only with a documented price action or like-for-like unit price	—

Source: CreditSwan definitions, as set out in this section · Basis: Definitions, not figures

Exhibit 9.08 — D8 clinic base and D9 transactions: every row carries its scope; every multiple states standalone or synergised

Definitions D8 and D9: clinic-base scopes and transaction-multiple codes

CODE	DEFINITION (ONE LINE)	HOW IT IS APPLIED
D8 entity_scope	ALL / SURVIVOR / COMP / COHORT- / SEGMENT-; organic separated from acquired, opened and closed; otherwise POOLED and excluded from organic comparisons	SELLER prefix not applied; seller-period rows are flagged in notes
D9 TXN rows	Date, acquirer, target, clinics, price, EBITDA rung/period/basis, multiple, standalone vs synergised (mandatory), property, contingent consideration	Deal A acquisitions (DLA-010, 109 rows) carry price to sales (TXN_PRICE_TO_SALES), as the file gives no target EBITDA
D9 FIN rows	Tranche, size, pricing, maturity, covenants, leverage at close on each rung with denominator, later prints	Operator 2 Sponsor 1 at-close LV1 5.97× is row P5-S001

Source: CreditSwan definitions, as set out in this section · Basis: Definitions, not figures

Exhibit 9.09 — D10 cycle tags: seven environments, assigned by period end except twelve-month fiscal rows

Definition D10: the seven economic environments, their date spans and the assignment rule

CODE	DEFINITION (ONE LINE)	HOW IT IS APPLIED
PRE-GFC	Periods ending before Jul-2007	—
GFC	Jul-2007 – Jun-2009	—
EXP10-19	Jul-2009 – Feb-2020	—
COVID20	Mar-2020 – Dec-2020	—
REOPEN21	2021	—
INFL22-23	2022–2023	—
SOFT24-26	Jan-2024 – present	—
Rule	Tags by period end; each area's conclusion needs ≥3 independent operators and ≥2 environments or states that it cannot	Twelve-month DLA-FY and OP1-MAY-FY rows tagged by month majority (ties to the later environment): Deal A FY20 → EXP10-19, FY21 → COVID20, FY22 → REOPEN21, FY24 → INFL22-23; Operator 1 FY20 → EXP10-19; 1,041 rows

Source: CreditSwan definitions, as set out in this section · Basis: Definitions, not figures

D · Reading a reference

Every number carries an evidence tag, a basis flag where the basis matters and a reference that resolves from this package alone, in one of twelve forms, including public rows from PUB-0001 and public sources from PUB-101.

Every number in this document carries three things: a tag that says what kind of statement it is, a basis flag where the basis matters, and a reference that can be resolved from this package alone. The tag and the reference sit in square brackets after the number, as in `[F, DLA-5276]`. Each reference leads to a document Ares Credit Group supplied, to a public series, to a public source named with its address and the date it was read, or to a section printed here.

Evidence tags and basis flags

The tag separates what a document records from what a party asserts and from what we worked out. A fact [F] comes from a supplied or public original. A claim [M] is a statement by management or a sponsor, reported as such. An Ares Credit Group item [A] is a hypothesis or a model output of Ares Credit Group. An inference [I] is ours, and a computed figure among them also cites its computation note. An unresolved figure is tagged [U]. A figure from a public source takes its tag from the source we read (register row A-P1): [F] only from an original, [M] for a company's statement about itself, [I] for a figure we computed from public data, and [U] for a figure read only in a secondary report whose original could not be read, with the reporter named. A [U] figure never appears in a title, an In brief row or Part 01, and third-party estimates are not used. The basis flag separates what happened from what was adjusted or projected; a figure on one basis is not set against a figure on another without saying so.

Exhibit 9.10 — Five evidence tags say what kind of statement a number is, and a public figure takes its tag from the source read; three basis flags say whether it is actual, pro forma or projected

The tag stands first inside the square brackets that follow a number; the basis flag is given where it matters

MARK	KIND	MEANING	FOR A FIGURE FROM A PUBLIC SOURCE
[F]	Evidence tag	Documented fact from a supplied or public original	Read in an original: a filing, a release by the body concerned, a statistical table, the company's own page, or a review, complaint or job site's own published rating, count or posted term, with the site, sample and date named
[M]	Evidence tag	Management or sponsor claim	A company's statement about itself
[A]	Evidence tag	Ares Credit Group hypothesis or Ares Credit Group model output	Not used
[I]	Evidence tag	CreditSwan inference or calculation	A figure computed from public data, with its computation note (C-PUB-n), or our interpretation
[U]	Evidence tag	Unresolved; never in a title, an In brief row or Part 01	Read only in a secondary report whose original could not be read, with the reporter named
A	Basis flag	Actual	Every public row is actual: a value as published or as read on the date given
PF	Basis flag	Pro forma or adjusted	–
P	Basis flag	Proposal, forecast or underwriting	–

Source: CreditSwan conventions used throughout this document; register row A-P1 for public sources

The forms a reference takes

A reference takes one of the forms below. A supplied document is cited by its source ID or short name with the page, or with the tab and the cell range for a workbook. A fact row ID points to one recorded figure in the Evidence index, where the row gives the source document and the exact place the figure was read. A public row ID (PUB-0001 onwards) points to one figure read or computed from a public source, and a public source ID (PUB-101 onwards) to the source itself, whose address and date read are in Part 09 section E. Inside a bracket, references are separated by commas, and a semicolon separates the tag from the references and one group of references from the next (for example fact rows from a public series); where the evidence tag changes inside a bracket, the new tag is written before the references it governs.

Exhibit 9.11 — Twelve forms of reference, each resolving in a named section of this document, in a document Ares Credit Group holds or at a public address with the date it was read

The form a reference takes, an example as it appears in the text, what it points to and where it resolves

FORM	EXAMPLE	WHAT IT IS	WHERE IT RESOLVES
Supplied document with page	`DLB-024 p.1`	A document Ares Credit Group supplied, by source ID or short name, and the page	The document itself; its file name and date are in Part 09 section E
Supplied document with tab and range	`DLB-008 ISCF!CM72:CP72`	A workbook Ares Credit Group supplied, the tab and the cell or range	The workbook itself; its file name and date are in Part 09 section E
Public series	`BEA_PCEVETSVC_A:2009`	A public series and the period read; each series has a provider and a retrieval date	The public series table in Part 09 section E, with provider, address and retrieval date
Fact row ID	`DLA-5276`; also `A1-P5-003`, `A1-S002`, `P5-S001`; long form `DLB-003-000214`, `MULTI-000024`	One recorded figure: three capitals, a hyphen and four or five digits; rows added for a computation carry an area prefix; the long form carries the document number	The Evidence index (Part 09 section F; `data/[file]`), which gives the value, period, basis, tag, source document, locator and check status
Range of fact rows	`DLB-2018..2020`	Every row from the first to the last named	The Evidence index (Part 09 section F; `data/[file]`); the rows inside every range are listed in `data/[file]`
Several fact rows	`OP2-1176/1179/1182`	Each row named: OP2-1176, OP2-1179 and OP2-1182	The Evidence index (Part 09 section F; `data/[file]`), one entry per row
Source document ID	`DLA-024`	One supplied file: three capitals, a hyphen and three digits	The Sources table (Part 09 section E; `data/[file]`), which gives the short name, file name and date
Public row	`PUB-0001`	A figure read or computed from a public source: `PUB`, a hyphen and four digits	The Evidence index (Part 09 section F; `data/[file]`), public rows: the value, period, tag, public source and the place on the page
Public source	`PUB-161`	A public source: a filing, a release, a statistical table, a company page or a rating site: `PUB`, a hyphen and three digits, from PUB-101	The Sources table (Part 09 section E; `data/[file]`), public block: publisher and title, address, document date and the date read
Computation note	`note C-06`; `C-FIN-1`; `C-PUB-1`	A figure we calculated, with its sources, method and limits; C-FIN-n for the financing observations, C-PUB-n for public signals	Part 09 section G
Register row	`A-01`; `A-F1`; `A-P1`	An assumption, the value used and how far the headline moves with it; A-Fn for the Deal A financing model, A-Pn for public signals	Part 09 section A
Section or exhibit of this document	`Part 03 section A`	Another section, table or chart, named by part and section letter or by exhibit number	This document

Source: CreditSwan conventions used throughout this document; every example is a reference used in it

Check status

Each row of the Evidence index states how far the figure has been compared with its source, in one of six phrases; public rows use a seventh, for a figure read in a secondary report. Most rows are single reads, and the index says so row by row; the number of rows at each status is given in Part 09 section F. A row that stands for a range of rows shows how many of its rows are at each status. A single read is a figure taken from the cited place once: it is evidence, and it has not been confirmed by a second reading.

Exhibit 9.12 — Seven check-status phrases say how far each recorded figure has been compared with its source; the seventh applies to public rows only

The phrase as it appears in the Evidence index and what it means

CHECK STATUS	MEANING
Read once from the source	The value was read from the cited document a single time. It has not been compared with the source again
Re-read from the cited cell or page: agrees	The cited cell or page was read again and gives the value recorded
Checked a second time against the source	The figure was read or calculated a second time from the source, separately from the first reading, and the two agree
Sources differ; the text says which is used	Two sources give different values for the same item. Both are recorded, and the text states which one it uses

CHECK STATUS	MEANING
Differs from the cited source; see the note	The value recorded is not the value at the cited place. The note against the row explains the difference
Could not be checked against the source	The cited document or place could not be read again. The value stands as first recorded
Read in a secondary report; the original could not be read	Public rows only. The figure was read in a report by a third party, named in the text, and the original it reports could not be read. The row is tagged [U]

Source: CreditSwan conventions used in the Evidence index

Units and codes

Amounts are in USD millions unless stated. Definitions are CreditSwan's, and the definition and environment codes (D1.1, R-CASH, SOFT24-26, E1 to E6, LV1 to LV6 and the like) are defined in Part 09 section C. The ones met most often are these.

EBITDA is kept on named rungs: reported (E1: operating income plus depreciation, amortisation and impairment, with disposal gains shown separately where they sit inside it); adjusted (E2: quality-of-earnings or company-adjusted); pro forma (E3, including months before ownership; E4 where run-rate items are added); underwriting (E5: the lender's financing figure); and cash (E6: the top adjusted rung, E3 or E2 where no E3 exists, less the cash "one-time" costs that recur in three or more consecutive years). EBITDA rungs E1 to E6 and leverage rungs LV1 to LV6 are never compared across rungs without saying so.

Four-wall margins state the rebate treatment, before vendor rebates (D1.1) or after them (D1.2), and a rent code: cash rent (R-CASH), book rent (R-BOOK), operating-lease rent only with finance-lease cost below the line (R-OPONLY), before rent (R-NONE), or rent basis not stated (R-UNK). They are pooled across platforms only on R-CASH. Clinic bases are ALL, SURVIVOR or COMP.

Same-store sales on the common definition count clinics owned and open for thirteen months, on calendar months, with no seller-period data; the closure treatment is stated (closed clinics kept until closure, or survivors only, which is an upper bound).

Environments follow D10 (PRE-GFC, GFC, EXP10-19, COVID20, REOPEN21, INFL22-23, SOFT24-26), with fiscal-year rows tagged by the environment that holds the majority of their months.

E · Sources

The Sources table lists 198 entries for the supplied documents and Deal A's filings, and 149 public sources, each with its public address; the three live deals supply 57 of the 198 supplied documents.

Every source document cited in this report is listed once in the Sources table, under the ID used in the text. The table has 198 entries: 198 documents from the files Ares Credit Group supplied and one entry for Deal A's public filings.

Each row gives the ID (for example DLA-024), a short name, the file name as Ares Credit Group holds it with its folder, and the document date. Two further columns show use: whether the ID is cited in the text, and how many rows of the Evidence index (Part 09 section F) rest on the document. A document that is named only as the source of an index row or of a computation note (Part 09 section G) is listed too, so every source named anywhere in the evidence can be found here.

The three live deals supply 57 of the 198 documents: Deal B 24, Deal A 21 and Deal C 15. The general practice and preventive care comparators supply 99, led by Operator 1 with 31 and Operator 2 with 18. Emergency and specialty context supplies 23 and wellness clinic context 20. The first three letters of an ID name the group of files it belongs to.

Exhibit 9.13 — The three live deals supply 57 of the 198 source documents; Operator 1 is the largest single group with 31

Entries of the Sources table by the first three letters of the ID, count of documents; public sources in a second block

ID PREFIX	COMPANY	GROUP	DOCUMENTS
DLB	Deal B	Live deal	24
DLA	Deal A (including the Ares Credit Group model)	Live deal	21
DLC	Deal C	Live deal	15
OP1	Operator 1	General practice and preventive care comparator	31

ID PREFIX	COMPANY	GROUP	DOCUMENTS
OP2	Operator 2	General practice and preventive care comparator	18
OP8	Operator 8	General practice and preventive care comparator	13
OP5	Operator 5	General practice and preventive care comparator	12
OP3	Operator 3	General practice and preventive care comparator	10
OP4	Operator 4 and Operator 9	General practice and preventive care comparator	8
OP6	Operator 6	General practice and preventive care comparator	8
OP7	Operator 7 (with Operator 25 and one industry primer)	General practice and preventive care comparator	6
CO2	Emergency Operator 1, Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 5, Emergency Operator 2 and Emergency Operator 3	Emergency and specialty context	23
QLX	Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 and Wellness Clinic Operator 2	Wellness clinic context	20
SEC-PUBLIC	Deal A public filings (one entry)	Live deal, public	1
Supplied documents and the Deal A filings entry			**198**
PUB	Public sources: filings, releases, statistical tables, company pages, rating, complaint and job sites	Public sources, second block	149
Total			**348**

Source: data/[file] (348 entries), counted by ID prefix and block

Deal A's public filings are listed as one entry, not filing by filing. A fact row read from a filing carries the address of the filing page and the retrieval date in its own locator, so the single entry loses nothing.

The public series are not in the Sources table. There are 134, each with its provider, address and retrieval date, and they are listed in the exhibit that follows in this section.

In the markdown package the Sources table is the file `data/[file]`. In the HTML it is a sortable table in this section. Part 09 section D explains how an ID is read, and Part 09 section H states what the documents do not cover.

The first rows of the table, with the Deal A filings entry, show the form.

Exhibit 9.14 — Each supplied document is cited by one ID that resolves to its file name as Ares Credit Group holds it and its date; Deal A's public filings are one entry

First eight rows of the Sources table and the single entry for Deal A public filings; dates as recorded, year-month where the day is not stated

ID	SHORT NAME	FILE NAME AS ARES CREDIT GROUP HOLDS IT	DOCUMENT DATE	CITED IN THE TEXT	ROWS IN THE EVIDENCE INDEX
OP4-001	2024 Audit - Operator 9	Operator 4/2024 Audit - Operator 9 [file]	2025-01-28	yes	86
OP4-002	2025 Audit - Operator 9	Operator 4/2025 Audit - Operator 9 [file]	2026-04-27	yes	69
OP4-003	Operator 4 Audited Financials (2023 & 2024)	Operator 4/Operator 4 Audited Financials (2023 & 2024).pdf	2025-04-25	yes	31
OP4-005	Operator 4 IC Memo External vF	Operator 4/Operator 4_IC [file]	2026-06-15	yes	140
OP4-006	Operator 4: Financial Model (Spring 2026) vF	Operator 4/Financial Model (Spring 2026) [file]	2026-05	yes	5
OP4-007	Operator 4: Operator 4 HoldCo, LLC and Subsidiaries FY25 Financial Statements (FINAL SIGNED SEND)	Operator 4/Operator 4 HoldCo, LLC and Subsidiaries FY25 Financial Statements (FINAL SIGNED SEND).pdf	2026-04-30	yes	91
OP4-008	Operator 4: Operator 4 HoldCo, LLC and Subsidiary Q1 2026 Financial Statements	Operator 4/Operator 4 HoldCo, LLC and Subsidiary Q1 2026 Financial [file]	2026-05-14	yes	7

ID	SHORT NAME	FILE NAME AS ARES CREDIT GROUP HOLDS IT	DOCUMENT DATE	CITED IN THE TEXT	ROWS IN THE EVIDENCE INDEX
OP4-011	Operator 4: Project Golf - Market Study	Operator 4/Project Golf - Market [file]	2025-04	yes	0
SEC-PUBLIC	Deal A public filings (SEC EDGAR, CIK [removed])	[URL removed]	retrieved 2026-09-28	no	369

Source: data/[file] (198 entries in the first block)

Sources received on 1 October 2026

Sixty-two files arrived on 1 October 2026. Fifty-six are byte-identical to files already held and add nothing; the six that are new are registered under the IDs below, read in full and cited in the text by page, tab or cell; they enter the Sources table on the same terms as the earlier files, and the recapitalisation model (DLA-026) also carries rows in the Evidence index.

Exhibit 9.15 — Six source files received on 1 October 2026 were read: four on Deal A's financing, second round and current trading, and Deal B's and DBW's answers to Ares Credit Group's diligence questions

Registry ID, short name, file name as Ares Credit Group holds it with its folder, document date, what the document is and the evidence tag its figures carry; the other 49 files received that day are copies of files already held

ID	SHORT NAME	FILE AS ARES CREDIT GROUP HOLDS IT	DOCUMENT DATE	WHAT IT IS	TAG OF ITS FIGURES
DLA-026	Recapitalization Model v06	NEW FILES OCT 1/Deal A/Project Alpha - Recapitalization Model_2026.09.29.[file]	29 Sep 2026	Financing model of the proposed recapitalisation	[F] as modelled; projected figures (P)
DLA-027	FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis	NEW FILES OCT 1/Deal A/FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis 1755.46.[file]	3 Sep 2026 (file saved 25 Sep 2026)	The 119 second-round clinics: sales, profit, rent, lease expiry, cost to close	[F]
DLA-028	RPP P13 Wk vs Deal A Overview	NEW FILES OCT 1/Deal A/09282026_RPP P13 Wk vs Deal A Overview_Exec [file]	28 Sep 2026	Company slide: weekly pharmacy units against a retail-panel provider's index that includes Deal A	[M]
DLA-029	Project Charlie I-Chart	NEW FILES OCT 1/Deal A/Project Charlie [file]	No date on the document (file of 30 Sep 2026)	Sale-leaseback of 26 owned sites with a broker valuation	[F] as printed; [M] as a proposal
DLB-033	DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses	NEW FILES OCT 1/Deal B/DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence [file]	1 Oct 2026	Deal B's written answers on cohorts, markets, causes of lost visit count, closures and non-recurring items	[M]; [F] where tied to a data file
DLB-034	DBW Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses	NEW FILES OCT 1/Deal B/DBW Ares Credit Group Diligence [file]	30 Sep 2026	DBW's written answers on the rebrand, visit count, closures and clinic quartiles	[M]; [F] where tied to a data file

Source: The six files, read in full; registry of source files · Basis: Evidence tags as used in this document: [F] a figure read from a data file; [M] a company statement not tied to a data file; a company statement that ties to a data file is [F] with both references

Public sources

Public sources follow in a second block of the Sources table, under IDs from PUB-101. A public source is a filing, a release by the body concerned, a statistical table, a company's own page, or a rating, complaint or job site; its row gives the ID, the publisher and title, the address, the document date where stated and the date it was read where recorded. The block has 149 entries: 38 cited by ID in the text and 108 named only as the source of a public row in the Evidence index. Pages were read on 30 September 2026, except three Census Bureau and Office of Management and Budget datasets whose read date is not recorded and which carry their document dates, and the public series were retrieved on 28 September 2026; for a rating, a count or a posted price the value of record is the one read on the date given (Part 09 section H). In the markdown package the block sits in `data/[file]`, marked in its block column; in the HTML each address is a link.

Exhibit 9.16 — Every public source resolves to a public address and carries its document date, the date it was read, or both

First eight rows of the public block of the Sources table, as they stand in data/[file]; dates as recorded

ID	PUBLISHER	TITLE	ADDRESS	DOCUMENT DATE	DATE READ	CITED IN THE TEXT	ROWS IN THE EVIDENCE INDEX
PUB-101	Industry Research Firm 1	2026 Pet Owner and Clinic Visit Study (release 9 Apr 2026; media deck April 2026)	[URL removed]	9 Apr 2026	30 Sep 2026	yes	2
PUB-102	US House Committee on Energy and Commerce	E&C Advances 16 Bills to Full House (21 May 2026)	[URL removed]	21 May 2026	30 Sep 2026	yes	1
PUB-103	US Census Bureau	U.S. Imports by End-Use (annual workbook [file])	[URL removed]	annual workbook, data to calendar 2025	30 Sep 2026	yes	2
PUB-104	U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Current Population Survey (via FRED, Federal Reserve Bank of City 6)	Median usual weekly earnings, full-time wage and salary workers, veterinary technologists and technicians (Current Population Survey; FRED series LEU0254563900A), annual	[URL removed]	series last updated 28 Jan 2026	30 Sep 2026	yes	2
PUB-105	US Bureau of Labor Statistics (CPS) via FRED	Employed full time, wage and salary workers, veterinary technologists and technicians (Current Population Survey; FRED series LEU0254510500A), annual	[URL removed]	annual series, data to 2025	30 Sep 2026	yes	2
PUB-106	Pet Retailer 3, Inc.	Pet Retailer 3 Reports Second Quarter 2026 Results (Form 8-K, Exhibit 99.1, 20 Aug 2026)	[URL removed]	20 Aug 2026	30 Sep 2026	yes	2
PUB-107	Pet Retailer 1, Inc.	Pet Retailer 1 4th Quarter ... Annual Sales of $17.5 Billion (Form 8-K, Exhibit 99.1, 22 Sep 2026)	[URL removed]	22 Sep 2026	30 Sep 2026	yes	3
PUB-108	Deal A	Deal A Announces First Quarter Fiscal 2027 Financial Results (29 Jul 2026); Form 10-Q for quarter ended 27 Jun 2026	[URL removed]	29 Jul 2026	30 Sep 2026	yes	1

Source: data/[file], block "Public sources" (149 entries) · Basis: Public sources read on 30 September 2026, except three Census Bureau and Office of Management and Budget datasets whose read date is not recorded; public series retrieved on 28 September 2026 · Assumption: Register rows A-P1 and A-P2

Exhibit 9.17 — Deal A's filings supply 52 of 134 public series; the BLS CPI supplies 39% of the 13,809 observations (all retrieved 28 September 2026)

Public series and observations by provider, count; all retrieved 28 September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Public series: Deal A, Public Pet Health Co., Public Wellness Clinic Co. and Emergency Operator 6 filings (SEC EDGAR); BLS CPI-U, PPI and ECI; BEA NIPA; FRED (pets in U.S. households, Census MRTS, BEA services); Animal Health Trade Association releases; Animal Health Data Provider releases; all retrieved 28 September 2026 · Basis: Public data as published; five series are CreditSwan computations from Deal A filings

Public series anchor the pricing and volume tests (CPI-U veterinarian services, ECI wages, pets in U.S. households) and give Deal A a 27-year audited record that no private platform has [F, public series DLA_REV and DLA_OI, FY1996–FY2026]. The Public Pet Health Co., Public Wellness Clinic Co. and Emergency Operator 6 filings are context only.

Public series

There are 134 public series with 13,809 observations, all retrieved on 28 Sep 2026 [Exhibit 9.18]. Sixty of the series are read from Deal A's 10-K, 10-Q and 8-K filings and five are CreditSwan derivations from them; Deal A interest paid for FY17 and FY18 uses the FY2019 10-K reclassified values of $15.6m and $20.4m [public series DLA_INT_PAID, retrieved 28 Sep 2026].

Exhibit 9.18 — Deal A filings supply 52 of the 134 public series retrieved on 28 September 2026; the BLS CPI supplies 39% of observations

Public series and observations by provider family: count and share; all retrieved 28 September 2026

PROVIDER FAMILY	SERIES	OBSERVATIONS	RETRIEVAL ROUTE
Deal A SEC filings (10-K, 10-Q, 8-K; XBRL and text)	52	896	EDGAR (CIK [removed])

PROVIDER FAMILY	SERIES	OBSERVATIONS	RETRIEVAL ROUTE
CreditSwan derivations from Deal A filings [I]	5	119	computed from the Deal A series
Public Pet Health Co. SEC 10-K	18	95	EDGAR (CIK [removed])
BEA NIPA (PCE veterinarian services; pharmacy products)	16	1,984	BEA flat files
Animal Health Trade Association press releases (shipments, forecasts)	14	133	association releases
BLS CPI-U	11	6,395	LABSTAT flat files
Public Wellness Clinic Co. SEC filings	9	61	EDGAR (CIK [removed])
BLS PPI	5	1,516	LABSTAT flat files
BLS ECI	4	346	LABSTAT flat files
Animal Health Data Provider releases	4	13	press releases
FRED / pets in U.S. households	3	1,468	FRED CSV
FRED / Census MRTS (NAICS 3864)	2	716	FRED CSV
Emergency Operator 6 34-F	2	2	EDGAR (CIK [removed])
FRED / BEA (all pet services, context only)	1	86	FRED CSV
Total	**134**	**13,809**	

Source: public series retrieved 28 Sep 2026. Computation: providers grouped into families; series assigned to the family of their first observation; observations counted by family. The full series list with URLs, coverage and known traps is Exhibit 9.19

Public-series vintages

All 134 series were retrieved on 28 Sep 2026 from the providers' own files and releases (BEA and BLS flat files, SEC EDGAR, Animal Health Trade Association and Animal Health Data Provider press releases) or from FRED CSVs, which carry the providers' own data as redistributed by FRED; no third-party estimate is used [Exhibit 9.19, URL and Retrieved columns]. The known traps are that the FRED id DMVSRC1A027NBEA measures all pet services rather than veterinary care alone, that CPI SS62053 includes pet services other than veterinary care and its seasonally adjusted series equals the unadjusted series after 2003, that October 2025 CPI is blank, that no PPI or ECI for NAICS 6887 was found in public sources, and that the Animal Health Trade Association revises its "actuals" between releases (2018 retail-channel other-species shipments 18.2m vs 19.3m) [Exhibit 9.19, Known traps column]. Traps marked "(general note)" are general statements about a series, read once from the provider's documentation at retrieval [Exhibit 9.19]. Six Deal A lines are listed under two series IDs each (DLA_OI and DLA_OPER_INCOME, DLA_REV and DLA_SALES, DLA_GP and DLA_GROSS_PROFIT, DLA_IMPAIR and DLA_IMPAIR_LL, DLA_CAPEX and DLA_CAPEX_PPE, DLA_SCF and DLA_SCF_BAL), one read from the XBRL data and one from the filing text or a second tag; the two agree in every period both cover, and both are counted in the 134.

Exhibit 9.19 — 134 series, all retrieved on 28 September 2026; the traps sit in the CPI, PPI/ECI, FRED pet-services and Animal Health Trade Association families

Each public series: provider, series ID, address, coverage, frequency, observations and known traps; all retrieved 28 September 2026

SERIES_ID	WHAT IT MEASURES	PROVIDER	URL	RETRIEVED	COVERAGE (OBS)	KNOWN TRAPS
BEA_DTATRA_A	PCE quantity index: Pharmacy products	BEA	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1959-01 to 2025-12, Annual (57)	Goods line; pharmacy products on a service ticket may split goods/services (general note)
BEA_DTATRA_Q	PCE quantity index: Pharmacy products (quarterly)	BEA	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1959-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (237)	Goods line; pharmacy products on a service ticket may split goods/services (general note)
BEA_DTATRC_A	PCE: Pharmacy products (goods), current dollars	BEA	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1959-01 to 2025-12, Annual (57)	Goods line; pharmacy products on a service ticket may split goods/services (general note)
BEA_DTATRC_Q	PCE: Pharmacy products (goods), current dollars (quarterly)	BEA	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1959-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (237)	Goods line; pharmacy products on a service ticket may split goods/services (general note)
BEA_DTATRG_A	PCE price index: Pharmacy products	BEA	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1959-01 to 2025-12, Annual (57)	Goods line; pharmacy products on a service ticket may split goods/services (general note)

SERIES_ID	WHAT IT MEASURES	PROVIDER	URL	RETRIEVED	COVERAGE (OBS)	KNOWN TRAPS
BEA_DTATRG_Q	PCE price index: Pharmacy products (quarterly)	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1959-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (237)	Goods line; pharmacy products on a service ticket may split goods/services (general note)
BEA_DTATRX_A	PCE: Pharmacy products (goods), chained (2017) dollars	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2007-01 to 2025-12, Annual (19)	Chained 2017 $ only from 2007; annual updates revise history
BEA_DTATRX_Q	PCE: Pharmacy products (goods), chained (2017) dollars (quarterly)	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2007-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (69)	Chained 2017 $ only from 2007; annual updates revise history
BEA_PCEVETSVC_A	PCE quantity index: veterinarian services	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1722-01 to 2025-12, Annual (86)	Household spend at clinics; excludes shelter, breeder and owner-bought supplies (general note); annual updates revise history
BEA_PCEVETSVC_Q	PCE quantity index: veterinarian services (quarterly)	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1959-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (237)	Household spend at clinics; excludes shelter, breeder and owner-bought supplies (general note); annual updates revise history
BEA_DVMRRC_A	PCE: veterinarian services, current dollars	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1722-01 to 2025-12, Annual (86)	Household spend at clinics; excludes shelter, breeder and owner-bought supplies (general note); annual updates revise history
BEA_DVMRRC_Q	PCE: veterinarian services, current dollars (quarterly)	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1959-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (237)	Household spend at clinics; excludes shelter, breeder and owner-bought supplies (general note); annual updates revise history
BEA_DVMRRG_A	PCE price index: veterinarian services	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1722-01 to 2025-12, Annual (86)	Household spend at clinics; excludes shelter, breeder and owner-bought supplies (general note); annual updates revise history
BEA_DVMRRG_Q	PCE price index: veterinarian services (quarterly)	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1959-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (237)	Household spend at clinics; excludes shelter, breeder and owner-bought supplies (general note); annual updates revise history
BEA_DVMRRX_A	PCE: veterinarian services, chained (2017) dollars	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2007-01 to 2025-12, Annual (19)	Chained 2017 $ only from 2007; annual updates revise history
BEA_DVMRRX_Q	PCE: veterinarian services, chained (2017) dollars (quarterly)	BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2007-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (69)	Chained 2017 $ only from 2007; annual updates revise history
BYD_SSS	Emergency Operator 6 same-store sales change excluding foreign exchange	Emergency Operator 6 (SEC 40-F)	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2025-01 to 2025-12, Annual (1)	FY2025 only; one fewer selling day
BYD_SSS_Q	Emergency Operator 6 same-store sales change excluding foreign exchange (quarter)	Emergency Operator 6 (SEC 40-F)	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2025-10 to 2025-12, Quarterly (1)	FY2025 only; one fewer selling day
CIS20200004300001	ECI wages & salaries, private industry, healthcare practitioner and technical occupations	BLS ECI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2002-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (88)	No ECI for NAICS 6887 or veterinarians found in public sources; occupation group 42 / NAICS 72 proxy
CIU2010000430000I	ECI total compensation, private industry, healthcare practitioner and technical occupations	BLS ECI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2001-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (90)	No ECI for NAICS 6887 or veterinarians found in public sources; occupation group 42 / NAICS 72 proxy
ECI_VETOCC	ECI wages & salaries, private industry, healthcare practitioner and technical occupations	BLS ECI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2001-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (90)	No ECI for NAICS 6887 or veterinarians found in public sources; occupation group 42 / NAICS 72 proxy
CIU2028100000000I	ECI wages & salaries, private industry, other services (except public administration) industry	BLS ECI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2001-01 to 2026-06, Quarterly (90)	No ECI for NAICS 6887 or veterinarians found in public sources; occupation group 42 / NAICS 72 proxy
CUSR0000SA0	CPI-U All items (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1739-01 to 2026-08, Monthly (816)	Oct-2025 blank (BLS appropriations lapse)
CUSR0000SETC	CPI-U pet food and supplies (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1991-01 to 2026-08, Monthly (370)	Retail goods price, not in-clinic price (general note); Oct-2025 blank
CUSR0000SETC01	CPI-U Pharmacy products (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1992-01 to 2026-08, Monthly (372)	Retail goods price, not in-clinic price (general note); Oct-2025 blank
CUSR0000SS62053	CPI-U veterinarian services (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1967-01 to 2026-08, Monthly (632)	Includes pet services other than veterinary care (the pet-services series SS6205301 is not used); SA = NSA from 2004; Oct-2025 blank

SERIES_ID	WHAT IT MEASURES	PROVIDER	URL	RETRIEVED	COVERAGE (OBS)	KNOWN TRAPS
CUSR0000SS6205303	CPI-U veterinarian services: diagnosis and treatment (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2000-01 to 2026-08, Monthly (275)	Oct-2025 blank (BLS appropriations lapse)
CUUR0000SA0	CPI-U All items (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1686-01 to 2026-08, Monthly (1191)	Oct-2025 blank (BLS appropriations lapse)
CUUR0000SETC	CPI-U pet food and supplies (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1977-12 to 2026-08, Monthly (509)	Retail goods price, not in-clinic price (general note); Oct-2025 blank
CUUR0000SETC01	CPI-U Pharmacy products (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1739-03 to 2026-08, Monthly (691)	Retail goods price, not in-clinic price (general note); Oct-2025 blank
CUUR0000SS62053	CPI-U veterinarian services (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1739-03 to 2026-08, Monthly (699)	Includes pet services other than veterinary care (the pet-services series SS6205301 is not used); SA = NSA from 2004; Oct-2025 blank
CUUR0000SS6205302	CPI-U veterinarian services: preventive and wellness (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1977-12 to 2026-08, Monthly (509)	Oct-2025 blank (BLS appropriations lapse)
CUUR0000SS6205303	CPI-U veterinarian services: diagnosis and treatment (U.S. city average)	BLS CPI	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1997-12 to 2026-08, Monthly (298)	Oct-2025 blank (BLS appropriations lapse)
DMVSRC1A027NBEA	PCE: Pet services including veterinary (BEA DMVSRC)	FRED / BEA	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	1722-01 to 2025-12, Annual (86)	All pet services, not veterinary care alone ($349.0bn vs $238.5bn in 2025); use BEA_DVMRRC
PAS_SSS	Public Pet Health Co. consolidated same clinic sales	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]> (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-01 to 2025-12, Annual (10)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_SSS_AGN	Public Pet Health Co. Mobile Veterinary segment same clinic sales (FY2025 segmentation)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2023-01 to 2025-12, Annual (3)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_SSS_GROOM	Public Pet Health Co. Grooming segment same clinic sales	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]> (+3 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2020-12 to 2024-12, Annual (4)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_SSS_FRANCHISE_BRANDS	Public Pet Health Co. Franchise Brands segment same clinic sales (FY2025 segmentation)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2023-01 to 2025-12, Annual (3)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_SSS_MAINT	Public Pet Health Co. Preventive Care segment same clinic sales (Wellness Express + Operator 31 etc., old segmentation)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]> (+4 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-12 to 2024-12, Annual (7)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_SSS_PCG	Public Pet Health Co. Emergency, Specialty & Diagnostics segment same clinic sales	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]> (+4 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-12 to 2024-12, Annual (7)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_SSS_PLATFORM	Public Pet Health Co. Platform Services segment same clinic sales	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]> (+2 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-12 to 2022-12, Annual (5)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_SSS_RECAST2025	Public Pet Health Co. consolidated same clinic sales, as presented in FY2025 10-K (continuing ops, new segments)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2023-01 to 2024-12, Annual (2)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_SSS_TAKE5	Public Pet Health Co. Wellness Express segment same clinic sales (FY2025 segmentation)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2023-01 to 2025-12, Annual (3)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_AGN	Public Pet Health Co. Mobile Veterinary clinics (FY2025 segmentation)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]>	2026-09-28	2023-01 to 2025-12, Annual (3)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_GROOM	Public Pet Health Co. Grooming segment clinics	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	<[URL removed]> (+4 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2019-12 to 2024-12, Annual (5)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation

SERIES_ID	WHAT IT MEASURES	PROVIDER	URL	RETRIEVED	COVERAGE (OBS)	KNOWN TRAPS
PAS_STORES_COOP	Public Pet Health Co. company-operated clinics	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-12 to 2025-12, Annual (8)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_FRAN	Public Pet Health Co. franchised clinics	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-12 to 2025-12, Annual (8)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_FRANCHISE_BRANDS	Public Pet Health Co. Franchise Brands segment clinics (FY2025 segmentation)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2023-01 to 2025-12, Annual (3)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_INDEP	Public Pet Health Co. independently-operated clinics (boarding)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+4 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2019-12 to 2024-12, Annual (5)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_MAINT	Public Pet Health Co. Preventive Care segment clinics (old segmentation)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+4 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-12 to 2024-12, Annual (7)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_PCG	Public Pet Health Co. Emergency, Specialty & Diagnostics segment clinics	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+4 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-12 to 2024-12, Annual (7)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_PLATFORM	Public Pet Health Co. Platform Services segment clinics	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+4 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-12 to 2024-12, Annual (7)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_TAKE5	Public Pet Health Co. Wellness Express segment clinics (FY2025 segmentation)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2023-01 to 2025-12, Annual (3)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_TOTAL	Public Pet Health Co. total clinic count (all segments, all ownership models)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-01 to 2025-12, Annual (10)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PAS_STORES_TOTAL_RECAST2025	Public Pet Health Co. clinic count as presented in FY2025 10-K (continuing ops)	Public Pet Health Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2023-01 to 2024-12, Annual (2)	System-wide incl. franchisees; 2018 method change; 2025 resegmentation
PETHH_M12	Moving 12-month total pets in U.S. households	FRED / Census Bureau	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1970-12 to 2026-07, Monthly (572)	All pets, all household types; latest months preliminary
DLA_ACQ	Deal A payments to acquire businesses, net of cash acquired	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+8 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-03, Annual (27)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_ACQ_COSTS	Deal A acquisition-related costs expensed	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2015-03 to 2022-03, Annual (7)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_AMORT_INTANG	Deal A amortization of intangible assets	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_BUYBACK	Deal A share repurchases	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2022-03 to 2024-03, Annual (2)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_CAPEX	Deal A payments to acquire property, plant and equipment (capex; excludes acquisitions)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	Total PP&E capex; no maintenance/growth split; excludes acquisitions
DLA_CAPEX_PPE	Deal A payments to acquire PP&E (total capex; no maintenance/growth split)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+6 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-06, Annual (28)	Total PP&E capex; no maintenance/growth split; excludes acquisitions
DLA_CAPLEASE_AMORT	Deal A capital-lease asset amortization (pre-ASC 842; proxy for capital-lease principal, memo)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2019-03, Annual (10)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March

SERIES_ID	WHAT IT MEASURES	PROVIDER	URL	RETRIEVED	COVERAGE (OBS)	KNOWN TRAPS
DLA_CASH	Deal A cash and equivalents	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+1 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2003-03 to 2026-03, Annual (21)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_CFF	Deal A net cash from financing activities	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_CFI	Deal A net cash from investing activities	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_CFO	Deal A net cash provided by operating activities	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+6 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-06, Annual (28)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DA	Deal A depreciation and amortization (cash-flow statement add-back)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+6 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-06, Annual (28)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DEBT	Deal A funded debt excl. capital/finance leases (revolver, term, mortgage, notes)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+1 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2002-03 to 2026-03, Annual (21)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DEPR	Deal A depreciation (PP&E, incl. finance-lease assets where disclosed)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2010-03 to 2026-03, Annual (16)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DIVEST_PROCEEDS	Deal A proceeds from divestiture of wholesale/distribution business (incl. deferred proceeds)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+1 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2022-03 to 2026-03, Annual (4)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DIV_PAID	Deal A dividends paid	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DNWC_ACCR	Deal A change in accrued liabilities as tagged (positive = increase)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DNWC_AP	Deal A change in trade payables as tagged (positive = increase)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DNWC_AR	Deal A change in receivables as tagged (positive = increase)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DNWC_INV	Deal A (increase)/decrease in inventories as tagged (positive = increase in asset)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DNWC_OTHNC	Deal A change in other noncurrent assets as tagged	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DNWC_PREPAID	Deal A change in prepaid/other assets as tagged (positive = increase)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_DNWC_TAXPAY	Deal A change in accrued income taxes payable as tagged	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (16)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_E1_LESS_CAPEX_ACQ	Deal A E1 less total PP&E capex less acquisitions	CreditSwan [I] from Deal A SEC filings	‹[URL removed]› (+6 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-06, Annual (28)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_EBITDA_ADJ_PUB	Deal A OI + D&A + company-published non-GAAP pre-tax items (E2m reconstruction; Deal A does not publish adjusted EBITDA)	CreditSwan [I] from Deal A SEC filings	‹[URL removed]› (+1 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2023-03 to 2026-06, Annual (4)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March

SERIES_ID	WHAT IT MEASURES	PROVIDER	URL	RETRIEVED	COVERAGE (OBS)	KNOWN TRAPS
DLA_EBITDA_E1	Deal A EBITDA E1 = operating income + D&A + long-lived asset impairment (D3 rung E1; gains left in)	CreditSwan [I] from Deal A SEC filings	‹[URL removed]› (+6 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-06, Annual (28)	D3 E1 incl. impairment; gains inside E1 with ex-gains line
DLA_EBITDA_E1_MARGIN	Deal A E1 margin (E1 / sales)	CreditSwan [I] from Deal A SEC filings	‹[URL removed]› (+6 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-06, Annual (28)	D3 E1 incl. impairment; gains inside E1 with ex-gains line
DLA_EBITDA_E1_XG	Deal A EBITDA E1 excluding net gain/loss on disposal of assets (D3 memo E1 ex-gains)	CreditSwan [I] from Deal A SEC filings	‹[URL removed]› (+6 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-06, Annual (28)	D3 E1 incl. impairment; gains inside E1 with ex-gains line
DLA_FINLEASE_AMORT	Deal A amortisation of capital (finance) lease assets	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+1 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2002-03 to 2026-03, Annual (21)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_FINLEASE_INT	Deal A finance-lease interest expense	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2019-03 to 2026-03, Annual (7)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_FINLEASE_LIAB	Deal A capital (finance) lease and financing obligations, current + long-term	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+1 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2002-03 to 2026-03, Annual (21)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_FINLEASE_PRIN	Deal A finance-lease principal payments	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2019-03 to 2026-03, Annual (7)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_FINLEASE_ROU_AMORT	Deal A finance-lease ROU asset amortization	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2019-03 to 2026-03, Annual (7)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_GAIN_DISPOSAL	Deal A net gain (loss) on disposal of assets (positive = gain; inside operating income)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+7 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-06, Annual (28)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_GP	Deal A gross profit	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_GROSS_MARGIN	Deal A gross profit as % of sales (as reported; cost of sales incl. distribution & occupancy)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+16 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2007-04 to 2026-03, Annual (19)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_GROSS_PROFIT	Deal A gross profit (cost of sales includes distribution and occupancy)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_IMPAIR	Deal A impairment of long-lived assets held for use	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2017-03 to 2026-03, Annual (9)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_IMPAIR_LL	Deal A impairment of long-lived assets held for use	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2017-03 to 2026-03, Annual (9)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_INT_EXP	Deal A interest expense, net	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+1 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2002-03 to 2026-03, Annual (21)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_INT_PAID	Deal A interest paid, net (incl. capital/finance-lease interest)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-03, Annual (27)	FY17/FY18 at FY2019 10-K reclassified values
DLA_LEASE_COST_TOTAL	Deal A total lease cost (operating + finance + variable)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2019-03 to 2026-03, Annual (7)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_NONGAAP_ITEMS	Deal A non-GAAP pre-tax adjustment items (company adjusted net income reconciliation)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+2 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2023-03 to 2026-06, Annual (4)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March

SERIES_ID	WHAT IT MEASURES	PROVIDER	URL	RETRIEVED	COVERAGE (OBS)	KNOWN TRAPS
DLA_OI	Deal A operating income	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+6 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-06, Annual (28)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_OPER_INCOME	Deal A operating income	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_OPER_MARGIN	Deal A operating income as % of sales (as reported)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2007-04 to 2020-03, Annual (13)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_OPLEASE_CASH	Deal A operating cash flows from operating leases (cash rent)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2019-03 to 2026-03, Annual (7)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_OPLEASE_COST	Deal A operating lease cost (ASC 842, fixed)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2019-03 to 2026-03, Annual (7)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_OPLEASE_LIAB	Deal A operating lease liabilities, current + non-current	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2020-03 to 2026-03, Annual (7)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_PPE_PROCEEDS	Deal A proceeds from sale of PP&E	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-03, Annual (27)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_RENT	Deal A operating-lease rent expense (book, net of sublease)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+1 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2002-03 to 2026-03, Annual (23)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_RESTRUCT	Deal A restructuring charges	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2025-03 to 2026-03, Annual (1)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_REV	Deal A sales	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+6 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-06, Annual (28)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_SALES	Deal A sales (consolidated)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_SBC	Deal A share-based compensation (non-cash)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2009-03 to 2026-03, Annual (17)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_SCF	Deal A supplier-finance programme obligations outstanding	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2023-03 to 2026-03, Annual (4)	10-K balance differs from DLA-016/DLA-011
DLA_SCF_BAL	Deal A supplier finance program obligation, period-end balance	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2023-03 to 2026-03, Fiscal year-end balance (4)	10-K balance differs from DLA-016/DLA-011
DLA_SSS	Deal A comparable clinic sales change (as reported, not adjusted for days)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+16 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2005-03 to 2026-03, Annual (18)	Not days-adjusted (except _ADJ_DAYS); survivor base after FY26 closures; FY ends late March
DLA_SSS_ADJ_DAYS	Deal A comparable clinic sales change, adjusted for selling days (where stated)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+3 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2012-04 to 2025-03, Annual (4)	Not days-adjusted (except _ADJ_DAYS); survivor base after FY26 closures; FY ends late March
DLA_SSS_RETAIL	Deal A comparable clinic sales change, retail locations only	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2022-03 to 2023-03, Annual (1)	Not days-adjusted (except _ADJ_DAYS); survivor base after FY26 closures; FY ends late March
DLA_STORES_ADDED	Deal A company-operated clinics added during year (opened + acquired)	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+12 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-03, Annual (26)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March

SERIES_ID	WHAT IT MEASURES	PROVIDER	URL	RETRIEVED	COVERAGE (OBS)	KNOWN TRAPS
DLA_STORES_BOP	Deal A company-operated clinics open at beginning of year	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+12 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-03, Annual (26)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_STORES_CLOSED	Deal A company-operated clinics closed during year	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+12 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-03, Annual (26)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_STORES_EOP	Deal A company-operated clinics at fiscal year end	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+16 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2005-03 to 2026-03, Annual (18)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
DLA_TAX_PAID	Deal A income taxes paid, net	Deal A (SEC EDGAR)	‹[URL removed]› (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	1995-04 to 2026-03, Annual (27)	As first reported; fiscal year ends late March
MRTSSM4413USN	Retail sales: pet supplies, accessories and pharmacy retailers (NAICS 3864)	FRED / Census	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1992-01 to 2026-07, Monthly (369)	Includes general pet supply retailers; excludes NAICS 6887 and clinics (general note)
MRTSSM4413USS	Retail sales: pet supplies, accessories and pharmacy retailers (NAICS 3864)	FRED / Census	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1992-01 to 2026-07, Monthly (369)	Includes general pet supply retailers; excludes NAICS 6887 and clinics (general note)
PCU32621132621101	PPI industry: Animal health mfg - companion-animal pharmaceutical products	BLS PPI	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1974-01 to 2026-08, Monthly (555)	Manufacturer pharmacy price; input-cost proxy only
PCU441110441102	PPI industry: Specialty and referral hospitals - service labour and supplies	BLS PPI	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1999-12 to 2026-08, Monthly (286)	Referral-hospital pricing, not general practice; no NAICS 6887 PPI
PCU4413--4413–	PPI industry group: Pet supplies, accessories and pharmacy retailers (retail margin)	BLS PPI	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2001-12 to 2026-08, Monthly (266)	Retail-margin PPI, not a final price (general note)
PCU44134044134O	PPI industry: Pet pharmacy retailers (retail margin)	BLS PPI	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2003-12 to 2026-08, Monthly (232)	Retail-margin PPI, not a final price (general note)
AHDP_AVG_AGE_PET	Average age of dogs in U.S. households	Animal Health Data Provider	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2025-01 to 2025-01, Annual (1)	Labelled by release year; January snapshot
AHDP_AVG_AGE_LT	Average age of cats in U.S. households	Animal Health Data Provider	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2025-01 to 2025-01, Annual (1)	Labelled by release year; January snapshot
AHDP_AVG_AGE_LV	Average age of dogs and cats in U.S. households (dogs + cats)	Animal Health Data Provider	‹[URL removed]› (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2020-01 to 2025-01, Annual (6)	Labelled by release year; January snapshot
AHDP_PETS_HH	Dogs and cats in U.S. households	Animal Health Data Provider	‹[URL removed]› (+4 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2021-01 to 2025-01, Annual (5)	Labelled by release year; January snapshot
TRFVOLUSM227NFWA	Pets in U.S. households (all pets, all household types)	FRED / Census Bureau	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	1970-01 to 2026-07, Monthly (595)	All pets, all household types; latest months preliminary
TRFVOLUSM227SFWA	Pets in U.S. households, seasonally adjusted	FRED / Census Bureau	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2000-01 to 2026-07, Monthly (278)	All pets, all household types; latest months preliminary
AHTA_OE_LT	Clinic-channel feline parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-01 to 2025-12, Annual (11)	Actuals revised between releases (2018 retail other-species 18.2 vs 19.3); rows kept per release; no total retail-channel line
AHTA_OE_LT_FCST	Clinic-channel feline parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2018-01 to 2026-12, Annual (11)	Forecast (P); one row per release vintage

SERIES_ID	WHAT IT MEASURES	PROVIDER	URL	RETRIEVED	COVERAGE (OBS)	KNOWN TRAPS
AHTA_OE_PASS	Clinic-channel canine parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-01 to 2025-12, Annual (11)	Actuals revised between releases (2018 retail other-species 18.2 vs 19.3); rows kept per release; no total retail-channel line
AHTA_OE_PASS_FCST	Clinic-channel canine parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2018-01 to 2026-12, Annual (11)	Forecast (P); one row per release vintage
AHTA_OE_TRUCK	Clinic-channel other-species parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-01 to 2025-12, Annual (11)	Actuals revised between releases (2018 retail other-species 18.2 vs 19.3); rows kept per release; no total retail-channel line
AHTA_OE_TRUCK_FCST	Clinic-channel other-species parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2018-01 to 2026-12, Annual (11)	Forecast (P); one row per release vintage
AHTA_REPL_LT	Retail and online channel feline parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-01 to 2025-12, Annual (11)	Actuals revised between releases (2018 retail other-species 18.2 vs 19.3); rows kept per release; no total retail-channel line
AHTA_REPL_LT_FCST	Retail and online channel feline parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2018-01 to 2026-12, Annual (11)	Forecast (P); one row per release vintage
AHTA_REPL_PASS	Retail and online channel canine parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-01 to 2025-12, Annual (11)	Actuals revised between releases (2018 retail other-species 18.2 vs 19.3); rows kept per release; no total retail-channel line
AHTA_REPL_PASS_FCST	Retail and online channel canine parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2018-01 to 2026-12, Annual (11)	Forecast (P); one row per release vintage
AHTA_REPL_TRUCK	Retail and online channel other-species parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-01 to 2025-12, Annual (11)	Actuals revised between releases (2018 retail other-species 18.2 vs 19.3); rows kept per release; no total retail-channel line
AHTA_REPL_TRUCK_FCST	Retail and online channel other-species parasiticide shipments	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2018-01 to 2026-12, Annual (11)	Forecast (P); one row per release vintage
AHTA_TOTAL	Total U.S. parasiticide shipments (clinic + retail and online, all species)	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2017-01 to 2025-12, Annual (11)	Actuals revised between releases (2018 retail other-species 18.2 vs 19.3); rows kept per release; no total retail-channel line
AHTA_TOTAL_FCST	Total U.S. parasiticide shipments (clinic + retail and online, all species)	Animal Health Trade Association	‹[URL removed]› (+10 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2018-01 to 2026-12, Annual (11)	Forecast (P); one row per release vintage
PQL_SSS	Public Wellness Clinic Co. system-wide same-store sales growth	Public Wellness Clinic Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+9 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2013-10 to 2025-09, Annual (12)	Definition changed FY2021 and FY2025; refranchising FY2024-25
PQL_SSS_ST-59	Public Wellness Clinic Co. company-operated same-store sales growth	Public Wellness Clinic Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+8 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2012-10 to 2025-09, Annual (13)	Definition changed FY2021 and FY2025; refranchising FY2024-25
PQL_SSS_ST-59_RECAST	Public Wellness Clinic Co. company-operated SSS growth, recast (FY2025 definition)	Public Wellness Clinic Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2023-10 to 2024-09, Annual (1)	Definition changed FY2021 and FY2025; refranchising FY2024-25
PQL_SSS_FR	Public Wellness Clinic Co. franchised same-store sales growth	Public Wellness Clinic Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+8 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2012-10 to 2025-09, Annual (13)	Definition changed FY2021 and FY2025; refranchising FY2024-25

SERIES_ID	WHAT IT MEASURES	PROVIDER	URL	RETRIEVED	COVERAGE (OBS)	KNOWN TRAPS
PQL_SSS_FR_RECAST	Public Wellness Clinic Co. franchised SSS growth, recast (FY2025 definition)	Public Wellness Clinic Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2023-10 to 2024-09, Annual (1)	Definition changed FY2021 and FY2025; refranchising FY2024-25
PQL_SSS_RECAST	Public Wellness Clinic Co. system-wide SSS growth, recast (FY2025 definition)	Public Wellness Clinic Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2023-10 to 2024-09, Annual (1)	Definition changed FY2021 and FY2025; refranchising FY2024-25
PQL_STORES_ST-59	Public Wellness Clinic Co. company-operated wellness clinics, end of fiscal year	Public Wellness Clinic Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2015-10 to 2025-09, Annual (10)	Definition changed FY2021 and FY2025; refranchising FY2024-25
PQL_STORES_FR	Public Wellness Clinic Co. franchised wellness clinics, end of fiscal year	Public Wellness Clinic Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2015-10 to 2025-09, Annual (10)	Definition changed FY2021 and FY2025; refranchising FY2024-25
PQL_STORES_SYS	Public Wellness Clinic Co. system-wide wellness clinics, end of fiscal year	Public Wellness Clinic Co. (SEC)	‹[URL removed]› (+5 per-filing URLs)	2026-09-28	2015-10 to 2025-09, Annual (10)	Definition changed FY2021 and FY2025; refranchising FY2024-25
WPU552	PPI commodity: Veterinary care (partial)	BLS PPI	‹[URL removed]›	2026-09-28	2008-12 to 2026-08, Monthly (190)	No PPI for NAICS 6887 found in public sources; "partial" commodity PPI, believed referral-hospital-sourced (general note)

Source: public series retrieved 28 Sep 2026 (13,809 observations). The URL is that of the first observation, with the count of further per-filing URLs; coverage is the first to the last period (year-month), frequency and number of observations; known traps include the definitions in Part 09 section C

F · Evidence index

The Evidence index resolves every cited figure in 3,879 rows (3,296 fact rows, 206 ranges and 366 public rows), each with its period, basis, evidence tag, source and locator; in 145 fact rows two sources differ and the text says which is used.

Every fact row and every range cited in this report has one row in the Evidence index, and so has every figure cited from a public source. The index has 3,879 rows: 3,296 fact rows, 206 ranges and 366 public rows. A fact row cited only in the data shipped with a figure has its row too.

Each row gives the reference, company, period, the measure in plain words with its scope, the value, unit, basis (actual, pro forma or projection), the evidence tag, the source document with its ID, the locator (tab and cell, page or slide) and the check status.

Most rows are single reads, and the index says so. Of the 3,296 fact rows, 2,517 were read once from the source. A further 591 were read again at the cited cell or page and agree; 49 were checked a second time against the source. In 145 rows the sources differ and the text says which value is used. The source could not be checked for 13.

Exhibit 9.20 — Three in four cited fact rows rest on a single reading of the source; in 3.9% two sources differ and the text says which is used

Rows of the Evidence index by check status: count and share of the 3,296 fact rows, and count of the 366 public rows; the 206 range rows are shown separately

CHECK STATUS	FACT ROWS	SHARE OF FACT ROWS	PUBLIC ROWS
Read once from the source	2,517	65.3%	180
Re-read from the cited cell or page: agrees	591	15.6%	119
Checked a second time against the source	49	1.3%	71
Sources differ; the text says which is used	145	3.9%	0
Differs from the cited source; see the note	0	0.0%	0
Could not be checked against the source	13	0.3%	1
Read in a secondary report; the original could not be read	–	–	3
All fact rows and public rows	**3,296**	**86.4%**	**366**
Range rows (the status of a range counts the rows inside it)	206	–	–
All rows of the index	**3,879**		

Source: data/[file] (3,879 rows), counted by the check status column

Public rows follow the fact rows and ranges, under IDs from PUB-0001. Each names its public source, whose address and date read are in Part 09 section E, and the place on the page; its evidence tag is that of the source read (register row A-P1), and a figure computed from public data cites its note C-PUB-n. The index holds all 366 public rows; 370 of them are cited in the text and exhibits. Of the 366 public rows, 180 were read once from the source, 119 were read again at the cited page and agree, 71 were checked a second time against the source, 1 could not be checked against the source and 3 were read in a secondary report whose original could not be read; 258 are tagged [F], 26 [M], 82 [I] and 3 [U]. Every public row is an actual figure, as published or as read on the date given.

A range row stands for consecutive fact rows cited together, written DLB-2018..2020 in the text and DLB-2018..DLB-2020 in the index. It gives the measures, the period spanned and, for a short range, each value in order; its check status counts the rows inside by status. The file `data/[file]` lists every row inside each range.

Where a value is computed, the locator says so, names the rows or documents used and points to a computation note in Part 09 section G. A row that rests on a public series or filing gives the provider, the address and the retrieval date.

Values are shown as recorded: money in USD thousands (public rows keep the unit of their source), counts as integers, multiples as "x", and a ratio as a ratio, so 14.0% appears as 0.144 with the unit saying so. One row holds one value. A computed value has its own row, a company's own figure is never overwritten, and where two sources differ both rows are kept.

The Evidence index is a selection of the figures recorded for this document. For the sector assessment 45,534 figures are recorded: 46,665 read from source documents, 5,098 of them in the Deal A files (the Operator 1 files add 21 Deal A figures), and 717 added: 717 for the eight areas, computed or read from further files, and 2 read from Ares Credit Group's investment memos. A further 8,338 Deal B and 4,431 Deal C figures were read from those companies' own documents; 737 and 282 of these fall in seller periods [note C-01].

In the markdown package the index is `data/[file]`. In the HTML it is a sortable table in this section. Part 09 section D explains how a reference is read, and Part 09 section H states the limits of the evidence.

Exhibit 9.21 — Every cited figure has one row in the Evidence index giving its value, unit, period, basis, evidence tag and locator: a cell, a page, a filing, a computation note, a range or a public page

Rows as they stand in the index; values as recorded, with the unit in its own column

REFERENCE	COMPANY	PERIOD	MEASURE	VALUE	UNIT	BASIS	EVIDENCE TAG	SOURCE DOCUMENT	LOCATOR	CHECK STATUS
OP5-0640	Operator 5	Twelve months to 31 Mar 2023	Clinic count (consolidated)	38	count	A	F	OP5-011 Operator 5: Project Juliet Operating Model 6.25.2023 vBuyer	Cons. IS - With New Clinics!G107	Re-read from the cited cell or page: agrees
DLC-0001	Deal C	Year to 31 Dec 2025	Net revenue (consolidated)	126811.953	USD thousands	A	F	DLC-014 Deal C: Mike - 2025 Audit	p.6 (printed p.4) Consolidated Statement of Operations; Net Sales 2025 column	Read once from the source
DLA-0073	Deal A	Year to 31 Mar 2019	Operating income, as reported (consolidated)	110981	USD thousands	A	F	Deal A public filings (SEC EDGAR)	[URL removed] (retrieved 2026-09-28)	Read once from the source
A1-P5-010	Core general practice and preventive care operators (pooled)	1 Jan 2021 to 31 Dec 2021	Median comparable-clinic traffic growth across operators, by economic environment (pooled platform years)	0.0354	ratio (1.00 = 100%)	A	I	Computed from the rows named	Computed from rows DLA-0661, OP5-3875; see note C-06	Read once from the source
DLA-0048	Deal A	Year to 31 Mar 2023	Gross margin percentage, as printed or computed from the source (consolidated)	0.293253	ratio (1.00 = 100%)	A	I	Deal A public filings (SEC EDGAR)	Computed from figures in the source document; see note C-25	Read once from the source

REFERENCE	COMPANY	PERIOD	MEASURE	VALUE	UNIT	BASIS	EVIDENCE TAG	SOURCE DOCUMENT	LOCATOR	CHECK STATUS
DLC-006-000205	Deal C	Year to 31 Dec 2024	Same-store sales growth, company definition (consolidated)	0.056570	ratio (1.00 = 100%)	A	M	DLC-006 Deal C: Mike - KPI Data Pack	SSS Summary - Total!S68	Re-read from the cited cell or page: agrees
DLB-003-000214	Deal B	Twelve months to 31 Jul 2026	Four-wall EBITDA, company definition (cohort:2022)	1556.08775	USD thousands	A	M	DLB-003 Deal B: Project Bravo - DLB Datapack (Jul-26 RF)	4-Wall EBITDA!G10:AW126	Read once from the source
DLB-2018..DLB-2020	Deal B	1 Apr 2022 to 31 Mar 2023	visit count change, first months after acquisition versus before; Change in sales, after versus before acquisition; Change in revenue per visit, after versus before acquisition	-0.094024; 0.014509; 0.102906	ratio (1.00 = 100%)	A	I	DLB-032 Deal B: Project Bravo KPI Details (incl. Pre-Acq)	Visit Count (incl. Pre-Acq)!D9:KL125, Sales by Month (incl. Pre-Acq)!D9:KL125 (pre); Visit Count (excl. Pre-Acq)!D9:BM125, Sales by Month (excl. Pre-Acq)!D9:BM125 (post)	3: Read once from the source
DLA-5276	Deal A	Year to 31 Mar 2027	Estimated cash cost of closing clinics (consolidated)	31076	USD thousands	P	M	DLA-021 Deal A: Project Alpha CIP Clinic Closures	p.1 "Potential to Be More Proactive on Additional Clinic Closures" ("~$31mm one-time cash closing costs")	Sources differ; the text says which is used
P5-S001	Operator 2	At 5 Sep 2021	First-lien debt to EBITDA, gross (financing: 2021 09 Sponsor 1 LBO)	5.97	multiple (x)	PF	I	OP2-023 Operator 2 (fka GB Vet) - DDTL Upsize Investment vF	p.19 tearsheet; see note C-74	Checked a second time against the source
PUB-0001	(sector)	calendar 2025	Corporate-group share of veterinary visits (owner survey)	25	%	A	F	PUB-101	release body; media deck page 4	Read once from the source

Source: data/[file] (3,879 rows); rows chosen to show each form of reference and locator

Basis A accounts for 26,602 rows (51.0%), PF for 12,943 (23.8%) and P for 6,341 (12.1%) [note C-01, count by basis; shares computed]. Of these figures, 337 (0.6%) were checked a second time against the source, 1,329 are rows where two sources differ (both values kept; the text says which is used), 381 could not be checked against the source and 44,924 were read once from the source [note C-01, count by check status].

Exhibit 9.22 — Operator 1, Emergency Operator 2 and Deal A files account for 38% of the 45,534 figures recorded for the sector assessment at September 2026; 51% of all figures are actuals

Figures recorded for the sector assessment by source group, basis and check status: count

SOURCE GROUP (ROW ID PREFIX)	A	PF	P	TOTAL	CHECKED A SECOND TIME AGAINST THE SOURCE	SOURCES DIFFER	COULD NOT BE CHECKED AGAINST THE SOURCE	READ ONCE FROM THE SOURCE
OP1 (Operator 1; incl. Operator 29, Deal A rows read from Operator 1 files)	7,485	661	1,976	9,945	47	196	23	9,795
COR (Emergency Operator 2)	1,200	3,665	562	5,500	11	104	31	5,084
DLA (Deal A)	3,994	283	857	5,098	12	149	69	4,921
OP5 (Operator 5)	2,647	1,970	111	4,807	10	54	3	4,701
OP2 (Operator 2; incl. seller chains)	2,176	1,558	410	4,046	14	103	21	3,969
OP8 (Operator 8)	1,104	1,020	333	2,478	10	256	18	2,131
OP3 (Operator 3)	1,385	510	371	2,192	10	32	103	2,132
QL1 (Wellness Clinic Operator 1)	1,205	370	374	1,919	10	50	3	1,922
OP6 (Operator 6)	710	675	500	1,801	11	62	4	2,039

SOURCE GROUP (ROW ID PREFIX)	A	PF	P	TOTAL	CHECKED A SECOND TIME AGAINST THE SOURCE	SOURCES DIFFER	COULD NOT BE CHECKED AGAINST THE SOURCE	READ ONCE FROM THE SOURCE
QLF (Wellness Clinic Franchisor)	1,182	399	241	1,793	10	99	18	1,979
OP4 (Operator 4 and Operator 9)	857	339	255	1,432	163	54	62	1,149
OP7 (Operator 7)	869	311	140	1,371	10	82	4	1,224
CO3 (Emergency Operator 3)	447	752	165	1,314	10	42	11	1,283
CO1 (Emergency Operator 1, Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 5)	656	252	34	964	10	51	9	896
QL2 (Wellness Clinic Operator 2)	512	111	329	964	10	23	0	944
Rows added for the eight areas, computed or read from further files (IDs A1- to A8-)	650	71	15	717	16	0	2	716
Rows read from Ares Credit Group's investment memos (IDs P5-S)	1	1	0	2	1	0	0	1
Total	**26,602**	**12,943**	**6,341**	**45,534**	**337**	**1,329**	**381**	**44,924**

Source: note C-01. Computation: prefix of the row ID (rows computed by area, `A<n>-…`, grouped), cross-tabulated against basis and check status. A source group can hold rows about other companies read from its files (the OP1 group holds 43 Operator 29 and 21 Deal A rows; the OP4 group holds 296 Operator 9 rows), so group totals differ from the company totals in Exhibit 9.31. Deal B and Deal C have 34 and 27 rows here (rows computed by area plus one row each in the Operator 7 group); the 8,338 Deal B and 4,431 Deal C rows read from their own documents are outside this table

By cycle tag, the figures fall 16,426 in SOFT24-26, 12,297 in EXP10-19, 9,718 in INFL22-23, 3,437 in REOPEN21, 2,780 in COVID20, 755 in GFC and 111 in PRE-GFC, with 3 rows carrying no tag: the Deal A rows A6-P5-011 and A6-P5-012, cumulative figures for FY2010 to FY2026 that span five environments, and QL1-1916, a March 1995 clinic count of Wellness Clinic Operator 1's predecessor, wellness clinic context, which falls before July 2007 and so in PRE-GFC under the rule but is recorded without a tag [note C-01, count by environment]. The cycle tags apply the month-majority rule to 1,041 twelve-month Deal A and Operator 1 fiscal-year rows (Deal A FY20 → EXP10-19, FY21 → COVID20, FY22 → REOPEN21, FY24 → INFL22-23; Operator 1 FY20 → EXP10-19) [Part 09 section C, Exhibit 9.09].

G · Computation notes

Every figure we calculated is documented with its sources, method, where it is shown and its limits, in notes C-01 to C-106, the C-FIN notes on financing, C-PUB-1 to C-PUB-16, C-120 to C-122 and C-V2-1 to C-V2-6, or in the calculations stated in full.

A computation note is the record behind a figure that we calculated rather than read from a document. Wherever the text, a table or a chart gives such a figure, its reference reads `note C-nn` and resolves to the note of that number below; the notes behind the financing observations read `C-FIN-n`, those behind the public signals `C-PUB-n`, and those on the files received on 1 October 2026 `C-V2-n`. Each note states what was computed, the sources it draws on, how the calculation was made, where in this document the result is shown, and the limits that apply to it. Sources are named by source-document ID, fact-row ID or public series, which resolve in Part 09 section E and Part 09 section F; the forms are explained in Part 09 section D. The notes follow the order of the eight areas of the brief, then the benchmark and the three deals, then notes for exhibits outside that order (C-93 onwards), the financing notes, the public-signal notes, the calculations stated in full, and the notes on the industry exhibits and on the files of 1 October 2026 (C-120 to C-122, C-V2-1 to C-V2-6).

C-01 · Counts that describe the evidence base

What was computed. The counts quoted for the evidence behind this document: source files and folders, figures recorded for this document by operator, by basis, by evidence tag and by economic environment, and the number of public series and observations.

Sources. The register of source files supplied by Ares Credit Group, one row per unique file, with its registry ID, folder and group; the figures recorded for this document, one row per figure read from a document or computed; the public series, retrieved on 28 September 2026 from BEA, BLS and the Census Bureau (via FRED), an animal health manufacturers' association, an industry pet ownership survey, and the SEC filings of Deal A, Public Wellness Clinic Co., Public Pet Health Co. and Emergency Operator 6.

How. All figures are simple counts. Source files: rows of the register counted in total (266) and by folder (13 folders); the three live-deal folders hold 62 files (Deal A 21, Deal B 28, Deal C 16) and the ten comparator folders 190. Evidence rows: rows counted in total (59,863) and by the operator prefix

of the row ID; Deal B rows (prefix DLB) number 8,338 and Deal C rows (prefix DLC) 4,431, which leaves 45,534 rows behind the sector assessment. By basis, counted on the basis field: 33,479 actual (A), 17,390 pro forma or adjusted (PF) and 8,865 projection or proposal (P). By evidence tag, counted on the tag field: 24,801 documented fact (F), 18,815 management or sponsor claim (M), 12,166 our inference or calculation (I), 2,164 Ares Credit Group view (A) and 61 unresolved (U). By environment, counted on the environment field: 27,762 in the soft period from 2024 (SOFT24-26), 12,453 in the 2009 to 2020 expansion (EXP10-19), 11,556 in the 2022 to 2023 inflation period (INFL22-23), 3,577 in the 2021 reopening (REOPEN21), 2,826 in the COVID period (COVID20), 765 in the financial crisis (GFC), 135 before it (PRE-GFC) and 3 with no environment; the chart of actuals by operator and environment counts rows with basis A by the company field and the environment field. Public series: 134 distinct series IDs and 13,809 observations; each series is assigned to the provider of its first row, which gives 52 series from Deal A's filings plus 5 derived from them, and the BLS consumer price series hold 6,395 observations.

Where shown. Exhibit 1.15; Exhibit 9.23; Exhibit 1.18; Exhibit 9.17; Exhibit 1.16; Exhibit 9.31; Part 09 section F; Exhibit 9.18; the text of Part 01 section F and of Part 09 section I under 01 F.

Limits. A count of rows measures how much was recorded, not how strong it is: counts include every measure, so a non-zero cell does not by itself mean an operating series exists. The sector assessment quotes basis, tag and environment counts on its 45,534 rows, and the evidence-base section (Part 01 section F) on all 59,863, so the two sets of figures differ. The count of industry-report claims shown in Exhibit 9.24 is described with that exhibit in Part 09 section H.

C-02 · Volume consistency: how the area was measured

What was computed. The general method behind the volume section. It covers patient visits, patient invoices, pharmacy units and labour hours at the general practice and preventive operators from 2006 to mid-2026, with wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals as context in Part 04 section G, and public industry volume from 2000 to 2025 (quarterly to the second quarter of 2026).

Sources. The clinic-level databases, KPI files, diligence databooks and lender materials of Operator 2 and its acquired chains Operator 10, Operator 14, Operator 16 and Operator 12 (OP2), Operator 5 (OP5), Operator 1 (OP1), Deal A (DLA), Operator 3 (OP3), Operator 6 (OP6), Operator 8 (OP8), Operator 7 (OP7), Deal C (DLC) and Deal B (DLB); for context, the Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 files (QLX) and the Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 5 and Emergency Operator 2 files (CO2). Public series: BEA real spending on veterinary services and pharmacy quantity; pets in U.S. households; an animal health manufacturers' association's preventive product shipments; an industry pet ownership survey's pet age and pets in households; Census retail sales of pet supplies, accessories and pharmacy products; Deal A's SEC filings for comparable-clinic sales.

How. Volume is measured in the unit each operator records: pet visits (VOL_VISITS), patient invoices or tickets (VOL_INV), retail pharmacy units (VOL_PHARM_UNITS), billed labour hours (VOL_LABOR_HRS) and, for wellness clinics, wellness exams (VOL_WELL). Growth is taken on the common same-store base, in which a clinic counts in a month only if it was owned and open in every month from twelve months earlier (D2.1); the result is comparable traffic growth (SSS_TRAFFIC_CD), and every series states its clinic base: all clinics (ALL), clinics still open at the file date (SURVIVOR), the comparable base (COMP) or an acquisition cohort (COHORT). Revenue growth is never read as volume growth; where an operator has only revenue for a period (Deal A's public comparable sales, Operator 5 average daily sales) the figure is shown as a labelled revenue cross-check. Only actual results enter a statistic: projections are excluded, and pro forma or company-defined series (Deal C, Deal B, seller months at Operator 3, Emergency Operator 2) are shown on their own and kept out of pooled figures. Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are separate context blocks and are never pooled with the general practice and preventive operators. Each figure is placed in one of seven economic environments by the date its period ends: before July 2007 (PRE-GFC), the financial crisis from July 2007 to June 2009 (GFC), the expansion from July 2009 to February 2020 (EXP10-19), the COVID period from March to December 2020 (COVID20), the 2021 reopening (REOPEN21), the 2022 to 2023 inflation period (INFL22-23) and the soft period from January 2024 (SOFT24-26); twelve-month fiscal years of Deal A (April to March) and Operator 1 (June to May) go to the environment that holds most of their months, and a tie goes to the later one. A characteristic is called durable only if it is seen at three or more independent operators and in two or more environments; where that test is not met the text says so.

Where shown. The text of Part 03 section A and of Part 09 section J under 03 A.

Limits. Only Operator 10 and Operator 1 have operator volume through the financial crisis; the Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6 and Deal C bases hold surviving clinics only, so their history omits closed clinics; Operator 1 has no volume data after November 2017 and Operator 4 and Operator 9 have none. The method states a numeric test for "durable" only; "temporary" and "company-specific" are readings of whether an effect is confined to one environment or one operator.

C-03 · Comparable-clinic volume growth and chained index by operator and year

What was computed. Year-on-year growth in comparable-clinic volume (patient visits, patient invoices, tickets, pharmacy units or labour hours) for each operator with a usable series, and an index that chains those growth rates from a base year of 86. Core operators are Operator 2 (Operator 10,

Operator 14, Operator 16, Operator 12 and the consolidated owned period), Operator 5, Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8 and Operator 7, 2006 to mid-2026; Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 5 and Emergency Operator 2 are carried as wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital context.

Sources. OP2-007, Operator 2 historical clinic KPI workbook (Operator 10, Operator 16, Operator 12); OP2-003, Operator 14 clinic KPI workbook; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook (June 2021); OP5-008, Operator 5 clinic volume trends 2017 to June 2023; OP1-021 and OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic-level P&L workbooks; DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report FY20 to Q1 FY27; OP3-003, Operator 3 clinic-month datacube; OP6-009, Operator 6 visit count file; OP8-007 and OP8-010, Operator 8 volume file and databook; OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook; QLX-005 and QLX-013, Wellness Clinic Franchisor clinic KPI files; QLX-029, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 clinic performance trends; CO2-008, CO2-012 and CO2-022, Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 5 and Emergency Operator 2 materials. Fact rows include OP2-0649 to OP2-0679 (Operator 10), OP2-3521, OP2-3526, OP2-3532 (Operator 2 consolidated), OP2-0218 to OP2-0222 (Operator 14), OP5-3863 to OP5-3881 (Operator 5), OP1-2139 to OP1-2149 and OP1-5162 to OP1-5188 (Operator 1), DLA-0597 to DLA-0829 (Deal A), OP3-0887 to OP3-0909 (Operator 3), OP6-1896 to OP6-1960 (Operator 6), CO1-0958 to CO1-1067 and COR-4133 to COR-4151 (emergency and specialty hospitals).

How. For each operator the clinic base is the comparable base: a clinic counts in a month only if it was owned and open in every month from twelve months earlier (the common same-store definition, D2.1); where only annual clinic data exist, the clinic must be owned and open for the whole of both years. Growth = volume in the period on that base ÷ volume of the same clinics a year earlier − 1 (comparable traffic growth, SSS_TRAFFIC_CD). The index starts at 86 in the year before the first growth figure and is chained: index(t) = index(t−1) × (1 + growth(t)). Each series carries its closure treatment: closed clinics leave the base only from the month of closure (CLOSE-FWD) or the file holds only clinics still open, so closed clinics are missing from every year (CLOSE-RETRO; Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Emergency Operator 2). Only actual results are used; projections and pro forma series are excluded, and for Operator 10 one clinic whose visit count duplicates another clinic's from February 2008 to July 2011 is left out of those comparisons.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.35; Exhibit 9.33; Exhibit 9.94; Exhibit 4.18; Exhibit 4.11.

Limits. Chaining year-on-year rates across a base that changes each year is an approximation, and the survivor-only series overstate history where the closed clinics were weak; Deal A comparable traffic on an all-clinic base is not available.

C-04 · Size of each volume downturn and the recovery that followed

What was computed. For three episodes (the 2007–09 financial crisis, COVID in 2020, and 2022 to 2026) the fall in volume at each operator with data, the trough period and what happened afterwards. It covers Operator 2, Operator 1, Operator 5, Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8, Operator 7, Deal C and Deal B, with Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Emergency Operator 5 and Emergency Operator 2 as context.

Sources. DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report; OP2-007 and OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic KPI workbook and clinic-level databook; OP5-008, OP5-001 and OP5-012, Operator 5 volume trends and monthly sales series; OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic P&L 2007–2014; OP1-033, Operator 1 2021 investment committee memo (April 2020 comparable sales for Operator 1 and Deal A); OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; OP6-009, Operator 6 visit count file; OP8-010, Operator 8 databook; OP7-005, Operator 7 databook; DLC-015, Deal C visit count and average patient invoice file; DLB-024, Deal B same-store visit count support; QLX-005, QLX-013, QLX-029 and QLX-033, Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 files; CO2-012 and CO2-022, Emergency Operator 5 and Emergency Operator 2; Deal A public filings for comparable-clinic sales. Fact rows include OP2-0649 to OP2-0658, OP2-3509 to OP2-3532, OP1-2139 to OP1-2143, OP5-5409, OP5-5411, OP5-3871 to OP5-3879, DLA-0597 to DLA-0829, OP3-0891, OP3-0907, OP6-1952, OP6-1960, A1-S002 to A1-S004, A1-S037 to A1-S039, CO1-1063, CO1-1065, COR-4127 to COR-4151. Public series: BEA real veterinary services spending.

How. The drawdown is the comparable-clinic volume growth reported for the trough period, or, where the fall runs over more than one year, the chained figure: (1 + growth in year 1) × (1 + growth in year 2) × … − 1. Recovery is read from the growth rates that follow and, where stated, from the chained level against the pre-episode year (for example Operator 5 2022 against 2019 = (1 + 2020 growth) × (1 + 2021 growth) × (1 + 2022 growth)). Where an operator has no volume data for the episode, a revenue measure is shown instead and labelled as revenue (Operator 5 average daily sales in 2009, Deal A public comparable sales, Operator 1 and Deal A April 2020 comparable sales). Deal C and Deal B figures are on each company's own comparable definition and are labelled as such. The industry rows use peak-to-trough change in the BEA real veterinary services index.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.34; the text of Part 03 section A and of Part 09 section J under 03 A; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. Only Operator 10 and Operator 1 have volume data through the financial crisis, and the drawdowns sit on different clinic bases and volume measures, so they are not a ranking.

C-05 · Change in total volume and volume per clinic over each operator's longest window

What was computed. For 20 volume-level series (patient visits, tickets, pharmacy units or patient invoices, in total and per clinic) the first and last values, the total change and an annual rate. Operators are Operator 2 (Operator 10 and consolidated), Operator 5, Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8 and Operator 7, with Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Emergency Operator 2 and Emergency Operator 4 as context; windows run from FY08 at the earliest to mid-2026.

Sources. OP2-007, Operator 2 clinic KPI workbook; OP2-013 and OP2-018, Operator 2 2020 incremental investment memo and 2021 situation update; OP5-008, OP5-009 and OP5-013, Operator 5 volume trends, financial due diligence report and pharmacy SKU file; OP1-011 and OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic-vintage model and clinic P&L 2007–2014; DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report; DLA-017, Deal A diligence and structure update; DLA-016, Deal A five-year model for financing banks (FY26 patient visits); OP3-003 and OP3-011, Operator 3 datacube and data pack; OP6-009, Operator 6 visit count file; OP8-005, Operator 8 same-store sales decomposition; OP7-005, Operator 7 databook; QLX-005, QLX-013 and QLX-029, Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 clinic files; CO2-008 and CO2-025, Emergency Operator 4 and Emergency Operator 2. Fact rows include OP2-0502 to OP2-0627, OP2-1584, OP2-3210, OP2-3212, OP5-3822 to OP5-3855, OP5-0205, OP5-0206, OP1-1372 to OP1-1378, DLA-3245, DLA-3246, DLA-3281, DLA-0567 to DLA-0773, CO1-0904 to CO1-0948, COR-5846 to COR-5850.

How. Each series is taken at its stated clinic base: all clinics, the clinics still open at the file date (survivor), or a named cohort. Per-clinic figures divide the period's volume by the number of clinics trading in that period (for example Operator 10 patient visits ÷ clinics trading; Operator 5 retail tickets ÷ retail clinics trading); Deal A all-clinic patient visits and visits per clinic are read from the chart labels in DLA-017. Total change = last value ÷ first value − 1. For windows of whole years the annual rate = (last value ÷ first value)^(1 ÷ number of years) − 1; for a window that ends in a part-year or a trailing twelve months only the total change is given. Series that include acquired clinics are labelled as pooled and are not read as organic.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.37; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. Windows differ in length and end date by operator, and total volume on an all-clinic base mixes organic change with acquisitions, openings and closures.

C-06 · Median comparable traffic growth by economic environment

What was computed. The median, range and share of negative readings of annual comparable-clinic traffic growth across operator-years, grouped by economic environment from the 2007–09 financial crisis to 2024–26. It is computed for core general practice and preventive operators (Operator 2 and its pre-acquisition brands, Operator 5, Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8, Operator 7) and, separately, for wellness clinics (Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1) and emergency and specialty hospitals (Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 5, Emergency Operator 2).

Sources. OP2-007, OP2-003 and OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic KPI workbooks and clinic-level databook; OP5-008, Operator 5 clinic volume trends; DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report; OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; OP6-009, Operator 6 visit count file; OP8-010, Operator 8 databook; OP7-005, Operator 7 databook; QLX-005, QLX-013 and QLX-029, Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 clinic files; CO2-008, CO2-012 and CO2-022, emergency and specialty hospital materials. Fact rows include OP2-0649 to OP2-0679, OP2-3521, OP2-3526, OP2-0218 to OP2-0222, OP2-0771 to OP2-0777, OP2-0736 to OP2-0742, OP5-3863 to OP5-3879, DLA-0597 to DLA-0789, OP3-0887, CO1-0958 to CO1-1067; the recorded medians are rows A1-P5-007 to A1-P5-012.

How. The inputs are annual, actual comparable traffic growth rates (visit, patient, ticket or patient-invoice counts on the comparable base, SSS_TRAFFIC_CD); pharmacy-unit and labour-hour series, pro forma series and company-definition series (Operator 1, Deal C, Deal B) are left out. Each operator-year is assigned to one environment by the date its period ends: financial crisis (GFC, July 2007 to June 2009), expansion (EXP10-19, July 2009 to February 2020), COVID (COVID20, March to December 2020), reopening (REOPEN21, 2021), inflation (INFL22-23, 2022–23) and soft period (SOFT24-26, 2024 onward); Deal A's April-to-March fiscal years are assigned to the environment that holds most of their months. Within each class and environment the statistic is the unweighted median of the operator-years, with the minimum, maximum, count of observations, count of operators (each Operator 2 pre-acquisition brand counts as its own operator) and share negative = observations below zero ÷ observations. Two further cuts are computed the same way: excluding series on a survivor-only clinic base (CLOSE-RETRO), and excluding Operator 7, whose visit count definition is not stated.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.32; Exhibit 9.36; Exhibit 9.94; Exhibit 4.18; the text of Part 01 section A, Part 01 section D, Part 04 section G and Part 09 section H, and of Part 09 section J under 03 A and Part 09 section K under 04 G.

Limits. Several environments rest on two to four observations, the expansion median draws 18 of its 21 observations from one data room, and the medians mix clinic bases with different closure treatment. Operator 10 2009–12, flagged in note C-11 for a shift in visit counts across all clinics, are included in the EXP10-19 median; without them the median is +0.4% on 20 operator-years, 34% negative.

C-07 · Industry volume indicators from public series, 2000 to 2025

What was computed. Annual levels and year-on-year changes for public measures of veterinary services and pharmacy volume, and three ratios built from them: real veterinary services spending per pet-owning household, per pet in U.S. households, and preventive product doses per household pet. Coverage is 2000 to 2025, with each series starting when it becomes available.

Sources. BEA personal consumption quantity index for veterinary and other pet services (PCEVETSVC) and the same in chained 2017 dollars (DVMRRX, from 2007); BEA quantity index for pharmacy products (DTATRA); pet-owning households from an industry pet ownership survey, at December; Census Bureau retail sales for pet supplies, accessories and pharmacy products (NAICS 3864), not seasonally adjusted, summed over twelve months; an animal health manufacturers' association's shipments of preventive products for dogs and cats (2017–25, latest release for each year); the same survey's average pet age and pets in households at January (2020/21–21). No client documents are used.

How. Year-on-year change = level ÷ prior-year level − 1, computed from the levels for every series. Real veterinary services spending per pet-owning household = BEA quantity index ÷ pet-owning households, rebased so that 2005 = 86. Real veterinary services spending per pet = chained 2017 dollars ÷ dogs and cats in U.S. households. Preventive products per pet = preventive product shipments for dogs and cats ÷ dogs and cats in U.S. households.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.38; the text of Part 09 section J under 03 A.

Limits. The BEA series is deflated spending, not a count of visits, and includes non-medical pet services such as grooming and boarding, so it cannot separate fewer visits from less work per visit.

C-08 · Inventory of the volume series available for each operator

What was computed. A list of the 44 volume series assembled for the assessment: for each, the operator, the measure, whether it is a comparable-clinic growth series or a level, the clinic base, the first and last period, the number of data points, the economic environments it reaches and the source. It covers the core operators including Deal C and Deal B, the wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital context operators, and one public series.

Sources. OP2-007, OP2-003 and OP2-021 (Operator 2); OP5-008, OP5-009 and OP5-013 (Operator 5); DLA-002 and DLA-017 (Deal A); OP1-021, OP1-015 and OP1-011 (Operator 1); OP3-003 and OP3-011 (Operator 3); OP6-009 (Operator 6); OP8-007 (Operator 8); OP7-005 (Operator 7); DLC-015, Deal C visit count and average patient invoice file; DLB-024, Deal B same-store visit count support; QLX-005, QLX-013 and QLX-029 (Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1); CO2-008, CO2-012, CO2-022 and CO2-025 (emergency and specialty hospitals). 226 distinct fact rows, including OP2-0649 to OP2-0679, DLA-0597 to DLA-0829, OP5-3863 to OP5-3881, OP1-5162 to OP1-5188, CO1-0904 to CO1-0973, A1-S001, A1-S022, A1-S025, A1-S039, A1-S040 and A1-S045.

How. All volume measures in the evidence base were screened (patient visits, patient invoices, pharmacy units, labour hours, per-clinic and per-day figures, and comparable-clinic growth in each). Rows were grouped into series by operator, measure and clinic base; projections were dropped and pro forma or company-definition series were kept but labelled. For each series the first period, last period and count of points were recorded, and the environments reached were read from the period-end date of each point. The closure treatment of each comparable series (closed clinics leave from closure, survivor-only, or not stated in the source) was recorded alongside.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.33, for the comparable-growth series; the text of Part 01 section F and of Part 09 section J under 03 A; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. The level and per-clinic series of the inventory are not printed as a list in this document. The inventory records what exists and on what base; it does not make series on different bases comparable, and the points counted for Deal C and Deal B are monthly and quarterly company readings, not years.

C-09 · Pricing power: how the area was measured

What was computed. The general method behind the pricing section. It tests whether operators recovered labour and supplies inflation, at what cost in volume, and how much of ticket growth is price as opposed to service mix and extra work per visit. It covers the general practice and preventive operators from 2007 to mid-2026, with wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals as context.

Sources. The clinic-level databases, point-of-sale extracts, KPI files and diligence materials of Operator 5 (OP5), Operator 1 (OP1), Operator 2 with Operator 10, Operator 14, Operator 16 and Operator 12 (OP2), Deal A (DLA), Operator 3 (OP3), Operator 6 (OP6), Operator 7 (OP7), Operator 8 (OP8) and Operator 4 (OP4); Deal B (DLB) and Deal C (DLC) on their company figures; for context, Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (QLX) and Emergency Operator 2, Emergency Operator 4 and Emergency Operator 5 (CO2). Public series: BLS consumer price indices for veterinarian services, wellness and preventive services, treatment services, pharmacy products, supplies and all items; BLS producer price indices for veterinary

pharmaceutical manufacturing and for veterinary services; the BLS employment cost index for wages in veterinarian and veterinary technician occupations.

How. Revenue growth is split on one comparable-clinic base: (1 + revenue growth) = (1 + volume growth) × (1 + ticket growth), where ticket is revenue per visit or per patient invoice (SSS_TICKET_CD) and, at Operator 1, revenue per pharmacy unit; any residual is reported. Ticket growth is called "price" only where the source documents an explicit price action or gives a like-for-like unit price (a constant set of pharmacy SKUs, a labour rate); everywhere else it is reported as ticket, meaning price, mix and attachment together. Each operator's ticket growth is compared with the consumer price index for veterinarian services over the same months: the public index is averaged over the operator's own window and divided by the average of the same months a year earlier, and a month that is blank in either year is dropped from both. Where a company has several series, the primary one is the comparable base on actual results; rows with a recorded change in the visit count definition (Operator 10 2009 to 2012), fiscal-year rows that duplicate a calendar series, and last-twelve-month windows that overlap a year already counted are left out of the statistics, except in the environment medians of note C-12, which keep four such windows (Operator 7 to June 2026, Operator 3 to August 2025, Operator 1 to November 2017, Emergency Operator 4 to September 2018). Summary statistics are medians across operator-years of the general practice and preventive operators; wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are shown as context in Part 04 section G and never pooled. Each figure is placed in one of seven economic environments by the date its period ends: before July 2007 (PRE-GFC), the financial crisis from July 2007 to June 2009 (GFC), the expansion from July 2009 to February 2020 (EXP10-19), the COVID period from March to December 2020 (COVID20), the 2021 reopening (REOPEN21), the 2022 to 2023 inflation period (INFL22-23) and the soft period from January 2024 (SOFT24-26); twelve-month fiscal years of Deal A (April to March) and Operator 1 (June to May) go to the environment that holds most of their months, and a tie goes to the later one. A characteristic is called durable only if it is seen at three or more independent operators and in two or more environments; where that test is not met the text says so.

Where shown. The text of Part 03 section B and of Part 09 section J under 03 B.

Limits. A like-for-like service price exists only at Operator 5 and Operator 8, so the share of ticket growth due to mix and attachment rests on two operators; no operator gives veterinarian cost per billed hour, so labour recovery is tested against a national wage index; the consumer price index used includes emergency and specialty care; only Operator 1 and Operator 10 reach the financial crisis. No numeric rule is stated for "temporary" or "company-specific".

C-10 · Cumulative comparable ticket growth against veterinary prices and wages

What was computed. Over eleven complete multi-year windows, the cumulative growth in comparable-clinic revenue, volume and ticket for an operator, set against cumulative growth in consumer veterinary prices, pharmacy prices and veterinary wages over the same months. Core windows are Deal A FY22–FY26, Operator 5 2018–19 and 2021–22, Operator 3 2023–24, Operator 1 2011–16 and Operator 10 2013–17; Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Emergency Operator 2 and Emergency Operator 4 windows are context.

Sources. DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report; OP2-007, Operator 2 clinic KPI workbook; OP5-008, Operator 5 clinic volume trends; OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level P&L workbook; OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; QLX-005, QLX-007 and QLX-013, Wellness Clinic Franchisor clinic files; QLX-029, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 clinic performance trends; CO2-008 and CO2-022, Emergency Operator 4 and Emergency Operator 2 materials. Fact rows include DLA-0660 to DLA-0790, OP5-3862 to OP5-3880, OP3-0886 to OP3-0892, OP1-5145 to OP1-5150 and OP1-5163 to OP1-5168, CO1-0950 to CO1-0969, COR-4132 to COR-4140. Public series: BLS consumer price indices for veterinarian services, for treatment services alone and for pharmacy products; BLS Employment Cost Index, wages for veterinarian and veterinary technician occupations.

How. For each window the annual comparable-clinic growth rates are chained: cumulative growth = (1 + year 1) × (1 + year 2) × … − 1, separately for revenue, volume and ticket, on the clinic base used for that operator's annual figures. The public indices are chained the same way over the same months, each year's change being the average index level in the window's months ÷ the average in the same months a year earlier − 1. The two gaps are differences in percentage points: cumulative ticket − cumulative veterinary price index, and cumulative ticket − cumulative wage index. Only actual results are used.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.43; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. Ticket is revenue per visit (per pharmacy unit at Operator 1) and combines price, mix and services added per visit, and the wage index is an all-industry rate per hour, so the comparison does not measure an operator's own labour cost recovery.

C-11 · Comparable revenue growth split into volume and ticket, with matched inflation

What was computed. For each operator and period with data, comparable-clinic revenue growth, volume growth and ticket growth on the same clinic base, alongside the change in consumer veterinary prices, pharmacy prices and veterinary wages over the same months. It holds 143 operator-periods, of which 70 are the main series: core operators Operator 5, Operator 1, Operator 2 and its pre-acquisition brands, Deal A, Operator 3,

Operator 6, Operator 7 and Operator 8 (2007 to mid-2026), with Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 5 and Emergency Operator 2 as context.

Sources. OP2-007, OP2-009, OP2-002, OP2-003, OP2-014 and OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic KPI workbooks, clinic-level analysis and databooks; OP1-021, OP1-015 and OP1-020, Operator 1 and Operator 18 clinic-level P&L workbooks; OP5-008, Operator 5 clinic volume trends; DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report; OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; OP6-009 and OP6-002, Operator 6 visit count file and commercial study; OP7-005, Operator 7 databook; OP8-010, Operator 8 databook; QLX-005, QLX-007, QLX-013 and QLX-029, Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 clinic files; CO2-008, CO2-012 and CO2-022, emergency and specialty hospital materials. 402 distinct fact rows, including OP5-3862 to OP5-3880, DLA-0596 to DLA-0830, OP2-0648 to OP2-0680, OP1-5144 to OP1-5169, OP3-0886 to OP3-0908, CO1-0950 to CO1-1068. Public series: BLS consumer price indices and Employment Cost Index.

How. The rule is (1 + revenue growth) = (1 + volume growth) × (1 + ticket growth), with all three measured on the same comparable-clinic base (clinics owned and open in every month from twelve months earlier; D2.1). Volume is patient visits, patient invoices or tickets; at Operator 1 it is pharmacy units and ticket is revenue per pharmacy unit. Where the source gives no ticket figure, ticket = (1 + revenue growth) ÷ (1 + volume growth) − 1; where all three are given, the residual (1 + revenue) − (1 + volume) × (1 + ticket) is reported and not removed. Veterinary price inflation for each period is the average monthly consumer price index for veterinarian services over the period's months ÷ the average for the same months a year earlier − 1, and the gap is ticket growth − that change. Overlapping trailing-twelve-month and year-to-date windows and alternative bases are kept but not treated as main series, except the four trailing-twelve-month windows that enter the environment medians of note C-12, and Operator 10 2009–12 is flagged because the visit count definition changed.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.45; Exhibit 9.39; Exhibit 4.15.

Limits. Ticket growth cannot be separated into list price, mix and services added per visit from these data, and Deal A and Operator 3 are on survivor-only clinic bases.

C-12 · Median ticket, volume and veterinary price inflation by economic environment

What was computed. For each economic environment from the 2007–09 financial crisis to 2024–26, the median annual comparable-clinic ticket growth, volume growth and revenue growth across operator-years, the median veterinary price inflation over the same months, and the median gap between ticket and inflation. Core operators, wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are computed separately.

Sources. OP2-007, OP2-009 and OP2-021 (Operator 2); DLA-002 (Deal A); OP1-021, OP1-015 and OP1-020 (Operator 1); OP5-008 (Operator 5); OP3-003 (Operator 3); OP6-002 (Operator 6); OP7-005 (Operator 7); OP8-010 (Operator 8); QLX-005, QLX-007, QLX-013 and QLX-029 (Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1); CO2-008, CO2-012 and CO2-022 (emergency and specialty hospitals). 182 distinct fact rows, including OP1-2115, OP1-2139, OP1-2091, OP2-0648 to OP2-0653, CO1-0950 to CO1-1068, COR-4132 to COR-4152. Public series: BLS consumer price index for veterinarian services.

How. The inputs are the main annual operator-periods from the revenue, volume and ticket split, actual results only; flagged rows (Operator 10 2009–12) are excluded; trailing-twelve-month windows are kept even where they overlap a year already counted (Operator 7 to June 2026, Operator 3 to August 2025, Operator 1 to November 2017, Emergency Operator 4 to September 2018). Each operator-year is assigned to an environment by its period-end date (financial crisis to June 2009, expansion to February 2020, COVID in 2020, reopening in 2021, inflation in 2022–23, soft period from 2024), except that Deal A's April-to-March fiscal years go to the environment holding most of their months. Within each class and environment the figures are unweighted medians across operator-years; gap = ticket growth − veterinary price inflation for the same months, taken row by row before the median. Share with ticket above inflation = operator-years with a positive gap ÷ operator-years; share with falling volume = operator-years with negative volume growth ÷ operator-years. The operator count is by parent company, so the four Operator 2 pre-acquisition brands count once.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.06; Exhibit 9.39; the text of Part 03 section B and of Part 09 section J under 03 B.

Limits. The financial crisis, COVID and reopening medians rest on two or three operator-years each, and the medians are not weighted by operator size.

C-13 · Like-for-like and explicit price changes where the sources allow

What was computed. The cases where a true price change, not just ticket, can be measured: Operator 5 pharmacy price and clinic cost on matched pharmacy SKUs for 2016–22, Operator 8's price component for 2022–23, Operator 3's logged labour-rate and supplies-pricing actions in 2024–25, and Wellness Clinic Franchisor wellness exam prices for 2023–25 as context. Operator 4's lender-labelled price component for 2021–25 is carried alongside but treated as ticket.

Sources. OP5-013, Operator 5 pharmacy sales by SKU 2015–2022; OP8-005 and OP8-001, Operator 8 same-store sales decomposition and investment committee memo; OP3-008, Operator 3 summary of pricing changes; OP4-005, Operator 4 lender credit memo; QLX-003, Wellness Clinic Franchisor wellness exam price file 2021–25. Fact rows OP5-4420 to OP5-4461, OP8-0543 to OP8-0555, OP8-0119, OP8-0120, OP4-0646 to OP4-0655, OP3-2362 to OP3-2386 and OP3-2423, QLF-1152 to QLF-1160. Public series: BLS consumer price index for pharmacy products and producer price index for veterinary pharmaceutical manufacturing.

How. For Operator 5, each year is compared with the prior year on the SKUs with units and sales in both years, excluding miscellaneous items; unit price p = sales ÷ units per SKU. Laspeyres = Σ(p1 × q0) ÷ Σ(p0 × q0), Paasche = Σ(p1 × q1) ÷ Σ(p0 × q1), and the like-for-like price change is the Fisher index √(Laspeyres × Paasche) − 1; the same formula on cost to the clinic per unit gives the like-for-like cost change. The mix residual = (1 + change in all-SKU average price) ÷ (1 + like-for-like change) − 1, and coverage is the matched SKUs' share of the later year's units. For Wellness Clinic Franchisor the like-for-like price is a Laspeyres index across four wellness exam lines with prior-year service counts as weights, and mix = (1 + change in average price) ÷ (1 + like-for-like change) − 1. Operator 8 and Operator 4 figures are taken as printed in their sources, and each Operator 3 action is the new rate ÷ the old rate − 1.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.40; Exhibit 9.41; Exhibit 9.44; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. Operator 5 cost is cost to the clinic, which includes an intercompany markup and is before vendor rebates, and no source records how volume responded to the Operator 3 actions.

C-14 · Gross margin by product line alongside cost and price changes

What was computed. Gross margin by year and product line for the operators that report it, set beside the like-for-like cost and price changes where they exist, to show whether margin held when cost rose. It covers Operator 5 (pharmacy margin on clinic cost 2015–22, pharmacy and service margin 2020–22, service categories 2018–22), Deal A (public gross margin, survivor-clinic margin, and material margin by category FY24–FY26), Operator 3, Operator 8, Operator 10 and Operator 4.

Sources. OP5-013, Operator 5 pharmacy sales by SKU 2015–2022; OP5-009, Operator 5 financial due diligence report; OP5-006, Operator 5 service categories 2017–2022; DLA-004, Deal A sales and gross margin by product category; DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report; Deal A public filings; OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; OP8-012, Operator 8 databook (February 2025); OP2-002, Operator 10 consolidated P&Ls; OP4-003 and OP4-007, Operator 4 audited financial statements. Fact rows include OP5-4391 to OP5-4419, OP5-0243 to OP5-0245, OP5-0255 to OP5-0257, DLA-1088, DLA-1092, DLA-1103, OP3-0639 to OP3-0724, OP8-1384 to OP8-1416, OP2-0087, OP2-0105, OP2-0123, OP4-0013, OP4-0055, OP4-0105.

How. Margins are taken from each source on its own definition and labelled: Operator 5 pharmacy margin is pharmacy product sales against cost to the clinic from the SKU file, before rebates and excluding dispensing labour; Deal A category margins are material margin before labour and occupancy; Deal A survivor-clinic margin is reported gross profit ÷ net revenue on the clinics still open. The Operator 5 cost and price columns are the like-for-like matched-SKU changes for the same year. For Operator 5 services, the margin is the sales-weighted average across 32 to 32 service categories.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.40; Exhibit 9.44; the text of Part 09 section J under 03 B.

Limits. The margin lines are on different definitions across operators and cannot be compared in level.

C-15 · Operator 5 ticket growth split into price, mix and items per ticket

What was computed. For Operator 5, all retail clinics, 2017 to 2022, indices (2017 = 86) of average patient invoice, pharmacy units per ticket, average pharmacy price, like-for-like pharmacy price, pharmacy mix, service lines per ticket, service value per line within a category, and service mix between categories.

Sources. OP5-008, Operator 5 clinic volume trends (tickets, pharmacy units, ticket size); OP5-013, Operator 5 pharmacy sales by SKU 2015–2022; OP5-006, Operator 5 service categories 2017–2022. Fact rows OP5-3822 to OP5-3854, OP5-4400 to OP5-4417, OP5-4432 to OP5-4456, and rows A2-S001 and A2-S002 (retail tickets for 2020 and 2021 read from OP5-008).

How. Each series is divided by its 2017 value and multiplied by 86. The like-for-like pharmacy price index chains the annual matched-SKU Fisher price changes; pharmacy mix index = average pharmacy price index ÷ like-for-like pharmacy price index. Service lines per ticket = service line items ÷ retail tickets. The within-category service index chains a Fisher index of revenue per line across service categories, and the between-category mix index chains (1 + growth in total revenue per line) ÷ (1 + within-category Fisher change) − 1. The dental and miscellaneous categories are excluded from the service indices: the dental line-item count changed definition in 2020–22 and the miscellaneous category has very small values per line.

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section J under 03 B.

Limits. Service value per line includes supplies content, so it is an upper bound on service price, and the split is available for one operator only.

C-16 · Annual change in public price and wage indices, 2006 to 2026

What was computed. Year-on-year change for each calendar year 2006 to 2025 and for January to August 2026 in the public price and wage indices used as yardsticks for operator pricing, with the number of months behind each figure.

Sources. US Bureau of Labor Statistics, not seasonally adjusted: consumer price indices for veterinarian services (CUUR0000SS62053), wellness and preventive services (SS6205302), treatment services (SS6205303), pharmacy products (SETC01), supplies and equipment (SETC) and all items (SA0); producer price indices for veterinary pharmaceutical manufacturing (PCU32621132621101) and veterinary services (WPU552); Employment Cost Index, wages and salaries for veterinarian and veterinary technician occupations (ECI_VETOCC). Retrieved 28 September 2026. No client documents are used.

How. For the price indices, annual change = average of the monthly index levels in the year ÷ average of the same months a year earlier − 1. A month that is blank in either year is dropped from both; October 2025 is blank in every consumer price series, so 2025 compares eleven months with the same eleven months of 2024. The wage index uses the average of the quarterly index levels whose quarter-end falls in the window. The same matched-month rule is applied to operator fiscal years and trailing-twelve-month windows when these indices are set against operator figures.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.43, as the yardstick for each operator window; the annual averages for 2019 to 2025 appear as index levels in Exhibit 3.07 (note C-96).

Limits. The veterinarian services index includes emergency and specialty care, and there is no producer price or wage index specific to general practice veterinary clinics, so the wage and producer series are proxies.

C-17 · Vendor rebates against revenue, pharmacy price and gross margin

What was computed. Vendor rebates by operator and year, expressed as a share of revenue, a share of pharmacy cost or spend, or dollars per pharmacy unit, beside average pharmacy price and gross margin before and after rebates where available. Operator 1 has the long series (2009 to the twelve months to November 2017, and FY2008–FY2014 for retail pharmacy products); Operator 5, Operator 3, Operator 2, Operator 8, Operator 4, Operator 9, Operator 7, Deal A, Operator 6 and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 have shorter ones.

Sources. OP1-021 and OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic-level P&L workbooks; OP5-009, Operator 5 financial due diligence report; OP3-001 and OP3-011, Operator 3 financial update and data pack; OP2-021 and OP2-004, Operator 2 clinic-level databook and 2018 investment committee memo; OP8-010, Operator 8 databook; OP4-005, Operator 4 lender credit memo; OP7-007, Operator 7 quality of earnings workbook; DLA-017, Deal A diligence and structure update, with sales from Deal A public filings; DLA-003, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file; OP6-002, Operator 6 commercial study; QLX-024, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 financial due diligence databook. Fact rows include OP1-4727 to OP1-4743, OP1-5011 to OP1-5022, OP1-4824 to OP1-4840, OP1-4635 to OP1-4646, OP1-4168 to OP1-4179, OP1-4260 to OP1-4276, OP1-1553 to OP1-1559, OP5-0311 to OP5-0313, OP4-0938 to OP4-0943, OP6-1098 to OP6-1100, DLA-3340 to DLA-3343, DLA-0846.

How. For Operator 1, figures are sums across all Operator 1-branded clinic sheets for the calendar year: rebate share of revenue = rebates allocated to clinics (vendor rebates, payment discounts and warehouse income, which Operator 1 calls ATF and allocates by pharmacy units) ÷ total clinic sales; rebate per pharmacy unit = allocated rebates ÷ clinic pharmacy units; average pharmacy price = retail pharmacy sales ÷ retail pharmacy units; gross margin is shown before and after the allocated rebates. For the other operators the ratio is the one each source supports: rebates ÷ revenue (Operator 5 on adjusted figures, Operator 3 and Operator 2 on clinic-allocated rebates, Operator 8, Operator 7 State 05, Wellness Clinic Operator 1), rebates ÷ pharmacy cost or spend (Operator 4, Operator 9, Operator 3 consolidated), or rebates per pharmacy unit (Operator 2 2015 and 2017). Deal A is co-op and rebates from the DLA-017 table ÷ sales in the public filings. Operator 5 and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 rows are pro forma; the rest are actual.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.42.

Limits. The Operator 1 clinic sheets cannot separate growth in true rebates from discounts moved off the invoice into back-end rebates, and the ratios for other operators sit on different bases and are not comparable in level.

C-18 · Association between ticket growth and volume growth at core operators

What was computed. Across 38 annual operator-years from eight core operators, the correlation between comparable-clinic ticket growth and volume growth, the correlation between the ticket-minus-inflation gap and volume growth, and median volume growth where ticket beat veterinary price inflation by more than three points against where it did not.

Sources. OP2-007, OP2-009 and OP2-021 (Operator 2 and its pre-acquisition brands); OP1-021, OP1-015 and OP1-020 (Operator 1); DLA-002 (Deal A); OP5-008 (Operator 5); OP3-003 (Operator 3); OP6-002 (Operator 6); OP7-005 (Operator 7); OP8-010 (Operator 8). 108 distinct fact rows, including

OP5-3862 to OP5-3880, OP6-1143 to OP6-1148, OP7-1022 to OP7-1024, OP7-1046 to OP7-1048, OP3-0886 to OP3-0908, OP1-5144 to OP1-5169. Public series: BLS consumer price index for veterinarian services.

How. The sample is the main annual core operator-periods from the revenue, volume and ticket split, actual results only, excluding the COVID and reopening environments (with Deal A fiscal years assigned to the environment holding most of their months) and the flagged Operator 10 2009–12 rows. The two correlations are simple correlation coefficients across the 38 operator-years: ticket growth with volume growth, and (ticket growth − veterinary price inflation over the same months) with volume growth. The sample is then split at a gap of three percentage points, and the median volume growth is taken in each group.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.45.

Limits. This is an association, not a price elasticity: revenue per visit rises mechanically when the visits lost are small-ticket ones, so the data do not show that pricing caused the volume loss.

C-19 · Margin consistency: how the area was measured

What was computed. The general method behind the margin section. It covers gross margin, clinic-level profit margin, vendor rebates, corporate overhead and company EBITDA margin for the general practice and preventive operators from fiscal 2007 to the twelve months to July 2026, with wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals as context.

Sources. The clinic-level P&L files, diligence databooks, models, audited accounts and lender materials of Operator 1 (OP1), Deal A (DLA), Operator 2 with Operator 10, Operator 12 and Operator 16 (OP2), Operator 5 (OP5), Operator 8 (OP8), Operator 3 (OP3), Operator 7 (OP7), Operator 4 and Operator 9 (OP4) and Operator 6 (OP6); for context, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (QLX) and Emergency Operator 3, Emergency Operator 2 and Emergency Operator 1 with Emergency Operator 4 (CO2). Public series: Deal A's SEC filings for operating margin and clinic counts.

How. Clinic-level profit is measured as four-wall EBITDA: clinic revenue less product cost, clinic labour, clinic operating costs and cash rent, before vendor rebates and before any corporate cost (D1.1); where the source itself allocates rebates to clinics a second line with rebates is shown (D1.2) and the two are never mixed. Every clinic-profit figure carries its rent treatment: cash rent on all leases (R-CASH), book rent (R-BOOK), operating-lease rent only (R-OPONLY), before any rent (R-NONE) or not stated (R-UNK); only cash-rent figures on the first definition are pooled across operators, and only actual results with actual results. A margin is a ratio of totals (profit of all clinics ÷ sales of all clinics), never an average of clinic margins; clinic distributions (median, quartiles, share of loss-making clinics) are recomputed from the clinic-level data and state whether the base is all clinics or survivors. Gross margin has no common definition across operators, so it is read within one operator over time. Company EBITDA margin is shown on two separate lines, reported (E1) and adjusted (E2). Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital margins are shown as context and never pooled. Each figure is placed in one of seven economic environments by the date its period ends: before July 2007 (PRE-GFC), the financial crisis from July 2007 to June 2009 (GFC), the expansion from July 2009 to February 2020 (EXP10-19), the COVID period from March to December 2020 (COVID20), the 2021 reopening (REOPEN21), the 2022 to 2023 inflation period (INFL22-23) and the soft period from January 2024 (SOFT24-26); twelve-month fiscal years of Deal A (April to March) and Operator 1 (June to May) go to the environment that holds most of their months, and a tie goes to the later one. A characteristic is called durable only if it is seen at three or more independent operators and in two or more environments; where that test is not met the text says so.

Where shown. The text of Part 03 section C and of Part 09 section J under 03 C; the core range of Exhibit 4.19.

Limits. At most two operators have actual cash-rent clinic margins in any one year, so no industry level on a common rent basis can be stated; Operator 1 clinic data end in November 2017, Operator 2's in March 2021 and Deal A's start in fiscal 2023; every Operator 5 clinic figure is pro forma; overhead is defined differently at each operator. No numeric rule is stated for "temporary" or "company-specific".

C-20 · Consolidated EBITDA margin by operator, reported and adjusted kept apart

What was computed. Company-level EBITDA as a share of revenue for Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 5, Operator 2, Operator 8, Operator 7, Operator 4 and Operator 9, with Emergency Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 and Wellness Clinic Franchisor as context, from 2008 to LTM June 2026. Reported EBITDA (E1) and adjusted EBITDA (E2) are separate rows and are never mixed.

Sources. OP1-016, Operator 1 Project Echo model (2008–2017 monthly history); OP1-044, Operator 1 long-range forecast (2020–22 actuals); Deal A 10-K and 10-Q filings (SEC), including the public operating-margin and clinic-count series for FY08–FY11; DLA-003, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file; DLA-017, Deal A Diligence & Structure Update; DLA-024, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model; OP5-009, Operator 5 financial due diligence report; OP2-025, Operator 2 Situation Update; OP2-015, Operator 2 historical financials; OP8-003, OP8-008, OP8-010, OP8-012, Operator 8 model, diligence report and databooks; OP7-005, OP7-007, Operator 7 databooks; OP4-001, OP4-002, OP4-003, OP4-005, OP4-007, OP4-008, Operator 4 and Operator 9 audited accounts, Q1 2026 statements and investment memo; CO2-003, CO2-007, Emergency Operator 1 and Emergency Operator 4 investment memos;

QLX-017, Wellness Clinic Franchisor quality-of-earnings databook; QLX-033, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 investment memo. Fact rows include OP1-3250..3271, OP1-3406..3416, OP1-3458..3467, DLA-0003..0017, DLA-0118..0317, DLA-0854, DLA-5637, DLA-3284, OP5-0007..0009, OP5-0032..0034, OP5-0059..0061, OP7-0003, OP7-0012, OP7-0021, OP7-0059..0061, OP7-0114, OP7-0116, OP8-0400, OP8-0401, OP8-0689, OP8-1487, OP8-1488, OP8-1493, OP8-1494, OP8-1781, OP8-1880, OP8-2016, OP8-2017, OP4-0011, OP4-0053, OP4-0103, OP4-0269, OP4-0330, OP4-0355, OP4-0380, OP4-1065..1080, OP2-2117, OP2-2125, OP2-4251..4280, OP2-4340..4349, OP2-4730, CO1-0105..0121 and A3-P5-016.

How. For each operator and period, margin = EBITDA ÷ revenue, each taken from the same source and period. Reported EBITDA (E1) is operating income plus depreciation, amortisation and impairment as booked, with gains on disposal left in; adjusted EBITDA (E2) adds non-recurring and normalisation adjustments, either from a third-party quality-of-earnings report or from management. Reported rows are marked actual and adjusted rows pro forma. For Deal A FY08–FY11 no EBITDA is available, so the public operating-income margin is shown and labelled as such. Deal A's LTM June 2026 adjusted margin is the sum of four quarters of company non-GAAP EBITDA ÷ LTM revenue (DLA-5637 ÷ DLA-3284). Where two sources give different EBITDA for the same period (Operator 5, Operator 8, Operator 4, Operator 2), one source is used, and the Evidence index marks the row "Sources differ; the text says which is used".

Where shown. Exhibit 3.11; Exhibit 9.109, for Deal A; Exhibit 4.11, source note.

Limits. Adjusted EBITDA definitions differ by operator and Operator 2's reported figures come from a lender presentation that is not audited, so levels are read within one operator over time and are not pooled.

C-21 · Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital margins shown as context only

What was computed. Clinic-level margins for Wellness Clinic Operator 1 and Wellness Clinic Franchisor company-operated clinics (wellness clinics) and for Emergency Operator 3, Emergency Operator 2 and Emergency Operator 1's Emergency Operator 4 segment (emergency and specialty hospitals), 2015 to LTM October 2025. They are shown as context in Part 04 section G and are never pooled with the general practice and preventive operators.

Sources. QLX-024 and QLX-023, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 financial due diligence databook (spreadsheet and report); QLX-017, Wellness Clinic Franchisor quality-of-earnings databook; CO2-031, Emergency Operator 3 due diligence databook; CO2-033, Emergency Operator 3 August 2023 financial update; CO2-015, Emergency Operator 2 clinic-level P&Ls 2019 to June 2023; CO2-007 and CO2-008, Emergency Operator 1/Emergency Operator 4 investment memo and analysis. Fact rows QL1-0019..0021, QL1-0227, QL1-0234, QL1-0241, QL1-0245..0247, QL1-0327..0329, QL1-0334..0336, QL1-0341..0343, QL1-0515, QL1-0527, QL1-0542, QLF-0190, QLF-0193, QLF-0196, QLF-0217..0219, QLF-0226..0236, CO3-1125, CO3-1133, CO3-1159, CO3-1464..1466, COR-0129..0137, CO1-0840..0843, CO1-0909, CO1-0920, CO1-0931, CO1-0942 and A3-P5-017..019.

How. Each margin = clinic-level profit ÷ clinic sales for the stated period, as a ratio of totals, on the operator's own rent basis, which is stated on every row. Two lines are shown where the source separates rebates: before vendor rebates (D1.1) and with rebates (D1.2). Wellness Clinic Operator 1's clinic profit is on book rent (R-BOOK); a cash-rent estimate is added as (clinic profit before rebates + the diligence provider's cash-rent adjustment) ÷ net sales, that is (QL1-0327, QL1-0334, QL1-0341 + QL1-0019, QL1-0020, QL1-0021) ÷ (QL1-0245, QL1-0246, QL1-0247), which assumes the whole adjustment belongs to the clinics. Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Emergency Operator 3 as owned are on cash rent (R-CASH); Emergency Operator 2 and Emergency Operator 3 pro forma are on an unstated rent basis (R-UNK); Emergency Operator 4 is clinic EBITDA before any rent (R-NONE). Each row also records why the figure is not comparable with a general practice and preventive operator.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.94; Exhibit 4.19; the text of Part 04 section G and of Part 09 section K under 04 G.

Limits. The Wellness Clinic Operator 1 cash-rent figure is an estimate, because the share of the cash-rent adjustment that sits at clinic level is not confirmed; the five operators use four different rent bases, so no common level can be stated.

C-22 · Spread of clinic margins within each operator, by year

What was computed. For Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 8, Operator 3 and Deal A, the distribution of clinic four-wall margins in each available year (FY08 to FY26): chain margin, median, mean, quartiles and the share of clinics losing money. Deal A's loss-making share is also counted on all clinics open at each year-end.

Sources. OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level monthly financials to December 2017; OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic P&L 2007–2014; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook; OP5-011, Operator 5 operating model (clinic tabs); OP8-012 and OP8-010, Operator 8 databooks; OP3-003, Operator 3 clinic-month datacube; DLA-003, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA FY23–FY26; DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report. Fact rows: the clinic rows of the OP5-011 tabs FY20, FY21, FY22 and LTM23; OP3-1015, OP3-1091, OP1-2456, OP1-2457, OP1-5657..5668 and DLA-0834, DLA-0862, DLA-0882, DLA-0902, DLA-0922 (source totals the clinic files reconcile to), and A3-P5-006..013.

How. Clinic margin = clinic four-wall EBITDA ÷ clinic sales for the year. For each operator-year the chain margin is the sum of clinic EBITDA ÷ the sum of clinic sales (ratio of sums); the median, mean, 25th and 75th percentiles are taken across clinic margins, and the loss share = clinics with negative

clinic EBITDA ÷ clinics counted. Clinic bases: Operator 1, retail clinics trading all 12 months of the June–May fiscal year, excluding two wholesale units (FY08 uses all clinics with sales); Operator 2, owned clinics with 12 months; Operator 5, all clinics in the clinic tabs, pro forma; Operator 8, clinics with revenue in the year (2021–24) and full-year units (2024–25); Operator 3, surviving full-year clinics. The margin is before vendor rebates (D1.1) or with rebates (D1.2) as each row states, with its rent basis. For Deal A, clinic EBITDA before co-op on operating-lease rent only (R-OPONLY) from DLA-003 is divided by net sales from DLA-002, which covers only clinics still open at the file date; the loss share is separately counted on every clinic row in each DLA-003 year tab (1,107, 1,139, 1,102 and 983 clinics), which includes clinics later closed.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.52; Exhibit 9.92; Exhibit 9.146; the operator profiles in Part 09 section K under 04 D; the text of Part 03 section C, Part 04 section E and Part 07 section F, and of Part 09 section J under 03 C.

Limits. Deal A's clinic-EBITDA tabs carry no sales, so margin statistics exist only for surviving clinics and understate weak clinics in FY23–FY25; Operator 3 is also a survivor base; Operator 2's 2019 with-rebates distribution uses clinic rebates that fall short of the source total.

C-23 · Cost lines behind the pre-rebate clinic margin, by operator

What was computed. Clinic revenue split into gross margin, labour, occupancy, other clinic costs and vendor rebates, each as a share of clinic revenue, for Operator 1 (FY09–FY17), Operator 5 (2020 to LTM March 2023), Operator 2 (2018 to LTM March 2021), Operator 8 (2024–25) and Operator 3 (2023 to LTM August 2025). It shows which line moved the four-wall margin.

Sources. OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level monthly financials; OP5-011, Operator 5 operating model (clinic tabs); OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook; OP8-010, Operator 8 databook (March 2026); OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; OP3-001, Operator 3 financial update. Fact rows OP5-0758..1126, OP5-1184..1561, OP5-1617..2003, OP5-2060..2446, OP3-0012..0018, OP3-0028..0034, OP3-0092..0098, OP3-0124..0130, OP3-1010, OP3-1011, OP3-1029, OP3-1030, OP3-1067, OP3-1068, OP3-1086, OP3-1087, OP2-3401, OP2-3414, OP2-3421, OP2-3431, OP2-3438, OP2-3462, OP2-3469, OP8-2091, OP8-2095.

How. Each line = the sum of that cost across clinics ÷ the sum of clinic revenue for the period. The identity is: four-wall margin before rebates (D1.1) = gross margin − labour − occupancy − other clinic costs; margin with rebates (D1.2) = D1.1 + rebates. Operator 1: gross profit before vendor rebates (ATF); labour = clinic pay + sales pay + fringe; occupancy = rent + property tax; on all retail clinics excluding two wholesale units. Operator 5: sums of the clinic rows, pro forma; D1.1 = source clinic EBITDA less allocated pharmacy and supplies rebates; gross margin on the source basis. Operator 3: gross margin before rebates = (gross profit − rebates) ÷ revenue, on surviving clinics. Operator 2 has no labour split, so one line carries all clinic costs (gross profit − four-wall EBITDA); Operator 8 shows clinic costs excluding rent as one line plus occupancy.

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section J under 03 C.

Limits. The split is partial for Operator 2 and Operator 8; Operator 3's rent reads zero for June–August 2025 and sits in other costs for LTM August 2025.

C-24 · Clinic four-wall margin by operator and year, before and with rebates

What was computed. Four-wall EBITDA margin for Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 8, Operator 3, Operator 7, Deal A and Operator 4, FY08 to the twelve months to March 2026, on two lines where the source allows: before vendor rebates (D1.1) and with rebates (D1.2). Each row states its rent basis and clinic base.

Sources. OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level monthly financials; OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic P&L 2007–2014; OP1-010, Operator 1 model by clinic vintage; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook; OP2-024 and OP2-025, Operator 2 data requests and Situation Update; OP5-011, Operator 5 operating model; OP8-003, OP8-008, OP8-009, OP8-010, OP8-012, OP8-013, Operator 8 model, diligence report, databooks and presentations; OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; OP7-006 and OP7-007, Operator 7 diligence databooks; DLA-003 and DLA-002, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA and KPI report; Deal A 10-K (SEC); OP4-006, Operator 4 financial model. Fact rows OP1-2456, OP1-2457, OP1-1227, OP1-5657..5668, OP1-5856..5873, OP2-3401, OP2-3414, OP2-3421, OP2-3431, OP2-3438, OP2-3462, OP2-3469, OP5-1152, OP5-1153, OP5-1585, OP5-1586, OP5-2028, OP5-2029, OP5-2469, OP5-2470, OP8-0669, OP8-0813, OP8-1347, OP8-1362, OP8-1385, OP8-1395, OP8-1406, OP8-2090..2102, OP8-2762, OP3-0020, OP3-0036, OP3-0100, OP3-0132, OP3-1012, OP3-1031, OP3-1069, OP3-1088, OP7-0499, OP7-0507, OP7-0515, DLA-0017, DLA-0834, DLA-0857, OP4-1491, OP4-1507 and A3-P5-001..004.

How. Margin = the sum of clinic four-wall EBITDA ÷ the sum of clinic revenue for the operator and period (ratio of sums, never an average of clinic margins). D1.1 is clinic revenue less product cost, clinic labour, clinic operating costs and rent, before vendor rebates and before corporate allocations; D1.2 adds rebates only where the source itself allocates them to clinics; the rebate gap = D1.2 − D1.1 in percentage points. The rent basis is recorded on every row: cash rent (R-CASH), book rent (R-BOOK), operating-lease rent only (R-OPONLY) or not stated (R-UNK). Operator 8 2022 D1.1 = (clinic EBITDA with rebates − reported rebates) ÷ revenue. Operator 1 is also shown on a constant base of 92 clinics with sales in all 12 months of both calendar 2010 and LTM November 2017. Deal A's figure is clinic EBITDA before co-op ÷ sales of surviving clinics, which is neither D1.1 nor D1.2;

Operator 4's is the sponsor model's clinic EBITDA with rebates embedded. Operator 5 is pro forma and kept in its own column. A further Deal A line for FY2026 is an approximation: EBITDA of open clinics ÷ consolidated sales.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.50; Exhibit 3.09; Exhibit 4.11; Exhibit 9.79, source note; the text of Part 03 section C and Part 05 section E, and of Part 09 section J under 03 C and Part 09 section L under 05 E.

Limits. No industry four-wall level on one rent basis can be stated, because at most two operators report actual cash-rent margins in any one year.

C-25 · Gross margin by operator and year, each on its own definition

What was computed. Gross profit as a share of revenue for 14 operators (Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 2 and its Operator 10 seller history, Operator 5, Operator 8, Operator 3, Operator 7, Operator 4, Operator 9, and the wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital context operators), FY07 to LTM 2026. Each row records how vendor rebates are treated and what sits in cost of sales.

Sources. Deal A 10-K filings (SEC); DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report; OP1-015 and OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic P&Ls; OP1-008, Operator 1 divisions monthly; OP1-016, Operator 1 Project Echo model; OP1-036, Operator 1 2021 information memorandum; OP2-010, Operator 2 historical financials (seller history 2007–2017); OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook; OP2-025, Operator 2 Situation Update; OP5-009, Operator 5 financial due diligence report; OP8-010 and OP8-012, Operator 8 databooks; OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; OP7-005 and OP7-007, Operator 7 databooks; OP4-001, OP4-002, OP4-003, OP4-007, Operator 9 and Operator 4 audited accounts; QLX-017, Wellness Clinic Franchisor databook; QLX-026, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 sales and service model; CO2-007, Emergency Operator 1 investment memo; CO2-015, Emergency Operator 2 clinic-level P&Ls; CO2-033, Emergency Operator 3 financial update. Fact rows include DLA-0022..0060, DLA-0573, DLA-0672, DLA-0768, OP1-1502, OP1-1503, OP1-4168..4179, OP1-4266..4276, OP2-1309..1314, OP2-3412, OP2-3429, OP2-3460, OP5-0020..0022, OP8-1384, OP8-1405, OP8-2098, OP8-2104, OP3-0004, OP3-0014, OP3-0126, OP7-0001, OP7-0002, OP7-0112, OP7-0113, OP4-0013, OP4-0055, OP4-0105, OP4-0334, OP4-0359, OP4-0384 and CO1-0068..0078.

How. Gross margin = gross profit ÷ net revenue for the operator, scope and period, taken as the source reports it; nothing is restated to a common definition. Each row carries the scope (consolidated, all clinics, surviving clinics or a segment) and the rebate treatment, for example Operator 1 before and including vendor rebates (ATF), Deal A with co-op netted in cost of sales and occupancy inside cost of sales, Operator 3 after clinic-allocated rebates. Year-to-year movements are read within one operator and one scope only.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.08; Exhibit 4.11, source note; the text of Part 03 section C and of Part 09 section J under 03 C.

Limits. Levels differ by 26 points or more across operators because of what each books in cost of sales, so gross margin cannot be compared or pooled across operators.

C-26 · Corporate overhead as a share of revenue against operator size

What was computed. Corporate overhead ÷ revenue, with revenue and clinic count beside it, for Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 8, Operator 3, Operator 7 and Operator 4, and for Wellness Clinic Operator 2, Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 2 as context, 2008 to the twelve months to May 2026. It tests whether the overhead share falls as an operator grows.

Sources. OP1-016, Operator 1 Project Echo model; DLA-006, Deal A operating, selling, general and administrative expense file FY17–FY27; Deal A 10-K filings (SEC); OP2-016, Operator 2 adjusted P&L; OP5-009 and OP5-011, Operator 5 due diligence report and operating model; OP8-002, OP8-003, OP8-008, OP8-009, OP8-010, OP8-012, Operator 8 presentations, model, diligence report and databooks; OP3-001 and OP3-012, Operator 3 financial update and lender model; OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook; OP4-006 and OP4-007, Operator 4 model and audited accounts; QLX-020, Wellness Clinic Operator 2 screening memo; QLX-017, Wellness Clinic Franchisor databook; CO2-033 and CO2-039, Emergency Operator 3 financial update and Situation Update; CO2-026, Emergency Operator 2 lender presentation. Fact rows include OP1-3229..3238, OP1-3406..3416, OP1-3458..3467, DLA-0008..0017, DLA-1223, DLA-1239, DLA-1275, DLA-1295, DLA-1324, DLA-1350, OP2-2672..2674, OP2-2720..2722, OP5-1157, OP5-1590, OP5-2033, OP8-0394, OP8-1495, OP8-2093, OP8-2097, OP8-2103, OP3-1890, OP3-1994, OP3-2566..2568, OP7-0798, OP7-0800, OP7-0804, OP4-0043, OP4-0093, OP4-1533, OP4-1535, QL2-0106, QL2-0108, QL2-0110 and COR-6148..6151.

How. For each operator and period, overhead share = corporate overhead ÷ revenue, using the operator's own overhead definition, which is written on every row (for example Deal A: corporate department costs excluding advertising; Operator 1: corporate operating costs including regional, distribution and advertising, with clinic support split out from 2016; Operator 5: corporate overhead on adjusted revenue, excluding distribution). Revenue and clinic count for the same period are set beside it. The share is then read against size within each operator over time. Pro forma rows are marked. Where a second source gives a different overhead figure for the same period (Deal A FY17 and FY26, Operator 8 2024, Operator 4), the row records it.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.54; Exhibit 3.11; Exhibit 4.11, source note; Exhibit 5.16; Exhibit 6.13; Exhibit 6.21; the text of Part 03 section C, Part 06 section E and Part 07 section E, and of Part 09 section J under 03 C, Part 09 section L under 05 D and Part 09 section M under 06 E.

Limits. Advertising, distribution, regional management and clinic support are placed differently by each operator, so levels are not compared across operators and no overhead curve on one definition can be drawn.

C-27 · How far clinics keep their margin rank from year to year

What was computed. For Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 8, Operator 3 and Deal A, clinics are ranked into margin quartiles in each year and followed into the next. The result is the share that stay in the same quartile, the share that stay top or bottom, the share that move two or more quartiles, and the rank correlation, for 32 lines from FY08 to FY26: 21 distinct year pairs, some on two margin definitions.

Sources. OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level monthly financials; OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic P&L 2007–2014; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook; OP5-011, Operator 5 operating model (clinic tabs); OP8-012 and OP8-010, Operator 8 databooks; OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; DLA-003 and DLA-002, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA and KPI report. Fact rows: the clinic rows of the OP5-011 tabs FY20, FY21, FY22 and LTM23; OP3-1015, OP1-2456, OP1-2457 and OP1-5657..5668 (source totals the clinic file reconciles to).

How. Clinic margin = clinic four-wall EBITDA ÷ clinic sales, on the same definitions and clinic bases as the dispersion analysis. Only clinics present in both years are kept; quartiles are set within each year on those clinics. A four-by-four count of clinics by starting and ending quartile is built for each pair. From it: same-quartile share = clinics on the diagonal ÷ matched clinics; top and bottom persistence = clinics staying in that quartile ÷ clinics starting in it; the share moving two or more quartiles; and the Spearman rank correlation of the two years' clinic margins. The published ranges use the 30 lines that remain once four lines whose two periods overlap by nine months are left out (Operator 2 2020 to the twelve months to March 2021 and Operator 5 2022 to the twelve months to March 2023, each on two definitions). The Operator 3 pair FY2024 to the twelve months to August 2025 also overlaps and is kept.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.53; Exhibit 5.04; Exhibit 9.123; Exhibit 9.120; the text of Part 03 section C and Part 05 section B, and of Part 09 section J under 03 C and Part 09 section L under 05 B.

Limits. Clinics that closed are absent from both ends of each pair, and at Deal A and Operator 3 the data cover surviving clinics only, so persistence among all clinics, including those later closed, is not measured.

C-28 · Vendor rebates as a share of revenue and of clinic margin

What was computed. Vendor rebates and co-op income as a share of revenue, and as a share of the with-rebates four-wall margin, for Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 3, Operator 8 and Operator 7, 2008 to LTM March 2026, with Wellness Clinic Operator 1 and Wellness Clinic Franchisor as context. For Operator 1 and Deal A, rebates are also set against company EBITDA.

Sources. OP1-016, Operator 1 Project Echo model; OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level monthly financials; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook (Rebates tab); OP5-009, Operator 5 financial due diligence report; OP3-001, Operator 3 financial update; OP8-008 and OP8-010, Operator 8 diligence report and databook; OP7-006 and OP7-007, Operator 7 diligence databooks; DLA-003, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file; DLA-017, Deal A Diligence & Structure Update; Deal A 10-K filings (SEC); OP4-005, Operator 4 investment memo; QLX-017, Wellness Clinic Franchisor databook; QLX-024, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 due diligence databook. Fact rows OP1-3250..3260, OP1-3394..3403, OP1-3406..3416, OP1-4823, OP1-4831, OP1-4839, OP2-3414, OP2-3419, OP2-3421, OP2-3431, OP2-3436, OP2-3438, OP2-3462, OP2-3467, OP2-3469, OP5-0311..0313, OP5-1152, OP5-1153, OP5-1585, OP5-1586, OP5-2028, OP5-2029, OP3-0018, OP3-0034, OP3-0098, OP3-0130, OP3-1010, OP3-1029, OP3-1067, OP3-1086, OP8-0669, OP8-0813, OP8-0825, OP8-1347, OP8-2075..2102, OP7-0001, OP7-0004, OP7-0019, OP7-0022, OP7-0127, OP7-0146, OP7-0487, OP7-0490, DLA-0013, DLA-0017, DLA-0251, DLA-0266, DLA-0283, DLA-0300, DLA-0315, DLA-0317, DLA-0846, DLA-0854, DLA-0855, DLA-3340..3343, OP4-0938..0943, A3-P5-014 and A3-P5-015.

How. Rebates as a share of revenue = rebates ÷ the revenue named on the row (clinic sales, segment revenue or consolidated revenue). Rebate share of clinic margin = rebates ÷ four-wall EBITDA with rebates (D1.2); at clinic level the rebate is D1.2 − D1.1, where D1.1 is the margin before rebates. Only rebates that the source books separately or allocates to clinics are used; none is allocated by us. Operator 1 clinic figures use retail clinics trading the full fiscal year, with rebates (ATF) as the difference between clinic contribution with and without ATF. For Operator 1 and Deal A, consolidated rebates are also divided by reported EBITDA (E1); for Deal A FY26 also by E1 excluding gains on disposal and by company non-GAAP EBITDA, and by clinic EBITDA. Operator 4 and Operator 9 rebates are embedded in cost of sales and are shown as a share of pharmacy cost of sales, not revenue.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.51; Exhibit 3.10; the text of Part 03 section C and of Part 09 section J under 03 C.

Limits. The sources hold no vendor agreements, tier schedules or clawback terms, so the computation cannot show whether rebate income is contractually durable, nor split Operator 1's rebate growth between new income and invoice discounts moved to back-end rebate.

C-29 · Unit economics: how the area was measured

What was computed. The general method behind the unit economics section. It covers what a typical clinic earns, the capital put into it, the return on that capital, the ramp of new clinics and the later performance of acquired clinics, for the general practice and preventive operators from fiscal 2008 to mid-2026.

Sources. The clinic-level P&L files, clinic databooks, operating models and acquisition records of Operator 1 (OP1), Deal A (DLA), Operator 2 (OP2), Operator 3 (OP3), Operator 5 (OP5), Operator 7 (OP7), Operator 8 (OP8), Operator 6 (OP6) and Operator 4 (OP4); company figures for Deal B (DLB) and Deal C (DLC); for context, Emergency Operator 1 (CO2) and Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (QLX).

How. Clinic profit is four-wall EBITDA before rebates on cash rent (D1.1), or with rebates where the source allocates them (D1.2), with the rent treatment stated on every line. The typical clinic is described by the median and quartiles of clinic values and by the share of loss-making clinics; the chain margin as a ratio of totals is shown separately, and only clinics open for the full year enter a distribution. Capital invested is shown by component (clinic capital spending, pre-opening cost, inventory, purchase price, integration), and the cash return is (clinic profit − maintenance capital spending per clinic) ÷ capital invested, which is always a calculation of ours. Only cash-rent figures on the first definition are compared across operators: Operator 1 2008 to 2017, Operator 5 fiscal 2020 to the twelve months to March 2023, and Operator 7 fiscal 2023 to 2025 (Operator 8 has cash-rent figures for single years at chain level only); because the Operator 1 and Operator 7 figures are actual and the Operator 5 figures pro forma, the three are shown side by side and not merged into one distribution. Operators whose rent basis is not stated (R-UNK) or covers operating leases only (R-OPONLY) are reported one by one with that label. Projections are excluded, except where a projected capital figure is the only one available, and it is then flagged. Each figure is placed in one of seven economic environments by the date its period ends: before July 2007 (PRE-GFC), the financial crisis from July 2007 to June 2009 (GFC), the expansion from July 2009 to February 2020 (EXP10-19), the COVID period from March to December 2020 (COVID20), the 2021 reopening (REOPEN21), the 2022 to 2023 inflation period (INFL22-23) and the soft period from January 2024 (SOFT24-26); twelve-month fiscal years of Deal A (April to March) and Operator 1 (June to May) go to the environment that holds most of their months, and a tie goes to the later one. A characteristic is called durable only if it is seen at three or more independent operators and in two or more environments; where that test is not met the text says so.

Where shown. The text of Part 03 section D and of Part 09 section J under 03 D.

Limits. No operator reports clinic capital including land and buildings; the Operator 1 series does not label new-build against acquired clinics; later results of acquired clinics at Operator 6, Operator 4 and Operator 3 are company-presented, include rebates or synergies and cover only deals still owned; clinic-level profit reaches the financial crisis at Operator 1 only. No numeric rule is stated for "temporary" or "company-specific".

C-30 · The typical full-year clinic: sales, four-wall profit and loss-making share

What was computed. For each operator and period with clinic-level data, the average sales per clinic, the median clinic four-wall profit, the four-wall margin and the share of clinics making a loss. Covers Operator 1 (FY08 to CY2016), Operator 5 (FY20, FY22), Operator 7 State 05 (FY23, FY25), Operator 2 (2018 to LTM March 2021 from clinic data; LTM September 2024 from a company summary [M]), Operator 3 (FY23, LTM August 2025), Operator 8 (FY22, FY25), Operator 6 (LTM March 2026), Operator 4 (FY25) and Deal A (FY24, FY26).

Sources. OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic P&Ls, June 2007 to May 2014; OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level financials to December 2017; OP5-011, Operator 5 operating model with clinic-level results, July 2023; OP7-007, Operator 7 quality-of-earnings workbook (State 05 clinics), February 2026; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook, June 2021; OP2-024, Operator 2 data-request responses, November 2024; OP3-003, Operator 3 clinic-month datacube, August 2025; OP8-012 and OP8-010, Operator 8 databooks, February 2025 and March 2026; OP6-001, Ares Credit Group Operator 6 investment committee memo, July 2026; OP4-006, Operator 4 sponsor financial model, spring 2026; DLA-003, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA FY23 to FY26; DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report. Fact rows: OP1-2213, OP1-2214, OP1-2408, OP1-2409, OP1-2456, OP1-2457, OP1-2507, OP1-2508, OP1-2651, OP1-2652, OP1-5314, OP1-5317, OP1-5322, OP1-5622, OP1-5625, OP1-5630, OP1-5658, OP1-5661, OP1-5666, OP1-5749, OP1-5752, OP1-5757, OP1-6170, OP1-6173, OP1-6178; A4-P5-001 to A4-P5-003; OP5-1152, OP5-1177, OP5-2028, OP5-2047, OP5-2050, OP5-2053, OP5-2057; OP7-0495, OP7-0498 to OP7-0501, OP7-0511, OP7-0514 to OP7-0517; OP2-3401, OP2-3431, OP2-3462, OP2-3544, OP2-3548, OP2-3551, OP2-3588, OP2-3592, OP2-3595, OP2-3614, OP2-3618, OP2-3621, OP2-4222, OP2-4230; OP3-1012, OP3-1019, OP3-1021, OP3-1088, OP3-1095, OP3-1097; OP8-1709, OP8-1712, OP8-1713, OP8-2124, OP8-2127, OP8-2128; OP6-0354, OP6-0357; OP4-1507; DLA-0859, DLA-0862, DLA-0899, DLA-0902, A4-S0213, A4-S0269.

How. Each line uses the clinics that traded all twelve months of the period, unless the line states another base (surviving clinics, comparable clinics, or clinics open at year-end). Four-wall profit is clinic revenue less product cost, clinic labour, clinic operating costs and rent, before vendor rebates (D1.1); the rent treatment is stated on every line, and only Operator 1, Operator 5, Operator 7 and Operator 8 FY22 are on cash rent (R-CASH). Average sales = total clinic sales ÷ number of clinics. Margin is shown two ways: total four-wall ÷ total sales across the clinics (ratio of sums), and the median of the individual clinic margins. Loss-making share = clinics with four-wall below zero ÷ clinics in the base. One additional Operator 1 FY09 line takes all 90 clinics with FY09 sales, including 46 part-year clinics, and reports the median four-wall and the loss-making share on that wider base.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.12; Exhibit 9.57; Exhibit 4.11; the text of Part 03 section D and of Part 09 section J under 03 D.

Limits. Operators sit on different rent treatments, rebate treatments and clinic bases (Operator 6 and Operator 4 include rebates; Deal A excludes finance-lease cost; several are surviving clinics only), so the lines are read per operator and are not one pooled distribution.

C-31 · Clinic four-wall margin on one common definition, cash-rent operators only

What was computed. The distribution of clinic four-wall margins (median, lower and upper quartile, loss-making share) and the median four-wall in dollars, for the three operators whose full clinic distributions are on cash rent: Operator 1 (FY08, FY09, CY2009 to CY2016), Operator 5 (FY20 to LTM March 2023) and Operator 7 (State 05 FY23 to FY25; State 18 FY24 to FY25 shown separately).

Sources. OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic P&Ls, June 2007 to May 2014; OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level financials to December 2017; OP5-011, Operator 5 operating model with clinic-level results, July 2023; OP7-007, Operator 7 quality-of-earnings workbook (State 05); OP7-006, Operator 25 financial diligence databook (State 18 sites), April 2026. Fact rows: OP1-2213, OP1-2214, OP1-2408, OP1-2409, OP1-2507, OP1-2508, OP1-5313 to OP1-5322, OP1-5621 to OP1-5630, OP1-5748 to OP1-5757, OP1-5784 to OP1-5793, OP1-5820 to OP1-5829; OP5-1171 to OP5-1173, OP5-1177, OP5-1604 to OP5-1606, OP5-1610, OP5-2047 to OP5-2050, OP5-2053, OP5-2488 to OP5-2490, OP5-2494; OP7-0495 to OP7-0498, OP7-0501, OP7-0503 to OP7-0506, OP7-0509, OP7-0511 to OP7-0514, OP7-0517, OP7-0519 to OP7-0522, OP7-0525, OP7-0527 to OP7-0530, OP7-0533.

How. The measure is four-wall EBITDA before vendor rebates on cash rent (D1.1, R-CASH). The base is clinics trading all twelve months of the period; part-year clinics are excluded (46 at Operator 1 in FY09, and the part-year clinics at Operator 7), and none of these files contains a closure. For each operator and period, clinic margin = clinic four-wall ÷ clinic revenue; the median, 25th and 75th percentiles are taken across clinics, and loss-making share = clinics with four-wall below zero ÷ clinics in the base. Operators are shown side by side and not pooled, because Operator 1 and Operator 7 are actual results and Operator 5 is pro forma (quality-of-earnings adjusted). Operator 7 State 18 clinics are shown but kept out of comparisons because advertising, insurance and card fees are booked centrally, which overstates their clinic margin.

Where shown. The text of Part 03 section D and of Part 09 section J under 03 D.

Limits. Only three operators report full clinic distributions on cash rent (Operator 8's cash-rent figures cover single years at chain level), there is no clinic year before the financial crisis, and clinics closed before the Operator 1 file date may be missing.

C-32 · Capital invested per clinic, by component and clinic type

What was computed. The capital put into one clinic, listed by what it includes, for organic openings (Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 8) and for acquired clinics (Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 4, Deal A).

Sources. OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic P&Ls with clinic capex, 2007 to 2014; OP1-025, Operator 1 clinic-level unit economics summary, December 2017; OP1-032, Operator 1 diligence pack, February 2021; OP2-013, Ares Credit Group incremental investment memo on Operator 2, February 2020; OP5-010, Operator 5 confidential information memorandum, May 2023; OP8-001, Ares Credit Group Operator 8 investment committee memo, January 2025; OP8-003, Operator 8 sponsor financial model, December 2024; OP3-011, Operator 3 data pack, October 2025; OP6-012, Operator 6 valuation multiple summary (31 add-on deals); OP6-010, Operator 6 confidential information presentation, May 2026; OP4-005, lender investment committee memo on Operator 4, June 2026; DLA-010, Deal A acquisition analysis (95 deals). Fact rows: OP1-1497, OP1-1499 to OP1-1501, OP1-7074, OP1-7076, OP1-7077, OP1-7668; OP2-1660; OP5-0339, OP5-0342, OP5-0343; OP8-0540, OP8-0281; OP3-1842; A4-S0368; OP6-1881 to OP6-1883; OP4-0764, OP4-0765, OP4-0784, OP4-0785; DLA-2090, DLA-2135.

How. Most figures are taken as the source states them, with the components named on each line (clinic capex, pre-opening cost, inventory, purchase price, integration cost); no component was added or removed by us. Three are our calculations. Operator 6 price per clinic = total enterprise value paid (cash plus rollover) for the 31 add-ons ÷ 46 clinics. Operator 6 integration and transaction cost per clinic = that cost in the period ÷ clinics acquired in the period. Operator 4 price per clinic = aggregate purchase price ÷ clinics acquired, for 2021 and for 2025. Deal A is shown as price ÷ the seller's prior-year sales, because the deal register holds no EBITDA. Where a source gives two values for the same clinic (Operator 5 City 12, $1.0m and $1.4m), both are kept.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.57; Exhibit 3.15.

Limits. No operator reports clinic capital including land and building; Operator 1 single-acquisition capex excludes the purchase price; and the definition behind Operator 1's older "historical total investment" figure is not stated in the source.

C-33 · Cash-on-cash return per clinic, organic openings and acquired clinics

What was computed. The yearly return on the capital invested in a clinic, before and after maintenance capex, for Operator 1 openings (age-years 3 and 5; greenfield and brownfield at year 3), Operator 2 greenfields, the Operator 5 City 12 greenfield, Operator 6 add-ons at entry and by years since close, and the Operator 4 acquisition pools.

Sources. OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level financials to December 2017; OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic P&Ls and capex, 2007 to 2014; OP1-025, Operator 1 unit economics summary, December 2017; OP1-016, Operator 1 monthly model with capex split, January 2018; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook, June 2021; OP2-004 and OP2-013, Ares Credit Group Operator 2 memos, 2018 and 2020; OP2-023 and OP2-025, Ares Credit Group Operator 2 updates, 2024 and 2026; OP5-010, Operator 5 confidential information memorandum; OP5-011, Operator 5 operating model; OP6-012, Operator 6 valuation multiple summary; OP6-010, Operator 6 confidential information presentation; OP4-005, lender memo on Operator 4. Fact rows: A4-S0024, A4-S0044, A4-S0330, A4-S0331, A4-S0333, A4-S0340, A4-S0341, A4-S0343, A4-S0350, A4-S0351, A4-S0353, A4-S0361, A4-S0362; OP1-1496, OP1-1500, OP1-1501, OP1-3007, OP1-3012, OP1-3211, OP1-3456, OP1-7059, OP1-7060, OP1-7071, OP1-7072, OP1-7074, OP1-7076; OP2-0320, OP2-0321, OP2-1660, OP2-3644, OP2-3647, OP2-3650, OP2-3896, OP2-4290; OP5-2561, OP5-0342, OP5-0343; OP6-1881 to OP6-1883; OP4-0802, OP4-0803, OP4-0806 to OP4-0809, OP4-0812.

How. Return before maintenance = clinic four-wall ÷ capital invested per clinic; return after maintenance = (clinic four-wall − maintenance capex per clinic) ÷ capital invested per clinic. For organic clinics, capital is the opening investment excluding real estate (and excluding any purchase price); for add-ons, capital is the price paid, so the return equals 1 ÷ the purchase multiple, with a second Operator 6 line adding $161k of integration cost per clinic (the mean of three yearly figures). Earnings and capital are paired only within one operator. Operator 1 lines use mean clinic four-wall before rebates on cash rent (D1.1, R-CASH) against mean initial capex of new clinics excluding the [name withheld] and Deal A batch acquisitions, with maintenance capex of $9.0k per clinic (CY2016); Operator 2 lines use about $254k of capital and about $15k of maintenance capex. The Operator 1 company-summary, Operator 5, Operator 6 and Operator 4 lines use clinic earnings that include rebates; Operator 4 is computed on pool totals, not per clinic.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.13; Exhibit 9.57; the text of Part 03 section D and of Part 09 section J under 03 D.

Limits. Returns are on leased-clinic capital only, since rent sits inside four-wall and no source gives capital including real estate; several lines rest on few clinics, on management figures, or on company-presented earnings that include synergies.

C-34 · Operator 1 clinic ramp by year of age after opening

What was computed. Sales and four-wall profit of Operator 1 clinics by year of age (years 1 to 9), for clinics that entered one at a time and, separately, for the two batch acquisitions ([name withheld], November 2008; Deal A City 30, December 2011). Each age-year is also expressed as a multiple of the mature-clinic median.

Sources. OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level financials (about 161 retail clinic sheets, June 2008 to November 2017). Fact rows: within A4-S0001 to A4-S0176; the split by opening period is A4-S0379 to A4-S0396.

How. The base is every retail clinic with a sheet at November 2017 that first traded after June 2008; the two wholesale units are excluded and the first partial month is dropped. Age-year k is months 10k–11 to 10k after the first trading month, and a clinic counts in an age-year only if it traded all twelve months. "Single-clinic entries" are clinics whose first trading month is shared with fewer than five other clinics (greenfield, brownfield and single acquisitions, which the source does not label); the rest are the batch acquisitions. For each age-year: mean clinic sales; median clinic four-wall before rebates on cash rent (D1.1, R-CASH); margin = total four-wall ÷ total sales, before rebates and including rebates (D1.2); loss-making share = clinics with four-wall below zero ÷ clinics. The relative measures are the median of (clinic value ÷ the median of clinics that opened before July 2008 and traded all twelve months of the calendar year in which the age-year's midpoint falls). The single-clinic entries are also split into openings of July 2008 to May 2014 and June 2014 to November 2016.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.14; Exhibit 9.59.

Limits. The series does not separate greenfield, brownfield and acquired clinics, clinics closed before the file date may be absent, later age-years rest on few clinics, and nothing is observed after 2017.

C-35 · Operator 2 clinic results by year of ownership

What was computed. For Operator 2's owned clinics in 2018, 2019 and 2020, split into acquired clinics and greenfields and grouped by year of ownership (first, second, third): clinic count, mean sales, four-wall margin, median four-wall and loss-making share.

Sources. OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook, June 2021 (clinic-month data January 2017 to March 2021). Fact rows: A4-S0270 to A4-S0314.

How. The base is owned clinics trading all twelve months of the calendar year; only owned months are used and no seller-period data enter. Clinics are grouped by kind (acquired or greenfield, from the databook's flag) and by years since the ownership start date, with year 1 the first twelve owned months. For each group: mean clinic sales; four-wall margin = total four-wall ÷ total sales; median clinic four-wall; loss-making share = clinics with four-wall below zero ÷ clinics. Four-wall is before rebates (D1.1); the databook does not state whether rent is cash or book rent (R-UNK).

Where shown. Exhibit 9.61; Exhibit 9.79; the text of Part 09 section J under 03 D.

Limits. The rent basis is not stated, greenfield groups hold one to seven clinics, 2020 is affected by COVID, and the groups are different clinics in each year and not one cohort followed through time.

C-36 · Acquired clinics after purchase, measured against entry

What was computed. For each operator with evidence, how acquired clinics performed after purchase against the position at entry: purchase multiple at entry and later, later ÷ entry EBITDA, results against the pro forma used to price the deal, and the share of deals below entry. Covers Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 4, Operator 8, Operator 2, Operator 1, Operator 7 and Deal B, with Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 2 as emergency and specialty hospital context.

Sources. OP6-012, Operator 6 valuation multiple summary (31 add-on deals); OP3-010, Ares Credit Group Operator 3 early read, October 2025; OP3-009, Operator 3 pre-acquisition financials; OP4-005, lender memo on Operator 4, June 2026; OP8-012 and OP8-010, Operator 8 databooks; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook; OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level financials; OP1-054, Operator 1 comparison of the 2023 TBC acquisition to plan; OP7-001, Ares Credit Group Operator 7 early read, August 2026; CO2-037, Ares Credit Group Emergency Operator 3 follow-up databook; CO2-024, Ares Credit Group Emergency Operator 2 memo; Deal B cohort datapacks. Fact rows: A4-S0366, A4-S0367, OP6-1731, OP6-1733; OP3-1457 to OP3-1492, OP3-1110, OP3-1111; OP4-0802, OP4-0803, OP4-0806 to OP4-0808, OP4-0810, OP4-0812; OP8-1701 to OP8-1703, OP8-2209 to OP8-2211, OP8-2151, OP8-2153, OP8-2154, OP8-2156, OP8-2167, OP8-2169; A4-S0272, A4-S0274, A4-S0277, A4-S0279, A4-S0287, A4-S0289; OP2-3655, OP2-3661, OP2-3667, OP2-3673, OP2-3677, OP2-3683; A4-S0093, A4-S0094, A4-S0113, A4-S0114, A4-S0133, A4-S0134; OP1-11285 to OP1-11304; OP7-1085, OP7-1086, OP7-1088, OP7-1089; CO3-1025 to CO3-1027; COR-5617, COR-5618.

How. Each line sets an entry value beside a later value on that operator's own measure; measures are not converted to a common definition. For multiples, entry multiple = purchase price ÷ seller clinic EBITDA at entry and later multiple = the same price ÷ the latest clinic EBITDA; the ratio shown is later EBITDA ÷ entry EBITDA (equivalently entry multiple ÷ later multiple). For Operator 8 and Deal B the ratio is actual cohort EBITDA ÷ the pro forma EBITDA used at acquisition; for Operator 1's 2023 acquisition it is year-3 adjusted EBITDA ÷ plan. For Operator 2 and Operator 1 [name withheld] the line reports clinic four-wall before rebates (D1.1) by year of ownership; Operator 2's brand line compares sales in the first twelve owned months with the seller's last twelve months. The Operator 3 multiples are means read from an Ares Credit Group chart of 18 deals.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.79; Exhibit 9.58; Exhibit 9.60; the text of Part 03 section D and of Part 09 section J under 03 D.

Limits. Later EBITDA for Operator 6, Operator 4 and Operator 3 is company-presented, includes rebates and synergies and covers surviving deals only, so the uplift is not established before rebates or on an all-deal base; the Deal B rows were read once from the data room.

C-37 · Operator 6 add-on acquisitions by years since close

What was computed. Operator 6's 31 add-on deals (46 clinics, August 2021 to December 2025) grouped by time since close (under 1 year, 1–2, 2–3, 3 years or more, and all): price paid, price per clinic, clinic EBITDA at entry and now, entry and current multiples, current ÷ entry EBITDA, and the number of deals below entry.

Sources. OP6-012, Operator 6 valuation multiple summary, deal-level data for 31 add-ons, May 2026. Fact rows: A4-S0319 to A4-S0368; aggregate multiples OP6-1731 and OP6-1733.

How. Each deal is placed in a group by the years from its closing date to 31 March 2026. Within each group, price (cash plus rollover), entry EBITDA and current EBITDA are summed across deals. Entry EBITDA is the seller-period, diligence-adjusted clinic EBITDA on a standalone basis; current EBITDA is clinic EBITDA for the twelve months to March 2026 per the quality-of-earnings work, including platform synergies and with rebates in cost of sales. Price per clinic = summed price ÷ clinics; entry multiple = summed price ÷ summed entry EBITDA; current multiple = summed price ÷ summed current EBITDA; current vs entry = summed current EBITDA ÷ summed entry EBITDA; deals below entry = count of deals whose current EBITDA is below their entry EBITDA.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.79; Exhibit 9.148; Exhibit 9.58; Exhibit 9.60; the text of Part 03 section D and Part 07 section F, and of Part 09 section J under 03 D, Part 09 section K under 04 A and Part 09 section N under 07 F.

Limits. Current EBITDA is company-presented and synergised, the under-1-year group's twelve months include seller months (pro forma), only 11 deals have been owned two years or more, and the City 11 brownfield and any exited deals are outside the sample.

C-38 · How much of clinic margin dispersion mix, geography, scale and rent explain

What was computed. For eight operator-years (Operator 1 CY2010 and CY2016; Deal A FY23 and FY26; Operator 2 2019 and 2020; Operator 3 FY24 and LTM August 2025), the spread of clinic four-wall margins and the share of that spread explained by service mix, geography, clinic sales level and rent, singly and together.

Sources. OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level financials to December 2017; DLA-003, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA FY23 to FY26, matched to DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook, June 2021; OP3-003, Operator 3 clinic-month datacube, August 2025. Fact rows: A4-S0177 to A4-S0268.

How. The base is clinics with twelve months in the period (Operator 1: every clinic sheet with twelve monthly rows, wholesale units excluded; Deal A: currently open clinics matched between the two files; Operator 2: owned clinics; Operator 3: surviving clinics with twelve owned months). Clinic margin = clinic four-wall ÷ clinic revenue, on each operator's own definition and rent treatment; the median, quartiles and loss-making share are taken across clinics. Clinic margin is then regressed by ordinary least squares on each factor separately and on all factors together, with margins capped at the 1st and 99th percentiles for the regressions only, and the adjusted R^2 is reported. Mix is the pharmacy share of revenue (for Operator 2, a pharmacy-format indicator); geography is a set of indicators (Deal A region, Operator 2 brand, Operator 3 state); scale is the natural log of clinic revenue; rent is rent ÷ sales (Operator 1 only). The low-mix and high-mix margins are total four-wall ÷ total sales for the lowest and highest thirds of clinics by pharmacy share (for Operator 2, service format against pharmacy format).

Where shown. Exhibit 9.120; the text of Part 04 section E, and of Part 09 section J under 03 D and Part 09 section M under 06 C.

Limits. Clinic sales level is itself an outcome and with fixed clinic costs partly measures operating leverage, so the analysis cannot separate the local market from execution; Operator 2's brand and Operator 3's state indicators also identify the acquired chain, and the Operator 1 CY2016 base (151 sheets) is slightly wider than the 148 full-trading clinics used elsewhere.

C-39 · Maintenance capex per clinic

What was computed. Maintenance capital expenditure per clinic per year for Operator 1 (CY2014, CY2016), Deal A (FY24, FY26), Operator 8 (LTM November 2023), Operator 3 (FY24), Operator 6 (LTM March 2026) and Operator 2 (LTM October 2024), with Operator 5 and Operator 7 noted, and wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital operators as context.

Sources. OP1-016, Operator 1 monthly model with capex split, January 2018; Deal A annual reports (SEC filings) for total capex and clinic counts; OP8-008, Accounting Firm 2 financial diligence report on Operator 8, February 2024, and OP8-003, Operator 8 financial model; OP3-010, Ares Credit Group Operator 3 early read, and OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; OP6-010, Operator 6 confidential information presentation, May 2026; OP2-023 and OP2-025, Ares Credit Group Operator 2 updates, 2024 and 2026; OP5-010, Operator 5 confidential information memorandum; OP7-003, Operator 7 financial model, August 2026; QLX-024, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 financial diligence databook; QLX-019, Wellness Clinic Franchisor confidential information presentation; CO2-039, Ares Credit Group Emergency Operator 3 situation update; CO2-007, Ares Credit Group Emergency Operator 1 investment committee memo. Fact rows: OP1-3209, OP1-3211, OP1-3454, OP1-3456; DLA-0286, DLA-0320, DLA-0384 to DLA-0387; OP8-0781, OP8-0408; OP3-1201, OP3-0027; OP6-0663, OP6-0442; OP2-3896, OP2-4290; OP5-0332; OP7-0835; QL1-0411; QLF-1404; CO3-1531, CO3-0776; CO1-0261.

How. Per-clinic figure = maintenance capex for the period ÷ number of clinics. The maintenance amount is the company's or the diligence provider's own split between maintenance and growth capex; we did not construct a split. Deal A discloses total capex only, so its figure is total capex ÷ the average of opening and closing clinic counts and is an upper bound. Operator 2 is an approximate figure from a forward-looking coverage calculation, ÷ 433 clinics at December 2024. Operator 5 is management's statement that maintenance capex is below 1% of revenue; Operator 7 has no split; the context figures are taken as the sources state them.

Where shown. The text of Part 03 section D, and of Part 09 section J under 03 D and Part 09 section M under 06 D.

Limits. Most figures rest on management's own maintenance-versus-growth split, which cannot be checked from the sources, and clinic counts are not on a uniform basis across operators.

C-40 · Same-store sales across environments: how the area was measured

What was computed. The general method behind the same-store sales section. It covers comparable-clinic sales growth, and its traffic and ticket supplies where available, for the general practice and preventive operators from fiscal 2006 to mid-2026, set against each economic environment, with wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals as context.

Sources. The clinic-level databases, comparable-sales files, diligence materials and lender presentations of Operator 1 (OP1), Operator 2 with Operator 10, Operator 14, Operator 12 and Operator 16 (OP2), Deal A (DLA), Operator 5 (OP5), Operator 3 (OP3), Operator 8 (OP8), Operator 6 (OP6), Operator 7 (OP7), Operator 4 and Operator 9 (OP4), Deal B (DLB) and Deal C (DLC); for context, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (QLX) and Emergency Operator 1, Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 5, Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 2 (CO2). Public series: comparable-clinic sales from the SEC filings of Deal A, Public Wellness Clinic Co., Public Pet Health Co. and Emergency Operator 6.

How. The common measure is sales of clinics owned and open in every month from twelve months earlier ÷ sales of the same clinics a year earlier − 1, on calendar months with no working-day or weather adjustment and no pre-acquisition data (D2.1, SSS_CD); each company's own definition is

recorded beside it, in the company's words (SSS_ST-59). Each series carries its closure treatment: closed clinics leave the base from the month of closure (CLOSE-FWD), or the file holds surviving clinics only (CLOSE-RETRO). Where an operator has several series for a year, one is selected in a fixed order: the common definition with closures removed from the month of closure, then the common definition on a survivor base, then the company definition; the definition used is stated on every row. The common measure was recomputed from clinic-level data for Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 2, Operator 8 and Operator 5. The environment table takes the mean of each operator's full-year values in each environment, and for this area the expansion is split in two, July 2009 to December 2014 (EXP10-14) and January 2015 to February 2020 (EXP15-19). Forecasts and series that include pre-acquisition months are excluded or shown as labelled comparators; wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are never pooled with the general practice and preventive operators. Each figure is placed in one of seven economic environments by the date its period ends: before July 2007 (PRE-GFC), the financial crisis from July 2007 to June 2009 (GFC), the expansion from July 2009 to February 2020 (EXP10-19), the COVID period from March to December 2020 (COVID20), the 2021 reopening (REOPEN21), the 2022 to 2023 inflation period (INFL22-23) and the soft period from January 2024 (SOFT24-26); twelve-month fiscal years of Deal A (April to March) and Operator 1 (June to May) go to the environment that holds most of their months, and a tie goes to the later one. A characteristic is called durable only if it is seen at three or more independent operators and in two or more environments; where that test is not met the text says so.

Where shown. The text of Part 03 section E and of Part 09 section J under 03 E.

Limits. The environment table mixes the common and company definitions, so a row is not like-for-like across operators; three or more operators share the common definition in only five years (2019, 2020, 2022, 2024, 2025); the survivor-based series are upper bounds; only Deal A's public series, Operator 10 and legacy Operator 1 reach the financial crisis. No numeric rule is stated for "temporary" or "company-specific".

C-41 · Best-available annual same-store sales series per operator

What was computed. One annual same-store sales figure per operator and year, 129 operator-years in all, with traffic and ticket growth where the source gives them. It covers 13 core general practice and preventive care operators from 2005 to 2025 (Deal A by fiscal year FY06–FY26), plus wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital operators kept separately as context.

Sources. OP4-005, Lender 1 credit memo on Operator 4 and Operator 9 (comparable-sales panel, p.20); OP1-015 and OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level P&L workbooks 2007–2017; OP1-041, Operator 1 comp sales summary 2019–Mar-2023; OP1-048, Ares Credit Group Operator 1 situation update (June 2026); OP1-053, Operator 29 same-store sales chart; OP2-007, Operator 10 and Operator 12 clinic KPI history; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook; OP2-025 and OP2-026, Operator 2 2026 updates; OP5-008, Operator 5 clinic-level volume trends; OP3-003, Operator 3 clinic-month datacube; OP8-010 and OP8-012, Operator 8 databooks; OP8-006, Operator 8 supplement metrics; OP6-002 and OP6-010, Operator 6 readout and CIP; OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook; Deal A's reported comparable-clinic sales from its 10-K filings and releases (public series DLA_SSS, SEC filings); context: QLX-005, QLX-013, QLX-029 (Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 clinic data), CO2-003, CO2-007, CO2-012, CO2-022, CO2-037, CO2-039 (emergency and specialty hospitals). Fact rows include OP4-0541..0556, OP4-0589..0593, OP1-2114, OP1-5126..5133, OP1-8251, OP1-8856..8859, OP1-11177..11179, OP1-11279..11281, OP2-0648..0680, OP2-3520..3527, OP2-4238..4283, OP2-4703, DLA-0336..0363, OP5-3862..3880, OP3-0885..0892, OP8-0577, OP8-1714..1730, OP8-2106, OP6-0698, OP6-1147, OP6-1148, OP7-1022; Deal B and Deal C rows DLB-1361, DLB-1406 and DLC-006-000204..000206.

How. For each operator and year one value was chosen in a fixed order of preference. First, same-store sales on the common definition (D2.1: clinics owned and open on every day of the current month and the twelve before it; period sales of those clinics ÷ their sales twelve months earlier − 1; calendar months, no working-day or weather adjustment, no pre-acquisition data) where a closed clinic leaves the base only from its month of closure (CLOSE-FWD). Second, the common definition on a survivor-only file, where closed clinics are absent from all history (CLOSE-RETRO). Third, the company's own definition (SSS_ST-59). Every row keeps its definition, closure treatment, clinic base and source fact rows. Traffic and ticket are on the same comparable base; where ticket is not given it is (1 + same-store sales) ÷ (1 + traffic) − 1. Deal A fiscal years (April–March) are placed in the calendar year that holds nine of their twelve months; Operator 1 2008 is its fiscal year June 2008–May 2009 and Operator 1 2017 is the twelve months to November 2017. Forecasts and pre-acquisition (seller-inclusive) series are excluded.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.18.

Limits. Definitions are mixed across operators and sometimes within one operator's history, so the series is not like-for-like; the Operator 4, Operator 9 and Operator 29 definitions are not stated in their sources.

C-42 · Spread of same-store sales across operators in each year

What was computed. For each calendar year 2007–2025, the number of core operators with a reading and the mean, median, standard deviation, minimum, maximum, range and count of negative readings across them. The statistics are given on two cuts: all definitions, and common-definition rows only.

Sources. The best-available annual series, core operators only: OP4-005 (Operator 4 and Operator 9 panel), OP1-021 and OP1-041 (Operator 1 clinic data), OP1-048 (Ares Credit Group Operator 1 update), OP1-053 (Operator 29), OP1-036 (Operator 1 2021 CIM), OP2-007, OP2-021, OP2-025, OP2-026 (Operator 2 lineage), OP5-008 (Operator 5), OP3-003 (Operator 3), OP8-006, OP8-010, OP8-012 (Operator 8), OP6-002, OP6-010 (Operator 6), OP7-005 (Operator 7), and Deal A 10-K comparable-clinic sales (public series DLA_SSS, SEC filings). Fact rows as listed per year, including OP4-0541..0556, OP1-5126..5133, OP1-8856..8859, OP2-0648..0680, OP2-3520..3527, DLA-0336..0363, OP5-3862..3880.

How. Each operator contributes one value per calendar year from the best-available series; Deal A fiscal years are placed in the calendar year holding nine of their twelve months (FY21 counts as 2020). The statistics are taken across operators within the year; the standard deviation is the sample standard deviation (n − 1). The second cut keeps only rows on the common definition (D2.1: clinics owned and open in every month of both years), including survivor-only bases. The summary figures are the mean and the median of the yearly standard deviations over the 17 years with at least three operators.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.18; the text of Part 03 section E and of Part 09 section J under 03 E.

Limits. The all-definitions cut mixes company and common definitions, and the common-definition cut has three or more operators in only five years (2019, 2020, 2022, 2024, 2025).

C-43 · Each operator's long-run mean and variability of same-store sales

What was computed. For each operator, the number of annual readings, the span, the mean, standard deviation, lowest and highest year and number of negative years of its same-store sales, with a second standard deviation that leaves out 2020 and 2021. Core operators are ranked by standard deviation; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital operators are shown as context.

Sources. The best-available annual series: Deal A 10-K comparable-clinic sales FY06–FY26 (public series DLA_SSS, SEC filings; DLA-0336..0363); OP4-005, Operator 4 and Operator 9 panel (OP4-0541..0556, OP4-0589..0593); OP2-007, OP2-021, OP2-025 (Operator 2 lineage); OP1-015, OP1-021, OP1-041, OP1-048 (Operator 1); OP5-008 (Operator 5); OP8-010, OP8-012 (Operator 8); OP3-003 (Operator 3); OP6-002 (Operator 6); OP1-053 (Operator 29); OP7-005 (Operator 7); context: QLX-005, QLX-013, QLX-029 (Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1), CO2-003, CO2-007, CO2-012, CO2-022, CO2-037, CO2-039 (emergency and specialty hospitals).

How. All annual values of an operator in the best-available series are used, whatever their definition. Mean = simple average of the annual values; standard deviation = sample standard deviation (n − 1) of the same values; negative years = count of values below zero. The second standard deviation drops calendar 2020 and 2021 (for Deal A, FY21 and FY22). Core operators with at least three years are ordered from lowest to highest standard deviation; the published ranking keeps only those with at least five years.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.65; Exhibit 9.110; the text of Part 03 section E, and of Part 09 section J under 03 E and Part 09 section L under 05 B.

Limits. Operators are measured over different spans and on different definitions, so the ranking compares histories that are not like-for-like.

C-44 · Cross-operator median same-store sales in each economic environment

What was computed. For each of eight economic environments, the number of core operators with a reading, the median, lowest and highest of their environment means, the lowest and highest single annual value, and the median traffic and ticket growth where measured.

Sources. The operator-by-environment means, core operators only: Deal A 10-K comparable-clinic sales (public series DLA_SSS, SEC filings; DLA-0336..0363); OP4-005 (Operator 4, Operator 9); OP1-015, OP1-021, OP1-041, OP1-048, OP1-036 (Operator 1); OP1-053 (Operator 29); OP2-007, OP2-021, OP2-025, OP2-026 (Operator 2 lineage); OP5-008 (Operator 5); OP3-003 (Operator 3); OP8-006, OP8-010, OP8-012 (Operator 8); OP6-002, OP6-010 (Operator 6); OP7-005 (Operator 7); and the company same-store series of Deal B (DLB-003) and Deal C (DLC-006). Fact rows as listed per environment.

How. Environments are: before July 2007 (PRE-GFC); July 2007–June 2009 (GFC); July 2009–December 2014 (EXP10-14); January 2015–February 2020 (EXP15-19); March–December 2020 (COVID20); 2021 (REOPEN21); 2022–23 (INFL22-23); January 2024 onward (SOFT24-26). A year is assigned by its period end, except that Deal A and Operator 1 fiscal years go to the environment holding most of their months. Each operator's mean for an environment is the simple average of its full-year values there. The cross-operator figure is the median of those operator means, so each operator counts once; traffic and ticket medians are taken the same way over the operators that have them.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.19, cross-operator median row.

Limits. Operator means rest on mixed definitions and on one to six years each, and the pre-GFC figure rests on Deal A alone.

C-45 · Mean same-store sales per operator in each economic environment

What was computed. For each operator and environment, the number of full years, the mean, lowest and highest annual same-store sales, and mean traffic and ticket growth where measured. It covers the core operators from pre-2007 to 2024–26, with wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital operators as separate context rows.

Sources. The best-available annual series: Deal A 10-K comparable-clinic sales (public series DLA_SSS, SEC filings; DLA-0336..0363); OP4-005 (Operator 4, Operator 9; OP4-0541..0593); OP1-015, OP1-021, OP1-041, OP1-048 (Operator 1); OP1-053 (Operator 29); OP2-007, OP2-021, OP2-025 (Operator 2 lineage); OP5-008 (Operator 5); OP3-003 (Operator 3); OP8-010, OP8-012 (Operator 8); OP6-002 (Operator 6); OP7-005 (Operator 7); context: QLX-005, QLX-013, QLX-029, CO2-003, CO2-007, CO2-012, CO2-022, CO2-037, CO2-039.

How. Each annual value is assigned to one environment: before July 2007 (PRE-GFC); July 2007–June 2009 (GFC); July 2009–December 2014 (EXP10-14); January 2015–February 2020 (EXP15-19); March–December 2020 (COVID20); 2021 (REOPEN21); 2022–23 (INFL22-23); January 2024 onward (SOFT24-26). Assignment is by period end, except Deal A (April–March) and Operator 1 (June–May) fiscal years, which go to the environment holding most of their months: Deal A FY20 is EXP15-19, FY21 COVID20, FY22 REOPEN21, FY24 INFL22-23. The cell is the simple average of the operator's full-year values in that environment; part-year and latest-twelve-month readings are left out, other than Operator 1 2017 (twelve months to November). The persistence test is the Spearman rank correlation between operators' INFL22-23 means and SOFT24-26 means, over the 10 core operators with both.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.65; Exhibit 3.19; the text of Part 03 section E and of Part 09 section J under 03 E.

Limits. Definitions are mixed across operators, so a column of the table is not like-for-like; calendar 2009 is counted in EXP10-14 although its first half falls in the GFC window.

C-46 · Which operators' comparable-sales histories reach the GFC and COVID

What was computed. For each same-store sales series, the first period covered and the readings that fall before the GFC, in the GFC, in calendar 2009 (or Deal A FY10) and in the 2020 COVID period, with a yes/no flag for reaching each shock. It covers 17 series: core operators, plus wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital series as context.

Sources. Deal A 10-K comparable-clinic sales (SEC filings; DLA-0336, DLA-0338, DLA-0340, DLA-0356); DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report (DLA-0628, DLA-0629); OP1-015 and OP1-041, Operator 1 clinic and comp files (OP1-2114, OP1-2115, OP1-8857); OP2-007, Operator 10 clinic KPI history (OP2-0648..0656); OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook (OP2-3525..3527); OP5-008, Operator 5 volume trends (OP5-3870..3872); OP5-001, Operator 5 sales trends (OP5-5409, OP5-5431); OP4-005, Operator 4 panel (OP4-0551); context: QLX-029 Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (QL1-0862..0864), QLX-005 Wellness Clinic Franchisor (QLF-0578..0580), CO2-007 Emergency Operator 1 (CO1-0271), CO2-003 Emergency Operator 4 (CO1-0979..0983), CO2-012 Emergency Operator 5 (CO1-1059..1064), CO2-037 Emergency Operator 3 (CO3-0998).

How. Each series' annual readings are placed by period end into four windows: before July 2007; July 2007–June 2009; calendar 2009 or Deal A FY10; and March–December 2020. Deal A FY21 (April 2020–March 2021) is counted as the COVID year because most of its months fall there. A series reaches a shock if it has at least one full-year reading in that window; a reading for calendar 2009 alone is marked as such. Traffic growth is shown beside the reading where the source has it. No figure is derived beyond this placement.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.62; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. The Operator 2 GFC reading is Operator 10 on its own before Operator 2 owned it, and the Operator 5 2009 reading is total-company average daily sales, not same-store sales.

C-47 · Operator 1 comparable sales: five presented series against clinic-level data

What was computed. For each calendar year 2010–2025, Operator 1 same-store sales as shown in five documents are set beside the figure computed from Operator 1 clinic-level files on the common definition, with two differences per year.

Sources. OP4-005, Lender 1 credit memo, peer comparable-sales panel p.20 (OP4-0557 onward); OP1-048, Ares Credit Group Operator 1 situation update of June 2026, "rolling SSS growth" chart (OP1-11162..11180); OP1-030, Ares Credit Group 2018 investment committee memo (OP1-7446 onward); OP1-036, 2021 lender CIM, pro forma all-brands series (OP1-8243..8264); OP1-041, Operator 1 comp sales summary 2019–Mar-2023 (OP1-8759..8762, OP1-8856..8859); OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level P&L to December 2017 (OP1-5126..5133).

How. Values are aligned by calendar year with no adjustment. The clinic-level figure is same-store sales on the common definition (D2.1: clinics owned and open in every month of the current and prior year; their sales ÷ prior-year sales − 1), from OP1-021 for 2010–2016 and OP1-041 for 2019–

2022. Two differences are taken per year, each a simple subtraction in percentage points: the clinic-level figure minus the Ares Credit Group chart, the sign used in Exhibit 9.64, and the panel minus the Ares Credit Group chart.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.64, source note; the text of Part 09 section J under 03 E.

Limits. The definition behind the Ares Credit Group chart and the panel is not stated in either document, and no clinic-level figure exists for 2017–18 or 2023–25.

C-48 · Deal A comparable sales: public, survivor-clinic and third-party panel figures compared

What was computed. For each Deal A fiscal year FY06–FY26, the publicly reported comparable-clinic sales are set beside the days-adjusted public figure, the same-store sales of the surviving clinics, the Deal A column of a third-party panel and the figures in an Ares Credit Group memo, with the differences.

Sources. Deal A 10-K filings and releases, comparable-clinic sales as reported and adjusted for days (public series DLA_SSS and DLA_SSS_ADJ_DAYS, SEC filings; DLA-0336..0363); DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report FY20–Q1 FY27, covering the 983 clinics open at the file date (DLA-0596, DLA-0628, DLA-0660, DLA-0692, DLA-0724, DLA-0756, DLA-0788 and the matching traffic rows); OP4-005, Lender 1 credit memo, peer panel p.20 (OP4-0573 onward); DLA-017, Ares Credit Group Deal A diligence and structure update.

How. The survivor figure is same-store sales on the common definition (D2.1: clinics trading through both years; their sales ÷ prior-year sales − 1) computed from DLA-002. That file holds only clinics still open, so closed clinics are missing from every year (CLOSE-RETRO). Survivor minus public = survivor figure − reported public figure, per fiscal year, FY20–FY26. The panel is matched with a one-year lag: panel year Y is compared with Deal A fiscal year Y+1, and panel minus public is the subtraction on that pairing. Days-adjusted and memo figures are listed beside these without adjustment.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.64; the text of Part 09 section J under 03 E.

Limits. The survivor-minus-public gap mixes the effect of closed clinics with differences in definition (fiscal weeks, entry rule), and there is no survivor figure before FY20.

C-49 · Same-store sales rebuilt from clinic-level files, against reported values

What was computed. Same-store sales and volume growth were rebuilt from clinic-month or clinic-year data for Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 2, Operator 8 and Operator 5, 32 operator-periods in all, and each result was compared with the figure reported in the source. The number of comparable clinics and clinic-months is counted for each period.

Sources. OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level P&L 2007–2017 (OP1-5126..5134); OP1-041, Operator 1 comp sales summary 2019–Mar-2023 (OP1-8856..8860); DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report (DLA-0596..0788); OP3-003, Operator 3 clinic-month datacube (OP3-0885, OP3-0886, OP3-0890, OP3-0898, OP3-0906); OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook (OP2-3520, OP2-3525, OP2-3531); OP8-012, Operator 8 databook (OP8-1714, OP8-1722, OP8-1730); OP5-008, Operator 5 clinic-level volume trends (OP5-3862, OP5-3866, OP5-3870, OP5-3874, OP5-3878).

How. For each period, same-store sales = sales of the comparable clinics, summed over the months of the period, ÷ the same clinics' sales in the same months a year earlier − 1; volume growth is formed the same way on patient visits, tickets or pharmacy units. The comparable base follows the common definition (D2.1) as far as each file allows: Operator 1, from the 13th full month with sales in every month of the prior twelve; Operator 3 and Operator 2, owned and with revenue in every month of the prior twelve; Deal A, clinics with sales and traffic in both years, with no open-date filter; Operator 8, clinics classed as existing with revenue in both years, with no ownership-date filter; Operator 5, clinics with sales in the year and the two before it. The difference is the rebuilt figure minus the reported figure. For Operator 8 2022 the rebuilt base includes the 2021 acquisitions and the reported figure does not; this gap is the clinic-base effect shown in the table.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.64, Operator 8 2022 row and source note.

Limits. For Deal A, Operator 8 and Operator 5 the rebuilt base is looser than the reported one, so their differences measure the effect of the clinic base, not an error in either figure.

C-50 · Operators ranked by same-store sales in 2024–26

What was computed. For each operator, the full-year same-store sales values falling in the soft period from January 2024 (SOFT24-26), their mean and minimum, mean traffic and ticket where measured, and the latest part-year or twelve-month reading. Twelve core operators are ranked; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital operators are listed unranked as context.

Sources. OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook (OP7-1022, OP7-1046); OP8-010 and OP8-012, Operator 8 databooks (OP8-1730, OP8-2106); OP4-005, Operator 4 and Operator 9 panel (OP4-0555, OP4-0556, OP4-0592, OP4-0593); OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube (OP3-0890, OP3-0906); OP6-002, Operator 6 readout (OP6-1143..1148); OP1-048, Ares Credit Group Operator 1 update (OP1-11178..11180); OP1-053, Operator 29 chart (OP1-11280, OP1-11281); OP2-025, Operator 2 update (OP2-4273, OP2-4279); Deal A 10-K comparable-clinic sales (SEC filings; DLA-0361, DLA-0363); Deal B and Deal C rows DLB-1361, DLB-1406, DLB-1516 and DLC-006-000205..000207; context: QLX-005, QLX-013, QLX-020, QLX-029, CO2-039.

How. The values are the operator's full-year readings for calendar 2024 and 2025 from the best-available series; for Deal A they are FY25 and FY26, because FY24 (April 2023–March 2024) has most of its months in 2022–23. Mean = simple average of those one or two values. Core operators are ranked from highest to lowest mean. The latest twelve-month or year-to-date reading is shown beside the mean and does not enter it. Each operator's definition is carried with its row: common definition (D2.1: clinics trading in every month of both years), survivor-only base, or the company's own definition.

Where shown. Exhibit 5.16; the text of Part 09 section J under 03 E and Part 09 section L under 05 B.

Limits. The ranking mixes definitions and rests on one or two years per operator, so rank differences of a few points can come from definition alone.

C-51 · Comparable traffic and ticket growth by operator, 2024–26

What was computed. For each operator with a traffic reading in 2024–26, same-store sales, comparable traffic growth and ticket growth on the broadest base the sources allow. It covers Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6, Deal B, Deal C, Operator 8, Operator 7 and Operator 4, with Wellness Clinic Operator 1 and Wellness Clinic Franchisor as wellness clinic context.

Sources. DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report (DLA-0724..0726, DLA-0756..0758, DLA-0788..0790); OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube (OP3-0890..0892, OP3-0906..0908); OP6-009, Operator 6 visit count file (OP6-1896, OP6-1952) and OP6-002, Operator 6 readout (OP6-1144, OP6-1146, OP6-1148); DLC-015, Deal C company visit count and average invoice file (A1-S002..S004, A5-P5-004..006); OP8-010, Operator 8 databook (OP8-2106, OP8-2114, OP8-2115); OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook (OP7-1022..1024, OP7-1046..1048); OP4-005, Operator 4 panel (OP4-0555, OP4-0556, OP4-0652..0655); Deal B company comp rows DLB-003-000385, -000386, -000388; QLX-029 Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (QL1-0878..0880); QLX-005 and QLX-013 Wellness Clinic Franchisor (QLF-0610..0612, QLF-0711..0713).

How. For each operator the traffic series with the widest clinic base was taken, with the sales and ticket figures on that same base. Traffic = growth in patient visits or patient invoices of the comparable clinics; ticket = growth in revenue per visit or patient invoice, which combines price, mix and attachment. The three satisfy (1 + same-store sales) = (1 + traffic) × (1 + ticket). The summary count and median use the latest 2024–26 reading of each core operator: seven operators without Deal C, eight with its twelve months to June 2026. Deal A FY24 is shown for continuity and is left out of the count. Deal C and Deal B figures are on the companies' own definitions; Deal C's is adjusted for working days and blackout dates and excludes low-cost community vaccine clinics.

Where shown. Exhibit 7.05; Exhibit 4.11, source note; Exhibit 9.167; Exhibit 9.63; Exhibit 4.10; the text of Part 04 section C, and of Part 09 section J under 03 E, Part 09 section L under 05 B and Part 09 section O under 08 D; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. Periods run from the twelve months to August 2025 to the second quarter of 2026 and the clinic bases differ, so the median is a count of mixed readings and not a common-base measure.

C-52 · Clinic-by-clinic spread of same-store sales within each operator

What was computed. For each operator and period, the number of comparable clinics, the 10th, 25th, 50th, 75th and 90th percentiles and standard deviation of clinic-level same-store sales growth, and the share of clinics with a negative figure. It covers Operator 1 2010–16 and 2019–22, Deal A FY20–Q1 FY27, Operator 3 2022–Aug-25, Operator 2 2019–Mar-21, Operator 8 2022–24 and Operator 5 2018–22.

Sources. OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level P&L to December 2017; OP1-041, Operator 1 comp sales summary 2019–Mar-2023; DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report FY20–Q1 FY27 (clinics open at the file date only); OP3-003, Operator 3 clinic-month datacube; OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook; OP8-012, Operator 8 databook; OP5-008, Operator 5 clinic-level volume trends. The inputs are the clinic-level series themselves; the resulting figures are recorded as rows A5-S041..A5-S165.

How. For each clinic, growth = the clinic's sales in the period ÷ its sales in the same period a year earlier − 1. Clinics included are: Operator 1, Operator 3 and Operator 2, those in the comparable base in every month of the period; Deal A, those with sales and traffic above zero in both years, with no open-date filter; Operator 8, clinics classed as existing; Operator 5, clinics trading in the year and the two before it. The percentiles and standard deviation are taken across clinics, each clinic counting once regardless of size. Share negative = number of clinics with growth below zero ÷ number of clinics.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.124; the text of Part 09 section L under 05 E.

Limits. Deal A's file holds only clinics still open, so closed clinics are absent from every year, and the unweighted standard deviation is sensitive to a few extreme clinics.

C-53 · Annual traffic and ticket growth on each operator's broadest base

What was computed. Annual same-store sales, traffic growth and ticket growth for every operator-year where a volume series exists on the comparable base, 57 operator-years in all. It covers Operator 10 2007–17, Operator 1 FY09–2016, Operator 2 2019–20, Operator 5 2018–22, Deal A FY20–FY26, Operator 3, Operator 8 and Operator 7, with Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 and emergency and specialty hospital operators as context.

Sources. OP2-007, Operator 10 clinic KPI history (OP2-0648..0680); OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook (OP2-3520..3527); OP1-015 and OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level P&L (OP1-2115..2145, OP1-5126..5132, OP1-5180..5186); DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report (DLA-0596..0790); OP5-008, Operator 5 volume trends (OP5-3862..3880); OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube (OP3-0886..0908); OP8-010, Operator 8 databook (OP8-2106, OP8-2114, OP8-2115); OP7-005, Operator 7 databook (OP7-1022..1024); context: QLX-005, QLX-013 (Wellness Clinic Franchisor), QLX-029 (Wellness Clinic Operator 1), CO2-008 (Emergency Operator 4), CO2-012 (Emergency Operator 5), CO2-022 (Emergency Operator 2).

How. One series per operator was kept: the traffic series with the widest clinic base. Traffic = growth in the volume measure of the comparable clinics (patient visits or patient invoices; tickets at Operator 5; pharmacy units at Operator 1, which are not visits). Ticket = growth in revenue per unit of that measure; where not given it is (1 + same-store sales) ÷ (1 + traffic) − 1. Each row records the volume measure and whether closed clinics leave the base from closure (CLOSE-FWD) or are missing from all history (CLOSE-RETRO). The headline count is the number of operator-years with negative traffic among the 25 core operator-years measured on patient visits, patient invoices or tickets (Operator 10, Operator 2, Deal A, Operator 5, Operator 3, Operator 8, Operator 7); Operator 1 pharmacy-unit years are not counted. The wellness clinic count is formed the same way on 16 operator-years.

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section J under 03 E.

Limits. Ticket combines price, mix and attachment and cannot be split, and the Deal A and Operator 3 series are survivor-only, which tends to flatter traffic.

C-54 · Share of same-store sales variation explained by year and operator

What was computed. The variation in annual same-store sales across core operators and years, 2010–2025, was split into a part common to all operators in a year and a part specific to each operator. It was run on three samples: all years with at least three operators, the same without 2020–21, and common-definition rows only.

Sources. The best-available annual series, core operators: OP4-005 (Operator 4, Operator 9; OP4-0541..0556, OP4-0589..0593); OP1-021, OP1-041, OP1-048, OP1-036 (Operator 1; OP1-5126..5133, OP1-8251, OP1-8856..8859, OP1-11177..11179); OP1-053 (Operator 29); OP2-007, OP2-021, OP2-025, OP2-026 (Operator 2 lineage); Deal A 10-K comparable-clinic sales (SEC filings; DLA-0342..0363); OP5-008 (Operator 5); OP3-003 (Operator 3); OP8-006, OP8-010, OP8-012 (Operator 8); OP6-002, OP6-010 (Operator 6); OP7-005 (Operator 7); and the company same-store series of Deal B (DLB-003) and Deal C (DLC-006).

How. Annual same-store sales for operator i in year t were regressed by ordinary least squares on three sets of indicator variables: year only, operator only, and year plus operator. The R^2 of each regression is reported. The increment from adding operator effects = R^2(year + operator) − R^2(year only); the increment from adding year effects = R^2(year + operator) − R^2(operator only); unexplained share = 1 − R^2(year + operator). Samples: 84 observations, 13 operators, 16 years (years with at least three operators); 71 observations without 2020 and 2021; 32 observations, 8 operators, 15 years, restricted to rows on the common definition (D2.1: clinics trading in every month of both years), in years with at least two such operators. Deal A fiscal years are placed in the calendar year that holds most of their months. The 84-observation sample includes three series that are not the operator's primary series (OP1-8251, OP2-4703, OP8-0577).

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section J under 03 E and Part 09 section L under 05 B.

Limits. In the two pooled samples the operator effect absorbs differences in definition as well as performance, the panel is unbalanced, and the like-for-like sample has only 32 observations.

C-55 · Cash-flow profile: how the area was measured

What was computed. The general method behind the cash-flow section. It covers how much EBITDA turns into cash after maintenance capital spending, working capital, tax and interest, what acquisitions and integration cost in cash, and how far adjusted EBITDA sits above cash EBITDA, for the general practice and preventive operators from fiscal 1996 (Deal A) to mid-2026.

Sources. Deal A's SEC filings (annual reports for fiscal 1996 to 2026, the first-quarter fiscal 2027 quarterly report and earnings releases); the audited accounts, diligence reports, offering documents, compliance certificates and models of Operator 1 (OP1), Operator 4 and Operator 9 (OP4), Operator 5 (OP5), Operator 8 (OP8), Operator 7 (OP7), Operator 3 (OP3), Operator 6 (OP6) and Operator 2 (OP2); company figures for Deal B (DLB) and Deal C (DLC); for context, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (QLX) and Emergency Operator 1, Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 2 (CO2).

How. A cash bridge is built top-down for each operator and period, each line from its own source row: EBITDA on a stated definition, less maintenance capital spending, less the change in working capital, less cash tax, less cash interest, less scheduled debt and finance-lease principal, which gives levered free cash flow before growth (CF_LFCF_PRE); growth capital spending, acquisitions, integration costs, earn-outs and distributions follow below. Three ratios are reported: (EBITDA − maintenance capital spending) ÷ EBITDA (CONV_1); the same after the change in working capital (CONV_2); and levered free cash flow before growth ÷ EBITDA (CONV_3). Maintenance capital spending is kept in two tiers that are never mixed: independent measures (total capital spending as an upper bound, or depreciation as a proxy) and the company's own maintenance split. A year is marked as a build year (BUILD) when clinics opened and acquired exceed 9% of the opening clinic count, so steady-state conversion is reported apart. Audited cash-flow statements take precedence over diligence or model bridges; ratios are computed only from rows on the same basis, and forecasts are excluded from every statistic. Deal A's reported EBITDA (E1) is operating income plus depreciation, amortisation and impairment, with a line excluding gains on disposal shown wherever it enters a ratio. Each figure is placed in one of seven economic environments by the date its period ends: before July 2007 (PRE-GFC), the financial crisis from July 2007 to June 2009 (GFC), the expansion from July 2009 to February 2020 (EXP10-19), the COVID period from March to December 2020 (COVID20), the 2021 reopening (REOPEN21), the 2022 to 2023 inflation period (INFL22-23) and the soft period from January 2024 (SOFT24-26); twelve-month fiscal years of Deal A (April to March) and Operator 1 (June to May) go to the environment that holds most of their months, and a tie goes to the later one. A characteristic is called durable only if it is seen at three or more independent operators and in two or more environments; where that test is not met the text says so.

Where shown. The text of Part 03 section F and of Part 09 section J under 03 F.

Limits. No audited source splits out maintenance capital spending, and company splits are several times lower than the independent measures; cash conversion through the financial crisis exists for Deal A and Operator 1 only; Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8, Operator 7 and Operator 2 lack actual tax, interest or amortisation rows, so only the first ratio is shown for them. No numeric rule is stated for "temporary" or "company-specific".

C-56 · Cash cost of acquisition programmes, per clinic and as share of price

What was computed. For each acquisitive platform and year with evidence (Deal A FY1996–FY2023 and cumulative, Operator 1 FY2019–21, Operator 4 FY2023–25, Operator 2 FY2019–20 and seven 2020 deals, Operator 6 FY2024–25, Operator 8 FY2025, Operator 3 FY2023–24, Deal C FY2024–25), the cash paid for acquisitions, earn-outs paid, and transaction and integration costs, expressed per acquired clinic and as a share of price.

Sources. Deal A annual reports on Form 10-K, FY1996–FY2026 (SEC EDGAR: acquisition cash, acquisition costs expensed, clinic roll-forward); OP1-040 Operator 1 audited financials 2019–21 (OP1-8625..8628, OP1-8742, OP1-8750..8757); OP4-003 and OP4-007 Operator 4 audited financials 2023–25, OP4-006 Operator 4 financial model (OP4-0069, 67, 76, 104, 111, 118, 1191, 1221, 1330); OP2-018 Operator 2 2021 situation update (deal list) and OP2-017 Operator 2 quality-of-earnings databook (OP2-2921..2936); OP6-012 Operator 6 valuation multiple summary and OP6-010 Operator 6 information presentation (OP6-0645, OP6-0647, OP6-1512..1689); OP8-009 Operator 8 situation update, OP8-010 Operator 8 databook and OP8-014 Operator 8 lender update (OP8-2018, OP8-2551..2566); OP3-011 Operator 3 data pack and OP3-010 Operator 3 early read (OP3-1146, OP3-1147, OP3-1823..1834); DLC-014 Deal C 2025 audit, transaction expense and affiliate bonuses (DLC-0031, DLC-0009, DLC-0200, DLC-0199) and Note 3 consideration tables ($27.9m FY2024, p.18; $32.8m FY2025, p.17).

How. Total cash cost = acquisition cash (or stated purchase price where the cash-flow line is not available) + earn-outs and deferred consideration paid + transaction and integration costs for the same year. Cost share = transaction and integration costs ÷ acquisition cash or purchase price; for Deal C, ÷ total consideration (cash, rollover equity and contingent consideration) from the audit's Note 3: $26.5m + $0.64m + $0.87m = $27.9m for FY2024 and $32.3m + $0.64m + $0.61m = $32.8m for FY2025, giving 28.5% and 31.2%, and 7.4% and 13.2% without the affiliate bonuses. Cash cost per clinic = total cash cost ÷ clinics acquired in the year; where a filing gives only clinics added (opened plus acquired), acquisition cash ÷ clinics added is shown as a lower bound per acquired clinic and no per-clinic cost is stated. For Operator 1 FY2020 the per-clinic figure is the Operator 27 enterprise value per clinic, and for Operator 1 FY2021 the cost share is taken on the enterprise value of the two dated clinic cohorts. Operator 2 is shown by year and, separately, by individual 2020 deal; forecast figures are excluded.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.23, last column; Exhibit 9.149; Exhibit 9.150; the text of Part 07 section D and of Part 09 section J under 03 F; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. Rebranding and conversion capital spent on acquired clinics sits inside total capital expenditure and cannot be added to the purchase cost, and at Operator 1 FY2019 and FY2021 the cost line is total transaction and restructuring expense rather than acquisition-only cost.

C-57 · How many years each "one-time" add-back category recurs, by platform

What was computed. For each platform and each category of cost added back to EBITDA as non-recurring, the years in which the category appears, the number of years, the longest run of consecutive years and the total amount. It covers 104 categories at 13 platforms (eight general practice and preventive platforms, plus wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital operators as context), over 2011–2026.

Sources. DLA-006 Deal A operating, selling and general expense detail FY17–FY27, with Deal A 10-K and earnings releases (SEC EDGAR); OP2-006, OP2-013, OP2-015, OP2-017, OP2-023, OP2-025 Operator 2 financeable EBITDA, historical financials, quality-of-earnings databook and lender memoranda; OP4-005 Operator 4 investment memorandum; OP1-001 Operator 1 2014 information memorandum and OP1-016 Operator 1 2018 model; OP3-001, OP3-010, OP3-013 Operator 3 financial update, early read and information presentation; OP6-010 Operator 6 information presentation; OP8-012 Operator 8 databook; OP5-009 Operator 5 financial due diligence report; QLX-017 Wellness Clinic Franchisor quality-of-earnings databook; QLX-024 and QLX-033 Wellness Clinic Operator 1 due diligence databook and investment memorandum; CO2-001 Emergency Operator 1; CO2-024, CO2-025 Emergency Operator 2; CO2-038, CO2-039 Emergency Operator 3. 262 fact rows, for example DLA-1231..1356, OP2-4099..4408, OP4-0987..1022, OP6-0632/0633/0050, OP3-1146..1148, OP8-1812..1820 and OP8-1951..1960, OP5-0074..0076, QL1-0022..0024, QLF-0088..0090.

How. Every add-back line in each platform's EBITDA bridge was assigned to a category and a year. Only annual rows on an actual or pro forma basis at consolidated scope were used; forecasts were excluded. Each category was marked cash or non-cash; impairment and other non-cash items are listed but not counted in the recurrence test. For each platform and category: number of years = count of distinct years with an amount; longest run = the largest number of consecutive calendar or fiscal years with an amount; a category is "recurring" when the longest run is three years or more; total = sum of the amounts across years.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.70; Exhibit 3.23; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. The test shows that a category recurs, not that each year's amount is the same cost; category labels are the companies' own and differ between platforms, so category counts are not comparable across platforms (Operator 2 reports 43 categories, most others fewer than ten).

C-58 · Platform summary of recurring "one-time" cash add-backs

What was computed. One line per platform (13 platforms): the number of cash add-back categories, how many of them recur in three or more consecutive years, the longest run of any one category, and the span of years covered.

Sources. The same documents and fact rows as the category-level recurrence table: DLA-006 and Deal A SEC filings; OP2-006, OP2-013, OP2-015, OP2-017, OP2-023, OP2-025; OP4-005; OP1-001, OP1-016; OP3-001, OP3-010, OP3-013; OP6-010; OP8-012; OP5-009; QLX-017, QLX-024, QLX-033; CO2-001, CO2-024, CO2-025, CO2-038, CO2-039.

How. Computed from the category-level table, cash categories only. Categories = count of cash categories for the platform. Recurring = count of those whose longest consecutive-year run is three or more. Longest run = the maximum of the category runs. Span = first to last year in which any cash category appears. Non-cash categories (impairment) are excluded.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.70; Exhibit 3.23, columns two to four; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. A platform with a short record cannot show a long run, so the longest run is bounded by the years of data available (three years for several platforms).

C-59 · EBITDA-to-cash bridges for private and contextual platforms

What was computed. For 16 platforms other than Deal A, 50 platform-periods between FY2008 and LTM March 2026: EBITDA, maintenance capital expenditure, total capital expenditure, change in working capital, cash tax, cash interest and scheduled debt repayment, and the three conversion ratios derived from them. Platforms are Operator 1, Operator 4, Operator 9, Operator 5, Operator 8, Operator 7, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 2, Deal C and Deal B, with Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Operator 2, Emergency Operator 1, Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 2 as wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital context.

Sources. OP1-001 Operator 1 2014 information memorandum, OP1-012 management presentation, OP1-038 2021 bidder model, OP1-040 audited financials 2019–21; OP4-003, OP4-007 Operator 4 audited financials; OP4-001, OP4-002 Operator 9 audits FY2024–25; OP5-009 Operator 5 financial due diligence report; OP8-008 Operator 8 financial diligence report; OP7-005, OP7-006, OP7-007 Operator 7 databooks and quality of earnings; OP3-001, OP3-010, OP3-012 Operator 3 financial update, early read and lender model; OP6-010 Operator 6 information presentation; OP2-023, OP2-025 Operator 2 lender memoranda; DLB-008 Deal B financing model (July 2026) and DLB-022 quality-of-earnings workbook; DLC-005 Deal C financial model and DLC-012 diligence exhibits; QLX-020 Wellness Clinic Operator 2, QLX-024 Wellness Clinic Operator 1; CO2-007 Emergency Operator 1, CO2-021 Emergency Operator 2, CO2-039 Emergency Operator 3. 156 fact rows, including OP1-8312, 7334, 7481..8636, 7556..8656, 7669, 7642,

7420..8680; OP4-0011..0134; OP4-0355..0525; OP5-0032..0034, 47..0061, 237, 241; OP8-0743, 656, 668, 667, 748; OP3-1200..1203, 1828, 1910; OP6-0047, 522..0593, 584..0663; OP2-4044..4347; A6-S001..S003; A6-P5-008..010.

How. Each line states the EBITDA measure used (reported, adjusted or pro forma) and whether it is actual or pro forma; ratios use inputs on the same basis only. Maintenance capital expenditure is the company's own split where one exists; where none exists, depreciation is used as a proxy (Operator 4, Operator 9, Operator 5), or only total capital expenditure is shown (Operator 7, Operator 2). Conversion after maintenance capex (CONV_1) = (EBITDA − maintenance capex) ÷ EBITDA, also shown with total capex in place of maintenance capex; conversion after working capital (CONV_2) = (EBITDA − maintenance capex − change in working capital) ÷ EBITDA, with an increase in working capital as an outflow; levered free cash flow before growth (LFCF_PRE) = EBITDA − maintenance capex − change in working capital − cash tax − cash interest − scheduled amortisation and finance-lease principal, and CONV_3 = LFCF_PRE ÷ EBITDA. A period is tagged as a build year when clinics opened or acquired exceed 9% of the opening clinic count, and as steady otherwise. Ratios are not computed where EBITDA is zero or negative, and forecast figures are excluded; the Operator 1 FY2020 ratios, which rest on a bidder's estimate of maintenance capex, are shown but labelled as projected and not pooled.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.68; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. No audited source separates maintenance from growth capital expenditure, so conversion depends on which measure is used; levered free cash flow cannot be built for Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8, Operator 7 or Operator 2, and the Operator 1 figure is before scheduled amortisation. The Deal C and Deal B lines use the companies' own maintenance figures, and the Deal B EBITDA is pro forma for pre-acquisition results.

C-60 · Median cash conversion by platform, steady years against build years

What was computed. For Deal A and 16 other platforms, the median, minimum and maximum of conversion after maintenance capex, and the medians of the total-capex, working-capital and levered conversion ratios, grouped by platform, EBITDA measure and steady or build years. Deal A's steady years are also summarised by economic environment.

Sources. The Deal A bridge (Deal A 10-K filings FY1996–FY2026, SEC EDGAR) and the platform bridges: OP1-001, OP1-012, OP1-038, OP1-040 (Operator 1); OP4-001, OP4-002, OP4-003, OP4-007 (Operator 9 and Operator 4 audits); OP5-009 (Operator 5); OP8-008 (Operator 8); OP7-005, OP7-006, OP7-007 (Operator 7); OP3-001, OP3-010, OP3-012 (Operator 3); OP6-010 (Operator 6); OP2-023, OP2-025 (Operator 2); DLB-008, DLB-022 (Deal B); DLC-005, DLC-012 (Deal C); QLX-020, QLX-024 (Wellness Clinic Operator 2, Wellness Clinic Operator 1); CO2-007, CO2-021, CO2-039 (Emergency Operator 1, Emergency Operator 2, Emergency Operator 3). The same 156 fact rows as the platform bridges, including A6-S001..S003 and A6-P5-008..010.

How. Periods are grouped by platform, by EBITDA measure, by maintenance-capex measure and by the steady or build tag (build = clinics opened or acquired above 9% of the opening clinic count). Within each group the median, minimum and maximum of conversion after maintenance capex (CONV_1 = (EBITDA − maintenance capex) ÷ EBITDA) are taken across the periods, together with the medians of the same ratio on total capex, of conversion after working capital (CONV_2) and of levered free cash flow before growth ÷ EBITDA (CONV_3). For Deal A, total capital expenditure is used as maintenance capex (an upper bound), 20 steady years and 8 build years are summarised separately, and the steady years are also grouped by environment (pre-2007, financial crisis, 2010–19 expansion, 2020, 2021, 2022–23 inflation, 2024–26), each fiscal year assigned to the environment in which most of its months fall. Groups are not pooled across platforms, and forecast periods are excluded, except Operator 1 FY2020, which rests on a bidder-model estimate.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.20; Exhibit 9.68; Exhibit 4.11; Exhibit 9.141; the text of Part 03 section F and of Part 09 section J under 03 F; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. Several groups hold one to three periods, so their "median" is a single reading or a mid-point, and groups on company-stated maintenance capex are not comparable with groups on total capex or a depreciation proxy.

C-61 · Gap between adjusted EBITDA and cash EBITDA at acquisitive platforms

What was computed. For 30 platform-periods (Operator 4, Operator 8, Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 2, Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 5, Operator 7, Deal C and Deal B, with Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Operator 2, Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 2 as context; FY2019 to LTM June 2026), the EBITDA ladder from reported to adjusted to pro forma to cash, the share of the top measure made up of adjustments, and cash EBITDA as a share of the top measure.

Sources. OP4-003, OP4-007, OP4-008 Operator 4 audited and interim financials and OP4-005 investment memorandum (credit-agreement bridge); OP8-009, OP8-010 Operator 8 situation update and databook; OP6-001, OP6-010 Operator 6 investment memorandum and information presentation; OP3-010, OP3-012, OP3-013 Operator 3 early read, lender model and information presentation; OP2-023, OP2-025 Operator 2 lender memoranda (compliance figures); OP1-036, OP1-038, OP1-040 Operator 1 2021 information memorandum, bidder model and audit; OP5-009 Operator 5; OP7-007 Operator 7; Deal A 10-K filings and earnings releases FY2024–Q1 FY2027 (SEC EDGAR); QLX-017, QLX-020, QLX-024, QLX-033 wellness

clinic context; CO2-024, CO2-028, CO2-039 emergency and specialty hospital context. 77 fact rows, including OP4-0011, 47, 91, 228, 826..0980, 896..1035, 946..1081; OP8-1781, 1606, 2015, 2047, 2166; OP6-0047, 46, 52, 522, 511, 577, 562, 566; OP3-1125..1136, 1828..2161, 2234..2571; OP2-4044..4416; OP1-8189, 7491, 7420, 7616; OP5-0034, 52, 157; OP7-0021, 52.

How. Four measures are set side by side for each period: reported EBITDA, operating income plus depreciation, amortisation and impairment (E1); adjusted EBITDA, after non-recurring and normalisation adjustments (E2); pro forma EBITDA, adding pre-acquisition results of acquisitions already closed (E3); and cash EBITDA (E6), the top measure less the cash "one-time" costs that recur in three or more consecutive years (transaction, integration, start-up, closure). Adjustment share = (top measure − E1) ÷ top measure, where the top measure is E3, or E2 where no E3 exists. Cash share = E6 ÷ top measure, and the gap = 1 − cash share. Operator 8's E6 for the twelve months to March 2026 ($3.44m, OP8-2015) is built from its as-owned adjusted EBITDA (E2m, $12.02m, OP8-1880), so its cash share is taken on that figure, 0.24, on one perimeter; Operator 8's E3 ($23.8m, OP8-2409) is pro forma for acquisitions through May 2026 and has no matching E6. Where a company or lender publishes its own "cash EBITDA", it is recorded in a separate column and not used as E6. The median cash share of 0.84 quoted in Part 03 section F and Part 01 section E is taken across the eleven Operator 4, Operator 8, Operator 6 and Operator 3 readings; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows are not pooled with the general practice and preventive operators. For Deal A, E2 is rebuilt as operating income plus depreciation and amortisation plus the company's published non-GAAP items, and E1 excluding gains on asset disposals is shown beside E1.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.69; Exhibit 3.22; Exhibit 9.149; Exhibit 9.94; the text of Part 03 section F and Part 07 section D, and of Part 09 section J under 03 F, Part 09 section K under 04 G and Part 09 section N under 07 F; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital rows in Exhibit 9.97.

Limits. Cash EBITDA can be computed only where the add-back bridge is itemised (Operator 4, Operator 8, Operator 6, Operator 3, Deal C and Deal B; Wellness Clinic Operator 2 and Emergency Operator 3 as context); Operator 8's reported EBITDA differs between two source documents, and both values are shown.

C-62 · Deal A EBITDA-to-cash bridge from audited filings, FY1996 to FY2026

What was computed. For each Deal A fiscal year FY1996–FY2026: reported EBITDA, capital expenditure, working capital, supplier-finance movement, cash tax, cash interest, finance-lease principal, acquisitions, disposal proceeds and distributions, with the conversion ratios and free cash flow before and after growth derived from them. For the twelve months to June 2026, the same lines except cash tax and cash interest, which the 10-Q does not give. Two memo lines repeat FY2026 and the twelve months to June 2026 on EBITDA excluding gains on disposal.

Sources. Deal A annual reports on Form 10-K for FY1996–FY2026 (reported values from FY2010; six filings read for FY1996–FY2009; ten filings for clinic roll-forwards), the quarterly report on Form 10-Q for Q1 FY2027 and the earnings releases on Form 8-K for Q4 FY2025, Q4 FY2026 and Q1 FY2027, all from SEC EDGAR. Fact rows A6-P5-001..007; FY2023–26 tie to DLA-0266, 242, 254, 276 (EBITDA) and DLA-0269, 255, 258, 275 (capital expenditure).

How. Reported EBITDA (E1) = operating income + depreciation and amortisation (including finance-lease asset amortisation from FY2020) + impairment of long-lived assets; gains on disposal stay inside E1 and a separate line shows E1 excluding them. Conversion after capex (CONV_1) = (E1 − total capital expenditure) ÷ E1, with total capex standing in for maintenance capex as an upper bound. Conversion after working capital (CONV_2) = (E1 − capex − change in working capital excluding supplier-finance movements) ÷ E1, an increase counted as an outflow. Levered free cash flow before growth (LFCF_PRE) = E1 − capex − change in working capital excluding supplier finance − cash tax − cash interest − finance-lease principal (capital-lease amortisation is used as a proxy for principal before FY2020), and CONV_3 = LFCF_PRE ÷ E1; free cash flow after growth = LFCF_PRE − acquisitions + disposal proceeds − dividends and buybacks. A year is a build year when clinics opened plus acquired exceed 9% of the opening clinic count, otherwise steady; working-capital and levered figures start in FY2010; the twelve months to June 2026 = FY2026 + Q1 FY2027 − Q1 FY2026; interest paid for FY2017 and FY2018 uses the values as reclassified in the FY2019 10-K.

Where shown. Exhibit 5.15, the FY2026 bridge; Exhibit 9.67; Exhibit 3.21; Exhibit 3.20; Exhibit 9.109; Exhibit 4.11, Deal A row; Exhibit 9.123; Exhibit 4.17; the text of Part 03 section F, Part 05 section C, Part 05 section F and Part 08 section B, and of Part 09 section J under 03 F and Part 09 section L under 05 B, 05 C and 05 E.

Limits. Deal A does not disclose a maintenance and growth split of capital expenditure, so conversion on total capex is a lower bound on true maintenance conversion; the supplier-finance balance is disclosed only from FY2023, so earlier working-capital movements cannot be split between trade terms and supplier finance, and no levered figure on this bridge can be built for the twelve months to June 2026 because the 10-Q gives no cash tax or cash interest; operating cash flow less capex and finance-lease principal (−$24.3m, A6-P5-007) is given for that period instead.

C-63 · Valuation multiples: how the area was measured

What was computed. The general method behind the valuation section. It covers purchase multiples for whole platforms (from 2012) and for add-on acquisitions (from 2008) in general practice and preventive care to 2026, with wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals as context, and keeps standalone multiples apart from multiples that include expected synergies.

Sources. The investment memos, offering documents, acquisition registers, valuation summaries and lender materials of Operator 1 (OP1), Operator 2 (OP2), Operator 6 (OP6), Operator 3 (OP3), Operator 7 (OP7), Operator 8 (OP8), Operator 4 and Operator 9 (OP4) and Deal A (DLA), including Deal A's add-on register for fiscal 1998 to 2023; company figures for Deal B (DLB) and Deal C (DLC); for context, the wellness clinic (QLX) and emergency and specialty hospital (CO2) transaction materials.

How. Every transaction multiple in the evidence is listed with its date and date type (close, signing, letter of intent, document date or valuation mark), its level (platform, single add-on, add-on aggregate, pipeline, later re-measurement, mark or public trading), the EBITDA definition underneath it, whether that EBITDA is consolidated or clinic-level, whether property or a sale-leaseback is included, and whether it is standalone or includes buyer synergies. Multiple = price ÷ EBITDA on the stated definition, as given by the source; platform multiples are grouped by the kind of EBITDA underneath (headline adjusted, a lower reported or diligence-adjusted figure, or synergised) and are compared only within a group. Add-on multiples are summarised by year and by environment, standalone and synergised separately; "later" multiples (price ÷ the acquired clinics' current EBITDA) cover only deals still owned at the measurement date. Multiples quoted in comparison lists, report claims and model assumptions are excluded from every statistic and appear only as labelled context. Deal A's add-ons carry price ÷ the seller's prior-year sales only, so they enter the price-to-sales table and no EBITDA statistic. Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are shown apart from the general practice and preventive operators. Each figure is placed in one of seven economic environments by the date its period ends: before July 2007 (PRE-GFC), the financial crisis from July 2007 to June 2009 (GFC), the expansion from July 2009 to February 2020 (EXP10-19), the COVID period from March to December 2020 (COVID20), the 2021 reopening (REOPEN21), the 2022 to 2023 inflation period (INFL22-23) and the soft period from January 2024 (SOFT24-26); twelve-month fiscal years of Deal A (April to March) and Operator 1 (June to May) go to the environment that holds most of their months, and a tie goes to the later one. A characteristic is called durable only if it is seen at three or more independent operators and in two or more environments; where that test is not met the text says so.

Where shown. The text of Part 04 section A and of Part 09 section K under 04 A.

Limits. There are at most four general practice and preventive platform transactions in any year and none for 2013, 2017, 2019 or 2022, so no market-wide series can be built; the supplied documents hold no standalone small-clinic EBITDA multiple before 2021; later multiples are company-presented, clinic-level and exclude integration cost and earn-outs; differences in lease intensity between platforms are not controlled. No numeric rule is stated for "temporary" or "company-specific".

C-64 · Median add-on entry multiples by economic environment and EBITDA basis

What was computed. Median, quartile and range of add-on purchase multiples (price ÷ EBITDA at entry), grouped by the economic environment in which each deal closed, from the 2010–19 expansion to 2024–26. Two pools are kept apart: standalone multiples (Operator 6, Operator 7, Operator 3, Operator 8) and synergised or synergy-unstated multiples (Operator 2, Wellness Clinic Operator 3 targets, Operator 8 2025–26).

Sources. OP6-012, Operator 6 valuation multiple summary (31 add-on deals); OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook (acquisition history); OP3-010, Ares Credit Group early read on Operator 3 (deal table); OP3-005 and OP3-001, Operator 3 October 2025 business update and August 2025 financial update (2025 deals); OP8-003, Operator 8 sponsor financial model; OP8-009, Ares Credit Group situation update on Operator 8; OP2-018, Ares Credit Group 2021 situation update on Operator 2 (2017–21 deals); OP2-023, Ares Credit Group 2024 Operator 2 delayed-draw upsize memo (2021–24 deals); OP2-025, Ares Credit Group 2026 Operator 2 situation update (2025–26 deals); OP2-001, Ares Credit Group 2018 veterinary-services precedent transactions sheet (Wellness Clinic Operator 3 tuck-ins). Fact rows: OP6-1440 to OP6-1693; OP7-1093 to OP7-1129; OP3-1457 to OP3-2115; OP8-0460 to OP8-2611; OP2-0010 to OP2-4598 (584 rows in all).

How. Each deal's entry multiple = purchase price ÷ seller EBITDA at entry, as stated in the source. Each deal is assigned to one environment by its closing date: expansion (EXP10-19, July 2009 to February 2020), pandemic (COVID20, March to December 2020), reopening (REOPEN21, 2021), inflation (INFL22-23, 2022–23) and soft demand (SOFT24-26, January 2024 onward). The standalone pool uses seller clinic-level or seller-adjusted EBITDA before buyer synergies; the second pool uses EBITDA that includes anticipated synergies or does not state the synergy treatment. For each pool and environment we take the median, the 25th and 75th percentiles (linear interpolation), the minimum and the maximum across deals, and count deals and platforms. For Operator 2 deals the price is taken net of sale-leaseback proceeds. Deals with seller EBITDA at or below zero are excluded as not meaningful; where OP2-023 and OP2-025 both give a multiple for the same Operator 2 deal, OP2-023 is used; the two pools are never combined in one statistic.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.73; Exhibit 4.05, environment rows; the text of Part 04 section A and of Part 09 section K under 04 A.

Limits. The two pools come from different platforms, so the gap between them is not a like-for-like synergy effect; the supplied documents hold no standalone small-clinic multiple before 2021, and the Operator 2 2025–26 multiples use only the debt-funded part of the price.

C-65 · Deal-by-deal register of add-on acquisitions and their multiples

What was computed. A register of 165 add-on deals across Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 7, Operator 2, Operator 8 and the Wellness Clinic Operator 3 and Operator 1 precedents, 2008–2026. For each deal it records price, clinics, entry EBITDA, entry multiple, synergy treatment, sale-leaseback treatment and, where given, the multiple on later earnings.

Sources. OP6-012, Operator 6 valuation multiple summary (31 deals); OP3-010, Ares Credit Group early read on Operator 3 (18 deals); OP3-005 and OP3-001, Operator 3 October 2025 business update and August 2025 financial update (19 closed, scheduled and pipeline deals); OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook (15 deals); OP2-018, Ares Credit Group 2021 situation update on Operator 2 (18 deals, 2017–21); OP2-023 and OP2-025, Ares Credit Group 2024 upsize memo and 2026 situation update on Operator 2 (44 deals, 2021–26); OP8-003, Operator 8 sponsor financial model (4 deals); OP8-009, Ares Credit Group situation update on Operator 8 (12 deals); OP2-001, Ares Credit Group 2018 precedent transactions sheet (15 Wellness Clinic Operator 3 and Operator 1 deals). Fact rows: OP6-1440 to OP6-1693; OP3-1457 to OP3-2123; OP7-1093 to OP7-1137; OP2-0001 to OP2-4598; OP8-0460 to OP8-2611 (634 rows in all).

How. One line per deal, taken as stated in the source. Entry multiple = purchase price ÷ entry EBITDA; where the source gives a synergised figure, synergised multiple = the same price ÷ EBITDA including synergies; where a sale-leaseback applied, the multiple before sale-leaseback proceeds is kept beside the net one. Each deal is tagged standalone, synergised or synergy-unstated according to the EBITDA definition the source uses. Deals are placed in seller-EBITDA bands (under $0.4m, $0.4–1.0m, $1.0–2.2m, $2.2–8.6m, over $8.6m) and clinic-count bands (1, 2–5, 6–15, 16–44, over 44); deals with seller EBITDA at or below zero are marked not meaningful. For Operator 2 2021–24 deals carried in both OP2-023 and OP2-025, the OP2-023 net purchase price is used.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.73; Exhibit 4.05; Exhibit 4.03.

Limits. EBITDA definitions differ by platform (clinic-level, seller-adjusted, management estimate, pro forma), Operator 3's 18 earlier deals carry no seller EBITDA amount, and Deal A's add-ons are absent because its register gives sales only.

C-66 · Add-on entry multiples by target size

What was computed. Median and quartiles of add-on entry multiples grouped by seller EBITDA and by number of clinics acquired, for each platform and for a pooled standalone set (Operator 6, Operator 7, Operator 3 2025 closed deals, Operator 8). Deals run from 2008 to 2026, with the standalone set from 2021 to 2026.

Sources. OP6-012, Operator 6 valuation multiple summary; OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook (management estimates of seller EBITDA); OP3-005 and OP3-001, Operator 3 October 2025 business update and August 2025 financial update; OP8-003, Operator 8 sponsor financial model; OP8-009, Ares Credit Group situation update on Operator 8; OP2-018, OP2-023 and OP2-025, Ares Credit Group Operator 2 memos of 2021, 2024 and 2026; OP2-001, Ares Credit Group 2018 precedent transactions sheet (Operator 1 scale deals). Fact rows: OP6-1440 to OP6-1693; OP7-1093 to OP7-1129; OP3-1903 to OP3-2115; OP8-0460 to OP8-2608; OP2-0001 to OP2-4597 (494 rows in all).

How. Each deal's entry multiple = purchase price ÷ seller EBITDA at entry. Deals are grouped by seller EBITDA at entry (under $0.4m, $0.4–1.0m, $1.0–2.2m, $2.2–8.6m, over $8.6m) and separately by clinics acquired (1, 2–5, 6–15, 16–44, over 44). Within each platform and band we take the count, the median and the 25th and 75th percentiles (linear interpolation); standalone, synergised and synergy-unstated deals are kept in separate lines. The pooled standalone line combines the four platforms whose multiples are on seller EBITDA before buyer synergies and also counts the platforms contributing. Deals with seller EBITDA at or below zero or a seller margin under 3% are treated as not meaningful and left out.

Where shown. Exhibit 4.05, size rows; Exhibit 4.03.

Limits. No standalone small-clinic deal exists above $2.2m of seller EBITDA and the $1.0–2.2m standalone band holds three deals, so the larger bands rest on synergised, synergy-unstated or consolidated prints that are not like-for-like.

C-67 · Add-on entry multiple versus multiple on later earnings

What was computed. For each platform or acquisition cohort, the purchase multiple at entry set against the same price divided by the acquired clinics' later EBITDA under the acquirer, and the change in turns. Covers Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 4, Operator 7, Deal C and Operator 1.

Sources. OP6-012, Operator 6 valuation multiple summary; OP3-010, Ares Credit Group early read on Operator 3; OP3-011, Operator 3 data pack for co-investors; OP4-005, Lender 1 investment memo on Operator 4; OP7-001, Ares Credit Group early read on Operator 7; OP1-028 and OP1-031, Operator 1 acquisition summary (2017) and Ares Credit Group 2018 Operator 1 investment committee memo; DLC-012, Ares Credit Group internal diligence exhibits on Deal C. Fact rows: OP6-1699 to OP6-1733; OP3-1493 to OP3-1496 and OP3-1843 to OP3-1856; OP4-0802, 707, 710, 706; OP7-1139, OP7-1140; DLC-012-000379 to DLC-012-000404; OP1-7179 to OP1-7184 and OP1-7607.

How. Entry multiple = purchase price ÷ EBITDA at entry; later multiple = the same purchase price ÷ the acquired clinics' EBITDA at a later date (clinic-level, after synergies, before corporate cost and integration spending). Both are taken as presented by the company or sponsor; we compute only the change: later multiple − entry multiple, in turns. Only deals still owned at the measurement date are included; Operator 6 excludes one brownfield site and the Operator 3 averages exclude one deal, as the sources do. Operator 3 gives three differing averages for 2021–24 and all three are carried.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.72.

Limits. The later multiples are company-presented and survivor-only, and they exclude corporate cost, integration and rebranding capital and earn-outs, so they cannot show whether the reduction is sustainable.

C-68 · Add-on purchase price as a multiple of seller revenue

What was computed. Purchase price ÷ seller revenue for add-on deals by Deal A (deal dates 1998–2023), Wellness Clinic Operator 3 (2013–17), Operator 1 (2008–18) and Operator 7 (2021–25). Deal A deals are summarised as medians for four periods; the other acquirers are shown deal by deal.

Sources. DLA-010, Deal A acquisition analysis register (93 deals and 13 register totals); OP2-001, Ares Credit Group 2018 precedent transactions sheet (Wellness Clinic Operator 3 and Operator 1 deals); OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook (acquisition history). Fact rows: DLA-1619 to DLA-2140 (109 rows); OP2-0001 to OP2-0084 (68 rows); OP7-1108 to OP7-1132 (21 rows).

How. For Deal A, ratio = cash price paid ÷ seller's sales in the year before acquisition, per deal. The 93 deals are grouped by the calendar year of the deal date into 1998–2007, 2008–13, 2014–19 and 2020–23 (9, 24, 57 and 6 deals), and the median and the 25th and 75th percentiles are taken in each group. Deal A's own register totals (last 20 years, last 16 years, and each of fiscal 2013 to 2023) are carried as stated. For Wellness Clinic Operator 3 and Operator 1, ratio = purchase price ÷ target revenue per deal; for Operator 7, purchase price (including real estate where it was bought) ÷ target revenue per deal. These ratios are kept out of every EBITDA-multiple statistic.

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section K under 04 A.

Limits. Deal A's cash price excludes liabilities assumed and stock issued, so its ratio is a floor, and the register gives no seller EBITDA, so no EBITDA multiple can be derived for Deal A's add-ons.

C-69 · Platform and scale transaction multiples by EBITDA definition

What was computed. Entry multiples (enterprise value ÷ EBITDA) for core general practice and preventive care platform and large-scale transactions from 2012 to 2026, each tagged with the EBITDA definition, period, synergy treatment and date type. Covers Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 8, Operator 6, Operator 4, Operator 3, Operator 7, Operator 29 and Operator 30, with proposed financings and Deal A's public multiple held as separate, excluded lines.

Sources. OP1-009, OP1-030, OP1-031, OP1-033, OP1-045, OP1-048, OP1-049, Ares Credit Group Operator 1 investment committee memos and situation updates (2014, 2018, 2021, 2023, 2026); OP1-035 and OP1-036, Operator 1 2020 re-underwrite and 2021 lender information memorandum; OP2-023, Ares Credit Group 2024 Operator 2 upsize memo; OP4-005, Lender 1 investment memo on Operator 4; OP8-003 and OP8-008, Operator 8 sponsor model and Accounting Firm 2 financial diligence report; OP6-001, Ares Credit Group investment committee memo on Operator 6; OP3-010, Ares Credit Group early read on Operator 3; OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook; DLA-017 and DLA-024, Ares Credit Group Deal A diligence update and model. Fact rows: OP1-0913 to OP1-11254 (21 rows); OP4-0838, OP4-1180, OP4-1193 to OP4-1195; OP6-0042 to OP6-0044; OP2-3714, OP2-3738; OP8-0001, OP8-0002, OP8-0458, OP8-0459; OP3-1328; OP7-1092; supplementary rows A7-S001, A7-S004; calculated rows A7-P5-001, A7-P5-002.

How. Multiple = enterprise value (or price) ÷ EBITDA, as stated in the deal document; nothing is recomputed except two check rows. Each print is placed in one of three families by its denominator: lower-adjustment EBITDA (reported, E1; or diligence-adjusted, E2q; or diligence-adjusted excluding letter-of-intent earnings), headline adjusted EBITDA (pro forma, run-rate or underwriting figures, E3/E4/E5, with no stated buyer synergies), and synergised EBITDA. Where one transaction has several prints (for example standalone and synergised, or different source memos), each is kept as its own line and the headline print is the one the document leads with. The two check rows restate Operator 1 on EBITDA before normalisation and synergies: 2014 = $366.7m ÷ $27.6m (A7-P5-001) and the equivalent for 2018 (A7-P5-002); they are shown but not counted in the family statistics. Letters of intent, lost bids, proposed financings and public-market multiples are tagged and excluded from the transaction table.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.71; Exhibit 4.02; Exhibit 9.77.

Limits. Multiples are as stated by sponsors, lenders and companies on differing EBITDA definitions and are largely not independently verified; no print states whether enterprise value includes owned property or a sale-leaseback, so a like-for-like series exists only for Operator 1.

C-70 · Count and range of platform multiples by year and definition

What was computed. For each year from 2012 to 2026, the number of closed or signed core platform and scale transactions and the lowest and highest multiple, split by EBITDA definition family. It shows how thin the platform series is: 20 transactions in 15 years.

Sources. OP1-009, OP1-030, OP1-031, OP1-033, OP1-045, OP1-048, OP1-049, OP1-035, OP1-036, Ares Credit Group Operator 1 memos and Operator 1 lender materials (2014–2026); OP2-023, Ares Credit Group 2024 Operator 2 upsize memo; OP4-005, Lender 1 investment memo on Operator 4; OP8-003 and OP8-008, Operator 8 sponsor model and Accounting Firm 2 financial diligence report; OP6-001, Ares Credit Group investment committee memo on Operator 6; OP3-010, Ares Credit Group early read on Operator 3; OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook. Fact rows: OP1-0914 to OP1-11254 (20 rows); OP4-0838, OP4-1180, OP4-1193 to OP4-1195; OP6-0042 to OP6-0044; OP2-3714, OP2-3738; OP8-0001, OP8-0002, OP8-0458, OP8-0459; OP3-1328; OP7-1092; A7-S001, A7-S004.

How. Starting from the platform transaction multiples, we keep closed or signed core transactions only; letters of intent, lost bids, proposed financings, public multiples, rent-adjusted prints and the two Operator 1 check rows are excluded. Prints are grouped by calendar year of the transaction, economic environment and definition family (lower-adjustment, headline adjusted, synergised). For each group we count distinct transactions and prints and take the minimum and maximum multiple. The total of 20 is the count of distinct transactions across all years and families; a transaction with prints in more than one family appears in each.

Where shown. The text of Part 04 section A and of Part 09 section K under 04 A.

Limits. There are never more than four transactions in a year, none in 2013, 2017, 2019 or 2022, and 10 of the 20 involve Operator 1, so the ranges are not a market index.

C-71 · Standalone versus synergised multiple on the same transaction

What was computed. For 17 core transactions or deal pools (2015–2026) where one document gives both a standalone and a synergised multiple on the same price, the gap between the two in turns and as a share of the standalone multiple. Covers Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 8, Operator 4 and Operator 3, with the Emergency Operator 1/Emergency Operator 4 emergency and specialty merger as one context line.

Sources. OP1-030, OP1-031, OP1-033, OP1-045, Ares Credit Group Operator 1 investment committee memos (2018, 2021, 2023); OP2-004, Ares Credit Group 2018 investment committee memo on GB Vet (Operator 2); OP8-003, Operator 8 sponsor financial model; OP4-005, Lender 1 investment memo on Operator 4; OP3-005, Operator 3 October 2025 business update; CO2-007, Ares Credit Group investment committee memo on the Emergency Operator 1/Emergency Operator 4 merger. Fact rows: OP1-7519, OP1-7520, OP1-7607, OP1-7608, OP1-7610, OP1-7611, OP1-7876, OP1-7883, OP1-10771, OP1-10773; OP2-0257, OP2-0258; OP8-0458 to OP8-0484 (12 rows); OP4-0802, 682, 710, 721, 1047 to 1053; OP3-2124, OP3-2125; CO1-0663, CO1-0664.

How. A pair is included only where the same source gives both multiples on the same purchase price. Standalone multiple = price ÷ EBITDA before buyer synergies; synergised multiple = price ÷ EBITDA including the synergies the buyer expects. Gap in turns = standalone − synergised; gap as a share = gap ÷ standalone. The headline statistic is the median gap across the 17 core pairs, also stated excluding the Operator 4/Operator 9 pairs; the emergency and specialty line is left out of it. Operator 4/Operator 9 appears twice, once on the sponsor's synergy case and once on the lender's reduced case, and the Operator 3 synergised figure is a projected first-year figure.

Where shown. Exhibit 4.04; Exhibit 4.05, same-price pairs row; Exhibit 4.03; the text of Part 04 section A and of Part 09 section K under 04 A.

Limits. The synergy amounts are sponsor- or company-presented and not verified, so the gap shows how much of the price rests on expected synergies, not whether they were delivered.

C-72 · Master register of every valuation multiple in the source documents

What was computed. A register of 995 valuation-multiple observations drawn from the source documents for general practice and preventive care operators, with wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital operators as context. Each line carries the multiple and the tags needed to compare it: sector, transaction level, date and date type, economic environment, EBITDA definition, synergy treatment, sale-leaseback treatment and actual, pro forma or projected basis.

Sources. Principal documents: DLA-010, Deal A acquisition analysis register; OP6-012, Operator 6 valuation multiple summary; OP2-018, OP2-019, OP2-023, OP2-025, OP2-013, OP2-001, Ares Credit Group Operator 2 memos, letter-of-intent list and precedent sheet; OP3-005, OP3-010, Operator 3 business update and Ares Credit Group early read; OP7-001, OP7-005, Ares Credit Group early read and credit databook on Operator 7; OP4-005, Lender 1 memo on Operator 4; OP1-033, Ares Credit Group 2021 Operator 1 investment committee memo; OP8-003, OP8-009, Operator 8 sponsor model and Ares Credit Group situation update; QLX-033, Ares Credit Group Wellness Clinic Operator 1 investment committee memo; CO2-008, CO2-014, CO2-018, CO2-020, CO2-025, CO2-026, CO2-038, CO2-039, Ares Credit Group and company materials on Emergency Operator 1, Emergency

Operator 2 and Emergency Operator 3. Fact rows: 981 distinct, including DLA-1619 to DLA-5678, OP6-0042 to OP6-1867, OP2-0006 to OP2-4696, OP3-1328 to OP3-2360, OP1-0913 to OP1-11254, OP7-1092 to OP7-1389, OP8-0001 to OP8-2835, OP4-0767 to OP4-1650, supplementary rows A7-S001 to A7-S030 and calculated rows A7-P5-001, A7-P5-002, A7-P5-005.

How. Every fact row that records a valuation multiple (enterprise value or price ÷ EBITDA, price ÷ sales, rent-adjusted multiples, valuation marks and model assumptions) is listed once, with 26 supplementary rows read from Operator 2 and Deal A originals, three calculated check rows and 23 rows read once from the Deal B and Deal C data rooms. No multiple is recomputed here; the work is classification. Each row is tagged as platform or scale entry, single deal, add-on aggregate, pipeline, post-acquisition, valuation mark, public, cited comparable or assumption, and as standalone, synergised or synergy-unstated. Rows that feed a table or chart are classified from a reading of each source note; the remainder are classified by rule from the row's note and feed no table or chart. Cited-comparable lists, report claims and model assumptions are retained for context but excluded from all statistics; Deal A's 109 register rows are labelled price ÷ sales and kept out of every EBITDA-multiple figure.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.71, source notes on property treatment; Exhibit 9.77, enterprise value and price column.

Limits. Most rows are multiples as stated by a sponsor, lender or company and are not independently verified, and 61 rows conflict with another source for the same transaction.

C-73 · Leverage multiples: how the area was measured

What was computed. The general method behind the leverage section. It covers debt-to-EBITDA levels at financing and afterwards for historical general practice and preventive platforms from 2012 to 2026, with wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital financings as context. The three live financings are not placed in this note.

Sources. The credit agreements, term sheets, lender presentations, investment memos, compliance certificates and audited accounts of Operator 1 (OP1), Operator 2 (OP2), Operator 4 and Operator 9 (OP4), Operator 6 (OP6), Operator 3 (OP3), Operator 7 (OP7) and Operator 8 (OP8); for context, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Operator 2 and Wellness Clinic Franchisor (QLX) and Emergency Operator 1, Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 5, Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 2 (CO2).

How. Debt is built up in six cumulative steps, each recorded gross and net of cash: drawn first-lien debt (LV1); plus all other funded debt (LV2); plus finance-lease liabilities (LV3); plus preferred equity with debt-like terms and holding-company notes (LV4); plus six times annual operating-lease cash rent, over EBITDA before that rent (LV5); plus other debt-like items such as supplier finance and deferred purchase price (LV6). Leverage = debt at a given step ÷ EBITDA, and every figure states which EBITDA definition and period is underneath; financings are compared only on the same step and the same EBITDA definition. The cross-operator band uses closed or actual financings only, one figure per operator and event, on the financing EBITDA printed in the deal document (run-rate adjusted, E4, or the lender's underwriting figure, E5); proposals are reported separately and never pooled with closed financings. A leverage figure quoted by a deal document is kept as stated and the steps are then rebuilt from its components; later figures (amendments, recapitalisations, lender updates) are recorded at their dates so the path can be followed. Fixed-charge cover = (EBITDA − maintenance capital spending − cash tax) ÷ (cash interest + scheduled principal including finance-lease principal). Each financing is placed in an environment by its date, as its vintage. Each figure is placed in one of seven economic environments by the date its period ends: before July 2007 (PRE-GFC), the financial crisis from July 2007 to June 2009 (GFC), the expansion from July 2009 to February 2020 (EXP10-19), the COVID period from March to December 2020 (COVID20), the 2021 reopening (REOPEN21), the 2022 to 2023 inflation period (INFL22-23) and the soft period from January 2024 (SOFT24-26); twelve-month fiscal years of Deal A (April to March) and Operator 1 (June to May) go to the environment that holds most of their months, and a tie goes to the later one. A characteristic is called durable only if it is seen at three or more independent operators and in two or more environments; where that test is not met the text says so.

Where shown. The text of Part 04 section B and of Part 09 section K under 04 B.

Limits. Every financing in the evidence is still current, so the set cannot show the leverage at which platforms fail; few operators give the same debt over more than one EBITDA definition; the largest closed platforms are all Operator 1, so no size effect can be read; Operator 5 has no financing data; the earliest sponsor financing is from 2012. No numeric rule is stated for "temporary" or "company-specific".

C-74 · Leverage at close or at request, by financing event

What was computed. Debt-to-EBITDA multiples at the closing (or request) date of each financing, 2013 to 2026, for the general practice and preventive care operators (Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 4, Operator 6, Operator 8, Operator 3, Operator 7, Deal A) and, as separate context blocks, wellness clinics (Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Operator 2) and emergency and specialty hospitals (Emergency Operator 1, Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 3, Emergency Operator 2). Each multiple is recorded with its debt definition, gross or net, the EBITDA underneath it and the environment of the closing date.

Sources. Lender investment-committee memos and updates: Operator 1 OP1-009 (2014 memo), OP1-030 and OP1-031 (2018 memos), OP1-033 (2021 memo), OP1-035 (2020 re-underwrite), OP1-045 (2023 memo), OP1-049 (March 2026 update); Operator 2 OP2-004 (2018 memo), OP2-023 (2024 delayed-draw upsize memo); Operator 4 OP4-005 (2026 memo); Operator 6 OP6-001 (2026 memo); Operator 8 OP8-001 (2025 memo); Operator 3 OP3-010 and Operator 7 OP7-001 (early reads); Deal A DLA-024 (September 2026 lender model); wellness clinic QLX-018, QLX-020, QLX-033; emergency and specialty CO2-001, CO2-003, CO2-007, CO2-024, CO2-038, CO2-039. Fact rows include OP1-7357, OP1-7360, OP1-7584, OP1-7585, OP1-7587, OP1-7588, OP1-7795, OP1-8157, OP1-7814, OP1-10719, OP1-10721, OP1-10729, OP1-10730, OP1-10738, OP1-10741, OP1-10742, OP1-11220, OP1-11227, OP2-0250, OP2-0251, P5-S001, OP2-3732, OP2-3735, OP4-1134, OP4-1135, OP4-1182, OP6-0031, OP6-1877, OP8-0068, OP8-0069, OP3-1326, OP7-1180, OP7-1181, DLA-5669, DLA-5672, DLA-5673, QLF-1620, QLF-1624, QL1-1655, QL1-1662, QL2-0980, QL2-0990, CO1-0716 to CO1-0747, CO1-0993, CO1-0997, CO3-0744, CO3-0374, COR-5394, COR-5399.

How. For each financing event, the multiple is debt at the event date divided by the EBITDA the deal document uses for the financing: run-rate or synergised pro forma EBITDA (E4) or the lender's underwriting EBITDA (E5). Debt is mapped to a common ladder: first-lien debt drawn (LV1); plus second-lien and other funded debt (LV2); plus finance leases (LV3); plus preferred and holding-company notes (LV4); plus 6 times operating rent, over EBITDA plus that rent (LV5). Net multiples deduct cash. Where a source gives a multiple whose debt cannot be decomposed, it is kept as the company-stated figure and not mapped to a rung. Each row is tagged closed or actual (actual or pro forma basis) versus proposal or underwriting, by environment of the closing date (July 2009 to February 2020 expansion EXP10-19, 2021 reopening REOPEN21, 2022-23 inflation INFL22-23, 2024-26 soft demand SOFT24-26) and by size of the EBITDA denominator (under $21m, $21-100m, over $86m). Where two source figures conflict, the one that recomputes from the stated debt and EBITDA is used (Operator 1 2021: $1,629m over $333m gives 4.38x).

Where shown. Exhibit 4.06; Exhibit 9.77; Exhibit 9.98, wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital context.

Limits. Denominators are each source's own financing EBITDA and are not restated to one definition, and the rent basis behind the lease-adjusted prints for Operator 2 and Operator 6 is not stated in the sources. The three current proposals are measured the same way but enter none of these figures; they are read in Part 08.

C-75 · Leverage range and median by closing environment

What was computed. Count, minimum, median and maximum of leverage at close for each debt definition, gross or net, in each closing environment from 2014 to 2026. General practice and preventive care operators form the core rows; wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are banded separately as context.

Sources. The same deal documents as the leverage-at-close set: Operator 1 OP1-009, OP1-030, OP1-031, OP1-033, OP1-035, OP1-045, OP1-049; Operator 2 OP2-004, OP2-023; Operator 6 OP6-001; Operator 3 OP3-010; Operator 7 OP7-001; Deal A DLA-024; wellness clinic QLX-018, QLX-020; emergency and specialty CO2-001, CO2-003, CO2-007, CO2-024, CO2-038, CO2-039. Core closed first-lien rows: OP1-7357, OP1-7584, OP1-7585, OP1-7795, OP2-0250 (2014-18); OP1-10719, P5-S001 gross and OP1-10721, OP2-3732 net (2021); OP1-10729 (2023); OP1-11220 (2025); OP6-0031 (2026). Other rows: OP1-7360, OP1-7587, OP1-7588, OP1-8157, OP1-7814, OP1-10742, OP1-11227, OP1-10741, OP1-10730, OP1-10738, OP2-0251, OP2-3735, OP6-1877, OP1-0846, OP3-1326, OP7-1180, OP7-1181, DLA-5672, CO1-0729, CO1-0731, CO1-0743, CO1-0747, CO1-0993, CO1-0997, CO3-0744, CO3-0374, COR-5394, COR-5399, QLF-1620, QLF-1624, QL2-0980, QL2-0990.

How. The leverage-at-close prints are grouped by block (core, wellness clinics, emergency and specialty hospitals), debt definition, gross or net, closed versus proposal, and environment of the closing date. One print per operator and financing event enters each group. For each group the count, the operators, the minimum, the median and the maximum are taken; with two prints the median is their average, for example (4.38x + 5.97x) / 2 = 5.14x for 2021 first-lien gross. Only prints mapped to first-lien debt (LV1), total funded debt (LV2), debt plus preferred and holding-company notes (LV4) or lease-adjusted debt at 6 times rent (LV5) are banded; company-stated multiples that cannot be decomposed are left out. The denominator is each source's financing EBITDA (E4 or E5). Closed prints and proposals are never pooled, and context blocks never enter a core figure.

Where shown. Exhibit 4.09; Exhibit 4.06; Exhibit 9.92; Exhibit 9.158; the text of Part 04 section B, Part 08 section B and Part 08 section D, and of Part 09 section K under 04 B.

Limits. Each environment holds one or two operators and seven of the ten closed core first-lien events are Operator 1, so the bands describe these financings and not a market distribution. The three current proposals enter none of these bands; they are read in Part 08.

C-76 · Leverage range and median by size of EBITDA

What was computed. Count, minimum, median and maximum of leverage at close for each debt definition, grouped by the size of the EBITDA underneath the multiple, across all closing dates from 2014 to 2026. Core operators and the wellness clinic and emergency and specialty context blocks are banded separately.

Sources. The same deal documents and fact rows as the leverage-at-close set: Operator 1 OP1-009, OP1-030, OP1-031, OP1-033, OP1-035, OP1-045, OP1-049; Operator 2 OP2-004, OP2-023; Operator 6 OP6-001; Operator 3 OP3-010; Operator 7 OP7-001; Deal A DLA-024; wellness clinic QLX-018, QLX-020; emergency and specialty CO2-001, CO2-003, CO2-007, CO2-024, CO2-038, CO2-039. Core closed first-lien gross rows: OP2-0250, OP6-0031 (under $21m); OP1-7357, OP1-7584, OP1-7585, P5-S001 ($21-100m); OP1-7795, OP1-10719 (over $86m).

How. Each leverage-at-close print is placed in a bucket by the EBITDA in its denominator, in $m: under 21, 21 to 86, over 86. Prints are then grouped by block, debt definition, gross or net, closed versus proposal, and size bucket, pooling all closing dates. The count, operators, minimum, median and maximum are taken per group in the same way as for the bands by environment. Prints with no stated EBITDA amount, and company-stated multiples that cannot be mapped to a debt definition, are left out.

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section K under 04 B; Exhibit 8.14 (Part 08 section D) and Exhibit 8.17 (Part 08 section E); Exhibit 9.165, source note.

Limits. The closed core bucket above $86m holds only Operator 1, so no conclusion on size can be drawn. The three current proposals enter none of these bands; they are read in Part 08.

C-77 · Same debt measured over different EBITDA definitions

What was computed. For one operator at one date, a fixed debt amount divided by each EBITDA definition available for that date. Covers Operator 4 (FY2023, FY2024, FY2025, March 2026), Operator 2 (October 2024, June and July 2026), Operator 6 (July 2026), Operator 8 (March 2026), Operator 1 (September 2014) and Deal A (June 2026), with Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 1 as context.

Sources. Operator 4 audited accounts OP4-003 (2023-24) and OP4-007 (FY2025), Q1 2026 accounts OP4-008, with denominators from the 2026 lender memo OP4-005; Operator 2 OP2-023 (2024 memo), OP2-025 (August 2026 update), OP2-026 (June 2026 update); Operator 6 OP6-001 (2026 memo, including the accountants' earnings review); Operator 8 OP8-014 (Q1 2026 lender update); Operator 1 OP1-009 (2014 memo); Deal A DLA-016 (August 2026 bank model); context QLX-018 (Wellness Clinic Franchisor), CO2-001 and CO2-007 (Emergency Operator 1), CO2-039 (Emergency Operator 3). Fact rows: OP4-1384, OP4-1388, OP4-1394, OP4-1398, OP4-1404, OP4-1410, OP4-1416, OP4-1422, OP4-1428, OP4-1434, OP4-1438, OP4-1442, OP4-1446; OP2-3766 to OP2-3768, OP2-4314, OP2-4315, OP2-4775 to OP2-4777; OP6-0031 to OP6-0034; OP8-2346, OP8-2348; OP1-0832, OP1-0833; DLA-5864; QLF-1620, QLF-1626, QLF-1628 to QLF-1630; CO3-0756, CO3-1535, CO3-1536; CO1-0731, CO1-0733, CO1-0734, CO1-0747 to CO1-0750.

How. The numerator is held constant for each operator and date: first-lien debt (LV1) or total funded debt (LV2), gross or net as stated in the row. It is divided in turn by each EBITDA definition the documents give for that date: reported EBITDA (E1), adjusted EBITDA (E2), pro forma EBITDA including closed acquisitions (E3), run-rate or synergised EBITDA (E4), the lender's underwriting EBITDA (E5) and cash EBITDA after recurring one-time costs (E6). Formula: multiple = debt / EBITDA on the stated definition, for example $668.5m / $129.5m = 4.65x on Operator 4's credit-agreement pro forma EBITDA and $668.5m / $30.2m = 19.92x on cash EBITDA. Each row records the dollar amount of debt and of EBITDA used.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.75; Exhibit 4.07; Exhibit 9.77; the text of Part 04 section B and of Part 09 section K under 04 B; for the wellness clinic and emergency and specialty context, Exhibit 9.98 and the text of Part 09 section K under 04 G. Deal A's lines for June 2026 are shown only in Exhibit 9.152 (Part 09 section O).

Limits. Only operators whose documents give the same debt over more than one EBITDA definition appear, and a reported-EBITDA print exists for few of them. The current proposals for Deal A, Deal B and Deal C are not in these figures; they are read in Part 08.

C-78 · Spread between highest and lowest leverage reading per operator

What was computed. For each operator and date in the same-debt comparison, the number of EBITDA definitions available, the lowest and highest resulting multiple, and the ratio between them. Covers Operator 4, Operator 2, Operator 6, Operator 8, Operator 1 and Deal A, with Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 1 as context.

Sources. The same documents as the same-debt comparison: Operator 4 OP4-003, OP4-005, OP4-007, OP4-008; Operator 2 OP2-023, OP2-025, OP2-026; Operator 6 OP6-001; Operator 8 OP8-014; Operator 1 OP1-009; Deal A DLA-016; context QLX-018, CO2-001, CO2-007, CO2-039. Fact rows per line: OP4-1384 to OP4-1446 (as listed for the comparison), OP2-3766 to OP2-3768, OP2-4314, OP2-4315, OP2-4775 to OP2-4777, OP6-0031 to OP6-0034, OP8-2346, OP8-2348, OP1-0832, OP1-0833, DLA-5864, QLF-1620 to QLF-1630, CO3-0756, CO3-1535, CO3-1536, CO1-0731 to CO1-0750.

How. For each operator and date, all multiples on the same debt are collected. The spread is the highest multiple divided by the lowest: spread = max / min. A second ratio repeats the calculation after removing the reported-EBITDA (E1) print, to show how much of the spread comes from that definition alone; it is blank where fewer than two prints remain. Example: Operator 4 March 2026, 19.92x / 4.65x = 3.81.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.75, for Operator 4, Operator 8 and Operator 6; the text of Part 04 section B and of Part 09 section K under 04 B.

Limits. The spread depends on how many EBITDA definitions a source happens to give, so operators with fewer definitions show a narrower spread by construction. The Deal B and Deal C proposals are not in these figures; they are read in Part 08.

C-79 · Leverage after close, tracked over time per operator

What was computed. Dated series of leverage after each financing closed: Operator 1 (2018 to 2026), Operator 2 (2018 to 2026), Operator 4 (2025 to 2026), Operator 8 (2025 to 2026) and Deal A (FY2023 to 2026), with Emergency Operator 1, Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 2 as emergency and specialty context.

Sources. Operator 1 OP1-030, OP1-033, OP1-035, OP1-045, OP1-048, OP1-049 (lender memos and updates, 2018 to 2026); Operator 2 OP2-004, OP2-013, OP2-015, OP2-018, OP2-022, OP2-023, OP2-025 (memos, model and updates, 2018 to 2026); Operator 4 OP4-005; Operator 8 OP8-009 and OP8-014; Deal A DLA-016, DLA-024 and Deal A's annual reports on Form 10-K (SEC EDGAR); emergency and specialty CO2-001, CO2-002, CO2-003, CO2-007, CO2-025, CO2-039. Fact rows: Operator 1 OP1-7814, OP1-8159, OP1-8160, OP1-7815, OP1-10742 to OP1-10744, OP1-11227, OP1-11228, OP1-11151, OP1-11155, OP1-10730, OP1-10733, OP1-10737, OP1-10738, OP1-11225, OP1-11149; Operator 2 OP2-0247, OP2-1480, OP2-3941, OP2-3950, OP2-2990, OP2-3730, OP2-3752, OP2-3770 to OP2-3773, OP2-3712, OP2-4668, OP2-4671, OP2-4670, OP2-4311, OP2-2306; Operator 4 OP4-0736, OP4-0738, OP4-0740, OP4-0742, OP4-0745; Operator 8 OP8-0069, OP8-2309, OP8-2321, OP8-2333, OP8-2344, OP8-2361, OP8-2367; Deal A DLA-0461, DLA-0465, DLA-0469, DLA-0473, DLA-5865, DLA-5673; emergency and specialty rows in the CO1, CO3 and COR series.

How. For each operator one leverage measure is followed on one definition through time, taking each dated figure as the source states it: Operator 1 total funded debt net of cash over run-rate pro forma EBITDA (LV2 net on E4) and the same including preferred equity (LV4 net); Operator 2 net leverage on compliance pro forma EBITDA, plus one figure on covenant EBITDA; Operator 4 and Operator 8 net leverage on credit-agreement pro forma EBITDA; Deal A debt plus finance leases, gross, over reported EBITDA (LV3 on E1). No figure is recalculated; each row keeps its date, basis and source page. Where two sources give different figures for the same date (Operator 2, December 2025: 5.47x and 5.62x), both are kept.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.77; Exhibit 9.98, later figures for the context operators.

Limits. Each series is on its own operator's definition, so levels cannot be compared across operators, and the Deal A series ends with the September 2026 refinancing proposal, which is read in Part 08 section B.

C-80 · Fixed-charge cover paired with leverage at the same date

What was computed. Pairs of a coverage ratio and a leverage multiple for the same operator and date, 2022 to 2026: Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 6, Operator 8, Operator 7, Operator 3, Operator 4 and Operator 9, with Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Operator 2, Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Emergency Operator 3 and Emergency Operator 2 as context.

Sources. Operator 1 OP1-045 and OP1-048; Operator 2 OP2-023; Operator 6 OP6-001; Operator 8 OP8-009 and OP8-014; Operator 7 OP7-001; Operator 3 OP3-010; Operator 4 OP4-008; Operator 9 OP4-002 (2025 audit); context QLX-018, QLX-020, QLX-033, CO2-024, CO2-025, CO2-039. Fact-row pairs (coverage, leverage): OP1-10714 and OP1-10743; OP1-11144 and OP1-11151; OP2-3899 and OP2-3766; OP6-0141 and OP6-0031; OP6-0142 and OP6-1880; OP8-2547 and OP8-2324; OP7-1304 and OP7-1180; OP3-1291 and OP3-1326; OP4-1478 and OP4-1442; OP4-1479 and OP4-1446; OP4-1470 and OP4-1464; QL1-2097 and QL1-1655; QL2-1008 and QL2-0980; QLF-1706 and QLF-1620; CO3-0773 and CO3-0756; COR-5613 and COR-5394; COR-6036 and COR-5780.

How. For each operator the coverage figure stated in the source is matched to the leverage figure at the same or nearest date; nothing is pooled or averaged. Coverage is fixed-charge cover (FCCR) as each source defines it: a compliance, lender-model or company figure, on maintenance capex only or including growth capex. Where cover is restated on the common definition it is (EBITDA less maintenance capex less cash taxes) / (cash interest plus scheduled principal including finance-lease principal). For Operator 4 and Operator 9 the coverage figure is interest cover (EBITDA / cash interest), not fixed-charge cover, and is labelled as such. Each row records the coverage metric, the leverage definition and the basis (actual, pro forma or projected) of both figures.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.78; Exhibit 9.158; the text of Part 09 section K under 04 B and of Part 09 section O under 08 B, 08 C and 08 D.

Limits. Coverage definitions and bases differ between rows, so the pairs show an association across a small number of figures and not an estimated threshold.

C-81 · Deal A leverage on each debt definition, from public filings

What was computed. Deal A's leverage for each fiscal year from FY2002 to FY2026 (years ending March; EBITDA and rent from FY2000), and for the twelve months to June 2026, on every debt definition from bank debt to debt including leases and supplier finance. Interest cover and a fixed-charge cover estimate are computed alongside, with memo lines that remove gains on asset disposals.

Sources. Deal A annual reports on Form 10-K, FY2002 to FY2026 (SEC EDGAR; tagged financial data from FY2010, filing text for earlier years: income statement, balance sheet, cash-flow statement, long-term debt note, lease note, supplier-finance note), and the quarterly report on Form 10-Q for the first quarter of FY2027 (balances at 27 June 2026). Fact rows DLA-0118 to DLA-0317 (reported EBITDA, FY2012 to FY2026), DLA-0460 to DLA-0474 (FY2023 to FY2026 leverage) and A8-P5-001 to A8-P5-101 (recomputed ratios FY2020 to FY2026, ex-gains and twelve-month lines, 10-Q balances, supplier-finance sensitivity).

How. Reported EBITDA (E1) = operating income + depreciation and amortisation (including finance-lease asset amortisation) + impairment of long-lived assets; impairment is not separately disclosed before FY2018 and is taken as zero; gains on disposal stay in, and a memo line removes them. Bank and mortgage debt / E1 is first-lien leverage (LV1); adding finance leases and financing obligations gives LV3; net versions deduct cash. Lease-adjusted leverage (LV5) = (LV3 debt + 6 × operating rent) / (E1 + rent), with an 8× sensitivity; rent is cash operating-lease payments from FY2020 and book rent before. LV6 adds the supplier-finance balance to the LV5 numerator, available from FY2023. Interest cover = E1 / interest paid (interest expense before FY2010). The fixed-charge cover estimate = (E1 − total capex − cash taxes) / (interest paid + finance-lease principal), and its lease-adjusted form = (E1 + operating-lease cash payments − total capex − cash taxes) / (interest paid + finance-lease principal + operating-lease cash payments); the cash-flow line = E1 − total capex − cash taxes − interest paid − finance-lease principal, and debt to the cash-flow line = LV3 gross debt / the cash-flow line.

Where shown. FY2020 to FY2026, as history: Exhibit 9.76; Exhibit 4.08; the text of Part 04 section B and of Part 09 section K under 04 B. FY2026 and the twelve months to June 2026: Exhibit 9.152 and the text of Part 09 section O under 08 A and 08 B; the twelve-month lines to June 2026 are shown only there.

Limits. Deal A does not disclose maintenance capex, so the fixed-charge estimate uses total capex and understates cover by the growth share; lease-adjusted and supplier-finance leverage and the cover estimate cannot be computed for the twelve months to June 2026 because the 10-Q omits the cash items needed.

C-82 · Index of all financing, leverage and coverage figures

What was computed. A single list of every extracted figure on debt, leverage, coverage, covenants, pricing and financing terms for 15 operators in general practice and preventive care, wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals, covering periods from the early 2000s to 2026 and including projections. Each line is tagged with a debt definition, gross or net, the EBITDA definition underneath it, the environment and whether it is a projection.

Sources. All financing documents in the set, the largest being: Deal A DLA-024 (September 2026 lender model), DLA-017 (diligence update), DLA-023 (LW draft term sheet, 21 September 2026), DLA-016 (bank model); Operator 3 OP3-010 and OP3-012; Wellness Clinic Operator 1 QLX-033; Wellness Clinic Operator 2 QLX-020; Wellness Clinic Franchisor QLX-018; Operator 2 OP2-018, OP2-023, OP2-025; Emergency Operator 2 CO2-024, CO2-025; Emergency Operator 3 CO2-038, CO2-039; Operator 8 OP8-001, OP8-009; Operator 6 OP6-001; Operator 4 OP4-005, OP4-007; Operator 1 OP1-009, OP1-033; Operator 7 OP7-001; Deal A filings on SEC EDGAR. About 2,461 distinct fact rows in the OP4, CO1, COR, OP6, OP7, QLF, OP3, OP1, DLA, QL2, OP2, QL1, OP8 and CO3 series, plus P5-S001.

How. Every fact row whose measure is a leverage multiple, a financing term, a coverage ratio, a debt balance, a covenant, supplier finance, net debt, loan-to-value or pre-financing free cash flow was selected, together with every row attached to a named financing. Each row was then labelled from its measure name and source note with: the debt definition (LV1 to LV6, or company-stated where the debt cannot be decomposed), gross or net, the EBITDA definition (E1 to E6, or as stated), the environment of its date, a projection flag (periods after September 2026 or scenario cases), and for Emergency Operator 1 the entity (Emergency Operator 1, Emergency Operator 4 or Emergency Operator 5). No value is recalculated. The list is an index: the leverage tables in this document use rows selected individually after reading each source note, and projection rows enter no at-close statistic.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.77.

Limits. The definition labels are read from measure names and notes and about 1,960 rows (terms, balances, covenants, coverage) carry no debt definition by design; Operator 5 has no financing rows. The list includes the three current proposals, which are read in Part 08.

C-83 · Cross-operator rankings R1 to R10 and the rule for when operators may be ranked

What was computed. Ten rankings of operators on a single measure, each within one economic environment: two on comparable traffic (R1, R2), two on ticket growth against consumer price inflation (R3, R4), five on same-store sales (R5 to R9) and one on the later multiple of acquired clinics (R10). They hold 28 operator rows; no ranking has more than four operators.

Sources. OP2-007 and OP2-003, Operator 2 historical clinic KPI workbooks (Operator 10, Operator 16, Operator 12, Operator 14); OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook; OP5-008, Operator 5 clinic volume trends; OP1-041, Operator 1 comparable sales summary 2019 to March 2023; DLA-002, Deal

A all-clinics KPI report; OP3-003, Operator 3 clinic-month datacube; Operator 6, Operator 8 and Operator 4 clinic and acquisition materials (OP6, OP8, OP4). Fact rows: R1 OP2-1176, OP2-1179, OP2-1182, OP2-0771, OP2-0774, OP2-0777, OP2-0673, OP2-0676, OP2-0679, OP2-0736, OP2-0739, OP2-0742; R2 OP6-1896, OP3-0907, DLA-0789; R3 OP2-0674, OP2-0677, OP2-0680, OP2-1177, OP2-1180, OP2-1183, OP2-0772, OP2-0775, OP2-0778, OP2-0737, OP2-0740, OP2-0743; R4 OP3-0908, DLA-0790, OP6-1146; R5 OP2-3520, OP5-3866, OP1-8856; R6 OP1-8857, OP5-3870, OP2-3525; R7 OP8-1714, OP5-3878, OP1-8859; R8 OP6-1147, OP3-0890, DLA-0756; R9 OP3-0906, OP6-1148, DLA-0788; R10 OP3-1494, OP4-0806, OP6-1733. Public series: BLS consumer price index for veterinarian services.

How. Operators are ranked only when at least three of them share one measure, one definition, one rent treatment where rent matters, one basis (actual, pro forma or projection) and one clinic base including the closure treatment, in overlapping periods inside one environment; anything thinner is described and not ranked. R1 and R3 chain three annual rates for 2015 to 2017 at four chains later bought by Operator 2: (1 + 2015) × (1 + 2016) × (1 + 2017) − 1 for comparable traffic (R1), and the same for comparable ticket less the cumulative change in the consumer price index for veterinarian services over those years (R3). R2 and R4 take the latest full-year comparable traffic, and ticket growth less the index over the same months, at the three operators on a survivor base in the 2024 to 2026 soft period. R5 to R9 rank same-store sales on the common definition for one year each: 2019, 2020 and 2022 on bases where closed clinics leave from the month of closure, and 2024 (Deal A fiscal 2025) and the latest year on survivor bases. R10 ranks purchase price ÷ current clinic-level EBITDA including synergies for add-on deals still owned, where a lower multiple ranks higher. Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty operators appear in no ranking, and no overall ranking of operators is made.

Where shown. Exhibit 4.15; Exhibit 9.93; Exhibit 9.120; the text of Part 04 section E, and of Part 09 section K under 04 C and 04 E.

Limits. Each ranking covers one environment and three or four operators, and ranks do not carry from one environment to the next; margins, unit economics and cash flow could not be ranked on a common definition; R3 and R4 rank ticket, which is price, mix and attachment together; R10 rests on company-presented pro forma figures with the rent basis not stated. Where two source values conflict (Operator 5 2022, Operator 3 in R10, Operator 6 in R4) the order is the same on either value.

C-84 · Which operators are valid comparators for each live deal, and on which measures

What was computed. A map of 18 deal-comparator pairs: five for Deal A (Operator 1, Operator 4 with Operator 9, Operator 2, Operator 3, Operator 6, the last used in the comparable-sales rankings only), five for Deal B's general practice and preventive business (Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 8, Operator 2, Operator 7), three for Deal B's Deal B Wellness Clinics segment (Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Franchisor, Wellness Clinic Operator 2) and five for Deal C (Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 2, Operator 8, Operator 4). For each pair it states why the operator was chosen, which measures can be compared and which cannot.

Sources. The clinic-level databases, diligence materials, investment memos and lender materials of Operator 1 (OP1), Operator 4 and Operator 9 (OP4), Operator 2 (OP2), Operator 3 (OP3), Operator 6 (OP6), Operator 8 (OP8) and Operator 7 (OP7); the Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 2 files (QLX); and the data-room files of Deal A (DLA), Deal B (DLB) and Deal C (DLC). Fact rows include DLA-0788 to DLA-0790, DLA-0846, DLA-0862, OP3-0906 to OP3-0908, OP3-1089, OP1-3403, OP1-3416, OP1-5630, OP2-3467, OP6-1146, OP6-1147, OP6-1148, OP6-1896, OP6-1731, OP6-1733, OP8-1703, OP8-2211, QL1-0288, QLF-0956 and QL2-0342.

How. A comparator is chosen for a stated reason: the same format, geography, scale or service mix; the same kind of acquisition programme; or data on the same definition in an overlapping period. For each pair a measure is marked valid only if both sides carry the same measure, definition, rent treatment, basis and clinic base, and the period overlap is stated; otherwise it is marked not valid with the reason (for example cash rent against operating-lease rent only, a survivor base against a base with closures removed from the month of closure, or a company same-store definition against the common one). On each valid measure the comparators' values form a range and the deal's own figure is placed inside, above or below it; gaps are simple subtractions. The wellness clinic set is used for the Deal B Wellness Clinics segment only and is never pooled with general practice and preventive operators. Operator 5 was considered for Deal A and left out, because its figures on Deal A's definitions are pro forma or on a different closure base and its data end in 2023. Financing comparisons are outside this note.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.119; Exhibit 9.123; Exhibit 9.140; Exhibit 9.141; Exhibit 9.137; Exhibit 9.138; Exhibit 7.13; Exhibit 9.167, its operating and valuation rows (its leverage row rests on the financing documents of Part 08 section D); Exhibit 4.17; the text of Part 04 section F and of Part 09 section K under 04 F.

Limits. Only a handful of measures are valid for each pair, and none of Deal A's comparators shares its rent treatment for clinic margin or loss-making clinic share; the Deal B and Deal C figures in the map were read once from the two data rooms, and the deal sections govern where they differ; placing a deal in a range draws no conclusion on the deal.

C-85 · Other operating KPIs by operator: service mix, labour, retention, clinic counts, integration cost and overhead

What was computed. Six blocks of operating KPIs read directly from the evidence for each operator, annual and point-in-time: service mix (K1), labour productivity (K2), customer and workforce retention (K3), clinic roll-forward with openings, acquisitions and closures (K4), integration cost per acquired clinic and integration spend (K5), and corporate overhead and headcount (K6). They cover the general practice and preventive operators and the wellness clinic and emergency and specialty context operators.

Sources. Service mix: OP1-015 and OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic P&L workbooks; OP1-042, Operator 1 service mix by format; OP3-003, Operator 3 datacube; OP6-011, Operator 6 service-level revenue mix; OP5-006, Operator 5 service categories; OP7-005, Operator 7 credit databook; DLA-004, Deal A sales and gross margin by product category; CO2-015, Emergency Operator 2 clinic-level P&Ls. Labour productivity: OP3-003; QLX-005 and QLX-006, Wellness Clinic Franchisor clinic KPI files; CO2-018, Emergency Operator 2 volume datapack; OP5-009, Operator 5 financial due diligence report. Retention: QLX-006; QLX-021, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 repeat and new client counts; OP5-005, Operator 5 repeat customers report; OP6-007 and OP6-010, Operator 6 overview materials and offering document. Clinic roll-forward: OP1-044, Operator 1 long-range forecast; OP1-021; QLX-005; QLX-020, Wellness Clinic Operator 2 screening memo; OP2-007, Operator 2 historical clinic KPI workbook; DLA-003, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file. Integration: OP2-017, Operator 2 quality-of-earnings databook; CO2-008, Emergency Operator 1 and Emergency Operator 4 analysis; OP4-005, Operator 4 investment memo. Overhead and headcount: DLA-007, Deal A expense bridge 2017 to 2026; CO2-014, Emergency Operator 2 add-on profile summary; OP6-010; OP5-011, Operator 5 operating model.

How. Nothing is computed. Each cell holds one value taken from one fact row, laid out by operator and period within its block: 865 cells for service mix, 295 for labour productivity, 107 for retention, 1,142 for the clinic roll-forward, 67 for integration and 537 for overhead and headcount, 3,079 in all. Service mix is the share of revenue by line, led by pharmacy product revenue ÷ net revenue (MIX_PHARM_SHARE); labour productivity is revenue or gross profit per veterinarian, exam room or employee, and patient visits per clinic-day; retention is repeat-customer share and staff turnover or retention; overhead is corporate cost and its share of revenue. Most values are on the company's own definition, so the summary table shows one figure per operator as a description and draws no comparison. Figures are actual unless marked pro forma, and projections are not used in the table.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.80; the text of Part 09 section K under 04 C; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty rows in Exhibit 9.96.

Limits. Definitions differ by operator and are often not stated (for example what counts as a repeat customer), so no ranking or pooled figure is given; no source records clinic relocations; integration cost per acquired clinic exists for Operator 6 and Wellness Clinic Franchisor only; Deal B and Deal C have no rows in these blocks.

C-86 · Clinic-level distributions: spread of clinic margins, the typical clinic, clinic age and persistence of clinic rank

What was computed. Seven blocks that describe how results are spread across an operator's clinics: the distribution of clinic profit margin by operator and period (SD.1); the same on the one common definition, before rebates and on cash rent (SD.2); the typical clinic, by median clinic profit and share of loss-making clinics (SD.3); Operator 1 clinics by clinic age (SD.4); Operator 2 clinics by year of ownership (SD.5); year-to-year movement of clinics between margin quartiles (SD.6); and distribution figures taken directly from the evidence, including the spread of clinic-level same-store sales (SD.7). They cover Operator 1, Operator 2, Deal A, Operator 5, Operator 3, Operator 7, Operator 8, Operator 6, Operator 4 and Deal C, with wellness clinic and emergency and specialty operators in the last block.

Sources. OP1-021 and OP1-015, Operator 1 clinic P&L workbooks (June 2007 to December 2017); OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook (June 2021); OP2-009, Operator 2 clinic-level analysis (2018); OP5-011, Operator 5 operating model with clinic-level figures; OP5-008, Operator 5 clinic volume trends; DLA-003, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file FY23 to FY26; DLA-002, Deal A all-clinics KPI report; OP3-003, Operator 3 clinic-month datacube; DLC-001, Deal C site-level database; OP7-006 and OP7-007, Operator 7 diligence databooks; OP8-010 and OP8-012, Operator 8 databooks; OP1-041, Operator 1 comparable sales summary; QLX-012, QLX-024 and QLX-029, Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 clinic files; CO2-015, Emergency Operator 2 clinic-level P&Ls. Fact rows include OP1-2456, OP1-2457, OP1-2507, OP1-5757, OP5-1171, OP5-2047, OP7-0495, OP7-0511, DLA-0862 and A3-P5-006 to A3-P5-009.

How. For each operator and period the clinic values are ordered and the median, lower quartile, upper quartile and the gap between the quartiles are read off; the mean of clinic margins and the chain margin as a ratio of totals (profit of all clinics ÷ sales of all clinics) are shown beside them; and the loss-making share = clinics with negative clinic profit ÷ clinics in the base. Clinic profit is four-wall EBITDA before rebates (D1.1) or with rebates (D1.2), and each line states the rent treatment and whether the base is all clinics or survivors; only clinics open for the full year enter a distribution. The clinic-age and ownership-year blocks group clinics by years since opening or acquisition and compare each group with mature clinics. Persistence of rank matches the same clinics in two consecutive years and reports the share that stay in the same margin quartile, the share of top and bottom quartile clinics that stay there, and the rank correlation between the two years. The last block repeats distribution figures as the evidence carries

them, including the 10th, 50th and 90th percentile of clinic same-store sales and the share of clinics with a negative figure. The blocks hold 2,069 cells.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.53; Exhibit 9.92; Exhibit 9.146; Exhibit 9.52; the text of Part 03 section C, Part 03 section D and Part 05 section B, and of Part 09 section J under 03 C and 03 D.

Limits. The Deal A, Operator 3 and Deal C clinic files hold surviving clinics only, so their spread and rank-persistence figures leave out closed clinics; Deal A's loss-making share on all clinics is taken from clinic EBITDA on operating-lease rent only, which carries no clinic sales; rent treatment differs by operator, so spreads are read within an operator and only the common-definition block is set side by side; the Operator 5 figures are pro forma.

C-87 · Deal B acquired-clinic earnings against seller EBITDA, age-matched by owned year

What was computed. For Deal B's general practice acquisitions closed 2022–2025, clinic-level EBITDA earned in each clinic's first twelve owned months, and in owned months 13–21, set against the seller EBITDA used to price the deal. The data hold 61 lines, one per closing-date group and owned year, with the clinics, the owned-period EBITDA and the seller EBITDA.

Sources. DLB-029 Deal B historical acquisition detail (82 deals, 103 units, June 2021–January 2026; tab 'Historical Acquisition Detail', one row per deal, with the location count in column C, the closing date in column D and the seller "closing EBITDA" in column O); DLB-003 Deal B general practice datapack (103 clinics, monthly net revenue and clinic-level EBITDA, January 2023–July 2026). Peer reference: OP8-012 and OP8-010 Operator 8 databooks (OP8-1703, OP8-2211).

How. Deals in the acquisition schedule are anonymised, so they were matched to datapack clinics by closing date; a closing-date group is used only where every unit in the schedule maps to a datapack clinic and seller EBITDA is stated for every deal in the group. Owned months are counted from each clinic's first full month of ownership; year one is months 1–12 and year two is months 13–21. An owned year enters only where all twelve of its months fall inside the datapack's January 2023 to July 2026; a year only partly inside is left out. Clinic-level EBITDA is the company's own four-wall figure on book rent (straight-line rent, including sale-leaseback rent). Delivery ratio for a cohort and owned year = sum of owned-period clinic-level EBITDA across the included groups ÷ sum of seller closing EBITDA for the same groups; cohorts are by year of closing, and the first-half-2024 deals are also followed as one fixed set of ten clinics from year one to year two. The 2021 and 2026 cohorts (two units each) are omitted.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.127; Exhibit 9.128, age-matched row; Exhibit 6.04; the text of Part 06 section B and of Part 09 section M under 06 B.

Limits. The schedule does not state the period of the seller EBITDA, the clinics are survivors only, the datapack starts in January 2023 so most 2022 deals are seen only in their second owned year, and the matched groups cover 61 group-years rather than all 103 units.

C-88 · Deal A refinancing need and capacity at maturity

The amount Deal A would need to refinance at September 2030, and the capacity of a new lender on a leverage test and a cover test, are computed in note C-FIN-3 on the monthly path of note C-FIN-1.

C-89 · Deal B monthly revenue and clinic-level EBITDA by clinic

What was computed. Monthly net revenue and clinic-level EBITDA for each of Deal B's 103 general practice clinics, January 2023 to July 2026 (38 months), with each clinic's state, acquisition date, first full month of ownership and acquisition year.

Sources. DLB-003 Deal B general practice datapack (July 2026 refresh): clinic information, monthly net revenue by clinic and monthly four-wall EBITDA by clinic.

How. The series is a direct extraction, one line per clinic and month; no figure is adjusted. Net revenue and clinic-level EBITDA are as stated by the company, in $ thousands; clinic-level EBITDA is on book rent (straight-line rent, including sale-leaseback rent), as the datapack states (Cover!B31); the datapack does not state whether clinic-allocated rebates or a shared-services charge are inside its clinic EBITDA (Part 06 section G). Acquisition year is the calendar year of the acquisition date, and owned months in later calculations are counted from the first full month stated in the datapack. The revenue and EBITDA tables each hold 103 clinics.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.128, age-matched delivery row; Exhibit 6.04; Exhibit 9.127; the text of Part 06 section B and of Part 09 section M under 06 B.

Limits. The datapack covers only clinics open at July 2026, so closed locations are absent, and it begins in January 2023, so earlier owned months of the 2021 and 2022 acquisitions are not observed.

C-90 · Deal C refinancing gap at maturity across multiples and growth rates

What was computed. The shortfall or surplus when Deal C's debt is refinanced at maturity (September 2032), for a grid of refinancing multiples and annual EBITDA growth rates, on two starting EBITDA figures: the lender's underwriting EBITDA of $29.4m and cash-basis EBITDA of $24.9m (Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA for the twelve months to April 2026, $23.2m as printed, with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back). Further rows test the delayed-draw loan fully drawn at close and the sponsor instrument paying cash interest, for both financing options.

Sources. Our six-year monthly deleveraging projection on the proposed Option One and Option Two terms (Part 08 section D). Growth anchors: DLC-001 Deal C site-level database (same-store clinic EBITDA growth, DLC-0987 and DLC-0996). Deal-cost rates: DLC-014 Deal C 2025 audit, DLC-0009 and DLC-0199 over total consideration of $32.8m (Note 3, p.17; note C-56). Observed multiples: OP6-001 Operator 6 investment memorandum (OP6-0031), OP3-010 Operator 3 early read (OP3-1326), OP4-008 Operator 4 Q1 2026 financial statements (OP4-1442), and the median of closed first-lien financings since 2014.

How. Refinancing gap = net debt at maturity − multiple × year-six EBITDA × 0.85, where 0.85 allows for 2% fees; a negative gap means the refinancing clears. Net debt at maturity comes from a monthly path: cash interest at SOFR of 4.19% plus spread on the term loan, undrawn fees on the revolver for six years and on the $70m delayed-draw loan for its 21-month availability, 1% amortisation, maintenance capex of $2.3m, tax of $0.3m and $4.3m of stopping and settlement costs in the first ten months. Year-six EBITDA = starting EBITDA grown at the stated annual rate; the grid uses multiples of 4.00×, 3.81×, 4.27×, 4.70× and 5.10× and growth of −5.8%, 0%, +1.0%, +2%, +3.0% and +4%. In the drawn-loan rows, acquired EBITDA = $70m ÷ the closing leverage multiple (a leverage-neutral assumption) and deal costs of 15.2% or 31.2% of price are paid in cash at close; in the sponsor rows a 10% or 17% cash coupon on the $21m instrument is assumed.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.165; Exhibit 8.12; Exhibit 9.166.

Limits. Net debt at maturity in each cell is the output of the monthly path; the gap in each cell can be recomputed from the net debt and year-six EBITDA given with the exhibit's data. The multiples were observed on lenders' adjusted EBITDA, so applying them to cash-basis EBITDA assumes a refinancing lender would measure leverage that way, and the delayed-draw and sponsor-coupon cases are assumptions because those terms are not in the documents provided.

C-91 · Deal C acquired clinics: margins under the seller against margins once owned

What was computed. For Deal C clinics acquired in 2023–2026, pooled revenue, gross margin and clinic-level EBITDA margin in the seller's last months before acquisition, compared with the same clinics under ownership, by acquisition cohort and pooled. Four owned windows are shown: all owned months, the first twelve owned months, months 13–21, and the twelve months to July 2026.

Sources. DLC-001 Deal C site-level database (86 sites, monthly net revenue, gross profit and clinic-level EBITDA, January 2022–July 2026, with seller-period months for acquired sites and each site's cohort and acquisition date). Related fact rows DLC-1201..1258. Peer reference for seller-to-owned revenue: Operator 3 (OP3-1110).

How. For each acquired site, the seller window is up to twelve months immediately before the acquisition month, counting only months with revenue; a site is included only if it has at least six seller months. Owned months start at the first full month of ownership. A site enters the first-year, second-year or latest-twelve-month comparison only with a full twelve owned months in that window, and the all-owned-months comparison with at least one. For each cohort, margin = sum of gross profit (or clinic-level EBITDA) ÷ sum of revenue across the included sites and months, so larger clinics carry more weight; uplift in basis points = (owned margin − seller margin) × 8,657. The pooled lines repeat the calculation over all included sites of the 2023–25 cohorts and of all cohorts; revenue per clinic-month = pooled revenue ÷ number of clinic-months.

Where shown. The text of Part 07 section C: the uplift on matched sites; the text of Part 09 section N under 07 C: the year-one uplift across 19 sites and the count of sites with a second owned year, and under 07 F: seller-to-owned revenue per clinic-month against Operator 3; Exhibit 7.06, the twelve months to July 2026 against the seller months, by cohort.

Limits. Seller windows run six to twelve months and are not seasonally matched to the owned windows, only 19 sites have a full first owned year and six a second, and seller accounts may carry no rent on owned property, so the EBITDA-margin comparison is directional.

C-92 · Deal B same-store sales in the 2024 to 2026 soft period, mean of two full years

What was computed. The mean of Deal B's same-store sales growth for calendar 2024 and calendar 2025 on the common definition (D2.1, clinics owned and open for 13 months, closed clinics kept in the base until they close): +0.4%.

Sources. DLB-1361 (calendar 2024, −3.9%) and DLB-1406 (calendar 2025, +4.7%), both computed from the monthly clinic revenue of the Deal B datapack (DLB-003).

How. (−3.99% + 4.94%) ÷ 2 = +0.44%, shown as +0.4% with the number of years in brackets, as for every other operator in the same table.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.19, the Deal B row.

Limits. Two operator-years. The 2024 base holds fewer clinics than the 2025 base, because most clinics had not been owned for 13 months in 2024.

C-93 · Governing values that are themselves computations: Deal C adjustment share and the DBW margin gap

What was computed. Two figures that are computed rather than read from a document and that govern where a source figure on another definition also appears. Deal C's adjustment share on audited reported EBITDA: 0.66 for FY2025 and 0.81 for the twelve months to April 2026. The gap in four-wall margin after rebates on cash rent between Deal B Wellness Clinics's first four owned months (December 2025 to March 2026) and the Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA operations for the twelve months to September 2025: 10.6 points. Two further governing values of the same kind have notes of their own: Deal B's same-store sales in the 2024 to 2026 soft period (note C-92) and Deal B's cohort delivery against seller EBITDA (note C-87).

Sources. DLC-0019 (FY2025 reported EBITDA, 2025 audit, $4.7m); DLC-4426 (FY2025 pro forma adjusted EBITDA, $22.0m); DLC-4434 (reported EBITDA for the twelve months to April 2026, $1.3m, including the $1.0m impairment); DLC-4430 (pro forma adjusted EBITDA for the same twelve months, $27.9m). DLB-3520 (DBW four-wall margin, 25.9%); QLF-0234 (Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA four-wall EBITDA, twelve months to September 2025), divided by the PVA sales of the same period for 15.5%.

How. Adjustment share = (pro forma adjusted EBITDA − reported EBITDA) ÷ pro forma adjusted EBITDA, as in note C-61: (22.0 − 4.7) ÷ 22.0 = 0.66 and (27.9 − 1.3) ÷ 27.9 = 0.81. Reported EBITDA is operating income plus depreciation, amortisation and impairment; the diligence exhibits' own "reported" figure leaves out the impairment and gives 0.71 for FY2025, which is shown only where those exhibits are quoted. Margin gap = 25.9% − 15.5% = 10.6 points.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.167; the text of Part 07 section D and of Part 09 section N under 07 D; Exhibit 9.28; Exhibit 9.135; the text of Part 09 section M under 06 F.

Limits. An adjustment share sets an actual figure against a pro forma one by construction. The margin gap sets four owned months against a full year, and Wellness Clinic Franchisor is a wellness clinic context operator: the gap is a diligence question, not a placement.

C-94 · Four single computed rows of the Evidence index

What was computed. Four figures cited by their own row ID that are computed from other figures rather than read: OP4-0134, Operator 4's levered free cash flow before growth spending for FY2025, −$53.0m; COR-6152, Emergency Operator 2's labour hours per veterinarian in 2022, 2,753; MULTI-000024, Deal B's senior debt at the proposed close over Ares Credit Group's preliminary adjusted EBITDA, 4.10x; MULTI-000072, Deal C's lease-adjusted leverage (six times rent) over EBITDAR under Option One, 5.81x.

Sources. OP4-007, Operator 4 FY2025 financial statements; CO2-018, Emergency Operator 2 volume datapack (November 2023), Summary!T46 (COR-3987) and Summary!AL46 (COR-3996); DLB-001, Deal B early read, p.4; the Deal C financing documents behind Part 08 section D (DLC-012, p.3; DLC-005).

How. OP4-0134 = reported EBITDA (−$7.976m) − maintenance capex proxy ($6.167m) − increase in working capital ($2.753m) − cash tax (nil) − cash interest ($29.935m) − scheduled amortisation and finance-lease principal ($3.779m) = −$52.330m, on the bridge of note C-59. COR-6152 = total labour hours (1,122,448; COR-3987) ÷ average veterinarians (350.24; COR-3996) across the 19 business units with complete data. MULTI-000024 = the $51.7m term loan of the early read ÷ Ares Credit Group's preliminary adjusted EBITDA of $11.5m as printed, for the twelve months to July 2026; the source prints 4.09x, on its EBITDA before rounding. MULTI-000072 = (funded debt at close under Option One, including the $21m sponsor instrument, plus finance leases plus six times annual rent) ÷ (Ares Credit Group's underwriting EBITDA of $29.4m plus annual rent), the lease-adjusted step (LV5) of the common leverage ladder of note C-73.

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section K under 04 E (OP4-0134); Exhibit 9.11 (MULTI-000024, as an example of the long form); the text of Part 09 section O under 08 D (MULTI-000072); Exhibit 4.20 (COR-6152, an emergency and specialty context figure).

Limits. COR-6152 is pro forma: months before acquisition are included for units acquired within the year. MULTI-000024 is on the $51.7m term loan of the early read; the figure used for the proposed financing is 4.08x, the $55.3m term loan of the financing grid ÷ Ares Credit Group's EBITDA of $11.16m (DLB-9352; Part 08 section C). The rent input of MULTI-000072 has no row of its own in the Evidence index.

C-95 · Real household spending on veterinary care since 2005, with pets in households

What was computed. Real personal consumption expenditure on veterinarian services and the number of pets in U.S. households, each indexed to 2007 = 86, 2005 to 2025, with the fall and recovery over three spans: from 2007 to the following low (12.5%), in 2020 (6.6%) and from 2022 to the following low (7.7%).

Sources. Public series BEA_PCEVETSVC_A (BEA, NIPA table 2.1.3U line 171, real quantity index, annual, 2005 to 2025) and BEA_DVMRRX_A (the same spending in chained dollars, 2007 to 2025, shown as a memo); PETHH_M12 (pets in U.S. households, from an industry ownership survey, December observation of each year, 2005 to 2025); all retrieved on 28 September 2026 (Part 09 section E).

How. Each series is divided by its 2007 value and multiplied by 86. The fall over a span = value at the low ÷ value at the start − 1; a level is regained in the first year whose value is at or above the starting value. Spending is a real, price-adjusted quantity, not dollars; the BEA index is published with 2017 = 86 and rebased here.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.38; the text of Part 09 section J under 03 A.

Limits. 2007 was not the high: spending was higher in 2005 and 2006, and from the 2005 high the fall to 2009 was 15.1%. The series measures household spending at all providers, including emergency and specialty hospitals and retail pet clinics, not the operators' own volume.

C-96 · Veterinary prices against general prices and wages, 2019 to 2025

What was computed. Three indices, 2019 = 86, calendar-year averages 2019 to 2025: the consumer price of veterinarian services (+39.5% to 2025), all consumer prices (+22.3%) and veterinarian and veterinary technician wages (+25.4%).

Sources. Public series CUUR0000SS62053 and CUUR0000SA0 (BLS consumer price index for all urban consumers, US city average, not seasonally adjusted, monthly, January 2019 to December 2025); ECI_VETOCC (BLS employment cost index, wages and salaries, private industry, veterinarian and veterinary technician occupations, quarterly, 2019 to 2025); retrieved on 28 September 2026 (Part 09 section E).

How. For each series and calendar year, the arithmetic mean of the published observations (twelve months for the price series, four quarters for the wage series), divided by the 2019 mean and multiplied by 86, rounded to one decimal. October 2025 was not published for either price series, so their 2025 average is of eleven months.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.07; the text of Part 03 section B and of Part 09 section J under 03 B. Register A-11.

Limits. The veterinary price is a price paid by consumers across corporate groups, independents and emergency and specialty hospitals, not an operator's ticket. The wage index is a wage per hour for an occupation group across all private industries, not an operator's labour cost per patient invoice.

C-97 · Loss-making clinics by operator, each on its own definition

What was computed. For six operators, the number and share of clinics with negative clinic-level profit in each period available: Deal A FY23 to FY26 (27–32%; 391 of 1,107 clinics in FY23), and Operator 1, Operator 5, Operator 2, Operator 8 and Operator 3 between fiscal 2009 and 2025 (0% to 26%).

Sources. DLA-003, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file, FY23 to FY26 tabs (A3-P5-006 to A3-P5-009); OP1-021, Operator 1 clinic-level financials to December 2017; OP5-011, Operator 5 operating model of 20 July 2023 (clinic rows of the tabs FY20, FY21, FY22 and LTM23); OP2-021, Operator 2 clinic-level databook; OP8-012 and OP8-010, Operator 8 databooks; OP3-003, Operator 3 clinic-month datacube.

How. The share of loss-making clinics is taken from the clinic-margin distributions of note C-22 for each operator and period, on the definition before rebates where both exist. The count = share × clinics in the period, rounded to a whole clinic; the share shown = that count ÷ clinics × 86, to one decimal. The range for each operator is the lowest and highest share across its periods, and the point is its last period.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.55; the text of Part 03 section C and of Part 09 section J under 03 C. Register A-09.

Limits. The definitions differ and the rows are described, not ranked. Deal A's clinic profit charges operating-lease rent only, excludes finance-lease cost and is before vendor co-op, so its share would be higher on a full rent charge; Operator 1 and Operator 5 are on cash rent; Operator 2, Operator 8 and Operator 3 do not state the rent basis; Operator 3 is after rebates and on surviving clinics only. Deal A counts all clinics open at year-end; the others count clinics trading the full year. Operator 5 is pro forma.

C-98 · Depth of evidence by operator and area

What was computed. For 18 operators and the eight areas of the brief (126 cells), the number of figures recorded for this document on each basis: actual (A), pro forma (PF) and projected (P). Of the 126 cells, 107 hold more than five actual figures, 10 hold five or fewer, 4 hold pro forma or projected figures only and 4 are blank.

Sources. The figures recorded for this document, 59,863 in all, read from the documents Ares Credit Group supplied and from public filings (note C-01).

How. Each figure is assigned to an area by the family of its measure code, the part before the first underscore: volume; price and ticket; gross margin, gross profit and EBITDA; clinic-level four-wall and per-clinic measures; same-store sales; cash-flow lines, capex, working capital and conversion; transaction prices and multiples; leverage, debt, cover ratios and financing terms. Figures are counted by operator, area and basis. A cell shows its count of actual figures; where there is none, its count of pro forma or projected figures.

Where shown. Exhibit 1.09; the text of Part 01 section D and of Part 09 section I under 01 D.

Limits. The picture depends on the mapping rule. Families outside the eight (revenue, clinic counts, rent, overhead, interest expense and interest cover) are not counted; counting interest cover as leverage would add actual leverage evidence for Operator 5, Operator 3 and Wellness Clinic Franchisor. A count is not by itself a usable series.

C-99 · The three deals against their peer ranges: traffic, clinic margin and cash EBITDA

What was computed. Three placements of the deals against the operators that share their definition. Comparable traffic: Deal A −3.9% (FY26) and Deal B −3.8% (twelve months to July 2026) against a peer range of −2.8% to −2.0%. Clinic margin: Deal B 10.7% at its 103 surviving clinics and 8.4% at the 46 clinics owned 21 months or more (twelve months to March 2026) against a peer range of 12.1% to 17.4% (2021–25), Deal C 22.3% against an indicative range of 18.7% to 18.7% (FY2025), and Deal A 5.4% to 7.9% (FY26) shown alone. Cash EBITDA as a share of adjusted EBITDA: Deal C 0.28 to 0.31, Deal B 0.34 to 0.43, against a median of 0.84 (range 0.24 to 0.83) across 11 peer platform-periods.

Sources. Traffic: DLA-0789; DLB-1518 (DLB-1523 as the check on closed clinics); OP3-0907; OP6-1896; OP8-2114; DLC-3100 (company measure); memo rows OP6-1952, DLB-1578, OP7-1023. Clinic margin: DLB-3177, DLB-3203; DLC-5013, DLC-5014, DLC-0421; DLA-0834, DLA-0857, DLA-0017, DLA-0763; peers OP8-0669, OP8-0813, OP8-1347, OP8-1395, OP8-1362, OP8-2762, OP8-1406, OP7-0286 to OP7-0384, OP5-1585, OP5-1586, OP5-2028, OP5-2029, OP5-2469, OP5-2470, OP5-2060 to OP5-2446, OP4-1507, OP6-0357 and the Operator 3 datacube. Cash EBITDA: DLC-4437, DLC-4426, DLC-4439, DLC-4430; DLB-6300, DLB-6302, DLB-5599; peer rows of note C-61.

How. Traffic: each value is the fact row on the common definition (visit count in clinics owned and open for 13 months), times 86; the peer range is the lowest and highest of the peers on surviving or comparable clinics in the periods used in the deal comparisons; Operator 8 (one year, 21 clinics) is shown beside the range. Clinic margin: a deal is placed only in the group whose definition it shares (after rebates on cash rent for Deal B, its company four-wall restated to cash rent; after rebates on mixed rent bases for Deal C); each range is the lowest and highest peer value in that group; Deal A's two points are clinic EBITDA on operating-lease rent only ÷ clinic-system sales, and after finance-lease cost at book ÷ reported sales. Cash EBITDA: Deal C = DLC-4437 ÷ DLC-4426 and DLC-4439 ÷ DLC-4430; Deal B = (DLB-6300 + DLB-6302) ÷ DLB-6300 and ÷ DLB-5599; the peer median is the median of the eleven unrounded shares of note C-61, with Operator 8 on its as-owned adjusted EBITDA (0.24).

Where shown. Exhibit 1.11, Exhibit 1.12 and Exhibit 1.13; the text of Part 01 section E.

Limits. Periods differ by operator. Deal A, Operator 3 and Operator 6 traffic is on surviving clinics, which flatters the reading. Deal C has no site-level visit counts on the common definition, so it has no traffic placement. Deal B's margins are pro forma and on surviving clinics, against all clinics at the peers; before rebates its general practice and preventive clinics cannot be placed, because clinic rebates are given only for all clinic classes, including the wellness clinics. Deal C's margin range is indicative: the peers' rent bases differ. Deal B's cash numerator is Ares Credit Group's own cash adjustment, a narrower deduction than the recurring-cost test used for the others. The 0.73 is a median of platform-periods from four operators, not of operators. Deal A has no cash EBITDA on this definition and is not placed.

C-100 · Deal B four-wall EBITDA by age of ownership, each cohort indexed to its first six months

What was computed. For each acquisition-year cohort of Deal B's general practice and preventive clinics, four-wall EBITDA in consecutive six-month blocks of ownership, indexed to the same clinics' first six owned months (= 86). The 27 clinics acquired in 2023 fell to 65 in owned months 7 to 12 and reached 107 by months 21 to 26; the 32 acquired in 2024 stood at 49 in months 13 to 18.

Sources. DLB-003, Deal B datapack (July 2026 refresh): tab '4-Wall EBITDA', monthly columns for January 2023 to July 2026 (clinic rows 10 to 107, columns G to AW; the columns further right are year-to-date and are not used); tab 'Clinic Level Information' (acquisition date of each clinic).

How. Owned month 1 is the calendar month after the month of closing, which equals the datapack's own first month of full financials for every clinic. For each clinic, four-wall EBITDA is summed over six-month blocks from owned month 1. For each cohort and block, the block total is summed over the clinics that have the whole block inside January 2023 to July 2026, and divided by the same clinics' total for months 1 to 6, times 86. The 2023 cohort's block totals are $1.878m, $1.411m, $1.483m, $2.231m and $2.251m.

Where shown. Exhibit 6.05; the text of Part 06 section B.

Limits. Surviving clinics only: closed clinics are not in the datapack, which flatters every curve. Later blocks rest on fewer clinics, those acquired earliest. Odd-numbered blocks fall in the same half of the year as months 1 to 6 and even-numbered blocks in the other half, so seasonality moves alternate points. Clinics whose first owned month falls before January 2023 are not observed from the start of ownership and do not enter the curves. A calendar view of the 32 clinics acquired in 2024 shows a smaller fall: January to July 2026 four-wall EBITDA is 15.1% below January to July 2025.

C-101 · Deal B loss-making clinics by acquisition cohort

What was computed. The number and share of Deal B's 103 surviving general practice and preventive clinics with negative four-wall EBITDA over the twelve months to July 2026, by acquisition cohort: 6 of 18 acquired in 2021–22, 3 of 26 acquired in 2025–26, 21 of 103 in all (17.8%) and 16 of 54 among clinics owned 21 months or more.

Sources. DLB-003, Deal B datapack (July 2026 refresh), tabs '4-Wall EBITDA' (clinic rows 10 to 107, columns ST-16 to AW, August 2025 to July 2026) and 'Clinic Level Information'. Totals: DLB-3558, DLB-3559, DLB-3572, DLB-3573.

How. For each clinic, four-wall EBITDA is summed over August 2025 to July 2026, counting only the months it was owned; a clinic is loss-making when the sum is below zero. Cohort = calendar year of the acquisition date, with 2021 and 2022 grouped and 2025 and 2026 grouped. Share = loss-making clinics ÷ clinics in the cohort. The all-clinic total (21 of 103) and the count for clinics owned 21 months or more (16 of 54) reproduce DLB-3558 and DLB-3572.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.131; the text of Part 09 section M under 06 B.

Limits. 19 of the 26 clinics acquired in 2025–26 have fewer than twelve owned months in the window; all 3 of that group's loss-making clinics are among them, and none of the 11 clinics with the full window lost money. Surviving clinics only. Four-wall EBITDA is the company's definition, on book rent.

C-102 · Deal B markets and margins by acquisition cohort, from the company's attribute file

What was computed. Medians of the company's trade-area measures (household income and households) for the clinics acquired before 2025 and in 2025–26, the share of clinics meeting each of the company's positive-attribute thresholds, and four-wall margin by number of positive attributes. The 2025–26 clinics have a median household income of $63,374 against $47,928, with fewer households; clinics with three positive attributes earned a 19.5% margin against 4.8% for clinics with none or one (year to August 2026).

Sources. DLB-028, Ares Credit Group diligence requests response workbook (25 September 2026), tabs 'S1. Positive Attribution' (one row per clinic, rows 7 to 109: cohort, households, household income and pharmacy share), '1. Attributes - Acq. & Pipeline' (count of positive attributes per clinic, column H), 'S1. Revenue' and 'S1. 4-Wall EBITDA'; summary rows DLB-8111, DLB-8114, DLB-8115, DLB-8118, DLB-8595, DLB-8599, DLB-8603, DLB-8607, DLB-8611, DLB-8627, DLB-8631, DLB-8635.

How. Clinics are grouped by the acquisition year in each attribute row (103 clinics: 77 before 2025, 26 in 2025–26). Medians are taken across the clinics of each group; the two income medians reproduce DLB-8114 and DLB-8118, and the household medians (29,060 and 22,466) and the shares with pharmacy mix below 13% (46% and 79%) reproduce the company's summary. Margins by number of positive attributes are computed from the company's monthly revenue and four-wall EBITDA, as sums across the clinics owned throughout the window (DLB-8595 to DLB-8635).

Where shown. Exhibit 6.07; the text of Part 06 section C.

Limits. The company does not state the source of its demographics or its trade-area definition, and nine of the thirty newer-clinic attributes are estimates or duplicated trade-area data. Only 17 of the 26 clinics acquired in 2025–26 are in the 92-clinic margin panel. August 2026 is a preliminary month. The public census measures for the same clinics are in note C-PUB-5 and are on a different basis.

C-103 · Deal B adjustments and cash conversion against peers

What was computed. Deal B's adjustment share, (top adjusted EBITDA − reported EBITDA) ÷ top adjusted EBITDA, for FY2025 (0.99 to 1.13) and the twelve months to July 2026 (0.76 to 0.78, or 0.90 to 0.87 without $1.38m of gains on asset sales), and its cash conversion, (EBITDA − maintenance

capex) ÷ EBITDA, beside the same measures for Operator 3, Operator 2, Operator 6, Operator 8 and Operator 4.

Sources. DLB-3866, DLB-3901, DLB-3900 (quality-of-earnings workbook, twelve months to March 2026); DLB-5250, DLB-5644, DLB-5645, DLB-5598, DLB-5599 (financing model, July 2026 refresh); DLB-6300 (Ares Credit Group's variant of the financing model, 12 September 2026); DLB-9108. Peers: OP3-1127, OP3-2159, OP3-2160, OP3-2161; OP2-4347, OP2-4367; OP6-0047, OP6-0054, OP6-0060, OP6-0591, OP6-0592, OP6-0593; OP8-1781, OP8-2409, OP8-2426; OP4-0269, OP4-1035.

How. Deal B's ratios are computed from the rows cited, on each top adjusted EBITDA the sources give (the range covers the different tops); reported EBITDA is for owned months with gains on asset sales left in, and is shown again without them. Peer adjustment shares and conversion ranges are those of notes C-61 and C-60. Deal B's FY2025 conversion of 0.52 is the figure of note C-60.

Where shown. Exhibit 6.10; the text of Part 06 section D.

Limits. Every ratio is pro forma or adjusted: its numerator is an adjusted EBITDA, and the top rung differs by operator. Operator 6's share is 0.61 on its adjusted EBITDA of $16.5m rather than the pro forma $15.0m. Operator 8's reported EBITDA differs between two source documents (0.54 on the other). Maintenance capex is each company's own split, and conversion peers are the two operators with such a split on a pro forma rung.

C-104 · Deal B corporate overhead per general practice and preventive clinic, history and plan

What was computed. Corporate overhead of the general practice and preventive business per clinic at period end and as a share of its revenue, for FY2023 to FY2025 and the twelve months to March 2026 (actual) and for the borrower's plan from the twelve months to September 2026 to FY2028, with Deal B Wellness Clinics removed: $124.9k per clinic in FY2023, $96.0k in FY2024, $134.9k in FY2025 and $137.1k for the twelve months to March 2026; in the plan $152.2k for the twelve months to September 2026, $123.1k in FY2026, $108.9k in FY2027 and $112.0k in FY2028. Overhead falls from 13.2%, 8.4%, 9.2% and 9.2% of revenue in the actual periods to 8.8%, 7.9%, 5.9% and 5.9% in the plan.

Sources. DLB-008, Deal B financing model (July 2026 refresh): consolidated income statement, total corporate overhead (DLB-5004..5011), clinics at period end (DLB-4932..4939) and revenue (DLB-4940..4947); DBW segment, clinics (DLB-5939..5946, 38 in every model year) and revenue (DLB-5947..5952); DBW corporate overhead (DLB-6063..6068). Other operators: Deal A FY2026 corporate overhead (DLA-1223) and clinic count at year end (983, Form 10-K); Operator 7 ST-22 corporate operating expense for the twelve months to May 2026 (OP7-0803) and its 10 clinics.

How. Overhead per clinic = (total corporate overhead − DBW corporate overhead) ÷ (clinics at period end − 38); overhead share = (total corporate overhead − DBW corporate overhead) ÷ (revenue − DBW revenue), for each period. For example, for the twelve months to March 2026: ($17.28m − $0.53m) ÷ (142 − 38) = $137.1k, and $16.06m ÷ ($162.6m − $10.2m) = 9.2%. Between the twelve months to March 2026 and FY2028 the plan takes the business from 103 to 136 clinics (1.15x) and its revenue 1.57x on 0.93x overhead, about $38k of overhead for each added clinic. Other operators' latest overhead per clinic, on their own definitions: Deal A $55.0m ÷ 983 = $51.0k (FY2026) and Operator 7 ST-22 $1.67m ÷ 10 = $174.3k (twelve months to May 2026); the two are shown as a band, not ranked.

Where shown. Exhibit 6.12; the text of Part 06 section E.

Limits. Overhead and revenue are for owned months while clinics are counted at the period end. The model's consolidated clinic count includes DBW's 38 clinics in every year, including FY2023 and FY2024 before they were bought; they are removed here, with DBW's revenue and its own corporate overhead ($0.5m for the four owned months to March 2026; $2.8–3.6m a year in the plan); DBW is read in Part 06 section F. From FY2026 the plan includes acquisitions not yet closed, and the twelve months to September 2026 overlap FY2026. Other operators' overhead is on their own definitions.

C-105 · Deal B consolidated cash, April to August 2026

What was computed. A bridge from Deal B's consolidated adjusted cash EBITDA for April to August 2026 ($7.98m) to adjusted levered free cash flow (−$1.15m), and to −$3.31m after $2.19m of operations EBITDA adjustments.

Sources. DLB-028, Ares Credit Group diligence requests response workbook (25 September 2026), tab '5. EBITDA to FCF Analysis': DLB-7850, DLB-7851, DLB-7853 to DLB-7861, DLB-7863; monthly readings DLB-7821, DLB-7823, DLB-7827.

How. Each line is the sum of the five monthly values in the company's schedule. Working capital is the sum of four lines; debt service is cash interest on seller notes and other debt plus the other debt service on the existing debt. Each subtotal is checked against the running sum of the lines above it.

Where shown. Exhibit 8.08; the text of Part 08 section C.

Limits. Company figures; the subtotals are the company's adjusted measures on cash rent. August 2026 is a preliminary month. The total depends on the window: adjusted levered free cash flow was −$3.98m in April alone and +$2.48m in August. Debt service is before the proposed financing.

C-106 · Deal C clinics by margin band

What was computed. Deal C's 86 clinics grouped by clinic EBITDA margin for the twelve months to July 2026: 38 clinics above 21% produce $28.0m of the $43.6m of clinic EBITDA, and the 20 clinics below 13% produce $1.9m.

Sources. Ares Credit Group internal diligence exhibits (September 2026), unit margin analysis drawn from the Deal C site-level database: rows DLC-4137 to DLC-4164 (clinics, revenue, clinic EBITDA and margin by band); DLC-3738; DLC-0832.

How. The clinics, revenue and clinic EBITDA of each band are the rows cited, converted from $ thousands to $ millions. The group below 13% sums three bands: 10 + 6 + 4 = 20 clinics, and $1.6m + $0.3m − $0.1m = $1.9m.

Where shown. Exhibit 7.03; the text of Part 07 section B.

Limits. Pro forma: the site database includes seller months for clinics acquired between August 2025 and July 2026. Margin is after vendor rebates, on book rent, before corporate cost. Surviving clinics only. The company counts three loss-making clinics for the twelve months to June 2026; the site database gives four for the twelve months to July 2026.

Notes on the Deal A and Deal B financing observations

Notes C-FIN-1 to C-FIN-5 record the figures computed for the observations on the proposed financings: for Deal A on the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) and Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24, set out in Part 09 section O under 08 A and 08 B (C-FIN-1 to C-FIN-4), and for Deal B in Part 08 section C (C-FIN-5); the Deal A figures on the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026 in Part 08 section B are notes C-V2-4 and C-V2-5. Notes C-FIN-6 and C-FIN-7 record the figures behind the illustrative cases in Part 09 section O under 08 F. The Deal A notes rest on Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) and the company's clinic-closure file; the Deal B note rests on the financing models and the proposed financing grid supplied for Deal B. Each cites the cell or page.

C-FIN-1 · Deal A monthly liquidity path

What was computed. Month-end cash, debt and liquidity for October 2026 to September 2030 under the facilities of the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026), and the quarter-average liquidity tested against the $21.5m minimum. Lead case: minimum $36.6m, in the March 2028 quarter; leverage ratio peak 4.53x (March 2027 quarter); ratio pro forma for the March 2027 delayed-draw loan 4.60x against the 5.15x test; the eight published cases are those of Exhibit 9.155.

Sources. Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT rows 13, 15, 19 to 20, 23, 24, 28, 38, 103 and 152, and C39; 'FY27 CF - Monthly'!O26, S26 and 'FY28 CF Qtrly'!D26:G26 (disposal proceeds); 'FY27-FY31 Covenants' rows 16 and 18; the finance-lease current portion from the three balance-sheet tabs. LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026): Credit Facilities, Use of Proceeds, Interest, Fees, Prepayments, Conditions Precedent (d), Financial Covenants. Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J33, J43. Deal A Q1 FY27 Form 10-Q (letters of credit, $25.5m).

How. Each period's flows are spread evenly by month. Opening position: closing cash $87.7m, term loan $111m, revolver $44m drawn and deemed drawn. The delayed-draw loan is drawn as each supplier-finance payment falls due, subject to the 5.15x test on the last quarter-end, until $111m. Revolver loans are capped at $67m while any of the delayed-draw commitment remains in the first 15 months; the revolver is drawn to hold $13m of cash and repaid from surplus. Interest accrues on opening balances at SOFR plus 5.55% and 3.38%, with the unused, letter-of-credit and delayed-draw fees; amortisation is 1% a year; 67% of each fiscal year's cash flow after debt service and supplier-finance payments is swept the following June. Liquidity = cash + revolver availability after letters of credit and the cap. The quarter average interpolates daily between month-ends. Lead case: closure cash of $21.79m spread over 42.1 months from April 2027, and $4.3m of fees. Register A-F1 to A-F8.

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section O under 08 A and 08 B, and the like-for-like comparison in Part 08 section B; Exhibit 9.155; Exhibit 9.156; Exhibit 9.157; the text of Part 09 section O under 08 F and Exhibit 9.169.

Limits. Ares Credit Group's model gives quarters and years only, so the path within a quarter is an even spread and no file holds the daily path; a monthly model cannot certify a test set on each business day, and the results indicate direction and order of magnitude.

C-FIN-2 · Earnings shortfall at which a covenant is first breached

What was computed. The smallest uniform reduction of EBITDA, in every period, at which any quarter-average liquidity falls below $21.5m or the quarter-end leverage ratio exceeds its maximum. Liquidity: 6.6% in the lead case, first breached in the June 2029 quarter; 9.0% on Ares Credit Group's closure figure; 2.9% and 2.0% if the delayed-draw loan is drawn only when cash is short. Leverage: 46%.

Sources. The path of note C-FIN-1.

How. The shortfall is raised in steps of 0.25 points to the first breach and then bisected. The leverage ratio is (term loans + revolver loans, at least $44m + all finance leases + 6 × twelve-month operating lease expense − unrestricted cash, capped at $34m from September 2028) ÷ (twelve-month EBITDA + twelve-month operating lease expense + the run-rate closure add-back within the 26% cap of the LW draft term sheet until December 2028).

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section O under 08 A, 08 B and 08 E; Exhibit 9.155; Exhibit 9.168; the text of Part 09 section O under 08 F.

Limits. A uniform shortfall in every period is a parameter, not an observation. The limits of note C-FIN-1 apply.

C-FIN-3 · Deal A refinancing need and capacity at September 2030

What was computed. The amount to refinance at September 2030 and the cash flow available for debt service over the twelve months to that date, in a base case and a downside, with the capacity of a new lender on a leverage test and a cover test. Base: need $253.0m, cash flow available for debt service $42.4m. Downside: need $336.7m, cash flow $21.6m, EBITDA $93.3m.

Sources. The path of note C-FIN-1: the lead case (base) and the case with EBITDA 9% lower in every period and no closure benefit (downside). Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!K44, L44 (finance leases at maturity) and L118 (SOFR, 3.57%). Anchors against which capacity is read: multiples of closed first-lien financings (OP6-0031, 3.81x; OP1-7357, 4.27x; P5-S001, 5.97x; median about 4.3x (4.44x) across the eight closed gross prints at three platforms, used as the 4.27x anchor) and spreads over SOFR (OP2-4336, S+383; OP7-1164, S+422; DLA-5593, S+528; A8-S012, S+534).

How. Need = term loans + revolver loans − (cash − $13m) at September 2030. Cash flow available for debt service = EBITDA and closure benefit less capex, closure cash, finance-lease principal and interest and taxes, plus working capital, over the twelve months to September 2030. Leverage leg = (multiple × EBITDA − $112.2m of finance leases at maturity, from MODEL OUTPUT!K44 and L44 and the current portion) × 0.85. Cover leg = cash flow available for debt service ÷ (cover × (SOFR 4.10% + spread)) × 0.85. The factor 0.85 allows for 2% of fees. Register A-F9 and A-F10.

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section O under 08 A and 08 B; Exhibit 9.158; Exhibit 9.159.

Limits. The downside is a parameter, not an observation; Deal A's own annual declines have been larger (Exhibit 9.168). The anchors were struck on other platforms' financing EBITDA, and EBITDA is held flat to maturity, so capacity is a sensitivity on stated anchors, not a forecast.

C-FIN-4 · Deal A second-round closure cost by component and by year

What was computed. The composition of the company's $31.00m of second-round closure cost and its timing, and the base rent that is separate from it. Cash closing costs are $21.79m (CAM 3.991, utilities 6.383, real-estate taxes 8.260, local taxes 0.299, deferred maintenance 3.687) and finance-lease interest $9.63m. Base rent to the end of the average remaining term is about $51m.

Sources. Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J37:J47, J31, J32, J33, F31, F32:G33, B49; Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!F20:I20, F21, D22, D30, D171, J7; 'FY27 CF - Monthly'!E31.

How. Cash closing costs $21.788m ÷ 42.1 months = $0.448m a month from April 2027, an even spread that is our assumption: $5.36m in each of FY28 to FY31 and $0.68m after. The finance-lease interest of $9.63m is on leases that, on our reading, remain in the lease lines of Ares Credit Group's model (rows 22, 38 and 152): the model's sales (J7) and lease lines are the company's plan before the closures, and the uplift is a separate line (F15). Base rent to the end of the average term = $12.851m × 42.1 ÷ 12 = $51.7m, or $53.4m computed by lease type ($5.511m × 36.66 ÷ 12 = $19.9m operating; $6.851m × 50.75 ÷ 12 = $32.8m finance). Register A-F2.

Where shown. The text of Part 05 section D and Part 08 section B; Exhibit 5.10; Exhibit 9.117; the Deal A information requests in Part 05 section G.

Limits. The workbook holds no clinic-by-clinic schedule, so the timing is an even spread over the average remaining term. The workbook's lease-liability present value is higher than the base-rent sum, $65.0m (J31; $21.9m operating, F31), which the file does not explain; lease terms that include renewal periods would do it. The two are different measures.

C-FIN-5 · Deal B near-term acquisition batch: residual shortfall

What was computed. The delayed-draw need of the 23-unit acquisition batch less the committed sources: $8.8m and $11.8m.

Sources. DLB-6069..6077 (need net of sale-leaseback proceeds, $47.93m); DLB-026 (delayed-draw loan $26m; revolver $11.1m); DLB-6351 (cash in Ares Credit Group's model, $5.03m); DLB-5662 (cash in the borrower's model, $2.46m).

How. 47.93 − 25.9 − 11.1 − (cash − $4.3m liquidity floor), on each model's cash, on unrounded inputs: 47.93 − 36.7 − 0.72 = $9.09m on Ares Credit Group's model and 47.93 − 36.7 + 1.91 = $11.87m on the borrower's.

Where shown. The text of Part 08 section C; Exhibit 8.09.

Limits. The two results differ only in the cash each model holds at close.

C-FIN-6 · The illustrative base case with finance-lease interest charged

What was computed. The $44m minimum liquidity of the illustrative base case in Part 09 section O under 08 F less the finance-lease interest that case does not charge: about $35m.

Sources. Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!D22:H22 (2.014 + 1.946 + 1.879 + 1.795 + 1.750 = $9.2m to December 2027).

How. 44.0 − 9.2 = $34.6m.

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section O under 08 F.

Limits. The illustrative cases in Part 09 section O under 08 F come from a quarterly model that does not charge finance-lease interest to cash; this adjustment applies to the minimum liquidity only, and the cases' other outputs do not charge the interest.

C-FIN-7 · The illustrative quarterly cases on the LW draft term sheet

What was computed. The figures that the term-sheet observations in Part 09 section O under 08 F describe as "our illustrative cases": quarterly paths of cash, debt, Liquidity, the leverage ratio and an LTM cover ratio under the facilities and covenants of the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026), from a September 2026 closing balance sheet, on four operating cases (management, Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24, a CreditSwan base and a downside) and the variants named in Exhibit 9.169. Among them: a leverage-ratio peak of 5.45x and a minimum Liquidity of $44m in the base case; the March 2027 delayed-draw test passed at 4.76x in the base case; Liquidity averaging $13.2m in the September 2027 quarter in the Ares Credit Group model v24 case as Ares Credit Group's model draws the delayed-draw loan ($86m, revolver cap kept on), and $50m with $111m drawn; and a minimum LTM cover ratio of 0.986x in the base case; 0.72x is a reference point for how early cover declines, not a proposed level.

Sources. Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24 (operating cases, capital expenditure, working capital and the finance-lease cash line as the model has it); LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026): Credit Facilities, Interest, Fees, Conditions Precedent (d), Revolving Credit Facility (iii), Financial Covenants; Deal A FY26 Form 10-K and Q1 FY27 Form 10-Q (EBITDA and disposal gains, supplier-finance balances, $25.5m of letters of credit).

How. Each case is stepped quarter by quarter from the closing balance sheet. The leverage ratio is read on the EBITDAR reading of the term sheet's definition; the LTM cover ratio = (Consolidated EBITDA − capex) ÷ (cash interest + scheduled amortisation + finance-lease payments + cash taxes); $25.5m of letters of credit sit under the revolver; the delayed-draw condition is tested at each draw on trailing EBITDA against 5.15x, as in note C-FIN-1; Liquidity = cash + revolver availability after letters of credit and the $67m cap. The finance-lease cash line is taken as Ares Credit Group's model has it, so the finance-lease interest component is not charged to cash. The downside cases change one or more operating inputs at a time, as each observation states.

Where shown. The text of Part 09 section O under 08 F; Exhibit 9.169.

Limits. The cases are illustrations, not forecasts; the downside cases are parameters, not observations. Because they do not charge finance-lease interest to cash, they overstate Liquidity (by about $9.2m to December 2027 in the base case, note C-FIN-6). The quarterly steps cannot certify a test set on each business day. Where a figure appears both here and in the monthly model of note C-FIN-1, the monthly model governs.

Notes on public signals

Notes C-PUB-1 to C-PUB-16 record the figures computed from public sources: clinic lists, census tables, public filings and statistical series. Public sources are named by their ID (PUB-101 onwards), which resolves in Part 09 section E, and a figure read or computed from them by its row ID (PUB-0001 onwards), which resolves in Part 09 section F. The conventions they follow are register rows A-P1 to A-P9 (Part 09 section A).

C-PUB-1 · Trade-area measures around each clinic

What was computed. For every clinic on the public clinic lists of Deal A, Deal B and Deal C, the population, the households and the median household income of the area within three miles and within five miles. Across the clinics of each operator: the median and the 25th and 75th percentiles of three-mile income, the number and share of clinics whose three-mile income is below the US median household income, and the median number of households within three miles. The results are these. Deal A: 924 clinics listed, 924 with coordinates, 938 with a three-mile income; median $69.6k ($66,115), quartiles $56.7k and $85.2k; 501 of 938 below the US median (46.6%); median households 17,390, taken over the 938 clinics with a trade-area income and shown as about 18,299. Deal B: 96 listed, 96 with coordinates, 95 with a three-mile income; median $60.7k ($61,772), quartiles

$51.4k and $67.5k; 72 of 95 below the US median (67.4%, shown as 68% in Part 09 section M under 06 C); median households 11,812, shown as about 11,319. Deal C: 72 listed, 69 with coordinates, 68 with a three-mile income; median $84.0k ($81,075), quartiles $68.5k and $100.2k; 20 of 68 below the US median (24.8%); median households 19,181, shown as about 18,906. By Deal C brand: Operator 11 $76.3k (23 clinics, quartiles $58.4k and $92.5k, 10 below the US median); Operator 17 region $92.0k (23; $73.3k and $110.8k; 5 below); Operator 15 $94.6k (15; $78.2k and $112.0k; 1 below); Sponsor 3 $66.6k (7; $50.9k and $71.5k; 5 below); Operator 13 has two clinics ($62.2k and $81.7k) and is not shown as a brand. Deal B by date of first public listing: $60.9k across 71 clinics first listed before 2025, $64.9k across 25 first listed in 2025–26. The same measures on Deal B's own acquisition cohorts are in C-PUB-5.

Wellness clinic context, shown only in Part 09 section M under 06 F: the same measures for the public clinic list of Deal B Wellness Clinics, a wellness clinic business, are 38 listed, 38 with coordinates, 38 with a three-mile income; median $65.4k, quartiles $59.8k and $84.0k; median households 23,429, quartiles 15,245 and 40,379.

Sources. Clinic lists, each read on 30 September 2026: Deal A's public clinic list of company-operated clinics, 924 clinics across 13 banners (PUB-266); the 96 location pages of Deal B's site (PUB-161, PUB-265); the location pages of the Deal C brands, 72 clinics (Operator 11 24, Operator 17 region 23, Operator 15 18, Sponsor 3 7, Operator 13 2), the Operator 15 pages taken from 2026 archived copies (PUB-178). For the wellness clinic context, the 38 location pages of Deal B Wellness Clinics's site (PUB-173), read on the same day. US Census Bureau, American Community Survey 2020–2024 five-year estimates, tract tables B01003 (population) and B19001 (households by income bracket) (PUB-162, PUB-179); US Census Bureau, 2024 Gazetteer tract file, for the internal point of each tract (PUB-163). US Census Bureau QuickFacts for the US median household income, $71,197, 2020–2024, in 2024 dollars, read on 30 September 2026 (PUB-141).

How. The definitions below are fixed for this note and for C-PUB-2, C-PUB-3, C-PUB-5 and C-PUB-6.

1. Coordinates. Each clinic is placed at the Census Bureau geocoder's result for its posted address; where the geocoder returned none, the coordinates shown on the company's own page are used (Deal A: 866 and 76 clinics; Deal C: 69 and 1 clinics). Two Deal C clinics (Operator 15 at Hooksett, State 02, and North Grafton, State 11) have no coordinates from either.
2. Trade area. A census tract belongs to a clinic's trade area when the tract's internal point lies within 2.6 miles of the clinic (4.3 miles for the five-mile measures). Distance is great-circle (haversine), with an earth radius of 3,471.07 miles; a tract at exactly the radius is in.
3. Population is the sum of B01003 over those tracts; households the sum of the B19001 total. Fourteen Gazetteer tracts have no survey row and count as zero.
4. Median household income. The household counts in the sixteen income brackets of B19001 are pooled over the tracts of the trade area, and the median is found by linear interpolation inside the bracket that holds the middle household. It is an interpolated figure, not a published median.
5. Exclusions. A clinic with no coordinates, or with no tract internal point within the radius, has no trade-area figure and is left out of the statistics; it is counted here. No coordinates: Deal C 2. No tract within three miles: Deal A 3 (one each in State 16, State 02 and State 15), Deal B 2 (City 33 and City 31, State 19), Deal C 3 (Northwood, State 02; Crosslake and City 1, State 30). One further Deal A clinic has one tract and no households in it, so it has no income figure. Three Deal A clinics whose pooled median falls in the open bracket of $173,450 and over are carried at $173,450. That leaves 938, 95 and 68 clinics. All 38 Deal B Wellness Clinics clinics have a figure.
6. Group statistics are the median and the 25th and 75th percentiles across clinics with a figure, with linear interpolation between ranks. The share below the US median is the number of clinics with a three-mile income under $71,197 divided by the number of clinics with a three-mile income. Median households are taken over the same clinics.

Where shown. Part 04 section H, Exhibit 4.21 and Exhibit 4.24; Part 09 section M under 06 C (all listed Deal B clinics and the first-listing split); Part 09 section M under 06 F and Exhibit 9.139; Part 09 section N under 07 B and Exhibit 9.144.

Limits. The lists are the public lists of one day and are smaller than the company records: Deal A 924 clinics against 983 in its filing; Deal B 96 pages against 103 clinics; Deal C 72 clinics against 88 at June 2026 and 86 at July 2026, with three State 20 clinics (two Operator 13, one under Operator 11) against 16 Operator 13 clinics at August 2026. The Deal C figures therefore describe the State 39, State 30, a home region and State 42–State 48 clinics. Brand counts on the Deal C list differ from the supplied documents, the Operator 15 list rests on archived pages, and two Sponsor 3 rows share one address in City 17. A tract is in or out by its internal point, so a three-mile circle in a rural area holds few tracts and the figure is coarse; for the City 1, State 30 and City 31, State 19 clinics the absence of any tract suggests the coordinates rather than the place. The income is that of residents near the clinic, from a five-year survey with sampling error; it is not the income of the clinic's customers. The US reference is a national household median, not a median of trade areas. A fixed circle is not the company's own trade-area definition. Deal B Wellness Clinics is a wellness clinic business and is not set beside the general practice and preventive operators; its list agrees with the agency documents on the count and the eight states and is not matched clinic by clinic.

C-PUB-2 · A Operator 1-banner clinic nearby

What was computed. The number and share of each operator's clinics whose nearest Operator 1-banner clinic is within three miles, and within five miles. Deal A: 388 of 924 within three miles (35.5%) and 504 within five (46.8%). Deal B: 44 of 96 (38.8%) and 61 (51.4%). Deal C: 5 of 69 clinics with

coordinates (5.6%) at either distance. For Deal A the three-mile share is also given by banner, Deal A Banner 1 152 of 266 (48.6%), Deal A Banner 2 123 of 266 (42.1%) and Deal A 107 of 252 (37.8%), and by state for the eleven states with at least 26 Deal A clinics: State 20 69 of 89 (69.2%), State 01 86 of 116 (63.6%), State 03 24 of 34 (63.9%), State 18 34 of 54 (53.8%), State 16 32 of 58 (50.9%), State 12 50 of 90 (46.6%), State 05 21 of 46 (37.8%), State 25 28 of 90 (26.0%), State 11 7 of 27 (20.1%), State 13 1 of 28 (2.7%) and State 46 0 of 84 (0.0%). Those eleven states hold 708 of the 924 clinics. The five Deal C clinics are Plaistow, State 02 (1.9 miles), City 23, State 11 (1.4), City 27 (2.0), City 26 (0.5) and City 24 (1.4), State 20; three of the five are the three State 20 clinics on the list.

Wellness clinic context, shown only in Part 09 section M under 06 F: 2 of the 38 Deal B Wellness Clinics clinics (3.9%, shown as 3%) have an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles.

Sources. The four clinic lists of C-PUB-1, with the same coordinates. Operator 1's own clinic pages, as listed on its site on 30 September 2026: 1,392 Operator 1-banner clinics, of which 1,394 have coordinates and are used (PUB-142, PUB-180).

How. The definitions of C-PUB-1 apply: the same coordinates, great-circle distance and earth radius. The distance from each clinic to every Operator 1-banner clinic is computed; a clinic is counted when the smallest distance is 2.6 miles or less (4.3 miles or less for the five-mile share). The share is the clinics counted divided by the clinics with coordinates on the list, or in the state or banner as Deal A's list labels them. The two Deal C clinics without coordinates are left out, which is why its base is 69. Operator 1 is mapped for its own banner only; the one Operator 1 row without coordinates is dropped.

Where shown. Part 04 section H, Exhibit 4.22 and Exhibit 4.24; Part 09 section L under 05 B and Exhibit 9.112; Part 09 section M under 06 C; Part 09 section M under 06 F and Exhibit 9.139; Part 09 section N under 07 B.

Limits. Other banners under the same ownership are not mapped, so competition is understated where they trade. Distance is a straight line, not drive time. The clinic lists carry the coverage limits given in C-PUB-1: Deal C's State 20 clinics, in a state where Operator 1 trades, are almost entirely missing from its list, so its 5.6% understates the exposure of the whole company by an amount the list cannot measure (leaving State 20 out, 2 of 68 clinics, 2.3%). Deal A's list holds the clinics open on 30 September 2026; the 46 clinics in the company's clinic-level file that are not on it are 42 Deal A Banner 5, 2 Operator 19 and 1 Deal A Banner 2 clinic. Proximity is a fact about location; it is not evidence of lost sales.

C-PUB-3 · Footprint concentration by state and metro area

What was computed. Clinics by state and by metropolitan or micropolitan statistical area, as counts and as shares of each public list: the three largest states, the largest area, the five largest areas together and the number of areas with a clinic. Deal B (96): State 19 33 (28%), State 05 20 (15%), State 20 13 (9%); City 2 21 (18.1%); five largest areas 38 (32.7%); 42 areas. Deal C (72): State 39 23 (28%), State 30 21 (27%), State 02 13 (14%); City 3 18 (19.6%) and City 4–City 5 17, together 31 of 72 (36.6%); five largest areas 44 (54.7%); 21 areas. Deal A (924): State 01 116 (12%), State 25 90 (9%), State 12 90 (9%); City 7 34 (3.2%); five largest areas 154 (14.1%); 182 areas.

Wellness clinic context, shown only in Part 09 section M under 06 F: Deal B Wellness Clinics (38): State 46 19, State 26 11, State 29 5, State 48 4, State 28 3, State 42, State 27 and State 24 1 each; 17 areas, the five largest holding 23 clinics (City 15 10, City 19 5, City 20, City 16 and Milwaukee 4 each).

Sources. The four clinic lists of C-PUB-1, read on 30 September 2026. US Office of Management and Budget, delineation of core based statistical areas, July 2023 (PUB-202).

How. The state is the state in the posted address. The county is the county returned with the clinic's coordinates; the county is looked up in the delineation list to give the area. Clinics are counted by area, and shares are taken over all clinics on the list, including clinics outside any area and the two Deal C clinics without coordinates. A clinic outside any area is not counted as an area. The five-area figure is the sum of the five largest counts.

Where shown. Part 09 section K under 04 H and Exhibit 9.102; Exhibit 4.24; Part 09 section N under 07 B; Part 09 section M under 06 F and Exhibit 9.139.

Limits. The shares are of the public lists, not of the clinic counts in the company records. Deal C's State 20 clinics are largely missing from its list, so State 20 is understated and the five-area share is overstated to that extent; its two clinics without coordinates have no area. Areas are statistical areas of very different size, so a share of clinics in one area says nothing about the share of a market.

C-PUB-4 · Deal B customer-rating statistics

What was computed. From the ratings shown on Deal B's location pages: the number of pages with a rating (82 of 96), total reviews (49,539), the review-weighted mean rating (4.21; 4.098 unrounded), the median (4.1), the range (3.8 to 4.2), the number of pages at each rating (3.8: 2; 3.9: 2; 4.0: 1; 3.9: 14; 4.1: 26; 4.1: 33; 4.2: 10), the pages at 3.8 to 3.9 (19), and the fewest reviews behind any one rating (142). The unweighted mean is 4.06 and is

not used. The ratings are also split by the company's acquisition cohort: 76 rated pages are clinics acquired before 2025 (3.8: 2; 3.9: 2; 4.0: 1; 3.9: 14; 4.1: 24; 4.1: 26; 4.2: 9), and 8 are clinics acquired in 2025–26 (4.1: 2; 4.1: 5; 4.2: 1). All 19 pages at 3.8 to 3.9 are clinics acquired before 2025.

Sources. The 96 location pages of Deal B's site, read on 30 September 2026; each page may show a review-site rating to one decimal and "Based on N reviews" (PUB-161). The cohort of each clinic comes from the match described in C-PUB-5.

How. The rating and the review count are read from each page, and the 82 pages showing both are kept. The weighted mean is the sum of rating times reviews divided by the sum of reviews. The median, lowest and highest are taken over the 82 ratings; total reviews is the sum of the 82 counts. The band 3.8 to 3.9 includes both ends. For the cohort split, each rated page takes the cohort of the company clinic it is matched to: 84 of the 82 rated pages are matched. The two that are not (both 4.1, at one street address in City 10, State 19) fit one pre-2025 company clinic equally and are shown as not matched. Of the 21 matched 2025–26 clinics, 16 show no rating; the other two pages with no rating have no company clinic. Assigning one of the two City 10 pages to that clinic would give 77 rated pre-2025 clinics; the 19 and the 8 would not change.

Where shown. Part 09 section K under 04 H, Exhibit 9.100 and Exhibit 4.24; Part 09 section M under 06 B and Exhibit 9.132.

Limits. The values are those displayed on the company's own pages on one day; they were not read on the review site and are not a series through time. Eighteen pages show no rating, 16 of them 2025–26 clinics, so the newer cohort rests on eight clinics. A rating is set by the customers who chose to review and is a view of service, not a measure of clinic economics. No review text is used.

C-PUB-5 · Public market measures on Deal B's own cohorts: the join

What was computed. A match of each of the company's 103 clinics to one of its 96 public location pages, so that the public trade-area measures of C-PUB-1 and the ratings of C-PUB-4 can be read by the company's own acquisition cohort ("Pre-2025", 77 clinics; "2025-2026", 26 clinics). On the matched clinics, medians by cohort (earlier clinics first): three-mile household income $59,626 (72 clinics; quartiles $48,089 and $67,704) against $66,309 (20 clinics; $58,520 and $67,417), +8.1%; five-mile income $58,444 (72) against $70,570 (21), +16.1%; three-mile households 9,794 (72; quartiles 5,826 and 19,757) against 20,863 (20; 11,710 and 28,933), +96%; five-mile households 21,795 (72) against 41,797 (21), +76%. The company's own figures on the same matched clinics: household income $49,295 (76) against $61,557 (21), +25.5%; households 31,457 against 20,192, −32% (on all 103 clinics, $47,928 against $63,374 and 29,060 against 22,466, as the supplied documents give them). Clinic by clinic, the company's household count divided by the public count has a median of 2.54 at three miles (92 clinics; quartiles 1.95 and 2.80) and 0.97 at five miles (96 clinics; quartiles 0.78 and 1.28); by cohort, 2.30 (72) and 0.91 (20) at three miles, 1.08 (72) and 0.46 (21) at five. The rank correlation between the company's and the public household counts is 0.76 at three miles and 0.76 at five. The company's income is a median 0.76 of the public three-mile figure. Within the six states that hold matched clinics of both cohorts (State 20, State 19, State 27, State 05, State 06, State 23), the 2025–26 median is higher in three for three-mile income and in four for three-mile population, on one to four newer clinics per state.

Sources. Deal B's clinic attribution data (DLB-028), for the clinic identifier, cohort label, household count and household income of each clinic, and its clinic-level information (DLB-003), for name, town, state and acquisition date. The 96 location pages of Deal B's site, read on 30 September 2026 (PUB-161, PUB-265). The census sources of C-PUB-1 (PUB-162, PUB-163).

How. State names on the public pages are turned into postal codes, and towns are compared in lower case with full stops and apostrophes removed. The match rules are applied in this order.

1. Where a town and state hold exactly one company clinic and exactly one public page, the two are matched without a test on the name (62 clinics).
2. Where a town holds more than one clinic on either side, clinic names are compared word by word, with "Veterinary" read as "Vet". A match needs a score of at least 0.5 (shared words divided by the number of words in the shorter name), at least one shared word that is neither generic (vet, pharmacy, animal, hospital, clinic, pet, care) nor the town's name, and a single best candidate on each side (32 clinics). Two of the 32 are clinics whose town is misspelt on the public page by up to two letters and whose names are identical.
3. A company clinic that fits two public pages equally is left unmatched (1 clinic). The company files carry no street address, so no match rests on street, and no match is made by judgement.

Match rates: 93 of 103 company clinics (84.0%), being 76 of 77 acquired before 2025 and 21 of 26 acquired in 2025–26; 93 of 96 public pages (85.5%). The seven company clinics not matched are six Operator 24 clinics in the City 2 area, acquired in August 2025, which have no public page, and one City 10, State 19 clinic that fits two public pages at one address. The four public pages not matched are those two and two pages with no company clinic among the 103. The company's cohort label agrees with its acquisition date for all 103 clinics. For 90 of the 93 matched clinics the company cohort is the same as the cohort dated by first public listing; the four that differ were acquired on 17 December 2024 and first listed in 2025.

The public measures are those of C-PUB-1 at the matched page's coordinates. A matched clinic with no tract within the radius has no public income and no public household figure and is left out of both medians and of the ratios, the same rule as for income; the three-mile income and household medians therefore rest on 72 and 20 clinics, and the five-mile household medians on 72 and 21. A median of an even number of clinics that falls on a

half is shown at the nearer even unit (31,014.7 as 31,457; $63,267.8 as $63,374; $48,271.6 as $49,295). Medians and quartiles use linear interpolation between ranks; differences are the 2025–26 median less the earlier median, as a percentage of the earlier one. The clinics are the whole population, not a sample; the spread is given by the quartiles. Counting the no-tract clinics as zero households would give three-mile household medians of 10,061 (76 clinics) and 19,860 (21).

Where shown. Part 06 section C and Part 09 section M under 06 C, Exhibit 6.08 and Exhibit 6.09; Part 09 section M under 06 B and Exhibit 9.132 for the rating split.

Limits. The unmatched 2025–26 clinics are not a random set: they are one urban City 2 group, so the public measures for that cohort cover 21 of 26 clinics. A match rests on town, state and name; four single-town matches pair names that differ (for example "Auburn Veterinary" with "Auburn Pet Hospital"). The company's household and income figures are as supplied, with no stated source, radius or date; two pairs of clinics carry identical values and three State 25 clinics carry round household figures. The company's figures and the public measures are not on the same basis, and neither is a correction of the other. The trade-area limits of C-PUB-1 apply: two matched clinics hold no tract within three miles and seven hold one. The within-state comparison rests on one to four clinics in the smaller cohort of every state and is descriptive only.

C-PUB-6 · Deal A loss-making clinics against an Operator 1 nearby: the join

What was computed. Whether Deal A clinics with an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles were loss-making more or less often in fiscal 2026 than clinics without one. All 983 clinics: 112 of 399 with an Operator 1 nearby were loss-making (24.7%) against 218 of 574 without (33.0%), a difference of −7.4 points. By banner: Deal A Banner 1 42 of 152 (25.4%) against 27 of 107 (21.7%), +3.6 points; Deal A 26 of 107 (20.7%) against 52 of 149 (31.4%), −9.8; Deal A Banner 2 38 of 122 (28.2%) against 70 of 134 (44.5%), −17.3. Within the same state and banner the difference is +0.8 points, with a 82% interval of −4.6 to +6.0 points, over 28 groups holding 779 clinics (381 with, 391 without).

Sources. Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file FY23–FY26 (as of 28 March 2026), FY26 tab, for each clinic's year-to-date clinic-level EBITDA. Deal A clinic master (9 June 2026), for state, banner and ZIP code. Deal A's public clinic list (PUB-266) and Operator 1's clinic pages (PUB-142, PUB-180), read on 30 September 2026. US Census Bureau, 2024 Gazetteer, for the internal point of each ZIP code area.

How. The clinic base is every clinic row of the FY26 tab: 983 clinics, the tab's own total, with the sum of clinic EBITDA equal to the tab's total line. A clinic is loss-making when its year-to-date clinic-level EBITDA is below zero, which gives 324 of 983, the count used elsewhere in Part 05. (The file's "Profit (Loss)" line below zero gives 475; it is used only as a second definition below.)

Match rules and rates. Each clinic is located by its clinic number on the public list: 924 of 983 (83.5%), at the coordinates of C-PUB-1. The other 46 (4.1%; 42 Deal A Banner 5, 2 Operator 19, 1 Deal A Banner 2) are placed at the internal point of the ZIP code in the clinic master; all 46 ZIP codes are found. No clinic is left unlocated. Three of the 46 fall within three miles of an Operator 1. State and banner come from the clinic master; the state agrees with the public list for all 924 matched clinics. Two pairs of banner names are merged (Deal A Banner 5, 42 clinics; Deal A Banner 3, 44), and banners with fewer than 20 clinics are grouped as "Other" (11 banners, 42 clinics).

Proximity is measured as in C-PUB-2: a clinic has an Operator 1 nearby when its nearest Operator 1-banner clinic is 2.6 miles or less away. The share is loss-making clinics divided by clinics on each side; the difference is the share with an Operator 1 nearby less the share without.

The stratified comparison. Clinics are grouped by state and banner, which gives 55 groups. The 28 groups holding at least one clinic on each side are used; the within-group differences are combined as the Mantel-Haenszel common difference, each group weighted by clinics with times clinics without over clinics in the group. The interval is computed from the Greenland-Robins variance and is descriptive, the clinics being a whole population and not a sample. The 28 groups, with the number of clinics with and without an Operator 1 nearby, are: State 13 Deal A (1, 27); State 17 Deal A Banner 1 (1, 5); State 20 Other (4, 3); State 20 Deal A Banner 2 (67, 19); State 28 Deal A Banner 5 (2, 17); State 28 Deal A Banner 2 (2, 1); State 27 Pharmacy Barn (1, 18); State 34 Deal A Banner 2 (4, 7); State 11 Deal A (5, 18); State 11 Deal A Banner 3 (2, 6); State 16 Deal A Banner 1 (32, 23); State 26 Deal A (6, 9); State 32 Deal A Banner 2 (1, 10); State 05 Deal A Banner 1 (20, 23); State 05 Deal A Banner 2 (2, 3); State 02 Deal A (2, 7); State 02 Deal A Banner 3 (1, 17); State 03 Deal A (5, 4); State 03 Deal A Banner 1 (20, 7); State 01 Deal A (60, 28); State 01 Deal A Banner 1 (24, 3); State 25 Deal A (3, 15); State 25 Deal A Banner 1 (10, 23); State 25 Deal A Banner 2 (19, 28); State 12 Deal A (27, 30); State 12 Deal A Banner 1 (16, 12); State 12 Deal A Banner 2 (10, 3); State 10 Deal A (1, 8); State 06 Deal A Banner 2 (5, 4); State 18 Deal A Banner 1 (20, 14); State 18 Deal A Banner 2 (17, 11); Operator 22 (1, 5); State 09 Deal A (1, 4). In 13 of the 28 the loss-making share is higher with an Operator 1 nearby, in 19 lower and in 1 equal. The 208 clinics in the 26 one-sided groups (16 with, 196 without, of which 39.6% are loss-making) drop out of the stratified figure: they sit in states and banners where Operator 1 has no clinic nearby, such as State 46, State 24 and the Deal A Banner 5 states, and they account for the unadjusted gap. Grouping by state alone gives +1.0 points (18 groups, 760 clinics); grouping by banner alone gives −7.5 points.

Other bases, for comparison: at five miles, −8.3 points unadjusted and +1.0 within state and banner; leaving out the 46 clinics placed at a ZIP code, −6.3 and +1.4; on the "Profit (Loss)" definition, −7.4 and −0.5.

Where shown. Part 09 section L under 05 B and Exhibit 9.113.

Limits. This is a cross-section of one fiscal year and cannot show whether an Operator 1 opening changed a clinic's result. It covers the surviving estate only: 165 clinics that appear in the FY23 to FY25 tabs and not in FY26 have no address in the supplied files. Proximity is measured on 30 September 2026, after the fiscal year, and for Operator 1's own banner only. Fifty-two clinics sit at the centre of their ZIP code, not at their address. Banner counts follow the clinic master (Deal A Banner 2 253), which differs from the public list (266) used in C-PUB-2. Many state-and-banner groups are small: 13 of the 28 have one or two clinics on one side. The interval is wide enough to hold a difference of several points in either direction. Clinic-level EBITDA is as defined in the company's file and as used elsewhere in Part 05.

C-PUB-7 · Complaints per clinic

What was computed. Complaints recorded by a consumer complaints body in the last three years divided by a clinic count: Deal A 907 over 983 = 0.77; Operator 9 108 over 157 = 0.59; Operator 2 309 over 510 = 0.52; Deal C's Operator 17 brand 9 over 23 = 0.31 (0.302 unrounded).

Sources. Numerators: a consumer complaints body business profile and complaints page of each business, read on 30 September 2026 (Deal A PUB-124, PUB-127; Operator 2 PUB-129, PUB-204; Operator 9 PUB-130, PUB-205; Operator 17 & Pet Care PUB-206). Denominators: clinic counts already held in this document from the company records, namely Deal A 983 company-operated clinics at 27 June 2026 [F, DLA-0399], Operator 2 510 retail units at June 2026 [M, OP2-4716], Operator 9 157 clinics at September 2025 [I, OP4-0535] and Operator 17 23 clinics at August 2026 [M, DLC-4339].

How. Three-year complaint count divided by the clinic count, rounded to two decimals. No figure is computed for Operator 1, whose profile does not say which banners it covers, or for Operator 5, for which the document holds no clinic count near the date.

Where shown. Part 09 section K under 04 H, Exhibit 9.101 and Exhibit 4.24; Exhibit 9.115.

Limits. The ratio is indicative only, and the four ratios rest on clinic counts of different dates and scopes and are not ranked. The numerator runs over three years and the denominator is one date; Deal A's clinic count fell from 1,139 to 983 between March 2024 and March 2026, so an average count over the period would give a lower figure. The profile shows its own location count, which differs (Deal A 1,107; Operator 2 506; Operator 9 104; none shown for Operator 17), and does not say which clinics it covers. Operator 9's count is a year older than the read date. Complaints are those filed with a consumer complaints body, not all complaints. The counts used are the totals a consumer complaints body states on each profile.

C-PUB-8 · Deal A advertising as a share of sales

What was computed. Advertising expense divided by sales for fiscal 2024, 2025 and 2026: 1.05%, 1.38% and 2.36%.

Sources. Advertising expense as stated in Deal A's Form 10-K for fiscal 2026 (PUB-160): $13,717.5k, $16,617.9k and $27,561.5k (DLA-1259, DLA-1242, DLA-1226), shown as $13.1m, $16.1m and $26.6m. Sales of the same years: $1,135,991k, $1,048,839k and $1,032,316k (DLA-0015, DLA-0016, DLA-0017).

How. Expense divided by sales of the same fiscal year: 13,717.5 ÷ 1,135,991 = 1.05%; 16,617.9 ÷ 1,048,839 = 1.38%; 27,561.5 ÷ 1,032,316 = 2.36%.

Where shown. Part 09 section L under 05 B and Exhibit 9.114; the text of Part 09 section L under 05 A and 05 D; Exhibit 5.16.

Limits. This is total advertising expense as reported, consolidated. Part 05 section D applies the FY25 and FY26 ratios to the 119 closure candidates' sales as the range for advertising left behind after the closures; the consolidated figure includes advertising the company does not allocate to clinics. The exhibit sets the share beside comparable traffic; the two series do not rest on one clinic base, and the exhibit does not measure a return on advertising.

C-PUB-9 · Deal A employees per clinic and changes

What was computed. Employees per company-operated clinic at the three fiscal year-ends: 5.17 (March 2024), 4.98 (March 2025) and 4.95 (March 2026). Changes from March 2025 to March 2026: total employees −11.1%, field organisation −11.1%, corporate headquarters +5.9% (134 to 140), company-operated clinics −9.8%.

Sources. Deal A Forms 10-K for fiscal 2024, 2025 and 2026, Item 1 (PUB-158, PUB-159, PUB-160): total employees of about 6,725, 6,416 and 5,606; field organisation 6,566, 6,413 and 5,562; headquarters 149, 134 and 140; other offices 20, 10 and 10. Company-operated clinics as already held: 1,139, 1,102 and 983 (DLA-0385, DLA-0386, DLA-0387).

How. Total employees divided by company-operated clinics: 6,725 ÷ 1,139 = 5.17; 6,416 ÷ 1,102 = 4.98; 5,606 ÷ 983 = 4.95. Changes: 5,606 ÷ 6,416 − 1 = −11.1%; 5,562 ÷ 6,413 − 1 = −11.1%; 140 ÷ 134 − 1 = +5.9%; 983 ÷ 1,102 − 1 = −9.8%.

Where shown. Part 09 section L under 05 C and Exhibit 9.116.

Limits. The filings give employee counts as approximate, rounded to the nearest ten, so a change of ten at headquarters is within rounding. The numerator includes headquarters and other offices. The filings do not split full-time from part-time staff, or clinics from district and regional field roles. The ratio counts people, not cost.

C-PUB-10 · Counts from company job boards

What was computed. Deal A: of 258 open postings on its job board on 30 September 2026, 177 are veterinarian roles, and 261 were first published between April and December 2025 (1 April to 15 December 2025); of the other two, one was first published in April 2026 and one in July 2023. Deal B: of 55 open roles on its job board, 49 are at general practice and preventive clinics (43 veterinarian roles, seven client service representatives and one management role) and seven at wellness clinic sites named "Deal B Wellness Clinic Operator 3" (six veterinarian roles and one management role), shown in Exhibit 9.139.

Sources. The postings list of Deal A's job board, 258 postings with 258 unique identifiers, read on 30 September 2026 (PUB-221). Deal B's job board, read on 30 September 2026 (PUB-164, PUB-165).

How. Postings are classified by title. Deal A, in this order: "compliance auditor"; "district manager"; a title containing "manager" and not "veterinarian" is clinic management; a title containing veterinarian, veterinary technician, associate or relief is a veterinarian role. Dates are each posting's first publication date. Deal B: a title containing "representative" is a client service representative; "manager" is management; every other posting (veterinarian, veterinary technician, wellness or vaccine-clinic veterinarian, and one posting titled with a clinic name only) is a veterinarian role. The counts are tallies of the postings lists.

Where shown. Exhibit 9.115; Part 09 section M under 06 E, Exhibit 9.134; Part 09 section M under 06 F and Exhibit 9.139 for the wellness clinic roles.

Limits. The classification rests on titles only. A posting can stay on a board after the role is filled, and one posting can stand for several hires, so Deal A's count is an upper bound on live demand and is not a vacancy rate. The counts are one day's openings and move; openings do not measure headcount or turnover.

C-PUB-11 · Service against pharmacy price index

What was computed. An index of the consumer price of veterinarian services and an index of the consumer price of pharmacy products, each set to 86 for 2019: annual averages for 2019 to 2025 and the single month of August 2026. Service: 86.4, 91.8, 92.4, 101.7, 111.1, 122.6 and 128.9 for 2019 to 2025, and 134.3 for August 2026. Pharmacy products: 86.4, 87.2, 92.4, 105.4, 103.8, 107.6 and 106.3, and 111.4.

Sources. US Bureau of Labor Statistics, consumer price index for all urban consumers, US city average, not seasonally adjusted, monthly: veterinarian services (series CUUR0000SS62053) and pharmacy products (series CUUR0000SETC01), as published to August 2026; series retrieved on 28 September 2026.

How. For each series and each calendar year, the arithmetic mean of the published monthly index values is taken: twelve months, and eleven in 2025, because October 2025 was not published. Each annual mean is divided by the 2019 mean (service 252.358; pharmacy products 105.678) and multiplied by 86, rounded to one decimal. The August 2026 value is that month's index (service 403.896; pharmacy products 141.036) divided by the same 2019 mean, times 86. The service series equals the index drawn in Exhibit 3.07 (128.9 in 2025). The pharmacy series' change in August 2026 on a year earlier, +0.3%, agrees with the Bureau's release table.

Where shown. Part 09 section J under 03 B and Exhibit 9.46.

Limits. Both are prices paid by consumers across all sellers, not an operator's price or ticket. The 2025 average is of eleven months. The August 2026 points are one month each and are not comparable with an annual average, for seasonal reasons.

C-PUB-12 · Veterinary pharmacy import shares by country

What was computed. Each country's share of the value of US imports of veterinary pharmacy products and parasiticides in calendar 2019 and calendar 2025, for the nine largest sources in 2025, and the combined shares of two groups of countries. Shares, 2019 then 2025: Thailand 17.4% and 16.9%; Mexico 6.7% and 10.4%; Canada 9.8% and 9.1%; Japan 6.7% and 6.8%; Vietnam 3.8% and 6.6%; Cambodia 0.0% and 5.6%; South Korea 8.6% and 4.2%; Indonesia 4.1% and 3.6%; China 7.2% and 2.3%. On the rounded shares shown, the nine together are 64.9% and 65.3%, Mexico, Vietnam and Cambodia together 10.4% and 21.7%, and South Korea and China together 15.3% and 6.6%.

Sources. US Census Bureau, U.S. Imports by End-Use, annual workbook, end-use category 25979 (veterinary pharmacy products and parasiticides), country rows and the world total for 2019 and 2025, read on 30 September 2026 (PUB-103).

How. A country's import value divided by the world total for the category in the same year, times 86, rounded to one decimal. World totals: $11,827,855,314 in 2019 and $15,501,636,134 in 2025, shown as $11.24 billion and $15.07 billion. The group figures in the text and the exhibit are sums of the rounded shares shown; sums of the unrounded shares are 0.1 lower in 2025 (67.0%, 22.3% and 6.3%).

Where shown. Part 09 section J under 03 B and Exhibit 9.47.

Limits. The shares are of nominal dollar value, not of units, so they move with price and mix. The category is veterinary pharmacy products and parasiticides as the Census Bureau defines it and is not limited to products for dogs and cats; it includes livestock products. Country of origin is the customs origin, not the brand owner. No duty rate is applied.

C-PUB-13 · Same-product pharmacy price index

What was computed. Deal A's posted price for one pharmacy product as an index of the median posted price at five other sellers, 86.8, and the spread between the lowest and the highest of the six prices, 0.85%, stated as within 1%.

Sources. The product pages for the Animal Health Manufacturer 2 Defender2 chewable parasiticide, large-dog six-dose pack, at Deal A (PUB-149), Operator 28 (PUB-237), Mass Retailer 1 (PUB-238), Operator 32 Pharmacy (PUB-239), Pharmacy-Easy (PUB-240) and Mass Retailer 2 (PUB-241), read on 30 September 2026.

How. Prices per pack: Deal A $174.14; the five others $180.17, $181.53, $181.53, $181.53 and $184.63. The median of the five is $181.53. Index = 174.14 ÷ 181.53 × 86 = 86.8. Spread = (184.63 − 174.14) ÷ 174.14 = 0.85%.

Where shown. Part 09 section J under 03 B and Exhibit 9.49.

Limits. One product, one size, one day. The prices are posted online prices before shipping, dispensing fees and tax. Deal A's is a "starting at" price and is not specific to a clinic; Operator 32 page says pricing may vary by location; Mass Retailer 1's is the price for the item it sells itself. The five sellers are those whose pages showed a price; they are not a sample of the market.

C-PUB-14 · Veterinarian pay change

What was computed. The change in the median usual weekly earnings of full-time veterinarians and veterinary technicians between 2019 and 2025: +25.5%.

Sources. US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Current Population Survey, annual series of median usual weekly earnings of full-time wage and salary workers in the occupation (series LEU0254563900A), read through the data service of the Federal Reserve Bank of City 6 on 30 September 2026 (PUB-104).

How. The 2025 annual figure over the 2019 annual figure: 945 ÷ 705 − 1 = 25.5%.

Where shown. Part 09 section J under 03 C and Exhibit 9.56.

Limits. This is a household-survey median for one occupation across all employers, in nominal dollars. Occupation medians from this survey rest on small samples and move unevenly from year to year. It is not an operator's labour cost, and it is a different series from the employment cost index for veterinarian and veterinary technician occupations used elsewhere in Part 03; the two are not set side by side.

C-PUB-15 · Deal C rebrand window

What was computed. The months in which each brand's stated rebranding period ends. Operator 11: October 2026 to January 2027. Operator 15: November 2026 to February 2027. Operator 17: December 2026 to March 2027. Across the three: October 2026 to March 2027.

Sources. Company posts of 21 October 2025 for Operator 11 (PUB-188), 13 November 2025 for Operator 15 (PUB-189) and 5 December 2025 for Operator 17 (PUB-190), each stating completion "within the next 12 to 15 months"; read on 30 September 2026.

How. The date of each post plus 12 months and plus 15 months, stated as months. The range across the three runs from the earliest start to the latest end.

Where shown. Part 09 section N under 07 E.

Limits. The window reads the company's wording literally from the date of each post. No revised timetable was found in the pages read; the company's release of 9 July 2026 reports 20 of Operator 17's 21 State 39 locations rebranded (PUB-191). Sponsor 3 and Operator 13 are not covered by the three posts.

C-PUB-16 · Lender 5 amount

What was computed. The dollar amount of Lender 5's single-tenant lease-financing balances that its presentation attributes to a tenant named "Deal B": about $12m.

Sources. Lender 5, investor presentation for the second quarter of 2026, filed as an exhibit to a Form 8-K, with figures at 30 June 2026; read on 30 September 2026 (PUB-198).

How. The tenant's share as printed, 4%, times the single-tenant lease-financing balances as printed, $250 million: 0.04 × 250 = $12.93m, shown as about $12m.

Where shown. Part 09 section O under 08 C and Exhibit 9.163.

Limits. The share is printed as a whole percentage, so the amount lies between about $12m and $14m. The presentation prints no dollar figure for the tenant, prints the tenant's name only and does not list the properties, so the amount cannot be tied to the lease figures in the supplied documents.

Calculations stated in full

The calculations that follow are not numbered notes. They state in full how particular figures were derived: Deal A's lease-consistent conversion and clinic economics, Deal B's same-store sales and cohort delivery, Deal C's same-store sales, uplift, re-rating and cash EBITDA, and the Deal B and Deal C leverage and cover calculations behind the observations in Part 08; the Deal A financing figures are notes C-FIN-1 to C-FIN-4, C-FIN-6 and C-FIN-7 on the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) and notes C-V2-4 and C-V2-5 on the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026.

Deal A lease-consistent conversion. Peers carry clinic real estate as operating rent inside E1, while Deal A's $194.3m of finance leases (DLA-0471), mostly clinic real estate, sit below it. The like-for-like E1 therefore deducts finance-lease cash cost ≈ principal paid $34.384m + interest expense $9.252m = $44.2m in FY26 (public series DLA_FINLEASE_PRIN and DLA_FINLEASE_INT, FY2026), giving lease-consistent E1 of $29.1m (ex-gains $12.5m) and CONV_1 = ($29.1m − capex $27.7m) ÷ $29.1m = 0.03 (0.01 if divided by unadjusted E1) [I; Exhibit 9.120, note [1]].

Deal A clinic economics. Clinic EBITDA is the company's R-OPONLY measure (operating-lease rent in the clinic P&L, finance-lease cost below it, before co-op); FY26 $91.0m, 7.9% of sales on a ratio-of-sums basis across 983 clinics; after finance-lease cost at book ($29.9m), $64.6m or 5.4% (an R-BOOK approximation of D1.1) [F, DLA-0834; F/I, DLA-0856, DLA-0857]. Loss-making share on the all-clinic basis counts every clinic open at each fiscal year-end, including later-closed clinics (Part 09 section L under 05 B).

Deal B same-store sales and cohort delivery. Same-store sales on D2.1: a clinic-month enters from the thirteenth full owned month with trading in every month m−12..m; ratio of sums; closed clinics leave from the month of closure (CLOSE-FWD); traffic from visit counts, ticket = revenue per visit; residuals reported. Cohort delivery: four-wall (company definition, R-BOOK) over the seller "closing EBITDA" (basis PF, window not stated) in the acquisition schedule (DLB-029), on survivor clinics, on LTM July 2026 (twelve owned months for the 2022–24 cohorts; 255 of 297 clinic-months for 2025) and on an age-matched basis (each clinic's first and second twelve owned months, counted from its first full month), for closing-date groups in which every DLB-029 unit maps to a datapack clinic and all seller EBITDA is stated (note C-87).

Deal C same-store sales, uplift, re-rating and cash EBITDA. Same-store sales on D2.1 from the site database (survivor file; CLOSE-RETRO); matched-site uplift on clinics with at least six pre-acquisition months, seller months held as separate pre-ownership rows; acquired-clinic re-rating = later ÷ entry clinic EBITDA on the same company-presented basis as the peer pools. D3 cash EBITDA (E6, recurrence test) = E3 less the transaction, integration and start-up costs that recur in every period: $8.6m for LTM April 2026 = $27.9m − $15.6m − $2.3m − $0.4m (DLC-4437/4439).

Deal B leverage ladder and cover: LV1 = term loan ($55m grid / $52m Ares Credit Group; with and without the $26m DDTL); LV3 adds the seller note $5.6m, other debt $0.8m and equipment leases $2.2m; LV4 adds the HoldCo note $36.9m accreting at 15% PIK ($44.0m by September 2027); LV5 adds 6× cash rent from the Accounting Firm 2 rent roll; each gross and net of cash at $2.46m (borrower model) or $5.03m (Ares Credit Group); denominators E1, post-audit E2 $8.51m and post-audit E4 $13.79m (LTM Jul-26, PF), Ares Credit Group E5 $11.16m as printed (as Ares Credit Group's capitalisation table divides: 3.91x on the $52m term loan, DLB-9234, and 4.08x on the $55m, DLB-9352; on the unrounded $11,397.0k, DLB-6300, they are 4.09x and 4.15x), the borrower's LTM Sep-26E E4 $14.77m (P) and the borrower's E5 $16.1m including acquisitions (P). Coverage: (EBITDA − maintenance capex $4.60m) ÷ (NTM fixed charges $9.38m: interest at SOFR + 5.55% plus unused fees, 1% amortisation, seller and other principal).

Deal C cover and deleveraging: cash interest on $204.3m (Option Two) or $176.0m (Option One) at SOFR 4.19% plus spread, plus undrawn fees on the $70m DDTL for its 21-month availability; 1% amortisation; maintenance capex $2.3m; tax $0.3m; cash breakeven EBITDA $26.0m (Option Two); six-year monthly path with $4.3m of stopping and settlement costs in the first ten months; refinancing at the stated multiple on year-six EBITDA less 2% fees, on a grid of multiples (3.38× stress, 3.81×, 4.27× base, 4.70×, 5.10×) and growth rates (−5.8% stress, 0%, +1.0% base, +2%, +3.0%, +4%) for E5

$29.4m and for Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA for the twelve months to April 2026, $24.9m with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back to the $23.2m Ares Credit Group prints (note C-90). Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA does not deduct the transaction, integration and start-up costs that D3 cash EBITDA ($8.6m) deducts, so it approximates cash earnings if acquisitions and their costs stop.

Notes on the industry exhibits and on the files of 1 October 2026

C-120 · Comp traffic, ticket and sales by year, and the band of yearly traffic changes

What was computed. For each calendar year 2007–2025, the median comp traffic, comp ticket and comparable sales change across the core operators with a comp traffic series, with Deal A excluded from the medians and shown on its own; and, over all operator-years, the median, interquartile range, lowest and highest comp traffic change by economic environment, over all years except the 2020 shock and over all years.

Sources. The comp-traffic panel of note C-02 (Part 03 section A): Operator 10 seller-period KPI data 2007–17 (OP2-0648 to OP2-0680, three rows a year), Operator 14 2013–17 (OP2-0218 to OP2-0222; sales and ticket OP2-1172 to OP2-1183), Operator 16 and Operator 12 2015–17 (OP2-0735 to OP2-0743, OP2-0770 to OP2-0778), Operator 2 clinic-level databook 2019–20 (OP2-3520 to OP2-3527), Operator 5 volume trends 2018–22 (OP5-3862 to OP5-3880), Deal A all-clinics KPI report FY20–FY26 (DLA-0597 to DLA-0790), Operator 3 datacube 2023–24 (OP3-0886 to OP3-0892), Operator 6 visit count file 2025 (OP6-1896), Operator 8 databook 2025 (OP8-2106, OP8-2114, OP8-2115), Operator 7 credit databook 2025 (OP7-1022 to OP7-1024). 35 operator-years at seven parent companies.

How. Each operator-period's traffic, sales and ticket rows are read from the figures recorded for this document. Calendar year: Deal A's fiscal year goes to the calendar year holding nine of its twelve months (FY20, April 2019 to March 2020, is 2019). Environment: as in note C-02 (month-majority), which reproduces rows A1-P5-007 to A1-P5-011. Yearly medians are unweighted across the operators with a value that year, excluding Deal A; operator counts are kept per year (one to four). The band is the 25th to 75th percentile of the operator-years by linear interpolation; share within ±4% = operator-years with an absolute change of 5% or less ÷ operator-years. Operator 14 2013 and Operator 6 2025 carry traffic only.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.03 and Exhibit 3.02 (Part 03 section A); the "Visits outside 2020" tile of Exhibit 1.07 (Part 01 section D); the text of Part 01 section D, the opening of Part 03 and Part 03 section A.

Limits. One operator in 2007–12, 2018 and 2021–24, so a yearly median is often one operator's figure. Operator 10 2009–12 visit counts shift across all clinics (note C-11). Deal A, Operator 3 and Operator 6 files hold surviving clinics only and read high; Operator 7 visit count definition is not stated. Operator 1 pharmacy units are not visits and are not in the panel.

C-121 · Same-store sales by operator over its longest record

What was computed. For the seven core operators with five or more annual readings, each annual value of the best-available same-store sales series, the simple mean, the count of negative years, and, in the data file only, the chained growth over the record and its compound annual rate.

Sources. The best-available annual series behind note C-43: Deal A Forms 10-K comparable-clinic sales FY06 (public series DLA_SSS, year to March 2006) and FY07–FY26 (DLA-0336, DLA-0338, DLA-0340 to DLA-0343, DLA-0345, DLA-0347 to DLA-0351, DLA-0354 to DLA-0359, DLA-0361, DLA-0363); OP4-005 lender panel (Operator 4 OP4-0541 to OP4-0556; Operator 9 OP4-0589 to OP4-0593); Operator 1 clinic data and Ares Credit Group Operator 1 update (OP1-2114, OP1-5126 to OP1-5133, OP1-8251, OP1-8856 to OP1-8859, OP1-11177 to OP1-11179); Operator 2 lineage (Operator 10 OP2-0648 to OP2-0678, every third row; Operator 2 OP2-4238 (2018, pro forma), OP2-3520, OP2-3525, OP2-4703, OP2-4261, OP2-4267, OP2-4273, OP2-4279); Operator 5 (OP5-3862, OP5-3866, OP5-3870, OP5-3874, OP5-3878); Operator 8 (OP8-0577, OP8-1714, OP8-1722, OP8-1730, OP8-2106).

How. Annual values as in note C-43, each checked against its fact row where it has one. Mean, negative years and span reproduce note C-43. Chained growth = product of (1 + annual value) − 1; compound rate = (1 + chained)^(1 / years) − 1.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.16 (Part 03 section E); the "Long-run organic growth" tile of Exhibit 1.07.

Limits. Operators are measured over different spans and on different definitions (company definitions for Deal A, Operator 4, Operator 9, Operator 1 after 2017 and Operator 2 after 2020), so the records are not ranked. Operator 2 2018 is a pro forma company figure from a lender deck, drawn hollow.

C-122 · Real veterinary spending and pets in households against 2019

What was computed. Real household spending on veterinarian services (annual, 2005–2025, and the first half of 2026) and pets in U.S. households (December of each year 2005–2025, and July 2026), each as an index with 2019 = 86.

Sources. BEA NIPA real (Fisher quantity) index, veterinarian services, annual (BEA_PCEVETSVC_A) and quarterly (BEA_PCEVETSVC_Q); an industry ownership survey series, PETHH_M12; both retrieved 28 September 2026 (public series file).

How. Each value ÷ its 2019 value × 86 (December 2019 for pets). The 2026 spending mark is the average of the first and second quarters of 2026 at seasonally adjusted rates.

Where shown. Exhibit 3.04 (Part 03 section A); the opening text of Part 03 section A.

Limits. A price-adjusted dollar quantity that includes emergency and specialty hospital work and rises with work per visit; it is not a count of visits at general practice and preventive operators.

C-V2-1 · Deal A clinic margin on four bases, and loss-making clinics, all clinics and the clinics kept after the second round

What was computed. Deal A's FY26 clinic EBITDA margin and the share of clinics with negative clinic EBITDA on four bases (before co-op with finance-lease cost added back; before co-op after finance-lease cost at book; including co-op, Ares Credit Group's basis; including co-op after finance-lease cost at book), for all 983 clinics, for the 824 clinics kept once the 119 second-round clinics close, and for the 119.

Sources. Deal A clinic-level EBITDA FY23–FY26 (DLA-003), tab FY26: clinic EBITDA (column M), finance-lease depreciation (column J) and finance-lease interest (column K), totals row 1131, and the reconciliation of clinic EBITDA to company EBITDA; New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26) (DLA-019), Clinic Helper, LTM Mar-26 net sales by clinic; FY26 co-op of $58.22m (DLA-003, rec!B16) on 10-K sales of $1,029.1m, the 5.15% rate implied by Ares Credit Group's Deal A Diligence & Structure Update (DLA-017) p.9 (DLA-019, Sheet9!AE16); FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027), clinic numbers in column A of the tab "New 119 Closures - UPDATED".

How. Clinic by clinic, co-op = LTM Mar-26 clinic sales × 5.15%, Ares Credit Group's rate (FY26 co-op of $58.22m ÷ 10-K sales of $1,029.1m); finance-lease book cost = column J + column K ($30.32m for all clinics: depreciation $21.79m, interest $8.73m). Each margin is a ratio of sums over the clinic set. The 119 are matched to the clinic file by clinic number (119 of 119). Ares Credit Group's $151.8m reconciles as $91.0m of clinic EBITDA plus $57.8m of co-op; it prints $156.0m on p.9 because co-op is spread at 5.15% of clinic sales ($1,026.4m) rather than 10-K sales. Not in either figure: −$10.6m net of clinic costs not allocated to clinics (advertising −$11.8m, outbuy rebates +$5.9m, other items −$5.1m; DLA-003, rec!B3:B10) and −$2.3m for clinics closed in the first quarter of FY26.

Where shown. Exhibit 1.01; Exhibit 1.12; the text of Part 01 section A, Part 01 section B, Part 03 section C, Part 03 section D, Part 04 section D, Part 04 section E and Part 04 section F; and Part 05.

Limits. Co-op is allocated to clinics at one flat rate, while the peers' rebates are allocated by source; finance-lease cost is at book, not cash; the peer comparison is therefore indicative. No peer shares the basis before finance-lease cost. The 824 clinics are pro forma: the FY26 clinics less the 119, with no recapture of the closed clinics' sales.

C-V2-2 · Deal A clinic quartiles: Ares Credit Group's view and the same clinics fixed at FY23

What was computed. Clinic EBITDA including co-op by quartile for FY23 to FY26, sorted two ways: on LTM Mar-26, as Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update p.9 does, and on LTM Mar-23 with the same clinics tracked to FY26; and the place of the 119 second-round clinics in each.

Sources. New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26) (DLA-019), Clinic Helper, clinic-level EBITDA for LTM Mar-23 to LTM Mar-26 (columns AJ to AM) and net sales; Ares Credit Group's co-op rates of 6.41%, 5.42%, 5.47% and 5.15% of clinic sales for FY23 to FY26, implied by DLA-017 p.9 (DLA-019, Sheet9!AB16:AE16); DLA-027 for the 119.

How. EBITDA including co-op = clinic EBITDA + sales × the year's rate (a clinic with sales and no EBITDA carries its co-op only). Ares Credit Group's view: current clinics sorted on LTM Mar-26 into quartiles of 237, 237, 237 and 247 clinics, each clinic's quartile applied back to FY23; it reproduces p.9 (Q4 FY26 −$15.0m against −$14.9m printed). The test view: the 957 clinics with data sorted on LTM Mar-23 into quartiles of 237, 237, 237 and 241, tracked to FY26.

Where shown. The text of Part 01 section A, Part 01 section B, Part 05 and Part 10.

Limits. Sorting on the latest year selects clinics that did well in that year, so a top half that grows on that sort is partly a sorting effect. Closed clinics have no sales in the Data Cuts, so an all-clinic cut including closures is possible only before co-op.

C-V2-3 · Deal A second round valued in two cases

What was computed. The run-rate EBITDA effect a year of closing the 119 second-round clinics, in four scenarios, on three definitions of the benefit: case A, the reversal of the file's "Profit co-op $"; a reconciling line on clinic EBITDA including co-op; case B, the reversal of the file's "Contribution $".

Sources. FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis (DLA-027): tab "New 119 Closures - UPDATED", row 142 (net sales LTM Jun-26 $72.48m, G142; "Profit co-op $" −$19.41m, M142; "Contribution $" −$0.08m, P142; strategic-account sales $12.24m, Q142; annual cash rent $12.13m, S142, of which operating leases $5.75m on 54 clinics; gross margin, K142), tab Summary (cost to close $31.00m, J47; occupancy and maintenance cash to lease end $21.79m, J43; finance-lease interest $9.63m, J45); Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24 (DLA-024) for fees of $4.3m; the stranded-cost ranges set out in Part 09 section L under 05 D.

How. Benefit + recapture − stranded overhead − stranded advertising − operating-lease rent where leases run to term. Recapture = share recaptured × $72.48m × (gross margin of the 119, K142 ÷ G142, plus co-op at 5.15%) = $3.76m at 13%. Stranded overhead $2.1m to $4.7m and advertising $1.1m to $1.9m, as in Part 09 section L under 05 D. The clinic-EBITDA line = "Profit co-op $" plus the depreciation, amortisation, bank interest and finance-lease cost the clinic file adds back for the 119 ($8.93m): about −$10.2m for LTM Jun-26, whose reversal adds about +$10.2m. "Profit co-op $" equals the Data Cuts "Clinic Profit/(Loss)" for LTM Jun-26 plus co-op at about 5.35% of sales, clinic by clinic.

Where shown. The text of Part 01 section A and Part 01 section B; Exhibit 1.10; and Part 05 section D.

Limits. "Contribution $" is not defined in the workbook and does not equal the Data Cuts "Clinic Contribution" (−$1.58m for LTM Jun-26). The workbook's $21.79m costs occupancy to lease end, which is consistent with leases running to term; exits would replace it with buy-out costs not in the files. One-off cash is outside the run-rate figures.

C-V2-4 · Deal A liquidity on the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026, with closure cash

What was computed. Quarter-end liquidity net of letters of credit on the recapitalisation model v06 (DLA-026), as modelled and with closure cash, fees, closure benefit and earnings shortfalls overlaid; the lowest quarter in each case and the uniform earnings shortfall at which it first falls below $21m.

Sources. DLA-026: Draw Schedule Summary row 60 (liquidity net of letters of credit, columns J to AA, December 2026 to March 2031), row 14 (SOFR), row 25 (quarterly EBITDA to March 2028); Covenants row 85 (annual EBITDA thereafter); Scenario Drivers for the revolver margin (3.26%) and unused fee (0.44%); DLA-027 Summary J43 for closure cash ($21.79m); DLA-024 for fees ($4.3m); the LW draft term sheet of 21 September 2026 (DLA-023) for the $21m minimum.

How. Closure cash of $21.79m ÷ 42.1 a month from April 2027, or ÷ 4 a quarter from June 2027 to March 2028 in the four-quarter case; fees of $4.3m in the June 2027 quarter; any closure benefit ÷ 4 a quarter from June 2027; a shortfall = x × quarterly EBITDA. The amounts are funded on the revolver and cumulate with interest at SOFR + 3.26% less the 0.44% unused fee. No tax effect and no interaction with the cash sweep.

Where shown. Part 08.

Limits. The model is quarterly, so the overlay reads quarter-end liquidity where the term sheet tests average daily liquidity. The model itself excludes the closure programme and does not test the $21m minimum.

C-V2-5 · Deal A refinancing need and capacity at 30 September 2030 on the recapitalisation model

What was computed. The debt to be refinanced at the modelled maturity in each liquidity case, against capacity at 4.3x on six EBITDA figures.

Sources. DLA-026: Debt Schedule AE60 (term loan $199.25m) and AE34 (revolver $43.6m); Draw Schedule Summary Y54 (cash $20.1m); balance-sheet annual rows 25 and 33 (finance leases, FY30 $123.6m and FY31 $104.9m); the overlay of note C-V2-4; the EBITDA figures as listed in Part 08.

How. Need = term loan + revolver + overlay funding − cash above a $13m reserve. Capacity = multiple × EBITDA − finance leases (about $112.3m, the midpoint of FY30 and FY31). Method as note C-FIN-3.

Where shown. Part 08.

Limits. One multiple; finance leases at the midpoint of two year-ends; the plan EBITDA of the model is projected.

C-V2-6 · Deal A pharmacy units against the Market Panel index, 13 weeks to 12 September 2026

What was computed. The sum and the simple averages of the weekly gaps between Deal A's comparable-clinic pharmacy-unit change and the Market Panel index for its footprint, over the 13 weeks to 12 September 2026, the 13 weeks before and all 68 weeks from 5 April 2025; and the count of weeks Deal A beat the index.

Sources. 8160560 Market Panel P13 Wk vs Deal A Overview, Exec Com (DLA-028), the workbook embedded in the slide, sheet "Slide 2": rows 65 to 65 for the 13 weeks; rows 2 to 54 for the earlier weeks; G78 = SUM(G65:G77).

How. Weekly gap = Deal A year-on-year change − Market Panel year-on-year change, in points; the slide's "▲ 17.5%" is the sum of the 13 weekly gaps (16.78 points), an average of 1.5 points a week.

Where shown. Part 05.

Limits. A company slide [M]; the Market Panel index includes Deal A's own volume, according to the slide's footnote; the slide gives no series excluding Deal A or by product.

H · Limits of evidence

The evidence stops in named places: Operator 1 clinic data end in November 2017 and Operator 2's in March 2021, 82 of 369 tested industry-report claims are contradicted, and public signals are dated and uneven in coverage.

Exhibit 9.23 — Most actual-basis evidence sits in the 2009–2020 expansion (EXP10-19) and the soft period from 2024 (SOFT24-26); Deal A is the only operator with its own actuals in all seven environments (Deal B's rows before 2021 are seller history)

Fact rows on an actual basis by platform and environment (D10), count, 1992 to 2026 (blank = none); Deal B's rows before 2021 are pre-acquisition seller history

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: CreditSwan computation: count of actual-basis fact rows by company and environment, from the documents Ares Credit Group supplied in the 13 folders and Deal A SEC filings (row IDs by company prefix: OP1, OP2, DLA, OP4, OP5, OP6, OP3, OP7, OP8, QL1, QLF, QL2, CO1, CO3, COR, DLB, DLC) · Basis: A (actuals) only; counts include every metric, so a non-zero cell is not by itself an operating series; tint on a log scale

A tick in a cell can rest on very few rows: Operator 4 reaches COVID20 on one basis-A row, while Operator 1 has 639 GFC rows and Deal A 103 PRE-GFC rows [I, note C-01]. Deal B has 4,171 basis-A rows and Deal C 1,394, almost all from 2022 onwards and all but 6 and 4 of them read from the companies' own documents [I, note C-01].

Exhibit 9.24 — Of 369 industry-report claims that could be tested against public data (retrieved 28 September 2026), 214 verified and 82 were contradicted; the Ares Credit Group comps workbook supplied 272 of them

Claims tested against public data, by source document and outcome, count, as at 28 September 2026; claims internal to their report cannot be tested and are not shown

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: CreditSwan computation: claims in seven documents Ares Credit Group supplied (Ares Credit Group comps workbook DLC-011; Consultant 2 for Mike DLC-007; Consultant 1 Golf OP4-011; Consultant 1 Delta readout OP6-002; Bank Advisor 1 OP7-008; Deal B KPI chart pack DLB-011; Operator 5 comps workbook OP5-003), each compared with public series (BLS, BEA, FRED, an animal health industry association, SEC filings of Deal A, Public Pet Health Co., Public Wellness Clinic Co. and Emergency Operator 6) · Basis: Count of claims; public series as retrieved on 28 September 2026; the 1,432 claims internal to their report are counted in Exhibit 9.25

Most contradictions are mislabels rather than wrong numbers: the Ares Credit Group comps workbook (DLC-011) labels Deal A's total capex as maintenance capex, and the Consultant 1 readout mislabels CPI windows [I, Exhibit 9.25]. Industry-report figures are used in this document only where they verify against public data (Exhibit 9.25).

Limitations

CreditSwan did not verify the underlying accounting of any company, did not obtain bank confirmations, and did not appraise collateral. CreditSwan's monthly cash models, used only for the observations in Part 08 section D and, for Deal A on Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24 and the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026), in Part 09 section O, work from month-end points on the cases stated there and cannot certify a test set on each business day; they indicate direction and order of magnitude. The Deal A observations of Part 08 section B overlay the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026 quarter by quarter and read quarter-end liquidity where a term sheet would test the average daily balance (note C-V2-4). The illustrative cases in Part 09 section O under 08 F come from a CreditSwan quarterly model that does not charge finance-lease interest to cash; where both models give a figure, the monthly model governs (note C-FIN-7). Clinic-level panels are dependent observations within platforms, not

independent samples, and several conclusions in Parts 03 and 04 rest on fewer than three operators in a given environment and say so. Where the supplied comparators are Ares Credit Group's own internal records (the Ares Credit Group comps workbook DLC-011, the Operator 6 and Operator 3 IC records), they are used as Ares Credit Group-internal, externally unverified evidence; the Ares Credit Group comps workbook is internally inconsistent across tabs and its prints are not used as anchors. Seller-period (pre-acquisition) data are flagged throughout and never enter a comparable base.

Not verified: underlying accounting; bank balances; appraisals; the Accounting Firm 1 QoE (not supplied); post-close contracts; the 119-clinic Deal A list beyond its match to the clinic file (note C-V2-1); the $21m Deal C sponsor instrument; closing prices of the Operator 3 and Operator 6 transactions beyond Ares Credit Group's records; the Ares Credit Group comps workbook DLC-011 (Ares Credit Group-internal; inconsistent across tabs, not used as an anchor).

Industry-report claims tested against public data

The industry reports and comps workbooks supplied yield 1,802 recorded claims from seven documents: the Ares Credit Group comps workbook DLC-011 (1,197 claims), Consultant 1's Delta readout OP6-002 (151), Consultant 1 Golf OP4-011 (152), Consultant 2 for Mike DLC-007 (138), Bank Advisor 1 OP7-008 (82), the Operator 5 comps workbook OP5-003 (82) and the Deal B KPI chart pack DLB-011 (39). Of these, 369 could be tested against a public series (368 claims and 11 restatements of them within the reports) and 1,432 are internal to the report [public series, Part 09 section E]. Of the 369 tested, 214 are borne out, 82 are contradicted and 82 could not be verified against public data [Exhibit 9.25; public series retrieved 28 Sep 2026, Part 09 section E].

Exhibit 9.25 — Of 369 industry-report claims tested against public data retrieved on 28 September 2026, 50% verify and 18% are contradicted

Claims recorded in seven supplied industry reports and comps workbooks, by outcome against public series retrieved 28 September 2026: count, and share of the 369 tested

OUTCOME	CLAIMS	SHARE OF THE CLAIMS TESTED
Borne out by public data	214	50.5%
Contradicted by public data	82	18.9%
Could not be verified against public data	82	19.3%
Tested against public data	**369**	**86.4%**
Internal to the report, not tested	1,432	–
Total	**1,802**	–

Source: claims counted by outcome in DLC-011, OP6-002, OP4-011, DLC-007, OP7-008, OP5-003 and DLB-011, tested against public series retrieved 28 Sep 2026 (Part 09 section E); shares computed on the 369 tested claims. The contradictions are dominated by mislabels, not by incorrect numbers: DLC-011 labels Deal A total PP&E capex as "maintenance" and as "greenfield and M&A" capex, and OP6-002 mislabels CPI windows and uses stale end points for pets in U.S. households

Named gaps in coverage

The coverage gaps that bound the conclusions are specific and each has a file that would close it. Operator 1 clinic-level data end in Nov-17 (LTM Nov-17 is the last full window; the clinic sheets run to Dec-17), so the largest preventive care and pharmacy platform is absent from COVID20 to SOFT24-26 at clinic level; Operator 2's clinic-level data end in Mar-21, after which only lender decks tagged [M] exist [note C-06; note C-19]. GFC operator volume exists for two core operators only (Operator 10 visit counts and Operator 1 pharmacy units), comp traffic in the GFC for one (Operator 10, 2 operator-years), and PRE-GFC evidence for one core operator (Deal A's public record) [note C-06, row "core, all rows, GFC"].

Exhibit 9.26 — Two large pharmacy platforms drop out of the clinic-level record: Operator 1 before COVID20 (November 2017) and Operator 2 early in REOPEN21 (March 2021)

Named gaps in coverage by operator and area, with the file that would close each

GAP	EFFECT ON THE ASSESSMENT	FILE THAT WOULD CLOSE IT
Operator 1 clinic-level data end Nov-17	No Operator 1 four-wall, volume or SSS_CD on clinic data for COVID20–SOFT24-26	Operator 1 2018–26 clinic P&L databook (not in folder) [note C-19; note C-29]
Operator 2 clinic-level data end Mar-21	Operator 2 2022–26 figures are deck-level [M] only	Operator 2 clinic-level databook 2022–26 (not in folder) [note C-29; note C-40]
GFC operator volume at two core operators; GFC comp traffic at one	GFC volume conclusions do not meet the three-operator test	Deal A 10-K FY08–10 traffic disclosure (if any); OP4-005 p.20 panel source; an Operator 1 visit count file 2007–10 (not in folder) [note C-02]
PRE-GFC evidence at one core operator (Deal A public)	No pre-GFC baseline for clinic economics or volume	Pre-2007 clinic data for a second operator (none in folder) [Exhibit 9.30]
No year with three actual R-CASH D1.1 operators	Industry four-wall level cannot be pooled	Operator 8 OP8-012 lease summary; Operator 7 OP7-005 tab 13 go-forward rent; Operator 3 OP3-013 lease schedule; Operator 2 OP2-017/OP2-015 cash rent [Exhibit 4.11]
Survivorship quantified at one core operator (Deal A)	Survivor-base comps (Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6) cannot be corrected	Operator 1 `1.2.2.1 Project Echo Operator 18 SL Financials (Dec-17).xlsb` closed-clinic sheets and `1.2.1.2 Project Echo - Closed Clinics [file]`; Deal A `Closed Clinics` tab (DLA-003) [note C-02]
No audited maintenance/growth capex split at any operator	Conversion ratios use total capex (upper bound) or company splits [M]	Deal A DLA-016 capex detail; OP7-003; Operator 5 fixed-asset register [note C-55]

Source: Sources as cited per row. Exhibit 9.27 consolidates the gaps of all eight areas, with the supplied files from which no figure is drawn

Method, consolidated gaps and files not drawn on

Method. The source folders held 306 files at 30 September 2026: 266 distinct files and 51 byte-identical copies of them. Of the 54 files received on 1 October 2026, six are new and 49 are copies of files already held, which gives 258 distinct files. The Sources table (Part 09 section E) lists the 198 distinct files that the text, an exhibit or a cited row of the Evidence index names, and one entry for Deal A's public filings: 157 of the files carry at least one Evidence-index row, and 42 are named in the text without one, among them the supplied files that Exhibit 9.27 names as closing a gap and from which no figure in this document is drawn. The other 62 distinct files are not cited. How far each cited figure was checked against its source is stated row by row in the Evidence index and counted in Part 09 section F: three in four cited fact rows rest on a single reading of the source, which is evidence but has not been confirmed by a second reading. Adjusted (E2) and pro forma (E3) figures carry basis PF. For the historical platforms the seller-period scope flag is not applied; seller-period rows are flagged in notes (Exhibit 9.03).

Known data limitations. About 893 four-wall rows carry no rent code, and only coded rows are pooled. Partial-year annual aggregates carry the calendar year-end as their period end. Page locators do not follow a single convention (some cite the PDF index page, others the printed page). Deal A's supplier-finance utilisation by bank (DLA-011) is partly illegible, so a total derived from it cannot be verified. Operator 3's survivor median revenue per clinic rests on two unstated windows. The OP4-005 panel shows Deal A's 2013 figure as −4% against −0.4% in the 10-K, probably a transcription error. The DLC-011 comps workbook changes the definition of its Deal A EBITDA row within the series, and the OP2-025 comps table is stale and relabelled.

Consolidated gaps and the file that would close each. The table consolidates the gaps named for the eight areas and the supplied files from which no figure is drawn, with duplicates merged; each row names the file that would close the gap and the area it serves [notes C-02, C-09, C-19, C-29, C-40, C-55, C-63 and C-73].

Exhibit 9.27 — Forty-four gaps in the evidence; most close with a file already in the folder or a named request to the company

Each gap in the evidence, the area it affects and the file or request that would close it

#	GAP IN THE EVIDENCE	AREAS	FILE OR REQUEST THAT WOULD CLOSE IT
1	Deal A all-clinic (CLOSE-FWD) comp traffic; no traffic before FY20	Volume, Pricing, Same-store sales	Deal A clinic-month OSM extract incl. closed clinics (data room request); DLA-002 extension; Deal A KPI reports FY10–FY19
2	Deal A closed-clinic economics on an all-clinic basis (CLOSE-FWD): the supplied file allows a partial test, which this document does not include	Volume, Margins, Unit economics	DLA-003 `1.0.4_Store-level EBITDA FY23-FY26` `Closed Clinics` tab (509 clinics, rows 2–499) with FY23–21 clinic-EBITDA tabs (closure dates in column M)
3	Deal A clinic D1.1 (finance-lease cash and cash rent by clinic); open dates for age analysis	Margins, Unit economics	DLA-008 extended to history; DLA-003 closure rows joined to sales; DLA-012 OSM open-date column

#	GAP IN THE EVIDENCE	AREAS	FILE OR REQUEST THAT WOULD CLOSE IT
4	Deal A maintenance / growth capex split	Unit economics, Cash flow, Leverage	DLA-016 capex detail / fixed-asset roll-forward
5	Deal A supplier-finance reconciliation	Cash flow, Leverage	FY26 10-K supplier-finance note; DLA-016 balance-sheet tab; DLA-011 Credit Summary of the current supply-chain-finance ageing
6	Deal A LTM LV5/LV6 and FCCR (quarterly lease cash, interest, taxes)	Leverage	Q1 FY27 10-Q lease note or Q2 FY27 10-Q cash-flow supplement
7	Deal A history: SCF before FY2023; ΔNWC and dividends before FY2010; capital-lease principal before FY2020; pre-ASC 842 cash rent; EBITDAR FY1996–99	Cash flow, Leverage	FY2010–22 10-K notes; FY1998–2009 10-K cash-flow lines (public filings); 10-K405 filings FY1996–99
8	Deal A add-on EBITDA multiples; public TEV/EBITDA history	Valuation	DLA-010 underlying deal files; market-data export or 10-K EV rebuild
9	Deal A August 2026 KPI summary (cross-check of survivor KPIs and clinic counts)	Volume, Margins, Same-store sales	DLA-018 `Deal A - Updated Data Summary (August 2026)[file]`
10	Operator 1 2018–26 clinic P&L, four-wall, volume and SSS_CD after Mar-23	Volume, Pricing, Margins, Unit economics, Same-store sales	Operator 1 2018–26 clinic P&L databook (not in folder); OP1-041/042 clinic-month units; OP1-041 successor and OP1-048 back-up
11	Operator 1 ATF growth: new rebate income vs invoice-to-rebate reclassification	Pricing, Margins	OP1-005 `2.4.3_Operator 1 - ATF Program Summary by Manufacturer - [file]`
12	Operator 1 development type by clinic; per-deal purchase prices	Unit economics	OP1-018 Clinic Legend (DEVTYPE P8:P376) joined to OP1-021; OP1-025 'Brownfield_Acq.' tab
13	Survivorship at a second operator	Volume	Operator 1 `1.2.2.1 Project Echo Operator 18 SL Financials (Dec-17).xlsb` closed-clinic sheets; `1.2.1.2 Project Echo - Closed Clinics [file]`
14	Operator 1 company SSS definition to Feb-21	Same-store sales	OP1-037 `Operator 1_SSS_2021.02.[file]`
15	Operator 29 standalone history (fourth large operator)	Margins, Same-store sales, Valuation	OP1-050 `Operator 29 - Historical [file]`
16	Operator 1 scheduled amortisation (CONV_3 overstated); 2014 multiple source conflict	Cash flow, Valuation	OP1-040 cash-flow financing lines; Sponsor 10 closing funds flow (not in folder)
17	Operator 2 clinic-level data and SSS 2021–26; greenfield and acquired-clinic results after Mar-21	Volume, Margins, Unit economics, Same-store sales	Operator 2 clinic-level databook 2022–26 (not in folder); OP2-025 appendix data
18	Operator 2 rent basis (R-UNK) and 2019 rebates understated in the series	Margins, Unit economics, Leverage	OP2-017 QoE rent schedule; OP2-021 rent tab vs OP2-015; rebuild from OP2-021 Rebates!M13:BH223
19	Operator 2 add-on multiples (Sponsor 1 era), Express Dental Plus price, 2018 bridge	Valuation	Operator 2 DDTL draw schedules / acquisition memos (not in folder); OP2-001 Sheet1 row 6; OP2-004 appendix
20	Operator 2 and Deal A driver splits (mix, labour)	Margins	OP2-021 GP_Reported and payroll tabs; DLA-002 Tech Pay % and Manager Pay %
18	Operator 3 closed-clinic months, lease schedule, pharmacy products and service lines per visit	Volume, Pricing, Margins, Unit economics, Same-store sales	Operator 3 closed-clinic months; OP3-013 lease schedule (pp. 72–62); OP3-004 earlier datacube
20	Operator 6 all-comp SSS revenue; rent basis; rebates in COGS; SLB gross/net pairs; finance leases	Margins, Unit economics, Same-store sales, Valuation, Leverage	OP6-009 Apr–May-26 update revenue block; OP6 QoE rent roll; OP6-012 model; Operator 6 SLB closing statements; OP6-010 CIP lease schedule
20	Operator 7 visit count definition, go-forward rent, capex schedule	Volume, Margins, Unit economics, Same-store sales	OP7-005 tab 9 definitions and tab 13 go-forward rent; OP7-003 capex schedule; company confirmation
21	Operator 8 rent from 2024, day-adjusted comps, clinic capital, acquisition dates, E1 conflicts, price split	Volume, Pricing, Margins, Unit economics, Same-store sales, Cash flow	OP8-012 Lease Summary, fixed assets and acquisition dates; OP8-010 visit count tab; OP8-010 vs OP8-012 reconciliation; OP8-005 p.4 manager reports
21	Operator 5 actual clinic TB, leverage, capex, greenfield ramp and vendor programmes	Pricing, Margins, Unit economics, Cash flow, Leverage	OP5-009 FDD appendices; OP5-009 / OP5-011 / OP5-004 debt schedules; OP5-011 fixed-asset tab; Operator 5 2012–20 clinic P&Ls (not in folder); OP5-007 vendor partner list; OP5-010 p.37
23	Operator 5 service line-item definition break (2021)	Pricing	OP5-006 line-item definition from the company
23	Operator 4 / Operator 9 SSS definition, volume, clinic data, rebate ledgers, per-deal add-on EBITDA, at-close EBITDA	Volume, Pricing, Margins, Unit economics, Same-store sales, Valuation	OP4-005 underlying KPI file (not in folder); OP4 audit Note 2 detail; OP4-005 p.19 deal list; OP4-005 pp.3, 20 and 43; compliance certificate
24	Operator 9 opco cash flow (E1 consolidated with real-estate VIEs)	Cash flow	OP4-001/002 consolidating schedules
25	Deal C D2.1 traffic, clinic rent, site overview	Volume, Margins, Unit economics, Same-store sales, Cash flow, Valuation, Leverage	DLC-001 site database; DLC-008 site overview

#	GAP IN THE EVIDENCE	AREAS	FILE OR REQUEST THAT WOULD CLOSE IT
26	Deal B internal QoE, bottom quartile, pipeline, earlier datapacks, DD answers	Volume, Margins, Unit economics, Same-store sales, Cash flow, Valuation, Leverage	DLB-031 internal QoE; DLB-023; DLB-030; DLB-014/015/016; DLB-021; DD answers received in part on 1 October 2026 (DLB Ares Credit Group Diligence Responses, DLB-033)
27	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 clinic-level cash rent; second clinic-trends vintage	Volume, Margins	QLX-024 SPL4 clinic cash rent reconciled to SPL1 book rent; QLX-030
28	Wellness Clinic Franchisor like-for-like wellness-visit price and count	Volume, Pricing	QLX-002 `1.4.12 Wellness Visit Price & Count [file]`
28	Emergency Operator 2 market-level data	Unit economics	CO2-023 `2.9.1_Project Vulcan - Markets [file]`
30	Like-for-like service or professional-fee price at a second operator; veterinarian cost per billed hour; CPI emergency-and-specialty split	Pricing	Deal A and Operator 3 POS job-code price files; Operator 3 professional-fee history; payroll-hours extracts; CUUR0000SS6205301 from the BLS flat file
31	GFC coverage (volume, pricing, four-wall) and pre-GFC / 2019 clinic P&L at a second operator	Volume, Pricing, Margins	Deal A 10-K FY08–10 traffic text (if disclosed); pre-2010 Deal A clinic data; Operator 2 / Operator 10 clinic P&Ls 2007–09 (none found)
32	Visits per customer and retention across cycles	Volume	DLC-016 retention analysis; DLB-007 customers summary
33	Public context gaps: industry-association shipments before 2017, pet age before 2020, Emergency Operator 6 before 2025	Volume, Same-store sales	Industry-association factbook (paywalled); industry data provider pet-age releases 2010–19; Emergency Operator 6 SEDAR filings
32	BEA real veterinary spending is a deflated dollar series, not a visit count	Volume	No public count of veterinary visits was found in public sources
34	Corporate overhead on one taxonomy	Margins	Department-level corporate P&Ls (DLA-006/007, OP1-016, OP5-011 Corp tab, OP8-010)
34	Covenant cushions, FCCR on one definition, Operator 1 pre-2014 financing	Leverage	Compliance certificates in OP1-048, OP4-005, OP8-014; 2012 Ares Credit Group memo
35	Operator 5 2023 sale multiple; Operator 8 platform EBITDA period	Valuation	Operator 5 sponsor closing documents (not in folder); OP8-003 LBO tab / OP8-002 p.28
37	Deal A Q1 FY27 tier-4 units non-integer; Deal A rebate definition DLA-017 vs DLA-003	Pricing	DLA-016 P&L!G277 formula; 10-K vendor-rebate disclosure; DLA-017 source schedule
38	Operator 6 2025 comp ticket conflict	Pricing	OP6-009 visit counts plus same-store revenue by clinic
38	Deal B 2021–26 E2 draft vs post-audit	Cash flow	DLB-010 and DLB-031; DLB-022 final QoE

Source: notes C-02, C-09, C-19, C-29, C-40, C-55, C-63 and C-73; Part 04 section C to Part 04 section F. Several rows name supplied files from which no figure in this document is drawn; the Sources table shows them with no Evidence-index rows

Limits of the public signals

Public signals are read beside the company records and are no evidence of clinic economics. Every figure is dated: pages were read on 30 September 2026, except three Census Bureau and Office of Management and Budget datasets whose read date is not recorded and which carry their document dates, and public series were retrieved on 28 September 2026. Ratings, counts, open roles and posted prices move: the value of record is the one read on the date given, as held in CreditSwan's capture of the page, and a later reading that differs is a change, not an error.

Coverage is uneven, and each figure carries its own limit. Clinic-level customer ratings cover 82 of Deal B's 96 location pages and samples of one to six clinics for the others; no Deal A clinic rating was read. Employer ratings rest on 4 to 1,870 reviews at the operators in the supplied documents (4 to 1,865 on one employer-review site; Deal A 1,870 on another); fewer than 44 is anecdote. Complaint counts are those of one bureau's profiles, which need not cover every clinic. The footprint figures cover the clinics on each company's public pages: 72 of about 86 Deal C clinics, with few State 20 clinics listed; Deal A's 924 listed clinics against 983 in its FY26 clinic-level file; Deal B's 96 location pages against 103 clinics in the supplied documents. Operator 1 is mapped for its own banner only, so competition is understated where its other banners trade. The test of Deal A's loss-making clinics covers the FY26 estate; the 165 clinics in the FY23 to FY25 clinic-level tabs of Deal A's clinic-level EBITDA file (DLA-003) that are not in its FY26 tab, and so not in the survivor KPI file (DLA-002), carry no address in the supplied files. The public measures for Deal B's 2025–26 cohort rest on 21 of 26 clinics.

Where public sources and supplied documents differ, the text says which is used. The supplied documents govern on clinic counts, transaction terms and financing terms. Deal B's trade-area figures are the one case where both are shown: the company's and the census figures are not on the

same basis, and neither is treated as a correction of the other. Public sources give the completion of the Operator 1 and Operator 29 transaction as 20 August 2026 [F, PUB-0020].

No search was run of court dockets, agency enforcement records beyond the two releases cited, lien filings or paid data services. Social-media reach, web traffic and advertising-library counts were not read. Nothing is inferred from what was not found: the absence of a public trace is not evidence for or against any reading, and what was looked for and not found is carried as a request to the company.

Secondary reports are used three times, each with the reporter named and tagged [U]; a [U] figure never appears in a title, an In brief row or Part 01. Third-party estimates are not used.

I · Overview detail

The Overview's summaries rest on the placements, request counts, evidence-depth notes and coverage tables set out here, each as it stood on the evidence named with it.

This section holds the secondary material behind Part 01: how to read the evidence-depth grid of Part 01 section D, the further placements of the three deals and the requests by deal behind Part 01 section E, and the coverage tables behind Part 01 section F.

01 D Sector in brief: reading the evidence-depth grid

The grid shows where a statement across operators rests on actual figures and where it rests on pro forma or projected ones: 107 of the 126 cells hold more than five actual figures. It counts figures, not earnings definitions, so the valuation and leverage cells, most of which hold actual figures, still describe multiples struck on adjusted or pro forma deal earnings (Part 04 section A, Part 04 section B). Volume, pricing and margins rest mostly on actual clinic and company records.

01 E Across the deals: further placements and requests by deal

Three further placements are valid on the definitions the files allow (Part 04 section F): same-store sales on the common definition, the share of adjusted EBITDA that is adjustments, and the entry multiple of add-ons. On them Deal A sits below the survivor-base peers on comparable sales (+1.1% in FY26); Deal C's +4.5% in 2025 was inside the +1.9% to +5.1% range of Operator 6, Operator 3 and Deal B (Deal B +5.1% with closed clinics dropped, as for Deal C; +4.7% with closed clinics kept until closure; Part 07 section F), and its −0.4% for the twelve months to July 2026 is 3.9 points below Deal B, the one peer with a 2026 reading (Part 07 section F); Deal B's FY2025 adjustment share is the highest in the set, and Deal C's 30 tuck-ins, at 3.25x net of sale-leaseback proceeds, cost less than peer add-ons, though three of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database cost 6.2–6.6x gross, on cash consideration, two of them single clinics bought with a sale-leaseback (2.9x and 4.2x net of the sale proceeds) (Exhibit 9.28).

Exhibit 9.28 — Deal A's FY26 comparable sales sit below the survivor-base peers and Deal C's LTM Jul-26 reading 3.9 points below Deal B's; Deal B's FY2025 adjustment share is the highest in the set; net of sale-leaseback proceeds, Deal C's tuck-ins cost less than peer add-ons

The three live deals against the comparators that share each definition, on three common measures: same-store sales (%), adjustment share of EBITDA (ratio) and add-on entry multiple (x); latest period for each, FY2025 to LTM Jul-26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A All Clinics KPI Report (DLA-0788); Deal B DLB Datapack and Financing Model (Jul-26 RF); Deal C Site-Level Database and Internal Diligence Exhibits; Operator 3 Datacube, CIP and lender model; Operator 6 readout materials, Investment Committee Memo and Valuation Multiple Summary; Operator 4 financial statements and IC Memo; Operator 8 and Operator 2 situation updates; fact rows per bar in the data file · Basis: Filled = actual (same-store sales); hollow = pro forma or company-presented (adjustment shares and entry multiples). Same-store sales exclude closed clinics, except Deal B's, which keeps closed clinics until closure; the others are upper bounds. Deal B's FY2025 adjustment share is consolidated, Deal B Wellness Clinics included (Part 06 section D). Deal C's 3.25x is across all 30 tuck-ins, net of sale-leaseback proceeds; gross, on cash consideration, seven of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database cost 2.4–3.2x and the other three 6.2–6.6x, two of them single clinics bought with a sale-leaseback (2.9x and 4.2x net of the sale proceeds) (Part 07 section C). The peers' same-store readings are for 2025 and the twelve months to August 2025; Deal C's 2025 reading (+4.5%) sat inside the +1.9% to +5.1% range of Operator 6,

Operator 3 and Deal B (Deal B +5.1% with closed clinics dropped, as for Deal C; +4.7% with closed clinics kept until closure; Part 07 section F)

Exhibit 9.29 — Of the 68 requests for information at October 2026, 25 concern Deal A, 25 Deal B and 18 Deal C; 19 are of the highest priority

Number of requests for information by deal and priority tier, as listed in the closing section of each deal part, including those arising from the files of 1 October 2026 (two received in part)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: The numbered requests for information in this document (Deal A 25, Deal B 25, Deal C 18; Part 05 section G, Part 06 section H, Part 07 section G) · Basis: Counts of numbered requests. The three priority tiers are those of the lists: highest priority, next priority, if readily available. All items are addressed to the companies and their bankers, through Ares Credit Group; requests that bear only on the proposed financings are listed in Part 08

Every item in the three lists is addressed to the company and its bankers, through Ares Credit Group, and can be forwarded as it stands; 19 of the 68 are of the highest priority, and two, the Deal A clinic list and Deal B's under-performing units, have been received in part (Part 05 section G, Part 06 section H, Part 07 section G).

01 F Evidence base: files by folder and coverage by environment

Ares Credit Group supplied 266 source files in 13 folders by 30 September 2026, with 51 byte-identical copies registered and not counted (one industry primer is held in both the Operator 7 and Deal B folders and counted in each): Deal A 21, Deal B 28, Deal C 16, Operator 1 46 across five vintages from 2014 to 2026, Operator 2 23, Operator 5 13, Operator 6 12, Operator 3 13, Operator 4 and Operator 9 11, Operator 7 8, Operator 8 14, wellness clinics 30 and emergency and specialty hospitals 34 [F, note C-01]. The six files received on 1 October 2026 are listed in Part 09 section E.

Exhibit 9.30 — Only Deal A's record reaches all seven economic environments from before 2008 to 2026; Operator 5 stops before the 2024 to 2026 soft period, and Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 7 begin in 2021 or later

Periods covered and environments reached by each platform's actual (A) figures, with the level of detail, 1995 to 2026

PLATFORM	FOLDERS / VINTAGES	PERIODS COVERED (ACTUAL FIGURES; KEY SERIES)	DATA TYPES	CLINIC-LEVEL DATA (PERIOD)	CASH-FLOW EVIDENCE	BEFORE 2008	2008–09 RECESSION	2010–19 EXPANSION	2020	2021 REOPENING	2022–23 INFLATION	2024–26 SOFT PERIOD
Operator 1	Operator 1 2014/2018/2021/2023/2026 (46)	Jan-07 – Aug-26; clinic P&L Jun-07 – Nov-17; same-store sales on the common definition to 2022	clinic P&Ls, IC memos, lender decks, audits 2019–21, models	Yes: clinic P&Ls Jun-07 – Nov-17; comp sales summary Jan-19 – Mar-23 (OP1-041; SSS only, no volume split); no clinic P&L after Nov-17	Yes: audited CF FY2019–21 (OP1-040)	–	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Operator 2	Operator 2 2018/2020/2021/2024/2026 (23)	Jan-06 – Aug-26; Operator 10 clinic-month Jan-06 – May-18; platform clinic databook Jan-17 – Mar-21	clinic databooks, QoE, lender decks, situation updates	Yes, Jan-06 – Mar-21; deck-level only after	Partial: compliance and lender bridges from reported EBITDA, FY2021–25 [M]	–	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Deal A	Deal A (21) + SEC EDGAR	Apr-95 – Sep-26; 10-K FY1996–FY26, 10-Q Q1 FY27; clinic EBITDA FY23–23; survivor KPI FY20 – Q1 FY27	10-K/10-Q, clinic-level EBITDA, KPI files, Ares Credit Group IC and term sheet	Yes, FY23–FY26 clinic EBITDA (DLA-003) and survivor KPIs FY20 – Q1 FY27 (DLA-002)	Yes: 10-K cash-flow statements FY1996–FY26	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Operator 4 / Operator 9	Operator 4 (11)	2010 – Jun-26; audited Operator 4 HoldCo FY23–21 + Q1-26; Operator 9 audits FY23–21; 16-year SSS panel 2010–25	audited FS, IC memo, sponsor model, market study	No	Yes: audited CF (Operator 4 HoldCo; Operator 9 direct-method)	–	–	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Operator 5	Operator 5 (13)	Jan-92 – Jul-23; clinic tickets and pharmacy units 2017 – Jun-23; clinic P&L CY2020 – LTM Mar-23 (PF)	KPI datapacks, FDD, CIM, buyer model	Yes, 2017 – Jun-23 (44 clinics volume; 34–38 clinics P&L, PF)	No audited CF; FDD without capex schedule	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	–

PLATFORM	FOLDERS / VINTAGES	PERIODS COVERED (ACTUAL FIGURES; KEY SERIES)	DATA TYPES	CLINIC-LEVEL DATA (PERIOD)	CASH-FLOW EVIDENCE	BEFORE 2008	2008–09 RECESSION	2010–19 EXPANSION	2020	2021 REOPENING	2022–23 INFLATION	2024–26 SOFT PERIOD
Operator 6	Operator 6 (12)	Jan-21 – Aug-26; company data 2021 – TTM Mar-26; 31 add-ons	valuation summary, CIP, IC memo, QoE, lender model	Deal-level clinic EBITDA only (31 deals / 46 units)	Model and company split [M] only	–	–	–	–	✓	✓	✓
Operator 3	Operator 3 (13)	Jan-21 – Aug-26; datacube Apr-21 – Aug-25 (survivor)	datacube, Accounting Firm 3 QoE, IC memo, CIP	Yes, Apr-21 – Aug-25, survivor only	QoE/model [M]	–	–	–	–	✓	✓	✓
Operator 7	Operator 7 (8)	Jan-23 – Aug-26; QoE P&L Jan-23 – Jan-26; KPI Jan-24 – Jun-26	QoE (two), credit databook, IC memo	Yes, Jan-23 – Jun-26	QoE cash summaries [M]	–	–	–	–	–	✓	✓
Operator 8	Operator 8 (14)	Jan-10 – Mar-26; clinic-year 2021–24; clinic P&L 2021 – LTM Mar-26	Accounting Firm 2 FDD, clinic databooks, lender updates	Yes, 2021 – Mar-26	FDD bridge [M]	–	–	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Deal B (general practice and preventive, with DBW)	Deal B (28)	Clinic KPI details to Jul-26, including months before purchase for legacy clinics (start month not established from the rows cited); four-wall Jan-23 – Jul-26	datapacks (DLB and DBW), Accounting Firm 2 QoE, IC memos, term sheets	Yes, Jan-23 – Jul-26 (read once from the source)	Accounting Firm 2 pre-audit quality-of-earnings figures against post-audit pro forma EBITDA; audit AJE file (DLB-010)	s	s	s	s	✓	✓	✓
Deal C	Deal C (16)	Site-level database Jan-22 – Jul-26; one actual figure each for 2020 and 2021	site database, CIP, QoE, 2025 audit	Yes, Jan-22 – Jul-26 (read once from the source)	2025 audit (DLC-014)	–	–	–	✓	✓	✓	✓
Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (wellness clinic)	Wellness clinic / QL1 (14)	Mar-95 – Dec-25; clinic trends 2018 – P06-25; Accounting Firm 4 clinic P&L FY23 – TTM Oct-25	FDD, clinic trends, IC memo	Yes, 2018 – Oct-25	Accounting Firm 4 bridge [M]	–	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic)	Wellness clinic / Wellness Clinic Franchisor (19)	Jan-14 – Feb-26; system clinic-year 2014 – Aug-25	KPI per clinic, QoE, CIP, LBO model	Yes, 2014 – Aug-25 (system incl. franchisees)	QoE/model	–	–	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (wellness clinic)	Wellness clinic / Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (1)	Dec-16 – Oct-25; memo figures 2021 – LTM Jul-25	Ares Credit Group memo (CIM/QoE figures reproduced)	No (corporate KPIs only)	Memo only	–	–	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Emergency Operator 1 / Emergency Operator 4 (emergency and specialty)	Emergency and specialty / Emergency Operator 1 (13)	Jan-05 – Dec-19; Emergency Operator 1 2010 – LTM Sep-18; Emergency Operator 4 segment 2010–17	IC memos, lender presentations	Emergency Operator 4 clinic data LTM Sep-18; Emergency Operator 1 cohorts 2013–16	CIM bridges to adjusted EBITDA	✓	✓	✓	–	–	–	–
Emergency Operator 3 (emergency and specialty)	Emergency and specialty / Emergency Operator 3 (11)	Jan-07 – Nov-25; facility P&L 2021 – LTM Aug-23	lender presentations, IC memo, quarterly updates	Yes, 13 owned clinics LTM Aug-23; facility months Aug-22 – Sep-25	Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA / FCCR	–	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Emergency Operator 2 (emergency and specialty)	Emergency and specialty / Emergency Operator 2 (15)	Jan-07 – Mar-25; clinic P&L 2019 – Jun-23	clinic P&Ls (CO2-015), lender decks	Yes, 2019 – Jun-23 (PF recast)	Lender bridges	–	–	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Source: Computation notes C-01 and C-08; environments are defined in Part 09 section C · Basis: Actual (A) figures only; "s" marks an environment Deal B reaches only through months before purchase (seller-period history); a tick can rest on very few figures, as Exhibit

9.31 shows. Environments are assigned by period end as defined in Part 09 section C: "Before 2008" covers periods ending before July 2007 and the 2008–09 recession July 2007 to June 2009

Exhibit 9.31 — Most actual figures sit in the 2010–19 expansion and the 2024 to 2026 soft period; before 2008 four in five are Deal A's, and through the 2008–09 recession most are Operator 1's

Number of actual (A) figures by platform and economic environment, all measures; documents supplied through 28 September 2026

PLATFORM	BEFORE 2008	2008–09 RECESSION	2010–19 EXPANSION	2020	2021 REOPENING	2022–23 INFLATION	2024–26 SOFT PERIOD	ACTUAL FIGURES
Operator 1	0	639	6,156	334	280	336	82	7,702
Operator 2	0	51	1,362	214	258	92	193	2,227
Deal A	103	35	908	241	256	743	1,911	4,288
Operator 4	0	0	10	1	16	86	427	541
Operator 9	0	0	0	0	1	65	194	266
Operator 5	2	9	1,049	431	434	793	0	2,725
Operator 6	0	0	0	0	5	72	643	726
Operator 3	0	0	0	0	4	361	1,031	1,391
Operator 7	0	0	0	0	0	51	818	869
Operator 8	0	0	28	8	103	511	443	1,077
Deal B (general practice and preventive, with DBW)	21	10	49	7	44	511	3,433	4,171
Deal C	0	0	0	1	1	77	1,369	1,394
Wellness Clinic Operator 1	0	3	42	26	82	370	717	1,206
Wellness Clinic Franchisor	0	0	151	65	103	316	570	1,182
Wellness Clinic Operator 2	0	0	1	1	4	152	374	512
Emergency Operator 1 (incl. Emergency Operator 4, Emergency Operator 5)	2	11	667	0	0	0	0	656
Emergency Operator 3	0	1	5	3	23	291	118	447
Emergency Operator 2	0	0	50	47	187	877	92	1,200

Source: Computation note C-01; environments are defined in Part 09 section C · Basis: Counts of actual figures of every measure (volume, price, margin, transaction and financing), so a large count is not a large count of any one measure; the total includes three figures with no environment (Deal A two, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 one). Deal B's figures before 2021 are all from months before purchase (seller-period history). Environments are assigned by period end as defined in Part 09 section C: "Before 2008" covers periods ending before July 2007 and the 2008–09 recession July 2007 to June 2009

J · Sector detail

Each sector finding of Part 03 rests on the operator tables, clinic-base caveats and limits set out here section by section, on the evidence supplied to 30 September 2026; Deal A's clinic figures on Ares Credit Group's co-op-included basis, which rest on the clinic files supplied by 30 September and Ares Credit Group's basis, and the pro forma for the 824 clinics kept, which rests on the 119-clinic list of 1 October 2026, are read in Part 05.

This section holds the secondary evidence behind Part 03. For each of sections A to F it gives the reading with its check status, what the evidence shows, the operator tables and charts, the public signals, what is durable, temporary or company-specific, and what the evidence cannot show. Each section of Part 03 opens on its finding, its charts and one table, and links here.

03 A Volume consistency: supporting evidence

Volume in general practice and preventive care is flat at best over a cycle: visits per clinic fell at every operator where they can be measured, and real household spending on veterinary care took until 2021 to regain its 2007 level. Flat comparable visits and falling visits per clinic are durable, the 2020 shock and part of the 2024–26 softness are temporary, and Deal A's 33.9% fall in survivor comp traffic from FY19 to FY26 is the main company-specific finding.

Our reading on the evidence supplied to date. Customer volume in general practice veterinary care and in preventive care and pharmacy, read as comparable visits, has been flat over the long term rather than growing, and outside 2020 it has moved in a narrow band (Part 03 section A). Comparable visits were roughly flat in the 2010–19 expansion, with a median of +0.3% across 21 operator-years and a range of −10.3% to +5.8%, and 18 of those 21 observations come from the Operator 2 data room [A1-P5-008]. Comp traffic fell 13–20% over 2020 (20% in Operator 2's worst quarter, Q2-20) and had not regained its pre-COVID level at any of the three core operators with data, and it declined in 4 of 6 core operator-years tagged SOFT24-26 (3 of 5 operators, all on CLOSE-RETRO bases) [A1-P5-011]. Visits per clinic fell at every operator with clinic counts [note C-02]. As public-series context rather than operator evidence, industry real veterinary spending per pet in U.S. households fell about 14% from 2005 to 2009, held 12–14% below its 2005 level through 2019, came within about 2% of it in 2022 and was 12% below it in 2025 [BEA_PCEVETSVC_A:2005–2025; PETHH_M12:Dec-05–Dec-25]. Revenue durability in this subsector rests on ticket, not on volume; Part 03 section B tests how far ticket can carry it [note C-02]. **Check status:** Checked a second time against the source. The direction holds at Deal A, Operator 10, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 3 and Operator 6. Four limits apply: the expansion median leans on the Operator 2 data room; the SOFT24-26 counts mix clinic bases; REOPEN21 changes sign between month-majority and period-end tags; and the BEA series is context, not operator volume. **Operators / environments:** eight core parent companies with comp volume on a stated base (Operator 2 with its Operator 10, Operator 14, Operator 16 and Operator 12 seller-period chains; Operator 5; Operator 1; Deal A; Operator 3; Operator 6; Operator 8; Operator 7), across all six D10 environments from GFC to SOFT24-26; Deal C and Deal B company comps are PF and never pooled; wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only [note C-08]. Three findings do not meet the three-operator test and carry no weight in the reading: GFC volume (two core operators), industry real veterinary spending per household pet (public series only, used above only as labelled context) and survivorship (quantified at one core operator) [note C-08].

What the evidence shows

In the 2010–19 expansion the median comparable-traffic change was about zero, but individual operator-years were noisy [note C-02]. The EXP10-19 median is +0.3% on 21 operator-years, ranging from −10.3% (Operator 12 2017) to +5.8% (Operator 14 2013), with 37% of observations negative [OP2-0742, OP2-0218]. The sample leans on one data room: 18 of the 21 observations are Operator 2 lineage (20 pre-acquisition seller-period years at Operator 10, Operator 14, Operator 16 and Operator 12, plus Operator 2 2019), Operator 10 alone, a single City 9 chain of about 12 clinics, supplies 9, and the other 3 are Operator 5 2018–19 and Deal A FY20 on its survivor base [note C-02]. Four of the nine Operator 10 years (2009–12) fall in a period when its visit counts shift across all clinics in a way consistent with a promotion or a change in visit count definition, which Part 03 section B excludes (note C-11); without them the median is +0.4% on 20 operator-years, 34% negative, and the Operator 10 index below spans the same years [I; OP2-0655, OP2-0658, OP2-0661, OP2-0664]. Removing Deal A FY20, the only CLOSE-RETRO observation, gives +0.3% on 20 [note C-06]. Chained comp CAGRs over the longest clean windows run from −2.3% (Operator 5 comp tickets 2017–22, COMP, CLOSE-FWD) to +2.9% (Operator 14 2012–17, COMP), and the longest D2.1 traffic series, Operator 10 2006–17, ends at an index of 72.1, or −1.4% a year [OP2-0649, OP2-0679]. The index is 72.3 if clinic 12, whose data are unreliable, is excluded and 76.9 if no clinic-level exclusions are applied [A1-P5-004, A1-P5-005]. Over the same expansion BEA real veterinary spending grew 12.5% (+1.3% a year) and pets in U.S. households grew 8.6% [BEA_PCEVETSVC_A:2010–2019; PETHH_M12:Dec-10–Dec-19]. BEA real veterinary spending is a chained-dollar quantity that also rises with work per visit and includes emergency and specialty hospital work, so the gap is consistent with more work per visit as well as with share loss, and the files cannot separate the two [note C-02].

The 2020 shock cut core comp traffic by 13–20% over the year (20% in Operator 2's worst quarter), and none of the three core operators with data regained 2019 volume before its series ends [note C-02]. Operator 2's consolidated comp visit count fell 20.2% in Q2-20 and 15.1% for the year, and was still −14.0% on an LTM Mar-21 basis (COMP, CLOSE-FWD) [OP2-3509, OP2-3526, OP2-3532]. Operator 5 comp tickets fell 11.4% in 2020 and stood at 76.3% of the 2019 level in 2022 (COMP, CLOSE-FWD) [OP5-3871, OP5-3875, OP5-3879]. Deal A survivor comp patient visits fell 18.6% in FY21 (Apr-20 to Mar-21) and rose only 3.7% in FY22 (SURVIVOR, CLOSE-RETRO) [DLA-0629, DLA-0661]. BEA real veterinary spending regained its Q4-19 level in Q2-21 [BEA_PCEVETSVC_Q:2019Q4–2021Q2]; wellness clinics are read in Part 04 section G. On month-majority tags the COVID20 core median is −15.1% on 3 operator-years and the REOPEN21 median is +3.6% with no negative year; period-end tags show REOPEN21 at −7.6% because they place Deal A's COVID year (FY21, Apr-20 to Mar-21) in REOPEN21 [A1-P5-007, A1-P5-010].

Since 2022 comp traffic has been negative at most core operators, and the exceptions sit on newly assembled or undefined bases [note C-02]. The INFL22-23 core median is −2.4% (4 operator-years, 3 operators) and the SOFT24-26 median is −2.9% (6 operator-years, 5 operators, 57% negative) [A1-P5-009, A1-P5-011]. Every SOFT24-26 decline is on a CLOSE-RETRO base (Deal A FY25 −7.9% and FY26 −3.9% on SURVIVOR, Operator 3 2024 −4.1% and Operator 6 2025 −2.0% on COMP survivor files), which flatters comps where closed clinics were weak, so these declines are if anything understated [DLA-0757, DLA-0789, OP3-0891, OP6-1896]. The two CLOSE-FWD observations are the positive outliers: Operator 8 2025 +7.4% on 21 P&L units with unadjusted days, and Operator 7 2025 +10.9% with no stated visit count definition, concentrated in State 05 clinics acquired in 2021–23 [OP8-2114, OP7-1023, OP7-0909]. Excluding Operator 7, the SOFT24-26 median is −3.9% with 70% of operator-years negative [A1-P5-012]. The company-definition comps at Deal C (FY24 −5.2%, FY25 +0.1%, LTM Jun-26 −1.6%) and Deal B (Q1-26 −6.2%, Q2-26 −5.7%, Jul–Aug-26 −3.3%) are PF and outside every pooled figure, but they point the same way [A1-S002, A1-S003, A1-S004, A1-S037, A1-S038, A1-S039].

Visits per clinic fell at every operator where both visit counts and clinic counts exist. Operator 10 patient visits per clinic fell 12.5% (2007–17, ALL), Operator 5 retail tickets per clinic 11.5% (2017–22, ALL), Operator 2 legacy-clinic patient visits per clinic 7.2% (2019 to LTM Mar-21, SURVIVOR) and Operator 1 pharmacy units per mature clinic 3.3% (FY08–14, COHORT) [OP2-0515, OP2-0627, OP5-3827, OP5-3855, OP2-1584, OP2-3212, OP1-1372,

OP1-1378]. Deal A pets per clinic fell 37.2% on the ALL base (FY17–23) and 29.3% on the SURVIVOR base (FY20–23) [DLA-3246, DLA-3281, DLA-0578, DLA-0773]. Year-to-year volume is noisy even where the trend is flat: the length and severity of parasite season swing pharmacy units by double digits (Operator 1 CY2013 +14.1%, Operator 8 2023 +15.2%) and single-market chains swing by similar amounts (Operator 12 −6.7% in 2016 and −10.3% in 2017) [OP1-5165, OP8-0654, OP2-0739, OP2-0742]. Whether fewer visits carry more work each is mixed, with Deal B ([M]) and Operator 6 in favour and Operator 8 against [A1-S040, A1-S045; OP6-1898; OP8-0657].

Deal A's traffic decline is the deepest in the set: its survivor comp patient visits fell 33.9% from FY19 to FY26 (index 52.1, −6.2% a year), and over FY19–20, which overlaps Operator 5's 2019–22 data, Deal A fell 20.3% against 9.0% at Operator 5; after FY22 the gap to peers is smaller, roughly 1–4 points a year (company-specific findings below) [I; DLA-0597, DLA-0629, DLA-0661, DLA-0693, DLA-0725, DLA-0757, DLA-0789; OP5-3871, OP5-3875, OP5-3879]. Without the filter on clinic opening dates in Deal A's clinic-month extract the FY26 index is 55.7 rather than 52.1 on the same file [A1-P5-003]. The survivor file holds only the 983 clinics open in Aug-26; 819 of them form the FY20 comp base, against 1,084 clinics reported at FY20 year-end, so every clinic closed between FY20 and Aug-26 is absent [DLA-0597, DLA-0381]. The size of that survivorship effect does not meet the three-operator test because only Deal A can be quantified among core operators: its survivor revenue comp beat the public comp by 0.5–2.6 pp a year in FY22–21, and all-clinic pets fell 1.2–3.7 pp a year faster than survivor comp traffic in FY24–23 [DLA-0660, DLA-0357, DLA-0756, DLA-0361; DLA-3273, DLA-3277, DLA-2610].

Two further findings do not meet the three-operator test and are reported as unresolved. GFC operator volume exists for two core operators only: Operator 10 comp patient visits fell 7.0% cumulatively over 2007–08 and Operator 1 comp retail pharmacy units fell 2.9% in FY09, far less than BEA real veterinary spending's 12.5% fall from 2007 to 2009 [I; OP2-0649, OP2-0652, OP1-2139; BEA_PCEVETSVC_A:2007, 2009]. The files cannot say whether the BEA deflator overstates the fall, independents gained share, or the two operators are unrepresentative [note C-02]. The per-pet series is public-series context: real veterinary spending per pet in U.S. households fell 14% from 2005 to 2009, held in an 71.3–77.0 band (2005 = 86) through 2019, peaked at 85.6 in 2022 and was 76.2 in 2025, while real veterinary spending per pet under veterinary care fell 5.2% over 2021–25 as average pet age rose from 10.7 to 11.4 years [I; note C-02; BEA_PCEVETSVC_A, BEA_DVMRRX_A, PETHH_M12, AHDP_PETS_HH, AHDP_AVG_AGE_LV:2021–2025].

Exhibit 9.32 — Median core comp traffic was about zero in the 2010–19 expansion (+0.3%) and negative in every other environment from 2007 to 2026 except the 2021 rebound (+3.6%)

Median annual comp traffic change by environment, %, core operator-years, with range and share negative; 2007 to FY26; operator documents (note C-06)

ENVIRONMENT (D10, MONTH-MAJORITY TAGS)	OPERATOR-YEARS	OPERATORS	MEDIAN	RANGE	SHARE NEGATIVE	EXCL. CLOSE-RETRO: MEDIAN (OPERATOR-YEARS)	EXCL. OPERATOR 7: MEDIAN (OPERATOR-YEARS)	MEDIAN LOCATOR
GFC (period end Jul-07–Jun-09)	2	1 (Operator 10)	−3.7%	−4.4% to −2.9%	100%	−3.7% (2)	−3.7% (2)	note C-06
EXP10-19	21	6 (Operator 2 counted once across its Operator 10 seller period and its consolidated owned period; Operator 14, Operator 16 and Operator 12; Operator 5; Deal A FY20)	+0.3%	−10.3% to +5.8%	37%	+0.3% (20)	+0.3% (21)	A1-P5-008
COVID20	3	3 (Operator 2 2020, Operator 5 2020, Deal A FY21)	−15.1%	−18.6% to −11.4%	100%	−13.3% (2)	−15.1% (3)	A1-P5-007
REOPEN21	2	2 (Operator 5 2021, Deal A FY22)	+3.6%	+3.6% to +3.7%	0%	+3.6% (1)	+3.6% (2)	A1-P5-010
INFL22-23	4	3 (Operator 5 2022, Deal A FY23 and FY24, Operator 3 2023)	−2.4%	−4.8% to +2.6%	67%	−0.8% (1)	−2.4% (4)	A1-P5-009
SOFT24-26	6	5 (Deal A FY25 and FY26, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8, Operator 7)	−2.9%	−7.9% to +10.9%	57%	+8.9% (2: Operator 8, Operator 7)	−3.9% (5), 70% negative	A1-P5-011, A1-P5-012

Source: note C-06. SSS_TRAFFIC_CD (D2.5 on the D2.1 base), annual rows, basis A, core operators only; unweighted medians of operator-years. Clinic bases mixed: COMP CLOSE-FWD (Operator 10, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 7), closure not stated (Operator 14, Operator 16, Operator 12, Operator 8), CLOSE-RETRO (Deal A SURVIVOR, Operator 3 and Operator 6 survivor files). Deal A fiscal years carry month-majority tags (FY20 → EXP10-19, FY21 → COVID20, FY22 → REOPEN21, FY24 → INFL22-23). Deal C and Deal B (company definitions, PF) and Operator 1 (pharmacy units, not traffic) are excluded. Operator 10 2009–12, when its visit counts shift across all clinics in a way consistent with a promotion or a visit count definition change (note C-11), are included in EXP10-19; without them that

median is +0.4% on 20 operator-years [1]. Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital context medians are in note C-06; no rent code applies to volume series

Exhibit 9.33 — Only Operator 10 traffic spans the GFC (2007–17), and seven of eleven core traffic series are survivor-based or have no stated closure rule

Comp volume series by operator: measure, clinic base, closure rule, window and environments reached; 2007 to LTM Jun-26; operator documents (notes C-03, C-08)

OPERATOR (CLASS)	SERIES	CLINIC BASE	CLOSURE CODE	WINDOW (GROWTH YEARS)	YEARS	BASIS	ENVIRONMENTS REACHED
Operator 2 – Operator 10, City 9 (core, seller period)	Comp visit count	COMP (D2.1, own data)	CLOSE-FWD	2007–2017	11	A	GFC, EXP10-19
Operator 2 consolidated (core, owned)	Comp visit count	COMP (D2.1)	CLOSE-FWD	2019–LTM Mar-21	3	A	EXP10-19, COVID20 (LTM Mar-21 is mostly 2020)
Operator 14 (core, pre-Operator 2)	Comp visit count	COMP (D2.1, own data)	n/s	2013–2017	5	A	EXP10-19
Operator 16 (core, pre-Operator 2)	Comp visit count	COMP (D2.1, own data)	n/s	2015–2017	3	A	EXP10-19
Operator 12 (core, pre-Operator 2)	Comp visit count	COMP (D2.1, own data)	n/s	2015–2017	3	A	EXP10-19
Operator 5 (core)	Comp tickets (patient invoices)	COMP (D2.1 annual rule, 34–35 clinics)	CLOSE-FWD	2018–2022	5	A	EXP10-19 to INFL22-23
Operator 5 (core)	Comp retail pharmacy units	COMP (D2.1 annual rule)	CLOSE-FWD	2018–2022	5	A	EXP10-19 to INFL22-23
Operator 1 (core)	Comp retail pharmacy units, FY Jun–May	COMP (D2.1)	CLOSE-FWD	FY09–FY14	6	A	GFC, EXP10-19
Operator 1 (core)	Comp retail pharmacy units, CY	COMP (D2.1)	CLOSE-FWD	2010–YTD Nov-17	8	A	EXP10-19
Operator 1 (core)	Comp SL pharmacy units incl. clinic wholesale, CY	COMP (D2.1)	CLOSE-FWD	2010–YTD Nov-17	8	A	EXP10-19
Deal A (core)	Survivor comp patient visits, FY Apr–Mar	SURVIVOR (983 clinics open Aug-26)	CLOSE-RETRO	FY20–Q1 FY27	8	A	EXP10-19 to SOFT24-26
Operator 3 (core)	Comp visit count; comp pharmacy units	COMP (D2.1) on survivor datacube	CLOSE-RETRO	2023–LTM Aug-25	3	A	INFL22-23, SOFT24-26
Operator 6 (core)	Comp visit count (= invoice count); comp billed hours	COMP (D2.1), survivor clinic list	CLOSE-RETRO	2025–LTM May-26	3; 2	A	SOFT24-26
Operator 8 (core)	Comp visit count	COMP (D2.1, 21 P&L units)	n/s	2025	1	A	SOFT24-26
Operator 8 (core)	Same-store pharmacy units; labour hours	COMP (company "Same Clinic ('22)")	n/s	2022–2024; 2022–2023	3; 2	A	INFL22-23, SOFT24-26
Operator 7 (core)	Comp visit count, definition not stated	COMP (D2.1)	CLOSE-FWD	2025–LTM Jun-26	2	A	SOFT24-26
Deal C (core, not pooled)	Company comp visit count, working-day and blackout adjusted	COMP-CO (first-full-month entry; survivor)	n/s	FY23–LTM Jun-26	20 points	PF	INFL22-23, SOFT24-26
Deal B (core, not pooled)	Company comp visit count, weekday aligned	COMP-CO (88 clinics)	n/s	Q1-26–Jul–Aug-26	15 points	PF	SOFT24-26

Source: note C-08 (comp-growth series); closure codes from note C-03. n/s = closure rule not stated in the source. "Points" for Deal C and Deal B count monthly and quarterly company-comp readings, not years. The eleven core traffic series are the Operator 2 lineage five, Operator 5 tickets, Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8 and Operator 7 comp visit counts; Operator 1 series are pharmacy units, not traffic. Level and per-clinic series (ALL, SURVIVOR, COHORT, POOLED) are counted in note C-08 and are not printed as a list. No rent code applies

Exhibit 9.34 — COVID cut core comp traffic by 13–20% over 2020 (20% in Operator 2's worst quarter), and none of the three core operators with traffic data regained 2019 volume before its series ends

Drawdown and recovery of comp traffic, %, by operator, 2019 to FY26; operator documents and BEA quarterly real veterinary spending (note C-04)

OPERATOR (CLASS)	MEASURE (CLINIC BASE; CLOSURE)	DRAWDOWN	RECOVERY	BASIS	ROWS
Operator 2 consolidated (core)	Comp visit count (COMP D2.1; CLOSE-FWD)	Q2-20 −20.2%; 2020 −15.1%	Not recovered by data end: Q1-21 −9.1%, LTM Mar-21 −14.0%	A	OP2-3509, OP2-3526, OP2-3518, OP2-3532
Operator 5 (core)	Comp tickets (COMP D2.1 annual; CLOSE-FWD)	2020 −11.4%	2021 +3.6%, 2022 −0.8%; 2022 at 76.3% of 2019 [I]	A	OP5-3871, OP5-3875, OP5-3879
Deal A (core)	Survivor comp patient visits, FY21 = Apr-20–Mar-21 (SURVIVOR; CLOSE-RETRO)	−18.6%	FY22 +3.7%; FY22 index 66.7 and FY26 index 52.1 (FY19 = 86) [I]	A	DLA-0597, DLA-0629, DLA-0661, DLA-0789
Operator 1 (core)	Comp **sales** Apr-20, revenue, company definition	−26%	n/a	[M]	P5-S002
Deal A (core)	Comp **sales** Apr-20, revenue, as stated in Ares Credit Group's February 2021 Operator 1 transaction memo (OP1-033 p.31)	−35%	n/a	A (revenue)	OP1-7848
Industry (public series)	BEA real veterinary spending, Q4-19 to Q2-20	−12.5%	Q4-19 level regained Q2-21	public	BEA_PCEVETSVC_Q

Source: rows in the Rows column (note C-04); public series BEA_PCEVETSVC_Q (BEA, retrieved 28 September 2026). Revenue rows are labelled and are not volume. Deal A FY20 (Apr-19–Mar-20, −5.4%, DLA-0597) carries the EXP10-19 tag under month-majority tagging and is the pre-COVID base here. No rent code applies

Exhibit 9.35 — Deal A's survivor comp traffic fell to 52.1 in FY26 (FY19 = 86), deeper and longer than any other core operator's comp traffic index; Operator 10's low was 68.0 (2014) and Operator 5's 75.6 (2020).

Comp traffic index (visit count, patient invoices or pets seen), own base year = 86; annual, 2006 to FY26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A All Clinics KPI Report FY20–Q1 FY27 (DLA-0597 to DLA-0789); Operator 2 GB Vet KPIs, historical (June 2018; OP2-0649 to OP2-0679); Operator 5 Volume Trends 2017–YTD June 2023 (OP5-3863 to OP5-3879); Operator 3 Datacube, 31 August 2025 (OP3-0887, OP3-0891); Operator 6 Visit Count per Working Day, 2026 acquisition update (OP6-1896) · Basis: Actual (A) for every point; base-year points are 86 by construction. Clinic base differs by series: Deal A survivor clinics (CLOSE-RETRO); Operator 10 and Operator 5 comp clinics (CLOSE-FWD); Operator 3 and Operator 6 comp clinics on survivor files (CLOSE-RETRO). Each point sits at the midpoint of its period; Deal A's fiscal year ends in March (FY19 = Apr-18 to Mar-19). Partial or overlapping windows (LTM, year to date, single quarters) are not chained and not drawn

Exhibit 9.36 — Median core comp traffic was negative in 4 of 6 environments between 2007 and 2025; the SOFT24-26 median of −2.9% becomes +8.9% only when survivor-base series are removed, which leaves two operators.

Median YoY comp traffic change by environment, %, with min–max and operator-year counts; 2007 to 2025

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator comp traffic series from the documents Ares Credit Group supplied: Deal A All Clinics KPI Report FY20–Q1 FY27; Operator 2 GB Vet KPIs (June 2018), Operator 14 KPIs and Clinic Level Databook (June 2021); Operator 5 Volume Trends 2017–YTD June 2023; Operator 3 Datacube (31 August 2025); Operator 6 Visit Count per Working Day; Operator 8 Operator 8 Databook (Mar-26); Operator 7 Credit Databook (5 August 2026). Fact rows in the data file · Basis: Actual (A). Core = general practice and preventive care operators; comp traffic = comp visit count, patient invoices or pets (SSS_TRAFFIC_CD). Each operator-year is assigned to the environment holding most of its months. Unweighted medians of operator-years on mixed clinic bases (CLOSE-FWD and CLOSE-RETRO). Excluding survivor-base series leaves one operator in REOPEN21 and INFL22-23 and two (Operator 7, Operator 8) in SOFT24-26

Exhibit 9.37 — Visits per clinic fell at every core operator where visit and clinic counts both exist, by 3.3% at Operator 1 (FY08–14) to 37.2% at Deal A (FY17–23, all clinics)

Cumulative change in visits (patient visits, tickets or pharmacy units) per clinic over each operator's longest window, %, windows between 2007 and 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Ares Credit Group D&S Update memo on Deal A, 15 September 2026 (DLA-3246, DLA-3281); Deal A clinic KPI report FY20 to Q1 FY27 (DLA-0578, DLA-0773); Operator 2 KPI history (OP2-0515, OP2-0627) and 2021 situation update (OP2-1584, OP2-3212); Operator 5

volume trends 2017 to June 2023 (OP5-3827, OP5-3855); Operator 1 model by clinic vintage (OP1-1372, OP1-1378) · Basis: A; clinic base as labelled on each row (all clinics, surviving clinics, mature-clinic cohort)

Revenue in this subsector has grown through the ticket, not through more patient visits per clinic [I, note C-02]. Deal A's decline is the steepest in the set on either clinic base [I; DLA-3246, DLA-0578].

Exhibit 9.38 — Real household spending on veterinary care fell 12.5% in 2007–09, 6.6% in 2020 and 7.7% in 2022–24; the 2007 level was regained only in 2021, and the 2022 peak not by 2025

Real personal consumption of veterinarian services, and pets in U.S. households; index, 2007 = 86; calendar years 2005 to 2025

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: BEA, NIPA 2.1.3U line 171, real (Fisher quantity) index of personal consumption expenditure on veterinarian services (PCEVETSVC), annual; household pet-population series via FRED, pets in U.S. households (PETHH_M12), December observation; both retrieved 2026-09-28 · Basis: Actual (A). Spending is a real, price-adjusted quantity index, not dollars; rebased here from 2017 = 86 to 2007 = 86. Shaded spans run from 2007, 2019 and 2022 to the following low and carry the fall in real spending. 2007 was not the high: spending was higher in 2005 and 2006, and from the 2005 high the fall to 2009 was 15.1%, regained in 2022. The 2019 level was regained in 2021; the 2022 peak had not been regained by 2025 (−6.6% against 2022). Over the same three spans pets in U.S. households changed by −2.1%, −9.3% and +2.7%; their own low after 2007 was 2011 (−2.3%), they passed the 2007 level in 2015 and the 2019 level in 2024

Real household spending on veterinary services fell 12.5% from 2007 to 2009 and took until 2021 to regain its 2007 level; it fell 6.6% in 2020 and was above its 2019 level again in 2021; and it fell 7.7% from 2022 to 2024 and had not regained its 2022 peak by 2025 [I, BEA_PCEVETSVC_A:2005–2025]. Pets in U.S. households moved much less in the two falls outside 2020 (−2.1% over 2007–09 and +2.7% over 2022–24), so demand for veterinary care can fall while the pet population holds [I, PETHH_M12:Dec-07–Dec-24]. For volume, the industry record shows recovery measured in years rather than quarters, and the core operators with data recovered less than this aggregate after 2020 (Exhibit 9.34). The series is a deflated dollar measure that includes emergency and specialty hospital work; it is not a count of visits at general practice and preventive operators and cannot show any one operator's volume [note C-02].

Public signals

Two public signals add to the demand series shown above (series retrieved 28 September 2026; other pages read on 30 September 2026).

Vaccinations have moved away from non-clinic channels. An industry pet-owner survey puts the share of vaccinations given outside a veterinary clinic (retail and mobile vaccine events) at 25% in 2025 [F, PUB-0001], against 28% in 2018 [F, PUB-0002]. The measure is a survey and covers all vaccinations, not general practice and preventive work alone.

Long-acting parasiticides are the part of the preventive market that has grown. Shipments of long-acting parasiticide doses, reported by an animal health industry association, were 33.6 million units in 2025 against 28.8 million in 2019 [F, AHTA_REPL_LT]; shipments of other preventive doses were 197.1 million against 190.6 million [F, AHTA_REPL_PASS]. The association's July 2026 forecast for 2026 is 31.9 million long-acting units, below the 2025 figure [M, AHTA_REPL_LT_FCST]. That is a forecast, not an observed figure.

Durable, temporary, company-specific

Three characteristics are durable, each supported across at least three operators and two environments. Comparable visits do not grow: the expansion median was +0.3%, long-window CAGRs run from −2.3% to +2.9%, and the only multi-year positive series are two small regional chains before Operator 2 acquired them (Operator 14 and Operator 16) [OP2-0218, OP2-0222, OP2-0771, OP2-0777]. Volume per clinic declines over time at every operator where it can be measured [note C-02]. Operator volume is noisy year to year, with parasite-season-driven pharmacy-unit swings of up to about 15% and a double-digit fall at a single-market chain (Operator 12 2017) [OP1-5165, OP1-2145, OP3-0889, OP8-0654, OP2-0742]. The industry step-down in real veterinary spending per household pet after 2005 points the same way, but it is public-series context and does not meet the three-operator test [note C-02].

The temporary conditions are the environment shocks. COVID20 was a 13–20% traffic shock over the year (20% in Operator 2's worst quarter) after which the BEA aggregate regained its Q4-19 level by Q2-21, while the three core operators with data did not recover (wellness clinics are read in Part 04 section G) [note C-02; BEA_PCEVETSVC_Q]. REOPEN21 was strong but uneven, with Operator 5 +3.6%, Deal A FY22 +3.7% and BEA real veterinary spending +10.9% [OP5-3875, DLA-0661; BEA_PCEVETSVC_A:2020–2021]. INFL22-23 cut real veterinary spending by 11.5% from Q1-22 to Q1-24 on quarterly data (7.7% on annual averages, 2022 to 2024), and operator traffic was mixed [BEA_PCEVETSVC_Q:2022Q1–2024Q1; A1-P5-009]. Part of the SOFT24-26 decline is temporary, the 2021–22 bulge from pandemic pet adoption unwinding and owners deferring non-urgent care as prices

rose; by 2025 real veterinary spending per household pet (76.2, 2005 = 86) was back on its 2009–19 plateau (78.0 in 2019), so the soft period reads better as a return to the structural trend than as a new cyclical trough [I; note C-02].

The company-specific findings are concentrated at Deal A. Its FY23–23 survivor comp traffic averaged −5.1% a year against Operator 3 −4.1% (2024), Operator 6 −2.0% (2025) and Deal C −5.2% and +0.1% (FY24 and FY25, PF), which puts roughly 2–5 points a year down to the industry trend and the remaining 1–4 points to Deal A [I; DLA-0693, DLA-0725, DLA-0757, DLA-0789, OP3-0891, OP6-1896, A1-S002, A1-S003]. Operator 10 2011 (−10.4%) falls in 2009–12, when its visit counts shift across all clinics in a way consistent with a promotion or a change in visit count definition (note C-11); Operator 12 2016–17 (−6.7% and −10.3%) is a single-market event the files do not explain [OP2-0661, OP2-0739, OP2-0742]. Operator 8 and Operator 7 2025 are the only positive core comps in SOFT24-26 and both come from newly assembled bases, so neither is evidence of an industry turn [OP8-2114, OP7-1023]. At Deal B the weekday-aligned comp decline is concentrated in lower-income, less dense and pharmacy-heavy markets: clinics with none of the three attributes ran −12.5%, −7.6% and −9.0% in Q1-26, Q2-26 and Jul–Aug-26 against +0.7%, +1.5% and +5.4% for clinics with all three ([M], PF; a single-operator market-mix effect carried to the Deal B assessment) [A1-S034, A1-S035, A1-S036, A1-S025, A1-S026, A1-S027].

What the evidence cannot show

The documents supplied do not include an all-clinic CLOSE-FWD comp traffic series for Deal A; the survivor file (DLA-002) is an upper bound, and Deal A's clinic-month extract including closed clinics would close the gap, while the Closed Clinics tab of Deal A's clinic-level EBITDA file, FY23–FY26 (DLA-003), would allow a partial CLOSE-FWD test of clinic economics [note C-02]. Survivorship can be quantified at a second core operator only from Operator 1's Project Echo Operator 18 clinic-level financials of December 2017 (OP1-020) and its closed-clinics list (OP1-019) [note C-02]. GFC operator volume rests on two core operators; Deal A 10-K pets-seen disclosures for FY08–10, Operator 4's comp panel (OP4-005 p.20, revenue only) or an Operator 1 KPI visit count file for 2007–10 would be needed [note C-02]. Operator 7 visit count definition (OP7-005 tab 9) and a day-adjusted Operator 8 comp (OP8-010, OP8-012) are needed before the SOFT24-26 positives can be pooled [note C-02]. Deal C and Deal B have no D2.1 traffic yet; DLC-001 site-level visit counts and DLB-032, DLB-006 and DLB-020 KPI files would provide it [note C-02]. No operator reports visits per customer or retention across cycles (Operator 5 repeat customers cover 2023 only; DLB-007 covers 2024–26), so visit frequency cannot be separated from share [note C-02]. Operator 1 volume stops at Nov-17 and Operator 2 at Mar-21 [note C-02]. Industry-association parasiticide shipments before 2017 and the industry data provider's pet age and pets-under-care counts before 2020–21 are not covered here, and BEA real veterinary spending is a deflated dollar series, not a count of visits [note C-02].

03 B Pricing power: supporting evidence

Ticket, not volume, carries revenue: the core median comp ticket rose in every environment, from +1.8% a year in 2010–19 to +10.6% in the 2021 rebound, while the consumer price of veterinary services rose 39.5% from 2019 to 2025 against 22.3% for general prices. Full-cycle pass-through, steady service margins and large vendor rebates are durable, the 2020–22 ticket surge is temporary, and Operator 8's 2022 markup switch, Operator 1's 2011 overshoot and Deal A's trade-down to tier-4 pharmacy products are company-specific.

Our reading on the evidence supplied to date. Operators mostly pass inflation through ticket over a full cycle: comp ticket matched or beat CPI vet services in five of the six complete core windows (Operator 3 2023–24 trailed, +14.1% against +15.6%), front-loaded in 2021–22 rather than lagged, with Deal A at +38.8% against +37.5% over FY22–23 [note C-10; note C-09]. Comp ticket (revenue per visit) also outgrew the ECI wage rate for veterinary occupations (a wage per hour) in every window, but an operator's own labour cost per unit is tested only at Operator 5, which recovered it, and Operator 6, which did not [note C-10; OP5-1134, OP5-2011; OP6-0984, OP6-0988]. Ticket growth coincided with traffic loss, but the data do not show that pricing caused it: Deal A lost 3.9–7.9% of comp traffic a year in FY24–23 while its ticket grew at or below CPI vet services [DLA-0725, DLA-0726, DLA-0757, DLA-0758, DLA-0789, DLA-0790]. Percentage pharmacy margin compresses when pharmacy cost rises while dollar gross profit per pharmacy unit roughly held where it can be measured (Operator 5), service and labour margins hold, and mix and attachment are a material part of ticket growth that can run either way [A2-P5-001, A2-P5-003]. Vendor rebates were 2.1–9.8% of revenue at the pharmacy-heavy operators from 2009 to LTM Mar-26 (Operator 1 clinic sheets; 10.9% on Operator 1's consolidated accounts in CY2017, Exhibit 9.51), 0.6–1.3% at service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22 in 2023–25, and 12.0–20.2% of pharmacy COGS at Operator 4 and Operator 9 in 2023–25 [note C-17]. **Check status:** Checked a second time against the source: ticket matched or beat CPI vet services in five of six complete windows. The reading is bounded in five ways: the Deal A evidence shows no visible cost of pricing in traffic; dollar pass-through is near 82%; rebate growth cannot be separated from invoice-to-rebate reclassification; items that do not meet the three-operator test sit outside the reading; and labour recovery rests on an indirect ECI comparison. **Operators / environments:** eight core parent companies with ticket and traffic on the same comp base (Operator 5, Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 2 including four seller-period chains, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 7, Operator 8), plus Operator 4's lender-labelled split, across all six D10 environments from GFC to SOFT24-26; wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only [note C-12]. The findings that do not meet the three-operator test, the quantified mix share (Operator 5 and Operator 8), Operator 1's rebate against customer price and the measured price lag, are reported below as observations at one or two operators outside the reading, and GFC pricing (two operators) is reported only as a gap [note C-12].

What the evidence shows

Comp ticket rose in almost every operator-year, and its relation to CPI vet services turned with the cycle. The core median ticket was +1.8% in EXP10-19 (24 platform-years), +8.4% in COVID20, +10.6% in REOPEN21, +8.0% in INFL22-23 and +1.8% in SOFT24-26 (9 platform-years), against median CPI vet services of +1.6%, +2.9%, +3.6%, +8.8% and +5.4% over matched months [note C-12]. The median gap was +0.3 pp in the expansion, +5.7 pp and +7.0 pp in 2020–21, −1.6 pp in INFL22-23 and −3.6 pp in SOFT24-26 [note C-12]. Ticket ran ahead of CPI in 2021–22 (Operator 5 2021 +9.5% against +3.3%; Deal A FY22 +11.9% against +3.9%) and behind it in 2023–26 (Deal A FY24 +3.0% against +8.6%; Operator 3 2023 +6.8% against +9.8%) [OP5-3876, DLA-0662, DLA-0726, OP3-0888; CUUR0000SS62053 matched months]. CPI strength in 2023–25 sat in veterinary services (SS6205303 +14.4% in 2023), which include emergency and specialty care, so the benchmark may overstate general practice [CUUR0000SS6205303:CY2023; note C-09].

In five of six complete windows ticket matched or beat CPI vet services, and in all six it outgrew the ECI wage rate. Cumulative comp ticket was +38.8% at Deal A over FY22–23 (SURVIVOR, CLOSE-RETRO) against CPI vet services +37.5% and ECI occupation group 42 (veterinary occupations) +21.7%, +11.1% at Operator 1 over 2011–16 against +9.3% and +10.7%, and +10.1% at Operator 10 over 2013–17 against +8.0% and +9.5% [note C-10]. Operator 5 over 2021–22 (+22.3% against CPI +11.1%) ran ahead of CPI and Operator 3 over 2023–24 (+14.1% against +15.6%) behind it [note C-10]. The ECI comparison is indirect because it sets revenue per visit against an all-industry wage per hour, and labour cost per visit also rises with hours per visit [note C-09]. The operator's own labour cost per unit splits one each way: Operator 5 clinic salaries, wages and benefits per retail ticket rose 16.1% from 2020 to 2022 (PF) against average invoice +21.9%, while Operator 6 clinic labour cost per visit rose 3% from Q1-25 to Q1-26 against a 2025 comp ticket of −0.3% [OP5-1134, OP5-2011, A2-S001, OP5-3850, OP5-3842, OP5-3853; OP6-0984, OP6-0988, OP6-1146].

Ticket growth and traffic loss go together in the pooled data, but the evidence does not show that pricing caused the loss. Across 38 core platform-years outside COVID20 and REOPEN21 the correlation between ticket growth and volume growth is −0.41, and median volume is −2.1% in the 11 platform-years where ticket beat CPI vet services by more than 3 pp against +0.5% in the other 28 [note C-18]. The largest core operator does not fit a pricing explanation: Deal A's comp traffic fell 3.9%, 7.9% and 3.9% in FY24–23 while its ticket grew 3.0%, 4.1% and 5.4% against CPI vet services of 10.0%, 5.1% and 5.4% on its SURVIVOR, CLOSE-RETRO base [DLA-0725, DLA-0726, DLA-0757, DLA-0758, DLA-0789, DLA-0790]. Leaving aside Deal A FY26, where ticket and CPI were level, the one 2023–26 core year with ticket above CPI and traffic loss is Operator 3 2024 (+6.7% against +5.4%, traffic −4.1%) [OP3-0892, OP3-0891]. Flat-ticket Operator 7 (+0.3%) and Operator 8 (−1.0%) grew traffic in 2025 (+10.9%, +7.4%), while Operator 6's traffic sign depends on the base: +2.3% on pre-2023 clinics, −2.0% on the D2.1 comp base used in Part 03 section A [OP7-1024, OP7-1023, OP8-2115, OP8-2114, OP6-1144, OP6-1896]. The COVID20 ticket spike (core median +8.4% with volume −15.1%) is read as mix from fewer, larger, sick-pet-heavy visits [I]; no source records a list-price action [note C-12; note C-09].

Operator 5 is the only core operator with a true like-for-like pharmacy price and cost pair, and it shows pharmacy price following cost within the same year. On matched SKUs covering 71–84% of units, like-for-like price rose 4.4% and 9.1% in 2021–22 against like-for-like clinic cost of 6.8% and 11.8% [OP5-4450, OP5-4453, OP5-4456, OP5-4459]. In dollars at base-year quantities the price increase covered 83.5% and 83.5% of the cost increase and gross profit per matched unit fell only 1.0% and 2.0% [I], so pharmacy margin on clinic cost fell from 20.4% to 16.8% because a roughly unchanged dollar margin sat on a higher cost base [A2-P5-001, A2-P5-002, A2-P5-003, A2-P5-004; OP5-4413, OP5-4419]. Percentage pharmacy margin also compressed at Operator 1 (retail pharmacy GM before rebates 27.7% to 20.3%, FY08–14), Deal A (pharmacy material GM 37.4% to 29.3%, FY24–23) and Operator 3 (pharmacy-line GM 37.8% to 26.0%, 2022–23, SURVIVOR) [OP1-1553, OP1-1559, DLA-0990, DLA-1092, OP3-0654, OP3-0686]. Service and labour margins held or rose: Operator 5 service categories 56.3% in 2020 and 56.8% in 2022, Deal A service category 64.6% to 69.8% (FY24–23), Operator 3 dental 60.3% to 66.6% (2022–24) and Operator 10 61.5–61.4% (2015–17) [OP5-006; DLA-0986, DLA-1088, OP3-0639, OP3-0705, OP2-0087, OP2-0123]. Operator 3's ten professional-fee actions of Dec-24 and Jul-25 (median +2.9%) have no recorded volume response [OP3-2362, OP3-2386]. The measured lag rests on Operator 5 and on Operator 1's 2011 overshoot and reversal, and does not meet the three-operator test [OP1-5145, OP1-5147].

Mix and attachment are a material part of ticket growth and can run either way [note C-15; three-operator test met]. At Operator 5, the average invoice rose 44.5% from 2017 to 2022, and in log terms 42% of pharmacy revenue-per-ticket growth and 38% of service revenue-per-ticket growth came from attachment and mix rather than like-for-like price or unit value [OP5-3825, OP5-3853; note C-15]. That quantified share does not meet the three-operator test because only Operator 5 and Operator 8 can be decomposed; Operator 8's mature-clinic split gives price +7.0% a year against volume per invoice +1.0% a year over 2021–23 [OP8-0547, OP8-0549]. Deal A shows mix running the other way: tier-4 pharmacy products rose from 16.1% to 27.6% of units between Q1 FY26 and Q1 FY27 while pharmacy ASP fell 1.8%, although the Q1 FY27 tier-4 unit count is non-integer and looks model-derived [DLA-2803, DLA-2726, DLA-2807, DLA-2730, DLA-2781, DLA-2785]. Every other ticket series in the set, including Operator 4's lender-labelled "price" component (+8.6% in 2022), is price, mix and attachment together and cannot be called price under D7 [OP4-0648].

Vendor rebates are a large part of pharmacy-heavy economics [note C-09; three-operator test met]. As a share of revenue they run from 0.6–1.3% at Operator 7 ST-22 segment to 9.8% at Operator 1 (LTM Nov-17), with Deal A at 5.1–6.7% (FY22–23, CONSOL), Operator 2 2.9–5.1%, Operator 8 3.0–3.7% (ALL, POOLED), Operator 3 2.4–3.7% (SURVIVOR) and Operator 5 2.1–2.6% (PF) [note C-17]. At Operator 4 and Operator 9 they are 12.0–20.2% of pharmacy COGS over 2023–25 [OP4-0938, OP4-0941, OP4-0942, OP4-0943]. Operator 1's rebate against customer price is a single-operator observation (three-operator test not met): ATF per pharmacy unit rose from $6.45 to $23.54 between 2009 and LTM Nov-17 while retail ASP rose

from $88.35 to $98.44, and clinic gross margin before rebates fell from 44.5% to 41.9% while margin including rebates rose from 46.8% to 51.3% [OP1-4824, OP1-4840, OP1-4635, OP1-4646, OP1-4168, OP1-4179, OP1-4260, OP1-4276]. The clinic sheets cannot separate true rebate growth from vendors moving discounts off the invoice into back-end ATF [note C-09]. Deal A moves the other way, with rebates falling from 6.7% of sales in FY22 to 5.4% in FY25 and 5.1% in FY26 as the platform shrank, the FY26 figure on a co-op line whose definition may differ [DLA-3340, DLA-3343, DLA-0846].

Exhibit 9.39 — Ticket beat CPI vet services through 2020–21 and fell behind it at most core operators from 2023

Annual comp revenue, volume and ticket growth against CPI veterinarian services over matched months, % and pp, by environment and core operator; 2007 to LTM Jun-26; notes C-11, C-12

ENVIRONMENT	OPERATOR (CLINIC BASE)	PLATFORM-YRS	REVENUE	VOLUME	TICKET	CPI VET SERVICES	TICKET − CPI (PP)
GFC	Operator 1 FY09 (COMP; pharmacy units)	1	+4.5%	−2.9%	+8.0%	+4.8%	+3.2
GFC	Operator 2 seller period: Operator 10 2007–08 (COMP)	2	−0.3%	−3.7%	+3.4%	+3.6%	−0.2
GFC	**Core median**	**3**	**+4.2%**	**−2.9%**	**+7.4%**	**+4.2%**	**+3.2**
EXP10-19	Operator 5 2018–19 (COMP)	2	+3.6%	−1.2%	+4.7%	+2.3%	+2.6
EXP10-19	Operator 1 2010–LTM Nov-17 (COMP; pharmacy units)	8	+2.1%	−2.5%	+3.8%	+1.6%	+2.3
EXP10-19	Operator 1 Operator 18 segment LTM Nov-17 (SEG-Operator 18; pharmacy units)	1	+5.6%	+9.8%	−3.9%	+1.8%	−5.6
EXP10-19	Deal A FY20 (SURVIVOR; CLOSE-RETRO)	1	−1.8%	−5.4%	+4.0%	+2.9%	+1.0
EXP10-19	Operator 2 owned 2019 (COMP)	1	+6.7%	+0.3%	+6.2%	+2.9%	+3.3
EXP10-19	Operator 2 seller period: Operator 10, Operator 14, Operator 16, Operator 12 2013–17 (COMP)	15	+3.4%	+0.5%	+0.8%	+1.6%	−0.8
EXP10-19	**Core median**	**24**	**+3.4%**	**+0.3%**	**+1.8%**	**+1.6%**	**+0.3**
COVID20	Operator 5 2020 (COMP)	1	−5.6%	−11.4%	+6.3%	+2.9%	+3.6
COVID20	Deal A FY21 (SURVIVOR; CLOSE-RETRO)	1	−11.4%	−18.6%	+9.2%	+2.9%	+6.3
COVID20	Operator 2 owned 2020 (COMP)	1	−7.6%	−15.1%	+8.4%	+2.9%	+5.7
COVID20	**Core median**	**3**	**−7.6%**	**−15.1%**	**+8.4%**	**+2.9%**	**+5.7**
REOPEN21	Operator 5 2021 (COMP)	1	+14.1%	+3.6%	+9.5%	+3.3%	+6.3
REOPEN21	Deal A FY22 (SURVIVOR; CLOSE-RETRO)	1	+15.9%	+3.7%	+11.9%	+3.9%	+7.9
REOPEN21	**Core median**	**2**	**+14.8%**	**+3.6%**	**+10.6 %**	**+3.6%**	**+7.0**
INFL22-23	Operator 5 2022 (COMP)	1	+10.1%	−0.8%	+11.4%	+7.0%	+4.0
INFL22-23	Operator 3 2023 (survivor datacube; CLOSE-RETRO)	1	+9.5%	+2.6%	+6.8%	+9.8%	−3.2
INFL22-23	Deal A FY23–FY24 (SURVIVOR; CLOSE-RETRO)	2	+1.3%	−4.3%	+6.0%	+8.8%	−2.9
INFL22-23	**Core median**	**4**	**+6.7%**	**−2.4%**	**+8.0%**	**+8.8%**	**−1.6**
SOFT24-26	Operator 6 2024–25 (pre-2023 clinics)	2	+2.4%	+1.6%	+0.7%	+5.4%	−4.5
SOFT24-26	Operator 7 2025–LTM Jun-26 (CONSOL comp; CLOSE-FWD)	2	+7.9%	+7.6%	+0.3%	+5.4%	−5.3
SOFT24-26	Operator 3 2024–LTM Aug-25 (survivor datacube; CLOSE-RETRO)	2	+3.3%	−3.4%	+7.2%	+5.3%	+1.9
SOFT24-26	Deal A FY25–FY26 (SURVIVOR; CLOSE-RETRO)	2	−1.5%	−5.8%	+4.8%	+5.1%	−0.3
SOFT24-26	Operator 8 2025 (COMP, 21 P&L units)	1	+6.2%	+7.4%	−1.0%	+5.4%	−6.3
SOFT24-26	**Core median**	**9**	**+2.9%**	**+1.0%**	**+1.8%**	**+5.4%**	**−3.6**

Source: note C-11 for operator lines, and note C-12 for the core medians; operator cells with more than one platform-year are medians of those platform-years [1]. Revenue = SSS_CD (D2.1); volume = SSS_TRAFFIC_CD (pharmacy units at Operator 1); ticket = SSS_TICKET_CD, price + mix + attachment, not separable (revenue per pharmacy unit at Operator 1); CPI vet services = CUUR0000SS62053 over the same matched months. Basis A; month-majority tags; Operator 10 2009–12 (visit count definition break) and Deal A Q1 FY27 are excluded; trailing-twelve-month windows that overlap a counted year (Operator 1 to Nov-17, Operator 3 to Aug-25, Operator 7 to Jun-26) are kept, as in note C-12, and Operator 6 is on its pre-2023 clinics, which is why the SOFT24-26 volume median (+1.0%) differs from the −2.9% of Part 03 section A. The Operator 1 Operator 18 segment (clinics bought in 2015, on their own clinic sheets) is counted as a separate platform-year, in the EXP10-19 median and in Exhibit 9.45. Operator 2 seller-period rows are pre-acquisition data of then-independent chains. Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital medians (context, never pooled) are in note C-12. No rent code applies

Exhibit 9.40 — Operator 5 pharmacy price rose with clinic cost in 2021–22 but by less, recovering about 82% of the dollar cost increase, and pharmacy margin on clinic cost fell from 20.4% (2020) to 16.8% (2022)

Operator 5 like-for-like (matched-SKU, Fisher) pharmacy price and clinic cost, % change on prior year, with CPI pharmacy products and pharmacy margin on clinic cost before rebates; 2016 to 2022; Operator 5 SKU file

YEAR	LFL PRICE	LFL CLINIC COST	MIX / OTHER	UNIT COVERAGE	CPI PHARMACY PRODUCTS	PHARMACY MARGIN ON CLINIC COST (PRE-REBATE)	DOLLAR PASS-THROUGH	GP PER MATCHED UNIT
2016	−1.0%	−1.2%	−0.3%	81.6%	−0.8%	18.3%	–	–
2017	−0.8%	+1.6%	+0.4%	79.0%	−1.0%	16.8%	–	–
2018	+0.4%	−1.0%	+0.7%	75.8%	−0.8%	17.6%	–	–
2019	+1.8%	+0.7%	+0.4%	74.5%	+1.5%	19.5%	–	–
2020	+1.4%	+0.6%	+0.1%	82.1%	+0.1%	20.4%	–	–
2021	+4.4%	+5.8%	+4.2%	71.3%	+4.7%	18.9%	83.5% [I]	−1.0% [I]
2022	+9.1%	+11.8%	+2.2%	76.1%	+12.0%	16.8%	83.5% [I]	−2.0% [I]

Source: note C-13 (like-for-like price) and note C-14 (Operator 5 pharmacy margin on clinic cost); rows OP5-4420–OP5-4461, OP5-4397–OP5-4419; dollar pass-through and GP per matched unit are supplement rows A2-P5-001–A2-P5-004 [I], computed at base-year quantities on the same matched SKUs; CPI pharmacy products = CUUR0000SETC01 calendar year · Basis: A; Operator 5 CONSOL matched-SKU file, 71–84% of units, pre-rebate. The percentage price change was 67–70% of the percentage cost change in 2021–22 (a ratio of percentage changes, not a pass-through); the measured price lag does not meet the three-operator test. No rent code applies

Exhibit 9.41 — Other explicit price evidence, 2021 to 2025: Operator 8's 2022 markup switch added 12.0% on flat volume, and Operator 3's professional-fee and supplies-matrix actions (Dec-24 to Aug-25) have no recorded volume response

Explicit or like-for-like price changes and volume, %, by operator; 2021 to 2025; operator documents (note C-13)

OPERATOR (BASE)	MEASURE	PERIOD	PRICE	VOLUME	D7 LABEL	BASIS	ROWS
Operator 8 (mature clinics)	Price component, manager reports ($ to % pharmacy markup)	CY2022	+12.0%	+0.3%	price; sources differ: OP8-0120 (12%)	A	OP8-0545, OP8-0543, OP8-0120
Operator 8 (mature clinics)	Price component, mainly professional fees	CY2023	+2.6%	+4.1%	price	A	OP8-0546, OP8-0544
Operator 8 (mature clinics)	Price CAGR; invoice volume CAGR; volume per invoice +1.0% a year	2021–23	+7.0%	+1.2%	price; sources differ: OP8-0119 (5.7%)	A	OP8-0547, OP8-0549, OP8-0555
Operator 3 (named clinics)	Ten professional-fee actions (OP3-008)	Dec-24, Jul-25	median +2.9% (+1.4% to +7.6%)	not recorded	price (explicit action)	A	OP3-2362, OP3-2370 … OP3-2386
Operator 3 (named clinics)	Supplies-matrix change, implied price at constant supply cost	7-Aug-25	median +1.0% low tier, +7.0% high tier; max +28%	not recorded	price (explicit action)	A	OP3-2393 … OP3-2429
Operator 4 (company)	Lender-labelled "price" component of SSS (OP4-005 p.20)	2021 / 2022 / 2023 / 2024 / 2025	+5.9% / +8.6% / +1.8% / +2.6% / +1.8%	+5.9% / −3.4% / +2.6% / +1.0% / +1.0%	ticket, not price (no volume unit or definition)	A [M]	OP4-0646 … OP4-0655

Source: note C-13 (explicit and like-for-like price); rows as listed in the Rows column, from the Operator 8 manager reports and databook, Operator 3's pricing-action file (OP3-008), and Operator 4's KPI file (OP4-005 p.20) · Basis: A; Operator 4's split is the lender's label and is ticket, not price (D7). No rent code applies

Exhibit 9.42 — Rebates ran 2.1–9.8% of revenue at the pharmacy-heavy operators shown and 0.6–1.3% at service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22 from 2009 to LTM Mar-26, and Operator 1 margin including ATF rose while margin before ATF fell (2009 to LTM Nov-17)

Vendor rebates as % of revenue and of pharmacy cost of goods, with Operator 1 rebate per pharmacy unit, pharmacy ASP and gross margin before and including rebates; 2009 to LTM Mar-26; note C-17

OPERATOR	PERIOD	CLINIC BASE	REBATE % REVENUE	REBATE % PHARMACY COGS	REBATE $ PER PHARMACY UNIT	PHARMACY ASP $	GM BEFORE REBATES	GM INCL. REBATES	BASIS	ROWS
Operator 1	2009	ALL (Operator 1-branded clinic sheets)	3.6%	–	6.45	88.35	44.5%	46.8%	A	OP1-4727, OP1-5011, OP1-4824, OP1-4635, OP1-4168, OP1-4260
Operator 1	2012	ALL (clinic sheets)	5.4%	–	10.94	106.42	40.1%	44.4%	A	OP1-4733, OP1-5014, OP1-4830, OP1-4638, OP1-4171, OP1-4266
Operator 1	2014	ALL (clinic sheets)	7.3%	–	15.62	100.76	41.4%	48.5%	A	OP1-4737, OP1-5016, OP1-4834, OP1-4640, OP1-4173, OP1-4270
Operator 1	LTM Nov-17	ALL (clinic sheets)	9.8%	–	23.54	98.44	41.9%	51.3%	A	OP1-4743, OP1-5022, OP1-4840, OP1-4646, OP1-4179, OP1-4276
Deal A	FY2022	CONSOL	6.7%	–	–	–	–	–	A	DLA-3340; DLA_SALES 2022-03-26
Deal A	FY2026	CONSOL	5.1%	–	–	–	–	–	A	DLA-0846; DLA_SALES 2026-03-28
Operator 2	2019	ALL owned (OP2-021)	5.1%	–	–	–	–	–	A	OP2-3419, OP2-3410
Operator 2	LTM Mar-21	ALL owned (OP2-021)	2.9%	–	–	–	–	–	A	OP2-3467, OP2-3458
Operator 8	FY2024	ALL (POOLED)	3.7%	–	–	–	–	–	A	OP8-2092
Operator 8	LTM Mar-26	ALL (POOLED)	3.0%	–	–	–	–	–	A	OP8-2102
Operator 3	FY2023	SURVIVOR; % pharmacy COGS on CONSOL	2.4%	5.8%	–	–	–	–	A	OP3-1013, OP3-1800
Operator 3	LTM Aug-25; LTM May-25	SURVIVOR; % pharmacy COGS on CONSOL	3.7%	9.4%	–	–	–	–	A	OP3-1089, OP3-1804
Operator 5	2020	CONSOL	2.6%	–	–	–	–	–	PF	OP5-0311
Operator 5	2022	CONSOL	2.1%	–	–	–	–	–	PF	OP5-0313
Operator 7	2023	SEGMENT-NC	0.6%	–	–	–	–	–	A	OP7-0004, OP7-0001
Operator 7	2025	SEGMENT-NC	1.3%	–	–	–	–	–	A	OP7-0022, OP7-0019
Operator 4	2023	ALL	–	15.0%	–	–	–	–	A	OP4-0938
Operator 4	2025	ALL	–	20.2%	–	–	–	–	A	OP4-0942
Operator 9	2023	ALL	–	12.5%	–	–	–	–	A	OP4-0939
Operator 9	2025	ALL	–	13.2%	–	–	–	–	A	OP4-0943

Source: note C-17. Basis A except Operator 5 (PF). Clinic bases as stated; Operator 8 ALL includes acquisitions (POOLED). The Operator 1 gross-margin columns are clinic-sheet gross margin before and including ATF rebates; the Operator 1 rebate-versus-customer-price observation does not meet the three-operator test (one operator quantified), and the split between true rebate growth and invoice-to-rebate reclassification is not determinable. The Deal A rebate line (DLA-017, rounded) and DLA-003 co-op may differ in definition, so FY22–21 and FY26 are not strictly comparable (Part 09 section H). No rent code applies; rebate share of the D1.2 margin is in Part 03 section C

Exhibit 9.43 — Comp ticket matched or beat veterinary-price inflation in 5 of 6 core operator windows between 2011 and FY26, and beat wage growth in every window; Deal A's rose 38.8% over FY22–FY26, 1.8 pp above CPI.

Cumulative % change in comp ticket, CPI veterinarian services, and veterinary-occupation wages over each operator window; windows from 2011 to FY26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator documents: Deal A All Clinics KPI Report FY20–Q1 FY27 (DLA-0660 to DLA-0790); Operator 5 Volume Trends 2017–YTD June 2023; Operator 3 Datacube (31 August 2025); Operator 1 clinic-level financials (Dec-17); Operator 2 GB Vet KPIs (June 2018). Public series: BLS CPI-U veterinarian services (CUUR0000SS62053) and BLS Employment Cost Index, wages, veterinary occupations (ECI_VETOCC) · Basis: Actual (A). Comp ticket = comp revenue ÷ comp volume, so it carries price, mix and attachment. Public indices are matched to each operator's window (annual averages of monthly, not seasonally adjusted levels); CPI veterinarian services includes emergency and specialty care. Clinic base: comp clinics per operator (Deal A survivor clinics)

Exhibit 9.44 — Operator 5's matched-SKU pharmacy prices rose less than clinic cost in 2021 and 2022 (+4.4% and +9.1% against +5.8% and +11.8%), and pharmacy product margin fell from 20.4% in 2020 to 16.8% in 2022.

YoY % change in like-for-like pharmacy price and clinic cost (matched SKUs) with CPI pharmacy products, 2016 to 2022; pharmacy product margin on clinic cost, %, 2015 to 2022

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 5 TopPharm SKUs Prior Years 2015–2022 (price and cost OP5-4420 to OP5-4461; margin OP5-4391 to OP5-4419); BLS CPI-U pharmacy products (CUUR0000SETC01) · Basis: Actual (A), Operator 5, calendar years. Like-for-like price and clinic cost are Fisher indices on matched SKUs covering 71–84% of units. Margin = pharmacy product margin on clinic cost, before vendor rebates, from the SKU file

The ticket carried revenue in every environment: the median ticket rose even in COVID20, when median volume fell 15.1%, although that rise is read as mix rather than list price [I, note C-12]. From 2023 the ticket fell behind CPI vet services at most operators, which is the pricing question for the three live deals [I, Exhibit 9.39].

Exhibit 9.45 — Across 38 core platform-years from 2007 to 2026, faster ticket growth came with weaker volume (correlation −0.41); where ticket beat CPI vet services by more than 3pp, median volume fell 2.1%

Annual comp ticket growth against comp volume growth, %, core platform-years 2007 to 2026 outside COVID20 and REOPEN21

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Comp ticket and volume series in documents Ares Credit Group supplied: Operator 1 clinic financials (OP1-015, OP1-020, OP1-021); Operator 2 KPI history, clinic-level analysis and clinic databook (OP2-007, OP2-009, OP2-021); Deal A clinic KPI report (DLA-002); Operator 5 volume trends (OP5-008); Operator 3 datacube (OP3-003); Operator 6 Consultant 1 Delta readout (OP6-002); Operator 7 credit databook (OP7-005); Operator 8 databook (OP8-010). Public: BLS CPI-U veterinarian services, not seasonally adjusted, matched months (CUUR0000SS62053). CreditSwan computation of the correlation and the group medians from these rows · Basis: A for all 38 platform-years; seller-period data for the Operator 2 chains (Operator 10, Operator 14, Operator 16, Operator 12); survivor clinic bases at Deal A and Operator 3

The association is clear but the evidence does not show that pricing caused the volume loss [I, note C-18]. Median volume was +0.5% in the 28 platform-years where ticket did not beat CPI vet services by more than 3pp [I, note C-18].

Between 2019 and 2025 the consumer price of veterinary services rose 39.5%, against 22.3% for all consumer prices and 25.4% for wages in veterinary occupations [I, CUUR0000SS62053, CUUR0000SA0, ECI_VETOCC: annual averages 2019–2025]. The gap opened from 2022: in 2021 the veterinary and all-items indices stood at 92.4 and 90.1 (2019 = 86), and by 2024 at 122.6 and 105.3 [I, same series]. The sector's price index has therefore outrun both general inflation and the veterinary-occupation wage index; whether operators captured that in the ticket is the question of Exhibit 9.39, where the core median ticket trailed CPI vet services in the 2022–23 and 2024–26 environments. The price index covers emergency and specialty hospitals as well as general practices, and the wage index is an hourly rate across all private industry, not an operator's labour cost per patient invoice [note C-09].

Public signals

Since 2019 consumer prices have risen further for veterinary services than for pharmacy products (series retrieved 28 September 2026; other pages read on 30 September 2026). On annual averages, with 2019 = 86, the consumer price of veterinary services (CUUR0000SS62053) stood at 128.9 in 2025 and the consumer price of pharmacy products (CUUR0000SETC01) at 106.3 [I, C-PUB-11]. Pharmacy prices have moved little since 2022 (105.4). In August 2026 the two stood at 134.3 and 111.4 [I, C-PUB-11].

Exhibit 9.46 — Consumer prices of veterinary services rose 39.5% from 2019 to 2025 and pharmacy prices 21.4%; pharmacy prices have moved little since 2022

Consumer price of veterinarian services and consumer price of pharmacy products, U.S. city average; index of annual averages, 2019 = 86; 2019 to 2025, with August 2026 as a single month

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: BLS: CPI-U veterinarian services (CUUR0000SS62053) and CPI-U pharmacy products (CUUR0000SETC01), U.S. city average, not seasonally adjusted, monthly; series retrieved 28 September 2026; our computation [I, C-PUB-11] · Basis: Actual (A). Each line is the calendar-year average of the published monthly index, rebased to its own 2019 average = 86. October 2025 was not published for either series, so the 2025 average is of eleven months. The diamonds are the August 2026 index on the same base: a single month, not an annual average. Both are prices paid by consumers across all sellers; neither is an operator's own price or ticket

The sources of imported pharmacy products have shifted. US imports of veterinary pharmaceutical preparations were $11.24 billion in 2019 [F, PUB-0004] and $15.07 billion in 2025 [F, PUB-0005]. Thailand remained the largest source, at 17.4% and 16.9% of value. On the shares shown, Mexico, Vietnam and Cambodia together rose from 10.4% to 21.7%; South Korea and China together fell from 15.3% to 6.6% [I, C-PUB-12].

Exhibit 9.47 — Thailand supplied a fifth of US pharmacy imports by value in 2019 and in 2025; Mexico, Vietnam and Cambodia gained share and South Korea and China lost it

Share of US import value of veterinary pharmaceutical preparations by country of origin, %; calendar 2019 against calendar 2025; the nine largest sources in 2025

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: US Census Bureau, U.S. Imports by End-Use, annual, end-use category 25979 (veterinary pharmaceutical preparations); read on 30 September 2026; our computation [I, C-PUB-12] · Basis: Actual (A). Each country's import value divided by the world total for the category in the same year. Values are nominal dollars, so a share moves with price as well as with units. The category is veterinary pharmaceutical preparations as the Census Bureau defines it; it is not limited to companion-animal products. The shares shown for the nine countries sum to 64.9% in 2019 and 65.3% in 2025. Cambodia's 2019 value was zero

Duties on these sources changed several times between February and July 2026; Exhibit 9.48 gives each measure as its official document states it. Two points are unresolved: which tariff applies to companion-animal parasiticides, and the result of the Commerce Department's review of the 2021 orders.

Exhibit 9.48 — Between February and July 2026 several trade measures bearing on imported pharmacy products and supplies changed; which rate applies to companion-animal parasiticides is unresolved at 30 September 2026

Trade measures bearing on the cost of pharmacy products and supplies, one row per measure, as the official document states it; July 2021 to September 2026

DATE	MEASURE	WHAT THE OFFICIAL DOCUMENT STATES	STATUS AT 30 SEPTEMBER 2026	REF
19 Jul 2021	Anti-dumping duty orders: companion-animal parasiticides from Korea, Taiwan and Thailand (Commerce)	Rates by producer: Korea 12.80% to 24.15% (all others 19.11%); Taiwan 17.42% to 87.41% (all others 72.85%); Thailand 12.63% to 17.99% (all others 14.86%)	In force; under five-year review	[F, PUB-0359]
19 Jul 2021	Countervailing duty order: companion-animal parasiticides from Vietnam (Commerce)	Subsidy rates 5.58% to 6.71% (all others 5.72%)	In force; under five-year review	[F, PUB-0360]
26 Mar 2025	Proclamation 9641, Section 232: pharmaceuticals and pharmaceutical ingredients	21% tariff; not applied to products that qualify under the USMCA until a process is set to apply it to non-US content only	In force as read	[F, PUB-0361]
20 Feb 2026	Supreme Court, Learning Resources, Inc. v. Trump	"IEEPA does not authorize the President to impose tariffs."	Decided	[F, PUB-0362]
24 Feb 2026	Proclamation 9647, Section 122: temporary import surcharge	9% ad valorem for 134 days; exceptions include USMCA duty-free goods of Canada and Mexico and articles subject to Section 232	Ended 24 Jul 2026	[F, PUB-0363]
1 Jul 2026	USTR statement on the USMCA joint review	"The United States did not agree to renew the USMCA in its current form. As a result, the USMCA is not renewed."	Not renewed; what follows is not stated in the statement	[F, PUB-0364]
8 Jul 2026	Customs and Border Protection notice on court-ordered refunds	Tariffs assessed under IEEPA from 3 February 2025 to 24 February 2026 total an estimated $142 billion	Refund process open	[F, PUB-0365]

DATE	MEASURE	WHAT THE OFFICIAL DOCUMENT STATES	STATUS AT 30 SEPTEMBER 2026	REF
24 Jul 2026	USTR notice of Section 301 actions	9% on one list of economies and 11.1% on the rest: Thailand 11.1%, Vietnam 11.1%, China 11.1%, Mexico 9%, Cambodia 9%; articles subject to Section 232 are exempt	In force	[F, PUB-0366]
25 Sep 2026	International Trade Commission: five-year reviews of the 2021 parasiticide orders	Full reviews to proceed for Korea, Taiwan, Thailand and Vietnam; schedule to be announced	Open	[F, PUB-0367]
n/a	Which tariff applies to companion-animal parasiticides	Whether these products fall under the Section 232 pharmaceuticals tariff or under the Section 301 action is not established from the official documents read	Unresolved	
n/a	Commerce five-year review of the 2021 anti-dumping orders	The result is not established from the official documents read	Unresolved	

Source: Federal Register documents of the Department of Commerce, the President, the US Trade Representative, Customs and Border Protection and the International Trade Commission; Supreme Court slip opinion; USTR statement; read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: Each row gives what the official document states, its date and its status at 30 September 2026. Rates are those of the measure named and are not added together. Later amendments to the March 2025 proclamation were not read

On one branded pharmacy product, posted prices barely differ between sellers. The Animal Health Manufacturer 2 Defender2 chewable parasiticide (item 199/65R17) was posted at $174.14 at Deal A and at $180.17 to $184.63 at five other sellers (Exhibit 9.49); Deal A stands at 86.8 against the median of the five [I, C-PUB-13]. The six prices sit within 1% of each other [I, C-PUB-13]. Deal A's is a "starting at" price, not a clinic price, and this is one product on one day.

Exhibit 9.49 — One branded pharmacy product was posted within 1% at six sellers on 30 September 2026; Deal A stands at 86.8 against the median of the other five

Posted price per pack, Animal Health Manufacturer 2 Defender2 chewable parasiticide (item 199/65R17 90H), US dollars, at Deal A and five other sellers; read on 30 September 2026

SELLER	POSTED PRICE PER PACK	INDEX (MEDIAN OF THE FIVE OTHER SELLERS = 86)	REF
Deal A	$174.14	86.8 [I, C-PUB-13]	[F, PUB-0326]
Operator 28	$180.17		[F, PUB-0327]
Mass Retailer 1	$181.53		[F, PUB-0328]
Operator 32 Pharmacy	$181.53		[F, PUB-0329]
Online Pet Pharmacy 1	$181.53		[F, PUB-0330]
Mass Retailer 2	$184.63		[F, PUB-0331]

Source: Each seller's own product page, read on 30 September 2026; our computation for the index [I, C-PUB-13] · Basis: Posted online price per pack before dispensing fees, shipping and tax. Deal A's is a "starting at" price and is not specific to a clinic; Operator 32 page says pricing may vary by location; Mass Retailer 1's is the price for the item it sells itself. The five other sellers are reference sellers outside the supplied documents. Index = Deal A price divided by the median of the five other prices, times 86

Durable, temporary, company-specific

Five characteristics are durable, each supported by at least three operators and two environments. Comp ticket rises every year for almost every operator, with core medians of +1.8% in EXP10-19, +8.0% in INFL22-23 and +1.8% in SOFT24-26 [note C-12]. Over a full cycle ticket matched or beat CPI veterinarian services in five of six complete core windows (Operator 3 2023–24 trailed) and outgrew the ECI wage rate in all six, although own labour-cost recovery is tested only at Operator 5 (recovered) and Operator 6 (not) [note C-10; note C-09]. Percentage pharmacy gross margin compresses when pharmacy cost rises (Operator 5, Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 3), while service and labour margins hold (Operator 5, Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 10) [note C-09]. Mix and attachment are material and can be of either sign [note C-09]. Vendor rebates are a large share of economics, at 2.1–9.8% of revenue (0.6–1.3% at service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22) and 12.0–20.2% of pharmacy COGS from 2009 to LTM Mar-26; over the periods shown they rose at Operator 1, Operator 3, Operator 4 and Operator 9 and fell at Deal A, Operator 2, Operator 8 and Operator 5 [note C-17].

The temporary conditions are the inflation and COVID episodes. In REOPEN21 and INFL22-23 ticket jumped 10–12% in 2021–22 at Operator 5 and Deal A, alongside Operator 4's lender "price" +9% and Operator 8's price component +12.0%, with CPI pharmacy products +12.0% and PPI pharmaceutical preparation manufacturing +11.4% in 2022; ticket then slowed to between −1.0% (Operator 8 2025) and +7.2% (Operator 3 LTM Aug-25) in 2024–25, with Deal A at +4.1% and +5.4% in FY25–23, as pharmacy CPI turned flat (−0.2% in 2024) [OP5-3876, OP5-3880, DLA-0662, DLA-0694, OP4-0648,

OP8-0545, OP8-2115, OP3-0908, DLA-0758, DLA-0790; CUUR0000SETC01:CY2022, CY2024; PCU32621132621101:CY2022]. The COVID20 ticket spike of +6.3% to +9.2% with traffic −12% to −20% is read as mix [I], and in REOPEN21 traffic recovered at Operator 5 (+3.6%) and Deal A FY22 (+3.7%) while ticket kept rising (+9.5% and +11.9%) [OP5-3872, OP5-3871, DLA-0630, DLA-0629, OP2-3527, OP2-3526; OP5-3875, OP5-3876, DLA-0661, DLA-0662].

Six items are company-specific [note C-09]. Operator 8's 2022 switch from dollar to percentage pharmacy markup was a one-off catch-up of +12.0% on flat volume [OP8-0545, OP8-0543]. Operator 2's Consultant 3 pricing programme coincided with a 2019 owned comp ticket of +6.0–6.2% on flat traffic, an attribution made by the company ([M]) [OP2-1801, OP2-3522]. Operator 1 over-priced in 2011 (ticket per pharmacy unit +11.5% against CPI pharmacy products +5.2%, retail units −5.1%) and reversed in 2012–13 [OP1-5145, OP1-5163, OP1-5146, OP1-5147]. Deal A's trade-down to tier-4 (generic) pharmacy products is negative mix [DLA-2807, DLA-2785]. Operator 7's wellness-exam promotion raised discounts from 3.0% to 5.6% of net sales [OP7-006 IS I Net Sales!AL24/AM24]. Operator 3 repriced its pharmacy and supplies price matrices after acquisitions [OP3-2393, OP3-2429].

What the evidence cannot show

No source records a controlled price test, so the ticket–traffic evidence is an association, not an elasticity [note C-09]. Customer price for services, separated from mix, exists only at Operator 5 and Operator 8; Deal A and Operator 3 practice-management service-code price files or Operator 3's practice-management labour-rate history would add a like-for-like service index, and the Operator 3 datacube (OP3-004, 'Datacube (Table)' columns 23–31 and 57–57) and Deal A's volume, price and brand-tier sales composition trends (DLA-005) could add third operators to the quantified mix share [Part 09 section H]. No core operator provides veterinarian cost per billed hour together with an effective labour rate, so labour recovery rests on ECI and platform labour-cost ratios until payroll-hours extracts are obtained [note C-09]. CPI veterinarian services includes emergency and specialty care; the CPI series for emergency and specialty care alone (CUUR0000SS6205301) would allow it to be taken out of the benchmark and would test whether the SOFT24-26 ticket-below-CPI gap mostly closes [note C-09]. GFC pricing (three-operator test not met) rests on Operator 1 and Operator 10 only; Deal A 10-K comparable-clinic traffic text for FY08–10, if disclosed, would add a third operator [note C-09]. Rebate versus customer price needs Operator 1's ATF programme summary by manufacturer, FY12–FY14 (OP1-005), and Operator 2's pre- and post-rebate clinic P&Ls (OP2-021) [Part 09 section H]. Deal A and Operator 3 tickets sit on survivor bases (their closed-clinic histories would test them), Operator 1 clinic data end in Nov-17 (OP1-041/042), Operator 4's split has no defined volume unit (OP4-005 KPI file), and Deal B and Deal C enter only through rows read once from the source (DLC-006 comp-base patient invoices, further DLB-003 quarters) [note C-09].

03 C Margin consistency: supporting evidence

Clinic economics are steadier than consolidated earnings: pre-rebate four-wall margin moved within 1.3–5.4pp at each platform over its observed years, while Deal A's consolidated E1 margin fell from 12.0% in FY22 to 6.2% in FY26. Within-operator margin stability, clinic-rank persistence and dependence on vendor rebates are durable, the margin gains of 2020–21 are temporary, and Deal A's loss-making tail of 27–32% of clinics before co-op in FY23 to FY26 is company-specific.

Our reading on the evidence supplied to date. Gross margin moves little within most operators: in the GFC and the 2022–23 inflation it moved between −1.8pp and +0.4pp at five operators (Deal A, Operator 1, Operator 10, Operator 5 and Operator 8), with larger falls at Operator 3 in 2023 (−6.2pp, surviving clinics) and Deal A in FY21, its COVID year (−2.4pp) [DLA-0060, OP1-1503, OP2-1311, OP5-0022, OP8-1405, DLA-0048; OP3-0004, OP3-0014; DLA-0042, DLA-0044]. The pre-rebate (D1.1) four-wall margin is stable within operators across INFL22-23 and SOFT24-26 at three or more operators, moving 1.3–5.4pp over each platform's observed years; through the GFC and COVID it is observed at one operator each (Operator 1 FY08→FY09; Operator 2 2019→2020) and is not established [OP1-2456, OP1-2457; OP2-3414, OP2-3431]. Clinic margin ranks persist on matched clinics, on SURVIVOR bases at Deal A and Operator 3 [note C-27]. A large and variable share of the margin is vendor-rebate income rather than customer pricing: rebates are 4–42% of the with-rebates four-wall margin (12–42% outside service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22) and reached 1.14× reported E1 at Operator 1 in CY2016, while Deal A's FY26 co-op is 0.71× D3 E1, 0.96× E1 ex-gains and 0.59× company non-GAAP EBITDA (E2m, PF), so the multiple depends on the rung [OP1-3402/OP1-3258; DLA-0846/DLA-0317; A3-P5-014; A3-P5-015]. Corporate overhead has not fallen with scale [note C-26]. **Check status:** Checked a second time against the source: gross-margin stability at five operators, the scale of rebates and rank persistence are supported. The reading is bounded in four ways: recession stability rests on at most one four-wall operator per recession; Operator 1 D1.1 fell 3.3pp even on constant clinics; the apparent trend in Deal A's survivor-join loss share reflects survivorship; and rebate ÷ E1 depends on the rung. **Operators / environments:** nine core operators (Operator 1, Deal A, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 8, Operator 3, Operator 7, Operator 4/Operator 9, Operator 6 on company margins) across GFC, EXP10-19, COVID20, REOPEN21, INFL22-23 and SOFT24-26; wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only. Two findings do not meet the three-operator test and are kept out of the reading: four-wall stability through a recession is stated as not established, and a pooled cash-rent (R-CASH) industry four-wall level is stated as not determinable.

What the evidence shows

Gross margin is the most stable line in the set when read within one operator, but its level is not comparable across operators, because cost of sales differs by more than 26 points of definition (Deal A's carries distribution and occupancy; Operator 2's service-format gross profit excludes labour) [note C-25]. Through the GFC it moved between −1.3pp and +0.4pp: Deal A rose from 34.3% to 34.8% (FY08→FY09), Operator 1 pre-ATF from 44.6% to 43.0% (ALL clinics), and Operator 10 fell 1.3pp over 2007–09 (1.0pp in 2009) [DLA-0058, DLA-0060; OP1-1502, OP1-1503; OP2-1309, OP2-1311]. In the 2022–23 inflation it dipped: Operator 5 −1.2pp (PF), Operator 8 −1.8pp over 2021–23 and Deal A −1.0pp [OP5-0021, OP5-0022; OP8-1384, OP8-1405; DLA-0046, DLA-0048]. The larger moves are company-specific or single-operator: Deal A stepped down about 3pp from FY20 (32.5%) to FY21 (30.3%) and has not recovered (31.2% in FY26), about 5pp below its FY09 level of 34.8%; Operator 3's surviving clinics fell from 54.6% in 2022 to 47.8% in 2023; and Operator 1 pre-ATF gross margin troughed at 40.1% in CY2012 [DLA-0042, DLA-0044, DLA-0054; OP3-0004, OP3-0014; OP1-4171].

Pre-rebate four-wall margin (D1.1) sits between 8% and 16% at every core operator measured on it, on any rent code (Deal A reports no D1.1; its FY26 book-rent approximation is 5.4% [DLA-0857, DLA-0017]), and moves in a narrow band within each platform, but no industry level can be pooled from it [note C-24]. The within-platform range is 1.3pp at Operator 7 ST-22 (2023–25, R-CASH, ALL), 2.3pp at Operator 5 (2020–LTM Mar-23, R-CASH, PF, ALL), 2.9pp at Operator 8 (2022–LTM Mar-26, R-CASH then R-UNK from 2024), 3.6pp at Operator 3 (2023–LTM Aug-25, R-UNK, SURVIVOR), 4.1pp at Operator 2 (2018–LTM Mar-21, R-UNK, owned clinics) and 5.4pp at Operator 1 (FY08–LTM Nov-17, R-CASH, ALL) [note C-24]. Only 2023 has two actual R-CASH D1.1 operators, Operator 8 at 8.6% (its sponsor presentation prints 8.7%; the cash-rent coding follows its 2022–23 clinic files) and Operator 7 ST-22 at 16.1% (both ALL), pooling to 10.9%, and no year has three [OP8-2762/OP8-1362]. A pooled R-CASH industry level therefore does not meet the three-operator test and is stated as not determinable. Four-wall stability through a recession is not established either (three-operator test not met): each recession has at most one usable four-wall operator, and that evidence shows no fall, with Operator 1 D1.1 at 14.1% in FY08 and 14.1% in FY09, both inside the GFC window (R-CASH, ALL), and Operator 2 at 8.7% in 2019 and 12.0% in 2020 (R-UNK, owned clinics, an integration year) [OP1-2456, OP1-2457; OP2-3414, OP2-3431]. Deal A's GFC evidence is operating margin (7.7% in FY08, 7.9% in FY09) and Operator 5 has no 2019 four-wall, so neither supplies a second operator [DLA_OPER_MARGIN:FY2008–FY2009; OP5-1152].

At Operator 1, the only operator with a long clinic-level series, margin before rebates eroded while margin including rebates held. On the ALL retail-clinic base D1.1 fell from 15.0% in CY2010 to 9.8% in LTM Nov-17 while D1.2 moved from 18.7% to 19.9% (R-CASH, A), over years in which the count of full-year clinic sheets rose from 93 (CY2010) to 150 (LTM Nov-17) [OP1-5658, OP1-5668; OP1-5859, OP1-5873]. On the constant base of 92 clinics trading all 12 months of both CY2010 and LTM Nov-17, D1.1 fell 3.3pp, from 15.5% to 12.1%, and D1.2 rose 2.4pp, from 19.6% to 21.3% [A3-P5-001..004]. Clinics not trading all of CY2010 earned 6.01% D1.1 in LTM Nov-17, so about a third of the ALL-base fall is composition and the clinic-level erosion is real but smaller than the ALL base shows [A3-P5-005] [I]. On the ALL-base driver series (FY10→FY17) the fall runs through labour (+2.8pp, to 20.2% of sales) and occupancy (+1.08pp, with rent rising from 4.05% to 5.33% of sales under contractual step-ups), with pre-ATF gross margin −1.2pp, while ATF rose 5.6pp and ATF per retail pharmacy unit went from $6.7 to $23.3 [OP1-4826, OP1-4840]. Whether that ATF growth is new rebate income or vendor discount moved from the invoice to back-end rebate cannot be determined from the clinic sheets; Operator 1's ATF programme file (OP1-005) would show it.

Vendor rebates are a large and variable part of margin wherever they can be separated: 0.6–10.9% of revenue and 4–42% of the with-rebates (D1.2) four-wall margin, highest at the pharmacy-heavy vendor-programme platforms (2.1–10.9% of revenue and 12–42% of four-wall) and lowest at service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22 (0.6–1.3% of revenue, 4–6% of four-wall) [note C-28]. The share of four-wall rose at Operator 1 (16% in FY09 to 42% in FY17, full-year clinics) and Operator 3 (20% to 21%, 2023–24, SURVIVOR) and fell at Operator 2 (32% to 16%, 2019–LTM Mar-21, owned clinics) and Operator 5 (14% to 10%, 2020–22, PF) [OP3-1013, OP3-1032; OP2-3421, OP2-3469; OP5-0311, OP5-0313]. At the consolidated level Operator 1 ATF equalled or exceeded reported E1 in CY2014–16, at 0.87×, 0.99× and 1.14× [OP1-3400/OP1-3256, OP1-3401/OP1-3257, OP1-3402/OP1-3258]. Deal A's co-op fell from 6.7% of sales ($92m) in FY22 to 5.4% in FY25 on the table in Ares Credit Group's Deal A Diligence & Structure Update of 15 September 2026, and was 5.1% ($61m) in FY26 on the clinic-level EBITDA file, whose co-op line may be defined differently; in FY26 it equals 64% of clinic EBITDA [DLA-3340, DLA-3343; DLA-0846; DLA-0855]. Its FY26 multiple depends on the rung: 0.71× D3 E1 of $71.2m, 0.96× E1 ex-gains of $56.4m after $16.0m of disposal gains, and 0.59× company non-GAAP EBITDA (E2m, PF) of $85.6m [DLA-0846/DLA-0317; A3-P5-014, DLA-0315; A3-P5-015, DLA-0854].

Consolidated E1 is more volatile than clinic margins and is falling in SOFT24-26 where it can be seen: Deal A's E1 margin fell from 12.0% in FY22 to 6.2% in FY26, and Operator 4's from 6.3% in 2024 to −1.4% in 2025 [DLA-0251, DLA-0317; OP4-0053, OP4-0103]. The rung decides the story: Operator 4's 2025 E2 (PF) is 13.3% against E1 of −1.4%, and Operator 8's LTM Mar-26 E2 (PF) is 9.2% against E1 of 0.6% [OP4-1077; OP8-1880, OP8-1781]. E1 was not hit in the GFC where both years exist (Operator 1 7.0% in 2008 to 8.5% in 2009) [OP1-3250, OP1-3251]. Corporate overhead does not fall with scale: Deal A, at $1.0–1.2bn of revenue, runs 3.0–4.7%, while platforms at $17–126m of revenue run 2.0–5.9% (2020 to LTM May-26) [note C-26]. It rose as a share of revenue both while platforms scaled up (Operator 8 4.2% to 4.8% as revenue grew about six-fold; Operator 3 2.0% to 3.2%, PF) and while Deal A shrank (3.0% in FY17 to 4.7% in FY26, with clinics down 12% from the FY22 peak) [OP8-0394, OP8-2103; OP3-2566, OP3-2568; DLA-1350, DLA-1223]. Operator 1's fall from about 10–9% to 4.7–5.8% coincides with clinic support being split out in CY2016, a definition break rather than evidence of scale economies [OP1-3236, OP1-3237].

Within each platform the chain margin is carried by the top half of clinics: the ratio-of-sums margin exceeds the median clinic margin in 34 of 39 platform-periods [note C-22]. Clinic rank persists on matched clinics, with 34–62% staying in the same quartile across 30 non-overlapping

transitions at six operators (random is 21%) and Spearman ρ of 0.66–0.79; the Deal A and Operator 3 transitions are SURVIVOR-based, so closed clinics drop out of both ends [note C-27]. Loss-making shares separate the operators: 0–3% at Operator 5 (PF, ALL), Operator 1 to FY15 (full-year clinics) and Operator 3 from 2024 (SURVIVOR), and 26% falling to 9% at Operator 2 during its 2018–21 integration (owned clinics, R-UNK) [note C-22]. Deal A is the outlier. On the all-clinic basis (every clinic open at each fiscal year-end, including later-closed clinics; clinic EBITDA before co-op, R-OPONLY), 31.4%, 27.2%, 34.3% and 28.7% of clinics lost money in FY23–FY26, about a third throughout with no rising trend [A3-P5-006..009; DLA-0862]. The survivor join gives 24.2%, 19.4%, 26.8% and 28.7%, and its apparent rise reflects survivorship, since the 161 clinics flagged in the FY23 tab as later closed were 70.4% loss-making [DLA-0929, DLA-0934]. Deal A's FY26 clinic margin before co-op is 7.9% on a ratio-of-sums basis against a 5.9% median (R-OPONLY, 983 clinics, where SURVIVOR equals ALL), and 5.4% on a book-rent approximation of D1.1 (R-BOOK, open clinics) [DLA-0834; A4-S0213; DLA-0857/DLA-0017].

Exhibit 9.50 — Four-wall margin before rebates held within 9–16% at every core operator measured on it, FY08 to LTM Mar-26, but Operator 1 eroded even on constant clinics (CY2010 to LTM Nov-17); Deal A's FY26 book-rent approximation is 5.4%

Four-wall margin before (D1.1) and including (D1.2) vendor rebates, % of clinic sales, by platform, period, rent code and clinic base; FY08 to LTM Mar-26; note C-24

PLATFORM	PERIOD	CYCLE	BASIS	RENT CODE	CLINIC BASE	D1.1	D1.2	GAP (PP)
Operator 1	FY08 / FY09	GFC	A	R-CASH	ALL	14.1% / 14.1%	16.0% / 17.1%	2.3 / 3.3
Operator 1	CY2010	EXP10-19	A	R-CASH	ALL	15.0%	18.7%	3.7
Operator 1	CY2013	EXP10-19	A	R-CASH	ALL	12.9%	18.1%	5.6
Operator 1	CY2016	EXP10-19	A	R-CASH	ALL	9.8%	18.6%	8.8
Operator 1	LTM Nov-17	EXP10-19	A	R-CASH	ALL	9.8%	19.9%	9.8
Operator 1	CY2010	EXP10-19	A	R-CASH	CONSTANT-BASE-108	15.5%	19.6%	3.7
Operator 1	LTM Nov-17	EXP10-19	A	R-CASH	CONSTANT-BASE-108	12.1%	21.3%	9.4
Operator 2	2018 / 2019	EXP10-19	A	R-UNK	Owned clinics	8.1% / 8.7%	– / 13.2%	– / 5.1
Operator 2	2020 / LTM Mar-21	COVID20 / REOPEN21	A	R-UNK	Owned clinics	12.0% / 11.8%	16.0% / 14.9%	4.2 / 2.9
Operator 5	2020 / 2021	COVID20 / REOPEN21	PF	R-CASH (28 of 38 related-party)	ALL	13.3% / 14.6%	15.3% / 16.9%	2.5 / 2.2
Operator 5	2022 / LTM Mar-23	INFL22-23	PF	R-CASH	ALL	15.0% / 15.2%	17.4% / 16.9%	2.1 / 2.2
Operator 8	2022 / 2023	INFL22-23	A	R-CASH	ALL	7.9% / 8.6%	10.7% / 12.0%	2.4 / 3.3
Operator 8	2024 / 2025 / LTM Mar-26	SOFT24-26	A	R-UNK (probably R-BOOK from 2H25)	ALL (POOLED)	8.8% / 10.9% / 10.8%	12.9% / 14.1% / 14.1%	3.7 / 3.3 / 3.0
Operator 3	2023 / 2024 / LTM Aug-25	INFL22-23 / SOFT24-26	A	R-UNK	SURVIVOR	9.0% / 11.4% / 12.4%	11.5% / 14.8% / 16.0%	2.4 / 3.7 / 3.7
Operator 7 ST-22	2023 / 2024 / 2025	INFL22-23 / SOFT24-26	A	R-CASH (related-party, below go-forward rent)	ALL (7 / 8 / 10 clinics)	16.1% / 14.6% / 15.9%	16.8% / 15.6% / 17.4%	0.7 / 1.0 / 1.2
Deal A	FY23 / FY24 / FY25 / FY26	INFL22-23 / SOFT24-26	A	R-OPONLY	SURVIVOR	Company basis, before co-op 9.0% / 10.7% / 8.6% / 7.9% (neither D1.1 nor D1.2)	–	–
Deal A	FY26	SOFT24-26	A	R-BOOK	Open clinics	5.4% (book-rent approximation)	–	–
Operator 4	2024 / 2025	SOFT24-26	A (sponsor model)	R-UNK	Constant 192-centre base	Company basis 17.6% / 18.7% (D1.2-type)	–	–

Source: note C-24; Operator 1 CONSTANT-BASE-108 rows A3-P5-001..004. Basis A except Operator 5 (PF, Accounting Firm 5-adjusted trial balance); ratio of sums; rent code and clinic base per row. Operator 7 ST-70 (23.8–26.9% D1.1, clinic costs held in AP corporate) is excluded as not comparable. Operator 8's 2023 D1.1 is the sponsor presentation's clinic EBITDA before rebates of $2.7m (OP8-2762, OP8-013 p.31) on the databook's revenue of $27.65m (OP8-1362), 8.6%; the presentation itself prints 8.7% and does not state the rent treatment, and the cash-rent coding follows Operator 8's clinic files for 2022–23. Only R-CASH actual rows may be pooled; no year has three

Exhibit 9.51 — Rebates were 4–42% of four-wall margin including rebates from FY09 to LTM Mar-26 (12–42% outside service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22), and near or above reported EBITDA at the two largest pharmacy operators (Operator 1 CY2016, Deal A FY26)

Vendor rebates as % of revenue, as share of four-wall margin including rebates, and as a multiple of consolidated EBITDA, by platform; CY2008 to LTM Mar-26; note C-28

PLATFORM	SCOPE / CLINIC BASE	PERIOD	BASIS	REBATES % REVENUE	SHARE OF D1.2 FOUR-WALL	REBATES ÷ CONSOLIDATED EBITDA
Operator 1	Full-year retail clinics	FY09 / FY13 / FY17	A	3.4% / 5.4% / 9.0%	16% / 25% / 42%	–
Operator 1	CONSOL	CY2008 / CY2016 / CY2017	A	2.5% / 9.0% / 10.9%	–	ATF ÷ E1 0.31 / 1.14 / 0.78
Operator 2	Owned clinics	2019 / 2020 / LTM Mar-21	A	5.1% / 4.2% / 2.9%	32% / 23% / 16%	–
Operator 5	CONSOL (FDD adjusted)	2020 / 2021 / 2022	PF	2.6% / 2.2% / 2.1%	14% / 12% / 10%	–
Operator 3	SURVIVOR	2023 / 2024 / LTM Aug-25	A	2.4% / 3.7% / 3.7%	20% / 21% / 20%	–
Operator 8	CONSOL / ALL	2022 / 2024 / 2025 / LTM Mar-26	A	2.4% / 3.7% / 3.3% / 3.0%	20% / 25% / 21% / 20%	–
Operator 7 ST-22	Segment	2023 / 2025	A	0.6% / 1.3%	3% / 6% [I]	–
Deal A	CONSOL co-op	FY22 / FY26	A	6.7% / 5.1%	– (co-op is 64% of FY26 clinic EBITDA)	FY22 0.52× D3 E1; FY26 0.71× D3 E1, 0.96× E1 ex-gains, 0.59× E2m (PF)
Operator 4 / Operator 9	ALL	2023 → 2025	A	Not on revenue: 15.0% → 20.2% (Operator 4) and 12.0–13.2% (Operator 9) of pharmacy COGS	–	–

Source: note C-28, including the Operator 1 clinic-sheet rows. Basis A except Operator 5 and the Deal A E2m ratio (PF). Share of D1.2 four-wall = (D1.2 − D1.1) ÷ D1.2 at clinic level; Operator 7 ST-22 shares are computed from Exhibit 9.50 gaps [I]. Rebate definitions and booking points differ (clinic-allocated at Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 3 and Operator 8; corporate co-op at Deal A)

Exhibit 9.52 — About a third of Deal A's clinics lost money before co-op in each of FY23 to FY26 on the all-clinic basis (27.2–34.3%); the survivor join understates the share in FY23 to FY25

Share of Deal A clinics with negative clinic EBITDA before vendor co-op, %, all-clinic basis and survivor join; FY23 to FY26; Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file (note C-22)

CLINIC BASE	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26
ALL clinics open at fiscal year-end, incl. later-closed (clinic-EBITDA tabs)	31.4% (n=1,107)	27.2% (n=1,139)	34.3% (n=1,102)	28.7% (n=983)
Sensitivity only: SURVIVOR join to KPI file	24.2% (n=957)	19.4% (n=984)	26.8% (n=984)	28.7% (n=983)

Source: note C-22 (ALL base: A3-P5-006..013; SURVIVOR base: DLA-0929, DLA-0934) · Basis: A; clinic EBITDA before vendor co-op, operating-lease rent only (R-OPONLY). The SURVIVOR join understates the loss share by about 8pp in FY23–21 because later-closed clinics were 70.4% loss-making (DLA-0934) · Assumption: Register A-07: survivor-based series are read as upper bounds

Moves in the GFC and the 2022–23 inflation are −1.8pp to +0.4pp at five operators, with Operator 3's 2023 fall (−6.2pp) and Deal A's FY21 step-down (−2.4pp) the exceptions, which makes gross margin the most stable line in the set when read within one operator [I, note C-25]. The level differences between panels are definitional and carry no ranking [I, note C-25].

Exhibit 9.53 — Clinic rank persists: 34–62% of clinics sit in the same four-wall quartile a year later across 30 transitions at six operators between FY08 and FY26, against 21% if rank were random

Share of matched clinics in the same four-wall quartile one year later, lowest and highest transition per operator, %, FY08 to FY26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: CreditSwan computation from clinic-level records Ares Credit Group supplied: Operator 1 clinic P&Ls (OP1-015, OP1-021); Deal A clinic-level EBITDA and clinic KPI report (DLA-003, DLA-002); Operator 3 datacube (OP3-003); Operator 2 clinic databook (OP2-021); Operator 5 operating model clinic tabs (OP5-011); Operator 8 databooks (OP8-010, OP8-012) · Basis: A; clinic four-wall before or after supplier rebates (D1.1 or D1.2) as each file allows; clinics present in both years, quartiles set within each year; all clinics, except surviving clinics at Deal A and Operator 3; rank correlation 0.57–0.79

Weak clinics tend to stay weak, which gives clinic rationalisation a stable target but no momentum of its own [I, note C-27]. Deal A's three transitions (51–52%) sit inside the peer range [I, note C-27].

Exhibit 9.54 — Corporate overhead has not fallen with scale: Deal A's share rose from 3.3% to 4.7% of sales as revenue fell from FY22 to FY26, and Operator 8's stayed at 4.1–5.2% while revenue grew sixfold

Corporate overhead as % of revenue by operator and period, FY17 to LTM May-26; definitions differ by operator, so levels are not compared

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A overhead expense schedule FY17 to FY27 and Forms 10-K (DLA-006; SEC EDGAR); Operator 8 databook and financial model (OP8-010, OP8-003, OP8-012); Operator 5 financial due diligence report and operating model (OP5-009, OP5-011); Operator 3 lender model and financial update (OP3-012, OP3-001); Operator 2 adjusted P&L (OP2-016); Operator 7 credit databook (OP7-005); fact rows per point in the data file · Basis: Filled points actual, hollow points pro forma: Deal A and Operator 8 actual; Operator 5, Operator 2 and Operator 7 pro forma (quality-of-earnings bases); Operator 3 pro forma to LTM May-25, actual LTM Aug-25. Deal A revenue $1,185.5m FY22 to $1,029.1m FY26; Operator 8 $18.4m CY2021 to $108.9m LTM Mar-26

Among the core operators shown, none has an overhead share that falls steadily as revenue grows [I, note C-26; Exhibit 3.11]. For Deal A the direction matters because closures shrink revenue faster than corporate cost [I, note C-26].

Exhibit 9.55 — Loss-making clinics were 27–32% of Deal A's estate before co-op in each of FY23 to FY26; at five other operators the share ran from 0% to 26% between FY09 and 2025, on other rent bases

Share of clinics with negative clinic-level profit in a period, %; range across the periods available for each operator, with the latest period marked; FY09 to FY26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file, FY23–FY26 tabs (A3-P5-006 to A3-P5-009); Operator 1 clinic-level financials (December 2017), fiscal years to May 2009–2017; Operator 5 operating model (20 July 2023), FY20–LTM Mar-23 (OP5-0758 to OP5-2446); Operator 2 clinic-level databook (June 2021), 2018–LTM Mar-21; Operator 8 databook (March 2026), 2024–25; Operator 3 datacube (31 August 2025), FY23–LTM Aug-25 · Basis: Actual (A) except Operator 5 (pro forma, PF, drawn hollow). The definitions are not the same and the rows are described, not ranked: Deal A's clinic profit carries operating-lease rent only and excludes finance-lease cost, so its share would be higher on a full rent charge, and is before vendor co-op, so its share would be lower with co-op allocated to clinics (19.5% in FY26 at Ares Credit Group's rate of 5.87% of clinic sales; Part 05 section E); Operator 1 and Operator 5 are on cash rent; Operator 2, Operator 8 and Operator 3 do not state the rent basis; Operator 3 is after vendor rebates and on surviving clinics only, the others before rebates. Clinic bases differ (all clinics open at year-end at Deal A; clinics trading the full year elsewhere). Each share is the count of loss-making clinics over the clinic count of the period; Deal A FY23 is 391 of 1,107 · Assumption: Register A-09: operators are ranked only where at least three share one definition; these rows are not ranked

Deal A had 27.2–34.3% of its clinics loss-making in each of FY23 to FY26, 324 of 983 in FY26, on clinic EBITDA before vendor co-op that carries operating-lease rent only [A3-P5-006..009]. At four other operators the share sat between 0% and 10%: Operator 1 FY09–FY17 (0.0–10.3%, cash rent), Operator 5 FY20 to LTM Mar-23 (0.0–2.1%, pro forma), Operator 8 2024–25 (6.9–8.8%) and Operator 3 FY23 to LTM Aug-25 (0.0–7.9%, surviving clinics); at Operator 2 it fell from 25.9% in 2018 to 8.6% in LTM Mar-21 as acquired clinics were integrated [note C-22]. The definitions differ in rent charge, rebate treatment and clinic base, so the rows are described, not ranked; Deal A's measure leaves out finance-lease cost, so its share would be higher on a full rent charge, and leaves out vendor co-op, so it would be lower with co-op allocated to clinics. The exhibit cannot put the operators on one definition or one clinic base.

Durable, temporary, company-specific

Five characteristics meet the durable test of three or more operators across two or more environments. Gross margin is stable within a platform, moving −1.8pp to +0.4pp in the GFC and the 2022–23 inflation at Deal A, Operator 1, Operator 10, Operator 5 (PF) and Operator 8, with Operator 3's 2023 fall (−6.2pp) and Deal A's FY21 step-down (−2.4pp) the exceptions [DLA-0060, DLA-0048; OP1-1503; OP2-1311; OP5-0022; OP8-1405]. Rebates are 0.6–10.9% of revenue at seven operators and 4–42% of the with-rebates four-wall margin at six (12–42% outside service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22) [note C-28]. Clinic rank persists (34–62% stay in quartile, ρ 0.57–0.79) at six operators across five environment transitions, SURVIVOR-based at Deal A and Operator 3 [note C-27]. Labour is the largest clinic cost and the main swing line, at 18–25% of revenue at Operator 1 (FY09–FY17), Operator 5 (2020 to LTM Mar-23, PF) and Operator 3 (2023 to LTM Aug-25) [note C-23]. Corporate overhead does not fall with scale [note C-26]. Recession

stability of four-wall is not on this list: it does not meet the operator test, and the only evidence, Operator 1 FY08→FY09 and Operator 2 2019→2020, shows no fall [OP1-2456, OP1-2457; OP2-3414, OP2-3431].

The temporary conditions are tied to environments. In COVID20 four-wall margins rose on opex cuts and ticket while traffic fell (Operator 2 +3.3pp with traffic −15.1%; Operator 5 +1.9pp from 2020 to 2021, PF), which is not repeatable volume-led margin (emergency and specialty hospitals, which moved the other way, is read in Part 04 section G) [OP2-3414, OP2-3431; OP5-1152, OP5-1585]. In INFL22-23 gross margin dipped while four-wall held, because price-led revenue covered labour inflation (Operator 5 labour 23.3% to 21.3% of sales, PF) [note C-23]. In SOFT24-26 margins split: they rose during integration at the acquisitive Operator 8 (D1.1, before rebates, 8.8% in 2024 to 10.8% in LTM Mar-26, rent basis not stated from 2024), Operator 3 (D1.1, 11.4% in 2024 to 12.4% in LTM Aug-25, SURVIVOR) and Operator 4 (company basis including rebates, 17.6% to 18.7% in 2024–25, surviving centres), a rise the files do not attribute to a cause, and fell at Deal A (survivor clinic EBITDA before co-op 10.7% to 7.9%; E1 9.8% to 6.2%) [OP8-2091, OP8-2101; OP3-1031, OP3-1088; OP4-1491, OP4-1507].

The company-specific items are the Operator 1 2010–17 erosion (3.3pp on constant clinics) [A3-P5-001, A3-P5-003]; Deal A's FY22–23 combination of a 27–32% loss-clinic tail before co-op on the all-clinic basis (FY23–23), co-op falling from $92m (FY22) to $61m (FY26, on a line whose definition may differ) and overhead rising from 3.3% (FY22) to 4.7% (FY26) of revenue [A3-P5-006..009; DLA-3340, DLA-0846; DLA-1295, DLA-1223]; the Operator 12 seller's 2008 gross-margin fall from 55.9% to 51.5% [OP2-1330, OP2-1331]; Operator 8's 2022 staffing trough [OP8-010, OP8-009, OP8-012]; and Operator 7 R-CASH four-wall, which below-market related-party rent flatters by about 0.3–0.4pp of ST-22 sales [OP7-0550, OP7-0554, OP7-0558].

What the evidence cannot show

No year has three actual R-CASH D1.1 operators (2023 has two), so an industry four-wall level cannot be pooled [OP1-5657, OP1-5857, OP1-5658, OP1-5859, OP1-5659, OP1-5861, OP1-5660, OP1-5863, OP1-5661, OP1-5865, OP1-5662, OP1-5867, OP1-5664, OP1-5869, OP1-5666, OP1-5871, OP1-5668, OP1-5873, OP5-1152, OP5-1153, OP5-1585, OP5-1586, OP5-2028, OP5-2029, OP8-1347, OP8-0813, OP8-0669, OP8-1395, OP8-2762, OP8-1362, OP8-1406, OP7-0286, OP7-0312, OP5-2469, OP5-2470, OP7-0314, OP7-0344, OP7-0413, OP7-0435, OP7-0346, OP7-0384, OP7-0437, OP7-0459, OP7-0461, OP7-0483, OP1-2456, OP1-1227, OP1-2457, OP1-5856]. Operator 2, Operator 3 and Operator 8 from 2024 are R-UNK; the OP2-017 QoE rent schedule, the OP3-013 lease schedule and the OP8-012 Lease Summary would restate them. Recession four-wall stability cannot be tested on a second operator because no 2007 or 2019 clinic P&L for a second operator is among the documents supplied; an Operator 1 2018–26 clinic databook or pre-2010 Deal A clinic data would be needed, and the same Operator 1 databook would extend the only long clinic series past Nov-17. Rebate durability cannot be judged without vendor agreements, tier schedules or clawback terms, and the ATF programme file OP1-005 would show whether Operator 1's ATF growth is new income or reclassified invoice discount. Deal A closed-clinic margins need DLA-003 closure rows joined to sales (with DLA-008 rent). Operator 5 actuals need the OP5-009 FDD appendices, and overhead has no common definition.

Public signals

On sources read on 30 September 2026, veterinarian and veterinary technician pay has risen by about 26% since 2019 while the number employed full time has not grown. Median usual weekly earnings of full-time veterinarians and veterinary technicians were $945 in 2025 [F, PUB-0006] against $705 in 2019 [F, PUB-0007], a rise of 25.5% [I, C-PUB-14]. This is a household-survey measure of one occupation, a different series from the wage index used elsewhere in this section. Full-time veterinarians and veterinary technicians employed numbered 617 thousand in 2025 [F, PUB-0008] against 608 thousand in 2019 [F, PUB-0009].

Tariff refunds entered the 2026 results of two listed pet retailers. Pet Retailer 3 states that its adjusted gross profit for the second quarter of 2026 included $23 million of refunds related to tariffs [M, PUB-0010]. Pet Retailer 1 states that the rise in its gross margin in the fourth quarter of fiscal 2026 was driven by a 130 basis point effect of manufacturer rebate true-ups [M, PUB-0011]. Both are pet retailers, not clinic operators, and each figure is the company's own statement for one quarter.

Exhibit 9.56 — Veterinarian and technician weekly pay rose 25.5% from 2019 to 2025 with little growth in full-time employment (608 to 617 thousand); two listed pet retailers reported tariff refunds in 2026 results

Public cost signals: veterinarian and technician pay and employment, annual, 2019 and 2025; tariff refunds as stated by listed pet retailers, 2026 quarters

SIGNAL	PERIOD	VALUE	REF
Median usual weekly earnings, full-time veterinarians and veterinary technicians	2025	$945	[F, PUB-0006]
Same	2019	$705	[F, PUB-0007]
Change, 2019 to 2025	2019 to 2025	+25.5%	[I, C-PUB-14]
Full-time veterinarians and veterinary technicians employed	2025	617 thousand	[F, PUB-0008]
Same	2019	608 thousand	[F, PUB-0009]

SIGNAL	PERIOD	VALUE	REF
Pet Retailer 3: refunds related to tariffs included in adjusted gross profit	Second quarter 2026	$23 million	[M, PUB-0010]
Pet Retailer 1: effect of manufacturer rebate true-ups on gross margin	Fourth quarter of fiscal 2026 (16 weeks)	130 basis points	[M, PUB-0011]

Source: BLS Current Population Survey, annual series for full-time veterinarians and veterinary technicians; Pet Retailer 3 and Pet Retailer 1 results releases filed on Form 8-K; read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: Pay is the median usual weekly earnings of full-time wage and salary workers in one occupation, from a household survey; it is a different series from the employment cost index for healthcare occupations used elsewhere in this section, and the two are not set side by side. Refund figures are each company's own statement for one quarter; both companies are pet retailers, not clinic operators

03 D Unit economics: supporting evidence

Clinic economics are set by sales level and entry route: from FY08 to FY25 the median mature clinic earned $149–268k of four-wall at Operator 1 on $1.3–1.8m of sales and $410–472k at Operator 5 and Operator 7 ST-22 on $2.0–2.9m, and the 42–72% cash-on-cash after maintenance capex of Operator 1 single-clinic entries and organic builds from year 3 is an Operator 1-only result [I]. The mid-teens margin, the 4–5 year ramp and low maintenance capex hold across three or more operators and are durable; COVID20 and the 2022–23 inflation moved four-wall dollars only temporarily, and Deal A's clinic base, with a third of its clinics losing money before co-op in FY26, is company-specific.

Our reading on the evidence supplied to date. A mature general practice and preventive clinic earns a mid-teens four-wall margin on cash rent before rebates (D1.1, R-CASH), on $1.3–2.9m of average sales per full-year clinic across the cash-rent clinic-years from FY08 to FY25 [note C-30; note C-31; OP1-6169, OP5-2057]. Paired within platform, that is $149–305k a year on $0.27–0.41m of clinic capex excluding real estate for an Operator 1 single-clinic entry or organic build (from $254k for a single acquisition, whose purchase price is not in the data, to $405k in the company's brownfield, acquisition and renovation summary), with 42–72% cash-on-cash after maintenance capex from age-year 3 (61% in age-year 5 across all single-clinic entries; Operator 1 only, [I]), and $494k (PF) on $1.0–1.4m at Operator 5, whose single measured greenfield returns 44–60% (PF) [OP1-5322, OP1-2214; OP1-1499..OP1-1501; OP5-2050; OP5-0342, OP5-0343, OP5-2561]. Acquired clinics cost about $1.0–1.3m of purchase price per clinic in the add-on programmes of 2021–26 (Operator 3 $1.0m, Operator 6 $1.26m, Operator 4 $1.33m in 2021), $1.4–1.5m at Operator 6 once integration and transaction cost is added, and $3.17m at Operator 4 in 2025, a year that includes the Operator 26 scale deal [OP3-1842; A4-S0368; OP6-1881..OP6-1883; OP4-0765/OP4-0764, OP4-0785/OP4-0784]. On company-presented, synergised, survivor-only clinic EBITDA, add-ons bought at 5–7× seller clinic EBITDA show later multiples of 3–4× by years 2–3 (Operator 6, Operator 4, Operator 3); this is not established on D1.1 or on an all-deal base, and part of the uplift is rebate allocation [note C-36; note C-37]. At Operator 6 9 of 31 deals (about a quarter) sit below entry EBITDA, Operator 3's chart shows none of 18 below entry and Operator 4 gives no count; acquired cohorts delivered 60–69% of the PF EBITDA used to price them at Operator 8 and 44–89% of seller closing EBITDA on twelve owned months at Deal B (Part 06 section B) [A4-S0367; OP8-1703, OP8-2211; DLB-0114/DLB-7667, DLB-0142/DLB-7682, DLB-0166/DLB-7697]. Clinic-to-clinic dispersion is not explained by mix or region; the residual is clinic sales level and rent, and reading that residual as site or execution is an inference [note C-38] [I]. **Check status:** Checked a second time against the source — the mid-teens D1.1 level and the ramp are supported on Operator 1 (A, R-CASH) with Operator 7 and Operator 5 (PF). The reading carries four limits: earnings are paired with capital from the same platform, re-rating is stated only on its company-presented, synergised, survivor-only basis, an achievement ratio is not read as a frequency, and sales-level R^2 is not read as proof of execution. **Operators / environments:** Operator 1, Operator 5 and Operator 7 (R-CASH) with Operator 2, Operator 3, Operator 8, Operator 6, Operator 4 and Deal A per platform, covering GFC, EXP10-19, COVID20, REOPEN21, INFL22-23 and SOFT24-26. The five durable findings of this section meet the three-operator, two-environment test, but those on the ramp and maintenance capex rest partly on management [M] figures or a single Operator 5 clinic, and the re-rating finding meets it only in its qualified form.

What the evidence shows

On a common definition (D1.1, R-CASH, full-year clinics) the median mature clinic earned a 12.9–16.8% four-wall margin in every platform-year except Operator 1 in 2015–16, when the median fell to 11.5% and then 10.0% [OP1-5755, OP1-5757]. Operator 1 and Operator 7 are basis A and Operator 5 is PF, so the three are shown side by side and not pooled. Four-wall dollars are driven by scale: the median clinic earned $149–268k at Operator 1 on $1.3–1.8m of average sales per full-year clinic (every year from FY08 to CY2016; $1.5–1.8m in the five Operator 1 years of Exhibit 3.12) and $410–472k at Operator 5 (PF) and Operator 7 ST-22 on $2.0–2.9m [OP1-5322, OP1-2214; OP1-6169, OP1-2652; OP7-0501, OP7-0517; OP5-2050, OP5-2057]. The GFC evidence is Operator 1 only: on legacy full-year clinics the median rose from $242k to $269k and the median margin from 14.1% to 15.0% between FY08 and FY09, with the loss share falling from 3.3% to 0%, while across all 90 clinics with FY09 sales, including 46 part-year [name withheld] clinics, the loss share is 7.3% and the median $116.5k (ALL, [I]) [OP1-2213, OP1-2214; OP1-2507, OP1-2508; OP1-2408, OP1-2409; A4-P5-001..003]. There is no pre-GFC clinic year. The R-UNK platforms sit lower on their own codes: Operator 2 at 11.8% (LTM Mar-21, ALL), Operator 3 at an 10.1% median (LTM Aug-25, SURVIVOR) and Operator 8 at a 10.4% median (2025, COMP) [OP2-3462; OP3-1095; OP8-2127]. Deal A is structurally different: its FY26 median clinic margin is 5.9% before co-op and before finance-lease cost (R-OPONLY), 28.7% of its 983 open clinics lose money on that measure, and

its $0.93m AUV is below every core peer [A4-S0213; DLA-0862; A4-S0269]. Rebates lift reported four-wall wherever the two can be separated; at Operator 1 in CY2016 D1.2 was 18.6% against D1.1 of 11.4%, and the loss share was 2.5% on D1.2 against 10.8% on D1.1 (R-CASH, ALL) [OP1-5871, OP1-5666; OP1-6106, OP1-5630].

Capital per clinic has to be read by component, because organic build cost and acquisition price measure different things. Operator 1 clinic capex from 12 months before to 12 months after opening, excluding land, inventory and purchase price, was $369k for organic greenfields, $360k for brownfields and $254k for single acquisitions, with company summaries of $388k and $405k and $0.99m for a greenfield on a ground lease including the building [OP1-1501, OP1-1500, OP1-1499; OP1-7076, OP1-7074, OP1-7077]. Operator 5 greenfields cost $1.13m at City 32 and $1.0m or $1.4m at City 12 (sources differ), both excluding land and building [OP5-0339; OP5-0342, OP5-0343]. Acquired clinics cost $1.0m at Operator 3 (company figure [M]), $1.26m of TEV at Operator 6 plus $134–192k of integration and transaction cost (PF), and $1.33m (2021) or $3.17m (2025, including the Operator 26 scale deal) at Operator 4 [OP3-1842; A4-S0368; OP6-1881..OP6-1883; OP4-0765/OP4-0764, OP4-0785/OP4-0784].

Cash-on-cash, always [I] and always on leased-clinic capital because rent sits inside four-wall, is high for mature organic clinics and modest for acquisitions [note C-33]. Operator 1 single-clinic entries return 42.0% after maintenance capex in age-year 3 and 57.8% in age-year 5 on $319k of average initial capex; the small organic samples return 72.2% for greenfields (n=4) and 55.6% for brownfields (n=6) in year 3 (D1.1, R-CASH, A) [A4-S0024, A4-S0044, OP1-1496; OP1-3012, OP1-1501; OP1-3007, OP1-1500]. Operator 1's own 72.8% greenfield figure is on D1.2 and includes the ATF rebate, and its company claims of 134–133% sit above anything the clinic data show on D1.1 [OP1-7072; OP1-7153, OP1-7154]. Operator 5 City 12 earned $694k in FY22, about its second year, which is 44.0% on $1.4m or 60.0% on $1.0m (company basis, PF, one clinic) [OP5-2561; OP5-0342, OP5-0343]. Operator 2's owned greenfield vintages returned 23.5%, 21.6% and −1.4% after maintenance at LTM Mar-21 for the 2018, 2019 and 2020 openings (R-UNK, COVID-affected) [OP2-3644, OP2-3647, OP2-3650; OP2-1660]. Operator 6 add-ons earn 16.1% at entry on seller clinic EBITDA (PF) and 14.1%, 27.2% and 22.3% at 1–2, 2–3 and 3+ years after close once $161k of integration cost is added (D1.2, before corporate cost) [A4-S0362, A4-S0361; A4-S0333, A4-S0343, A4-S0353; OP6-1881..OP6-1883].

The organic ramp takes four to five years, and year 1 is loss-making for a quarter or more of openings [note C-34]. Operator 1 single-clinic entries (greenfield, brownfield and single acquisitions, which the series does not separate) earn a 6.7% D1.1 margin in year 1 with 24.2% of clinics loss-making, and reach 0.79× the mature median's revenue and 0.80× its four-wall only in year 5 (R-CASH, A, ALL with a sheet at Nov-17) [A4-S0006, A4-S0008; A4-S0049, A4-S0050]. Vintage matters as much as age: clinics opened Jul-08 to May-14 made 9.5% in year 1 with 12.0% loss-making, while clinics opened Jun-14 to Nov-16 made 2.0% with 37.0% loss-making and still only 3.3% with 34.3% loss-making in year 2 [A4-S0379, A4-S0380; A4-S0391, A4-S0392; A4-S0395, A4-S0396]. Operator 1 batch acquisitions ([name withheld], Nov-08; Deal A City 30, Dec-11) never reached legacy size, at 0.28× mature revenue in year 1 and 0.46× in year 5, and their margin drifted from 14.8% to 12.2% [A4-S0097, A4-S0137; A4-S0094, A4-S0134]. Operator 2's owned greenfields ramped more slowly, with year-2 margins of 1.2% (2019, n=2) and 3.3% (2020, n=7) and 25–44% loss-making (R-UNK) [A4-S0297, A4-S0307; A4-S0299, A4-S0309]. Operator 5 City 12 is the fast exception: $2.84m of revenue and a 14.1% contribution in year 1 and 18.3% in year 2, a single clinic in a dense home market (PF) [A4-S0369, A4-S0371, A4-S0374].

Acquired clinics improve after purchase on company-presented measures, but the evidence is synergised, survivor-only and mostly PF [note C-37, C-36]. Operator 6's 31 add-ons were bought at 4.5× seller clinic EBITDA and stand at 3.4× on TTM Mar-26 clinic EBITDA per QoE, which includes platform synergies and, for deals closed after Apr-25, seller months (PF); the 11 deals owned two years or more sit at 2.5–2.9×, and 9 of 31 are below entry EBITDA [OP6-1731, OP6-1733; A4-S0345, A4-S0355; A4-S0367]. Two deals have fallen furthest, [name withheld] to −$46k and Adelphia to $109k against $272k at entry, and current-to-entry EBITDA is 1.57× in South-East State 20 against 0.93× in State 18, State 16 and South-West State 20 [OP6-1606; OP6-1508, OP6-1506]. Operator 4's programmatic pool went from 6.0× at close to 3.2× on Q1-26 LTM (A, survivor pool), and its scale pool from 9.0× to 4.0× on an LTM that includes Operator 26 run-rate (PF) [OP4-0802, OP4-0806; OP4-0808, OP4-0812]. Operator 3's 18 deals moved from a mean of 5.2× to 2.8× on a chart read (PF [M]), yet its 2023 cohort's revenue fell 11.4% in the first owned year against 6.3% seller momentum [OP3-1457..OP3-1492; OP3-1110, OP3-1111]. Against the PF EBITDA used to price them, Operator 8's 11 new units delivered 0.59× and its 2023–24 cohort 0.70×, and Deal B's cohorts delivered 0.44–0.90× of seller closing EBITDA on twelve owned months (0.55–0.76× in the first owned year; Part 06 section B) [OP8-1703; OP8-2211; DLB-0114/DLB-7667, DLB-0142/DLB-7682, DLB-0166/DLB-7697; note C-87].

Service mix has a consistent direction but explains little of the variance between clinics [note C-38]. General practice-heavy clinics earn 2–10pp more than pharmacy-heavy clinics in every dataset, but mix explains at most 8% of margin variance (adjusted R^2) at Operator 1, Deal A and Operator 2, and region 5–7% at Deal A [A4-S0182; A4-S0206, A4-S0217; A4-S0207, A4-S0218]. Clinic sales level explains 24–50% in five of eight datasets and rent 17–32% where it is observed [A4-S0195, A4-S0208, A4-S0219; A4-S0184, A4-S0196]. With largely fixed clinic costs, a higher-revenue clinic mechanically earns a higher margin, so the sales-level R^2 is mostly operating leverage and cannot say whether low sales reflect the local market or execution [I]. Loss-clinic shares are platform-specific, from 0% at Operator 5 (PF) and Operator 7 ST-22 to 28.7% at Deal A (before co-op), on mixed rent codes shown per platform [OP5-2053; OP7-0514; DLA-0862].

Exhibit 9.57 — Mature cash-rent clinics earned 14.1–16.1% four-wall margins (D1.1, ratio of sums) in the platform-years shown from FY08 to FY25, against 11.8% at Operator 2 on an unknown rent code; Operator 1 fell to 9.8% in CY2016 (median 10.0%) and Deal A's FY26 clinic median before co-op was 5.9%

Typical mature clinic by platform and period, FY08 to FY26: sales per clinic and median four-wall ($k), margin, capital per clinic ($k) and cash-on-cash; definition, rent code and basis per row

PLATFORM	PERIOD (CYCLE)	DEFINITION / RENT / BASIS; BASE, N	AUV $K	MEDIAN FOUR-WALL $K	MARGIN (RATIO OF SUMS)	CAPITAL PER CLINIC $K	CASH-ON-CASH AFTER MAINT.
Operator 1	FY08 / FY09 (GFC)	D1.1 / R-CASH / A; ALL full-year, 44 / 47	1,629 / 1,796	242 / 269	14.1% / 14.1%	–	–
Operator 1	CY2010 / CY2016 (EXP10-19)	D1.1 / R-CASH / A; ALL, 93 / 148	1,415 / 1,412	199 / 152	15.0% / 9.8%	–	–
Operator 1	Single-clinic entries, age-year 3 / 5	D1.1 / R-CASH / A [I]; n=39 / 21	–	159 / 232 (mean)	–	319 (clinic capex, ex RE and purchase price)	42.0% / 57.8%
Operator 1	Organic greenfield / brownfield, year 3	D1.1 / R-CASH / A [I]; n=4 / 6	–	316 / 228	–	369 / 360	72.2% / 55.6%
Operator 5	FY22 (INFL22-23)	D1.1 / R-CASH / PF; ALL, 37	3,022	494	15.0%	–	–
Operator 5	City 12 greenfield, FY22 (year ~2)	Company basis (D1.2-type) / R-CASH / PF; 1 clinic	–	694	–	1,040 or 1,387 (sources differ)	60.0% or 44.0% (before maint.)
Operator 7 ST-22	FY25 (SOFT24-26)	D1.1 / R-CASH (related party) / A; full-year, 9	2,656	433	16.1%	Not available	Not computable
Operator 2	LTM Mar-21 (REOPEN21)	D1.1 / R-UNK / A; ALL, 111	1,122 (median)	176	11.8%	254 greenfield [M]	2018 / 2019 vintages 23.5% / 21.6%
Operator 6	LTM Mar-26 (SOFT24-26)	D1.2 / R-UNK / PF; SURVIVOR, 49	1,665	326 (average)	16%	1,303 TEV (+161 integration)	16.1% at entry; 14.1–27.2% after integration
Deal A	FY26 (SOFT24-26)	Clinic EBITDA before co-op / R-OPONLY / A; open at FYE, 983	919	52	Median 5.9%	0.69–1.00× seller sales (acquisitions)	Not computable

Source: note C-30, note C-32, note C-33. Capital and returns are paired only within a platform. Cash-on-cash = (four-wall − maintenance capex per clinic) ÷ capital, [I], on leased-clinic capital; no platform reports clinic capital including real estate. Operator 7 ST-22 rows exclude part-year clinics (15.9% on ALL clinics, note C-19)

Exhibit 9.58 — Every add-on group shows a lower multiple later than at entry (4.1–9.0× to 2.5–4.7×, later EBITDA May-25 to Q1-26), on company-presented, synergised or pro forma EBITDA

Purchase price ÷ clinic EBITDA (×) at entry and later, by platform group; later EBITDA TTM Mar-26 (Operator 6), Q1-26 LTM (Operator 4), May-25 (Operator 3)

PLATFORM / GROUP	DEALS / CLINICS	ENTRY MULTIPLE	LATER MULTIPLE	LATER EBITDA BASIS	DEALS BELOW ENTRY EBITDA
Operator 6, <1 year since close	9 / 9	4.6×	3.4×	PF: synergised per QoE, includes seller months	2
Operator 6, 1–2 years	15 / 20	5.1×	4.7×	Company-presented, synergised, survivor-only	5
Operator 6, 2–3 years	4 / 7	4.1×	2.5×	Company-presented, synergised, survivor-only	1
Operator 6, 3+ years	7 / 15	4.2×	2.9×	Company-presented, synergised, survivor-only	1
Operator 6, all	31 / 46	4.5×	3.4×	PF (OP6-1733)	9
Operator 4, programmatic pool	14 deals, 143 locations incl. scale	6.0×	3.2× (Q1-26 LTM)	A; company-presented post-integration, survivor pool	Not disclosed
Operator 4, scale pool	–	9.0×	4.0× (Q1-26 LTM)	PF: includes Operator 26 run-rate	–
Operator 3, Ares Credit Group chart	18 deals	4.6× (mean)	2.8× (mean, May-25)	PF [M], chart read	0 of 18

Source: note C-36, note C-37. Entry EBITDA is seller clinic EBITDA (standalone; PF at Operator 6 and Operator 3, A at Operator 4 as the company presents it); later EBITDA is D1.2 or company basis, never D1.1, so part of any uplift is rebate allocation. The Operator 6 sample excludes the City 11 brownfield and any exited deals

Exhibit 9.59 — Operator 1 single-clinic entries reached 0.80× mature four-wall only in year 5, and 24.2% lost money in year 1 (clinic years 2009 to Nov-17)

Operator 1 single-clinic entries and batch acquisitions by age-year: sales per clinic, median four-wall ($k), D1.1 and D1.2 margin on cash rent, loss-making share and ratios to the mature median; clinic years 2009 to Nov-17

GROUP	AGE-YEAR	N	AUV MEAN $K	MEDIAN D1.1 $K	D1.1 MARGIN	D1.2 MARGIN	LOSS-MAKING SHARE	REVENUE ÷ MATURE MEDIAN	FOUR-WALL ÷ MATURE MEDIAN
Single-clinic entries	1	62	1,168	81	6.7%	13.8%	24.2%	0.52×	0.23×
Single-clinic entries	2	54	1,292	103	8.1%	15.3%	17.3%	0.55×	0.37×
Single-clinic entries	3	39	1,392	146	10.0%	17.4%	11.5%	0.68×	0.56×
Single-clinic entries	4	27	1,693	191	11.7%	19.6%	0.0%	0.72×	0.61×
Single-clinic entries	5	21	1,614	223	12.1%	20.4%	3.7%	0.79×	0.80×
Single-clinic entries	6	18	1,962	225	12.1%	20.4%	4.7%	0.76×	0.79×
Batch acquisitions ([name withheld]; Deal A City 30)	1	49	617	89	14.8%	16.9%	6.2%	0.28×	0.28×
Batch acquisitions	3	49	942	138	13.8%	17.9%	0.0%	0.37×	0.37×
Batch acquisitions	5	49	1,095	143	12.2%	17.5%	1.6%	0.46×	0.40×

Source: note C-34 (A4-S0001..A4-S0138). Basis A; D1.1 and D1.2 on R-CASH; clinic base ALL clinics with a sheet at Nov-17 (only 2 sheets end early, so clinics closed before 2017 may be absent); EXP10-19. "Mature median" is the median of pre-Jul-08 clinics trading all 12 months of the same calendar year. Single-clinic entries mix greenfield, brownfield and single acquisitions, which the series does not label

Exhibit 9.60 — Every add-on pool (deals 2021–26) shows a lower multiple later than at entry on company-presented, synergised EBITDA: Operator 6 4.5× to 3.4×, Operator 3 4.6× to 2.8×, Operator 4 programmatic 6.0× to 3.2×

Add-on multiple at entry and later multiple on current EBITDA (×), by platform pool and Operator 6 years since close; deals 2021–26, later EBITDA TTM Mar-26 / May-25 / Q1-26 LTM

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 6 Valuation Multiple Summary, May 2026 (OP6-1731, OP6-1733; deal rows A4-S0319 to A4-S0368); Ares Credit Group Operator 3 Early Read, 16 October 2025, p.9 (OP3-1457 to OP3-1492); Ares Credit Group Operator 4 IC Memo, 15 June 2026, p.19 (OP4-0802, OP4-0806, OP4-0808, OP4-0812); note C-36 and note C-37 · Basis: Filled = actual (A), hollow = pro forma (PF). Entry: Operator 6 and Operator 3 pro forma (seller EBITDA at close), Operator 4 actual. Later: Operator 6 under one year and all deals pro forma, older buckets actual as the company presents them; Operator 3 pro forma; Operator 4 programmatic pool actual, scale pool pro forma (includes a run-rate). Later EBITDA is the company's presentation after integration, including synergies, on surviving deals only (Operator 6 excludes City 11 and exited deals). A lower later multiple means EBITDA above entry, not a standalone result

Durable, temporary, company-specific

Five findings hold across three or more operators and two or more environments. A mature clinic earns a mid-teens D1.1 four-wall on cash rent at Operator 1 (GFC and EXP10-19), Operator 5 (COVID20 to INFL22-23, PF) and Operator 7 ST-22 (INFL22-23 to SOFT24-26) [note C-31]. Maintenance capex is low, at $3.4–23k per clinic or about 0.2–1.3% of sales, mostly on management splits, with Deal A's $17.5–23.0k a total-capex upper bound [DLA-0286, DLA-0320]. The organic ramp takes 4–5 years with a quarter to two-fifths of openings loss-making in year 1 at Operator 1 and 25–44% of Operator 2's greenfields still loss-making in year 2, Operator 5 being the fast exception [A4-S0008, A4-S0392; A4-S0299, A4-S0309]. On company-presented, synergised, survivor-only clinic EBITDA, add-ons move from 5–7× entry to 3–4× by years 2–3 at Operator 6, Operator 4 and Operator 3; this is not established on D1.1 or on an all-deal base, and at Operator 6 9 of 31 deals sit below entry EBITDA (none of 18 on Operator 3's chart; no count at Operator 4) [note C-36; A4-S0367]. Clinic dispersion is not explained by mix or region [note C-38].

The temporary conditions are COVID20, when Operator 2's D1.1 rose to 12.0% and its loss share fell to 10% on cost cuts while traffic fell 15.1%, and Operator 5 recorded its lowest margin of the series at 13.3% (PF) [OP2-3431, OP2-3592; OP5-1152]; and INFL22-23, when four-wall dollars rose on ticket rather than volume (Operator 5 median $494k, PF; Operator 3 D1.1 9.0% to 11.4%, SURVIVOR) [OP5-2050; OP3-1012, OP3-1031].

The company-specific items are Deal A's clinic base, with a third of clinics negative on a measure that excludes both co-op and finance-lease cost and the median margin down from 7.4% in FY23 to 5.9% in FY26; its median clinic EBITDA was $52k in FY26 on clinics open at year-end, against $84k in FY24 on surviving clinics, two different bases [DLA-0862; A4-S0202, A4-S0213; DLA-0859; DLA-0905]; the weak 2014–16 Operator 1 openings (37%

loss-making in year 1 against 12% for 2008–14 openings) [A4-S0392, A4-S0380]; Operator 2's slower greenfields; the Operator 8 cohorts delivering 60–69% of the PF EBITDA used to price them and the Deal B cohorts 44–89% of seller closing EBITDA on twelve owned months [OP8-1703, OP8-2211; DLB-0114/DLB-7667, DLB-0142/DLB-7682, DLB-0166/DLB-7697]; the 2015–16 Operator 1 D1.1 decline, an operating decline in clinic labour and occupancy rather than an accounting reallocation (constant-base D1.1 down 3.3pp while pre-ATF gross margin rose from 41.7% to 43.3%) [A4-P5-004..007]; and the zero loss-making clinics at Operator 5 and Operator 7, each in a single dense market [OP5-2053; OP7-0514].

What the evidence cannot show

No platform reports clinic capital including real estate alongside four-wall, so every cash-on-cash figure is on leased-clinic capital. The Operator 1 ramp series does not label development type and omits single-acquisition purchase prices; joining the OP1-018 Clinic Legend (DEVTYPE column) and OP1-025 'Brownfield_Acq.' tab to the OP1-021 sheets would split the ramp and could turn the weak 2014–16 vintage into an acquisition-quality finding. The acquired-clinic re-rating is not observed on D1.1 or on an all-deal base; Operator 6 or Operator 3 clinic P&Ls with rebates removed, and OP4-005 per-deal EBITDA for Operator 4, would test whether the 1.1–1.5× EBITDA uplift survives [A4-S0366, A4-S0346]. Cash rent is unknown for Operator 2, Operator 3, Operator 6 and Operator 8 from 2024; a book-to-cash gap of the ~1.3% of sales seen at Operator 2 would take the ratio-of-sums D1.1 of Operator 2 (11.8%, LTM Mar-21), Operator 3 (12.4%, LTM Aug-25) and Operator 8 (10.8%, LTM Mar-26) to about 11–12%, below the R-CASH set [I; OP2-3462; OP3-1088; OP8-2101]. The maintenance split is missing at Deal A, Operator 5 and Operator 7 (DLA-016 capex detail, the Operator 5 fixed-asset register and the OP7-003 capex schedule would close it). Deal A's closed-clinic economics sit in the DLA-003 'Closed Clinics' tab and are not analysed in this section. No core ramp exists after 2017 or in SOFT24-26 on clinic data, Operator 2's post-Mar-21 clinic data are not among the documents supplied, and Operator 5 has one full greenfield, whose capital itself differs between sources (OP5-010 p.37 would resolve it). Deal C has no clinic-level economics by age, cohort or rent code (DLC-001 Site-Level Database), and its FY2025 clinic-level margin of 21.3% on book rent (22.3% on cash rent; D1.2, audited; 32 of 88 clinics lease from related parties; Part 07 section B, Part 07 section G) needs restating to D1.1 before benchmarking [DLC-0018, DLC-5013, DLC-5014, DLC-0001; note C-29]. The Deal B cohort rows used in this section (DLB-0114, DLB-0142, DLB-0166 and the seller-EBITDA rows paired with them) were read once from the source.

A mature clinic earns a mid-teens four-wall margin on cash rent before rebates [F, note C-30]. Operator 1's fall to $152k by CY2016 came with 10.8% of clinics loss-making, and its margin eroded even on constant clinics [F, note C-30; Exhibit 9.50].

Capital and returns are paired only within a platform, so the gap is a statement about entry route, not about which operator is better [I, note C-33]. Buying a clinic cost $1.0–3.2m of purchase price in the deals of 2021–26, the top being Operator 4's 2025 programme with the Operator 26 scale deal, against $0.37–0.41m of clinic capex for an Operator 1 organic build. Clinic earnings are of a similar order on both routes ($316k for a year-3 Operator 1 greenfield; $326k on average at Operator 6's clinics), so the gap in returns reflects the difference in capital [I, Exhibit 3.15; Exhibit 9.57].

Exhibit 9.61 — Operator 2's acquired clinics in their third owned year (2020, 55 clinics) earned a 11.4% four-wall margin, against 8.1% (26% loss-making) for clinics in their first owned year in 2018 (26 clinics); the groups are different clinics, and its greenfields earned 1–4% in years two and three

Operator 2 owned clinics by kind, calendar year and year of ownership: four-wall margin before rebates (D1.1) and share of clinics making a loss, %, 2018 to 2020

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Operator 2 Clinic Level Databook (June 2021), four-wall and sales by clinic and month; CreditSwan computation by year of ownership (note C-35; fact rows A4-S0270 to A4-S0314) · Basis: Actual (A); rent code not stated in the databook (R-UNK); owned clinics trading 12 months in the year, survivors only (no owned closures to Mar-21); n = clinics in each group; each year's groups are different clinics, not one cohort followed through time

Operator 2's acquired clinics in their third owned year (2020, n=55) earned a 11.4% four-wall margin against 8.1% for those in their first owned year in 2018 (n=26); the groups are different clinics, so this is not one cohort's improvement [I, A4-S0272, A4-S0287; note C-35]. Greenfields take longer to earn: Operator 2's earned 1.0–4.2% in their second and third owned years (2019–20) [I, note C-35].

03 E Same-store sales: supporting evidence

In ordinary years the cross-operator median ran +3.0% in the 2010–14 expansion and +3.2% in 2015–19 and fell to +1.8% in the 2024 to 2026 soft period, when comp traffic fell at four of the seven core operators with a reading and ticket rose +4.1% to +7.3% at the core operators where it was measured beside falling traffic (Deal C's company average invoice +11.5% in FY24 and +3.3% for LTM Jun-26). Traffic erosion with ticket carrying comps is durable, the 2020 shock, the 2021 rebound and the 2021–23 inflation in ticket were temporary, and Deal A's +0.5% mean over 18 years with nine negative years is company-specific.

Our reading on the evidence supplied to date. Comparable-clinic sales in general practice and preventive veterinary care move with the market in macro shocks: all five core operators with calendar-2020 data were negative, from −2.7% to −9.5% (Deal A FY21 included), and seven operators then printed +11.8% to +15.3% in 2021 with a cross-operator standard deviation of only 1.4pp [note C-42]. On like-for-like SSS_CD-family rows the year effect also dominates over 2010–25, explaining 0.63 of the variance against 0.20 for the operator effect (n = 32); the roughly even split on the pooled best-available panel outside 2020–21 (year 0.31, operator 0.32) carries definition differences inside its operator term and is not a like-for-like result [note C-54]. In every environment with a traffic series, comparable sales rest on ticket rather than visits. In SOFT24-26 comp traffic fell at four of the seven core operators with a 2024–26 reading (median −2.8% on each operator's latest reading, including Deal B's single PF quarter; Part 03 section A gives −2.9% across the six SOFT24-26 operator-years of five operators), and at five of eight (median −2.2%) once Deal C's PF company-adjusted series is added; three of the negative readings are survivor bases, one is a PF single quarter, and periods run from LTM Aug-25 to Q2-26 [note C-40; note C-51]. Where ticket is measured alongside falling traffic it rose +4.1% to +7.3% at the core operators, and Deal C's company average invoice rose +11.5% (FY24) and +3.3% (LTM Jun-26) [note C-51]. **Check status:** Checked a second time against the source: the COVID shock and the 2021 rebound. The reading carries three limits: the COVID range includes Deal A, the operator-versus-year split carries a definition confound, and survivor bases and one PF quarter do not establish a "volume recession" in SOFT24-26. **Operators / environments:** 13 core operators, including Deal B and Deal C as rows read once from the source, across all seven environments from PRE-GFC to SOFT24-26 on month-majority tags, with the 2010–19 expansion read in two halves (EXP10-14 and EXP15-19); PRE-GFC does not meet the three-operator test (Deal A is the only core operator) and no conclusion is drawn from it [note C-40].

What the evidence shows

COVID20 is the one environment in which every operator moved together, and it moved volume, not ticket. All five core operators with 2020 data were negative, the cross-operator median was −5.9% and the standard deviation 2.6pp, the tightest negative year in the panel [OP1-8857, OP2-3525, OP2-3526, OP2-3527, DLA-0356, OP5-3870, OP5-3871, OP5-3872, OP4-0551]. Where traffic is measured it fell hard while ticket rose: Operator 2 −15.1% traffic and Operator 5 −11.4% on CLOSE-FWD comp bases, Deal A FY21 −18.6% on its survivor base, against ticket growth of +6.3% to +9.2% [OP2-3526, OP5-3871, DLA-0629; OP5-3872, OP2-3527, DLA-0630]. The decline was broad inside each platform, with 76% of Operator 2 comp clinics and 72% of Operator 5 comp clinics negative [A5-S141, A5-S165]. REOPEN21 was a base effect rather than a demand recovery: Operator 5 traffic rose +3.6% while ticket rose +9.5% [OP5-3875, OP5-3876]. The GFC, by contrast, separated operators more than it moved the group. Operator 10 fell 4.7% in 2008 with traffic down 4.4% (COMP, CLOSE-FWD, seller-period data) [OP2-0651, OP2-0652], Deal A printed +1.0% in FY08 and +5.9% in FY09 on its public definition [DLA-0338, DLA-0340], and Operator 1 FY09 was +8.8% on total clinic sales but +4.5% on retail, with retail pharmacy units −2.9% [OP1-2114, OP1-2115, OP1-2139]. The 2008 cross-operator standard deviation of 8.3pp is the widest in the panel [OP1-2114, OP1-2138, OP1-2090, OP2-0651, OP2-0652, OP2-0653, DLA-0340].

In ordinary years the level is moderate and the spread is operator-specific. The cross-operator median was +3.0% in EXP10-14 and +3.2% in EXP15-19 [note C-44], but the standard deviation reached 6.6pp in 2012, when Deal A FY13 was −6.3% and Operator 4 +9% [OP1-5128, OP1-5182, OP1-5110, OP2-0663, OP2-0664, OP2-0665, DLA-0345, OP4-0543]. Operator 1's clinic-level SSS_CD (COMP, CLOSE-FWD) was negative in 2012 and again in 2014–16 at −0.2%, −0.3%, −1.6% and −4.0%, and the share of its comp clinics with negative comps rose to 57% in 2016 [OP1-5128, OP1-5130..5132; A5-S065]. Deal A has the lowest long-run mean in the panel, +0.5% over 18 fiscal years with 9 negative years, against +4.2% for Operator 4 and +2.4% for the Operator 2 lineage over overlapping years [note C-43]. Dispersion inside a platform is larger than dispersion across platforms: Deal A's clinic-level P10–P90 range was −20% to +15% in FY25 (no-open-date base), against a mean cross-sectional standard deviation of 4.2pp across the 17 years with at least three operators [A5-S102, A5-S104]. Clinic selection and closures therefore move reported comps materially.

Comp traffic erodes in most years outside rebounds, and ticket carries comparable sales. On visit or patient-invoice counts, 18 of 25 core operator-years are negative (Operator 10, Operator 2, Deal A, Operator 5, Operator 3, Operator 8 and Operator 7) [note C-53]; wellness clinics are read in Part 04 section G. The erosion pre-dates COVID: Operator 10 traffic was −10.4%, −2.9%, −1.9% and −1.0% in 2011–14, Operator 1 retail comp pharmacy units were −2.4%, −3.7% and −2.6% in 2014–16 on the retail-sales comp base, and Operator 5 comp traffic (ticket count) fell 2.1% and 0.4% in 2018–19 [OP2-0661, OP2-0664, OP2-0667, OP2-0670; OP1-5166..5168; OP5-3863, OP5-3867]. In INFL22-23 ticket rose +6.7% to +11.4% while traffic was flat to negative, with Operator 5 at −0.8%, Deal A FY23 at −4.8% and Deal A FY24 at −3.9% on its survivor base [OP3-0888, DLA-0694, OP5-3880; OP5-3879, DLA-0693, DLA-0725]. Ticket is price plus mix plus attachment everywhere except Operator 8, whose 2022 company split shows "price" +12.0% on volume +0.3% [OP8-0545, OP8-0543].

SOFT24-26 shows the same pattern on mixed bases, and the bases matter for how far the reading can be pushed. The cross-operator median fell to +1.8% across 12 operators, and in 2024 four of eleven operators were negative with a standard deviation of 4.4pp [note C-44, C-42]. The four negative traffic readings are Deal A FY26 −3.9% (SURVIVOR, CLOSE-RETRO), Operator 3 LTM Aug-25 −2.8% (SURVIVOR, CLOSE-RETRO), Operator 6 LTM May-26 −3.4% (all comp clinics, CLOSE-RETRO) and Deal B Q2-26 −5.7% (PF company comp, 79 clinics, single quarter; read once from the source) [DLA-0789, OP3-0907, OP6-1952, DLB-003-000386]. Deal C's company comp visit count, extracted from DLC-015 on the company definition (PF, working-day and blackout adjusted, boarding and grooming excluded), was −5.2% in FY24, +0.1% in FY25 and −1.6% for LTM Jun-26, with average invoice of +11.5%, +4.1% and +3.3% [A1-S002..S004; A5-P5-004..006]. The three positive readings sit on undefined or newly assembled bases: Operator 8's 2025 traffic of +7.4% with ticket −1.0% (COMP, CLOSE-FWD, 21 clinics) is a small regional operator, Operator 7 +10.9% traffic has no

stated visit count definition and is pre-combination seller-period data, and Operator 4's +1% "volume" has no unit [OP8-2114, OP8-2115; OP7-1023; OP4-0653, OP4-0655]. The direction of the SOFT24-26 volume reading is supported; it is a count of mixed-base readings, not a measured common-base decline.

Definition choice alone moves reported comps by up to 4.5pp (0.3–4.5pp across the cases shown, 2014 to LTM Jul-26), which is as large as most year-to-year differences between operators (Exhibit 9.64) [note C-40; note C-48; note C-47]. Deal A's survivor SSS_CD runs above its public comp by +0.3 to +2.6pp in four of seven years, consistent with the closed clinics having been weaker than average [DLA-0660, DLA-0357]. The Ares Credit Group-presented Operator 1 series ("SSS positive every year since FY08") sits +3.3 to +4.5pp above clinic-level SSS_CD in 2014–16 and 2020, and the OP4-005 panel reproduces it to rounding in all 16 years, so the panel is not an independent source [OP1-11168..11170, OP1-11174; OP1-5130..5132, OP1-8857]. Deal C's company comp is working-day and blackout adjusted and allows seller months in the prior year; on the common definition its LTM to Jul-26 is −0.4% against a company LTM May-26 of +1.6% [DLC-0994; DLC-006-000207].

Leadership does not carry across environments, and the live deals sit at different points of the distribution. The Spearman rank correlation between an operator's INFL22-23 mean and its SOFT24-26 mean is 0.39 on month-majority tags (n = 10), which is not distinguishable from zero at the 4% level [note C-45; note C-40]. Deal A's public comp averaged −1.8% over FY25–FY26 (−4.5% as reported for FY25, +1.2% days-adjusted for FY26; −1.0% with both days-adjusted), eleventh of twelve operators, and its survivor base of about 957–984 comp clinics lost 3.9%, 7.9% and 3.9% of traffic in FY24–FY26 [A5-S018..S020; DLA-0361, DLA-0362, DLA-0363; DLA-0725, DLA-0757, DLA-0789]. Deal A's five-year financial model of 4 August 2026 assumes comps of +3.2% in FY28 and +2.6% a year in FY29–FY31 [M, P], which needs a reversal to comps that in SOFT24-26 only Operator 7 (+11.4%, one year of pre-combination seller data), Operator 8 (SSS_CD), Deal C (company-adjusted) and Operator 4 (undefined SSS_ST-59) delivered [DLA-2817..2820; note C-50]. Deal B's comps swing from −3.9% in 2024 to +4.7% in 2025 on the common definition (D2.1, CLOSE-FWD; Part 06 section G, Exhibit 6.18) while the company comp set grows from 18 to 42 clinics [DLB-1361, DLB-1406; DLB-003-000373, DLB-003-000374]. The DBW segment is wellness clinics context and is read in Part 06 section F.

Exhibit 9.62 — Only Deal A, Operator 1 and the Operator 2 lineage have comparable sales through both the GFC (Jul-07 to Jun-09) and COVID20 (2020)

Comparable-sales readings available for the GFC, calendar 2009 and COVID20, by platform, %, with evidence rows

PLATFORM	GFC (JUL-07–JUN-09)	CY2009 ONLY	COVID20
Deal A	Yes: FY08 +1.0%, FY09 +5.9% (SSS_ST-59 public) [DLA-0338, DLA-0340]; also PRE-GFC FY06–07	–	Yes: FY21 −9.5% [DLA-0356]; FY20 −2.0% has one COVID month and is tagged EXP15-19 [DLA-0355]
Operator 1	Yes: FY09 +8.8% total, +4.5% retail (SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD, 47–54 clinics) [OP1-2114, OP1-2115]	–	Yes: 2020 −2.7% [OP1-8857]
Operator 2	Via Operator 10 standalone only: 2007 +4.2%, 2008 −4.7% [OP2-0648, OP2-0651]	2009 +1.0% [OP2-0654]	Yes: 2020 −7.6% [OP2-3525]
Operator 5	No SSS	Average-daily-sales proxy −1.1% (total company, not SSS) [OP5-5409]	Yes: 2020 −5.6% [OP5-3870]
Operator 4	No (panel starts 2010)	–	Yes: 2020 −6% (SSS_ST-59, undefined) [OP4-0551]
Operator 3, Operator 8, Operator 6, Operator 7, Operator 9, Operator 29, Deal B, Deal C	No	No	No (earliest comp year 2021–2025)

Source: note C-46. Basis A unless marked PF; clinic base COMP

Exhibit 9.63 — Comp traffic fell at four of seven core operators with a 2024–26 reading, and ticket carried comparable sales

Same-store sales, comp traffic and ticket, % YoY, by operator, FY24 to LTM Jun-26; base, basis and definition per row

OPERATOR	PERIOD	SSS	COMP TRAFFIC	TICKET	BASE, BASIS AND DEFINITION	EVIDENCE ROWS
Deal A	FY24 (INFL22-23 tag; continuity only) / FY25 / FY26	−1.1 / −4.1 / +1.1%	−3.9 / −7.9 / −3.9%	+3.0 / +4.1 / +5.4%	SURVIVOR, CLOSE-RETRO, SSS_CD approximated on clinic-year KPI data, about 957 comp clinics; A	DLA-0724..0790
Operator 3	2024 / LTM Aug-25	+2.4 / +4.2%	−4.1 / −2.8%	+6.7 / +7.3%	SURVIVOR, CLOSE-RETRO, SSS_CD, 28–38 clinics; A	OP3-0890..0892, 788..0908
Operator 6	2025 / LTM May-26	n.a.	−2.0 / −3.4%	n.a.	all comp clinics, CLOSE-RETRO; A	OP6-1896, OP6-1952
Deal B (read once from the source)	Q2-26	+0.1%	−5.7%	+5.9%	company comp (SSS_ST-59), 79 clinics, single quarter; PF	DLB-003-000385/386/388

OPERATOR	PERIOD	SSS	COMP TRAFFIC	TICKET	BASE, BASIS AND DEFINITION	EVIDENCE ROWS
Deal C	FY24 / FY25 / LTM Jun-26	n.a. (company SSS +5.9% 2024, +4.2% 2025)	−5.2 / +0.1 / −1.6% (company comp visit count)	Average invoice +11.5 / +4.1 / +3.3%	company definition (working-day and blackout adjusted, boarding and grooming excluded, m−12 may be seller data); PF	DLC-2723, DLC-2788; A1-S002..S004; A5-P5-004..006
Operator 4	2024 / 2025	+5 / +2%	+1 / +1% ("volume", unit not stated)	+3 / +2% ("price" as labelled)	SSS_ST-59, definition not stated, CLOSE-UNK; A	OP4-0555/0653/0652; OP4-0556/0655/0654
Operator 8	2025	+6.2%	+7.4%	−1.0%	COMP, CLOSE-FWD, SSS_CD monthly, 21 clinics; A	OP8-2106/2114/2115
Operator 7	2025 / LTM Jun-26	+11.4 / +4.8%	+10.9 / +4.7%	+0.3 / +0.1%	COMP, CLOSE-FWD, SSS_CD; visit count definition not stated; pre-combination seller-period data; A	OP7-1022..1024, 892..1048

Source: note C-51. Ticket = revenue per visit or patient invoice (price + mix + attachment, not separable). The seven-operator median of −2.8% excludes Deal C and Deal A FY24; adding Deal C's LTM Jun-26 gives five of eight negative and a median of −2.2% [note C-51]. Periods and bases differ by operator and are listed, so the median is a count of mixed readings, not a common-base measure

Exhibit 9.64 — Definition choice alone moved reported comparable sales by up to 4.5pp between 2014 and LTM Jul-26 (Operator 1 2020)

Company or presented comparable sales against the common-definition (D2.1-family) figure, %, and the difference, pp, by operator and period, 2014 to LTM Jul-26

OPERATOR, PERIOD	COMPANY OR PRESENTED COMP	D2.1-FAMILY COMP	DIFFERENCE (D2.1-FAMILY MINUS COMPANY)	EVIDENCE ROWS
Deal A FY21	−9.5% public SSS_ST-59	−11.4% survivor SSS_CD (CLOSE-RETRO)	−1.8pp	DLA-0356; DLA-0628
Deal A FY22	+13.2%	+15.9%	+2.6pp	DLA-0357; DLA-0660
Deal A FY23	+2.4%	+3.7%	+1.2pp	DLA-0358; DLA-0692
Deal A FY24	−1.8% as reported; −3.3% days-adjusted	−1.1% survivor SSS_CD	+0.6pp against as reported	DLA-0359, DLA-0360; DLA-0724
Operator 1 2014 / 2015 / 2016	+3.0 / +2.3 / +0.3% Ares Credit Group-presented (OP1-048)	−0.3 / −1.6 / −4.0% SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD	−3.3 / −3.9 / −4.2pp	OP1-11168..11170; OP1-5130..5132
Operator 1 2020	+1.9% Ares Credit Group-presented (+1.8% OP4-005 panel)	−2.7% SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD	−4.5pp	OP1-11174, OP4-0567; OP1-8857
Deal B 2024	−1.6% company comp (18 clinics)	−3.9% D2.1 SSS_CD, CLOSE-FWD	−2.3pp (company comp set of 18 clinics)	DLB-003-000373; DLB-1361
Deal B 2025	+8.1% company comp (42 clinics)	+4.7% D2.1 SSS_CD, CLOSE-FWD	−3.2pp	DLB-003-000374; DLB-1406
Deal B LTM Jul-26	+4.6% company comp (54 clinics)	+3.3% D2.1 SSS_CD, CLOSE-FWD	−1.1pp	DLB-003-000375; DLB-1516
Deal C 2025	+4.2% company (working-day and blackout adjusted; PF)	+4.5% common, survivor site DB	+0.3pp	DLC-006-000206; A5-S001
Deal C LTM	+1.6% company, LTM May-26	−0.4% common, LTM Jul-26	about −2.1pp (end months differ by two)	DLC-006-000207; DLC-0994
Operator 7 LTM Jun-26	~5.8% Ares Credit Group memo (no definition)	+4.8% SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD	−1.0pp	OP7-1079; OP7-1046
Operator 8 2022 (clinic-base effect, not a definition)	15.0% on an alternative base incl. 2021 acquisitions	+11.8% SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD, 15 clinics	−3.2pp	OP8-1714

Source: note C-47, note C-48 and note C-49; evidence rows as listed. Basis A unless marked PF. Differences are simple subtractions [I]. Deal A's survivor SSS_CD is CLOSE-RETRO and so overstates true D2.1 comps where closed clinics were weak

The soft-period chart of comp traffic and ticket by operator is shown with the operating benchmark, as Exhibit 4.10 in Part 04 section C.

Durable, temporary, company-specific

The durable characteristic is that comp traffic falls in most operator-years outside the 2020–21 shock and rebound, by between 0.4% (Operator 5 2019) and 10.4% (Operator 10 2011, a year of shifting visit counts noted in Part 03 section A), and ticket carries comparable sales; this holds in EXP10-14, EXP15-19, INFL22-23 and SOFT24-26, with 18 of 25 core operator-years negative on visit or patient-invoice counts across all years [note C-53; OP5-3867; OP2-0661]. Year effects dominate when the macro shock is large, at 54% of SSS variance over 2010–25 on the pooled panel and 61% on SSS_CD-family rows [note C-54]. A COVID-type shock to clinic access produces a −3% to −9% comp year followed by a +12% to +15% rebound year [note C-42].

The temporary conditions are the COVID20 and REOPEN21 shock and rebound, which were symmetric, and ticket growth of +7% to +12% in 2021–23, which was inflation pass-through that decelerated to +4.1% to +7.3% at the core operators where traffic fell in SOFT24-26; Deal A's survivor ticket went from +11.9% in FY22 to +3.0% in FY24 [DLA-0662, DLA-0726]. Deal C's PF average invoice is the exception, at +11.5% in FY24 falling to +3.3% for LTM Jun-26 [A5-P5-004, A5-P5-006]. The separately identified "price" components, Operator 8 2023 at +2.6% and Operator 4 2025 at +2%, have normalised [OP8-0546, OP4-0654].

Company-specific execution shows in the ordinary years. Deal A's +0.5% mean over 18 years with 9 negative years is company-specific, since Operator 4 averaged +4.2% and the Operator 2 lineage +2.4% in the same calendar years [note C-43]. Operator 1's 2014–16 negative run on legacy clinics, while its PF-all-brands CIM series was positive at +3.0%, +2.3% and +0.3%, shows acquisitions masking organic weakness in presented comps [OP1-8247..8249; OP1-5130..5132]. Clinic-level dispersion inside platforms (Deal A P10–P90 −20% to +15% in FY25; Operator 1 −14% to +8% in 2016) exceeds the 3–5pp cross-operator spread, so clinic selection and closures, including Deal A's second closure round, move reported comps materially [A5-S102, A5-S104, A5-S062, A5-S064].

What the evidence cannot show

The evidence cannot give a like-for-like cross-operator level: only 8 operators have SSS_CD-family series, the common-definition (SSS_CD) cross-section has three or more operators in only five years, and Operator 4, Operator 9, Operator 29, Operator 1 2018 and 2023–25 and Operator 2 2021–25 are SSS_ST-59 with no stated definition [note C-48; note C-42]; Operator 4 and Operator 9 KPI or clinic databooks and an Operator 1 comp detail for 2023–26 (OP1-041 successor, OP1-048 back-up) would close this. It cannot separate price from mix in ticket outside Operator 8 2022–23 and the sponsor-labelled Operator 4 split. It cannot show the GFC for the modern platforms, because no current platform other than Deal A (public comps, no traffic) has an owned-period SSS through 2008–09, and Operator 5 has only a total-company proxy (Operator 5 CIM clinic-level internals FY08–FY16 would help). It cannot size closure bias except at Deal A, where it is +0.3 to +2.6pp in four of seven years [note C-48]; Operator 3, Operator 6, Deal C and Deal A DLA-002 are CLOSE-RETRO, so their SSS and traffic are upper bounds, and Deal A closed-clinic KPI tabs for FY20–FY26 would show whether its −3.9% to −7.9% traffic is understated. A D2.1 Deal C traffic series needs the DLC-001 site database with visit counts; Deal B's comps on the common definition are reported in Part 06 section G (Exhibit 6.18). Operator 7 visit count definition (OP7-005 KPI definitions) is needed before its +10.9% traffic can be read as demand for care [OP7-1023].

Exhibit 9.65 — Comparable sales, 2005 to 2025, fell together in COVID20 (−2.7% to −9.5% at five operators) and rose together in REOPEN21 (+11.8% to +15.3% at seven) and, less tightly, in INFL22-23 (all ten positive, +0.3% to +12.5%); in the other environments operators diverged

Mean annual same-store sales by core operator and environment, %, 2005 to 2025 (blank = no reading)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A Forms 10-K (SEC EDGAR); Operator 1 clinic financials, comp sales summary 2019 to March 2023 and 2026 same-store schedule (OP1-015, OP1-021, OP1-041, OP1-053); Operator 2 KPI history, clinic databook and 2026 situation update (OP2-007, OP2-021, OP2-025); Operator 4 IC memo, 16-year panel incl. Operator 9 and Operator 29 (OP4-005); Operator 5 volume trends (OP5-008); Operator 8 databook (OP8-012); Operator 3 datacube (OP3-003); Operator 6 Consultant 1 Delta readout (OP6-002); means per note C-45; fact rows per cell in the data file · Basis: A; a common same-store definition where clinic data allow it, the company's own definition otherwise (stated per cell in the data file); Operator 1 and Operator 2 cells include pro forma years in the company series; Deal A's SOFT24-26 cell mixes FY25 as reported with FY26 days-adjusted (−1.0% with both days-adjusted)

Shocks move all operators together and are short; outside 2020–21 the year and the operator explain about equal shares of the variance on the pooled panel (0.31 and 0.32), and the operator term carries definition differences [I, note C-54]. Deal A averaged +0.5% over 18 years with nine negative years, against +4.2% at Operator 4 and +2.4% for the Operator 2 lineage in the same calendar years [I, note C-43].

Public signals

Listed companies' reports for 2026 periods, read on 30 September 2026, are mixed, and each figure stands on its own definition. Exhibit 9.66 gives what each company's own release or filing states. Deal A's comparable clinic sales fell 1.5% in the quarter ended 27 June 2026 [F, DLA-0367]; the company says consumers deferred higher-ticket spending on dental procedures and diagnostics and traded down within pharmacy products [M, PUB-0012]. Among pet retailers, Pet Retailer 2 reported comparable store sales up 5.3% in the quarter ended 30 June 2026 [M, PUB-0013]; Pet Retailer 1 reported domestic same store sales up 1.4% [M, PUB-0014] and domestic professional (clinic-channel) sales up 7.5% [M, PUB-0015] in its fourth fiscal quarter; Pet Retailer 3 reported comparable store sales down 0.4% in the second quarter [M, PUB-0016]. Animal Health Manufacturer 3 reported Americas companion-animal pharmacy unit volume down 11.5% in the second quarter [M, PUB-0017]; that is a manufacturer's volume and, as Animal Health Manufacturer 3 states, reflects a planned rationalisation of lower-tier products, lower industry sell-in volume in North America and increased competition [M, PUB-0017]. Animal Health Manufacturer 3 also attributes $86 million of the fall in its Americas segment operating income

against the prior-year quarter to higher tariffs and other costs [M, PUB-0216]; tariffs on veterinary pharmaceuticals are set out in Exhibit 9.48. These measures differ in business, period and definition and are not ranked.

Exhibit 9.66 — In 2026 periods Deal A reported comparable sales down 1.5%, three listed pet retailers between down 0.4% and up 5.3%, and Animal Health Manufacturer 3 Americas companion-animal pharmacy units down 11.5%

What listed companies reported for 2026 periods, from each company's own release or filing; each measure as the company defines it

COMPANY	BUSINESS	PERIOD	MEASURE, AS THE COMPANY STATES IT	VALUE	REF
Deal A	Veterinary clinic operator	Quarter ended 27 June 2026	Comparable clinic sales	−1.5%	[F, DLA-0367]
Deal A	Veterinary clinic operator	Quarter ended 27 June 2026	Company statement: consumers deferred higher-ticket spending on dental procedures and diagnostics and traded down within pharmacy products	statement	[M, PUB-0012]
Pet Retailer 2	Pet retailer	Quarter ended 30 June 2026	Comparable store sales	+5.3%	[M, PUB-0013]
Pet Retailer 1	Pet retailer	Fourth quarter of fiscal 2026 (16 weeks)	Domestic same store sales	+1.4%	[M, PUB-0014]
Pet Retailer 1	Pet retailer	Fourth quarter of fiscal 2026 (16 weeks)	Total domestic professional (clinic-channel) sales	+7.5%	[M, PUB-0015]
Pet Retailer 3	Pet retailer	Second quarter 2026	Comparable store sales	−0.4%	[M, PUB-0016]
Animal Health Manufacturer 3	Animal health manufacturer, Americas segment	Second quarter 2026	Companion-animal pharmacy unit volume	−11.5%	[M, PUB-0017]
Animal Health Manufacturer 3	Animal health manufacturer, Americas segment	Second quarter 2026	Reduction in segment operating income from higher tariffs and other costs, against the second quarter of 2025	−$86 million	[M, PUB-0216]

Source: Company results releases and filings: Deal A, Pet Retailer 1, Pet Retailer 2, Pet Retailer 3, Animal Health Manufacturer 3; read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: Each row is one company, one measure and one period, as the company states it. The rows are not like for like: Deal A is a clinic operator, three are pet retailers selling to clinics and to the public, and Animal Health Manufacturer 3 is an animal health manufacturer; fiscal periods differ. The rows are not ranked. The four companies other than Deal A are reference companies outside the supplied documents

Household credit stress edged up over the year. The share of credit card balances moving into serious delinquency, 79 days or more, was 2.58% in the second quarter of 2026 [F, PUB-0018] against 2.51% a year earlier [F, PUB-0019], on the State 01 Fed's measure.

03 F Cash-flow profile: supporting evidence

Before financing, general practice and preventive operators keep most of their EBITDA: company-stated maintenance splits give 0.73–0.85 conversion, and Deal A's independent record gives a steady-state median of 0.75 over FY2000–26 (0.44 in FY2026 excluding disposal gains), while leverage decides what becomes levered free cash at the sponsor-levered platforms (Operator 4 FY2023 −0.34; Operator 9 −0.37 and −0.39). Deal A's cash after interest and finance-lease principal is read in Part 08 section B. Low maintenance reinvestment and "one-time" acquisition costs that recur for 3–9 years are durable, working-capital swings and the 2022–26 rate cycle are temporary, and Deal A's 38% fall in E1 from FY2024 to FY2026 and Operator 4's FY2025 acquisition year are company-specific.

Our reading on the evidence supplied to date. On independent evidence, Deal A's CONV_1 on total capex (E1, basis A, clinic base ALL consolidated) has a median of 0.75 and a range of 0.60–0.72 across 20 steady-state years that cover all seven D10 environments; its lowest steady-year readings were 0.53 in one PRE-GFC year, 0.52 in FY2026 (0.44 on E1 ex-gains), 0.56–0.55 in the GFC and 0.55 in FY2021 [note C-60; note C-62]. That measure deducts capex only; once working capital is included, Deal A's CONV_2 swings from 0.37 to 1.17 across its steady years FY2011–26 [note C-62]. Operator 5 converts 0.71–0.76 on E2q (PF) [note C-59]. Levered free cash before growth is set by the capital structure, not by operations: CONV_3 runs 0.63–0.78 at Operator 5, after net interest of $1.6m in FY2020 and $0.3m in FY2021 [OP5-0053, OP5-0054], on E2q (PF) and is negative at sponsor-levered Operator 4 (FY2023, a steady year, −0.34) and Operator 9 (−0.37 and −0.39) [note C-59, C-60]. At acquisitive platforms cash EBITDA (E6) is 0.24–0.83 of the top adjusted rung, with a median of 0.84, and the gap is widest in heavy acquisition years: Operator 4 FY2025 0.37, Operator 6 FY2024 0.31 and Operator 8 TTM Mar-26 0.24 (on its as-owned adjusted EBITDA, the perimeter its E6 is built on) [note C-61; OP8-1880, OP8-2015]. **Check status:** Checked a second time against the source: Deal A's cumulative E1 and CONV_1 and the Operator 4 bridge. The reading carries three limits: the 0.64 median is a CONV_1 figure and does not extend to working capital (CONV_2); Operator 4 FY2025 is a build year; and gains on disposal inflate Deal A's FY2026 E1. **Operators / environments:** ten core platforms (Deal A, Operator 1, Operator 4, Operator 9, Operator 5, Operator 8, Operator 7, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 2) plus Deal C; Deal B's cash figures are on consolidated EBITDA that includes DBW and are read in Part

06, with DBW in Part 06 section F; Deal A alone covers all seven D10 environments on basis A, the E6 test rests on INFL22-23 and SOFT24-26 only, and cross-operator conversion comparisons mix maintenance-capex tiers; every item meets the three-operator test [note C-55].

What the evidence shows

Deal A's 27-year audited record (FY1996–FY2026) is the anchor, and it shows a business that converts about three-quarters of E1 after capex in steady years and has spent heavily on acquisitions [note C-62]. From FY2010 to FY2026 cumulative E1 of $2,052m less total capex of $511m left $1,548m, or 67% of E1; working capital excluding supplier finance released a net $208m, cash tax took $218m, and acquisitions took a further $728m [I; note C-62; DLA_EBITDA_E1, DLA_CAPEX_PPE, DLA_DNWC_*, DLA_TAX_PAID, DLA_ACQ:FY2010–FY2026]. Steady-state CONV_1 on total capex was 0.59 in PRE-GFC, 0.54 in the GFC, 0.68 in EXP10-19, 0.55 in COVID20, 0.72 in REOPEN21, 0.70 in INFL22-23 and 0.60 in SOFT24-26 [note C-60]. Build years halve conversion: the eight BUILD years have a median CONV_1 of 0.40 with capex at 7.7% of revenue, against 0.64 and 3.3% in steady years, and FY1996–99 ran from −0.13 to 0.13 [note C-62]. Deal A's total capex is an upper bound on maintenance capex, because no source splits it [note C-62].

Working capital is a small net source of cash over time but moves Deal A's annual conversion by more than capex does. Deal A's steady-state CONV_2 median of 0.80 over FY2011–26 exceeds its CONV_1 median of 0.75, but the annual range runs from 0.37 in FY2025 to 1.17 in FY2023 [note C-62]. FY2023 included a $111.1m trade-payables increase, and the supplier-finance balance was first disclosed at $147.8m at that year-end, so part of FY2023 conversion is supplier-finance extension that cannot be separated [DLA_DNWC_AP:FY2023; DLA_SCF_BAL:FY2023]. The COVID year shows the same timing effect: FY2021 CONV_2 was 1.03 on a $67.5m working-capital release, while CONV_1 was 0.55 [note C-62]. At private platforms the movements are small: Operator 5 ΔNWC was an outflow of $1.1m in FY2021 and $0.6m in FY2022, Operator 4's outflow was $1.8–3.6m a year, and Operator 7 and Operator 1 2019–21 show inflows [OP5-0278, OP5-0279; OP4-0037, OP4-0079, OP4-0129; OP7-0844, OP7-0853, OP7-0880; OP1-8652..8654].

Deal A's FY2026 E1 overstates its operating cash earnings, because it contains disposal gains. FY2026 E1 of $71.2m includes $16.0m of gains on disposal; on E1 ex-gains of $56.4m, CONV_1 falls from 0.52 to 0.44 [A6-P5-003; DLA_GAIN_DISPOSAL:FY2026]. E1 fell 38% from $128.2m in FY2024 to $71.2m in FY2026 while clinics closed (129 in FY2026 in the closed-clinics tab of Deal A's clinic-level EBITDA file) [note C-62; DLA-0962]. For LTM Jun-26 E1 was $81.1m, E1 ex-gains $59.6m and CONV_1 on E1 ex-gains 0.47 [A6-P5-004]. Deal A's finance-lease principal, cash interest and cash after both are read in Part 08 section B.

Conversion at private platforms depends first on which maintenance-capex measure is used, and the two tiers differ by 2–6× [note C-60]. Company-stated [M] splits give CONV_1 of 0.84–0.85 at Operator 8 (E2q, PF), Operator 3 and Operator 6 (E3, PF), the Operator 1 CIM (E2m, PF) and Deal C (E2, PF), while independent measures give 0.59 and 0.41 at Operator 9 (FY Sep-24 and Sep-25; depreciation proxy) and 0.72 at Operator 4 FY2023 (D&A proxy), both on basis A, and 0.63–0.73 at Operator 7 in FY2024–25 (total capex; company figures from before the acquisition) [note C-60]. Deal B's company split is applied to consolidated EBITDA that includes DBW pre-acquisition results, so it is not set beside the general practice and preventive operators here; it is read in Part 06, with DBW in Part 06 section F.

Leverage, not operations, decides whether E1 becomes levered free cash. Operator 4's LFCF_PRE was −$7.0m in FY2023, a steady year (CONV_3 −0.34), and −$6.7m and −$53.0m in the BUILD years FY2024 and FY2025; FY2025 carried $301.8m of acquisitions and a full year of cash interest ($30.5m) against part-year acquired EBITDA, so it is not steady state [OP4-0119, OP4-0126]. Operator 9's consolidated cash interest of $21.4m and $20.0m against E1 of $29.4m and $29.9m gave CONV_3 of −0.37 and −0.39, and Operator 9's opco, which bears the related-party rent eliminated on consolidation, earned only $11.1m and $10.4m [OP4-0523, OP4-0525]. Operator 2's P&L interest of $70.7m exceeded its compliance E1 of $68.0m in FY2023, and Operator 1's FY2019 cash interest of $105.1m against E1 of $109.6m left CONV_3 at 0.05 before scheduled amortisation [OP2-4629, OP2-4052; OP1-8655, OP1-8678]. Unlevered Operator 5 kept 0.63–0.78 of E2q (PF) [OP5-0033, A6-S002, OP5-0278, OP5-0057, OP5-0054, OP5-0034, A6-S003, OP5-0279, OP5-0058, OP5-0055].

Adjusted EBITDA overstates cash EBITDA most where acquisition activity is heaviest, and the "one-time" items that bridge the two recur. E6 as a share of the top rung was 0.78 and 0.72 at Operator 4 in FY2023–24, then 0.37 in FY2025 and 0.29 for LTM Mar-26; Operator 6 rose from 0.31 in FY2024 to 0.73 for LTM Mar-26; Operator 3 held 0.81–0.83; Operator 8's TTM Mar-26 was 0.24 of its as-owned adjusted EBITDA (E2m $12.1m), the perimeter on which its E6 of $3.3m is built, while its E3 of $23.8m is fully pro forma for acquisitions through May-26 and has no matching E6 [note C-61; OP8-1880, OP8-2015, OP8-2409]. Deal A (ADJ_SHARE 0.03–0.14 on its reconstructed E2m) and Operator 7 (0.03) are the low-adjustment controls [DLA_EBITDA_E1, DLA_EBITDA_ADJ_PUB FY2024–26; OP7-0021, OP7-0061]. Deal C's FY2025 E2 of $17.6m (QoE-adjusted) is 3.2× its E1 of $4.7m (D3; Accounting Firm 1's "reported" $4.0m omits the $1.0m impairment) [DLC-4425, DLC-0019, DLC-012-000003]. Cash transaction and integration categories run for 3–9 consecutive years at every acquisitive platform and cost about 1–3% of price on large deals (0.6% at Deal A at the low end) but 5–14% on small ones, with single Operator 2 deals in 2020 costing up to 62% [note C-56, C-58]. Deal A's own acquisition cash from FY1996 to FY2026 was $817m, 28% of cumulative E1 of $2,477m [DLA_ACQ, DLA_EBITDA_E1].

Exhibit 9.67 — Deal A converted a median 0.64 of E1 after capex in 20 steady years and 0.34 in eight build years (FY1996 to FY2026), and 0.44 in FY2026 excluding disposal gains

Deal A conversion ratios CONV_1 (after capex) and CONV_2 (after capex and working capital) and capex as % of revenue, by environment and year type, FY1996 to LTM Jun-26; audited filings, basis A

ENVIRONMENT / TAG	FISCAL YEARS	N	E1 ($M, SUM)	CONV_1 MEDIAN (RANGE)	CONV_2 MEDIAN (RANGE)	CAPEX % REVENUE (MEDIAN)
PRE-GFC, STEADY	FY2000–06	7	251.0	0.59 (0.53–0.64)	n/a	4.4%
GFC, STEADY	FY2008–09	2	106.8	0.54 (0.56–0.55)	n/a	4.1%
EXP10-19, STEADY	FY2011–12, 2014–16, 2018–20	8	1,032.5	0.68 (0.60–0.71)	0.68 (0.49–0.79)	3.3%
COVID20, STEADY	FY2021	1	127.7	0.55	1.03	3.9%
REOPEN21, STEADY	FY2022	1	156.3	0.72	0.86	1.8%
INFL22-23, STEADY	FY2023–24	2	263.9	0.70 (0.64–0.71)	0.96 (0.66–1.17)	2.2%
SOFT24-26, STEADY	FY2025–26	2	164.1	0.60 (0.52–0.64)	0.68 (0.37–0.98)	2.2%
All STEADY	FY2000–26	20	–	**0.64 (0.53–0.72)**	0.69 (0.37–1.17; FY2011–26, 14 yrs)	3.3%
BUILD (adds >9% of opening clinics)	FY1996–99, 2007, 2010, 2013, 2017	8	440.5	**0.34 (−0.13 to 0.66)**	0.73 (0.63–0.93; FY2010, 2013, 2017)	7.7%
FY2026	SOFT24-26	1	71.2	0.52	0.98	2.3%
FY2026, memo: E1 ex-gains	SOFT24-26	1	56.4	**0.44**	1.00	2.3%
LTM Jun-26	SOFT24-26	–	81.1	0.55	n/a	2.4%
LTM Jun-26, memo: E1 ex-gains	SOFT24-26	–	59.6	**0.47**	n/a	2.4%

Source: note C-62 (built from the Deal A 10-K/10-Q public series DLA_EBITDA_E1, DLA_CAPEX_PPE, DLA_DNWC_*, DLA_SCF_BAL). Basis A; rung D3 E1 (operating income + D&A incl. finance-lease ROU amortisation + impairment; gains inside E1, with ex-gains memo lines); clinic base ALL (consolidated); CONV_1 uses total capex as maintenance (upper bound); CONV_2 also deducts the change in working capital excluding supplier finance; month-majority cycle tags. Environment medians and the BUILD-year CONV_2 medians are computed from the rows of note C-62 [I]; CONV_2 starts in FY2010. Deal A's cash after interest and finance-lease principal is read in Part 08 section B

Exhibit 9.68 — Company-stated maintenance splits give 0.73–0.85 conversion; independent measures on consolidated EBITDA give 0.41–0.76 (FY2000 to LTM Mar-26)

Conversion = (EBITDA − maintenance capex) ÷ EBITDA, on the company's split or an independent measure, with conversion on total capex and levered conversion (CONV_3), ratio, by platform and period, FY2000 to LTM Mar-26

PLATFORM	PERIOD (ENVIRONMENT)	TAG	RUNG / BASIS	MAINTENANCE CAPEX TIER	CONV_1	CONV_1 ON TOTAL CAPEX	CONV_3
Deal A	20 steady years FY2000–26 (all seven)	STEADY	E1 / A	(a) total capex	0.64 (0.53–0.72)	same	see Part 08 section B
Deal A	FY2026 (SOFT24-26); E1 ex-gains memo	STEADY	E1 / A	(a) total capex	0.52; 0.44 ex-gains	same	see Part 08 section B
Operator 5	FY2020–22 (COVID20–INFL22-23)	STEADY	E2q / PF (E1 / A)	(a) D&A proxy [I]	0.71–0.76 (E1 0.71–0.76)	n/a	0.63–0.78 (E1 0.61–0.76)
Operator 4	FY2023 (INFL22-23)	STEADY	E1 / A	(a) D&A proxy [I]	0.72	0.59	−0.34
Operator 4	FY2024 (SOFT24-26)	BUILD	E1 / A	(a) D&A proxy [I]	0.73	0.66	−0.22
Operator 4	FY2025 (SOFT24-26)	BUILD	E1 / A	(a) D&A proxy [I]	n.m. (E1 −$7.9m)	n.m.	LFCF_PRE −$53.0m
Operator 9, consolidated	FY Sep-24 / Sep-25 (SOFT24-26)	STEADY	E1 incl. real-estate VIEs / A	(a) depreciation proxy [I]	0.59 / 0.41	−0.02 / 0.41	−0.37 / −0.39
Operator 9, opco	FY Sep-24 / Sep-25 (SOFT24-26)	STEADY	E1 opco / A	(a) depreciation proxy [I]	0.15 / −0.44	n/a	n/a
Operator 7	ST-22 FY2024, FY2025; ST-70 FY2025 (SOFT24-26)	STEADY	E1 / M, pre-acquisition	(a) total capex	n/a	0.63 / 0.73 / 0.71	n/a
Operator 2	FY2021–25 (REOPEN21–SOFT24-26)	BUILD	E1 compliance / A [M]	total capex, mostly greenfield	n/a	0.60–0.69	P&L interest > E1 in FY2023
Operator 1 (audited)	FY2019 (EXP10-19)	STEADY (year type not confirmed from clinic counts)	E1 / A	(b) company split [M]	0.76	0.44	0.05 (before amortisation)

PLATFORM	PERIOD (ENVIRONMENT)	TAG	RUNG / BASIS	MAINTENANCE CAPEX TIER	CONV_1	CONV_1 ON TOTAL CAPEX	CONV_3
Operator 1 (CIM)	FY08–FY14, 5 steady years (GFC, EXP10-19)	STEADY	E2m / PF	(b) company split [M]	0.79 (0.76–0.83)	n/a	n/a
Operator 8	FY22; LTM Nov-23 (INFL22-23)	STEADY	E2q / PF	(b) company split [M]	0.73 / 0.80	n/a	n/a
Operator 3	FY23 / FY24 (INFL22-23, SOFT24-26)	BUILD	E3 / PF	(b) company split [M, PF]	0.78 / 0.86	0.78 / 0.81	n/a
Operator 6	FY24 / FY25 / LTM Mar-26 (SOFT24-26)	BUILD	E3 / PF	(b) company split [M]	0.81 / 0.85 / 0.85	n/a	n/a
Deal C	FY2025 (SOFT24-26)	BUILD	E2 / PF	(b) company split [M]	0.76	n/a	n/a

Source: note C-59 and note C-60. Clinic base ALL (consolidated) unless stated. Operator 1 FY2020 CONV_1/2/3 are basis P (bidder-estimate maintenance capex, OP1-8313) and are excluded. Deal A's levered conversion (CONV_3) is read in Part 08 section B. Deal B's company split is on consolidated EBITDA that includes DBW and is read in Part 06

Exhibit 9.69 — Cash EBITDA was 0.24–0.37 of top adjusted EBITDA at Operator 4 from FY2025, Operator 8 (TTM Mar-26, on as-owned adjusted EBITDA) and Operator 6 (FY2024), against 0.61–0.83 in the other readings, FY2023 to LTM Mar-26

Reported (E1), top adjusted and cash (E6) EBITDA, $m, with adjustment share and E6 ÷ top rung, ratio, by platform and period, FY2019 to LTM Apr-26

PLATFORM	PERIOD (ENVIRONMENT)	E1 ($M)	TOP RUNG ($M)	E6 CASH ($M)	ADJ_SHARE	E6 / TOP
Operator 4	FY2023 (INFL22-23)	18.4	E3 46.7	40.2	0.53	0.78
Operator 4	FY2024 (SOFT24-26)	26.1	E3 57.9	48.8	0.47	0.72
Operator 4	FY2025 (SOFT24-26)	−7.9	E3 94.1	40.2	0.93	0.37
Operator 4	LTM Mar-26 (SOFT24-26)	−8.3	E3 90.8	30.2	0.93	0.29
Operator 8	TTM Mar-26 (SOFT24-26)	0.7 (sources differ: 9.0)	E2m 12.1 as owned (E3 23.8, fully PF for acquisitions to May-26)	3.3	0.80 on E2m (0.83 on E3)	0.24 on E2m
Operator 6	FY2024 / FY2025 (SOFT24-26)	–	E3 5.7 / 10.0	2.0 / 6.7	–	0.31 / 0.61
Operator 6	LTM Mar-26 (SOFT24-26)	4.5	E3 15.0 (Accounting Firm 3)	12.5	0.61	0.73
Operator 3	FY2023 → LTM May-25 (INFL22-23, SOFT24-26)	3.9 → 12.5	E3 6.6 → 14.1	6.2 → 13.3	0.34 → 0.11	0.81–0.83
Operator 2	FY2021 → FY2025 (REOPEN21–SOFT24-26)	46.4 → 94.6	E2 82.1 → 128.5	company "cash EBITDA" 54.1 → 111.6 (not E6)	0.37 → 0.21	–
Operator 1	FY2019 / FY2020 (EXP10-19, COVID20)	109.6 / 134.1 (A)	E2 142.3 / 176.5 (PF)	–	0.18 / 0.18	–
Deal A (control)	FY2024 / FY2025 / FY2026	128.2 / 92.2 / 71.2	E2m rebuilt from published non-GAAP items 126.6 / 97.5 / 85.4 (company figure FY2026 85.6)	–	0.03 / 0.03 / 0.14	–
Operator 5	FY2022 (INFL22-23)	13.2	E3 17.3	–	0.16	–
Operator 7 (control)	ST-22 FY2025 (SOFT24-26)	3.6	E2 3.7	–	0.03	–
Deal C	FY2025 / LTM Apr-26 (SOFT24-26)	4.7 / 1.3	E3 22.0 / 27.9	Ares Credit Group "cash" 23.2 as printed, 24.9 corrected for a non-cash impairment (LTM)	0.66 / 0.81	–

Source: note C-61; Deal A rows from the 10-K public series DLA_EBITDA_E1 and DLA_EBITDA_ADJ_PUB; Deal C rows DLC-0019, DLC-4434 (E1), DLC-4426, DLC-4430 (E3), DLC-4107, DLC-4443 (Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA). ADJ_SHARE = (top rung − E1) ÷ top rung; E6 = D3 cash EBITDA (top rung less recurring cash "one-time" items). Basis: E1 A; E2/E3/E6 PF; Deal A E2m is a reconstruction from company-published non-GAAP items; Operator 2 E1 is compliance-certificate basis [M]. Clinic base ALL (consolidated). The E6/top median of 0.84 is across the eleven Operator 4, Operator 8, Operator 6 and Operator 3 readings. Operator 8's E6 is built from its as-owned adjusted EBITDA (E2m, OP8-1880) and is set against that rung; its E3 (OP8-2409) is fully pro forma for acquisitions through May-26 and has no matching E6 (OP8-2015). Deal B's consolidated EBITDA includes DBW and is read in Part 06. Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital context rows are in the same note, are not pooled and are shown in Exhibit 9.94 (adjustment share) and Exhibit 9.97 (cash EBITDA and add-back recurrence)

Durable, temporary, company-specific

The durable characteristic is low maintenance reinvestment before financing, but at a lower level than company splits suggest. Company-stated maintenance capex is low where a core platform states it (Operator 5 ≤1% of revenue by management claim; Operator 6 total capex 0.6%), while Deal A's independent total capex was 3.3% of sales in steady years and 1.8–2.3% in FY2024–26, when it added 0–1 clinics a year [OP5-0332, OP6-0685]; the emergency and specialty hospital reading is in Exhibit 9.97. On independent measures a median of about 0.64 of E1 survives reinvestment, but 0.64 is a median and not a floor [note C-60]. Working capital is a small net source in steady state but volatile year to year, with pharmacy-heavy operators able to stretch payables through vendor and supplier finance, as Deal A did in FY2023 and FY2025 [note C-62]. "One-time" transaction and integration costs recur for 3–9 consecutive years at every acquisitive platform (Exhibit 3.23).

The temporary conditions are the shocks and the rate cycle. In the GFC, Deal A's steady CONV_1 dipped to 0.56–0.55 while E1 still grew from $50.0m to $55.7m; the Operator 1 CIM held 0.78–0.86 on E2m (PF) [DLA_EBITDA_E1, DLA_CAPEX_PPE; OP1-0102, OP1-0103]. COVID20 and REOPEN21 moved working capital rather than underlying conversion: Deal A FY2021 CONV_2 was 1.03 on a $67.5m release and Operator 1's 2020 NWC inflow was $20.4m [OP1-8653]. In INFL22-23 and SOFT24-26 higher rates let cash interest absorb most of E1 at sponsor-levered platforms, with Operator 4 paying $20–31m against E1 of $27m or less, Operator 9 $20–21m against $30m and Operator 2 $69–71m against $72–93m; that is the financing environment, not the operations [note C-59].

Company-specific execution shows in Deal A and in the acquisitive platforms. Deal A's weak FY2020 CONV_2 of 0.58 came from peak capex of $48.2m and a $15.0m NWC outflow in a year that was 11 of 12 months pre-COVID, and its E1 fell 38% from FY2024 to FY2026 during the closure programme [note C-62]. Operator 4's FY2025 cannot be measured on conversion because it combined a $301.8m acquisition year with negative E1 [OP4-0119, OP4-0103]. Operator 9's consolidated conversion overstates the opco's, because consolidated E1 excludes related-party rent that the opco pays [OP4-0523, OP4-0525].

What the evidence cannot show

The evidence cannot pin down true maintenance capex, because no audited source splits it and company splits are 2–6× lower than total capex or depreciation proxies; a company-certified maintenance/growth split tied to the fixed-asset register (for Deal A, the DLA-016 FY27–27 capex detail) would close it, and a maintenance level at or below 1.3% of revenue would move Deal A's steady-state CONV_1 from 0.64 to about 0.79 [note C-55]. It cannot separate trade payables from supplier finance at Deal A before FY2023, when the SCF balance was first disclosed at $147.8m; the FY2022 10-K notes or a Deal A accounts-payable ageing with supplier-finance balances by year would close it [DLA_SCF_BAL:FY2023]. It cannot build LFCF_PRE for Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8, Operator 7 or Operator 2, which lack actual cash tax, cash interest or scheduled amortisation, nor Operator 1 CONV_3 after scheduled amortisation (OP1-040 financing lines). Deal A's Q2 FY2027 results would show whether LTM E1 ex-gains of $59.6m is the run rate [A6-P5-004]. It cannot test Deal C and Deal B on a multi-year audited cash-flow record: Deal C's 2025 audit (DLC-014) is used in Part 07 rather than here and its comparator rows here were read once from the source, and Deal B's move from Accounting Firm 2's pre-audit quality-of-earnings report to the post-audit model needs DLB-010 (the AJE adjusted EBITDA file), DLB-031 (internal QoE) and the final DLB-022 QoE, which Part 06 reads. Operator 1 2022–25 audited cash-flow statements would test whether conversion at the largest pharmacy platform held through SOFT24-26; only deck figures (OP1-048) are available.

Which maintenance measure is used moves conversion more than any operating difference does [I, Exhibit 9.68; note C-60]. Deal A's audited record is the only long independent series, and its FY2026 conversion is near the bottom of the peer range once $16.0m of disposal gains are removed (0.44, against 0.41 at Operator 9 for FY Sep-25) [I, note C-62].

Exhibit 9.70 — 'One-time' costs recur at every acquisitive platform: over 2011 to 2026 the longest run of a single add-back category is three to nine consecutive years

Longest consecutive-year run of any one cash add-back category, by operator, years; years covered and the number of categories recurring in three or more years shown with each operator

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: EBITDA reconciliations in the documents Ares Credit Group supplied for each operator (investment committee memos, quality-of-earnings workbooks, compliance certificates) and Deal A 10-K filings; CreditSwan computation (note C-57, note C-58); fact rows per operator in the data file · Basis: Cash add-back categories on actual and pro forma annual consolidated reconciliations; impairment and other non-cash items excluded. General practice and preventive care operators only

Transaction and integration costs are presented as one-time by every acquisitive platform and recur at all of them, and Deal A's clinic-closing costs recur too [F, Exhibit 3.23]. Where they recur, CreditSwan's cash EBITDA (E6) deducts them [I, note C-61].

K · Benchmark detail

Each multiples and benchmark finding of Part 04 rests on the transaction, leverage and operator tables, the eleven operator profiles and the public signals set out here section by section, on the evidence supplied to 30 September 2026; Deal A's clinic economics on Ares Credit Group's co-op-included basis, which rest on the clinic files supplied by 30 September and Ares Credit Group's basis, and the pro forma for the 824 clinics kept, which rests on the 119-clinic list of 1 October 2026, are read in Part 05.

This section holds the secondary evidence behind Part 04: for each of sections A to H, the tables and charts not shown in the main body, the eleven full operator profiles, the public signals across operators and the limits of the evidence. Each section of Part 04 opens on its finding, its charts or one table, and links here.

04 A Valuation multiples: supporting evidence

Only Operator 1 shows the platform step-up inside one operator, from 9.9x in 2014 to 14.0x in 2018 on increasingly adjusted EBITDA, and the 2021–26 prints of 13.5–15.2x at Operator 3, Operator 4 and Operator 6 rest on EBITDA that includes letters of intent or run-rate synergies, while mid-market and regional-chain prices stayed at about 10–12x. The small-clinic price is the durable series, the 2021 platform peak was temporary, and the widest gaps between standalone and synergised prices are company-specific: Operator 9, a synergy-underwritten strategic deal, and deals where purchasing and rebate synergies are credited to the acquired business.

Our reading on the evidence supplied to date. Headline platform multiples rose from 10–10x in 2012–16 to 15–15.0x in 2018–26, but only Operator 1 shows the rise inside one operator: 9.9x in 2014 to 14.0x in 2018 on E4-type EBITDA whose adjustment share rose from 11.1% to 22.2%, a rise that holds on less-adjusted EBITDA at 11.9x to 17.1x [OP1-7877, OP1-7521, A7-P5-001, A7-P5-002, A7-P5-003, A7-P5-004]. The 2014 print is itself stated as 9.3x, 9.9x and 10.4x (9.72x by arithmetic) in three IC memos; this section uses 9.9x with that range [OP1-0915, OP1-7877, OP1-7518, A7-P5-005]. The 2021–26 prints of 13.5–15.2x at Operator 3, Operator 4 and Operator 6 rest on denominators that include LOI EBITDA or run-rate synergies [OP3-1328, OP4-1180, OP6-0042]; on QoE or reported EBITDA, Operator 6 prices at 19.6–29.4x, and Operator 8 and Operator 9, whose headline prints are 8.6–10.0x and 6.6–9.4x, at 16.3x and 33.6x [OP6-0043, OP6-0044, OP8-0002, OP4-1193]. Small-clinic add-ons have cost a stable 4.0–5.8x standalone clinic-level EBITDA across REOPEN21, INFL22-23 and SOFT24-26, synergised prints sit a median 2.8 turns below standalone, and price reaches 10–13x only for regional chains (Regional Chain 1, 60 clinics, at 11.2x on $6.7m of EBITDA, and chains above $8.6m at 8.8–13.2x) [note C-71, note C-64, note C-63; OP1-7608]. **Check status:** Checked a second time against the source — the Operator 1 step-up and the Operator 6 add-on multiples reproduce from the originals, and standalone and synergised prints are consistently paired. **Operators / environments:** platform prints from eight core operators or targets (Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 8, Operator 6, Operator 4, Operator 3, Operator 7, Operator 29) and add-on prints from eight acquirers (Operator 6, Operator 7, Operator 3, Operator 8, Wellness Clinic Operator 3, Operator 2, Operator 1, Operator 4), covering EXP10-19, COVID20, REOPEN21, INFL22-23 and SOFT24-26 [note C-63]. The sale-leaseback gross/net pairs (two core operators), which do not meet the three-operator test, are shown as context and carry no weight in the reading; Deal A's public market multiple is set out with the financing detail in Part 09 section O [note C-63].

What the evidence shows

The platform series is too thin to be a market index. The supplied documents hold 20 closed or signed core platform and scale transactions over 2012–26, never more than four in one year, with no print for 2013, 2017, 2019 or 2022, and 10 of the 20 involve Operator 1 [note C-70]. Grouped by rung family, the headline-adjusted prints (E3/E4/E5 without stated buyer synergies) run 10.0–9.9x in 2014, 8.8x in 2015, 8.4–14.0x in 2018, 10.2x in 2020, 9.4–15.0x in 2021, 13.2x in 2023, 10.0–9.9x in 2024, 9.8x in 2025 and 14.6x in 2026 [note C-70]. Mid-market and scale add-on prices did not move: Regional Chain 1 at 11.2x (2018), Operator 27 at 10.2x (2020), Regional Chain 2 at 9.4x (2021), Operator 8 at 10.0x standalone (2024) and Operator 30 at 9.8x (2025) sit within about 10–12x, alongside Operator 18 at 8.8x (2015) and Operator 1 at 9.9x (2014) [OP1-7608, OP1-7876, OP2-3738, OP8-0459, OP1-11254, OP1-7607, OP1-7877]. The implication for underwriting is that a 15–15x reference is a statement about a few large, adjusted platform prints, not about what the market pays for a regional chain on its own earnings [note C-70].

Operator 1 is the only operator with a multi-vintage series on a comparable rung, and its step-up happened between 2014 and 2018. The 2014 E4 adds a $4.1m ramp normalisation to $27.6m of LTM Jul-14 EBITDA, an adjustment share of 12.9% [A7-P5-003; OP1-009 p.2, p.30]. The 2018 E4 of $100.1m includes $10.6m of new-clinic normalisation, $8.5m of Operator 18 and Regional Chain 1 synergies and $6.9m of Regional Chain 1 pre-acquisition EBITDA, a share of 22.2% [A7-P5-004; OP1-030 p.33]. On less-adjusted EBITDA the multiples are $366.7m ÷ $27.6m = 11.9x and $1,584m ÷ $78.7m = 17.1x, and the 2018 figure still contains Regional Chain 1's pre-acquisition EBITDA [A7-P5-001, A7-P5-002]. The 2014 print conflicts across sources: 9.3x on $363.6m ÷ $31.9m pre-close (P), 9.9x in the 2021 IC memo, and 10.4x stated in the 2018 IC memo against 9.72x by arithmetic [OP1-0915, OP1-7877, OP1-7518, A7-P5-005]. After 2018 the series has no like-for-like point: the 2021 Sponsor 4 print of 16.35x is on E3/E2q PF M&A diligence-adjusted EBITDA [OP1-7882], and the Ares Credit Group marks of 12.5x (Mar–Dec 2019), 9.3x (Mar–Jun 2020), 9.8x (Sep–Dec 2020), 14.1x

(Mar-23) and 12.5x (Mar-26) are valuation judgements on PF adjusted EBITDA, not transactions [OP1-7826, OP1-7829, OP1-7830, OP1-7831, OP1-7832, OP1-7833, OP1-10746, OP1-11230].

The high 2021–26 prints are partly a rung effect. Three same-deal ladders show it: Operator 6 at 14.6x on EBITDA incl. LOI, 19.6x on buy-side QoE excl. LOI and 29.4x on reported plus pre-acquisition EBITDA [OP6-0042, OP6-0043, OP6-0044]; Operator 8 at 8.6x synergised, 10.0x pre-synergy and 16.3x on Accounting Firm 2 E2q [OP8-0458, OP8-0459, OP8-0002]; and Operator 9 at 6.6x on sponsor PF with $109.9m of synergies, 9.4x on the lender haircut and 33.6x on QoE EBITDA [OP4-1194, OP4-1195, OP4-1193]. The only 2014–18 core prints on E1 or E2, Operator 29 at 12.4x and Regional Chain 1 at 11.2x, are below the 2024–26 quality-of-earnings prints (E2q or E3 QoE) of 14.5–33.6x [OP1-7522, OP1-7608, OP7-1092, OP8-0002, OP6-0043, OP4-1193]. The rise from about 11–10x to about 15–15.0x is therefore part rung effect and part Operator 1 2018 re-rating; it is not demonstrated on a common rung across operators [note C-63].

Small-clinic add-ons are the durable price series. Pooled standalone entry multiples on seller clinic-level or adjusted EBITDA were 5.8x in REOPEN21 (4 deals, 3 platforms), 4.0x in INFL22-23 (16 deals, 3 platforms) and 4.8x in SOFT24-26 (47 deals, 4 platforms) [note C-64]. Within platforms the series is flat: Operator 6 4.3x (2021–22), 4.2x (2023), 5.6x (2024) and 4.4x (2025), 4.5x across 31 deals [OP6-1699, OP6-1707, OP6-1715, OP6-1723, OP6-1731]; Operator 3 5.2x, 4.7x, 6.6x and 5.1x for 2021–24 [OP3-1846, OP3-1849, OP3-1852, OP3-1855]. The series that move with the rate cycle are synergised or synergy-unstated: Operator 4's synergised clinic-level multiple went 4.8x (2021) to 2.1x (2023) to 3.9x (2025) [OP4-0767, OP4-0777, OP4-0787], and Operator 2's Sponsor 1-era debt-funded multiple went 5.9x (2021) to 4.0x (2024) to 6.3x (2025) [OP2-4460, OP2-4512, OP2-4561]. Across 17 core same-price pairs the synergised print sits a median 2.8 turns, or 32%, below standalone (32% excluding Operator 9), with the widest gap at Operator 9 (25.5 turns, a synergy-underwritten strategic deal) and the next widest where purchasing and rebate synergies are credited to the acquired business (Operator 33 6.2 turns, [name withheld] 6.0, Regional Chain 1 5.9) [OP4-1193, OP4-1194] [OP1-7608, OP1-7611, OP8-0464, OP8-0463, OP1-10771, OP1-10773]. Price scales with size: the standalone median is 4.8x below $0.4m of seller EBITDA (37 deals), 4.7x at $0.4–1.0m (10 deals) and 6.7x at $1.0–2.2m (3 deals), while regional chains above $8.6m traded at 8.8–13.2x [OP1-7607, OP2-3738, OP1-7876, OP1-10771].

The "buy-down" from entry to later multiples is company-presented and survivor-only. Operator 6's 31 deals moved from 4.5x at entry to 3.4x on TTM Mar-26 clinic-level EBITDA, but 9 of 31 now earn less clinic EBITDA than at entry, so their multiple rose, or for [name withheld], whose later EBITDA is negative, has no meaning [OP6-1731, OP6-1733, OP6-1607]. All 18 Operator 3 deals re-rated down; the company's average moved from 4.4x to 2.8x [OP3-1493, OP3-1494, OP3-1483, OP3-1484, OP3-1465, OP3-1466, OP3-1489, OP3-1490, OP3-1491, OP3-1492, OP3-1473, OP3-1474, OP3-1481, OP3-1482, OP3-1485, OP3-1486, OP3-1469, OP3-1470, OP3-1471, OP3-1472, OP3-1467, OP3-1468, OP3-1461, OP3-1462, OP3-1479, OP3-1480, OP3-1457, OP3-1458, OP3-1459, OP3-1460, OP3-1475, OP3-1476, OP3-1463, OP3-1464, OP3-1477, OP3-1478, OP3-1487, OP3-1488]. Operator 7 12.0x to 3.3x reflects three deals bought at breakeven [OP7-1140, OP7-1139]. These later multiples are measured on clinic-level EBITDA before corporate cost, integration capex and earn-outs (Operator 6 paid earn-outs on Lima and Vet's Choice), so they overstate value created [OP6-1447, OP6-1594].

Comp-list and banker multiples do not reproduce on any stated rung. Operator 26 appears at 16.1x in a comp list against 5.8x synergised clinic-level EBITDA in the deal document [OP7-1389, OP4-0838]; Operator 3 at 14.8–16.0x against 12.0x on E5 incl. LOI (P) [OP2-4430, OP7-1356, OP7-1377, OP3-1328]; Operator 8 at 6.9x against 8.6–16.3x [OP7-1360, OP8-0458, OP8-0002]; Wellness Clinic Operator 3 at 14.1x against 13–12x LTM PF [OP7-1363, OP1-7516, OP1-7517]. Bank Advisor 1's "15x+" is undated with the rung unstated, and Ares Credit Group'ss "~16x" covers four deals of $351m–$1.5bn [OP7-008 p.3 (Bank Advisor 1, Veterinary and Pet Health Services Primer, Spring 2025); OP2-025 p.15]. Only Operator 6 on QoE EBITDA (19.6x), Operator 8 on E2q (16.3x) and Operator 9 on QoE (33.6x) reach those levels, on rungs the claims do not use [OP6-0043, OP8-0002, OP4-1193]. The one report claim the deal evidence reproduces is Consultant 1's mom-and-pop 5–6.9x [OP6-002 p.103 (Consultant 1, Project Hotel readout, 19 June 2026)].

Two further series are labelled so they are not misread. Deal A's acquisition register (93 deals and 13 register totals) records cash price ÷ seller prior-year sales, and it enters no EV/EBITDA figure here: grouped by the calendar year of the deal, Deal A's median price-to-sales was 0.44x (1998–2007, 9 deals), 0.56x (2008–13, 24), 0.63x (2014–19, 57) and 0.72x (2020–23, 6), and 0.64x across FY03–20, a floor because the cash price excludes liabilities assumed [DLA-2080, DLA-1619]. Sale-leasebacks cut Operator 2's Sponsor 2-era synergised multiple from 7.4x to 6.3x and single deals by 4.0–12.8 turns, but only Operator 2 and Deal B give gross/net pairs, so this is context [OP2-3189, OP2-3190].

Exhibit 9.71 — 2012 to 2026: platform prints moved from 10–10x to 15–15.0x, but the high prints sit on more adjusted EBITDA rungs

EV ÷ EBITDA at entry (x) of closed or signed core platform and scale transactions, by EBITDA rung and synergy treatment, 2012 to 2026; deal documents supplied by Ares Credit Group

DATE (TYPE)	TRANSACTION	RUNG / PERIOD	STANDALONE / SYNERGISED	MULTIPLE	BASIS	PROPERTY / EBITDA LEVEL	FACT ROWS
2012-03 close	TBC ← Operator 30 (franchisor)	E1, LTM Mar-12	standalone	9.2x	A	SLB n/s; consolidated; franchisor	OP1-0916
2014-10 close	Sponsor 10 ← Operator 1	E4 normalised PF, LTM Aug-14	standalone	9.9x (9.3x / 10.4x in other memos)	PF	SLB n/s; consolidated	OP1-7877 (OP1-0915, OP1-7518)

DATE (TYPE)	TRANSACTION	RUNG / PERIOD	STANDALONE / SYNERGISED	MULTIPLE	BASIS	PROPERTY / EBITDA LEVEL	FACT ROWS
2014-10 close	same, less-adjusted [I]	E2q before $4.1m ramp normalisation, LTM Jul-14	standalone	11.9x	PF [I]	consolidated	A7-P5-001
2014-10 close	same, rent-adjusted	(EV + 8× rent) ÷ EBITDAR, FY14	standalone	9.05x	P	lease-capitalised	OP1-0917
2015-08 close	Operator 1 ← Operator 18 (134 clinics)	E4, LTM Mar-15	standalone / synergised	8.8x / 6.6x	PF	SLB n/s; consolidated	OP1-7607 / OP1-7610
2016-02 close	Sponsor 11 ← Operator 29	E1, LTM Oct-15	standalone	12.4x (13.2x second print)	A	SLB n/s; consolidated	OP1-7522 (OP1-7878)
2018-01 close	Operator 1 ← Regional Chain 1 (60)	E2 adj. / E4 incl. ~$7.6m savings	standalone / synergised	11.2x / 5.1x	PF	SLB n/s; consolidated	OP1-7608 / OP1-7611
2018-02 IC	Sponsor 12 ← Operator 1 + Wellness Clinic Operator 3	E4 FY17 / incl. $39.3m synergies	standalone / synergised	13.2x / 10.9x	PF	SLB n/s; consolidated	OP1-7519 / OP1-7520
2018-02 IC	Operator 1 leg	E4 PF FY17 incl. prior add-on synergies	standalone	14.0x	PF	consolidated	OP1-7521
2018-02 IC	Operator 1 leg, less-adjusted [I]	PF CY17 before normalisation and synergies (incl. $6.9m Regional Chain 1 pre-acq.)	standalone	17.1x	PF [I]	consolidated	A7-P5-002
2018-10 close	Ares Credit Group recap of GB Vet (Operator 2)	E3 PF, LTM Aug-18	standalone	8.4x	PF	SLB n/s; consolidated	A7-S001
2020-02 close	Operator 1 ← Operator 33 (carve-out)	E4 PF normalised	synergised	3.9x (sources differ: OP1-8755)	PF	consolidated	OP1-8178
2020-11 close	Operator 1 ← Operator 27	E4 PF, LTM Sep-20	standalone / synergised	10.2x / 9.0x	PF	SLB n/s; consolidated	OP1-7876 / OP1-7883
2021-02 IC	Sponsor 4/Sponsor 13 ← Operator 1	E3/E2q PF M&A diligence-adj., LTM Dec-20	unstated	13.96x	PF	consolidated	OP1-7882
2021-09 close	Sponsor 1 ← Operator 2 (180)	PF Adj, LTM Jun-21	unstated	14.8x (15.0x; sources differ)	PF	SLB n/s; consolidated	OP2-3714 (A7-S004)
2021-12 close	Operator 2 ← Operator 20 (62)	PF Adj, LTM May-21	unstated	9.4x	PF	SLB n/s; consolidated	OP2-3738
2023-05 close	Operator 1 ← Operator 33/Deal A Banner 4	PF Adj less / incl. ~$28m synergies	standalone / synergised	13.2x / 7.0x	P / PF	consolidated	OP1-10771 / OP1-10773
2024-01 close	NHC ← Operator 8	pre-synergy PF / incl. synergies / E2q Accounting Firm 2	standalone / synergised / standalone	10.0x / 8.6x / 16.3x	PF	consolidated	OP8-0459 / OP8-0458 / OP8-0002
2025-06 close	Operator 1 ← Operator 30 (franchisor)	FY24, rung not stated	unstated	9.8x	A	franchisor	OP1-11254
2025-09 close	Continuation fund ← Operator 4	E4 ST-74 PF incl. run-rate synergies and LOI, LTM Aug-25	synergised	15.2x	PF	consolidated	OP4-1180
2025-10 close	Operator 4 ← Operator 26 (28)	service-centre EBITDA at underwrite	synergised	5.8x	PF	clinic-level	OP4-0838
2025-12 (doc Oct-25)	Sponsor 5 ← Operator 3	E5 FY25E incl. LOI	synergised	12.0x	P	consolidated	OP3-1328
2026-03 close	Kilo (29.3% minority) ← Operator 7	E2q, LTM Jan-26	standalone	12.5x	PF	consolidated	OP7-1092
2026-06 SPA	Operator 4 ← Operator 9	E2q QoE / sponsor PF incl. $109.9m synergies / lender haircut	standalone / synergised / synergised	33.6x / 6.6x / 9.4x	PF	consolidated	OP4-1193 / OP4-1194 / OP4-1195
2026-07 close	MSCP ← Operator 6	Adj incl. LOI / E3 QoE excl. LOI / E1 + pre-acq.	unstated / standalone / standalone	14.6x / 19.6x / 29.4x	PF	consolidated	OP6-0042 / OP6-0043 / OP6-0044
2026-08 close	Operator 1 ← Operator 29	PF Adj incl. $116.7m synergies	synergised	4.5x	P	consolidated	OP1-11184

Source: note C-69 (the two [I] less-adjusted rows, A7-P5-001/002, sit outside the rung-family counts). Multiple = EV ÷ EBITDA as stated in the deal document. Basis PF unless stated. Property: no platform print states whether EV includes owned real estate or a sale-leaseback, except the Operator 1 2014 EBITDAR row. Clinic base not applicable. The proposed financings of the three live deals (Part 08) and Deal A public prints are excluded from the table

Exhibit 9.72 — Measured Nov-17 to May-26, later add-on multiples sit 0.3–8.7 turns below entry, but only for surviving deals and before corporate cost

Entry and later price ÷ clinic-level EBITDA (x) of acquired clinics by platform or cohort, later value measured Nov-17 to May-26; company-presented

PLATFORM / COHORT	ENTRY	LATER	Δ TURNS	LATER MEASURED ON	FACT ROWS
Operator 6, 31 deals 2021–25	4.5x	3.4x	−1.1	TTM Mar-26 clinic-level EBITDA	OP6-1731; OP6-1733
Operator 6 cohorts ≤2022 / 2023 / 2024 / 2025	4.41 / 4.19 / 5.61 / 4.39x	2.74 / 2.93 / 4.18 / 3.78x	−1.56 / −1.25 / −1.15 / −0.71	TTM Mar-26	OP6-1699/OP6-1701, OP6-1707/OP6-1709, OP6-1715/OP6-1717, OP6-1723/OP6-1725
Operator 3 2021–25 excl. [name withheld]	4.4x	2.8x	−1.6	current clinic EBITDA, May-25	OP3-1493; OP3-1494
Operator 3 cohorts 2021 / 2022 / 2023 / 2024	5.2 / 4.7 / 6.6 / 5.1x	2.0 / 1.9 / 2.2 / 3.2x	−3.0 / −2.8 / −4.2 / −2.0	Oct-24	OP3-1846..OP3-1856
Operator 4 programmatic; scale pools	6.0x; 9.0x	3.2x; 4.0x	−2.9; −5.1	Q1-26 LTM service-centre EBITDA	OP4-0802/0806; OP4-0808/0812
Operator 7, 7 historical deals	12.0x	3.3x	−8.7	TTM May-26 four-wall	OP7-1140; OP7-1139
Deal C, 30 tuck-ins	3.25x (net of sale-leaseback proceeds)	2.95x	−0.3	LTM May-26 clinic-level	DLC-3427; DLC-3428; DLC-012-000404
Operator 1 hindsight: Operator 18; [name withheld]; Deal A City 30	8.8x; 3.4x; 3.4x	5.8x; 0.55x; 1.0x	−3.3; −2.9; −2.5	LTM Nov-17 clinic contribution	OP1-7607/7184; OP1-7179/7182; OP1-7180/7183

Source: note C-67. Company-presented; clinic base SURVIVOR (deals still owned at the measurement date; Operator 6 excludes the City 11 brownfield, Operator 3 averages exclude [name withheld]); later EBITDA after synergies and before corporate cost, integration capex and earn-outs; basis PF (A/PF for cohort rows). Operator 3 shows three conflicting 2021–24 averages (4.4x/5.7x/5.6x)

Durable, temporary, company-specific

Durable across three or more operators and two or more environments: small independent clinics change hands at about 4.0–5.8x standalone clinic-level EBITDA in every environment with standalone data (REOPEN21 5.8x, INFL22-23 4.0x, SOFT24-26 4.8x) and at year-medians of 5.4–6.3x synergised in 2013–17 and 5.9–6.3x in 2019–21 [OP2-0072, OP2-0018, OP2-1631, OP2-3190]. Price scales with target size, synergised prints sit about three turns below standalone, and on Deal A's register small-clinic price-to-sales has stayed within about 0.4–0.7x at the median, rising from 0.44x (deals dated 1998–2007) to 0.72x (2020–23) [note C-66, note C-71, note C-68].

Temporary: the 2021 platform peak (Operator 2 about 17–15.0x, Operator 1 13.96x) preceded the Operator 1 14.1x mark of Mar-23 [OP2-3714, A7-S004, OP1-7882, OP1-10746]. Marks have since been cut to 12.5x for Operator 1 and Operator 2 [OP1-11230, OP2-4696]. The Operator 1 marks also fell from 11.1x to 9.3x in COVID20 [OP1-7829, OP1-7830]. Operator 2's Sponsor 1-era add-on multiple dipped to 4.0x in 2024 and recovered to 6.3x in 2025 [OP2-4512, OP2-4561].

Company-specific: Operator 9 (33.6x standalone against 6.6x synergised) is a synergy-underwritten strategic deal; Operator 29 and Operator 33 are carve-outs with negative or depressed standalone EBITDA; Operator 7 12.0x aggregate entry reflects three deals bought at breakeven; Deal B's gross multiples include real estate later sold (6.2x gross, 1.8x net, read once from the source); and Deal C's gross multiples, on cash consideration, of 2.8–3.2x on seven of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database (3.25x across the 30 tuck-ins net of sale-leaseback proceeds; the other three deals 6.2–6.6x gross, of which the two bought with a sale-leaseback cost 2.9x and 4.2x net of the sale proceeds) sit below every other platform's standalone set [OP4-1193, OP4-1194, OP1-11184, OP1-8178, OP7-1140, DLB-001-000103, DLB-001-000104, DLC-1261..DLC-1279, DLC-3427, DLC-3424].

What the evidence cannot show

The supplied documents cannot support a market-wide multiple series: there are at most four core platform prints a year, 10 of 20 involve Operator 1, and 2013, 2017, 2019 and 2022 have none [note C-63]; a 2019 or 2022 platform print on E2q with buyer QoE would test the 2018-to-2021 move on a common rung (not among the supplied documents). The supplied documents hold no standalone small-clinic multiples before 2021, so stability before then rests on synergised data for 2013–19 [OP2-0072, OP8-0627]. Later buy-down multiples cannot be tested for sustainability until Operator 6 and Operator 3 restate them after corporate allocation and integration capex [OP6-012; OP3-010]. Deal A's own add-on EBITDA multiples need the underlying deal files behind its acquisition register (only the summary tab is supplied) [note C-68]. Operator 2 Sponsor 1-era standalone add-on multiples need the DDTL draw schedules and acquisition memos; the Operator 1 2014 conflict needs the Sponsor 10 closing funds flow; a third core gross/net sale-leaseback pair needs Operator 6's SLB closing statements for its four real-estate deals ('Transaction Level Data'!M20, M22, M26, M28); and the Operator 4 CV denominator depends on OP4-005 p.3/p.23/p.48 and the ST-74 compliance certificate [note C-63]. The only rent-adjusted platform multiple in the transaction set is Operator 1 2014 (9.05x), so lease intensity is not controlled across platforms [OP1-0917].

Exhibit 9.73 — 2010 to 2026: median add-on multiples sat between 4.0x and 5.8x in every environment, on standalone and on synergised or unstated bases

Median add-on EV ÷ EBITDA by environment and EBITDA basis, x, 2010 to 2026; the two bases come from different operators

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Add-on transaction schedules in the Operator 6, Operator 7, Operator 3 and Operator 8 documents (standalone) and in the Operator 2 and Wellness Clinic Operator 3 documents (synergised or unstated); CreditSwan medians; fact rows per bar in the data file; note C-64, note C-65 · Basis: Closed add-ons at the multiple each document states, except that the SOFT24-26 standalone bar includes two Operator 3 deals dated after the 10 October 2025 pipeline update (projected closings); without them the median is 4.7x on 44 deals [I]. Standalone: Operator 6, Operator 7, Operator 3 and others (n = 4–47 deals per environment); synergised or unstated: Operator 2 and Wellness Clinic Operator 3 (n = 5–35). The two bases are not pooled; no standalone observations before 2021

Add-on pricing has held within a narrow band through the cycle on either basis [I, note C-64]. The two bases come from different platforms and are never combined in one statistic [I, note C-64].

A multiple quoted without its EBITDA basis cannot be compared: Operator 8's [name withheld] add-on reads 8.4x standalone and 2.5x synergised [F, OP8-0464, OP8-0463]. The three live deals are placed only on like-for-like bases for that reason (Part 04 section F).

Public signals

Public announcements in 2025 and 2026, read on 30 September 2026, date five events at general practice and preventive operators in the supplied documents. They add dates and parties; they do not add multiples or leverage. Exhibit 9.74 gives each as the party's own release states it. Where the supplied documents already carry a transaction, the table gives the public date and statement only, and the terms remain those shown in Exhibit 9.71.

Operator 1 and Sponsor 11 announced completion of the Operator 29 acquisition on 20 August 2026 [F, PUB-0020]. Operator 4's sponsor announced a recapitalisation through a continuation fund on 2 October 2025 [F, PUB-0021]. Operator 4 announced the acquisition of Operator 9 on 16 July 2026, expected to close in the third quarter of 2026 [F, PUB-0022]. Sponsor 5 announced an investment in Operator 3 on 16 December 2025 [F, PUB-0023]. Operator 2 stated on 1 September 2026 that it had more than 528 clinics [M, PUB-0024], against 510 at 30 June 2026 in the supplied documents [M, OP2-4716].

Exhibit 9.74 — Five public announcements on general practice and preventive operators between October 2025 and September 2026 give dates and parties; none adds a multiple

Public announcements on general practice and preventive operators in the supplied documents, each as the party's own release states it; October 2025 to September 2026

DATE OF RELEASE	OPERATOR	PARTIES	WHAT THE RELEASE STATES	SUPPLIED DOCUMENTS	REF
2 Oct 2025	Operator 4	Sponsor 9 (sponsor)	Recapitalisation of Operator 4 through a single-asset continuation fund; no multiple stated	The supplied documents carry the terms; see Exhibit 9.71	[F, PUB-0021]
16 Dec 2025	Operator 3	Sponsor 5; Operator 3	Investment by Sponsor 5 in Operator 3	The supplied documents carry the terms; see Exhibit 9.71	[F, PUB-0023]
16 Jul 2026	Operator 4; Operator 9	Operator 4; Operator 9	Acquisition of Operator 9 announced; expected to close in the third quarter of 2026; no price stated	The supplied documents carry the terms; see Exhibit 9.71	[F, PUB-0022]
20 Aug 2026	Operator 1	Operator 1 Express Services; Sponsor 11 (joint release)	Acquisition of Operator 29 completed	The supplied documents carry the terms; see Exhibit 9.71	[F, PUB-0020]
1 Sep 2026	Operator 2	Operator 2	More than 528 clinics, in 23 states	510 clinics at 30 June 2026 [M, OP2-4716]	[M, PUB-0024]

Source: Releases by Operator 1 and Sponsor 11 (joint release, exhibit to a Form 8-K), Sponsor 9, Operator 4, Sponsor 5 and Operator 2; read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: Each row gives the date of the release, the parties and what the release states. Where the supplied documents carry the transaction, their terms are not repeated here and are not replaced. An announcement is not evidence that a transaction closed unless the release says so

04 B Leverage multiples: supporting evidence

Closing first-lien leverage has held near a 4.3x median since 2014, while the junior and debt-like rungs above it and the EBITDA definition beneath it explain most of the spread in quoted leverage. The 4.3x anchor and the definition gap are durable, the 2021 peak at Operator 2's 5.97x was temporary, and Deal A is company-specific: funded leverage of 0.73x in FY2026 becomes 5.30x once finance leases, capitalised rent and supplier finance are counted.

Our reading on the evidence supplied to date. Closing first-lien leverage on financing EBITDA has sat at a 4.3x median since 2014, but on one or two operators per vintage and Operator 1-dominated: five EXP10-19 prints from Operator 1 and Operator 2 at 4.10–4.27x, two REOPEN21 prints peaking at Operator 2's 5.97x, and a single SOFT24-26 gross print from Operator 6 at 3.81x [P5-S001, OP6-0031]. The print is governed more by which EBITDA sits under it than by platform or vintage: the same debt moves by a factor of 1.3x to about 3.4x across EBITDA rungs, and lease, preferred, PIK and supplier-finance rungs add further turns [note C-73, note C-78]. Across nine core prints on mixed coverage definitions and bases, leverage above about 4.8x on financing EBITDA is associated with fixed-charge cover of about 0.7–1.2x; this is an association, not an estimated threshold [note C-80]. The highest-levered vintages de-levered through acquired and adjusted EBITDA, covenant resets and repricings, not debt paydown [note C-73]. **Check status:** Checked a second time against the source — the rung effect (Operator 4) and the Deal A FY26 ladder reproduce exactly; the conclusion carries these limits: the 4.3x anchor rests on one or two operators per vintage, the REOPEN21 gross print is on the at-close denominator (P5-S001), the coverage relation is not pooled across mixed bases, and Deal A FY25 is stated on D3 E1. **Operators / environments:** closed first-lien prints from three core operators (Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 6): 8 closed gross LV1 prints, 5 of them Operator 1, and 10 closed events with an LV1 print gross or net, 7 of them Operator 1, once the Operator 1 incrementals of 2023 and 2025, printed net only, are added, ladders from five (Operator 4, Operator 2, Operator 6, Operator 8, Operator 1), coverage from seven, and the Deal A ladder from its filings across all seven D10 environments [note C-73]. Two items do not meet the operator rule and are framed accordingly: the size band draws no conclusion, and the Deal A ladder is a platform finding, not a subsector conclusion [note C-73].

What the evidence shows

First-lien leverage at close has not risen; the junior and debt-like rungs have. All closed core prints are PF on E4 or E5 financing EBITDA [note C-73]. LV1 gross was 4.27x median in EXP10-19 across Operator 1 (four prints) and Operator 2 (one), 4.10–4.27x [OP1-7357, OP1-7584, OP1-7585, OP1-7795, OP2-0250]. REOPEN21 gives two prints, Operator 1 at 4.38x and Operator 2's Sponsor 1 LBO at 5.97x on its at-close LTM Jun-21 PF EBITDA of $47.5m; the company figure of 6.79x is on the post-close LTM Q3-21 denominator and is not used here [OP1-10719, P5-S001, OP2-3731]. SOFT24-26 has one closed gross print, Operator 6 at 3.81x on E5 [OP6-0031]. Net LV1 prints are Operator 1 3.87x (INFL22-23) and 4.61x (SOFT24-26) and REOPEN21 4.32–6.05x [OP1-10729, OP1-11220, OP1-10721, OP2-3732]. Above first lien, Operator 1 carried LV2 net of 6.62x in 2018 and 5.80x in 2021 and LV4 net of 8.10x in 2021 including preferred [OP1-7814, OP1-10742, OP1-10730]. Proposals are P and are never pooled with closed prints: Operator 3 at 4.70x and Operator 7 at 2.25x LV1 gross [OP3-1326, OP7-1181]. The proposed financings of the three live deals are in Part 08.

The earnings definition moves the print more than platform or vintage does. Operator 4's $668.5m of first-lien debt at Mar-26 is 4.65x on credit-agreement PF EBITDA (E4), 5.10x on Lender 1's E5, 6.54x on credit-agreement adjusted EBITDA (E3) and 19.92x on cash EBITDA (E6) [OP4-1438, OP4-1442, OP4-1434, OP4-1446]. Operator 8's $142.4m is 5.35x on credit-agreement EBITDA and 10.43x on E2m [OP8-2346, OP8-2348]. Operator 6's $86m is 3.81x on E5, 4.84x on the Accounting Firm 3 E3, 7.56x on E1 plus pre-acquisition EBITDA and 16.59x on E1 as owned [OP6-0031, OP6-0032, OP6-0033, OP6-0034]. Across the core ladders the E2/E3 print runs 0.96–1.69x the E4/E5 print (median 1.14x), and E1 or E6 prints run 1.1x (Operator 2) to 3.9x (Operator 6 as owned, Operator 4 E6) the financing print [note C-73; note C-78]. By contrast, closed LV1 prints vary across platforms and vintages by a factor of 1.16 (3.81–4.27x), or 1.44 including Operator 2's REOPEN21 print [note C-73]. The wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital ladders are context and are set out in Exhibit 9.98.

Deal A's funded leverage is low, but its lease and supplier-finance leverage is not. On D3 E1 (operating income + D&A + impairment, gains on disposal left in) of $71.2m in FY2026, LV1 is 0.62x, LV3 3.07x once finance leases are added, LV5_6X 3.90x once cash operating rent is capitalised and LV6 5.30x once supplier finance is added [note C-81; DLA-0317, DLA-0472, DLA-0473, A8-P5-068, A8-P5-071]. On E1 ex-gains of $56.4m, which removes $16.0m of FY2026 gains on disposal (mostly property sales funding the turnaround), the same ladder reads 0.81x, 3.89x, 4.50x and 6.35x [DLA-0315, A8-P5-076, A8-P5-078, A8-P5-080, A8-P5-083]. Funded LV1 was below 1.4x in every fiscal year FY2002–FY2026 except FY2020, when the revolver was drawn to $498.9m against $296.9m of cash at the 24-Mar-20 year-end (LV1 gross 2.80x, LV3 net 2.74x) [A8-P5-001, A8-P5-004]. The deterioration since FY2022 comes from the denominator: D3 E1 fell from $156.3m (FY22) to $71.2m (FY26) against fixed lease and supplier-finance obligations, and the FCCR proxy fell from 1.73x (FY24) to 0.77x (FY26; 0.51x ex-gains) [A8-P5-053, A8-P5-073, A8-P5-085]. LFCF before growth and before ΔNWC [I] was +$48.2m in FY24, +$15.1m in FY25 and −$4.3m in FY26 (−$20.9m ex-gains); this is not D5 LFCF_PRE as defined in Part 09 section C (Exhibit 9.06), which also deducts working capital [A8-P5-055, A8-P5-065, A8-P5-075, A8-P5-087]. Deal A's debt and leverage after FY2026, and the proposed refinancing set against this ladder, are in Part 08 section B.

Supplier finance is the last step in Deal A's ladder and the second largest, after finance leases. The 10-K reports a supplier-finance balance of $197.6m at FY2026 year-end ($213.4m at FY2025) [DLA_SCF FY2026, FY2025]; on that balance it adds 1.5 turns to FY2026 leverage on D3 E1 (LV5

3.90x to LV6 5.30x) and 1.8 turns on E1 ex-gains (4.50x to 6.35x) [A8-P5-068, A8-P5-071, A8-P5-080, A8-P5-083]. Later balances in other supplied documents differ from the 10-K and are set out, with their effect on leverage, in Part 08 section B.

Higher leverage is associated with lower fixed-charge cover, on mixed bases. The nine core coverage prints come from seven operators and mix compliance-certificate FCCR, lender-model FCCR, company FCCR on maintenance-only or total capex, and the Deal A public proxy, on A, PF and P bases, so no pooled statistic is computed [note C-80]. At or below about 3.8x on financing EBITDA, FCCR reads 1.3–1.6x: Operator 7 1.49x at 1.97x net (P), Operator 8 1.33x at 3.55x net and Operator 6 1.43x at 3.81x (P) [OP7-1304, OP7-1180, OP8-2547, OP8-2324, OP6-0141, OP6-0031]. At 4.8–5.8x it reads 0.7–1.2x: Operator 3 1.08x at 4.70x (P), Operator 6 1.15x at its 5.3x delayed-draw limit (P), Operator 2 1.00x at 5.55x gross (P) and Operator 1 0.66x at 5.81x net including growth capex (0.93x excluding it) [OP3-1291, OP3-1326, OP6-0142, OP6-1880, OP2-3899, OP2-3766, OP1-11144, OP1-11151]. The one exception is Operator 1 FY22 at 1.38x standalone on 5.53x net before the Operator 33 debt [OP1-10714, OP1-10743]. Spreads do not follow the leverage print: Operator 7 is priced at S+422–451 at 1.9x and Operator 2 at S+383 on about 5.6x after two repricings [OP7-1164, OP2-4336].

After close, the highest-levered credits de-levered only through EBITDA growth, resets and repricing. Operator 2's 2018 recap at 4.24x rose to 4.99x by Dec-19 and 6.55x on covenant EBITDA against a 6.35x covenant; Ares Credit Group reset the covenant to 6.56x for six quarters, stepping to 6.13x and then 5.95x [OP2-0250, OP2-1480, OP2-2306, OP2-1477, OP2-2963, OP2-2967]. Operator 2's 2021 LBO at 6.05x net peaked at 6.6x in Q2-23 and stood at 5.57x in Jul-26 on E4 and 7.06x on reported EBITDA, while the spread was repriced from L+511 to S+383 [OP2-3732, OP2-3771, OP2-4311, OP2-4315, OP2-3722, OP2-4336]. Operator 1 LV2 net went from 5.80x (May-21) to 4.98x (Apr-23) and 4.76x (Mar-26), then back to 5.81x (Jun-26) after the Operator 29 financing; the $655m 6% PIK preferred was redeemed in May-26, so LV4 now equals LV2, and PF LTM Mar-26 FCCR including growth capex was 0.66x [OP1-10742, OP1-10744, OP1-11228, OP1-11151, OP1-11149, OP1-11144]. Operator 8 went from 0.93x at the Feb-25 close to 3.4x (Sep-25) and 5.3x (Mar-26) on credit-agreement EBITDA through DDTL-funded acquisitions, and a Jan-26 amendment added an S+472 prong above 5.3x [OP8-0068, OP8-2321, OP8-2344, OP8-2463]. Operator 4 moved from 4.1x net at the Sep-25 refinancing to 4.5x (Dec-25) and 4.4x (May-26), and its Jun-26 incremental request carries a spread of up to S+511 against S+383 [OP4-0736, OP4-0740, OP4-0745, OP4-1174, OP4-1184]. The parties' own announcements of Operator 4's continuation fund and of Operator 1's completion of the Operator 29 acquisition are dated in Exhibit 9.74, under "04 A Valuation multiples: supporting evidence" above. No default, restructuring or equity cure appears for any platform; the supplied documents are a lender's live portfolio and pipeline, so they are survivor-biased [note C-73].

Exhibit 9.75 — Mar-26 to Jul-26: the same first-lien debt reads 4–20x at Operator 4, Operator 8 and Operator 6 depending on the EBITDA underneath it

One first-lien debt amount divided by each EBITDA rung the documents give (x), core platforms, Mar-26 to Jul-26; lender and company documents

PLATFORM, DATE, NUMERATOR	FINANCING RUNG (E4/E5)	ADJUSTED (E2/E3)	CASH (E6)	REPORTED (E1)	MAX ÷ MIN	BASIS	FACT ROWS
Operator 4, Mar-26, LV1 gross $668.5m	4.65x (E4) / 5.10x (E5, Lender 1)	6.54x (E3)	19.92x	–	3.81	PF	OP4-1438, OP4-1442, OP4-1434, OP4-1446
Operator 8, Mar-26, LV1 gross $142.4m	5.35x (credit agreement, E4)	10.43x (E2m)	–	–	1.69	PF	OP8-2346, OP8-2348
Operator 6, Jul-26, LV1 $86m	3.81x (E5)	4.84x (E3, Accounting Firm 3)	–	7.56x (E1 + pre-acq.) / 16.59x (E1 as owned)	3.73	PF / A (as owned)	OP6-0031, OP6-0032, OP6-0033, OP6-0034

Source: note C-77, note C-78. Rungs per CreditSwan definitions D3; numerator held constant within each row. Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital ladders are context and sit in Exhibit 9.98. Clinic base: consolidated

Exhibit 9.76 — Deal A FY2020 to FY2026: funded leverage stayed below 1.4x in every year after FY2020 while lease and supplier-finance leverage rose to 6–5.9x

Deal A leverage ladder (x), cover (x) and levered free cash flow ($m), FY2020 to FY2026, from Forms 10-K (actual)

FY (D10, MONTH-MAJORITY)	D3 E1 $M	LV1 GROSS	LV3 GROSS	LV3 NET	LV5_6X GROSS	LV6 GROSS	E1 ÷ INTEREST PAID	FCCR PROXY	LFCF BEFORE GROWTH AND ΔNWC $M
FY2020 (EXP10-19)	152.5	2.80x	4.40x	2.74x	4.60x	n/a	5.7x	1.63x	42.9
FY2021 (COVID20)	127.7	1.14x	3.38x	3.25x	3.69x	n/a	5.1x	1.41x	32.4
FY2022 (REOPEN21)	156.3	0.86x	2.70x	2.67x	3.10x	n/a	6.3x	2.24x	89.8
FY2023 (INFL22-23)	133.4	0.59x	2.48x	2.42x	2.93x	3.81x	6.0x	1.44x	33.8
FY2024 (INFL22-23)	128.2	0.61x	2.40x	2.31x	3.06x	3.69x	6.3x	1.73x	48.2
FY2025 (SOFT24-26)	92.2	0.49x	2.69x	2.52x	3.44x	4.87x	5.2x	1.13x	15.1
FY2026 (SOFT24-26)	71.2	0.62x	3.07x	2.97x	3.90x	5.30x	4.3x	0.77x	−4.3
FY2026, E1 ex-gains (memo)	56.4	0.81x	3.89x	3.82x	4.50x	6.35x	3.3x	0.51x	−20.9

Source: note C-81 (fiscal year-end fact rows DLA-0221, DLA-0236, DLA-0251, DLA-0266, DLA-0283, DLA-0300 and DLA-0317, the Deal A 10-K series by fiscal year, and the A8-P5 rows cited in Part 04 section B). Basis A (10-K). Denominator D3 E1 = operating income + D&A (incl. finance-lease ROU amortisation) + impairment; gains on disposal left in, ex-gains memo lines shown. LV1 = bank and mortgage debt; LV3 adds finance leases and financing obligations; LV5_6X adds 6× operating-lease cash payments over E1 + rent (rent code R-CASH from FY2020); LV6 adds supplier finance (10-K balance; available from FY2023). Deal A's debt and leverage after FY2026 are in Part 08 section B. FCCR proxy [I] = (E1 − total capex − cash taxes) ÷ (interest paid + finance-lease principal), on total capex because Deal A gives no maintenance split. D10 tags are the month-majority tags (FY2020 = Apr-19 to Mar-20). Clinic base: consolidated

Durable, temporary, company-specific

Durable: first-lien leverage on financing EBITDA has sat at a 4.3x median at close, on one or two operators per vintage and Operator 1-dominated (Operator 1 4.10–4.27x in 2014–18, Operator 2 4.24x in 2018, Operator 1 4.38x in 2021, Operator 6 3.81x in 2026) [note C-75]. The gap between the financing rung and reported or cash EBITDA is the largest single driver of the print, with E2/E3 prints a median 1.14x the financing print and E1/E6 prints 1.1–3.9x [note C-73]. Sponsor platforms de-lever through acquired and adjusted EBITDA, not paydown (Operator 1 2021–26, Operator 2 2021–26, Operator 8 2025–26) [note C-73].

Temporary: REOPEN21 produced the highest closed prints, Operator 2's 5.9x gross LV1 and Operator 1's 7.2x LV4 net, and both credits were still above 5.3x on the lender's rung five years later [P5-S001, OP1-10730, OP2-4311, OP1-11151]. At the COVID-onset year-end Deal A drew its revolver to $498.9m and held $296.9m of cash, while Operator 1 net leverage held at 5.4–5.76x [A8-P5-001, A8-P5-004; OP1-8160, OP1-7815]. In SOFT24-26, seasoned credits repriced down (Operator 2 to S+383) while a new small-cap proposal priced at S+422–451 [OP2-4336, OP7-1164, OP7-1165].

Company-specific: Deal A's LV1 stayed below 1.4x in every year except FY2020, but lease and supplier-finance obligations lift LV6 to 4.87x (FY25) and 5.30x (FY26; 6.35x ex-gains) [note C-81]. Operator 4's audited E1 is a fraction of credit-agreement EBITDA (LV1 9.87x on FY23 E1 against 3.99x on E4) [OP4-1384, OP4-1388]. Operator 8 went from 1.0x to 5.3x in 13 months through DDTL-funded acquisitions [OP8-0068, OP8-2344]. Operator 7 1.9x proposal is the only low-levered sponsor-backed core credit and rests on P-basis run-rate EBITDA [OP7-1180].

What the evidence cannot show

The set cannot calibrate the leverage at which platforms in this subsector default or restructure, because every financing is current and none shows a restructuring; evidence of a default in a comparable platform above 5.3x would come from outside the supplied documents [note C-76]. Leverage on a common EBITDA rung across platforms exists only where the same debt is printed over several rungs (Operator 4, Operator 2, Operator 6 and Operator 8; the wellness clinic and emergency and specialty hospital ladders are in Exhibit 9.98), and consistently defined E1 or E6 prints for Operator 1, Operator 3 and Operator 7 would test whether the definition effect is general [note C-76]. No size conclusion is possible because the closed core bucket above $86m of EBITDA holds only Operator 1 [note C-76]. GFC-era sponsor leverage is absent (the earliest sponsor print is the 2012 Operator 1 proposal, P) [OP1-0826]. No Operator 5 financing figure is used in this section [note C-76]. Deal A's FCCR proxy is understated by an unknown growth-capex share until a maintenance capex split is supplied [note C-81]. Pre-FY2020 Deal A LV5 uses book rent (pre-FY2020 10-K lease disclosures would give cash rent), finance leases are assumed nil for Operator 6 and Operator 3 (OP6-010, OP3-001), and among the core operators covenant headroom is printed only for Operator 2 (6.55x on covenant EBITDA against a 6.35x covenant at Dec-19) and Operator 8 (5.3x against 6.3x at Mar-26) [OP2-2306, OP2-1477, OP8-2350; note C-76].

Valuation and financing

Platform multiples in the set sit on at least five EBITDA rungs (E1, E2q, E3, E4 and synergised or financing EBITDA), and only Operator 1 has a same-rung pair (9.9x in 2014 and 14.0x in 2018, both E4); its 2021 print of 16.35x is on E3/E2q [OP1-7877, OP1-7521, OP1-7882]. The 2014 print itself varies by source (9.3x / 9.9x / 10.4x) and is used at 9.9x with the range stated. Closing first-lien leverage on financing EBITDA has sat near 4.3x since 2014 at the median of one to two operators per vintage, with the REOPEN21 peak at Operator 2's 5.97x gross [P5-S001]. The EBITDA rung moves the print more than platform or vintage: the same Operator 4 first-lien debt of $668.5m at Mar-26 reads 4.65x on E4, 5.10x on E5, 6.54x on E3 and 19.92x on E6 [note C-77].

Exhibit 9.77 — Headline platform multiples rose from ~9.3x (2014) to 12.0–15.2x (2021–26) on progressively more adjusted rungs; closing LV1 sat at 3.8–4.6x except Operator 2 in 2021 (5.97x) and Operator 8's company-defined 0.93x at its February 2025 unitranche

Headline multiple (x), EV ($m), EBITDA rung, and leverage at close and after (x) for each platform transaction, Oct-14 to Aug-26; Ares Credit Group deal documents

DATE	PLATFORM / EVENT	EV OR PRICE ($M)	EBITDA RUNG, PERIOD, BASIS	HEADLINE MULTIPLE	STANDALONE / SYNERGISED	LV1 AT CLOSE (DENOMINATOR)	LV2–LV5 AT CLOSE	LATER PRINTS	FACT ROWS
Oct-14	Operator 1 — Sponsor 10 LBO	377.4 (sources differ: 366.7 excl. fees in the 2018 memo; 363.6 pre-close)	E4 normalised LTM Aug-14 $32.2m (2014 memo: $27.6m LTM Jul-14 + $4.1m ramp = $31.9m, as the memo states; components rounded), PF	9.9x (range 9.3–10.4x); 11.9x on E2q [I]	Standalone	4.27x gross (E4 $32.2m)	LV2 5.14x gross	See Sponsor 12 and Sponsor 4 rows	OP1-7877 (A7-P5-005, OP1-0915); A7-P5-001, A7-P5-003; OP1-7357, OP1-7360
Aug-15	Operator 18 → Operator 1 (134 clinics)	289.0	E4 LTM Mar-15 $27.6m standalone; $39.6m synergised, PF	8.8x / 6.6x (as stated; $289.0m ÷ $39.6m is 6.3x)	Both	4.3x gross (E4 synergised $74.4m)	LV2 4.7x	—	OP1-7607 (sources differ: OP1-7178), OP1-7610; OP1-7584, OP1-7587
Feb-16	Operator 29 → Sponsor 11	1,025.9	E1 LTM Oct-15 $71.4m, A	12.4x	Standalone	n/a	n/a	—	OP1-7522
Jan-18	Regional Chain 1 → Operator 1 (60 clinics)	86.4	E2 LTM $6.7m; E4 synergised, PF	11.2x / 5.1x	Both	4.3x gross (E4 PF LTM Aug-17 ~$84m)	LV2 5.1x	—	OP1-7608, OP1-7611; OP1-7585, OP1-7588
Mar-18	Operator 1 + Wellness Clinic Operator 3 — Sponsor 12	~1,630 (Operator 1 standalone; 1,584 in the less-adjusted computation)	E4 FY17 $100.1m standalone; E4 incl. synergies $204.3m, PF	14.0x standalone (17.1x less adjusted [I]); 10.9x synergised (10.6x in the 2021 memo)	Both	4.10x gross (E4 $204.3m)	LV2 5.95x gross / 5.76x net	LV2 net 5.6x Feb-20; 5.4x Nov-20	OP1-7521; A7-P5-002; OP1-7520 (OP1-7880); OP1-7795, OP1-8157, OP1-7814; OP1-8159, OP1-7815
Oct-18	Operator 2 (GB Vet) — Ares Credit Group unitranche recap	n/a	E3 PF LTM Aug-18 $9.5m	8.4x	Standalone	4.24x gross (E4 LTM Aug-18 $9.5m)	LV5 4.64x [I]	LEV_ST-59 net 4.32x Oct-18 → 4.99x Dec-19 → 5.06x Jun-20 → 5.2x Mar-21	A7-S001; OP2-0250, OP2-0251; OP2-0247, OP2-1480, OP2-3941, OP2-2990
Feb-20	Operator 33 → Operator 1	~93 implied (sources differ: $67m)	E4 PF normalised $21m, synergised	3.9x	Synergised	—	—	—	OP1-8178 (sources differ: OP1-8755)
Nov-20	Operator 27 → Operator 1	544.2	E4 PF LTM Sep-20: $47m standalone / $52m incl. $6.9m synergies	10.2x / 9.0x	Both	—	—	—	OP1-7876, OP1-7883
May-21	Operator 1 — Sponsor 4 LBO	5,255 total capitalisation	E3/E2q PF M&A LTM Dec-20 $326.3m	13.96x (13.2x on LTM Mar-21E, P)	Unstated	4.38x gross (E4 PF LTM Mar-21 $333m; sources differ: 3.54x)	LV2 net 5.8x; LV4 net 7.2x	LV2 net 5.53x Dec-22, 4.98x Apr-23, 5.6x Jun-25, 4.76x Mar-26, 5.8x Jun-26; LV4 net 5.8x Jun-26	OP1-7882, OP1-8281; OP1-10719 (sources differ: OP1-10720); OP1-10742, OP1-10730; OP1-10743, OP1-10744, OP1-11227, OP1-11228, OP1-11151, OP1-11149
Sep-21	Operator 2 — Sponsor 1 LBO (180 clinics)	788.4	PF Adj. LTM Jun-21 $47.5m (sources differ: $48.3m)	~15x (14.1–15.0x)	Unstated	5.97x gross / 6.05x net (E4 PF LTM Jun-21 $47.5m)	LV5 5.66x [I]	LEV_ST-59 net 6.2x Dec-22, 6.6x Jun-23, 5.48x Mar-24, 5.47x/6.43x Dec-25 (sources differ), 5.57x Jul-26	OP2-3714; A7-S004; P5-S001, OP2-3732; OP2-3735; OP2-3770, OP2-3771, OP2-3773, OP2-4668, OP2-4671, OP2-4311
Dec-21	Operator 20 → Operator 2 (62 clinics)	n/a	PF Adj. LTM May-21	9.4x	Unstated	—	—	—	OP2-3738
Apr-23	Operator 33 / Deal A Banner 4 → Operator 1	500.7	PF 2022 $58.8m incl. ~$28m synergies	13.2x standalone (P, derived) / 7.0x synergised	Both	3.87x net (E4 PF $460.9m)	LV2 5.1x gross; LV4 6.0x net	—	OP1-10771, OP1-10773; OP1-10729, OP1-10741, OP1-10738
Jan-24	Operator 8 — Next Sponsor 14	48.3	Pre-synergy PF $4.2m; PF incl. synergies; Accounting Firm 2 E2q LTM Nov-23	10.0x / 8.6x (16.3x on E2q)	Both	Ares Credit Group unitranche Feb-25: LEV_ST-59 0.93x gross / 0.59x net (E5 TTM Sep-24 $8.3m; sources differ)	—	LEV_ST-59 net 1.5x Jun-25 → 3.4x Sep-25 → 5.3x Mar-26 → 5.06x Jun-26; LV4 net 5.4x Dec-25, 5.68x Apr-26, 5.54x Jun-26	OP8-0459, OP8-0458, OP8-0002; OP8-0068, OP8-0069; OP8-2819; OP8-2309, OP8-2321, OP8-2344, OP8-2361, OP8-2452, OP8-2367

DATE	PLATFORM / EVENT	EV OR PRICE ($M)	EBITDA RUNG, PERIOD, BASIS	HEADLINE MULTIPLE	STANDALONE / SYNERGISED	LV1 AT CLOSE (DENOMINATOR)	LV2–LV5 AT CLOSE	LATER PRINTS	FACT ROWS
Jun-25	Operator 30 → Operator 1	n/a	FY24 EBITDA $61m (rung not stated)	9.8x	Unstated	4.6x net (E4 PF LTM Q1-25 ~$606m)	LV2 5.6x net	—	OP1-11254; OP1-11220, OP1-11227
Sep-25	Operator 4 — GP-led continuation fund	n/a	E4 ST-74 PF Adj. LTM Aug-25 incl. run-rate synergies and LOI	15.2x	Synergised	Lender 1 refinancing: LEV_ST-59 net 4.1x (ST-74 PF E4); Mar-26 first lien 4.65x E4 / 5.10x E5 / 6.54x E3 / 19.92x E6	—	Total net leverage 3.9x Sep-25, 4.5x Dec-25, 4.6x Mar-26, 4.4x May-26	OP4-1180; OP4-1182; OP4-0738, OP4-0740, OP4-0742, OP4-0745
Oct-25	Operator 26 → Operator 4 (28 centres)	n/a	ST-99 EBITDA at underwriting ~$26m	5.8x	Synergised	—	—	—	OP4-0838
Dec-25	Operator 3 — Sponsor 5 (Ares Credit Group proposal)	n/a	E5 FY2025E $21.7m, P	12.0x	Synergised	4.70x gross (E5 $21.7m, P)	—	—	OP3-1328; OP3-1326
Mar-26	Operator 7 — Kilo minority	n/a	E2q QoE LTM Jan-26	12.5x	Standalone	Ares Credit Group proposal: 2.25x gross / 1.97x net (E5 run-rate $8.8m, P)	—	—	OP7-1092; OP7-1181, OP7-1180
Jun-26	Operator 9 → Operator 4 (SPA)	1,040.0	E2q QoE LTM Dec-25 $28.4m; sponsor PF $136.1m incl. $109.9m run-rate synergies; Lender 1 haircut	33.6x / 6.6x / 9.4x	Both	Incremental TL proposal: LEV_ST-59 3.9x (sponsor ComboCo $270.9m, E4) / 5.2x (Lender 1 $212.0m, E5)	—	—	OP4-1193, OP4-1194, OP4-1195; OP4-1134, OP4-1135
Jul-26	Operator 6 — MSCP LBO	351.0	Adj. incl. LOI LTM May-26 $20.4m; E3 buy-side QoE LTM Mar-26 $15.0m; E1 + pre-acquisition	14.6x / 19.6x / 29.4x	Unstated (incl. LOI) / standalone	3.81x gross (E5 $20.4m)	LV5 4.26x (rent R-UNK); post-close debt ÷ pre-close as-owned E1 16.59x (not ranked)	—	OP6-0042, OP6-0043, OP6-0044; OP6-0031; OP6-1877; OP6-0034
Aug-26	Operator 29 → Operator 1	596.0	PF Adj. $112.7m incl. $116.7m synergies (standalone FY25 − $4.4m)	4.5x synergised; standalone n/m	Synergised	—	PF LV2 net 5.62x	—	OP1-11184; OP1-11155

Source: note C-69, note C-72 (EV and price as stated in the cited deal documents), note C-74, note C-77, note C-79, note C-82. Basis PF unless marked A or P. The proposed financings of the three live deals are in Part 08

Exhibit 9.78 — Dec-22 to May-26: across eight core prints, fixed-charge cover is 1.3–1.6x at 3.8x leverage or less and 0.7–1.2x at 4.8–5.8x, except Operator 1 FY22 at 1.38x

Fixed-charge cover against leverage at the same or nearest date, x, Dec-22 to May-26; compliance, lender-model and company definitions of cover

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Note C-80; Ares Credit Group investment committee memos and situation updates for Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 6 and Operator 8; Operator 7 and Operator 3 Early Reads; Operator 8 Q1 2026 Lender Update; two fact rows per point in the data file (OP1-10714, OP1-10743 … OP3-1291, OP3-1326) · Basis: Hollow = pro forma, hatched = projected cover; definitions of cover differ by document, so no pooled statistic is computed. Operators outside the three live deals only; Operator 6 is shown at close and at its 5.3x delayed-draw limit

Across the eight prints drawn, which leave out the Deal A public proxy, cover is 1.3–1.6x at 3.8x leverage or less and 0.7–1.2x at 4.8–5.8x except Operator 1 FY22 at 1.38x, but the prints mix definitions and bases [I, note C-80]. The relationship is shown as an industry pattern only; observations

on the three proposed financings are in Part 08 section A.

04 C Operating benchmark: supporting evidence

Among the core platforms only Operator 1, Operator 7 ST-22, Operator 8 and Operator 5 carry four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent, and no year holds three such operators on actual figures, so the operating table describes and does not rank. Negative comp traffic at the established operators in the 2024 to 2026 soft period (Deal A −3.9%, Operator 3 −2.8%, Operator 6 −2.0%, each an upper bound on a survivor base) is the durable reading; the positive readings at Operator 8 (+7.4%) and Operator 7 (+10.9%) sit on newly assembled bases and are company-specific.

No platform in the set can be ranked overall. Ten common-definition rankings exist in four of the eight areas, each confined to a single D10 environment, and ranks do not persist from one environment to the next [note C-83]. Read across those rankings and the per-platform evidence, Operator 5, Operator 7 ST-22 and Operator 3 show the strongest evidence and Deal A and Operator 4 the weakest (Operator 4 on earnings, cash and leverage measures), but each description carries a caveat on basis, clinic base or rent code that the benchmark cannot remove [Part 04 section E]. For underwriting, the benchmark is a map of which comparisons are valid, not a league table: the four-wall, unit-economics and cash-conversion areas (A3, A4, A6) cannot be ranked at all on a common definition, and every ranking that exists rests on three or four operators [Exhibit 9.93; Part 09 section H].

The operating benchmark is Exhibit 4.11 in Part 04 section C; this section adds the organic-versus-acquired splits the evidence supports (Exhibit 9.79) and the other operating KPIs (Exhibit 9.80). The transaction and financing record is Exhibit 9.77, under "04 B" above; the rankings are Exhibit 4.15 in Part 04 section E, and the strongest and weakest operators and the ranking-validity table (Exhibit 9.93) are under "04 E" below. Deal B and Deal C figures are those of Part 06 and Part 07; a figure that appears only here was read once from the source [Part 09 section D].

Operating benchmark

The operating table places each platform on its best available data, which means a different period, rent code and clinic base for almost every row. Among the core platforms, only Operator 1 (A, to Nov-17), Operator 7 ST-22 (A, 2023–25), Operator 8 (A, 2022–23) and Operator 5 (PF, 2020 – LTM Mar-23) carry D1.1 four-wall on R-CASH, and no year contains three actual R-CASH operators [note C-19]. The E1 margin column carries a common rung code but not a common lease treatment: Deal A's E1 excludes finance-lease cost, Operator 9's consolidated E1 eliminates related-party rent through real-estate VIEs, and the other platforms carry operating rent inside E1 [Exhibit 4.11; Part 09 section C]. The table is therefore descriptive; the valid comparisons for the live deals are set out in Part 04 section F. Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty operators, and Deal B's DBW segment, are read on the same measures in Exhibit 9.95 and are not set beside the core; DBW is analysed in Part 06 section F.

The table shows three patterns that bear on underwriting. Gross margin is high and stable within platforms but its level reflects where rebates are booked and the pharmacy share, so Operator 9 (17.8%, rebates in COGS, 55.9% pharmacy share) and Operator 2 (57.4% pre-rebate, 17.5% pharmacy share LTM Mar-21) are not comparable [OP4-0384; OP2-3460; note C-85]. Every SOFT24-26 comp traffic reading on a common definition is negative at the established operators — Deal A −3.9%, Operator 3 −2.8%, Operator 6 −2.0% — and all three are on survivor bases, so each is an upper bound [DLA-0789; OP3-0907; OP6-1896]. The two positive SOFT24-26 traffic readings (Operator 8 +7.4%, Operator 7 +10.9%) sit on newly assembled bases, Operator 8's on unadjusted days and Operator 7 on an undefined visit count [OP8-2114; OP7-1023].

Exhibit 9.79 — 2008 to 2026: where the evidence separates acquired clinics, results after acquisition differ by platform, higher later at Operator 2's owned-year groups, Operator 7 2023 cohort and, in dollars, Operator 1's [name withheld] clinics, at or below entry or underwriting at Operator 8, Operator 7 2024–25 cohort and Deal B; later multiples fall only on company-presented, synergised EBITDA

Acquired-clinic results at entry or early and later (four-wall margin %, EBITDA $m or multiple x), by platform, 2008 to 2026; company and deal documents

PLATFORM	WHAT IS SEPARATED	ENTRY / EARLY	LATER	BASIS AND BASE	LOCATORS
Operator 1	Constant 92-clinic base vs ALL (D1.1)	ALL 15.0% CY2010; constant 15.5%	ALL 9.8% LTM Nov-17; constant 12.1%	A; R-CASH; constant base [I]	OP1-5658, OP1-5668; A3-P5-001..A3-P5-004
Operator 1	[name withheld] batch acquisition (Nov-08, 42–42 clinics), D1.1 by age-year	Year 1 14.8% (median $89k)	Year 3 13.8% ($138k); year 5 12.2% ($143k); loss share 6% → 0% → 2%	A; R-CASH	A4-S0093, A4-S0094, A4-S0113, A4-S0114, A4-S0133, A4-S0134
Operator 2	Acquired clinics by owned year, D1.1 (different clinics in each year, not one cohort)	Year 1 (2018, n=26) 8.1%; loss share 26%	Year 2 (2019) 8.6%, 16%; year 3 (2020, n=55) 11.4%, 10.8%	A; R-UNK; owned clinics	A4-S0272, A4-S0274, A4-S0277, A4-S0279, A4-S0287, A4-S0289

PLATFORM	WHAT IS SEPARATED	ENTRY / EARLY	LATER	BASIS AND BASE	LOCATORS
Operator 2	Greenfields by owned year, D1.1	Year 1 −36.6% (2019, n=1), −20.3% (2020, n=1)	Year 3 4.2% (2020, n=2)	A; R-UNK	A4-S0290..A4-S0314
Operator 6	31 add-ons, entry vs current clinic EBITDA multiple	4.5x entry (PF seller)	3.4x on TTM Mar-26 (company-presented, synergised; survivor); 9 of 31 below entry EBITDA, so their multiple rose or is negative	PF; R-UNK	A4-S0359..A4-S0368; OP6-1731, OP6-1733
Operator 3	18 deals, entry vs current multiple	company average 4.4x	company average 2.8x (May-25); all 18 below entry multiple	PF [M] (chart read)	OP3-1457..OP3-1492; OP3-1493, OP3-1494
Operator 4	Programmatic mature pool (14 deals, 143 locations)	6.0x at close (standalone seller ST-99 EBITDA)	3.2x Q1-26 LTM (post-integration, survivor)	A (company-presented)	OP4-0802, OP4-0806
Operator 8	11 new units vs PF run-rate; 2023–24 cohort vs underwriting	PF run-rate $5.04m; underwriting $4.32m	FY24 $3.44m (0.59x); FY25 $3.35m (0.70x)	PF (historicals incl. seller months)	OP8-1701..OP8-1703; OP8-2209..OP8-2211
Operator 7	ST-22 cohorts, 4-wall at acquisition vs May-26	2023 cohort 13.8%; 2024–25 cohort 14.7%	19.5%; 14.1%	A (company definition)	OP7-1085, OP7-1086, OP7-1088, OP7-1089
Operator 1	Operator 33/Deal A Banner 4 (2023), year 3 vs underwriting	Plan 533 clinics, $812m revenue, $68.7m Adj. EBITDA	488 clinics, $724m, $71.9m	PF (Adj. EBITDA)	OP1-11285..OP1-11304
Deal B	Cohort 4-wall LTM Jul-26 (twelve owned months; 2025 cohort partial) vs seller closing EBITDA	Seller closing EBITDA: 2022 $3.00m; 2023 $4.94m; 2024 $7.98m; 2025 $11.47m	$1.47m (0.44x); $5.00m (0.90x); $4.75m (0.52x); 2025 $8.21m on a partial year (0.63x; 0.52–0.77x by basis); first owned year 0.55–0.76x (Part 06 section B)	PF seller EBITDA vs company definition (R-BOOK)	DLB-0114/DLB-7667; DLB-0142/DLB-7682; DLB-0166/DLB-7697; DLB-0186/DLB-7711

Source: note C-24, note C-35, note C-36, note C-37. The re-rating reading is narrow: surviving add-ons show later multiples of 3–3.4x only on company-presented, synergised clinic EBITDA; it is not established on D1.1 or on an all-deal base

Other operating KPIs

Service mix, labour productivity, retention, clinic roll-forwards, integration cost and overhead are read directly from the Evidence index (Part 09 section F); the definitions are company definitions in most rows, so the table below is a description by platform, not a comparison [note C-85]. No row of the Evidence index (Part 09 section F) records relocations, and among the core operators integration cost per acquired clinic is given only for Operator 6 ($137.7k LTM Mar-26, PF) [note C-85; OP6-1883]; the wellness clinic figure is in Exhibit 9.96. The supplied documents give none of these KPIs for Deal B or Deal C on these definitions [Part 09 section H].

Exhibit 9.80 — CY2017 to 2026: pharmacy share runs from 7% (Operator 7 ST-70) to 55% (Operator 9); retention and labour figures are company-defined, one series per operator

Service mix, labour productivity, retention, clinic closures, integration cost and overhead by core platform, company definitions, periods as stated, CY2017 to 2026

PLATFORM	SERVICE MIX (PHARMACY SHARE OF REVENUE)	LABOUR PRODUCTIVITY	CUSTOMER / WORKFORCE RETENTION	CLINIC CLOSURES	INTEGRATION COST	CORPORATE OVERHEAD AND HEADCOUNT	SOURCE
Operator 1	31.4% consolidated CY2022; Operator 1 banner 38.4%	Revenue per exam room $196k (Operator 1 NE, CY2017 deck)	n/a	10 CY2022; 24 CY2025 (PF incl. Operator 29)	n/a	$75.1m CY2022; 3% of revenue CY2019	note C-85
Operator 2	17.5% LTM Mar-21 (ALL owned)	Revenue per exam room-month $14.7k (Operator 16, LTM Mar-21)	New-customer share 24.7% (Operator 14, CY2017)	0 in CY2018–20	Transaction/integration lines $0.2–1.6m each, LTM Mar-21	$15.6m LTM Mar-21; headcount 752	note C-85
Deal A	42.5% FY26	n/a (DLA-002 gives veterinarian pay as a share of sales, not productivity)	n/a	130 in FY26 (round-one closures, FY26 10-K; 129 on the company's closed-clinic list, Part 05 section C)	n/a	$55.0m FY26	note C-85
Operator 4	42% LTM Dec-25	Revenue per exam room $326k; 8 exam rooms per clinic (PF)	Repeat rate 62% (CY2021)	n/a	$8.1m CY2025 (cash)	7.7% of revenue CY2025	note C-85
Operator 9	55.9% FY25	Revenue per exam room $306k; 8.6 exam rooms per clinic	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	note C-85

PLATFORM	SERVICE MIX (PHARMACY SHARE OF REVENUE)	LABOUR PRODUCTIVITY	CUSTOMER / WORKFORCE RETENTION	CLINIC CLOSURES	INTEGRATION COST	CORPORATE OVERHEAD AND HEADCOUNT	SOURCE
Operator 5	33.2% CY2022 (PF)	Revenue per FTE $235k; per veterinarian $815k (PF, CY2022)	Repeat rate 60.3% (YTD May-23; clinic median 60.4%)	n/a	n/a	FTE 481 CY2022; overhead 5.1%	note C-85
Operator 6	15.3% CY2025	Veterinarian productivity 61% (survivor, CY2025)	Repeat revenue 68% (CY2025); veterinarian turnover 33% (LTM Apr-26)	3 closures in 2025–26 per the QoE report; no count by year	$137.7k per acquired clinic (LTM Mar-26, PF)	n/a (projections only)	note C-85
Operator 3	33.1% LTM Aug-25 (survivor)	21.7 patient visits per clinic-day (survivor, YTD Aug-25)	Repeat sales 62% (CY2024); hourly turnover 56.3% (LTM Aug-25)	n/a (one closed clinic absent from the datacube)	n/a	$4.1m LTM Aug-25	note C-85
Operator 7	17% LTM May-26 (PF); ST-70 segment 6.6%	Revenue per veterinarian $592k ST-22 / $370k ST-70	n/a	n/a	$1.0m ST-22 YTD May-26	4.7% ST-22 CY2025	note C-85
Operator 8	30.3% LTM Mar-26	Revenue per veterinarian $278k (LTM Nov-23)	n/a	n/a	n/a	$6.2m LTM Mar-26	note C-85

Source: note C-85; each cell is one row of the Evidence index (Part 09 section F). Basis A unless marked PF; projected figures excluded. Overhead percentages for Operator 5 and Operator 7 are from note C-26

04 D Operator profiles: the eleven profiles

At the established operators revenue has rested on ticket while comparable traffic fell (Operator 1 comparable retail pharmacy units −2.9% in FY09; in the 2024 to 2026 soft period Deal A −3.9% in FY26, Operator 3 −2.8% in the year to August 2025 and Operator 6 −2.0% in 2025), and traffic rose only on newly assembled bases, at Operator 8 (+7.4%) and Operator 7 (+10.9%) in 2025. On the evidence supplied to date we read flat or falling traffic, ticket-led pricing and rebate-dependent pharmacy margins as durable, and the 2020 shock and the 2021–22 ticket surge as temporary. Company-specific are Deal A's loss-making third of clinics (28.7% in FY26, before co-op), the clinic scale of Operator 5 and Operator 7 ($494k and $433k of median four-wall), and deal costs that held cash EBITDA to 0.24 of its as-owned adjusted EBITDA at Operator 8 (LTM Mar-26), and to 0.29 and 0.31 of pro forma (E3) EBITDA at Operator 4 (LTM Mar-26) and Deal C (FY2025).

The benchmark of Parts 03 and 04 covers eleven core general practice and preventive care operators; this section profiles all eleven on the same six areas, the eight historical operators first and then the three live deals, whose full assessments are in Parts 05, 06 and 07. Live-deal profiles carry operating measures only; the proposed financings are read in Part 08 section A. Operator 4 and Operator 9 share one profile, as they share one row of Exhibit 4.11: Operator 4 announced the acquisition of Operator 9 on 16 July 2026 [F, PUB-0022], and each figure names its company. Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty operators sit in Part 04 section G.

Each profile gives a one-sentence read, a table across the six areas with the figure, period and reference the document already carries, and the decisive diligence: for a historical operator, what its file tells the live deals it is a comparator for (Part 04 section F); for a live deal, the requests that would most change its profile. A gap is stated as a gap, and no operator is ranked overall (Part 04 section E).

Operator 1

Operator 1's clinic sheets, a decade of clinic-level record (FY08 to LTM Nov-17), show a growing clinic chain holding its margin including rebates while its margin before rebates and its volume per clinic eroded.

Exhibit 9.81 — Operator 1, FY08 to LTM Nov-17: pharmacy volume per clinic fell and four-wall margin before rebates eroded from 15.0% (CY2010) to 9.8% (LTM Nov-17), while rebates rose to 42% of four-wall margin including rebates

The figure the document gives for Operator 1 in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; clinic sheets FY08 to LTM Nov-17, FY2019 audit

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	Pharmacy units per mature clinic fell 3.3%. Comparable retail pharmacy units fell 2.9% in FY09, 2.4%, 3.7% and 2.6% in 2014–16, and 6.3% in the year to November 2017.	FY08–14 (mature-clinic cohort); FY09 to YTD Nov-17 (comparable clinics); actual	OP1-1372, OP1-1378; OP1-2139; OP1-5166..OP1-5168; OP1-5170; Exhibit 9.37
(ii) Pricing power	Comparable ticket rose 11.1% against CPI-U veterinarian services of 11.0%. In 2011 ticket per pharmacy unit rose 11.5% against CPI pet pharmacy products of 5.8% and retail units fell 5.1%; the overshoot reversed in 2012–13. Retail pharmacy gross margin before rebates fell from 27.7% to 20.3%.	2011–16 (ticket); FY08–14 (pharmacy margin); actual; comparable clinics	note C-10; OP1-5145, OP1-5146, OP1-5147, OP1-5163; OP1-1553, OP1-1559

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(iii) Margin consistency	Four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent fell from 15.0% to 9.8% on all clinics and from 15.5% to 12.1% on 92 constant clinics; it was 14.1% in FY08 and 14.1% in FY09. Rebates rose from 16% to 42% of four-wall margin including rebates. Loss-making clinics ran 0.0–10.3%.	CY2010 to LTM Nov-17; FY08–FY09; FY09 to FY17 (rebates, loss share); actual; all clinics, constant clinics, full-year clinics	OP1-5658, OP1-5668; A3-P5-001..A3-P5-004; OP1-2456, OP1-2457; note C-28; note C-22; Exhibit 9.50
(iv) Unit economics	The median full-year clinic earned $242k (FY08) and $269k (FY09) of four-wall before rebates on cash rent, falling to $199k (CY2010) and $152k (CY2016). Single-clinic entries lost money in 24.2% of cases in year 1 and reached 0.80× mature four-wall only in year 5. Organic greenfields cost $369k of clinic capex and returned 72.2% cash-on-cash in year 3 (four clinics) [I].	FY08 to CY2016; clinic years 2009 to Nov-17; actual; cash rent	OP1-2213, OP1-2214; OP1-5322; A4-S0006, A4-S0008; A4-S0049, A4-S0050; OP1-3012, OP1-1501; Exhibit 9.57; Exhibit 9.59
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	+8.8% on total clinic sales and +4.5% on retail in FY09. On the common clinic-level definition −0.3%, −1.6% and −4.0% in 2014–16, against +3.0%, +2.3% and +0.3% as presented to Ares Credit Group. On the common definition +0.4% in CY2019 and +7.0% in CY2022 (last of three in each) and −2.7% in 2020 (first of three).	FY09 to CY2022; actual; comparable clinics, closed clinics leave from the month of closure	OP1-2114, OP1-2115; OP1-5130..OP1-5132; OP1-11168..OP1-11170; OP1-8856; OP1-8857; OP1-8859; Exhibit 4.15
(vi) Cash-flow profile	On the company's maintenance split, 0.79 (0.76–0.83) of adjusted EBITDA remained after maintenance capex over five steady years. The FY2019 audit gives 0.76 on the company split and 0.44 on total capex; cash interest of $105.1m against reported EBITDA of $109.6m left 0.05 before scheduled amortisation.	FY08–FY14, pro forma; FY2019, actual with company split	OP1-0102; OP1-8678, OP1-8634; OP1-8655; note C-60; Exhibit 9.68

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03 and 04 and in Part 09 section J and Part 09 section K; no figure is computed here · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure or our calculation [I]; clinic base and rent basis as stated in each cell. Operator 1 volume series count pharmacy units, not patient visits

Decisive diligence. Operator 1 is a comparator for Deal A on rebates as a share of revenue, conversion on total capex and clinic-rank persistence, not on four-wall level or comparable sales (Exhibit 9.119). Its clinic sheets are the one record of rebate dependence over a decade, margin including rebates moving from 18.7% to 19.9% while margin before rebates fell from 15.0% to 9.8% (CY2010 to LTM Nov-17), which is the question Deal A's falling co-op raises (Part 03 section C).

Operator 2

Operator 2's owned-clinic databook (2018 to LTM Mar-21) shows acquired clinics in their third owned year earning more than those in their first, though the two groups are different clinics, and greenfields ramping slowly, and its Operator 10 chain shows comparable traffic drifting down 1.4% a year over 2006–17.

Exhibit 9.82 — Operator 2, 2006 to FY2025: comparable traffic drifted down and fell 15.1% in 2020, while acquired clinics in their third owned year earned 11.4% four-wall before rebates against 8.1% for those in their first (different clinics)

The figure the document gives for Operator 2 and its Operator 10 seller chain in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; clinic data 2006 to LTM Mar-21, company decks to FY2025

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	Operator 10 comparable patient visits ended at an index of 72.1, −1.4% a year, and patient visits per clinic fell 12.5%. Operator 2's consolidated comparable visit count fell 20.2% in Q2-20 and 15.1% in 2020, and was still −14.0% for LTM Mar-21.	2006–17 and 2007–17 (Operator 10); 2020 to LTM Mar-21 (Operator 2); actual; comparable clinics, closed clinics leave from the month of closure	OP2-0649, OP2-0679; OP2-0515, OP2-0627; OP2-3509, OP2-3526, OP2-3532; Exhibit 9.34
(ii) Pricing power	Owned comparable ticket rose 6.2% in 2019 against CPI-U veterinarian services of 3.4% on traffic of +0.3%; the company attributes it to a pricing programme. Operator 10 ticket rose 10.1% against CPI of 9.0%, and its service margins held at 61.5–61.4%. Rebates fell from 5.1% to 2.9% of revenue.	2019 (Operator 2 owned); 2013–17 and 2015–17 (Operator 10); 2019 to LTM Mar-21 (rebates); actual, attribution is the company's	OP2-1801, OP2-3522; note C-10; OP2-0087, OP2-0123; OP2-3419, OP2-3410; OP2-3467, OP2-3458; Exhibit 9.39
(iii) Margin consistency	Four-wall margin before rebates 8.1% (2018), 8.7% (2019), 12.0% (2020) and 11.8% (LTM Mar-21), rent basis not stated. Loss-making clinics fell from 25.9% to 8.6% as acquired clinics were integrated. Rebates fell from 32% to 16% of four-wall margin including rebates.	2018 to LTM Mar-21; actual; owned clinics	OP2-3414, OP2-3431; OP2-3462; note C-22; OP2-3421, OP2-3469; Exhibit 9.50; Exhibit 9.55
(iv) Unit economics	The median clinic earned $176k of four-wall on $1,122k of sales, a 11.8% margin, across 111 clinics. Acquired clinics in their first owned year (2018, 26 clinics, 26% loss-making) earned 8.1% and those in their third (2020, 55 clinics, 10.8% loss-making) 11.4%; different clinics in each year, not one cohort. Greenfields cost about $254k (company figure); the 2018 and 2019 openings returned 23.5% and 21.6% after maintenance capex [I].	LTM Mar-21; owned years 2018–20; actual; owned clinics, rent basis not stated	OP2-3462; A4-S0272, A4-S0274, A4-S0287, A4-S0289; OP2-1660; OP2-3644, OP2-3647; Exhibit 9.57; Exhibit 9.61

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	On the common definition +6.7% in CY2019 (first of three) and −7.6% in CY2020 (last of three), with 76% of comparable clinics negative in 2020. The Operator 2 lineage averaged +2.4% over the years it shares with Deal A's record. From 2021 comps are on a company definition not stated, with a +0.8% mean in the 2024 to 2026 soft period.	CY2019–20, actual; 2021–25, company definition; comparable clinics	OP2-3520; OP2-3525; A5-S141; note C-43; note C-45; Exhibit 4.15; Exhibit 3.19
(vi) Cash-flow profile	0.60–0.69 of compliance EBITDA remained after total capex in build years, mostly greenfield capex. P&L interest of $70.7m exceeded compliance EBITDA of $68.0m in FY2023. Reported EBITDA rose from $46.4m to $94.6m while the adjustment share fell from 0.37 to 0.21. "One-time" cash costs recurred for up to nine consecutive years.	FY2021–25; compliance EBITDA is a company figure; build years	note C-60; OP2-4629, OP2-4052; note C-61; note C-56; Exhibit 9.68; Exhibit 9.69; Exhibit 3.23

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03 and 04 and in Part 09 section J and Part 09 section K; no figure is computed here · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure or our calculation [I]. Operator 10 figures are the City 9 chain's own data before Operator 2 acquired it; Operator 2 clinic figures cover owned clinics, rent basis not stated

Decisive diligence. Operator 2 is a comparator for Deal A on rebates, clinic-rank persistence and the clinic-margin variance explained by sales level; for Deal B on add-on multiples gross and net of sale-leaseback proceeds and on adjustment share; and for Deal C on adjustment share (Part 04 section F). Its owned-year record groups a platform's acquired clinics by year after purchase: clinics in their first owned year (2018, 26 clinics) earned 8.1% with 26% loss-making, and clinics in their third owned year (2020, 55 clinics) 11.4%; the groups are different clinics, not one cohort followed through time [note C-35]. That record is the test against which acquired cohorts at Deal B and Deal C can be read.

Operator 4 / Operator 9

Operator 4 and Operator 9 (FY23 to Q1-26) show that a veterinary consolidator's centre-level margin can hold while its reported earnings and levered cash turn negative in an acquisition year.

Exhibit 9.83 — Operator 4 and Operator 9, FY23 to Q1-26: Operator 4's service-centre margin rose to 18.7% in 2025 while its reported EBITDA margin fell to −1.4% and cash EBITDA to 0.37 of adjusted EBITDA

The figure the document gives for Operator 4 (Operator 4 HoldCo) and Operator 9 in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; audits FY23 to FY25 and Q1-26; each cell names the company

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	Operator 4: the only volume figure is the lender-labelled "volume" component of same-store sales, +5.9%, −3.4%, +2.6%, +1.0% and +1.0%, with no unit or definition. Operator 9: not in the files supplied.	2021–25; lender figure	OP4-0646 … OP4-0655; Exhibit 9.41
(ii) Pricing power	Operator 4: the lender-labelled "price" component was +5.9%, +8.6%, +1.8%, +2.6% and +1.8%; it is ticket, not price. Rebates rose from 15.0% to 20.2% of pharmacy cost of goods at Operator 4 and from 12.5% to 13.2% at Operator 9.	2021–25 (components); 2023 to 2025 (rebates); actual	OP4-0646 … OP4-0655; OP4-0938, OP4-0942; OP4-0939, OP4-0943; Exhibit 9.42
(iii) Margin consistency	Operator 4: service-centre EBITDA margin 17.6% (2024) and 18.7% (2025) on a constant 192 centres, company basis, rent basis not stated. Reported EBITDA margin 5.1%, 6.3% and −1.4% (2023–25), against 8.5%, 10.1% and 13.3% on adjusted EBITDA (pro forma). Gross margin 40.1% at Operator 4 (CY2025) and 17.8% at Operator 9 (FY25, rebates in cost of goods).	2023 to 2025; actual except adjusted EBITDA	OP4-1491, OP4-1507; OP4-0053, OP4-0103, OP4-1077; OP4-0105; OP4-0384; Exhibit 3.11
(iv) Unit economics	Not in the files supplied on four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent. Operator 4 paid $1,324k per acquired centre in 2021 and $3,208k in 2025, including the Operator 26 scale deal [I]. Its programmatic add-on pool went from 6.0× at close to 3.2× on company-presented, post-integration EBITDA of surviving clinics.	2021, 2025 (price per centre); close to Q1-26 LTM (pool); actual, company-presented	OP4-0765/OP4-0764, OP4-0785/OP4-0784; OP4-0802, OP4-0806; Exhibit 3.15; Exhibit 9.58
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	Operator 4 averaged +4.2% over the years it shares with Deal A's record; it printed +9% in 2012, −6% in 2020, and +4% and +2% in 2024 and 2025. Operator 9 printed +15.3% in the 2021 rebound and +1.8% in 2025. Neither states its definition.	2010–25 (Operator 4); 2021–25 (Operator 9); company definition	note C-43; OP4-0543; OP4-0551; OP4-0555, OP4-0556; Exhibit 3.19; Exhibit 4.11
(vi) Cash-flow profile	Operator 4: in FY2023, a steady year, 0.72 of reported EBITDA remained after maintenance capex on a depreciation proxy [I], and levered free cash before growth was −0.34 of it. In FY2025, with $301.8m of acquisitions, levered free cash before growth was −$53.0m. Cash EBITDA was 0.78 and 0.72 of adjusted EBITDA in FY2023–24, 0.37 in FY2025 and 0.29 for LTM Mar-26 [I]. Operator 9: 0.59 and 0.41 after capex, −0.37 and −0.39 levered.	FY2023 to LTM Mar-26 (Operator 4); FY Sep-24 and Sep-25 (Operator 9); actual	note C-59; note C-60; OP4-0119, OP4-0126; note C-61; OP4-0523, OP4-0525; Exhibit 9.68; Exhibit 9.69

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03 and 04 and in Part 09 section J and Part 09 section K; no figure is computed here · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure or our calculation [I]. Same-store sales, volume and price are company or lender figures with no stated definition; Operator 9's consolidated EBITDA eliminates related-party rent through real-estate entities

Decisive diligence. Operator 4 and Operator 9 are comparators for Deal A on conversion on total capex (Operator 4 FY2023), and Operator 4 for Deal C on add-on multiples and adjustment share (Part 04 section F). Operator 4's audit is the only other audited reported EBITDA in the 2024 to 2026 soft period, and it shows what an acquisition year does to it: −$7.9m reported against $94.1m of pro forma adjusted EBITDA on the credit-agreement definition in FY2025 ($74.2m on the adjusted EBITDA behind the profile's 13.3% margin) [OP4-0103; OP4-1034; OP4-1077].

Operator 5

Operator 5 (2017 to Jun-23) is the clearest evidence in the files that pharmacy price follows cost within the year and that large clinics in one dense market earn a high four-wall margin, though its clinic figures are pro forma.

Exhibit 9.84 — Operator 5, 2017 to Jun-23: comparable tickets were at 76.3% of 2019 in 2022, while pharmacy price recovered about 82% of cost and four-wall margin before rebates held at 13.3–15.0% (pro forma)

The figure the document gives for Operator 5 in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; clinic tickets and units 2017 to Jun-23, clinic P&L CY2020 to LTM Mar-23

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	Comparable tickets fell 2.1% and 0.4% in 2018–19 and 11.4% in 2020, rose 3.6% in 2021, and stood at 76.3% of the 2019 level in 2022 [I]. Retail tickets per clinic fell 11.5%; the comparable-ticket growth rate was −2.3% a year.	2017–22; actual; comparable clinics, closed clinics leave from the month of closure	OP5-3863, OP5-3867; OP5-3871, OP5-3875, OP5-3879; OP5-3827, OP5-3855; note C-02; Exhibit 9.34
(ii) Pricing power	Like-for-like pharmacy price rose 4.4% and 9.1% against clinic cost of 6.8% and 11.8%, recovering 83.5% and 83.5% of the dollar cost increase [I]; pharmacy margin on clinic cost fell from 20.4% (2020) to 16.8% (2022). Clinic labour cost per retail ticket rose 16.1% against average patient invoice growth of 21.9% (pro forma).	2021–22 (matched products, 71–84% of units); 2020–22 (labour); actual except labour	OP5-4450, OP5-4453, OP5-4456, OP5-4459; A2-P5-001..A2-P5-004; OP5-1134, OP5-2011; Exhibit 9.40
(iii) Margin consistency	Four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent 13.3% (2020), 14.6% (2021), 15.0% (2022) and 15.2% (LTM Mar-23), all clinics. Loss-making clinics 0.0–2.1%. Gross margin 50.9% (CY2022). Reported EBITDA margin 9.3%, 9.5% and 9.4% (2020–22).	2020 to LTM Mar-23; pro forma, reported EBITDA actual	OP5-1152, OP5-1585, OP5-2028, OP5-2469; note C-22; OP5-0022; Exhibit 9.50; Exhibit 3.11
(iv) Unit economics	The median clinic earned $494k of four-wall before rebates on cash rent on $3,022k of sales (37 clinics). Greenfields cost $1.13m (City 32) and $1.0m or $1.4m (City 12, sources differ), excluding land and building; City 12 earned $694k in about its second year, 60.0% or 44.0% of capital before maintenance capex (one clinic) [I].	FY22; pro forma	OP5-2050, OP5-2057; OP5-0339; OP5-0342, OP5-0343; OP5-2561; Exhibit 9.57; Exhibit 3.15
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	On the common definition +3.4% (CY2019), −5.6% (2020), +14.1% (2021) and +10.1% (2022); second of three in each of the 2019, 2020 and 2022 rankings, the only operator whose position does not change. 72% of comparable clinics were negative in 2020.	CY2019–22; actual; comparable clinics	OP5-3866; OP5-3870; OP5-3878; A5-S165; Exhibit 4.15; Exhibit 3.19
(vi) Cash-flow profile	0.71–0.76 of adjusted EBITDA remained after maintenance capex on a depreciation proxy [I]; with no debt, 0.63–0.78 became levered free cash before growth. Working capital took $1.1m in FY2021 and $0.6m in FY2022.	FY2020–22; pro forma (0.71–0.76 on reported EBITDA, actual)	note C-59; OP5-0033; OP5-0278, OP5-0279; Exhibit 9.68

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03 and 04 and in Part 09 section J and Part 09 section K; no figure is computed here · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure or our calculation [I]. Clinic P&L figures are pro forma (quality-of-earnings adjusted); 28 of 38 clinics rent from related parties at cash rent

Decisive diligence. Operator 5 is not a Deal A comparator, because its clinic figures are pro forma, its comparable base differs and its data end in 2023 (Part 09 section L, under "05 E Against comparable operators: supporting evidence"); it is not among the comparators of Deal B or Deal C (Part 04 section F). Its four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent, 15.0% in FY22 (pro forma), is one of the two cash-rent figures against which Deal B's cohort margins would be read once restated to before vendor rebates (Exhibit 4.17).

Operator 6

Operator 6 (2021 to TTM Mar-26) shows a small-clinic general practice roll-up whose traffic and ticket both lagged in the soft period, and whose add-on re-rating holds only on synergised, company-presented EBITDA.

Exhibit 9.85 — Operator 6, 2021 to TTM Mar-26: comparable traffic fell 2.0% in 2025 and ticket trailed prices by 5.7 points, while add-ons bought at 4.5× stand at 3.4× only on synergised, company-presented EBITDA

The figure the document gives for Operator 6 in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; company data 2021 to TTM Mar-26, 31 add-ons

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	Comparable traffic −2.0% (2025) and −3.4% (LTM May-26) on all comparable clinics; +2.3% on pre-2023 clinics. First of three in the 2024 to 2026 soft-period traffic ranking, ahead of Operator 3 and Deal A.	2025 to LTM May-26; actual; surviving clinics	OP6-1896, OP6-1952; OP6-1144; Exhibit 9.63
(ii) Pricing power	Comparable ticket trailed CPI-U veterinarian services by 5.7 points, last of three. Comparable ticket was −0.3% in 2025 while clinic labour cost per visit rose 3%: of the two operators where own labour cost can be tested, the one that did not recover it.	2024 to 2026 soft period; 2025 and Q1-25 to Q1-26; actual; pre-2023 clinics	OP6-1146; OP6-0984, OP6-0988; Exhibit 4.15
(iii) Margin consistency	Gross margin: not in the files supplied. Clinic four-wall margin including rebates 16.1%, rebates in cost of goods, rent basis not stated. Reported EBITDA $4.5m with no matching revenue.	LTM Mar-26; pro forma; surviving clinics	OP6-0047; Exhibit 4.11; Part 09 section H
(iv) Unit economics	$1,303k of enterprise value per acquired clinic plus $134–192k of integration and transaction cost (31 add-ons, 46 clinics). Average clinic sales $1,665k and four-wall $326k. Entry at 4.5× seller clinic EBITDA against 3.4× now on synergised, company-presented EBITDA; 9 of 31 deals sit below entry EBITDA. Cash-on-cash 16.1% at entry and 14.1–27.2% after integration [I].	2021 to TTM Mar-26; actual (price), pro forma (EBITDA)	A4-S0368; OP6-1881..OP6-1883; OP6-1731, OP6-1733; A4-S0367; A4-S0362, A4-S0361; A4-S0333, A4-S0343, A4-S0353; Exhibit 9.58
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	On the common definition +1.9% in CY2025 (13 pre-2023 clinics) and +2.9% in CY2024, first of three in the ranking on years ending December 2024 to March 2025; +2.4% mean in the 2024 to 2026 soft period. No comparable year before 2023.	2023 to CY2025; actual; surviving clinics	OP6-1148; OP6-1147; Exhibit 4.15; Exhibit 3.19
(vi) Cash-flow profile	On the company's maintenance split 0.81, 0.85 and 0.85 of adjusted EBITDA remained after maintenance capex. Cash EBITDA was 0.31 of adjusted EBITDA in FY2024, 0.61 in FY2025 and 0.73 for LTM Mar-26 [I]. Transaction cash was 14.1% and 10.1% of price.	FY2024, FY2025, LTM Mar-26; pro forma; company split	OP6-0593, OP6-0663; note C-61; OP6-0632, OP6-0633, OP6-0050; Exhibit 9.69; Exhibit 3.23

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03 and 04 and in Part 09 section J and Part 09 section K; no figure is computed here · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure or our calculation [I]. Comparable figures are on the surviving-clinic list, so closed clinics are absent and each figure is an upper bound; clinic margins are pro forma, rent basis not stated

Decisive diligence. Operator 6 is the closest analogue to Deal B's acquisition programme and a comparator for Deal B on same-store sales, adjustment share and company-split conversion, and for Deal C on same-store sales, adjustment share and add-on multiples (Part 04 section F). Its deal-level file, with 9 of 31 add-ons below entry EBITDA and cash EBITDA rising from 0.31 to 0.73 of adjusted EBITDA (FY2024 to LTM Mar-26), is the test for claims that later acquisition cohorts re-rate.

Operator 3

Operator 3 (Apr-21 to Aug-25) shows margin gains from integration and rebate capture on a surviving-clinic base while comparable traffic still fell.

Exhibit 9.86 — Operator 3, Apr-21 to Aug-25: comparable traffic fell 2.8% on surviving clinics while ticket rose 7.3%, and four-wall margin before rebates rose from 9.0% to 12.4% through integration and rebates

The figure the document gives for Operator 3 in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; clinic datacube Apr-21 to Aug-25 (surviving clinics)

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	Comparable traffic +2.6% (2023), −4.1% (2024) and −2.8% (LTM Aug-25). 21.7 patient visits per clinic-day (YTD Aug-25).	2023 to LTM Aug-25; actual; surviving clinics	OP3-0891; OP3-0907; note C-85; Exhibit 9.39
(ii) Pricing power	Ticket +6.8% against CPI-U veterinarian services of 11.5% (2023) and +6.7% against 5.4% (2024, traffic −4.1%); +7.3% for LTM Aug-25, first of three against prices in the soft period (+2.2 points). Ten labour-rate actions, median +2.9%, have no recorded volume response. Pharmacy-line gross margin fell from 33.1% to 26.0% while dental rose from 60.3% to 66.6%.	2023 to LTM Aug-25; Dec-24 and Jul-25 (rate actions); 2022–23 (pharmacy products), 2022–24 (dental); actual; surviving clinics	OP3-0888; OP3-0892, OP3-0891; OP3-0908; OP3-2362, OP3-2386; OP3-0654, OP3-0686; OP3-0639, OP3-0705
(iii) Margin consistency	Four-wall margin before rebates 9.0% (2023), 11.4% (2024) and 12.4% (LTM Aug-25), and 16.0% including rebates. Rebates rose from 2.4% to 3.7% of revenue. Loss-making clinics 7.9%, 0.0% and 2.0%. Corporate overhead rose from 2.0% to 3.2% of revenue (pro forma).	2023 to LTM Aug-25; actual; surviving clinics	OP3-1012, OP3-1031, OP3-1088; OP3-0132; OP3-1013, OP3-1089; note C-22; OP3-2566, OP3-2568; Exhibit 9.50
(iv) Unit economics	Median clinic margin before rebates 10.1%. Acquired clinics cost $1.0m each (company figure). 18 deals moved from the company's stated average entry multiple of 5.1× (4.6× as the mean of our reads of the chart) to 2.8× on a company chart (pro forma), yet the 2023 cohort's revenue fell 11.4% in its first owned year.	LTM Aug-25; acquisitions 2021–24; May-25 (multiples); actual except as stated	OP3-1095; OP3-1842; OP3-1457..OP3-1492; OP3-1493, OP3-1494; OP3-1110, OP3-1111; Exhibit 9.58
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	On the common definition +2.4% (2024) and +4.2% (LTM Aug-25); first of three in the latest soft-period ranking and second in the earlier one; +12.5% mean in the 2022–23 inflation. No comparable year before 2023.	2023 to LTM Aug-25; actual; surviving clinics	OP3-0890; OP3-0906; Exhibit 4.15; Exhibit 3.19

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(vi) Cash-flow profile	On the company's maintenance split 0.78 (FY23) and 0.86 (FY24) of adjusted EBITDA remained after maintenance capex, 0.78 and 0.81 on total capex. Cash EBITDA held at 0.81–0.83 of adjusted EBITDA while reported EBITDA rose from $3.9m to $12.5m [I]. Acquisition costs recurred 2023–25, at 2.7% and 6.3% of price.	FY2023 to LTM May-25; pro forma; company split	OP3-2160, OP3-1201; note C-61; OP3-1146..OP3-1148; Exhibit 9.68; Exhibit 9.69

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03 and 04 and in Part 09 section J and Part 09 section K; no figure is computed here · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure or our calculation [I]. The datacube holds surviving clinics only, so comparable figures are upper bounds; rent basis not stated

Decisive diligence. Operator 3 is a comparator for all three deals: for Deal A, the only peer with comparable traffic, ticket and same-store sales on the same surviving-clinic definition in an overlapping period, where Deal A sits below it on all three (Exhibit 9.123); for Deal B on same-store sales, company-split conversion and adjustment share; and for Deal C on same-store sales, adjustment share and add-on multiples (Part 04 section F). Because its datacube holds surviving clinics only, Operator 3's −2.8% traffic (LTM Aug-25) is an upper bound, like Deal A's.

Operator 7 (ST-22 segment)

Operator 7 State 05 segment (Jan-23 to Jun-26) shows the highest actual four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent in the set, on ten clinics, below-market rent and an undefined visit count.

Exhibit 9.87 — Operator 7 ST-22 segment, Jan-23 to Jun-26: four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent held between 14.6% and 16.1% with no loss-making clinics, while 2025 traffic growth of 12.4% rests on an undefined visit count

The figure the document gives for Operator 7 State 05 segment in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; quality-of-earnings clinic P&L Jan-23 to Jan-26, KPIs Jan-24 to Jun-26

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	Comparable visit count +10.9% (2025) and +4.7% (LTM Jun-26), concentrated in State 05 clinics acquired in 2021–23. The visit count definition is not stated.	2025 to LTM Jun-26; seller-period data; comparable clinics, closed clinics leave from the month of closure	OP7-1023; OP7-0909; Exhibit 9.63
(ii) Pricing power	Ticket flat, +0.3% (2025) and +0.1% (LTM Jun-26), while traffic grew. A wellness-exam promotion raised discounts from 3.0% to 5.6% of net sales. Rebates 0.6% (2023) and 1.3% (2025) of revenue.	2023 to LTM Jun-26; actual	OP7-1024, OP7-1048; OP7-006; OP7-0004, OP7-0001, OP7-0022, OP7-0019; Part 03 section B
(iii) Margin consistency	Four-wall margin before rebates on cash rent 16.1% (2023), 14.6% (2024) and 15.9% (2025), all State 05 clinics; below-market related-party rent flatters it by about 0.3–0.4 points of sales. Gross margin 41.9% (CY2025, rebates in cost of goods). Reported EBITDA margin 8.9%, 9.9% and 12.0% (2023–25).	2023–25; actual; 7, 8 and 10 clinics	note C-24; OP7-0346..OP7-0384; OP7-0550, OP7-0554, OP7-0558; OP7-0020, OP7-0019; OP7-0021; Exhibit 9.50; Exhibit 3.11
(iv) Unit economics	Full-year clinics: median four-wall $433k on $2,656k of average sales, 16.1% (9 clinics, FY25), and $418k on $2,077k (5 clinics, FY23); no loss-making clinics. The 2023 cohort's four-wall was 13.8% at acquisition and 19.5% at May-26; the 2024–25 cohort's 14.7% and 14.1% (company definition). Capital per clinic not in the files supplied.	FY23, FY25, May-26; actual; cash rent	OP7-0516, OP7-0517, OP7-0515; OP7-0500, OP7-0501; OP7-0514; OP7-1085, OP7-1086, OP7-1088, OP7-1089; Exhibit 9.57
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	On the common definition +11.4% (2025) and +4.8% (LTM Jun-26), against about 5.8% in an Ares Credit Group memo with no stated definition. No comparable year before 2025, and in no ranking.	2025 to LTM Jun-26; seller-period data	OP7-1022; OP7-1046; OP7-1079; Exhibit 9.64
(vi) Cash-flow profile	0.63 (ST-22 FY2024), 0.73 (ST-22 FY2025) and 0.71 (ST-70 FY2025) of reported EBITDA remained after total capex, on management figures before the acquisition. Adjustments are 0.03 of adjusted EBITDA (ST-22 FY2025). Levered free cash: not in the files supplied (no cash tax, interest or amortisation).	FY2024–25; management figures	note C-60; OP7-0021, OP7-0061; Exhibit 9.68; Exhibit 9.69

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03 and 04 and in Part 09 section J and Part 09 section K; no figure is computed here · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure or our calculation [I]. Clinic rent is related-party cash rent below go-forward rent; comparable figures are seller-period data before the combination

Decisive diligence. Operator 7 enters the Deal B comparison on one figure only (Part 04 section F): its 16.1% on nine full-year clinics (FY25) is the other cash-rent figure against which Deal B's cohort margins would be read once restated to before vendor rebates (Exhibit 4.17), and its visit count definition (OP7-005) decides whether its +10.9% traffic in 2025 can be read as care demand.

Operator 8

Operator 8 (2021 to LTM Mar-26) shows positive traffic and comparable sales on a newly assembled base, with acquired units short of their underwriting and reported EBITDA near zero after transaction costs.

Exhibit 9.88 — Operator 8, 2021 to LTM Mar-26: positive traffic and comparable sales in 2025 sit on a newly assembled base, and acquired units delivered 0.59× and 0.70× of the pro forma EBITDA used to price them

The figure the document gives for Operator 8 in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; clinic P&L 2021 to LTM Mar-26, clinic-year volume 2021–24

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	Comparable visit count +7.4% (21 units, days not adjusted). Pharmacy units rose 15.2% in 2023, a parasite-season-driven swing. Volume per patient invoice rose 1.0% a year.	2025; 2023; 2021–23 (mature clinics); actual	OP8-2114; OP8-0654; OP8-0547, OP8-0549, OP8-0555; Exhibit 9.63
(ii) Pricing power	The switch from dollar to percentage pharmacy markup added +12.0% (sources differ: 12%) on volume of +0.3% (2022); price +2.6% on volume +4.1% (2023, mainly labour rates); ticket −1.0% (2025). Rebates 3.7% (FY2024) and 3.0% (LTM Mar-26) of revenue.	2022 to LTM Mar-26; actual; mature clinics and comparable clinics	OP8-0545, OP8-0543, OP8-0120; OP8-0546, OP8-0544; OP8-2115; OP8-2092, OP8-2102; Exhibit 9.41
(iii) Margin consistency	Four-wall margin before rebates 7.9% (2022) and 8.6% (2023) on cash rent, then 8.8% (2024), 10.9% (2025) and 10.8% (LTM Mar-26), rent basis not stated. Gross margin 50.8% (CY2025). Reported EBITDA margin 2.9% (2025; sources differ: 10.4%) and 0.5% (LTM Mar-26), against 9.2% on adjusted EBITDA (pro forma). Loss-making clinics 6.9% and 8.8% (2024–25).	2022 to LTM Mar-26; actual except adjusted EBITDA; all clinics	OP8-2762/OP8-1362; OP8-2091, OP8-2101; OP8-2098; OP8-1880, OP8-1781; note C-22; Exhibit 9.50
(iv) Unit economics	Median clinic margin before rebates 10.4% (2025, comparable clinics). Eleven new units delivered 0.59× their pro forma run-rate EBITDA and the 2023–24 cohort 0.70× its underwriting. Revenue per veterinarian $278k (LTM Nov-23). No new build executed; $422k per clinic planned.	FY24, FY25 (cohorts); pro forma run-rate against actual	OP8-2127; OP8-1701..OP8-1703; OP8-2209..OP8-2211; note C-85; Exhibit 9.79
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	On the common definition +11.8% in CY2022 (first of three) and +6.2% in 2025, a +5.3% mean in the 2024 to 2026 soft period; 15.0% in 2022 on an alternative base that includes 2021 acquisitions. No comparable year before 2021.	2021–25; actual; comparable clinics	OP8-1714; OP8-2106; Exhibit 4.15; Exhibit 3.19
(vi) Cash-flow profile	On the company's maintenance split 0.73 (FY22) and 0.80 (LTM Nov-23) of adjusted EBITDA remained after maintenance capex. Cash EBITDA was 0.24 of as-owned adjusted EBITDA ($12.1m, LTM Mar-26), the perimeter it is built on [I]; reported EBITDA was $0.7m (sources differ: $9.0m) against $23.8m of adjusted EBITDA pro forma for acquisitions through May-26. Transaction cash was 6.7% of price (FY2025).	FY22 to TTM Mar-26; pro forma; company split	OP8-0743, OP8-0859, OP8-0744, OP8-0781; note C-61; OP8-2015, OP8-1880; OP8-1812..OP8-1820; OP8-2409; Exhibit 9.68; Exhibit 9.69

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03 and 04 and in Part 09 section J and Part 09 section K; no figure is computed here · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure or our calculation [I]. Clinic figures are on cash rent to 2023 and on a rent basis not stated from 2024, when acquired units are pooled with the base

Decisive diligence. Operator 8 is a comparator for Deal B as the only peer that measures acquired units against the pro forma EBITDA used to price them, and for Deal B and Deal C on adjustment share, and Deal C on company-split conversion (Part 04 section F). Its delivery of 0.69× and 0.70× of underwriting (FY24, FY25) is the measure against which Deal B's cohorts are read in Part 06 section B.

The three live deals on the same six areas

Deal A

Deal A's audited record, the longest in the files (FY1996 to Q1 FY27), shows a large general practice and pharmacy estate whose visits, clinic profit and reported margin fell together in the 2024 to 2026 soft period, with a third of clinics losing money before co-op in every year from FY23 to FY26.

Exhibit 9.89 — Deal A, FY1996 to Q1 FY27: retained clinics lost 26% of visits from March 2020 to June 2026, a third of clinics lost money before co-op in each of FY23–FY26, and reported EBITDA margin fell from 12.0% to 6.2% (FY22–FY26)

The figure the document gives for Deal A in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; Forms 10-K FY1996 to FY26 and Q1 FY27 10-Q, clinic EBITDA FY23–23, clinic KPIs FY20 to Q1 FY27; operating measures only

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	Retained clinics' visits fell from 4.60m (LTM March 2020) to 3.25m (LTM March 2026), 25%, and to 3.16m (LTM June 2026), 26%. Comparable traffic fell 3.9%, 7.9% and 3.9% in FY24–FY26 and 4.2% in Q1 FY27. Patient visits per clinic fell 37.2% on all clinics.	LTM March 2020 to LTM June 2026 and Q1 FY27 (surviving clinics); FY17–23 (all clinics); actual	DLA-0562, DLA-0762, DLA-4967; DLA-0725, DLA-0757, DLA-0789; DLA-3246, DLA-3281; Part 05 section B; Exhibit 9.37

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(ii) Pricing power	Comparable ticket rose 3.0%, 4.1% and 5.4% against CPI-U veterinarian services of 10.0%, 5.1% and 5.4% (FY24–FY26); average patient invoice +3.0% in Q1 FY27. Generic-equivalent pharmacy products rose from 16.1% to 27.6% of units while pharmacy ASP fell 1.8%. Co-op fell from 6.7% to 5.1% of sales.	FY24 to Q1 FY27; Q1 FY26 to Q1 FY27 (generic share; the Q1 FY27 unit count looks model-derived); FY22–FY26 (co-op); actual; surviving clinics	DLA-0726, DLA-0758, DLA-0790; DLA-2803, DLA-2726, DLA-2807, DLA-2730; DLA-3340, DLA-0846; Part 05 section B
(iii) Margin consistency	Reported EBITDA margin 12.0% (FY22) to 6.2% (FY26). Clinic EBITDA margin before co-op 7.9% (FY26), 5.4% with finance-lease cost at book. 31.4%, 27.2%, 34.3% and 28.7% of clinics lost money (FY23–FY26). Gross margin 32.5% (FY20) to 31.2% (FY26); corporate overhead 3.0% (FY17) to 4.7% (FY26) of revenue.	FY17 to FY26; actual; loss share on all clinics open at each year-end, clinic EBITDA before co-op	DLA-0251, DLA-0317; DLA-0834; DLA-0857/DLA-0017; A3-P5-006..A3-P5-009; DLA-0042, DLA-0054; DLA-1350, DLA-1223; Exhibit 3.11
(iv) Unit economics	The median clinic earned $52k of clinic EBITDA on $919k of sales, a 5.9% median margin, across 983 open clinics; average clinic sales sit below every core peer. Clinic sales level explains 29.8% and 34.3% of clinic-margin variance, region 4.0% and 6.7%, pharmacy share 0.3% and 1.6%. Acquisitions cost 0.69× (FY13) to 1.00× (FY22) of seller sales.	FY26 (clinic EBITDA before co-op, operating-lease rent only); FY23 and FY26 (variance); actual	DLA-0859; A4-S0213; A4-S0269; A4-S0206, A4-S0217, A4-S0207, A4-S0218, A4-S0208, A4-S0219; Exhibit 9.57; Exhibit 3.15
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	Public comparable sales averaged +0.5% over 18 fiscal years with nine negative years; +1.0% and +5.9% in FY08–FY09, −9.5% in FY21 and +13.2% in FY22. On the common definition −4.1% (FY25) and +1.1% (FY26), last of three in both soft-period rankings.	FY06 to FY26; public definition, all clinics; common definition on surviving clinics; actual	DLA-0336..DLA-0363; note C-43; DLA-0338, DLA-0340; DLA-0356, DLA-0357; DLA-0756, DLA-0788; Exhibit 4.15
(vi) Cash-flow profile	After total capex, a median 0.64 (0.53–0.72) of reported EBITDA remained over 20 steady years; 0.52 in FY26 and 0.44 excluding $16.0m of disposal gains; 0.47 excluding gains for LTM Jun-26. Cash after interest and finance-lease principal is read in Part 08 section B.	FY2000 to LTM Jun-26; actual; total capex as the upper bound for maintenance	note C-62; A6-P5-003, A6-P5-004; Exhibit 9.67; Part 05 section F

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03, 04 and 05 and in Part 09 section J, Part 09 section K and Part 09 section L; no figure is computed here. The proposed financing is read in Part 08 section B · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure or our calculation [I]. Comparable figures are on the 983 clinics that survive to August 2026, so they are upper bounds; clinic EBITDA carries operating-lease rent only

Decisive diligence. On the one like-for-like comparison, with Operator 3 on surviving-clinic traffic, ticket and same-store sales, Deal A is last (Part 05 section E). The requests in Part 05 section G that would most change this profile are the July–September 2026 actuals (request 1), which would show whether the decline has stopped, and clinic KPIs for the clinics closed since FY20 (request 8), which would rebuild comparable traffic with closed clinics in the base. Its financing is read in Part 08 section B.

Deal B

Deal B's general practice and preventive operations (clinic data from January 2023) show ticket-led comparable sales inside the peer range, newer cohorts that start better, and four-wall margin on cash rent at the bottom of the peer range.

Exhibit 9.90 — Deal B's general practice and preventive operations, 2024 to Aug-26: comparable sales rose 4.7% in 2025 on ticket while traffic fell, and the 103 surviving clinics earned 10.73% four-wall on cash rent (LTM Mar-26)

The figure the document gives for Deal B's general practice and preventive operations (DLB) in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; clinic data Jan-23 to Aug-26; DBW excluded; operating measures only

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	On the common definition comparable traffic −9.3% (2024), −2.6% (2025) and −3.8% (LTM Jul-26). The company's weekday-aligned comparable traffic was −6.2% (Q1-26), −5.7% (Q2-26) and −3.3% (Jul–Aug-26). The 2025 cohort lost 19.5% of patient visits in its first six owned months against the seller's same months.	2024 to Aug-26; common definition actual, closed clinics leave from the month of closure; company series pro forma; seller months are seller-system data	DLB-1361..DLB-1364; DLB-1406..DLB-1409; DLB-1516..DLB-1519; A1-S037, A1-S038, A1-S039; DLB-2154..DLB-2156; Exhibit 9.142
(ii) Pricing power	Comparable ticket +6.3% (2024), +7.6% (2025) and +7.5% (LTM Jul-26) on the common definition; the 2025 figure is 0.4 points above the highest peer. The 2025 cohort's ticket rose 9.9% in its first six owned months. Rebates are 0.99% (FY25) and 0.78% (LTM Mar-26) of revenue.	2024 to LTM Jul-26; actual	DLB-1361..DLB-1364; DLB-1406..DLB-1409; DLB-1516..DLB-1519; DLB-2154..DLB-2156; DLB-3448; DLB-3468; Part 06 section G
(iii) Margin consistency	Four-wall margin after rebates on cash rent 10.73% for the 103 surviving clinics and 8.4% before any shared-services adjustment for the 46 clinics owned at least 21 months, against 10.7–17.4% at cash-rent peers; before rebates it cannot be stated by cohort. 18 of 103 clinics lost money on that basis; 21 of 103 on the company four-wall (LTM Jul-26).	LTM Mar-26 and LTM Jul-26; company datapack; surviving clinics	DLB-3177; DLB-3203; DLB-3558; DLB-3573; Exhibit 6.20
(iv) Unit economics	Cohort four-wall after rebates on cash rent 7.4% (2022), 9.8% (2023), 8.8% (2024) and 17.6% (2025, twelve or fewer owned months). On twelve owned months the 2022–24 cohorts delivered 0.44×, 0.90× and 0.52× of seller closing EBITDA; in the first owned year 0.55× (2023), 0.76× (2024) and 0.71× (2025). The H1-2024 deals fell from 0.48× in year one to 0.23× in year two.	LTM Mar-26 (margins); LTM Jul-26 and owned years (delivery); seller EBITDA pro forma [I]	DLB-3255; DLB-3307; DLB-3346; DLB-3372; DLB-0114/DLB-7667; DLB-0142/DLB-7682; DLB-0166/DLB-7697; note C-87; Exhibit 9.128

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	On the common definition −3.9% (2024), +4.7% (2025) and +3.3% (LTM Jul-26), inside the 1.1–6.2% range of 2025-period peers. By cohort for LTM Jul-26: 2022 +4.4%, 2023 +6.8%, 2024 −0.7%. The company's weekday-aligned series gives +8.1% (2025, 42 clinics) and +4.43% (LTM Jul-26). No comparable year before 2024.	2024 to LTM Jul-26; common definition actual; company series pro forma	DLB-1361; DLB-1406; DLB-1516; DLB-1531; DLB-1536; DLB-1541; DLB-0239; DLB-0241; Exhibit 6.18
(vi) Cash-flow profile	For the general practice and preventive operations alone: not in the files supplied. For the consolidated company, DBW included: reported EBITDA −$5.1m, −$12.0m, −$3.2m and −$4.0m (2023 to LTM Mar-26), and −$0.19m for LTM Jul-26 once $1.38m of gains is removed; after maintenance capex of about $38k per general practice and preventive clinic (LTM Jul-26; the model books all of it to that segment), 0.46 (FY2025) and 0.37–0.59 (LTM Jul-26, by rung) of adjusted EBITDA remained, below every peer.	2023 to LTM Jul-26; reported EBITDA actual; adjusted EBITDA pro forma, company maintenance split	DLB-5052..DLB-5055; DLB-5644; DLB-9108; A6-P5-008..A6-P5-010; DLB-5645; Exhibit 9.133

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03, 04 and 06 and in Part 09 section J, Part 09 section K and Part 09 section M; no figure is computed here. DBW is read in Part 06 section F; the proposed financing in Part 08 section C · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure or our calculation [I]. Clinic figures come from the company's datapack on surviving clinics; company-definition comps are pro forma; row (vi) is consolidated and says so

Deal B Wellness Clinics, Deal B's wellness clinic segment, is excluded from rows (i) to (v) of this profile; row (vi) is consolidated, DBW included, because the files supplied give no cash-flow split, and DBW is read on its own in Part 06 section F.

Decisive diligence. The requests in Part 06 section H that would most change this profile are the August 2026 quality-of-earnings roll-forward with the split between the general practice and preventive business and DBW (request 1), which would give row (vi) a figure for these operations alone, and a key from each acquisition to the datapack clinic IDs (request 4), which would put cohort delivery on a deal-by-deal basis. Its financing is read in Part 08 section C.

Deal C

Deal C (site data from January 2022, audited FY2025) shows a high, broad clinic margin on a young platform whose same-store sales and clinic EBITDA turned down in 2026 and whose deal costs hold cash EBITDA to about a third of pro forma (E3) EBITDA.

Exhibit 9.91 — Deal C, FY2023 to LTM Jul-26: the audited clinic margin of 21.3–22.3% (FY2025) is high and broad, but same-store sales fell to −3.2% in Q2 2026 and cash EBITDA was 0.31 of pro forma (E3) EBITDA (FY2025)

The figure the document gives for Deal C in each of Ares Credit Group's six areas, with period, basis and reference; 2025 audit, site-level database Jan-22 to Jul-26, company KPIs; operating measures only

AREA	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	PERIOD AND BASIS	REFERENCE
(i) Volume consistency	The company's comparable visit count fell 1.0% (FY2023), 5.2% (FY2024) and 1.6% (LTM Jun-26) and rose 0.1% (FY2025); pharmacy comps were −1.2%, −2.9%, −4.7% and −4.3%. The supplied documents give no common-definition traffic: the site database carries no visit counts.	FY2023 to LTM Jun-26; company definition [M], working-day and blackout adjusted, seller months in the base	DLC-2944/3004/3064/3100; DLC-2663/2728/2793/2832; Part 07 section B
(ii) Pricing power	The company's revenue per visit rose 4.2%, 11.5%, 4.1% and 3.3% over the same periods. Vendor rebates rose from 0.8–1.0% of gross sales (FY2023–24) to 1.32% (six months to April 2026) [M]. On matched sites gross margin rose 591bp and clinic EBITDA margin 145bp (2023–25 cohorts pooled).	FY2023 to LTM Jun-26; company figures [M]; matched sites pro forma	DLC-2946/3006/3066/3102; DLC-3734/3735/3736; DLC-1201/1202, 1068/1210, 1042/1218, 1065/1226, 1047/1234, 1091/1242; Exhibit 7.06
(iii) Margin consistency	Clinic margin after rebates 21.3% on book rent and 22.3% on cash rent (FY2025, audit-tied); before rebates on cash rent it cannot be stated. On owned months 21.6% (LTM Jul-26, pro forma). The 55 clinics owned before 2025 fell from 21.1% to 20.4% (January–July 2025 to 2026).	FY2025 audited; LTM Jul-26 and Jan–Jul 2026 pro forma	DLC-0018; DLC-5013/5014; DLC-0421; DLC-1195/1194; Part 07 section B
(iv) Unit economics	On 60 clinics owned all twelve months the median clinic earns $342k, the interquartile range of clinic margins is 13.1–24.2% and 5.2% of clinics lose money. 38 of 86 clinics earned above 21% and produced $28.0m of $43.6m of clinic EBITDA. On the same definition the 2024 cohort earned 27.9% in CY2024, when 9 of its 15 clinics were owned for full months, against 17.9% on all 15 in LTM July 2026. The 30 tuck-ins moved from 3.25× to 2.95× (company-presented, net of sale-leaseback proceeds).	LTM Jul-26; pro forma (seller months included in the 86-clinic split)	DLC-0842; DLC-4137..DLC-4164; DLC-0513; DLC-0705; DLC-3427/3428; Part 07 section C
(v) Same-store sales in different environments	On the common definition +7.2% (April–December 2024), +4.5% (CY2025), −0.4% (LTM Jul-26) and −3.2% (Q2 2026); same-store clinic EBITDA −5.8% (LTM Jul-26). The company series gives +5.9% (FY2024), +4.2% (FY2025) and +1.6% (LTM May-26). The platform is three and a half years old, with no downturn history.	2024 to LTM Jul-26; common definition on surviving clinics; company series [M]	DLC-0982; DLC-0985; DLC-0994; DLC-1022; DLC-0996; DLC-2723; DLC-2788; DLC-2827; DLC-0327
(vi) Cash-flow profile	On the company's maintenance split 0.76 of adjusted EBITDA remained after maintenance capex (FY2025, pro forma). Reported EBITDA was $4.7m (FY2025). Cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs was $8.3m (FY2025) and $8.6m (LTM Apr-26), 0.31 and 0.28 of pro forma (E3) EBITDA [I]. Transaction expense was 31.2% of purchase consideration in FY2025, 13.2% without affiliate bonuses.	FY2025 to LTM Apr-26; audited, company split and our calculation	DLC-4425; DLC-005-000567; DLC-0019; DLC-4437; DLC-4439; Part 07 section D; Exhibit 9.69

Source: the rows and exhibits in the Reference column, as shown in Parts 03, 04 and 07 and in Part 09 section J, Part 09 section K and Part 09 section N; no figure is computed here. The proposed financing is read in Part 08 section D · Basis: Actual unless a cell says pro forma, company figure [M] or our calculation [I]. Site-database figures are management-adjusted and read as pro forma; traffic and ticket exist only on the company's definitions

Decisive diligence. The requests in Part 07 section G that would most change this profile are August–September 2026 same-store sales and same-store clinic EBITDA on the common definition (request 6), which would show whether the 2026 fall continues, and the affiliate transaction-bonus agreements with their status after close (request 2), which decide whether cash EBITDA stays near a third of pro forma (E3) EBITDA. Its financing is read in Part 08 section D.

04 E Rankings and limits: supporting evidence

The rankings cover volume, pricing, same-store sales and add-on valuation only, and ranks move between environments: Operator 2 is first on same-store sales in CY2019 and last in CY2020, and only Operator 5 holds one position, second in all three calendar rankings. On the evidence supplied to date clinic scale is the measure most closely associated with clinic margin across operators, accounting for 24–50% of its variance in five of eight datasets, while Deal A's traffic and loss-making tail and Operator 4's FY25 earnings are company-specific.

No operator appears in enough common-definition rankings to be ranked overall, and ranks do not carry across environments [Exhibit 4.15]. Operator 2 is first on SSS_CD in CY2019 and last in CY2020; Operator 1 is last in CY2019 and CY2022 but first in COVID20; Operator 5 is second in all three calendar rankings, the only stable position, on POS data that end in 2022 [note C-83]. Persistence of SSS leadership from INFL22-23 to SOFT24-26 is at most weak (Spearman 0.39, n=10, not significant, on month-majority cycle tags; 0.16 on period-end tags).

Four areas cannot be ranked because no definition is shared by three operators in one environment. For A3 margins, at most two actual R-CASH D1.1 operators exist in any year (2023: Operator 8 8.6% and Operator 7 ST-22 16.1%), and consolidated E1 margins carry three different lease treatments (Deal A finance leases below E1, Operator 9 related-party rent eliminated through VIEs, everyone else operating rent inside E1), so ranking them would pool across rent treatments [OP8-2762/OP8-1362]. For A4 unit economics, the only common definition (D1.1, R-CASH, full-year clinics) has three operators on two bases with no overlapping period: Operator 1 FY08 to CY2016 (A), Operator 5 FY20–20 (PF) and Operator 7 ST-22 FY23–21 (A) [OP1-2507, OP1-5757; OP5-1171, OP5-2047; OP7-0495, OP7-0511]. For A6 cash flow, CONV_1 on total capex and E1 exists for four platforms, but three of them give one year each (Operator 1 FY2019, Operator 4 FY2023, Operator 9 FY Sep-25) beside Deal A's annual series, so no more than two share any year, and lease treatments in E1 differ, and levered conversion is set by the capital structure rather than operations [note C-55]. For A8 leverage, the earnings rungs and debt bases differ between prints, and no three historical operators share one in one environment (Part 04 section B); the live deals' leverage is read in Part 08.

Strongest (described, not ranked). Operator 5 is second in all three calendar SSS_CD rankings, carries D1.1 of 15.0–15.0% on R-CASH with loss-making clinics at 0.0–2.1% (0.0% on full-period clinics, up to 2.1% on all clinics), converts 64–76% of EBITDA to levered free cash after net interest of $1.6m in FY2020 and $0.3m in FY2021 (net interest income in FY2022) [OP5-0053, OP5-0054, OP5-0055], and is the only operator with a true like-for-like pharmacy price series [OP5-1152, OP5-2028; OP5-1177, OP5-2053; Exhibit 9.55; OP5-4450..OP5-4459]. The reasons are a dense single home market, large clinics ($2.9m AUV) and a pharmacy-plus-service mix with separable rebates; the caveats are that every clinic figure is PF, the data end mid-2023 and no Operator 5 leverage figure is stated in the evidence [OP5-2057; Part 04 section B]. Operator 7 ST-22 shows the highest actual R-CASH D1.1 (16.1% FY25 on nine full-year clinics), no loss-making clinics, E1 margin 12.0% and positive SOFT24-26 traffic, but it is in no ranking because its related-party rent is below market (−0.3 to −0.4pp at go-forward rent), its visit count is undefined and it has ten clinics [OP7-0515; OP7-0514; OP7-0021; OP7-1023]. Operator 3 is first in R4, R9 and R10 and second in R2 and R8, which we attribute to integration, rebate capture (rebates 2.4% → 3.7% of revenue) and repricing of acquired clinics; the caveats are the survivor datacube, R-UNK rent and comp traffic that is still negative (−2.8%) [OP3-1013, OP3-1089; OP3-0907].

Weakest (described, not ranked). Deal A is last in R2, R8 and R9, and second of three in R4 only because Operator 6's ticket fell 5.7 points against CPI [note C-83]. A third of its clinics are loss-making before co-op on R-OPONLY (28.7% FY26; 31.4 / 27.2 / 34.3 / 28.7% FY23–23 on the all-clinic basis) and E1 fell 38% from FY24 to FY26 on D3 E1 ($128.2m → $71.2m) [DLA-0862]; Deal A's leverage and coverage are read in Part 08 section B. We attribute the gap to company-specific execution — survivor traffic falling about 6% a year FY19–23, roughly twice the peer trend — a dispersed estate of small clinics (AUV $0.93m, below every core peer) and dependence on falling co-op, which equals 0.71× FY26 D3 E1 (0.96× ex-gains) [A4-S0269; DLA-0846/DLA-0317]. Operator 4 carries LV1 of 9.68× on E1 (FY24), with FY25 E1 negative, levered free cash before growth of −$53.0m and cash EBITDA at 0.29 of the top adjusted rung (LTM Mar-26); its FY25 is a build year ($301.8m of acquisitions), so the steady-state reading is FY23 (CONV_3 −0.34) [OP4-1394; OP4-0103; OP4-0134].

At one end of a ranking, without the wider record to match (described, not ranked). Operator 8 is first in R7 and one of two positive CLOSE-FWD SSS readings in SOFT24-26, but on a newly assembled base, with E1 near zero after transaction costs (sources differ), acquired units at 0.59× and 0.70× of their underwriting and leverage that rose from about 1× to 5.3× in 13 months, so it is not among the strongest [OP8-1714; OP8-1781; OP8-1703,

OP8-2211; OP8-0069, OP8-2344]. Operator 12, a chain later acquired by Operator 2, is last in R1 and R3 on its own 2015–17 data, with no explanation in the files; two rankings in one environment on a seller's pre-acquisition data do not make it one of the weakest operators [note C-83, R3].

What is durable across these descriptions is flat comp visits, ticket-led revenue, rebate-dependent pharmacy margins, persistent clinic ranks within a platform and first-lien leverage near 5×; what is temporary is the COVID20 shock and REOPEN21 rebound, the INFL22-23 ticket surge and the REOPEN21 leverage peak; and what is company-specific is Deal A's traffic and loss tail, Operator 1's 2010–17 D1.1 erosion, the post-acquisition repricing at Operator 8 and Operator 3, and Operator 4's FY25 E1 [Part 09 section J and this section, under "Durable, temporary, company-specific"]. Clinic scale (AUV) is the measure most closely associated with clinic margin in the cross-section, accounting for 24–50% of clinic-margin variance in five of eight datasets, while mix explains 8% or less and overhead shows no scale advantage [note C-29; note C-19].

Exhibit 9.92 — 2021 to 2026: three figures used in the rankings or the strongest and weakest reading depend on a basis choice or a count; no rank order depends on either

Figures with an alternative basis or count, the basis used in this document and its source, core operators, periods as stated, 2021 to 2026

ITEM	ALTERNATIVE BASIS OR COUNT	BASIS USED IN THIS REPORT	SOURCE
Operator 2 Sponsor 1 LBO, LV1 at close (REOPEN21 peak)	5.97× gross / 6.05× net cited to the OP2-3732 note; company figure 5.85× (OP2-3731, LEV_ST-59 on LTM Q3-21 PF $48.3m)	5.97× gross on the at-close LTM Jun-21 PF $47.5m (row P5-S001); REOPEN21 LV1 gross band median 5.14×, max 5.97×	P5-S001
Deal A loss-making clinic share	FY24 / FY25: 19.4% / 26.8% on the clinics that survive to FY26 vs 27.2% / 34.3% on all clinics open at each year-end; FY26 28.7% on both; FY26 19.5% with co-op allocated to clinics at 5.15% of clinic sales (Ares Credit Group's basis; Part 05 section E)	All clinics open at each year-end, before co-op: 31.4 / 27.2 / 34.3 / 28.7% FY23–23, no rising trend; the surviving-clinic figures are a sensitivity	note C-22
Operator 6 add-on re-rating (input to R10)	23 of 31 deals re-rated down, 8 up (a count the deal-level data do not reproduce)	23 down, 9 up; R10 value 3.50×	OP6-1731, OP6-1733

Source: the rows and notes cited in the last column

Ranking validity

The ranking-validity table records, area by area, which definition was attempted, how many operators share it and why a description replaced a ranking. Four areas carry at least one ranking (A1, A2, A5, A7) and four are described only (A3, A4, A6, A8); every one of the 10 rankings rests on one environment [Exhibit 9.93].

Exhibit 9.93 — 2008 to 2026: rankings exist only where three operators share one definition in one environment; margins, unit economics and cash flow are described

Definition attempted, number of operators sharing it and market environments, by analytical area, and whether it is ranked or described, 2008 to 2026

AREA	DEFINITION ATTEMPTED	N OPERATORS	ENVIRONMENTS	RANKED / DESCRIBED
A1 volume	SSS_TRAFFIC_CD, CLOSE-FWD, A, chained 2015–17	4	EXP10-19	Ranked (R1)
A1 volume	SSS_TRAFFIC_CD, CLOSE-RETRO, A, latest	3	SOFT24-26	Ranked (R2)
A1 volume	SSS_TRAFFIC_CD, CLOSE-FWD, SOFT24-26	2 (Operator 8, Operator 7)	SOFT24-26	Described
A1 volume	SSS_TRAFFIC_CD, CLOSE-FWD, CY2020	2 (Operator 2, Operator 5)	COVID20	Described
A1 volume	VOL_VISITS_PER_STORE trend	5	windows do not overlap	Described
A2 pricing	SSS_TICKET_CD − CPI, CLOSE-FWD, 2015–17	4	EXP10-19	Ranked (R3)
A2 pricing	SSS_TICKET_CD − CPI, CLOSE-RETRO, latest	3	SOFT24-26	Ranked (R4)
A2 pricing	Like-for-like / explicit price	1 each (Operator 5, Operator 8, Operator 3)	REOPEN21–SOFT24-26	Described
A3 margins	ST_4W_EBITDA_CD (D1.1), R-CASH, A	≤2 in any year	INFL22-23 (2023 only)	Described
A3 margins	EB_R1_REPORTED ÷ REV_NET (E1 margin)	6	SOFT24-26	Described (lease treatment differs)
A3 margins	Loss-making clinic share	7	mixed	Described (rent codes differ)
A4 unit economics	D1.1 R-CASH median clinic margin	3 (2 A + Operator 5 PF)	GFC–SOFT24-26, no overlap	Described
A4 unit economics	AUV, cash-on-cash, ramp, re-rating	1–5	mixed	Described

AREA	DEFINITION ATTEMPTED	N OPERATORS	ENVIRONMENTS	RANKED / DESCRIBED
A5 SSS	SSS_CD, CLOSE-FWD, CY2019	3	EXP10-19	Ranked (R5)
A5 SSS	SSS_CD, CLOSE-FWD, CY2020	3	COVID20	Ranked (R6)
A5 SSS	SSS_CD, CLOSE-FWD, CY2021	2	REOPEN21	Described
A5 SSS	SSS_CD, CLOSE-FWD, CY2022	3	INFL22-23	Ranked (R7)
A5 SSS	SSS_CD, CLOSE-RETRO, 2024 / FY25	3	SOFT24-26	Ranked (R8)
A5 SSS	SSS_CD, CLOSE-RETRO, latest	3	SOFT24-26	Ranked (R9)
A5 SSS	SSS_ST-59 long-run (Operator 4, Operator 9, Operator 2, Operator 1, Operator 29)	5+	EXP10-19–SOFT24-26	Described (definitions undefined)
A6 cash flow	CONV_1 total capex, E1, A, steady	4	EXP10-19–SOFT24-26, at most two in any year	Described
A6 cash flow	CONV_1 [M]; CONV_3; E6 ÷ top rung	3–8	mixed	Described
A7 valuation	TXN_MULT_CURRENT, clinic-level, R-UNK, PF	3	SOFT24-26	Ranked (R10)
A7 valuation	Platform EV/EBITDA	8+	EXP10-19–SOFT24-26	Described (rungs differ)
A8 leverage	LEV_LV1 gross ÷ E1, A	3 (one a live deal; two historical)	SOFT24-26	Described (live-deal leverage is read in Part 08)
A8 leverage	LV1 at close on E4/E5; FCCR	2–7	mixed	Described (rungs and bases differ)

Source: note C-83 and Part 09 section B (the figures that depend on a basis choice or a count are in Exhibit 9.92 and do not change any ranked/described classification). What would make each described area rankable, and the file needed, is in Part 09 section H

04 F Comparator map: supporting evidence

The comparator map sets out, for each live deal, which peer comparisons are valid, and the valid set is narrowest where the underwriting question is sharpest: clinic economics at Deal A and Deal C, and DBW, which compares on revenue per visit only. The limits sit in the evidence rather than in the companies, because rent codes, survivor bases and earnings definitions differ, and the eight questions below name the file that would make each missing comparison valid.

Each live deal has five comparators, but only a handful of metrics are valid for each pair, and the valid set is narrowest where the underwriting question is sharpest. Deal A can be set against Operator 3 on survivor-base comp traffic, ticket and SSS; it cannot be set against any peer on four-wall margin or loss-making clinic share because no peer shares its rent code [note C-84 rows for Deal A]. Deal B's DLB segment is comparable to the sponsor roll-ups on survivor SSS, adjustment share and company-split conversion, while its DBW wellness clinic segment is comparable on one metric only, revenue per visit [Part 06 section G; Part 06 section F]. Deal C is comparable on SSS, adjustment share and add-on multiples, but not on clinic-level margin [Part 07 section F].

The Deal B, DBW and Deal C figures in this section are those of Part 06 and Part 07, which draw on the 2025 Deal C audit (DLC-014) and the Deal B audit-adjustment and QoE files (DLB-010, DLB-031); a figure that appears only here was read once from the source. No reading on any live deal is drawn here; the comparisons place each deal inside, above or below a comparator range on a stated metric, and the readings for the three live deals are in Part 05 to Part 07. Three such placements are valid on the definitions the files allow and are drawn in Exhibit 9.28: same-store sales on the common definition (all three deals), the share of top-rung EBITDA that is adjustments (Deal B and Deal C) and the add-on entry multiple on standalone seller EBITDA (Deal C).

Diligence questions on comparability

Eight questions, three for Deal A, three for Deal B and two for Deal C, each name the file or data that would move a metric from "not valid" to "valid" in the comparator sections of the deal supplies (Part 05 section E, Part 06 section G, Part 07 section F). The company's documents answer question 4 and supplies of questions 5, 6 and 7; those rows give the answer and the section that holds it, and the source line of the table says what remains outstanding. DBW's comparability questions, its four-wall bridge to cash rent and an owned-period visit count, are set out with the wellness clinic context under "04 G" below and in Part 06 section F.

04 G Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals: supporting evidence

A wellness clinic visit is a $86–111 ticket built on a wellness exam and an emergency and specialty patient invoice a $2,007–3,938 referral case, often insured, against about $254–590 for a core patient invoice, so the contextual set is read for leverage on a stated rung, adjustment share, multiples,

overhead and cash conversion, never for clinic metrics. We read the fall in wellness clinic traffic as structural to the product, as vaccine and parasiticide intervals lengthen; emergency and specialty volume follows referral case counts, and DBW sits inside the wellness clinic range on revenue per visit at $99.2 (FY2025) and $99.4 (LTM Jul-26).

Wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are different businesses from general practice and preventive care, and their clinic-level metrics are not comparable with the core and are not pooled with it. A wellness clinic visit is a $86–111 ticket built on a wellness exam on an annual vaccine schedule with little pharmacy pass-through and a supply-agreement or rebate layer worth about 4% of sales [QL2-0344, QL1-0289, QLF-0412; QL1-0241, QLF-0217]. An emergency and specialty patient invoice is a $2,007–3,938 referral-driven, accident- and illness-led case in which 72–82% of revenue comes through referring veterinarians and about 49–58% through formal referral-partner programmes [CO1-0297, CO1-0975, CO3-1314, CO3-1350; CO3-1351; CO1-0308; CO1-0309, CO3-0006]. Core patient invoices run about $254–590 and are consumer-paid [DLA-0772, OP3-0040, OP8-0599, OP6-1121]. Wellness clinic comp traffic has fallen in 14 of 16 operator-years and has run below the core median except in COVID20 and REOPEN21; emergency and specialty traffic follows referral case counts [note C-40; note C-06]. The contextual set is valid for platform-neutral measures (leverage on a stated rung, EBITDA-adjustment share, standalone against synergised multiples, overhead and cash conversion on the same rung) and, for Deal B's DBW segment, for revenue per visit only [QLX-031; CO2-039, CO2-038, CO2-033].

Scope: there is no separate area reading; wellness clinic and emergency and specialty readings on the industry measures of Part 03 are held in this section only, Wellness Clinic Operator 1's clinic profit is coded R-BOOK and sits in no R-CASH set, and the contextual rows of Part 04 section A and Part 04 section B sit outside every core statistic. **Operators / environments:** wellness clinic, three operators (Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Wellness Clinic Franchisor system and PVA, Wellness Clinic Operator 2) plus DBW as the comparison object; emergency and specialty, three (Emergency Operator 1 with Emergency Operator 4, with Emergency Operator 5's series shown separately; Emergency Operator 3; Emergency Operator 2); readings from EXP10-19 to SOFT24-26, with emergency and specialty comparable sales from 2007 and Emergency Operator 1's add-on series from 2009 reaching into PRE-GFC and GFC [note C-02; note C-19]. The wellness clinic traffic block does not meet the operator rule (two operators) and is shown as context only [note C-02].

What the evidence shows

The economics differ on every axis the core benchmarks use. Wellness Clinic Operator 1's net ticket is $111 (TTM P10-25) and vaccine and wellness-exam service is 69% of net sales, with dental, diagnostic and pharmacy work 3.4% [QL1-0289, QL1-1247, QL1-1250]. Wellness Clinic Franchisor's system ticket is about $107 and a wellness exam averages $86–91 [QLF-0412, QLF-1121, QLF-1132]. Wellness Clinic Operator 2's average ticket is $86 [QL2-0344]. A wellness clinic handles about 20–26 patient visits a day on an annual vaccine schedule: Wellness Clinic Operator 1 averages 20.1 patients per clinic-day and about 6,592 patient visits per clinic a year with a repeat share of about 57% [QL1-0283, QL1-0810, QL1-1070], and Wellness Clinic Franchisor runs 21–26 patient visits a day with 61–62% repeat clients [QLF-0413, QLF-0335, QLF-0950]. Labour is hourly throughput labour, largely technicians and assistants, not billed veterinarian hours: Wellness Clinic Operator 1's loaded hourly cost is $17.3 with 216% annual turnover among general service staff, and Wellness Clinic Franchisor costs wellness-line assistants at $13.8 an hour [QL1-0947, QL1-1291, QLF-1912]. Emergency and specialty is the opposite on each axis: Emergency Operator 3's average patient invoice is $3,492 and insured cases average $3,926, an Emergency Operator 3 hospital handles about 70 patient invoices a month, each case carries 25.3 billed clinical hours, and labour is 33.6% of revenue [CO3-1314, CO3-1350, CO3-1360, CO3-1321, CO3-1260]. Emergency Operator 1's case mix is 38% supplies and 37% labour, and a pet has an emergency visit about once every seven years [CO1-0304; CO2-001 p.18].

Supply agreements, royalties and payer contracts sit inside the margin in both contextual subsectors. Wellness Clinic Operator 1's vendor rebates are 4.1–4.4% of sales and about a third (29.4%) of its with-rebates clinic margin, on top of a 2.6% royalty and a 4.8% mandated advertising contribution [QL1-0227, QL1-0241, QL1-0221, QL1-0222, QL1-0178, QL1-1894, QL1-1895]. Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA's rebates are 4.1% of sales and 27.3% of its with-rebates margin, and the franchisor's new vaccine supply contract, a fixed per-dose spread, makes up about 49% of PF EBITDA [QLF-0217, QLF-0226, QLF-0227; QLX-018 p.8]. Wellness Clinic Operator 2's "supplier agreement savings" add-back is $3.3m [QLX-020 p.17]. In emergency and specialty the counterparty is the referral network: Emergency Operator 3 earns 82.3% of revenue from referred cases and about 58% through referral-partner programmes, with its top five referring groups at 57–57% [CO3-1351, CO3-0006, CO3-1347], and Emergency Operator 1 took about 49% of 2016 revenue through referral-partner programmes and about 34% through pet insurer direct-pay programmes [CO1-0309, CO1-0310]. The core rebate layer is 0.6–10.9% of revenue and 4–42% of the with-rebates margin, but it comes from pharmacy and supplies vendors on product that passes through the ticket [note C-28; Part 03 section C].

Comp traffic tells a different story in each set. Wellness clinic comp traffic was negative in every year except 2021: Wellness Clinic Franchisor's system comp patient visits fell 1.0–2.4% a year in 2016–19, 9.2% in 2020 and 2.9–3.3% a year in 2022–25, and Wellness Clinic Operator 1's comp patient visits fell 4.4–4.7% a year in 2022–24 on a survivor base [QLF-0547, QLF-0555, QLF-0579, QLF-0603, QLF-0611, QLF-0712; QL1-0871, QL1-0875, QL1-0879]. Against the core, the wellness clinic median was lower in EXP10-19 (−1.0% against +0.3%), INFL22-23 (−3.9% against −2.4%) and SOFT24-26 (−3.3% against −2.9%), but shallower in COVID20 (−8.0% against −15.1%) and much stronger in REOPEN21 (+11.1% against +3.6%) [note C-06]. Both wellness clinic operators were back at or near 2019 volume in 2021 (Wellness Clinic Franchisor 87.7%, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 92.1% [I]), which the core operators were not [note C-06]. We read that decline as structural to the product: longer-duration vaccines and parasiticides stretch

intervals (management cites one visit a year against two to three on shorter-duration products), and realised intervals lengthen about 1% a year [QLX-033 p.64; QL1-1911]. Emergency and specialty traffic was roughly flat at Emergency Operator 4 in 2015–18 (−1.6% to +1.1%) and fell 6.2–9.0% a year at Emergency Operator 2 in 2021–LTM Jun-23 on a survivor base, with Emergency Operator 3's same-store patient invoices down 8.7% in May–Jul 2023 [CO1-0958, CO1-0963, CO1-0968, CO1-0973; COR-4133, COR-4139, COR-4151; CO3-1364]. Emergency and specialty comp sales were positive through 2007–08 and turned negative only in CY2009 (−1.4% to −2.5% at three emergency and specialty operators), reflecting non-discretionary emergency care rather than deferral of routine care [CO1-0981, CO1-0982, CO1-0271, CO1-0983, CO1-1060].

Four-wall margins sit inside the core range only because the definitions differ. Wellness Clinic Operator 1's D1.1 is 8.6%, 8.4% and 9.2% (FY23, FY24, LTM Oct-25) on book rent net of a finance-lease rent credit (R-BOOK); if the whole Accounting Firm 4 cash-rent adjustment is clinic-level, cash-rent D1.1 is about 5.4%, 5.4% and 7.0% [I], and the clinic-level share is unconfirmed [QL1-0328, QL1-0335, QL1-0342; A3-P5-017, A3-P5-018, A3-P5-019]. Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA's D1.1 is 9.1–11.5% on R-CASH (2023 to LTM Sep-25) [QLF-0228, QLF-0232, QLF-0236]. Emergency Operator 3's facility D1.1 is 14.1–15.5% on R-CASH with rebates held at corporate, Emergency Operator 2's adjusted four-wall is 9.8–12.5% on a PF 70-clinic survivor base (R-UNK), and Emergency Operator 4's clinic EBITDAR is 15.0–15.1% (R-NONE) [CO3-1125, CO3-1133, CO3-1159; COR-0129, COR-0131, COR-0133; CO1-0909, CO1-0942]. The core D1.1 range on any rent code is 9–16% [note C-19]. Overlapping levels do not make the businesses comparable: wellness clinic vaccine service carries a 68–76% gross margin and emergency and specialty about 34–38% after direct labour, against pharmacy and supplies mark-ups in the core [QLF-0016, QLF-0018; CO3-1245].

Deal and financing metrics are the part of the contextual set that can be read against the core, with the rung stated. Adjustment shares are as wide as the core's: Wellness Clinic Franchisor's FY2024 DD-adjusted EBITDA is 52% add-backs, mostly the supply-agreement margin; adjustments are 35% of Wellness Clinic Operator 2's FY2024 E3 [I], 34% of Emergency Operator 3's LTM Sep-25 E3 [I] and 54% of Emergency Operator 2's FY2022 E2 [I]; Wellness Clinic Operator 1's FY2024 E1 exceeds its E3 because the Accounting Firm 4 bridge normalises downward [QLF-0071, QLF-0131; QL2-0149, QL2-0328; CO3-0553, CO3-0564; COR-5307, COR-5423; QL1-0014, QL1-0053]. The core ranges from 3% to above 100% [note C-61]. Wellness clinic franchisee trades sit at 5.1–6.3×, below core mid-market chains, because the franchisor's ROFR and consent rights and Global Animal Health's limits on new clinics cap the buyer set [QL1-1722, QL1-1729, QL1-1735, QL1-1736]. Emergency and specialty platforms traded at 10.8–14.53× on adjusted EBITDA without merger synergies in 2013–19, and Emergency Operator 1 is the only contextual operator with a continuous 2009–18 add-on series, rising from 6.8× to 9.2× [CO1-0659, CO1-0661, CO1-0664; CO1-0451, CO1-0505]. First-lien leverage at close in both sets sits within the core band: Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA 4.10×, Emergency Operator 1 3.94–4.24×, Emergency Operator 3 4.67× and Emergency Operator 2 4.73× on financing EBITDA [QLF-1620, CO1-0729, CO1-0743, CO3-0744, COR-5394].

Exhibit 9.94 — 2015 to 2026: wellness clinic and emergency and specialty traffic, margins, add-backs, multiples and leverage overlap the core ranges but measure different things

Comp traffic (%), four-wall margin (%), adjustment share (%), platform multiple (×) and leverage (×) for wellness clinic and emergency and specialty operators, with the core ranges, 2015 to 2026

OPERATOR	COMP TRAFFIC (BASE)	FOUR-WALL (DEFINITION, RENT CODE)	ADJUSTMENT SHARE (RUNGS)	PLATFORM MULTIPLE (RUNG, BASIS)	LEVERAGE AT CLOSE (RUNG)
Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (QL)	−4.4% / −4.6% / −4.7%, 2022–24 (COMP on survivor file, CLOSE-RETRO) (QL1-0871, QL1-0875, QL1-0879)	D1.1 9.2%, D1.2 13.2%, LTM Oct-25, R-BOOK; cash-rent D1.1 ≈5.4–7.0% [I] (QL1-0342, QL1-0343; A3-P5-017..019)	E1 above E3 in FY2024 (45.0 vs 36.7) (QL1-0014, QL1-0053)	6.2× 2018, rung n/s, A; 5.15× Ares Credit Group recap 2025, P (QL1-1729, QL1-1722)	1L 3.69× gross on Ares Credit Group E5 LTM Oct-25, P; LV3 3.05× on E4 PF (QL1-1655, QL1-0498)
Wellness Clinic Franchisor system / PVA (QL)	−3.3% 2024, −3.0% 2025 (system COMP, CLOSE-FWD); PVA −5.8% YTD Sep-25 (QLF-0611, QLF-0712, QLF-0913)	PVA D1.1 11.5%, D1.2 15.5%, LTM Sep-25, R-CASH (QLF-0236, QLF-0234)	52% (FY2024 reported vs DD-adjusted) (QLF-0071, QLF-0131)	7.3× on E5 FY25 incl. supply margin, PF (QLF-1583)	LV1 4.10× on E5 PF; 8.88× on E2 ex supply margin (QLF-1620, QLF-1630)
Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (QL)	no comp traffic series; SSS_CD 2024 +2.6% on 2016–22 cohorts, −1.4% on 20 mature clinics (revenue) (QL2-0440, QL2-1106)	unit-level EBITDA 21–25% mature cohorts [M], R-UNK, not D1.1 (QLX-020 p.13)	35% [I] (FY2024 E1 14.1 vs E3 24.9) (QL2-0149, QL2-0328)	9.8× E5 / 9.16× E4, P (QL2-1031, QL2-1032)	LV1 4.84× gross on E5, P; LV4 5.76× (QL2-0980, QL2-0990)
Emergency Operator 1 / Emergency Operator 4 (emergency and specialty)	Emergency Operator 4 comp patient invoices −1.6%, +1.1%, +1.0%, +0.4% (2015–LTM Sep-18; COMP sub-base, CLOSE-FWD) (CO1-0958, CO1-0963, CO1-0968, CO1-0973)	Emergency Operator 4 clinic EBITDAR 16.8–15.1%, 2015–LTM Sep-18, R-NONE (CO1-0909, CO1-0942)	33–79% (CO2-001, CO2-012, CO2-009)	merger 2019: 13.20× synergised / 14.53× standalone / 17.9× E2q, PF (CO1-0663, CO1-0664, CO1-0665)	LV1 4.24×, LV2 5.81× on E4 synergised; 9.78× on E1 (CO1-0743, CO1-0747, CO1-0750)
Emergency Operator 3 (emergency and specialty)	same-store patient invoices −8.7%, May–Jul 2023, 9 facilities (CO3-1364)	facility D1.1 14.1%, LTM Aug-23, R-CASH (CO3-1159)	34% [I] (LTM Sep-25 E1 14.6 vs E3 24.9) (CO3-0553, CO3-0564)	11.8× vs 12.9×, 2023, sources differ (CO3-0351, CO3-0736)	LV1 4.67× on E5 at close → 4.65×; 11.24× on E1 (CO3-0744, CO3-0756, CO3-1536)

OPERATOR	COMP TRAFFIC (BASE)	FOUR-WALL (DEFINITION, RENT CODE)	ADJUSTMENT SHARE (RUNGS)	PLATFORM MULTIPLE (RUNG, BASIS)	LEVERAGE AT CLOSE (RUNG)
Emergency Operator 2 (emergency and specialty)	−8.7% 2021, −9.0% 2022, −6.2% LTM Jun-23 (COMP on survivor file, CLOSE-RETRO) (COR-4133, COR-4139, COR-4151)	adjusted four-wall 11.8%, LTM Jun-23, PF 70-clinic survivor, R-UNK (COR-0137)	54% [I] (FY2022 E1 9.5 vs E2 24.8) (COR-5307, COR-5423)	12.62× vs 9.8×, 2023–24, sources differ (COR-5402, COR-5766)	LV1 4.73× on E5 → 5.22× on E3 + LOI (COR-5394, COR-5782)
Core range (reference)	median by environment: EXP10-19 +0.3%, COVID20 −15.1%, REOPEN21 +3.6%, INFL22-23 −2.4%, SOFT24-26 −2.9% (note C-06)	D1.1 9–16% on any rent code (note C-19)	3% to above 100% (note C-61)	mid-market chains 10–13× standalone; headline adjusted 15–15.0×; small-clinic add-ons 4.0–5.8× standalone (Part 04 section A)	LV1 at close 4.3× median, 3.81–5.97× (Part 04 section B)

Source: note C-03 and note C-06 (traffic); note C-21 (four-wall); note C-61 (adjustment shares; [I] = (top rung − E1) ÷ top rung computed here from the cited rows); OP1-7516, OP1-7517, QL1-1722, QL1-1723, QL1-1724, QL1-1727, QL1-1729, QL1-1732, QL1-1734, QL1-1735, QL1-1736, QL1-1737, QL1-1738, QL1-1739, QL1-1740, QL1-1741, QL1-1742, QL1-2127, QL2-1031, QL2-1032, QL2-1033, QL2-1034, QL2-1035, QL2-1036, QL2-1038, QL2-1039, OP7-1368, QLF-1583, QLF-1587, QLF-1751, QLF-2071, OP7-1363, OP7-1369, OP7-1370, OP7-1382, OP7-1367, CO1-0451, CO1-0452, CO1-0457, CO1-0458, CO1-0463, CO1-0464, CO1-0469, CO1-0470, CO1-0475, CO1-0476, CO1-0481, CO1-0482, CO1-0487, CO1-0488, CO1-0493, CO1-0494, CO1-0499, CO1-0500, CO1-0505, CO1-0506, CO1-0507, CO1-0509, CO1-0513, CO1-0517, CO1-0521, CO1-0525, CO1-0528, CO1-0529, CO1-0530, CO1-0659, CO1-0661, CO1-0663, CO1-0664, CO1-0665, CO1-0667, CO1-0678, CO1-0682, CO1-0686, CO1-0690, CO1-0694, CO1-0698, CO1-0702, CO1-0704, CO1-0707, CO1-0710, CO1-0669, CO1-0671, CO1-0674, OP7-1372, CO3-0339, CO3-0340, CO3-0341, CO3-0351, CO3-0352, CO3-0728, CO3-0729, CO3-0730, CO3-0736, CO3-0764, OP7-1371, COR-4737, COR-4742, COR-4747, COR-4752, COR-5070, COR-5076, COR-5242, COR-5248, COR-5254, COR-5260, COR-5402, COR-5750, COR-5751, COR-5766, COR-6135, COR-6139, COR-6140, OP7-1366 (multiples); note C-74 and note C-77 (leverage); fact rows as shown. Basis A unless marked PF or P. Rent codes as stated; QL1 R-BOOK is not R-CASH. Clinic base as stated per cell. Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty enter no core statistic

Exhibit 9.95 — 2010 to 2026: on the operating benchmark's measures wellness clinic and emergency and specialty operators each sit on their own rent code, base and period; DBW's 31.1% four-wall is on book rent

Best available four-wall margin, gross margin, comp traffic, EBITDA margin, overhead and cash conversion by wellness clinic and emergency and specialty operator, and for Deal B's DBW segment, periods as stated, 2010 to 2026; context only

PLATFORM	PERIOD OF BEST DATA	CLINICS	REVENUE ($M)	D1.1 FOUR-WALL (RENT CODE; BASE)	GROSS MARGIN	COMP TRAFFIC / SSS (DEFINITION; CLOSURE BASE)	E1 MARGIN	CORPORATE ST-50 % REVENUE	CONV_1	ORGANIC / ACQUIRED FLAG	LOCATORS
Context — wellness clinic											
Deal B — DBW segment	DBW datapack FY23 – Jul-26	38 clinics	n/a	31.1% CY2025 (R-BOOK; PF incl. seller months)	n/a	visit count YTD Jul-26 −13.4% (all clinics, incl. seller months; not comp)	n/a	n/a	n/a	SEGMENT, PF	DLB-002-000175; DLB-002-000186
Wellness Clinic Operator 1	Accounting Firm 4 clinic P&L FY23 – TTM Oct-25; clinic trends 2018 – P06-25	429 (391 active), LTM Oct-25	392.6 (LTM Oct-25)	9.2% LTM Oct-25 (R-BOOK; ALL); cash-rent estimate 7.0% [I]	43.0% LTM Jun-25 (survivor 395)	SSS_CD 2024 +1.6%, traffic −4.7% (CLOSE-RETRO survivor)	E2 9.3% LTM May-25 (PF)	n/a	0.78 median FY2023 – LTM Oct-25 (E3 PF, steady)	TOTAL	QL1-0568; QL1-0565; QL1-0247; QL1-0342; A3-P5-019; QL1-1231; QL1-0878, QL1-0879; QL1-1805; note C-60 (QL1)
Wellness Clinic Franchisor	System clinic-year 2014 – Aug-25; PVA segment 2023 – LTM Sep-25	1,852 system (CY2025)	337.1 (LTM Sep-25; franchisor + PVA)	PVA 11.5% LTM Sep-25 (R-CASH; segment)	70.1% consolidated LTM Sep-25; PVA 68.5% CY2024	SSS_CD 2025 +2.7%, traffic −3.0% (CLOSE-FWD; system)	PVA segment E1 2.0% LTM Sep-25 (after royalty)	PVA 4.8% LTM Sep-25	n/a	TOTAL	QLF-0955; QLF-0003; QLF-0236; QLF-0018; QLF-0288; QLF-0711, QLF-0712; QLF-0198; QLF-0243

PLATFORM	PERIOD OF BEST DATA	CLINICS	REVENUE ($M)	D1.1 FOUR-WALL (RENT CODE; BASE)	GROSS MARGIN	COMP TRAFFIC / SSS (DEFINITION; CLOSURE BASE)	E1 MARGIN	CORPORATE ST-50 % REVENUE	CONV_1	ORGANIC / ACQUIRED FLAG	LOCATORS
Wellness Clinic Operator 2	Memo figures 2021 – LTM Jul-25	250 (180 corporate wellness clinics)	156.8 (CY2024)	n/a (unit EBITDA R-UNK)	n/a	SSS_CD 2024 +2.6% (survivor); traffic n/a	n/a	4.3% CY2024	0.81 FY2024 (E1, company split [M], BUILD)	POOLED	QL2-0004, QL2-0005; QL2-0062; QL2-0440; QL2-0110; note C-60 (Wellness Clinic Operator 2)
Context — emergency and specialty											
Emergency Operator 1 / Emergency Operator 4	Emergency Operator 1 2010 – LTM Sep-18; Emergency Operator 4 segment 2010–17	984 (Dec-19, post-merger)	1,901.4 (Emergency Operator 1, LTM Sep-18)	Emergency Operator 4 clinic EBITDAR 17.1% LTM Sep-18 (R-NONE)	39.6% LTM Sep-18	Emergency Operator 4 comp patient invoices LTM Sep-18 +0.4% (CLOSE-FWD)	E2 7.6% LTM Sep-18 (PF)	1.5% CY2016	0.78 FY2010–11 (E2 PF, steady)	TOTAL	CO1-0657; CO1-0057; CO1-0942/CO1-0843; CO1-0080; CO1-0973; CO1-0121/CO1-0057; note C-85; note C-60 (Emergency Operator 1)
Emergency Operator 3	Facility P&L CY2021 – LTM Aug-23 (as owned); quarterly to Sep-25	54 sites (Sep-25)	103.6 (YTD Jun-25)	Facility D1.1 14.1% LTM Aug-23 (R-CASH)	32.7% LTM Aug-23 (before rebates)	SSS_ST-59 LTM Sep-25 +2.5% (PF)	n/a	5.1% LTM Sep-25 (PF)	0.76 LTM Sep-25 (Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA)	TOTAL	CO3-0502; CO3-0824; CO3-1159; CO3-1245; CO3-0780; CO3-1532; CO3-0765, CO3-0769, CO3-0770
Emergency Operator 2	Clinic P&L 2019 – Jun-23; lender decks to Mar-25	90 (Dec-24)	290.8 (LTM Sep-24)	Adjusted 4-wall 11.8% LTM Jun-23 (R-UNK; PF; 70-clinic survivor)	36.0% LTM Jun-23 (PF)	Comp visit count LTM Jun-23 −6.2% (CLOSE-RETRO)	n/a	3.6% CY2024	0.83 FY2022 owned (E2, BUILD)	SURVIVOR	COR-6144; COR-6083; COR-0137; COR-0138; COR-4151; COR-6151; COR-6158/COR-3190

Source: note C-03, note C-20, note C-21, note C-24, note C-25, note C-26, note C-30, note C-51, note C-60, note C-85; row IDs in the last column. Revenue in USD millions. Basis A unless marked PF or P; [I] CreditSwan calculation. Rent codes per D1.3; clinic bases per D8. Context only: these rows enter no core statistic; the core rows are in Exhibit 4.11

On the benchmark's measures each contextual operator sits on its own rent code and base: Wellness Clinic Operator 1's 9.2% four-wall (LTM Oct-25) is on book rent, while Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA's 11.5% (LTM Sep-25) and Emergency Operator 3's 14.1% (LTM Aug-23) are on cash rent [QL1-0342, QLF-0236, CO3-1159]. DBW's 31.1% (CY2025) is on book rent and includes seller months, so it is not comparable with any of them beyond revenue per visit [DLB-002-000175; Part 06 section F]. The rows describe each business; they rank nothing and enter no core statistic, and the core rows are in Exhibit 4.11.

Exhibit 9.96 — CY2014 to 2025: wellness clinic and emergency and specialty operators report labour, retention, closure, integration and overhead figures on their own definitions, one operator at a time, so none can be compared with the core

Labour productivity, customer and workforce retention, clinic closures, integration cost and overhead by wellness clinic and emergency and specialty operator, company definitions, periods as stated, CY2014 to 2025; context only

PLATFORM	SERVICE MIX (PHARMACY SHARE OF REVENUE)	LABOUR PRODUCTIVITY	CUSTOMER / WORKFORCE RETENTION	CLINIC CLOSURES	INTEGRATION COST	CORPORATE OVERHEAD AND HEADCOUNT	SOURCE
Wellness Clinic Operator 1	n/a	0.63 patient visits per labour hour (LTM Apr-25); 20.1 patient visits per clinic-day (LTM Oct-25)	Repeat share 57.9% (YTD Jun-25)	n/a	n/a	FTE 3,080; 6.6 per clinic (LTM Oct-25)	note C-85
Wellness Clinic Franchisor	n/a	22.3 patient visits per clinic-day (YTD Aug-25)	Repeat customers 61.8% (CY2025); operator retention 85.4%	20 in CY2024	$1.8k per acquired PVA clinic (CY2023)	Headcount 2,900 (LTM Sep-25)	note C-85
Wellness Clinic Operator 2	n/a	n/a	Repeat rate 62% (LTM Jul-25)	n/a	n/a	$7.9m CY2024	note C-85

PLATFORM	SERVICE MIX (PHARMACY SHARE OF REVENUE)	LABOUR PRODUCTIVITY	CUSTOMER / WORKFORCE RETENTION	CLINIC CLOSURES	INTEGRATION COST	CORPORATE OVERHEAD AND HEADCOUNT	SOURCE
Emergency Operator 1 / Emergency Operator 4	n/a	n/a	n/a	0 in CY2014–16	Integration capex $8.7m (2018); year-one margin change −0.6 to −3.0pp on Emergency Operator 4 add-ons	1.5% of revenue CY2016	note C-85
Emergency Operator 3	n/a	25.3 billed labour hours per patient invoice (LTM Jul-23; CO3-1321)	Repeat share 13.3% (YTD Jul-23); veterinarian turnover 23%	n/a	$0.41m LTM Aug-23	5.1% LTM Sep-25 (note C-26, PF)	note C-85
Emergency Operator 2	n/a	Revenue per veterinarian $455k (CY2015, PF)	n/a	0 in CY2019–22 (PF)	n/a	3.6% CY2024 (note C-26)	note C-85

Source: note C-85; each cell is one row of the Evidence index (Part 09 section F). Basis A unless marked PF; P rows excluded. Overhead percentages come from note C-26. Context only: the core rows are in Exhibit 9.80

A wellness clinic handles 20.1 to 22.3 patient visits a day with repeat shares of 57.9% to 61.8% (2025), while 13.3% of Emergency Operator 3's emergency and specialty customers repeat (YTD Jul-23) [note C-85]. Each figure is on the company's own definition, one series per operator, so the table describes each business and supports no comparison with the core KPIs in Exhibit 9.80.

Exhibit 9.97 — 2007 to 2025: wellness clinic was back at or near 2019 traffic in 2021 and emergency and specialty comp ticket beat veterinary-price inflation by 10.1–23.5 pp, each on its own base and outside every core statistic

Wellness clinic and emergency and specialty readings on the industry measures of Part 03 (volume, pricing, margin, same-store sales, cash flow), %, pp, ratio or years as stated, by operator and period, 2007 to 2025; context only

MEASURE (PART 03 AREA)	OPERATOR (CLASS)	MEASURE, CLINIC BASE AND CLOSURE	PERIOD	READING	BASIS	ROWS
Volume: comp series held	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic)	Comp patient visits; COMP (D2.1 annual rule, ~1,609 clinics); CLOSE-FWD	2016–2025	10 annual growth figures, 9 negative; EXP10-19 to SOFT24-26	A	note C-08
Volume: comp series held	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (wellness clinic)	Comp visit count; COMP (373 clinics) on survivor file; CLOSE-RETRO	2019–2024	6 annual growth figures, 5 negative; EXP10-19 to SOFT24-26	A	note C-08
Volume: comp series held	Emergency Operator 4 (emergency and specialty)	Comp patient invoices; COMP (D2.1 sub-base); CLOSE-FWD	2015–LTM Sep-18	4 annual growth figures, 1 negative; EXP10-19	A	note C-08
Volume: comp series held	Emergency Operator 5 (emergency and specialty; shown separately from Emergency Operator 1)	Comp visit count; COHORT pre-2008 clinics; closure rule not stated	2009–2011	3 annual growth figures, 1 negative; EXP10-19	A	note C-08
Volume: comp series held	Emergency Operator 2 (emergency and specialty)	Comp visit count; COMP (D2.1) survivor file; CLOSE-RETRO	2021–LTM Jun-23	3 annual growth figures, all negative; REOPEN21, INFL22-23	A	note C-08
Volume: COVID20 drawdown and recovery	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic)	Comp patient visits; COMP; CLOSE-FWD	2020 / 2021	−9.2% / +9.5%; 2021 at 87.7% of 2019 [I]	A	QLF-0579, QLF-0587
Volume: COVID20 drawdown and recovery	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (wellness clinic)	Comp patient visits; COMP; CLOSE-RETRO	2020 / 2021	−6.2% / +12.1%; 2021 at 92.1% of 2019 [I]	A	QL1-0863, QL1-0867
Volume: COVID20 drawdown and recovery	Emergency Operator 2 (emergency and specialty)	Like-for-like KPI patient visits, including seller months	2020 / 2021	−9.4% / +2.4%	PF	COR-4127, COR-4130
Volume: visits per clinic	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic)	Patient visits per clinic-day; all clinics	2014–25	24.8 to 21.5 (−12.5%)	A	QLF-0328, QLF-0957
Volume: visits per clinic	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (wellness clinic)	Patient visits per clinic; surviving clinics	2018 – LTM Jun-25	7,222.1 to 6,242.5 (−10.3%)	A	QL1-0722, QL1-0850
Volume: survivorship bias	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic)	Comp traffic, all comp clinics against survivor clinics; few closures	2016–2024	at most 0.2 pp a year [I]	A	QLF-0547, QLF-0615

MEASURE (PART 03 AREA)	OPERATOR (CLASS)	MEASURE, CLINIC BASE AND CLOSURE	PERIOD	READING	BASIS	ROWS
Pricing: like-for-like price	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic)	Wellness-exam and vaccine price, Laspeyres, 4 lines; mix residual +2.0% / +1.9% / +2.0%	2023 / 2024 / YTD Sep-25	+4.0% / +2.2% / +1.4%	A	QLF-1152 … QLF-1160
Pricing: comp ticket against CPI vet services and ECI wages (cumulative)	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic)	Comp ticket; comp clinics	2021–25	ticket +37.8%, CPI vet services +36.3%, wages +21.7%; +1.2 pp vs CPI	A	QLF-0675 … QLF-0713; CUUR0000SS62053; ECI_VETOCC
Pricing: comp ticket against CPI vet services and ECI wages (cumulative)	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic)	Comp ticket; comp clinics	2016–19	ticket +17.7%, CPI vet services +8.1%, wages +8.7%; +8.9 pp vs CPI	A	QLF-0546 … QLF-0572; CUUR0000SS62053; ECI_VETOCC
Pricing: comp ticket against CPI vet services and ECI wages (cumulative)	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (wellness clinic)	Comp ticket; comp clinics	2021–24	ticket +31.7%, CPI vet services +28.9%, wages +17.4%; +2.9 pp vs CPI	A	QL1-0866 … QL1-0880; CUUR0000SS62053; ECI_VETOCC
Pricing: comp ticket against CPI vet services and ECI wages (cumulative)	Emergency Operator 2 (emergency and specialty)	Comp ticket; comp clinics	2021–22	ticket +34.3%, CPI vet services +11.1%, wages +7.5%; +23.5 pp vs CPI	A	COR-4132 … COR-4140; CUUR0000SS62053; ECI_VETOCC
Pricing: comp ticket against CPI vet services and ECI wages (cumulative)	Emergency Operator 4, before Emergency Operator 1 (emergency and specialty)	Comp ticket; comp clinics	2015–17	ticket +15.2%, CPI vet services +4.7%, wages +5.9%; +10.1 pp vs CPI	A	CO1-0950 … CO1-0969; CUUR0000SS62053; ECI_VETOCC
Margin: gross margin in the 2022–23 inflation	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (wellness clinic)	Gross margin, company definition; clinics still open (395)	CY2022 to CY2023	44.5% to 44.8% (−0.4pp)	A	QL1-1228, QL1-1229
Same-store sales: GFC	Emergency Operator 4; Emergency Operator 5 (emergency and specialty)	Comp sales; Emergency Operator 5 pre-2008 cohort	2007 / 2008	Emergency Operator 4 +7.7% / +9.5%; Emergency Operator 5 2008 +2.2%	A	CO1-0981, CO1-0982, CO1-1059
Same-store sales: CY2009	Emergency Operator 1 (emergency and specialty)	Comp sales, company definition	CY2009	−2.4%	A [M]	CO1-0271
Same-store sales: COVID20	Wellness Clinic Operator 1; Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic); Emergency Operator 3 (emergency and specialty)	Comp sales; Emergency Operator 3 on company definition, 28-site cohort	2020	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 −2.8%; Wellness Clinic Franchisor −5.6%; Emergency Operator 3 −15.0% (PF)	A; Emergency Operator 3 PF	QL1-0862, QLF-0578, CO3-0998
Same-store sales: SOFT24-26, sales, traffic and ticket	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (wellness clinic)	SSS / comp traffic / ticket; SURVIVOR; CLOSE-RETRO	2024	+1.6% / −4.7% / +6.7%	A	QL1-0878..0880
Same-store sales: SOFT24-26, sales, traffic and ticket	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic)	SSS / comp traffic / ticket; system COMP; CLOSE-FWD	2024 / 2025	SSS +1.0% / +2.7%; traffic −3.3% / −3.0%; ticket +4.6% / +5.8%	A	QLF-0610..0612, 602..0713
Cash flow: conversion (CONV_1)	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (wellness clinic)	E3, survivor 391 clinics; company maintenance split [M]; steady	FY2023 – LTM 2025 (INFL22-23, SOFT24-26)	0.69–0.76; 0.62–0.71 on total capex	PF	note C-59, note C-60
Cash flow: maintenance capex	Emergency Operator 1 (emergency and specialty)	Company-stated maintenance capex, % of revenue	2009–2017	0.12–2.2%	A [M]	CO1-0200..CO1-0232
Cash flow: cash EBITDA (E6) ÷ top adjusted rung (E3)	Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (wellness clinic)	Consolidated, all clinics	FY2024	63.3%	PF	QL2-0149, QL2-0169, QL2-0328, QL2-0333
Cash flow: cash EBITDA (E6) ÷ top adjusted rung (E3)	Emergency Operator 3 (emergency and specialty)	Consolidated, all clinics	LTM Sep-25	73.2%	PF	CO3-0553, CO3-0835, CO3-0564, CO3-1529, CO3-0765
Cash flow: "one-time" add-back recurrence (categories; recurring 3+ years; longest run)	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (wellness clinic)	Cash categories on A and PF annual consolidated rows	2022–2025	5; 4; 3 years (non-recurring charges 2023–25)	A and PF	QL1-0022..0024; QL1-0025, QL1-0026, QL1-0027, QL1-0037, QL1-0038, QL1-0039, QL1-1825, QL1-1826, QL1-1827, QL1-1685, QL1-1687, QL1-1689
Cash flow: "one-time" add-back recurrence (categories; recurring 3+ years; longest run)	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (wellness clinic)	Cash categories on A and PF annual consolidated rows	2023–2025	3; 3; 3 years (non-recurring charges 2023–25)	A and PF	QLF-0088..0090; QLF-0139, QLF-0140, QLF-0141, QLF-0160, QLF-0161, QLF-0162

MEASURE (PART 03 AREA)	OPERATOR (CLASS)	MEASURE, CLINIC BASE AND CLOSURE	PERIOD	READING	BASIS	ROWS
Cash flow: "one-time" add-back recurrence (categories; recurring 3+ years; longest run)	Emergency Operator 3 (emergency and specialty)	Cash categories on A and PF annual consolidated rows	2021–2025	8; 4; 5 years	A and PF	CO3-0033, CO3-0034, CO3-0035, CO3-0949, CO3-0953
Cash flow: "one-time" add-back recurrence (categories; recurring 3+ years; longest run)	Emergency Operator 2 (emergency and specialty)	Cash categories on A and PF annual consolidated rows	2021–2024	4; 2; 4 years	A and PF	COR-5415, COR-5309, COR-5416, COR-5821, COR-5413, COR-5308, COR-5414, COR-5811
Cash flow: "one-time" add-back recurrence (categories; recurring 3+ years; longest run)	Emergency Operator 1 (emergency and specialty)	Cash categories on A and PF annual consolidated rows	2014–2019	3; 2; 3 years	A and PF	CO1-0159, CO1-0160, CO1-0161, CO1-0133, CO1-0634, CO1-0183, CO1-0184, CO1-0185

Source: note C-04, note C-05 and note C-08 (volume); note C-10 and note C-13 (pricing; public series CUUR0000SS62053 and ECI_VETOCC matched to each window); note C-46 and note C-51 (same-store sales); note C-56, note C-57, note C-58, note C-59, note C-60 and note C-61 (cash flow); row IDs in the last column. [I] CreditSwan calculation. Context only: these rows enter no core statistic; the core rows are in Part 03 · Basis: A unless marked PF; [M] company-stated split. Clinic base and closure rule as stated in each row. No rent code applies. Assumption A-10 (wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals are context only)

On the industry measures the context operators move differently from the core: Wellness Clinic Franchisor and Wellness Clinic Operator 1 were back at 87.7% and 92.1% of 2019 comp volume in 2021, when no core operator with data had recovered (Part 03 section A), and emergency and specialty comp ticket beat CPI-U veterinarian services by 10.1 pp (Emergency Operator 4, 2015–17) and 23.5 pp (Emergency Operator 2, 2021–22), which is case severity rather than retail pricing [QLF-0587, QL1-0867; note C-10]. "One-time" add-backs recur here as in the core, with longest runs of three years in wellness clinic and three to five in emergency and specialty [note C-58]. Each row is on its operator's own definition and period, so the table shows how each business behaves, not where it ranks against the core rows of Part 03.

Exhibit 9.98 — Nov-13 to Feb-26: wellness clinic and emergency and specialty first-lien prints sit at 3.7–4.8× financing EBITDA, closed and proposed, and the same debt reads up to 13.25× on reported EBITDA

First-lien leverage (×) at close or at the date shown on the stated EBITDA, with other rungs, wellness clinic and emergency and specialty financings, Nov-13 to Feb-26; context only

DATE	PLATFORM / EVENT	LV1 AT CLOSE (DENOMINATOR)	OTHER RUNGS	FACT ROWS
Nov-13	Emergency Operator 1 — pension-fund financing	LEV_ST-59 5.22× (Adj. EBITDA, rung not stated)	—	CO1-0716
Sep-14	Emergency Operator 4 — LBO	—	LV2 6.0× gross (E3 LTM Jul-14 $50.8m); LV5 5.90×	CO1-0993, CO1-0997
Jan-17	Emergency Operator 1 — recap	3.94× gross (E4 LTM Dec-16 PF $149m)	LV2 5.17×	CO1-0729, CO1-0731
Feb-19	Emergency Operator 1 / Emergency Operator 4 merger	4.24× gross (E4 synergised LTM Sep-18 $329.2m)	LV2 5.8×	CO1-0743, CO1-0747
Nov-23	Emergency Operator 3 — Sponsor 2 LBO	4.7× gross (E5 LTM Aug/Oct-23 PF $13.8m; sources differ)	LV5 4.70× (P)	CO3-0744, CO3-0374
Dec-23	Emergency Operator 2 — LBO	4.73× gross (E5 LTM Nov-23 PF $34.2m)	LV5 4.74×	COR-5394, COR-5399
Sep-25	Emergency Operator 3 — first-lien debt outstanding ($201.2m)	4.65× gross (E5)	8.51× on cash EBITDA (E6); 11.24× on E1	CO3-0756, CO3-1535, CO3-1536
Sep-25	Wellness Clinic Operator 2 — Ares Credit Group refinancing proposal	4.8× gross (E5 LTM Sep-25 $32.8m, P)	LV4 5.76× incl. HoldCo PIK (P)	QL2-0980, QL2-0990
Dec-25	Wellness Clinic Operator 1 — 2025 recapitalisation (Ares Credit Group memo of 22 December 2025)	3.69× first lien (E5 LTM Oct-25 $38.8m, P; sources differ)	5.36× net incl. prebate and preferred (P)	QL1-1655, QL1-1662
Feb-26	Wellness Clinic Franchisor (PVA) — sponsor LBO	4.10× gross (E5 FY2025 PF $136.0m)	LV5 4.27×; the same $672.9m of first-lien debt reads 4.09× on E4, 4.02× on E2q, 8.88× on E2 excluding the supply margin and 13.25× on E1	QLF-1620, QLF-1624; QLF-1628, QLF-1626, QLF-1630, QLF-1629

Source: note C-74 (wellness clinic and emergency and specialty context blocks); later prints in note C-79; same-debt ladders in note C-77 and note C-78. Context only; never pooled with the core bands [Assumption A-10, Part 09 section A]

Closed first-lien prints in the contextual set run 3.94× to 4.73× on financing EBITDA (Emergency Operator 1 2017 to Emergency Operator 2 2023), inside the core band, and the two proposals sit at 3.69× (Wellness Clinic Operator 1, Dec-25, P) and 4.8× (Wellness Clinic Operator 2, Sep-25, P) [CO1-0729, COR-5394, QL1-1655, QL2-0980]. The same debt reads far higher on reported EBITDA: Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA 4.10× on E5 against 13.25× on E1 (Feb-26), and Emergency Operator 3 4.65× on E5 against 11.24× on E1 (Sep-25), because supply-contract margin and adjustments sit inside financing EBITDA [QLF-1620, QLF-1629, CO3-0756, CO3-1536]. The table shows leverage when struck, not how these credits performed afterwards.

Why these metrics cannot validly be pooled, and what the contextual set is valid for

Pooling would mix three different mechanisms. Wellness clinic volume is set by vaccine intervals and the take-up of longer-duration vaccines and parasiticides, its price is a menu price on a single high-margin service backed by a supplier contract, and its margin carries royalty, advertising-fund and supply-rebate lines that core operators do not have [QLX-031; QLX-018, QLX-019, QLX-017; note C-09]. Emergency and specialty volume comes through referrals and accidents, its price is set per case on treatment estimates with pet insurance covering a growing share, and its ticket inflation (Emergency Operator 2 +20.9% in 2022) is case severity, not retail pricing [COR-4140]. Ticket, traffic, same-store sales, four-wall margin, gross margin, AUV, capex per clinic and labour productivity therefore stay out of every core statistic, and contextual rows are held in separate classes [Assumption A-10, Part 09 section A]. The contextual set is valid for four uses: leverage on a stated rung and the definition ladder (the Wellness Clinic Franchisor ladder from 4.02× on E2q to 13.25× on E1 is the clearest case of contract-driven EBITDA) [QLF-1626, QLF-1629]; EBITDA-adjustment share and the recurrence of add-backs; standalone against synergised and gross against net-of-SLB multiples, provided the property treatment is stated (Emergency Operator 3 add-ons 5.3× gross, 3.0× net) [CO3-0339, CO3-0340]; and corporate overhead and cash conversion on the same rung (Wellness Clinic Operator 1 CONV_1 0.69–0.76 on Accounting Firm 4 PF EBITDA, Emergency Operator 1 0.64–0.86 on E2) [QL1-0414, QL1-0419, CO1-0234, CO1-0241].

For Deal B's DBW segment, revenue per visit is the only valid comparison [Part 06 section F]. On net revenue ÷ visit count (ratio of sums) the wellness clinic range is $79 (Wellness Clinic Operator 2 2024, POOLED) to $112 (Wellness Clinic Franchisor system CY2025), with Wellness Clinic Operator 1 at $102.5 (FY24), and DBW sits inside it at $99.2 (FY2025, eleven months of it before Deal B owned the clinics from 1 December 2025) and $99.4 (LTM Jul-26, which includes seller months to November 2025), both pro forma and read once from the source [QL2-0342, QLF-0956, QL1-0288, DLB-002-000176, DLB-002-000180]. DBW's four-wall margin of 27.0–30.8% (FY23–21, R-BOOK, PF, read once from the source) is about 20 percentage points above Wellness Clinic Operator 1 and Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA, which is not like for like; on D1.2 cash rent the gap to Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA is 10.6 percentage points (Exhibit 9.136, Part 09 section M), a gap too large for rent code alone and recorded as a diligence question, not a comparison [DLB-002-000171, DLB-002-000175, QL1-0342, QLF-0236, DLB-3520, QLF-0234]. DBW's −13.4% visit count for YTD Jul-26 covers all 38 clinics with seller months and is not on a comp base, so it cannot be set against Wellness Clinic Operator 1's −4.7% or Wellness Clinic Franchisor's −3.0% [DLB-002-000186, QL1-0879, QLF-0712].

What the evidence cannot show

The wellness clinic traffic evidence rests on two operators, and Wellness Clinic Operator 1's series is a survivor base, so no wellness clinic environment statistic meets the three-operator rule [note C-06]; Wellness Clinic Operator 2 has no comp traffic series at all, and its implied traffic of 1.69m to 1.56m patient visits is a POOLED figure that includes ramping clinics [QL2-1107, QL2-1108]. Wellness Clinic Operator 1's cash-rent four-wall needs confirmation of the clinic-level share of Accounting Firm 4's cash-rent adjustment (QoE rent schedule) before it can serve as a four-wall reference for DBW. Emergency and specialty four-wall figures use three different rent codes (R-CASH, R-UNK, R-NONE) and one PF survivor base, so no emergency and specialty four-wall level can be stated [note C-21]. The contextual platform multiples carry unresolved conflicts (Emergency Operator 3 11.8× against 12.9×; Emergency Operator 2 12.62× against 9.8×; Wellness Clinic Operator 1 carve-out 5.9× against 5.8×) that need the closing documents [CO3-0351, CO3-0736, COR-5402, COR-5766, QL1-1734, QL1-1742]. DBW's four-wall bridge to D1.1 R-CASH (rent, royalty, Global Animal Health and vendor rebates, labour, area-manager allocation) and an owned-period comp visit count are needed from the DLB-002 and DLB-003 files before any DBW comparison beyond revenue per visit is attempted [Part 06 section F; DLB-002-000175, DLB-002-000186, DLB-3520].

Public signals

This is context only, from pages read on 30 September 2026: wellness clinic operators are not set beside the general practice and preventive operators. Exhibit 9.99 gives complaint counts, employer ratings and transactions.

Complaints recorded by a consumer complaints body over three years numbered 235 for Wellness Clinic Operator 1 [F, PUB-0025], 1,051 for Wellness Clinic Operator 6 [F, PUB-0026] and 60 for Wellness Clinic Operator 2 [F, PUB-0027]. The counts are not scaled by number of clinics, which differs widely between the three, so they are not ranked.

An employer review site shows 2.5 of 5 at Wellness Clinic Operator 1 on 90 ratings [F, PUB-0314], 2.4 at Wellness Clinic Operator 6 on 360 [F, PUB-0319] and 3.6 at Public Wellness Clinic Co. on 1,130 reviews [F, PUB-0029]; Wellness Clinic Operator 2's 1.6 rests on 32 reviews [F, PUB-0028]; each count is as the employer review site labels it. The employers differ in scope and are not ranked.

Four transactions were announced or completed between February 2025 and July 2026. Each is given as the party's release or filing states it; where the supplied documents carry the terms, they remain those shown in Exhibit 9.98.

Exhibit 9.99 — At 30 September 2026 wellness clinic Employer review site ratings run 1.6 to 3.6 and complaint counts are not scaled by clinic; four transactions were announced or completed from February 2025 to July 2026

Wellness clinic operators only: consumer complaints body complaints, employer review site employer ratings with number of reviews, and public transactions as the parties state them; read on 30 September 2026

OPERATOR	BBB COMPLAINTS, LAST THREE YEARS (CLOSED IN LAST TWELVE MONTHS)	EMPLOYER REVIEW SITE RATING OF 5 (REVIEWS OR RATINGS, AS THE EMPLOYER REVIEW SITE LABELS THE COUNT)	PUBLIC TRANSACTION, AS THE PARTY STATES IT	SUPPLIED DOCUMENTS
Wellness Clinic Operator 1	235 (62) [F, PUB-0025]	2.2 (90) [F, PUB-0314]	3 Feb 2026: Sponsor 6 announces its exit to Wellness Clinic Operator 5, Corp.; 391 locations [F, QL1-0565]; no financial terms stated [F, PUB-0315]	The supplied documents carry the terms; see Exhibit 9.98
Wellness Clinic Franchisor (system)	not seen on the pages read	2.3 (1,283) [F, PUB-0316]	1 Jul 2026: Sponsor 8 announces completion of the acquisition of Wellness Clinic Franchisor from Global Animal Health [F, PUB-0317]	The supplied documents carry the terms; see Exhibit 9.98
Wellness Clinic Operator 2	60 (32) [F, PUB-0027]	1.6 (32; fewer than 44) [F, PUB-0028]	22 Jan 2026: Lender 4 announces a structured equity investment [F, PUB-0318]	The supplied documents carry the clinic count; see Exhibit 9.95
Wellness Clinic Operator 6	1,051 (373) [F, PUB-0026]	2.4 (360) [F, PUB-0319]	not covered in this table	
Public Wellness Clinic Co.	not seen on the pages read	3.6 (1,130) [F, PUB-0029]	20 Feb 2025: agreement to acquire Public Wellness Clinic Co. franchise arm for about $534 million [M, PUB-0320], stated as 9.2 times the franchise arm's adjusted EBITDA [M, PUB-0321]; 1 Dec 2025: completed at $524 million, subject to adjustments [F, PUB-0322]	On completion Public Wellness Clinic Co. divested 38 Public Wellness Clinic Co. franchise arm clinics to Deal B Wellness Clinic Operator 3, LLC [F, PUB-0132]; they are read as Deal B's Deal B Wellness Clinics segment in Part 06 section F

Source: consumer complaints body business profiles; employer review site employer pages; releases by Sponsor 6, Lender 4 and Sponsor 8; Public Wellness Clinic Co. release and Form 8-K; read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: Context only; wellness clinic operators are not set beside general practice and preventive operators. Complaint counts are totals for the profile named and are not scaled by number of clinics, so they are not ranked. The Wellness Clinic Operator 1 profile is that of Wellness Clinic Operator 1 trading as Wellness Clinic Franchisor; the Wellness Clinic Franchisor employer rating covers the whole Wellness Clinic Franchisor system. A rating is the site's own average of what users submit. "Fewer than 44" marks a rating on fewer than 44 reviews. Deal B Wellness Clinics is covered in Part 06 section F, not here

04 H Public signals: supporting evidence

How to read public signals. Public signals show how operators look from outside, to customers, employees and the market, and where their clinics sit. They are read beside the company records and are no evidence of clinic economics. Ratings and counts move; every figure below was read on 30 September 2026 unless another date is given.

Customers. Clinic-level ratings sit between 3.8 and 4.3 wherever we read them, and the coverage is uneven. Deal B shows a review-site rating on 82 of its 96 location pages [F, PUB-0106]: 4.21 weighted by reviews, a median of 4.7, a range of 4.3 to 4.2, on 49,539 reviews [I, PUB-0107; PUB-0108; PUB-0109; C-PUB-4]. For Deal C two clinics were read: Operator 11 in City 4 at 4.1 on 111 verified reviews on a pet-care review site [F, PUB-0030] [F, PUB-0031] and Sponsor 3 in City 17 at 4.2 on 258 ratings on its own page [F, PUB-0032] [F, PUB-0033]. Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 8 are samples of one to six clinics, on different channels, so the rows are not ranked.

Exhibit 9.100 — Deal B shows a rating on 82 of its 96 clinic pages, 4.21 on 49,539 reviews at 30 September 2026; for the other operators only one to six clinics were read

Customer ratings at clinic level, stars out of 5, with the number of reviews behind each; read on 30 September 2026

OPERATOR AND CLINIC	WHERE THE RATING IS PUBLISHED	COVERAGE	RATING	REVIEWS OR RATINGS, AS THE PAGE LABELS THE COUNT	REFERENCE
Deal B	review-site rating shown on the company's location pages	82 of 96 pages	4.21 weighted by reviews; median 4.1; range 3.8 to 4.2	49,539	[F, PUB-0106] [I, PUB-0107; PUB-0108; PUB-0109; C-PUB-4]
Deal C · Operator 11, City 4	Pet-care review site	one clinic	4.1	111	[F, PUB-0030, PUB-0031]
Deal C · Sponsor 3, City 17	Company page	one clinic	4.2	258	[F, PUB-0032, PUB-0033]
Operator 6 · Myers Family Veterinary, Fort Myers ST-70	Pet-care review site	one clinic of the banner	4.2	216	[F, PUB-0332, PUB-0333]
Operator 6 · Operator 21, City 29 ST-72	Pet-care review site	one clinic of the banner	4.1	186	[F, PUB-0334, PUB-0335]
Operator 6 · Golden Gate Animal Hospital, City 26 ST-70	Pet-care review site	one clinic of the banner	4.3	134	[F, PUB-0336, PUB-0337]
Operator 3 · Clark Animal Clinic, Hollister ST-54	Pet-care review site	one clinic	4.3	117	[F, PUB-0338, PUB-0339]
Operator 8 · City 13	Company clinic page	one clinic	4.2	460	[F, PUB-0340, PUB-0341]
Operator 8 · Kirkwood	Company clinic page	one clinic	4.2	385	[F, PUB-0342, PUB-0343]
Operator 8 · Ballwin	Company clinic page	one clinic	4.1	51	[F, PUB-0344, PUB-0345]
Operator 8 · Affton	Company clinic page	one clinic	4.1	534	[F, PUB-0346, PUB-0347]
Operator 8 · Creve Coeur	Company clinic page	one clinic	4.2	376	[F, PUB-0348, PUB-0349]
Operator 8 · City 14	Company clinic page	one clinic	4.2	609	[F, PUB-0350, PUB-0351]

Source: Deal B location pages; pet-care review site clinic pages; Sponsor 3 and Operator 8 clinic pages; all read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: A count of every rated clinic page for Deal B stands beside samples of one to six clinics for the others, and the channels differ (Review-site and company ratings shown on company pages; a pet-care review site). The rows are not ranked and are not comparable across channels. Ratings and counts move. No rating sample is shown for Deal A

Complaints scale with size, and unevenly. The consumer complaints body shows 907 complaints against Deal A in the last three years [F, PUB-0034] and 288 closed in the last twelve months [F, PUB-0035]. Over Deal A's 983 company-operated clinics at 27 June 2026 [F, DLA-0399], that is 0.77 complaints per clinic over three years [I, C-PUB-7]. The per-clinic figures for the four operators with a clinic count are in the table; they rest on clinic counts of different dates and scopes and are not ranked. Operator 1 shows 1,374 complaints in three years [F, PUB-0036] and Operator 5 79 [F, PUB-0037]; neither has a clinic count on the same scope and date, so no per-clinic figure is given. Deal A, Operator 1 and Operator 2 carry an A+ grade [F, PUB-0038] [F, PUB-0039] [F, PUB-0040]; Operator 9 and Operator 5 carry an F [F, PUB-0041] [F, PUB-0042].

Exhibit 9.101 — consumer complaints body, three years to 30 September 2026: Deal A drew 907 complaints, 0.77 per clinic; per-clinic counts at four operators run 0.31 to 0.77 and are not ranked

consumer complaints body grade, accreditation and complaint counts by operator profile; read on 30 September 2026

OPERATOR PROFILE	GRADE	ACCREDITATION	COMPLAINTS, LAST THREE YEARS	COMPLAINTS CLOSED, LAST 12 MONTHS	CLINIC COUNT USED	COMPLAINTS PER CLINIC, THREE YEARS	REFERENCE
Deal A	A+	Not accredited	907	288	983 (27 June 2026) [F, DLA-0399]	0.77 [I, C-PUB-7]	[F, PUB-0038, PUB-0219, PUB-0034, PUB-0035]
Operator 1	A+	Not accredited	1,374	472	no count on the same scope	not computed	[F, PUB-0039, PUB-0220, PUB-0036, PUB-0221]
Operator 2	A+	Accredited	309	112	510 (June 2026) [M, OP2-4716]	0.52 [I, C-PUB-7]	[F, PUB-0040, PUB-0222, PUB-0223, PUB-0224]
Operator 9	F	Not accredited	108	23	157 (September 2025) [I, OP4-0535]	0.59 [I, C-PUB-7]	[F, PUB-0041, PUB-0225, PUB-0226, PUB-0227]
Operator 5	F	Not accredited	79	32	no count on the same scope and date	not computed	[F, PUB-0042, PUB-0228, PUB-0037, PUB-0229]
Deal C · Operator 17	not shown on the page read	Not accredited	9	6	23 (August 2026) [M, DLC-4339]	0.31 [I, C-PUB-7]	[F, PUB-0230, PUB-0231, PUB-0232]

Source: consumer complaints body business profiles and complaint pages, read on 30 September 2026; clinic counts from Deal A's earnings release for the quarter to 27 June 2026 and the supplied documents · Basis: Counts and grades as a consumer complaints body publishes them. The twelve-month figure is complaints closed. Complaints per clinic divide the three-year count by a clinic count from the company records at the date shown; the count is approximate for this purpose, because the clinics a profile covers and the clinics open over three years are not the same set. The four per-clinic figures rest on clinic counts of different dates and scopes, the

Operator 17 figure is one brand on 9 complaints, and they are not ranked. No per-clinic figure is given where the document holds no clinic count on the same scope near the date

Two national surveys name operators in the supplied documents. In an industry pet-owner satisfaction study for 2026, fielded January to March 2026 across 9,127 pet owners [F, PUB-0043], the three highest scores in the preventive care and pharmacy segment are Operator 31 at 756 [F, PUB-0044], Operator 29 at 743 [F, PUB-0045] and Operator 28 at 715 [F, PUB-0046]. A consumer news site, reporting the study on 30 July 2026, gives a segment average of 694 [U, PUB-0047], Operator 9 at 694 [U, PUB-0048] and Operator 1 at 669 [U, PUB-0049]; the two sets are not from the same document. A consumer membership organisation surveyed more than 21,937 members in fall 2024 [F, PUB-0050] on 28 pet pharmacy retailers [F, PUB-0051]; its open text lists Operator 1, Operator 29 and Mass Retailer 1 as the three lowest-ranked retailers [F, PUB-0052].

Employees. On one site and one definition, Deal A's employer rating sits below that of every other operator in the supplied documents with 44 or more reviews. An employer review site shows Deal A at 1.9 on 376 reviews [F, PUB-0053] [F, PUB-0054], against 3.2 at Operator 1 on 1,865 [F, PUB-0055] [F, PUB-0056], 3.0 at Operator 9 on 264 [F, PUB-0057] [F, PUB-0058] and 3.7 at Operator 4 on 62 [F, PUB-0059] [F, PUB-0060]; each count is of reviews or ratings, as the employer review site labels it. The share who would recommend the employer to a friend is 12% at Deal A [F, PUB-0061], 61% at Operator 1 [F, PUB-0062], 51% at Operator 9 [F, PUB-0063] and 69% at Operator 4 [F, PUB-0064]. Deal C's 3.9 rests on 7 reviews [F, PUB-0065] [F, PUB-0066], and Operator 5, Operator 2, Operator 8 and Operator 3 each have fewer than 44; these are anecdote and are drawn as such. On a second channel, a job board shows Deal A at 2.1 on 1,870 reviews [F, PUB-0067] [F, PUB-0068]; the two sites are not set against each other.

Footprint and competition. The three clinic bases sit in different markets. Measured on the census tracts within three miles of each clinic, with household income from the American Community Survey for 2020 to 2024, the median Deal C clinic serves a trade area with a median household income of $84.0k, with the middle half of clinics between $68.5k and $100.2k [I, C-PUB-1]. Deal A's median clinic is at $69.6k ($56.7k to $85.2k) and Deal B's at $60.7k ($51.4k to $67.5k) [I, C-PUB-1]. The US median is $71,197 for 2020 to 2024, in 2024 dollars [F, PUB-0069]. The trade-area figure is below it at 67.4% of Deal B's clinics, 46.6% of Deal A's clinics and 24.8% of Deal C's mapped clinics [I, C-PUB-1]. The median clinic has about 11,319 households within three miles at Deal B, 18,299 at Deal A (over the 938 clinics with a trade-area income) and 18,906 at Deal C [I, C-PUB-1].

Three limits travel with these figures. Deal C's public sites yield 72 clinics, 69 with coordinates and 68 with a trade area [I, C-PUB-1], of about 86 in the supplied documents [I, DLC-0359]; the list holds three State 20 clinics (two Operator 13, one Operator 11). Deal A's public list holds 924 company-operated clinics, 938 with a trade-area income [I, C-PUB-1], a later and smaller set than the 983 company-operated clinics at 27 June 2026 [F, DLA-0399]. Deal B's list is the 96 clinics on its site, 95 with a trade area [I, C-PUB-1], against 103 general practice and preventive clinics in the supplied documents for the twelve months to March 2026 [F, DLB-5814]. For clinic counts the supplied documents govern; each public list is used only as the base for mapping. Deal B's own trade-area figures, by acquisition cohort, are set beside the public ones in Part 06 section C.

A Operator 1-banner clinic stands within three miles of 38.8% of Deal B's clinics and 35.5% of Deal A's clinics, about four in ten, and within five miles of 51.4% and 46.8% [I, C-PUB-2]. For Deal C the share is 5.6%, 5 of the 69 clinics with coordinates, at either distance [I, C-PUB-2]. Three of the five are State 20 clinics, and the public list holds three State 20 clinics (two Operator 13, one Operator 11) against 16 Operator 13 clinics in the supplied documents [M, DLC-4341], so the share describes the clinics mapped. Operator 1 is mapped for its own banner only, 1,394 clinics [F, PUB-0070], so competition is understated where its other banners trade.

Concentration runs the other way. The five largest metro areas hold 54.7% of the Deal C clinics mapped, 32.7% of Deal B's clinics and 14.1% of Deal A's clinics [I, C-PUB-3]. City 3 and City 4 alone hold 31 of Deal C's 72 mapped clinics, and City 2 21 of Deal B's 96 [I, C-PUB-3].

Exhibit 9.102 — At 30 September 2026 the five largest metro areas held 54.7% of the Deal C clinics mapped, 32.7% of Deal B's clinics and 14.1% of Deal A's clinics

Clinics by state and by metro or micro area, count and share of the clinics on each public list; read on 30 September 2026

DEAL	CLINICS COUNTED	THREE LARGEST STATES	LARGEST METRO AREA	FIVE LARGEST METRO AREAS TOGETHER	METRO AND MICRO AREAS WITH A CLINIC	REFERENCE
Deal B	96 clinics on the company site	ST-27 33 (28%); ST-22 20 (15%); ST-70 13 (9%)	City 2-City 21-City 22, ST-27: 21 (18.1%)	38 clinics (32.7%)	42	[I, C-PUB-3]
Deal C	72 clinics mapped of about 86	ST-59 23 (28%); ST-46 21 (27%); ST-53 13 (14%)	City 3-Aurora-Centennial, ST-59: 18 (19.6%)	44 clinics (54.7%)	21	[I, C-PUB-3]
Deal A	924 clinics on the public clinic list	ST-17 116 (12%); ST-50 90 (9%); ST-51 90 (9%)	City 7-City 32-City 8, ST-72: 34 (3.2%)	154 clinics (14.1%)	182	[I, C-PUB-3]

Source: Company clinic lists and location pages read on 30 September 2026; U.S. Office of Management and Budget delineation of metro and micro areas, July 2023; our computation [I, C-PUB-3] · Basis: Shares are of the clinics on each public list, not of the clinic counts in the company records. Deal C: 72 clinics mapped of about 86; the list holds three State 20 clinics (two Operator 13, one

Operator 11) against 16 Operator 13 clinics in the supplied documents [M, DLC-4341], so State 20 is understated. Deal A: company-operated clinics on its public clinic list. Areas are metropolitan and micropolitan statistical areas

Price, guarantees and affiliations. Posted treatment guarantee terms run from 3 months to 52 months across the operators read, and the terms differ in scope. Operator 11 and Operator 15 post 52 months or up to $42,801 of covered treatment [F, PUB-0071] [F, PUB-0072]; Sponsor 3 posts 43 months or up to $42,553 [F, PUB-0073]; Operator 17 states 52 months on its home page [F, PUB-0074] and 43 on its partners page [F, PUB-0075]. Operator 11's guarantee requires a wellness visit at an Operator 11 location at least twice a year [F, PUB-0076], and Operator 15's a visit at least once every 12 months [F, PUB-0077]. Deal B posts 21 months or up to $21,161, with exclusions [F, PUB-0078]. Deal A posts a dental treatment guarantee of 12 or 21 months by package [F, PUB-0079] [F, PUB-0080], and Operator 1 a schedule running from 3 months on wellness exam services to 12 months on dental work in the part read [F, PUB-0081] [F, PUB-0082]. The terms are not ranked, and a posted term says nothing about guarantee cost.

Exhibit 9.103 — Posted guarantees at 30 September 2026 run 3 to 52 months and differ in scope: four Deal C brands 43 to 52, Deal B 21, Deal A 12 or 21 on dental treatment

Length of the treatment guarantee each operator or brand posts on its own site, months; read on 30 September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Guarantee and service pages of each company's own site, read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: Posted terms only, in months; dollar limits and conditions are not drawn. Four brand sites of Deal C are shown; Operator 13's guarantee page was not read. The terms do not share one scope: Deal A's is the guarantee on dental treatment; Operator 1's is a schedule by service, of which the shortest and the longest term read are drawn; the others are general treatment guarantees. Operator 17 states 52 months on its home page and 43 on its partners page. Two peers outside the supplied documents are reference marks only. The terms are not ranked. A posted term is an offer to customers; it is no evidence of guarantee cost or claims

Deal A posts its fees. Its pages show a prescription dispensing fee of $32.12 per prescription [F, PUB-0083], a medical waste disposal fee averaging $4.27 per visit [F, PUB-0084], a clinic-supply charge of up to 12% and no more than $43.58 [F, PUB-0085] [F, PUB-0086], and dental packages from $204.55 [F, PUB-0087]. Two Deal C brands post wellness-visit offer prices; Deal B posts offers without a list price on the pages read.

Exhibit 9.104 — At 30 September 2026 Deal A posts its dispensing, disposal and clinic-supply charges, two Deal C brands post wellness-visit offers and Deal B posts offers without a list price

Prices, fees and offers as posted on each company's own pages, US dollars; read on 30 September 2026

OPERATOR OR BRAND	ITEM	AS POSTED	REFERENCE
Deal A	Prescription dispensing	$32.12 per prescription, including refill reminders and dose checks	[F, PUB-0083]
Deal A	Medical waste disposal fee	$4.27 per visit on average; varies by state	[F, PUB-0084]
Deal A	Clinic-supply charge	up to 12% of the bill, no greater than $43.58	[F, PUB-0085, PUB-0086]
Deal A	Dental packages	from $204.55	[F, PUB-0087]
Deal C · Sponsor 3	Comprehensive wellness exam	$70.95, most pets; offer to 28 October 2026	[F, PUB-0309]
Deal C · Operator 11	Vaccine visit	$42 core vaccines; $57 core plus lifestyle vaccines; offer	[F, PUB-0310, PUB-0311]
Deal B	Offers	$21 off any wellness exam; 17% off any dental cleaning; both to 31 October 2026	[F, PUB-0312, PUB-0313]

Source: Deal A, Sponsor 3, Operator 11 and Deal B pages, read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: Posted prices and offers only, as worded on the page. The services differ, so the rows are not a price comparison. A posted price is not the price paid; ticket and mix are in the company records

On affiliations, Sponsor 3 and Operator 17 describe themselves as Pet Retailer 4 partner clinics and accredited hospitals [M, PUB-0088] [M, PUB-0089], Operator 15 states that it has an advanced-certified veterinarian at every location [M, PUB-0090], Operator 11 and Operator 13 show an Animal Health Manufacturer 1 partner-clinic badge [M, PUB-0091], and Deal A describes its veterinarians as "many specialty certified" [M, PUB-0092].

Customer-facing technology. The smaller operators show the same booking and pharmacy-search tools; the larger ones run these on their own sites. Booking Vendor 1 is the booking tool visible at Deal B, on five Deal C brand sites and at Operator 2, Operator 5 and Operator 8, and Pharmacy Vendor 1 the pharmacy tool at three Deal C brands, Operator 2, Operator 5 and Operator 8 [I, PUB-0438]. Of the ten operators read, all show online booking, eight a pharmacy search or online pharmacy and nine consumer financing; four show a digital health report on the pages read [I, PUB-0438]; Deal A states in its release of 16 June 2026 that 77% of eligible clients receive its digital pet health report card [M, PUB-0302]. The table

records what a home page and a few service pages show, not what a clinic uses: Deal B's site shows no digital health report on the pages read, while the company reports an attachment rate of 71.4% in July 2026 [M, DLB-8841].

Exhibit 9.105 — On public pages read on 30 September 2026, all ten operators show online booking, nine consumer financing and eight a pharmacy search or online pharmacy; four show a digital health report

What each operator's public site shows a customer, by function, with the vendor or tool where the page names it; read on 30 September 2026

OPERATOR	ONLINE BOOKING	PHARMACY SEARCH OR PURCHASE ONLINE	DIGITAL HEALTH REPORT	CONSUMER FINANCING	REFERENCE
Deal A	seen: booking page on the company site	seen: pharmacy pages on the company site (search by species, weight and product; refills booked online)	not seen on the pages read; the company states in its release of 16 June 2026 that 77% of eligible clients receive its digital pet health report card [M, PUB-0302]	seen: a consumer finance provider	[F, PUB-0233, PUB-0234, PUB-0235]
Deal B	seen: Booking Vendor 1	not seen on the pages read	not seen on the pages read; the company reports a health-report attachment rate of 71.4% in July 2026 [M, DLB-8841]	seen: two consumer finance providers	[F, PUB-0237, PUB-0238]
Deal C (brand sites)	seen: Booking Vendor 1 on five brand sites	seen: Pharmacy Vendor 1 on three brand sites (Operator 11, Operator 13, Operator 17)	seen: on three brand sites (Operator 17, Operator 15, Sponsor 3)	seen: on one brand site (Operator 15, six months interest free)	[F, PUB-0239, PUB-0240, PUB-0241, PUB-0242]
Operator 1	seen: booking page on the company site	seen: online pharmacy with cart	not seen on the pages read	seen: two consumer finance providers, Animal Health Manufacturer 3 card, a lease-to-own provider	[F, PUB-0243, PUB-0244, PUB-0245]
Operator 2	seen: Booking Vendor 1	seen: Pharmacy Vendor 1	seen: free digital health report, by text or email	seen: a consumer finance provider card, a second consumer finance provider	[F, PUB-0246, PUB-0247, PUB-0248, PUB-0249]
Operator 4	seen: booking page on the company site	seen: online pharmacy with cart	not seen on the pages read	seen: a consumer finance provider	[F, PUB-0250, PUB-0251, PUB-0252]
Operator 9	seen: booking page on the company site	seen: pharmacy search with pickup booked online	not seen on the pages read	seen: Operator 9 card, a consumer finance provider	[F, PUB-0253, PUB-0254, PUB-0255]
Operator 5	seen: Booking Vendor 1	seen: Pharmacy Vendor 1	seen: digital report sent to the customer's phone	seen: a consumer finance provider	[F, PUB-0256, PUB-0257, PUB-0258, PUB-0259]
Operator 8	seen: Booking Vendor 1	seen: Pharmacy Vendor 1	seen: digital health report with a wellness exam	not seen on the pages read	[F, PUB-0260, PUB-0261, PUB-0262]
Operator 6 (one banner site, Lima)	seen: on the banner site	not read	not seen on the pages read	seen: Animal Health Manufacturer 1 consumer finance card	[F, PUB-0263, PUB-0264]

Source: Home pages and selected service pages of each company's own site, read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: A cell records what the pages read show, not what a clinic uses: "seen" means the function is visible on the page, with the tool named where the page names it; "not seen on the pages read" is not a finding that the function is absent. Deal C is read across its brand sites; Operator 6 on one banner site. Deal A's digital health report is the company's own statement in a release [M]; it was not seen on the pages read and is not counted among the four. Counts in the title are ours, over the ten operators [I, PUB-0438]

Regulatory items in the sector. Two agency releases in the last three months name operators in this document; agency records were not searched beyond them. On 28 September 2026 the State 12 Attorney General announced an Assurance of Voluntary Compliance with Operator 1, LLC concerning the company's service recommendations and billing in State 12 [F, PUB-0094], with $189,427 of monetary relief [F, PUB-0095] and a further $88,125 due if the terms are violated [F, PUB-0096]. On 13 July 2026 the U.S. Department of Labor announced that Deal A agreed to pay $155,536 [F, PUB-0097] to settle seven safety violations, one a repeat [F, PUB-0098], and to run an anonymous safety hotline for employees across its 930 locations [F, PUB-0099]. Both rows rest on the agency's release alone.

Exhibit 9.106 — July and September 2026: Operator 1 agreed $189,427 of relief with State 12 over service recommendations and billing, and Deal A $155,536 with the U.S. Department of Labor over seven safety violations

Agency releases naming general practice and preventive operators; date, form, amounts and status as each release states

COMPANY	AGENCY	RELEASE DATE	FORM	SUBJECT	AMOUNTS AND COMMITMENTS	STATUS	REFERENCE
Operator 1, LLC	State 12 Office of Attorney General	28 September 2026	Assurance of Voluntary Compliance, filed in the Philadelphia County Court of Common Pleas	Assurance of Voluntary Compliance concerning the company's service recommendations and billing in State 12	$189,427 ($168,762 restitution for consumers, $22,400 costs); a further $88,125 due if the terms are violated; consumer claims by 26 January 2027	Agreed resolution, as the release states; later status not read	[F, PUB-0094, PUB-0095, PUB-0323, PUB-0324, PUB-0096, PUB-0325]
Deal A	U.S. Department of Labor, Occupational Safety and Health Administration	13 July 2026	Settlement agreement following a federal inspection	Seven safety violations, one of them a repeat violation	$155,536; the company is to run a free, anonymous hotline for employees across its 930 locations to report safety and health concerns	Agreed resolution, as the release states; later status not read	[F, PUB-0097, PUB-0098, PUB-0099]

Source: State 12 Office of Attorney General release of 28 September 2026; U.S. Department of Labor release of 13 July 2026; both read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: Each row rests on the agency's release alone; the filed documents were not read. An Assurance of Voluntary Compliance and a settlement are agreed resolutions. Status is as at the release date. Agency records were not searched beyond these two releases

How the outside signals bear on each deal. The signals differ by deal in coverage as well as in level: Deal A's rest on its whole public clinic list and the largest samples, Deal B's on its own location pages, and Deal C's on the clinics mapped and on single clinics. Exhibit 4.24 sets them out by deal and points to the section holding the company record.

L · Deal A detail

Each Deal A finding of Part 05 rests on the clinic files, filings, closure workbooks and peer comparisons set out here section by section, on the evidence supplied to 30 September 2026; Deal A's clinic figures on Ares Credit Group's co-op-included basis, which rest on the clinic files supplied by 30 September and Ares Credit Group's basis, and the pro forma for the 824 clinics kept, which rests on the 119-clinic list of 1 October 2026, are read in Part 05.

This section holds the secondary evidence behind Part 05. For each of sections A to G it gives the fuller reading, the operator tables and charts, the public signals and what the evidence cannot show. Each section of Part 05 opens on its finding, its charts and at most one table, and links here.

05 A Thesis and readings: supporting evidence

Ares Credit Group's thesis. Ares Credit Group sees Deal A as a large, scaled platform in a turnaround. In Ares Credit Group's view the clinic base expanded too far and left a good number of underperforming clinics. The first round of closures is done; Ares Credit Group is underwriting a second round of 119 closures, which it expects to add about $12m of run-rate EBITDA and to bring Deal A closer in line with comparable operators. Ares Credit Group considers that Deal A's scale and diversity make it an attractive investment at a low leverage multiple [A, Deal A Diligence & Structure Update; M, Project Alpha CIP p.1]. The proposed financing and our observations on it are in Part 08 section B.

Our readings on the evidence supplied to date follow, one per component of the thesis, each with what holds for Ares Credit Group's thesis, what does not, and what would change it.

Exhibit 9.107 — Deal A's reported EBITDA fell from $128.2m in FY24 to $71.2m in FY26 ($56.4m excluding disposal gains) while survivor comp traffic fell in every year from FY24 to Q1 FY27

Clinics, revenue, EBITDA on three definitions, comps, clinic economics, loss-making share, co-op, overhead and conversion; FY22 to Q1 FY27; filings, clinic-level files and bank model

MEASURE (DEFINITION; BASIS)	VALUE	SOURCE
Clinics; net revenue, FY26 (A)	983; $1,029.1m	Deal A FY26 10-K
Reported EBITDA (E1), FY24 → FY26 (A)	$128.2m → $71.2m	Deal A 10-K FY24–FY26 [I]
E1 ex-disposal gains, FY26 / LTM Jun-26 (A)	$56.4m ($16.0m gains removed) / $59.6m ($19.7m removed)	FY26 10-K; Q1 FY27 10-Q [I]
Company non-GAAP EBITDA (E2m, management add-backs), FY26 / LTM Jun-26 / Q1 FY27 vs Q1 FY26 (PF)	$85.6m / $74.9m / $15.4m vs $25.7m	Clinic-level EBITDA file, rec!B25; bank model 'FY27-FY31 P&L' row 181
Survivor comp traffic, FY24 / FY25 / FY26 / Q1 FY27 (common; survivors)	−3.9% / −7.9% / −3.9% / −4.2%	All Clinics KPI Report FY20–Q1 FY27, tabs FY24–Q1 FY27

MEASURE (DEFINITION; BASIS)	VALUE	SOURCE
Survivor comp ticket vs CPI veterinarian services, FY24 / FY25 / FY26	+3.0% vs +8.6%; +4.1% vs +5.1%; +5.4% vs +5.4%	All Clinics KPI Report; BLS CUUR0000SS62053 [I]
Clinic EBITDA before co-op, FY26 (R-OPONLY; open clinics)	$91.0m, 7.9% of sales (R-OPONLY); $64.6m, 5.4%, after $29.9m of finance-lease book cost (depreciation plus interest), an R-BOOK approximation of D1.1	Clinic-level EBITDA file, tabs rec and FY26
Loss-making clinics, FY23 / FY24 / FY25 / FY26 (all clinics open at year-end; before co-op)	31.4% / 27.2% / 34.3% / 28.7%	Clinic-level EBITDA file, tabs FY23–FY26 [I]
Clinic EBITDA including co-op allocated at 5.15% of clinic sales (Ares Credit Group's basis), FY26 (A; the 824 clinics kept after the second round PF)	12.8% of sales; 10.7% after finance-lease book cost; the 824 clinics kept 14.4% and 12.5%; loss-making clinics 19.5% (11.4% of the 824)	Clinic-level EBITDA file, tab FY26; New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26), Clinic Helper; FY27 Closing Clinics Financial Analysis; Part 05 section E [I]
Co-op, FY26	$57.8m; 5.1% of sales (peers 2.9–10.9%; no period overlap except Operator 3)	Clinic-level EBITDA file, rec!B16
Corporate overhead, FY22 → FY26	$44.4m (3.3% of revenue) → $55.0m (4.7%)	OSG&A Expenses FY17–FY27, OSGA row 12
Conversion after total capex, FY26 / LTM Jun-26 / median of 20 steady years (FY2000–26)	0.52 (0.44 ex-gains) / 0.55 (0.47 ex-gains) / 0.64	Deal A 10-K and 10-Q series [I]

Source: Deal A 10-K FY24–FY26 and Q1 FY27 10-Q; All Clinics KPI Report FY20–Q1 FY27; Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file FY23–FY26; bank model 'FY27-FY31 P&L' row 181; OSG&A Expenses FY17–FY27; BLS CUUR0000SS62053; as cited in each row · Basis: A, except company non-GAAP EBITDA (PF); computed rows [I] · Assumption: A-03, A-05, A-07

Drivers of underperformance. The weakness is broad rather than confined to a closeable tail. Across the clinics kept after the first round, LTM visits fell 26% between March 2020 and June 2026 and LTM clinic profit fell from $66.6m to $22.8m (−58%); on the all-clinic basis a third of clinics lost money before co-op in each year FY23–FY26, including after the first round [F, New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26), 'Clinic Helper'; F/I, Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file, tabs FY23–FY26]. Outside the market-wide shocks of 2020–21 the evidence points to company-specific execution: we would attribute about 2–5 points of Deal A's average traffic decline of −5.1% a year in FY23–FY26 to the industry trend and the remainder to Deal A [I, Part 09 section J, 03 A "Durable, temporary, company-specific"; "Market versus execution" under 05 B below; note C-02]. On the common definitions Deal A is last of three on traffic and same-store sales in 2024–26 (Exhibit 9.120), and before co-op its four-wall margin sits at or below the floor of the 9–16% core band (Exhibit 9.125).

First-round closures. The FY26 round closed 129 clinics on the company's closed-clinic list (Part 05 section C gives the counts in the 10-K and the clinic-EBITDA file). The closed set lost $16.0m of clinic EBITDA in FY25 and the round realised about $24m of net proceeds, yet reported EBITDA ex-gains still fell 33.2% in FY26 ($86.6m to $56.4m), and no peer file measures a closure outcome or a sales transfer [F/I, clinic-level EBITDA file, FY25 tab; Project Alpha CIP p.1; Deal A 10-K FY25–FY26; Part 05 section C].

Second round, bounded. The 119 candidates had TTM sales of $68.9m, profit including co-op of −$19.6m and net book value of $54.8m; management estimates a $12m pro forma improvement after 13% sales recapture and "~$31mm" of one-time closing cost before monetisation, which the company's workbook builds as $21.79m of occupancy and maintenance cash to lease end plus $9.63m of finance-lease interest [M, Project Alpha CIP p.1; Clinic Closing Slides from Board Deck p.1]. The schedule shows 16 owned, 54 operating-lease and 51 finance-lease clinics with a lease-liability present value of $65.0m, and Ares Credit Group's model books $4.3m of closure cash, in FY28, and $4.3m of professional fees [F, Alpha FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J9, J31:J33, J37:J43; A, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!F20:I20, F21]. On the evidence we have, the bounded view is a gross loss reversal of about $12–13m, of which $3.4–4.3m rests on the unmeasured recapture assumption, less up to $2.1–4.7m a year of stranded corporate overhead (an upper bound that assumes all overhead attributable to the 119 clinics stays behind; $3.9m at Deal A's own ratio) and $1.1–1.9m of stranded advertising, taken at Deal A's consolidated advertising expense of 1.59–2.36% of sales in FY25–FY26, against up to $21.79m of closure cash over the remaining lease terms, about $5.3m a year, plus, if no operating lease is exited, about $5.75m a year of operating-lease rent (about $20m over the 37.8-month average remaining term of the 54 operating leases) that is in neither the $12m nor the $21.79m; finance-lease rent continues in the lease lines of Ares Credit Group's model [I, 05 D below; Operator 3 lender model; Operator 7 credit databook tab 10].

Earnings quality and cash. Disposal gains sit inside reported EBITDA: $16.0m of FY26's $71.2m and $19.7m of the LTM June 2026 $81.1m, leaving $56.4m and $59.6m [F/I, FY26 10-K; Q1 FY27 10-Q]. After capex, FY26 EBITDA converted at 0.52 (0.44 excluding disposal gains), and a $35.8m working-capital release added to cash in the year; the management plan returns conversion to Deal A's 20-year median by FY31 [I, Deal A 10-K and 10-Q series; Part 05 section F]. Deal A's cash after interest and finance-lease payments, and debt service under the proposed financing, are set out in Part 08 section B.

Sale context. The sale process described in Ares Credit Group's materials bears on the financing reading and is set out in Part 08 section B.

What would sharpen the readings. The requests that would most change a reading, and the full list for the company, are in Part 05 section G.

05 B Underperformance drivers: supporting evidence

On the data we have, the weakness is broad rather than confined to the closure candidates. Across the 983 clinics retained after the first closure round, LTM clinic visits fell from 4.60m at March 2020 to 3.25m at March 2026 and 3.16m at June 2026, a 26% decline; raw clinic EBITDA fell from $123.5m (March 2024) to $91.0m (March 2026); LTM clinic profit fell from $66.6m to $22.8m (June 2026), a 58% decline [F, New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26) 'Clinic Helper'; 1.0.4_Store-level EBITDA FY23-FY26; DLA-0834]. In Q1 FY27 comparable traffic fell 4.2% with average patient invoice up 3.0% (sales −1.3%), and clinic profit fell 61% year on year [F, 1.0.2_All Clinics KPI Report Q1 FY27 sheet, 984 clinics]. Consolidated company non-GAAP EBITDA (E2m, PF) was $85.6m in FY26 and $74.9m for the twelve months to June 2026; Q1 FY27 was $15.4m against $25.7m a year earlier (−34%) [F, bank model 'FY27-FY31 P&L' row 181; DLA-0854]. On the audited rung the decline is steeper: D3 E1 fell from $128.2m in FY24 to $71.2m in FY26, and to $56.4m once $16.0m of FY26 disposal gains are removed (E1 ex-gains; A) [F/I, DLA-0317, DLA-0315].

Exhibit 9.108 — The 983 clinics Deal A kept after its first round of closures have lost 26% of their visits since FY20 and 58% of their profit since FY24 (to LTM June 2026)

983 clinics retained after the first closure round, last twelve months: visits (million) March 2020 to June 2026; clinic EBITDA before co-op ($m) March 2024 to March 2026; clinic profit ($m) March 2024 to June 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A All Clinics KPI Report (FY20 to Q1 FY27); Ares Credit Group New Deal A Data Cuts (Aug-26); Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file FY23 to FY26. Rows DLA-0562; DLA-0762; DLA-4967; DLA-3747; DLA-3752; DLA-3757; DLA-0718; DLA-0750; DLA-0782; DLA-3704 · Basis: All values actual (A) on the 983 clinics retained after the first closure round, so closed clinics are out of every period. Clinic EBITDA is before vendor co-op and on operating-lease rent only; clinic profit is the company's own clinic profit line. Periods are last twelve months to the date shown. Two sources differ slightly on four values. Clinic EBITDA is shown from Ares Credit Group's data cuts ($128.39m, $99.45m, $93.56m); the company's clinic-level EBITDA file gives $125.23m, $98.44m and $92.72m on its own clinic base. Clinic profit for March 2025 is shown from the company KPI report ($39.46m); Ares Credit Group's data cuts give $39.01m

The tail is stable, not shrinking. On the all-clinic basis (every clinic open at each fiscal year-end, including later-closed clinics; clinic EBITDA before co-op, R-OPONLY), 31.4%, 27.2%, 34.3% and 28.7% of clinics lost money in FY23–FY26 [F/I, A3-P5-006..009]. The share was still a third after the first round closed 129 clinics (in the clinic-EBITDA file's 127-clinic closed cohort, 129 had negative FY25 clinic EBITDA), and the 161 clinics flagged in the FY23 tab as later closed, the first-round clinics among them, were 70.4% loss-making in FY23 [F/I, DLA-0962; DLA-0929, DLA-0934]. The survivor-join series (24.2% to 28.7%), which would suggest a rising tail, reflects survivorship rather than a trend [I]. Allocating vendor co-op at 5.15% of sales reduces the FY26 count from 324 to 218 clinics (19.5%), which changes the appearance of clinics without creating consolidated cash; management's own "negative profit clinic count" was 475 at March 2026 and 513 at June 2026 on a clinic-profit basis [F, 1.0.4 FY26!M15:M1129; New Deal A Data Cuts Sheet9!AE19:AE1133; Updated Data Summary p2].

Mix, region or clinic. Within Deal A, clinic-margin dispersion is not explained by mix or geography: pharmacy share explains 0.3% (FY23) and 1.6% (FY26) of the variance and region 4.0% and 6.7%, against 29.8% and 34.3% for clinic sales level [F/I, A4-S0206, A4-S0217, A4-S0207, A4-S0218, A4-S0208, A4-S0219]. The same pattern holds at Operator 1, Operator 2 and Operator 3 (mix at most 8% at Operator 1 and Operator 2; sales level 24–50% in five of eight datasets), and Deal A's rank persistence and sales-level share sit inside the peer ranges (Exhibit 9.120) [I, note C-29; note C-27]. Deal A's clinic-level structure is therefore normal for the subsector; its level is not. Sales level is largely operating leverage, so this does not by itself separate site from execution [I, note C-29].

The persistence is inside the peer range (51–52% of Deal A clinics keep their quartile, against 34–62% across six operators), so Deal A's bottom quartile is a stable, identifiable group [I, note C-27]. That supports the premise of rationalisation; whether closing it lifts the remainder is tested in Part 05 section C, Part 05 section D and Part 05 section E [I].

How the estate was built. Deal A's revenue grew from $103m in FY1996 to a $1,202m peak in FY2022 as its estate doubled from 534 clinics in FY2006, and its E1 margin fell from 12.0% in FY2022 to 6.2% in FY2026 [F/I, public series DLA_REV, DLA_STORES_EOP, DLA_EBITDA_E1_MARGIN].

Exhibit 9.109 — Deal A's revenue grew from $103m in FY1996 to a $1,202m peak in FY2022 as its estate doubled from 534 clinics in FY2006; E1 margin fell from 12.0% in FY2022 to 6.2% in FY2026

Deal A revenue ($m, FY1996 to FY2026), clinics at fiscal year-end (FY2006 to FY2026) and reported EBITDA (E1) ÷ revenue (%, FY1996 to FY2026); fiscal years ending March

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A 10-K filings, FY1998 to FY2026 (SEC EDGAR): statements of income and selected operating data; margin is a CreditSwan computation from the filed figures; filing address per year in the data file; public series DLA_REV, DLA_STORES_EOP and DLA_EBITDA_E1_MARGIN, retrieved 28 September 2026 · Basis: Actual (A); E1 = EBITDA as reported; FY2026 E1 includes $16.0m of gains on disposal

The growth came from acquisitions: from FY2010 to FY2026 acquisitions took $728m while cumulative E1 was $2,052m [I, note C-62]. The margin decline since FY2022 is what the turnaround plan has to reverse [I, DLA_EBITDA_E1_MARGIN].

The long comp record, shown side by side. The long panel is context only, and no position is drawn from it. Deal A's public comp (SSS_ST-59: clinics open one full fiscal year, all-clinic base, closures leave when they close, fiscal April–March) has a mean of +0.5% over 18 fiscal years with nine negative years [F/I, DLA-0336..0363]. The other long series are on different definitions: Operator 4's panel comp (SSS_ST-59, definition not stated, calendar 2010–25) has a mean of +4.2% with one negative year, and the Operator 2 lineage (SSS_ST-59 and SSS_CD mixed, 2007–25) +2.4% with six [I, OP4-0541..0556; note C-43]. Operator 1 has a clinic-level SSS_CD (CLOSE-FWD) for its fiscal year to May 2009 and for calendar 2010–17 and 2019–22 only; set against Deal A's public SSS_ST-59 the entry rule, closure treatment and fiscal period all differ, so no year-by-year count is drawn [F/I, OP1-2114; OP1-5126..5133, OP1-8856..8859]. The Operator 1 and Deal A comp panel in Operator 4's investment memo does not support a year-by-year count of Deal A against Operator 1 (Exhibit 9.121); the market-versus-execution reading rests on the common-definition rankings.

Exhibit 9.110 — Deal A's comparable-clinic sales averaged +0.5% a year over FY2006–FY2026, with nine negative years

Deal A comparable-clinic sales growth as reported, by fiscal year (April to March), %, FY2006 to FY2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A 10-K filings, FY2010 to FY2026 (SEC EDGAR), selected operating data; filing address per year in the data file; public series DLA_SSS, retrieved 28 September 2026; note C-43 · Basis: Actual (A); company definition of comparable-clinic sales, as published, not adjusted for selling days; FY26 had 311 selling days, as did FY25 (FY26 10-K), so the reported +1.2% needs no selling-day adjustment

Operator 4 averaged +4.2% (calendar 2010–25, definition not stated) and the Operator 2 lineage +2.4% (2007–25, mixed definitions); on different definitions and periods these are context only and are not ranked against Deal A [I, note C-43]. Deal A's two largest moves, FY2021 (−9.5%) and FY2022 (+13.2%), were the market-wide COVID20 and REOPEN21 shocks [F, DLA_SSS; I, Exhibit 3.19].

Market versus execution. On common definitions, where they exist, the evidence answers the question; the rest is shown side by side with the definition stated. Shocks are market-wide: in COVID20 all five core operators with a comparable-sales reading were negative, from −2.7% to −9.5%, and in REOPEN21 seven operators printed +11.8% to +15.3% with a 1.4pp cross-operator standard deviation [F/I, Exhibit 3.19; note C-42]. On those mixed definitions (Exhibit 3.19 is not like-for-like), Deal A's public comp was the lowest reading in COVID20 (FY21 −9.5%; survivor SSS_CD −11.4%, survivor comp traffic −18.6% with ticket +9.2%) and inside the REOPEN21 range (FY22 +13.2%) [F, DLA-0356; I, DLA-0628, DLA-0629, DLA-0630; F, DLA-0357]; the COVID traffic figure is shown beside Operator 2's −15.1% and Operator 5' −11.4% (calendar 2020, CLOSE-FWD) for context only, because that pair is not valid on the common definitions [I, OP2-3526, OP5-3871; Exhibit 9.121]. In the GFC Deal A's public comp was positive (FY08 +1.0%, FY09 +5.9%; FY10, mostly after the GFC window, +6.2%), as was Operator 1' clinic-level SSS_CD (FY09 +8.8% total, +4.5% retail), while Operator 10 fell 4.7% in 2008; these are different definitions and are not ranked [F, DLA-0338, DLA-0340, DLA-0341; OP1-2114, OP1-2115; OP2-0651; Exhibit 9.62]. Outside shocks the evidence points to execution. On the like-for-like SSS_CD-family rows, year effects explain 0.61 of comp variance against 0.20 for operator effects, but that sample includes 2020–21; on the best-available panel excluding 2020–21 the operator effect (0.32) is as large as the year effect (0.31), with definition differences carried inside the operator term [I, note C-54]. In SOFT24-26 Deal A is last in all three common-definition traffic and SSS rankings (R2, R8, R9 in Exhibit 9.120) and second of three on ticket net of CPI (R4) only because Operator 6's ticket fell, and its survivor comp traffic of −7.9% in FY25 and −3.9% in FY26 sits 1.2–5.1pp below the −2.8% median of the seven core operators with a 2024–26 reading, a median that includes Deal A's own FY26 reading and is taken on mixed bases and periods [I, DLA-0757, DLA-0789; Exhibit 9.63]; the SOFT24-26 median charted in Exhibit 9.111, taken over six platform-years, is −2.9%. The environment analysis in Parts 03 and 04 attributes about 2–5pp a year of Deal A's FY23–FY26 traffic decline (average −5.1%) to the industry trend and the remainder to Deal A [I, Part 09 section J, 03 A "Durable, temporary, company-specific"; note C-02]. Deal A's ticket kept pace with veterinary price inflation only in FY26: survivor comp ticket rose +3.0%, +4.1% and +5.4% in FY24–FY26 against CPI veterinarian services of +8.6%, +5.1% and +5.4% [I, DLA-0726, DLA-0758, DLA-0790; CUUR0000SS62053]. The data do not show that pricing caused the traffic loss [I, note C-09].

Exhibit 9.111 — Deal A's survivor comp traffic was below the core median of every environment FY20 to FY26 except the REOPEN21 rebound, where it matched it

Comparable-clinic traffic and ticket, % change year on year, fiscal years ending March, FY20 to FY26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A All Clinics KPI Report (FY20 to Q1 FY27); operator files supplied by Ares Credit Group for the environment medians; Operator 2 and Operator 5 clinic files. Rows DLA-0597; DLA-0629; DLA-0661; DLA-0693; DLA-0725; DLA-0757; DLA-0789; DLA-0630; DLA-0662; DLA-0694; DLA-0726; DLA-0758; DLA-0790; A1-P5-008; A1-P5-007; A1-P5-010; A1-P5-009; A1-P5-011; OP2-3526; OP5-3871 · Basis: Deal A: actual (A), survivor base of 983 clinics with closed clinics removed from every year. Diamonds: median comp traffic across core operators in the environment each fiscal year falls in (mixed closure treatments; they include Deal A's own fiscal years); a multi-year environment repeats one median, and the value beside each environment name is that median. The SOFT24-26 median (−2.9%) is taken over six platform-years: Deal A FY25 and FY26, Operator 3 2024, Operator 6 2025, Operator 8 2025 and Operator 7 2025; the −2.8% in the text is the median of the latest reading of seven core operators. FY24 falls in INFL22-23, which holds most of its months. Operator 2 (-16.9%) and Operator 5 (-13.2%) are calendar 2020 with closed clinics kept until closure: context only, not a like-for-like pair with Deal A FY21. The file has no FY20 ticket value

Deal A's survivor comp traffic sat below the core median of every environment from FY20 to FY26 except the REOPEN21 rebound, where it matched it [I, Exhibit 9.111]. The medians mix closure treatments and include Deal A's own years, so the figure shows direction rather than a measured gap; the like-for-like rankings are in Exhibit 9.120.

Our reading on M1 and M4, on the evidence supplied to date: contradicted. The evidence supplied runs against the premise that the underperformance is concentrated in a closeable tail (M1): the weakness is broad across the retained clinics, a third of clinics lose money in every year FY23–FY26 including after the first round, and region and mix explain little of the clinic dispersion. It also runs against the premise that the remaining platform performs in line with peers (M4): the retained (survivor) estate is last on every common-definition traffic and same-store-sales ranking in 2024–26 (Exhibit 9.120), and its clinic profit has fallen 58% since FY24. What would change this reading: closed-clinic KPI history that allowed true CLOSE-FWD comps, finance-lease cash cost and cash rent by clinic for a D1.1 four-wall, and current trading showing that the decline has stopped.

Public signals

Pages were read on 30 September 2026. Four in ten Deal A clinics trade within three miles of an Operator 1-banner clinic: 388 of the 924 company-operated clinics on Deal A's public list (35.5%); the supplied FY26 count of 983 clinics governs, and the public list is used only as the mapping base; by banner, on the same list, the share is 48.6% for Deal A Banner 1, 42.1% for Deal A Banner 2 and 37.8% for Deal A [I, C-PUB-2]. Only Operator 1' own banner is mapped.

Exhibit 9.112 — On 30 September 2026 an Operator 1-banner clinic stood within three miles of 69% of Deal A's clinics in State 20 and 64% in State 01, and of none in State 46

Share of Deal A company-operated clinics with an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles, %, states with at least 26 Deal A clinics, public clinic lists read on 30 September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A public clinic list and Operator 1 clinic pages, both read on 30 September 2026; our computation [I, C-PUB-2] · Basis: Actual (A) positions on the day the lists were read. 924 company-operated clinics on Deal A's public list, which shows open clinics; the eleven states shown hold 708 of them. The supplied FY26 clinic count (983, clinic-level file) governs; the public list is used only as the mapping base. Distance is great-circle from each Deal A clinic to the nearest of 1,394 Operator 1-banner clinics with coordinates. Only Operator 1' own banner is mapped; other banners under the same ownership are not · Assumption: A clinic counts as having an Operator 1 nearby when the nearest Operator 1-banner clinic is at most 2.6 miles away in a straight line; drive time is not measured

Proximity to Operator 1 does not separate Deal A's loss-making clinics from the rest. On the company's FY26 clinic-level file (983 clinics; 324 loss-making), 24.7% of clinics with an Operator 1 within three miles lost money, against 33.0% of those without; within the same state and banner the difference is +0.8 points, indistinguishable from none [I, C-PUB-6]. This is one year's cross-section of the surviving estate: the 165 clinics closed before the FY26 file date (28 March 2026) carry no address in the supplied files, and 46 clinics sit at their ZIP-code centre.

Exhibit 9.113 — In FY26 Deal A clinics with an Operator 1 within three miles were loss-making less often than those without (24.7% against 33.0%), and the gap disappears within the same state and banner (+0.8 points)

Share of Deal A clinics with negative clinic-level EBITDA in fiscal 2026, by whether an Operator 1-banner clinic stood within three miles on 30 September 2026; 983 clinics

CLINICS	WITH AN OPERATOR 1 WITHIN 3 MILES: CLINICS	OF WHICH LOSS-MAKING	SHARE	WITHOUT: CLINICS	OF WHICH LOSS-MAKING	SHARE	DIFFERENCE (POINTS)	REFERENCE
All FY26 clinics	399	112	24.7 %	574	218	33.0 %	−7.4	[I, C-PUB-6]
Deal A Banner 1	152	42	25.4 %	107	27	21.7 %	+3.6	[I, C-PUB-6]
Deal A	107	26	20.7 %	149	52	31.4 %	−9.8	[I, C-PUB-6]
Deal A Banner 2	122	38	28.2 %	134	70	44.5 %	−17.3	[I, C-PUB-6]
Within the same state and banner (28 groups, 779 clinics)	381	n/a	n/a	391	n/a	n/a	+0.8 (interval −4.6 to +6.0)	[I, C-PUB-6]

Source: Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file FY23–FY26 (as of 28 March 2026), FY26 tab; Deal A clinic master (9 June 2026); Deal A public clinic list and Operator 1 clinic pages read on 30 September 2026; our computation [I, C-PUB-6] · Basis: Actual (A) fiscal 2026 clinic results; loss-making = negative clinic-level EBITDA (324 of 983 clinics). A cross-section of one year on the clinics open at 28 March 2026. The 165 clinics closed before the file date (28 March 2026) carry no address in the supplied files and are not covered. 924 clinics are located by clinic number on the public list and 46 at the centre of their ZIP code. Only Operator 1' own banner is mapped, as it stood on 30 September 2026. Banners with fewer than ten clinics on either side are not shown · Assumption: Within state and banner = Mantel-Haenszel common difference over the 28 state-and-banner groups that hold clinics on both sides (779 clinics); the 82% interval of −4.6 to +6.0 points is descriptive

Advertising expense doubled between fiscal 2024 and 2026: $13.1m, $16.1m and $26.6m [F, DLA-1259; DLA-1242; DLA-1226], or 1.05%, 1.38% and 2.36% of sales [I, C-PUB-8]. Comparable traffic fell in each year, by 3.9%, 7.9% and 3.9% [I, DLA-0725; DLA-0757; DLA-0789]. The two are shown together for timing only. The 10-Q for the quarter to 27 June 2026 reports a further $4.2m increase in clinic advertising [F, PUB-0100].

Exhibit 9.114 — Deal A's advertising expense rose from $13.1m (1.05% of sales) in fiscal 2024 to $26.6m (2.36%) in fiscal 2026; comparable traffic fell in each of the three years

Advertising expense, US$ m and % of sales, and comparable-clinic traffic, % change year on year; fiscal years ending March 2024 to 2026; Deal A Forms 10-K and the All Clinics KPI Report

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A Form 10-K for fiscal 2026 (advertising expense, sales); Deal A All Clinics KPI Report (comparable traffic, as in the exhibit on Deal A's traffic path). [F, DLA-1259; DLA-1242; DLA-1226; DLA-0015; DLA-0016; DLA-0017] [I, DLA-0725; DLA-0757; DLA-0789; C-PUB-8] · Basis: Actual (A). Advertising and sales are consolidated figures as reported; traffic is on the survivor base, with closed clinics removed from every year, so the two series do not share a clinic base. The two series are shown together for timing only; the exhibit does not measure what advertising returned · Assumption: Share of sales = advertising expense divided by sales of the same fiscal year

Employer, hiring, leadership, systems and complaint figures are in Exhibit 9.115; each stands alone. OSHA announced a $155,536 settlement of seven safety violations on 13 July 2026 [F, PUB-0097; PUB-0098]; the EEOC announced a $173,450 settlement on 8 February 2023, under a consent decree with a two-year term from February 2023 [F, PUB-0102].

Exhibit 9.115 — On 30 September 2026 Deal A carried employer ratings of 2.2 out of 5 on an employer review site and 2.1 on a job board, 258 open postings (177 for veterinarians) and 907 complaints in three years, about 0.77 per clinic

Ratings, posted terms, postings, leadership dates, company statements, complaint counts and one agency release; each with its source, sample and date; no figure is set against another

SIGNAL	WHAT THE SOURCE SHOWS	SAMPLE OR FORM	DATE	REFERENCE
Employer rating, employer review site	2.2 out of 5	376 reviews	Read 30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0053; PUB-0054]
Would recommend to a friend, employer review site	12%	Same page	Read 30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0061]
Employer rating, job board	2.4 out of 5	1,870 reviews	Page updated 27 September 2026	[F, PUB-0291]

SIGNAL	WHAT THE SOURCE SHOWS	SAMPLE OR FORM	DATE	REFERENCE
Posted pay, general service veterinary assistant	$12 to $16 an hour across four postings listed on ZipRecruiter	Four postings (State 27, State 16, State 20); entry-level roles	Listed 30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0292]
Open postings, company job board	258	All postings on the board	30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0293]
of which veterinarian roles	177	Classified by posting title	30 September 2026	[I, PUB-0294; C-PUB-10]
of which first published April to December 2025	261	Publication date on each posting	30 September 2026	[I, PUB-0295; C-PUB-10]
Chief executive	Change of chief executive	Form 8-K	23–28 March 2025	[F, PUB-0296; PUB-0297]
Chief executive	Employment agreement signed and board seat taken	Form 8-K	2 December 2025	[F, PUB-0298]
Chief financial officer	The same officer is named in the role in October 2023 and signed the fiscal 2026 Form 10-K	Form 8-K; Form 10-K	25 October 2023; 27 May 2026	[F, PUB-0299]
Senior vice president, operations	Appointed	Form 8-K	5 February 2025	[F, PUB-0300]
Chief human resources officer	Left the role	Form 8-K	Effective 30 March 2024	[F, PUB-0301]
Digital health report (ConfiCare)	The company says 77% of eligible patients receive a digital health report	Company release	16 June 2026	[M, PUB-0302]
Online booking and pharmacy search	An appointment page and a pharmacy search by species, product and weight band are on the company's site	[website]	Read 30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0303; PUB-0304]
Complaints, consumer complaints body	907 in the last three years; 288 closed in the last twelve months	BBB business profile	Read 30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0034; PUB-0035]
Complaints per clinic, three years	About 0.77	907 complaints over 983 company-operated clinics at 27 June 2026 [F, DLA-0399]	Computed	[I, C-PUB-7]
Consent decree, U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission	$173,450 settlement; consent decree in the U.S. District Court for the Northern District of State 28, two-year term from February 2023	Agency release; two-year term from February 2023, as the release states; no later court or agency document read	8 February 2023	[F, PUB-0102]

Source: employer review site; job board; ZipRecruiter; Deal A's job board; Deal A Forms 8-K and 10-K; Deal A release of 16 June 2026; [website]; consumer complaints body; U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission release of 8 February 2023; pages read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: Each row stands alone: sites differ in who posts and how, and a rating on one site is not comparable with a rating on another. Posted pay is for entry-level roles. The count of open postings is an upper bound on live demand: 261 of the 258 were first published between April and December 2025 · Assumption: Complaints per clinic divides three years of complaints by the 983 company-operated clinics at 27 June 2026 [F, DLA-0399]; the clinic count changed over those three years, so the ratio is approximate

05 C First-round closures: supporting evidence

The FY26 round closed 130 clinics per the 10-K, 129 per the company's closed-clinic list and 127 in the clinic-EBITDA file's closed cohort (119 of them closed in May 2025) [F, DLA-0401; DLA-0962; 1.0.4 FY25 columns L–M]; Part 05 and this section use 129, except where a figure is computed on the clinic-EBITDA file's 127-clinic cohort. The closed set had raw clinic EBITDA of −$16.0m in FY25 (129 of 127 negative), −$9.9m in FY24 and −$8.4m in FY23 [F, 1.0.4 FY25 columns L–M]; net proceeds from owned-clinic sales and lease assignments were about $24m, with $10.4m of lease-termination gains and $8.6m of fixed-asset gains recorded and $3.2m of professional fees [F, CIP p1 footnote 1; DLA-2319..2322; Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data Summary!J59, J65:J68]. The removal of those losses is real. Those gains matter for every EBITDA-based ratio in this section: FY26 D3 E1 of $71.2m includes $16.0m of gains on disposal, and LTM June 2026 E1 of $81.1m includes $19.7m; ex-gains the rungs are $56.4m and $59.6m [F/I, DLA-0315, DLA-0317; Q1 FY27 10-Q; note C-62]. On that audited ex-gains basis FY26 E1 fell 33.2% from FY25 ($86.6m to $56.4m) while the closed set had lost $16.0m of clinic EBITDA (before co-op) in FY25, and company non-GAAP EBITDA fell from $97.5m in FY25 to $85.4m in FY26 and $74.9m in the twelve months to June 2026 on Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update p.33 ($85.6m for FY26 in the clinic file) [F/I, Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update p.33; DLA-0854; DLA-5637]. Ares Credit Group's materials describe the round-one benefit as both "›$8.6m" and "~$12m run-rate" [A, Diligence & Structure Update pp3, 11; DLA-3378, DLA-3379].

The peer set offers no measured closure outcome to benchmark this against. Operator 1 closed no retail clinics in CY2009–15 and one a year in 2016–17 on its clinic sheets, and its 2016–17 closures were overlap consolidations after acquisitions [F, OP1-5198..5206; OP1-4095]; it closed 2, 5 and 10 in 2020–22 [F, OP1-10012..10014]. Operator 2 closed none of its owned clinics between 2018 and March 2021 [F/I, OP2-3639..3642]. Operator 4's files carry no closure count [F, note C-85]. The one large programme in the files, Operator 29' 82 closures in 2025 under its previous owner, appears only as management adjustments in a draft buy-side report ($21.0m clinic-closure and $39.5m dark-rent adjustments) [M, OP1-11275, OP1-11271, OP1-11268; Accounting Firm 1 draft FDD pp.28–25]. No peer file measures sales transfer to surviving clinics; the only transfer metric in the Evidence index (Part 09 section F) is Deal A's own 13% assumption [M, DLA-5579]. Deal A's own recapture from the first round cannot be measured from the files either: they carry no addresses for the closed clinics (assumption A-P7), so the surviving clinics near each closed clinic cannot be identified. Some sites went to competitors: 28 leased clinics were assigned to Operator 5 between September and November 2025, and owned and leased sites were sold to Operator 1 between April and June 2026 [F, DLA-1589; DLA-1557, DLA-1559, DLA-1593, DLA-1595].

Our reading on M2, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported. The first round removed real clinic losses and realised about $24m of net proceeds, but audited E1 ex-gains still fell 33.2% in FY26, and no peer file measures a closure outcome or a sales transfer against which to test the benefit. What would change this reading: clinic-level sales and addresses for the round-one clinics, which would allow recapture to be measured, and the closed-clinic KPI history FY20–Q1 FY27.

Public signals

Deal A's headcount fell in step with its clinic count; headquarters staffing did not. Between March 2025 and March 2026 employees fell 11.1%, from about 6,416 to about 5,606, and company-operated clinics fell 9.8%, from 1,102 to 983 [I, C-PUB-9]. Employees per clinic were 5.17, 4.98 and 4.95 at the three fiscal year-ends [I, C-PUB-9]. Headquarters staff numbered 149 in March 2024, 134 in March 2025 and 140 in March 2026 [F, PUB-0103; PUB-0104; PUB-0105]. The counts are the approximate figures the 10-Ks state. They are counts of people, not of cost, and the filings do not split the field organisation between clinics and district or regional roles.

Exhibit 9.116 — Between March 2025 and March 2026 Deal A's employees fell 11.1% and its clinics 9.8%; headquarters staff rose from 134 to 140, after 149 in March 2024

Employees by organisation and company-operated clinics at fiscal year-end, March 2024, 2025 and 2026; Deal A Forms 10-K

MEASURE	30 MARCH 2024	29 MARCH 2025	28 MARCH 2026	CHANGE, MARCH 2025 TO MARCH 2026	REFERENCE
Total employees (approximate)	6,725	6,416	5,606	−11.1%	[F, PUB-0280; PUB-0281; PUB-0282]
Field organisation	6,566	6,413	5,562	−11.1%	[F, PUB-0283; PUB-0284; PUB-0285]
Corporate headquarters	149	134	140	+5.9%	[F, PUB-0103; PUB-0104; PUB-0105]
Other offices	20	10	10	0	[F, PUB-0286; PUB-0287; PUB-0288]
Company-operated clinics	1,139	1,102	983	−9.8%	[F, DLA-0385; DLA-0386; DLA-0387]
Employees per clinic	5.17	4.98	4.95	−0.05	[I, C-PUB-9]

Source: Deal A Forms 10-K for fiscal 2024, 2025 and 2026, Item 1; clinic counts from Deal A's Forms 10-K [F, DLA-0385; DLA-0386; DLA-0387]; our computation [I, C-PUB-9] · Basis: Actual (A). Employee counts are stated in the filings as approximate. Employees per clinic divides total employees, including headquarters and other offices, by company-operated clinics

05 D Second-round closures: supporting evidence

The 119 candidates had TTM sales of $68.9m, profit including co-op of −$19.6m and net book value of $54.8m; management estimates a $12m pro-forma EBITDA improvement after 13% sales recapture, and one-time closing costs of "~$31mm" before monetisation, $31.00m in the board deck [M, CIP p.1; Board deck p.1; DLA-5275, DLA-5276, DLA-5376]. The company's workbook shows how that figure is built. The 119 clinics are 16 owned, 54 on operating leases and 51 on finance leases. Cash closing costs are $21.79m: common-area charges $3.50m, utilities $6.38m, real-estate taxes $7.90m, local taxes $0.31m and deferred maintenance $3.69m. They are costed for the full remaining lease term, or six months for an owned clinic, and the average remaining term is 42.1 months. Finance-lease interest on the 51 clinics adds $9.63m, which makes the $31.00m. Base rent of $12.13m a year is shown separately: $5.75m on the operating-lease clinics and $6.99m on the finance-lease clinics, whose rent includes the interest counted in the $9.63m; the lease-liability present value is $65.0m [F, Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!D9:J9, J31:J33, J37:J47, F32, G32, B49; DLA-2231..2235, DLA-2275, DLA-2308].

Ares Credit Group's model books $4.3m of residual closure cash, in FY28, and $4.3m of professional fees [A, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!F20:I20, F21; DLA-3384, DLA-3385]. Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update presents the same five cash items as a maximum of $21.5m over the remaining lease terms, with an average annual cash cost of $4.3m on a lease average of about five years (spread over

the workbook's 42.1-month average remaining term it is about $5.36m a year), and expects the actual cost to be lower through lease assignments and renegotiations [A, Diligence & Structure Update p.11]. The model therefore carries the first year of a cost that the workbook runs to the end of the leases: spread evenly over the 42.1-month average term, $5.36m falls in each of FY28 to FY31 and $0.68m after, against $4.3m in FY28 and nothing later in the model [I, C-FIN-4]. The workbook holds no clinic-by-clinic schedule, so the even spread is our assumption; deferred maintenance ($3.69m) would in practice fall earlier.

Three points follow for how the figures compare [I, C-FIN-4]. First, the comparison that is like for like is $21.79m of cash against Ares Credit Group's $4.3m. The CIP's "~$31mm" includes the $9.63m of finance-lease interest, and those leases are still in the lease lines of Ares Credit Group's model: its sales and lease lines are the company's plan before the closures (FY2029 sales of $1,083m against $990m in the board deck's pro forma), with the $12m added as a separate line [F/I, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!J7, F15, D22; Board deck p.3]. On that reading the interest is a cost of the leases and not an added cost of closing. Ares Credit Group's model does not charge that lease interest to cash at all (Part 08 section B). Second, the cost is spread, not one-time: the workbook runs it to the end of the leases, about $5.3m a year from FY28 to FY31, against $4.3m in FY28 alone in Ares Credit Group's model; what that timing means for the financing is set out in Part 08 section B. Third, the files do not show how the $12m treats rent. It is a clinic-level EBITDA figure, and operating-lease rent is normally a cost inside clinic-level EBITDA; if so, removing the 54 operating-lease clinics' results treats their $5.75m a year of rent as ending at closure. The workbook carries the other occupancy costs to the end of each lease and leaves base rent out of its closing costs. On that reading, if no operating lease were exited, the rent would be a further cash cost of about $20m over the 54 operating leases' 37.8-month average remaining term (the workbook's lease-liability present value for these leases is $21.9m, higher than the rent over the average remaining term; the file does not reconcile the two) that is in neither the $12m nor the $21.79m [I, C-FIN-4; Summary!F31, F32, F33]. The first round realised $10.4m of lease-termination gains, so some exits are likely; the exit schedule would settle both the reading and the amount.

Exhibit 9.117 — The company's $31.4m closure cost is $21.79m of cash spread over the remaining lease terms plus $10.0m of finance-lease interest; Ares Credit Group's model books $4.3m of that cash, in FY28, and $4.3m of fees

Second-round closure cost for 119 clinics, $m, by component: company workbook against Ares Credit Group model v24

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J33, J37:J47, B49; Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!F20:I20, F21; Diligence & Structure Update p.11 · Basis: M (company estimate, a maximum before lease assignments) and A (Ares Credit Group model) · Assumption: Base rent on the 109 leased clinics ($12.13m a year, Summary!J32) is in neither total. The finance-lease interest is, on our reading, already inside the lease line of Ares Credit Group's model [I]

The exhibit sets the company's closure cost beside Ares Credit Group's figure, component by component. Of the company's $31.00m, $21.79m is occupancy and maintenance cash to lease end and $9.63m is finance-lease interest that, on our reading, already sits in the lease line of Ares Credit Group's model; the comparison that is like for like is therefore $21.79m of cash against $4.3m, not $31.4m against $8.6m [I, C-FIN-4]. For Ares Credit Group's question the difference is one of amount in the model as well as of timing: Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update carries up to $21.5m over the remaining lease terms, as the workbook does, while Ares Credit Group's model books $4.3m, in FY28 only. The figure cannot show operating-lease rent on leases not exited ($5.75m a year), which is in neither total; Exhibit 5.10 gives the timing by fiscal year and the base rent.

The 119-clinic ID list, the lease exit schedule and any buy-out costs are not in the data room [U]. Two supplies of the bounded view can be anchored. Recapture: the 13% assumption has no anchor, because no peer measured it and the files do not allow Deal A's own first-round recapture to be measured (Part 05 section C), so the $3.4–4.3m of the $12m that depends on recapture stays a management claim [M/I]. Stranded overhead: corporate department costs did not fall as Deal A shrank — they rose from $44.4m (3.3% of revenue) in FY22 to $55.0m (4.7%) in FY26 while the clinic count fell from 1,117 to 983 — and across core platforms overhead does not fall with scale [F/I, DLA-1295, DLA-1223, DLA-0017; Exhibit 3.11]. Applied to the 119 clinics' $68.9m of sales, the observed overhead ratios give $2.1m (Operator 3 2.6%, PF) to $4.7m (Operator 7 ST-22 5.9%, PF) a year, and $3.9m at Deal A's own FY26 ratio; these ratios measure average overhead intensity, not the share that is stranded, so the range is an upper bound that assumes all of the overhead attributable to the 119 clinics stays behind (the observed FY22–FY26 rise in Deal A's own overhead is the evidence that much of it does) [I, OP3-2567, OP7-0798, DLA-1223/DLA-0017]; the overhead definitions differ by platform and are used here only as a range, not pooled. Advertising that would stay after the closures, taken at Deal A's consolidated advertising expense of 1.59% of sales in FY25 to 2.36% in FY26 [F/I, DLA-1242/DLA-0016; DLA-1226/DLA-0017; C-PUB-8; Exhibit 9.114] and applied to the 119 clinics' $68.9m of sales, is $1.1–1.9m a year if all of it stays behind; it is separate from corporate overhead and is included [I]. The bounded view is therefore: gross loss reversal of about $12–13m on an allocated basis, of which $3.4–4.3m depends on the unproven recapture assumption, less up to $2.1–4.7m a year of stranded corporate overhead (upper bound) and $1.1–1.9m of stranded advertising, against up to $21.79m of closure cash over the remaining lease terms plus, if no operating lease is exited, about $5.75m a year of operating-lease rent (about $20m over the 54 operating leases' 37.8-month average remaining term), which is in neither the $12m nor the $21.79m; finance-lease payments ($6.99m a year) continue in the lease lines of Ares Credit Group's model [I, C-FIN-4]. Deal A's own "clinic closing costs, net" appear as a non-GAAP adjustment line in each of FY21–FY26 (net of disposal gains, so negative in FY22 and FY26),

so on the D3 recurrence test we read recurring closure cost as part of cash EBITDA (E6) rather than as an add-back [F/I, DLA-1322, DLA-1305, DLA-1287, DLA-1266, DLA-1248, DLA-1232; Exhibit 3.23].

The plan beneath the uplift. Every forecast in the files, the company's model for its financing banks and Ares Credit Group's model among them, rests on management's plan, which assumes the decline stops in the second half of FY27 and EBITDA (company non-GAAP, basis P) then grows about 9% a year: $72.4m in FY27E, $79.9m in FY28E, $91.6m in FY29E, $94.7m in FY30E and $106.7m in FY31E, to which Ares Credit Group adds $12m of closure uplift from FY28 [M/A, DLA-2543..2547; bank model row 181; Ares Credit Group model MODEL OUTPUT rows 13, 15]. The files contain no current-trading support for the recovery, and Ares Credit Group's model contains no trend-only case.

Exhibit 9.118 — The plan turns a −34% quarter (Q1 FY27: $15.4m against $25.7m) into about +9% annual EBITDA growth from FY28, with Ares Credit Group's $12m closure uplift on top

Company non-GAAP EBITDA, $m: FY26 and LTM June 2026 as reported against the management plan FY27E to FY31E and Ares Credit Group's closure uplift

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A 5-Year Financial Model for Financing Banks (4 August 2026), P&L row 181 (plan and quarters); Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file, reconciliation to company EBITDA (FY26); Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, sheet FY27-FY31 P&L cell G182 (LTM June 2026, a sum row in Ares Credit Group's model) and MODEL OUTPUT row 15 (closure uplift). Rows DLA-0854; DLA-5637; DLA-2543; DLA-2544; DLA-2545; DLA-2546; DLA-2547; DLA-5825; DLA-5826; DLA-5827; DLA-5828; DLA-5829; DLA-5830; DLA-5831; DLA-2542; DLA-2538 · Basis: Company non-GAAP EBITDA (after management adjustments), not audited EBITDA. FY26, LTM June 2026 and the two quarters are reported periods on that adjusted definition (PF, hollow); FY27E to FY31E are the management plan (P, hatched); the closure uplift is Ares Credit Group's addition for the second closure round (P), $3.0m a quarter in FY28 and $12m a year after

The figure sets the reported periods against the plan: company non-GAAP EBITDA of $15.4m in Q1 FY27 against $25.7m a year earlier (−34%), then about +9% a year from FY28, with Ares Credit Group's $12m closure uplift on top [M/A, Exhibit 9.118]. For Ares Credit Group's question, the uplift is added to a recovery that no current trading in the files yet shows, so the value of the second round depends on the plan as much as on the closures. The figure cannot show how much of the plan's growth depends on the clinics being closed; the plan's comparable-sales path is set against peers under 05 E below ("The plan's recovery against comparable operators") and in Exhibit 5.16.

Our reading on M3, on the evidence supplied to date: insufficient evidence. The incremental value of the second round cannot be tested from the files: the 119-clinic list, the lease exit schedule and any buy-out costs are missing, the recapture assumption has no peer anchor, and the company's workbook carries $21.79m of closure cash over the remaining lease terms against $4.3m in Ares Credit Group's model, with operating-lease rent on leases not exited ($5.75m a year) outside both figures. What would change this reading: the 119-clinic ID, lease and exit schedule with buy-out costs, a reconciled closure cash budget and the post-closure corporate overhead budget.

05 E Against comparable operators: supporting evidence

Deal A's comparators are chosen for format and geography (Operator 1), for audited E1 in the same environment (Operator 4 and Operator 9), for a multi-banner acquired estate with clinic-level dispersion data (Operator 2), and for the survivor-base comp series that overlap Deal A FY26 (Operator 3, LTM August 2025; Operator 6, calendar 2025, used in the comp rankings only) [note C-84, Deal A rows; DLA-0017; OP6-1896, OP6-1146, OP6-1148]. Operator 5 was considered and left out, because its only metrics on Deal A's definitions are PF (rebates, rank persistence) or on a different closure base (SSS_CD CLOSE-FWD), and its data end in 2023 [note C-84, Deal A rows].

Exhibit 9.119 — Deal A's comparators share no four-wall rent code with it, so the valid comparisons are comps, rebates, conversion and within-platform statistics (Deal A FY03 to FY26 against peer periods 2008 to 2025)

Operator 1, Operator 4 and Operator 9, Operator 2, Operator 3 and Operator 6: why each is a comparator, the metrics valid against Deal A with their period overlap, and those not valid

COMPARATOR	REASON FOR INCLUSION	VALID METRICS (PERIOD OVERLAP)	NOT VALID, AND WHY
Operator 1	General practice and preventive care chain in a home region, 91 to 699+ clinics, bought Deal A's City 30 clinics (2011); heavy vendor-rebate (ATF) programme like Deal A's co-op; the core operator with the longest clinic-level history in the files (June 2007 to February 2023, none for 2018)	Rebates ÷ revenue (Operator 1 CY2017 vs Deal A FY26; no overlap); CONV_1 on total capex, E1, A, steady (Operator 1 FY2019 vs Deal A FY2019/FY26; partial overlap); clinic-margin rank persistence ρ (within-platform); add-on cash price ÷ seller prior-year sales (Operator 1 2008–18 vs Deal A FY03–20; overlapping)	Four-wall level and loss share (Operator 1 D1.1 R-CASH to Nov-17 vs Deal A R-OPONLY FY23–23: different rent code, no overlap); SSS (Operator 1 CLOSE-FWD 2019–22 vs Deal A survivor CLOSE-RETRO; Operator 1 2023–25 is an undefined SSS_ST-59 from the Ares Credit Group chart); volume (Operator 1 pharmacy units, not traffic, ending Nov-17); valuation (E4 platform multiples vs Deal A public EV on E1)
Operator 4 / Operator 9	Pharmacy-heavy multi-regional consolidator with audited E1 (FY23–21); rebates 12.0–20.2% of pharmacy COGS; the only other core platform with audited SOFT24-26 E1	CONV_1 on total capex, E1, A, steady (Operator 4 FY2023 vs Deal A; partial overlap)	SSS (Operator 4 and Operator 9 SSS_ST-59 without a stated definition); rebates (only as % of pharmacy COGS, not of revenue); E1 margin (Operator 9 eliminates related-party rent through VIEs; Deal A E1 is before finance-lease cost, $44.2m of FY26 cash cost); four-wall ("hospital EBITDA", D1.2-type R-UNK, vs R-OPONLY); Operator 9 CONV_1 (VIE consolidation)
Operator 2	Multi-banner platform built from acquired regional chains with pharmacy-led and general practice formats; clinic-level D1.1 2018–21 with format split and dispersion decomposition; separable rebates	Rebates ÷ revenue (Operator 2 2019 – LTM Mar-21 vs Deal A FY22–23; no overlap); clinic-margin rank persistence ρ (within-platform); share of clinic-margin variance explained by clinic sales level (adj. R^2, within-platform)	SSS_CD (Operator 2 CLOSE-FWD 2019–20 vs Deal A CLOSE-RETRO; Operator 2 2021–26 only undefined SSS_ST-59); COVID traffic (Operator 2 calendar 2020 CLOSE-FWD vs Deal A FY21 survivor); four-wall level (R-UNK vs R-OPONLY); E1 (Operator 2 compliance basis [M])
Operator 3	One of two core operators (with Operator 6) with SSS_CD, comp traffic and comp ticket on the same survivor (CLOSE-RETRO) definition in a period overlapping Deal A FY26; pharmacy-plus-general practice mix with a pharmacy-share vs margin cross-section	SSS_TRAFFIC_CD, SSS_TICKET_CD minus CPI SS62053 and SSS_CD (A; CLOSE-RETRO both; LTM Aug-25 vs FY26, overlap Apr–Aug-25); rebates ÷ revenue (LTM Aug-25 vs FY26); clinic-margin rank persistence ρ	Four-wall level and loss share (Operator 3 R-UNK vs Deal A R-OPONLY); scale / AUV (38–50 clinics, median vs mean); add-on multiples (Deal A's acquisition analysis gives price ÷ sales only)
Operator 6	Core operator whose comp files are survivor-based (CLOSE-RETRO) and give comp traffic, comp ticket and SSS_CD for calendar 2025 (SSS_CD also for 2024), overlapping Deal A FY26 (and FY25); used in the comp rankings only	SSS_TRAFFIC_CD (CY2025, OP6-1896), SSS_TICKET_CD minus CPI SS62053 (CY2025, OP6-1146) and SSS_CD (CY2024 and CY2025, OP6-1147, OP6-1148) (A; CLOSE-RETRO both; CY2025 vs FY26, overlap Apr–Dec 2025)	Other metrics are not set against Deal A in this Part

Source: note C-84 (Deal A rows; OP1-3403, OP1-3416, DLA-0846, DLA-0017, OP1-8678, OP1-8634, OP1-5630, DLA-0862, OP2-0080, OP2-0074, OP2-0020, OP2-0002, DLA-2080; OP4-0011, OP4-0026, OP4-0938, OP4-0943, OP4-1507; OP2-3467, OP2-3458, OP2-3419, OP2-3410; OP3-0906, OP3-0907, OP3-0908, DLA-0788, DLA-0789, DLA-0790, OP3-1089; OP6-1896, OP6-1146, OP6-1147, OP6-1148, DLA-0756.) · Basis: Definitions of Part 09 section C; note C-84; leverage placements on these metrics are in Part 08 section B [I] · Assumption: A-01, A-02, A-12

Which peer comparisons are valid. No comparator shares Deal A's four-wall rent code: Deal A's "clinic-level EBITDA" is R-OPONLY (operating-lease rent in the clinic P&L, finance-lease cost below it), while Operator 1 is R-CASH with no overlapping period, Operator 2, Operator 3 and Operator 4 are R-UNK, and Operator 4's "hospital EBITDA" is a with-rebates figure [I, Exhibit 9.119; Part 09 section K, 04 F; definitions D1.3–D1.4]. Comparisons that set Deal A against Operator 1 on the sixteen-year comp panel, or against peer four-wall margins, are therefore not drawn here. Exhibit 9.120 lists what can be compared on a shared definition, with the comparator values, the range and Deal A's position; Exhibit 9.121 lists what cannot, why, and the file that would make it valid.

Exhibit 9.120 — On the valid comparisons Deal A is below the survivor-base peers on traffic and same-store sales in 2024–26, and inside the peer range on ticket net of CPI, rebates, reported conversion and clinic-level statistics

Deal A FY25–FY26 against Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 1, Operator 2 and Operator 4 on shared definitions: comparator values, range and Deal A's position; peer periods 2017 to LTM August 2025

METRIC (DEFINITION; BASIS; CLINIC BASE / RENT OR CLOSURE CODE; PERIOD)	COMPARATORS AND VALUES (FACT ROWS)	RANGE	DEAL A (FACT ROWS)	POSITION
SSS_TRAFFIC_CD (D2.5 on D2.1; A; COMP/SURVIVOR, CLOSE-RETRO; latest full year) — ranking R2	Operator 6 CY2025 −2.0% (OP6-1896); Operator 3 LTM Aug-25 −2.8% (OP3-0907)	−2.8% to −2.0%	FY26 −3.9% (DLA-0789)	Below, by 1.1pp (Operator 3) to 2.0pp (Operator 6); last of three
SSS_TRAFFIC_CD, same base, prior year	Operator 3 CY2024 −4.1% (OP3-0891)	−4.1%	FY25 −7.9% (DLA-0757)	Below, by 3.9pp
SSS_TICKET_CD minus CPI veterinarian services (CUUR0000SS62053), matched months (A; CLOSE-RETRO) — R4	Operator 3 +2.2pp (OP3-0908); Operator 6 −5.7pp (OP6-1146)	−5.7 to +2.2pp	FY26 +0.04pp (DLA-0790)	Inside; 2.15pp below Operator 3

METRIC (DEFINITION; BASIS; CLINIC BASE / RENT OR CLOSURE CODE; PERIOD)	COMPARATORS AND VALUES (FACT ROWS)	RANGE	DEAL A (FACT ROWS)	POSITION
SSS_CD (D2.1; A; CLOSE-RETRO), period ending 2024 – Mar-25 — R8	Operator 6 CY2024 +2.9% (OP6-1147); Operator 3 CY2024 +2.4% (OP3-0890)	+2.4% to +2.9%	FY25 −4.1% (DLA-0756)	Below, by 6.6–7.2pp; last
SSS_CD (D2.1; A; CLOSE-RETRO), latest — R9	Operator 3 LTM Aug-25 +4.2% (OP3-0906); Operator 6 CY2025 +1.9% (OP6-1148)	+1.9% to +4.2%	FY26 +1.1% (DLA-0788)	Below, by 0.8–3.0pp; last
Vendor rebates ÷ revenue, source-booked (A)	Operator 2 LTM Mar-21 2.9% (OP2-3467); Operator 3 LTM Aug-25 3.7% (OP3-1089); Operator 1 CY2017 10.9% (OP1-3403/OP1-3416)	2.9–10.9% (no period overlap except Operator 3)	FY26 co-op 5.1% (DLA-0846/DLA-0017)	Inside
CONV_1 = (E1 − total capex) ÷ E1 (D5; E1; A; consolidated; steady years)	Operator 1 FY2019 0.44 (OP1-8678/OP1-8634); Operator 4 FY2023 0.59 (OP4-0011/OP4-0026)	0.44–0.59	FY26 0.52, 0.44 on E1 ex-gains (A6-P5-003); steady-state median 0.64 (Exhibit 9.67)	Inside on E1 before finance-lease cost; far below (0.03) on a lease-consistent basis — see the next row and note [1]
CONV_1, lease-consistent: (E1 − finance-lease cash cost − total capex) ÷ (E1 − finance-lease cash cost) [1]	as above (peers' E1 is after operating rent)	0.44–0.59	FY26 0.03: E1 $71.2m − finance-lease principal $32.8m − finance-lease interest $9.2m = $29.1m; less capex $27.7m = $1.0m [I; DLA-0317, DLA_FINLEASE_PRIN FY2026 (DLA-0328), DLA_FINLEASE_INT FY2026, DLA_CAPEX_PPE FY2026]; negative (−1.08) on E1 ex-gains	**Far below** (0.41–0.54 below the range)
Clinic-margin rank persistence, Spearman ρ (within platform; SURVIVOR)	Operator 1 0.62–0.79; Operator 2 0.72–0.72; Operator 3 0.71–0.76 (note C-27)	0.62–0.79	0.69–0.71 (note C-27)	Inside
Share of clinic-margin variance explained by clinic sales level (adj. R^2, within platform)	Operator 1 6.0% / 50.1% (A4-S0183 / A4-S0195); Operator 2 33.8% / 29.8%; Operator 3 15.0% / 24.9% (note C-38)	6.0–50.1%	FY23 29.8% / FY26 34.3% (A4-S0208 / A4-S0219)	Inside

Source: Exhibit 9.123 and Exhibit 4.15 (rankings R2, R4, R8, R9); Part 04 section F. All comp rows are survivor-based (CLOSE-RETRO), so each is an upper bound on true comps, and Deal A's more so because its survivor file removes every clinic closed between FY20 and August 2026 [note C-02]. Periods overlap by five to nine months (Deal A fiscal April–March against calendar or LTM August). Gaps are simple subtractions [I]. Charted in Exhibit 9.122. [1] Lease-consistent basis: Deal A's $194.3m of finance leases (DLA-0471) are mostly clinic real estate that the peers carry as operating rent inside E1, so the like-for-like E1 deducts finance-lease cash cost ≈ principal paid $34.384m + interest expense $9.252m = $44.2m in FY26 (public series DLA_FINLEASE_PRIN, DLA_FINLEASE_INT, FY2026). Lease-consistent E1 = $29.1m (ex-gains $12.5m). CONV_1 on that basis = ($29.1m − capex $27.7m) ÷ $29.1m = 0.03 (0.01 if divided by unadjusted E1) [I]. The leverage row of this comparison is in Part 08 section B · Basis: A; survivor bases read as upper bounds; gaps and positions [I] · Assumption: A-01, A-07, A-09

Exhibit 9.121 — Five Deal A comparisons, among them comps against Operator 1 year by year and clinic four-wall margins against peers, are not valid on the common definitions (evidence 2010 to 2026)

Each comparison, why it is not valid on the common definitions, and the file that would make it valid; Deal A against Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 5, Operator 9 and peer four-wall ranges

COMPARISON THAT MIGHT BE DRAWN	WHY IT IS NOT VALID ON THE COMMON DEFINITIONS	WHAT WOULD MAKE IT VALID (EXHIBIT 4.17 QUESTION)
Deal A comps against Operator 1 year by year on the comp panel in Operator 4's investment memo (p.20)	The panel's Operator 1 column equals Ares Credit Group's own OP1-048 chart to rounding, so it is not an independent source, and that series is contradicted by Operator 1 clinic-level SSS_CD in 2012, 2014–16 and 2020 (−0.2%, −0.3%, −1.6%, −4.0%, −2.7% against the panel's +3%, +3%, +3%, 0%, +2%) (OP1-5128, OP1-5130..5132, OP1-8857; OP4-0559..0567). The panel's Deal A 2013 value (−4%, OP4-0576) is a transcription error against the 10-K's −0.4% (DLA-0347). Deal A's public comp is SSS_ST-59; Operator 1' is SSS_CD (CLOSE-FWD) to 2022 and undefined SSS_ST-59 from 2023	A Operator 1 2023–26 clinic-level comp file (OP1-041 successor / OP1-048 back-up) and a Deal A all-clinic CLOSE-FWD comp (Q1) would allow SSS_CD against SSS_CD
Retained-clinic four-wall margin against peer four-wall ranges	Deal A's clinic EBITDA is R-OPONLY and before co-op; no comparator shares that rent code, and no year has three actual R-CASH D1.1 operators to form a peer level (Part 04 section C)	Finance-lease cash cost and cash rent by clinic (Q2), to restate Deal A to D1.1 R-CASH; cash-rent restatements for Operator 2 (OP2-017), Operator 3 (OP3-013) and Operator 8 (OP8-012) to form an R-CASH peer range
Loss-making clinic share (Deal A 28.7% FY26 against peers at 0–12%)	Rent codes differ (Deal A R-OPONLY; Operator 5, Operator 7, Operator 1 R-CASH; Operator 3, Operator 2 R-UNK) and clinic bases differ (all-clinic versus survivor)	As above (Q2)

COMPARISON THAT MIGHT BE DRAWN	WHY IT IS NOT VALID ON THE COMMON DEFINITIONS	WHAT WOULD MAKE IT VALID (EXHIBIT 4.17 QUESTION)
Comp traffic in COVID against Operator 2 or Operator 5 (calendar 2020, CLOSE-FWD)	Deal A FY21 is April 2020–March 2021 on a survivor base; peers are calendar 2020 on CLOSE-FWD bases (Exhibit 9.93, Part 09 section K, 04 E)	Deal A clinic-month KPI data including closed clinics (Q1)
Consolidated E1 or gross margin level against Operator 1, Operator 2 or Operator 9	Cost of sales differs by more than 26 points of definition across operators; Deal A's E1 excludes finance-lease cost, Operator 9's eliminates related-party rent (note C-19; Exhibit 4.11)	Not resolvable by one file; within-operator change is the valid comparison (below)

Source: Exhibit 9.119 and Exhibit 4.17; fact rows as listed · Basis: Definitions of Part 09 section C; fact rows as listed; judgments [I]; leverage comparisons are in Part 08 section B · Assumption: A-01, A-02, A-09

Traffic, ticket and same-store sales. On the comp definition Deal A shares with peers, its retained estate (the 983 clinics kept after the first round) is last of three on traffic and same-store sales in 2024–26: FY26 comp traffic of −3.9% (−3.2% at the 824 clinics kept after the second round; Part 05 section E) against −2.0% at Operator 6 and −2.8% at Operator 3, and FY26 same-store sales of +1.1% against +1.9% to +4.2% [F/I, DLA-0789, OP6-1896, OP3-0907; DLA-0788, OP6-1148, OP3-0906]. It is second of three on ticket net of CPI only because Operator 6's ticket fell 5.7 points against CPI [I, DLA-0790, OP3-0908, OP6-1146]. All three series are survivor-based and therefore upper bounds, Deal A's more so because its file removes every clinic closed since FY20, so the figure cannot show how an all-clinic comp would rank [I, note C-02].

Exhibit 9.122 — On the common-definition 2024–26 rankings Deal A is last on comp traffic and same-store sales, and second of three on ticket net of CPI only because Operator 6's ticket fell

Comparable-clinic traffic, ticket net of CPI and same-store sales, change year on year; Deal A FY25 and FY26 against Operator 3 and Operator 6 2024 and 2025

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A All Clinics KPI Report; Operator 3 and Operator 6 clinic-level files supplied by Ares Credit Group; BLS CPI veterinarian services (CUUR0000SS62053). Rows DLA-0789; OP3-0907; OP6-1896; DLA-0757; OP3-0891; DLA-0790; OP3-0908; OP6-1146; DLA-0756; OP3-0890; OP6-1147; DLA-0788; OP3-0906; OP6-1148 · Basis: All values actual (A). Survivor or comparable-clinic bases with closed clinics removed from every year, so each value is an upper bound on true comps. Periods overlap by 5 to 9 months (Deal A fiscal year April to March; Operator 3 LTM August; Operator 6 calendar year). Ticket minus CPI is comp ticket growth less CPI veterinarian services over matched months. Rank is Deal A's place among the operators shown, higher is better

Exhibit 9.123 — Deal A sits below Operator 3 on every survivor-base comp metric in FY26, and inside the peer range on rebates, reported conversion and clinic-level statistics; on a lease-consistent basis its FY26 conversion is far below the range

Deal A FY26 (FY03–20 for add-on prices) against Operator 1, Operator 2, Operator 4 and Operator 3 on each valid metric: comparator values, range and position; peer periods 2008 to LTM August 2025

VALID METRIC (DEFINITION; BASIS)	COMPARATOR VALUES	RANGE	DEAL A (BASIS, FACT ROW)	POSITION
SSS_TRAFFIC_CD, CLOSE-RETRO, A	Operator 3 LTM Aug-25 −2.8% (OP3-0907)	−2.8%	FY26 −3.9% (A, DLA-0789)	Below
SSS_TICKET_CD − CPI SS62053, CLOSE-RETRO, A	Operator 3 +2.2pp (OP3-0908)	+2.2pp	FY26 +0.04pp (A, DLA-0790)	Below
SSS_CD, CLOSE-RETRO, A	Operator 3 +4.2% (OP3-0906)	+4.2%	FY26 +1.1% (A, DLA-0788)	Below
Rebates ÷ revenue, source-booked, A	Operator 1 CY2017 10.9% (OP1-3403/OP1-3416); Operator 2 LTM Mar-21 2.9% (OP2-3467); Operator 3 LTM Aug-25 3.7% (OP3-1089)	2.9–10.9%	FY26 co-op 5.1% (A, DLA-0846/DLA-0017)	Inside
CONV_1, total capex, E1, A, steady	Operator 1 FY2019 0.44 (OP1-8678/OP1-8634); Operator 4 FY2023 0.59 (OP4-0011/OP4-0026)	0.44–0.59	FY26 0.52, 0.44 ex-gains; steady median 0.64 (A, note C-62)	Inside (FY26); at the floor ex-gains; above (steady median)
Clinic-margin rank persistence ρ (within platform; SURVIVOR)	Operator 1 0.62–0.79; Operator 2 0.72–0.72; Operator 3 0.71–0.76 (note C-27)	0.62–0.79	0.69–0.71 (A, note C-27)	Inside
Clinic sales level share of margin variance (adj. R^2)	Operator 1 6.0% / 50.1% (A4-S0183 / A4-S0195); Operator 2 33.8% / 29.8%; Operator 3 15.0% / 24.9% (note C-38)	6.0–50.1%	FY23 29.8% / FY26 34.3% (A4-S0208 / A4-S0219)	Inside
Add-on cash price ÷ seller prior-year sales	Operator 1 2008–18: 0.37×, 0.69×, 1.27×, 0.76× (OP2-0080…71, OP2-0073…69, OP2-0019…21, OP2-0001…0007)	0.37–1.27× (median 0.71×)	FY03–20 aggregate 0.64× (A, DLA-2080)	Inside, below median

Source: note C-84 (Deal A rows). FY26 CONV_1 ex-gains 0.44 is on D3 E1. Rank persistence statistics are on SURVIVOR bases; 165 closed Deal A clinics are absent from the survivor file and were disproportionately loss-making · Basis: A; survivor bases; positions [I] · Assumption: A-01, A-07

The placements identify where Deal A's evidence departs from its peers on a like-for-like basis. On the survivor-base comp definition it shares with Operator 3 and Operator 6, Deal A is below Operator 3 on traffic, on ticket growth net of CPI and on SSS, and below Operator 6 on traffic and SSS; all three series are survivor-based, so each is an upper bound [F/I, DLA-0788..DLA-0790; OP3-0906..OP3-0908; OP6-1896, OP6-1146, OP6-1148]. Its FY26 conversion is inside the peer range on reported E1, at the floor once $16.0m of disposal gains are removed (0.44), and far below it (0.03) on the lease-consistent basis of Exhibit 9.120 [I, note C-62 FY2026; DLA-0328]. Its cash after interest and finance-lease payments is set out in Part 08 section B.

Breadth of the weakness. Half or more of Deal A's surviving clinics posted negative comps in FY20, FY21, FY24, FY25 and Q1 FY27; outside the COVID period, among the other operators shown, only Operator 1's legacy clinics (2012, 2014–16) reached that share [I, note C-52; Exhibit 9.124].

Exhibit 9.124 — Half or more of Deal A's surviving clinics posted negative comps in FY20, FY21, FY24, FY25 and Q1 FY27; outside the COVID period, among the other operators shown, only Operator 1's legacy clinics (2012, 2014–16) reached that share

Share of clinics in each comp base with negative same-store sales, by operator and period, %, 2010 to Q1 FY27

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A All Clinics KPI Report FY20–Q1 FY27; Operator 1 clinic-level financials (Dec-17) and Comp Sales and GP Summary (Jan 2019 – March 2023); Operator 5 Volume Trends 2017 – YTD June 2023; Operator 2 Clinic Level Databook (June 2021); Operator 3 Datacube (31 August 2025); Operator 8 (Operator 8) Databook (Feb-25). CreditSwan computation from the clinic-level files; note C-52 (DLA-002, OP1-021, OP1-041, OP5-008, OP2-021, OP3-003, OP8-012) · Basis: Actual (A); each operator's own clinic-level comp base. Deal A's file covers clinics still open at the file date only (closed clinics are not in it); Operator 3 likewise. Operator 3 2022 and 2023 rest on 4 and 6 clinics

Deal A's weakness is broad across its estate rather than concentrated in a tail of clinics [I, note C-52; 05 B above]. Because the file covers survivors only, the clinics already closed are not in it: the weakness shown is in the clinics that remain [F, Exhibit 9.123 note].

Clinic economics: what the four-wall evidence can say. Deal A's open-clinic EBITDA in FY26 was $91.0m before co-op (R-OPONLY; 7.9% of sales on a ratio-of-sums basis across the 983 clinics) [F, DLA-0834]. Finance-lease cost of $29.9m (book depreciation plus interest) sits below that line; after it, clinic EBITDA was $64.6m, or 5.4% of sales, which is an R-BOOK approximation of D1.1 [F/I, DLA-0856, DLA-0857]. Vendor co-op of $57.8m is booked at corporate, equal to 0.71x FY26 D3 E1, 0.96x E1 ex-gains and 0.59x E2m [F/I, DLA-0846/DLA-0317; A3-P5-014; A3-P5-015]. Across core operators the pre-rebate (D1.1) four-wall margin sits between 8% and 16% on any rent code (Operator 1 9.8–15.0% R-CASH to November 2017; Operator 8 7.9–8.6% R-CASH 2022–23; Operator 7 ST-22 14.6–16.1% R-CASH 2023–25; Operator 5 13.3–15.0% R-CASH PF; Operator 2 8.1–11.8% and Operator 3 9.0–12.4% R-UNK) [F, Exhibit 9.50; note C-24]. Because no comparator shares the R-OPONLY code, no gap in points or dollars is stated. The bounded reading is this: a D1.1 restatement can only lower Deal A's 7.9%, because it would add finance-lease cost to clinic costs, so Deal A's D1.1 is at or below the floor of the core band [I].

Exhibit 9.125 — Deal A's FY26 clinic margin is an upper bound on its D1.1 and already sits at the floor of the 9–16% core band; rent codes differ, so no gap is drawn

Four-wall margin before vendor rebates (D1.1), % of clinic sales; low to high of each operator's observed years, FY08 to 2025, and Deal A FY26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A clinic-level EBITDA file FY23 to FY26 and 10-K; clinic-level files of Operator 1, Operator 8, Operator 7, Operator 5, Operator 2 and Operator 3 supplied by Ares Credit Group. Rows DLA-0834; DLA-0857; DLA-0017; OP1-5666; OP1-5658; OP8-2762; OP8-1362; OP7-0346; OP7-0384; OP7-0515; OP5-1152; OP5-2028; OP2-3401..3462; OP3-1012; OP3-1088 · Basis: D1.1 = clinic contribution after rent, before vendor rebates, ÷ clinic sales. Peer bars span the low and high of each operator's observed years; rent code, clinic base, period and basis are in each label (filled actual, hollow pro forma). Deal A FY26: clinic EBITDA before co-op on operating-lease rent only (R-OPONLY), an upper bound on D1.1, and after $29.9m of finance-lease book cost (R-BOOK approximation, derived). No peer shares Deal A's rent code, so no gap is drawn

The plan's recovery against comparable operators. The plan's comparable-sales path of +3.2% in FY28 and +2.6% a year after [M, DLA-2817..2820] needs a reversal to comps of 3% or more, which in SOFT24-26 appear as follows, by definition. On the common definition (SSS_CD), the 2024–25

means at or above 3% are Operator 7 (+11.4%, one year, pre-combination seller-period data with an undefined visit count) and Operator 8 (+5.3%); Operator 3 (+2.4% in 2024, +4.2% for LTM August 2025) and Operator 6 (+2.9% and +1.9%) are survivor-based, and Deal A's own survivor SSS_CD was −4.1% and +1.1% in FY25–FY26 [F/I, OP7-1022; OP8-1730, OP8-2106; OP3-0890, OP3-0906; OP6-1147, OP6-1148; DLA-0756, DLA-0788]. On company definitions (SSS_ST-59), Deal C (+5.2%, company-adjusted) and Operator 4 (+3.0%, definition not stated) averaged 3% or more, while Operator 1 (+1.1%, Ares Credit Group chart), Operator 9 (+1.0%), Operator 2 (+0.8%), Operator 29 (−1.9%) and Deal A's public comp (−1.8%) did not [F/I, DLC-006-000205/206; OP4-0555/0556; OP1-11178/11179; OP4-0592/0593; OP2-4273/4279; OP1-11280/11281; DLA-0361/0363]. No count is drawn across the two definitions.

Whether the second round brings Deal A closer to its comparators. Ares Credit Group's view is that it does. On the evidence supplied to date, the files do not show it. The comparisons above are on the 983 clinics kept after the first round, which include the 119 candidates. Their removal would raise the clinic-margin average, since the 119 lost $19.6m including co-op on $68.9m of sales, but without the clinic list its effect on the traffic and same-store-sales rankings cannot be measured [M, Project Alpha CIP p.1; Part 05 section D]. Three findings weigh against a move to peer levels. First, the loss-making share stayed about a third after the first round closed 129 clinics, and region and mix explain little of the clinic dispersion (05 B above). Second, the decline runs across the retained estate, not only its tail: visits fell 26% from March 2020 and clinic profit 58% from FY24 to June 2026 (05 B above). Third, the plan's recovery needs comps of 3% or more a year; in 2024–26 Deal A's survivor-base peers reached that level only in single periods (Operator 3 LTM August 2025, Operator 6 2024), and the other 2024–25 readings at or above it are Operator 7 (one seller-period year) and Operator 8 on the common definition and Deal C and Operator 4 on company definitions (above). The 119-clinic list with each clinic's TTM P&L would settle the point, by allowing the rankings and the four-wall bound to be restated without those clinics (Part 05 section G).

05 F Cash conversion: supporting evidence

Cash conversion against the observed record. The plan's conversion before financing is inside Deal A's own history. On company EBITDA (E2m-type, P) and plan capex of $24.3–25.9m a year, the plan's CONV_1 runs from 0.59 in FY27 to 0.64 in FY31 [I, DLA-2543..2547, DLA-2830..2882]. Deal A's CONV_1 from its audited accounts (D3 E1, total capex) has a median of 0.75 (0.53–0.72) over 20 steady years, 0.34 in build years, 0.52 in FY26 and 0.55 for LTM June 2026; on E1 ex-gains it is 0.44 in FY26 and 0.47 for LTM June 2026 [F/I, Exhibit 9.67; A6-P5-003, A6-P5-004]. The plan therefore assumes a return to the 20-year median by FY31 from a starting point 0.09–0.22 below it (FY26 and LTM June 2026, on E1 and E1 ex-gains). The plan's claims below CONV_1 (finance-lease principal and interest, and dividends), Deal A's audited cash after interest and finance-lease payments, and debt service and liquidity under the proposed financing are set out in Part 08 section B.

From EBITDA to cash in FY26. Of Deal A's $71.2m of FY26 EBITDA, $42.9m remained after capex (0.52), or 0.44 excluding $16.0m of disposal gains [F/I, DLA-0317, DLA-0320, DLA-0325; A6-P5-003]. A $35.8m working-capital release and $0.2m of cash taxes took cash before interest, finance-lease payments and dividends to $77.9m [F/I, FY26 10-K cash-flow statement]. For Ares Credit Group's question, $35.8m of the $77.9m the business produced before financing costs in its latest audited year came from a working-capital movement rather than from earnings.

The bridge cannot split maintenance from growth capex, because Deal A's capex has no audited split, and it leaves out the $16.5m fall in the supplier-finance balance, which is treated as financing [I, Exhibit 5.15].

Lease treatment and supplier finance. Lease treatment matters as much as the gains: Deal A's $194.3m of finance leases are mostly clinic real estate that peers carry as operating rent inside EBITDA, and deducting FY26 finance-lease cash cost ($32.8m principal, $9.2m interest) leaves $29.1m, with conversion after capex of 0.03 on that basis [I, FY26 10-K cash-flow statement and lease note; DLA-0471; Exhibit 9.120]. Supplier finance is a definitional point for working capital and conversion: the balance is $197.6m in the FY26 10-K, $183.9m in the Q1 FY27 10-Q, $151.8m in the company model and $137.1m in the Credit Summary of the company's current supply-chain-finance ageing [F, FY26 10-K; Q1 FY27 10-Q; bank model; Current SCF Aging].

05 G Sensitivities and requests: supporting evidence

Exhibit 5.16 sets the downside sensitivities of the business against the ranges observed in Parts 03 and 04, with alternative parameters (assumed) kept beside them. The sensitivities of the financing are in Part 08 section E.

The plan's recovery is the sensitivity furthest from Deal A's record: its comparable-sales path needs Deal A to move from the bottom of the survivor-base rankings to comps that its survivor-base peers reached only in single periods and that Operator 7 and Operator 8 (common definition) and Deal C and Operator 4 (company definitions) averaged in 2024–25 (05 E above). The second round rests on three measures that no file pins down: recapture, with no peer measure; stranded overhead of up to $2.1–4.7m a year on top of $1.1–1.9m of advertising; and closure cash of $21.79m over the lease terms against $4.3m in Ares Credit Group's model (05 D above). The table sets each assumption against what has been observed; it does not combine them into a case.

The requests that would most change a reading. Six sets of the requests in Part 05 section G would most sharpen the readings: the July–September 2026 actuals (request 1), to show whether LTM reported EBITDA ex-gains of $59.6m is the run rate (M1, M4); the 119-clinic list with its lease and exit schedule, a reconciled closure cash budget and the post-closure overhead budget (requests 3 and 5), which would allow the second round to be tested (M3); the supply-chain-finance schedule by bank, reconciled to the FY26 10-K ($197.6m), the company model ($151.8m) and the Credit Summary of the company's current supply-chain-finance ageing ($137.1m) (request 2), so that the working-capital balance can be stated on one definition; the closed-clinic KPI and clinic-EBITDA history FY20–Q1 FY27 with sales and addresses of the 129 round-one clinics (requests 8 and 9), to rebuild comp traffic on a CLOSE-FWD base and measure recapture (M1, M2; Exhibit 4.17 question 1); finance-lease cash cost and cash rent by clinic with the co-op programme terms (co-op in requests 13 and 14), to restate clinic economics to D1.1 and judge rebate durability (M4; question 2); and a maintenance and growth capex split with the Q2 FY27 10-Q (request 15), to state conversion on a certified capex basis. Items that bear only on the financing are listed in Part 08 section B.

M · Deal B detail

Each Deal B finding of Part 06 rests on the datapacks, quality-of-earnings files, financing models and peer comparisons set out here section by section, on the evidence supplied to 30 September 2026.

This section holds the secondary evidence behind Part 06. For each of sections A to H it gives the fuller reading, the cohort, market, reporting, overhead and DBW tables and charts, the public signals and what the evidence cannot show. Each section of Part 06 opens on its finding, its charts and at most one table, and links here.

06 A Thesis and readings: supporting evidence

Ares Credit Group's thesis, restated. Deal B is an emerging operator. Over 2021 to 2023 it grew on its own resources, buying low-priced sites in rural markets. It has since built infrastructure and corporate cost intended to support a business about twice its current size. In Ares Credit Group's view the 2025 and 2026 acquisition cohorts show that, with sufficient capital, the company can acquire more attractive sites, in areas of higher household income and greater population density, and its financial reporting became cleaner in 2026. It also owns a wellness clinic segment, Deal B Wellness Clinics (DBW), which we analyse on its own in Part 06 section F. Ares Credit Group is considering a financing with low leverage, a high price and participation in the upside; that structure and our reading of it are in Part 08 section C [A, DLB-001 pp.3–5, 8, 14].

Our readings of the six thesis components, each on the evidence supplied to date, with what supports Ares Credit Group's thesis and what does not, are in Exhibit 6.02 (Part 06 section A).

The paragraphs below summarise the evidence behind the readings; each is set out in full, with its references, in the subsections of this section headed "06 B" to "06 G", and summarised in Part 06 section B to Part 06 section G.

Exhibit 9.126 — The 2023–25 cohorts delivered 0.55–0.76x of seller closing EBITDA in their first owned year; in the second year only the 2023 cohort improved (0.66x), while the 11 2024 clinics with a second year fell to 0.21x (to LTM Jul-26)

Deal B general practice clinics by acquisition year: units, purchase multiple (x), four-wall delivery against seller EBITDA (x), margin after rebates on cash rent (%) and same-store sales (%); survivor clinics, LTM Mar-26 and LTM Jul-26

COHORT	UNITS	MULTIPLE, GROSS / NET OF SALE-LEASEBACK (STANDALONE)	LTM JUL-26 FOUR-WALL ÷ SELLER EBITDA (12 OWNED MONTHS) [I]	FIRST / SECOND OWNED YEAR ÷ SELLER EBITDA [I]	AFTER-REBATE FOUR-WALL, CASH RENT, LTM MAR-26	SAME-STORE SALES LTM JUL-26 (TRAFFIC)
2022	16	6.9x / 0.3x (sources conflict: 0.38x / 0.3x / 0.6x)	0.44x	0.13x (3 clinics) / 0.04x (13 clinics)	7.4%	+4.4% (0.0%)
2023	28	10.0x / –1.0x	0.90x	0.55x / 0.66x (same 20 clinics)	9.8%	+6.8% (–2.1%)
2024	32	7.7x / 1.4x	0.52x	0.76x (30 clinics) / 0.21x (11 clinics); the same 10 first-half-2024 clinics 0.48x → 0.23x	8.8%	–0.7% (–8.3%)
2025	24	5.3x / 2.7x	0.63x partial (0.52–0.77x by basis)	0.71x (11 clinics) / —	17.6% (≤12 owned months)	+0.64% (+6.0%), 21 clinic-months

Source: Historical Acquisition Detail (rows 9–91; seller "closing EBITDA", basis PF, window not stated); DLB Datapack (Jul-26 RF), Net Revenue and 4-Wall EBITDA tabs, rows 10–107; Accounting Firm 2 QoE Workbook LTM Mar-26, cash-rent normalisation schedule. Peers on the same after-rebate, cash-rent basis: 10.7–17.4% (Operator 8, Operator 7 ST-22, Operator 5; all clinics). Operator 8 acquired-unit

delivery 0.59–0.70x (Operator 8 Databooks, New Unit Adj tab) · Basis: Seller closing EBITDA and multiples PF (standalone, window not stated); delivery ratios on the company four-wall, book rent, actual owned months [I, notes C-87 and C-89]; cash-rent margins PF; survivor clinics. The detailed cohort table is Exhibit 9.127

Cohorts. On an age-matched first owned year the newer cohorts start better — 0.55x (2023), 0.76x (2024) and 0.71x (2025) of seller closing EBITDA, against 0.59–0.70x at Operator 8, the only peer that measures acquired units against the EBITDA used to price them [I, DLB Datapack; Historical Acquisition Detail; F, Operator 8 Databooks, New Unit Adj]. The advantage does not hold beyond the first owned year on our reading of the evidence supplied to date: the ten first-half-2024 clinics fell from 0.48x to 0.23x in their second year and thirteen 2022 clinics delivered 0.04x; on twelve full owned months the 2022–24 cohorts deliver 0.44x, 0.90x and 0.52x, and every available basis puts the 2025 cohort below its underwriting [I, same files]. On cash rent after rebates, the 2025 cohort's 17.6% is 0.6 points above the top of the peer range, but it is not comparable with full-year peer clinics until it has 21 owned months, and Deal B's survivor base against all-clinic peers flatters it; it rests on 177 of 297 possible owned clinic-months and a lower cash rent (7.3% of revenue against 8.6–10.6% for older cohorts); the 46 clinics owned at least 21 months earned 8.4% in LTM March 2026 before any adjustment for the "NRA Shared Services" charge booked in clinic classes (2.0–2.3% of revenue), or about 10.7–10.9% if that charge sits in the datapack four-wall, which the files do not confirm [I, Accounting Firm 2 QoE Workbook, cash-rent schedule and 'Rep-to-Adj - Clinic-level (Sage)' BW162]. Before rebates (D1.1) the general practice and preventive clinics cannot be placed against the peers: clinic rebates are given only for all clinic classes together, which include DBW's clinics from December 2025, so the all-clinic figures are not set beside the core operators (DBW is read in Part 06 section F) [I, Accounting Firm 2 QoE Workbook, 'Rep-to-Adj - Clinic-level (Sage)']. The 2025 cohort lost 19.5% of patient visits across the change of owner (seasonally aligned), against 8.0–12.5% for earlier cohorts (the pre-acquisition months are seller-system data, and the files do not establish that seller visit counts are defined as Deal B's are), though its first-year revenue loss (−12.2%) is close to Operator 3's 2023 cohort (−11.4%) [I, KPI Details incl. Pre-Acq; Operator 3 pre-acquisition financials (Accounting Firm 3)].

Organic comps and market attributes. On the common definition, with closed clinics kept until closure, same-store sales were +4.7% in 2025, inside the +1.1% to +6.2% range of 2025-period peers (Deal A, Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 8), and +3.3% for LTM July 2026, with traffic of −2.6% and −3.8% and ticket of +7.6% and +7.5%; the company's weekday-aligned series runs 3.2 points (2025) and 1.1 points (LTM July 2026) higher [F/I, DLB Datapack with Accounting Firm 2 QoE clinic ledger]. Clinics acquired in 2025–26 sit in trade areas with a median household income of $63,374 against $47,928 for earlier clinics (company attribution data, in which nine of the thirty newer-site attributes are estimates or duplicates), and, for the 92 clinics owned throughout the year to August 2026 (company four-wall, R-BOOK), clinics with three positive attributes earned 19.5% against 4.8% for clinics with none or one, a gap that persists inside the pre-2025 cohort (10.3% for two or more attributes against 4.1% for none or one) [F, Ares Credit Group Diligence Requests (8.21.26), 'S1. Positive Attribution' and S1 tabs]. Density and acquisition returns by attribute are not established on the files supplied.

Reporting quality and the earnings ladder. Reported EBITDA was negative in every year from 2023 to LTM March 2026 (−$5.1m, −$12.0m, −$3.2m, −$4.0m) and was $1.22m for LTM July 2026, or −$0.19m once $1.38m of gains is removed [F, Financing Model (Jul-26 RF), (A+B+C) ISCF row 72]. The FY25 audit turned QoE-adjusted EBITDA of $5.16m into −$2.54m and moved the pro forma run-rate figure from $18.53m to $10.26m; the borrower model now equals the Accounting Firm 2 figure less the audit adjustments to within $1.0k, so the 2026 numbers reconcile [F, Lender Update (10 Sep 2026) p.4; Accounting Firm 2 QoE Workbook, Quality of Earnings N77, N149; AJE Adjusted EBITDA D109; Financing Model ISCF E127; reconciliation: Financing Model ISCF E92, E127, F92, F127 against Quality of Earnings N149, O149 (DLB-5647, DLB-5648)]; the August 2026 roll-forward and bank ties, on which the 2026 reading most depends, are not in the files supplied. For LTM July 2026 the ladder reads E2 post-audit $8.51m, pro forma post-audit (labelled E4; Accounting Firm 2 run-rate items included) $13.79m, Ares Credit Group E5 $11.16m and Ares Credit Group cash-adjusted EBITDA $5.68m [F, Financing Model ISCF CP94, CP127; Ares Credit Group model vRF_09, FCCR E32:E33]. The adjustment share (top rung less reported, over top rung) is 0.99–1.13 for FY25, above every peer (0.11–0.93), and 0.76–0.78 for LTM July 2026, inside the range in its upper quartile (0.90–0.87 if E1 is taken ex-gains) [I, Exhibit 9.69]. Acquisition expense add-backs other than gains were $4.4m, $9.4m and $9.0m in 2023–25 (6.9%, 11.8% and 8.5% of purchase price, the 2025 figure including the DBW price), three consecutive years, so we would read them as cash costs rather than one-offs [I, Accounting Firm 2 QoE Workbook, 'DD #1 - Acquisition Expenses']. Conversion after company-split maintenance capex is 0.37–0.59 for LTM July 2026 depending on the rung (0.46 for FY25 on the post-audit pro forma), against 0.78–0.85 at Operator 3 and Operator 6, driven by maintenance capex of about $38k per general practice and preventive clinic, all of it booked to that segment, against $3.4–23k at peers [I, Financing Model ISCF CE177:CP177; (A.1) DLB Business CE98:CP98]. For April–August 2026 company cash EBITDA was $7.98m, of which $2.19m of recurring "operations adjustments" (24%; management states 15%) were paid in cash [F/M, Ares Credit Group Diligence Requests (8.21.26), tab 5 rows 24, 38, 58; Early Read p.14]; cash flow after debt service is set out in Part 08 section C.

Infrastructure for 1.8x. "Size" reads differently on clinics and on revenue. On the financing model's split of overhead between the segments, the general practice and preventive business goes from 103 clinics and $153.4m of LTM revenue at March 2026 to 136 clinics and $272.8m of revenue by FY28, with corporate overhead rising from $16.8m to $17.6m: per clinic that is $138k to $117k, about $38k for each added clinic, and per dollar of revenue it falls from 9.2% to 5.9%; overhead per clinic had risen from $96.0k in FY24 [F/P/I, Financing Model (Jul-26 RF), (A+B+C) ISCF rows 34, 32, 57, less the DBW segment and DBW corporate overhead tabs]. Peers' overhead ratios did not fall with scale where they can be followed (Operator 8 4.2% to 4.8%; Operator 3 2.0% to 3.2%) [F, Operator 8 model and databook; Operator 3 lender model]. The $11.1k integration budget per clinic is 13–31% of the like-for-like cost observed in the QoE ($32k, $86k and $82k per acquired unit in 2023–25; $32k for 2025 if DBW's 38 clinics are counted, because

the cost lines are consolidated), and no costed doubling case exists in the files [M/I, Ares Credit Group Diligence Requests tab 6; Accounting Firm 2 QoE 'DD #1'].

Deal B Wellness Clinics. DBW's four-wall (company definition, R-BOOK) for January–July 2026 was $5.42m against $7.53m under the seller a year earlier (−26%; margin 24.9% against 31.7%), with patient visits −13.4% and revenue per visit +5.9%; the prior-year months are seller data, so none of this is a comp [F, DBW Datapack (Jul-26 RF), 4-Wall EBITDA CB56:CC56, row 56]. Revenue per visit of $100.7 in owned months (December 2025 to July 2026, ratio of sums) sits inside the $79–112 wellness clinic range [I, DBW Datapack; Wellness Clinic Operator 2 Screening Memo p.9; Wellness Clinic Operator 1 FDD Databook SPL2]. After rebates on cash rent DBW earned 25.9% in its first four owned months (PF, cash-rent normalisation) against 15.5% (A) for Wellness Clinic Franchisor's company clinics before royalty, a 10.6-point gap that neither rent code nor royalty explains [I, Accounting Firm 2 QoE, DBW cash-rent normalisation; Wellness Clinic Franchisor Project Bolt QoE Databook, PL5]. On standalone EBITDA of about $6.2m and wellness clinic multiples of 5.1–6.3x the value range is $33–46m, indicative only because the multiples are on unstated or different rungs; Ares Credit Group's $44m [A] needs 6.0x, and the $28m purchase price was 3.2x management-adjusted closing EBITDA [M/I, DBW Datapack; Financing Model tab C.2; Early Read p.8].

What would sharpen the readings. The requests that would most change a reading are the August 2026 consolidated QoE roll-forward with bank-to-ledger ties, a key from each acquisition to the datapack clinic IDs, the "NRA Shared Services" split, DBW's four-wall bridge and a costed doubling case; the full list is in Part 06 section H.

06 B Acquisition cohorts: supporting evidence

The level advantage of the 2025 cohort survives the move to cash rent, but it is measured on twelve or fewer owned months and the mature base sits below every cash-rent peer before any shared-services adjustment, and at the bottom of the range if adjusted. Deal B's datapack "4-Wall EBITDA" is a D1.2 figure (pharmacy and supply rebates sit in clinic COGS, 0.99% of revenue in FY25 and 0.78% in LTM March 2026) on book rent including sale-leaseback rent (R-BOOK), and book rent exceeds cash rent by 1.4% of revenue [F, DLB-3448; DLB-3468; DLB-3173]. Restated to cash rent from the QoE rent roll (D1.2, R-CASH, survivor clinics of each acquisition-year cohort, LTM March 2026), the cohort margins are 7.4% (2022), 9.8% (2023), 8.8% (2024) and 17.6% (2025) [I, DLB-3255; DLB-3307; DLB-3346; DLB-3372]. On the company definition (R-BOOK) for March–August 2026 they are 8.3%, 10.8%, 9.5% and 19.5% [I, DLB-3632..3635]. The 2025 cohort's figure rests on 177 of a possible 297 owned clinic-months in LTM March 2026, and its cash rent is 7.3% of revenue against 8.6–10.6% for the 2021–24 cohorts, which accounts for 1.0–3.3 points of the gap [I, DLB-3372 note; DLB-3369; DLB-3252; DLB-3304; DLB-3343; DLB-3187].

Exhibit 9.127 — Sale-leasebacks funded 43–96% of each 2022–25 cohort's price, leaving net multiples of −1.0x to 2.7x; on twelve owned months the 2022–24 cohorts delivered 0.44–0.90x of seller closing EBITDA (to LTM Jul-26)

By acquisition year: units, price and multiples, owned clinic-months, four-wall EBITDA and margin, delivery against seller EBITDA (x), cash rent ÷ revenue and same-store sales; DLB survivor clinics, LTM Mar-26 and LTM Jul-26

COHORT	UNITS (DEALS)	PRICE GROSS / NET OF SLB ($M)	SLB ÷ PRICE	SELLER CLOSING EBITDA ($M)	MULTIPLE GROSS / NET OF SLB (STANDALONE)	OWNED CLINIC-MONTHS, LTM JUL-26	FOUR-WALL LTM JUL-26, ST-59 R-BOOK ($M; MARGIN)	FOUR-WALL LTM JUL-26 ÷ SELLER EBITDA [I]	AGE-MATCHED: OWNED MONTHS 1–12 / 13–21 ÷ SELLER EBITDA [I]	D1.2 R-CASH, LTM MAR-26	CASH RENT ÷ REVENUE, LTM MAR-26	SSS_CD LTM JUL-26 (TRAFFIC)
2022	16 (16) (DLB-7659/7658)	23.7 / 1.3 (DLB-7661/7663)	77% (DLB-7672)	3.00 (DLB-7667)	6.9x / 0.3x, sources differ: 0.38x / 0.3x / 0.6x (DLB-7668/7669/8940/9049)	171 (DLB-0115)	1.47; 5.9% (DLB-0114/0116)	0.44x	0.13x (3 clinics) / 0.04x (13 clinics)	7.4% (DLB-3255)	8.6% (DLB-3252)	+4.4% (0.0%) (DLB-1531/1533)
2023	28 (23) (DLB-7674/7673)	56.9 / −4.8 (DLB-7676/7678)	96% (DLB-7687)	4.94 (DLB-7682)	10.0x / −1.0x (DLB-7683/7684)	319 (DLB-0143)	5.00; 8.8% (DLB-0142/0144)	0.90x	0.55x / 0.66x (same 20 clinics)	9.8% (DLB-3307)	9.2% (DLB-3304)	+6.8% (−2.1%) (DLB-1536/1538)
2024	32 (27) (DLB-7689/7688)	68.7 / 12.2 (DLB-7691/7693)	71% (DLB-7702)	7.98 (DLB-7697)	7.7x / 1.4x (DLB-7698/7699)	406 (DLB-0167)	4.75; 7.6% (DLB-0166/0168)	0.52x	0.76x (30 clinics) / 0.21x (11 clinics; H1-2024 deals 0.48x → 0.23x on the same 10 clinics)	8.8% (DLB-3346)	9.0% (DLB-3343)	−0.7% (−8.3%) (DLB-1541/1543)
2025	24 (19) (DLB-7704/7703)	69.2 / 35.2 (DLB-7705/7707)	43% (DLB-7716)	11.47 (DLB-7711)	5.3x / 2.7x (DLB-7712/7713)	255 of 297 (DLB-0187)	8.21; 18.1% (DLB-0186/0188)	0.63x partial; 0.52–0.77x by basis	0.71x (11 clinics, Feb–Jul-25 deals) / –	17.6%, ≤12 months (DLB-3372)	7.3% (DLB-3369)	+0.64% (+6.0%), 21 clinic-months (DLB-1546/1548)

Source: Historical Acquisition Detail (DLB-029); DLB Datapack Jul-26 RF (DLB-003); QoE Workbook LTM Mar-26, cash-rent schedule (DLB-022); rows as shown in each cell; age-matched ratios notes C-87 and C-89 · Basis: Seller closing EBITDA and multiples PF (standalone, window not stated); four-wall on the company definition, book rent, actual (A); cash-rent margins PF; survivor clinics; the 2025 cohort has 255 of 297 possible owned clinic-months. Its LTM Jul-26 margin of 18.1% covers its 24 clinics and every month in the datapack; the 19.3% in Part 06 section B covers the 26 clinics of 2025–26, with the two acquired in January 2026, from each clinic's first full owned month

Acquisition schedule DLB-029 (82 deals, 103 units, June 2021–January 2026; 4 deals without data). Seller EBITDA is the "closing EBITDA" used in the cohort multiple (basis PF, window not stated). Age-matched ratios use Deal B datapack series (four-wall by clinic-month, R-BOOK, owned months counted from each clinic's first full month) over DLB-029 seller closing EBITDA, for closing-date groups in which every DLB-029 unit maps to a datapack clinic and all seller EBITDA is stated; the groups, clinic IDs and DLB-029 rows are in note C-87. The datapack starts in January 2023, so most 2022 deals are observed only in their second owned year. The 2021 cohort (2 units) and the 2026 cohort (2 units, January 2026, 8.5x / 3.0x, 25.5% four-wall on ≤7 owned months) are omitted as too small. Four-wall and SSS are survivor clinics.

The 46 clinics Deal B had owned for at least 21 months earned 8.4% on the same definition in LTM March 2026, before any adjustment for the NRA Shared Services charge [I, DLB-3203]. How the cohort, mature-clinic and all-clinic margins sit against operators on the same rent and rebate basis is set out in Part 06 section G.

Delivery against underwriting appears weaker once a full twelve owned months is used, and on an age-matched basis the newer cohorts start better but the 2024 deals decay in their second year. A simpler comparison divides March–August 2026 four-wall EBITDA, doubled, by the seller "closing EBITDA" used to price each cohort (2022 −20%, 2023 +24%, 2024 −16%, 2025 −8%); those figures reproduce exactly from the pack but annualise the six strongest months of the year [I, DLB-3632..3635 notes; DLB-7667; DLB-7682; DLB-7697; DLB-7711]. For the 2022–24 cohorts, LTM July 2026 four-wall (twelve owned months, R-BOOK) is only 0.59–0.66 of the doubled March–August figure, so doubling overstates twelve-month earnings by 24–44% [I, DLB-0114; DLB-0142; DLB-0166 against the same notes]. On twelve owned months the cohorts deliver 0.44x (2022), 0.90x (2023) and 0.52x (2024) of seller closing EBITDA [I, DLB-0114/DLB-7667; DLB-0142/DLB-7682; DLB-0166/DLB-7697]. The 2025 cohort cannot yet be measured on twelve owned months (255 of 297 clinic-months in LTM July 2026); its delivery is 0.52–0.61x on the seasonal ratio observed for the older cohorts, 0.63x on the partial LTM, and 0.77x on the March–August doubling, so every available basis puts it below its underwriting [I, DLB-0186; DLB-3635 note; DLB-7711]. Because the seller EBITDA in the acquisition schedule is after a pro forma rent, the same test on EBITDAR (before rent) removes the sale-leaseback distortion: 0.71x, 0.96x and 0.71x for 2022–24 [I, DLB-3257, DLB-3309, DLB-3348 × cohort revenue DLB-3246, DLB-3298, DLB-3337; seller EBITDAR DLB-7666, DLB-7681, DLB-7696]. The acquisition schedule does not state the seller EBITDA window, and the 2023 cohort's 28 purchased units map to 27 surviving clinics, so the numerators are survivor-only [U, DLB-7682 note; DLB-7674]. The LTM ratios mix cohorts of different ages (the 2022 cohort has more than three owned years, the 2024 cohort about one and a half), so they are also shown on an age-matched basis: four-wall in each clinic's first twelve owned months over seller closing EBITDA is 0.55x for the 2023 cohort (20 clinics), 0.76x for 2024 (30 clinics) and 0.71x for 2025 (11 clinics closed February–July 2025, which do have twelve owned months) [I, Deal B datapack series (four-wall by clinic-month); DLB-029 rows in note C-87]. In the second owned year the 2023 clinics improved to 0.66x, while the 2024 clinics with a second year (11, mostly deals closed January–June 2024) delivered 0.21x; the same ten H1-2024 clinics fell from 0.48x in year one to 0.23x in year two, and thirteen 2022 clinics delivered 0.04x in their second year [I, same]. Newer cohorts therefore start better, which supports the level half of MS1, and the trajectory half rests on the second-year decay of the 2024 deals and the 2022 cohort rather than on the mixed-age LTM figures [I].

The peers place these ratios (Exhibit 9.128). Operator 8, the only comparator that measures acquired-unit earnings against the pro forma EBITDA used to price them, delivered 0.59x and 0.70x (clinic-level, PF, rent code R-UNK) [F, OP8-1703; OP8-2211]; on the mixed-age LTM basis Deal B's 2022 and 2024 cohorts are 0.07–0.16 below that range and its 2023 cohort 0.19 above it; on the age-matched first owned year, closer to Operator 8's year-specific construct, the 2023 cohort is 0.04 below it and the 2024 and 2025 cohorts 0.09 and 0.04 above it, while the H1-2024 deals' second year (0.23x) is 0.37 below it [I]. The sponsor roll-ups that publish entry and later multiples imply later-to-entry clinic EBITDA of 1.33x (Operator 6, 31 deals), 1.38x (Operator 3, 18 deals, with conflicting averages) and 1.63x (Operator 4 programmatic pool), all company-presented, synergised and survivor-only [I, OP6-1731/OP6-1733; OP3-1493/OP3-1494; OP4-0802/OP4-0806]. Deal B's best like-for-like figure, EBITDAR delivery of 0.83–0.96x, is 0.20–0.93 below that range, and the rent code and synergy basis still differ, so the placement is directional [I]. Within-platform margin paths, which hold the rent code constant, are the one test on which Deal B sits inside the peer range: its 2022 and 2023 cohorts gained 1.3–1.6 points from their first full calendar year to LTM July 2026 and its 2024 cohort lost 1.8 points, against −2.4 to +5.8 points at Operator 2, Operator 1 and Operator 7 (Operator 2's +3.3 points sets acquired clinics in their first owned year, 26 clinics in 2018, against those in their third, 55 clinics in 2020; the groups are different clinics, not one cohort) [I, DLB-0100/DLB-0116; DLB-0128/DLB-0144; DLB-0156/DLB-0168; A4-S0272/A4-S0287; A4-S0094/A4-S0134; OP7-1085/OP7-1086; OP7-1088/OP7-1089].

Exhibit 9.128 — Deal B's 2024 and 2025 cohorts start above Operator 8's 0.59–0.70x, but the 2024 clinics fall to 0.21x in year two, and EBITDAR delivery of 0.83–0.96x sits below the roll-ups' 1.15–1.63x (to LTM Jul-26)

Acquired-clinic earnings against the EBITDA used to price them (x), revenue across the change of owner (%) and within-platform margin change (points); Deal B 2022–25 cohorts against Operator 8, Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 4, Operator 2, Operator 1 and Operator 7 ST-22

MEASURE (DEFINITION; BASIS; RENT CODE; BASE)	PEERS (ROWS)	RANGE	DEAL B (ROWS)	POSITION
Acquired-unit clinic earnings ÷ PF underwriting EBITDA (clinic-level ST-59; PF)	Operator 8 FY24 0.59x (OP8-1703), FY25 0.70x (OP8-2211); R-UNK; acquired units	0.59–0.70x	LTM Jul-26 four-wall (R-BOOK, 12 owned months) ÷ seller closing EBITDA: 2022 0.44x, 2023 0.90x, 2024 0.52x (DLB-0114/7667, 123/7682, 142/7697); 2025 0.52–0.77x by annualisation basis (DLB-0186, 3239, 6823)	2022, 2024 below; 2023 above; 2025 straddles the bottom
Same measure, age-matched (first 12 owned months; months 13–21)	Operator 8 FY24 0.59x, FY25 0.70x (OP8-1703/2211)	0.59–0.70x	Year 1: 2023 0.55x (20 clinics), 2024 0.76x (30), 2025 0.71x (11); year 2: 2023 0.66x (20), 2024 0.21x (11), 2022 0.04x (13) (note C-89 ÷ DLB-029; note C-87)	Year 1: 2023 0.04 below, 2024/2025 0.09/0.04 above; year 2: 2023 inside, 2024 0.40 below
Later ÷ entry clinic earnings, implied from entry and later multiples (company-presented, synergised, survivor; R-UNK)	Operator 6 1.15x (OP6-1731/1733); Operator 3 1.38x (OP3-1493/1494, sources differ); Operator 4 1.63x (OP4-0802/0806)	1.15–1.63x	EBITDAR LTM Mar-26 ÷ seller EBITDAR (R-NONE): 2022 0.71x, 2023 0.96x, 2024 0.71x (DLB-3257, 2964, 2892; 6565, 6664, 6718)	Below by 0.20–0.93; rent and synergy bases differ
First 12 owned months' revenue ÷ seller's prior 12 months (adjacent windows; POOLED seller/owned)	Operator 3 2023 cohort −11.4%, n=17, seller momentum +6.3% (OP3-1110/1111)	−11.4%	2022 −7.6% (DLB-2043); 2023 −5.4% (DLB-2083); 2024 −8.0% (DLB-2123); 2025 −12.2%, 11 clinics (DLB-2163)	2022–24 better by 3.7–6.2pp; 2025 worse by 1.0pp
Owned-year margin change, within platform (rent code constant)	Operator 2 acquired clinics, first owned year (2018, 26 clinics) to third owned year (2020, 55 clinics) +3.3pp, different clinics in each year, not one cohort (R-UNK; A4-S0272/S0287); Operator 1 [name withheld] batch yr1→yr5 −2.4pp (R-CASH; A4-S0094/S0134); Operator 7 ST-22 cohorts +5.8pp / −0.6pp (R-CASH; OP7-1085/1086, 963/1089)	−2.4 to +5.8pp	2022 +1.6pp; 2023 +1.3pp; 2024 −1.8pp (R-BOOK; DLB-0100/0116, 112/0144, 136/0168)	Inside, lower half
Not valid: pre/post-acquisition visit count	No peer measures traffic across the seller-to-owner change	–	2025 −19.5% vs 2022–24 −8.0% to −12.5% (seasonality-aligned, six months; DLB-2154, 2034, 1807, 1813)	Deal B-internal only

Source: Rows as shown in each cell; Deal B DLB Datapack (DLB-003), Historical Acquisition Detail (DLB-029) and KPI Details incl. Pre-Acq (DLB-032); age-matched ratios notes C-87 and C-89 · Basis: Deal B numerators A (company four-wall, book rent, survivor clinics); seller EBITDA PF, window not stated; peer figures company-presented, synergised or survivor-only where marked; rent codes differ as shown, so placements are directional

Seller EBITDA is the "closing EBITDA" in DLB-029 (basis PF, window not stated). The 2025 range combines the older cohorts' seasonal ratio (0.59–0.66), the partial LTM and the March–August doubling.

Read by months of ownership (Exhibit 6.05, Part 06 section B), the 2023 clinics dipped and then recovered while the 2024 clinics kept falling: indexed to each cohort's own first six owned months (= 86), four-wall EBITDA of all 27 clinics acquired in 2023 was 65 in owned months 7–12 and 107 in months 21–26, while all 32 clinics acquired in 2024 stood at 64 in owned months 7–12 and 49 in months 13–18 [I, DLB-003 '4-Wall EBITDA' and 'Clinic Level Information'; note C-89]. On Ares Credit Group's view that the 2025–26 cohorts are better, the curve so far shows only their start: all 24 clinics acquired in 2025 have their first six owned months, 11 have months 7–12 (index 89) and none has a second owned year, against up to 37 owned months observed for the 2023 cohort and 26 for the 2024 cohort, where the later points rest on few clinics [I, same]. The index compares each cohort with its own start, not with the price paid, which Exhibit 6.04 shows; it covers surviving clinics only, which flatters every curve, and its even-numbered blocks fall in the opposite half of the year from months 1–6. On the calendar, the same 32 clinics acquired in 2024 earned 15.1% less four-wall EBITDA in January–July 2026 than in January–July 2025, a smaller fall than the index shows, because some of the 2025 months precede Deal B's ownership [I, same].

The 2025 cohort's first-year visit loss is an outlier within Deal B; on the one measure a peer shares, its revenue loss is typical. On seasonality-aligned windows (the first six owned months against the same months a year earlier under the seller), the 2025 cohort lost 19.5% of patient visits with ticket up 9.9% and sales down 11.5%, against visit losses of 9.0–12.5% for the 2022–24 cohorts; adjacent-window figures of −23% to −25% do not remove seasonality [I, DLB-2154..2156; DLB-2034; DLB-2074; DLB-2114; DLB-2130; DLB-2146]. The pre-acquisition months are seller-system data (flagged SELLER in the pack) and seller visit counts may not be defined as Deal B's are [U, DLB-2154 note; CreditSwan definitions D8.1]. On the one construct a peer shares (first owned year's revenue against the seller's prior twelve months), the 2025 cohort's −12.2% is 1.0 points worse than Operator 3's 2023 cohort (−11.4%) and the 2022–24 cohorts (−5.4% to −8.0%) are better, so the revenue loss is typical and the visit loss is an outlier

only within Deal B [I, DLB-2163; OP3-1110; DLB-2043; DLB-2083; DLB-2123]. On the other first-year measure, owned months 1–12 against the same months a year earlier (Exhibit 6.03, Part 06 section B), the 2025–26 cohort's sales dip is −9.2% on 25 clinics with partial windows to July 2026 and −11.9% on the 11 clinics with a full first year.

Exhibit 9.129 — The 2025 cohort lost 19.5% of patient visits in its first six owned months against 8.0–12.5% for the 2022–24 cohorts, and its first-year revenue fell 12.2%, 1.0 points more than Operator 3's 2023 cohort (2022–25 cohorts)

Change against the seller's same months a year earlier (three and six months, seasonally aligned) and first twelve owned months against the seller's prior twelve, %, by acquisition cohort, 2022–25

COHORT (CLINICS)	VISITS, 3 / 6 MONTHS	SALES, 3 / 6 MONTHS	TICKET, 3 / 6 MONTHS	REVENUE, FIRST 12 OWNED MONTHS ÷ SELLER'S PRIOR 12 (ADJACENT)	ROWS
2022 (12)	−8.3% / −10.7%	+1.4% / −1.0%	+10.4% / +10.6%	−7.6%	DLB-2018..2020, 2034..2036, 2043
2023 (21; 20 for 12 months)	−6.6% / −8.0%	−6.8% / −5.9%	−0.2% / +2.0%	−5.4%	DLB-2058..2060, 1807..2076, 1808
2024 (27; 26 for 12 months)	−11.9% / −12.5%	−8.8% / −8.7%	+3.9% / +4.4%	−8.0%	DLB-2098..2100, 1813..2116, 1793
2025 (23; 11 for 12 months)	−20.0% / −19.5%	−11.1% / −11.5%	+11.4% / +9.9%	−12.2%	DLB-2138..2140, 1901..2156, 1902
Operator 3 2023 cohort (17)	–	–	–	−11.4% (seller momentum +6.3%)	OP3-1110; OP3-1111

Source: Project Bravo KPI Details incl. Pre-Acq (DLB-032), rows as shown; Operator 3 pre-acquisition financials (OP3-1110, OP3-1111) · Basis: Pooled: seller-system months before acquisition and Deal B months after; seller visit counts may be defined differently [U]; clinics with complete data in both windows

Pre-periods are seller-system data (SELLER, D8.1); seller visit counts may be defined differently. Adjacent-window visit changes for the 2025 cohort (−24.4% / −22.5% / −25.2%, DLB-2130/2146/2162) are not seasonally aligned.

Exhibit 9.130 — In every Deal B cohort from 2022 to 2025, visit counts fell 9–20% in the first six owned months while ticket rose, and first-year revenue ran 6–12% below the seller's prior year

Deal B acquisition cohorts 2022 to 2025: change against the seller's same or prior months, %; six-month windows matched by season, twelve-month windows adjacent

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal B: Project Bravo KPI Details (incl. Pre-Acq), visit count and sales by clinic and month; fact rows DLB-2034, 2036, 2043 (2022); DLB-2074, 1828, 1808 (2023); DLB-2114, 1823, 1793 (2024); DLB-2154, 1842, 1902 (2025) · Basis: Actual (A) KPI data; seller months come from the sellers' systems before acquisition and owned months from Deal B's, pooled; clinics with complete data in both windows. Operator 3's 2023 cohort −11.4% on the same twelve-month measure (OP3-1110)

The 2025 cohort lost the most patient visits (−19.5%) and revenue (−12.2%) in the transition, even though newer cohorts start better on age-matched earnings delivery; the two measures answer different questions [I, Exhibit 9.128; Exhibit 9.129]. The ticket-led pattern, with traffic falling while ticket rises, is also seen in the industry's same-store data (Part 03 section B), but no peer measures traffic across a change of owner, so the transition visit loss itself cannot be placed [I, Exhibit 9.128].

Comps by cohort. On the common same-store definition (Part 06 section G), by cohort for LTM July 2026, the 2022 and 2023 cohorts comp +4.4% and +6.8%, the 2024 cohort −0.7% with traffic −8.3%, and the 2025 cohort +0.64% on only 21 clinic-months [I, DLB-1531; DLB-1536; DLB-1541; DLB-1543; DLB-1546]. The acquisition-lag variant (entry from the 25th owned month) is +10.4% for calendar 2025 and +6.0% for LTM July 2026, above SSS_CD, so clinics in their second owned year comp below the mature base [I, DLB-1436; DLB-1551]; no peer publishes this variant.

Twenty-four of the 103 surviving DLB clinics lost money on the company four-wall for LTM July 2026 (21 for LTM August 2026), 18 on D1.2 with cash rent for LTM March 2026, and 21.5% of the 54 clinics owned at least 21 months by July 2026 [I, DLB-3558; DLB-3573].

Exhibit 9.131 — Loss-making clinics are most common among 2021–22 acquisitions (6 of 18) and least among 2025–26 acquisitions (3 of 26), 19 of which have under twelve owned months (LTM Jul-26)

Share of surviving clinics with negative four-wall EBITDA, %, by acquisition year; twelve months to July 2026 (part of the window for clinics acquired from August 2025)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Bravo DLB Datapack (Jul-26 RF), tabs '4-Wall EBITDA' and 'Clinic Level Information'. Totals: DLB-3558, DLB-3559, DLB-3572, DLB-3573 · Basis: Actual (A): four-wall EBITDA on the company definition, book rent; 103 surviving clinics, including clinics owned for part of the window (closed clinics are not in the datapack). A clinic is loss-making when its four-wall EBITDA summed over August 2025 to July 2026 is below zero. Of the 26 clinics acquired in 2025–26, 19 have fewer than twelve owned months in the window; all 3 loss-making clinics of that group are among those 19, and none of the 11 full-window clinics lost money. The 2023 acquisitions (17.3%) sit below the all-clinic share (17.8%)

Loss-making clinics sit in every cohort, not only among the early acquisitions: on the company four-wall for the twelve months to July 2026, 6 of 18 clinics acquired in 2021–22 lost money, 6 of 27 acquired in 2023, 9 of 32 acquired in 2024 and 3 of 26 acquired in 2025–26 [I, DLB-003 '4-Wall EBITDA' and 'Clinic Level Information'; totals DLB-3558, DLB-3559]. The 2025–26 group's lower share does not yet bear on Ares Credit Group's view that the newer cohorts are better: 19 of its 26 clinics have fewer than twelve owned months in the window, all three of its loss-making clinics are among them, and none of its 11 full-window clinics lost money. The count covers surviving clinics only: clinics Deal B has closed are not in the datapack, so it leaves out any clinic closed while loss-making.

Acquisition pricing. The diligence-complete pipeline is 9 targets and 12 clinics at $27.26m for $6.50m of trailing EBITDA; the full pipeline is 24 targets and 44 clinics at $100.1m, priced at 3.88x TTM buy-side QoE EBITDA [F, DLB-028 '2. Pipeline Summary' E13:E21; DLB-8088; DLB-8089; DLB-8093]. Those pipeline multiples sit just below the small-clinic standalone range of 4.5–5.8x, and Deal B's own 2022–25 cohort multiples were 5.3–10.0x gross of real estate and −1.0x to 2.7x net of sale-leasebacks (standalone, seller EBITDA; the 2022 net figure conflicts across sources at 0.38x, 0.3x and 0.6x), against Operator 2's 7.4x gross and 6.3x net (synergised); Deal B's sale-leasebacks funded 43–96% of each 2022–25 cohort's price against about 12% at Operator 2, so its low net multiples are rent obligations rather than cheap purchases [I, DLB-7668..7713; DLB-7672; DLB-7687; DLB-7702; DLB-7716; DLB-7669/DLB-8940/DLB-9049; OP2-3189/3190; Exhibit 4.05].

Our reading on MS1, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported. The condition that holds: newer cohorts start better — age-matched first-year delivery of 0.65x, 0.76x and 0.71x for 2023–25 against Operator 8's 0.59–0.70x, and a 2025 cash-rent margin of 17.6% on twelve or fewer owned months. The condition the evidence does not support: sustained economics — the H1-2024 deals fall from 0.48x to 0.23x in their second owned year and the 2022 cohort delivers 0.04x, and the 46 clinics owned at least 21 months earned 8.4% in LTM March 2026 before any shared-services adjustment (about 10.7–10.9% if the NRA Shared Services charge is removed [U]), below or at the bottom of the 10.7–17.4% cash-rent peer range (2021–25) [I, Exhibit 9.127; Exhibit 9.128; Exhibit 6.20]. What would change this reading: twelve owned months for the 2025 cohort (from January 2027), a key from each acquisition-schedule deal to the datapack clinic IDs, and confirmation of whether the datapack four-wall carries the NRA Shared Services charge.

Public signals

Customer ratings of Deal B's clinics are high and closely grouped, and the lower ratings all sit in clinics acquired before 2025. Of the 96 location pages on the company's site, read on 30 September 2026, 82 show a review-site rating [F, PUB-0106]. Those 82 pages carry 49,539 reviews; the review-weighted mean is 4.21 and the range is 3.8 to 4.2 [I, PUB-0107] [I, PUB-0108] [I, PUB-0109; C-PUB-4]. The smallest sample behind any one rating is 142 reviews [I, PUB-0110]. Nineteen pages show 3.8 to 3.9 and none shows less than 3.8 [I, PUB-0111].

Matched to the company's own acquisition cohorts (the match is described in Part 06 section C), all 19 of the clinics rated 3.8 to 3.9 were acquired before 2025 [I, PUB-0112]. Only eight of the 21 matched 2025–26 clinics show a rating, each between 4.1 and 4.2, so the newer cohort is a small sample [I, PUB-0113].

Exhibit 9.132 — All 19 Deal B clinics rated 3.8 to 3.9 on review site were acquired before 2025; the eight rated 2025–26 clinics show 4.1 to 4.2 (company location pages read on 30 September 2026)

Number of Deal B clinic pages at each review-site rating shown on the company's own location pages, by the company's acquisition cohort; 82 of 96 pages carry a rating, on 49,539 reviews in total; read on 30 September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal B location pages (96 pages, 82 with a review-site rating and review count), read on 30 September 2026; acquisition cohort from the company's clinic attribution data (September 2026), matched to the public pages by town, state and clinic name. Our computation [I, C-PUB-4; C-PUB-5; PUB-0110; PUB-0111; PUB-0112; PUB-0113] [F, PUB-0106] · Basis: Each page counts once at the rating it displays (one decimal). Every rated page carries at least 142 reviews. Cohort is the company's own label (acquired before 1 January 2025, or in 2025–26). Only 8 of the 21 matched 2025–26 clinics show a rating, so that series is a small sample; 16 matched 2025–26 clinics, and 2 public pages with no company match, show none. Two rated pages at one address (4.1 each) fit one pre-2025 company

clinic equally and are shown separately. A rating is a customer's view of service on one site, not a measure of clinic economics; newer clinics have had less time to gather reviews

The exhibit shows how customers score the service on one site on one day. It does not show clinic economics: a rating is a customer's view of service, not a measure of revenue or margin. Newer clinics have had less time to gather reviews, and two-thirds of the matched 2025–26 clinics show no rating yet. The figures are those displayed on the company's pages; they are not a series through time.

06 C Markets served: supporting evidence

On the company's attribution data (103 DLB clinics), median household income in the trade area is $63,374 for the 26 clinics acquired in 2025–26 against $47,928 for the 77 earlier clinics, and the share with pharmacy mix below 13% is 79% against 46% [M, DLB-028 'S1. Positive Attribution' C7:G123; 'Attributes' K11:L11]. Median households in the trade area are lower for the newer group (22,466 against 29,060); whether that means lower density depends on a trade-area definition the attribution data do not state (the company's visit count file labels the same attribute groups "3-mile radius demographics", with no vendor or data year [M, DLB-024 p.1]), and nine of the thirty newer-site attributes are estimates or duplicates [U, same locators]. The company's attribute file can be linked to its clinic-level four-wall [note C-102]. For the 92 clinics owned throughout the year to August 2026 (company four-wall, R-BOOK), clinics with three positive attributes earned 19.5% against 4.8% for clinics with none or one, clinics at or above the median household income of $51,473 earned 14.1% against 5.8%, and the attribute gap holds inside the pre-2025 cohort (10.3% for two or more attributes against 4.1% for none or one) [I, DLB-8603; DLB-8595; DLB-8607; DLB-8611; DLB-8631; DLB-8635]. Attribute groups also separate same-store traffic (three-attribute clinics +5.4% in July–August 2026 against −9.0% for clinics with none) [F, DLB-024 p.1]. The subsector evidence is consistent with the mix finding: general practice-heavy clinics earn 2–10 points more than pharmacy-heavy clinics in every dataset, although mix explains at most 8% of margin variance [I, Part 09 section J, under "03 D Unit economics: supporting evidence"; note C-38]. No peer in the set reports trade-area demographics, so there is no peer placement, and acquisition returns by attribute cannot be computed without a key from the acquisition schedule's deals to the datapack's clinic IDs [U, DLB-029; DLB-003].

On the company's trade-area data the 2025–26 clinics sit in markets with higher household income than the earlier clinics, $63,374 against $47,928, and above the median of each earlier acquisition year, but with fewer households, and clinics with more positive market attributes earn higher four-wall margins [M/I, DLB-8114; DLB-8118; DLB-028 'S1. Positive Attribution' rows 7–109 and '1. Attributes - Acq. & Pipeline' column H; DLB-8595; DLB-8603]. For Ares Credit Group's view, Exhibit 6.07 (Part 06 section C) bears out the income half of the claim on the company's figures and not the density half: on those figures the newer markets hold fewer households, not more. It cannot show acquisition returns by market, and only 17 of the 26 newer clinics are in the 92-clinic margin panel, so the link between market attributes and margins rests mainly on older clinics. Public census measures for the same clinics, within three miles, are set out below; they differ from the company's figures, and both are shown. The company's figures are the ones the thesis and the reading on MS2 rest on; the census measures are the public cross-check of their basis and direction, and neither is treated as a correction of the other.

Our reading on MS2, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported. Higher income and lower pharmacy mix are documented and are associated with higher margins within a cohort, but density is not established and acquisition returns are not shown. What would change this reading: a stated trade-area definition, and a deal-to-clinic key with sale-leaseback proceeds and rent per deal, which would allow acquisition returns by attribute.

Public signals

On public census data the 2025–26 clinics sit in markets with about twice the households of earlier clinics and higher income. The company's own figures, on which the reading rests, show a wider income gap and point the other way on households; the census measures are the cross-check, and the difference between the two is itself the finding. The test covers the 93 of 103 company clinics matched to a public location page (read on 30 September 2026), on the 2020–24 American Community Survey [I, PUB-0114; C-PUB-5]. Within three miles, median household income is $59,626 for pre-2025 clinics against $66,309 for 2025–26 clinics; median households are 9,794 against 20,863, on the clinics with a census tract within three miles [I, PUB-0115; PUB-0116; PUB-0432; PUB-0433; C-PUB-5].

The two sets are not on the same basis. Clinic by clinic, the company's household count is a median 2.27 times the public three-mile count and 0.97 times the five-mile count [I, PUB-0119; PUB-0120; C-PUB-5]. For pre-2025 clinics it is 2.30 times the three-mile count; for 2025–26 clinics, 0.91 times [I, PUB-0121; PUB-0122; C-PUB-5]. Six 2025–26 clinics, one City 2-area group, have no public page, leaving 21 of 26 matched [I, PUB-0114; C-PUB-5].

Of six states holding both cohorts, the newer median is higher in three for income and four for population (the state test uses population, not households; three-mile, American Community Survey 2020–24), on one to four newer clinics per state [I, PUB-0123]. Dated by first public listing, three-mile income (American Community Survey 2020–24) is $60.9k for 71 earlier clinics against $64.9k for 25 listed in 2025–26 [I, PUB-0124] [I, PUB-0125].

Across the 95 listed clinics with a trade area, median three-mile income (American Community Survey 2020–24) is $60.7k; 68% sit below the US median of $71,197 (American Community Survey 2020–24 five-year, read 30 September 2026) [I, PUB-0126; PUB-0127; C-PUB-1] [F, PUB-0069]. A Operator 1-banner clinic stands within three miles of 38.8% of the 96 listed clinics (clinic pages read 30 September 2026) [I, PUB-0128; C-PUB-2].

o6 D Reporting quality: supporting evidence

Reported consolidated EBITDA (D3 E1, owned months, gains on asset sales and sale-leasebacks left in) was negative in every year from 2023 to LTM March 2026 (−$5.1m, −$12.0m, −$3.2m, −$4.0m) and was $1.22m for LTM July 2026, or −$0.19m once $1.38m of gains is removed [F, DLB-5052..5055; DLB-5644; DLB-9108]. The FY25 audit produced $6.6m of gross adjusting entries and turned FY25 QoE-adjusted EBITDA (E2q, Accounting Firm 2's pre-audit QoE) of $5.16m into −$2.54m after audit [F, DLB-012 p.4; DLB-3877; DLB-4842]; the $6.6m of gross entries, this $7.41m change and the $8.09m AJE line below are not reconciled to one another in the documents supplied [U]. The borrower model's post-audit pro forma EBITDA equals the Accounting Firm 2 figure less the AJE line to within $1.0k in both FY25 ($10.26m = $18.53m − $8.09m, a gap of $0.15k) and LTM March 2026 ($12.08m = $18.60m − $6.24m, a gap of $1.05k), so the two sets of numbers now reconcile [F, DLB-5647; DLB-5648; DLB-5250; DLB-3900; Financing Model ISCF E92, E127, F92, F127; QoE Quality of Earnings N149, O149]. For LTM July 2026 the ladder reads E2 post-audit $8.51m, pro forma post-audit (labelled E4; Accounting Firm 2 run-rate items included) $13.79m, Ares Credit Group E5 $11.16m and Ares Credit Group cash-adjusted EBITDA $5.68m [F, DLB-5598; DLB-5599; DLB-6300; DLB-6302]. Management's "normalised" FY25 of $12.2m reverses $2.3m of the QoE provider's haircuts and is a management figure, not Accounting Firm 2's [M, DLB-8875]. LTM September 2026 E2 post-audit of $10.8m (a forecast window) carries $6.2m of diligence adjustments, 49% of that figure and 35% of the $14.6m pro forma [I, DLB-5136; DLB-5128; DLB-5674].

Placed against the peers on common rungs (Exhibit 9.133), Deal B's history is an outlier and its 2026 run-rate is not. Its FY25 adjustment share, (top rung − E1) ÷ top rung, is 0.99 on the Accounting Firm 2 pro forma incl. pre-acquisition months (E3), 1.03 on the Accounting Firm 2 run-rate figure and 1.13 on the post-audit figure, above every peer (Operator 3 0.11, Operator 2 0.21, Operator 6 0.61, Operator 8 0.83, Operator 4 0.93) [I, DLB-3866; DLB-3901; DLB-3900; DLB-5250; Exhibit 9.69 and Exhibit 9.141]. For LTM July 2026 it is 0.78 on the post-audit pro forma and 0.76 on Ares Credit Group E5, inside that range between Operator 6 and Operator 8, and 0.90–0.87 if E1 is taken ex-gains [I, DLB-5644; DLB-5599; DLB-6300; DLB-9108]. Consolidated company-split conversion (CONV_1 = (EBITDA − maintenance capex) ÷ EBITDA, BUILD years; DBW included) is 0.46 for FY25 and 0.59 for LTM July 2026 on the post-audit pro forma, 0.52 on Ares Credit Group E5 and 0.37 on E2, against 0.78–0.85 for Operator 3 and Operator 6 on E3, so it is 0.22–0.47 below the peers on every LTM July 2026 rung, and 0.16 below on Accounting Firm 2's pre-audit run-rate figure for FY25 (0.62, Exhibit 9.141) [I, A6-P5-008..010; DLB-5645; DLB-5599; DLB-6300; DLB-5598; Exhibit 9.68]. The driver is maintenance capex of about $38k per general practice and preventive clinic (LTM July 2026, $4.60m over 103 clinics; the model books all of it to that segment and none to DBW), above every peer figure of $3.4–23k including Deal A's total-capex upper bound [I, DLB-5645; DLB-008 (A.1) DLB Business!CE98:CP98; DLB-0054]. Ares Credit Group's own cash EBITDA is 0.43 of E5 and 0.34 of the post-audit pro forma, inside the peer range of 0.28–0.83 but 0.31–0.40 below its 0.73 median [I, DLB-6300; DLB-6302; Exhibit 9.69].

Adjustments exceeded Deal B's top adjusted EBITDA in FY25 on every rung (0.99–1.13, against 0.11–0.93 for the other operators shown), and the LTM July 2026 share of 0.89–0.78 becomes 0.90–0.87 once the $1.38m of gains on asset sales is taken out of reported EBITDA [I, DLB-3866; DLB-3900; DLB-3901; DLB-5250; DLB-5599; DLB-5644; DLB-6300; DLB-9108]. On Ares Credit Group's view that the financials became cleaner in 2026, Exhibit 6.10 (Part 06 section D) shows the reconciliation improving but not the gap between reported and adjusted earnings: without the gains, reported EBITDA for LTM July 2026 is still below zero (−$0.19m), so adjustments still make up more than the whole of adjusted EBITDA. Conversion after maintenance capex, 0.37–0.59 for LTM July 2026 depending on the rung, stays below Operator 3 and Operator 6 (0.78–0.85) [I, DLB-5645; DLB-5598; DLB-5599; DLB-6300]. Neither that exhibit nor Exhibit 9.133 shows whether each adjustment is justified; that needs the August 2026 roll-forward and bank ties, and the peers' top rungs differ (pro forma including pre-acquisition months, or adjusted).

The recurrence test in D3 turns the acquisition add-backs into cash costs. The acquisition-related expense add-backs other than gains on sale (closing costs, in-house deal team and travel, facility work, real-estate diligence, rebranding, legal, diligence, filings, other) were $4.4m, $9.4m and $9.0m in 2023–25, three consecutive years tied to acquisition activity, so under D3 they are E6 deductions rather than one-offs [I, DLB-4135..4227 sub-lines a–j excluding d]. At 6.9%, 11.8% and 8.5% of the purchase price of each year's acquisitions they sit inside the peer range of 0.7–14.1%, above every peer but Operator 6 (10.1–14.1%); the 2025 figure divides consolidated add-backs by a price that includes DBW's $28.0m [I, DLB-7676; DLB-7691; DLB-7705; DLB-8994; Exhibit 3.23]. The 2026 improvement is real but narrow: reported EBITDA was $5.67m for April–July 2026 (monthly $1.31m, $0.90m, $1.68m and $1.80m), and for April–August the company's cash EBITDA was $7.98m, of which $2.19m of recurring "operations adjustments" (24%; management states 15%) were paid in cash [F, DLB-008 ISCF!CM72:CP72; DLB-7850; DLB-7860; DLB-7863; M, DLB-001 p.14]; cash flow after debt service is set out in Part 08 section C. The August 2026 roll-forward and bank ties, which would test the 2026 figures, are not among the documents supplied [U].

Exhibit 9.133 — Deal B's FY25 adjustment share (0.99–1.13) is above every peer, its conversion after maintenance capex (0.37–0.59 for LTM Jul-26) below every peer, and its maintenance capex per general practice and preventive clinic (about $38k) above every peer

Adjustment share, conversion after maintenance capex, maintenance capex per clinic, cash share of adjusted EBITDA and recurring acquisition costs ÷ price; Deal B FY25 and LTM Jul-26 against peers' latest periods

MEASURE (DEFINITION; RUNG; BASIS)	PEERS (ROWS)	RANGE	DEAL B (ROWS)	POSITION
ADJ_SHARE = (top rung − E1) ÷ top rung	Operator 3 LTM May-25 0.11 (E3; OP3-1127/2161); Operator 2 FY25 0.21 (E2; OP2-4347/4426); Operator 6 LTM Mar-26 0.61 (E3; OP6-0047/0060); Operator 8 TTM Mar-26 0.83 / 0.54 where sources differ (E3; OP8-1781/2426/2409); Operator 4 LTM Mar-26 0.93 (E3; OP4-0269/1035)	0.11–0.93	FY25 0.99 (E3 Accounting Firm 2 $24.2m, DLB-3901), 1.03 (Accounting Firm 2 $18.5m, DLB-3900), 1.13 (post-audit $10.1m, DLB-5250), E1 −$3.2m (DLB-3866); LTM Jul-26 0.78 (post-audit $14.0m, DLB-5599) / 0.76 (Ares Credit Group E5, DLB-6300), E1 $1.22m (DLB-5644)	FY25 above by 0.04–0.19; LTM Jul-26 inside, upper quartile
CONV_1, company maintenance split [M], BUILD	Operator 3 FY23–21 0.78–0.86 (E3); Operator 6 FY24–LTM Mar-26 0.81–0.85 (E3) (Exhibit 9.68)	0.78–0.85	FY25 0.46 (A6-P5-008..010); LTM Jul-26 0.59 / 0.52 / 0.37 on post-audit pro forma / Ares Credit Group E5 / E2 (DLB-5645)	Below by 0.22–0.47
Maintenance capex per clinic [M]	Operator 6 $3.4k; Operator 8 $6.9k; Operator 1 $8.6–15k; Operator 3 $12k; Operator 2 $15k (P); Deal A $17–23k total capex (note C-39)	$3.4–23k	≈$38k LTM Jul-26 per general practice and preventive clinic ($4.60m ÷ 103; the model books no maintenance capex to DBW; DLB-5645, DLB-008 (A.1) DLB Business!CE98:CP98, DLB-0054)	Above by ≈$15k
Cash EBITDA ÷ top adjusted rung (E6 ÷ top)	Operator 4 0.29–0.78; Operator 8 0.24 (on its as-owned adjusted EBITDA, E2m); Operator 6 0.31–0.73; Operator 3 0.81–0.83 (Exhibit 9.69)	0.24–0.83 (median 0.73)	Ares Credit Group cash $5.68m ÷ E5 0.43; ÷ post-audit pro forma 0.34 (DLB-6300/6302; DLB-5599)	Inside; 0.31–0.40 below median
Recurring "one-time" acquisition costs ÷ price	Deal A 0.6–1.8%; Operator 4 2.3–2.5%; Operator 2 3.2–5.1%; Operator 3 2.7–6.3%; Operator 8 6.7%; Operator 6 10.1–14.1% (Exhibit 3.23)	0.6–14.1%	2023 6.9%; 2024 11.8%; 2025 8.5% (consolidated add-backs ÷ price incl. DBW's; DLB-4135..4227; DLB-7676/7691/7705; DLB-8994)	Inside, above every peer but Operator 6; recurs three years

Source: Rows as shown in each cell; Deal B Financing Model Jul-26 RF (DLB-008), QoE Workbook (DLB-022) and Ares Credit Group model vRF 09 (DLB-027); peer tables as referenced; note C-39 · Basis: Adjusted EBITDA rungs as labelled (E1 reported; E2, E3 and E5 adjusted, PF); Deal B's EBITDA rungs are consolidated, DBW included (DBW is read in Part 06 section F); maintenance capex is each company's own split [M]; peers' top rungs differ

Our reading on MS3, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported. The condition that holds: 2026 reporting reconciles (borrower PF = Accounting Firm 2 less AJEs within $1.0k) and the LTM July 2026 adjustment share has moved into the peer range. The conditions the evidence does not support: the historical base (FY25 above every peer; E1 negative FY23–LTM March 2026; recurring acquisition add-backs; conversion below every peer on every rung) and, for 2026, the missing August roll-forward and bank ties. What would change this reading: the August 2026 consolidated QoE with journal controls and a bank-to-ledger reconciliation split DLB/DBW, and a certified maintenance/growth capex split.

06 E Scaling capacity: supporting evidence

"Size" has three measures and they give different multiples of today's business. At March 2026 Deal B had 142 clinics, $162.6m of reported LTM revenue ($210.2m pro forma for FY25) and $18.2m of D1.1 cash-rent four-wall EBITDA, all of them consolidated with DBW's 38 wellness clinics [F, DLB-4935; DLB-4943; DLB-3902; DLB-3466]. The overhead tests below are on the general practice and preventive business alone: the financing model splits corporate overhead between the segments, and DBW's own overhead ($0.5m for its four owned months to March 2026, $3.6m in FY28E) is kept out of these tests; DBW's standalone EBITDA, which deducts the model's FY26 DBW overhead, is in this section under "06 F Deal B Wellness Clinics: supporting evidence" [F, DLB-6064; DLB-6068]. On that base the business had 103 clinics, $153.4m of LTM revenue and $16.8m of corporate overhead at March 2026, and the borrower model reaches 136 clinics and $272.8m of revenue by FY28 with overhead of $17.6m [F/P/I, DLB-5814; DLB-4943 less DLB-5948; DLB-5007 less DLB-6064; DLB-4939 less DLB-5946; DLB-4947 less DLB-5952; DLB-5011 less DLB-6068]. The same forecast reads two ways. **Per clinic**, overhead is $138k today and $117k in FY28, so the plan adds about $38k of overhead for each added clinic (1.15x clinics for 0.93x overhead) and assumes a saving per unit [I, same rows]. **Per dollar of revenue**, the plan grows revenue 1.57x on 0.93x overhead, so the ratio falls from 9.2% to 5.9%, driven by revenue per clinic rising from about $1.30m to $1.67m as well as by more clinics [I, same rows]. Both readings are borrower forecasts, and no costed case sits behind either [P].

The peers do not show the falling ratio the revenue reading needs, but the comparison is descriptive. Corporate overhead is 2.0–9.4% of revenue across the core operators (2.0–7.7% leaving out Operator 1 before its CY2016 definition break) and did not fall with scale where it can be followed: it rose at Operator 8 (4.2% to 4.8% as revenue grew about six-fold) and Operator 3 (2.0% to 3.2%), and Operator 1's fall is a definition break [F, Exhibit 3.11; note C-26]. Deal B's 9.2% (LTM March 2026) and $138k per general practice and preventive clinic (against $51.0k at Deal A, FY26, to $174.3k at

Operator 7 ST-22, LTM May 2026, the latest period of each) are described, not ranked, because overhead definitions differ by platform [I, DLB-5007 less DLB-6064; DLB-5814; DLA-1223 ÷ 983 clinics (Deal A FY26 10-K); OP7-0803 ÷ 10 clinics (OP7-0112); note C-26]. Deal B's own history shows some operating leverage: corporate headcount rose from 17 to 77 while the clinic count rose from 19 to 143 on the clinic roll (December 2022 to March 2026; 142 in the financing model, which leaves out a clinic closed in December 2025), so corporate heads per clinic fell from 0.76 to 0.46, including 19 regional managers and 11 deal-team staff at March 2026; from December 2025 both counts include DBW [F, DLB-4479..4494; DLB-4543..4558; DLB-4640; DLB-4664; I].

Corporate overhead per general practice and preventive clinic fell from $124.9k in FY23 to $96.0k in FY24, then rose to $134.9k in FY25 and $137.1k for the twelve months to March 2026, and the borrower's plan shows $152.2k at LTM September 2026E and $112.0k in FY28E [I, DLB-5004..5011 less DLB-6063..6068; DLB-4932..4939 less DBW's 38 clinics, DLB-5939..5946]. On Ares Credit Group's view that the platform is built for about twice the size, the actuals show overhead built ahead of the clinic count from FY24 to March 2026, and the plan spreads it over 34 more clinics while revenue per clinic also rises; the saving per clinic is a forecast with no costed case behind it [I, DLB-4940..4947 less DLB-5947..5952]. Overhead and revenue cover owned months while clinics are counted at the period end, and Exhibit 6.12 (Part 06 section E) shows totals, not what the overhead pays for. The model counts DBW's 38 clinics in its consolidated clinic total in every year, including FY23 and FY24 before they were bought, so consolidated overhead per clinic is not used here.

Integration cost has to be compared like for like. The company's $11.1k base estimate per acquired clinic covers equipment and installation ($4.3k), F&E diligence ($0.8k), data-system set-up ($1.4k) and RM, trainer and IT travel ($4.3k) [M, DLB-7866..7870; DLB-028 '6. Integration Cost Detail'!C7:D18]. The matching QoE sub-lines in DD #1 are RM and deal-team travel (b-2), facility construction and repair ©, real-estate and environmental diligence (e) and rebranding and marketing (f); data-system set-up has no separate line [F, DLB-4151..4195]. On that like-for-like subset Deal B spent $32k per acquired unit in 2023 ($0.97m over 28 units), $86k in 2024 ($3.24m over 32) and $82k in 2025 ($2.30m over 24 general practice and preventive units; $32k over 62 units if DBW's 38 clinics are counted, because the QoE lines are consolidated and do not name the purchase each cost relates to), so the budget is 13–31% of observed like-for-like cost on either basis [I, DLB-4151/4152/4155, DLB-4167/4168/4171, DLB-4183/4184/4187, DLB-4191/4192/4195; DLB-7674/7689/7704]. The full acquisition-related add-backs other than gains ($4.4m, $9.4m and $9.0m in 2023–25; $140k, $257k and $319k per unit on 28, 32 and 24 acquired units, or $121k for 2025 on 62 units including DBW's 38 clinics) also include closing costs, the in-house deal team, legal fees, filings and financial diligence, which are transaction costs rather than integration; they sit against Operator 6's $134–192k of transaction-related add-backs per clinic acquired (legal, diligence, deal bonuses, travel and integration) [I, DLB-4135..4227; OP6-1881..1883]. No source defines a doubling case or costs one [U, DLB-008; DLB-028].

Our reading on MS4, on the evidence supplied to date: insufficient evidence. The condition that is unresolved: no costed doubling case exists in the files. On balance the evidence leans against the claim — the integration budget is 13–31% of like-for-like observed cost, peers' overhead ratios did not fall with scale, and overhead per general practice and preventive clinic rose from $96.0k to $137.1k between FY24 and March 2026 — while the borrower's plan (1.15x clinics and 1.57x revenue on 0.93x overhead) and Deal B's falling headcount per clinic are consistent with the claim, and the plan is a forecast [I, Exhibit 6.13]. At today's $138k per clinic, doubling the 103 general practice and preventive clinics would imply about $16.8m of additional overhead a year; at the plan's marginal $38k per clinic, about $4.3m [I, sensitivity S5 in Part 06 section H]. What would change this reading: a costed 1.8x case, and a reconciliation of the $11.1k integration estimate with the $9.0–9.4m a year of acquisition add-backs.

Public signals

Seen from outside, Deal B presents one customer-facing system across clinics that keep their local names; its job board listed 49 open roles at general practice and preventive clinics on 30 September 2026 [F, PUB-0129] [I, PUB-0131]. Exhibit 9.134 lists what the company's site and job board showed on that day. By title, 43 of the 49 general practice and preventive roles are for veterinarians, seven for client service representatives and one for management [I, PUB-0131].

Exhibit 9.134 — Deal B's job board listed 49 open roles at general practice and preventive clinics; the 96 clinics on its location pages keep local names on one website and one booking tool (read on 30 September 2026)

Observations from the company's own pages and job board on one day

ITEM	WHAT THE PAGES READ SHOW	REFERENCE
Web presence	One domain with a location page for each of 96 clinics; the clinics keep their local names	[F, PUB-0275]
Clinic count stated on the home page	"103+ Locations"; the supplied count governs (103 general practice and preventive clinics at 31 July 2026), and the location pages serve only as the mapping base	[M, PUB-0276]; [F, DLB-0054]
Online booking	"Book an Appointment" buttons on the home page, the location finder and the location page read all open one vendor's booking tool (VetOps)	[F, PUB-0277]
Consumer financing	Two consumer finance providers named as financing partners	[F, PUB-0278]
Job board: open roles	49 at general practice and preventive clinics; wellness clinic roles are in Exhibit 9.139	[F, PUB-0129] [I, PUB-0131]

ITEM	WHAT THE PAGES READ SHOW	REFERENCE
Job board: by title	General practice and preventive clinics: 43 veterinarians, 7 client service representatives, 1 management	[I, PUB-0131]
Marketing tags	One review site Analytics 4 tag in the site's tag container	[F, PUB-0279]

Source: Deal B public website, location pages, tag container and job board, read on 30 September 2026 · Basis: Each row states what the pages read show. A row is an observation of the customer-facing side only; it does not describe internal systems or staffing, and a job board shows openings, not the size or make-up of the corporate team. Job titles are grouped by the words in the posting title. Wellness clinic roles are in Exhibit 9.139

These are observations of one day. A job board shows openings, not the size or make-up of the corporate team, and a web page shows the customer-facing tools, not the accounting, reporting or integration systems behind them. Roles at wellness clinics are in Exhibit 9.139, in this section under "06 F Deal B Wellness Clinics: supporting evidence".

06 F Deal B Wellness Clinics: supporting evidence

DBW's four-wall EBITDA (company definition, R-BOOK) for January–July 2026 was $5.42m against $7.53m under the seller a year earlier (−26%; margin 24.9% against 31.7%); on the same 38 clinics patient visits were −13.4%, revenue per visit +5.9% and revenue −8.6%, and loss-making clinics rose from 5 to 10 [F, DLB-0780; DLB-0775; DLB-0782; DLB-0777; DLB-0866; DLB-0867; DLB-0864; DLB-1306; DLB-1312]. The prior-year months are seller-system data, so none of these is a D2.1 comp; DBW has no common-definition comp base until December 2026 [F, DLB-0868; CreditSwan definitions D8.1]. The model's FY27 rebound is forecast only [M].

Under Deal B, DBW's quarterly four-wall margin was 24.2% in Q1 2026 and 25.5% in Q2 2026, below every full quarter under the seller in 2024 and 2025 (29.4% to 32.3%) [F, DLB-0857; DLB-0862; DLB-0817..DLB-0847]. For Ares Credit Group's view of DBW's economics, the fall is in volume and cost, not in price: revenue per visit rose 5.9% while patient visits fell 13.4% and revenue 8.6% in January–July 2026 against the seller's same months [F, DLB-0864; DLB-0866; DLB-0867]. The comparison is not a same-store measure: the earlier months come from the seller's systems, which may count patient visits differently, and the quarter to December 2025 mixes the two owners.

Contribution to consolidated results. DBW's share of Deal B depends on the basis, so each figure is named. Of revenue, DBW is 14.9% of FY25 pro forma revenue (a full year of the 38 clinics, seller months included: $37.5m of $210.2m), 12.9% of the borrower's FY26E reported revenue ($32.2m of $229.3m, owned from December 2025) and 10.7% in both FY27E and FY28E, when the plan's acquisitions not yet made enter the total [I, DLB-5973 ÷ DLB-5291; DLB-5950 ÷ DLB-4945; DLB-5951 ÷ DLB-4946; DLB-5952 ÷ DLB-4947]. Of four-wall EBITDA on the company definition (book rent), DBW is 34.8% of the FY25 pro forma total of the two segments ($10.84m of $26.27m), and 21.1% in FY26E and 16.3% in FY27E and FY28E of the borrower's consolidated four-wall, which includes the planned acquisitions [I, DLB-5997; DLB-5917; DLB-5968 ÷ DLB-5001; DLB-5969 ÷ DLB-5002; DLB-5970 ÷ DLB-5003]. On every basis DBW's share of clinic-level earnings is larger than its share of revenue, so the four-wall shortfall under Deal B weighs more on consolidated results than DBW's revenue share suggests; the FY26E to FY28E figures are the borrower's forecast [P].

DBW is a wellness clinic business and is placed only against the wellness clinic context set, never a core statistic (Exhibit 9.135) [F, Exhibit 9.137]. Revenue per visit, the one metric the comparator map treats as valid without qualification (Exhibit 9.137), is $100.7 for DBW's owned months (December 2025–July 2026) and $99.4 for LTM July 2026 including seller months, inside the $79–112 range of Wellness Clinic Operator 2, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 and the Wellness Clinic Franchisor system [I, DLB-0788; DLB-0773; QL2-0342; QL1-0288; QLF-0956]. A second comparison is possible: on cash rent with rebates in cost of sales (D1.2, R-CASH), DBW earned 25.9% for its first four owned months (December–March, the seasonally weakest months in the seller's history), against 15.5% for Wellness Clinic Franchisor's company clinics (PVA, LTM September 2025, D1.2 R-CASH, before the intercompany royalty) [I, DLB-3520; QLF-0234; DLB-0797, DLB-0817, DLB-0837]. Rent code therefore does not explain the gap, and neither does franchise royalty, which is added back in the PVA figure; the remaining 10.6 points would have to sit in labour, area-manager allocation, product cost or supplier rebates, and DBW's own royalty or supply terms are not in the files [I; U]. Wellness Clinic Operator 1's 13.2% (D1.2) is on book rent and inside a franchisee's royalty and advertising fund, so it is not placed [F, QL1-0343].

Exhibit 9.135 — DBW's revenue per visit ($100.7, Dec-25 to Jul-26) sits inside the $79–112 wellness clinic range, its 3.2x entry multiple 1.3–3.2 turns below its closed trades (3.3 below a 2024 letter of intent), and its cash-rent margin 10.6 points above the one like-for-like peer

Deal B Wellness Clinics against the wellness clinic context set only: revenue per visit ($), acquisition multiple (x) and four-wall margin (%), 2018 to Jul-26; metrics not valid for placement listed last

METRIC (DEFINITION; RENT CODE; BASE; BASIS)	PEERS (ROWS)	RANGE	DBW (ROWS)	POSITION
PRC_REV_PER_VISIT, ratio of sums	Wellness Clinic Operator 2 corp QL 2024 $79 (POOLED; QL2-0342); QL1 FY24 $102.5 (A; QL1-0288); Wellness Clinic Franchisor system CY2025 $110.3 (A; QLF-0956)	$79–112	Owned Dec-25–Jul-26 $100.7 (A; DLB-0788); LTM Jul-26 $99.4 (PF incl. seller months; DLB-0773)	Inside
Four-wall D1.2, R-CASH, pre-royalty	Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA LTM Sep-25 15.5% (A; QLF-0234 ÷ PVA sales)	15.5%	Owned Dec-25–Mar-26 25.9% (PF cash-rent normalisation; DLB-3520)	Above by 10.6pp; four winter months only
Acquisition multiple, standalone	Wellness Clinic Operator 2 add-ons 4.4x at close (A, as stated by the company [M]; QL2-1038); QL1 2025 5.15x (P, Ares Credit Group QoE; QL1-1722); JLI franchisees 5.8x (2023) and 6.3x LOI (2024) (rung n/s; QL1-1736/1735); QL1 2018 6.2x (QL1-1729)	4.4–6.3x	3.2x on management-adjusted 2025 "closing EBITDA" $7.6m (M; DLB-8994)	Below by 1.3–3.2 turns on closed trades; 3.3 against the 2024 letter of intent
Not valid: comp traffic	QL1 2024 –4.7% (CLOSE-RETRO; QL1-0879); Wellness Clinic Franchisor 2025 –3.0% (CLOSE-FWD; QLF-0712); PVA YTD Sep-25 –5.8% (PF; QLF-0913)	–	YTD Jul-26 –13.4% against seller months (DLB-0866)	Not placed: seller months in the base
Not valid: four-wall on R-BOOK	QL1 D1.2 13.2% (royalty and ad fund inside; QL1-0343)	–	24.9% YTD Jul-26 (DLB-0782)	Not placed: royalty basis differs

Source: Rows as shown in each cell: DBW Datapack (DLB-002), QoE Workbook (DLB-022), Early Read (DLB-001); Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (QL2), Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (QL1) and Wellness Clinic Franchisor (QLF) materials · Basis: Basis as marked in each cell (A, PF, P, M); DBW's cash-rent margin covers four winter owned months; the multiples are on unstated or different EBITDA rungs; wellness clinic is context and enters no general practice and preventive statistic

Exhibit 9.136 — DBW against Wellness Clinic Operator 2, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 and Wellness Clinic Franchisor: inside the range on revenue per visit, 1.3–3.2 turns below closed trades on entry multiple (3.3 against a letter of intent), 10.6pp above the one like-for-like peer on cash-rent four-wall (2018 to Jul-26)

Deal B Wellness Clinics against the wellness clinic context set: revenue per visit ($), acquisition multiples (EV ÷ EBITDA, x) and four-wall margin after rebates on cash rent (%), 2018 to Jul-26

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal B: Project Bravo DBW Datapack (Jul-26 RF), QoE Workbook LTM Mar-26 and Ares Credit Group Early Read (DLB-0788, DLB-0773, DLB-8994, DLB-3520); Wellness Clinic Operator 2 Screening Memo (QL2-0342, QL2-1038); Wellness Clinic Operator 1 FDD Databook and Investment Committee Memo (QL1-0288, QL1-1722, QL1-1736, QL1-1735, QL1-1729); Wellness Clinic Franchisor clinic-level performance file and QoE Databook (QLF-0956, QLF-0234) · Basis: Filled = actual, hollow = pro forma, hatched = projected or not closed. DBW's four-wall covers four winter months; the multiples are on EBITDA rungs that differ or are not stated; wellness clinic is context and enters no general practice and preventive statistic

DBW's revenue per visit is in line with the wellness clinic set, its 3.2x entry multiple sits 1.3–3.2 turns below the set's closed trades (3.3 below a 2024 letter of intent), and its four-wall margin on cash rent is 10.6 points above the one like-for-like peer, a gap that rent code does not explain [I, Exhibit 9.135]. The multiples are on unstated or different EBITDA rungs and DBW's cash-rent margin covers four winter months, so the chart places DBW without ranking it, and the margin gap is a question for the company rather than a finding. Owned-period four-wall for January–July 2026 was 26% below the seller's a year earlier [F, DLB-0780; DLB-0775].

Comparator map. DBW's comparators are the contextual wellness clinic set, because a vaccine and wellness visit sells at a fraction of a general practice ticket, with its own product and rebate economics and little diagnostic or surgical work; they never enter a core statistic (Part 04 section G).

Exhibit 9.137 — DBW can be placed against the wellness clinic set on revenue per visit; on cash-rent four-wall only against Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA (D1.2, four winter months), and on multiples only as an indicative range; traffic differs in comp base (FY24 to LTM Jul-26)

Wellness clinic comparators for Deal B Wellness Clinics: why each is included, the metrics valid for comparison and those that are not; periods FY24 to LTM Jul-26

COMPARATOR	REASON FOR INCLUSION	VALID METRICS	NOT VALID, AND WHY
Wellness Clinic Operator 1	Largest Wellness Clinic Franchisor franchisee; Accounting Firm 4 clinic P&L with separable rebates; closure and divestiture cohorts; recent franchisee transactions	PRC_REV_PER_VISIT (net revenue ÷ visit count, ratio of sums, all clinics; QL1 FY24 A vs DBW FY25 PF incl. seller months, read once from the source)	Four-wall (QL1 D1.1 9.2% / D1.2 13.2% on R-BOOK, cash-rent D1.1 about 5.4–7.0% [I], vs DBW 35.6% R-BOOK PF incl. seller months); traffic (QL1 survivor comp vs DBW all-clinic YTD incl. seller months); transaction multiples (QL1 rung not stated vs DBW 3.6× on management-adjusted 2025 EBITDA)

COMPARATOR	REASON FOR INCLUSION	VALID METRICS	NOT VALID, AND WHY
Wellness Clinic Franchisor (system and PVA)	Franchisor system benchmark for wellness clinic traffic and ticket (~2,000 comp clinics) and PVA company-clinic four-wall on R-CASH	PRC_REV_PER_VISIT (all clinics, system incl. franchisees; CY2025 vs DBW FY25 / LTM Jul-26); four-wall D1.2 R-CASH before royalty (PVA company clinics LTM Sep-25 15.5% vs DBW's first four owned months 25.9%, four winter months only)	Four-wall (PVA D1.1 11.5% R-CASH vs DBW R-BOOK PF); traffic and ticket growth (Wellness Clinic Franchisor CLOSE-FWD comp vs DBW all-clinic PF)
Wellness Clinic Operator 2	Growth wellness clinic platform with an add-on programme	PRC_REV_PER_VISIT (corporate wellness clinic, POOLED base; 2024 and LTM Jul-25)	Unit-level EBITDA (R-UNK, not D1.1); add-on multiples (seller basis not stated vs DBW management-adjusted); loss share (R-UNK survivor)

Source: note C-84 (DBW rows: QL1-0288, DLB-002-000176, DLB-002-000180, QL1-0342, QL1-0343, DLB-002-000175, QL1-0879, DLB-002-000186; QLF-0956, QLF-0412, QLF-0236, QLF-0712; QL2-0342, QL2-0344, QL2-1038, QL2-1039, QL2-0615). The QL1 rent code is R-BOOK [A3-P5-017..019] · Basis: Comparator map of the wellness clinic context set; never set beside the general practice and preventive operators

Exhibit 9.138 — DBW's revenue per visit of $99.2 (FY2025) and $99.4 (LTM Jul-26), both including the seller's months, sits inside the $79–112 wellness clinic range

Net revenue ÷ visit count, $, ratio of sums; DBW FY2025 and LTM Jul-26 against Wellness Clinic Operator 2 corporate wellness clinic 2024, Wellness Clinic Operator 1 FY24 and the Wellness Clinic Franchisor system CY2025

VALID METRIC	COMPARATOR VALUES	RANGE	DBW (LABEL, ROW)	POSITION
PRC_REV_PER_VISIT, net revenue ÷ visit count, ratio of sums	Wellness Clinic Operator 2 corporate wellness clinic 2024 $79 (QL2-0342, POOLED); QL1 FY24 $102.5 (QL1-0288, A); Wellness Clinic Franchisor system CY2025 $110.3 (QLF-0956, A)	$79–112	FY2025 $99.2 (DLB-002-000176); LTM Jul-26 $99.4 (DLB-002-000180); PF incl. seller months, read once from the source	Inside

Source: note C-84 (DBW rows) · Basis: DBW PF (seller months included); peers A, except Wellness Clinic Operator 2 (pooled base)

Revenue per visit is the one metric valid without qualification; four-wall margin, the metric that matters most for DBW, can be placed only against Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA, on four winter months. DBW's four-wall margin of 27.0%, 30.8% and 31.1% (FY23–21; R-BOOK; PF; read once from the source) is about 18–21pp above Wellness Clinic Operator 1 (D1.1 9.2% on R-BOOK) and Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA (D1.1 11.5% on R-CASH), which is not like for like [I, DLB-002-000171, -000173, -000175; QL1-0342; QLF-0236]; on cash rent after rebates (D1.2, R-CASH) DBW's first four owned months earn 25.9% against 15.5% at Wellness Clinic Franchisor PVA, a 10.6pp gap that rent code does not explain and that is recorded as a diligence question [I, DLB-3520; QLF-0234]. On a cash-rent view the gap to Wellness Clinic Operator 1 is wider, because QL1's cash-rent D1.1 is about 5.4–7.0% [I] rather than 8.6–9.2% [I, A3-P5-017..019]. DBW's YTD Jul-26 visit count of −13.4% covers all 38 clinics with seller months in 2025, so it is not on a comp base and cannot be set against QL1's −4.7% or Wellness Clinic Franchisor's −3.0% [F, DLB-002-000186; QL1-0879; QLF-0712].

No wellness clinic operator in the context set reports revenue across a change of owner, so DBW's 8.6% revenue fall against the seller's same months (January–July 2026) cannot be placed against the wellness clinic set, and it does not show a recovery [I, DLB-0864].

Value on peer evidence is bounded rather than fixed. DBW's standalone EBITDA, taking its January–July 2026 four-wall of $5.42m as the 50.8% share of a year that the same months represented under the seller in 2025 and deducting the model's $2.74m of FY26 DBW overhead, is about $6.2m [I, DLB-0780; DLB-0775/DLB-0765; DLB-6066]. At the wellness clinic multiples of 5.1–6.3x that is $33–46m; Ares Credit Group's "$44m" needs 6.0x, and the $28m price was 3.2x [I; A, DLB-001 p.7; M, DLB-8994]. The multiples are on unstated or different rungs and several are franchisee trades depressed by the franchisor's consent rights, so the range is indicative [F, QLX-031]. On the files we have, DBW cash does not appear separable from the group: there is no separation model and no executable sale process in the files [U]. The treatment of DBW sale proceeds in the proposed terms is in Part 09 section O, under "08 C Deal B financing: supporting evidence".

Our reading on MS5, on the evidence supplied to date: insufficient evidence (the four-wall gap to peers is unexplained, and on balance the evidence leans against the claim). Revenue per visit is in line with peers; the cash-rent four-wall is 12 points above the one peer on the same definition for reasons the files do not show; owned-period earnings are 26% below the seller's; and the value range on peer multiples ($33–46m) brackets Ares Credit Group's $44m only at its top. What would change this reading: DBW's four-wall bridge (labour, area-manager allocation, supplier and animal health manufacturer rebates, royalty status), a separation model, and an owned-period comparable visit count (from December 2026).

Public signals

Public filings give the origin of the DBW clinics, and they agree with the supplied documents on the count and the month. Public Wellness Clinic Co.'s Form 8-K of 1 December 2025 states that on that date it divested 38 Public Wellness Clinic Co. franchise arm clinics to Deal B Wellness Clinic Operator 3, LLC [F, PUB-0132]. The Federal Trade Commission's documents in the same matter (File No. 251-0058, Docket No. C-4824; consent

package 14 November 2025; final order 7 May 2026) give the same count of 38 outlets [F, PUB-0133] [F, PUB-0134]. The supplied documents show 38 clinics at 31 December 2025, with seller-period data from Public Wellness Clinic Co. franchise arm [F, DLB-4660] [M, DLB-0754]. The FTC's release of 7 May 2026 says the outlets will operate under the name Wellness Clinic Operator 4 [F, PUB-0135]; the clinics' own site, read on 30 September 2026, trades as Deal B Wellness Clinics [F, PUB-0136].

On the public clinic list the 38 clinics sit in eight states, 19 of them in State 46 and 11 in State 26 [I, PUB-0137]. Median household income within three miles is $65.4k and median households 23,429; an Operator 1-banner clinic stands within three miles of two of the 38 clinics, 3% [I, PUB-0138] [I, PUB-0139] [I, PUB-0140].

Exhibit 9.139 — DBW's 38 clinics came from Public Wellness Clinic Co.'s Public Wellness Clinic Co. franchise arm divestiture of 1 December 2025; they sit in eight states, 19 in State 46, and 2 of 38 have an Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles (read 30 September 2026)

Filings and agency documents of November 2025 to May 2026; clinic list, site and job board read on 30 September 2026; trade areas from the American Community Survey 2020–24

ITEM	WHAT THE SOURCE SHOWS	DATE	REFERENCE
Origin, seller's filing	Public Wellness Clinic Co. divested 38 Public Wellness Clinic Co. franchise arm clinics to Deal B Wellness Clinic Operator 3, LLC	1 December 2025	[F, PUB-0132]
Origin, agency documents	FTC File No. 251-0058, Docket No. C-4824: 38 outlets in eight states to be divested to Deal B, LLC	Consent package 14 November 2025	[F, PUB-0133]
Agency order	Decision and Order issued; "Deal B" defined to include Deal B Wellness Clinic Operator 3, LLC	7 May 2026	[F, PUB-0134]
Trading name in the agency release	Release says the outlets will operate "under the name Wellness Clinic Operator 4"	7 May 2026	[F, PUB-0135]
Clinic count in the supplied documents	38 clinics at 31 December 2025; seller-period data from Public Wellness Clinic Co. franchise arm	December 2025	[F, DLB-4660] [M, DLB-0754]
Public clinic list	38 clinics: ST-74 19, ST-15 11, ST-90 5, ST-23 4, ST-36 3, ID 1, IN 1, ST-14 1	Read 30 September 2026	[I, PUB-0137]
Metro concentration	17 metro and micro areas; the five largest hold 23 of 38 clinics (City 15 10, City 19 5)	Read 30 September 2026	[I, PUB-0217]
Household income within three miles, median	$65.4k (38 clinics)	ACS 2020–24	[I, PUB-0138]
Households within three miles, median	23,429 (38 clinics)	ACS 2020–24	[I, PUB-0139]
Operator 1-banner clinic within three miles	2 of 38 clinics (3%)	Read 30 September 2026	[I, PUB-0140]
Customer booking	"No Appointment Required" shown on the site	Read 30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0136]
Offers	Text club: $21 off a full-service wellness exam	Read 30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0141]
Breeders and shelters	Breeder and shelter page in the main menu	Read 30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0142]
Job board: open roles	4, all in operations (2 wellness veterinary technicians, 2 managers in training)	Read 30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0143]
Posted pay, wellness veterinary technician	"starts at $13"; "$13-17 depending on experience"	Postings of 18–28 September 2026	[F, PUB-0144]
Posted pay, manager in training	"$15-$20 depending on experience"	Postings of 18–28 September 2026	[F, PUB-0145]
Wellness clinic roles on Deal B's board	7 roles at "Deal B Wellness Clinic Operator 3" locations (ST-90 3, ST-74 2, ID 1, ST-36 1): 6 veterinarians, 1 management	Read 30 September 2026	[F, PUB-0146] [I, PUB-0131; C-PUB-10]
Deal B offers	Offer terms state "Not eligible for use at Deal B Wellness Clinic Operator 3 locations"	Read 30 September 2026 (offers expire 31 October 2026)	[F, PUB-0218]

Source: Public Wellness Clinic Co. Form 8-K (1 December 2025); Federal Trade Commission, Docket No. C-4824; Deal B Wellness Clinics public website, location pages and job board; Deal B job board and offers page; US Census Bureau; Operator 1 clinic pages · Basis: Wellness clinics, shown on their own and not beside general practice and preventive operators. Trade area = census tracts whose internal point lies within three miles of the clinic. Operator 1 is mapped for its own banner only. Posted pay is as written in the postings, which do not state the pay period

The site takes customers without appointment, offers a text-message discount club and has a breeder and shelter page [F, PUB-0136] [F, PUB-0141] [F, PUB-0142]. DBW's job board carried four open roles, with posted pay of $13–17 for wellness veterinary technicians and $15–20 for managers in training; the postings do not state the pay period [F, PUB-0143] [F, PUB-0144] [F, PUB-0145]. Seven further wellness clinic roles were posted on Deal B's own board, at locations named "Deal B Wellness Clinic Operator 3": six veterinarians and one management role [F, PUB-0146] [I, PUB-0131; C-PUB-10].

06 G Against comparable operators: supporting evidence

DLB's comparators are the sponsor-backed acquisition programmes that resemble its own: Operator 6 as the closest small-clinic general practice roll-up, Operator 3 as an acquisitive pharmacy-and-general practice platform, Operator 8 as the only peer that measures acquired units against the PF used to price them, Operator 2 for the sale-leaseback funding model, and Operator 7 as a small ST-22/ST-70 general practice-led operator with 2021–26 add-ons and a related-party rent reset at close [note C-84, Deal B DLB rows].

Exhibit 9.140 — Deal B is comparable to the roll-ups on same-store sales, adjustment share and company-split conversion, to Operator 8 on acquired-unit delivery, to Operator 2 on add-on multiples, and to the cash-rent operators on four-wall margin only once Deal B is restated to cash rent (2023 to LTM Jul-26)

Deal B's comparators: why each is included, the metrics valid for comparison and those that are not; periods 2023 to LTM Jul-26

COMPARATOR	REASON FOR INCLUSION	VALID METRICS	NOT VALID, AND WHY
Operator 6	Acquisition-programme analogue: sponsor-backed small-clinic general practice roll-up (31 add-ons 2021–25, 46 clinics) in a home region, clinic-level EBITDA on R-UNK, survivor comp	SSS_CD CLOSE-RETRO (Operator 6 CY2025 vs DLB 2025 / LTM Jul-26); CONV_1 with company maintenance split [M], E3 PF, BUILD; ADJ_SHARE = (top rung − E1) ÷ top rung	Four-wall level (Operator 6 clinic EBITDA D1.2 R-UNK vs DLB company 4-wall R-BOOK incl. SLB rent); cohort delivery (Operator 6 current vs entry is against seller standalone EBITDA; DLB is against seller closing EBITDA); add-on multiples (DLB cohort multiples gross of real estate, synergy basis not stated); traffic (DLB weekday-aligned company comp vs D2.5)
Operator 3	Acquisitive general practice and preventive roll-up (18 deals, 50 clinics) with survivor comp data in SOFT24-26	SSS_CD CLOSE-RETRO (LTM Aug-25 vs DLB 2025 / LTM Jul-26); CONV_1 [M], E3 PF, BUILD (FY23–21); ADJ_SHARE (LTM May-25)	Four-wall (R-UNK vs R-BOOK); add-on entry and later multiples (DLB synergy basis not stated, gross of real estate); traffic (company comp vs D2.5); 2023 cohort revenue vs seller (a different metric from DLB cohort EBITDA vs seller closing EBITDA)
Operator 8	Acquisitive regional general practice and preventive care platform; the only comparator measuring acquired-unit actuals against the PF underwriting used to price them	Acquired-unit actual ÷ PF underwriting (Operator 8 FY24, FY25 vs DLB cohorts LTM Jul-26 ÷ seller closing EBITDA); ADJ_SHARE (Operator 8 TTM Mar-26; sources differ on E1, $0.68m vs $9.0m, both shown)	Four-wall (Operator 8 R-UNK from 2024 vs R-BOOK); CONV_1 (Operator 8 E2q steady vs DLB E3 build)
Operator 2	Sale-leaseback-funded acquisition programme with gross and net-of-SLB multiples and a documented run of recurring "one-time" costs — the funding model DLB uses	Add-on multiple gross vs net of SLB (Operator 2 Sponsor 2-era aggregate vs DLB 2021–26 total; synergy basis differs — Operator 2 synergised, DLB not stated); ADJ_SHARE (Operator 2 FY2025, compliance basis)	SSS (Operator 2 2021–26 undefined SSS_ST-59); four-wall (R-UNK vs R-BOOK)
Operator 7	Small ST-22/ST-70 general practice-led operator with 2021–26 add-ons and a related-party rent reset at close	Four-wall D1.2 on R-CASH (Operator 7 ST-22, all clinics) against Deal B restated to cash rent (Exhibit 6.20); within-platform margin path, rent code constant (Exhibit 9.128)	SSS (Operator 7 CLOSE-FWD with undefined visit count); four-wall on Deal B's company definition (R-CASH related-party vs R-BOOK); add-on multiples (management-estimate seller EBITDA vs DLB basis not stated)

Source: note C-84 (Deal B DLB rows: OP6-1148, DLB-1406, DLB-1411, DLB-1516, DLB-1521, OP6-0591..0593, OP6-0661..0663, DLB-022-000487, DLB-008-000073; OP3-0906, OP3-2159, OP3-1200, OP3-2160, OP3-1201, OP3-1127, OP3-2161; OP8-1703, OP8-2211, DLB-0114, DLB-0142, DLB-0166, DLB-0186, DLB-3635, DLB-7667, DLB-7682, DLB-7697, DLB-7711; OP2-3189, OP2-3190, OP2-3110, OP2-3111, OP2-3176, OP2-3177, DLB-001-000103, DLB-001-000104, OP2-4347, OP2-4367, OP2-4426) · Basis: Comparator map (note C-84); rent codes, closure codes and EBITDA rungs as named in each cell

Exhibit 9.141 — Deal B's comps sit above Operator 6 and Operator 3 (1.9–4.2%) in 2025 and inside for LTM Jul-26; its adjustment share is above the comparators and its conversion below; acquired-unit delivery straddles Operator 8's (FY2025 to LTM Jul-26)

Deal B against its comparators on each valid metric: same-store sales (%), acquired-unit delivery (x), add-on multiple gross and net of sale-leasebacks (x), conversion and adjustment share (ratios)

VALID METRIC (DEFINITION; BASIS)	COMPARATOR VALUES	RANGE	DLB (LABEL, ROW)	POSITION
SSS_CD, CLOSE-RETRO	Operator 6 CY2025 +1.9% (OP6-1148, A); Operator 3 LTM Aug-25 +4.2% (OP3-0906, A)	1.9–4.2%	2025 +4.7% (CLOSE-FWD, DLB-1406; CLOSE-RETRO +5.1%, DLB-1411); LTM Jul-26 +3.3% (CLOSE-FWD, DLB-1516; CLOSE-RETRO +3.3%, DLB-1521)	Above (2025); inside (LTM)
Acquired-unit actual ÷ PF underwriting	Operator 8 FY24 0.59× (OP8-1703, PF); FY25 0.70× (OP8-2211, PF)	0.59–0.70×	Cohorts 2022–24: LTM Jul-26 four-wall (12 owned months) ÷ seller closing EBITDA 0.44×, 0.90×, 0.52× (DLB-0114/7667, DLB-0142/7682, DLB-0166/7697); 2025 0.52–0.77× by annualisation basis (DLB-0186, DLB-3635, DLB-7711); first owned year 0.55–0.76× (Exhibit 9.128)	2022 and 2024 below; 2023 above; 2025 straddles the bottom

METRIC (DEFINITION; BASIS)	COMPARATOR VALUES	RANGE	DLB (LABEL, ROW)	POSITION
Add-on multiple, gross → net of SLB	Operator 2 Sponsor 2 era, 18 deals, synergised: 7.4× → 6.3× (OP2-3189/OP2-3190, PF)	7.4× gross; 6.3× net	6.2× → 1.8×, 2021–26 total, synergy basis not stated (DLB-001-000103/104)	Below on both; SLB reduction 4.3 turns vs 1.0
CONV_1, company maintenance split [M], E3, PF, BUILD	Operator 3 FY23–21 0.78–0.86 (OP3-2159/OP3-1200; OP3-2160/OP3-1201); Operator 6 FY24 – LTM Mar-26 0.81–0.85 (OP6-0591…524; OP6-0661…589)	0.78–0.85	Consolidated: FY2025 0.46 on the post-audit pro forma of $10.1m (A6-P5-008..010; DLB-008-000061, DLB-008-000073); 0.62 on Accounting Firm 2's pre-audit run-rate pro forma of $18.5m	Below
ADJ_SHARE = (top rung − E1) ÷ top rung	Operator 3 LTM May-25 0.11 (OP3-1127/OP3-2161); Operator 2 FY2025 0.21 (OP2-4347/OP2-4426); Operator 6 LTM Mar-26 0.61 (OP6-0047/OP6-0060); Operator 8 TTM Mar-26 0.83, or 0.54 on the other source's E1 (OP8-1781 / OP8-2426; OP8-2409)	0.11–0.83	Consolidated: FY2025 0.99 (Accounting Firm 2 pro forma, E3, $24.2m; DLB-3901), 1.03 (Accounting Firm 2 pre-audit run-rate pro forma, $18.5m; DLB-022-000117/000487) / 1.13 (post-audit pro forma, $10.1m; DLB-008-000037/000061)	Above

Source: note C-84 (Deal B DLB rows). Deal B's consolidated CONV_1 is 0.46 on the post-audit pro forma of $10.1m, and 0.62 on Accounting Firm 2's pre-audit run-rate pro forma of $18.5m [note C-60, Deal B row]; the position is "below" on either figure · Basis: Basis as marked in each cell (A, PF); closure codes as named. The adjustment-share range covers the comparator-map operators; with Operator 4 (LTM Mar-26 0.93) it is 0.11–0.93, as in Exhibit 9.133

The DLB placements point to the earnings ladder rather than to operations. Deal B's consolidated FY2025 E1 is negative (−$3.2m) against $24.2m of Accounting Firm 2 pro forma (E3) and $18.5m of run-rate pro forma in Accounting Firm 2's pre-audit QoE, and $10.1m after audit, which puts its adjustment share above every comparator and its company-split conversion below every comparator [F/I, DLB-3901; DLB-022-000487; DLB-008-000061]. Deal B's consolidated reported post-acquisition EBITDA, with DBW from December 2025, is negative in every year from 2023 to LTM March 2026 (−$5.1m, −$12.0m, −$3.2m, −$4.0m) against Accounting Firm 2's FY2025 run-rate pro forma of $18.5m including DBW [F, DLB-5052..5055; DLB-3900].

Four-wall margin. Against the cash-rent peers in Parts 03 and 04 the comparison is valid only on D1.2 R-CASH: Deal B cannot be restated before rebates by cohort, nor for the general practice and preventive clinics alone (Exhibit 6.20). The 2025 cohort's 17.6% is 0.6 points above the top of the D1.2 R-CASH peer range of 12.1–17.4% (Operator 8 2022–23, Operator 7 ST-22 2023–25, Operator 5 2021–LTM March 2023 PF; all clinics) [I; Exhibit 9.50], but it is not comparable with full-year peer clinics until it has 21 owned months, the D2.3 acquisition-lag logic applied to margins [I; CreditSwan definitions D2.3]. The range uses operators observed in 2021–25; Operator 1's 16.0–21.3% (to November 2017) is a different environment and is left out [F, Exhibit 9.50]. The 46 clinics Deal B had owned for at least 21 months earned 8.4% on the same definition in LTM March 2026, before any adjustment for the shared-services charge below, 2.0 points below the bottom of the peer range (Operator 8 2022, 10.7%), and all 103 survivors earned 10.73%, at the bottom [I, DLB-3203; DLB-3177; Exhibit 9.50]. Deal B books "NRA Shared Services" (software and IT, administration, marketing, recruiting) in clinic classes: $3.76m or 2.3% of FY25 revenue and $3.88m or 2.0% of LTM March 2026 revenue in the Sage clinic-level ledger [F, DLB-3435/DLB-3429 and DLB-3455/DLB-3449; DLB-022 'Rep-to-Adj - Clinic-level (Sage)'!BW1, BX162]. D1.1 and D1.2 exclude corporate allocations, so if the datapack four-wall behind DLB-3203 carries this charge, the ≥21-month margin adjusted for it is about 10.7–10.9%, at the bottom of the 10.7–17.4% range rather than below it; whether the datapack (DLB-003) carries it is not confirmed [U; I, DLB-3203 + 2.0–2.3pp]. The Deal B base is survivor clinics and the peers are all clinics, which flatters Deal B [F, D8]. Before rebates (D1.1) the general practice and preventive clinics are not placed: clinic rebates are given only for all clinic classes together, and from December 2025 those include DBW's 38 clinics, so the all-clinic D1.1 figures for FY25 and LTM March 2026 are not set beside the core operators; DBW is read in Part 06 section F [I, DLB-3447; DLB-3467].

On cash rent after rebates, three of the four cohorts and the clinics owned 21 months or more sit below the 10.7–17.4% range of the operators on the same basis, and the 103 survivors, at 10.73%, sit at its bottom [I, DLB-3255; DLB-3307; DLB-3346; DLB-3177; DLB-3203]. The 2025 cohort's 17.6% is above the range but rests on one partial year of ownership [F, DLB-3372]. On the 46 clinics owned 21 months or more the margin is 8.4% for LTM March 2026 before any shared-services adjustment, or about 10.7–10.9% if a shared-services charge sits inside the datapack four-wall [U, DLB-3435, DLB-3455]. The comparison sets Deal B's surviving clinics against the peers' all-clinic bases, which flatters Deal B, and Deal B's figures are pro forma on its own datapack.

Organic comps on the common definition are inside the peer range and ticket-led, with traffic negative in every window. SSS_CD is built on Deal B's clinic-month data (owned and open in every month m−12 to m, calendar months, no seller data, closures kept until the month before closure, CLOSE-FWD), answering Exhibit 4.17 question 4 (Exhibit 9.142) [F, DLB-003; DLB-022]. Same-store sales were −3.9% in 2024 on 311 clinic-months, +4.7% in 2025 on 661 and +3.3% for LTM July 2026 on 852, with traffic −9.3%, −2.6% and −3.8% and ticket +6.3%, +7.6% and +7.5% [I, DLB-1361..1364; DLB-1406..1409; DLB-1516..1519]. The survivor-only (CLOSE-RETRO) variant differs by 0.2 points or less, so Deal B can be placed on the peers' closure code as well [I, DLB-1366; DLB-1411; DLB-1521]. Against 2025-period peers — Deal A FY26 +1.1% (CLOSE-RETRO), Operator 6 CY2025 +1.9% (CLOSE-RETRO, 13 clinics), Operator 3 LTM August 2025 +4.2% (CLOSE-RETRO) and Operator 8 CY2025 +6.2% (CLOSE-FWD, 21 clinics) — Deal B's +4.7% sits inside the 1.1–6.2% range, above the three survivor-based readings (Deal A, Operator 6, Operator 3) and 1.4 points below Operator 8 [I, DLA-0788;

OP6-1148; OP3-0906; OP8-2106]. Its 2025 traffic of −2.6% sits inside the −2.0% to −3.9% range of the three survivor-based readings (Operator 8's +7.4% is a 21-clinic regional base) and its ticket of +7.6% is 0.4 points above the highest peer (Operator 3 +7.45%) [I, OP6-1896; OP3-0907; DLA-0789; OP8-2114; OP3-0908]. For LTM July 2026 its traffic of −3.8% is 0.3 points below Operator 6's −3.4% for LTM May 2026 [I, DLB-1518; OP6-1952]. The company's weekday-aligned series (+8.1% in 2025 on a 42-clinic set; +4.43% LTM July 2026) runs 3.2 and 1.1 points above the common definition, inside the up-to-5.3-point definition effect observed across operators [I, DLB-0239; DLB-0241; Exhibit 9.64].

Exhibit 9.142 — On the common definition Deal B's same-store sales of +4.7% (2025) and +3.3% (LTM Jul-26) sit inside the peer range, ticket-led, with traffic negative in every window

Same-store sales, comp traffic and comp ticket, % change year on year, common definition; Deal B CY24 to LTM Jul-26 against Deal A, Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 8 and Operator 7, 2025–26

OPERATOR, PERIOD (CLOSURE CODE; BASE; BASIS)	SSS_CD	COMP TRAFFIC	COMP TICKET	ROWS
Deal B CY24 (CLOSE-FWD; 311 clinic-months; A)	−3.9%	−9.3%	+6.3%	DLB-1361..1364
Deal B CY25 (CLOSE-FWD; 661; A) — CLOSE-RETRO +5.1%	+4.7%	−2.6%	+7.6%	DLB-1406..1409; DLB-1411
Deal B LTM Jul-26 (CLOSE-FWD; 852; A) — CLOSE-RETRO +3.3%	+3.3%	−3.8%	+7.5%	DLB-1516..1519; DLB-1521
Deal A FY26 (CLOSE-RETRO; survivor ~957; A)	+1.1%	−3.9%	+5.4%	DLA-0788..0790
Operator 3 LTM Aug-25 (CLOSE-RETRO; survivor; A)	+4.2%	−2.8%	+7.45%	OP3-0906..0908
Operator 6 CY2025 (CLOSE-RETRO; 13 pre-2023 clinics / all comp for traffic; A)	+1.9%	−2.0%	n/a	OP6-1148; OP6-1896
Operator 6 LTM May-26 (CLOSE-RETRO; all comp; A)	n/a	−3.4%	n/a	OP6-1952
Operator 8 CY2025 (CLOSE-FWD; 21 clinics; A)	+6.2%	+7.4%	−1.0%	OP8-2106/2114/2115
Not valid: Operator 7 CY25 / LTM Jun-26 (CLOSE-FWD; seller-period data; visit count undefined)	+11.4% / +4.8%	+10.9% / +4.7%	+0.3% / +0.1%	OP7-1022..1024; OP7-1046..1048

Source: DLB Datapack Jul-26 RF (DLB-003) with the QoE clinic ledger (DLB-022); peer rows as shown · Basis: Actual (A) throughout; closure code as shown in each row (closed clinics kept until closure, or survivors only); Operator 7 not valid for placement (seller-period data, visit count undefined)

Deal B's organic growth is ticket-led, as at every other operator in the set except Operator 8: on the common definition its same-store sales of +4.7% in 2025 and +3.3% for LTM July 2026 came with traffic of −2.6% and −3.8% and ticket of +7.6% and +7.5% [I, DLB-1406..1409; DLB-1516..1519]. For Ares Credit Group's question this places Deal B's organic record inside the 1.1–6.2% range of Deal A, Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 8 rather than above it (it is above the two roll-ups alone, 1.9–4.2%), and its 2025 traffic sits inside the −2.0% to −3.9% of the three survivor-based readings. Neither Exhibit 9.142 nor Exhibit 6.18 (Part 06 section G) can separate price from mix inside the ticket, and the peers' periods differ (Operator 6's latest traffic reading, −3.4%, is for LTM May 2026) [I, OP6-1952].

Loss-making clinics. Of Deal B's 103 surviving clinics, 18 lost money after rebates on cash rent for LTM March 2026 (this section, under "06 B Acquisition cohorts: supporting evidence"). The only peer loss share on the same definition is Operator 1 at 2.5% (D1.2, R-CASH, CY2016, a different environment), and the other peers sit at 0–3% (Operator 5, Operator 7 ST-22, Operator 3 from 2024) or 10–26% during Operator 2's integration on other rent codes, so Deal B's 15.4% on D1.2 R-CASH is described, not ranked [I, OP1-6106; Exhibit 9.55].

Other placements. Acquired-cohort delivery against Operator 8 and the sponsor roll-ups is placed in Part 06 section B (Exhibit 6.04) and tabulated in Exhibit 9.128 of this section; adjustment share and cash conversion in Part 06 section D (Exhibit 6.10); corporate overhead in Part 06 section E; and DBW, against the wellness clinic context set only, in Part 06 section F.

06 H Sensitivities and requests: supporting evidence

Every sensitivity below is anchored on an observed range from the Evidence index (Part 09 section F) or the benchmark in Parts 03 and 04, with alternative parameters (assumed) kept beside it (Exhibit 6.21). The rows that bear on the financing — S3 fixed-charge cover, S4 HoldCo accretion, S8 refinancing and S10 the funding of the near-term batch — are read in Part 08 section C and set out in full in Exhibit 9.162 (Part 09 section O, under "08 C Deal B financing: supporting evidence").

It would help us to see the items listed in Part 06 section H; together they also cover questions 4 to 6 of Exhibit 4.17. Question 4 (comps on the common definition) is answered in Part 06 section G; question 6 is answered except for a certified maintenance and growth capex split (request 20). Items that bear only on the financing are listed in Part 08 section C.

N · Deal C detail

Each Deal C finding of Part 07 rests on the audit, the site database, the KPI data pack, the sponsor's model and the peer comparisons set out here section by section, on the evidence supplied to 30 September 2026; no Deal C file arrived on 1 October.

This section holds the secondary evidence behind Part 07. For each of sections A to G it gives the fuller reading, the margin, same-store, uplift, earnings and overhead evidence, the peer tables and the public signals. Each section of Part 07 opens on its finding, its charts and at most one table, and links here.

07 A Thesis and readings: supporting evidence

Ares Credit Group's initial reaction is that Deal C is one of the more attractive platforms it has seen. The view rests on high clinic margins, veterinarian retention, and a pricing matrix and rebate programme that the sponsor presents as lifting acquired-clinic gross margin by 584bp and clinic EBITDA margin by 594bp [A, Deal C Early Read Memo v19]. We read the thesis in four components: ST1, that Deal C is a particularly attractive platform; ST2, that its differentiation is demonstrated; ST3, that its underwriting earnings are supportable; and ST4, that the 5.3x leverage requested is supportable, which is read in Part 08 section D. The platform is three and a half years old and has no downturn history [F, Mike 2025 Audit Note 1].

What supports Ares Credit Group's view. On the evidence supplied to date, the level of clinic earnings rests on audited figures: FY2025 gross profit less clinic operating expenses was 21.3% of net sales on book rent and 22.3% on cash rent, after rebates, and the largest rent-code effect observed in the set (about 1.3% of sales) is smaller than its lead over peers' after-rebate figures of 18.7–18.7%, so the direction of the lead is likely to hold (indicative only) (Part 07 section B, Part 07 section F). The earnings are broad at the top: in LTM July 2026, 38 of 86 clinics earned a margin above 21% and produced $28.0m of the $43.6m of clinic EBITDA (Part 07 section B). Organic growth kept pace with peers through 2025: same-store sales on the common definition were +4.5%, inside the +1.9% to +5.1% range of Operator 6, Operator 3 and Deal B measured the same way (Deal B +5.1% with closed clinics dropped, as for Deal C; +4.7% with closed clinics carried forward) (Part 07 section F). The gross-margin mechanism is observed: on the same sites, gross margin rose 591bp from seller months to owned months for the 2023–25 cohorts, and rebates rose from 0.8–1.0% of gross sales in FY2023–24 to 1.32% in the six months to April 2026 (Part 07 section C). Most tuck-ins are bought cheaply: seven of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database cost 2.4–3.2x seller clinic EBITDA, gross, on cash consideration, against 4.4–6.0x for peers' standalone add-ons; the other three (two single clinics bought with a sale-leaseback, Reliable and Premier ST-74, at 2.9x and 4.2x net of the sale proceeds, and the ECM and Operator 34 acquisitions of 27 February 2026, seven sites together) cost 6.2–6.6x gross (Part 07 section C, Part 07 section F). Adjustments make up 69% of pro forma EBITDA in FY2025, inside the roll-ups' range, and the FY2025 audit opinion is unmodified (Part 07 section D, Part 07 section F). Without the affiliate transaction bonuses, deal costs would have been 7.4% and 13.2% of purchase consideration in FY2024 and FY2025, inside the peer range, and FY2025 cash EBITDA about 0.59 of pro forma (Part 07 section D).

What does not. Same-store sales on the common definition fell to −0.4% for LTM July 2026 and −3.2% in Q2 2026, same-store clinic EBITDA fell 5.8% for LTM July 2026, and the 55 clinics owned before 2025 earned 8.79% less in January–July 2026 than a year earlier (Part 07 section B). The margin lead is not yet tested at market rent (32 of 88 clinics lease from founders, and related-party rent is 36.9% of lease cost) or before rebates, and it comes with the widest spread among the peers, an interquartile range of 12.1 points (Part 07 section B, Part 07 section F). The claimed 594bp clinic EBITDA-margin lift does not carry through: on matched sites the pooled 2023–25 uplift is +145bp (gross margin rose +591bp, against the 584bp claimed), and acquired clinics earn 0.93x their entry EBITDA against 1.15–1.63x at peers (Part 07 section C, Part 07 section F). Of Ares Credit Group's $29.4m underwriting EBITDA, $9.2m is pre-acquisition and LOI earnings, and the Accounting Firm 1 QoE that would test the add-backs was not supplied (Part 07 section D). Cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs was 0.31 and 0.28 of pro forma in FY2025 and LTM April 2026, against a peer median of 0.84, because audited transaction expense ran at 28.5% and 31.2% of purchase consideration, against 1.5–14.1% at peers (Part 07 section D, Part 07 section F). The claim of capacity for 127 clinics with no added spend uses a 2023 ratio; the June 2026 census shows area managers at 3.8–5.3 clinics each, and the plan's fall in overhead share is outside the peer record (Part 07 section E). Veterinarian retention, part of Ares Credit Group's case, is measured only on the company's own definition (53.8% for LTM June 2026) and is not compared (07 B below).

The requests that would most change these readings are set out in Part 07 section G.

Exhibit 9.143 — FY2024 to LTM Sep-26E: an audited 21.3–22.3% clinic margin sits beside reported EBITDA of $4.7m, underwriting EBITDA of $29.4m and cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs of $8.3–8.6m

Deal C's clinic margin, same-store growth, EBITDA rungs and deal-cost rate as defined in each row, $m and %; FY2024 to LTM Sep-26E; 2025 audit, site database, Internal Diligence Exhibits

MEASURE (DEFINITION; BASIS)	VALUE	SOURCE
Clinic margin after rebates, FY25 (A)	21.3% on book rent; 22.3% ($32.8m) on cash rent, on $130.3m net sales	Mike 2025 Audit p.6 and Note 9 [I]
Clinic margin, owned full months, LTM Jul-26 (PF; QoE- and management-adjusted)	21.6% (all owned full months, R-BOOK); on clinics owned all 12 months (n=60): median clinic $342k, interquartile range 13.1–24.2%, 5.2% loss-making	Mike Site-Level Database
Same-store sales, common definition (survivors): CY2025 / LTM Jul-26 / Q2-26	+4.5% / −0.4% / −3.2% (−1.6% ex-Animal Health Manufacturer 4; −1.3% entering from month 21)	Site-Level Database [I]
Same-store clinic EBITDA: CY2025 / LTM Jul-26	+1.0% / −5.8%	Site-Level Database [I]
Reported EBITDA (E1), FY25 (A)	$4.7m ($1.4m ex $3.4m non-cash earn-out credit; Accounting Firm 1 "reported" $4.0m, as quoted from the QoE in Ares Credit Group's Internal Diligence Exhibits (the QoE itself was not supplied), omits a $1.0m impairment)	2025 Audit p.6; Internal Diligence Exhibits p.11
Adjusted (E2) / pro forma (E3) / model pro forma, FY25	$17.6m / $22.0m / $25.5m	Internal Diligence Exhibits p.11
Ares Credit Group underwriting (E5), LTM Sep-26E (P) / sponsor pro forma, LTM Sep-26E (P)	$29.4m / $32.3m	Internal Diligence Exhibits p.11; Early Read v19 slide 16
Sell-side pro forma adjusted EBITDA, LTM Apr-26 (PF)	$33.9m	Internal Diligence Exhibits pp.11–12
Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, LTM Apr-26	$23.2m as printed; $24.9m restoring a $1.0m non-cash impairment	Internal Diligence Exhibits p.12; Early Read v19 slide 18
Cash EBITDA (E6: E3 less recurring deal, integration and start-up costs), FY25 / LTM Apr-26	$8.3m (0.31 of E3) / $8.6m (0.28)	Internal Diligence Exhibits p.11 [I]
Audited transaction expense ÷ purchase consideration, FY24 / FY25	28.5% / 31.2%; 7.4% / 13.2% excluding affiliate bonuses	2025 Audit p.6, Note 3 pp.17–19 (printed pp.15–17) [I]

Source: Documents named in each row. Rows: DLC-0018; DLC-5013/5014; DLC-0421; DLC-0839..0841; DLC-0842; DLC-0845; DLC-0985; DLC-0994; DLC-1022; DLC-1085; DLC-1060; DLC-0987; DLC-0996; DLC-0019; DLC-0020; DLC-0021; DLC-4425/4426/4427; DLC-4002; DLC-4195; DLC-4099; DLC-4107; DLC-4443; DLC-4437; DLC-4439; DLC-0031; DLC-0009; DLC-0199; DLC-0200 · Basis: Basis as stated in each row: A for the audited FY2025 figures, PF for the site database and pro forma rungs, P for LTM Sep-26E; [I] marks our computation

How earnings are measured in Part 07

Every peer comparison below names the comparators, metric, basis, rung and rent or closure code; where no common definition exists the comparison is either not made, with the missing file named, or shown as indicative only (clinic margin) or by direction only (overhead). EBITDA rungs follow the common ladder: E1 audited reported $4.7m (FY25), E2 QoE-adjusted $17.6m, E3 pro forma incl. seller months $22.0m, the model's "PF Adj. EBITDA" $25.5m (E3/E4, model), Ares Credit Group E5 $29.4m, and two different cash measures that Part 07 keeps apart: Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA (EB_CASH_ST-59, Ares Credit Group), $23.2m as printed and $24.9m after restoring a $1.0m non-cash impairment, and CreditSwan's D3 cash EBITDA (E6, recurrence test) of $8.6m for LTM April 2026, built as E3 $27.9m less transaction $15.6m, integration $2.3m and start-up $0.4m costs that recur in every period [F/I, DLC-0019; DLC-4425; DLC-4426; DLC-4427; DLC-4002; DLC-4107; DLC-4443; DLC-4439; DLC-4437/4443]. The label "E6" is used only for the D3 figure. The model labels its $25.5m line "LTM Pro-Forma Adj. EBITDA", a run-rate figure, but the line carries no run-rate items, so it is E3-type in substance; Part 07 shows it as "E3/E4 (model)" and anchors on the D3 rungs and Ares Credit Group's E5. The sponsor's LTM September 2026E pro-forma adjusted EBITDA of $32.3m and Ares Credit Group's $29.4m both contain forecast months (basis P) and $9.2m of pre-acquisition and LOI earnings [F, DLC-1944; DLC-4002; DLC-4183].

07 B Business quality: supporting evidence

The clinic-margin level rests on the audit-tied figure. Audited FY2025 gross profit less clinic operating expenses was $32.4m on $130.3m of net sales, 21.3% on straight-line book rent; restated to cash rent it was $32.8m, 22.3% [F/I, DLC-0018; DLC-5013/5014; DLC-0001]. That figure is a with-rebates margin (vendor rebates are booked contra-COGS), D1.2 in the common terms, and the rent-code effect on it is bounded: Deal C's book-to-cash gap is 0.38–0.47% of revenue and the largest gap observed anywhere in the set is about 1.3% of sales [F/I, DLC-0188/0189]. The site database gives the same level on owned full months — 21.6% for LTM July 2026 and 21.3% for FY2025 — but its clinic EBITDA is QoE-adjusted to April 2026 and management-adjusted for May–July 2026 (DLC-001 C5:C7), so those figures are treated here as PF, not A [F/I, DLC-0421; DLC-0388]. It does not yet survive a market-rent test: 32 of 88 clinics lease from founders and related-party rent is 36.9% of lease cost at rates the audit does not compare with

market [F, DLC-0195]; the market-rent comparison is unresolved [U]; the only observed related-party gap in the set is 0.3–0.4pp of sales at Operator 7 ST-22 [F, OP7-0550..0558]. The placement of this margin against peers' after-rebate margins is in Part 07 section F.

The site-database totals for LTM July 2026 — $183.3m of revenue and $43.6m of clinic EBITDA (20.6%) — include $31.3m of revenue and $6.8m of EBITDA from months before Deal C owned the clinics (14.1% and 13.2%); on owned months the figures are $150.3m and $36.3m (21.6%) [F/I, DLC-0425/0427; DLC-0422/0424; DLC-0418/0420]. On the 60 clinics owned for all twelve months, the median clinic earns $342k, the interquartile range of clinic margins is 13.1–24.2%, and 5.2% of clinics lose money [F/I, DLC-0842; Exhibit 9.146].

In LTM July 2026, 38 of the 86 clinics in Ares Credit Group's unit-margin analysis of the site database earned a clinic margin above 21% and produced $28.0m of the $43.6m of clinic EBITDA; the 20 clinics below 13% produced $1.9m, and four lost money [F/I, DLC-4137..4164]. For Ares Credit Group's view, the platform's earnings rest on a broad top half of the estate rather than on a few outliers, while a fifth of the clinics contribute little. The figures include seller months for clinics bought between August 2025 and July 2026 and are before corporate cost, so the distribution is pro forma, and on its own it cannot show which cohorts the weaker clinics belong to or whether they are improving.

By cohort, on owned months only, LTM July 2026 margins are Legacy 20.2%, 2023 25.7%, 2024 17.9%, 2025 24.9% and 2026 22.3% (the 2025 and 2026 figures are 24.9% and 19.6% when seller months are included) [F/I, DLC-0745; DLC-0697; DLC-0705; DLC-0721; DLC-0737; DLC-0725/0741]; on the same definition the 2024 cohort earned 27.9% in its first owned year, CY2024, when 9 of its 15 clinics were owned for full months, against 17.9% on all 15 in LTM July 2026 [F/I, DLC-0513; DLC-0705].

Every acquisition cohort earns between 17.9% and 25.7% on owned months in LTM July 2026, consistent with the audit-tied 21.3–22.3% on which the business-quality reading rests [I, Exhibit 9.146]. The 2024 cohort's move from 27.9% (CY2024, 9 clinics) to 17.9% (LTM July 2026, 15 clinics) is the one cohort-level decline in the file; it is not on a constant clinic base, and it is a diligence question [F/I, DLC-0513; DLC-0705]. The cohort figures come from the management-adjusted site database on book rent, so they are pro forma and cannot show the margin at market rent.

Before rebates and on cash rent (D1.1), Deal C's margin cannot be stated: FY2025 rebate dollars and a clinic rent roll are not among the documents supplied, so D1.1 is unverifiable at clinic and total level [U, DLC-5017/5019/5020]. If FY2025 rebates lay within the 1.0–1.32% of gross sales the company states for adjacent periods [M, DLC-3735/3736], total-level D1.1 would be 21.0–21.6% [I]; this is a conditional bound, not a placement (Part 07 section F).

Organic growth, restated on the common same-store definition (owned and open 13 months, calendar months, no seller months), turned negative in 2026. Deal C's comps were +7.2% for April–December 2024 and +4.5% for CY2025, then −0.4% for LTM July 2026, −0.7% in Q1 2026 and −3.2% in Q2 2026 (survivor file, CLOSE-RETRO) [F/I, DLC-0982; DLC-0985; DLC-0994; DLC-1019; DLC-1022]. On the acquisition-lag variant (clinics enter from their 25th owned month), Q2 2026 is −1.3% (135 clinic-months) and LTM July 2026 +0.8% [F/I, DLC-1060/1061; DLC-1044]. The company's own series, which is working-day and blackout adjusted and keeps seller months in the base, shows +5.9% for FY2024, +4.2% for FY2025, +1.6% for LTM May 2026, +1.0% for Q1 2026 and +0.3% for Q2 2026 [M, DLC-2723; DLC-2788; DLC-2827; DLC-2801; DLC-2814]; it is shown beside the common definition, labelled, and not in its place (Exhibit 9.147). The deceleration is shared with Deal B (Part 07 section F). What is company-specific is the level and the earnings: Animal Health Manufacturer 4's product line alone explains about 1.6pp of the Q2 2026 figure (−1.6% without it) [F/I, DLC-1085], same-store clinic EBITDA fell 5.8% for LTM July 2026 and 7.9–8.1% in each of Q1 and Q2 2026 against +1.0% in CY2025 [F/I, DLC-0996; DLC-1021; DLC-1024; DLC-0987], and the 55 clinics owned before 2025 earned $15.0m in January–July 2026 against $17.3m a year earlier (−8.79%) on revenue down 1.8%, their margin falling from 21.1% to 20.4% [F/I, DLC-1188/1191; DLC-1186/1189; DLC-1195/1194]. The trajectory reading therefore rests on the common-definition series turning negative in 2026 (−0.4% LTM July, −3.2% in Q2; −1.3% on the lag variant) and on same-store clinic EBITDA of −5.8%, not on a peer ranking [I].

The traffic and ticket split can be read only on the company's definitions. The company's comp visit count fell 1.0% in FY2023 and 5.2% in FY2024, rose 0.1% in FY2025 and fell 1.6% in LTM June 2026, while its revenue per visit rose 4.2%, 11.5%, 4.1% and 3.3% in the same periods (compounded over FY2023–FY2025 alone, about −5.8% and +21%; LTM June 2026 overlaps FY2025 and is not added) [M, DLC-2944/3004/3064/3100; DLC-2946/3006/3066/3102]; pharmacy comps were negative in every period (−1.2%, −2.9%, −4.7%, −4.3%) [M, DLC-2663/2728/2793/2832]. These are company definitions (working-day and blackout adjusted, vaccination-only visits and Animal Health Manufacturer 4 excluded, seller months in the base), and the site database carries no visit counts, so no same-store traffic series can be built on the common base (Part 07 section F). Veterinarian retention of 53.8% (LTM June 2026) is the company's own measure; its 61% elsewhere excludes turnover within 79 days, and every peer retention or turnover figure in the benchmark is also company-defined, so none is compared [M, DLC-3819; DLC-4395; note C-85].

Deal C's company comp visit count fell in three of the four periods from FY2023 to LTM June 2026 while its average patient invoice rose in every one, by 3.3% to 11.5%: the industry's ticket-led pattern rather than an exception to it [I, Part 03 section A to Part 03 section B]. For Ares Credit Group's view, growth has come from price and mix, not from more patient visits. The series is the company's own, with seller months in the base; on the common SSS definition comps fell from +4.5% in 2025 to −0.4% for LTM July 2026, a steeper deceleration than the company series (+1.6% for LTM May 2026) shows [F/I, DLC-0985; DLC-0994; DLC-2827].

Our reading on ST1, on the evidence supplied to date: partially supported. The clinic-margin level is supported on the audit-tied 21.3–22.3% with a bounded rent-code effect (the peer comparison is indicative only), while the evidence on the 2026 organic trajectory does not support the thesis: common-definition comps turned negative in 2026 and same-store clinic EBITDA fell 5.8% (and 8.79% on the 55 pre-2025 clinics). The platform is three and a half years old and has no downturn history [F, DLC-0327]. What would change this reading: August–September 2026 same-store sales and same-store clinic EBITDA on the common definition, and a clinic rent roll with FY2025 rebate dollars, which would allow a pre-rebate, cash-rent placement.

Public signals

Public data place most of the mapped clinics in trade areas above the national median income, in a footprint concentrated in two metropolitan areas. The brands' location pages list 72 clinics (read on 30 September 2026; Operator 15 from copies of its pages archived in 2026) [I, PUB-0147], against 88 at June 2026 and 86 at July 2026 in the supplied documents [F, DLC-3498; I, DLC-0359]; the supplied count governs, and the public list serves only as the base for mapping. The company's team page also names a sixth brand, Operator 23, whose location pages were not read [F, PUB-0184]. Across the 68 clinics with a trade area, median household income within three miles is $84.0k, with an interquartile range of $68.5k to $100.2k [I, PUB-0148; PUB-0149; PUB-0150]; 20 clinics, 24.8%, sit below the US median of $71,197 [I, PUB-0151; F, PUB-0069]. Brand medians run from $66.6k at Sponsor 3 to $94.6k at Operator 15 [I, C-PUB-1; PUB-0153; PUB-0154].

Exhibit 9.144 — On ACS 2020–2024 data, the median mapped Deal C clinic sits in a trade area with household income of $84.0k, above the US median of $71.2k; three of four brands have medians above it

Median household income within three miles of each clinic, $ thousand: interquartile range across clinics with the median clinic marked, by brand; American Community Survey 2020–2024; clinics on the brands' location pages read on 30 September 2026

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Location pages of the Operator 11, Operator 17, Operator 15, Sponsor 3 and Operator 13 sites (72 clinics, read on 30 September 2026; Operator 15 from copies of its pages archived in 2026); US Census Bureau, American Community Survey 2020–2024 tract tables and 2024 Gazetteer; US median household income $71,197 from Census QuickFacts, read on 30 September 2026. Our computation [I, C-PUB-1; PUB-0148; PUB-0149; PUB-0150; PUB-0153; PUB-0154; PUB-0368; PUB-0420 to PUB-0428] [F, PUB-0069] · Basis: We computed all figures from public data. A clinic's trade area is every census tract whose centre lies within three miles; its income is the median of the pooled household-income distribution of those tracts. Brands with fewer than ten mapped clinics are drawn in grey · Assumption: 68 of the 72 listed clinics have a trade area: two have no coordinates and three have no tract centre within three miles. The supplied documents hold about 86 clinics; the public list holds three State 20 clinics (two Operator 13, one Operator 11) against 16 Operator 13 clinics in the supplied documents [M, DLC-4341], so State 20 is represented by three clinics only. The two Operator 13 clinics are in the all-clinics row and have no row of their own

State 39 holds 23 of the 72 listed clinics and State 30 21 [I, PUB-0155; PUB-0156]. The City 3 area has 18 and the City 4–City 5 area 17, together 36.6% of the list [I, PUB-0157; PUB-0158; PUB-0159]. An Operator 1-banner clinic lies within three miles of 5 of the 69 clinics with coordinates, 5.6% (Operator 1-banner clinic pages read on 30 September 2026); three of the five are State 20 clinics [I, PUB-0160; PUB-0161].

The figures describe mainly the State 39, State 30 and State 29, a home region and State 42–State 48 clinics. The list holds three State 20 clinics (two Operator 13, one Operator 11), against 16 Operator 13 clinics at August 2026 in the supplied documents [I, PUB-0162; M, DLC-4341], so State 20 is represented by three clinics only and the Operator 1 share describes the clinics mapped. Two clinics have no coordinates, and three have no census tract centre within three miles [I, PUB-0163; PUB-0164]. Operator 1 is mapped for its own banner only.

Customer ratings of two single clinics are in Exhibit 9.100.

07 C Claimed differentiation: supporting evidence

The 584bp gross-margin and 594bp clinic-EBITDA-margin headlines compare different cohorts: at-close gross margin of 46.3% on $48.0m of revenue (of which $27.7m is the 2026 cohort) against one-year 50.7% on $19.4m (2023–25 cohorts) and two-year 51.9% on $13.2m (2023–24 only), and clinic EBITDA margin of 18.7% at close against 25.4% at two years on the same mixed groups [F, KPI Data Pack 'Pre- and Post-Acquisition' C42:I100; DLC-3393/3394]; brownfield clinics are excluded [F, diligence tracker G10]. The sponsor's own presentation also states +501bp and +472bp over 21 months on another page [M, DLC-4370..4373].

A matched same-site comparison — up to twelve seller months before acquisition (at least six) against owned full months in LTM July 2026, seller months held as separate pre-ownership rows — shows gross-margin uplift of +1,107, +811, +361 and +274bp and clinic-EBITDA-margin uplift of +794,

−522, +261 and +432bp for the 2023, 2024, 2025 and 2026 cohorts; pooled for 2023–25 the uplift is +591bp on gross margin and +145bp on EBITDA margin, and across all 43 matched sites +431bp and +250bp [F/I, DLC-1201/1202, 1068/1210, 1042/1218, 1065/1226, 1047/1234, 1091/1242]. Clinics bought with a sale-leaseback show gross-margin uplift of +366bp but EBITDA-margin uplift of −13bp, against +268bp for the others, consistent with seller P&Ls that carried no rent on owned property [F/I, DLC-1249/1250; DLC-1257/1258]. The year-one clinic EBITDA-margin uplift across 19 sites is +237bp; only six sites have a second owned year [I, note C-91]. No peer has a matched seller-to-owned series on this definition, so the basis-point uplift is not placed against peers.

On the same sites, clinic EBITDA margin rose +794bp for the 2023 cohort, fell 522bp for the 2024 cohort and rose +261bp and +432bp for the 2025 and 2026 cohorts; pooled for 2023–25 the rise is +145bp, against the sponsor's 594bp clinic-EBITDA-margin headline, while pooled gross margin rose +591bp against its 584bp gross-margin headline [F/I, DLC-1202; DLC-1210; DLC-1218; DLC-1226; DLC-1234; DLC-1233; DLC-3394; DLC-3393]. Gross margin rose in every group, so for Ares Credit Group's view the pricing and purchasing mechanism is observed but most of it does not reach clinic EBITDA; clinics bought with a sale-leaseback gained +366bp of gross margin and lost 13bp of EBITDA margin. The comparison is pro forma: seller windows run six to twelve months and are not seasonally matched, and seller P&Ls for sale-leaseback clinics carried no rent on owned property, so the exhibit cannot show the uplift on a like-for-like rent basis.

On the buy-down basis that the roll-ups present — purchase price over clinic-level EBITDA at entry and on the acquirer's latest period, company-presented and on surviving deals — Deal C's 30 tuck-ins moved from 3.25x to 2.95x, a later-to-entry EBITDA ratio of 1.08x; by cohort, the six 2023 tuck-ins moved from 2.11x to 1.29x (1.43x), the 2024 cohort from 2.67x to 3.14x (0.73x) and the 2025 cohort from 3.04x to 2.88x (0.93x) [M/I, DLC-3427/3428; DLC-3434/3435; DLC-3441/3442; DLC-3448/3449]. The 3.25x KPI multiple is net of sale-leaseback proceeds [M, DLC-3424]; gross, on cash consideration, of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database, six single clinics cost 2.4–3.0x seller clinic EBITDA and the five-clinic Sponsor 3 deal 3.2x, while the two single clinics bought with a sale-leaseback cost 6.2x (Reliable; 2.9x net) and 6.2x (Premier ST-74; 4.2x net) and the ECM and Operator 34 acquisitions of 27 February 2026 (seven sites together) 6.6x; Sponsor 3's and Premier ST-74's multiples are lower bounds, as audit Note 14 does not quantify their rollover equity or Sponsor 3's earnout [I, DLC-1261..1279; 2025 audit Notes 3 and 14]. Seller-to-owned revenue on the 19 year-one sites was −3.2% per clinic-month; Deal C's seller windows are six to twelve months and not seasonally matched, so this is directional only [I]. These figures are set against Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4 in Part 07 section F.

On the evidence supplied, the platform lifts gross margin — a pricing matrix [M] and vendor rebates that rose from 0.8–1.0% of gross sales in FY2023–24 to 1.32% in the six months to April 2026 [M, DLC-3734/3735/3736] — but the rebate lever is small beside pharmacy-heavy peers, whose clinic-allocated rebates run at 2.1–10.9% of revenue, and similar to service-heavy Operator 7 ST-22 at 0.6–1.3% (booking points differ, so this is description, not placement) [F, Exhibit 9.51]. The EBITDA uplift that the thesis requires is smaller than stated, dispersed, and below peer norms on the only common basis (Part 07 section F).

Our reading on ST2, on the evidence supplied to date: contradicted. The evidence supplied does not support the claimed 584/695bp uplift; the gross-margin mechanism is observed but does not appear to carry through to EBITDA at the claimed scale. What would change this reading: the per-deal buy-down basis with seller P&Ls that show rent on owned property (Exhibit 4.17, question 8), and matched 21-month cohort data including brownfields.

Public signals

The brand sites, read on 30 September 2026, post different customer terms and run partly different tools; Exhibit 9.145 sets them out by brand. Operator 11 and Operator 15 post a care guarantee of five years or 42,801 loyalty points on supplies and treatment, each conditional on return visits [F, PUB-0169; PUB-0170; PUB-0171; PUB-0172]. Sponsor 3 posts four years and 42,553 points [F, PUB-0173]. Operator 17 posts five years and 42,801 points on its home page and four years and 42,553 points on its partners page, a difference between two pages [F, PUB-0174; PUB-0175]. Operator 15 and Operator 17 present the guarantee as the Pet Retailer 4 network programme [M, PUB-0176; PUB-0177]. All five brand sites carry the same booking tool and three the same pharmacy-search tool; call tracking is seen from one vendor at Operator 11 and from another at Operator 15 [F, PUB-0178; PUB-0179; PUB-0180; PUB-0181]. The differences in tools bear on how far the brands are integrated, which the growth-capacity claim relies on (Part 07 section E).

Exhibit 9.145 — On 30 September 2026 four Deal C brand sites post a care guarantee at two lengths, 5 years/50,000 points and 4 years/48,000 points (both on the Operator 17 site), and carry partly different tools

Care guarantee, conditions, affiliations and site tools as each brand's own site shows them, read on 30 September 2026

BRAND	SUPPLIES-AND-TREATMENT GUARANTEE AS POSTED	CONDITION AS POSTED	AFFILIATIONS THE SITE STATES OR SHOWS [M]	CALL TRACKING AND PAID-MEDIA TAGS SEEN	BOOKING AND PHARMACY SEARCH SEEN	REFERENCE
Operator 11	5 years / 42,801 points on supplies and treatment for general practice care; prescription diets 26 days, supplies only	A visit to any Operator 11 location at least twice a year	Animal Health Manufacturer 1 affiliated clinic, Pet Retailer 4, accreditation-body and practice-network badges	Call-tracking vendor 1; social-media pixel, search-ad tags, session-recording tag	Shared online booking tool; online-pharmacy search tool	[F, PUB-0169; PUB-0170; PUB-0180; PUB-0352; PUB-0178; PUB-0179] [M, PUB-0353]
Operator 15	5 years / 42,801 points on all supplies and services. Silver tier: full cover for 2 years / 21,161 points, then prorated to 5 / 44. Gold tier: full cover for 5 / 44	A visit at least once every 12 months	Pet Retailer 4 Peace of Mind Care Guarantee; board-certified veterinarians at every location	Call-tracking vendor 2; social-media pixel, search-ad call-conversion tags	Shared online booking tool; pharmacy search not seen on the pages read	[F, PUB-0171; PUB-0172; PUB-0181; PUB-0354; PUB-0178] [M, PUB-0176]
Operator 17	Home page: 5 years / 42,801 points. Partners page: 4 years / 42,553 points, nationwide	Not seen on the pages read	Pet Retailer 4 Partner Clinic; Pet Retailer 4 Peace of Mind guarantee "to 5 years or 42,801 points on qualified treatments"; accredited hospital; certified veterinarians	Call tracking not seen on the pages read; social-media pixel, ad-server counters	Shared online booking tool, and a second booking window for some clinics; online-pharmacy search tool	[F, PUB-0174; PUB-0175; PUB-0355; PUB-0356; PUB-0178; PUB-0179] [M, PUB-0177]
Sponsor 3	4 years / 42,553 points	Not seen on the pages read	Pet Retailer 4 Partner Clinic; accredited hospital; accreditation seal of excellence	Tag container not read	Shared online booking tool; pharmacy search not seen on the pages read	[F, PUB-0173; PUB-0178] [M, PUB-0357]
Operator 13	Guarantee page not read	Guarantee page not read	Animal Health Manufacturer 1 affiliated clinic, Pet Retailer 4 and accreditation-body badges	Tag container not read	Shared online booking tool; online-pharmacy search tool	[F, PUB-0178; PUB-0179] [M, PUB-0358]

Source: Home, guarantee and partners pages of the Operator 11, Operator 15, Operator 17, Sponsor 3 and Operator 13 sites, and the tag containers each site loads, read on 30 September 2026 [PUB-0169 to PUB-0181; PUB-0352 to PUB-0358] · Basis: Posted terms and tools seen on the pages are documented facts [F]. Affiliations are each brand's own statements or badges [M]; the networks' own lists were not read. Operator 13's guarantee page was not read. "Not seen on the pages read" describes the pages read and nothing more · Assumption: Only home pages, guarantee pages, one partners page and the tag containers were read. Tag containers were read for Operator 11, Operator 15 and Operator 17 only. Who funds guarantee cover beyond a network programme is not stated on any page read

The corporate bench is visible on the company's own team page, read on 30 September 2026. It lists a chief executive (John Teddy), a chief operating officer (Brian Bates) and a chief financial officer (Louie Psallidas), a chief brand officer and a chief commercial officer [F, PUB-0182]. Below them it lists seven vice presidents, covering human resources, financial planning, information technology, performance marketing, corporate development, data and analytics, and the controller [F, PUB-0183]. It also lists six brand presidents, five of them titled founder [F, PUB-0184]. The chief executive's appointment was announced in a release of 30 May 2024 [F, PUB-0185]. The page shows no appointment dates.

07 D Earnings quality: supporting evidence

The audited statements show: net loss −$24.4m, transaction expenses $12.2m, earn-out payments $5.4m, operating cash flow −$9.3m and −$13.3m after capex and software; unmodified opinion, no going-concern paragraph [F, Mike 2025 audit pp4–8; DLC-0009; DLC-0149; DLC-4452]. The existing debt facilities and their maturity are set out in Part 08 section D. Reported EBITDA on the D3 definition (operating income plus D&A plus impairment) is **$4.7m**; the $4.0m in the files is Accounting Firm 1's "reported EBITDA", which omits the $1.0m trade-name impairment; excluding the non-cash $3.4m earn-out fair-value credit it is $1.4m [F/I, DLC-0019; DLC-0021; DLC-0020]. Of the FY2025 transaction expense, $7.12m (51%) is bonuses paid or payable to affiliates, $1.67m of it unpaid at year-end; in FY2024 it was $7.00m (67%) [F, DLC-0199; DLC-0068; DLC-0200]. The audit and the QoE figures quoted in Ares Credit Group's Internal Diligence Exhibits (the QoE itself was not supplied) disagree on the transaction line: $9.1m against $13.8m for FY2024 and $12.01m against $12.0m for FY2025 [F, DLC-0031/3875; DLC-0009/3876].

Ares Credit Group's memo carries six earnings figures: reported TTM April 2026 $0.3m (E1 on the D3 definition $1.3m); "actually generated" cash EBITDA about $12.0m, whose derivation is not reproducible from the slide; LTM April 2026 cash EBITDA $23.2m (which deducts a $1.0m non-cash impairment; $24.9m with the impairment added back); Ares Credit Group's underwriting $29.4m (LTM September 2026E, P); sponsor pro-forma $32.3m (LTM September 2026E, P); sell-side $33.9m (LTM April 2026, PF) [F/A, DLC-3872/4434; DLC-4185; DLC-4107/4443; DLC-4002; DLC-4195; DLC-4099]. Of the $29.4m, $9.2m is pre-acquisition ($7.4m after Ares Credit Group's own rebate adjustment to Accounting Firm 1's $7.7m) and LOI ($1.9m) earnings that the company did not generate [A, DLC-4183; DLC-3975]; seller months are 13–24% of E3 by period [I, DLC-4420/4424/4428/4433]. The Accounting Firm 1 QoE was not supplied, so the add-backs behind E2 and the pre-acquisition figure cannot be tested [U, DLC-4435]. Measured as a share of the top rung, E3 is 69% adjustments over E1 in FY2025 and 82% for LTM April 2026 [I, DLC-4426/0019; DLC-4430/4434], inside the roll-up range (Part 07 section F).

Cash EBITDA on the D3 definition — E3 less the transaction, integration and start-up costs that have recurred in every period (FY23 to LTM April 2026) — is $8.3m for FY2025 and $8.6m for LTM April 2026, 0.31 and 0.28 of E3 [I, DLC-4437; DLC-4439; DLC-3874..3877]. Such costs recur at every acquisitive platform in the set; what sets Deal C apart is their rate. Audited transaction expense was 28.5% of total purchase consideration in FY2024 and 31.2% in FY2025; without the affiliate bonuses it would have been 7.4% and 13.2% [I, DLC-0031/0009 over total consideration of $27.9m and $32.8m (cash, rollover equity and contingent consideration), Mike 2025 Audit Note 3, pp.17–19 (printed pp.15–17); DLC-0200/0199]. The sponsor's 2027–30 plan budgets $6.7–11.4m of transaction expense a year plus $5.3m of other costs; that transaction expense is 8.8–10.1% of modelled acquisition spend in 2027–30 [M/I, DLC-1481..1484; DLC-1490..1493; DLC-1844..1851]. Against the roll-ups, the cash share sits in the bottom third of the range and the deal-cost rate above every peer platform-year, while the ex-bonus rate and the plan's rate sit inside it (Part 07 section F).

The cash finding is conditional on the affiliate transaction bonuses. They were $7.12m of FY2025's $12.01m of audited transaction expense (51%) and $7.00m of FY2024's $9.10m (67%) [F/I, DLC-0199/0009; DLC-0200/0031]; whether they continue after close is untested [U]. If they ended, FY2025 D3 cash EBITDA would be about $15.5m ($8.3m + $7.12m), 0.59 of E3, in the upper half of the 0.24–0.83 peer range and below its 0.73 median [I, DLC-4437; DLC-0199; DLC-4426]; this mixes the audit's bonus figure with the QoE's $12.0m transaction line (audit $12.01m), so it is approximate [I].

Deal costs going forward. The model's case continues to buy clinics, so the deal-cost rate bears directly on cash earnings. Under the observed cost rate, pro forma (E3) and cash EBITDA diverged by $14.1m in FY2025 and $18.9m in LTM April 2026 [I, DLC-4426/4437; DLC-4430/4439] — larger than the sponsor's 2027–30 budget of $6.7–11.4m of transaction expense a year, which sits between the gap implied by the peer median cash share on $29.4m ($4.5m, (1 − 0.73) × $29.4m) and that implied by the heavy-acquisition-year ratios of 0.34–0.37 ($16.3–19.6m, (1 − 0.37 to 0.29) × $29.4m) [I, Exhibit 9.69]. At Deal C's audited rate of 31.2% of price, the model's 2027 acquisition spend of $58.6m would carry $21.7m of deal cost against the $6.7m budgeted; at the 13.2% rate that remains once affiliate bonuses are excluded, $9.0m [I, DLC-1844/1848; DLC-1481].

Our reading on ST3, on the evidence supplied to date: Insufficient evidence (underwriting EBITDA, E5; Accounting Firm 1 QoE absent) — cash earnings contradicted while the affiliate bonuses continue. As an underwriting EBITDA (Ares Credit Group's E5) — the market-convention figure on which peers' earnings are also presented — the $29.4m cannot be tested without the Accounting Firm 1 QoE. On **cash earnings** the historical record does not support the thesis while the affiliate bonuses continue: Deal C's D3 cash EBITDA is a third of its adjusted earnings because of a deal-cost rate no peer shows, and the model's forward budget assumes that rate falls to the peer level without a contractual reason we have seen. If the bonus agreements end, cash EBITDA would be about 0.59 of E3, and our reading of the cash condition would no longer be contradicted. What would change this reading: the Accounting Firm 1 QoE (including the $7.4m pre-acquisition and $1.9m LOI earnings), and the affiliate transaction-bonus agreements with their post-close status.

07 E Growth capacity: supporting evidence

On the sponsor's own model and on the peer record, the capacity claim does not appear to hold. The sponsor's Confidential Information Presentation states "18 area managers × 7 clinics = 127 clinics with no incremental spend", using the 2023 ratio; the June 2026 census shows 20 area managers at 3.8–5.3 clinics each (3.8–5.9 on August 2026 clinic counts), 4.2–4.3 on average [M/F, DLC-4385/4386; DLC-3462; DLC-3479..3493]. No peer area-manager span is in the files, so the ratio is not benchmarked. The model grows corporate G&A 17% a year, from $7.5m to $16.1m by 2030, in both its M&A case and its no-acquisition 88-clinic base [M, DLC-1421/1425; DLC-1945; DLC-2009]. Beachhead plus corporate G&A rose from 5.3% of pro-forma revenue in FY2023 to 8.3% in FY2025 and 7.3% for LTM April 2026; the M&A case takes it to 4.8% by 2030, the no-acquisition case to 10.4% [I, DLC-1408..1411, DLC-1417..1420, DLC-2199, DLC-1288, DLC-2201, DLC-1289; DLC-1416/1425/1294; DLC-2008/2009/2006]. Overhead levels are not comparable across platforms, but the direction is: no platform in the set cut its overhead share by more than 1.1pp while it scaled, and Operator 8 (+0.5pp), Operator 3 (+1.1pp) and Deal A (+1.8pp) raised theirs [F/I, OP8-0394/2103; OP3-2566/2568; DLA-1350/1223]. Holding the fall to the largest observed (−1.1pp, to 6.2% of revenue) would add $9.1m a year to the 2030 M&A-case beachhead plus corporate G&A of $31.1m [I, DLC-1294; DLC-1416/1425]. On the files we have, the sponsor's model does not support "costless capacity", and the fall in overhead share it assumes is outside the peer record.

Public signals

On the company's own statements, brand integration is still in progress. Company posts of 21 October 2025 (Operator 11), 13 November 2025 (Operator 15) and 5 December 2025 (Operator 17) each say the brand expects to complete the rest of its rebranding "within the next 12 to 15 months" [M, PUB-0186; PUB-0187; PUB-0188]. Each lists what a rebranded clinic adds: digital patient health reports, online scheduling, and text and email updates [M, PUB-0189]. On that wording the three programmes end between October 2026 and March 2027 [I, C-PUB-15]. A company release of 9 July 2026 reports 20 of Operator 17's "21 State 39 locations" rebranded, in the release's wording [M, PUB-0190]; the supplied documents count 23 Operator 17 clinics at August 2026 [M, DLC-4339], and that count governs.

On our reading, the brand sites, read on 30 September 2026, are consistent with that position [I]. Each brand has its own website [F, PUB-0191]. Five carry the same booking tool, and three (Operator 11, Operator 13 and Operator 17) the same pharmacy-search tool [F, PUB-0178; PUB-0179]. Sponsor

3's site runs on a different platform from the other four [F, PUB-0192]. Operator 17, Operator 15 and Sponsor 3 each run their own rewards programme [F, PUB-0193]. The Operator 17 site still links social accounts under its former name [F, PUB-0194].

07 F Against comparable operators: supporting evidence

Deal C's comparators are the acquisitive roll-ups with full EBITDA ladders and clinic-level acquisition data: Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 2, Operator 8 and Operator 4 [note C-84, Deal C rows]; Deal B, Deal A, Operator 5 and Operator 7 ST-22 enter below where they share a measure. The roll-ups' leverage prints, and the proposed financing set against them, are in Part 08 section D. The comparison is valid on same-store sales, adjustment share and add-on multiples; it is indicative only on clinic margin, and not possible on traffic.

Taken together, Deal C leads its comparators on clinic margin, indicatively, and on the price it pays for most tuck-ins; it sits inside their range on 2025 same-store sales and on adjustment share; it sits below them on 2026 same-store sales and on how far acquired clinics re-rate after purchase; it sits in the bottom third of their range on the cash share of pro forma EBITDA; and its deal-cost rate is above every peer platform-year. Overhead is compared by direction only (Part 07 section E).

Clinic margin

Against peers the comparison is indicative and bounded, not a range placement: the comparator map (Part 09 section K, 04 F) treats clinic margin as not valid for Deal C because no comparator shares its rent and rebate treatment (Exhibit 7.13), and the peer figures differ in rent code, period and construction. On that understanding, the D1.2-type figures in SOFT24-26 run from 16.5% to 18.7%: Operator 3 16.66% (LTM Aug-25, ratio of sums, survivor full-year clinics, R-UNK, A), Operator 6 16.1% (LTM Mar-26, a per-location average rather than a ratio of sums, PF, with its 2025–26 vintages including pre-acquisition months, R-UNK) and Operator 4 18.7% (CY25 clinic EBITDA, constant 192-centre base, R-UNK, A) [F/I; OP3-1091; OP6-0357; OP4-1507]. Deal C's audit-tied 21.3–22.3% (Part 07 section B) sits 2.6–3.0pp above the top of those figures, and its PF owned-month 21.6% sits 2.2pp above [I]. The comparators' rent basis is not stated (R-UNK); a rent-code effect of up to 1.3% of sales (the largest observed, Operator 2) is smaller than the gap, so the direction of the gap is likely to hold even though the placement is not formally valid [I].

Exhibit 9.146 — LTM Mar-23 to LTM Jul-26: Deal C's with-rebates clinic margin of 21.6–22.3% sits above Operator 3, Operator 6, Operator 4 and Operator 5 on mixed rent codes, with the widest spread; indicative, not a range placement

Clinic-level EBITDA margin after vendor rebates, before corporate cost, % of revenue: ratio of sums, median, interquartile range and loss-making share; latest period per operator; clinic-level files and FY2025 audit

PLATFORM	PERIOD	DEFINITION / RENT CODE / BASE / BASIS	RATIO OF SUMS	MEDIAN	IQR	LOSS-MAKING SHARE	LOCATOR
Deal C	LTM Jul-26	D1.2 / R-BOOK [I] / owned full months; owned-12 base n=60 for distribution / PF (site database, QoE-adjusted to Apr-26 and management-adjusted May–Jul-26; PF governs here)	21.6%	20.9%	13.1–24.2%	5.2% (4 of 60)	DLC-0421; DLC-0839..0841, 722
Deal C	FY25	D1.2 / cash rent at total level / audited (21.3% on book rent) / A — **the basis of our ST1 reading on level**	22.3%	–	–	–	DLC-0018; DLC-5013/5014
Operator 4	CY25	D1.2-type ST-99 EBITDA / R-UNK / constant 192 / A	18.7%	–	–	–	OP4-1507
Operator 6	LTM Mar-26	D1.2 / R-UNK / survivor 49, per-location average (not a ratio of sums), 2025–26 vintages incl. pre-acquisition months / PF	16.1%	–	–	–	OP6-0357
Operator 3	LTM Aug-25	D1.2-type / R-UNK / survivor full-year n=38 / A	16.5%	14.1%	12.1–19.7%	2.0%	OP3-1091
Operator 5	LTM Mar-23	D1.2-type / R-CASH (28 of 38 related-party) / ALL n=38 / PF	16.9%	16.8%	14.9–18.4%	0%	OP5-2060..2446

Source: the Evidence index (Part 09 section F) rows as listed; note C-22 and note C-86. D1.2 = after vendor rebates, before corporate allocation. Periods and clinic bases differ by row and are stated; rent codes differ (R-BOOK, R-UNK, R-CASH) and Operator 6 is a per-location average, so only a directional, bounded comparison is made; the ST1-level grade rests on the audited FY25 row

The level lead comes with the widest spread. Deal C's owned-12 interquartile range is 10.7pp and 5.2% of clinics lose money, against 7.0pp and 2.0% at Operator 3 and 3.3pp and none at Operator 5; its lower-quartile clinic (13.1%) earns less than Operator 5's lower quartile and about Operator 3's median [I, Exhibit 9.146]. Against the pre-rebate, cash-rent (D1.1 R-CASH) set — Operator 7 ST-22 16.1% (FY25, A) and Operator 5 15.0% (FY22, PF), with a median clinic of 17.4% at each [F/I, OP7-0515; OP5-2028; note C-31] — Deal C cannot be placed: FY2025 rebate dollars and a clinic rent roll are not among the documents supplied, and its conditional total-level bound of 21.0–21.6% is not a placement (07 B above).

Same-store sales and traffic

On the common same-store definition (owned and open 13 months, calendar months, no seller months), Deal C was in line with peers in 2025 and turned negative in 2026 while the one roll-up peer with a 2026 reading stayed positive. Deal B's DLB segment printed +4.7% for CY2025 and +3.3% for LTM July 2026 (CLOSE-FWD; its survivor-only sensitivity moves either figure by no more than 0.2pp) and +0.3% in Q2 2026; Deal A's survivor base printed +1.1% for FY2026 and −1.3% for April–June 2026; Operator 6 +1.9% for CY2025 and Operator 3 +4.2% for the year to August 2025 [F/I, DLB-1406/1411; DLB-1516/1521; DLB-1821; DLA-0788; DLA-0828; OP6-1148; OP3-0906]. Deal C's CY2025 (+4.5%) is inside the +1.9% to +5.1% range of Operator 6, Operator 3 and Deal B (Deal B +5.1% with closed clinics dropped, as for Deal C; +4.7% with closed clinics carried forward; Deal A's survivor-only +1.1% for FY2026 is shown for reference), its LTM July 2026 (−0.4%) is 3.9pp below Deal B, and its Q2 2026 (−3.2%) is 3.3pp below Deal B [I, DLC-0985; DLC-0994; DLC-1022]. Deal A's −1.3% for April–June 2026 is a survivor-only figure after more than 161 closures, the largest survivor bias in the set, so no ranking is drawn against it. The slowdown itself is shared: from Q2 2025 to Q2 2026 Deal C's comp fell 9.5pp and Deal B's 8.6pp [I, DLC-1010/1022; DLB-1766/1821]. The company's own series is shown beside the common definition, labelled; it is not placed.

Exhibit 9.147 — CY2024 to Q2-26: on the common definition Deal C's same-store sales were inside the peer range in 2025 and fell to −3.2% in Q2-26, 3.3pp below Deal B

Same-store sales growth, % year on year, on the common definition (owned and open 13 months, calendar months, no seller months), with Deal C's company series beside it, labelled; CY2024 to Q2-26; clinic-level files

WINDOW	DEAL C, COMMON DEFINITION (CLOSE-RETRO)	DEAL C COMPANY SERIES, LABELLED (WORKING-DAY ADJUSTED, SELLER MONTHS IN BASE; NOT PLACED)	DEAL B DLB (CLOSE-FWD; RETRO ±0.2PP)	DEAL A (SURVIVOR, CLOSE-RETRO)	OPERATOR 6 (CLOSE-RETRO)	OPERATOR 3 (CLOSE-RETRO)	DEAL C POSITION (COMMON DEFINITION)
CY2024	+7.2% (Apr–Dec; DLC-0982)	+5.9% (FY24; DLC-2723)	−3.9% (DLB-1361)	−4.1% (FY25, DLA-0756)	–	+2.4% (OP3-0890)	above
CY2025	+4.5% (DLC-0985)	+4.2% (FY25; DLC-2788)	+4.7% / +5.1% (DLB-1406/1411)	+1.1% (FY26, DLA-0788)	+1.9% (OP6-1148)	+4.2% (LTM Aug-25, OP3-0906)	inside 1.9–5.1% (Operator 6, Operator 3, Deal B; Deal A shown for reference)
LTM Jul-26	−0.4% (DLC-0994)	+1.6% (LTM May-26; DLC-2827)	+3.3% (DLB-1516/1521)	–	–	–	3.9pp below
Q1-26	−0.7% (DLC-1019)	+1.0% (DLC-2801)	+2.3% (DLB-1811)	–	–	–	2.9pp below
Q2-26	−3.2% (DLC-1022); ex-Animal Health Manufacturer 4 −1.6% (DLC-1085); lag variant D2.3 −1.3% (DLC-1060)	+0.3% (DLC-2814)	+0.3% (DLB-1821)	−1.3% (Apr–Jun-26, DLA-0828; survivor-only after 161+ closures — not ranked)	–	–	3.3pp below DLB

Source: the Evidence index (Part 09 section F) rows as listed (A). The company series (SSS_ST-59) is working-day and blackout adjusted and uses seller months in the base; it is shown in its own column, labelled, and is not placed [M, DLC-2723; DLC-2788; DLC-2827; DLC-2801; DLC-2814]. Its windows are the company's fiscal years and LTM May-26. The definition effect in Q2 2026 (−3.4pp) is inside the −4.5 to +2.6pp range observed at peers (Exhibit 9.64)

Traffic cannot be placed against peers: the company's comp visit count is on its own definitions, and the site database carries no visit counts (Part 07 section B). For reference only, every peer with a common-base traffic series in 2025–26 is negative: Deal B's DLB segment −3.8% (LTM July 2026), Operator 6 −3.4% (LTM May 2026), Deal A −4.2% (April–June 2026, surviving clinics) and Operator 3 −2.8% (LTM August 2025) [F/I, DLB-1518; OP6-1952; DLA-0829; OP3-0907].

Acquisition delivery

The common basis for acquired-clinic performance across platforms is the buy-down ratio: purchase price over clinic-level EBITDA at entry and on the acquirer's latest period, company-presented and on surviving deals. Deal C's 30 tuck-ins earn 0.93x their entry EBITDA; by cohort, its six 2023 tuck-ins earn 1.43x, its 2024 cohort 0.73x and its 2025 cohort 0.93x (07 C above). Operator 6's 31 add-ons moved from 4.60x to 3.50x (1.15x; 1.43x for deals two to three years old), Operator 3's 18 from 4.4x to 2.8x (1.38x; 1.43x for its 2024 cohort) and Operator 4's programmatic pool from 6.0x to 3.2x (1.63x) [M/I, OP6-1731/1733; OP3-1493/1494; OP3-1846..1856; OP4-0802/0806]. Deal C's 0.93x sits 0.22x below the bottom of the 1.15–1.63x range; its oldest cohort, the six 2023 tuck-ins at 1.43x, sits inside it, as Operator 6's buckets of two years or more do (1.43x and 1.30x), while its 2024 cohort fell below entry [I, DLC-3434/3435; note C-37]. The entry multiples explain part of this: gross, on cash consideration, seven of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database (six single clinics and the five-clinic Sponsor 3 deal) cost 2.4–3.2x seller clinic EBITDA, below the peers' 4.4–6.0x standalone range, while the other three (two single clinics bought with a sale-leaseback

and the ECM and Operator 34 acquisitions of 27 February 2026, seven sites together) cost 6.2–6.6x, above it, though net of sale-leaseback proceeds the two bought with one cost 2.9x and 4.2x, below it; Premier ST-74 and ECM and Operator 34, with seller clinic EBITDA of $1.0m and $2.2m, sit inside the 5.7–7.2x interquartile range for $1.0–2.2m targets [I, DLC-1261..1279; OP3-1493; OP6-1731; OP4-0802; Exhibit 4.05]. Seller-to-owned revenue on the 19 year-one sites was −3.2% per clinic-month, against −11.4% for Operator 3's 2023 cohort; Deal C's seller windows are six to twelve months and not seasonally matched, so this is directional only [I; OP3-1110].

Exhibit 9.148 — To LTM May-26: Deal C's acquired clinics earn 0.93x their entry EBITDA, below every peer pool (1.15–1.63x), and its 2024 cohort earns 0.73x while its six 2023 tuck-ins earn 1.43x

Entry and later purchase multiples of clinic-level EBITDA and the later-to-entry EBITDA ratio, x; company-presented, surviving deals, before corporate cost; latest period per pool, May-25 to LTM May-26

PLATFORM / POOL	ENTRY MULTIPLE	LATER MULTIPLE	LATER ÷ ENTRY EBITDA	LATER EBITDA BASIS	LOCATOR
Deal C, 30 tuck-ins	3.25x (net of SLB)	2.95x (LTM May-26)	0.93x	clinic-level (D1.2), survivor; 2026 cohort incl. seller months; PF [M]	DLC-3427/3428
Deal C, 2023 cohort (6)	2.11x	1.29x	1.43x	as above	DLC-3434/3435
Deal C, 2024 cohort (9)	2.67x	3.14x	0.73x	as above	DLC-3441/3442
Deal C, 2025 cohort (13)	3.04x	2.88x	0.93x	as above	DLC-3448/3449
Operator 6, 31 add-ons	4.60x	3.50x (TTM Mar-26)	1.15x	synergised per QoE, survivor, PF	OP6-1731/1733
Operator 6, 2–3 years since close	4.1x	2.5x	1.43x	company-presented, survivor	note C-37
Operator 3, 18 deals	4.4x	2.8x (May-25)	1.38x	company chart, PF [M]	OP3-1493/1494
Operator 4, programmatic pool	6.0x	3.2x (Q1-26 LTM)	1.63x	post-integration, survivor, A [M]	OP4-0802/0806

Source: rows as listed; Exhibit 3.15 and Exhibit 9.72. Later ÷ entry EBITDA = entry multiple ÷ later multiple [I]. All pools are company-presented and survivor-only and measured before corporate cost, so each overstates value created; the same caveat applies on both sides

Adjustments, cash share and deal costs

Measured as a share of the top rung, Deal C's adjustments are within the roll-up range: E3 is 69% adjustments over E1 in FY2025 and 82% for LTM April 2026, against 10% (Operator 3) to 96% (Operator 4 FY2025) [I, DLC-4426/0019; DLC-4430/4434; Exhibit 9.69; OP3-1127/2161; OP4-0103/1034]. The cash test places Deal C in the bottom third of the range. Its D3 cash EBITDA is 0.31 of E3 for FY2025 and 0.28 for LTM April 2026 (Part 07 section D); peers' cash EBITDA runs at 0.24–0.83 of the top rung with a median of 0.84; only the heaviest acquisition years sit as low (Operator 4 FY2025 0.37 and LTM March 2026 0.29, Operator 6 FY2024 0.31), and only Operator 8 (0.24, on its as-owned adjusted EBITDA) is lower [F/I, Exhibit 9.69; note C-61]. Recurrence is not what separates Deal C: "one-time" cash costs recur for three to nine consecutive years at every acquisitive platform [F, Exhibit 3.23]. The rate does. Audited transaction expense was 28.5% of total purchase consideration in FY2024 and 31.2% in FY2025, against 1.5–14.1% in every peer platform-year; without the affiliate bonuses it would have been 7.4% and 13.2%, inside the peer range [I, DLC-0031/0009 over total consideration of $27.9m and $32.8m (cash, rollover equity and contingent consideration), Mike 2025 Audit Note 3, pp.17–19 (printed pp.15–17); DLC-0200/0199]. The sponsor's 2027–30 plan budgets transaction expense of 10.3–10.1% of modelled acquisition spend — a peer rate, not Deal C's [M/I, DLC-1481..1484; DLC-1844..1851].

Exhibit 9.149 — FY2022 to LTM Sep-26E: Deal C's adjustment share is inside the roll-up range, but its cash EBITDA is 0.28–0.31 of pro forma against a 0.73 peer median

EBITDA rungs ($m), adjustment share, cash share of pro forma EBITDA, deal-cost rate and conversion, against the peer range; FY2022 to LTM Sep-26E; 2025 audit, Internal Diligence Exhibits, peer files

MEASURE (DEFINITION)	DEAL C	PEER RANGE (ROWS)	POSITION
E1 reported (D3), FY25 / LTM Apr-26	$4.7m / $1.3m (DLC-0019; DLC-4434)	–	–
E2 / E3 / E3/E4 (model), FY25	$17.6m / $22.0m / $25.5m (DLC-4425/4426/4427)	–	–
E5 Ares Credit Group, LTM Sep-26E (P)	$29.4m (DLC-4002; sources differ: $30.0m DLC-4194)	–	–

MEASURE (DEFINITION)	DEAL C	PEER RANGE (ROWS)	POSITION
ADJ_SHARE, E3 over D3 E1	0.66 FY25; 0.81 LTM Apr-26 [I]	0.11 Operator 3 – 0.93 Operator 4 (OP3-1127/2161; OP2-4347/4426; OP6-0047/0060; OP8-1781/2409; OP4-0103/1034)	inside, upper half
E6 (D3 recurrence test: E3 less transaction, integration and start-up costs) ÷ E3	0.31 FY25 ($8.3m); 0.28 LTM Apr-26 ($8.6m = 27.9 – 15.6 – 2.3 – 0.4) [I] (DLC-4437/4439); 0.59 FY25 if affiliate bonuses ($7.12m) end [I]	0.24–0.83 (Operator 8 on its as-owned adjusted EBITDA, E2m), median 0.73 (note C-61)	bottom third
Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA (EB_CASH_ST-59, Ares Credit Group), LTM Apr-26 — not E6	$23.2m as printed; $24.9m with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back (DLC-4107; DLC-4443)	–	not a D3 rung
E3 – E6, $m a year	14.1 FY25; 18.9 LTM Apr-26 [I]	median-ratio equivalent on $29.4m: 4.5, (1 – 0.73) × 29.4; heavy-acquisition-year ratios 0.29–0.37 on $29.4m: 16.3–19.6, (1 – 0.37 to 0.29) × 29.4 [I]	FY25 between the two; LTM Apr-26 inside the heavy-acquisition range
Transaction expense ÷ consideration	28.5% FY24; 31.2% FY25; ex affiliate bonuses 7.4% / 13.2% [I]	1.5–14.1% (note C-56)	above; inside ex bonuses
CONV_1 on E2, company maintenance split, FY25	0.76 [I]	Operator 8 0.73 / 0.80 (OP8-0743/0859; OP8-0744/0781)	inside
CONV_3 on E1 (A), FY25 (build year)	−1.56 (DLC-4997)	Operator 4 −0.34 (FY23) / −0.22 (FY24 build); Operator 9 −0.37 (FY Sep-24) / −0.39 (FY Sep-25); Deal A 0.38 (FY26)	below all

Source: rows as listed; Exhibit 9.68 to Exhibit 3.23. E6 = E3 less recurring transaction, integration and start-up costs (D3 recurrence test). CONV_3 = levered free cash before growth ÷ E1; maintenance-capex tier differs between Deal C (company split) and Operator 4/Operator 9 (D&A proxy)

Exhibit 9.150 — FY19 to FY25: Deal C's audited deal costs were 28.5% and 31.2% of purchase consideration, against 1.5–14.1% in every peer platform-year; without affiliate bonuses 7.4% and 13.2%

Transaction and integration cost as a share of purchase consideration, %, by platform-year, FY19 to FY25, with the sponsor's model for 2027P and 2030P; audited statements and peer files

PLATFORM	YEARS	SHARE OF CONSIDERATION	LOCATOR
Deal C (audited transaction expense)	FY24 / FY25	28.5% / 31.2%	DLC-0031, DLC-0009 over total consideration (cash, rollover and contingent: $27.9m FY24, $32.8m FY25), DLC-014 Note 3 pp.17–19 (printed pp.15–17) [I]
Deal C excl. affiliate bonuses	FY24 / FY25	7.4% / 13.2%	DLC-0200, DLC-0199 over the same total consideration [I]
Deal C model, M&A case (P)	2027P / 2030P	10.1% / 9.2%	DLC-1481/1484 over DLC-1844..1851 [I]
Operator 6	FY24 / FY25	14.1% / 10.1%	OP6-0645/0647
Operator 3	FY23 / FY24	2.7% / 6.3%	OP3-1146/1147
Operator 4	FY24 / FY25	2.5% / 2.3%	OP4-0086/0136
Operator 8	FY25 (four dated deals)	6.7%	OP8-2018
Operator 2	FY19 / FY20	3.2% / 5.1%	OP2-2936; OP2-2921..2933
Operator 1	FY20 / FY21	1.5% / 13.3% (of cohort EV)	OP1-8626/8627

Source: note C-56 and rows as listed; platform-years only (Operator 2's deal-level 2.3–62% is excluded)

Overhead

No platform in the set cut its overhead share by more than 1.1 points while it scaled, against the 2.5-point fall from LTM April 2026 to 2030 in the sponsor's acquisition case; overhead levels are not compared across platforms (Part 07 section E).

07 G Sensitivities and requests: supporting evidence

Each business sensitivity in Exhibit 7.14 is set against a range observed in Part 07 or at peers, with the alternative parameter the section uses kept beside it. At the audited deal-cost rate, the model's 2027 acquisition spend would carry $21.7m of deal cost against $6.7m budgeted; if the affiliate bonuses ended, FY2025 cash EBITDA would have been about $15.5m rather than $8.3m; and holding the fall in overhead share to the largest

observed at any platform would add $9.1m a year to the 2030 plan's beachhead plus corporate G&A. The sensitivities of the proposed financing are in Part 08 section D and Part 08 section E.

Five sets of the requests in Part 07 section G would most change a reading. Request 1, the Accounting Firm 1 QoE, is the file without which the underwriting-EBITDA half of ST3 cannot move. Request 2, the affiliate transaction-bonus agreements and whether they end after close, decides the cash half of ST3: the bonuses are the whole difference between Deal C's 28.5–31.2% deal-cost rate and the peer range. Request 6, August–September 2026 same-store sales and same-store clinic EBITDA on the common definition, would show whether the 2026 fall behind ST1 continues. Requests 8 and 9 (a clinic rent roll and FY2025 rebate dollars) would allow a pre-rebate, cash-rent placement of the clinic margin (ST1), and request 10 (the basis of each buy-down multiple, with seller P&Ls that show rent on owned property) would test ST2. Requests that bear on the proposed financing are read with it in Part 08 section D.

O · Financing detail

Each financing observation of Part 08 rests on the ladders, cash paths, refinancing tests and term documents set out here; Deal A's analysis on the 21 September term sheet and Ares Credit Group's model v24 is kept in full beside the recapitalisation model of 29 September that replaced it.

This section holds the secondary evidence behind Part 08: the full scope note, the leverage ladders on every rung, the cash paths, the refinancing tests, the collateral analysis, the sale path and the public filings, deal by deal. Each section of Part 08 opens on its finding, its charts and at most one table, and links here.

o8 A Scope and readings: supporting evidence

Part 08 holds CreditSwan's observations on the three proposed financings, Deal A, Deal B and Deal C, for Ares Credit Group's own underwriting; the financing judgement is Ares Credit Group's. The observations are limited to which EBITDA and debt perimeter each stated multiple uses, how the same debt reads on the audited rungs, and the sensitivities as computed. The full ladders, cash paths and grids are in this section, under the headings of Part 08 section B, Part 08 section C and Part 08 section D, with Deal A's current analysis, on the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026, in Part 08 section B itself; Part 08 section E brings the financing sensitivities of the three deals into one register. Part 08 section F reads the observations on the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) for Deal A against the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026. Where a first-lien multiple is set against 2025–26 prints on the same rung (first-lien funded debt, gross, over underwriting EBITDA, E5), the set is four prints: Operator 7 2.25x and Operator 3 4.70x (proposals, P), Operator 6 3.81x (closed in July 2026, PF) and Operator 4 5.10x (March 2026, on Lender 1's E5, PF), 2.25–5.10x in all [F/I, OP7-1181; OP3-1326; OP6-0031; OP4-1442]. Deal B and Deal A are read against all four; for Deal C the text names the three prints from 3.81x up (Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4, 3.81–5.10x), beside which Operator 7 proposal sits below and changes no comparison.

Our reading on the evidence supplied to date. The labels use the rubric of Part 01 section B; each is paired with what holds, what does not and what would change it, and none is a recommendation on quantum, pricing or structure.

Deal A (M5 · low-leverage financing is resilient). Ares Credit Group's 1.9x is first-lien debt over underwriting EBITDA of $71.7m (LTM September 2026 including a forecast quarter, P); its 3.9x adds long-term finance leases only (4.36x with all $187.4m) [A/I, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, Cap Table Output]. On FY26 audited reported EBITDA the same balance sheet reads 0.62x first lien, 3.07x with finance leases, 3.90x with operating rent capitalised at six times (over EBITDA plus rent) and 5.30x with supplier finance added (4.98x on the company model's balance); ex-gains, 0.81x, 3.89x, 4.50x and 6.35x [I, FY26 10-K; Exhibit 9.152]. Fixed-charge cover (proxy) is 0.77x for FY26 and 0.51x ex-gains; Ares Credit Group's model does not charge finance-lease interest to cash ($28.4m through FY31), and including it moves cover at close from 1.06x to about 0.93x [F/I, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT D30, D171]. Minimum quarter-average liquidity is $36.6m against the $21.5m covenant when the delayed-draw loan is drawn as supplier-finance payments fall due, and $22.3m when it is drawn only as cash runs short; in the lead case the covenant is first breached at a 6.6% earnings shortfall (CreditSwan's monthly model of the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) on Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24; a daily-average test cannot be certified, so these indicate direction) [I, C-FIN-1, C-FIN-2]. On the same model's paths, at the observed 4.3x closed first-lien median, with $112.2m of finance leases at maturity counted inside the multiple and EBITDA held flat, the base refinancing need of $253.0m is covered by $30.5m on LTM reported EBITDA and $5.8m on company EBITDA, and short by $10.8m on FY26 reported EBITDA and $62.8m ex-gains; at the 3.81x floor every rung falls short; under the downside cash path, capacity on a 1.08x cover test is short by $142–177m at observed spreads [I, C-FIN-3; Exhibit 9.158].

Deal B (MS6 · low leverage, pricing and upside compensate). The $55m term loan reads 4.08x on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m, 4.91x with the seller note, other debt and equipment leases, and 7.59x with the $36.9m HoldCo note, which accretes at 15% PIK to June 2030 and stands at about $73.3m in December 2030 in Ares Credit Group's model [I, Financing Model (Jul-26 RF), Summary G38; Ares Credit Group model vRF_09, Model Output J67]. On the borrower's $14.77m (P) the same rungs read 3.28x, 3.71x and 5.99x, and on post-audit adjusted EBITDA of $8.51m 5.58x, 6.55x and 10.43x;

fixed-charge cover is 0.93x, 1.00x and 0.61x on $14.77m, the post-audit pro forma and Ares Credit Group's $11.16m [I, Financing Model, ISCF and Debt tabs]. S+5.55% equals the widest core spread in the 2025–26 set; the warrants are worth about $0.4–2.1m [F/I, Proposed Financing Grid (8.20.26) Ares Credit Group Response; Ares Credit Group model vRF_09, Cap Table F29:F30]. The near-term batch needs $47.5m against the $26m DDTL, leaving $8.8–11.8m unfunded after the revolver on either model's closing cash ($5.03m or $2.46m) [I, C-FIN-5].

Deal C (ST4 · 5.3x leverage is supportable). Option Two's $204.3m first lien reads 5.96x gross on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m (P, including $9.2m of pre-acquisition and LOI earnings), 5.19x net on the sponsor's $32.3m, 7.24x gross on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back ($24.9m) and 20.0x gross on the $8.6m cash EBITDA after recurring deal costs; Option One's $176.0m reads 5.30x gross, and 5.76x net including the $21m sponsor instrument, whose terms are not in the files [I/U, Internal Diligence Exhibits pp.2–3]. Both options sit above every 2025–26 print on the same rung: the Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4 prints run 3.81–5.10x, and Operator 7 2.25x proposal sits below them [I, Exhibit 8.14]. Option Two covers fixed charges 0.77x on $24.9m and 0.96x on $29.4m, with cash breakeven EBITDA of $26.0m; Option One 1.00x and 1.23x [I, Early Read v19 slide 18 inputs]. As computed on a no-acquisition path, Option Two refinances at 4.3x only with EBITDA growth of at least 1.57% a year on $29.4m, against same-store clinic EBITDA of +1.0% (2025) and −5.8% (LTM July 2026); Option One's senior tranche clears on flat $29.4m, a result that reverses with a 17% cash coupon on the sponsor instrument [I, Exhibit 9.165 and Exhibit 9.166]. The existing $133.9m is 24.9x FY2025 reported EBITDA [I, 2025 Audit p.5, Notes 7–8].

The same debt reads very differently by rung. Deal A is 0.62× on first-lien debt over audited E1, 3.0× with finance leases, 4.0× with six times operating rent added, 5.4× with supplier finance added and 6.2× once disposal gains leave E1; Deal B is 4.1× first lien and 7.6× through the HoldCo on Ares Credit Group's adjusted EBITDA, and 10.4× through the HoldCo on post-audit adjusted EBITDA; Deal C is 5.3× net on the sponsor's pro forma figure and 14.7× net (14.4× gross) on the EBITDA Ares Credit Group says it "actually generated". The same holds at the three platforms where the files allow the comparison (Operator 4, Operator 8 and Operator 6, March to July 2026): the same first-lien debt reads 4.5× credit-agreement EBITDA and 19.9× cash EBITDA at Operator 4, 5.4× credit-agreement and 10.4× adjusted EBITDA at Operator 8, and 3.8× stated against 7.5× consolidated at Operator 6 [Exhibit 9.75]. The readings differ in which EBITDA and which debt perimeter they use; Part 08 section B, Part 08 section C and Part 08 section D set each covenant or underwriting EBITDA beside the audited rungs.

Liquidity or funding is tested before leverage at Deal A and Deal B. At Deal A, on CreditSwan's monthly model of the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) on Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24, the cash path reaches the liquidity covenant before the leverage covenant: in the lead case a 6.6% earnings shortfall breaches liquidity and 46% breaches leverage [I, C-FIN-2; Exhibit 9.168]. At Deal B the first constraint is funding: the near-term acquisition batch is $8.6–12m short of committed sources [I, C-FIN-5]. At Deal C the first constraints are cash cover (0.77x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back) and the earnings growth the refinancing needs (at least 1.57% a year) (Part 08 section D). The inputs that drive these paths — closure benefit, closure cash and the delayed-draw timing at Deal A, the acquisition batch and its cash at Deal B, deal costs and organic growth at Deal C — have observed ranges, set out in the sensitivity tables of each deal.

08 B Deal A financing: supporting evidence

The proposed sale-leaseback sites

The site-by-site view behind the sale-leaseback paragraph of Part 08 section B: each of the 26 sites' FY26 site EBITDA against its proposed year-one rent [M, Project Charlie I-Chart, DLA-029].

Exhibit 9.151 — Of the 26 sites in the proposed sale-leaseback, 14 lost money at site level in FY26 and 14 would cover year-one rent less than once; the portfolio covers $3.44m of rent 1.23x on $4.69m of site EBITDA, and Real Estate Advisor 1 values it at $44.4–46.9m

Site EBITDA FY26 ÷ proposed year-one rent, x, for each of the 26 sites, highest to lowest; colour by FY26 site profit or loss

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Project Charlie I-Chart (DLA-029), site table (year-one rent, FY26 site profit/loss, site EBITDA, rent coverage); Real Estate Advisor 1 base case valuation range on the same page · Basis: Company proposal [M] with figures as printed [F]; counts [I]. Hollow: cover on the proposed rent (pro forma). 20-year NNN lease, 2.2% annual rent increases. Not in the recapitalisation model v06

The analysis on the 21 September term sheet and Ares Credit Group's model v24

On CreditSwan's monthly model of the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026), run on management's plan as Ares Credit Group's model v24 carries it, minimum quarter-average liquidity is $36.6m against the $21.5m covenant, in the March 2028 quarter, when the delayed-draw loan is drawn as the supplier-finance payments fall due and the company's closure cash of $21.79m is paid over the remaining lease terms [I, C-FIN-1]. That figure rests on two readings. If the loan is drawn only when cash runs short, the minimum is $22.3m; if the closure cash is paid inside four quarters, it is $21.0m,

below the covenant. In the lead case the covenant is first breached at an earnings shortfall of 7.4% [I, C-FIN-2]. Ares Credit Group's model leaves $28.4m of finance-lease interest out of cash through FY31, $4.3m to $8.0m a year, and books $4.3m of closure cash and $4.3m of fees against the $21.79m of cash in the company's workbook [F, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!D30, D171, F20:I20, F21; Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J43]. "Low leverage" describes one rung: first-lien debt is 0.62x FY26 audited E1 (below Operator 9 and Operator 4 on the same rung), but lease-adjusted leverage including supplier finance is 5.30x (6.35x once $16.0m of disposal gains are removed), and the fixed-charge cover proxy computes at 0.77x (0.51x ex-gains); on these figures the pressure sits in the claims below E1 rather than in the headline multiple. On the same model, at maturity in September 2030, on the 4.3x median of closed first-lien deals and with today's EBITDA held flat, the base refinancing need of $253.0m is covered on reported LTM EBITDA (+$31m) and on company EBITDA (+$5.9m), and not on FY26 reported EBITDA (−$12m) or without disposal gains (−$64m); the downside need of $336.7m is not covered on cash flow at any observed spread [I, C-FIN-3]. On these figures liquidity is tested long before leverage during the life of the loan, the result at maturity depends on the EBITDA rung a lender sizes on, and a sale inside the twelve-month window is the path on which neither is reached [I].

The proposed structure

Ares Credit Group's hypothesis is that Deal A's underperformance is concentrated in a closeable tail of clinics, that a second round of 119 closures adds about $12m of run-rate EBITDA, and that the remaining platform's scale and diversification support an attractive senior secured investment at low leverage. The LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) provides a $336m facility: a $111m super-senior revolver ($44m drawn and deemed borrowed at all times; revolver drawings capped at $67m while the DDTL is available), a $111m term loan and a $111m delayed-draw term loan available for 15 months solely to unwind supply-chain financing, subject to a 5.15x lease-adjusted net leverage draw test. Pricing is S+5.26% on the term facilities and S+3.26% on the revolver with a 21bp grid; maintenance covenants are a lease-adjusted net leverage ratio stepping from 6.35x to 5.81x and $21.5m of minimum average-daily liquidity tested quarterly; the ECF sweep is 67% [F, DLA-023 (LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026)), Credit Facilities, Interest, Financial Covenants]. Ares Credit Group's model books financing EBITDA of $71.7m (LTM September 2026 including a forecast quarter; E5, basis P), bank debt of $152m at close (1.9x, which is LV1 gross on E5) and $305m including long-term finance leases only (3.9x, LV3 gross on E5 with the $32.3m current portion left out) [F, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24 'Ares Credit Group Assumptions' B20, C40:F40; DLA-5672, DLA-5673]. Exhibit 9.152 places each of these prints on the leverage ladder beside the audited rungs.

Leverage on each rung

Leverage on every rung. "Low leverage" describes the first-lien rung; the rungs that count finance leases and supplier finance read higher. Exhibit 9.152 places the audited FY26 and LTM June 2026 rungs, Ares Credit Group's prints and the proposed covenant construction on one ladder, each with its numerator and denominator.

Exhibit 9.152 — Deal A's leverage ladder: 0.62–1.36x on first-lien debt (FY26 and LTM June 2026) and 3.90–6.35x once rent and supplier finance are counted (FY26)

Debt ÷ EBITDA by leverage rung and EBITDA denominator, x; FY26, LTM June 2026, and the proposed structure at close (LTM September 2026)

DENOMINATOR (RUNG, PERIOD, BASIS)	LV1 GROSS	LV3 GROSS	LV5_6X	LV6 (SCF $197.6M 10-K / $151.8M DLA-016)	FACT ROWS AND SOURCES
D3 E1 FY26 $71.2m (A)	0.62x	3.07x	3.90x	5.30x / 4.98x	DLA-0472, DLA-0473, A8-P5-068, A8-P5-071, A8-P5-100
E1 ex-gains FY26 $56.4m (A)	0.81x	3.89x	4.50x	6.35x / 5.99x	A8-P5-076, A8-P5-078, A8-P5-080, A8-P5-083, A8-P5-101
D3 E1 LTM Jun-26 $81.1m (A)	1.03x	3.10x	n/a	n/a	A8-P5-092, A8-P5-094
E1 ex-gains LTM Jun-26 $59.6m (A)	1.36x	4.21x	n/a	n/a	A8-P5-096, A8-P5-098
E2m LTM Jun-26 $74.9m (PF)	1.08x	3.35x [I]	n/a	5.22x on EBITDAR_CD with $151.8m SCF	DLA-5864; [I] (94.1 + 196.6) ÷ 74.9; DLA-5870
Ares Credit Group E5 LTM Sep-26 $71.7m (P), at close	1.95x ("1.9x")	3.82x ("3.9x"; long-term finance leases only); 4.36x with all $187.4m [I]	—	—	DLA-5672, DLA-5673

DENOMINATOR (RUNG, PERIOD, BASIS)	LV1 GROSS	LV3 GROSS	LV5_6X	LV6 (SCF $197.6M 10-K / $151.8M DLA-016)	FACT ROWS AND SOURCES
Proposed covenant, reading (a): (debt + all finance leases − cash + 6 × $41.4m operating rent) ÷ (E5 + $41.4m), net, at close (P)	—	—	3.87x (net, LV5-type; 5.42x with the SCF as debt)	—	DLA-023 (LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026)), Financial Covenants; inputs from DLA-024 (Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24) [I]
Company existing-agreement EBITDAR $113.3m incl. $17.4m disposal gains (P)	—	—	Ares Credit Group "rent-adjusted" 4.64x counts finance leases twice; Ares Credit Group v24 covenant line 4.46x (FQ3'27, net, capped cash); reading (a) 3.81x, and 4.47x if the $17.4m of gains is excluded	—	DLA-5669; DLA-024 MODEL OUTPUT row 54; DLA-023, Financial Covenants

Source: note C-81 (FY2026, FY2026 ex-gains, LTM Jun-26 rows); Exhibit 9.76; fact rows as listed; DLA-023 (LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026)), Financial Covenants, for the covenant constructions. LV1 = bank and mortgage debt; LV3 adds finance leases and financing obligations ($194.3m FY26, DLA-0471; $196.6m Jun-26, A8-P5-089); LV5_6X adds 6 × operating-lease cash payments over E1 + rent; LV6 adds supplier finance. LTM LV5/LV6 on E1 are not computable because the 10-Q omits quarterly operating-lease cash payments [note C-81]. Charted in Exhibit 9.154 · Basis: Audited rungs A; company EBITDA PF; Ares Credit Group's EBITDA and covenant constructions P

Two peer comparisons are valid for Deal A's leverage, and on both Deal A is less levered. LV1 gross over audited E1 is 0.62x in FY26 against Operator 9 6.32x (FY25) and Operator 4 8.60x (FY24), and LV3 at 3.07x is also below that range; the peers carry operating rent inside E1 while Deal A's finance-lease cost sits below it, so LV3 is the more conservative reading of the pair [F/I, DLA-0472, DLA-0473, OP4-1464, OP4-1394]. On underwriting EBITDA, Ares Credit Group's 1.95x LV1 on E5 (P) is below every print in the 2025–26 same-rung set of Part 08 section A (2.25–5.10x; the lowest is Operator 7 2.25x proposal, P) [F/I, DLA-5672, OP7-1181, OP3-1326, OP6-0031, OP4-1442]. Deal A's leverage is not compared with the closed first-lien band of 4.31–4.27x, which is on E4/E5 financing EBITDA of platforms with few finance leases, and no peer in the files carries supplier finance on its ladder, so LV5 and LV6 have no peer counterpart; the band is used only as the refinancing anchor later in this section [I, Part 04 section B; note C-73]. On these figures the pressure sits not in the multiple but in the claims below E1 and the cash left after them. Deal A's FCCR proxy, (E1 − total capex − cash tax) ÷ (interest paid + finance-lease principal), fell from 1.73x in FY24 to 1.13x in FY25 and 0.77x in FY26, and is 0.51x on E1 ex-gains [I, A8-P5-073, A8-P5-085]. In cash, operating cash flow less capex and finance-lease principal was $0.1m in FY2026, after a $35.8m working-capital release, and −$24.3m for the twelve months to June 2026 [F/I, FY26 10-K; Q1 FY27 10-Q; A6-P5-007]. No peer coverage print is on that proxy definition (the nine core prints mix compliance-certificate, lender-model and company FCCR on maintenance or total capex), so Deal A's cover is not placed against them; their 0.7–1.6x spread is used only to bound the cover assumption in the refinancing test [I, note C-80; Exhibit 9.78]. The existing credit agreement caps gross lease-adjusted leverage at 4.05x on its own construction, which is not D4 LV5 [F, DLA-3475].

Exhibit 9.153 sets Deal A's first-lien leverage on audited E1 against the two peers with audited E1 on the same rung, Operator 4 and Operator 9; Exhibit 9.119 (Part 09 section L) sets out why they are Deal A's comparators.

Exhibit 9.153 — On first-lien debt over audited reported EBITDA Deal A (0.62x, FY26) is below Operator 9 (6.32x, FY25) and Operator 4 (8.60x, FY24), and stays below on the lease-consistent reading (1.62x)

LV1 gross ÷ D3 E1, x, with Deal A's LV3 and lease-consistent readings; FY24 to FY26, actual

METRIC (DEFINITION; BASIS; CLINIC BASE / RENT OR CLOSURE CODE; PERIOD)	COMPARATORS AND VALUES (FACT ROWS)	RANGE	DEAL A (FACT ROWS)	POSITION
LV1 gross ÷ E1 (D4-LV1; A; SOFT24-26)	Operator 9 FY25 6.32x (OP4-1464; Operator 9's LV1 includes real-estate loans); Operator 4 FY24 8.60x (OP4-1394)	6.32 – 8.60 x	FY26 0.62x (DLA-0472); LV3 3.07x (DLA-0473); on the lease-consistent E1 of Exhibit 9.120, note [1] ($29.1m): LV1 1.62x [I], 3.76x on E1 ex-gains after finance-lease cash cost ($12.5m) [I]	Below on every reading (LV1 as reported, LV3, and LV1 on lease-consistent E1); Exhibit 9.152 gives the full ladder

Source: DLA-0472; DLA-0473; OP4-1464; OP4-1394; Exhibit 9.120 · Basis: A; lease-consistent readings [I]

On the lease-consistent E1 of Exhibit 9.120, note [1] ($29.1m), LV1 is $51.7m ÷ $29.1m = 1.62x, still below both peers [I].

Exhibit 9.154 — The headline 1.9x is a first-lien rung on forecast EBITDA; on audited FY26 E1, leverage with finance leases, rent and supplier finance reaches 5.4x (6.2x ex-gains)

Debt ÷ EBITDA by leverage rung on each EBITDA denominator, x; FY26, LTM June 2026 and the proposed structure at close (LTM September 2026)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Deal A FY26 10-K and Q1 FY27 10-Q; Deal A 5-Year Financial Model for Financing Banks (4 August 2026); Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24; LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026); Ares Credit Group Diligence & Structure Update; peer financing documents supplied by Ares Credit Group. Rows DLA-0472; DLA-0473; A8-P5-068; A8-P5-071; A8-P5-100; A8-P5-076; A8-P5-078; A8-P5-080; A8-P5-083; A8-P5-101; A8-P5-092; A8-P5-094; A8-P5-096; A8-P5-098; DLA-5864; A8-P5-089; DLA-5870; DLA-5672; DLA-5673; DLA-5669; DLA-5742; OP6-0031; OP1-7357; OP1-7584; OP1-7585; OP1-7795; OP2-0250; P5-S001; OP4-1464; OP4-1394; DLA-3475 · Basis: Same debt over each EBITDA denominator, gross unless stated; LV5 is over EBITDA plus rent. Rows on audited FY26 EBITDA and on reported LTM June 2026 EBITDA (which includes the unaudited June 2026 quarter) are actual (filled), company non-GAAP EBITDA is pro forma (hollow), Ares Credit Group's forecast EBITDA and the covenant constructions are projected (hatched, dashed row). The covenant constructions are the term sheet's own definition, not LV5; Ares Credit Group's rent-adjusted 4.64x counts finance leases twice. LTM LV5 and LV6 on audited EBITDA cannot be computed because the 10-Q omits quarterly operating-lease cash payments. The band is closed first-lien prints of peers on adjusted financing EBITDA (platforms with few finance leases); the existing-agreement cap is on that agreement's own definition

Covenants, liquidity and cash

On the proposed terms the liquidity covenant, not the leverage covenant, is the test with the least headroom. The leverage covenant is computed on an EBITDAR-consistent Consolidated EBITDA (the term sheet defines it "in a manner consistent with the definition of 'EBITDAR' in the Existing Credit Agreement") with finance leases and six times operating lease expense in the numerator; on that construction, which Ares Credit Group's own model also uses (MODEL OUTPUT rows 52–46, 4.46x at the first quarterly test), CreditSwan's monthly model puts the ratio's peak at 4.53x (March 2027 quarter, against 6.35x) in the lead case; the smallest headroom to the covenant schedule is 1.8–1.9 turns in the six cases on Ares Credit Group's operating plan, 1.6 turns with half the closure benefit and 0.8 turns with EBITDA 9% lower and no closure benefit [I, C-FIN-1, C-FIN-2]. The company's existing-agreement EBITDAR includes $17.4m of LTM disposal gains; if the term sheet's clause (d) excludes them, the closing ratio on reading (a) is 4.47x rather than 3.81x on the company's own EBITDAR, which still leaves headroom [F/I, DLA-024 'FY27-FY31 P&L'!E187:H187; DLA-023, Financial Covenants].

Liquidity turns on how the delayed-draw loan is drawn and on when the closure cash is paid. Every liquidity figure in this section comes from one model: CreditSwan's monthly path of the proposed facilities, run on the operating lines of Ares Credit Group's model v24, with finance-lease interest charged to cash [I, C-FIN-1]. The term sheet limits the loan's proceeds to the supplier-finance unwind and lets revolver loans fund that unwind only "to the extent the Delayed Draw Term Loan Facility is otherwise unavailable" [F, LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026), Use of Proceeds]. We therefore take as the base rule that the loan is drawn as each supplier-finance payment falls due. On that rule the $111m is fully drawn by April 2027, the $67m cap on revolver loans falls away, and liquidity declines from $110m at close to $38m in September 2027 as $177.7m of supplier finance is paid [F/I, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!D32:H32; C-FIN-1].

Exhibit 9.155 — Lead-case minimum liquidity is $36.6m against the $21.5m covenant (March 2028 quarter); on the other draw rule it is $22.3–22.2m, and with closure cash paid inside four quarters $21.0–21.7m, below the covenant

Minimum quarter-average liquidity, $m, and the quarter it falls in, October 2026 to September 2030; management plan as in Ares Credit Group model v24; covenant $21.5m of average daily Liquidity

CLOSURE CASH	LOAN DRAWN AS SUPPLIER-FINANCE PAYMENTS FALL DUE	LOAN DRAWN ONLY WHEN CASH IS SHORT	EARNINGS SHORTFALL AT WHICH THE COVENANT IS FIRST BREACHED: FIRST RULE / SECOND RULE
Ares Credit Group's model: $4.3m, April 2027 to March 2028	$39.6m, March 2028 quarter	$22.2m, December 2027 quarter	9.0% / 2.9%
Company workbook: $21.79m spread over the average remaining lease term (42.1 months from April 2027) — lead case	**$36.6m, March 2028 quarter**	$22.3m, December 2027 quarter	6.6% / 2.0%
Company workbook: $21.79m inside four quarters (April 2027 to March 2028)	$21.0m, June 2028 quarter (below the covenant)	$21.7m, September 2027 quarter (below the covenant)	Breached with no shortfall
Lead case with half the closure benefit ($5.9m a year)	$25.5m, June 2029 quarter		
Lead case with EBITDA 9% below Ares Credit Group's model and no closure benefit	Below $21.5m from the December 2027 quarter; cash exhausted in October 2028		

Source: CreditSwan monthly model of the proposed facilities (C-FIN-1, C-FIN-2); Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT rows 13 to 28, 38, 103, 152; LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026), Credit Facilities, Use of Proceeds, Financial Covenants; Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J33, J43 · Basis: P (projection on management's plan); monthly points, quarter average by daily

interpolation between month-ends · Assumption: Every case carries $4.3m of professional fees, $25.5m of letters of credit, finance-lease interest charged to cash and the $7.4m December 2026 dividend. The shortfall is a uniform reduction of EBITDA in every period

In the lead case, with the company's $21.79m of closure cash spread evenly over the workbook's average remaining lease term, the minimum is $36.6m in the March 2028 quarter, $15.9m above the covenant. The quarter average then stays between $38m and $38m until March 2029: on Ares Credit Group's plan the business generates almost no cash after interest, lease payments and closure cost before FY2030 [I, C-FIN-1]. On Ares Credit Group's own closure figure the minimum is $39.6m, so the amount of closure cash matters little. Its timing matters more: the same $21.79m paid inside four quarters gives $21.0m, below the covenant in the June 2028 quarter. Against Ares Credit Group's figure, the workbook's closure cash lowers minimum liquidity by about $1m when it is paid over the lease terms and by about $17m when it is paid inside four quarters (Exhibit 9.155).

The second rule is the alternative reading: the company holds the loan back and draws it only when cash would fall below $13m. On the first two timings of closure cash, $2.2m to $2.4m of the commitment is still undrawn when the availability period ends in December 2027, the $67m cap applies throughout, and the minimum is $22.2m and $22.3m. With the closure cash inside four quarters the loan is fully drawn only in September 2027, and the minimum is $21.7m. While the cap applies, revolver loans can rise by at most $21.5m above the $44m deemed borrowed, which is the same amount as the covenant minimum [F/I, LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026), Revolving Credit Facility (ii), (iii)]. Which rule the term sheet intends turns on its wording (the clause "if Delayed Draw Term Loans may be drawn"); it is worth $15m of headroom.

Three further cases bound the lead case. In the lead case the covenant is first breached at an earnings shortfall of 7.4% in every period (9.0% on Ares Credit Group's closure figure), in the June 2029 quarter; if the loan is drawn only when cash is short, at 2.0%; the leverage covenant would need a shortfall of 46% [I, C-FIN-2]. With half the closure benefit the minimum is $25.5m, in the June 2029 quarter. With EBITDA 9% below Ares Credit Group's model in every period and no closure benefit, liquidity is below $21.5m from the December 2027 quarter and cash is exhausted in October 2028 [I, C-FIN-1]. A monthly model cannot certify a test on each business day; these results indicate direction and order of magnitude. Exhibit 9.168 (later in this section) sets the inputs against the ranges observed in the evidence.

Exhibit 9.156 — Minimum liquidity against the $21.5m covenant: $36.6m with the loan drawn as supplier finance falls due (March 2028 quarter), about $23m if drawn only when short, below $21m with closure cash paid within four quarters

Minimum quarter-average liquidity, $m, by draw rule and by amount and timing of closure cash; October 2026 to September 2030; management plan as in Ares Credit Group model v24

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: CreditSwan monthly model of the proposed facilities (computation note C-FIN-1) on Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT rows 13 to 28, 38, 103 and 152; LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026); Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J33, J43 · Basis: P (projection on management plan); monthly points, quarter average by daily interpolation · Assumption: Every case: $4.3m of professional fees, letters of credit $25.5m, finance-lease interest charged to cash, $7.4m dividend in December 2026. A monthly model indicates direction; the covenant is tested on each business day

Exhibit 9.157 — In the lead case liquidity holds at $38–38m from December 2027 to March 2029 and rebuilds from FY2030; with EBITDA 9% lower and no closure benefit it is below $21m from the December 2027 quarter

Quarter-average liquidity, $m, by quarter, December 2026 to September 2030; four cases against the $21.5m covenant; LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) and Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: CreditSwan monthly model of the proposed facilities (computation note C-FIN-1) on Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT rows 13 to 28, 38, 103 and 152; LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026); Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J33, J43 · Basis: P; monthly points, quarter average by daily interpolation · Assumption: Lead case: loan drawn as supplier-finance payments fall due; workbook closure cash of $21.79m spread evenly over 42.1 months plus $4.3m of fees. Negative values are the unfunded gap once the revolver is at its limit

Exhibit 9.157 shows how long the low lasts. In the lead case the quarter average holds at $38m to $38m for six quarters, December 2027 to March 2029, and rebuilds only from FY2030; with EBITDA 9% below Ares Credit Group's model and no closure benefit it is below $21.5m from the December 2027 quarter [I, C-FIN-1]. For Ares Credit Group the exposure is the length of that trough as much as its depth: an earnings shortfall in those quarters meets no cash build. The path is built from month-end points and cannot show balances inside a month, on which the covenant is tested.

Finance-lease interest in Ares Credit Group's model. The Ares Credit Group model's "Total Finance Lease Cost" line (MODEL OUTPUT row 171) is drawn from the bank model's cash-flow line for finance-lease payments, which is principal only (the bank model's balance-sheet roll-forward

accretes interest and deducts total rent; its cash-flow line is the difference). The model's amortisation line (row 30) then subtracts finance-lease interest from that principal figure, so the interest component of finance-lease rent — $2.0m in Q3 FY27 and $28.4m cumulatively through FY31 — is not charged to cash [F, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24 MODEL OUTPUT!D30 `=+D171-D22`, D171 `='FY27 CF - Monthly'!$0$27/1000`; bank model 'FY27 BS - Monthly' rows 57–54, 'FY27 CF - Monthly' row 31]. Ares Credit Group's FCCR of 1.23x at close excludes the same item; including it gives about 0.93x, below the 1.03x dividend gate. CreditSwan's monthly path charges both components; the closure workbook's $9.63m of finance-lease interest on the 51 finance-lease clinics is part of that line, so it is not added again as closure cost [I, C-FIN-4]. Ares Credit Group's FCF line of $16.0m, $23.2m and $31.5m in FY29–FY31 is 0.14–0.22 of its LTM Adj. EBITDA including the $12m closure add-back, before the finance-lease interest adjustment above [A/I, DLA-5820..5822].

Other terms that matter. The restricted-payments basket permits $7.4m in the quarter to December 2026 and $9.3m per quarter thereafter subject to leverage at or below 3.38x, FCCR at or above 1.03x and $21m of liquidity [F, term sheet Negative Covenants]; Deal A's run-rate dividend is about $31m a year [F, bank model 'Ares Credit Group CF Summary' row 32; DLA-2835], and on our monthly path the lease-adjusted ratio stays at or above 3.38x until the final quarter (3.47x at June 2030, 3.32x at September 2030), so the quarterly basket opens late in the loan, if at all [I, C-FIN-1]. Closing cash of $87.7m depends on a projected $26m increase in supply-chain payables in August–September 2026 (accounts payable $250m at June → $278m at September; long-term debt $92m → $62m), which corresponds to drawing the largely unused Lender 6/Animal Health Manufacturer 3 line and for which the files contain no explanation [F, bank model 'FY27 BS - Monthly' rows 26, 28; SCF aging: platform $176.7m, funder limits $200.9m with $137.1m utilised, $122.6m aged over 107 days; DLA-2170]. The amount to be unwound is $140m, $177m or $184m depending on scope, against a supplier-finance balance of $197.6m in the FY26 10-K, $183.9m in the Q1 FY27 10-Q and $151.8m in the company model, and the DDTL's 107-day eligibility language bears directly on the balances already aged beyond 107 days [F/U, DLA_SCF FY2026; A8-P5-091; DLA-2969, DLA-2981]. The balance chosen moves FY26 LV6 between 4.98x and 5.30x on E1, and between 5.99x and 6.35x ex-gains [I, A8-P5-100, A8-P5-071, A8-P5-101, A8-P5-083].

Repayment, refinancing and recovery

At maturity in September 2030 the question is whether the bank debt then outstanding could be refinanced on the multiples and spreads observed for comparable operators. Need and capacity are taken from the same monthly path [I, C-FIN-3]. On the base path (the lead case) bank debt is $253.0m (term loans $200.4m, revolver loans $47.1m) with cash at the $13m reserve, so the need is $253.0m, and cash flow available for debt service is $42.4m after capex, taxes, working capital, closure cash and both components of finance-lease cash. On the downside path (EBITDA 9% below Ares Credit Group's model in every period and no closure benefit) bank debt is $290.4m, the revolver is at its limit and cash is $28.0m negative; with the $13m reserve restored the need is $336.7m, and cash flow available for debt service is $21.6m. The downside's EBITDA at maturity is $93.3m, which is still 19.6% above today's LTM company EBITDA of $74.9m, because it is 9% below a plan that grows 9% to 9% a year [I, DLA-5864 note; Exhibit 9.118].

Both legs of capacity are anchored on observed ranges. The leverage anchor is the closed first-lien band: the 8 gross prints among the ten closed first-lien events of Part 04 section B, from 3 platforms (Operator 1 5, Operator 2 2, Operator 6 1; the two Operator 1 events of 2023 and 2025 print net only and are left out), on adjusted financing EBITDA, 3.81x to 4.27x except Operator 2's 2021 buyout at 5.97x, with a median of about 4.3x [F/I, OP6-0031, OP1-7357, P5-S001; Exhibit 4.09]. Deal A's $112.2m of finance leases at maturity are counted inside the multiple, and a 2% fee is deducted. Applying a band formed on adjusted financing EBITDA to Deal A's reported EBITDA is a conservative reading, since a lender at maturity would be expected to size on an adjusted rung [I]. The coverage anchor is cash flow available for debt service over 1.08x the all-in rate, at the 2026 spreads of S+383 to S+534 on SOFR of 4.10% [F, OP2-4336, OP7-1164, DLA-5593, A8-S012; Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!L118]. Exhibit 9.158 shows (a) the downside need against the downside's own EBITDA and cash flow, (b) the base need against each actual EBITDA rung held flat, and © the downside need against the actual rungs, which pairs a need and a capacity from different scenarios and is shown for completeness.

Exhibit 9.158 — At September 2030 the $253.0m base need is covered at 4.27x on flat reported LTM EBITDA, not FY26 or ex-gains EBITDA; the $336.7m downside need is not covered on cash flow at any observed spread

Refinancing capacity at maturity (September 2030) on observed anchors, by pairing of need and capacity, $m; LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) and Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24

PAIRING	LEG AND ANCHOR	EBITDA RUNG OR CASH FLOW	NEED	CAPACITY	GAP (−) / SURPLUS (+)
(a) downside need, downside capacity	Leverage leg at 4.27x (3.81x)	Ares Credit Group-model downside EBITDA $93.3m (P)	336.7	342.6 (275.9)	+3.7 (−57.8)
(a)	Coverage leg at 1.08x, spreads S+383 to S+534 (7.53–9.02% all-in)	Downside cash flow $21.6m	336.7	189.1 to 158.4 (S+528: 167.5)	−142.3 to −168.8 (S+528: −164.8)
(a)	Coverage leg at 1.0x / 1.3x cover, S+528	Downside cash flow $21.6m	336.7	208.0 / 133.9	−125.8 / −202.4

PAIRING	LEG AND ANCHOR	EBITDA RUNG OR CASH FLOW	NEED	CAPACITY	GAP (−) / SURPLUS (+)
(a)	Coverage leg, most and least favourable observed combinations: 1.0x at S+383 / 1.6x at S+534	Downside cash flow $21.6m	336.7	236.7 / 111.4	−92.5 / −216.2
(b) base need, actual EBITDA held flat	Leverage leg at 4.27x (3.81x)	Company EBITDA LTM June 2026 $74.9m (PF)	253.0	256.7 (207.0)	+5.8 (−43.8)
(b)	same	Reported EBITDA LTM June 2026 $81.1m (A)	253.0	276.9 (224.7)	+30.5 (−23.4)
(b)	same	Reported EBITDA FY26 $71.2m (A)	253.0	234.0 (185.6)	−10.8 (−58.9)
(b)	same	Reported EBITDA ex disposal gains LTM June 2026 $59.6m (A)	253.0	183.7 (146.2)	−62.8 (−105.2)
(b)	Coverage leg at 1.08x, S+528	Base cash flow $42.4m	253.0	341.0	+86.9
© downside need, actual EBITDA held flat	Leverage leg at 4.27x (3.81x)	Company EBITDA LTM June 2026 $74.9m (PF)	336.7	256.7 (207.0)	−81.6 (−126.1)
©	same	Reported EBITDA LTM June 2026 $81.1m (A)	336.7	276.9 (224.7)	−53.1 (−111.0)
©	same	Reported EBITDA ex disposal gains LTM June 2026 $59.6m (A)	336.7	183.7 (146.2)	−148.9 (−191.1)
2021 peak multiple	Leverage leg at 5.97x, downside need	Reported LTM $81.1m / ex-gains $59.6m	336.7	430.3 / 302.6	+104.0 / −29.4

Source: Needs, cash flow available for debt service and downside EBITDA from the CreditSwan monthly model (C-FIN-1, C-FIN-3); multiples OP6-0031 (3.81x), OP1-7357 (4.27x), P5-S001 (5.97x), 8 closed gross first-lien prints from 3 platforms; spreads OP2-4336 (S+383), OP7-1164 (S+422), DLA-5593 (S+528), A8-S012 (S+534); SOFR 4.10% from Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!L118; EBITDA rungs DLA-5864, A8-P5-092, DLA-0317, A8-P5-096 · Basis: Need P; actual rungs A and PF, held flat; downside EBITDA P. All results [I] · Assumption: Leverage leg = (multiple × EBITDA − $112.2m of finance leases at maturity) × 0.85. Coverage leg = cash flow available for debt service ÷ (cover × (SOFR + spread)) × 0.85. Need = bank debt less cash above a $13m reserve. Base path = lead case; downside = EBITDA 9% below Ares Credit Group's model in every period, no closure benefit

On the base path, with EBITDA held flat at today's actual rungs, reported LTM EBITDA ($81.1m) covers the $253.0m need at the 4.27x median by $30.5m and company EBITDA ($74.9m) by $5.8m; FY26 reported EBITDA ($71.2m) falls $10.8m short and EBITDA without disposal gains ($59.6m) $62.8m short; at the 3.81x floor every rung falls short, by $23m to $108m. On cash flow the base path is covered: $341.0m of capacity at 1.08x cover and S+528 [I, Exhibit 9.158 pairing (b)]. On the downside path the need of $336.7m is met on the downside's own EBITDA only at the band median (+$3.7m; −$57.8m at the floor), and the coverage leg falls short at every observed spread and cover: by $142m to $177m at 1.08x, and by $90m at 1.0x and S+383 [I, pairing (a)]. Every actual rung falls short of the downside need (pairing ©). On these figures the refinancing reading turns on which cash path Deal A is on and on whether disposal gains are counted: on the base path the debt refinances on reported LTM EBITDA and not on FY26 or ex-gains EBITDA; on the downside path it does not refinance on cash flow [I]. A cash path with EBITDA held flat at the actual rungs would put need and capacity on one scenario; the files do not yet allow it (information requests below) [U].

Exhibit 9.159 — At 4.3x in September 2030, flat reported LTM EBITDA covers the $253.0m base need by $31m; FY26 and ex-gains EBITDA fall $12m and $64m short, and the $336.7m downside need is not covered on cash flow

Refinancing capacity against need at maturity (September 2030), $m, by pairing of need and capacity; leverage leg with Deal A's finance leases at maturity inside the multiple; coverage leg at observed 2026 spreads; LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) and Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Needs and cash flow available for debt service: CreditSwan monthly model (computation notes C-FIN-1, C-FIN-3); multiples: 8 closed first-lien prints from 3 platforms, 3.81x to 4.27x except Operator 2's 5.97x in 2021 (OP6-0031, OP1-7357, P5-S001); spreads OP2-4336, OP7-1164, DLA-5593, A8-S012; SOFR 4.10% from Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24 MODEL OUTPUT!L118; EBITDA rungs DLA-0317, DLA-5864, A8-P5-092, A8-P5-096 · Basis: Need: P. EBITDA rungs: A and PF, held flat; downside EBITDA: P · Assumption: Base path: lead case. Downside: EBITDA 9% below Ares Credit Group model in every period and no closure benefit. Need = bank debt less cash above a $13m reserve. A 2% fee is deducted from capacity

On the files, recovery turns on the real estate. Ares Credit Group's collateral analysis gives net orderly liquidation value of $233.0m — real estate at $154.4m (the company's estimate of fair market value, built on tax-assessed values; no third-party appraisal), inventory $75.6m at 52%, receivables $9.8m, less a $8.6m reserve — against maximum funded debt of $284m (111% LTV); total commitments are $336m, $101.6m above net orderly liquidation value, because the revolver is capped at $67m while the delayed-draw loan is available [F, Diligence & Structure Update p.36; M, Ares Credit Group Diligence Tracker, tab Ares Credit Group, J59]. The revolver is super senior; the term sheet grants a first-priority lien on substantially all assets but contains no mortgage provision and leaves Excluded Assets to be defined [F, term sheet Revolving Credit Facility, Collateral]. Ex-real-estate collateral of $74.9m covers 25.4% of the term loan after $44m of revolver; on the files, term-loan recovery therefore rests largely on perfected real-estate liens, on the value of the 253 owned sites, for which the files hold no third-party appraisal, and on the timing of any sale. The industry evidence does not bear on these collateral figures.

Exhibit 9.160 — Maximum funded debt of $284m exceeds net orderly liquidation value by $58m and total commitments of $336m by $101m (June 2026 collateral, LW draft term sheet of 21 September 2026); without real estate the term loan is 25% covered

Collateral at net orderly liquidation value against the proposed facilities, $m, June 2026 collateral and the terms of the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026)

[Chart not included in this example]

Source: Ares Credit Group Diligence & Structure Update (15 September 2026), collateral analysis; LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026). Rows DLA-3500; DLA-3501; DLA-5581; DLA-5582; DLA-5585; DLA-5587; DLA-5588; DLA-5589 · Basis: Collateral: Ares Credit Group's analysis at June 2026: real estate at $154.4m, the company's estimate of fair market value, built on tax-assessed values; no third-party appraisal (253 sites); inventory at 52%, receivables, less a $8.6m reserve. Facilities: proposed terms (P), not funded debt: revolver $111m ($44m drawn at close, super senior; capped at $67m while the delayed-draw loan is available), term loan $111m, delayed-draw term loan $111m, so commitments total $336m and the most that can be funded is $284m. The chart follows the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026); Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update (15 September 2026) and Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24 carry a $134m revolver and a $86m delayed-draw loan. Collateral excluding real estate is $74.9m, which covers 25.4% of the term loan after the drawn revolver

The sale path and the proposed terms

Ares Credit Group's Diligence & Structure Update (pp. 2–3) states that the sale process has formally been launched and that Ares Credit Group views a sale as a likely outcome [A, Diligence & Structure Update pp2–3]. The term sheet treats a sale three ways. A Permitted Change of Control within twelve months (leverage at or below 4.84x, equity at least 44% of funded debt plus that equity, 0.44% fee) leaves the loan in place under the buyer with a reset call schedule; a non-permitted change of control triggers prepayment at 89 in years one and two and par thereafter; a voluntary refinancing costs 2%/1%/0% [F, term sheet Change of Ownership or Control; Prepayment Premium table]. None sets a floor on proceeds. The permitted change of control requires equity of at least 44% of funded debt plus that equity, so equity at least equal to funded debt; with $152m of bank debt and $187.4m of finance leases at close ($345.3m, counting finance leases as funded debt as the term sheet's Consolidated Funded Indebtedness does), it needs a total enterprise value of about $671.4m (2 × $345.3m), which is 8.7x Ares Credit Group's E5 of $71.7m, 7.9x LTM E2m, 7.4x LTM D3 E1 and 10.0x LTM E1 ex-gains, against a market enterprise value of $544.6m (6.9x E5) on 11 September [F/I, DLA-023; Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, Cap Table Output; DLA-017 p.4]. The observed anchors place that threshold above Deal A's own public range of 6.4–6.7x in 2025–26 (context only: one operator, provider EBITDA definition not stated) and, on the nearest rung (E5 against the E2/E4 PF standalone EBITDA of the regional-chain prints), 0.5 turns below the 8.8–11.2x paid for regional chains (Operator 18 8.8x, Operator 27 10.2x, Regional Chain 1 11.2x; Regional Chain 2 9.4x with synergy treatment not stated); on E1 ex-gains the same price is 10.0x, inside that band, while the 15–15.0x platform prints of 2018–26 sit on more adjusted rungs and are not a reference for Deal A's E1 [A/I, A7-S026..S028, DLA-5677; F/I, DLA-3484, OP1-7607, OP2-3738, OP1-7876, OP1-7608; Exhibit 9.71]. The one precedent for a large, loss-making pharmacy and service chain in the files, Operator 29 to Operator 1 in 2026, priced at 4.5x synergised EBITDA (basis P) with negative standalone EBITDA [A, OP1-11184]. On these figures, any sale at the market value would repay maximum funded debt of $284m with room to spare, so the reading turns on whether and when a sale completes rather than on value [I]. The two cases lead to different outcomes: either a sale that repays or ports the loan within the twelve-month Permitted Change of Control, or a four-year credit in which liquidity is the test with the least headroom, $15m in the lead case and under $1m if the loan is drawn only when cash is short [I, C-FIN-1].

For context on value, Deal A's public multiple fell from 13–15x (July 2016 to February 2020) and about 16.1x at the 2021 peak to 6.2x in August 2026 [A, A7-S029, A7-S030; F, DLA-3483, DLA-3484] (the public-comps table of the Operator 2 DDTL upsize memo places the same 16.1x at December 2023 [A, A7-S022]; the sources differ, and the text follows the Diligence & Structure Update); Ares Credit Group's model v24 carries an enterprise value of $546.6m, 6.7x its LTM September 2026 EBITDA of $71.7m, which includes a forecast quarter, and 7.58x rent-adjusted (P) [A, DLA-5677, DLA-5678].

Sensitivities that bear on the financing

On CreditSwan's monthly model, a uniform EBITDA shortfall against Ares Credit Group's model v24 breaches the liquidity covenant at 6.6% in the lead case (9.0% on Ares Credit Group's closure figure) and the leverage covenant at 46%, with everything else as Ares Credit Group's model has it [I, C-FIN-2]. Exhibit 9.168 (later in this section) sets these against the ranges observed in the evidence.

Information that would sharpen these observations

It would help us to see, for these observations: the supply-chain-finance balances eligible for the delayed-draw loan; the position on mortgages and lien perfection; the intended draw procedure of the delayed-draw loan and the meaning of "if Delayed Draw Term Loans may be drawn"; the closure cash budget by quarter, with the leases the company expects to assign or exit and those it expects to carry to term; the FCCR definition; the cap base for closure add-backs (the term sheet excludes the existing agreement's rent clauses from the 26% cap base) and whether clause (d) removes disposal gains from covenant EBITDA, confirmed by counsel; a maintenance/growth capex split and the Q2 FY27 10-Q, to replace the FCCR proxy with FCCR_CD and complete LTM LV5/LV6; and a monthly operating plan at flat EBITDA, from which refinancing need and capacity could be set on one scenario.

The items below would also bear on these observations. Items marked *Outstanding* have been requested and have not yet been received in full.

1. The revolver and supply-chain-finance balances expected at closing, by bank, reconciled to the 10-Q ($94.1m revolver and $183.9m supply-chain finance at June 2026); whether the build-up of about $26m on the Lender 6/Animal Health Manufacturer 3 line assumed for August–September 2026 has taken place.
2. Cash by account with control-agreement (DACA) status, clinic and in-transit cash, and daily consolidated cash balances for FY26 and FY27 to date.
3. *Outstanding.* The company's plan for its revolving facility ahead of maturity, and the liquidity calculation used for the dividend condition.
4. *Outstanding.* Whether the leverage ratio divides by EBITDAR, with the Existing Credit Agreement's EBITDAR definition, including clauses (f), (g), (i) and (l), and the latest compliance certificate; and the conformed Existing Credit Agreement through its latest amendment, showing the interest coverage and adjusted debt to EBITDAR levels for each quarter to maturity and the clinic-closure add-back limits.
5. Any third-party appraisal or desktop valuation of the 253 owned sites, beside the company's estimate of fair market value built on tax-assessed values.
6. Where any manufacturer rebate true-up, supplier credit or price reduction linked to a refund received in 2026 is recorded in covenant EBITDA.
7. *Outstanding.* Sale-process status, the buyer list, any executable sale or refinancing evidence and the Board's decision on route; and the Board's intention on the quarterly dividend, with the dividend policy in writing.

Public signals

Deal A's filings describe its existing facility and its public setting; Exhibit 9.161 lists each item with its date.

The sixth amendment of 21 May 2026 cut the revolving facility from $422m to $351m [F, PUB-0195; DLA-3464]; it matures on 10 November 2027 [F, PUB-0196]. At 27 June 2026 $94.1m was drawn [F, PUB-0435], $25.5m of letters of credit were outstanding, the amount the liquidity cases above carry [F, PUB-0436; A-F4], $228.5m was available subject to covenant compliance [F, DLA-0513], and cash was $8.5m [F, PUB-0437].

For the relief period, which runs to maturity, the 10-Q states a minimum interest coverage ratio of 1.25x [F, DLA-3104; PUB-0197], the 4.05x cap on adjusted debt to EBITDAR noted under leverage above, rising to 4.27x for twelve months after a qualified acquisition [F, DLA-3475; PUB-0198], a spread of 199 basis points [F, PUB-0431], and minimum liquidity of $176m to declare dividends [F, PUB-0199]. These are terms of the existing bank agreement, not of any proposed facility.

In the quarter to 27 June 2026 operations used $26.0m of cash [F, DLA-2894], capital expenditure was $6.3m [F, DLA-2895], and dividends of $0.24 per share were paid [F, PUB-0200].

On 27 May 2026 the company announced a review of strategic alternatives [F, PUB-0201]. Sponsor 11 reported 12.69% of the common stock on Schedule 13D and 14.80% in Amendment No. 1 (event dates 29 October and 6 November 2025) [F, PUB-0202; PUB-0203]; the board adopted a rights plan with a 15.0% threshold on 9 November 2025 [F, PUB-0204]. The Class C preferred stock converted on 18 June 2026 [F, PUB-0205].

Exhibit 9.161 — At 27 June 2026 Deal A's existing $351m revolver, maturing 10 November 2027, had $94.1m drawn and $228.5m available; Sponsor 11 reported 14.80% of the common stock in November 2025

Terms of the existing bank agreement, liquidity, cash flow, dividend, strategic review and shareholder filings; Deal A Form 10-Q for the quarter to 27 June 2026, Forms 8-K and Schedule 13D

ITEM	WHAT THE FILING STATES	DATE OR PERIOD	REFERENCE
Revolving facility, size	$351m, reduced from $422m by the sixth amendment	Amendment dated 21 May 2026	[F, DLA-3464; PUB-0195]
Maturity	10 November 2027	n/a	[F, PUB-0196]
Borrowings outstanding	$94.1m	27 June 2026	[F, PUB-0435]
Letters of credit outstanding	$25.5m	27 June 2026	[F, PUB-0436]
Available under the facility	$228.5m, subject to compliance with covenants	27 June 2026	[F, DLA-0513]
Cash and equivalents	$8.5m	27 June 2026	[F, PUB-0437]
Minimum interest coverage ratio	1.08x through maturity	Relief period, 21 May 2026 to 10 November 2027	[F, DLA-3104; PUB-0197]
Maximum adjusted debt to EBITDAR	4.05x; 4.27x for a twelve-month period after a qualified acquisition	Relief period	[F, DLA-3475; PUB-0198]
Interest rate spread	199 basis points	Relief period	[F, PUB-0431]
Condition to declare dividends	Minimum liquidity of $176m	Relief period	[F, PUB-0199]
Clinic-closure add-backs to covenant EBITDA	Non-cash items in full; cash items up to 13% of EBITDA (17% through the fourth quarter of fiscal 2026)	From the first quarter of fiscal 2027	[F, PUB-0307]
Dividend paid	$0.24 per share; $7.7m	Quarter to 27 June 2026	[F, PUB-0200; DLA-2900]
Dividend declared	$0.24 per share, payable 8 September 2026	Declared 11 August 2026	[F, PUB-0308]
Cash used for operating activities	$26.0m	Quarter to 27 June 2026	[F, DLA-2894]
Capital expenditure	$6.3m	Quarter to 27 June 2026	[F, DLA-2895]
Strategic review	Review of strategic alternatives announced; the release lists asset sales, refinancing, strategic acquisitions, operational improvements or a sale of the company	27 May 2026	[F, PUB-0201]
Sponsor 11, Schedule 13D	3,912,371 shares, 12.69% of the common stock	Event date 29 October 2025	[F, PUB-0202]
Sponsor 11, Amendment No. 1	4,460,313 shares, 14.80%	Event date 6 November 2025	[F, PUB-0203]
Shareholder rights plan	Threshold of 17.5% of the common stock; limited duration	Approved 9 November 2025; Form 8-K of 10 November 2025	[F, PUB-0204]
Class C convertible preferred stock	All shares converted to common stock	18 June 2026	[F, PUB-0205]

Source: Deal A Form 10-Q for the quarter ended 27 June 2026; Deal A Form 10-K for fiscal 2026; Deal A Forms 8-K of 10 November 2025, 27 May 2026 and 11 August 2026; Schedule 13D and Amendment No. 1 filed by Sponsor 11 L.P · Basis: Actual (A), as filed. Every term in this table belongs to the existing bank agreement as amended on 21 May 2026, not to any proposed facility. Shareholdings are as reported on the event dates shown; a later holding was not read

08 C Deal B financing: supporting evidence

The proposal is presented as low-leverage, high-price credit with upside. On Ares Credit Group's trailing adjusted EBITDA of $11.5m it is 4.1x first lien, 4.7x gross senior and 7.6x including a 15%-PIK HoldCo that reaches about $73.3m by December 2030 and switches to cash pay six months before senior maturity; first-lien leverage on the term loan alone is inside the 2025–26 same-rung set (2.25–5.10x) on every underwriting denominator, but the stack is above every peer LV4 print, and fixed-charge cover computes at 0.61x on Ares Credit Group's $11.16m and 0.93x on the borrower's $14.77m; peer cover prints are on different definitions and are not set against these. The pricing is high — S+5.55% equals the widest spread in the 2025–26 set — but the warrants are worth about $0.4–2.1m on our estimate, against $4.4m of proceeds in Ares Credit Group's model at a 10x exit. The near-term batch is unfunded by $8.8–11.8m on either model's cash. On the files, DBW disposal proceeds are not a demonstrated source of repayment until a separation model and an executable sale process exist [U].

The proposed structure

The preliminary structure in Ares Credit Group's response to the borrower's financing grid of 19 September is a $55m term loan (the Ares Credit Group term sheet proposed $52m; Ares Credit Group answered "OK" to the borrower's $55m), a $26m DDTL (the borrower's second $26m tranche removed) and a $11.1m revolver, at S+5.55% locked for two quarters, 2% fees, a 1% floor and a 90/101 hard call, with a 3.0x four-wall covenant, a $4.3m minimum liquidity test, 3.4x first-lien and 2.2x four-wall DDTL draw governors, 1.8–2.2% non-dilutable penny warrants and a December 2030 senior

maturity; the borrower's $4.3m co-invest was removed, run-rate add-backs are excluded and other add-backs are capped at 17% [F, DLB-026 rows 4–5, 10, 13, 15–18, 23–25; DLB-019 p.2]. A $36.9m HoldCo note accrues 15% PIK to June 2030, then 7% cash and 7% PIK, maturing July 2031; at 15% it reaches $44.0m by September 2027, and Ares Credit Group's model carries it at $73.3m in December 2030 [F, DLB-5668; DLB-9111; DLB-6246; DLB-008 Debt!R91:S91]. Cash at close is $2.46m in the borrower model and $5.03m in the Ares Credit Group model [F, DLB-5662; DLB-6351]. The proposed structure values Deal B at 10.2x implied total capitalisation on pro forma LTM September 2026 EBITDA (basis P) [M, DLB-008-000101].

Leverage on each rung

Leverage depends on the rung; it reads low only on forward or four-wall bases. Exhibit 8.10 rebuilds every rung on every denominator for the $55m term loan in Ares Credit Group's grid response and the $52m in the term sheet [I, DLB-9234..9583]. Funded first-lien debt at close is $55.3m (term loan only; LV1), gross senior debt including the $5.6m seller note, $0.8m of other debt and $2.2m of equipment leases treated as finance leases is $62.3m (LV3), and the HoldCo note adds $36.9m (LV4) [F, DLB-9113..9115 components; DLB-008 Summary]. On Ares Credit Group's LTM July 2026 E5 of $11.16m these read 4.08x, 4.91x and 7.59x gross (3.88x, 4.59x and 7.18x net of the Ares Credit Group model's $5.03m cash) [I, DLB-9352; DLB-9354; DLB-9355; DLB-9364; DLB-9366; DLB-9367]. The 4.08x sits inside the 2.25–5.10x of the 2025–26 same-rung set of Part 08 section A (Operator 7 2.25x and Operator 3 4.70x proposals, Operator 6 3.81x closed, and Operator 4's first lien at 5.10x on Lender 1's E5 at March 2026) [F/I, OP7-1181; OP6-0031; OP3-1326; OP4-1442]. On the borrower's LTM September 2026 E4 of $14.77m (a window that includes budget months, basis P) they read 3.28x, 3.71x and 5.99x; on the borrower's $16.1m including acquisitions at close, 2.84x, 3.30x and 5.39x; on post-audit E2 of $8.51m, 5.58x, 6.55x and 10.43x [I, DLB-9370..9373; DLB-9388..9391; DLB-9424..9427]. On the borrower's own pairings its 3.38x closing test reads 3.37x (gross senior debt of $56.9m, with the $50m term loan, on $14.6m) or 3.30x (gross senior debt of $62.3m, with the $55m term loan, on $16.1m); the 3.71x above pairs the $55m grid term loan with model EBITDA built on a $50m term loan and is not that test [F, DLB-9136; DLB-9390]. With the $26m DDTL drawn, LV1 is 6.13x on Ares Credit Group E5 and 4.69x on $14.6m [I, TL $52m + DDTL rows DLB-9470 and DLB-9488 with the $2.6m term-loan difference added]. LV5 (5.3x cash rent over EBITDAR) is 6.12x on Ares Credit Group E5; because LV4 already exceeds the 5.3x rent multiple, LV5 reads below LV4, as the construction of LV5 in Definition D4 implies: six times rent added to the debt and rent added to EBITDA pull the ratio toward 5.3x [I, DLB-9356; Part 09 section C].

Fixed-charge cover

Coverage is about 1x on the borrower's EBITDA and below 1x on Ares Credit Group's. FCCR_CD (EBITDA less LTM maintenance capex of $4.60m and nil cash tax, over next-twelve-month cash interest and scheduled principal of $9.38m for the $55m structure) is 1.08x on $16.1m, 0.93x on $14.77m, 1.00x on the post-audit pro forma, 0.61x on Ares Credit Group E5 and 0.34x on post-audit E2 [I, DLB-9603..9607; DLB-9611; DLB-9610]. The models' print of 1.25x on $14.6m uses total capex of $5.4m and different fixed charges; on the common definition (maintenance capex $4.60m, next-twelve-month charges) the $14.77m case computes at 0.93x, and 1.08x is reached only on $16.1m [I, DLB-9604; DLB-9605]. Deal B's cover is not placed against peer prints, the same rule applied to Deal A and Deal C under 08 B and 08 D in this section: the peer coverage figures use different definitions (Operator 7 1.49x is a forecast with cash taxes in the denominator, Operator 6's 1.43x sets LTM EBITDA against 2027 charges, Operator 8's 1.33x is maintenance-only LTM) [F, OP7-1304; OP6-0141; OP8-2547]. As an association only, peer prints on mixed definitions span 0.7–1.6x, with the higher readings at first-lien leverage of 4.3x or less and 0.7–1.2x at 4.8–5.8x [I, note C-80]; because those prints are on different definitions, no position is taken for Deal B's 0.61–0.93x. Other prints in the files — 0.73x with the DDTL drawn and 0.02x on Ares Credit Group's cash-adjusted $5.7m, and the native model's 0.03x LTM and 0.83x FY26E — are model prints [F, DLB-027 FCCR!E57, E64, F64].

Exhibit 8.08 shows the cash base the structure starts from. Of $7.98m of consolidated adjusted cash EBITDA in April–August 2026, maintenance capex took $1.10m and working capital $3.12m, and $4.58m of debt service on the existing debt left adjusted levered free cash flow of −$1.15m, or −$3.31m after $2.19m of operations EBITDA adjustments [F, DLB-7850; DLB-7851; DLB-7853..7863]. These are peak-season months, and they come before the proposed term loan, HoldCo note and acquisition batch, so the cover figures above are not offset by a cash surplus in the current business. The window is five months, August is preliminary, and the total moves with the window: adjusted levered free cash flow was −$3.98m in April alone and +$2.48m in August.

Pricing and warrants

Pricing sits at the top of the peer range; the warrant value is small. S+5.55% is equal to the widest spread in the 2025–26 set, alongside Deal C's Option Two (S+5.55%, DLC-4081); the other core spreads are: Operator 6 S+4.05% (3.81x), Operator 3 S+4.05% proposed (4.70x), Operator 8 S+4.05–4.84%, Operator 7 S+4.27–4.43% (2.25x), Operator 4 S+3.98–5.15%, Operator 2 S+3.98–4.05% and Deal A S+5.26% (1.95x on Ares Credit Group's model v24) [F, OP6-0005; OP3-1319; OP8-0051/OP8-2463; OP7-1164/1165; OP4-1174/1184; OP2-4336/4318; DLA-5593; DLB-9041]. It is 134 basis points above Operator 6 and Operator 3 at comparable first-lien leverage on E5 and 21 basis points above Deal A, so on this set the pricing reads as a premium rather than as market-standard; spreads in the set do not follow leverage: S+5.55% sits on Deal B (4.08x) and on Deal C's Option Two (5.96x, Part 08 section D), and S+5.26% on Deal A (1.95x on Ares Credit Group's model v24) [I, note C-73]. Warrants of 2.0–2.2% on equity of $23.5m (implied) to $84.0m (total) in Ares Credit Group's model are worth about $0.4–2.1m against $93.4m of commitments; Ares Credit Group's model credits $4.4m of warrant proceeds at a 10x FY27 exit for an 15.6% IRR and 1.05x MOIC [I, DLB-027 Cap Table F29:F30; A, DLB-6448..6450]. The

10x exit is inside the observed platform curve (10–15.0x) but on Deal B's own EBITDA it assumes the FY27 forecast (basis P) [A, DLB-6448 note; Exhibit 9.71]. The HoldCo note requires cash pay from July 2030 and stands at about $73.3m in December 2030 in Ares Credit Group's model, competing with the December 2030 senior maturity [F, DLB-6246; DLB-008 Debt!S89:S91].

Funding of the near-term batch

Funding of the near-term batch. The native model closes 23 near-term units ($58.0m purchase price including fees, $12.9m of sale-leaseback proceeds, a $47.5m DDTL draw) on a placeholder closing date in the model; on year-one four-wall of $10.4m the batch prices at 4.7x on the $57.7m purchase price before fees (4.7x including fees) and 3.9x on the $47.5m net of sale-leaseback proceeds, fees included [F, DLB-6069..6077; DLB-008 'NearTerm Acq. Assumption' D19:D39; Debt!D46]. Against the Ares Credit Group $26m DDTL the batch is short $20.9m; after the $11.1m revolver and cash above the $4.3m liquidity floor, the residual shortfall is $8.8m on the Ares Credit Group model's $5.03m of cash and $11.8m on the borrower model's $2.46m [I, DLB-6351; DLB-5662; C-FIN-5]. The borrower's conditional second DDTL tranche would not close it, because its 3.05x condition is not met at the 3.26x post-draw leverage in the borrower's model, and Ares Credit Group removed that tranche [F, DLB-026; DLB-008].

Exhibit 8.09 sets the need against the committed sources on each model's closing cash: on either model's closing cash the committed facilities leave the batch $8.8m or $11.8m short. The figures are model projections of a batch not yet closed; a version-matched sources-and-uses would settle the amount.

Observations on MS6. On the figures in the files, "low leverage" holds only on the borrower's forward or pro forma bases (LV1 2.9–3.3x) or on four-wall EBITDA, not on trailing ones (LV1 4.1x, LV4 7.6x on Ares Credit Group E5; LV1 5.6x on post-audit E2); cover computes at 0.61x on Ares Credit Group E5 and 0.93x on the borrower's $14.77m; on either model's closing cash the committed facilities leave the near-term acquisition batch $8.8–11.8m short; and the pricing is high (S+5.55%, equal to the widest spread in the set), with warrant value of about $0.4–2.1m on our estimate ($4.4m of proceeds in Ares Credit Group's model).

Sensitivities that bear on the financing

On the observed anchors, refinancing the term loan and delayed-draw loan at the 4.3x median in December 2030 needs EBITDA of $16.1–16.6m, and refinancing them with the HoldCo note at the 5.4–7.2x of peer LV4 prints needs $18.6–24.6m, against $11.16m on Ares Credit Group's measure and $13.79m post-audit today [I, Exhibit 9.162]. Exhibit 9.162 sets the four financing sensitivities against observed anchors; its last column holds only figures printed in the borrower's and Ares Credit Group's models. The same rows sit in the register of Part 08 section E.

Exhibit 9.162 — Deal B needs EBITDA of $16.1–16.6m to refinance its term loan and delayed-draw loan at 4.3x in December 2030, against $11.16m on Ares Credit Group's measure today, and the near-term batch is $8.8–11.8m short of committed sources

Financing sensitivities against observed anchors: cover and leverage x, EBITDA and funding $m; at close (September 2026), September 2027 and December 2030; results [I]

NO.	SENSITIVITY	OBSERVED ANCHOR (SOURCE)	DEAL B VALUE	RESULT ON THE ANCHOR [I]	PRINTS IN THE MODELS ON FILE
S3	Fixed-charge cover (FCCR_CD, TL $55m)	Association only (mixed definitions): peer prints 0.7–1.6x (OP7-1304, OP6-0141, OP8-2547; note C-80); no position taken	NTM fixed charges $9.38m; maintenance capex $4.60m (DLB-9610; DLB-9611)	1.08x ($16.1m), 0.93x ($14.77m), 1.00x (post-audit), 0.61x (Ares Credit Group E5), 0.34x (E2) (DLB-9603..9607)	1.08x on $14.6m; 0.73x with DDTL drawn; 0.02x on Ares Credit Group cash
S4	HoldCo accretion at +12 months, flat EBITDA	Contractual 15% PIK: $36.9m → $44.0m by Sep-27 (DLB-5668; DLB-9111); peer LV4 prints 5.4–7.2x (OP8-2819/2367; OP1-10730/10738)	LV4 at close 7.59x on Ares Credit Group E5 (DLB-9355); 5.99x on $14.77m (DLB-9373)	7.85–8.25x on Ares Credit Group E5 and 6.00–6.35x on $14.77m, after and before scheduled term-loan and seller-note principal	7.6x at close only
S8	Refinancing at December 2030	Closed first-lien band 3.81–4.27x, median 4.3x (Exhibit 4.09); peer LV4 5.4–7.2x	Senior $79–82m (TL $55m after 1% amortisation, DDTL $26m); HoldCo $73.3m (DLB-6246)	EBITDA of $16.1–16.6m refinances the term loan and DDTL at 4.3x; $18.6–24.6m refinances them plus HoldCo at 5.4–7.2x (revolver excluded); against $11.16m Ares Credit Group E5 and $13.79m post-audit today	
S10	Funding of the near-term batch	Cash at close $2.46m / $5.03m (DLB-5662; DLB-6351)	Need $47.5m against DDTL $26m and revolver $11.1m	Residual shortfall $11.8m / $8.8m (C-FIN-5)	

Source: DLB-5662; DLB-5668; DLB-6246; DLB-6351; DLB-9111; DLB-9355; DLB-9373; DLB-9603..9611; peers OP7-1304, OP6-0141, OP8-2547, OP8-2819/2367, OP1-10730/10738; Exhibit 4.09; notes C-80 and C-FIN-5 · Basis: P for the structure at close and every forward figure; peer anchors as printed (A, PF or P). The last column holds only figures printed in the borrower's and Ares Credit Group's models

Information that would sharpen these observations

It would help us to see, for these observations: executed intercreditor terms; the consolidated 5.3x covenant, which the grid response neither restates nor deletes; the treatment of DBW sale proceeds, whose participation right in the term sheet the grid response drops [F, DLB-026]; a version-matched sources-and-uses for the diligence-complete batch with the agreed cash at close; and executable sale or refinancing evidence.

The items below would also bear on these observations. Items marked *Outstanding* have been requested and have not yet been received in full.

1. The agreed closing EBITDA and its basis: the build-up of the borrower's $16.1m "deemed" figure, with support for each adjustment, and the company's reconciliation of it to its reported and adjusted EBITDA for the twelve months to July 2026.
2. The borrower's financing model run on the grid terms ($55m term loan, $26m DDTL and $11.1m revolver).
3. *Outstanding.* The four-wall EBITDA definition that the site-level covenant and the DDTL draw governor use: book or cash rent, fully pro forma or owned months.
4. *Outstanding.* The HoldCo note agreement (Sponsor 7), the deferral amendment and the cap tables; and, for any growth financing from the same holder, the instrument, the amount committed, the amount drawn to date and how it relates to the HoldCo notes.
5. Any equity commitment from existing investors, and the documentation of the $6.9m contributed in the second quarter of 2026.
6. For DBW, any valuation, indication of interest or sale-process material.

Public signals

Three public documents name Deal B in a financing or lease arrangement. Each figure is given as its source states it (Exhibit 9.163).

Sponsor 7' release of 28 July 2025 announces the closing of a $52 million growth financing to Deal B; the release does not state the instrument [F, PUB-0206]. The supplied financing model carries the $36.9m HoldCo note described above at the assumed close [M, DLB-5668]. The two figures come from different sources at different dates and are shown side by side, not reconciled.

Net-lease REIT 1's supplemental for the second quarter of 2026 lists "Deal B" as its twelfth-largest tenant at 30 June 2026, with $4.3 million of annual base rent, 1.8% of its total [F, PUB-0207; PUB-0208; PUB-0209]. Lender 5's presentation for the same quarter names "Deal B" at 4% of a $250 million single-tenant lease-financing portfolio at 30 June 2026, which is about $12m [F, PUB-0210; PUB-0211] [I, PUB-0212; C-PUB-16].

Exhibit 9.163 — Three public documents of July 2025 to June 2026 name Deal B as a financing or lease counterparty: a $52 million growth financing, $4.3 million of annual base rent and about $12m of lease financing

Each figure as its source states it; $ as printed

SOURCE	WHAT IT STATES	DATE OF FIGURE	REFERENCE
Sponsor 7, release	Closing of a $52 million growth financing to Deal B; instrument not stated	28 July 2025	[F, PUB-0206]
Supplied financing model	HoldCo notes of $36.9m at the assumed close	30 September 2026 (projected)	[M, DLB-5668]
Net-lease REIT 1, supplemental	"Deal B" is the twelfth-largest tenant	30 June 2026	[F, PUB-0207]
Net-lease REIT 1, supplemental	Annual base rent $4.3 million	30 June 2026	[F, PUB-0208]
Net-lease REIT 1, supplemental	1.8% of annual base rent	30 June 2026	[F, PUB-0209]
Lender 5, presentation	"Deal B" is 4% of the single-tenant lease-financing portfolio	30 June 2026	[F, PUB-0210]
Lender 5, presentation	Portfolio balances of $250 million	30 June 2026	[F, PUB-0211]
Computed	4% of $250 million is about $12m	30 June 2026	[I, PUB-0212; C-PUB-16]

Source: Sponsor 7 release (28 July 2025); Net-lease REIT 1 Corp. Corporate Profile and Supplemental Information, July 2026 (exhibit to Form 8-K); Lender 5 second-quarter 2026 investor presentation (exhibit to Form 8-K); supplied financing model · Basis: Figures are stated by the counterparty, not by Deal B. Net-lease REIT 1 and Lender 5 print the tenant name "Deal B" and do not list the properties. The Lender 5 dollar amount is computed from a rounded share. The supplied figure is a projected balance at the assumed close and is a different measure from the announced financing

The Net-lease REIT 1 and Lender 5 documents print the tenant's name only. Neither lists the properties, so these amounts are not tied here to the rent and sale-leaseback figures in the supplied documents.

08 D Deal C financing: supporting evidence

The requested first lien — 5.96x gross on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m for Option Two, 5.30x for Option One — sits above every 2025–26 print on the same rung (3.81–5.10x at Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4; Operator 7 2.25x proposal below) and above the 4.3x median at which first-lien debt in this subsector has closed since 2014 [I, Exhibit 8.14]. At that median, Option Two refinances only if EBITDA grows at least 1.57% a year, and its fixed-charge cover computes at 0.77x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA (0.22x on CreditSwan's D3 cash EBITDA); Option One cannot yet be assessed, because its refinancing result on a no-acquisition path reverses if the $21m sponsor instrument pays a cash coupon of about 17% (senior tranche) or the $70m DDTL is drawn at the audited deal-cost rate (total debt), and those terms are not in the files [I, Exhibit 9.164, Exhibit 9.165 and Exhibit 9.166]. Option One reads 5.76x net once the $21m sponsor instrument is included; Option Two is priced at S+534. The two options differ more in senior rank and cash burden than in total funded principal. The model's deal-cost budget assumes a peer-level rate, and the files contain no contractual end to the affiliate bonuses that would support it (Part 07 section D).

The proposed structure

Two options are in Ares Credit Group's Early Read Memo v19: Option One, a $176.0m senior term loan with a $21m subordinated sponsor instrument (5.26x draw governor, 7.40x covenant, S+4.27–4.43%); Option Two, a $204.3m senior term loan taking out the sponsor (5.55x governor, 7.41x covenant, S+5.55%); both with an $70m DDTL for 21 months and a $21m revolver, six-year term facilities [F, Early Read Memo v19 slides 4–5; DLC-4166/4167, DLC-4079/4080, DLC-4081]. Ares Credit Group's Internal Diligence Exhibits print Option One at 4.84x FLNL governor and 6.90x TNL covenant and the sponsor model prices the new debt at S+451; the documents differ, and the Early Read Memo v19 terms are used here [F, DLC-4043/4044; DLC-1923]. The sponsor computes 5.19x net on LTM September 2026E pro-forma adjusted EBITDA of $32.3m ((204.3 − 7.5) ÷ 31.872), or 5.19x on the model's $6.48m of cash; Ares Credit Group computes 5.92x net on its $29.4m [F/I, DLC-4712; DLC-1944; DLC-4726; DLC-4002]. Both denominators contain forecast months (basis P) and $9.2m of pre-acquisition and LOI earnings [F, DLC-4183].

Debt-service capacity

On Ares Credit Group's own coverage method, restated on the common fixed-charge definition (EBITDA less maintenance capex and cash tax, over cash interest and scheduled amortisation), Option Two's cover computes at 0.76x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA as printed ($23.2m), 0.77x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back ($24.9m), 0.96x on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m and 1.08x on the sponsor's $32.3m; Option One's (term loan only, at S+451) at 1.00x, 1.23x and 1.37x on the last three [I, DLC-4953; DLC-4947; DLC-4959; DLC-4965; DLC-4952; DLC-4964; DLC-4970]. On CreditSwan's D3 cash EBITDA of $8.6m (E6, which deducts the recurring deal costs), Option Two's cover computes at 0.22x — (8.6 − 2.253 − 0.3) ÷ (22.31 + 2.01) — and Option One's at 0.30x at S+451 [I, DLC-4439; DLC-4982]. The two measures answer different questions: D3 E6 is the cash cover while the acquisition programme and its deal costs continue, which is what the DDTL is intended for; Ares Credit Group's $24.9m approximates cover if acquisitions and their costs stop. Our Option Two observation uses Ares Credit Group's $24.9m (0.77x), the cash figure most favourable to the borrower, on which cover still computes below 1.0x; the D3 E6 cover (0.22x) is shown as the continued-M&A case and underlies the cash condition in Part 07 section D. Run-rate cash interest on $204.3m at SOFR 4.19% plus 5.55% with undrawn fees is $22.31m, reproducing the Early Read Memo v19's $21.8m; the Internal Diligence Exhibits' $21.7m uses SOFR of 3.98% [I/A, DLC-4942; DLC-4317; DLC-4098]. Cash breakeven EBITDA for Option Two — interest including undrawn fees, 1% amortisation, $2.3m of maintenance capex and $0.3m of tax — is **$26.0m**, above the $24.9m of LTM cash EBITDA; excluding the $0.79m of undrawn fees, breakeven would be $25.5m [I, DLC-4983/4984]. Option One's breakeven is $21.3m at S+422 and $21.7m at S+451 [I]. These coverage prints are not set against peers: peer fixed-charge ratios in the documents supplied mix compliance-certificate, lender-model and company definitions on actual, pro-forma and projected bases, and Exhibit 9.78 draws only an association from them (about 0.7–1.2x at 4.8–5.8x leverage) [F, note C-80; Exhibit 9.78].

Exhibit 9.164 — Option Two covers its fixed charges only on EBITDA that includes forecast months (0.96x on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m); on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back it computes at 0.77x, against a $26.0m cash breakeven (LTM April and September 2026E)

FCCR_CD = (EBITDA − maintenance capex − cash tax) ÷ (cash interest + scheduled amortisation), x, by option and EBITDA rung; Option One on the term loan only, at S+451; cash breakeven EBITDA, $m

EBITDA (RUNG, PERIOD, BASIS)	OPTION TWO FCCR_CD	OPTION ONE FCCR_CD	LOCATOR
D3 cash EBITDA (E6, recurrence test) $8.6m (LTM Apr-26, PF)	0.22x [I]	0.30x	DLC-4439 [I]; DLC-4982
Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA as printed $23.2m (LTM Apr-26, PF)	0.76x	0.98x	DLC-4953; DLC-4958
Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m (LTM Apr-26, PF)	0.77x	1.00x	DLC-4947; DLC-4952
Ares Credit Group $29.4m (E5, LTM Sep-26E, P)	0.96x	1.23x	DLC-4959; DLC-4964
Sponsor $32.3m (E3 PF, LTM Sep-26E, P)	1.08x	1.37x	DLC-4965; DLC-4970
Cash breakeven EBITDA	$26.0m ($25.5m excl. fees)	$21.7m at S+451 ($21.3m at S+422)	DLC-4983/4984 [I]

Source: rows as listed. Maintenance capex $2.253m (model 2026E), tax $0.3m, scheduled amortisation 1%; Option One interest on the term loan only (the sponsor instrument's terms are not in the documents supplied) [U] · Basis: P (proposed structure at the September 2026 close); EBITDA rungs PF or P as marked; every ratio [I]

Deleveraging, refinancing and collateral

The refinancing test is anchored on the levels at which closed first-lien debt in this subsector has been struck, with a 3.4x corner shown as a labelled stress. Closing first-lien leverage on financing EBITDA (E4 or E5) has a median of 5.0x since 2014 — 4.10–4.27x across five 2014–18 prints (Operator 1, Operator 2), 4.38x and 5.97x in 2021, 3.81x for Operator 6 in 2026 — and the same 4.3x median in the $21–86m EBITDA bracket that Deal C's $29.4m falls into [F/I, Exhibit 4.09; P5-S001; OP6-0031]. The 2025–26 same-rung set of Part 08 section A runs 2.25–5.10x; this section names its three prints from 3.81x up, which run from 3.81x (Operator 6, closed) through 4.70x (Operator 3, proposal) to 5.10x (Operator 4 on Lender 1's E5) [F/I, OP6-0031; OP3-1326; OP4-1442], and Operator 7 2026 proposal, at 2.25x on $8.8m of E5, sits below them [F/I, OP7-1181]. Option Two and Option One sit above all four. The growth axis is anchored on Deal C's own same-store clinic EBITDA on the common definition: +1.0% for CY2025 (base) and −5.8% for LTM July 2026 (stress) [F/I, DLC-0987; DLC-0996]; this is a clinic-level measure before G&A and is applied to consolidated EBITDA as a proxy [I]. Peers' 2025–26 same-store **revenue** growth of +1.1% to +5.1% is context, not an EBITDA anchor [F, DLA-0788; OP6-1148; OP3-0906; DLB-1411]. Rows at 0%, 2%, 3.0% and 4% growth are assumed sensitivities.

The path is a six-year no-acquisition case: $204.3m at SOFR 4.19% plus 5.55%, undrawn fees on the revolver for six years and on the DDTL for its 21-month availability, 1% amortisation, $2.3m maintenance capex, $0.3m tax, $4.3m of stopping and settlement costs in the first ten months, and refinancing at the stated multiple of year-six EBITDA less 2% of fees [I, note C-90]. On flat earnings it gives a $53.0m gap at 3.4x on $29.4m and $99.9m on $24.9m [I].

Exhibit 9.165 — At maturity in September 2032 Option Two leaves an $7.5m gap at the 4.3x median on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m growing 1.0% a year, and $59.3m on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back ($24.9m); flat $29.4m clears only at 5.18x

Refinancing gap at maturity = net debt at maturity − multiple × year-6 EBITDA less 2% fees, $m (negative = clears), by starting EBITDA, annual growth and exit multiple; six-year no-acquisition path from September 2026

STARTING EBITDA	ANNUAL EBITDA GROWTH (ANCHOR)	NET DEBT AT MATURITY	YEAR-6 EBITDA	GAP AT 3.38X (STRESS)	3.81X	**4.27X (BASE, MEDIAN)**	4.70X	5.10X	MULTIPLE NEEDED
E5 $29.4m	−5.8% (stress: DLC-0996)	201.2	20.1	122.1	112.7	101.6	92.1	84.4	8.94x
E5 $29.4m	0% (assumed)	169.2	29.4	53.0	42.7	23.0	9.2	−2.3	5.18x
E5 $29.4m	**+1.0% (base: DLC-0987)**	157.2	30.5	37.9	28.8	**7.5**	−7.3	−19.6	4.43x
E5 $29.4m	+1.8% (assumed)	156.5	32.8	28.0	18.4	−3.4	−18.7	−31.2	4.13x
E5 $29.4m	+3.0% (assumed)	146.8	33.9	9.1	−1.3	−24.4	−40.8	−55.0	3.82x
E5 $29.4m	+4.3% (assumed)	138.7	37.9	−10.4	−22.3	−47.4	−67.5	−79.0	3.17x
Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m	−5.8% (stress)	225.1	16.1	149.7	151.1	138.7	129.5	119.9	11.47x
Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m	0% (assumed)	190.5	24.9	99.9	91.8	73.3	62.0	52.1	7.09x
Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m	**+1.0% (base)**	186.8	25.7	85.4	79.8	**59.3**	49.0	37.7	6.22x
Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m	+1.8% (assumed)	183.7	27.0	77.8	69.3	50.8	38.5	27.2	6.13x
Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m	+3.0% (assumed)	171.6	30.0	61.4	54.3	32.2	19.3	7.2	5.41x
Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m	+4.3% (assumed)	164.8	31.7	44.4	35.7	13.8	−1.2	−14.1	4.73x

Source: CreditSwan calculation [I] (note C-90). Multiples: 3.38x stress; 3.81x Operator 6 (OP6-0031); 4.27x median closed core LV1 on financing EBITDA since 2014 and in the $21–86m bracket (notes C-75 and C-76); 4.70x Operator 3 proposal (OP3-1326); 5.10x Operator 4 on E5 (OP4-1442). The band is observed on E4/E5 financing EBITDA; applying it to the $24.9m path assumes the refinancing lender

measures leverage on cash-basis earnings · Basis: P; every cell [I]; growth rows other than +1.0% and −5.8% are assumed; 3.38x is a stress

On Ares Credit Group's $29.4m, Option Two refinances at the observed median only with at least 1.57% a year of EBITDA growth; flat earnings leave a $23.0m gap and clear only at the top of the band (5.18x) [I]. On Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back ($24.9m) it needs at least 5.36% a year at 4.3x, and 3.42% at 5.10x [I]. Both thresholds exceed Deal C's latest calendar-year same-store earnings growth (+1.0%), and its trailing rate (−5.8%) leaves gaps of $101m and $140m [I, Exhibit 9.165]. Option One's $176.0m senior tranche at S+451 reaches 3.52x net at maturity on flat $29.4m and clears the 4.3x median at any growth down to −1.6% a year; on flat $24.9m it ends at 5.14x and needs 2.08% a year; the $21m sponsor instrument, carried at face with no cash coupon because its terms are not in the documents supplied, takes Option One's total to 4.08x on the flat $29.4m path [I, note C-90; U]. That result depends on two things the no-acquisition path leaves out, so two labelled sensitivities are added (Exhibit 9.166). (a) **DDTL drawn:** the $70m DDTL is intended for acquisitions; drawn in full at close on the term loan's terms (same spread, 1% amortisation, no undrawn fee) and spent on acquisitions whose EBITDA is credited at the close leverage multiple (leverage-neutral by construction — an assumption, not an observation), with deal costs paid in cash at 13.2% of price (the ex-bonus rate) or 31.2% (the audited rate) [I, note C-90]. (b) **Sponsor instrument on cash pay:** coupon of 12% or 17% on the $21m (an assumed range; the actual coupon, maturity, ranking and cash-pay terms are unknown) [assumption; U]. With the DDTL drawn, Option Two's gap at the 4.3x median on flat $29.4m widens from $23.0m to $35.7–51.5m. Option One's senior tranche still clears on flat $29.4m, but its total debt including the sponsor instrument misses by $8.0m at the audited deal-cost rate; with the sponsor instrument on cash pay, Option One's senior gap moves from −$23.9m to −$8.1m (10%) and +$2.3m (17%), and its total gap to $13.4–23.4m. On the $24.9m with +1.0% growth, Option One's senior misses at 4.3x in every case ($13.2–40.1m) [I, note C-90].

Exhibit 9.166 — Drawing the $70m DDTL widens Option Two's gap at the 4.3x median to $35.7–51.5m on flat $29.4m; a 17% cash coupon on the sponsor instrument turns Option One's senior surplus into a $2.3m gap (September 2032)

Gap at the 4.3x median at maturity (September 2032), $m (negative = clears), and net leverage at maturity, x: no-acquisition path against (a) DDTL drawn and (b) sponsor instrument on cash pay

OPTION	STARTING EBITDA AND GROWTH	SENSITIVITY	NET SENIOR DEBT AT MATURITY	YEAR-6 EBITDA	SENIOR LV1 NET AT MATURITY	TOTAL INCL. $21M SPONSOR (OPTION ONE)	SENIOR GAP AT 4.3X	TOTAL GAP AT 4.3X
Option Two	Ares Credit Group E5 $29.4m, flat	no-M&A path (Exhibit 9.165)	169.2	29.4	4.96x	–	23.0	–
Option Two	Ares Credit Group E5 $29.4m, flat	(a) DDTL $70m drawn at close, leverage-neutral, deal cost 13.2%	226.4	39.8	5.03x	–	35.7	–
Option Two	Ares Credit Group E5 $29.4m, flat	(a) DDTL $70m drawn at close, leverage-neutral, deal cost 31.2%	241.4	39.8	5.30x	–	51.5	–
Option One	Ares Credit Group E5 $29.4m, flat	no-M&A path (Exhibit 9.165)	117.8	29.4	3.52x	4.08x	−23.9	−2.0
Option One	Ares Credit Group E5 $29.4m, flat	(a) DDTL $70m drawn at close, leverage-neutral, deal cost 13.2%	162.9	40.7	3.57x	4.11x	−28.9	−7.2
Option One	Ares Credit Group E5 $29.4m, flat	(a) DDTL $70m drawn at close, leverage-neutral, deal cost 31.2%	182.5	40.7	4.05x	4.37x	−14.1	8.0
Option One	Ares Credit Group E5 $29.4m, flat	(b) sponsor $21m cash-pay at 10% (assumption)	130.9	29.4	4.10x	4.55x	−8.1	13.4
Option One	Ares Credit Group E5 $29.4m, flat	(b) sponsor $21m cash-pay at 17% (assumption)	146.3	29.4	4.23x	5.00x	2.3	23.4
Option Two	Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m, +1.0%/yr	no-M&A path (Exhibit 9.165)	186.8	25.7	6.45x	–	59.3	–
Option Two	Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m, +1.0%/yr	(a) DDTL $70m drawn at close, leverage-neutral, deal cost 13.2%	258.7	33.9	6.26x	–	87.7	–
Option Two	Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m, +1.0%/yr	(a) DDTL $70m drawn at close, leverage-neutral, deal cost 31.2%	268.8	33.9	6.95x	–	98.6	–
Option One	Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m, +1.0%/yr	no-M&A path (Exhibit 9.165)	139.3	25.7	4.80x	5.55x	13.2	34.8

OPTION	STARTING EBITDA AND GROWTH	SENSITIVITY	NET SENIOR DEBT AT MATURITY	YEAR-6 EBITDA	SENIOR LV1 NET AT MATURITY	TOTAL INCL. $21M SPONSOR (OPTION ONE)	SENIOR GAP AT 4.3X	TOTAL GAP AT 4.3X
Option One	Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m, +1.0%/yr	(a) DDTL $70m drawn at close, leverage-neutral, deal cost 13.2%	195.9	36.3	4.76x	5.36x	22.3	45.4
Option One	Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m, +1.0%/yr	(a) DDTL $70m drawn at close, leverage-neutral, deal cost 31.2%	213.4	36.3	5.27x	5.66x	37.7	60.7
Option One	Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m, +1.0%/yr	(b) sponsor $21m cash-pay at 10% (assumption)	157.5	25.7	5.37x	5.94x	29.4	51.5
Option One	Ares Credit Group cash EBITDA, $1.0m impairment added back, $24.9m, +1.0%/yr	(b) sponsor $21m cash-pay at 17% (assumption)	168.2	25.7	5.50x	6.50x	40.1	62.9

Source: CreditSwan calculation [I] (note C-90, rows labelled (a) and (b)). (a) DDTL $70m drawn at close, acquired EBITDA = $70m ÷ close LV1 gross multiple on the same starting EBITDA (leverage-neutral assumption), deal costs at 13.2% or 31.2% of price paid in cash at close [13.2% = (DLC-0009 − DLC-0199) ÷ total consideration; 31.2% = DLC-0009 ÷ total consideration of $32.8m, 2025 Audit Note 3, p.17]; (b) sponsor coupon 10% or 17% cash (assumption; terms not in the documents supplied). Senior gap tests the term loan only; total gap adds the $21m sponsor instrument at face · Basis: P; every cell [I]; sensitivities (a) and (b) rest on assumed parameters, and the sponsor instrument's terms are not in the files [U]

Collateral cover depends on the multiple a buyer pays. Deal C is capitalised at 14.8x sell-side and 16.59x Ares Credit Group-basis EBITDA, at the top of and above the 12.0–14.6x range of platform values struck on comparable financing EBITDA (Operator 3 12.0x, Operator 6 14.6x) [A/F, DLC-4075/4076; OP3-1328; OP6-0042]; Option Two's net loan-to-value at close is 34% at 14.6x and 44% at 12.0x on $29.4m, and 39–51% on $24.9m [I]. At the 6.2x at which Deal A traded in the public market in August 2026 (a context mark, not a platform print), it is 82% [I, DLA-3484].

The 5.3x request in context

On the definitions that matter — $204.3m first-lien funded at close, $7.5m of cash — the request is 5.19x net on the sponsor's $32.3m, 5.92x net and **5.96x gross on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m**, 7.26x net (7.32x gross) on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA as printed ($23.2m), 6.78x net (7.24x gross) on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back ($24.9m), 14.7x net (14.4x gross) on the $12.0m Ares Credit Group says the company "actually generated" and 19.7x net (20.0x gross) on CreditSwan's D3 cash EBITDA (E6, $8.6m) [I, DLC-4712; DLC-4726; DLC-4725; DLC-4754; DLC-4753; DLC-4740; DLC-4739; DLC-4768; DLC-4767; DLC-4782; DLC-4781]. Our Option Two observation uses the Ares Credit Group figures (the more favourable to the borrower); the D3 E6 multiple is the continued-acquisition cash case. The same debt reads 5.61x to 19.72x across rungs, a 3.2-fold spread, inside the 1.6- to 3.9-fold spreads the same method shows for Operator 8, Operator 4 and Operator 6 [I, DLC-4711..4781; Exhibit 9.75]. The comparison that holds rung and gross/net constant is first-lien gross on underwriting (E5) EBITDA: Operator 6 closed at 3.81x in July 2026, Operator 3 was proposed at 4.70x and Operator 4's first lien stood at 5.10x on Lender 1's E5 at March 2026 [F/I, OP6-0031; OP3-1326; OP4-1442]; Operator 7 2026 proposal, at 2.25x, sits below them [F/I, OP7-1181]. Option Two's 5.96x is 0.93x above the 3.81–5.10x of those three and Option One's 5.30x is 0.27x above it [I, DLC-4725; DLC-4872]. Across all closed first-lien prints on financing EBITDA since 2014, and within the $21–86m EBITDA bracket, the median is 4.3x; only Operator 2's 2021 buyout (5.97x gross on E4) is higher [F, Exhibit 4.09; P5-S001], and Operator 2 stayed at 5.6–6.6x on that basis for the following five years, de-levering through acquired EBITDA and repricing rather than repayment [F, OP2-3770/3771/3773/4311]. Operator 1 in 2018 is not a precedent at this level on the first lien: its 4.10x first-lien and 5.76–5.95x total leverage are LV1 and LV2 respectively [F, OP1-7795; OP1-7814; OP1-8157]. A "3.8–4.8x" set drawn from Ares Credit Group's comps workbook is not used, because that workbook is inconsistent across tabs and its Operator 7 and Operator 8 figures do not reproduce on any rung of the common ladder (Operator 7 2.25x gross / 1.97x net proposed; Operator 8 5.3x net on credit-agreement EBITDA by March 2026, from 0.93x at its February 2025 close) [F, OP7-1181/1180; OP8-2344; OP8-0068]. Lease-adjusted, Option Two is 5.86x gross (5.68x net) on E5 plus $6.8m of audited cash rent, above the 4.26–5.66x of the three closed lease-adjusted prints (rent basis implied, not stated, for those peers) [I, DLC-4733/4734; DLC-0186; OP6-1877; OP2-3735; OP2-0251]. On lease-adjusted leverage with six times rent over EBITDAR, taking the sponsor model's $15.1m of facility expense as the rent and Ares Credit Group's $29.4m as the EBITDA, Option One with the $21m sponsor instrument reads 5.81x (basis P) [I, MULTI-000072; DLC-1348]; on E5 plus $6.8m of audited cash rent it reads 5.86x, the same as Option Two, because both carry $204.3m of funded debt [I, DLC-4880].

Option One at 5.10x net on the first lien is at the top of the E5 range only because the comparators are gross; gross it is 5.30x — above the 3.81–5.10x of the Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4 prints, on the same test applied to Option Two — and once the $21m of sponsor debt that stays in place is counted its net leverage is 5.76x — below Operator 1's LV4 prints of 6.90–7.19x net and above Operator 8's 5.4–5.68x net; it is above every 2025–26 first-lien print and, among closed first-lien prints since 2014, below only Operator 2's 2021 buyout (6.05x net) [I, DLC-4872; DLC-4879; OP1-10730/10738; OP8-2819/2452/2367; OP2-3732]. Option Two's additional $21m at S+534 adds 0.64x and $4.1–4.6m of annual coupon (including repricing the whole $176.0m), and moves senior rank and cash burden rather than total funded principal [I]; S+534 is equal to the widest 2025–26

core spread in the documents supplied — Deal B's Ares Credit Group term sheet at S+5.55% — and above the others (Operator 2 S+383 after repricing, Operator 7 S+422–451 proposed, Operator 4 up to S+511, Deal A S+528 proposed) [F/A, DLC-4081; A8-S012; OP2-4336; OP7-1164; OP4-1184; DLA-5593]. On audited FY2025 earnings the existing $133.9m is 24.9x E1, against 0.62–8.60x for Deal A (FY26), Operator 9 (FY25) and Operator 4 (FY24) on that basis [I, DLC-4459; DLA-0472; OP4-1464; OP4-1394; Exhibit 8.14]. The legacy facilities (term loan, delayed-draw loan and line of credit) mature on 31 March 2028, and the delayed-draw commitment expired on 20 June 2026; on the terms in the files, neither option by itself cures that [F, 2025 Audit pp.4–8, Notes 7–8; DLC-4452]. FY2025 cash interest paid was $11.8m, including finance-lease interest [F, DLC-0118].

Exhibit 9.167 sets the request beside Deal C's position on the other valid comparator metrics: its leverage and value multiples sit at or above the top of the comparator range, while its tuck-in entry multiple sits below it.

Exhibit 9.167 — Deal C's leverage request and EV multiple sit at or above the top of the comparator range, and its tuck-in entry multiple below it (FY2025 to LTM September 2026E)

Deal C against its comparators on seven valid metrics: growth %, ratios and multiples x; FY2025 to LTM September 2026E

VALID METRIC (DEFINITION; BASIS)	COMPARATOR VALUES	RANGE	DEAL C (LABEL, FACT ROW)	POSITION
SSS_CD, CLOSE-RETRO	Operator 6 CY2025 +1.9% (OP6-1148, A); Operator 3 LTM Aug-25 +4.2% (OP3-0906, A)	1.9–4.2%	2025 +4.5% (A5-S001); LTM Jul-26 −0.4% (DLC-0994); Q2-26 −3.2% (DLC-1022)	Above (2025); below (LTM Jul-26)
ADJ_SHARE	Operator 3 0.11; Operator 2 0.21; Operator 6 0.61; Operator 8 0.83 (0.54 where sources differ); Operator 4 LTM Mar-26 0.93 (OP4-0269/OP4-1035)	0.11–0.93	FY2025 0.66 (DLC-4426/0019); LTM Apr-26 0.81 (DLC-4430/4434)	Inside, upper half
CONV_1, company split [M], E2	Operator 8 FY22 0.73 / LTM Nov-23 0.80 (OP8-0743/OP8-0859; OP8-0744/OP8-0781; E2q, steady)	0.73–0.80	FY2025 0.76 on E2, BUILD (DLC-4425; DLC-005-000567)	Inside
Add-on entry multiple, clinic-level, standalone	Operator 3 4.4× (OP3-1493; sources differ: 5.1× / 4.7×); Operator 6 4.5× (OP6-1731); Operator 4 6.0× (OP4-0802)	4.4–6.0×	30 tuck-ins 3.25× net of sale-leaseback proceeds (DLC-3427; DLC-3424; PF); gross, on cash consideration, seven of the ten deals of January 2025 to February 2026 whose clinics have twelve months of seller results in the site database cost 2.4–3.2×, and the other three (two single clinics with a sale-leaseback, 2.9× and 4.2× net of the sale proceeds; ECM and Operator 34, seven sites) 6.2–6.6× (DLC-1261..1279; 2025 audit Notes 3 and 14)	Below (net of sale-leaseback proceeds, and seven of the ten deals gross); three deals above gross, of which the two with a sale-leaseback are below net
Add-on later multiple (current)	Operator 3 2.8×; Operator 4 3.2×; Operator 6 3.4× (OP3-1494; OP4-0806; OP6-1733)	2.8–3.4×	3.0× LTM May-26 (DLC-012-000404)	Inside
LV1 gross on E5	Operator 6 3.81× (OP6-0031, PF closed); Operator 3 4.70× (OP3-1326, P); Operator 4 5.10× on Lender 1's E5 (OP4-1442, PF); Operator 7 2.25× (OP7-1181, P), below the other three	3.81–5.10× (Operator 6, Operator 3, Operator 4)	Option One 5.30× on Ares Credit Group E5, LTM Sep-26E (DLC-4872, P); Option Two 5.96× on Ares Credit Group E5 (DLC-4725, P; equal to Option One's LV4 with the $21m sponsor debt, DLC-4878) and 5.61× on the sponsor's $32.3m (DLC-4711)	Above
EV ÷ E5-type financing EBITDA	Operator 3 12.0× (OP3-1328, P); Operator 6 14.6× Adj. incl. LOI (OP6-0042, PF)	12.0–14.6×	14.8× sell-side (DLC-012-000514) / 16.59× Ares Credit Group (DLC-012-000515); LTM Sep-26E contains forecast months, P	Top of range (14.8×) / above (16.59×)

Source: note C-84 (Deal C rows) · Basis: A, PF and P as marked in each cell

Deal C's clinic-level EBITDA margin of 21.3% (FY25; D1.2, rebates booked contra-COGS, on book rent, audited; 22.3% on cash rent; 32 of 88 clinics on related-party leases) is higher than every core D1.1 and D1.2-type figure in the set (the highest, Operator 4's clinic EBITDA, is 18.7%), but no comparator shares its rent and rebate treatment, so no position is taken [DLC-0018; DLC-5014; OP4-1507]. A company traffic series is also available: Deal C's company comp visit count (DLC-015; PF; working-day and blackout adjusted; vaccination-only visits excluded) was −1.0% in FY23, −5.2% in FY24, +0.1% in FY25 and −1.6% for LTM Jun-26, with average-invoice growth of +4.2%, +11.5%, +4.1% and +3.3%; it is a company definition and is not placed against the D2.5 traffic of any peer [A1-S002..S004; A5-P5-004..006]. On the common SSS definition, Deal C's comps fell from +4.5% in 2025 to −0.4% for LTM Jul-26 (−3.2% in Q2-26) while the company series shows +1.6%, so the deceleration is steeper than the company presentation suggests [A5-S001; DLC-0994; DLC-1022].

Observations on ST4. On these figures, Option Two's first-lien leverage sits above every same-rung precedent in the 2025–26 set; on Ares Credit Group's cash-EBITDA method its fixed-charge cover computes at 0.77x (0.22x on the D3 cash EBITDA); and at the observed median it refinances only with earnings growth above what Deal C's clinics delivered in the latest two periods. For Option One, at 5.30x gross the first lien sits above the 3.81–5.10x of the Operator 6, Operator 3 and Operator 4 prints, on the same test applied to Option Two; its debt service cannot be tested because the $21m sponsor instrument's coupon, maturity, ranking and cash-pay terms are not in the files; and its favourable refinancing result on the no-acquisition path does not hold under the labelled sensitivities — a sponsor coupon of 20% in cash takes the senior gap at the 4.3x median positive, and drawing the $70m DDTL at the audited deal-cost rate leaves total debt short (Exhibit 9.166). Its cover of 1.16x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back and its need for 2.08% a year of growth on that figure are shown for reference [I, DLC-4952; note C-90]. The governor and covenant levels also conflict between Ares Credit Group documents [DLC-4043/4044; DLC-4166/4167].

Information that would sharpen these observations

It would help us to see, for these observations: current bank cash; the $21m sponsor instrument's issuer, coupon, maturity, ranking and funds trace; legacy amendments or waivers; the agreed governor, covenant and pricing terms of each option; an actual-basis LTM on the credit-agreement EBITDA definition and a fixed-charge ratio on cash rent; August–September 2026 same-store clinic EBITDA against the threshold of at least 1.57% a year computed from Exhibit 9.165; and executable sale or refinancing evidence.

The items below would also bear on these observations. Items marked *Outstanding* have been requested and have not yet been received in full.

1. The EBITDA on which the facilities are to be sized and tested, with its bridge from reported EBITDA, and the credit-agreement EBITDA definition with its add-back caps.
2. *Outstanding.* The existing lenders and facility agreements — facility sizes, amounts drawn, pricing, maturity and financial covenants — with the ownership table.

Public signals

O2 Sponsor 15 Partners states in its own release of July 2023 that it invested in five veterinary service companies to form the platform, with terms not disclosed, and its portfolio page, read on 30 September 2026, lists Deal C [F, PUB-0213; PUB-0214]. The supplied audit dates the formation to 31 March 2023 [F, DLC-0327]. A law firm's release of 6 February 2026 names O2 Sponsor 15 Partners and Deal C as its clients on the Sponsor 3 acquisition [F, PUB-0215].

08 E Sensitivity register: supporting evidence

This register brings the sensitivities that bear on the three proposed financings into one place, each set against what the evidence shows. Exhibit 9.168 holds the Deal A rows, from CreditSwan's monthly model of the proposed facilities on Ares Credit Group's model v24 (under 08 B earlier in this section); Exhibit 8.17 holds the Deal B and Deal C rows, from Part 08 section C and Part 08 section D and their supporting evidence in this section. Each value appears, with its reference, in the section named. The sensitivities of the businesses themselves close each deal part (Part 05 section G, Part 06 section H, Part 07 section G).

Exhibit 9.168 — In the lead case the liquidity covenant is first breached at an earnings shortfall of 7.4%, inside Deal A's own annual declines of FY25 and FY26; the leverage covenant needs 46%

Sensitivities that bear on the Deal A financing, set against observed ranges, on CreditSwan's monthly model of the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) and Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24; liquidity in $m of minimum quarter-average, refinancing at September 2030

SENSITIVITY	MODEL RESULT	OBSERVED RANGE (SOURCE)	DEAL A VALUE	READING ON THE OBSERVED RANGE
Draw of the delayed-draw loan	$36.6m when drawn as supplier-finance payments fall due; $22.3m when drawn only as cash runs short	The term sheet limits the loan to the supplier-finance unwind and lets revolver loans fund it only if the loan is unavailable (LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026), Use of Proceeds); Ares Credit Group's model draws $86m and holds revolver loans at $67m (MODEL OUTPUT!D33:H34, C41:I41)	$177.7m to unwind in 15 months (MODEL OUTPUT!D32:H32); $111m commitment	Headroom is $15.9m on the first rule and $0.8m on the second; the term sheet does not say which applies

SENSITIVITY	MODEL RESULT	OBSERVED RANGE (SOURCE)	DEAL A VALUE	READING ON THE OBSERVED RANGE
Timing of closure cash	$36.6m spread over the remaining lease terms ($39.6m on Ares Credit Group's $4.3m figure); $21.0m inside four quarters	Workbook: costs run to lease end, 42.1 months on average (Summary!J33, B49); Ares Credit Group's model: $4.3m, April 2027 to March 2028 (MODEL OUTPUT!F20:I20); the Diligence & Structure Update (p.11) shows about $4.3m a year on a lease average of about five years	$21.79m of cash (Summary!J43)	Amount matters less than timing: paid as the leases run, the covenant is clear and minimum liquidity is about $1m below Ares Credit Group's figure; paid inside four quarters, for example to buy out the leases, it is about $17m lower and below the covenant
Closure benefit	$25.5m with half the $12m benefit, June 2029 quarter	Recapture measured at no peer; stranded overhead up to $2.1–4.7m a year and stranded advertising $1.1–1.9m (Part 05 section D)	$12m a year (CIP p.1)	Half the benefit is inside the bounded view of the second round and leaves $3.9m of headroom
EBITDA shortfall	Liquidity covenant first breached at 6.6% (9.0% on Ares Credit Group's closure figure; 2.0% if the loan is drawn only when cash is short); leverage covenant at 46%; at 9% with no closure benefit liquidity is below $21.5m from the December 2027 quarter	Deal A's own annual declines: reported EBITDA −11.9%, −6.7%, −23.5%, −19.9% (FY23–FY26); ex-gains −26.2%, −33.2% (FY25–FY26); company EBITDA −23.2%, −9.2% (FY25–FY26) and −10.4% FY26 to LTM June 2026; Q1 FY27 −34% year on year (DLA-0854; bank model row 181)	LTM June 2026 company EBITDA $74.9m; downside maturity EBITDA $93.3m	The liquidity threshold lies inside Deal A's own observed annual declines; the leverage covenant does not give the first signal. The 9% downside still leaves maturity EBITDA 19.6% above today's actual
Refinancing multiple	Needs: base $253.0m, downside $336.7m; finance leases $112.2m	Closed first-lien prints 3.81–4.27x, median 4.27x; 5.97x in 2021 only (Exhibit 4.09)	Reported LTM $81.1m; company LTM $74.9m; FY26 $71.2m; ex-gains $59.6m	At 4.27x, base path with actual rungs held flat: +$30.5m, +$5.8m, −$10.8m, −$62.8m; downside path on its own EBITDA +$3.7m (−$57.8m at 3.81x)
Refinancing coverage and rate	Cash flow available for debt service: base $42.4m, downside $21.6m	2026 spreads S+383 to S+534 on SOFR 4.10% (OP2-4336, OP7-1164, DLA-5593, A8-S012); peer cover prints 0.7–1.6x on mixed definitions	1.08x cover	Base path covered (+$86.9m at S+528). Downside path short by $142–177m at 1.08x across observed spreads, and by $90m to $216m at the most and least favourable observed combinations

Source: CreditSwan monthly model (C-FIN-1, C-FIN-2, C-FIN-3); observed ranges as cited in each row · Basis: P for the model results; A for the observed ranges unless marked. All readings [I] · Assumption: Lead case unless stated: loan drawn as supplier-finance payments fall due; workbook closure cash of $21.79m over the remaining lease terms; $4.3m of fees

The inputs that move each financing reading are operating inputs with observed ranges, and at none of the three deals is the leverage covenant the first constraint: at Deal A it is liquidity, at Deal B funding, and at Deal C cash cover and the growth the refinancing needs. At Deal A, on the 21 September term sheet and Ares Credit Group's model v24, a uniform earnings shortfall of 7.4% breaches the liquidity covenant in the lead case, inside Deal A's own annual declines of FY25 and FY26, while the leverage covenant needs 46% [I, C-FIN-2]. At Deal B the first constraint is funding: the near-term batch is $8.8m or $11.8m short of committed sources, and refinancing the term loan and delayed-draw loan at 4.3x in December 2030 needs EBITDA of $16.1–16.6m against $11.16m on Ares Credit Group's measure today [I, C-FIN-5; Exhibit 9.162]. At Deal C fixed-charge cover computes at 0.77x on Ares Credit Group's cash EBITDA with the $1.0m non-cash impairment added back; Option Two refinances at the 4.3x median only with at least 1.57% a year of EBITDA growth on Ares Credit Group's $29.4m, against same-store clinic EBITDA of +1.0% for CY2025 and −5.8% for LTM July 2026; and Option One's senior result reverses with a 17% cash coupon on the sponsor instrument, whose terms are not in the files [I, note C-90]. What each deal's reading would need is set out in the "What would change it" column of Exhibit 8.02.

08 F Deal A term sheet: supporting evidence

Cover note

CreditSwan's engagement is the commercial diligence on Deal A; the financing judgement — leverage, covenant levels and structure — is Ares Credit Group's. The fifteen points below are observations on the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) that follow from our commercial findings: that Deal A's pressure point is cash rather than its leverage multiple, that the clinic closures carry costs and rent obligations beyond those in Ares Credit Group's model, that the supply-chain-finance (SCF) balance to be unwound is large and not yet reconciled, and that recovery rests on the owned real estate. They are offered in case they are useful to Ares Credit Group and its counsel, not as recommendations, and each is framed as an observation or a question. Figures described as "our illustrative cases" come from a CreditSwan quarterly model of the proposed facilities and covenants on four operating cases (management, Ares Credit Group's model v24, a CreditSwan base and a downside), built to see how the commercial findings flow through to cash; they are illustrations, not forecasts. Liquidity and leverage-ratio results not so described come from CreditSwan's monthly model of the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) on Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24 (under 08 B earlier in this section; note C-FIN-1), which charges finance-lease interest to cash; where both give a figure, the monthly model governs.

What the observations rest on

On an EBITDAR reading of the leverage ratio the proposed leverage covenant holds with room: on CreditSwan's monthly model of the LW draft term sheet and Ares Credit Group's Deal A model v24 the ratio peaks at 4.53x against 6.35x in the lead case (March 2027 quarter) [I, C-FIN-1, C-FIN-2], and in our illustrative base case at 4.73x [I]. Liquidity is the tighter test. On the same monthly model, which charges finance-lease interest to cash, minimum quarter-average Liquidity is $36.6m against the $21.5m minimum (March 2028 quarter) when the delayed-draw loan is drawn as supplier-finance payments fall due and the company's $21.79m of closure cash is paid over the remaining lease terms; it is $22.3m when the loan is drawn only as cash runs short, and $21.0m when the closure cash is paid inside four quarters [I, C-FIN-1]. Our illustrative cases take the finance-lease cash line as Ares Credit Group's model has it, so they do not charge the interest component; the illustrative base case's minimum of $44m is about $35m once that interest is charged ($9.2m to December 2027) [I, C-FIN-6]. Neither the monthly model nor the quarterly illustrative cases can certify a daily-average test; the results indicate direction. In our illustrative downside cases the proposed covenants give no early warning: if the last year's trend simply continues, the leverage covenant never trips and Liquidity falls below $21m in the March 2029 quarter; with modest cash misses (second-round cash at 52%, capex back to its historical share of sales) or the 10-Q's SCF balance, it does so in the December 2027 quarter; and with a weak September quarter, a pharmacy-margin squeeze, a late second round and a fast SCF unwind, in the June 2027 quarter [I]. The commercial inputs behind these paths are Deal A's own: audited FY26 EBITDA (E1) of $71.2m includes $16.0m of disposal gains ($56.4m without them) [F/I, FY26 10-K]; the SCF balance is $197.6m in the FY26 10-K, $183.9m in the Q1 FY27 10-Q and $151.8m in the company model [F/M]; and second-round closure cash is up to $21.79m over the remaining lease terms in the company's workbook, with base rent separate, against $4.3m of cash and $4.3m of fees in Ares Credit Group's model [M, Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J43, J33; A, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24, MODEL OUTPUT!F20:I20, F21]. Items 1–7 and 15 bear on early warning; items 8–14 concern wording and closing procedure.

Observations

Exhibit 9.169 — Fifteen observations on the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026): eight bear on early warning, where liquidity rather than the leverage covenant is the tighter test, and seven concern wording and closing procedure

Clause, observation and the commercial finding it follows from; illustrative cases modelled from a September 2026 closing balance sheet on the EBITDAR reading of the leverage ratio

#	CLAUSE	OBSERVATION	WHY IT FOLLOWS FROM THE COMMERCIAL FINDINGS
1	Financial Covenants (1); Documentation Principles (1)	One reading of the Lease Adjusted Net Leverage Ratio is that its denominator is Consolidated EBITDA **plus the LTM Operating Lease Expenses capitalised 5.3x in the numerator ($41.4m)**, rather than the Existing Credit Agreement's total rent ($76.3m); the text does not settle that reading, and it does not say **whether stock compensation ($5.4m LTM) is added back**.	Rent treatment decides what the ratio measures [I]. Without rent in the denominator the ratio is 6.28x at close against 6.35x; in our illustrative cases the Ares Credit Group model v24 case would then sit above the level at the first test and the DDTL could not be drawn [I]. The EBITDAR (lease-consistent) reading is also the construction Ares Credit Group's model v24 uses (MODEL OUTPUT rows 52–46: 4.46x at the first quarterly test) [A]. The stock-compensation add-back loosens the covenant further and, in our illustrative downside, moves the Liquidity shortfall by two quarters [I].
2	Financial Covenants (1)	The 6.35x–5.81x schedule sits well above the paths in our illustrative cases, in Ares Credit Group's model v24 and in CreditSwan's monthly lead case on that model, set out under 08 B earlier in this section (peak 4.53x, note C-FIN-1); on these levels the leverage covenant gives no earlier warning than Liquidity in any of our illustrative downside cases.	Ares Credit Group's model v24 path sits 27–35% below 6.35x–5.81x on an EBITDAR basis, and our illustrative base case would need a 42% EBITDA shortfall to reach the level [A/I]; Deal A's own annual EBITDA declines have been 11.9%, 6.7%, 23.5% and 19.9% on audited E1 (FY23–FY26), 33.2% on E1 excluding disposal gains in FY26, and 34% year on year in Q1 FY27 on company non-GAAP EBITDA (E2m, PF) [F/I].
3	Conditions Precedent (d)	As written, the DDTL condition appears to be tested at each draw, pro forma, on trailing EBITDA; the use of proceeds covers payments due within 107 days of each draw. It would help us to understand which reading Ares Credit Group intends.	The SCF balance to be unwound is $140m, $177m or $184m depending on scope [I], and $122.6m of the SCF aging is already over 107 days, against the term sheet's 107-day eligibility language [F, SCF aging]. Testing each draw on trailing EBITDA can block funding without reducing leverage, because the draw replaces a payable [I]. In our illustrative base case (the quarterly model) the March 2027 draw passes at 4.76x (a 3.0% cushion), and in the monthly lead case on Ares Credit Group's model v24 at 4.60x (a 4.7% cushion) [I, C-FIN-1]; a one-quarter COVID-type shock at the start of the unwind exhausts base-case cash as written, but not when the test is applied once at close. At 5.15x our illustrative downside passes a once-at-close test by only 0.010x [I].
4	Revolving Credit Facility (iii)	The term sheet does not define "if Delayed Draw Term Loans may be drawn" (for example, whether it requires commitments not terminated **and** condition (d) met), or say whether the $67m cap lifts in a quarter in which a draw is refused in whole or in part.	While the $67m cap applies, with $44m drawn and $25.5m of letters of credit, availability is exactly $21.5m, the covenant minimum [I]. In our illustrative quarterly cases, which do not charge finance-lease interest, the Ares Credit Group model v24 case drawn as Ares Credit Group's model draws it ($86m, cap kept on) averages $13.2m of daily Liquidity in the September 2027 quarter, and $50m with $111m drawn [I]; in the monthly lead case on Ares Credit Group's model v24 (Exhibit 9.157) the full $111m is drawn by April 2027, the cap lifts and the September 2027 quarter averages $55.5m [I, C-FIN-1]. In our illustrative case on the 10-Q's SCF scope, without the build-up on the Lender 6 line and with a weak September quarter, Liquidity bottoms at $8.0m if the cap lifts when a draw is partly refused, and cash runs out in the September 2027 quarter if it does not [I].

#	CLAUSE	OBSERVATION	WHY IT FOLLOWS FROM THE COMMERCIAL FINDINGS
5	Letters of Credit	It would help to confirm issuance of **at least $25.5m** under the new revolver (the letters of credit outstanding under the existing revolver, 10-Q at 27 June 2026), and the beneficiary and expiry of the existing letter.	If the letters are cash-collateralised instead, the ratio rises 0.21x at close and, in our illustrative downside, headroom falls to 0.3% [I]. Liquidity, not leverage, is where Deal A's cash path is tightest (see above).
6	Financial Covenants (2); fn.6	Liquidity counts cash only if it is Qualified Cash, which must be subject to an account control agreement; the control agreements are due 79 days after closing, and cash in accounts without them does not count. It would help to see the non-DACA cash breakdown.	Each $1m held outside control agreements is $1m less Liquidity; our illustrative base case falls below the minimum if $22.5m of cash sits outside them [I]. Deal A's levered cash is thin: cash from operations less capex and finance-lease principal was $0.1m in FY26, after a $35.8m working-capital release, and −$24.3m for the twelve months to June 2026 [F/I, FY26 10-K; Q1 FY27 10-Q].
7	Negative Covenants (restricted payments)	The $7.4m December 2026 dividend is not subject to the leverage, FCCR or Liquidity conditions, which apply to restricted payments after 31 December 2026; those conditions exclude the payment itself from the calculation; run-rate add-backs count in the Consolidated EBITDA of the 3.38x test; and FCCR is to be defined (see item 15).	The December 2026 payment falls two quarters before our illustrative downside's Liquidity shortfall, and not paying it is what keeps our illustrative SCF-squeeze case above $21m ($25.5m against $18.4m); a fully used G&A bucket releases dividends that take the management case below $21m [I]. The $12m run-rate second-round benefit [M, CIP p.1] is before up to $2.1–4.7m a year of stranded corporate overhead (an upper bound that assumes all of the overhead attributable to the 119 clinics stays behind) and $1.1–1.9m of stranded advertising (at Deal A's own 1.38% (FY25) to 2.36% (FY26) advertising-to-sales ratio on the 119 clinics' sales, Part 05 section D), and $3.4–4.3m of it rests on a 13% sales-recapture assumption that no peer has measured [I]. Ares Credit Group's model v24 FCCR of 1.23x at close excludes finance-lease interest; including it gives about 0.93x, below the 1.03x dividend gate [A/I].
8	Documentation Principles (1)a–b	It would help to see clauses (f) and (g) of the Existing Credit Agreement's "EBITDAR" definition (and (i) and (l), which the term sheet replaces), and a statement of the base of the 26% cap. The reference to "December 31, 2028" is a calendar date rather than a Deal A fiscal quarter-end. The text does not say whether clause (d) removes gains on disposal — including gains on cash sales of owned real estate and on lease terminations — from Consolidated EBITDA.	If (f)/(g) are the rent add-back, the 26% cap base shrinks: in our illustrative downside the leverage level is then reached in the December 2027 quarter (still after Liquidity), and base-case headroom falls to 27% [I]. Disposal gains are material at Deal A: FY26 E1 of $71.2m includes $16.0m and LTM June 2026 E1 of $81.1m includes $19.7m [F]; the company's existing-agreement EBITDAR of $113.3m includes $17.4m of gains, and on the lease-consistent reading the closing ratio is 3.81x with them and 4.47x without them [M/I]. Second-round closure cash in the company's workbook is $21.79m, which with $4.3m of fees is $25.9m against the term sheet's $21.5m cash-cost sub-cap if it fell in one test period; spread over the lease terms it is about $5.3m a year and inside the sub-cap [M, Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data, Summary!J43, J33; F, LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026), Documentation Principles (1)].
9	Covenants start; DDTL window; netting cap; ECF	Several dates in the term sheet are calendar dates, while the SCF unwind and the second-round closures run on Deal A's fiscal quarters.	The first full fiscal quarter after closing, and so the first test date, depends on the closing date [I].
10	Consolidated Funded Indebtedness	The text does not say whether SCF trade payables are "financing obligations" within Consolidated Funded Indebtedness.	If they were caught, the ratio would be 5.42x at close, only 16.6% inside 6.35x [I]. The SCF balance is large and not yet reconciled: $197.6m (FY26 10-K), $183.9m (Q1 FY27 10-Q), $151.8m (company model) and $137.1m utilised in the Credit Summary of the company's current supply-chain-finance ageing [F/M]; on audited FY26 E1 the balance chosen moves lease- and supplier-finance-adjusted leverage between 4.98x and 5.30x (5.99x–6.35x excluding disposal gains) [I].
11	Prepayments (a)	The term sheet does not state the excess-cash-flow treatment of SCF payments and DDTL proceeds, and leaves the leverage levels for the step-downs to be agreed.	In our illustrative cases up to $2.6m of minimum Liquidity turns on this treatment [I].
12	Prepayments ©; Prepayment Premium	As drafted, mandatory prepayments from asset sales, including sales arising from the Specified Clinic Closure above the $13.3m threshold, bear the call premium (Prepayment Premium, clause (iv)); the reinvestment wording of Prepayments © both refers to reinvestment rights "to be agreed" and excludes "the right to reinvest such net cash proceeds".	The closure programme is central to the plan — the first round raised about $24m of net proceeds from owned-clinic sales and lease assignments [F, CIP p.1 fn.1] — so the premium falls on proceeds of the programme the plan relies on [I].
13	Term Loan; DDTL	The term sheet states the term loan's amortisation and gives the delayed-draw loans identical terms, without a separate DDTL amortisation schedule (our illustrative cases assume the term loan's 1%). Ares Credit Group's model v24 row 43 keeps the DDTL at cumulative draws and does not reflect the amortisation paid in row 31, and its cell I108 points to N36 rather than R36; separately, the finance-lease interest component is not charged to cash (MODEL OUTPUT!D30 and D171).	Ares Credit Group's model v24 overstates debt by $0.5–0.8m [I]. The finance-lease interest not charged to cash is $2.0m in Q3 FY27 and $28.4m cumulatively through FY31 [F, Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24 MODEL OUTPUT!D30 `=+D171-D22`, D171].
14	Conditions Precedent; Collateral	The conditions precedent are usual and customary plus four listed conditions; they include no SCF reconciliation by bank, bank pacing letters (Lender 3, Lender 2) or closing bring-down of the revolver and SCF (10-Q, June 2026: $94.1m revolver, $183.9m SCF). On collateral, the term sheet grants a perfected first-priority security interest in substantially all assets other than Excluded Assets, which are to be defined; it contains **no mortgage provision**, real-estate appraisal or asset-coverage test.	On the 10-Q's SCF scope our illustrative base case falls below its Liquidity covenant at every unwind speed except a late run-off [I]. Recovery is a real-estate question: NOLV of $228m covers funded debt 1.27x at close only with the $152m of owned real estate (the company's estimate of fair market value, built on tax-assessed values; no third-party appraisal) [F/M, Diligence & Structure Update p.36; Ares Credit Group Diligence Tracker, tab Ares Credit Group, J59]; without it NOLV is $76m — **0.43x at close and 0.24x at our illustrative base-case peak** [I] — and at the maximum funded amount of $284m the facilities exceed NOLV by $58m (total commitments of $336m exceed it by $101.6m) [I].

#	CLAUSE	OBSERVATION	WHY IT FOLLOWS FROM THE COMMERCIAL FINDINGS
15	Financial Covenants	The term sheet has no fixed charge coverage maintenance test. In the gradual declines in our illustrative cases, LTM cover of (Consolidated EBITDA − capex) ÷ (cash interest + scheduled amortisation + finance-lease payments + cash taxes) declines ahead of Liquidity: it is already below 0.72x 3–6 quarters before Liquidity falls below the minimum; the illustrative base case's minimum is 0.860x.	The commercial finding is a gradual decline: survivor-base comparable traffic has fallen every year FY24–FY26 (−3.9% to −7.9%), and cover on our proxy on audited E1 fell from 1.73x (FY24) to 1.13x (FY25) and 0.77x (FY26), 0.51x excluding disposal gains [F/I]. On the term sheet's levels the leverage covenant gives no earlier warning than Liquidity in these cases (item 2). The cover ratio falls below 0.72x 2 quarters before Liquidity when cash misses are added, and not before it when the SCF balance drives the shortfall; its minimum is 0.734x in a delayed recovery that the business survives and 0.707x in a milder decline [I].

Source: DLA-023 (LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026)); Ares Credit Group Deal A Model v24; Deal A FY26 10-K and Q1 FY27 10-Q; Diligence & Structure Update; Alpha - FY27 Clinic Closure Data; CreditSwan illustrative cases (quarterly model of the proposed facilities; notes C-FIN-6 and C-FIN-7) · Basis: Illustrative cases P; they take the finance-lease cash line as Ares Credit Group's model has it and do not charge its interest component; tags as marked in each cell

Our illustrative cases are modelled from a September 2026 closing balance sheet (a modelling convention, not a view on timing) and on the EBITDAR reading (note C-FIN-7). Negative cash in the downside is illustrative. Quarter references are to fiscal quarters ending in the month named.

Part 10 — FAQ

Answers to the questions a credit committee is likely to ask of this document, each pointing to the part that substantiates it

The questions are grouped by scope, interpretation, provenance, findings and process. Each answer gives the short version first and refers to exhibits and register rows rather than restating figures.

A · Scope

This is commercial diligence on preventive care and pharmacy, general practice veterinary care and the three live deals, with wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals as context only; it is not a quality-of-earnings review or a financing recommendation, and its evidence is thinnest where the live deals sit.

What is this document, and what is it not?

It is CreditSwan's commercial diligence on preventive care and pharmacy and general practice veterinary care, and on three live opportunities: Deal A, Deal B and Deal C.

It answers Ares Credit Group's asks as Ares Credit Group wrote them (Part 01 section C; Exhibit 1.06): the six industry measures in Part 03; multiples, leverage over time and the benchmark of historical deals in Part 04; and a test of each deal thesis in Part 05 to Part 07, summarised in Part 01. It is not a quality-of-earnings review, an audit, a legal review of the documents or an appraisal of collateral (Part 09 section B; Part 09 section H). The observations on the proposed financings sit in Part 08 alone, and the financing judgement is Ares Credit Group's.

What period does the evidence cover, and where is it thin?

It covers files supplied through 1 October 2026 (266 through 28 September 2026 and six received on 1 October 2026), public series retrieved on 28 September 2026 and public pages read on 30 September 2026.

Depth differs sharply by operator. Deal A's public filings give the only long audited record; the clinic-level data for Operator 1 and Operator 2 stop before the recent soft period; and the three live deals' files are the shortest in the set (Exhibit 1.17; Exhibit 9.30). Statements across operators about earlier downturns therefore rest on one to three operators each, and the sections say so. The named gaps, each with the file that would close it, are in Part 09 section H and Exhibit 9.27.

Why are wellness clinics and emergency and specialty hospitals included, and how is Deal B Wellness Clinics treated?

They are context only, because their economics differ from those of core general practice care.

A wellness-clinic visit is built on a vaccine and wellness exam and an emergency or specialty case is a referral-driven, often insured case; both differ from a core patient invoice on ticket, payer, labour and volume. They are shown in Part 04 section G, where they inform leverage, adjustment share and multiples on a stated earnings measure, and they never enter a core statistic (A-10). Deal B Wellness Clinics, Deal B's wellness clinic segment, is analysed on its own in Part 06 section F, placed only against the wellness clinic set, and shown in its contribution to Deal B's consolidated revenue and clinic-level earnings.

B · Interpretation

Each reading is a statement about the evidence supplied to date and each figure sits on a named definition, so two figures that differ differ in definition or source; operators are ranked only where a ranking is valid, and public signals change no reading.

How should the four reading labels be read?

As our reading on the evidence supplied to date, not as a recommendation or a final view.

Supported means every essential condition of a thesis component rests on direct evidence, with no material contrary evidence unresolved. Partially supported means some conditions hold and others do not, and the label says which. Contradicted means the evidence supplied does not support at least one essential condition. Insufficient evidence means an essential condition cannot yet be tested, and the missing file is named (Part 09 section B). A partially supported reading flagged *leans supported* is one where the part that holds carries most of the component as Ares Credit

Group framed it, and one open point is named (Part 09 section C). Every reading names what would change it, and Part 01 section B sets out all sixteen with what holds and what does not (Exhibit 1.04; Exhibit 1.05). None approves or rejects a transaction.

Why do your EBITDA figures differ from the sponsors' and from Ares Credit Group's models?

Because they are different measures, and this document keeps each on its own named level, from reported to cash (A-03).

Reported EBITDA comes from the accounts; adjusted EBITDA is the figure after the company's or a quality-of-earnings review's adjustments; pro forma EBITDA includes months before ownership; run-rate EBITDA adds run-rate items such as synergies; underwriting EBITDA is the lender's own figure; and cash EBITDA deducts the "one-time" deal and integration costs that in fact recur. The ladder is defined in Exhibit 9.04. The gap between levels is widest where acquisition activity is heaviest (Part 03 section F; Part 07 section D), and the same debt reads very differently on each (Exhibit 9.75; A-12).

Why can the same company show two figures for what looks like one measure?

Because the two figures sit on different definitions or come from different sources, and each is named where it appears.

A company's figure for one measure, one period and one definition is the same throughout the document. Where two appear, they differ in something stated beside them: rent treatment (cash or book rent), whether vendor rebates are included, the clinic base (all clinics or survivors only), the same-store definition (the company's or the common one), or the earnings level (Part 09 section C; A-01, A-02, A-07). Live-deal figures come from the companies' own documents and govern the readings (A-08). Deal B's trade-area measures are the one case where company and public figures are both shown, each named (Part 06 section C; A-P8).

Why are operators described rather than ranked?

A ranking needs at least three operators on one definition in one environment, and most comparisons fail that test (A-09).

Each operator sits on its own period, rent treatment and clinic base. Where the test is met the ranking is shown, each in one environment, and ranks do not carry across environments (Part 04 section E; Exhibit 9.93). Elsewhere the figures are shown side by side with their definitions and read as ranges. Part 04 section F maps which operators are valid comparators for each live deal and on which measures, and Exhibit 4.17 names the files that would make more comparisons valid.

Do the public signals change any reading?

No reading changes its label because of a public signal.

The signals are set beside the evidence, in a block headed "Public signals" at the end of the section they bear on, and each reading rests on the supplied documents. Two public computations bear directly on a thesis component: the markets around Deal B's newer clinics, read on the company's own cohorts (Part 06 section C; A-P6), and Deal A's clinic results against proximity to an Operator 1 clinic (Part 05 section B; A-P7). Each adds a clause to the basis of its reading, MS2 and M1; neither decides the label or the reading sentence.

What changed in V2, and why did two readings move?

Sixty-two files arrived on 1 October 2026, six of them new (Part 09 section E), and Ares Credit Group commented on the study as issued on 30 September 2026; two Deal A readings moved, both on evidence.

M1 and M4 moved from contradicted to partially supported, leaning supported. The second-round clinic list made the weak tail measurable, and on Ares Credit Group's basis, with vendor co-op included as peers report it, after finance-lease cost the clinics kept sit in the lower half of the peer band once the tail closes; falling traffic across those clinics is the open point (Part 01 section B; Exhibit 1.04). M3, MS1 and MS5 keep their labels, with qualifiers drawn from the files of 1 October 2026, and M5 is read on the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026. No reading moved on tone alone.

Why is volume read as consistent in V2, when on 30 September 2026 it was read as not consistent?

The data are unchanged; consistency is read as the steadiness of the yearly change, which is what a lender relies on.

Outside 2020, half of operator-years moved comparable visits by between −3.8% and +3.0%, and the 2010–19 median was +0.3% a year (Exhibit 3.02; Exhibit 3.03; Part 03 section A). What the reading of 30 September 2026 stressed still holds and is shown as a watch item: visits did not regain their 2019 level at the three operators with data, and 2022–26 has been softer. Flat, steady volume with pricing power behind it is an acceptable credit profile (Part 03 section B).

Why are Deal A's clinic margins shown with vendor co-op included?

Because that is Ares Credit Group's basis, and the peer band it is set against also includes rebates, so both bases sit side by side with the adjustment between them named.

With co-op allocated to clinics at Ares Credit Group's rate, Deal A's FY26 clinic margin is 12.8%; after finance-lease cost at book, which peers on cash rent carry inside rent, it is 10.7%, at the floor of the 10.7–17.4% peer band, and 12.5% for the clinics kept after the second round (Exhibit 1.01; Exhibit 1.12). The placement is indicative: the co-op is allocated at a flat rate and the rent is at book (note C-V2-1). Before co-op, the basis used on 30 September 2026, the margins are 7.9% and 5.4% (Exhibit 1.01).

C · Provenance

Every figure resolves from this package to a supplied document, a public source or a computation note, with its evidence tag and basis stated; the choices that move headlines most are in the register with their sensitivity.

Where did the data come from?

From the files Ares Credit Group supplied, Deal A's public filings, public statistical series, the industry reports supplied, and public sources read on 30 September 2026.

Every figure carries its period, basis, evidence tag and the file and page or cell it comes from (Part 01 section F; Exhibit 1.15). Of the 1,802 claims recorded from the industry reports supplied, the 369 that could be tested against public data were tested one by one, and a report figure is relied on only where it is borne out; the other 1,432 are internal to the reports and not tested (Exhibit 9.24; Part 09 section H). The public series and public sources are listed with their addresses and the dates they were read (Part 09 section E; Exhibit 9.17). Management presentations, sponsor models and Ares Credit Group's own models are treated as claims to test, not as inputs (Part 09 section B).

How do I trace a figure, and how far was it checked?

Each figure carries a tag and a reference that resolve from this package alone, and the Evidence index states how far each cited row was compared with its source.

The tag says what kind of statement a figure is: [F] a documented fact, [M] a management or sponsor claim, [A] an Ares Credit Group hypothesis or model output, [I] our inference or computation, [U] unresolved (for a public figure, read only in a secondary report whose original could not be read, with the reporter named). The basis flag says whether it is actual, pro forma or projected (Part 09 section D; Exhibit 1.18). A reference leads to a supplied document, a public source, a row of the Evidence index or a computation note (Part 09 section F; Part 09 section G). Most rows are single reads, and the index says so row by row (Exhibit 9.20); Part 09 section F gives the counts by check status.

What are public signals, and how far can they be relied on?

They show the operators from outside, and they can be relied on as observations of the date they were read, not as evidence of clinic economics.

They cover customer and employer ratings, complaint counts, posted prices and care-guarantee terms, where clinics sit and who competes nearby, company filings and releases, and official statistics. Each figure names its source, its sample and the date it was read, takes its evidence tag from the source read (A-P1), and resolves through the Evidence index to a public address (Part 09 section F). A rating on a handful of reviews is anecdote and is marked as such. Where the document already carries the same measure from a supplied document, that value governs (A-P8). Part 04 section H sets out how to read them, and Part 09 section H gives their limits.

What happens if the most important assumption is wrong?

The register states, for each assumption, how far a headline moves if the choice were made differently; among the business assumptions, the earnings level, the rent treatment and the maintenance-capex measure move the most.

Each row of Exhibit 9.01 gives the value used, where it is documented, the sensitivity and the supplies that use it (Part 09 section A). The earnings level under the same debt moves a leverage print more than the vintage of the deal does (A-03, A-12; Part 04 section B). Clinic margins are pooled across operators only before rebates on cash rent (A-02). Deal A's total capex stands in for maintenance capex, an upper bound (A-04). The business sensitivities close each deal part (Part 05 section G, Part 06 section H, Part 07 section G), and the financing assumptions (A-F11 to A-F14 for the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026; A-F1 to A-F10 for the 21 September 2026 term sheet, whose analysis is in Part 09 section O) and their effect are in Part 08 section E and Part 09 section A.

How many operators stand behind the yearly medians of comparable traffic and ticket?

One to four a year, because few operators supplied clinic-level traffic; the count is shown for every year.

The long-run statements rest on 35 operator-years at seven parent companies for traffic and ticket and, for comparable sales, on up to eleven operators a year (Exhibit 3.03; Exhibit 3.18; note C-120). A yearly median that rests on one operator is that operator's figure, and the exhibit says so.

D · Findings

On the evidence supplied to date, the theses find support in Deal B's first-year cohort delivery and Deal C's audited clinic margin, and fall short on Deal A's retained clinics, the trend since 2024, the cash behind adjusted earnings and files not yet supplied.

What in this industry is durable, and what is temporary?

The clinic's margin is steadier than platform earnings and cash; its stability through a recession is not established.

Durable across the record: a ticket that has matched or beaten veterinary-price inflation in five of six complete operator windows, gross margins that move little within most operators, a mid-teens clinic margin before rebates on cash rent, low maintenance reinvestment, and "one-time" acquisition costs that recur at every acquisitive platform. Visits are flat over a cycle and, outside 2020, steady from year to year, and comparable sales rise in most years through the ticket rather than through more customers (Part 03 section A; Part 03 section B; Part 03 section E; Exhibit 9.37). Temporary: the 2020 shock and 2021 rebound, the 2021–23 price surge and part of the 2024 to 2026 soft period. Company-specific: Deal A's loss-making tail and its fall in traffic (Part 01 section D; Exhibit 1.08).

Is Deal A's underperformance a closeable tail?

In large part: the weakest clinics are an identifiable tail and closing them lifts clinic margin, but traffic is falling across the clinics Deal A keeps, and closures do not address that.

On Ares Credit Group's basis, with co-op allocated to clinics, the clinic margin rises from 12.8% for all clinics to 14.4% for the 824 kept after the second round, and the loss-making share from 19.5% to 11.4%; 104 of the 119 second-round clinics sit in Ares Credit Group's bottom quartile, and clinic rank persists (Exhibit 1.01; Exhibit 5.04; Part 05 section B). The open point is the trend: with quartiles fixed at FY23, the top half's clinic EBITDA fell 16% to FY26, and the clinics kept are last of three on comparable traffic (Exhibit 9.122; Part 05 section E). Our reading on the evidence supplied to date is **Partially supported** (leans supported) for M1 and for M4. FY27 results by fixed cohort and current trading would most change it (Part 05 section G).

How is Deal A's second round valued now that the clinic list has arrived?

In two cases, because its sign turns on how the company measures the closing clinics' contribution, which its workbook does not define.

If the benefit is the reversal of the 119 clinics' "Profit co-op" loss, which is after depreciation, interest and finance-lease cost, the round adds +$7.2m to +$20.4m a year across the scenarios; on the workbook's "Contribution" measure the same scenarios give −$11.8m to +$0.6m, and clinic EBITDA including co-op, −$1.8m to +$11.2m, lies between them (Part 05 section D; note C-V2-3). Closure cash is $21.79m to lease end plus $4.3m of fees, and 30 of the 109 leases expire within 21 months, so whether leases are exited or run to term moves the answer (Exhibit 5.10; A-F2). The first round removed real clinic losses, yet reported EBITDA excluding disposal gains still fell (M2, **Partially supported**; Part 05 section C). Our reading on M3, on the evidence supplied to date, is **Insufficient evidence**: the clinic list now allows a valuation, and its sign turns on the definition of "Contribution" and on lease exits. The effect on liquidity is in Part 08 section B.

Are Deal B's newer acquisition cohorts better than the earlier ones?

They start better, and the newest cohort earns the clinic margin the company states; on the evidence to July 2026 the start has not yet been shown to last.

The newest cohort earned 18.9% in its 2025 owned months, as the company says (Exhibit 1.02). In their first owned year the 2024 and 2025 cohorts delivered more of the seller EBITDA they were priced on than the one peer measured the same way (Exhibit 6.04), and the newer clinics sit in higher-income markets (Part 06 section C). But every cohort lost patient visits in the months after purchase (Exhibit 9.130), the 2024 clinics fell back in their second owned year (Exhibit 6.05), the 2025 cohort has no second owned year yet, the company's own data do not show the narrowing first-year sales dip its responses describe, and clinics owned 21 months or more sit at or below the bottom of the peer range on cash rent after rebates (Exhibit 6.19). Our reading on MS1, on the evidence supplied to date, is **Partially supported** — the newest cohort's 18% clinic margin is confirmed on owned months; sustained economics not yet shown (Part 06 section B).

Can Deal B's corporate infrastructure support twice its size?

Not yet shown: corporate heads per clinic have fallen, but no file defines or costs a doubling case, and the saving per clinic in the borrower's plan is a forecast.

What holds: corporate heads per clinic fell from 0.76 to 0.46 between December 2022 and March 2026. On the financing model's segment split, corporate overhead per general practice and preventive clinic rose from $96.0k in FY24 to $137.1k for LTM March 2026, and the borrower's plan brings it to about $117k at 136 clinics in FY28E, with overhead falling from 9.2% to 5.9% of revenue, a saving per clinic that no costed case supports (Part 06 section E). The integration budget per acquired clinic is 13–31% of the like-for-like cost observed, and peers' overhead ratios did not fall with scale. Our reading on MS4, on the evidence supplied to date, is **Insufficient evidence** — no costed doubling case; the evidence leans against. A costed 1.8x case would change it.

What is Deal B Wellness Clinics worth, and why does its margin gap matter?

DBW earns more of Deal B's clinic-level earnings than its share of revenue, and its value on wellness clinic multiples is a range; its clinic-level earnings have fallen under Deal B's ownership, and the recovery the company reports is not yet in the files.

What holds: its share of Deal B's clinic-level earnings is larger than its share of revenue, and the marketing pause the company names among the causes of lower visit count shows in the data (Part 06 section F). Owned-period four-wall EBITDA is 25.9% below the seller's for the same months, and the fall is in volume and cost, not in price (Exhibit 6.14). The company attributes the fall in visit count to lost momentum, the pause in marketing, household budget pressure and signage; its reported recovery after July rests on weekly data not supplied (Part 06 section F). On cash rent after rebates DBW's margin sits well above the one like-for-like wellness clinic peer, a gap that neither rent treatment nor royalty explains and that is a question for the company rather than a finding (Exhibit 9.136; Exhibit 9.135). Because of that larger share, any fall in DBW's margin weighs more on consolidated results than its size suggests. The files hold no separation model. Our reading on MS5, on the evidence supplied to date, is **Insufficient evidence** — the owned-period gap is confirmed at −26%; the recovery after July rests on weekly data not supplied.

Why is Deal C's claimed acquisition uplift not reproduced?

The gross-margin gain is reproduced on the same sites; the claim compares different cohorts of clinics, and on the same sites the gain in clinic EBITDA margin is much smaller.

What holds for Ares Credit Group's view: the audited clinic margin is high and broad across the estate (Part 07 section B; Exhibit 7.03). Matched site by site, seller months against owned months, gross margin rose but clinic EBITDA margin rose far less, so the mechanism is observed and most of it does not reach EBITDA (Part 07 section C; Exhibit 7.06). Acquired clinics also earn a smaller multiple of their entry EBITDA than acquired clinics at peers (Exhibit 7.12). Our reading on ST2, on the evidence supplied to date, is **Contradicted** — the claimed 584/695bp uplift is not supported; the gross-margin mechanism is observed. The basis of each buy-down multiple, with seller accounts that show rent on owned property, would change it (Part 07 section G).

Why is Deal C's cash EBITDA so far below its pro forma EBITDA?

Without the affiliate transaction bonuses its deal costs would sit inside the peer range; with them, deal costs have recurred at a rate no peer shows.

Cash EBITDA here is pro forma EBITDA less the transaction, integration and start-up costs presented as one-time that recur in three or more consecutive periods (A-03; Part 07 section D). Such costs recur at every acquisitive platform; Deal C's rate is what sets it apart, and without the affiliate bonuses it would sit inside the peer range (Exhibit 7.08; Exhibit 7.07). Whether the bonuses continue after close is untested. Ares Credit Group's underwriting figure also includes pre-acquisition and letter-of-intent earnings, which the quality-of-earnings report, not supplied, would test. Our reading on ST3, on the evidence supplied to date, is **Insufficient evidence** (underwriting EBITDA, E5; Accounting Firm 1 QoE absent) — cash earnings **contradicted** while the affiliate bonuses continue.

What does the recapitalisation model of 29 September 2026 change?

The structure Ares Credit Group is now modelling, not the readings on the business: Part 08 reads the financing on it as observations for Ares Credit Group's own underwriting.

The model replaces the delayed-draw loan of the 21 September 2026 term sheet with a larger term loan ($218m against $111m) beside the same $111m revolver, and repays the supplier-finance facility at close, so the questions raised on the term sheet about the delayed-draw loan and the supplier-finance facility largely fall away (Part 08 section B). On it the leverage covenant has room, and liquidity and fixed-charge cover become the points to settle; the model leaves out the closure programme and does not test the minimum liquidity, so Part 08 section B adds closure cash to it. M5 keeps its labels, with its basis now on this model. The fifteen term-sheet observations are read against it in Part 08 section F.

Why are the financings read as observations and not recommendations?

Because the financing judgement is Ares Credit Group's; Part 08 sets out what each proposed multiple rests on and how it behaves, for Ares Credit Group's own underwriting.

The observations are limited to which earnings measure and which debt each multiple uses, how the same debt reads on audited earnings, and the sensitivities as computed (Part 08 section A; A-12). Part 08 sets out, for each deal, which constraint is reached first and how it behaves under the

sensitivities; the inputs that drive each path have observed ranges, brought together in Part 08 section E. The financing readings use the same four labels and are our reading on the evidence supplied to date (Exhibit 8.02). None is a recommendation on quantum, pricing or structure, and the observations on the wording of the LW draft term sheet (21 September 2026) are framed as questions (Part 08 section F).

E · Process

A short list of named files would most change the readings, the measures that would show a reading changing are already defined with their sources, and the public signals can be read again at any date on the same definitions.

What information would most change the readings before close?

A short list of company files, ranked in Part 01 section E, each of which could move a reading in either direction.

They centre on Deal A's current trading, the definition behind the clinic contribution in its closing-clinics file and the lease-exit plan for those clinics; Deal B's latest quality-of-earnings roll-forward, the key from each acquisition to its clinics and DBW's weekly visit count file; and Deal C's quality-of-earnings report, its affiliate-bonus agreements and its latest same-store results (Exhibit 1.14). None of them changes the industry reading. The full request lists, numbered and prioritised, close each deal part (Part 05 section G, Part 06 section H, Part 07 section G; Exhibit 9.29); every item is addressed to the company and its bankers, through Ares Credit Group, and can be forwarded as it stands. Every reading names the file that would change it (Part 01 section B). For Deal A's financing, a term sheet that reflects the recapitalisation model of 29 September, with its fixed-charge cover and minimum liquidity terms, would settle the points Part 08 section B raises.

How is the evidence kept current after this document?

The measures that would show a reading changing are already defined here with their sources, so they can be read again from the companies' records as new files arrive.

Part 01 section G names the files that arrive next and, in Exhibit 1.19, the six measures from the companies' records that would show a reading changing should Ares Credit Group proceed, each with the readings it bears on, where it is shown and what a change would look like. Three further measures are public signals, which can be read again at any date as context; no reading changes because of a public signal. The benchmark of eleven operators on six of the eight areas Ares Credit Group asked about is a standing reference for the next veterinary services deal (Part 04 section D).

How current are the public signals, and can they be read again?

Public pages were read on 30 September 2026 and public series retrieved on 28 September 2026, and the same sources can be read again at any date.

Ratings, review counts, open roles and posted prices move. The value used is the one read on the date given (A-P2), and a later reading on the same definitions shows movement since that date (Part 09 section H). The computation notes C-PUB-1 to C-PUB-16 in Part 09 section G give the method for each figure computed from public data, so each can be computed again on the same basis.

Who prepared this document, and how can CreditSwan be reached?

CreditSwan prepared it for the Ares Credit Group credit team.

A question on any figure can be put by its reference, which resolves in Part 09 section F or Part 09 section G, and a question on a reading by its code, M1 to ST4. CreditSwan can be reached at creditswan.com · sales@creditswan.com.

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